

**738**  
**PRACTICAL**  
**EXERCISES**

PETER GIANNATOS

# **EVERYONE'S FIRST CHESS WORKBOOK**

NEW IN CHESS

**FUNDAMENTAL TACTICS AND  
CHECKMATES FOR IMPROVERS**



# **Everyone's First Chess Workbook**

**Peter Giannatos**

**Everyone's First Chess Workbook**

**Fundamental Tactics and Checkmates for Improvers – 738  
Practical Exercises**

**New In Chess 2021**

## **Dedication**

To my first chess coach, Saul Jeremy O'Conner.



## **Acknowledgements**

To my friends, family and colleagues who assisted me with the proof reading, troubleshooting, and critiquing the book.

To New in Chess and Chessable for giving me the opportunity to share my knowledge with the world.

© 2021 New In Chess

Published by New In Chess, Alkmaar, The Netherlands

[www.newinchess.com](http://www.newinchess.com)

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without the prior written permission from the publisher.

Cover design: Buro Blikgoed

Editing, typesetting, supervision: Frank Erwich

Proofreading: Peter Boel

Production: Sandra Keetman, Anton Schermer

Have you found any errors in this book?

Please send your remarks to [editors@newinchess.com](mailto:editors@newinchess.com). We will collect all relevant corrections on the Errata page of our website [www.newinchess.com](http://www.newinchess.com) and implement them in a possible next edition.

ISBN: 978-90-5691-988-7

# Contents

[Foreword](#)

[Preface](#)

[Introduction](#)

## [\*\*Part I General Board Visualization\*\*](#)

[Chapter 1 Capturing Free Pieces](#)

[Chapter 2 Counting Attackers and Defenders](#)

[Chapter 3 Intro to Defense](#)

[Chapter 4 Assorted Checkmates in One](#)

## [\*\*Part II Introduction to Chess Tactics\*\*](#)

[Chapter 5 Forks](#)

[Chapter 6 Pins](#)

[Chapter 7 Skewer](#)

[Chapter 8 Discovered Attack](#)

[Chapter 9 Discovered Check and Double Check](#)

[Chapter 10 Removing the Guard](#)

[Chapter 11 In-Between Move](#)

[Chapter 12 Decoy](#)

[Chapter 13 Overloaded](#)

[Chapter 14 X-Ray](#)

[Chapter 15 Interference](#)

[Chapter 16 Trapping Pieces](#)

[Chapter 17 Defense/Recognizing Threats](#)

### **[Part III Intermediate Checkmates and Combinations](#)**

[Chapter 18 Assorted Checkmates in Two](#)

[Chapter 19 Themed Checkmate Patterns](#)

[Chapter 20 Combinations/Setting up Tactics](#)

[Chapter 21 Finish like the World Champions](#)

### **[Part IV Solutions to Exercises](#)**

# Foreword

As a chess coach, I have answered thousands of questions on every imaginable topic related to chess improvement. At first, I struggled to provide succinct and meaningful responses even to the most straightforward queries: 'What is the best book on positional chess?' 'How many puzzles per day should I solve?' 'How do I learn theoretical endgames without dying of boredom?'

Gradually, I developed the ability to assist my students in formulating a training regimen that suited their level, time constraints, and learning style. With over a decade of teaching experience under my belt, there is almost no question that leaves me stumped. I am confident that I can point my students to the best book on positional chess at their level (and no, it is not a certain volume called *Mastering Positional Chess*) or estimate the number of puzzles that they should aim for in a day. I have no problem telling a talented young student's parents which tournaments I think their son or daughter should travel to over the summer.

Yet, there is one question that continues to bedevil me to this day. It was first posed to me years ago by the father of a talented girl (I will refer to her as Emily for the sake of privacy) whom I was teaching at the time. After showing a lot of promise in her first few months, Emily had gotten stuck at a rating of approximately 700, unable to make further progress for over a year.

At our initial consultation, her father expressed frustration that she seemed to solve basic puzzles effortlessly during a training session, yet the simplest tactical and mating patterns eluded her during

tournaments. She would spot hanging pieces and checkmating patterns with ease during their casual blitz games, but blunder those very same pieces and miss those very same checkmates when a clock and a scoresheet were added. On my way home, I searched every corner of my mind for an explanation to this inconsistency. The only plausible theory I came up with was that Emily's weakness lay primarily in the realm of pattern recognition. During the game, no one taps you on the shoulder and politely notifies you when your tactical detector should be going off. Emily's tactical detector was malfunctioning.

This is a problem shared by many players in Emily's rating range. Chess enthusiasts both young and old who climb the very first steps toward chess mastery with relative ease often get stuck at a kind of improvement no-man's land, when one must learn to consistently spot basic patterns and apply them at the board. The book you hold in your hands is, to my knowledge, one of the first attempts to help those who find themselves stuck in this difficult spot.

As the author, my good friend FM Peter Giannatos, phrases it in his introduction, 'developing keen tactical vision is important, but there are very few resources which compile the exercises in a structured and exhaustive way that is conducive to developing the student's board vision.' Those last two words – board vision – are the most important ones in the sentence. Board vision is exactly what Emily needed in order to cross the barrier to the next level. And after carefully examining this book's contents, I am supremely confident that this book would have helped her do just that. Indeed, this book will be tremendously helpful whether you are looking to improve your knowledge and recognition of the most basic patterns that make up tactical mastery or advance your ability to spot and calculate longer sequences and calculations.

Tactical puzzle compilations exist by the basinful. This book is not just another puzzle compilation. Most puzzle books contain hundreds of puzzles that are haphazardly sorted by theme. They are certainly useful in helping to build rote tactical vision, but online tactics servers such as ChessTempo.com essentially do the same thing, in a fashion more convenient and accessible to the average player. Peter has broken down each chapter into well-thought out topics and themes that are frequently glossed over or improperly defined in puzzle books. Each chapter contains two different types of exercises: the guided exercises arm the solver with key elements of the position that assist in finding the solution, while the test exercises give the conscientious solver an opportunity to fully master the theme.

I have reviewed every single exercise in the book, and I can attest to the tremendous care and detail that Peter has poured into their creation and selection. The problems are clean, without unnecessary fluff that detracts from their instructive value or clunky alternate solutions. The more difficult problems often ask the reader to find a preliminary move that sets up the combination, an addition that I find to be incredibly helpful in building the kind of board vision which is helpful in real games. The solutions are equally clean and well-written. In short, there is not a single exercise that does not substantively build up the reader's understanding of the theme at hand. There are also not many books that are geared both toward a player at the very start of his or her tactical journey, as well as a more seasoned beginner who is looking to master more complex tactical patterns and 2-3 move combinations.

But perhaps the most innovative quality of the book is the fact that it is not a book at all! Okay, I may have scared you there... it is a book, but it is more accurate to refer to it as a workbook. I cannot transmit the number of times that I have assigned exercises from a book, only to find that the solutions were either illegibly scribbled in the margins or written in some mythical 'solutions notebook' that never quite seemed to materialize. This book eliminates the problem by providing ample dedicated space beside each exercise. This is



tremendously helpful for both students and coaches, who can assign homework from the book without having to worry about being unable to review the solutions.

As Peter's close friend, I watched him labor over this book for many months. The effort that he put into it shines through on every page. It is now up to you, dear reader, to expend the same effort to solve these exercises and learn the lessons contained therein as Peter expended in curating and organizing them. If you are willing to do so conscientiously, if you are willing to solve and sometimes revisit each exercise and explanation in the book, you may very well find that your stay in chess no man's land will be a short one.

*GM Daniel Naroditsky*

*Charlotte, North Carolina, USA*

*May 2021*

# Preface

While I was teaching countless classes to thousands of beginner students over the last decade, it had always been apparent to me that there was not enough organized material to assist students in improving their board vision at an early stage. Board vision, or the ability to recognize opportunities on the chess board, is the most important skill a chess player can learn. The better one's tactical and calculation ability, the better of a chess player they can become.

Everyone recommends 'doing tactics' or maybe you have even heard the saying 'chess is 99% tactics'. Developing keen tactical vision is indeed important, but there are very few resources which compile the exercises in a structured and exhaustive way that is conducive to developing the student's board vision. Most students are solving tactics using books or online tactics servers that provide no structure or explanation. In this workbook, I strive to provide a step-by-step guide to improving board vision by breaking down each topic into separate chapters, as well as by providing the necessary number of supplemental problems to represent each concept.

In addition, many of the resources available were not actually 'workbooks'. When I reached out to New in Chess about my interest in writing this book, I specifically asked for it to be formatted as a workbook. They graciously agreed to structuring it as a traditional workbook, which is a bit different from what they have done in the past. My desire to create a traditional workbook is so students can enhance their board vision and tactical skills by combining reading, writing and comprehension skills. You can read more on the value of this in the introduction.

Lastly, I had a great desire to create a workbook that everyone could use. One of the most beautiful facts about chess is that age does not play a vital role in one's ability. Throughout my chess career, I have seen eight-year-olds that had the same rating as players who had been playing for decades. The need for quality fundamental material does not discriminate based on age or any other factor. Regardless of when the student is making their first strides in chess, this book will provide the necessary and fundamental knowledge they need to becoming better at visualizing the board.

This resource is something that I wish I had years ago and hope that it will greatly assist in providing coaches and students alike with the resources they need to establish a fundamental level of checkmating and tactical abilities. I have full confidence that students, of all ages, who genuinely read the explanations and solve all the problems this book will see a drastic improvement in board vision and in turn their chess-playing ability.

## **Who is this Book For?**

Any student who knows the rules of the game but is having trouble visualizing opportunities on the board. The only assumption for this book is that students must have learned all the fundamental basics of the game, such as: piece movement, board set-up, check, checkmate, stalemate, and the special rules (castling and en passant capturing).

This workbook is great for students who are:

- Unrated – no tournament experience but know the rules of chess.
- Rated under 1000 over-the-board.
- Rated under 1300 online.

By reading the explanations and solving all the puzzles in this book, students will:

1. Gain a more structured approach to thinking tactically.
2. Add to their pattern recognition.
3. Refine their problem-solving ability.
4. Enhance their overall vision of the chess board.
5. Increase their overall playing ability.

*Peter Giannatos*

*Charlotte, North Carolina, USA*

*May 2021*

# Introduction

## Goal of this Book

Before you can seriously progress as a chess player, you must first develop better board vision. Board vision is instrumental to chess growth, no matter what level. As you progress as a player, there will always be an emphasis on improving board vision and calculation. Once you have the necessary tactical foundation, you will be able to continue your growth by pushing yourself to go deeper in calculation. For any chess player, myself included, one of the key areas of improvement is depth and accuracy of calculation. No matter how experienced you are, there is always room to improve your board vision.

Strategy, the other element of chess, is not featured in this book. While this is important, it's best to first learn how to visualize the chess board. Strategic ideas are certainly important but require great precision and board vision to successfully carry out. Before you dig deeper into chess strategy, it's important to first learn how to command your army.

This book is designed to help you organize your thoughts and develop a better way of approaching tactical situations. In addition, the organization and repetition of concepts will also help you better remember patterns, which is instrumental to enhancing your total vision of the chess board.

## **Book Sections**

### **•Part I – General board visualization**

•This part deals with fundamental concepts related to board vision: taking free pieces, counting attackers and defenders, basic piece defense, and checkmates in one move.

### **•Part II – Introduction to tactical vision**

•Tactics are often surprising and abstract ways of obtaining an advantage in chess. Each tactic is assigned its own chapter along with relevant problems. So that you don't get carried away with game-winning moves, I have also added a special chapter on defense.

### **•Part III – Intermediate checkmates and combinations**

•The last part focuses on winning the game in two moves or more. In this part, you will practice checkmates in two, learn advanced checkmate patterns, and practise combinations. This part of the book is designed to bring all the concepts from Parts I and II together. The ability to combine different patterns and themes into game- winning sequences is the final step from beginner to intermediate tournament player.

## What's Different?

- Chapters are broken down into two sections: a guided practice section and a test section.
- In the guided practice section, I help you solve the problems by pointing out things to look for in each position. This is designed to help you develop your ability to identify the specific patterns in each chapter. Once I feel like I've helped you enough, you'll be on your own in the test section.
- Each chapter is assigned a defined topic.
- There are an exhaustive number of puzzles to represent each topic. Repetition of the patterns is an essential key to learning. I have included the number of puzzles I feel is necessary to learn the concepts at hand.
- A place to write your answer.
- In this book, you will have to write your complete answer using chess notation. That means both what you will play, and, if a puzzle takes more than one move, what your opponent will play. One reason for this is so that you can practice taking notation, an essential skill for tournament play. Another reason, and arguably even more important, is that by having to log both your move and the opposing move, you push yourself to find your opponent's moves



and not just your own. The combination of finding winning moves, and the best defenses to those moves, will improve your visualization and calculation abilities drastically.

## **How to Use the Book**

- The book is organized in the order that you should learn the concepts;
- Always read the text and example problem at the beginning of each chapter;
- Solve all the problems in the chapter before checking the answer key;
- Give yourself at least five minutes to solve each problem before skipping one;
- If you get a problem wrong or are unable to solve it, set the problem up on a physical chess board and try again;
- Write your complete answers in the book.

## **Board Vision**

I break down board vision into the following categories:

1. The ability to visualize the movement of the pieces through a series of moves;
2. The ability to visualize the chess board at the completion of those moves.

Helping beginner and intermediate players develop these types of board vision is almost completely neglected in chess literature. Too often, fundamental concepts are taken for granted by chess authors. As a coach, I think there is nothing more important than learning the fundamentals properly.

## **Importance of Tactics**

The purpose of tactics is to obtain an advantage and/or to help you prevent your opponent from gaining one. Tactics can often be abstract and overlooked since they are not always the most obvious moves. The result of a successful tactic could be game ending, like checkmate, or it could mean winning material. Tactics may also be used to prevent your opponent from winning the game.

## **Note to Coaches**

Learning can be broken down into four main categories:

1. Visual;
2. Auditory;
3. Kinesthetic (hands-on);
4. Reading and Writing.

The major format difference of this book, compared to others, is that students are able to write their answers in the book. I would not allow students a pass on this step unless the student has not yet learned how to read or write. Analytical comprehension goes hand in hand with chess, as students are both surveying and attempting to comprehend the position. The literary comprehension comes in the form of the guided hints (reading) and the notation keeping (writing). Part of the educational value of the book is that students can practice both analytical and literary comprehension. The analytical and literary comprehension aspects used in the book are known tools in education.

According to the study Read to Write by Graham & Hebert (2010), 'evidence shows that having students write about the material they read does enhance their reading abilities.' Later in the same section they go on to add, 'Answering questions about a text can be done verbally, but there is greater benefit from performing such activities in writing. Writing answers to text questions makes them more memorable, as writing an answer provides a second form of rehearsal.'

Citation: Read to Write by Graham & Hebert 2010

After introducing a topic to the student, have them attempt all the supplemental problems in the chapter before moving on to the next. For each problem missed by the student, you should set up the puzzle on a physical board and provide a leading hint. Setting up the problems on a physical chess board (kinesthetic) can be a great learning tool as it offers a different dimensional perspective (visual). Of course, there is no great way for me to create auditory learning through a physical book. This workbook will likely make it to Chessable, where a guided video course may be created adding even greater value for the auditory learner.

I hope that you find this resource useful for your students. I have spent the last decade teaching students of all ages the fundamental basics and cannot tell you how much I wish I had a resource like this during those years. By having your students work through this book, they will learn the fundamental thought processes, concepts, and patterns related to tactical thinking.

## **General Advice for Students**

Chess is an extremely fun game to play and learn, but it's also difficult. You will be a student of the game forever. Having said that, most of us want to improve and there is only one well known way to do that – hard work. I have yet to come across a student that puts in the hard work and does not increase their level of play. Of course, as with most things, there is always an upper bound. All of us have so much more to learn before we reach our limit.

In this book, we focus on the fundamental building blocks of board vision: checkmates and tactics. If I could recommend one sure way

for you to become a better chess player, it would be increasing your checkmating and tactical ability. Fortunately, you are holding the right book in your hands to get you started with that!

The need to work on your tactical and calculation abilities will not go away after reading this book. There are always new patterns and themes to learn. Having said that, by going through this book, you will have the necessary foundation to take on any puzzle that comes your way from here on out.

I sincerely hope you will enjoy going through this book and I know it will be useful for you. Carefully go through each chapter, and do not rush. It's okay to get problems wrong, just be sure you understand why before moving on to the next chapter. If you give this book your all, and seriously try to solve each puzzle, I am confident that your tactical ability will be that of a four-digit OTB rating level. Have fun, improve your skills and be sure to write me success letters after you complete the book!

## **Terms and General Knowledge**

### **Algebraic Chess Notation**

K = King

Q = Queen

R = Rook

B = Bishop

N = Knight

x = captures

+ = check

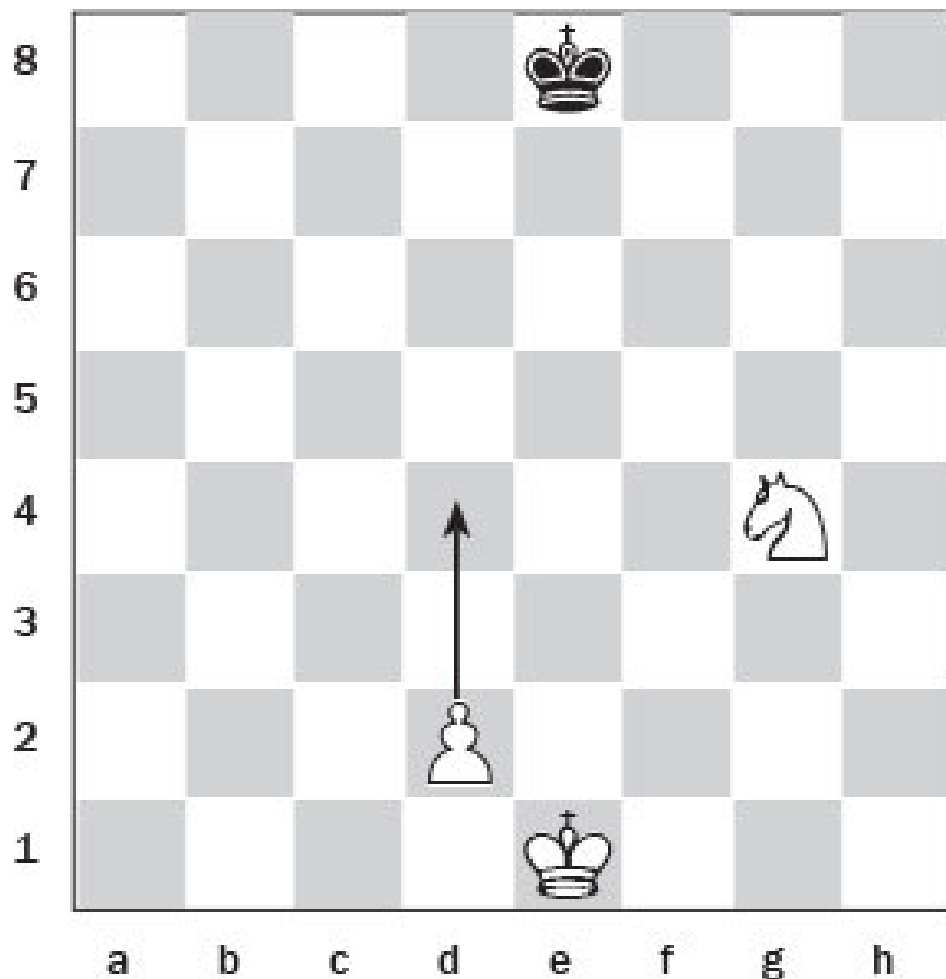
# = checkmate

0-0 = Kingside castle

0-0-0 = Queenside castle

note: Moves without a capital letter are assumed to be pawn moves.

### Notation Example 1

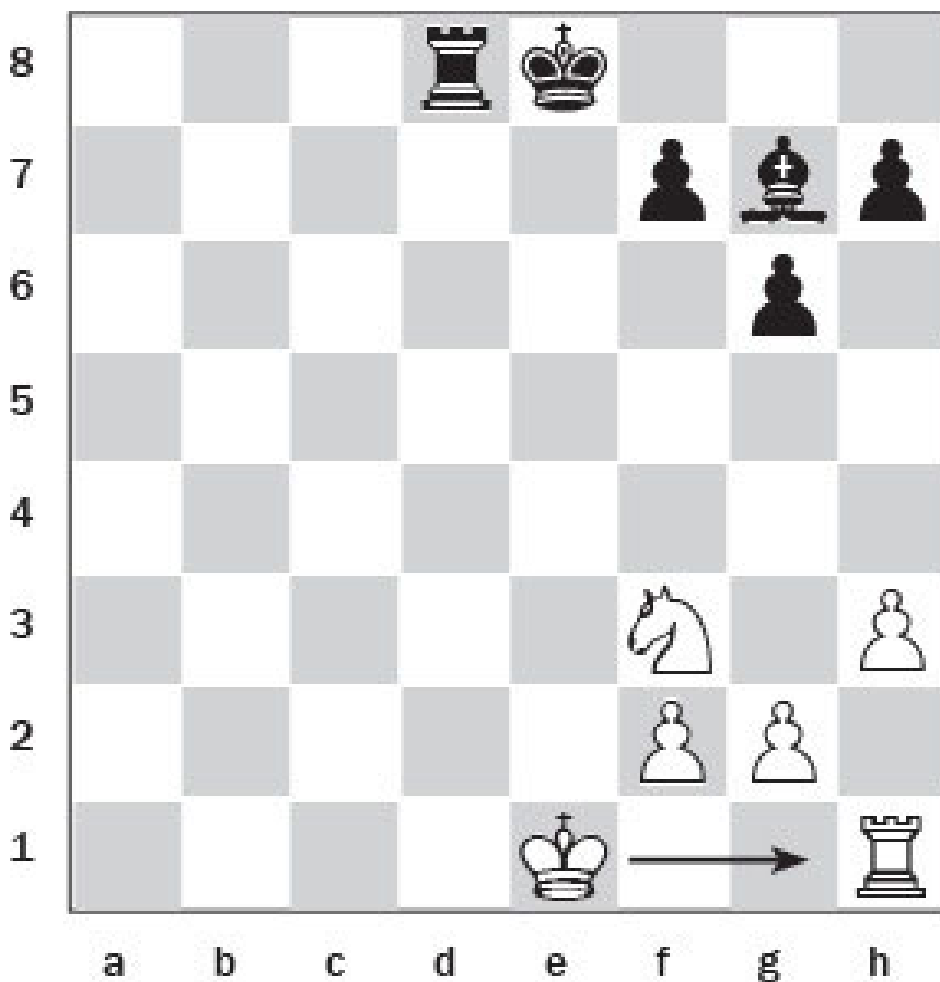


If White wanted to move the pawn as shown above, the notation would be written as:

**1.d4**

Notice that with pawn moves there is no capital letter before the coordinate square. Only the destination square of the piece needs to be written. Coordinate squares are always kept lowercase.

## Notation Example 2

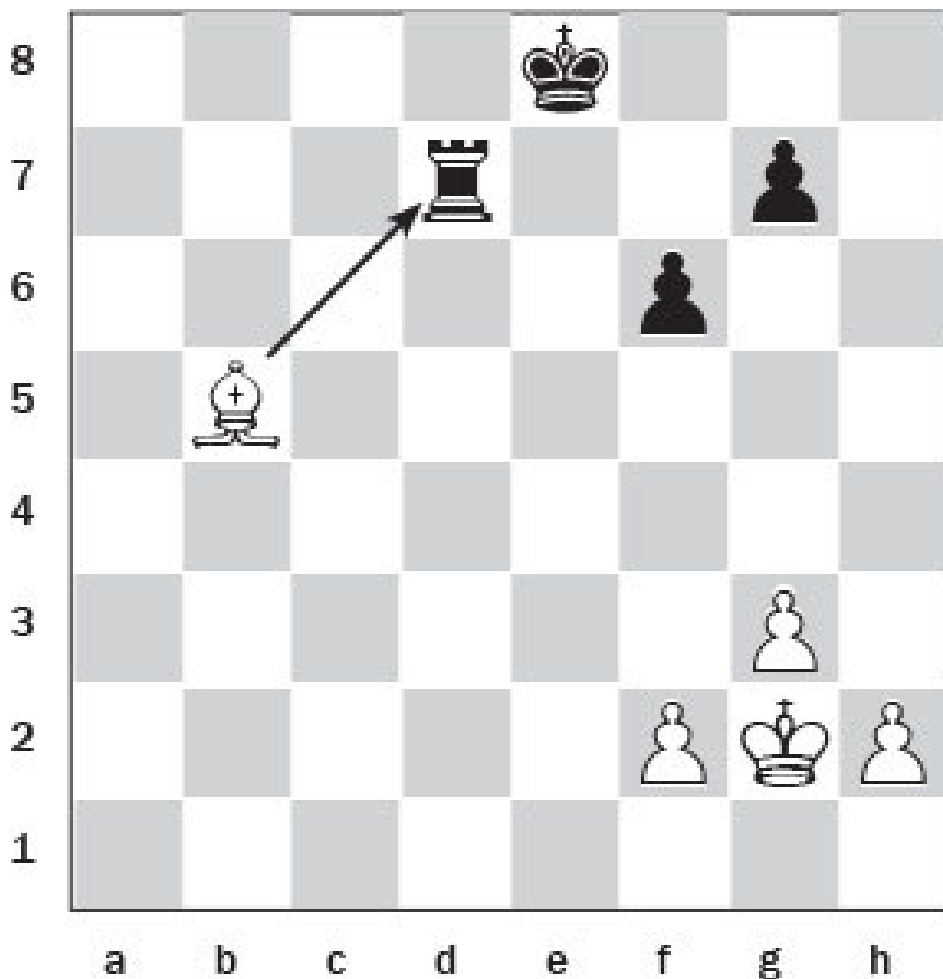


Let's suppose White wanted to castle here, the notation would be written as:

**1.0-0**

Since White castled kingside, castling is written as 0-0. If White were castling queenside, it would be written as 0-0-0.

### Notation Example 3



Let's suppose White wanted to capture the rook on d7, the notation would be written as:



## 1.Bxd7+

Since the move is a capture, White writes 'x' to show that. In addition, Black would be in check after the capture so the '+' is added to depict that. Notice that the letter 'B', for bishop, is capitalized. The piece you are moving should be written as a capital letter, the square the piece is moving to is kept lowercase.

## Relative Piece Values

King = Invaluable

Queen = 9

Rook = 5

Bishop = 3

Knight = 3

Pawn = 1

The queen and rook are classified as major pieces. The bishop and knight are classified as minor pieces.

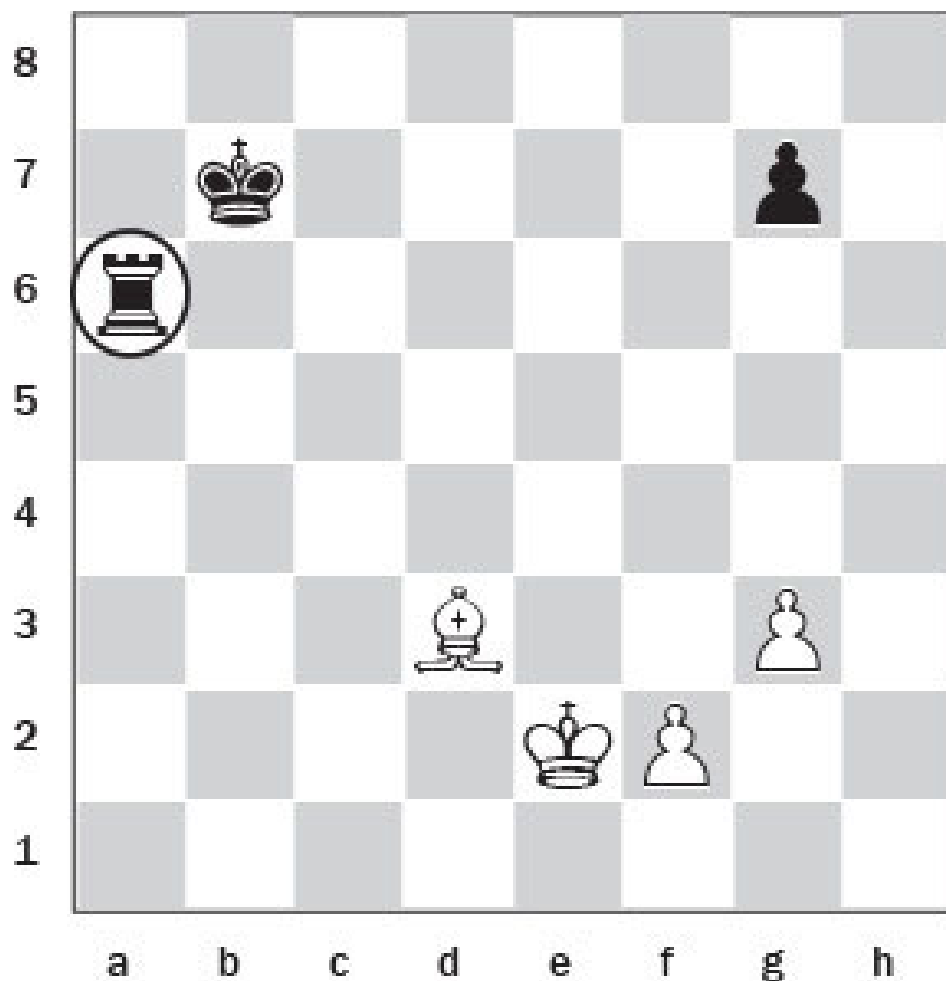
The relative values of pieces in chess are extremely important to understanding the game. When you first begin, it is typical to have an immense attachment to each piece and to try to keep all of them – that is impossible.

It is normal in a chess game for pieces to arrive in conflict with one another. Trading, or the exchanging of pieces, is going to happen regularly throughout a game. The purpose of the piece values is to

assist you with making good trades. You should not consider trading as 'losing' pieces. You are not 'losing' anything unless you make a bad trade.

Let's take a look at a few examples:

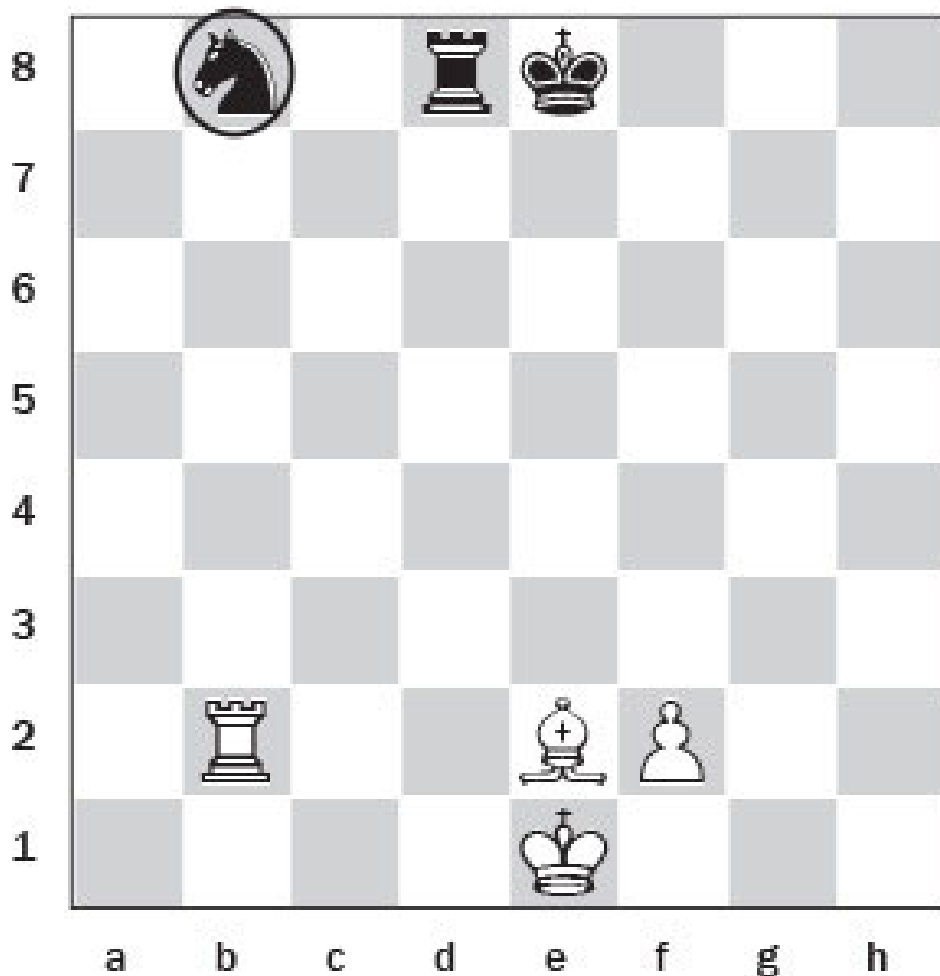
### Example 1



In this example, White could capture the rook on a6. The rook on a6 is protected by the king, which means that White would gain a rook

for a bishop in this trade. That is a good trade for White. White is getting 5 material points for the rook, while Black is only getting 3 material points in return. White should not consider this 'losing a piece', quite the opposite, White should consider this a big gain.

## Example 2



In this example, White could capture the knight on b8. The knight on b8 is protected by the rook on d8. This is a trade that White would not want to make and indeed he would lose material on the trade. If White captured the knight, they would be trading a rook (5) for only a

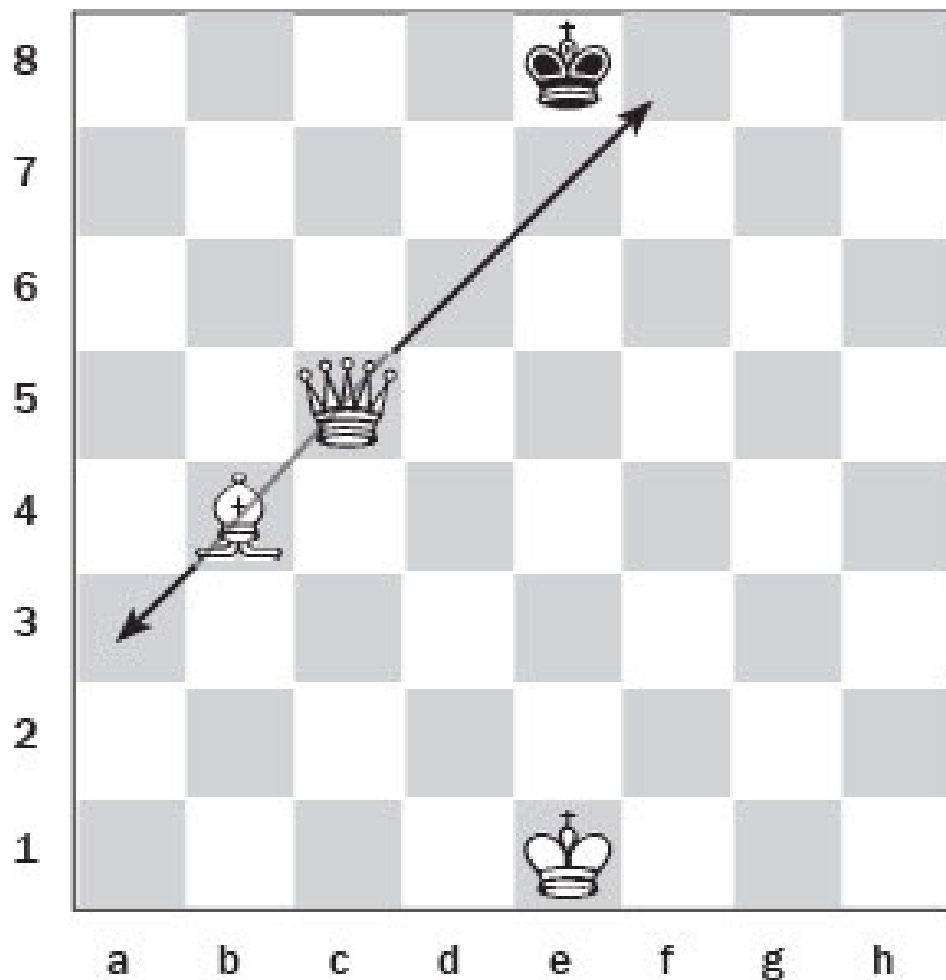
knight (3). That would be considered a bad trade and should be avoided.

The piece values are considered relative for a reason: in some special circumstances, the pieces could have greater or less value. Having said that, in most cases the point values are accurate and should be used for guidance in trading.

### **Chess Terms Regularly Used Throughout the Book**

Attack – When a piece is being threatened.

Battery – When two of your own pieces align with each other and can move along the same rank, file, or diagonal (see diagram below).



**The Exchange** – The exchange is the difference between a minor piece (knight or bishop) and a rook. For example, if White gives away a bishop but gets a rook in return, White would have ‘won the exchange’.

**Material** - The number of pieces you have.

Note to student: material is not everything in a chess game but is an extremely important factor. All else being equal, the greater your material advantage, the better chance you have of winning the game. In general, we consider a winning material advantage a 2-point material advantage or greater (see piece values on page 17).

**Hanging** – A piece that is attacked and unprotected may be referred to as a ‘hanging piece’. Example: ‘the bishop on e4 is hanging.’

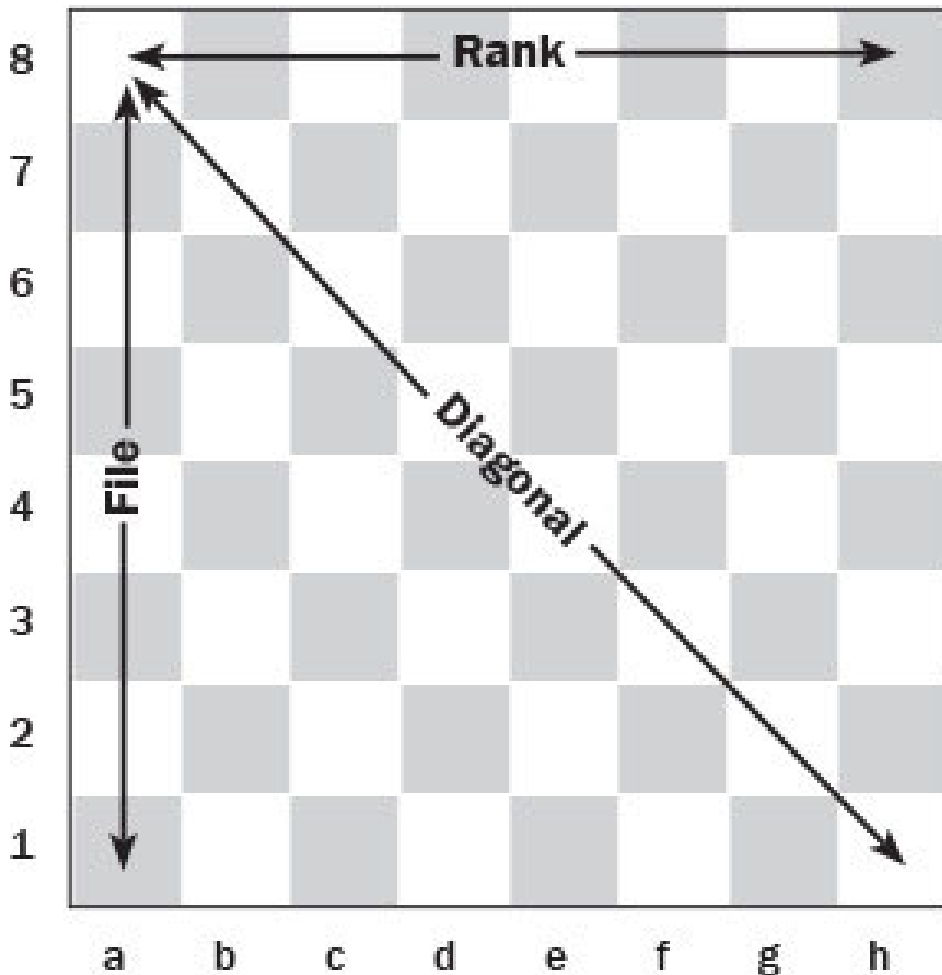
Trading – Exchange of pieces or giving one piece away for another.

## The Chess Board

Diagonals – Slanted lines that match the same color squares.

Files – Columns that run up and down the chess board. Files are represented by the letters along the side.

Ranks – Rows that run across the chess board. They are represented by the numbers along the side.



## **Workbook Solving Tips**

When solving the problems in this book, particularly in Parts II and III, you must look for forcing moves:

1. Checks;
2. Captures;
3. Threats.

**Checks should be the first thing you look for in any position. Checks are the most forcing moves possible. Being able to place your opponent in check is not inherently strong or weak, but because your opponent is forced to respond, it enables you to better calculate what may happen thereafter. Similarly, you must determine whether your own king is vulnerable to checks.**

**Captures (taking pieces) are next important for a similar reason. Captures are the second most common type of forcing move. Generally, when you capture a piece of your opponent's you can expect they would want to capture back since if they do not, they would be at a material disadvantage.**

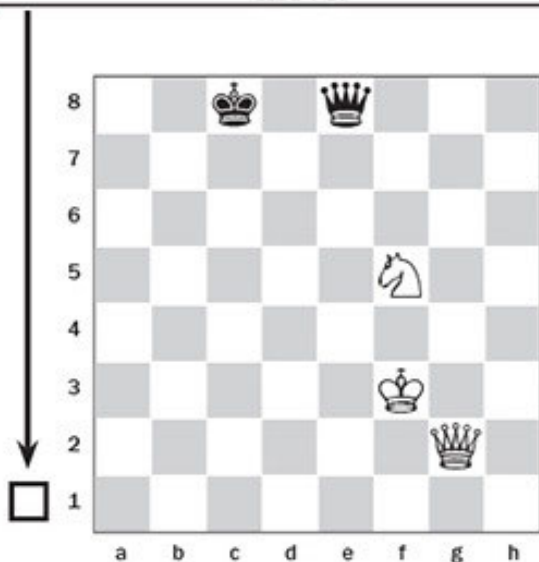
**Threats are attacks on an enemy piece or square where if ignored the player would gain a winning advantage. Most of the time, your opponent must react to a threat and thus can also be labelled as a forcing move.**

In addition to the forcing moves listed above, it will also help to pay attention to unprotected pieces. In many chess tactics, material is often won because of pieces that are not well protected. Which leads us into our first chapter, 'Taking free pieces'.

Forcing moves will be something you will have to think about in each tactical position you solve. Bookmark this page and visit it as many times as you need to!

## How to Complete the Exercises

The box in the bottom left corner of each diagram tells you whose move it is. A white box means it is White to move and a black box means it is Black to move.



Column for  
White's moves

Column for  
Black's moves

Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic. Use all lines provided.

Where hints are placed in  
guided practice sections.



Be sure to provide a complete answer by using all of the designated lines. This means in cases where there is more than one line, you must write down the move you would like to play and what move you believe the opposing side would play. I have provided the number of lines I believe is necessary to display the understanding of each puzzle.

## **PART I**

# **General Board Visualization**

In this section of the workbook, we are going to focus on the following concepts:

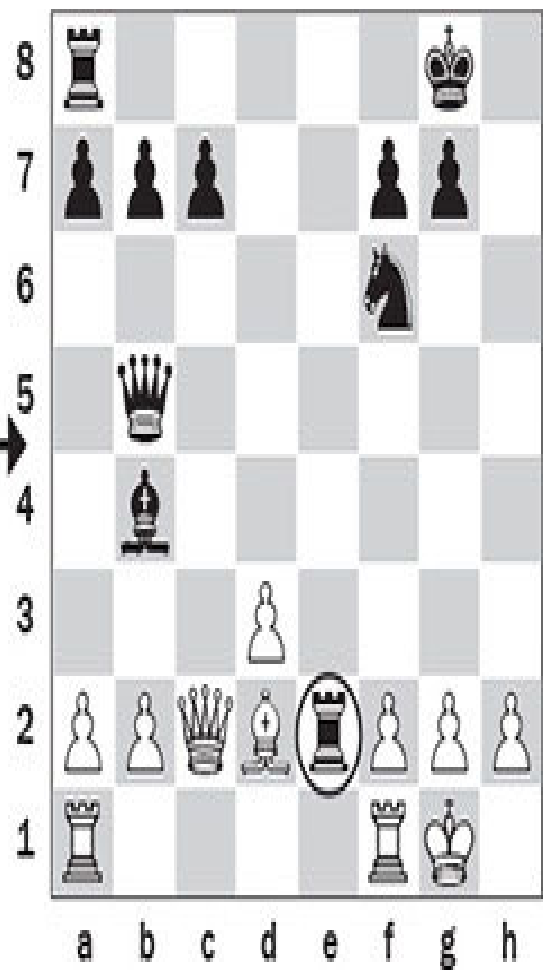
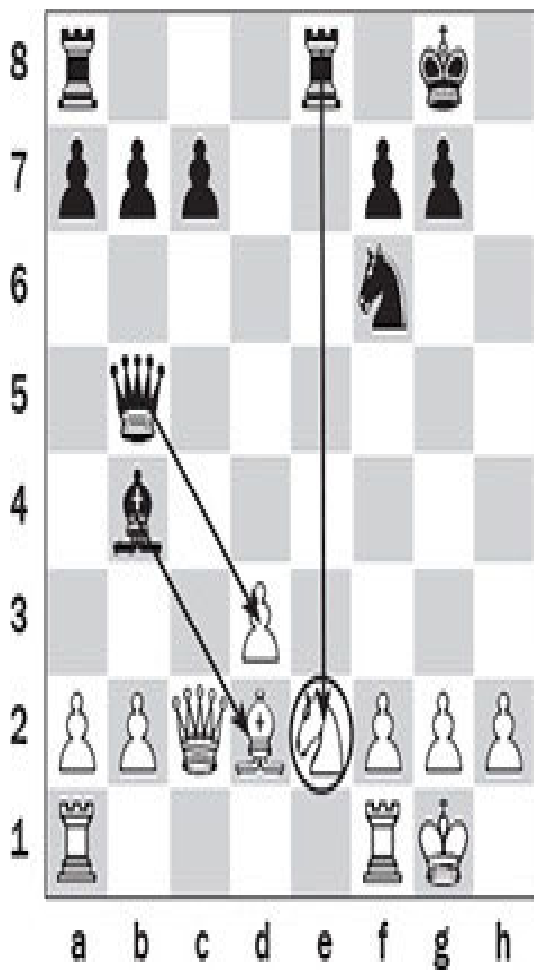
- Capturing free pieces;
- Counting attackers and defenders;
- Piece defense;
- Checkmates in one.

Before you can move on to more advanced topics, such as tactics, it is important that you are able to visualize existing opportunities on the board. While this section may be a bit easier for players who already have some experience playing, consider it a warm-up for the rest of the problems and concepts to be learned in the workbook. The concepts learned in this section are the fundamental building blocks for what is to come.

## CHAPTER 1

# Capturing Free Pieces

In this chapter we look at one of the most fundamental areas of improving board vision: taking unprotected pieces. Visualizing the chess board as a whole can be tough if you are just starting. Be sure to look at all of your pieces, near and far, and identify what they are attacking. A piece which is unprotected and can be captured for free may also be referred to as 'en prise' (än prēz).



Black is attacking a few pieces in this position:

1. The black bishop is attacking the bishop on d2.
2. The black queen is attacking the pawn on d3.
3. The black rook is attacking the knight on e2.

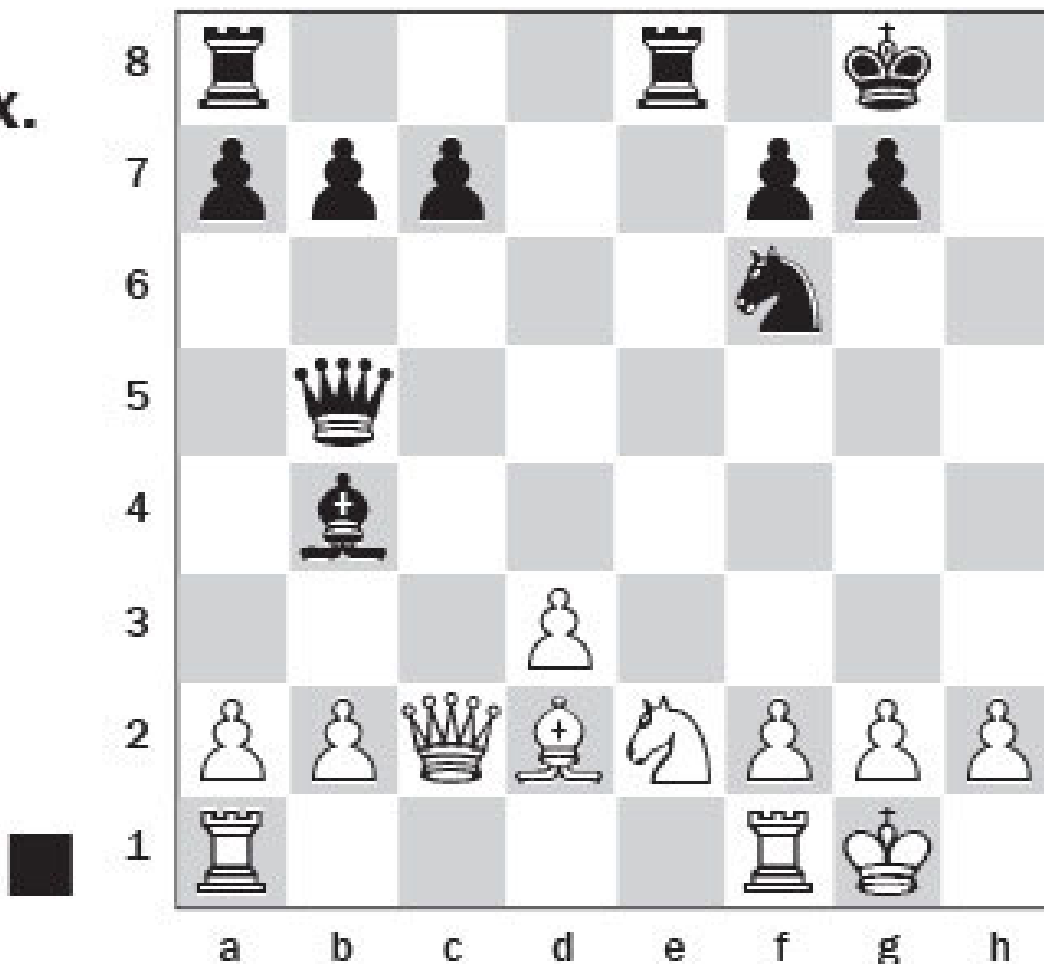
The only piece that is 'en prise', or free of protection, is the knight on e2. The others are defended by other pieces and would not count as 'free' pieces.

The best move for Black is 1...Rxe2 (see diagram 2).

Visualizing the chess board as a whole can be tough if you are just starting, so I have compiled 20 puzzles to help you identify inadequately defended pieces.

# Capture Free Pieces – Guided Practice

Ex.



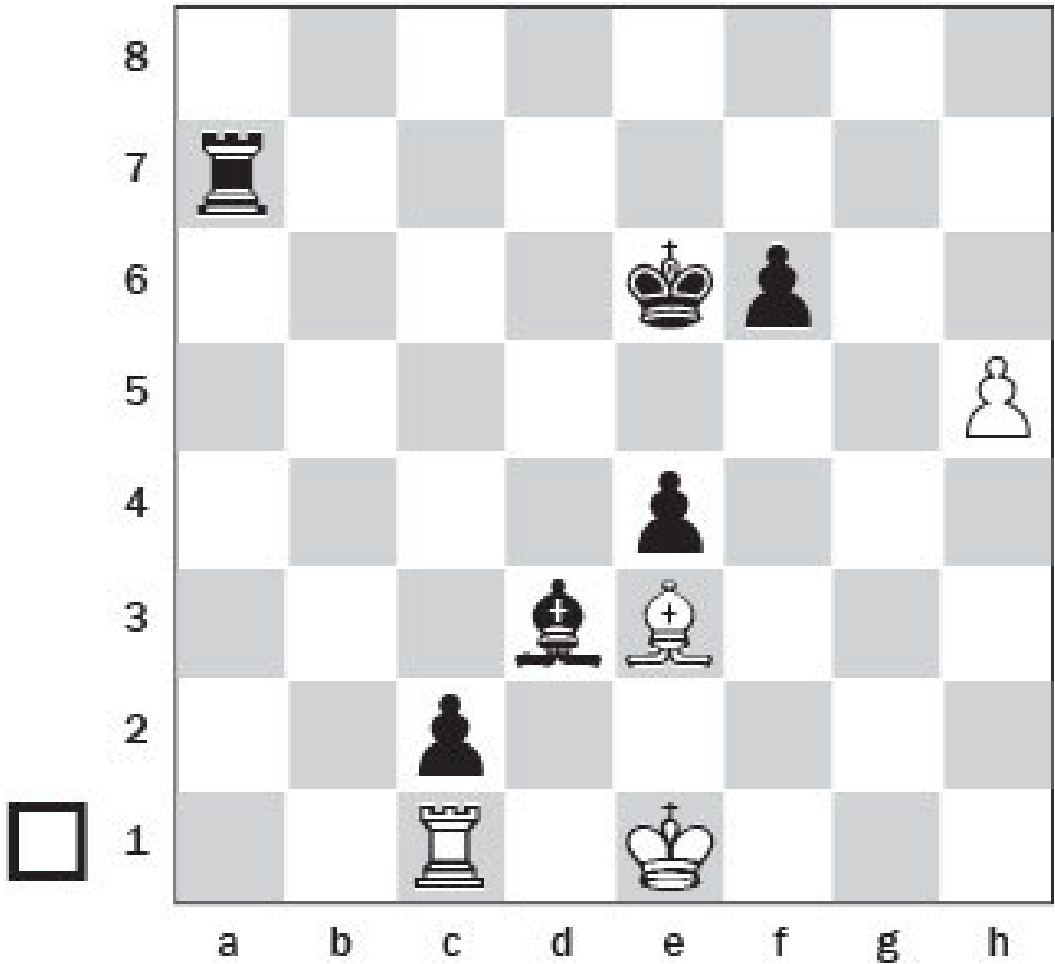
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_ Rxe2

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 1

**1**



Answer:

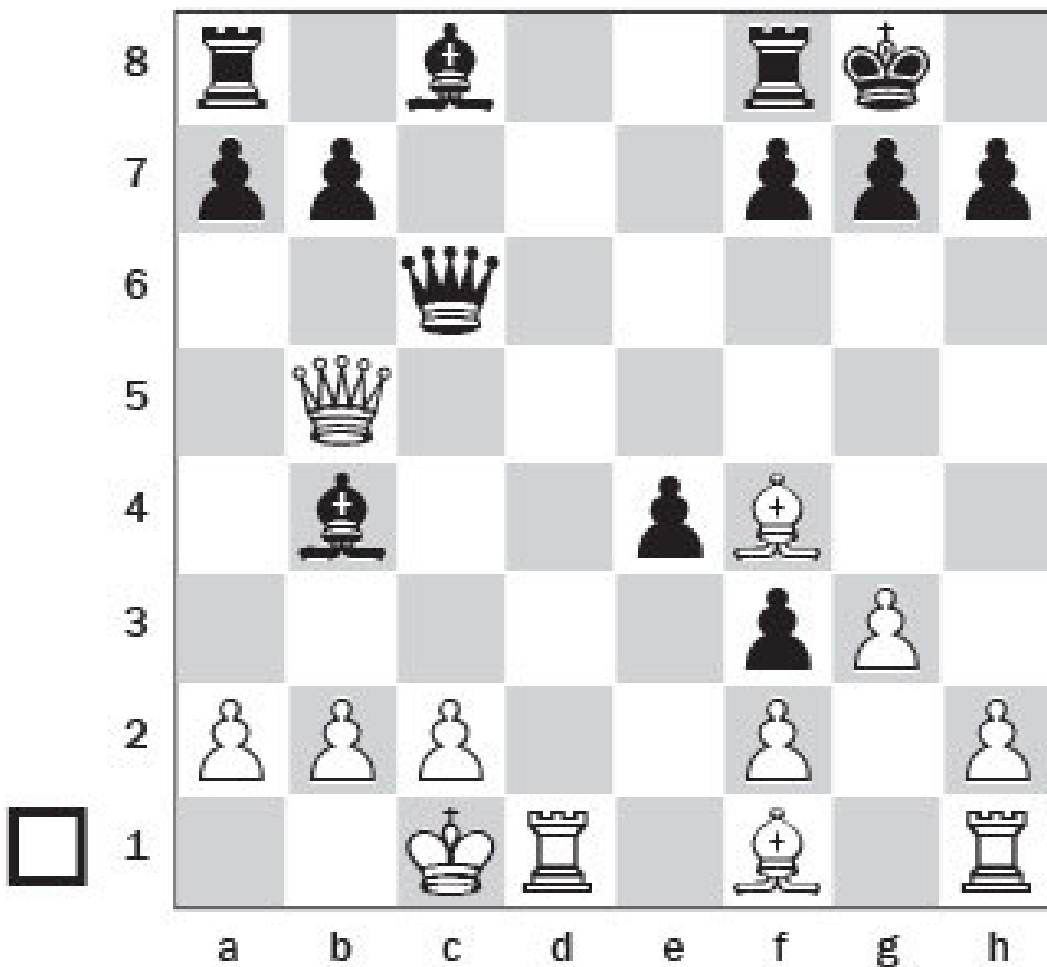
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White has several captures. Take a look at each one and find the unprotected piece.

### Exercise 2

2



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



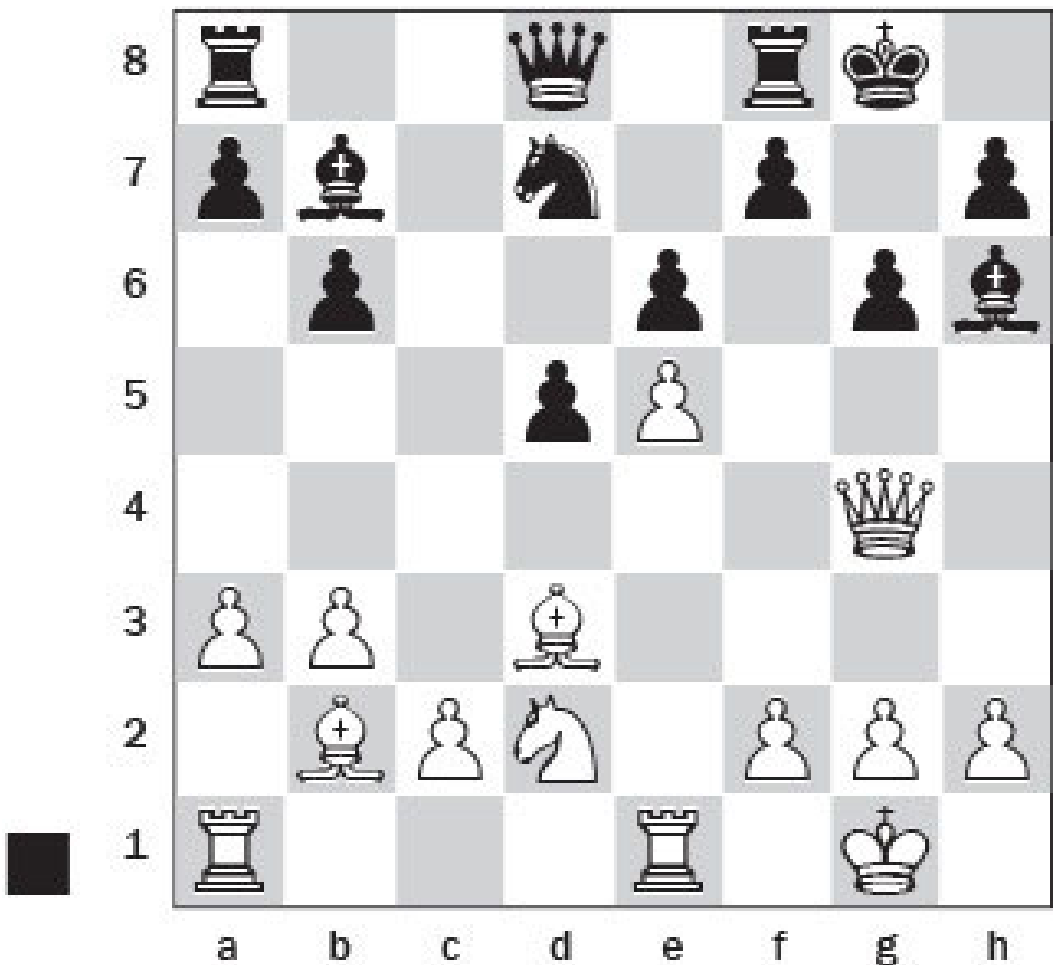
## HINT

White could capture Black's queen but it's defended by the pawn.  
Find the unprotected piece.

# Capture Free Pieces – Test

## Exercise 3

3

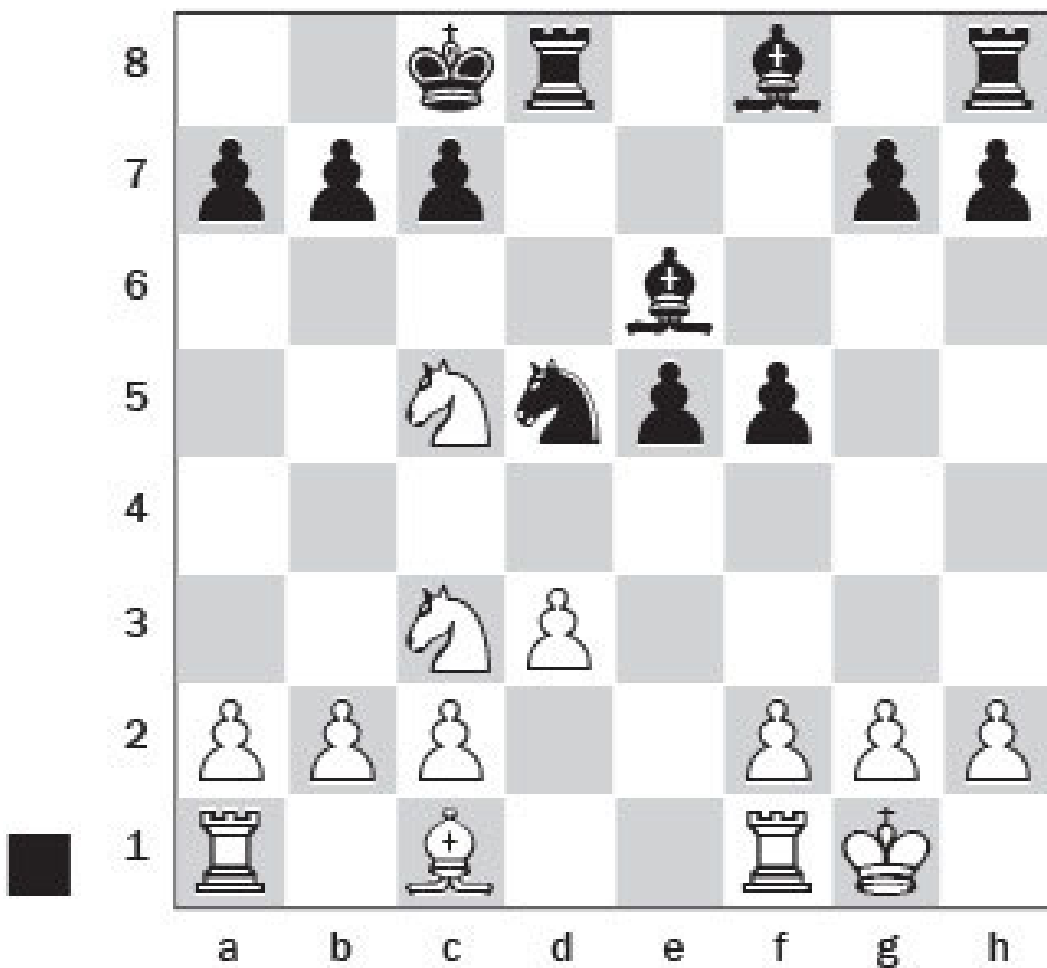


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 4

4

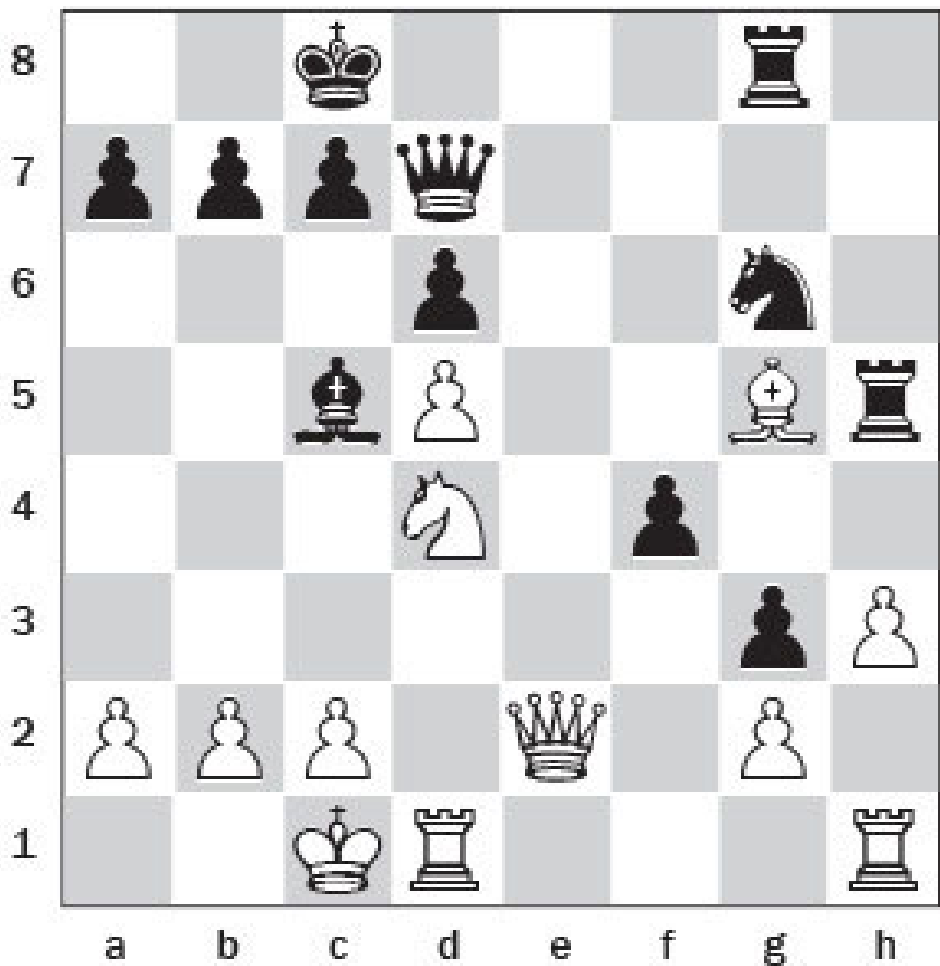


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 5

5



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 6](#)

6

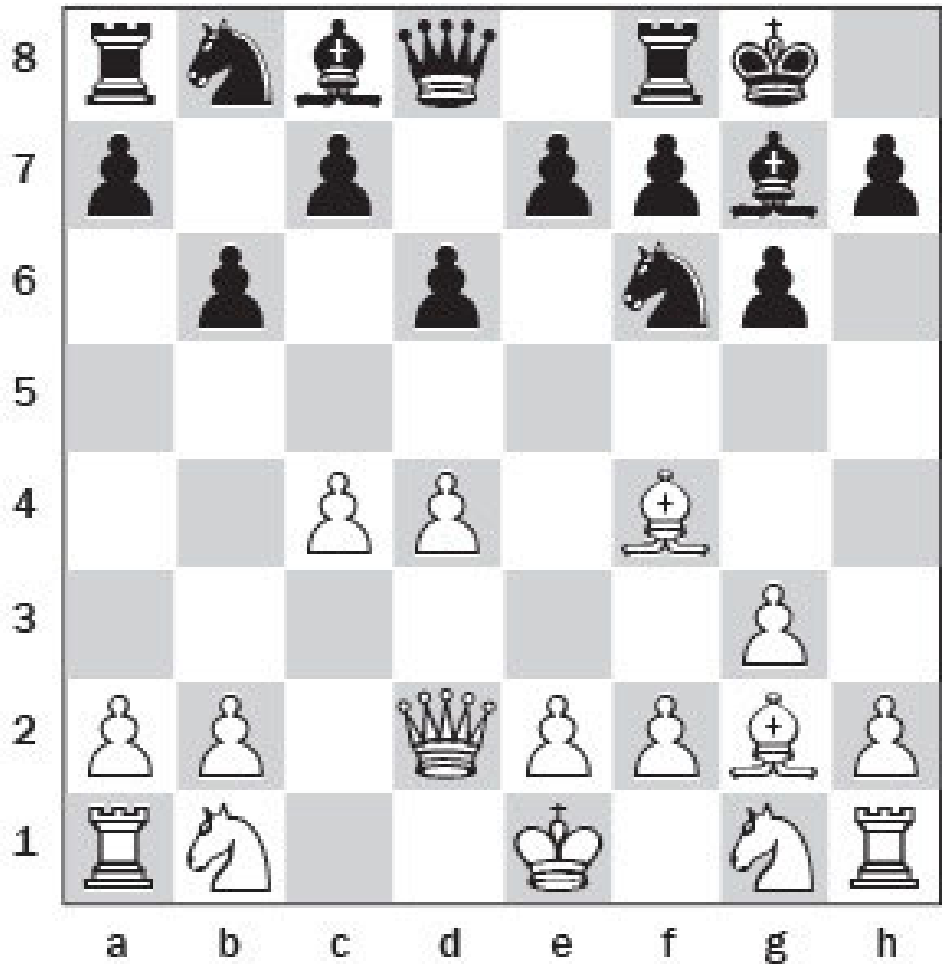


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 7](#)

7

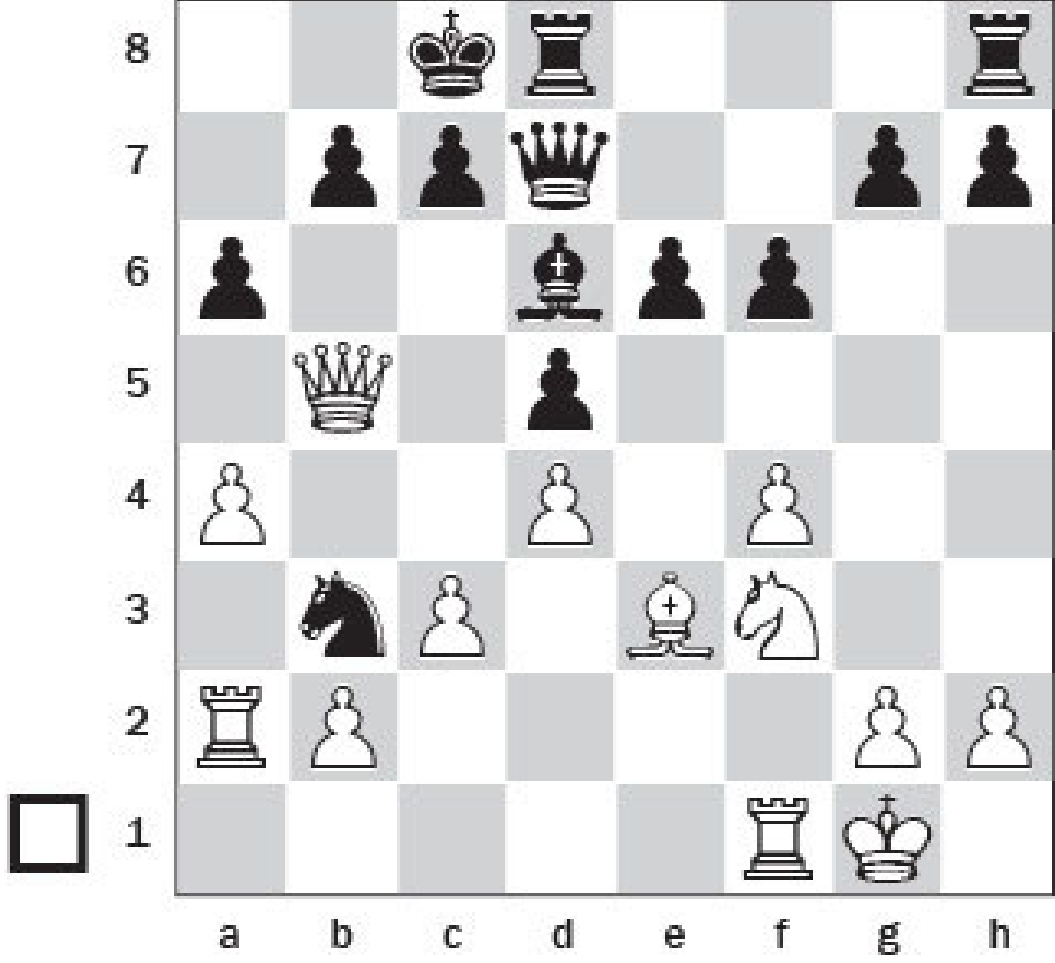


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 8

8

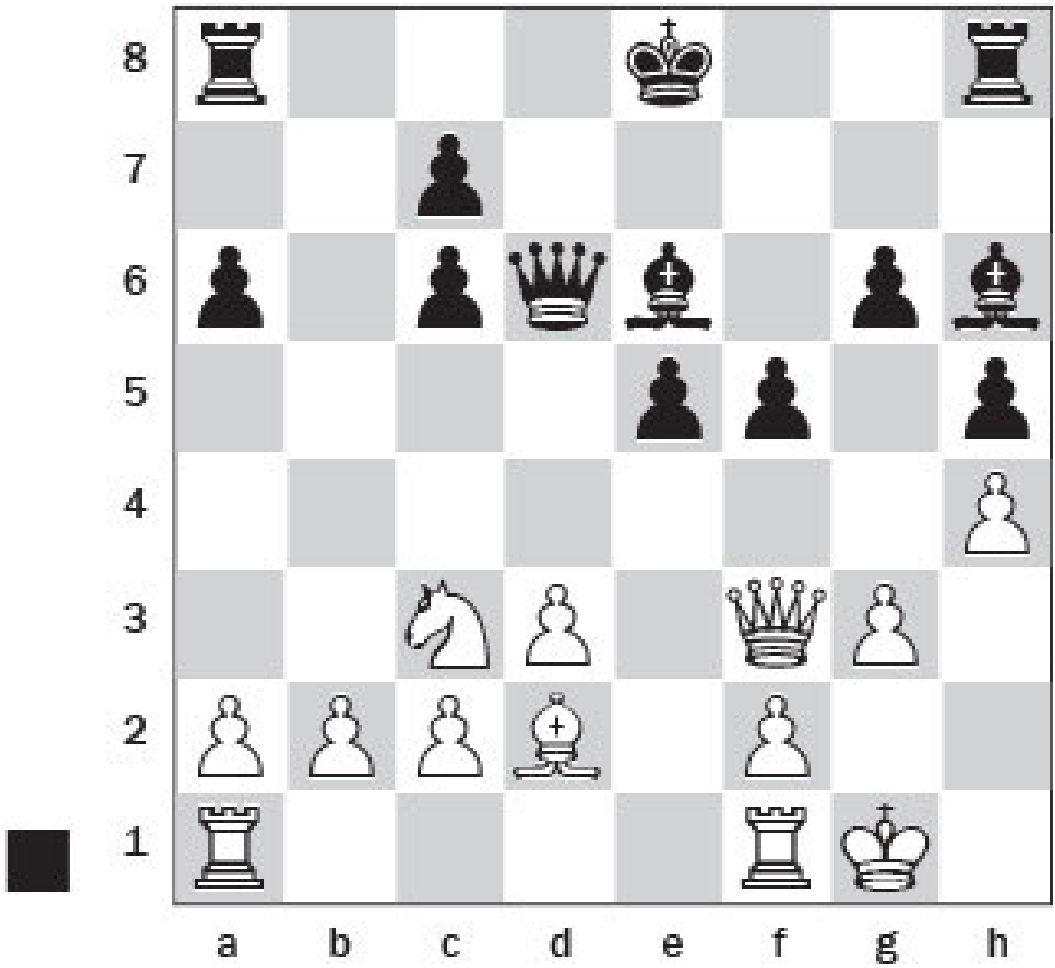


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 9

9



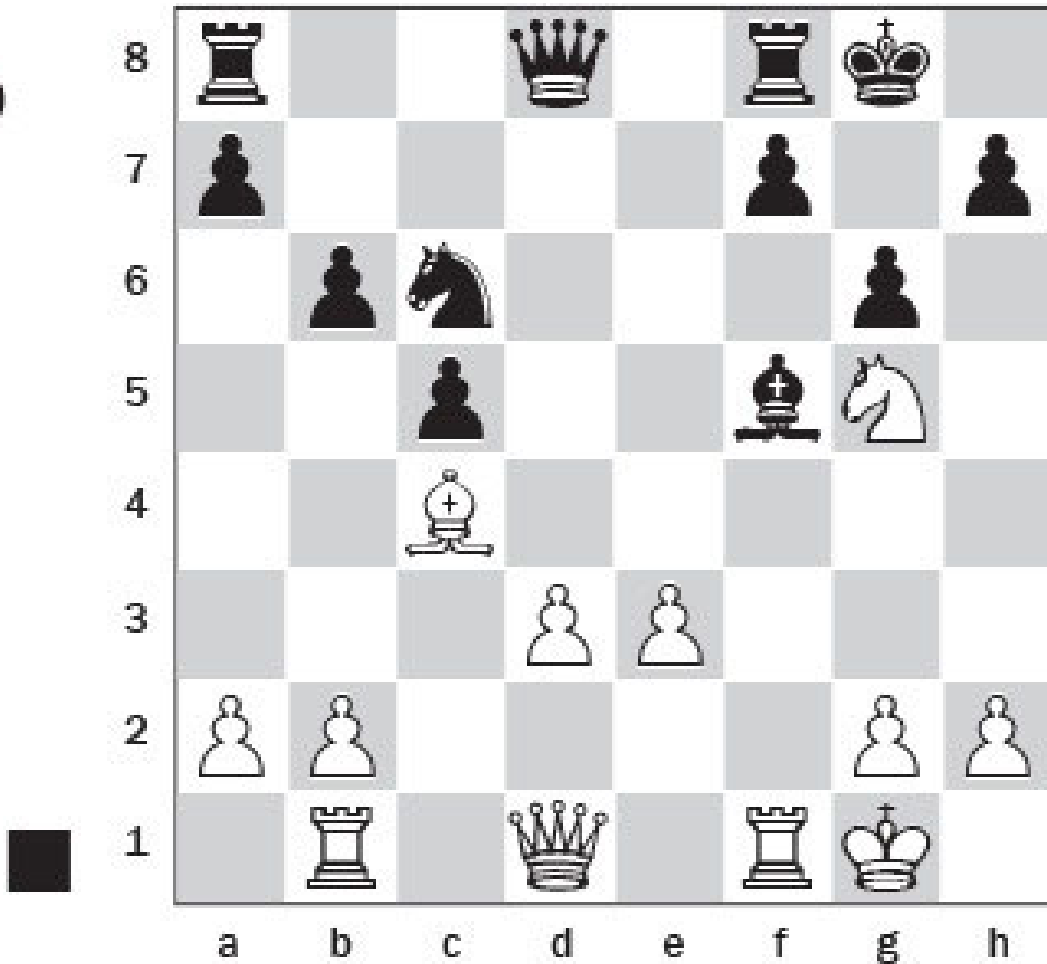
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 10](#)



10

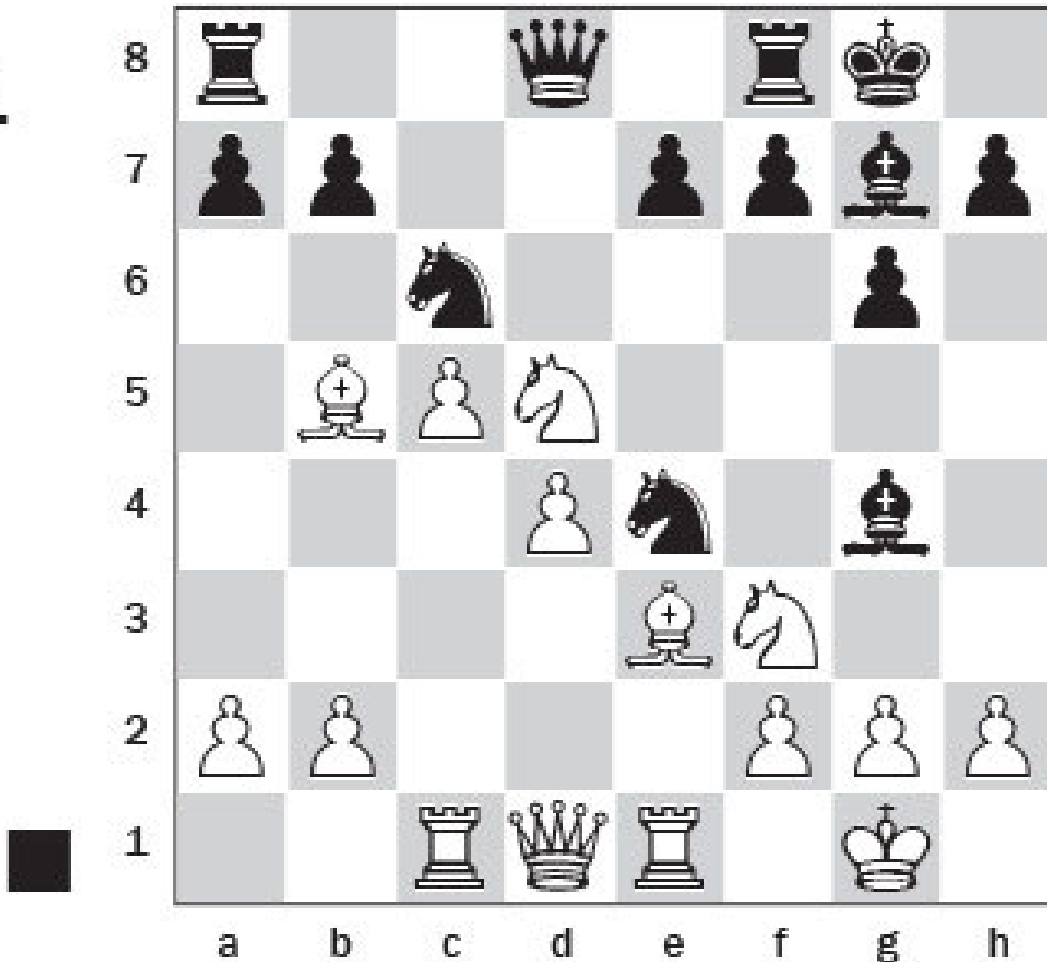


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 11](#)

# 11

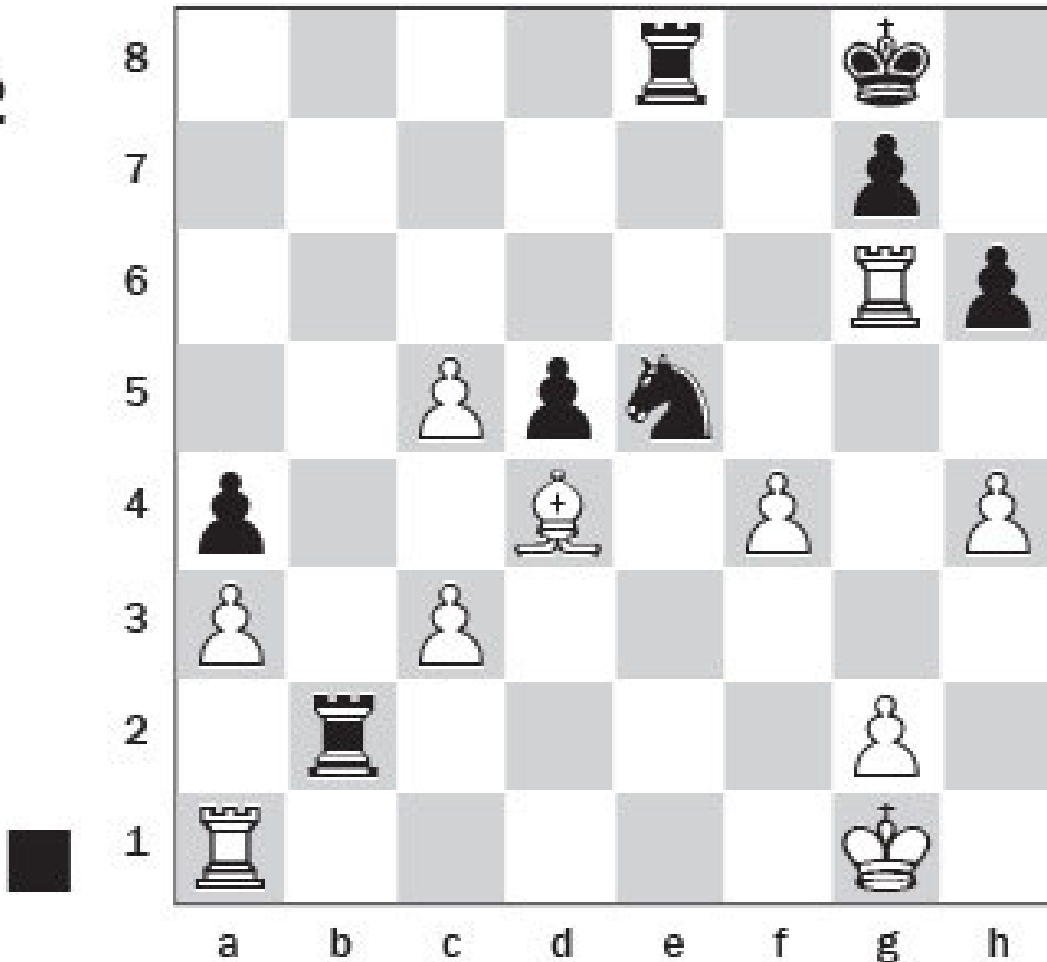


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 12](#)

# 12

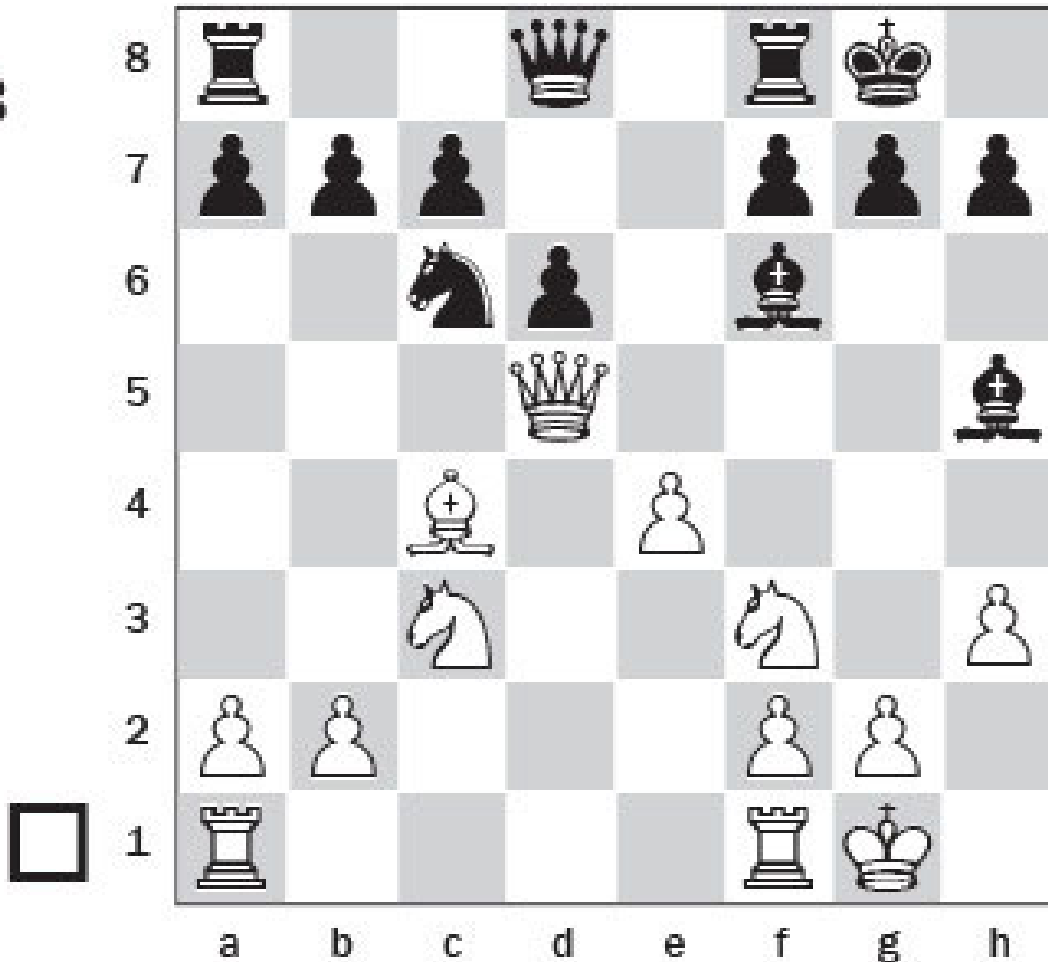


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 13](#)

13

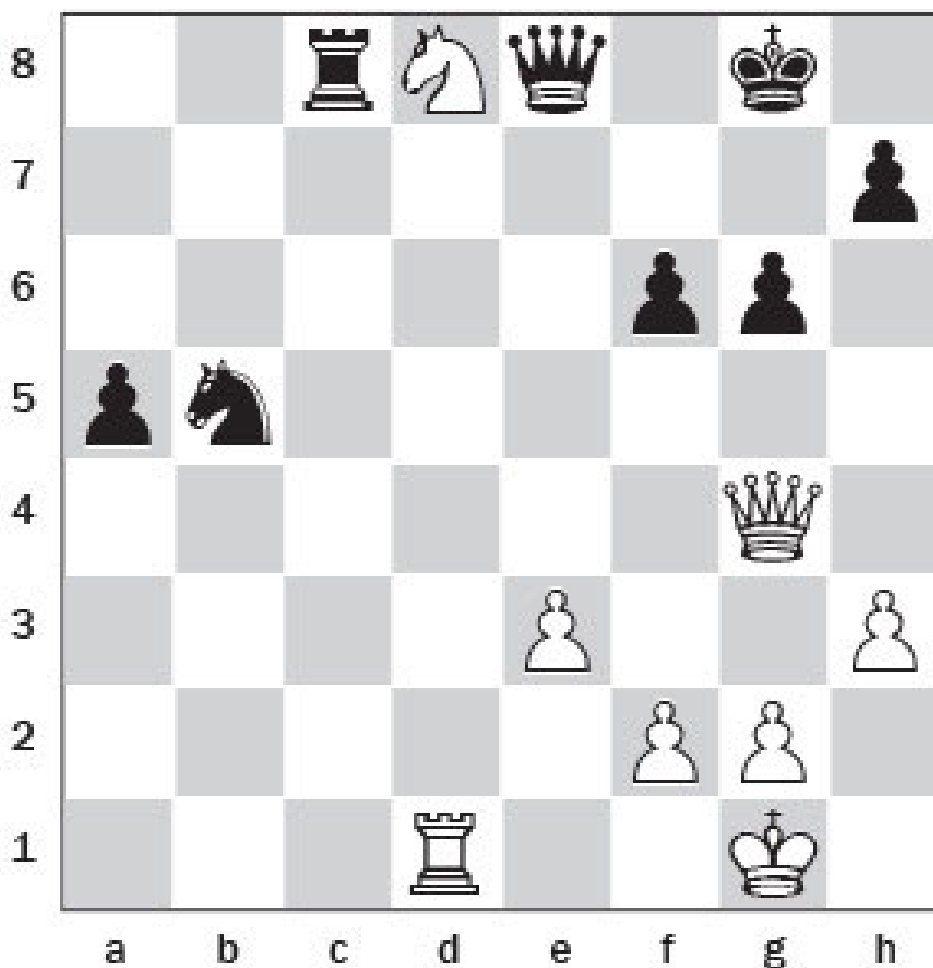


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 14](#)

14



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 15](#)

15

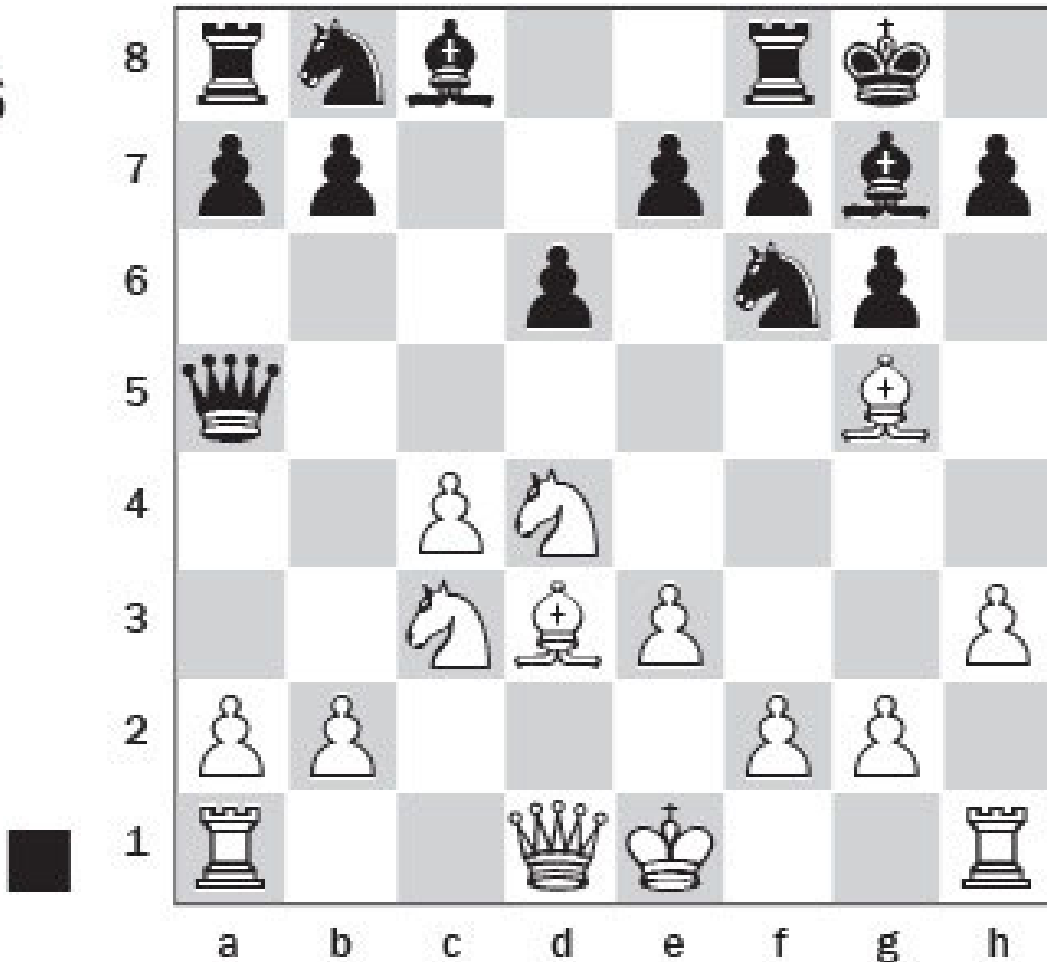


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 16](#)

16

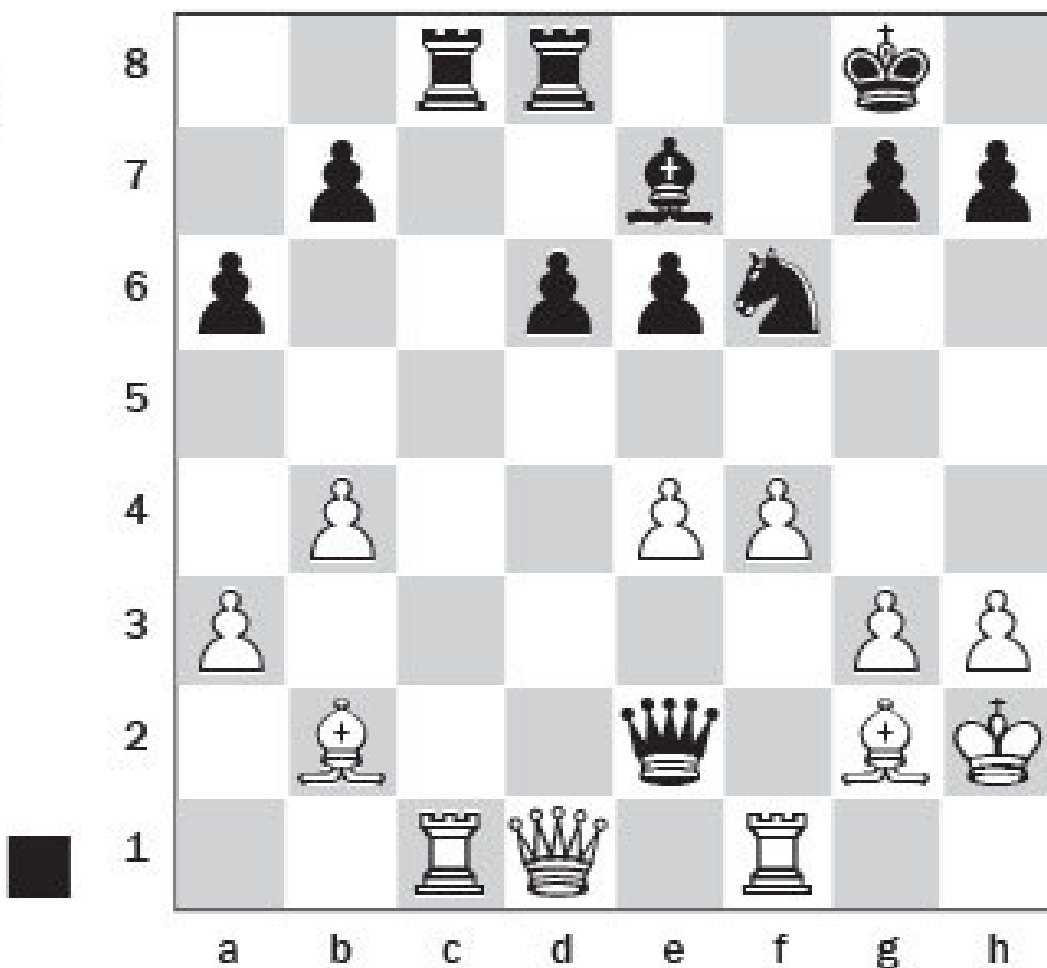


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 17](#)

17



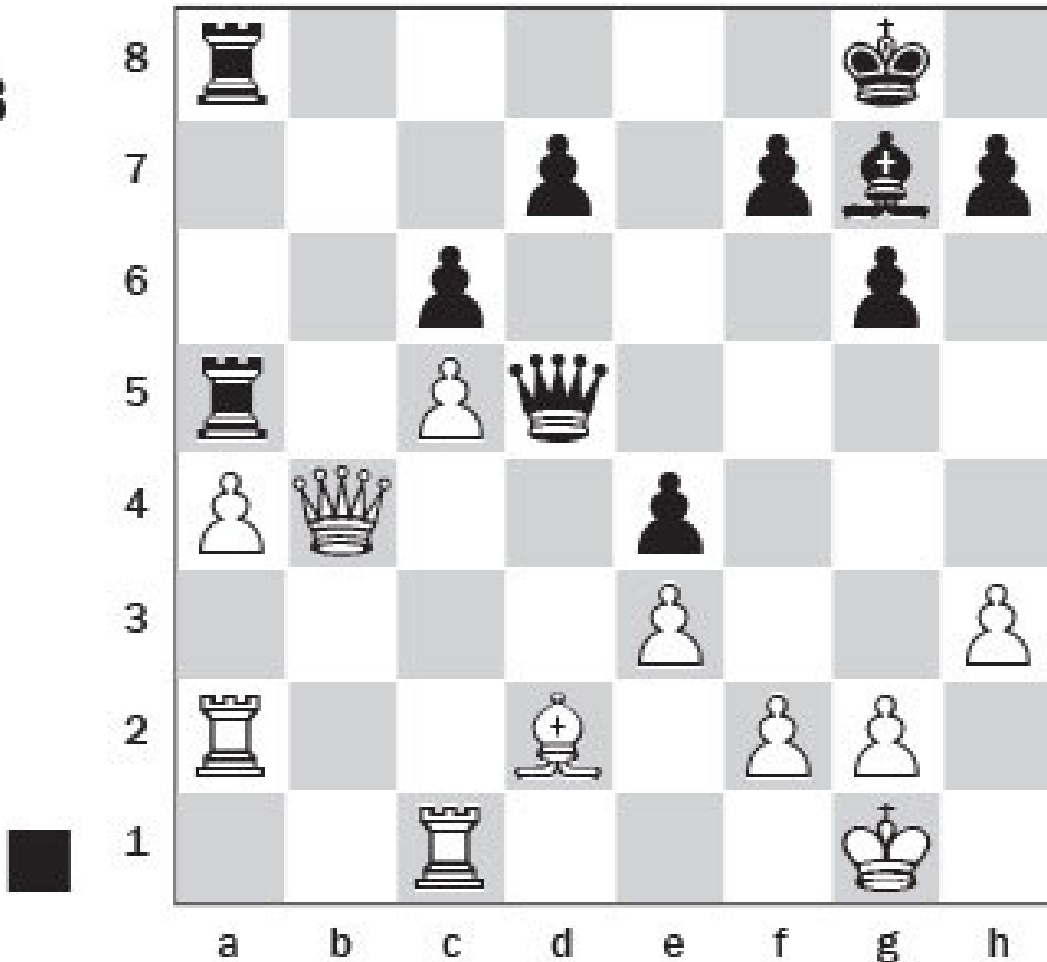
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 18](#)



18

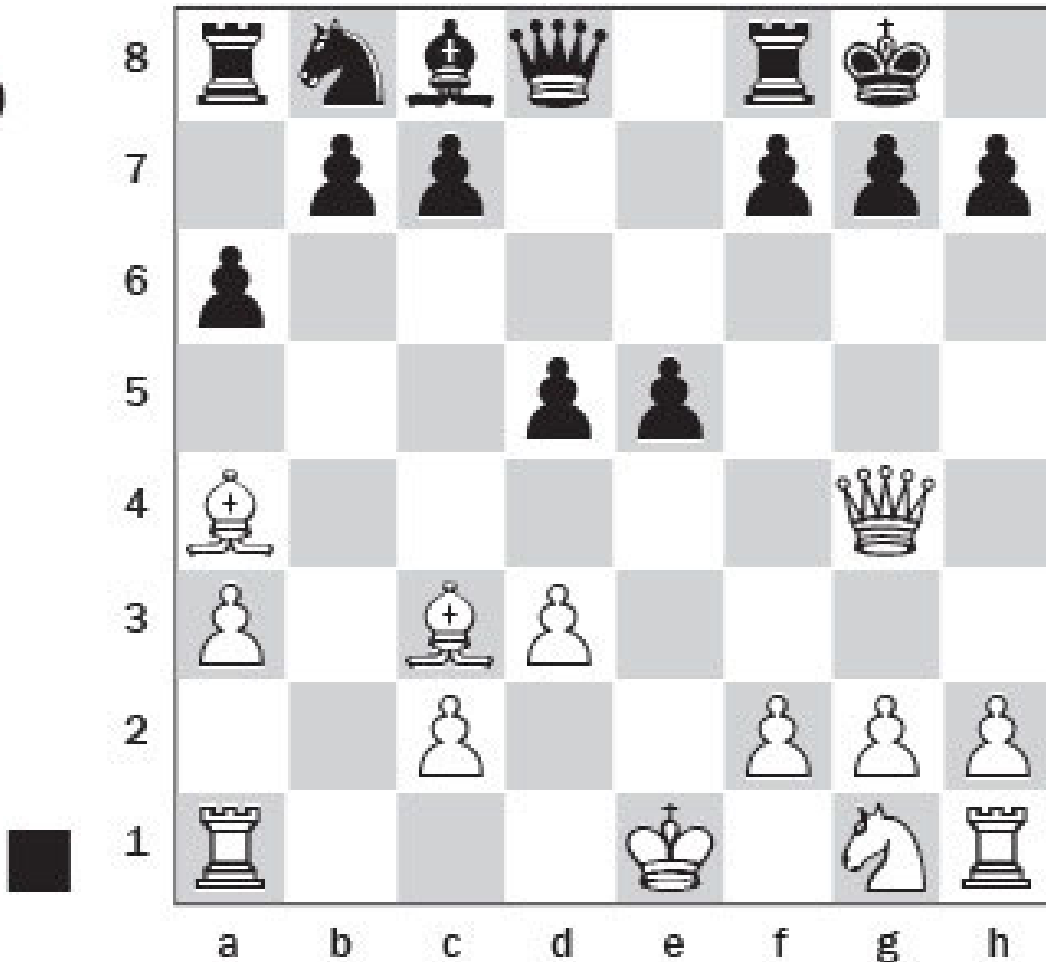


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 19](#)

19



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 20](#)

20



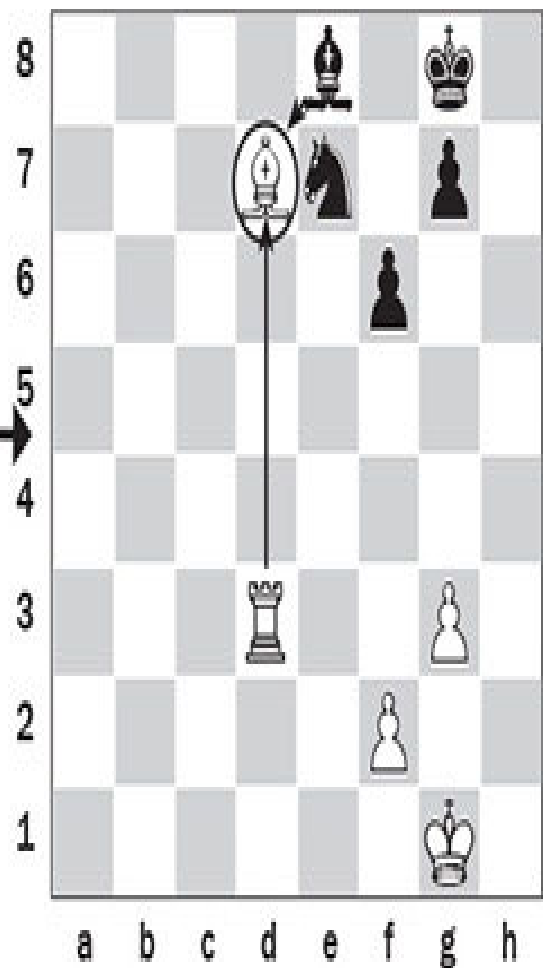
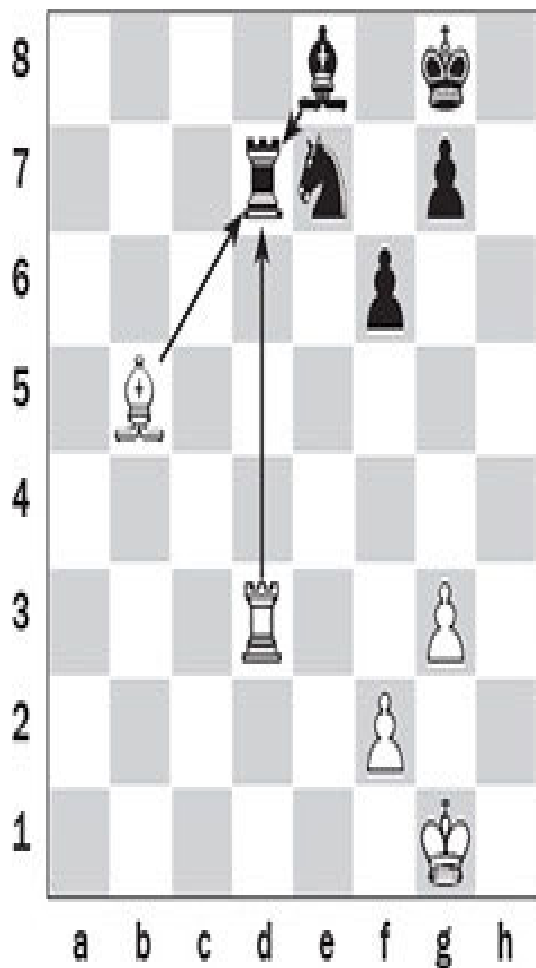
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 2

# Counting Attackers and Defenders

Once you feel comfortable with capturing free pieces, the next step is counting attackers and defenders. Generally, in order to gain an advantage, there must be more attackers than defenders. Another rule of thumb related to counting attackers and defenders is that you should capture with the weakest piece first. In other words, first capture with the piece of the lowest material value since it may be lost in the trade, then you'll be left with your more valuable piece in the end.



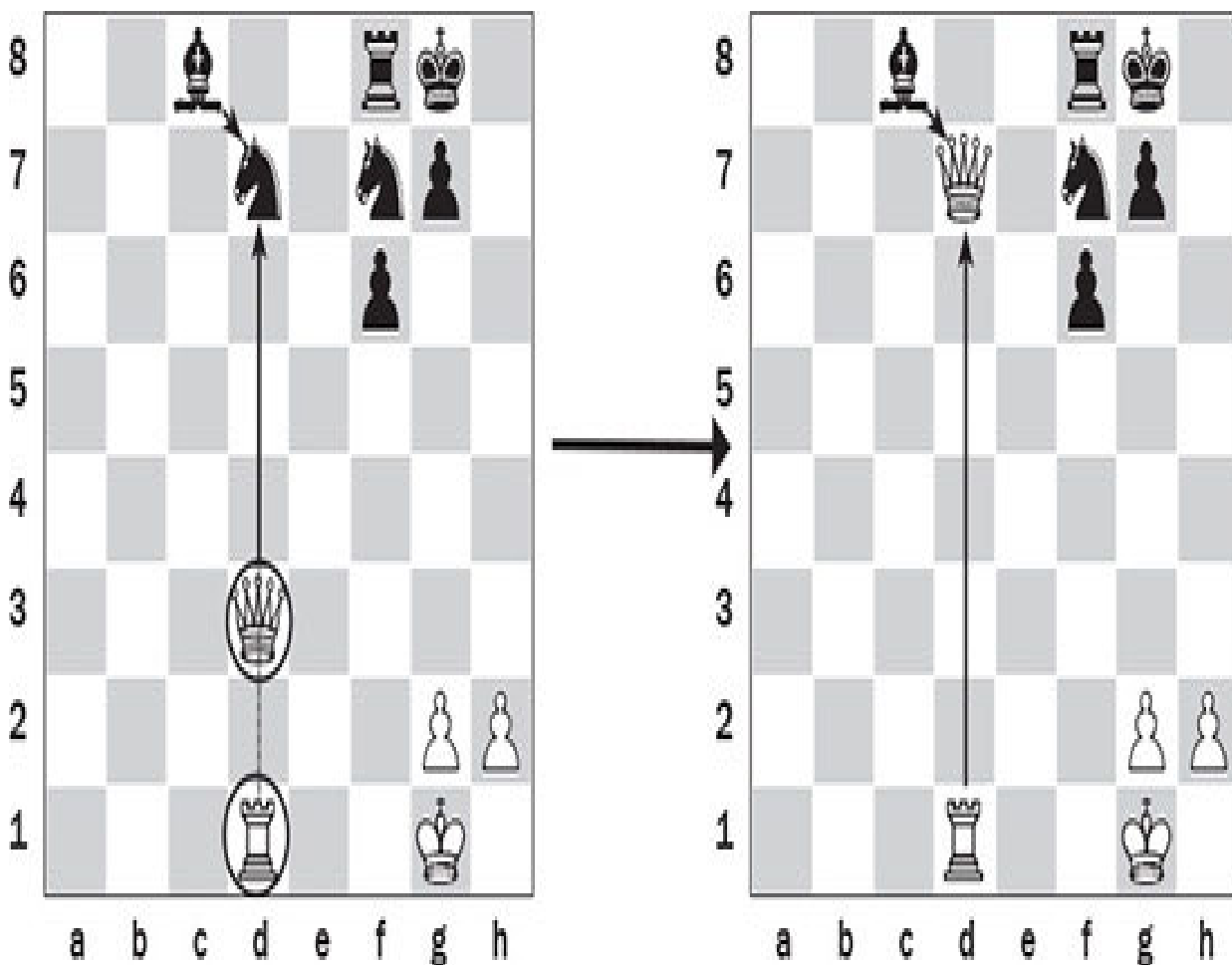
In the position above, White is attacking the rook on d7 with the bishop on c4 and the rook on d3. Black is only protecting the rook once. Now the question is whether White should capture with the rook (5 points) or the bishop (3 points) first. In this case, it makes the most sense for White to capture with the bishop, since it's 2 points less in value than the rook.

The best move for White is 1.Bxd7 (see diagram 2).

After 1...Bxd7 2.Rxd7, White has captured a rook (5 points) and bishop (3 points) and only given away a bishop (3 points). White

comes out ahead a rook (5 points) and should go on to win the game. There are exceptions when more attackers does not always mean it's safe to capture.

Let's take a look at the following example as an exception to the rule.



Here, White's queen and rook are set up in a battery formation. The battery, in this case, adds up to two attackers: the queen and the rook. The only defender of the knight on d7 is the bishop on c8. Even though White has more attackers than Black has defenders, it is unsafe to capture the knight since White would lose material on the exchange of pieces.

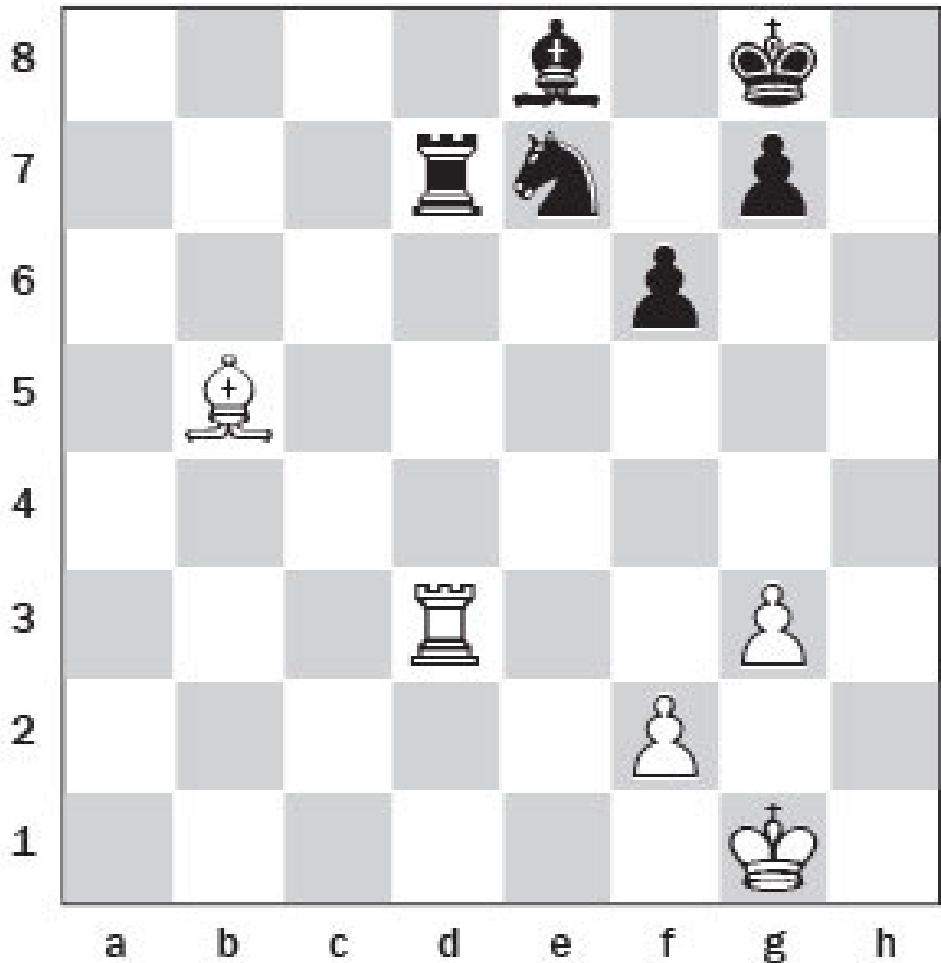
After 1.Qxd7 (see diagram 2) 1...Bxd7 2.Rxd7 White has made two captures, first capturing the knight (3 points) and then the bishop (3 points). Black in return has won the queen (9 points). White comes out at a 3 point disadvantage and hence capturing the knight would have been a bad idea.

I have designated 20 puzzles for you to solve in regard to finding pieces that are not protected enough. Look for pieces that are attacked more than they are defended.

Remember: when possible, it is generally best to capture with the weakest piece first.

# Counting Attackers and Defenders – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

1. Bxd7 Bxd7

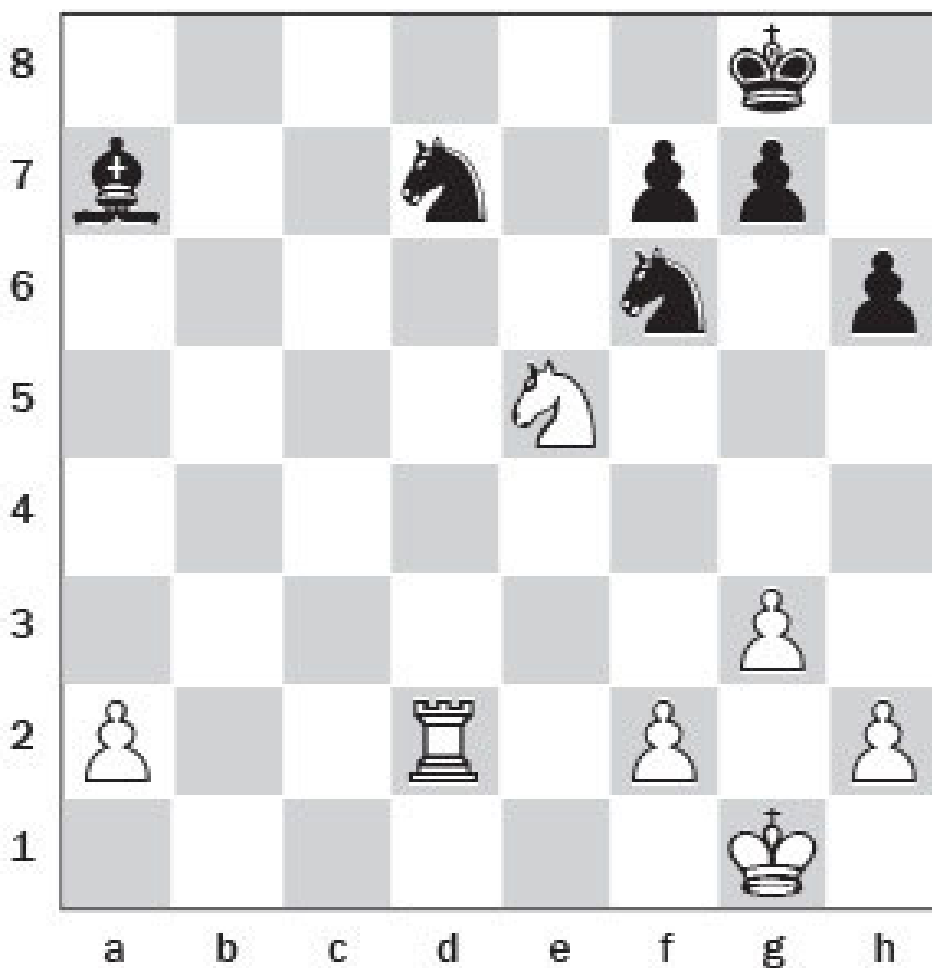


2. Rxd7 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 21

**21**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

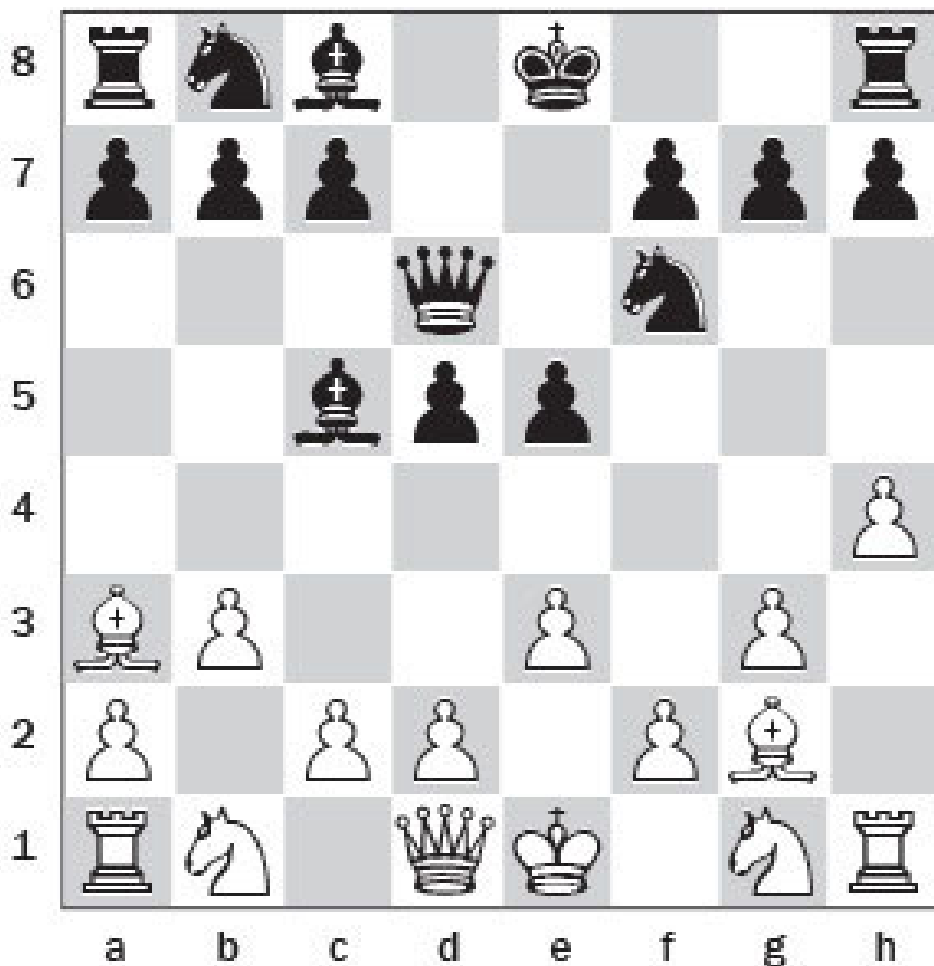
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Find Black's piece that is attacked more than it's defended.  
Remember, capture with the weakest piece first.

## Exercise 22

22



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

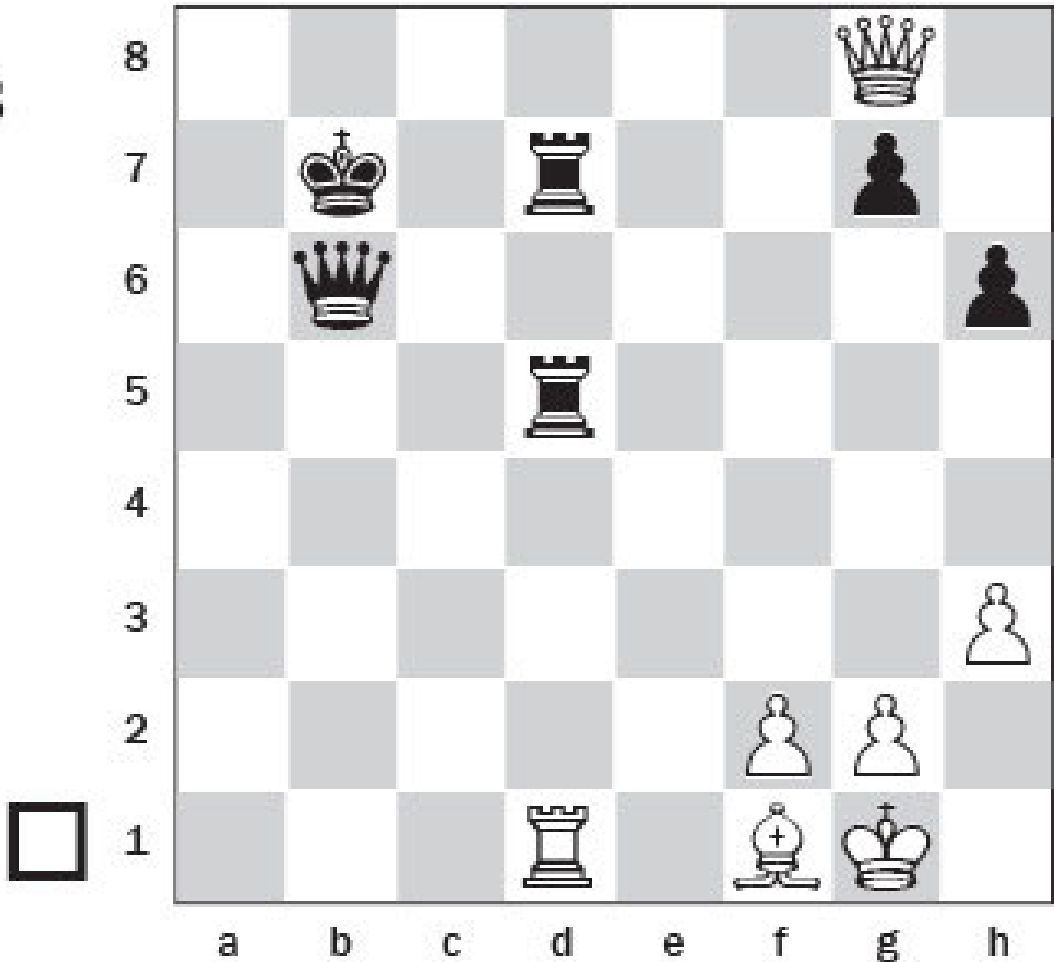
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

Find Black's battery. Remember that pieces lined up in a battery count as more than one attacker.

### Exercise 23

23



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

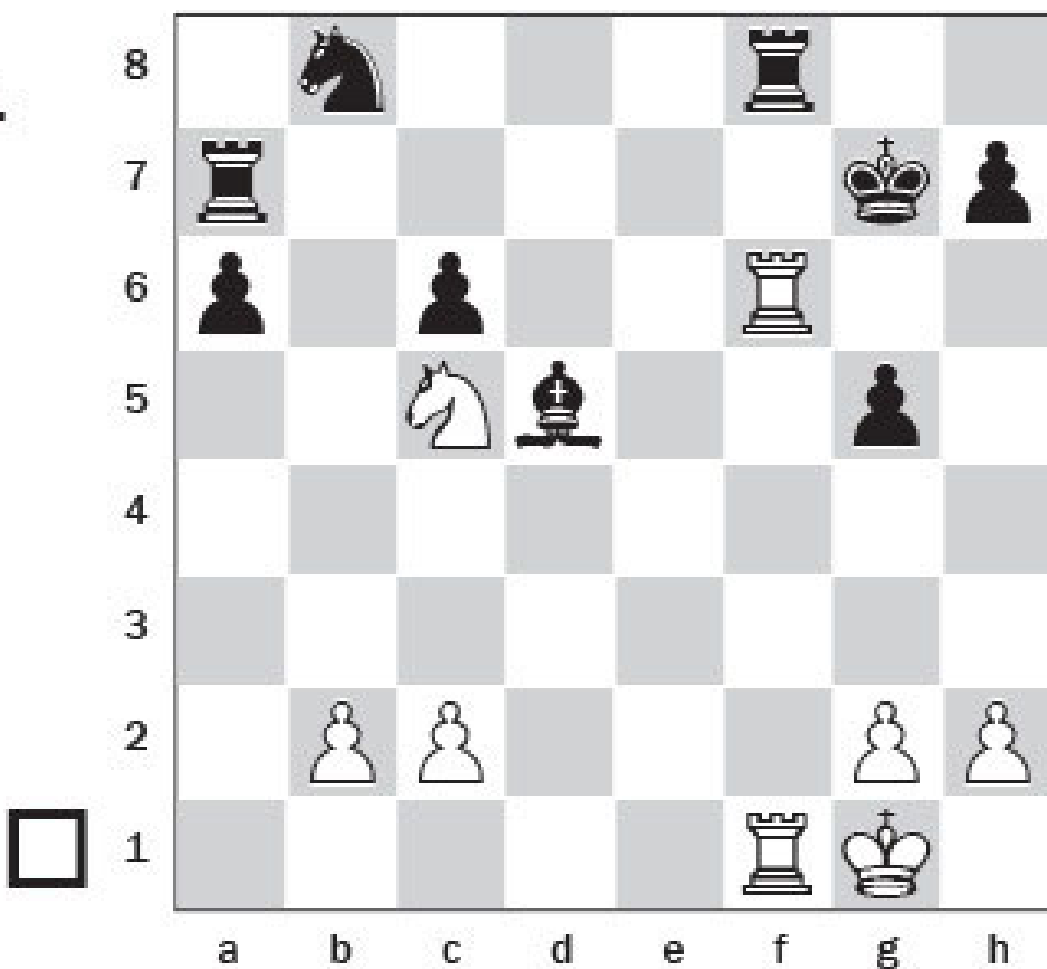
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's queen seems to be hiding, don't miss what it's attacking.  
Don't forget to capture with the weakest piece first!

### Exercise 24

24



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's rooks are lined up in a battery. Is Black defending enough times?

### Exercise 25

25



Answer:

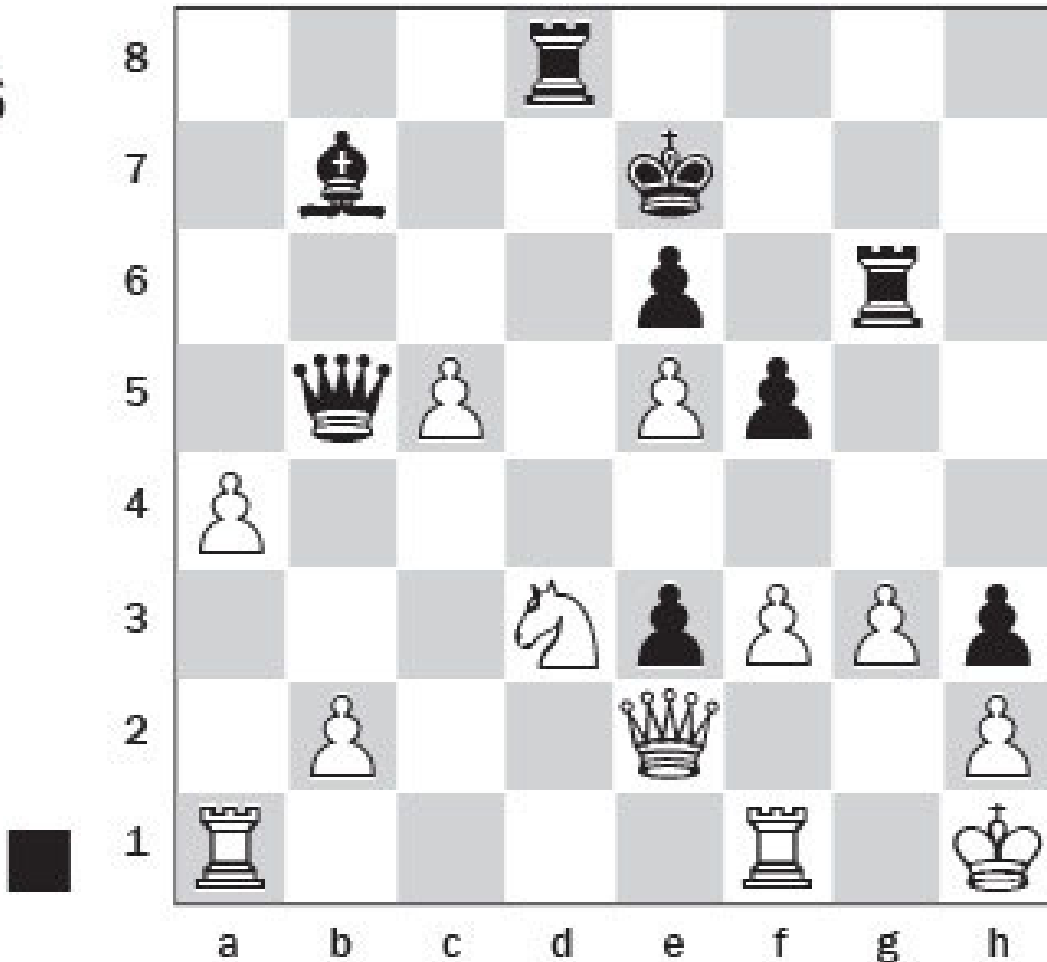
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Bishops are long range pieces. Look at the whole board and find a piece that is being attacked more than it's defended. Remember: capture with the weakest piece first.

## Exercise 26

26



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

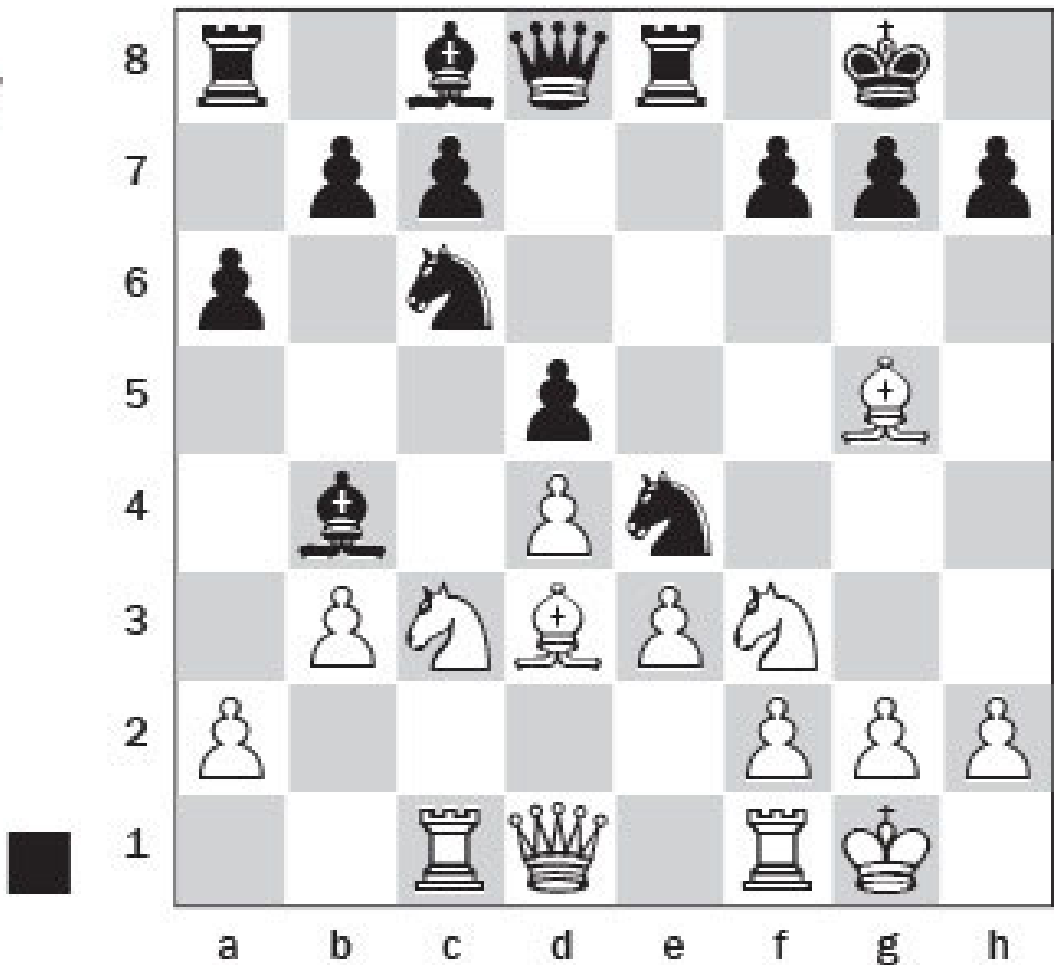
HINT



Normally we want to capture with the weakest piece first, but we also have to pay attention to what our opponents are threatening. In this case, which piece should Black capture with first?

### Exercise 27

27



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

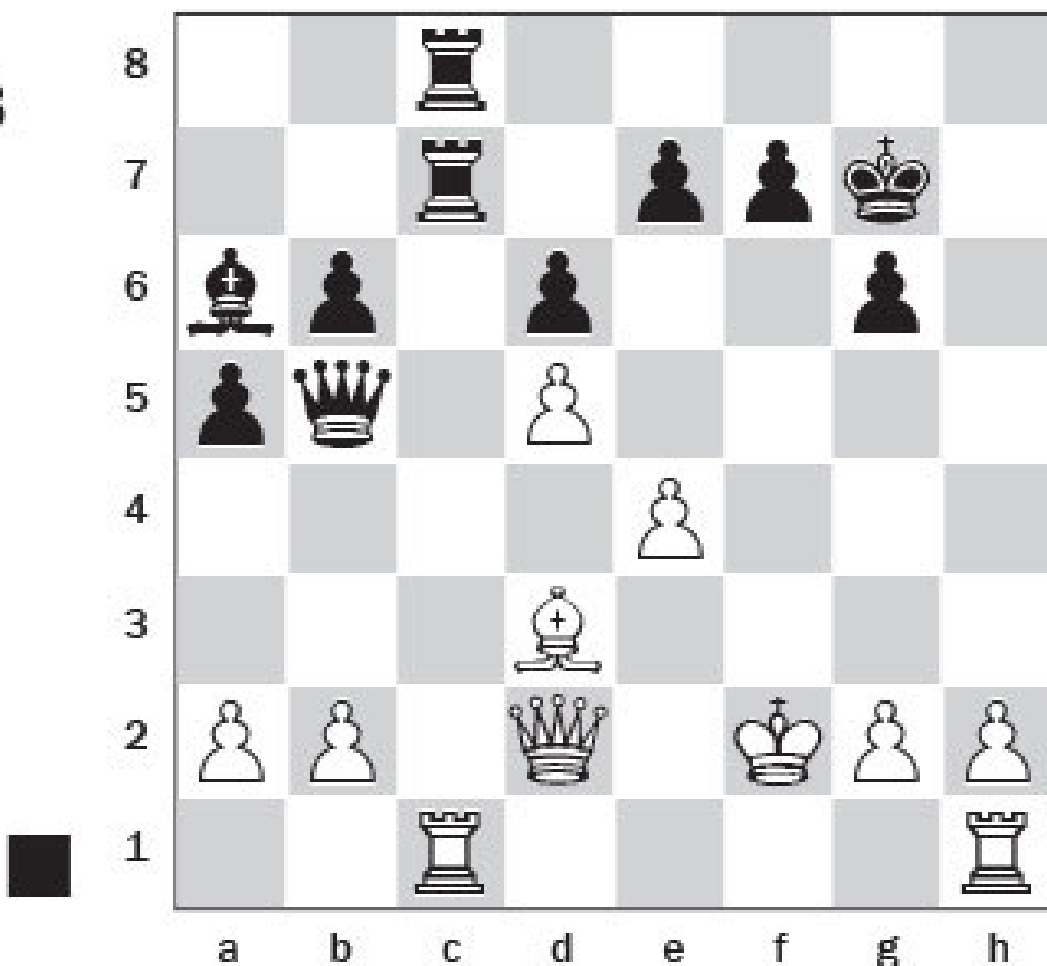
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Careful, White has a dangerous threat. Black has many captures, but only one wins material and deals with the threat!

### Exercise 28

28



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

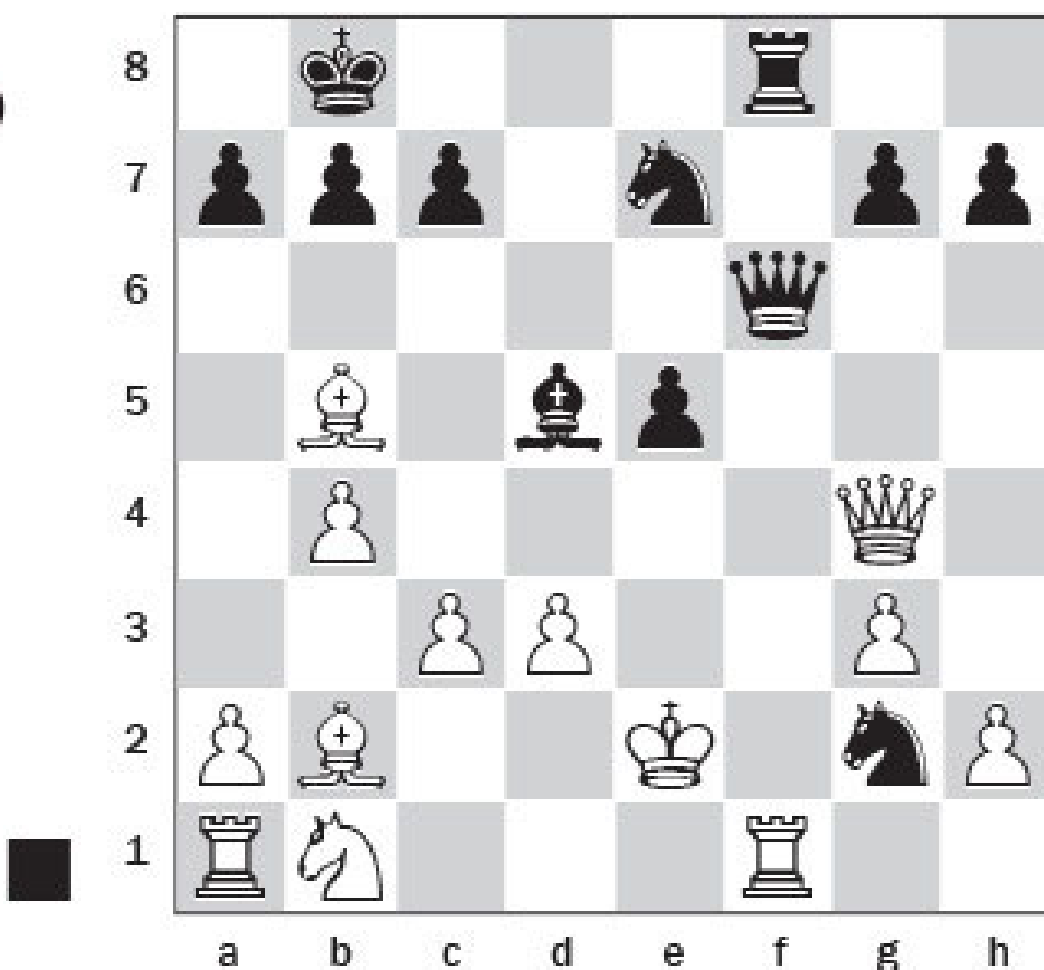
### **HINT**

Black has two batteries but only one of them wins material. First you need to identify White's threat, once you do that, you'll know which battery to use!

# Counting Attackers and Defenders – Test

## Exercise 29

29



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 30

**30**



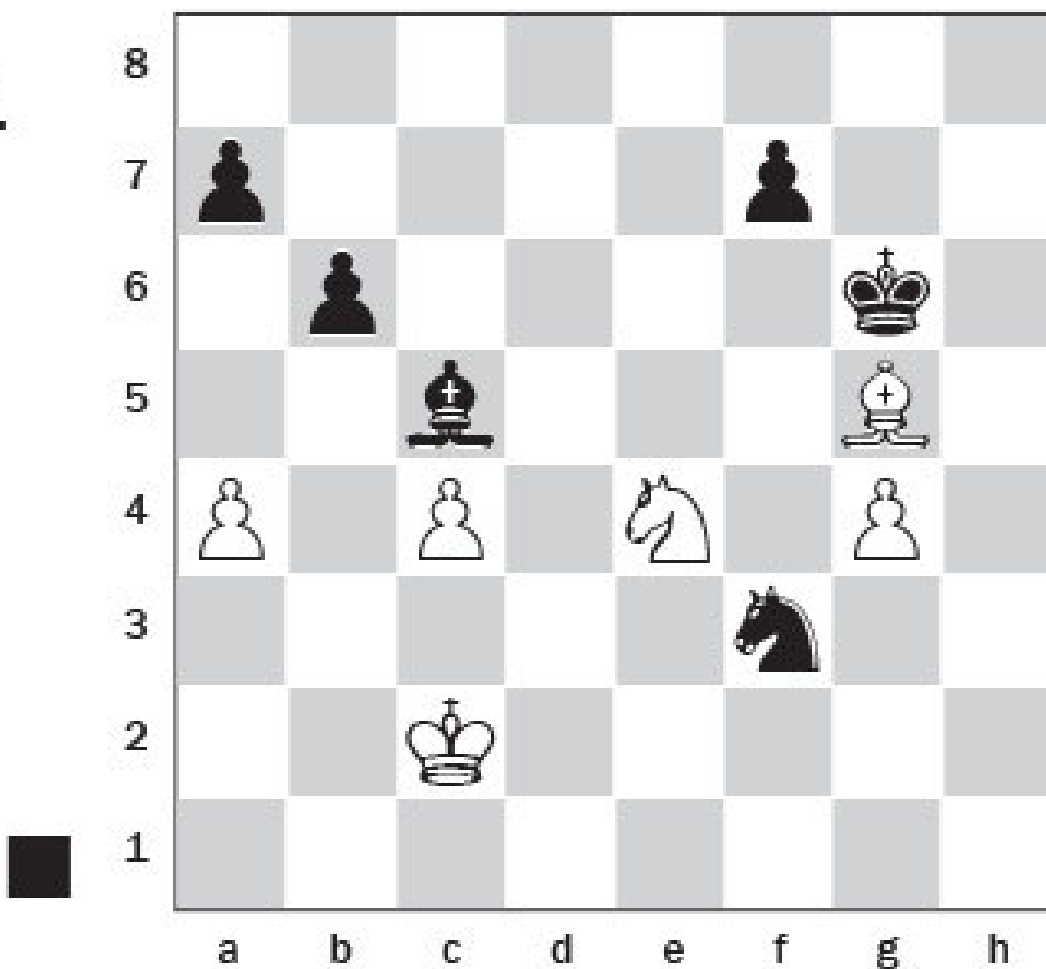
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 31

**31**



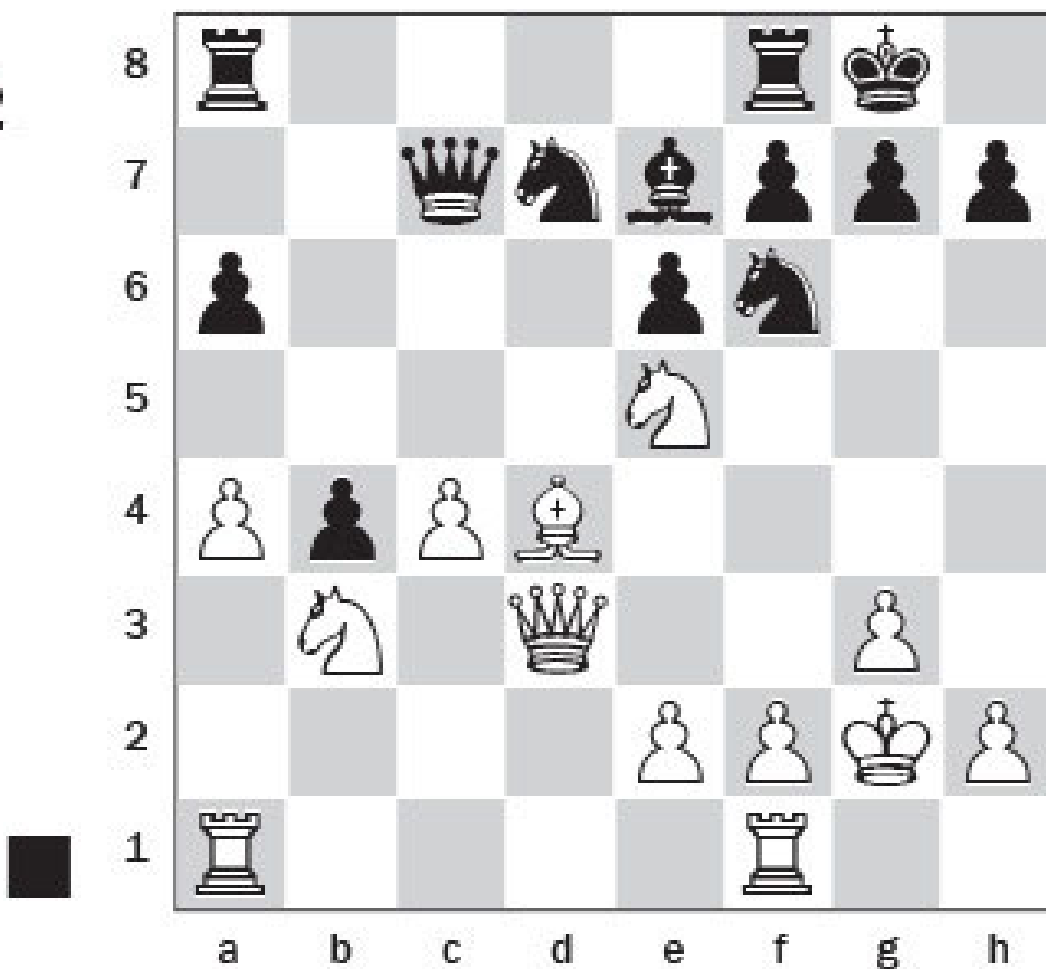
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 32

32



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 33

33



Answer:

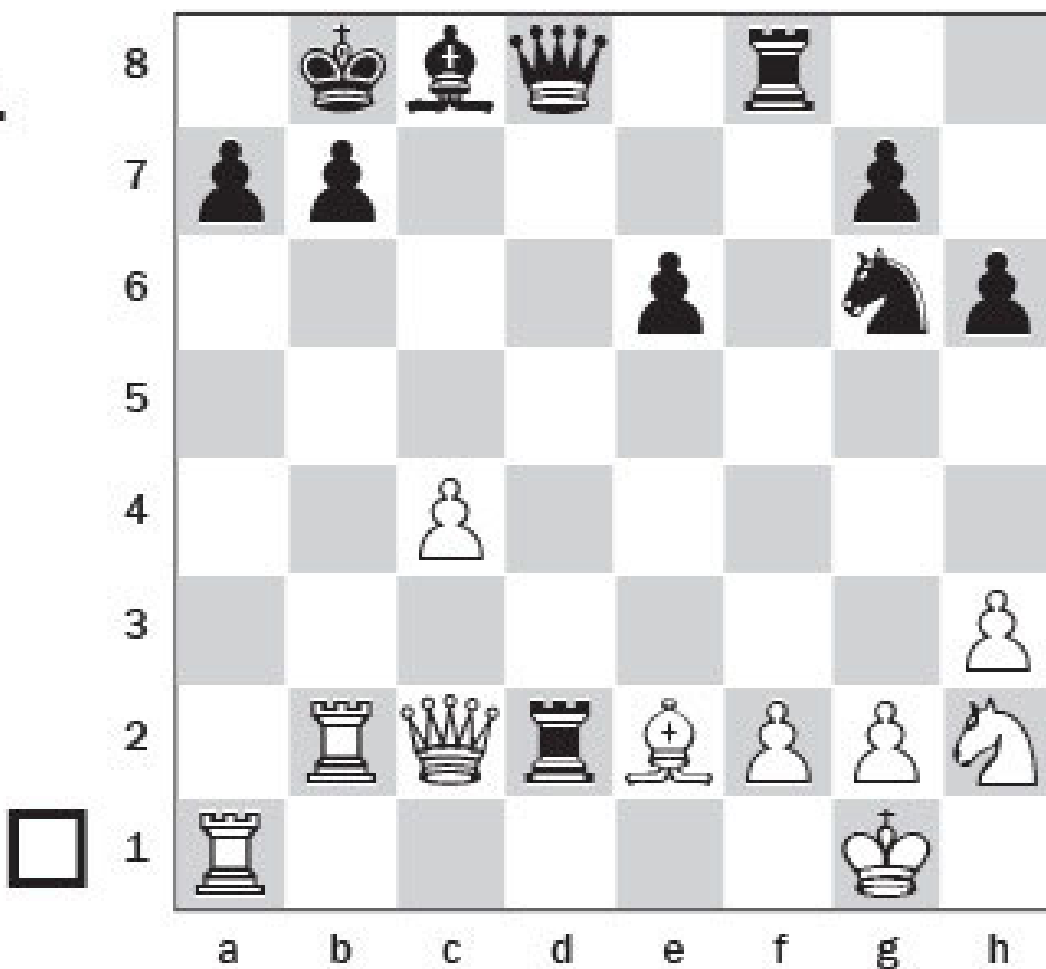
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 34

34



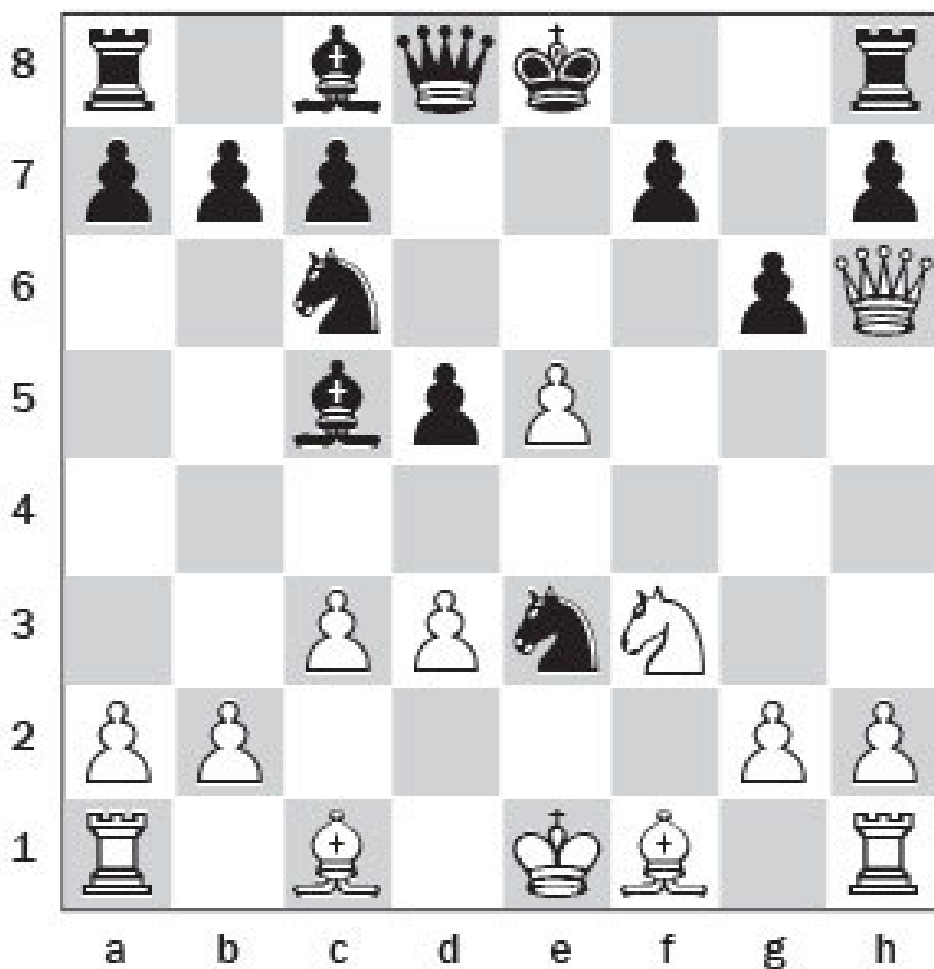
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 35

35



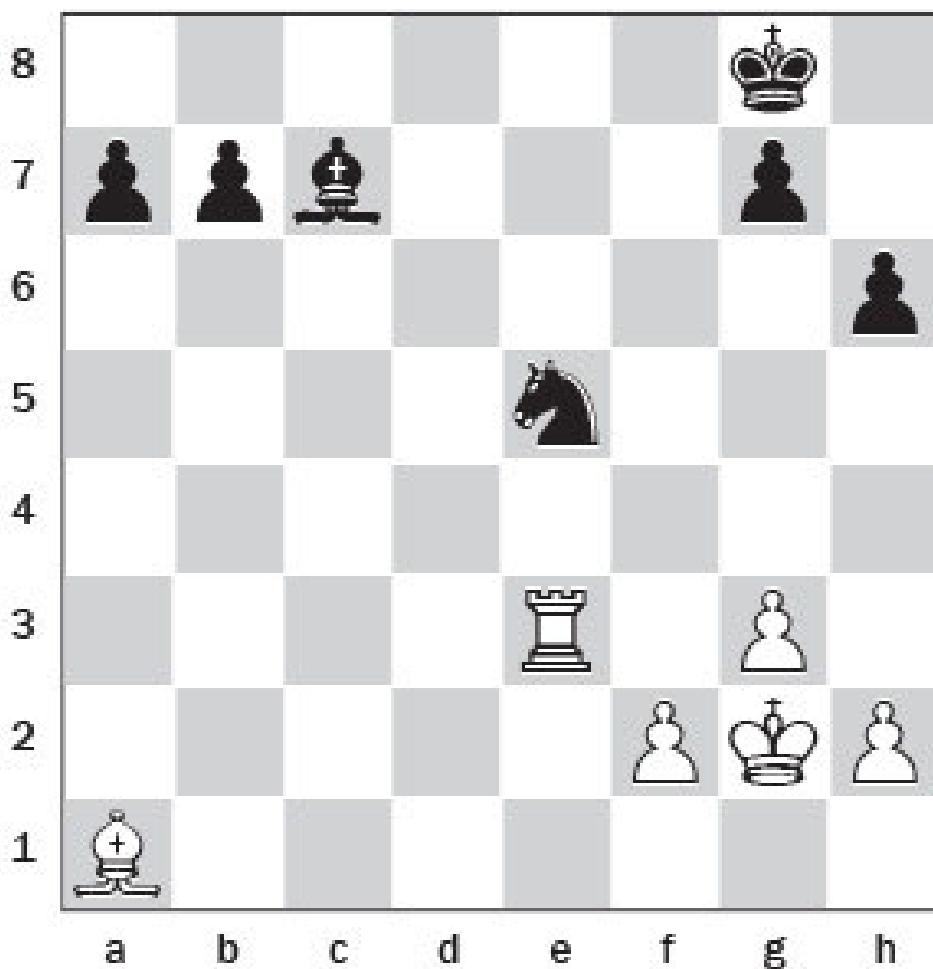
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 36

**36**



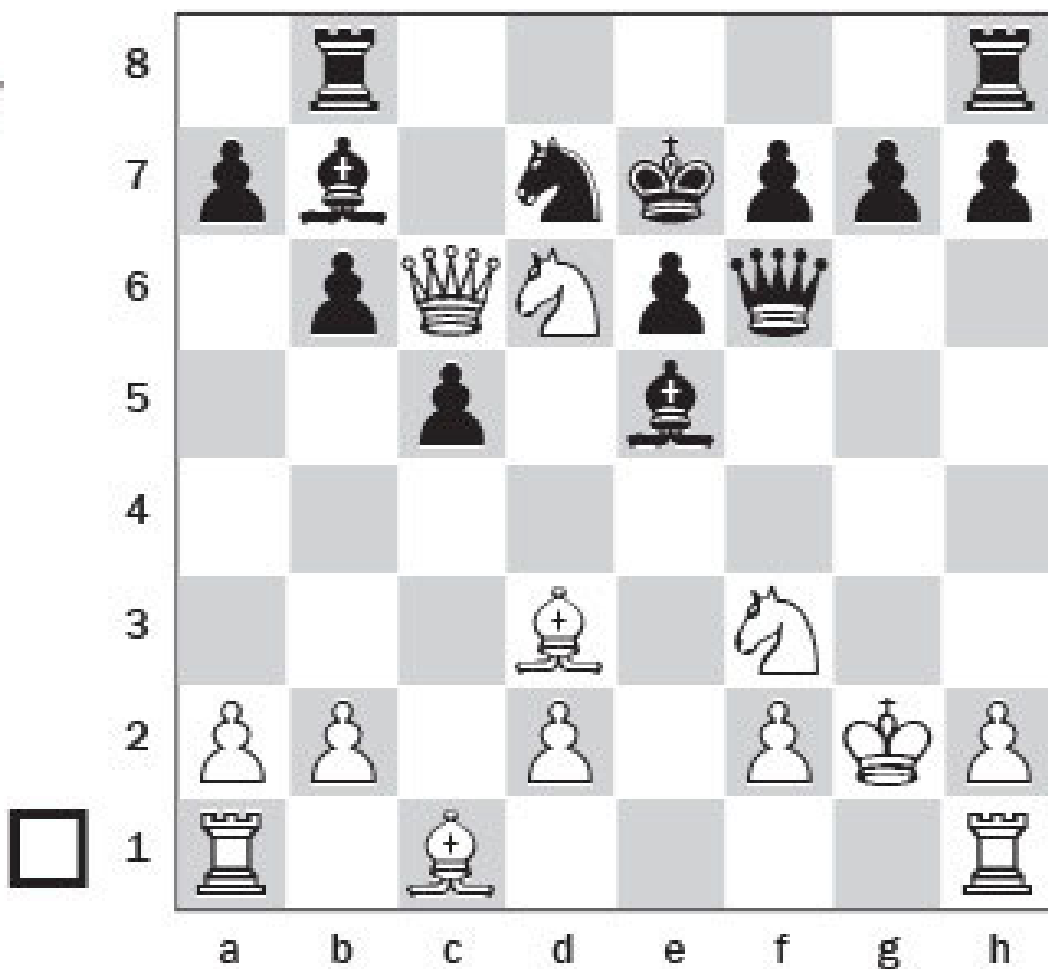
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 37

**37**

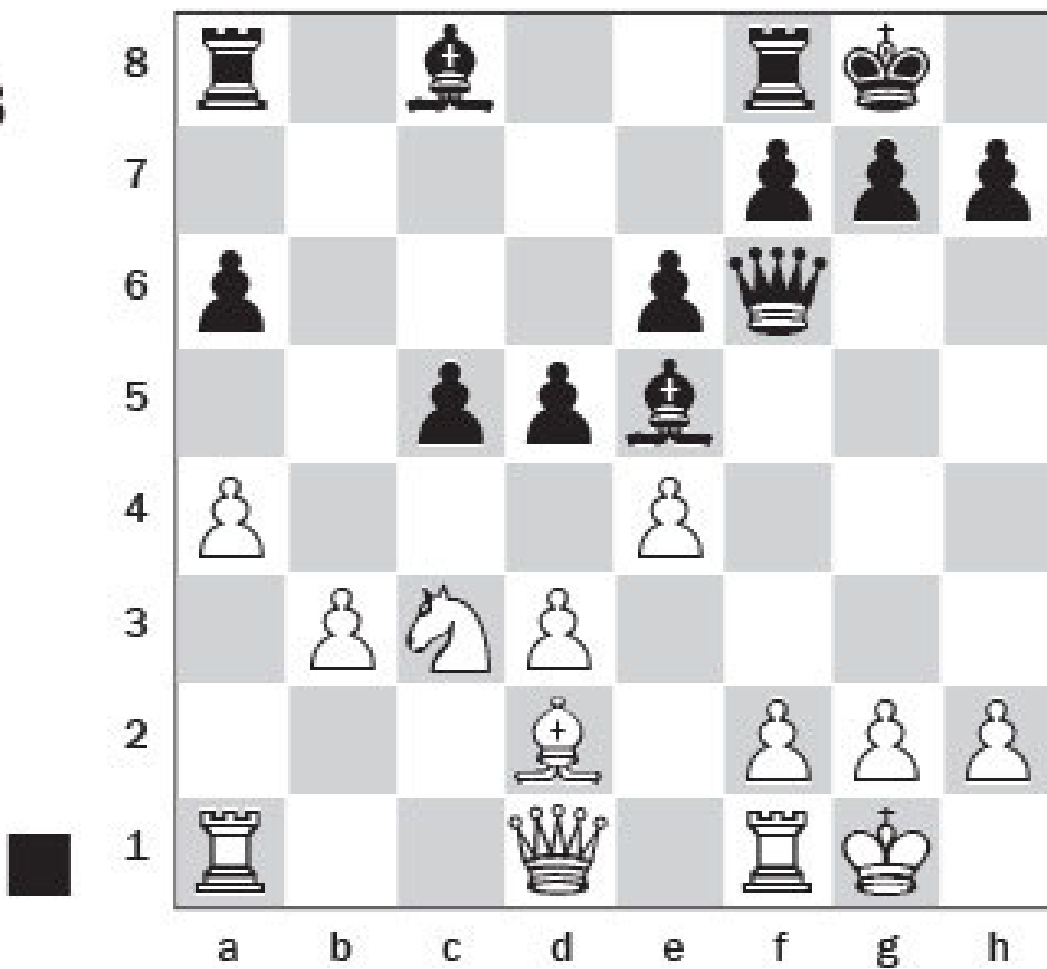


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 38

38



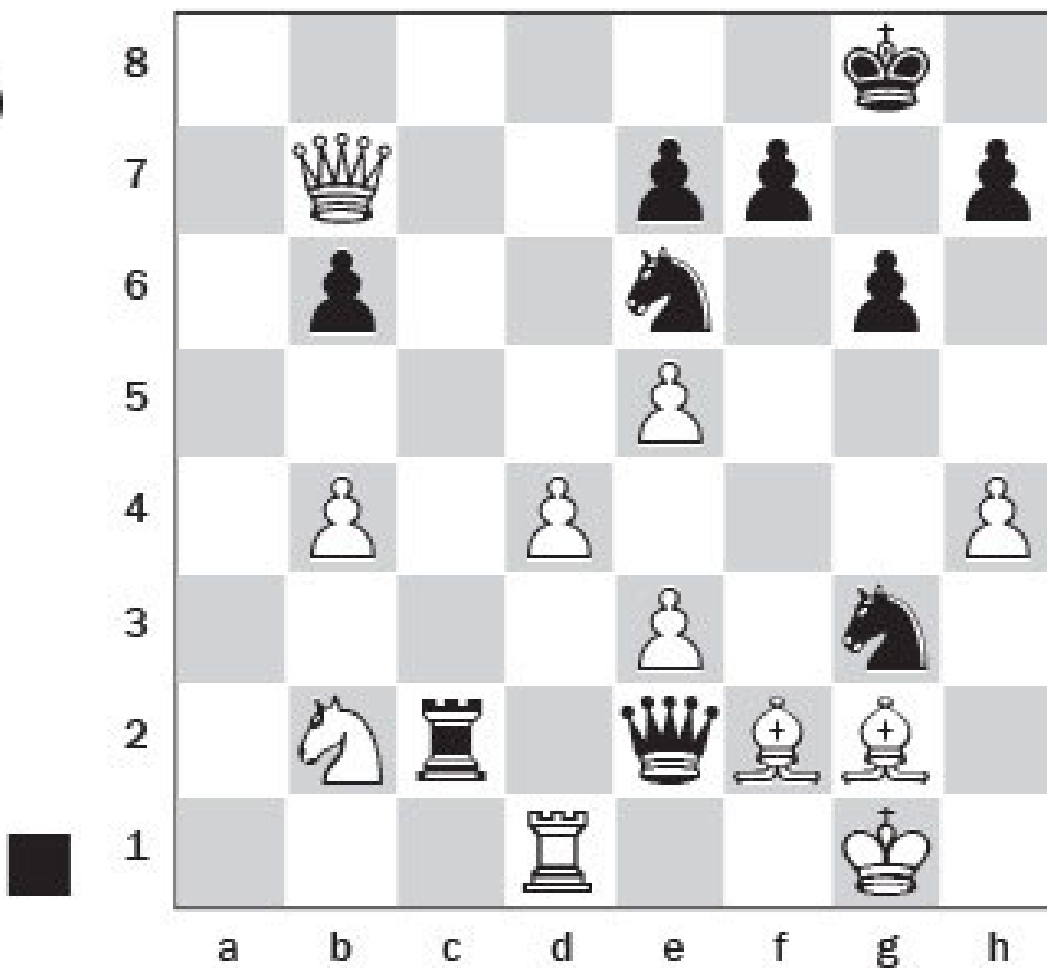
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 39

39



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 40

40



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 3

# Intro to Defense

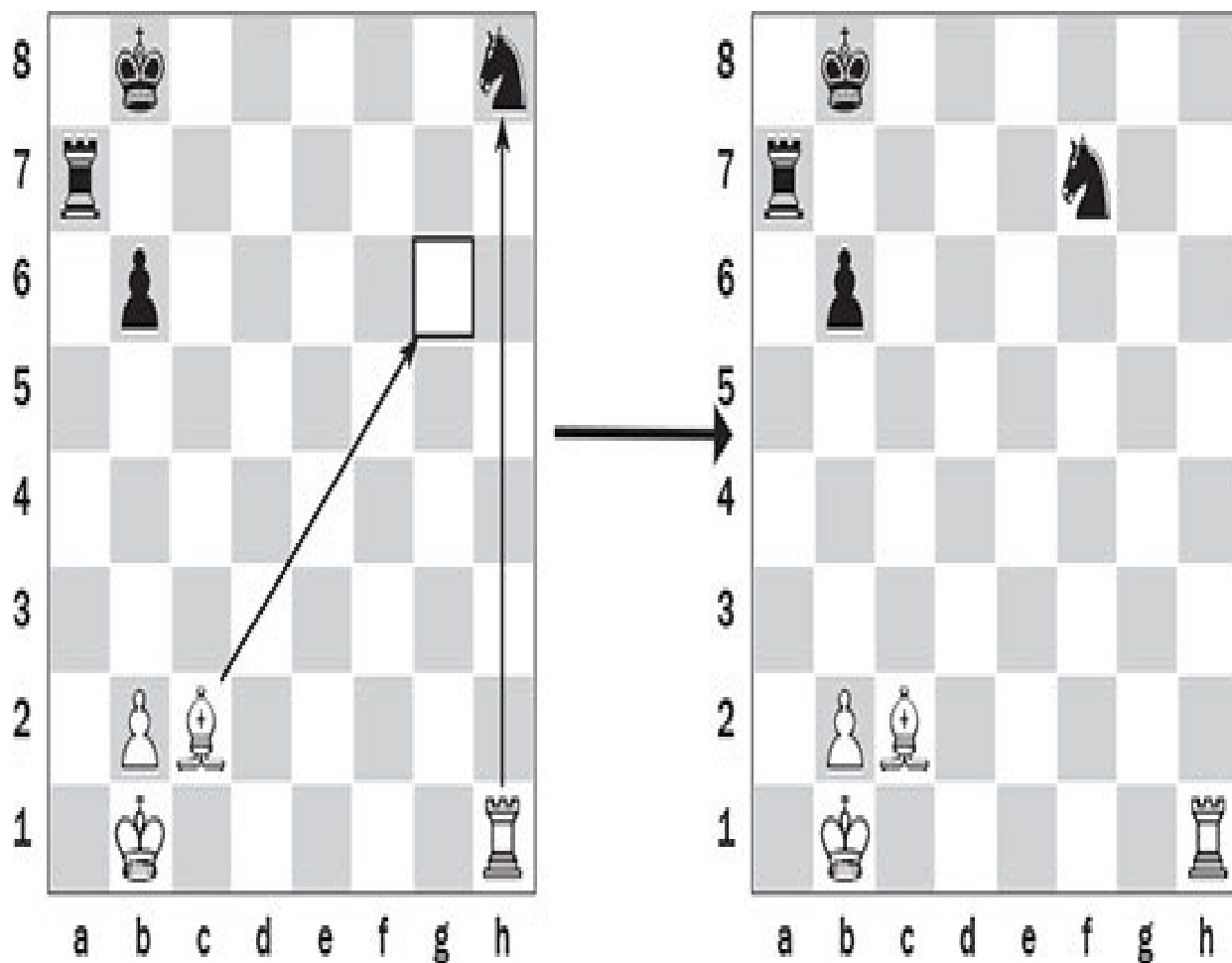
In this chapter we are going to look at basic defense. In the previous chapters we looked at situations where you were able to take advantage of undefended and/or underprotected pieces. In this chapter, we are going to look at the ways that you can protect and save your own pieces from danger.

Ways to protect your pieces:

1. Run away;
2. Block (interpose);
3. Add a defender.

Let's look at the first example, running away from danger:



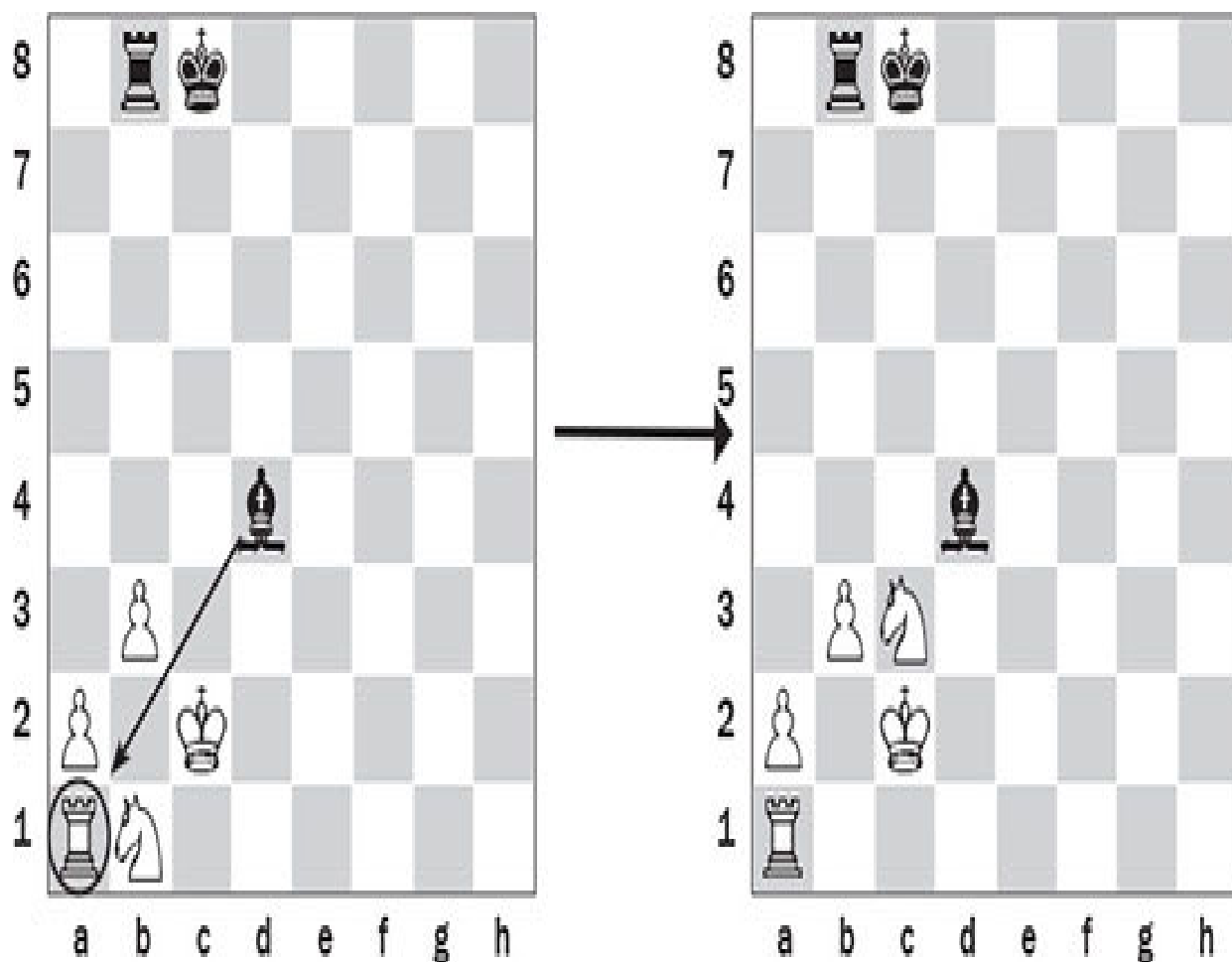


Black's knight on h8 is being attacked by the rook on h1. There is no way to block the attack, or safely defend the knight, so Black must run away from danger.

The best move for Black is 1...Nf7 (see diagram 2).

Black saves the knight and the game remains even. Any other move would have resulted in the loss of the knight or more! Remember that in chess it's important to keep your pieces safe and protected.

In the next example we look at blocking the attack.



Here, the bishop on d4 is attacking the rook in the corner. There is no move for the rook. However, the knight can block the bishop's attack.

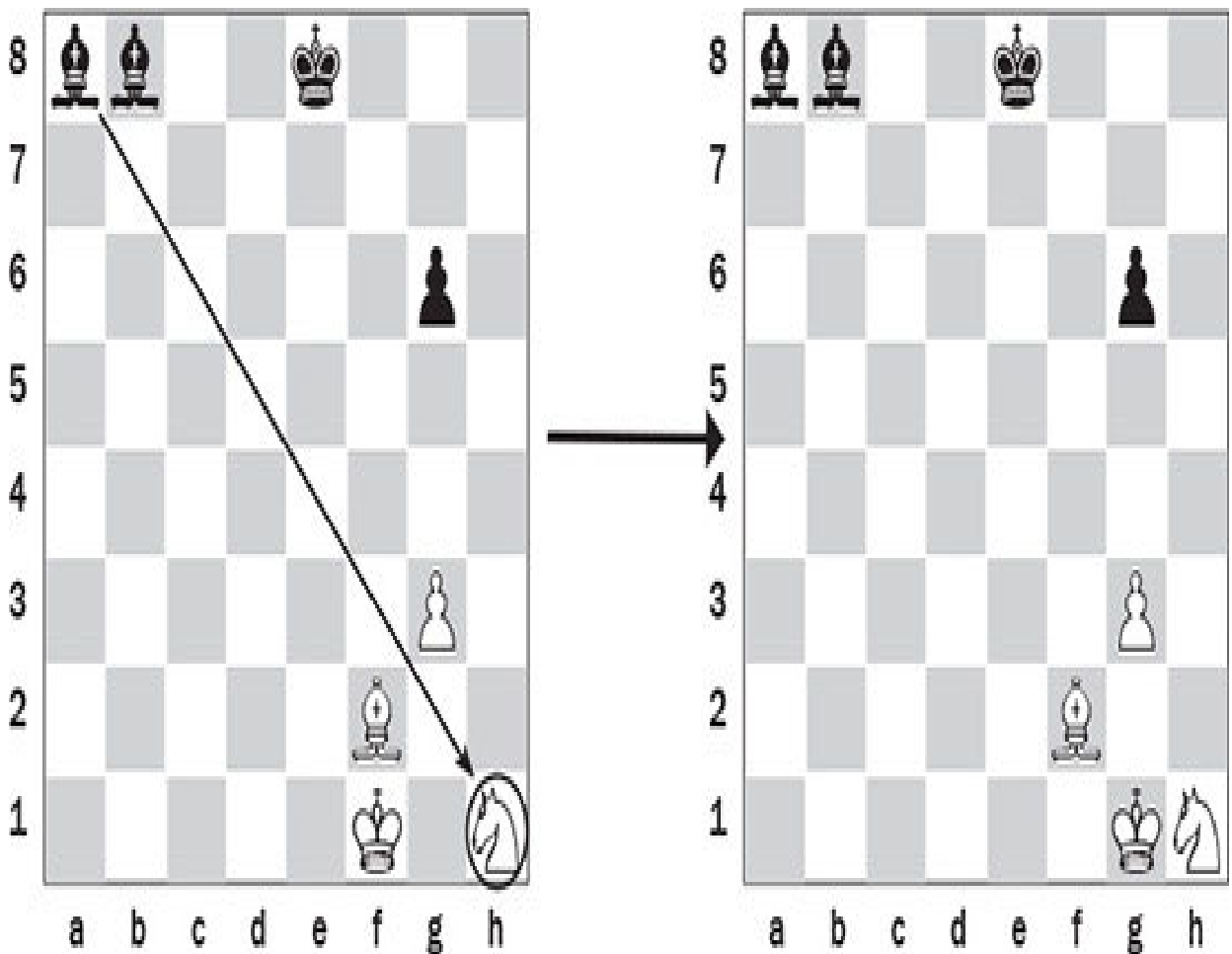
The best move for White is 1.Nc3 (see diagram 2).

In this example, White saved the rook from capture by blocking. Here, Black could take the knight (3) but then White's king would capture

the bishop (3) where the trade would be even. White has saved the rook!

Remember: trades in chess will happen (like bishop for knight above), you just want to keep them even or better for you!

In the final example problem, we look at defending a piece that is attacked.



Here, White's knight on h1 is attacked by Black's bishop on a8. It cannot move, and blocking the attack is not possible. That leaves White with only one choice, to defend:

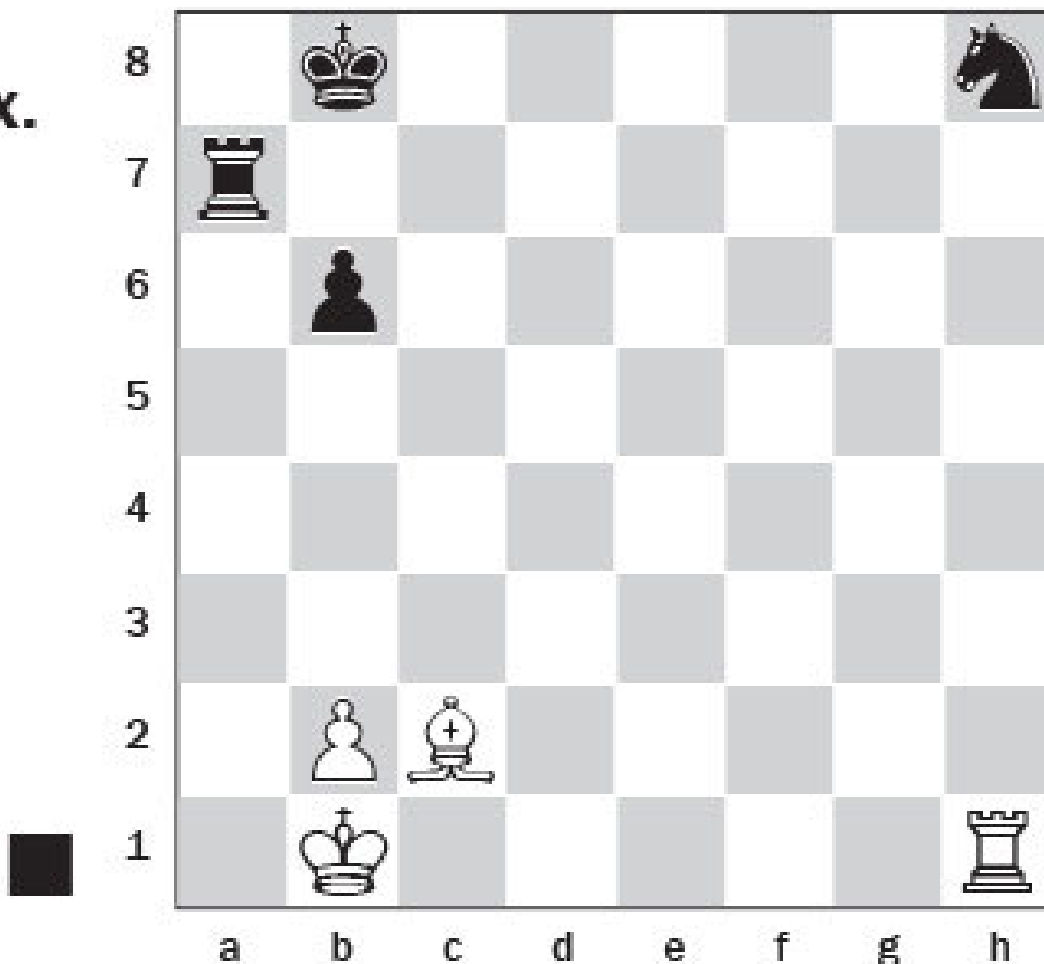
### **1.Kg1 (see diagram 2)**

White uses the king to guard the knight. This is the only move that avoids losing material for White. Yes, Black could use their bishop to capture the knight (3) but then White would capture the bishop (3) back. That would be an even trade – no harm, no foul.

Now it's your turn! On the next pages there are combinations of all three defensive concepts: running away, blocking (interposing), and defending (protecting).

# Intro to Defense – Guided Practice

Ex.

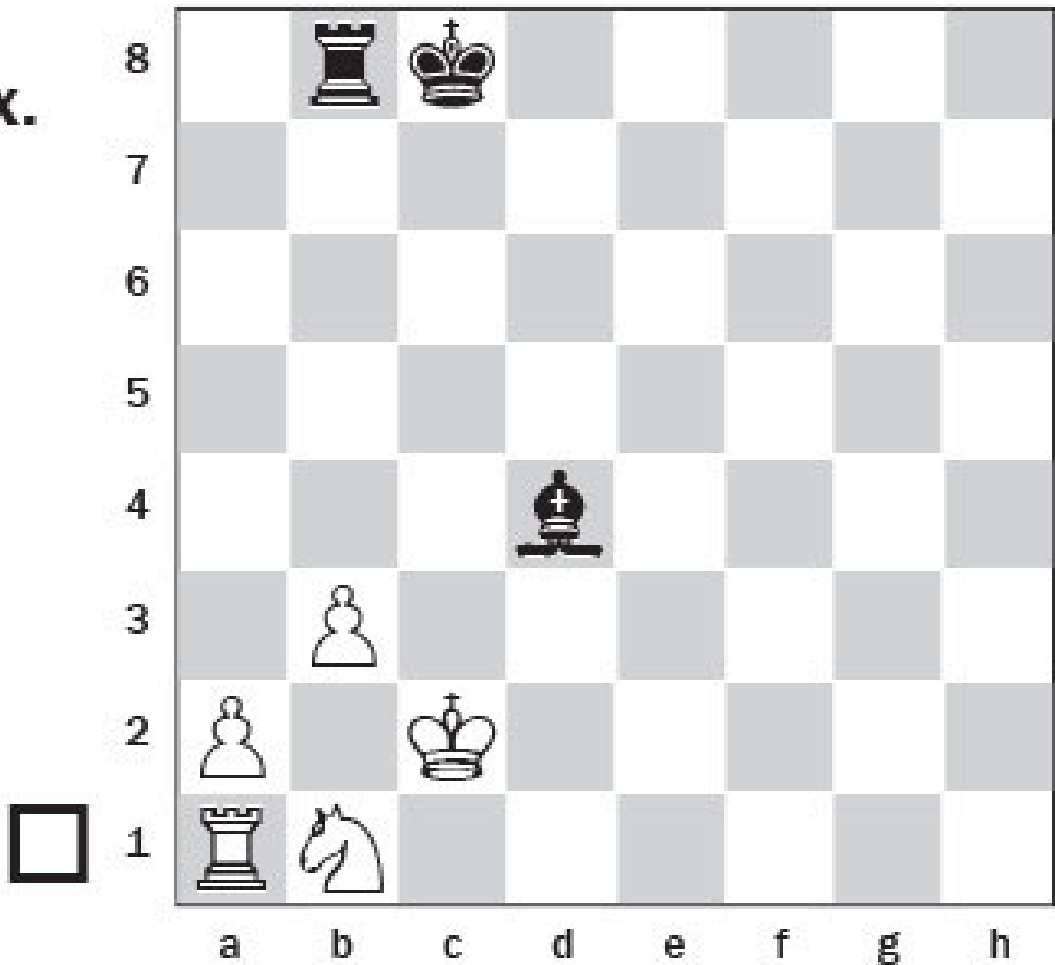


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_ Nf7

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

**Ex.**

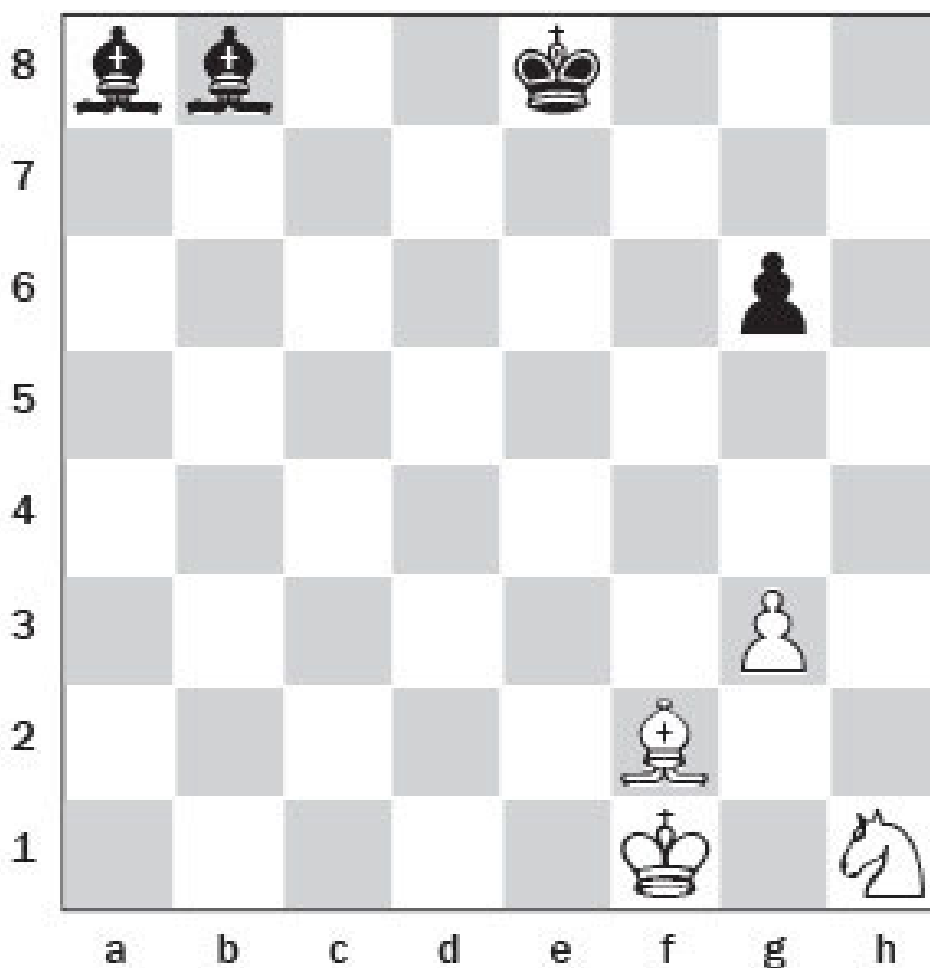


Answer:

**1. Nc3** \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Ex.



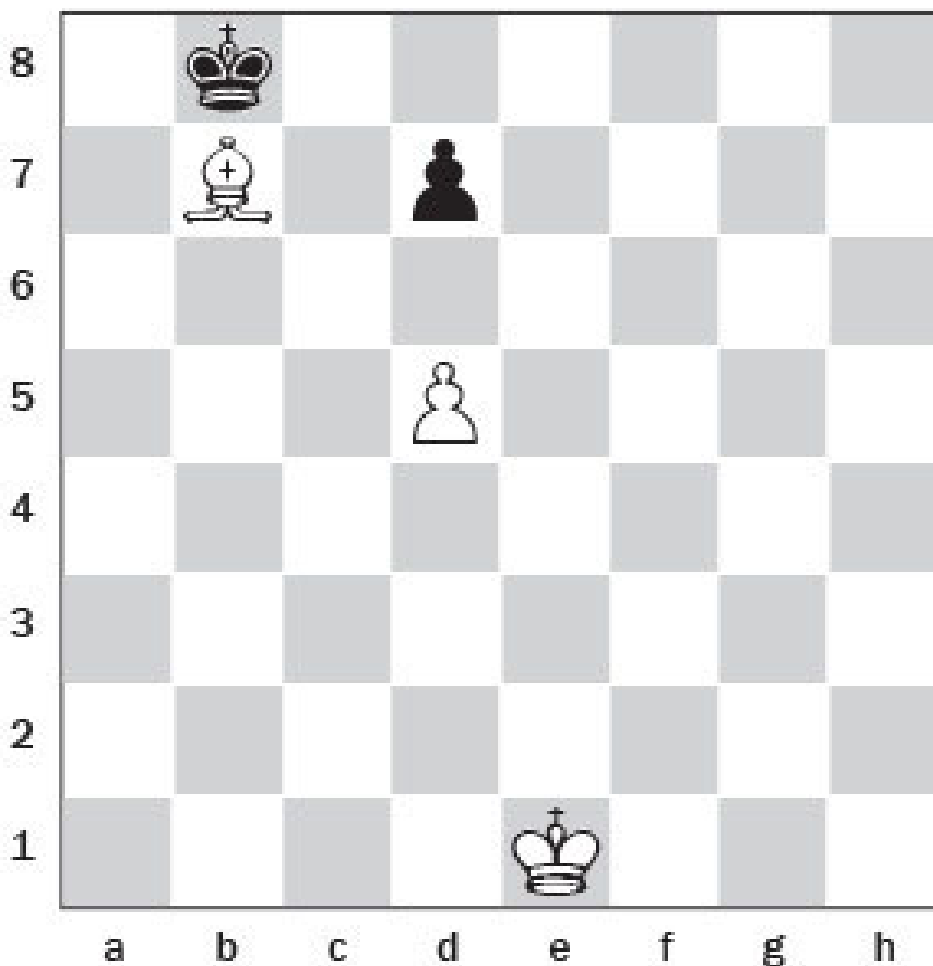
Answer:

1. Kg1 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

[Exercise 41](#)

41



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

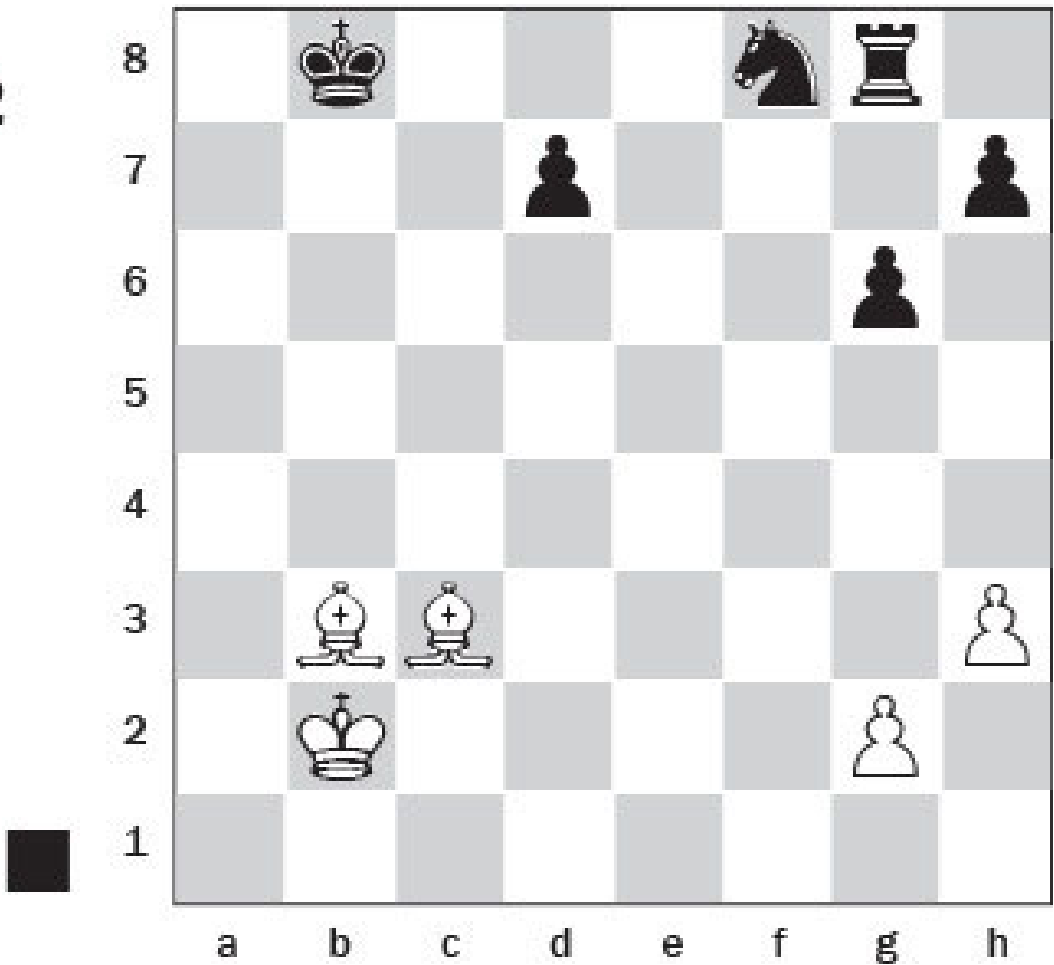
## HINT

Black's king is attacking the bishop. What should White do to save it?



## Exercise 42

42



Answer:

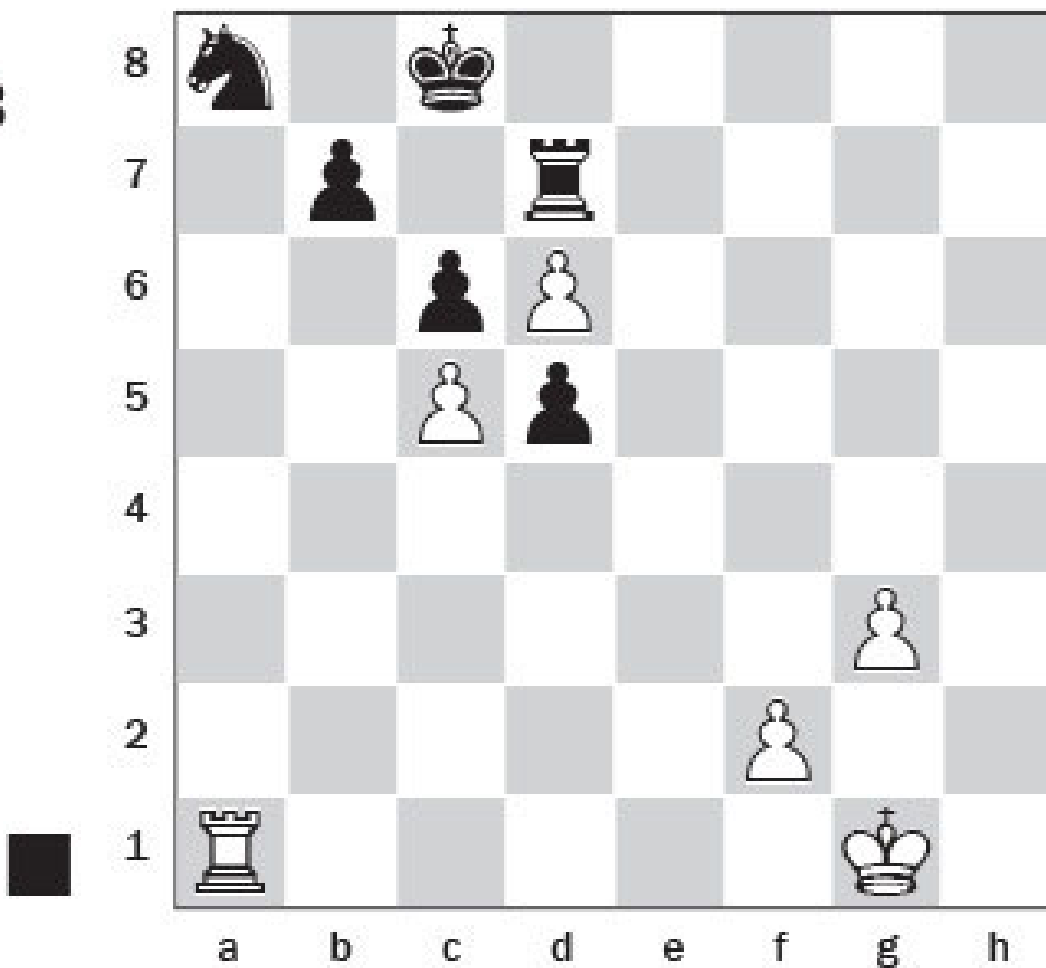
1. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The rook on g8 seems to be completely trapped by the bishops. How can Black avoid losing the rook?

## Exercise 43

43



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

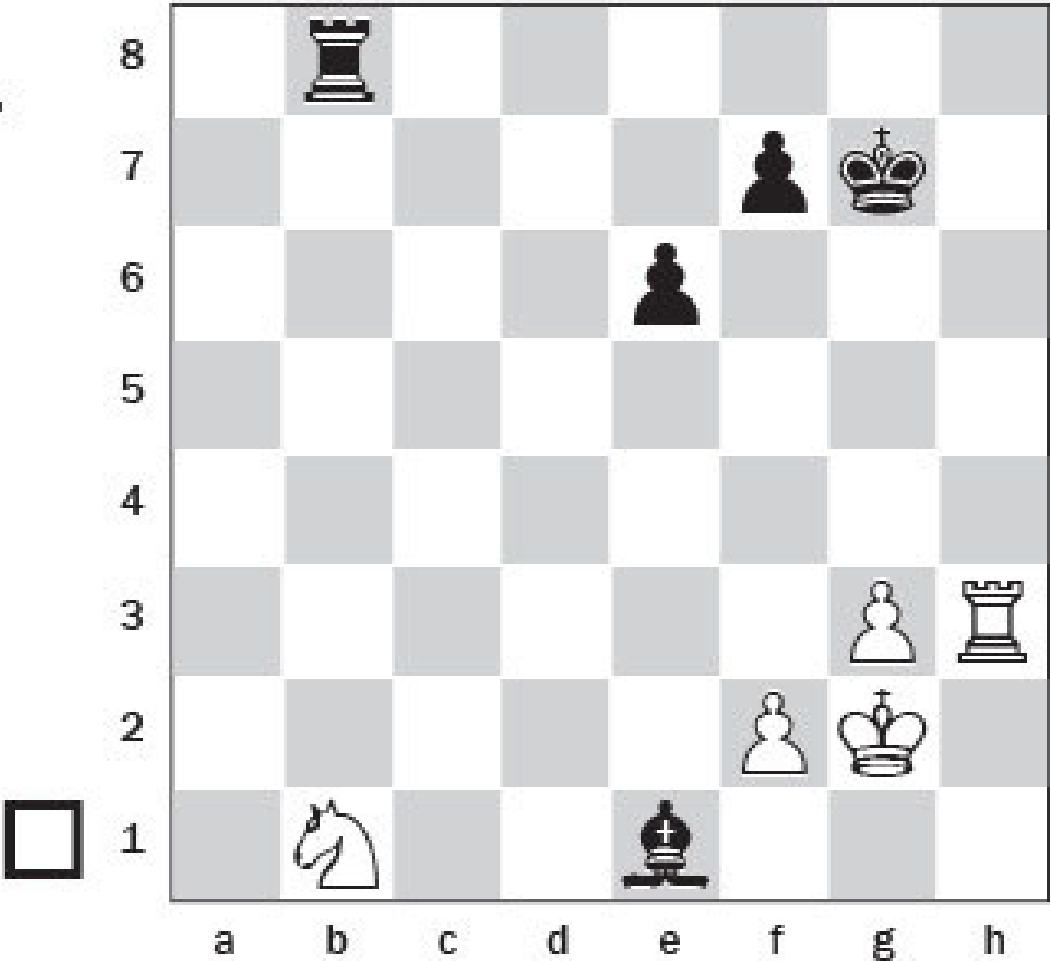
HINT

White's rook is attacking the knight. The pawns stop the knight from moving safely. How can Black avoid losing material?

# Intro to Defense – Test

## Exercise 44

44

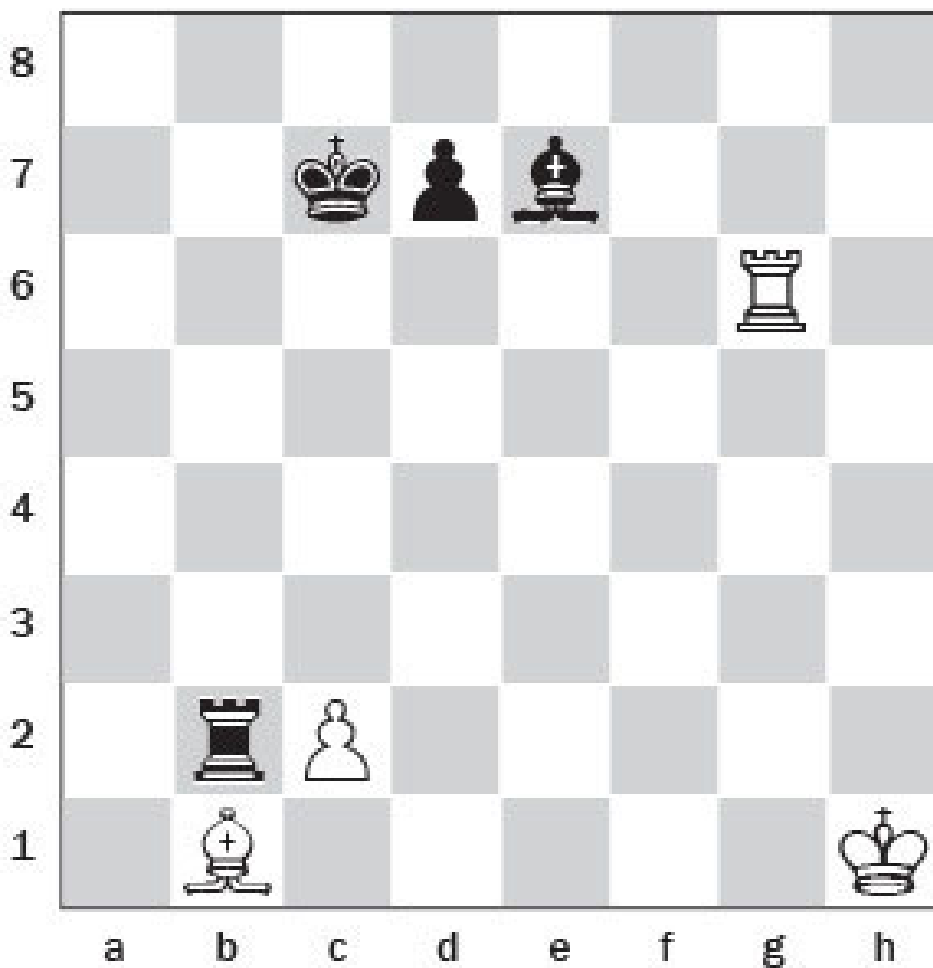


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 45

45

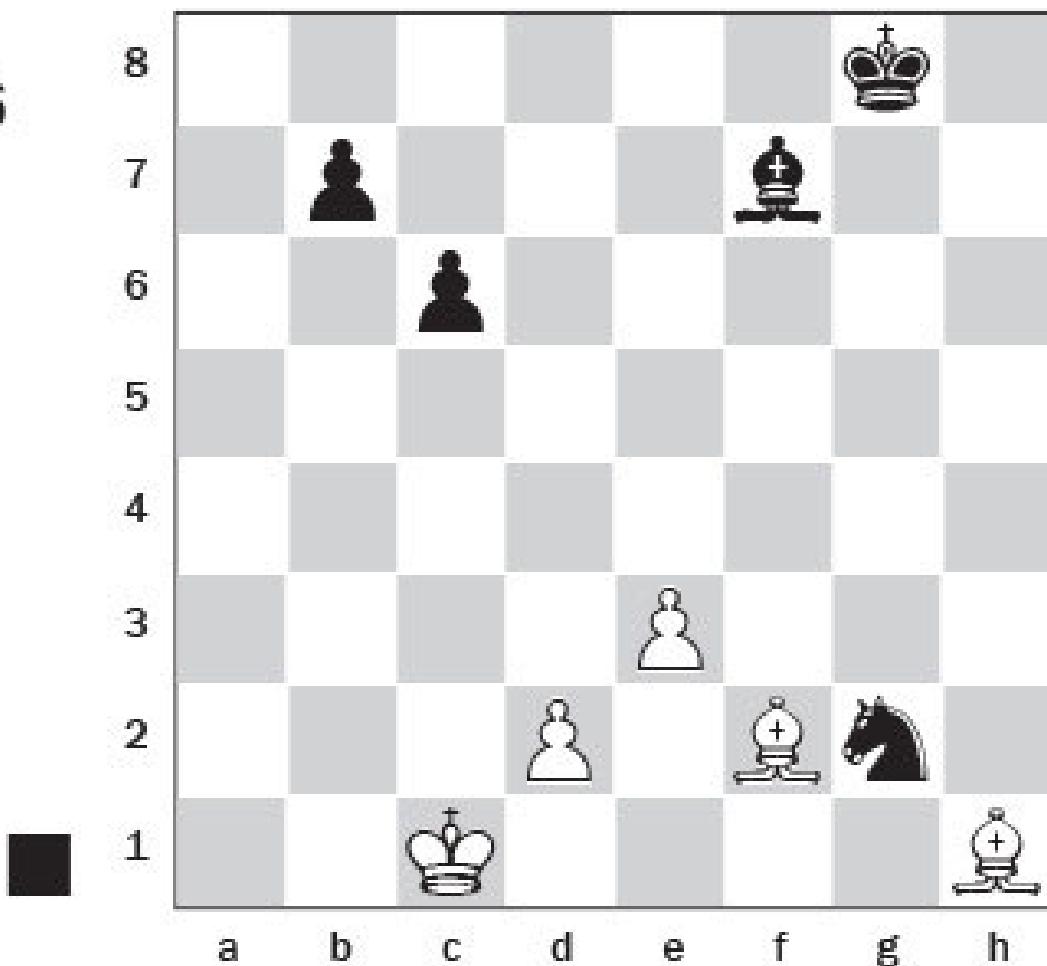


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 46

46

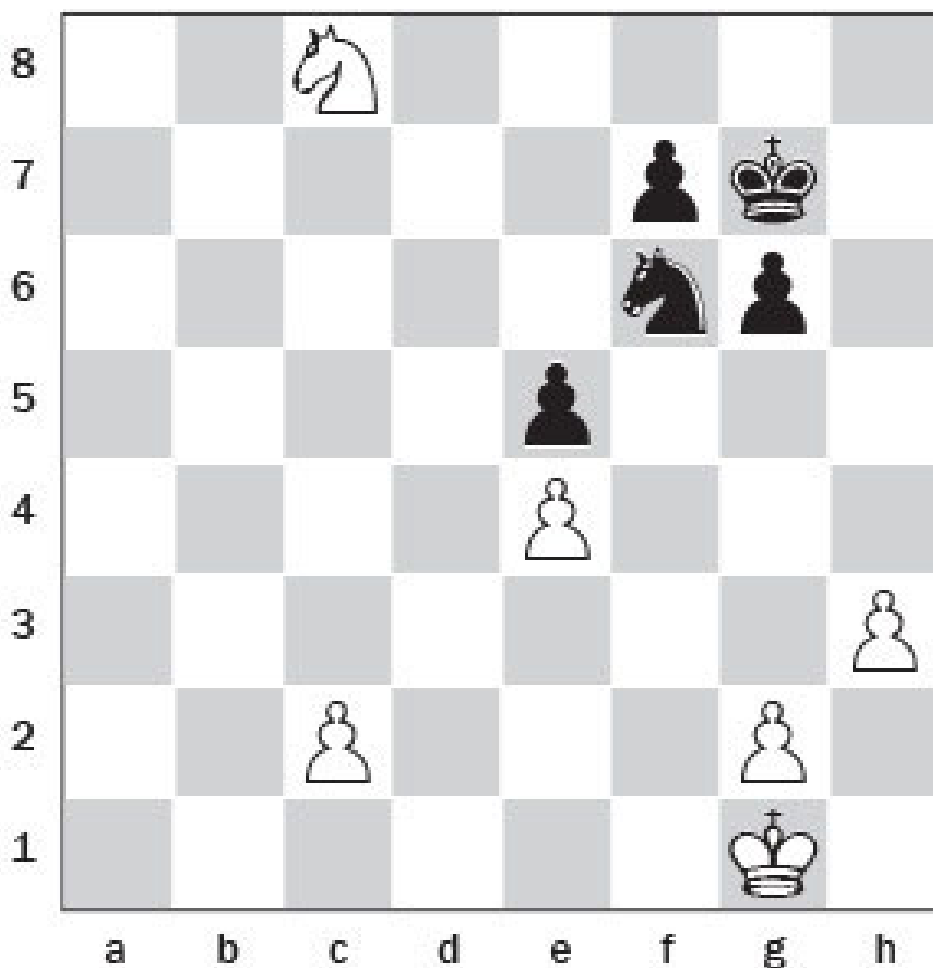


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 47](#)

47

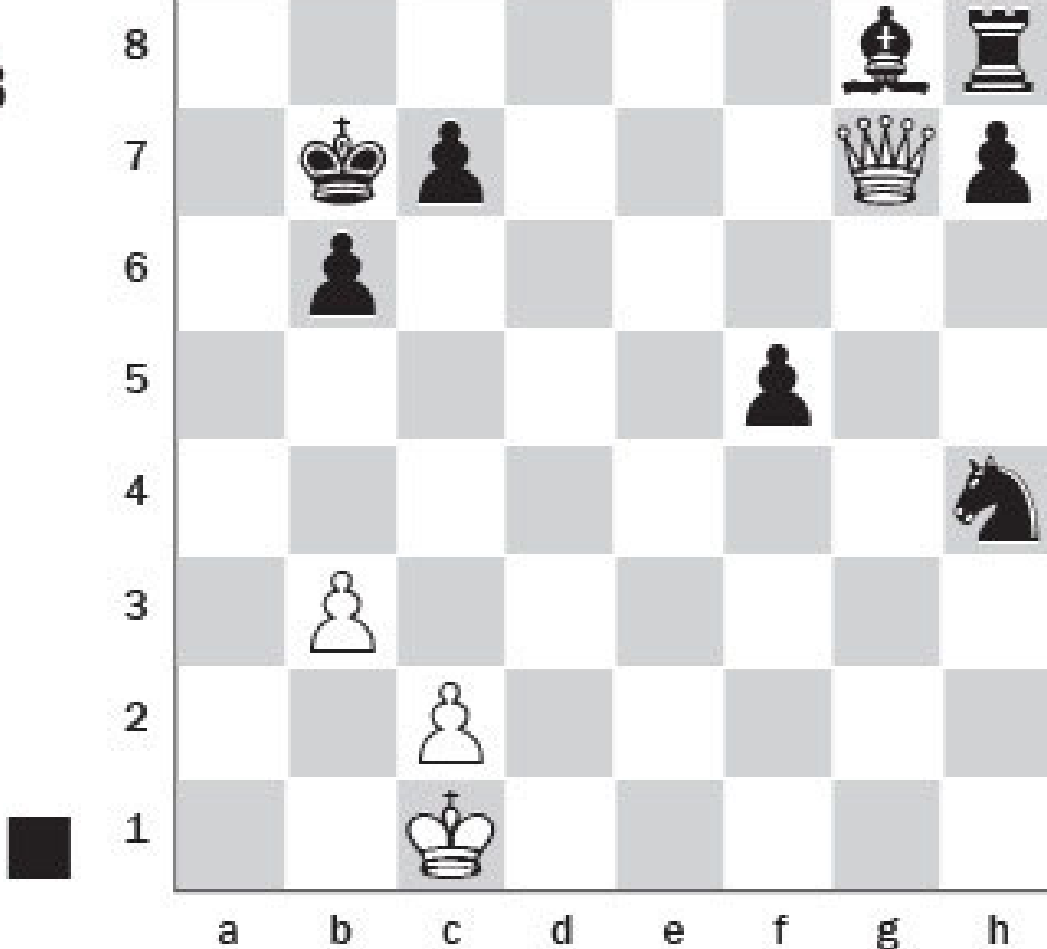


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 48](#)

48



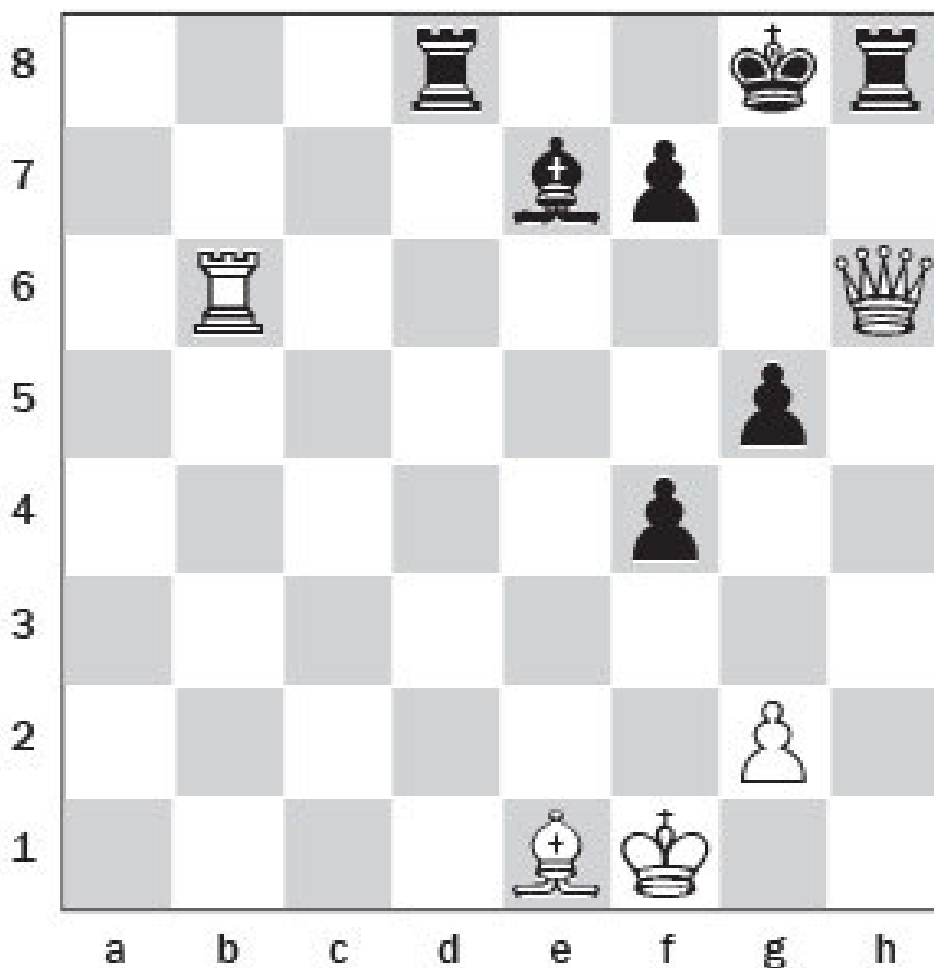
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 49](#)



49

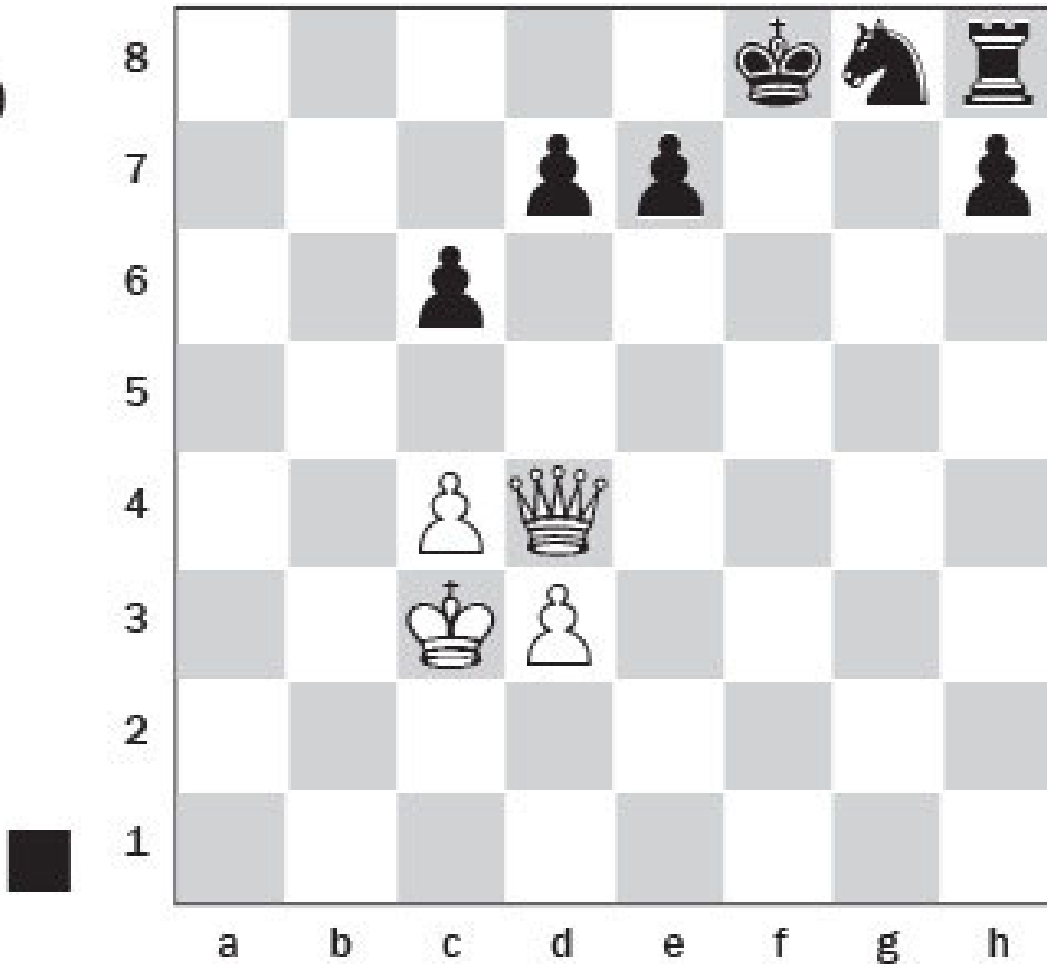


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 50](#)

50

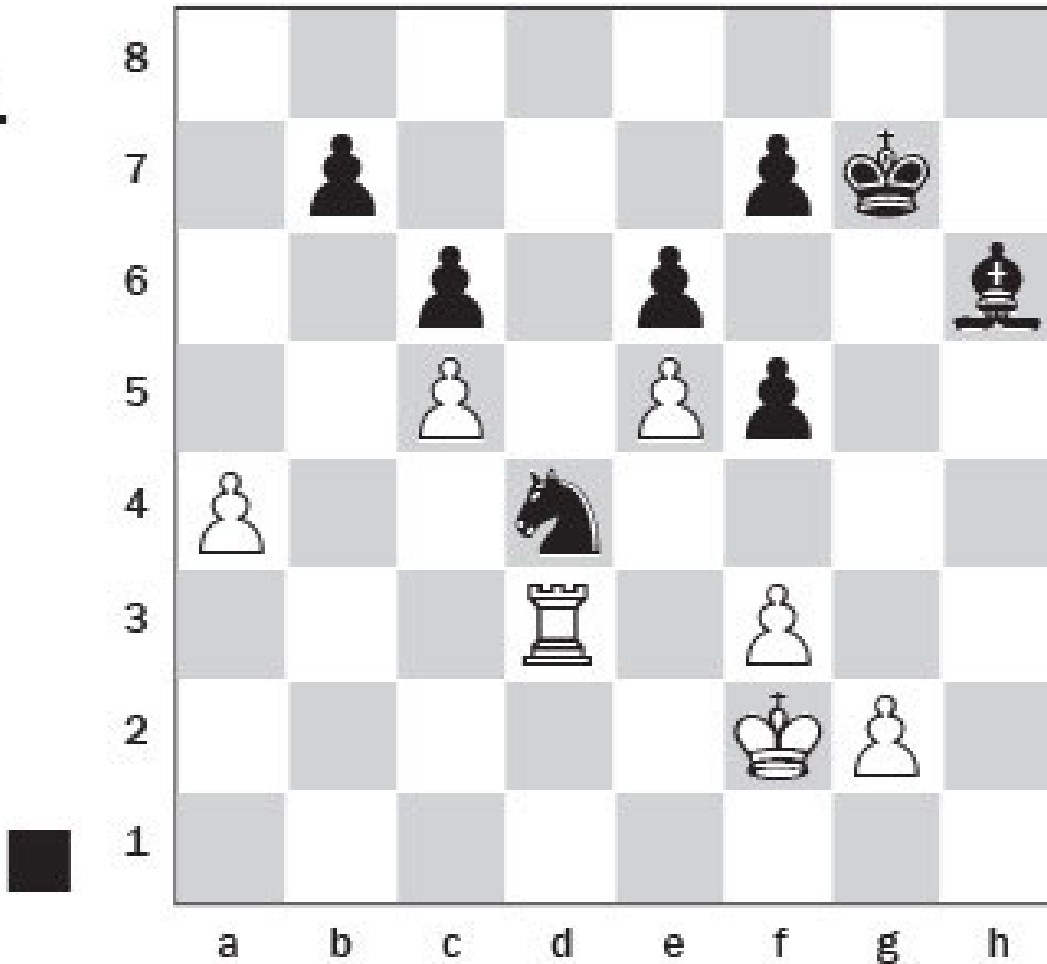


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 51](#)

51

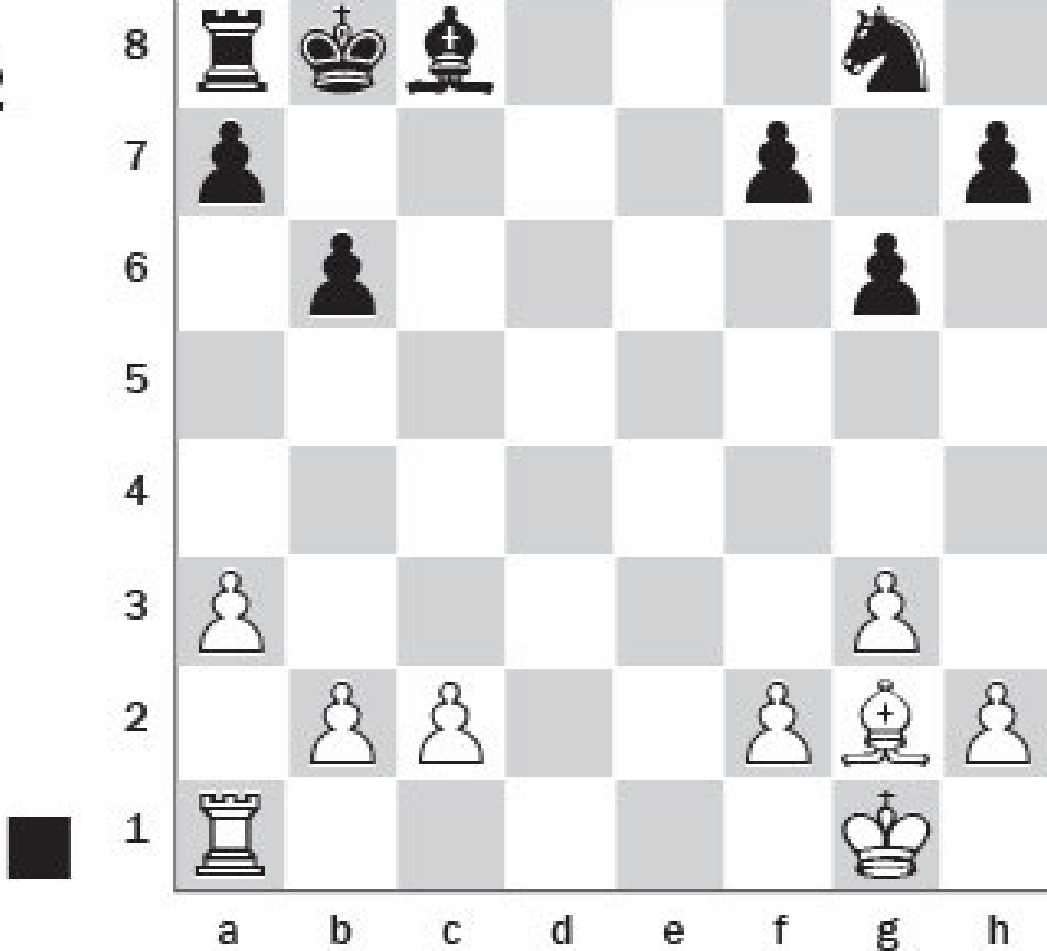


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 52](#)

52



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 4

# Assorted Checkmates in One

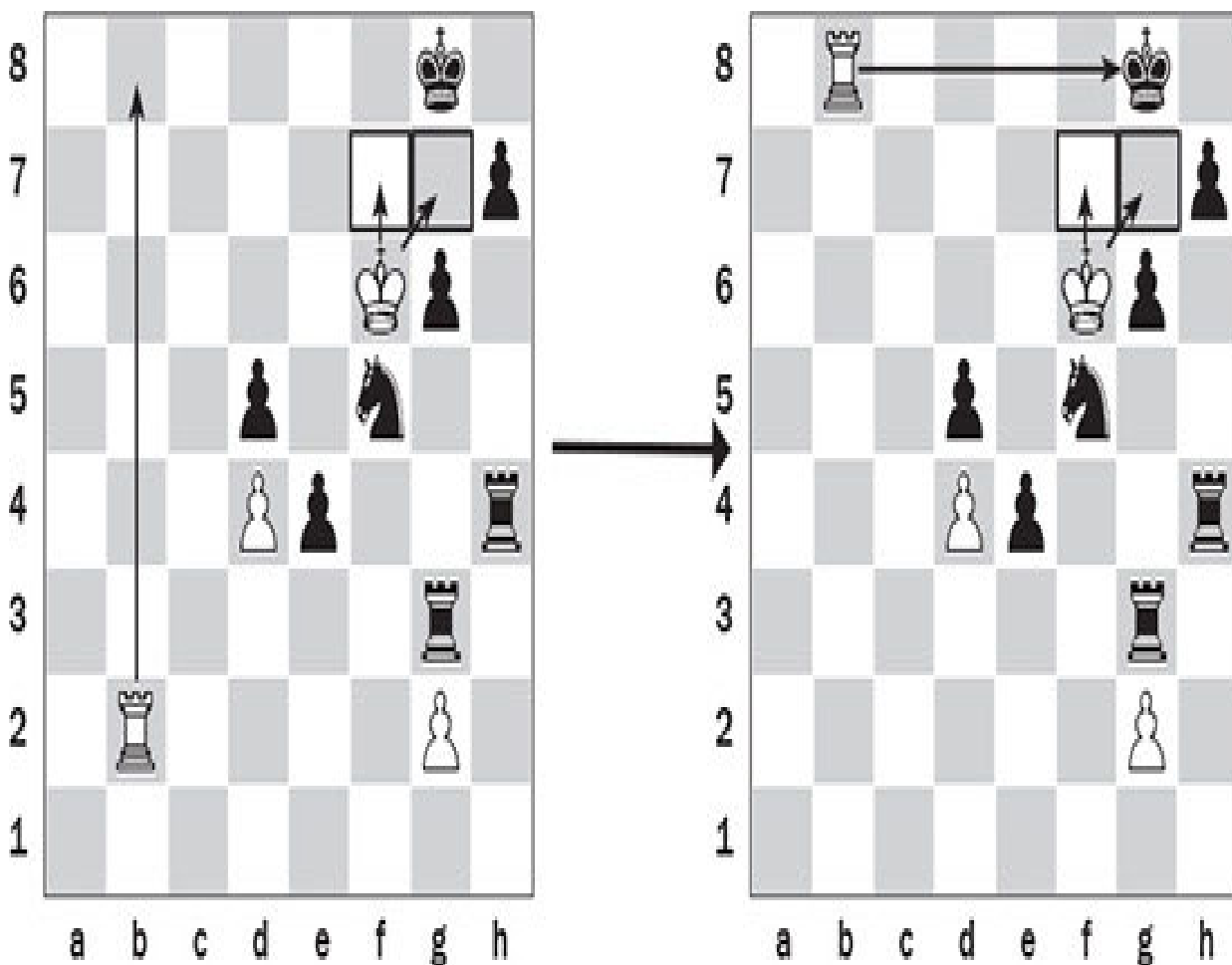
Checkmate ends the game. There is no more important skill to master than delivering the final blow. In this chapter, you will practice executing checkmates in one move.

The checkmates in this chapter are broken down into four categories:

1. Basic checkmates;
2. Helper or supporting checkmates;
3. Checkmates using a battery;
4. Back rank checkmates.

## Basic Checkmates

In this section of the chapter, you will give checkmates where the king is checked from a safe distance. In the following example, White's king is boxing in the black king on the back rank. White's rook can check the king from b8 and issue a checkmate. Let's see:

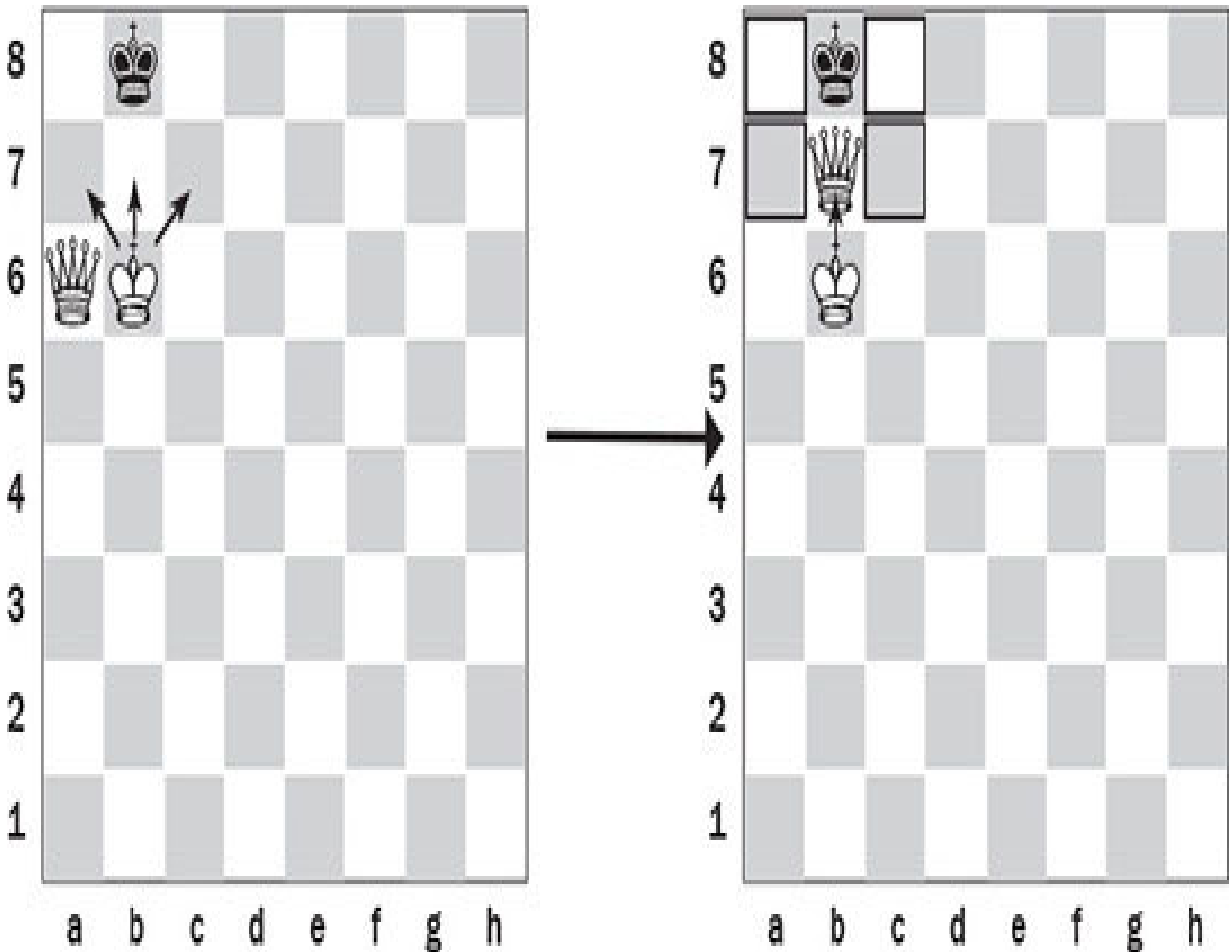


**1.Rb8# (see diagram 2)**

The rook checks the black king on the 8th rank from a safe distance; the white king prevents Black's escape to the 7th rank – checkmate.

## Helper/Supporting Checkmates

A helper or supporting checkmate is one when you check from a very close distance and the checking piece is protected so that it cannot be captured by the king. Let's take a look at the following example:



The white king is protecting the squares a7, b7, and c7. The white queen could use any of the squares to attack the black king since they are protected. Let's see:

**1.Qb7# (see diagram 2)**

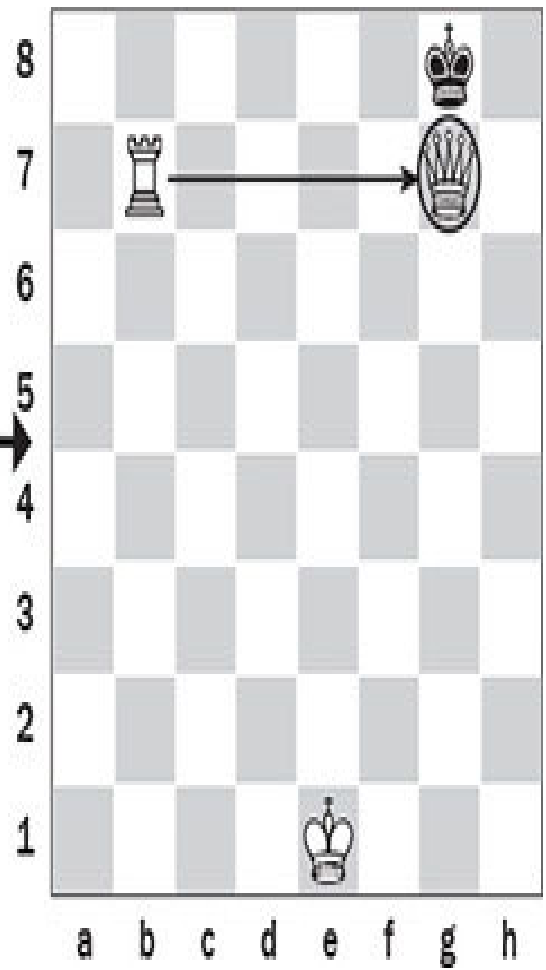
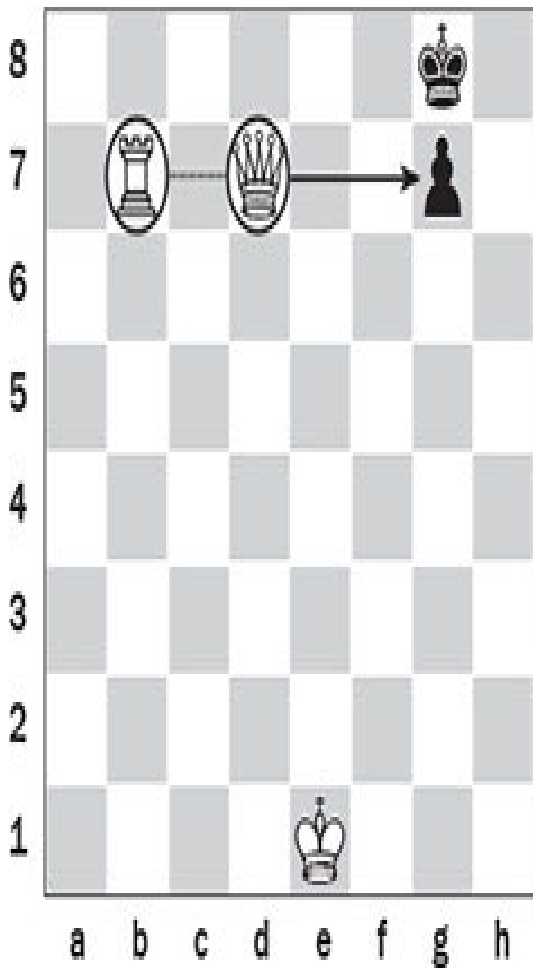
Checkmate! The white king is protecting the queen and therefore Black cannot capture. The king is the 'helper' or 'supporting' piece in this particular case. All pieces can serve as helpers in a checkmate as you will see in this section of the chapter.

## **Battery Checkmates**

A battery is when two pieces that move along the same line (rank, file or diagonal) partner up for an attack. A battery checkmate is when the result of the said attack is checkmate. A battery checkmate is a form of helper checkmate.

Note to student: when your pieces are lined up in a battery, they protect one another and act as two attackers together!





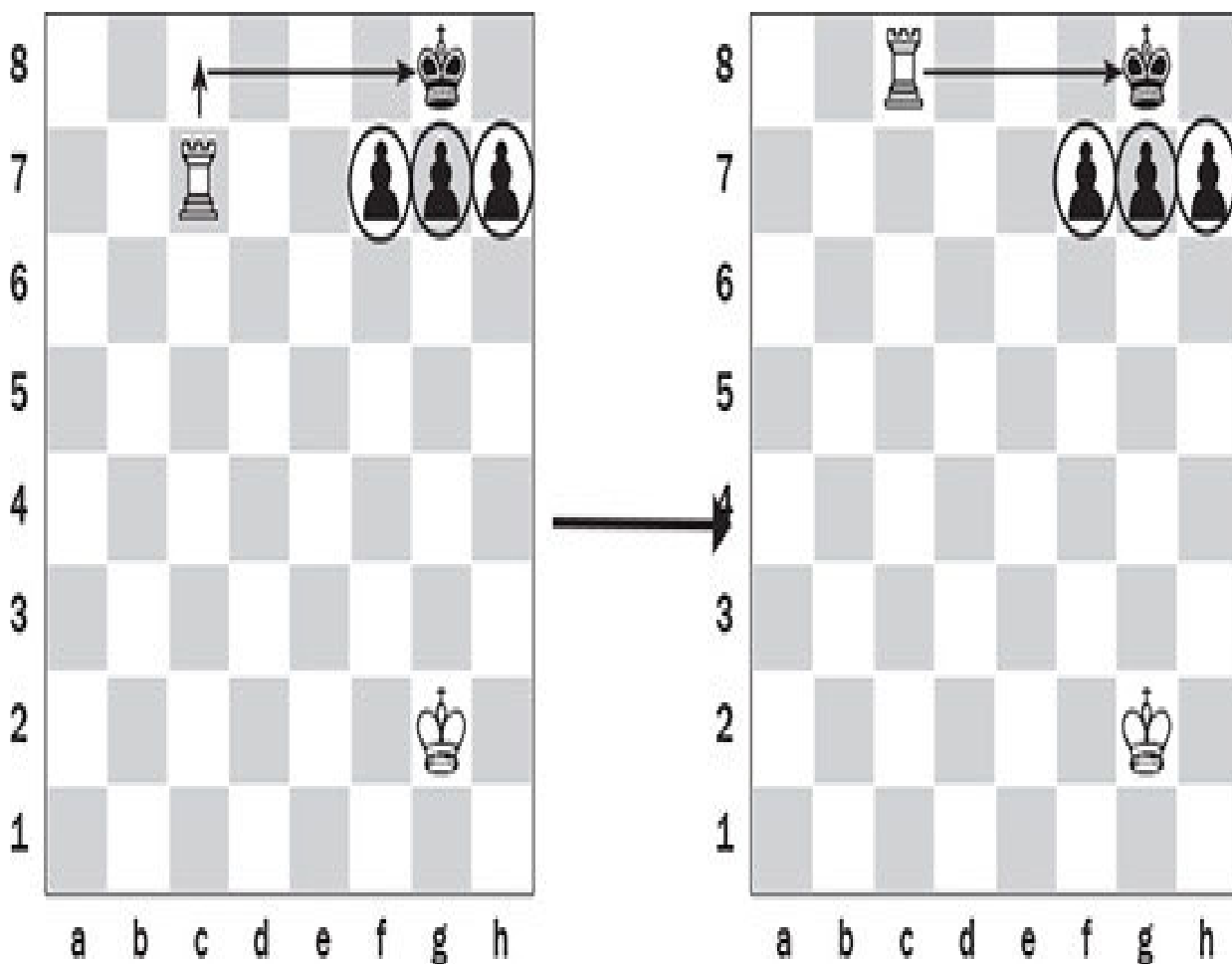
The rook and queen are aligned on the 7th rank. Because the rook and queen can both move horizontally, they protect one another in the form of a battery. With the correct move, White could end the game by checkmate:

### 1.Qxg7# (see diagram 2)

Notice that the rook protects (helps) the queen so that the king cannot capture.

## Back Rank Checkmates

A back rank checkmate is a common type of checkmate that occurs when a queen or rook delivers check along the back rank, and the king cannot escape to the next rank forward, due to its own pieces. Generally it is good to have a pawn shield in front of your king. Having said that, a pawn shield that hasn't moved blocks the king from moving forward which may lead to positions where a back rank checkmate is possible.

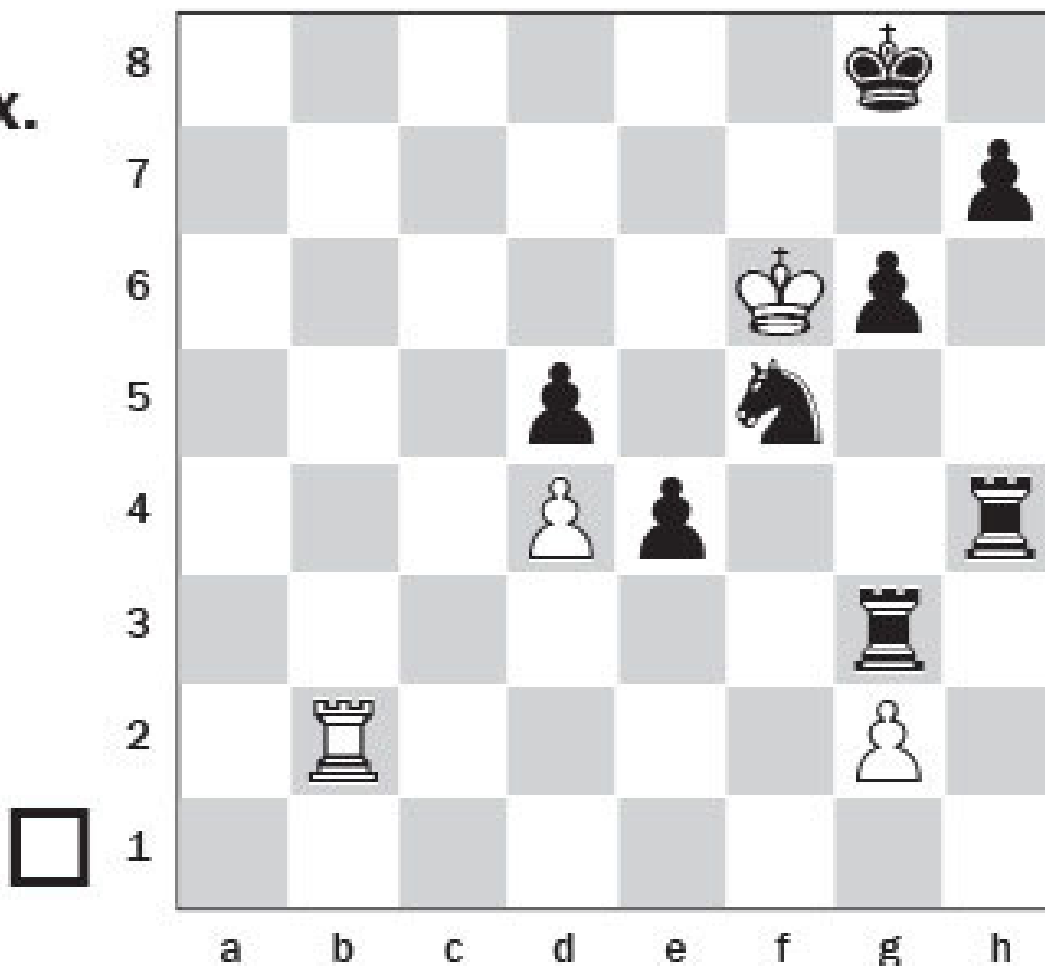


The best move for White is 1.Rc8# (see diagram 2).

White's rook attacks the 8th rank and Black's king is trapped by its own pawns, resulting in checkmate. The back rank checkmate is quite a common checkmate and in chess it's important to keep an eye out for this pattern. We will look at more difficult versions of this checkmate later in the book.

# Basic Checkmates in One – Guided Practice

Ex.



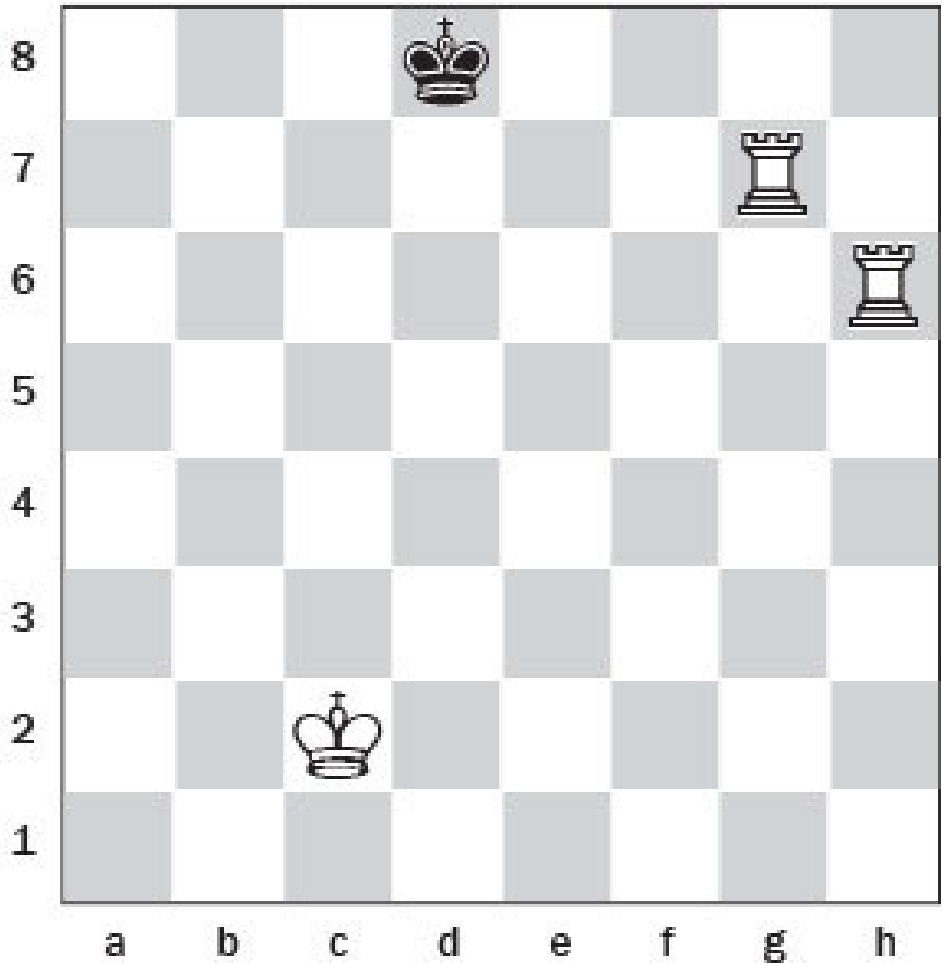
Answer:

1. Rb8# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 53

**53**



Answer:

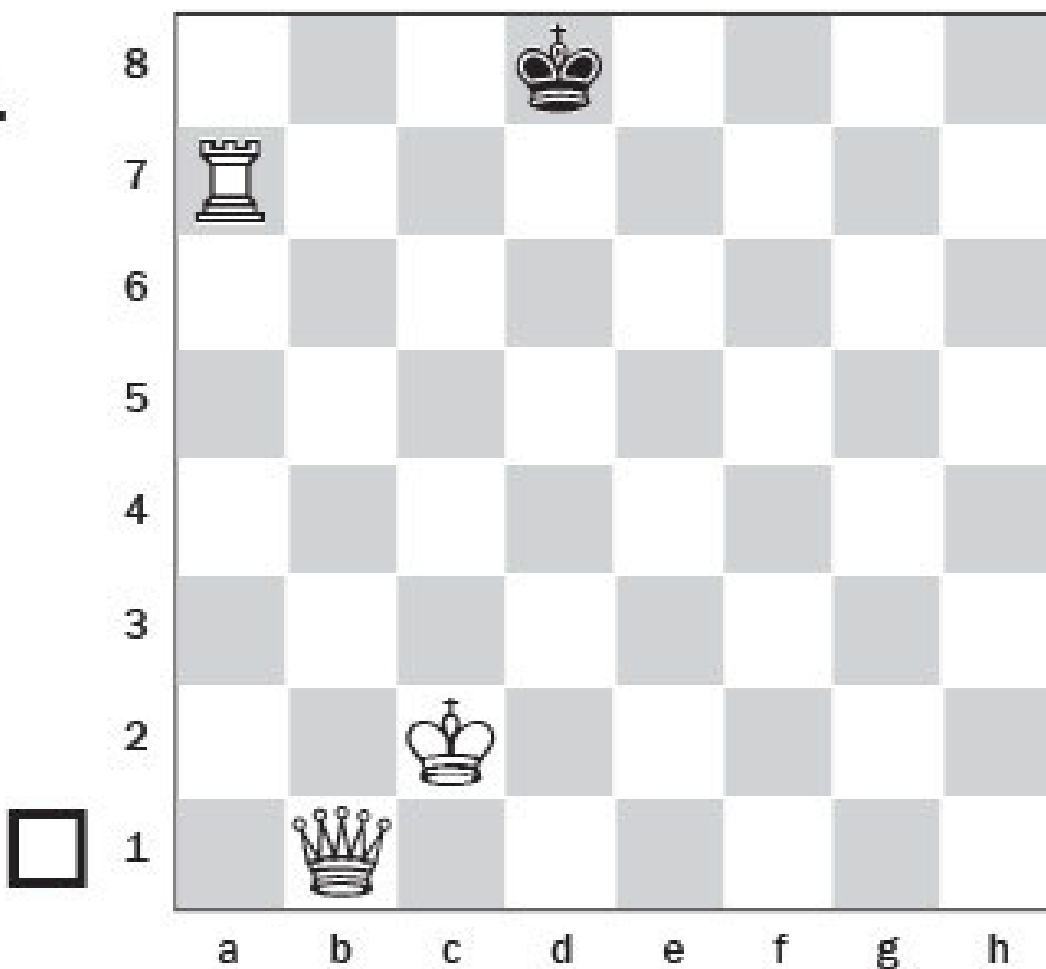
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

This is the end of a checkmate called the 'ladder checkmate'. White's rook on g7 stops the king from coming forward. What should White do?

### Exercise 54

**54**



Answer:

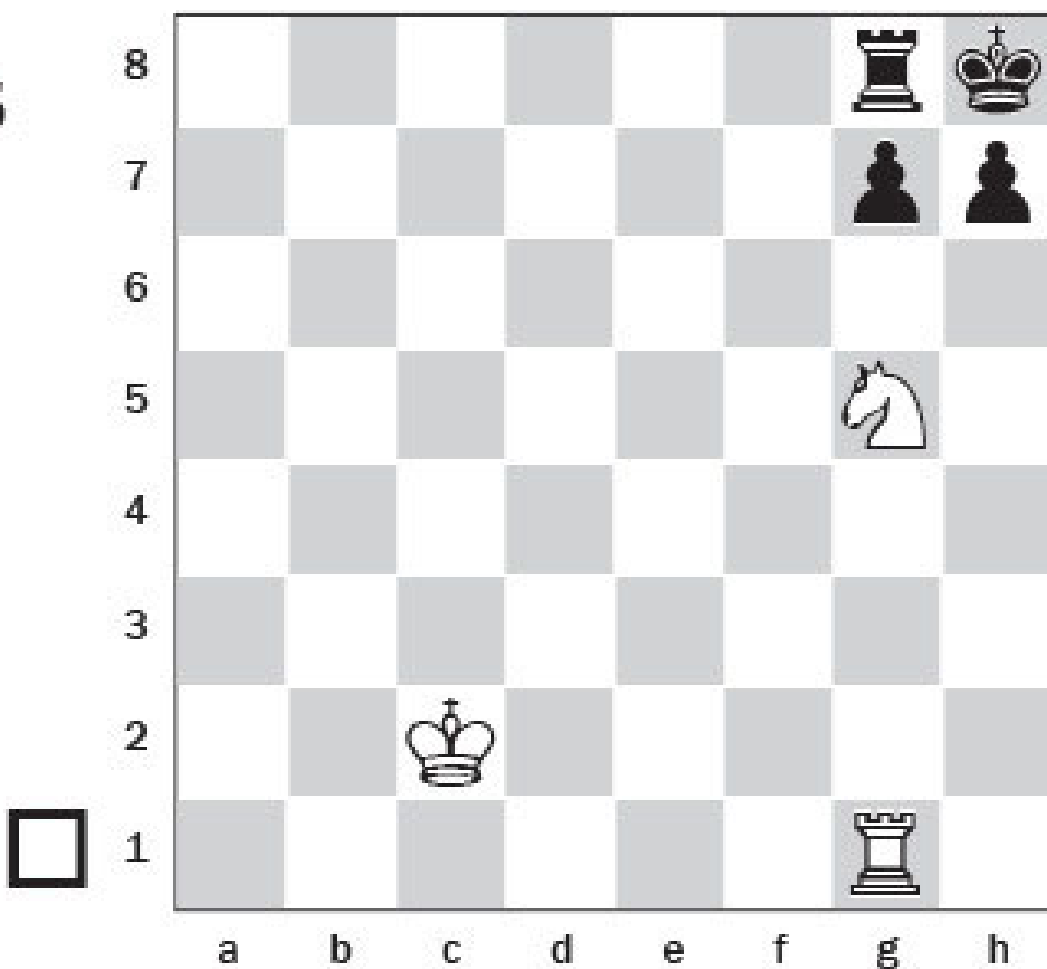
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Similar to the last example, White's rook is stopping the king from moving off of the back rank. Use all of your pieces!

### Exercise 55

**55**



Answer:

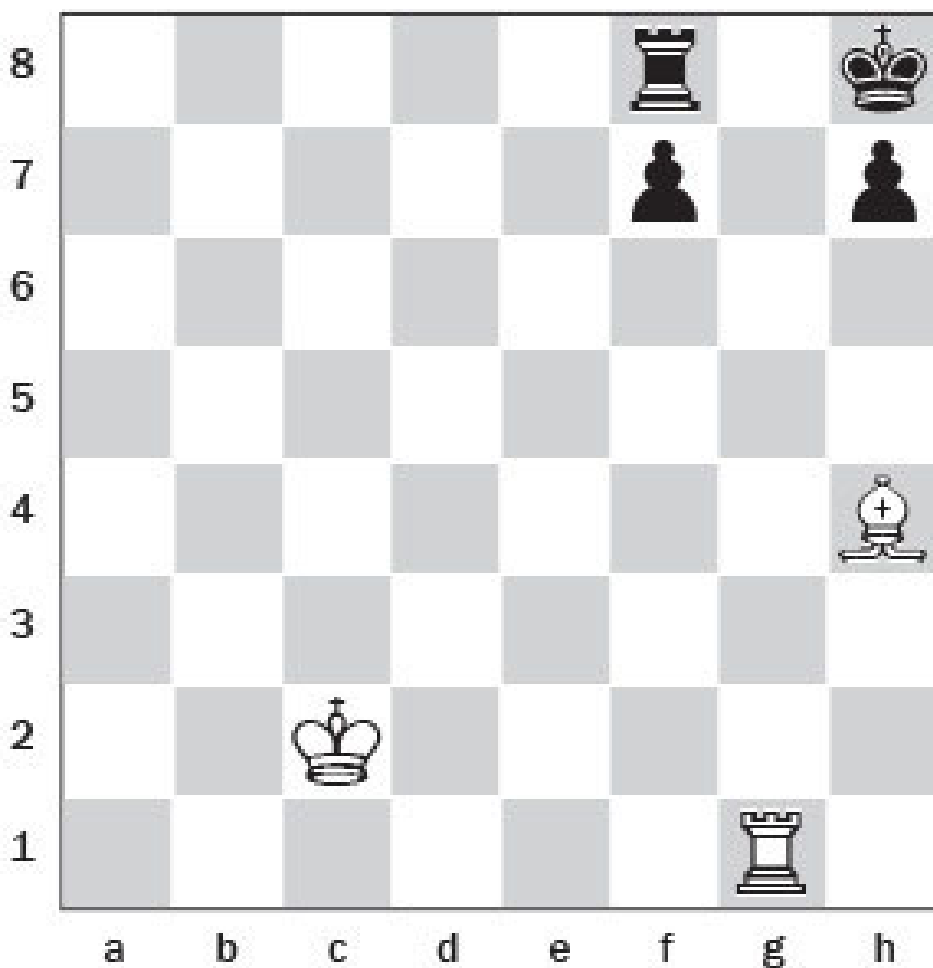
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The black king is surrounded by its own pieces and cannot move.  
What can White do?

### Exercise 56

**56**





Answer:

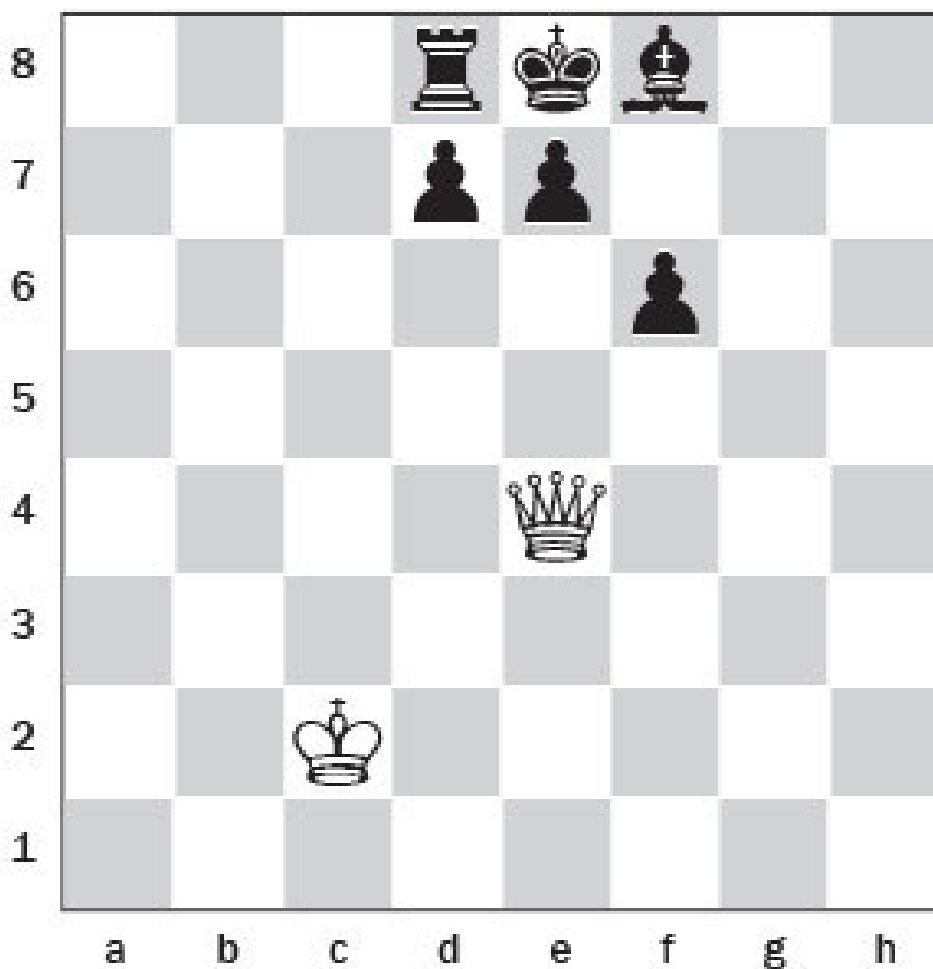
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's rook is cutting off the king. How can White finish the game?

### Exercise 57

**57**



Answer:

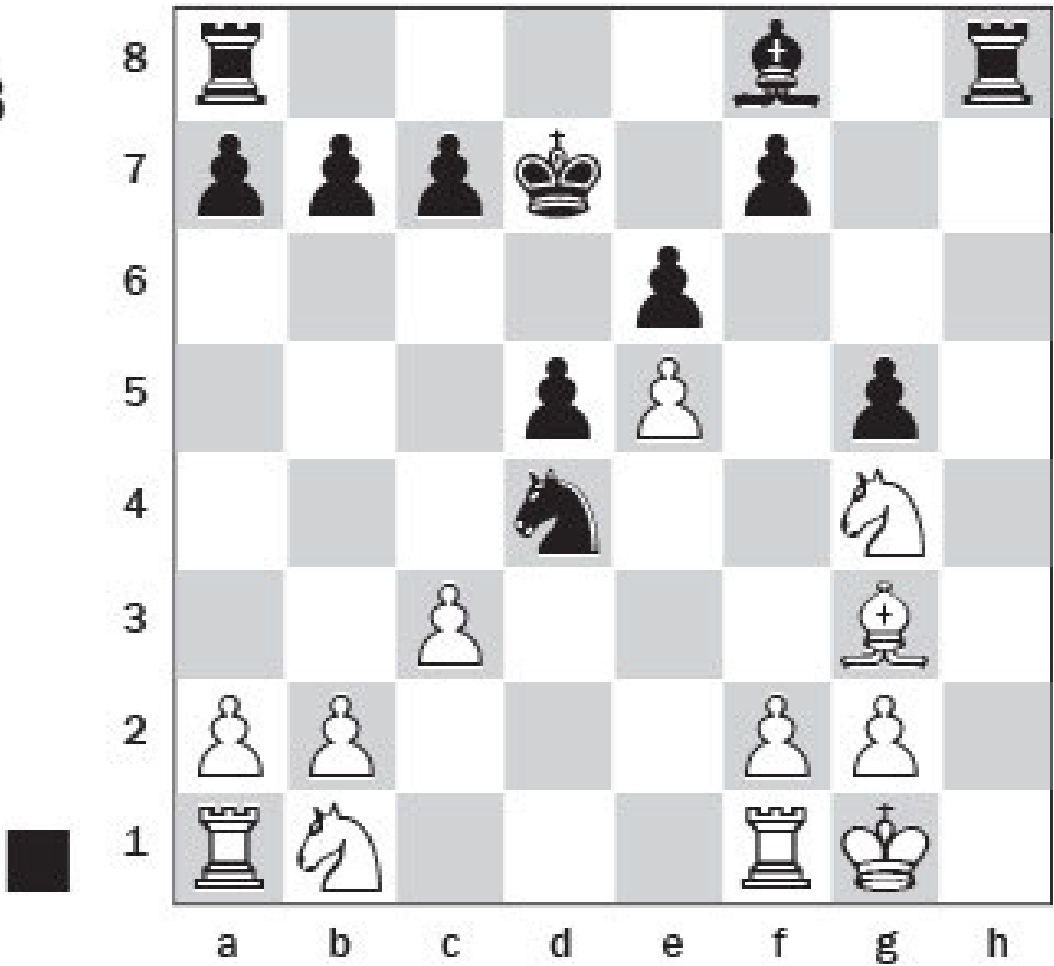
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black has moved their f-pawn and left the king open on a particular diagonal.

## Exercise 58

58



Answer:

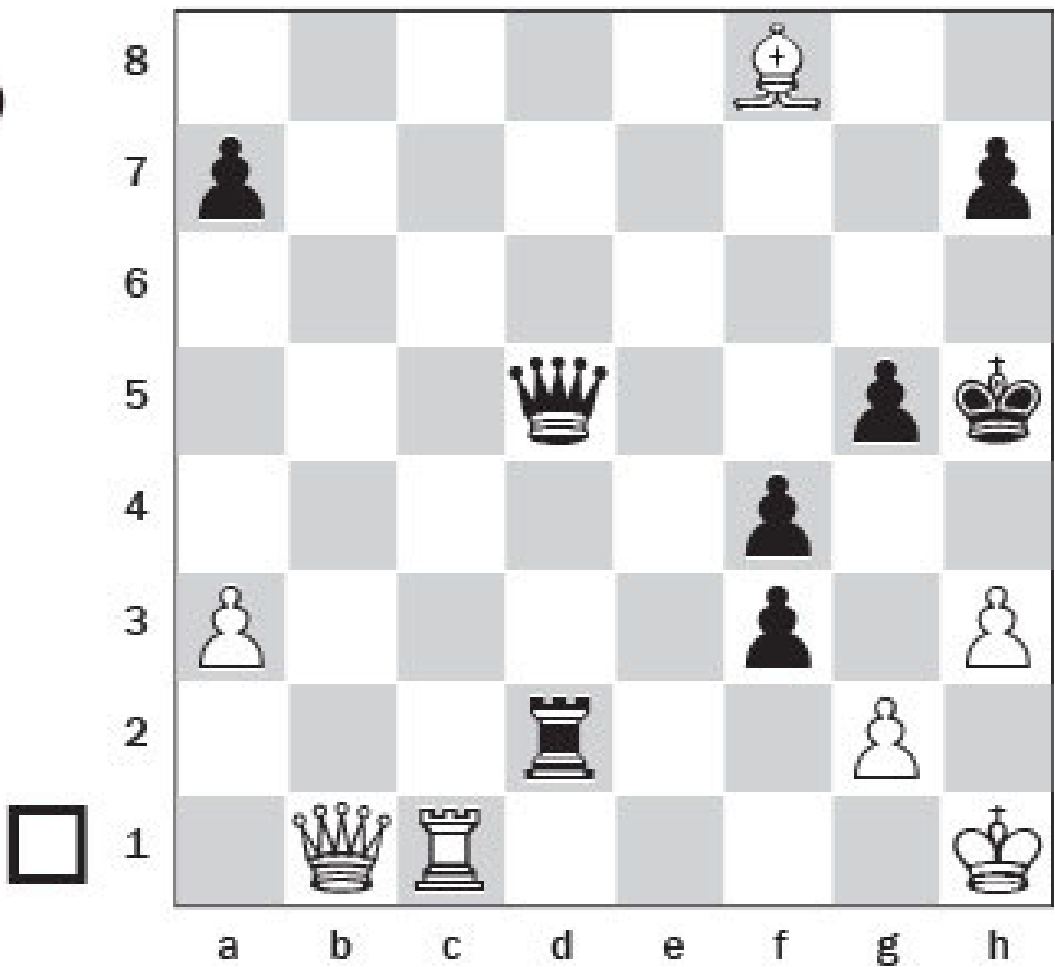
1. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Black's rook is attacking the entire h-file. White's king otherwise cannot move. What should Black play?

## Exercise 59

59



Answer:

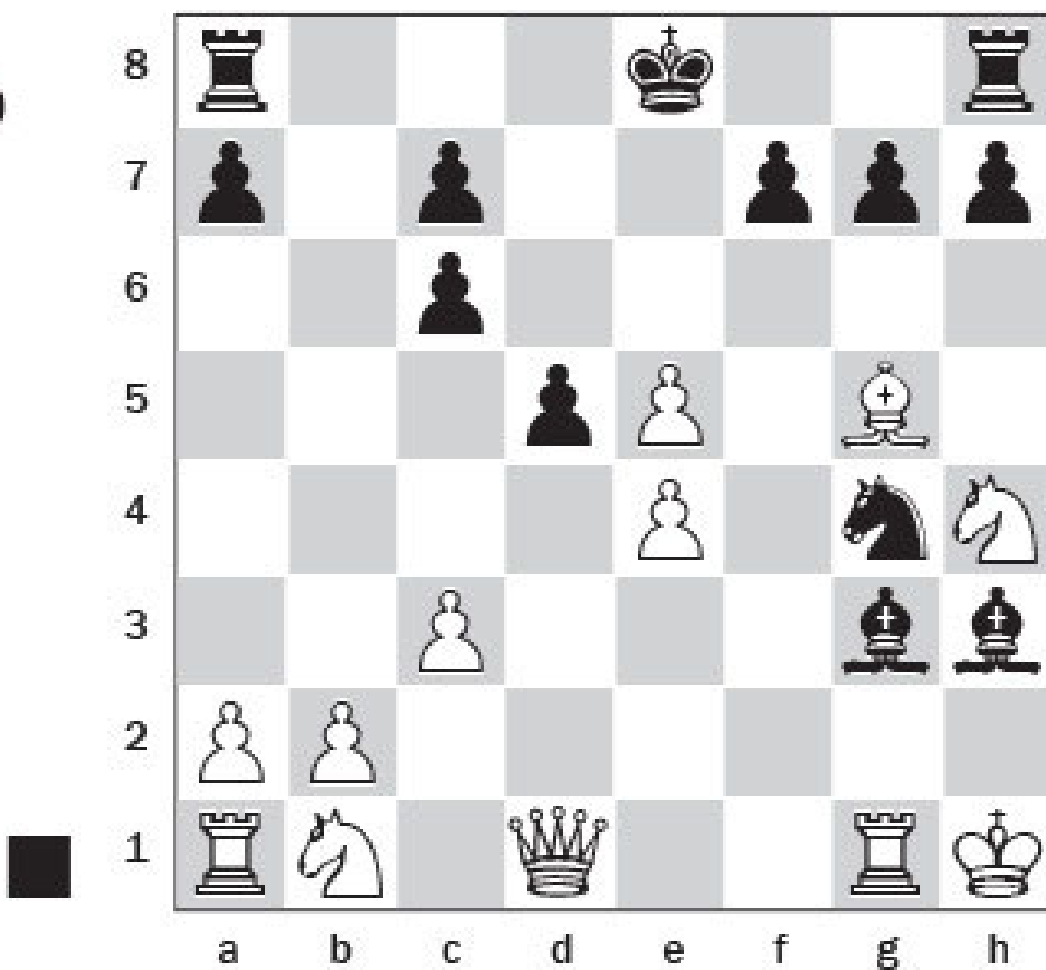
1. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Queens are long range pieces. Look at the whole board and find checkmate!

## Exercise 60

60



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

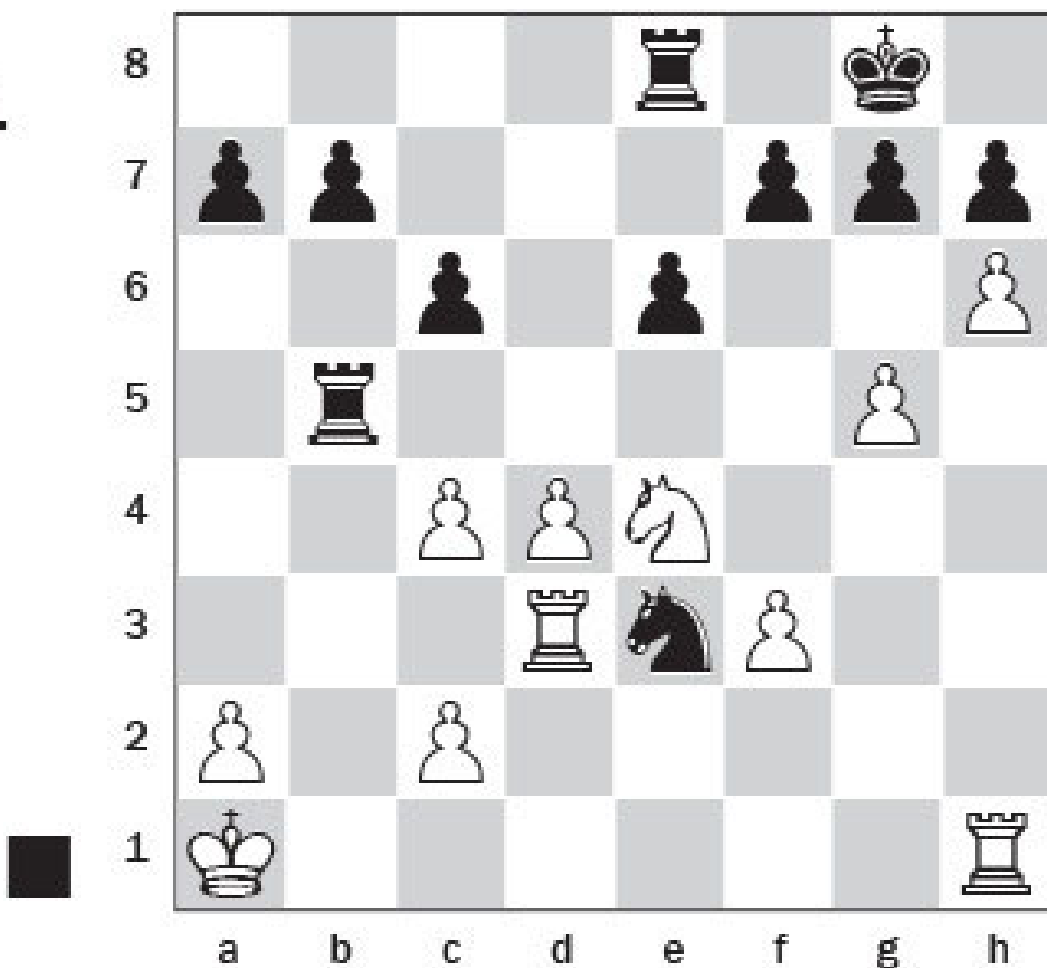
HINT

Black's bishops stop the king from moving, but the king is not in danger. Use a different piece to finish the game.

# Basic Checkmates in One – Test

## Exercise 61

**61**

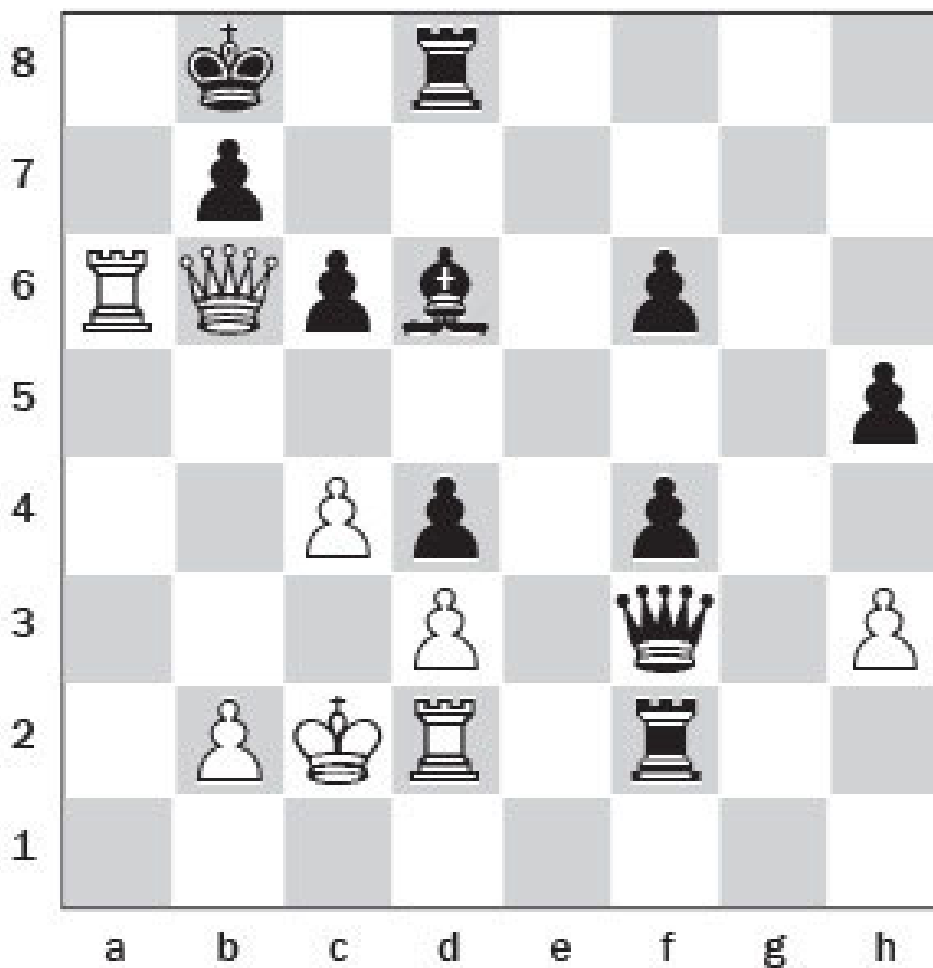


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 62

62



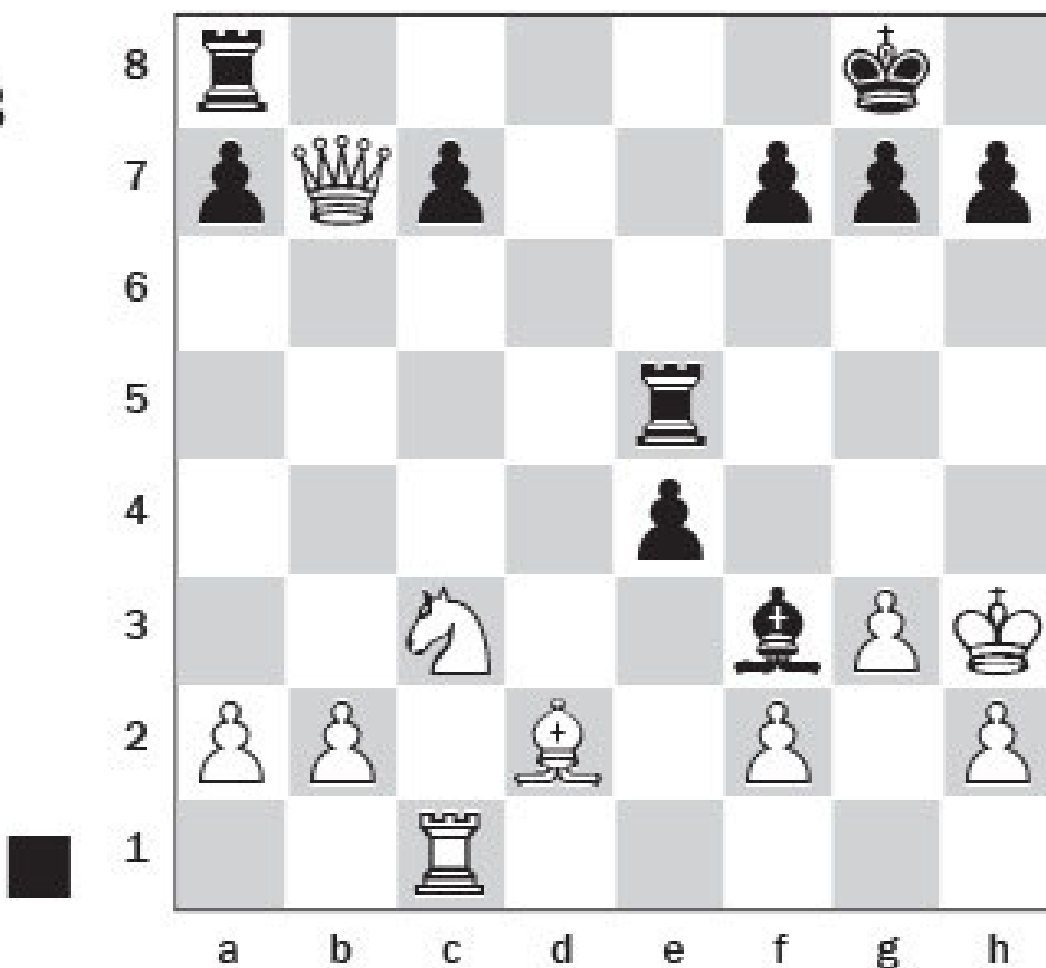
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 63



63

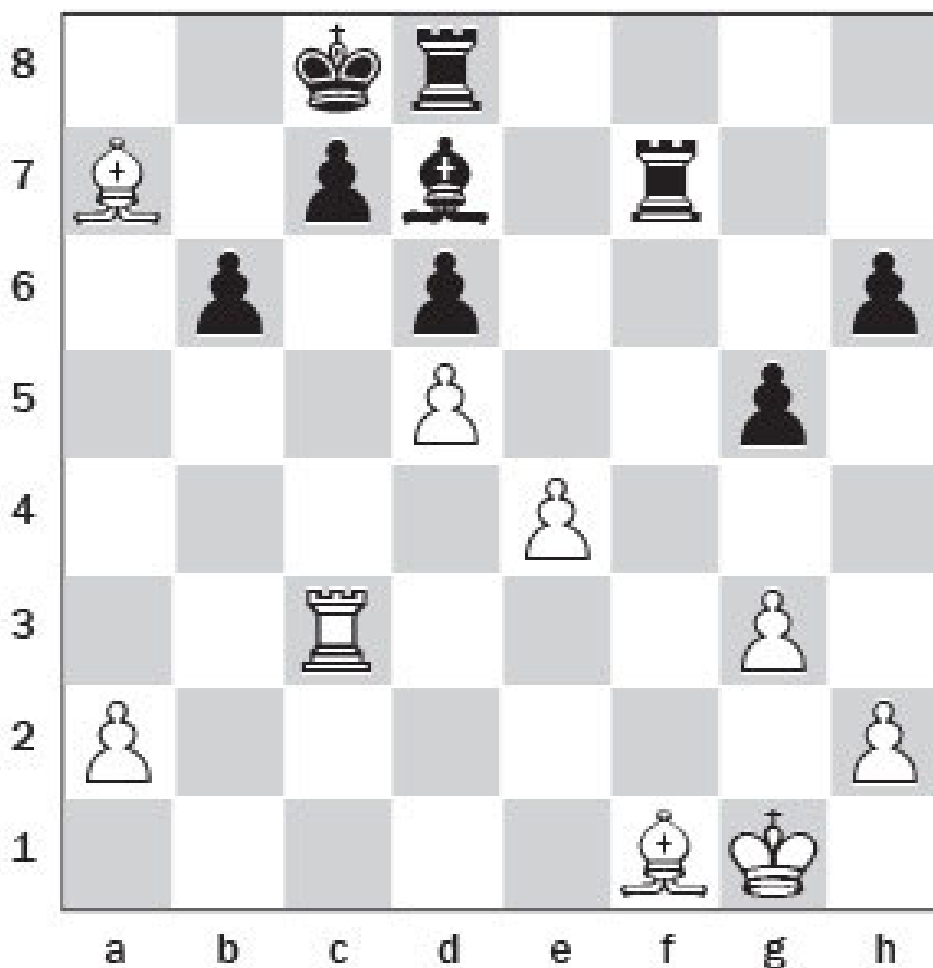


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 64](#)

64

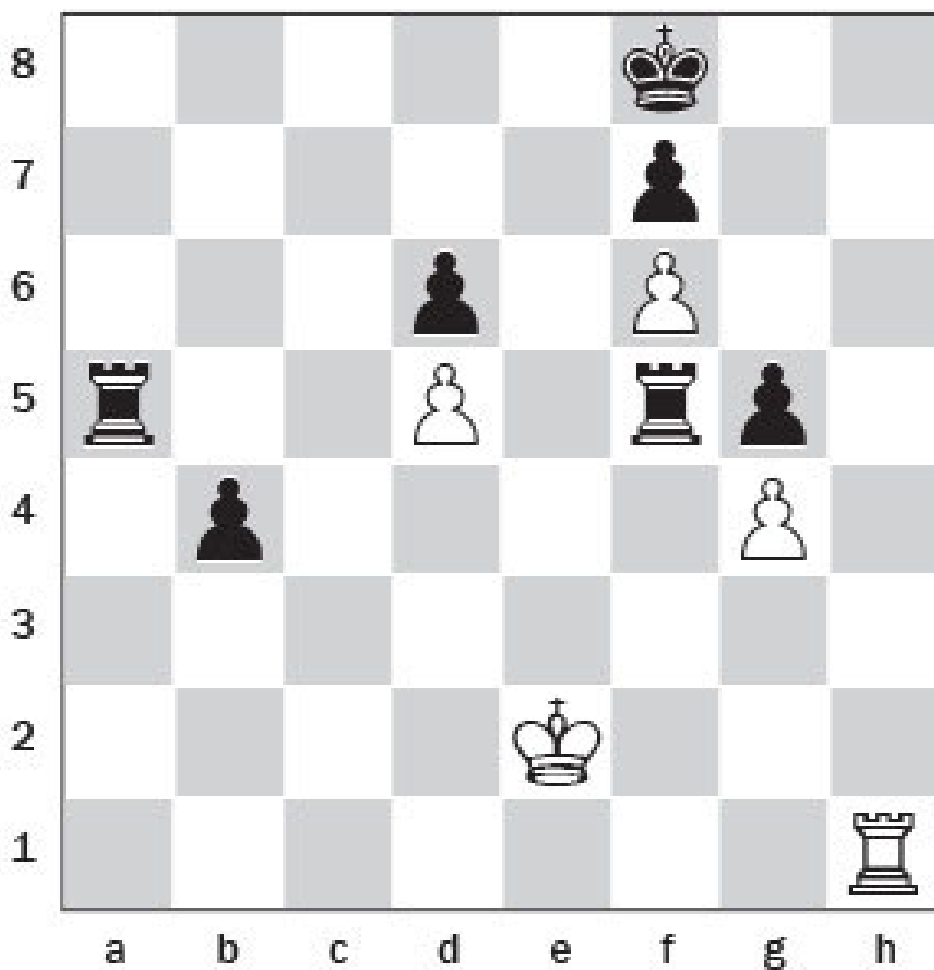


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 65](#)

65



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 66](#)

66



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 67](#)

67



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 68](#)

68

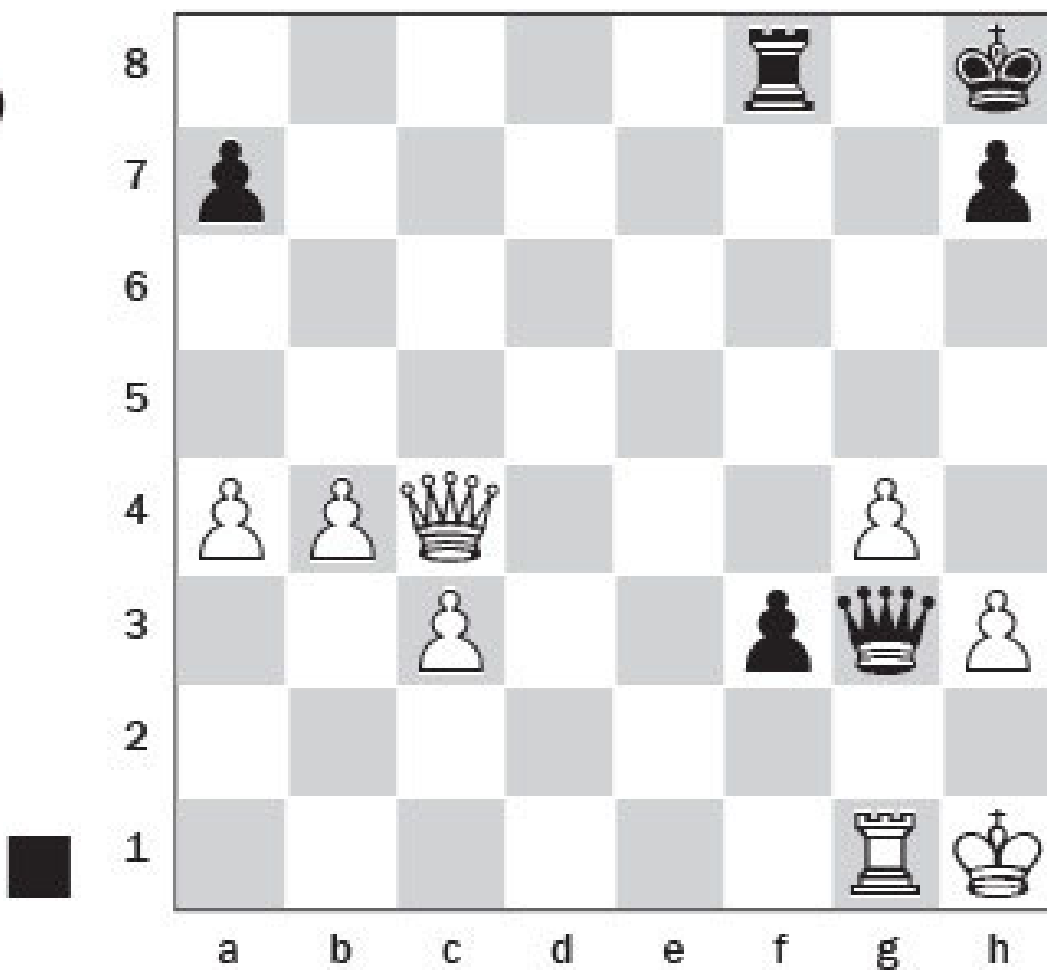


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 69](#)

69

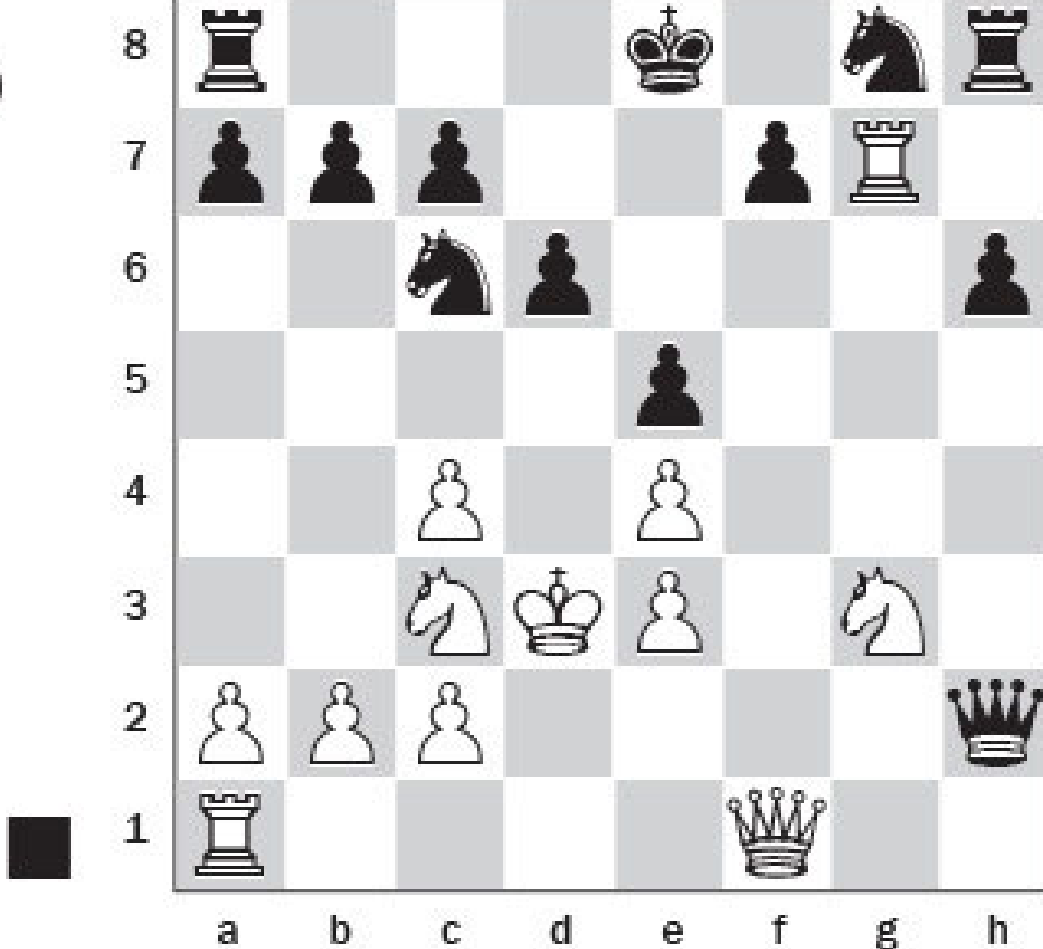


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 70](#)

70



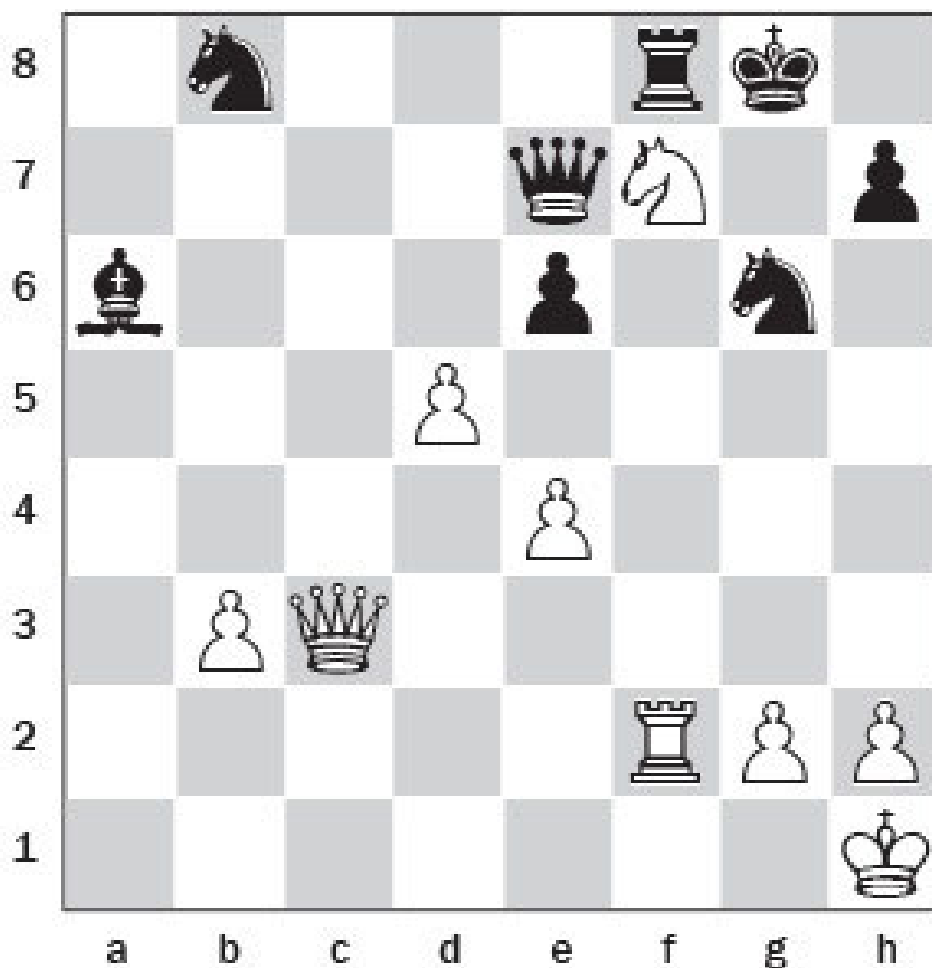
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 71](#)



71



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 72](#)

72

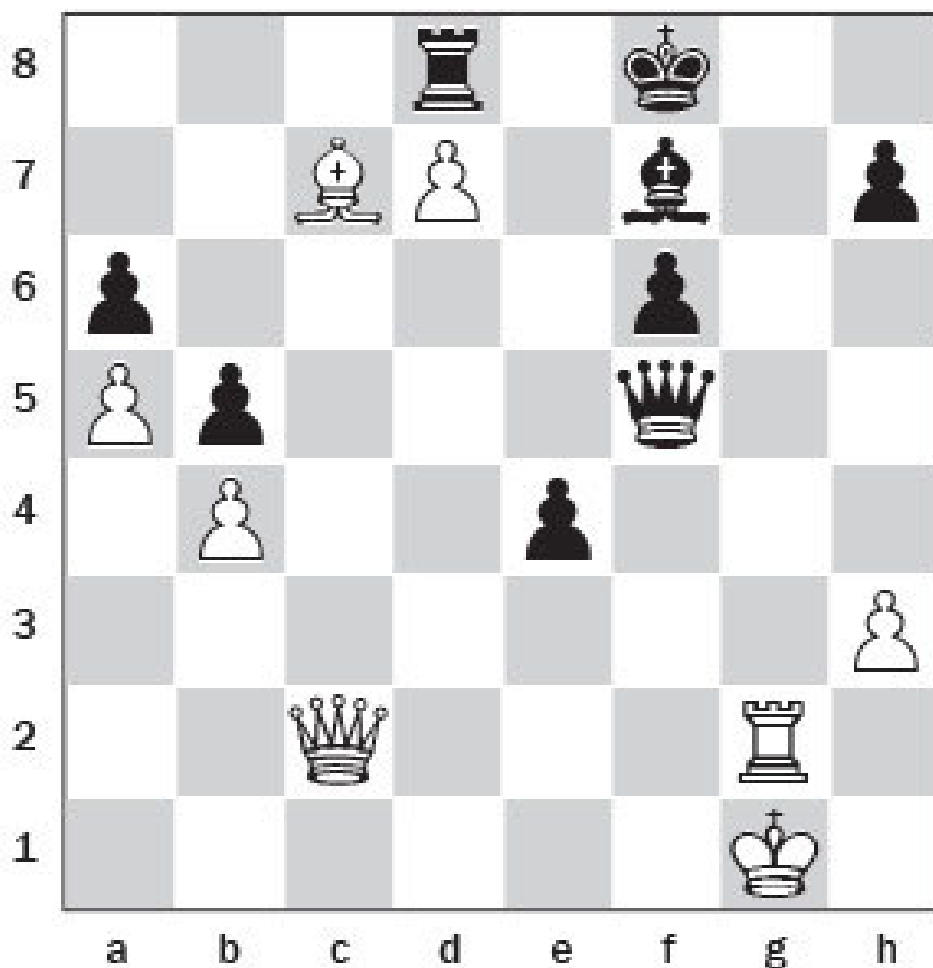


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 73](#)

# 73

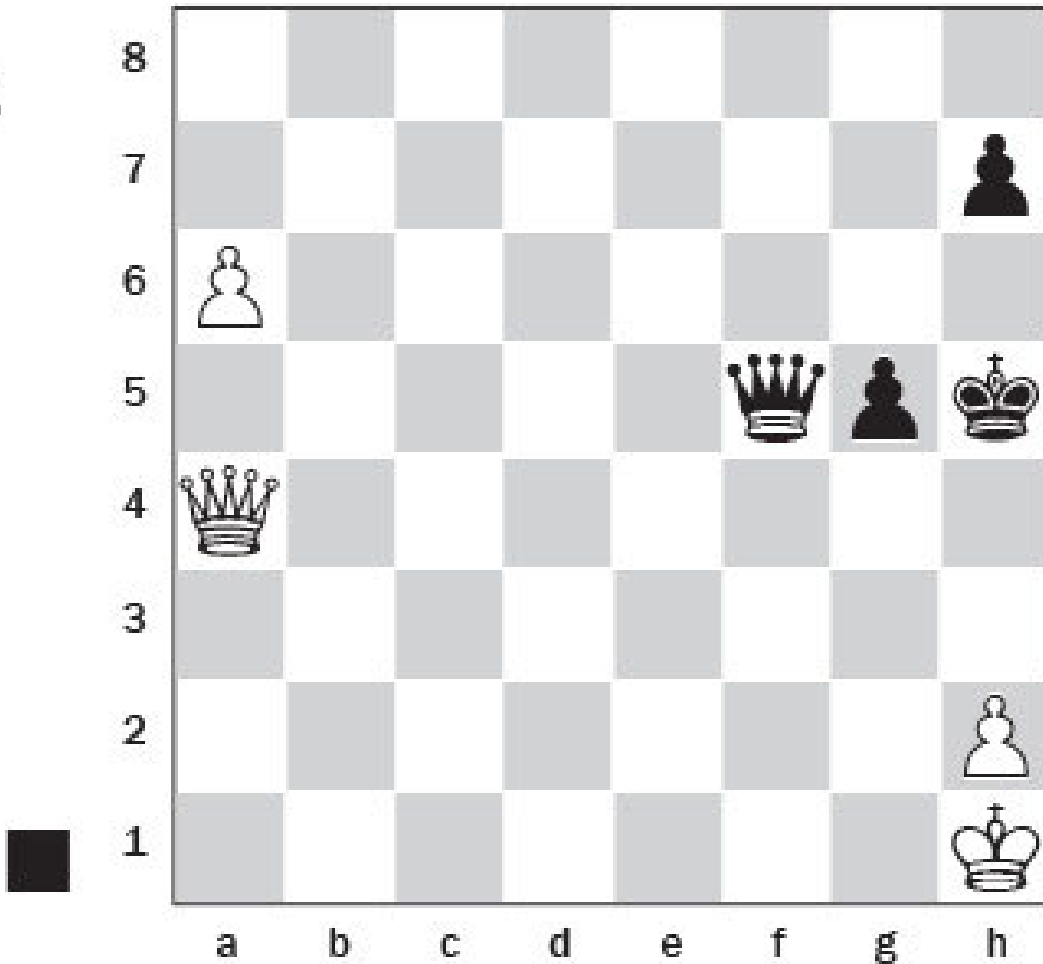


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 74](#)

# 74

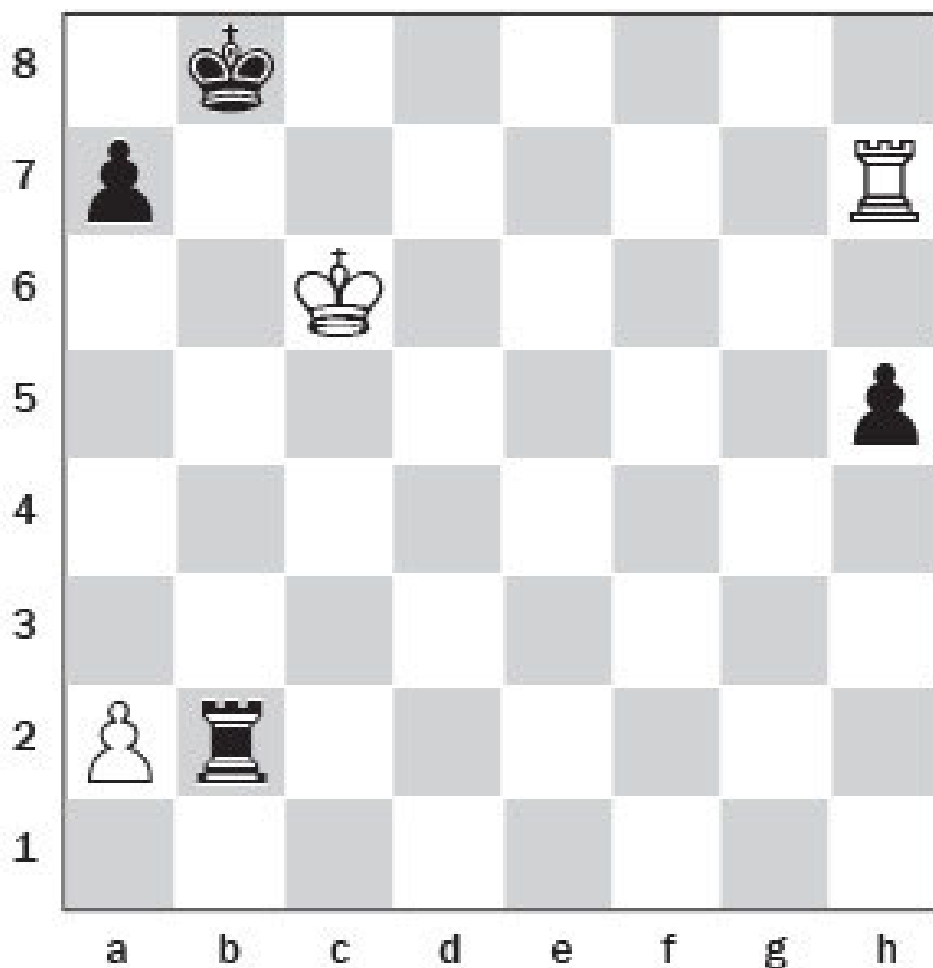


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 75](#)

75

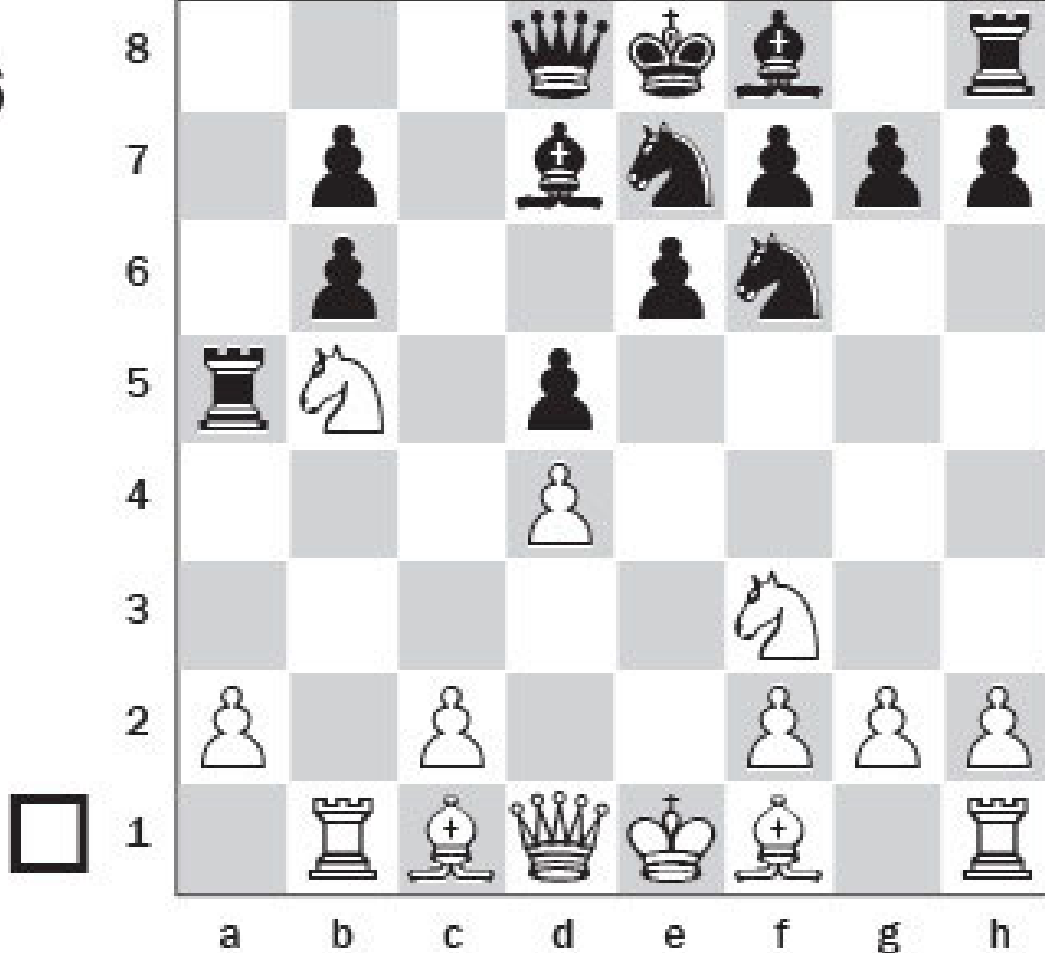


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 76](#)

76

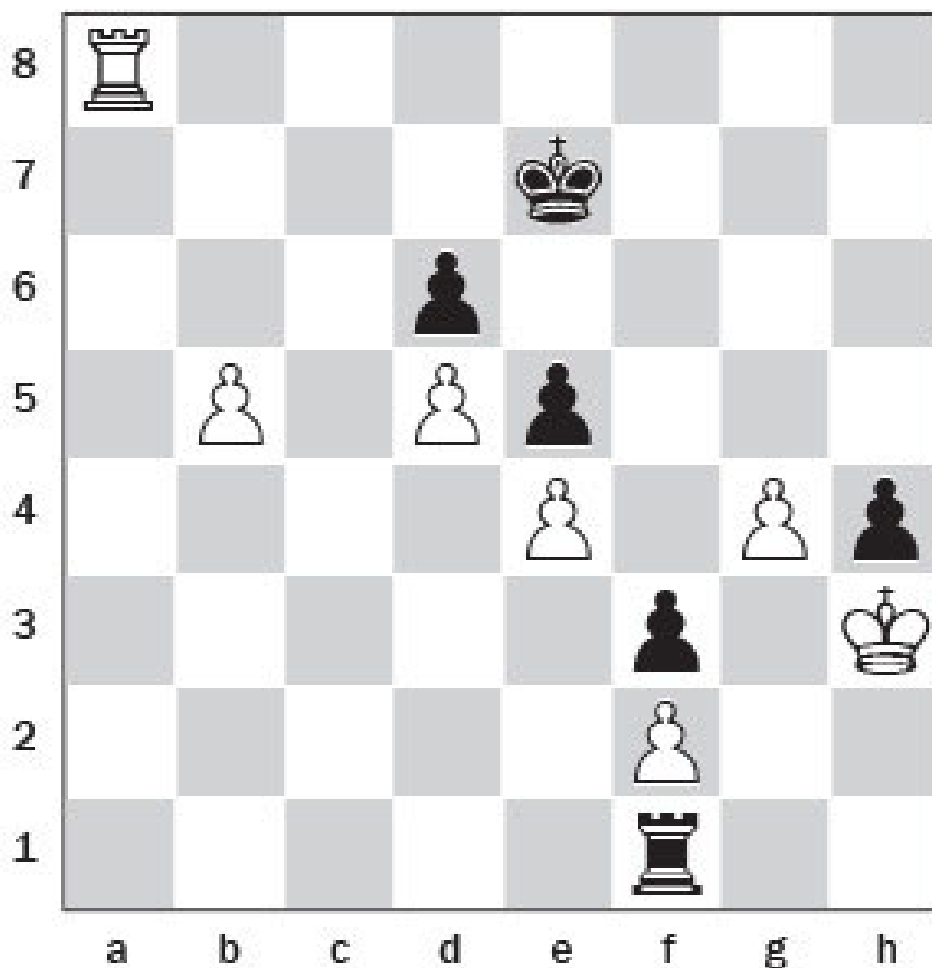


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 77](#)

77

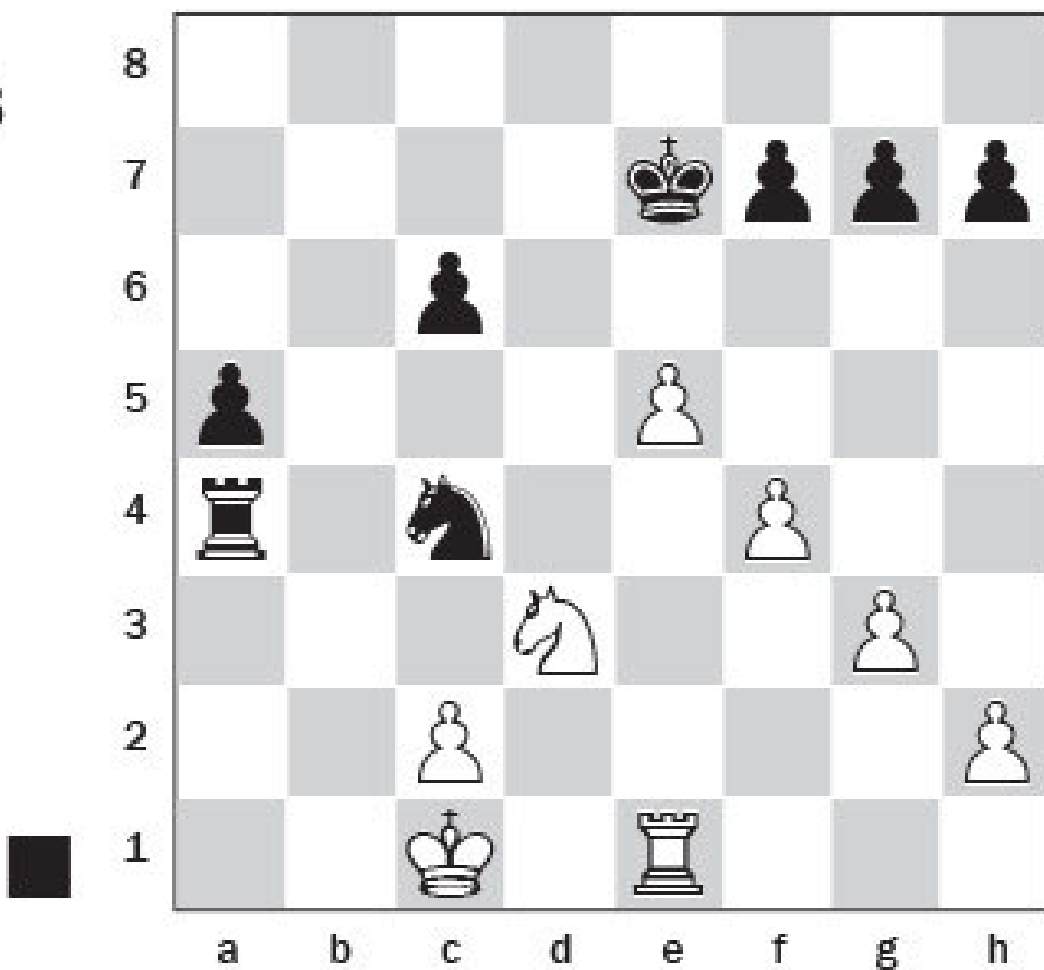


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 78](#)

78



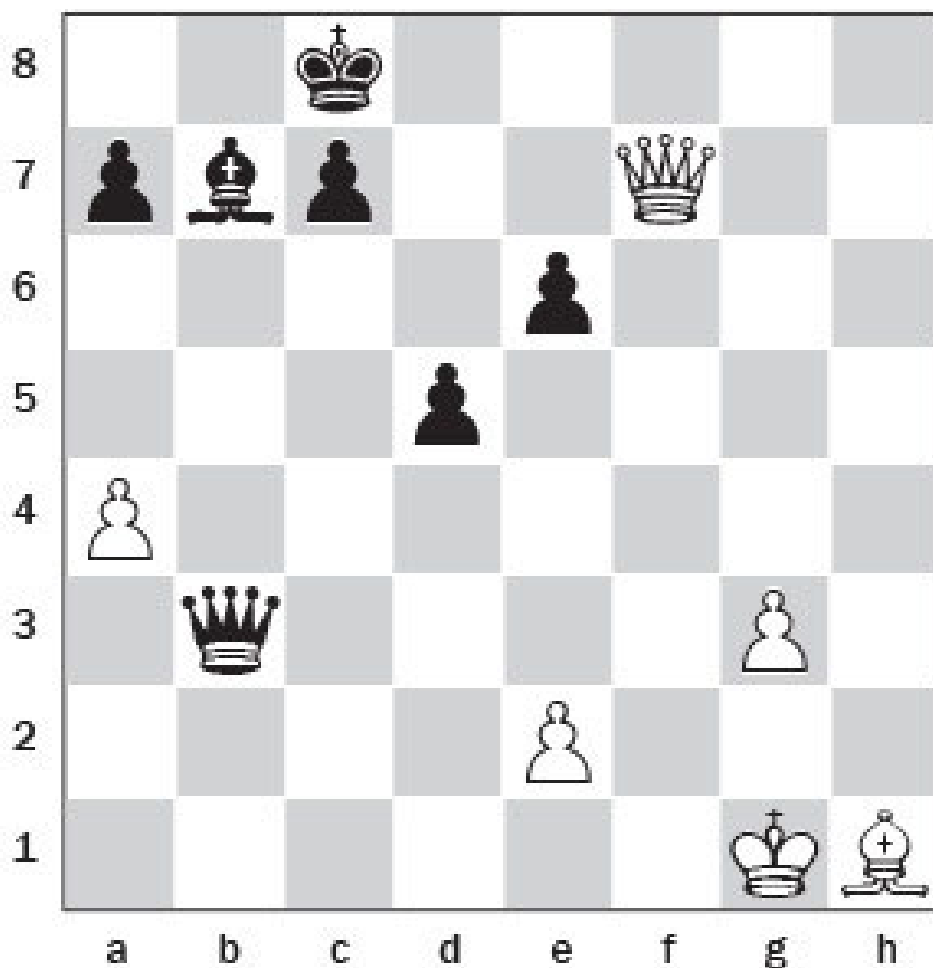
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 79](#)



79

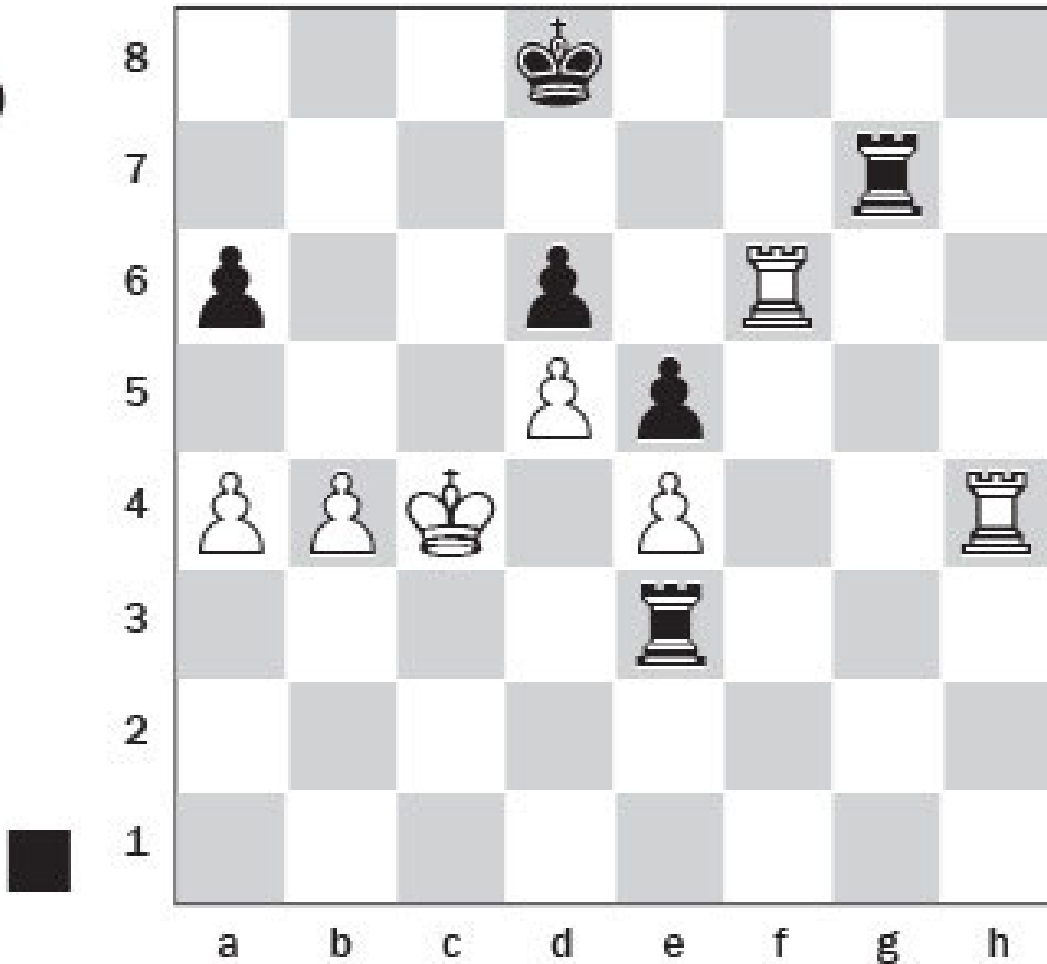


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 80](#)

80



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 81](#)

81

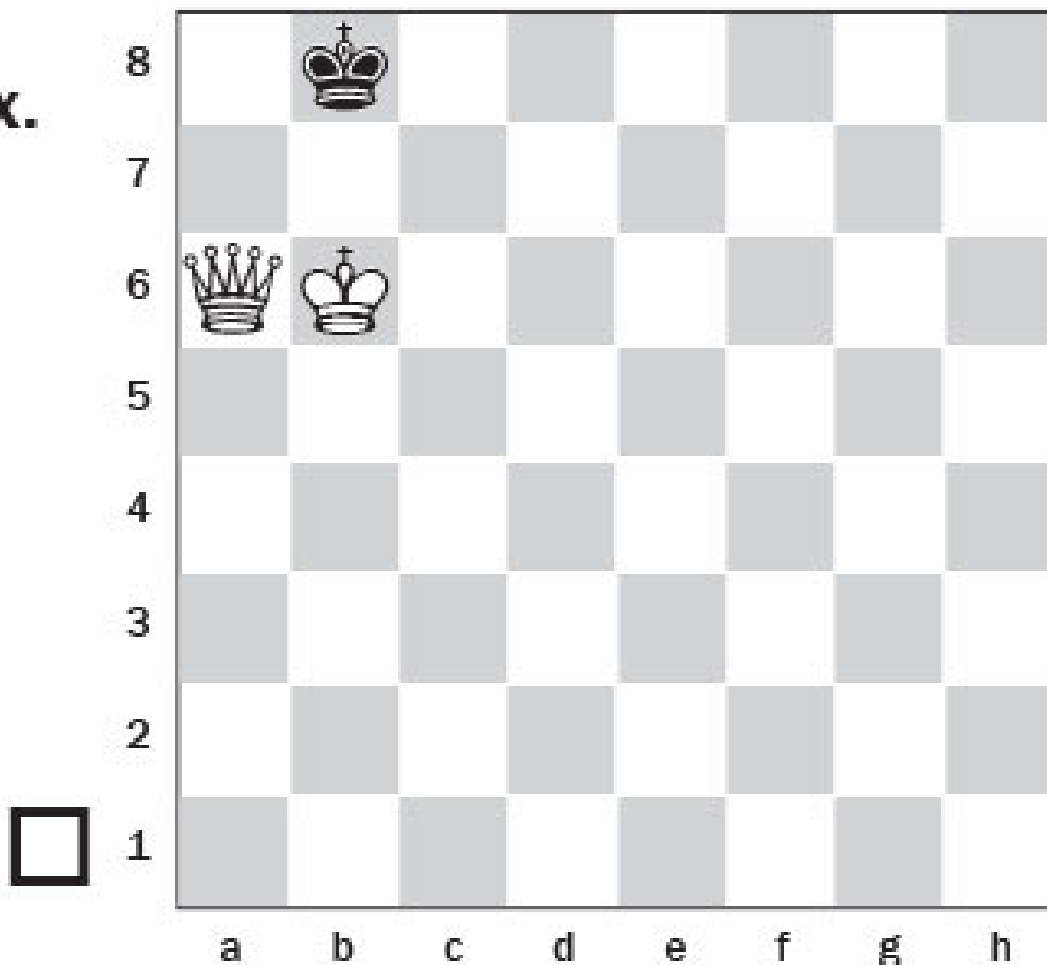


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

# Helper Checkmates in One – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



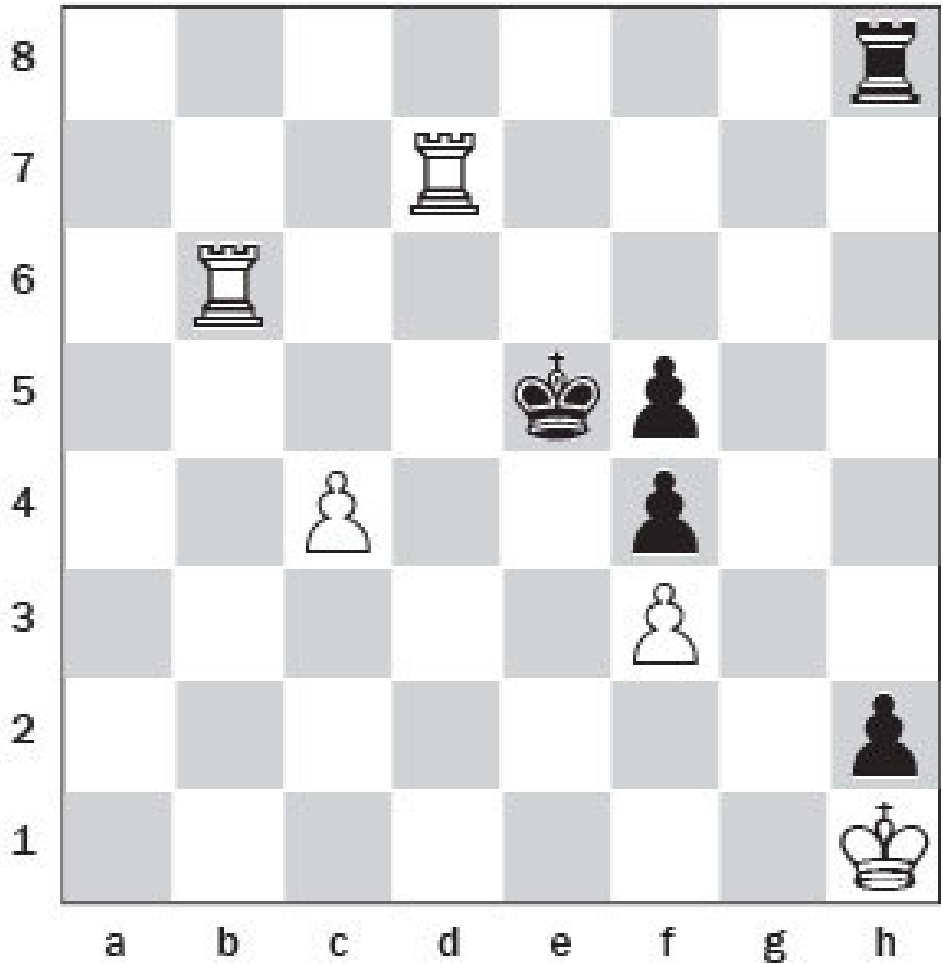
Answer:

1. Qb7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 82

82



Answer:

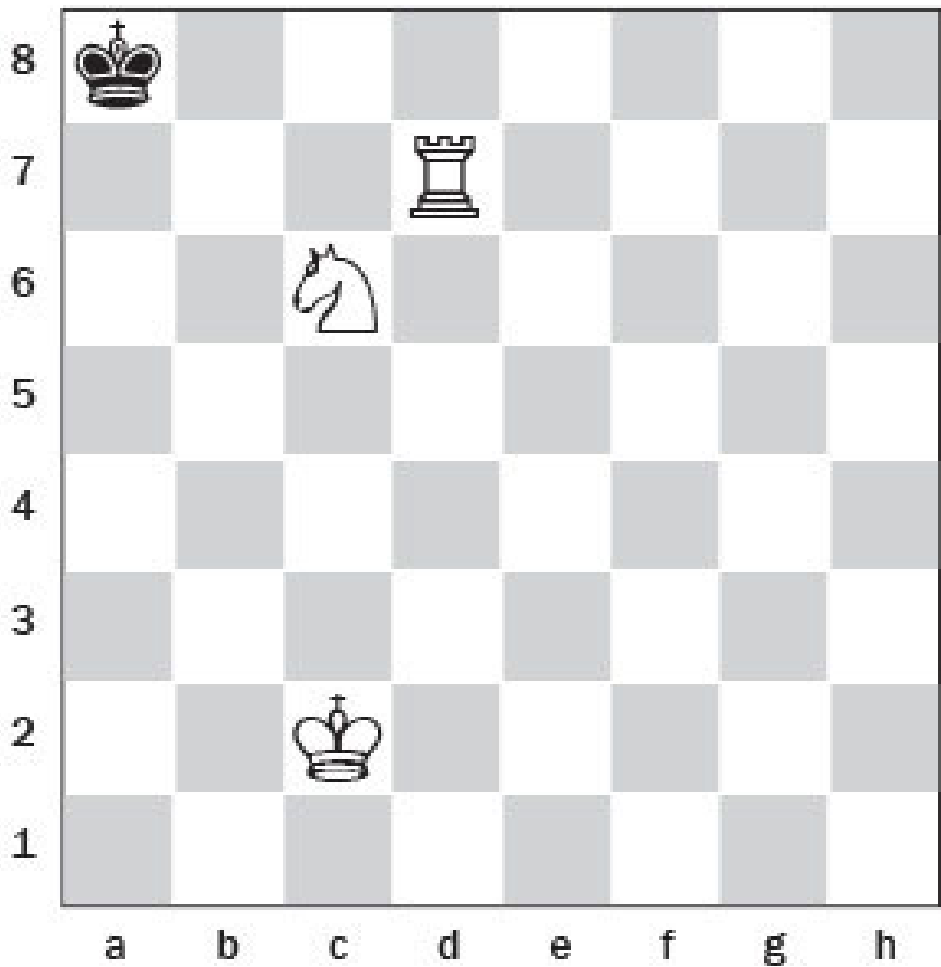
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The pawn on c4 is an important helper!

### Exercise 83

83



Answer:

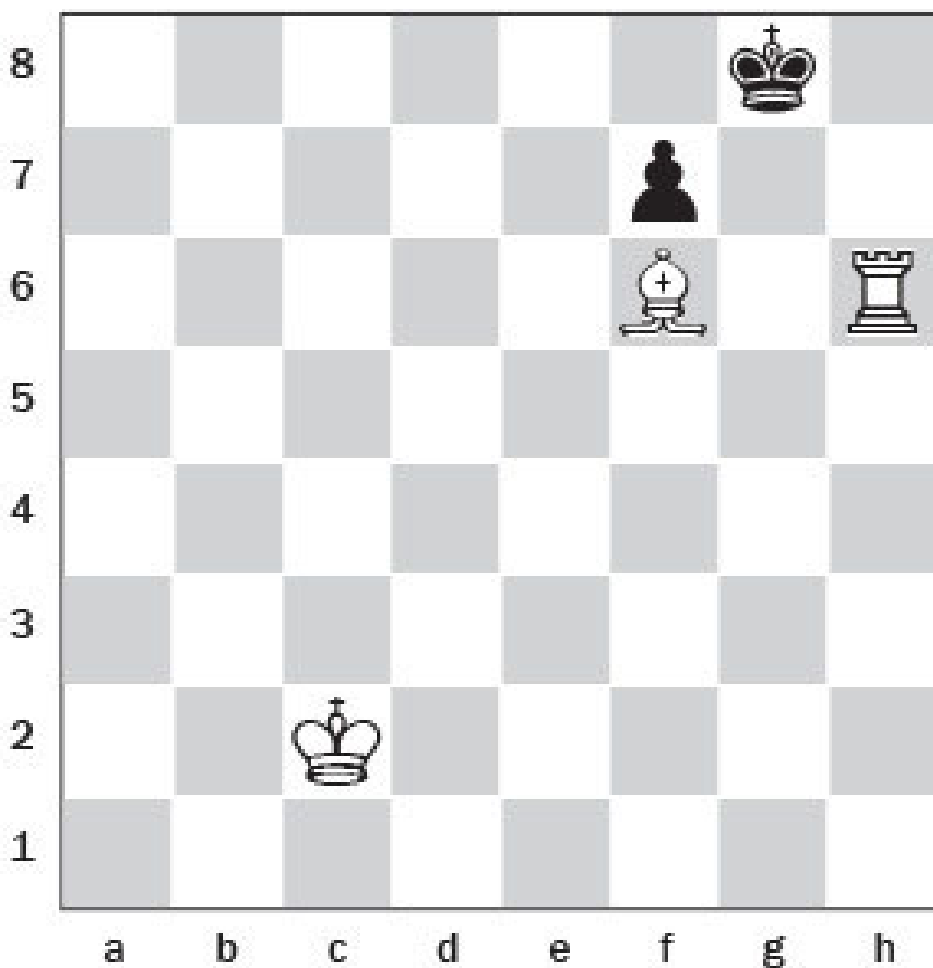
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The king cannot move, but is not in check. The knight is a great helper here – finish the game!

### Exercise 84

84



Answer:

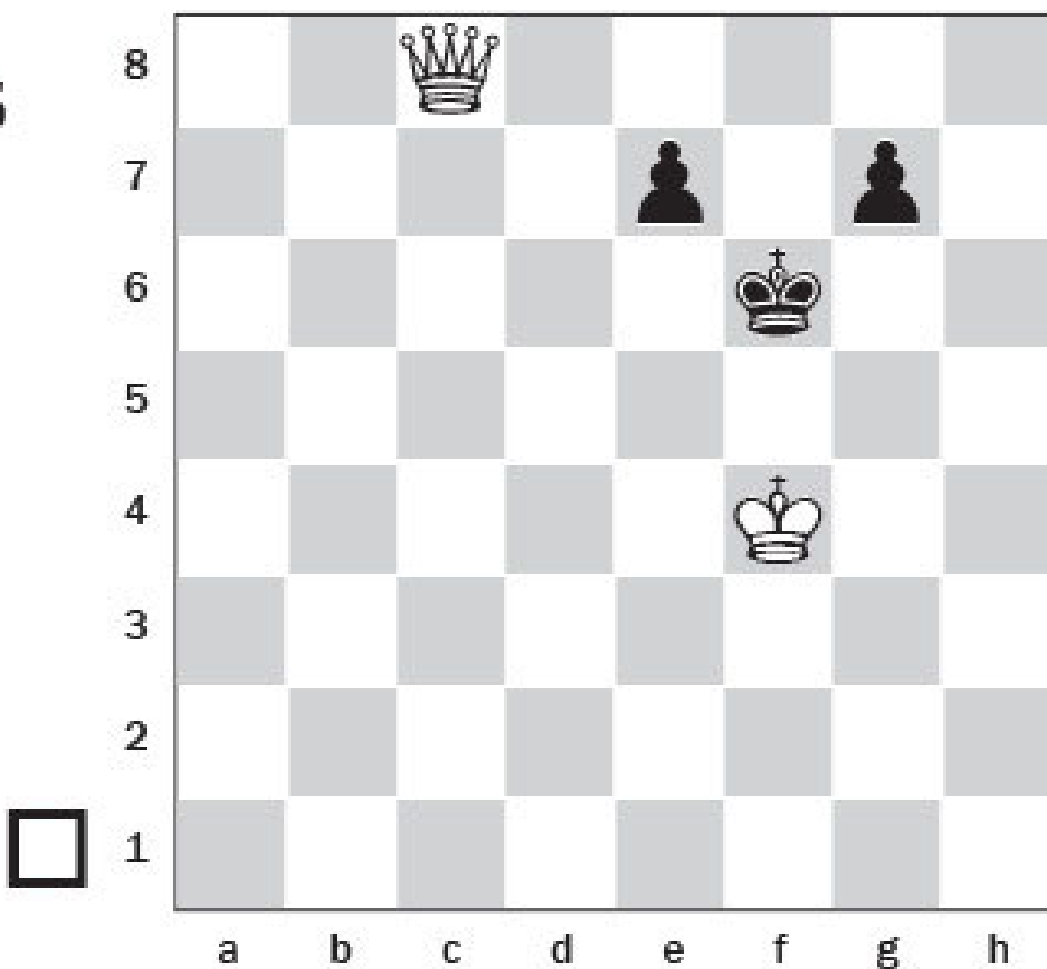
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop and rook are surrounding the king. The bishop is the helper. Find the checkmate!

### Exercise 85

**85**



Answer:



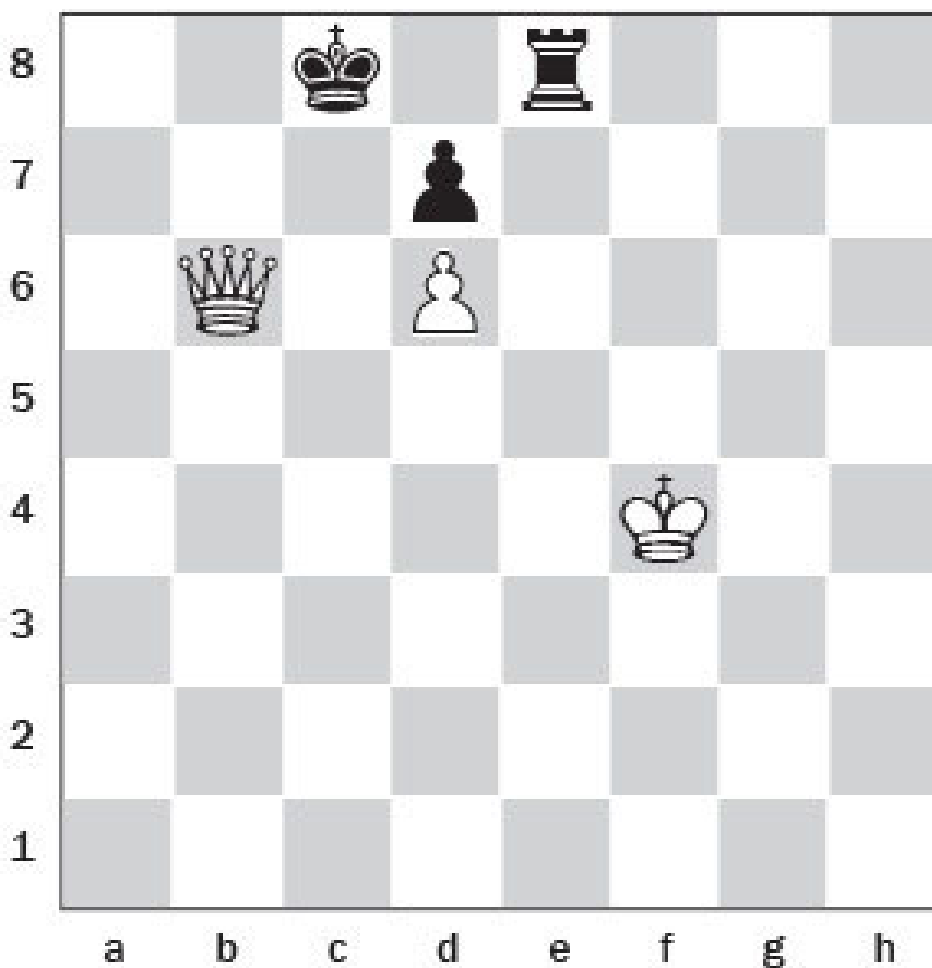
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black's own pawns are blocking the escapes backward diagonally.  
Use the king as a helper!

### Exercise 86

**86**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

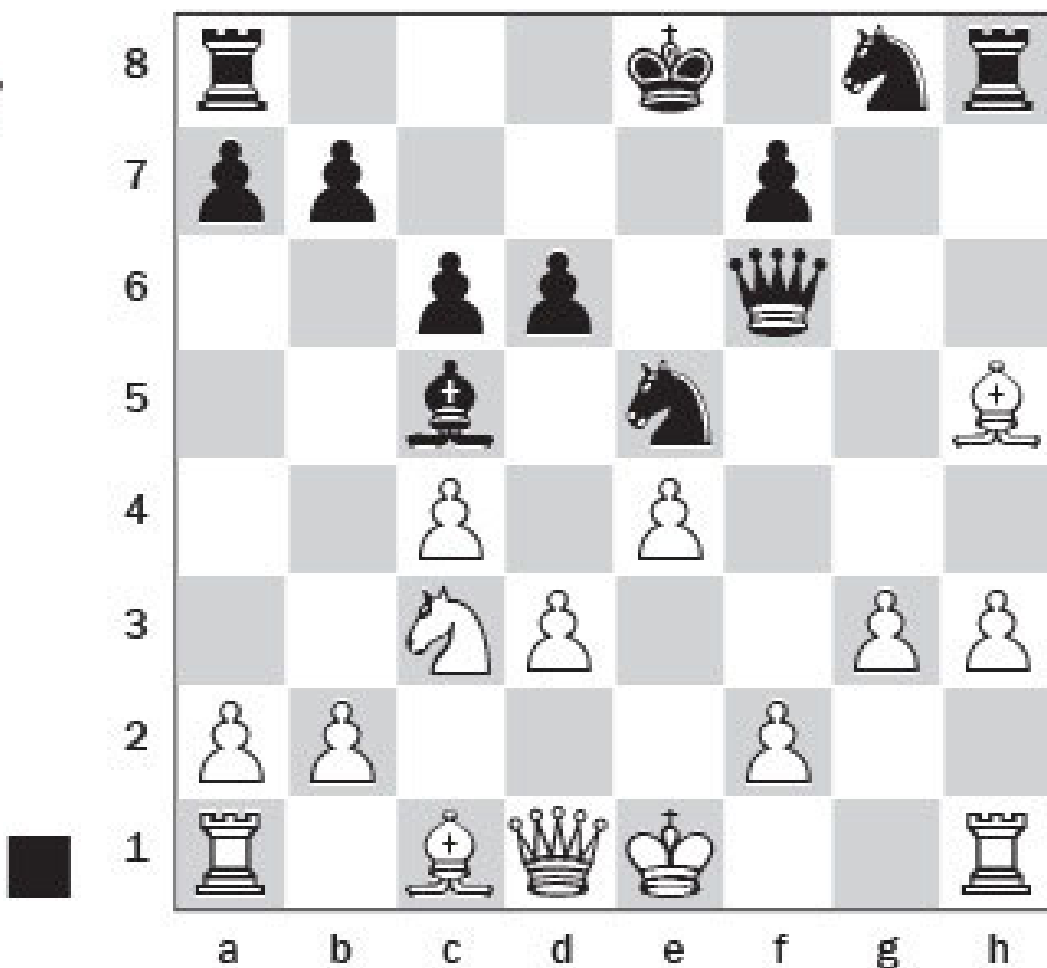
### **HINT**

The pawn on d6 is controlling a very important square near the king.

# Helper Checkmates in One – Test

## Exercise 87

87

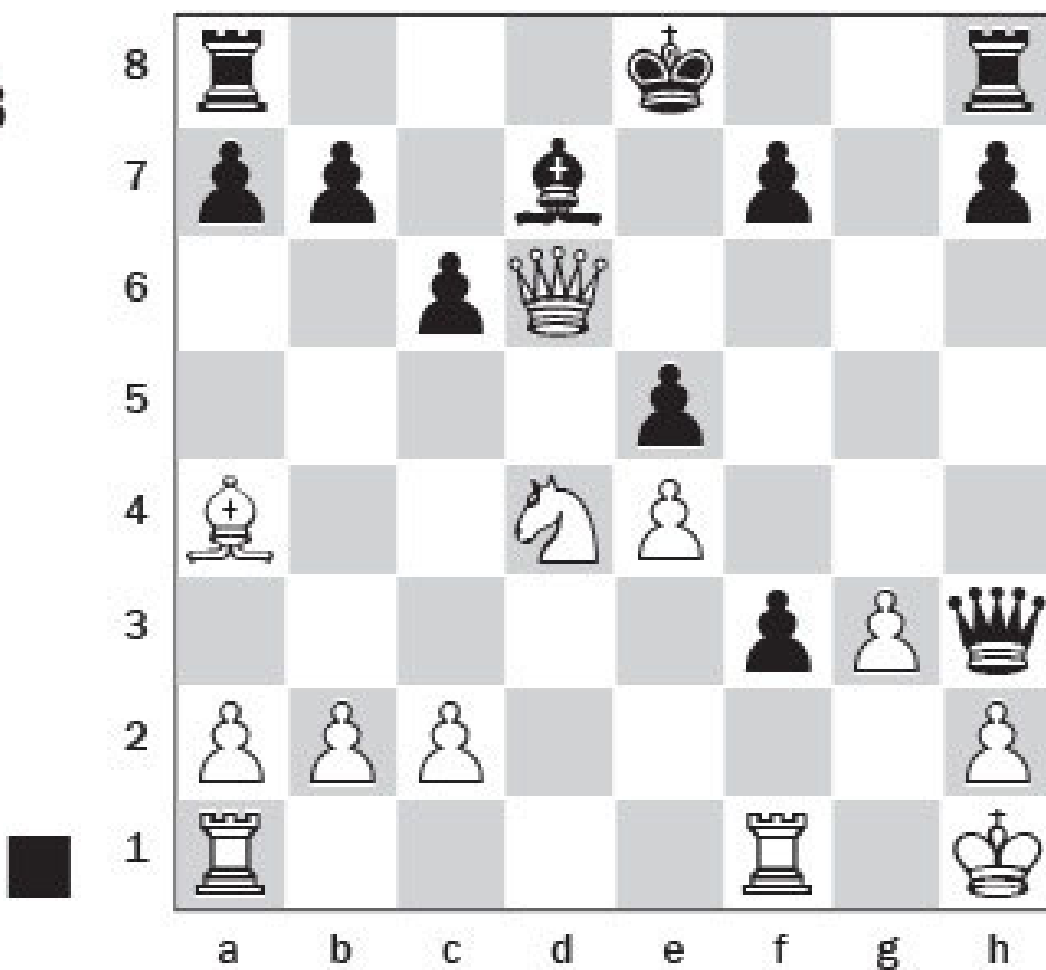


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 88

88

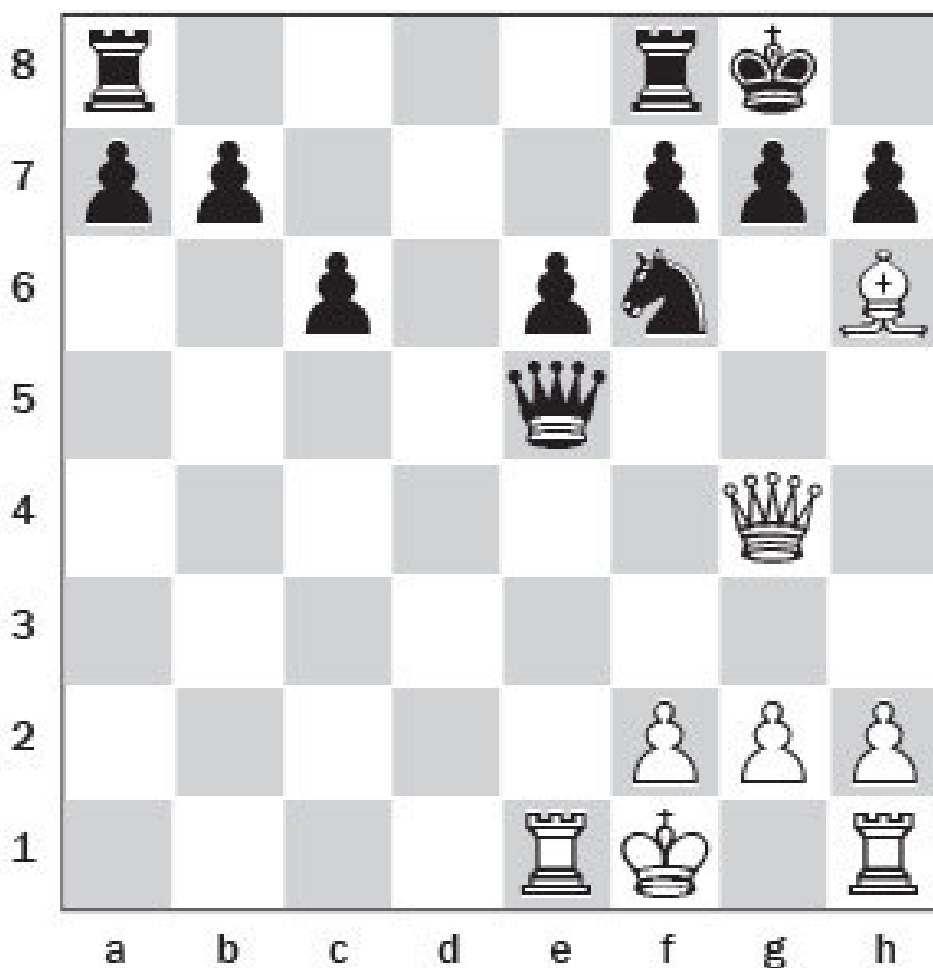


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 89

89



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 90](#)

90

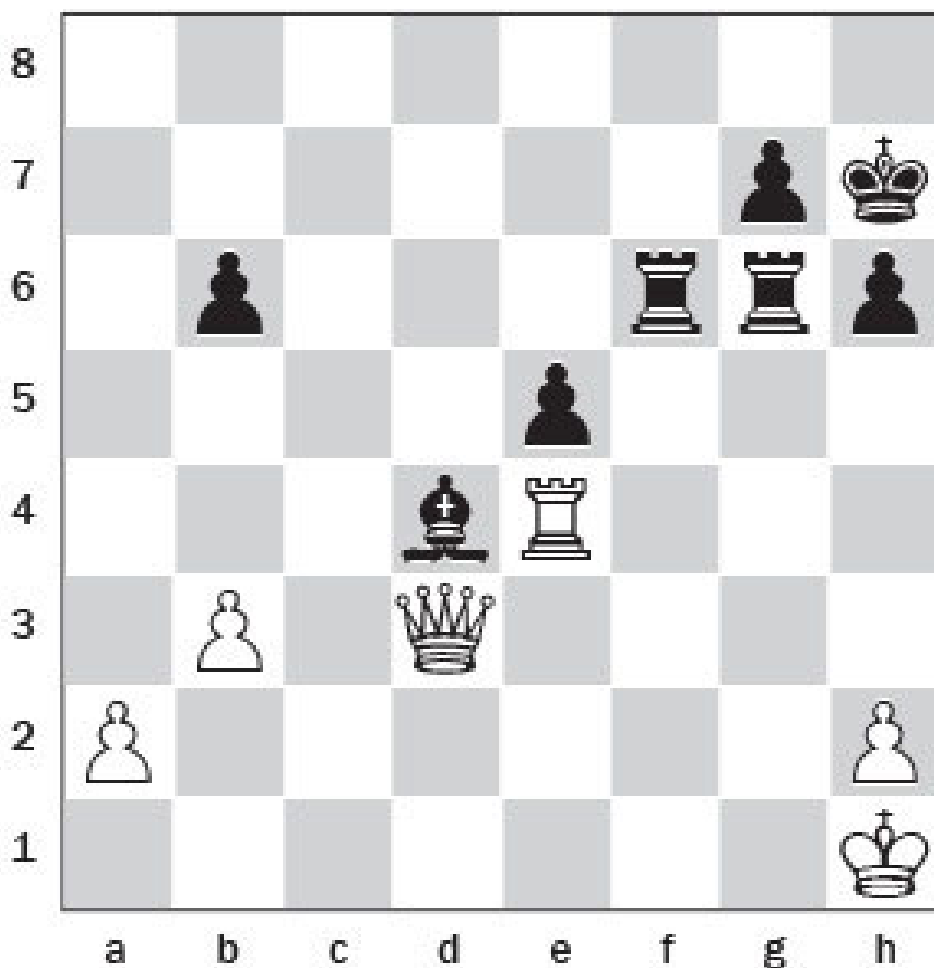


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 91](#)

# 91

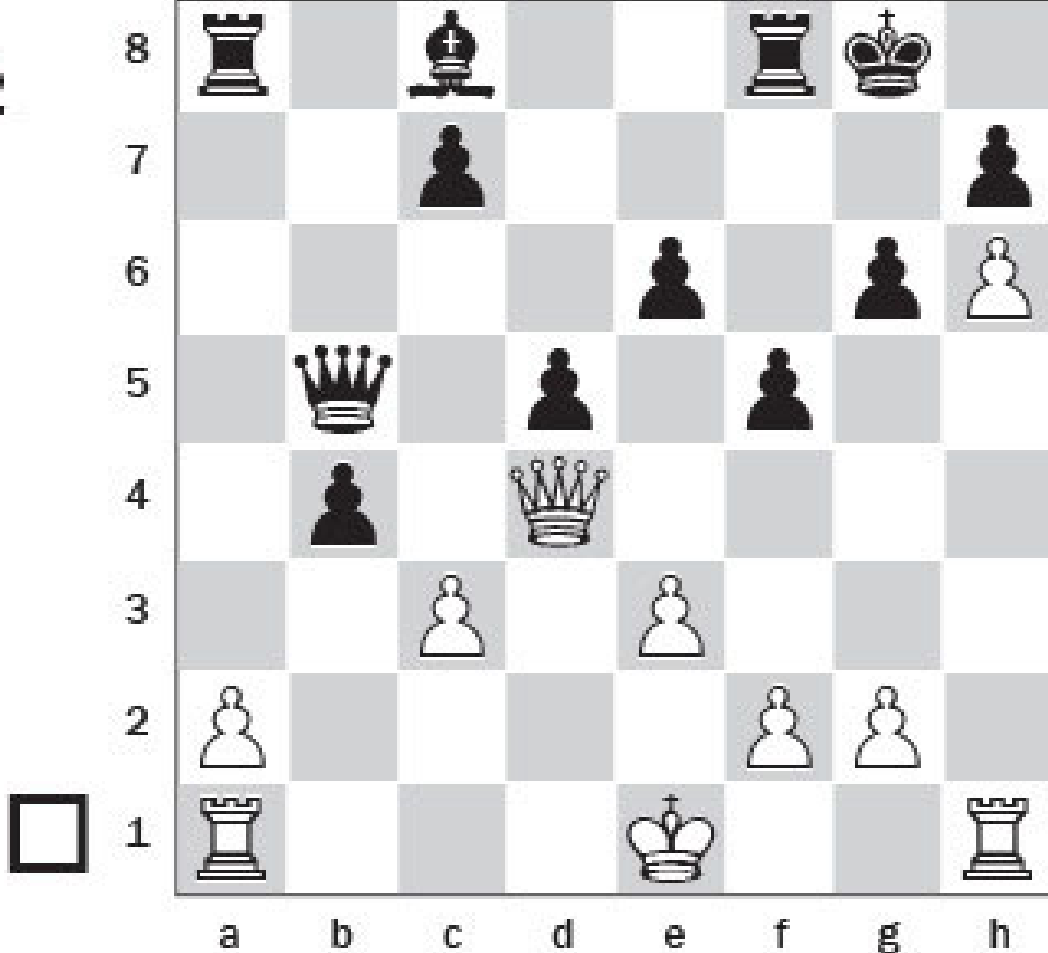


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 92](#)

92



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 93](#)



93



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 94](#)

94

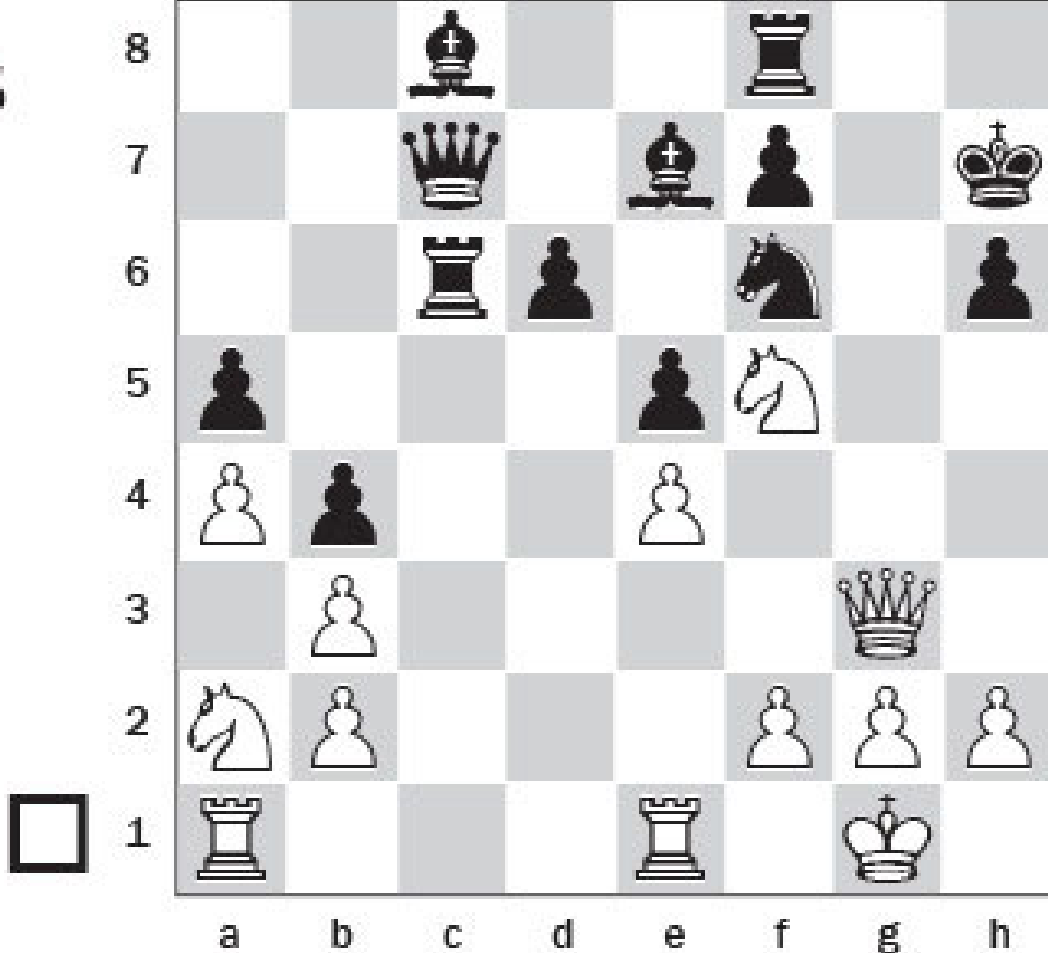


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 95](#)

95

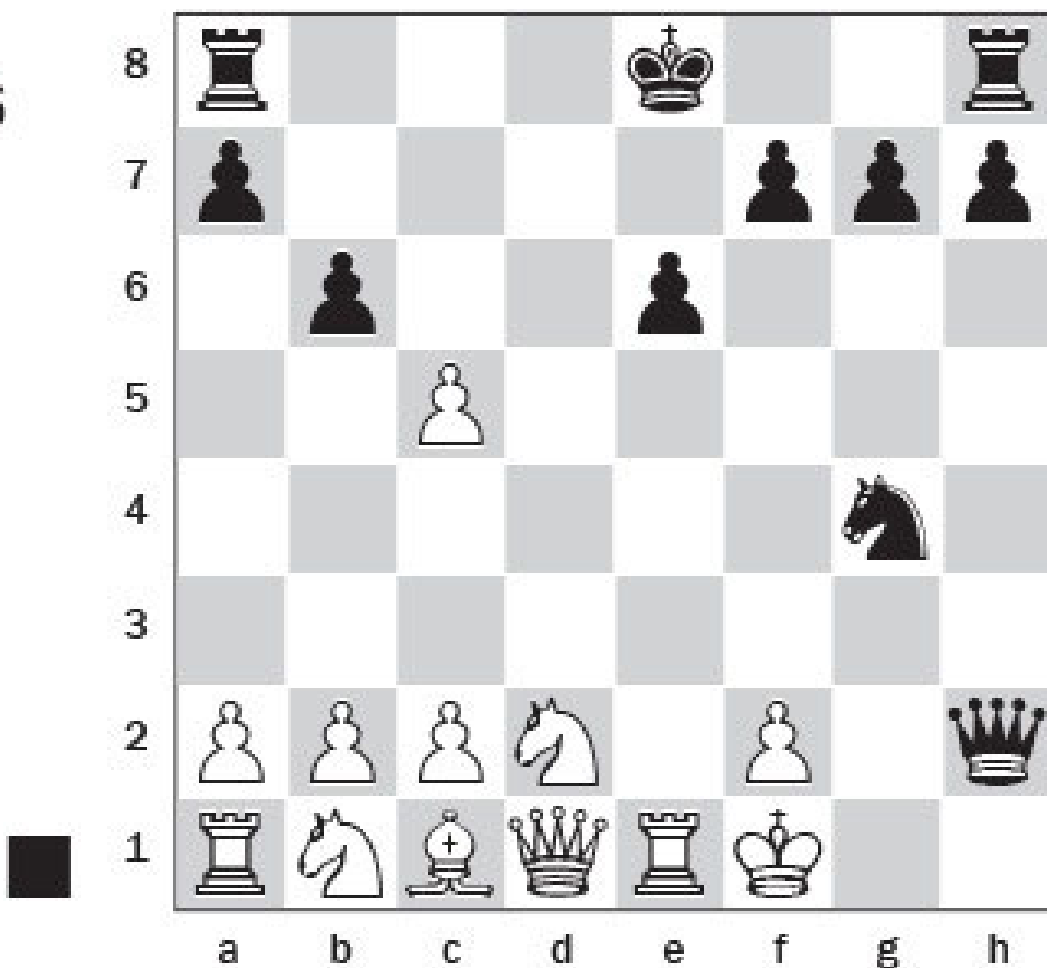


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 96](#)

96



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 97](#)

97

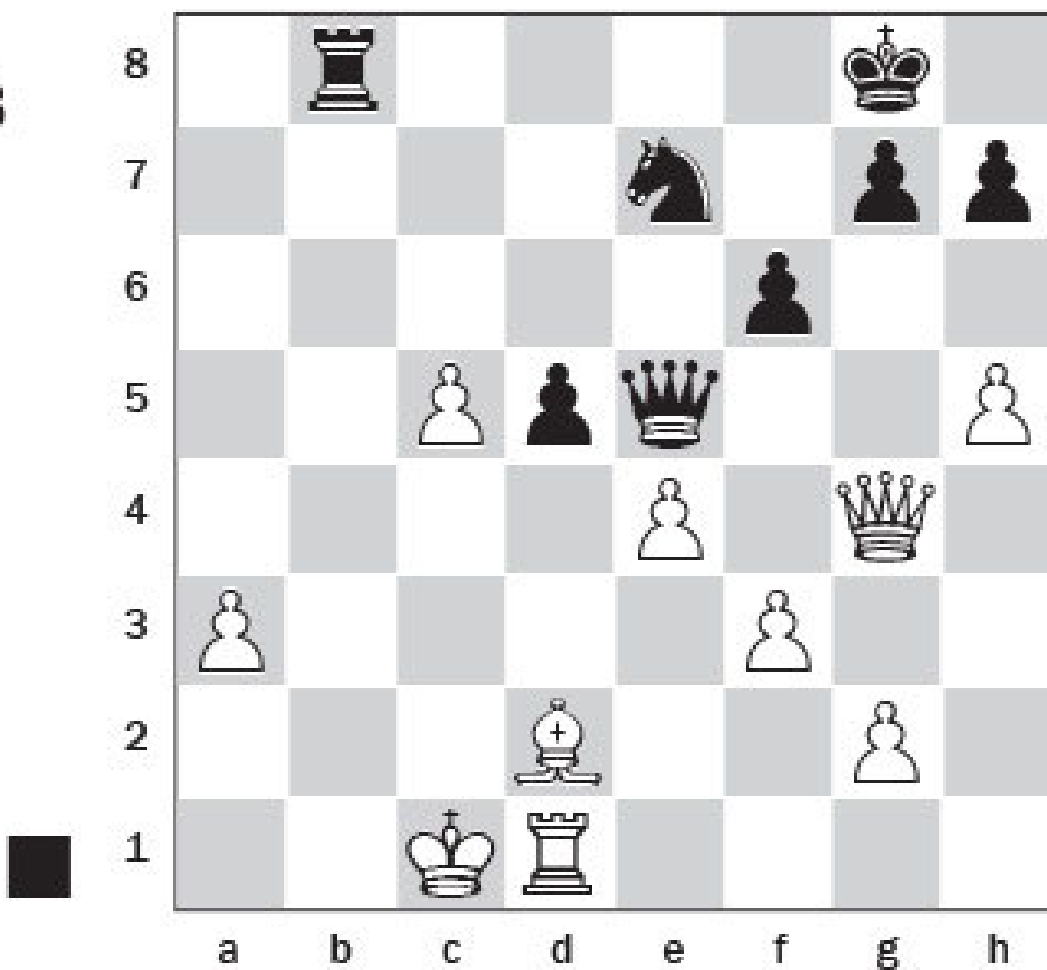


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 98](#)

98

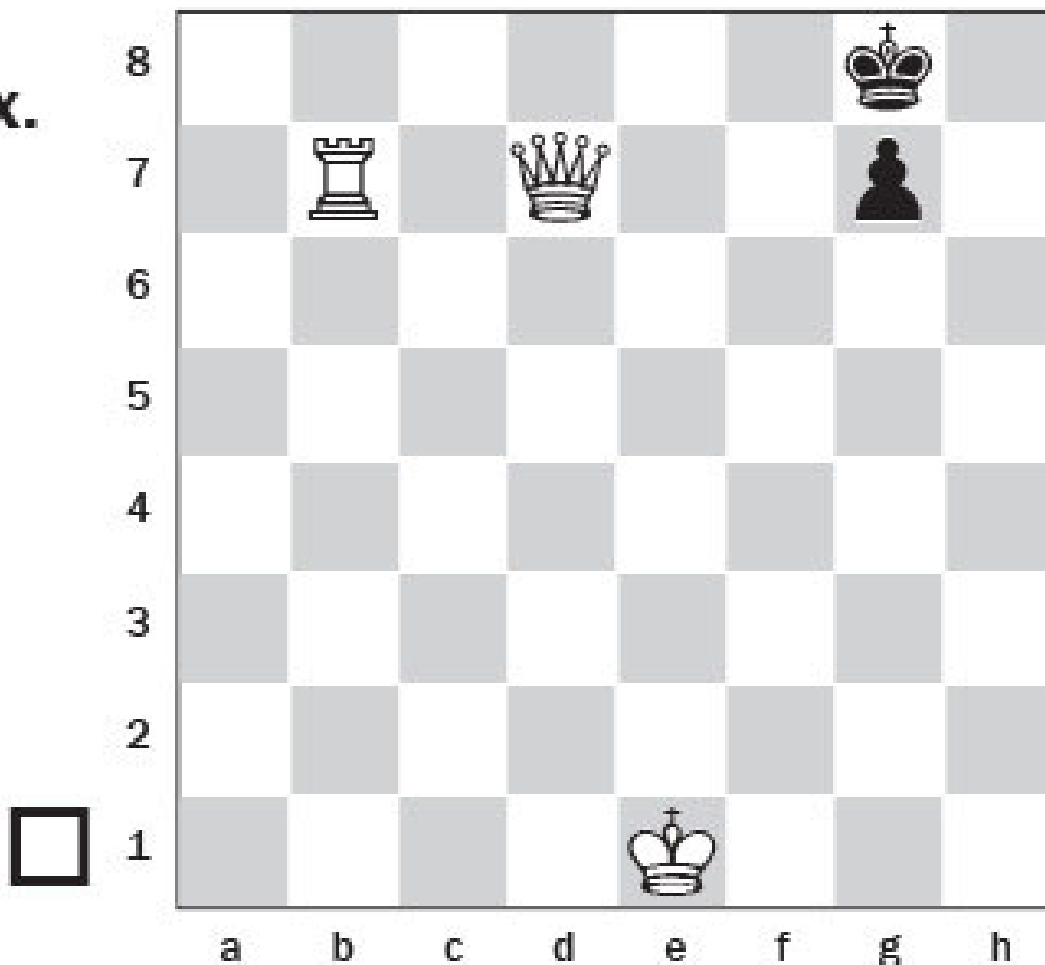


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

# Battery Checkmates in One – Guided Practice

Ex.



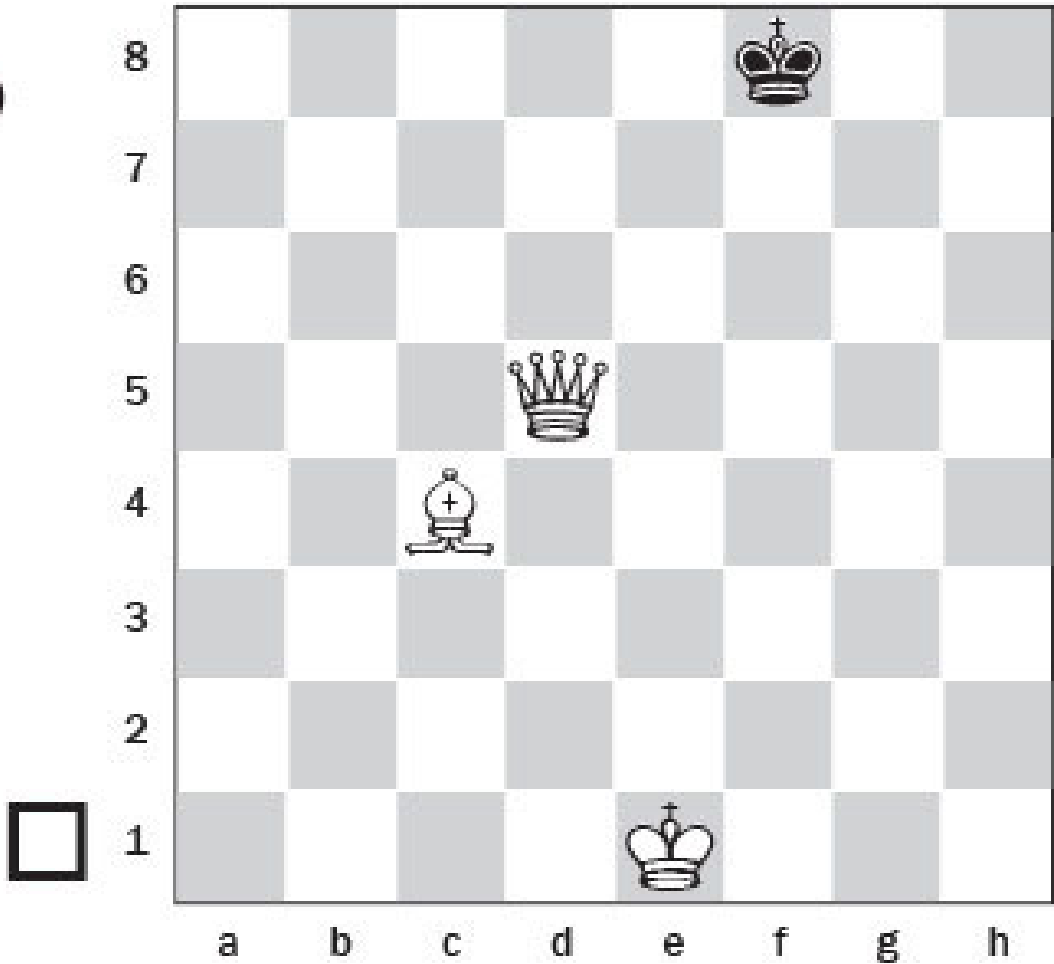
Answer:

1. Qxg7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 99

99



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

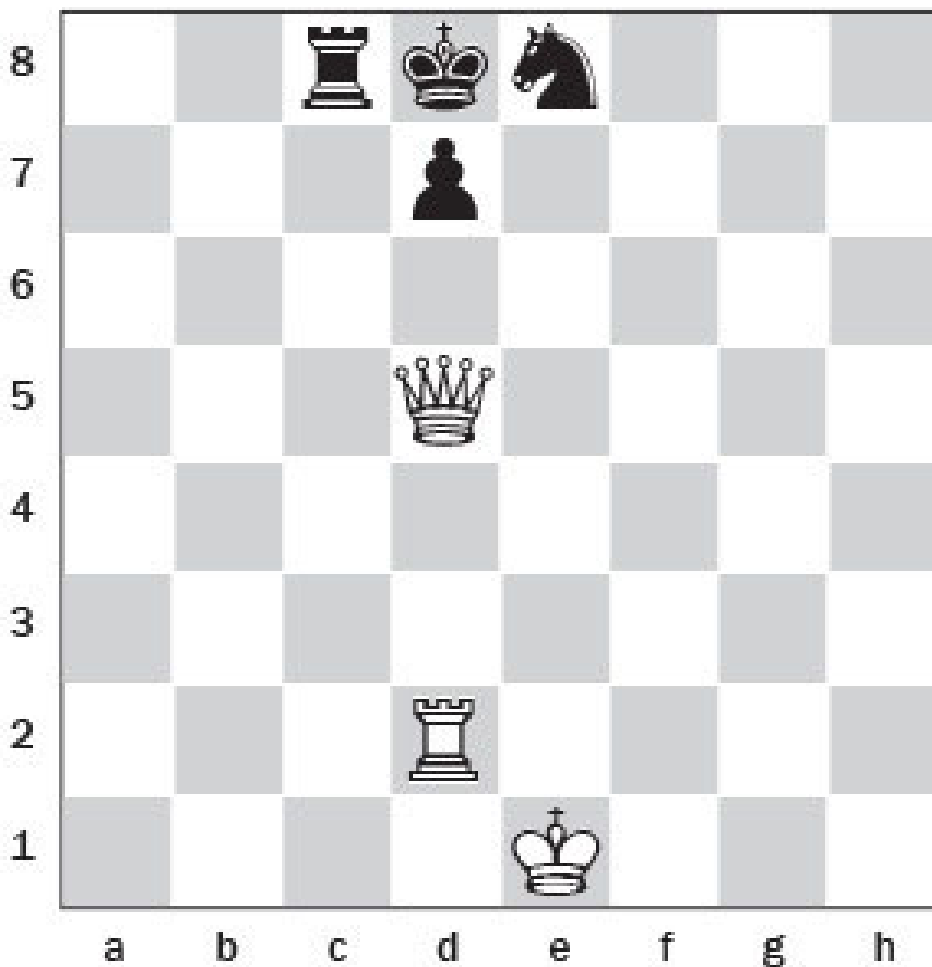


## HINT

The queen and bishop are lined up in a battery. Find the checkmate.

### Exercise 100

100



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

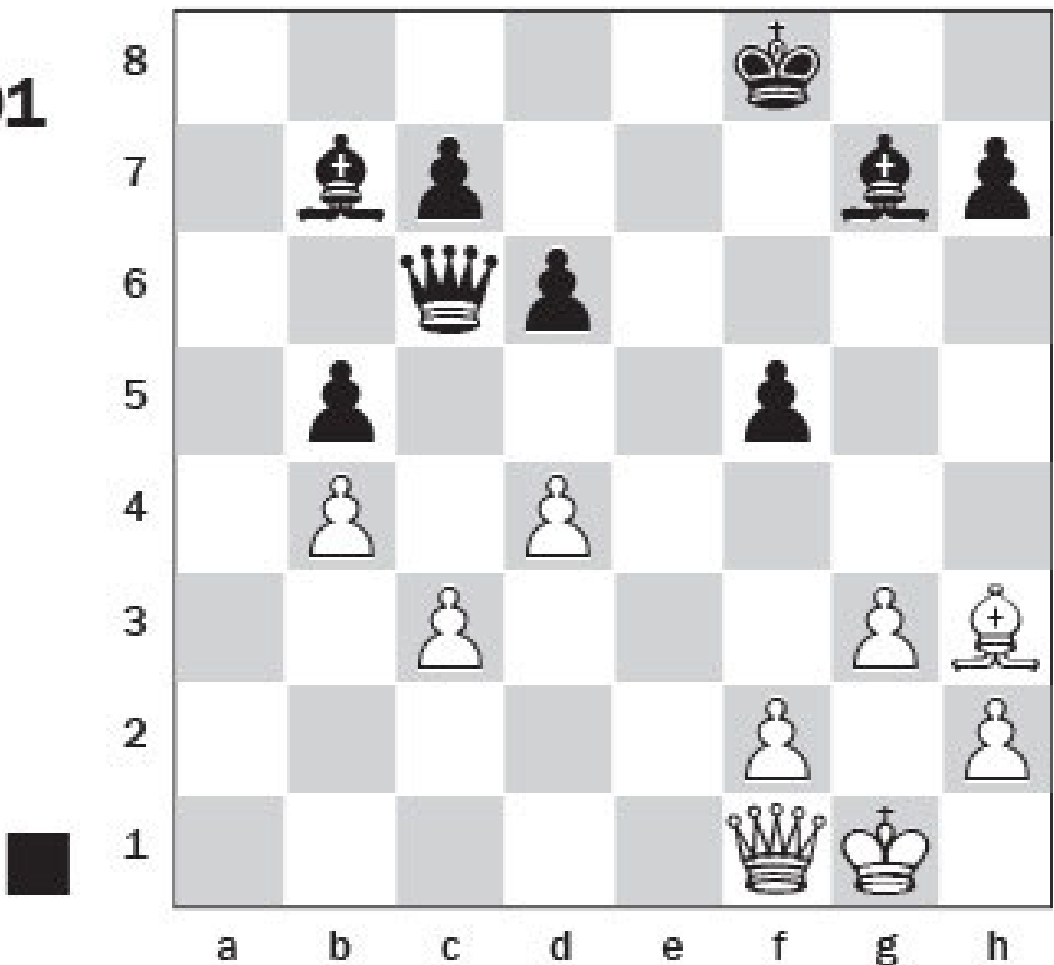
## **HINT**

The queen and rook are lined up on the d-file. Use the battery for a checkmate.

# Battery Checkmates in One – Test

## Exercise 101

**101**

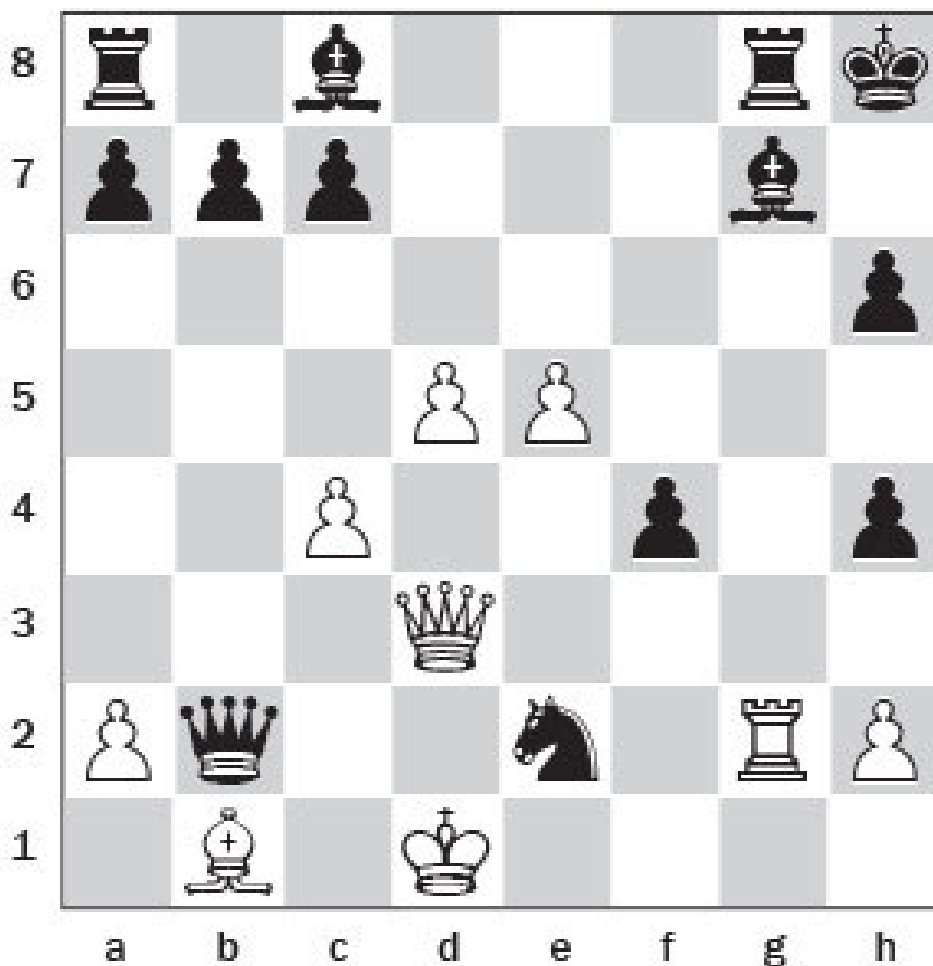


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 102

102

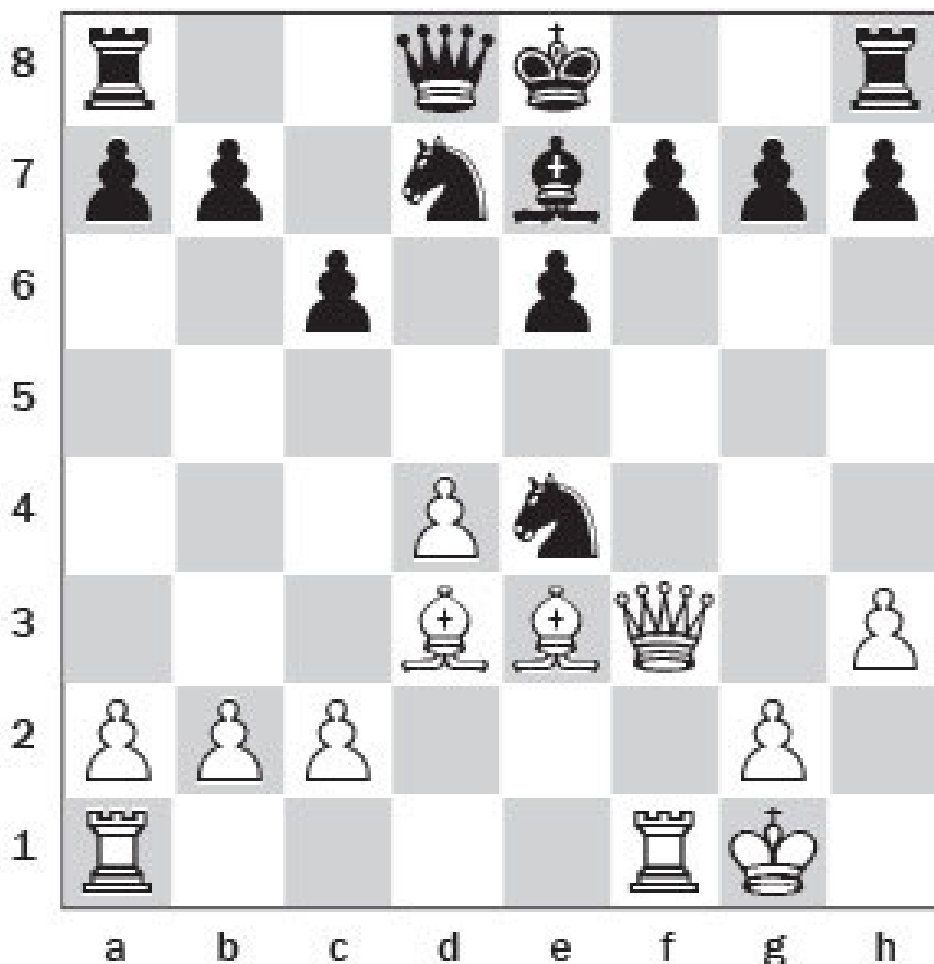


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 103

103

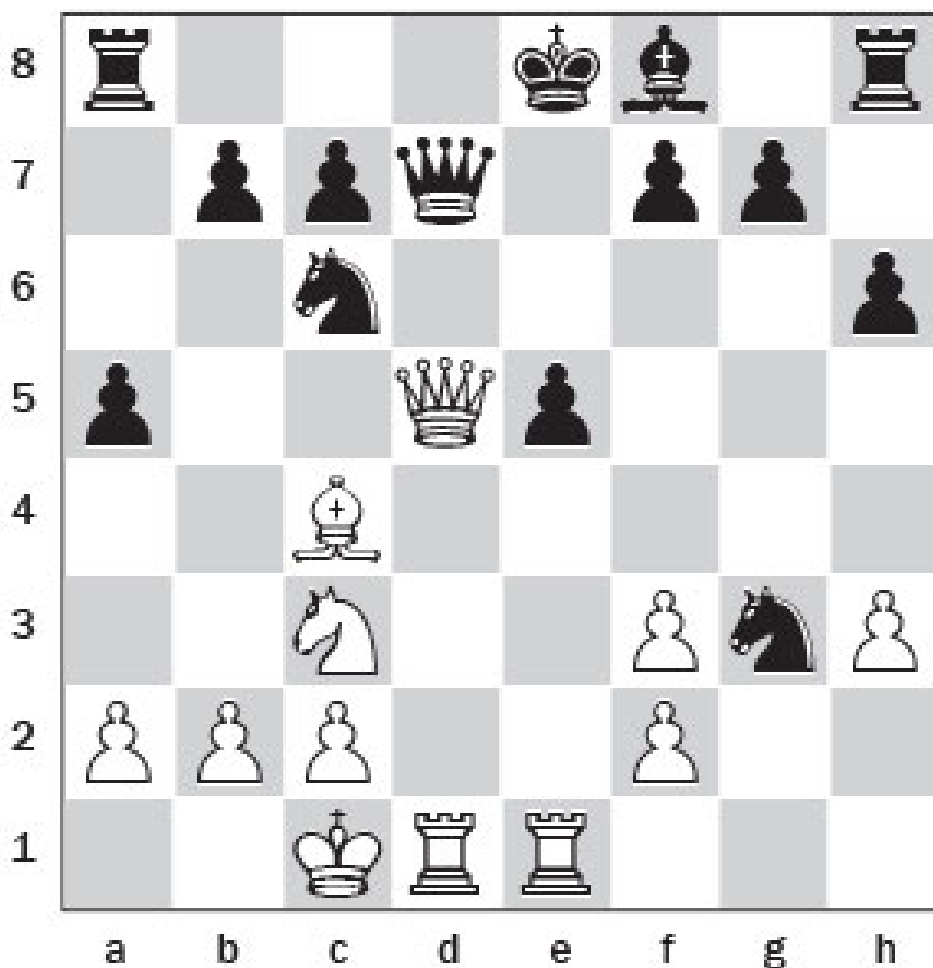


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 104](#)

104



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 105](#)

105

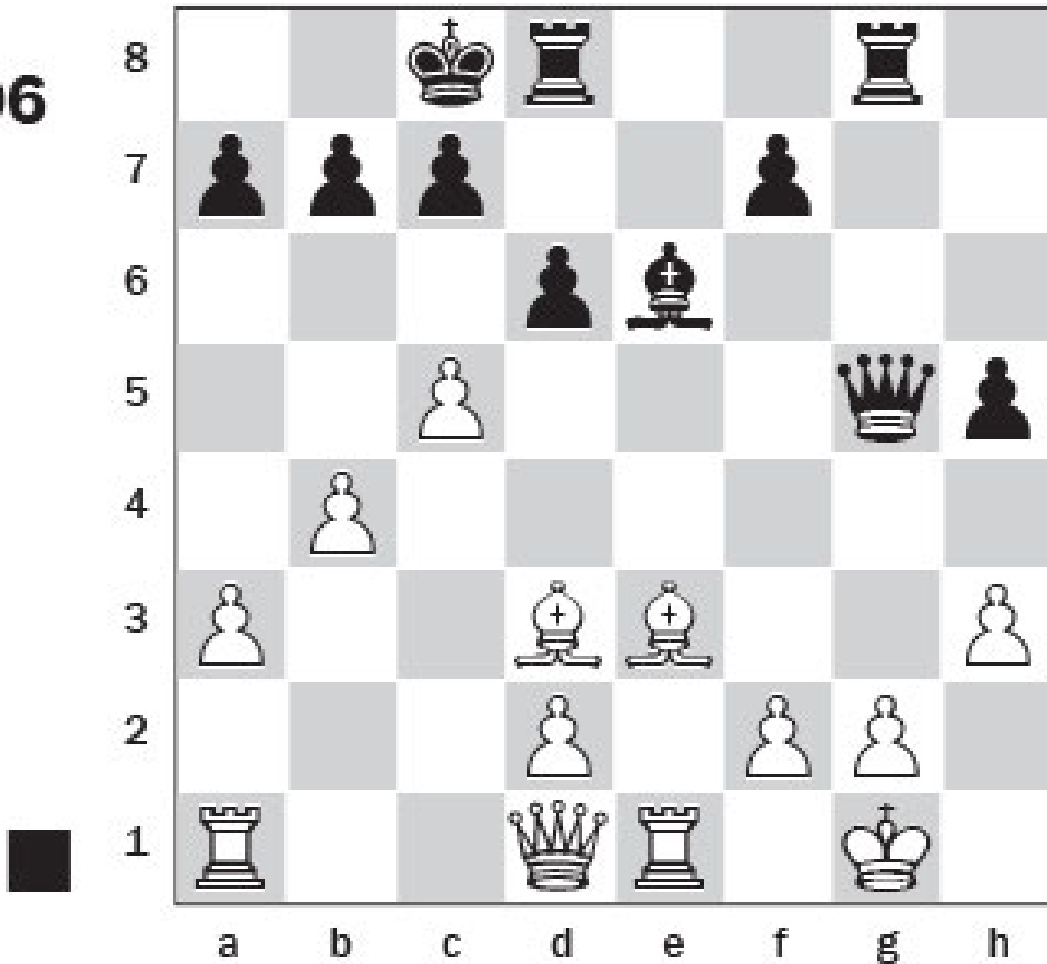


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 106](#)

106



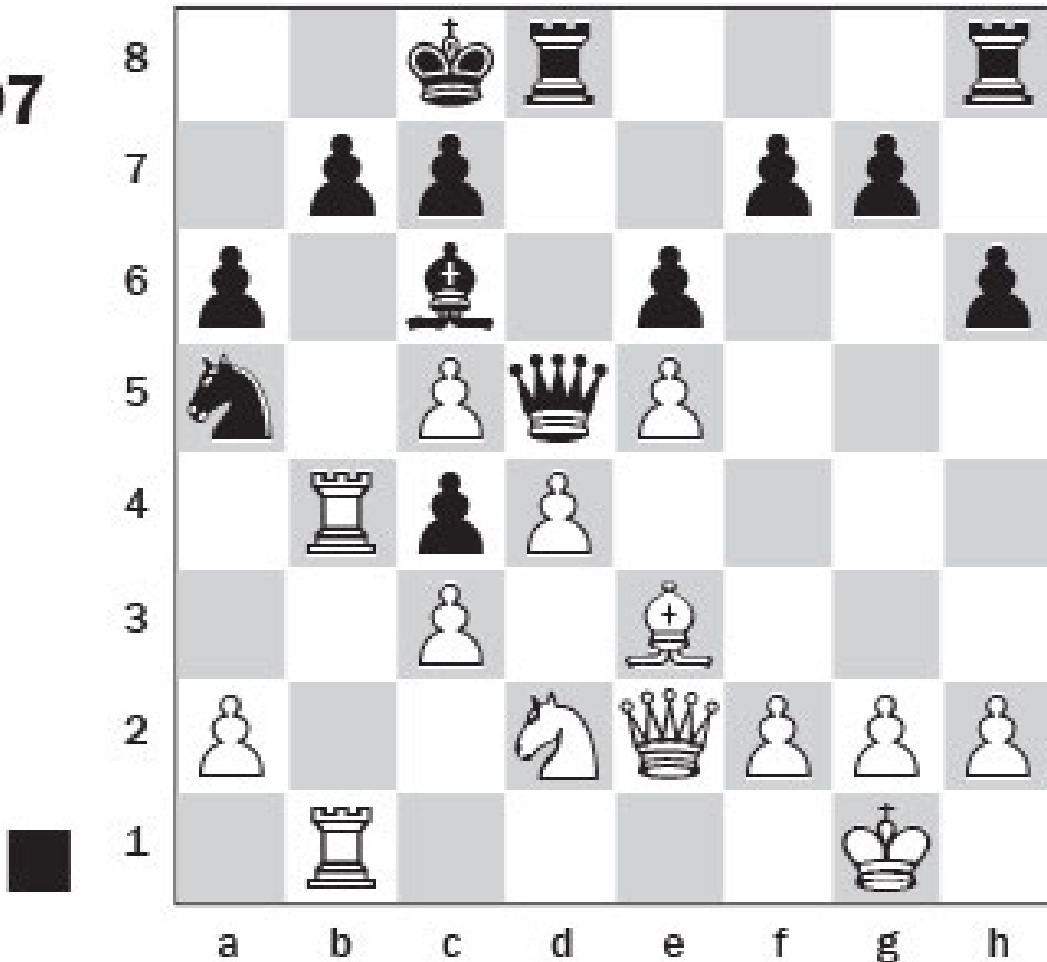
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 107](#)



107



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 108](#)

108

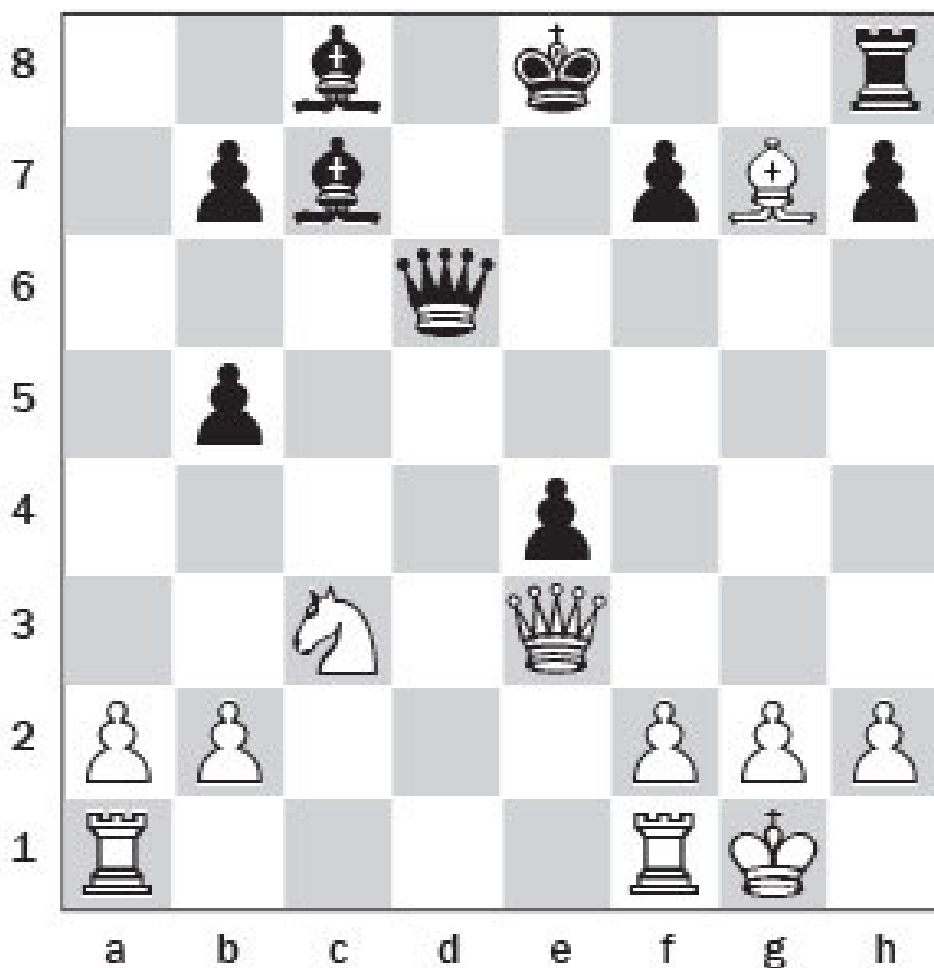


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 109](#)

109

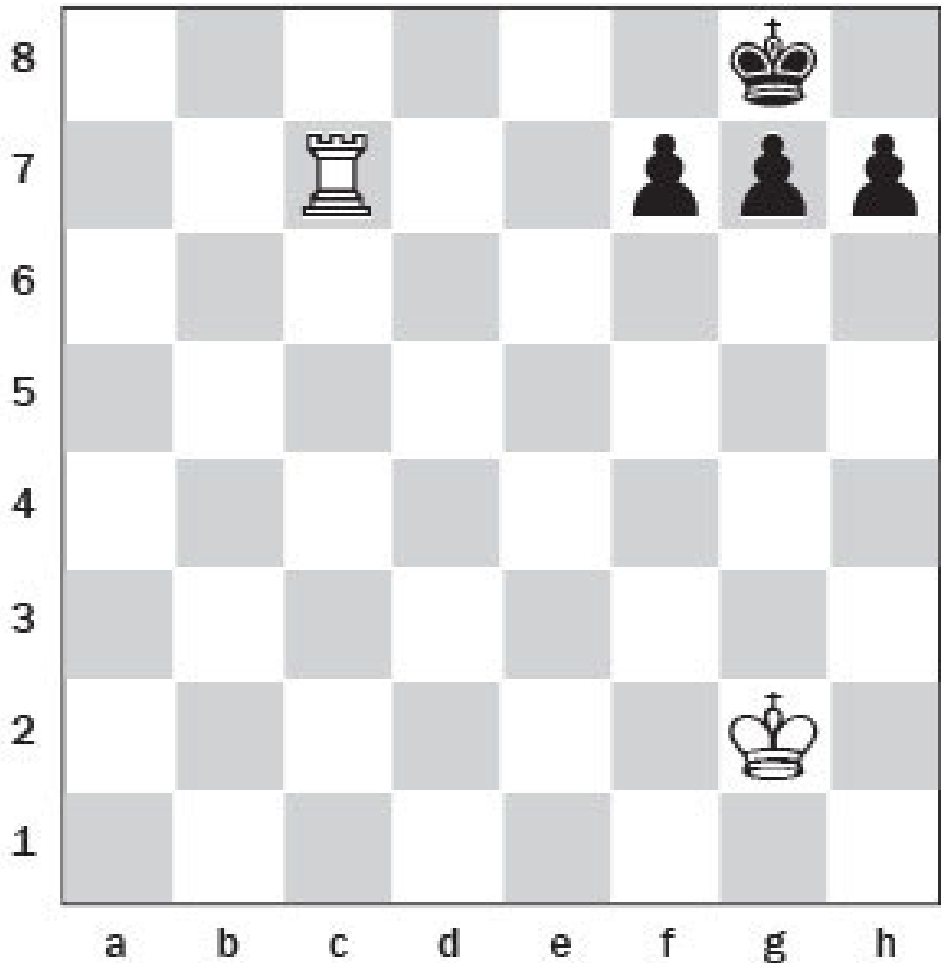


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

# Back Rank Checkmates in One – Guided Practice

Ex.



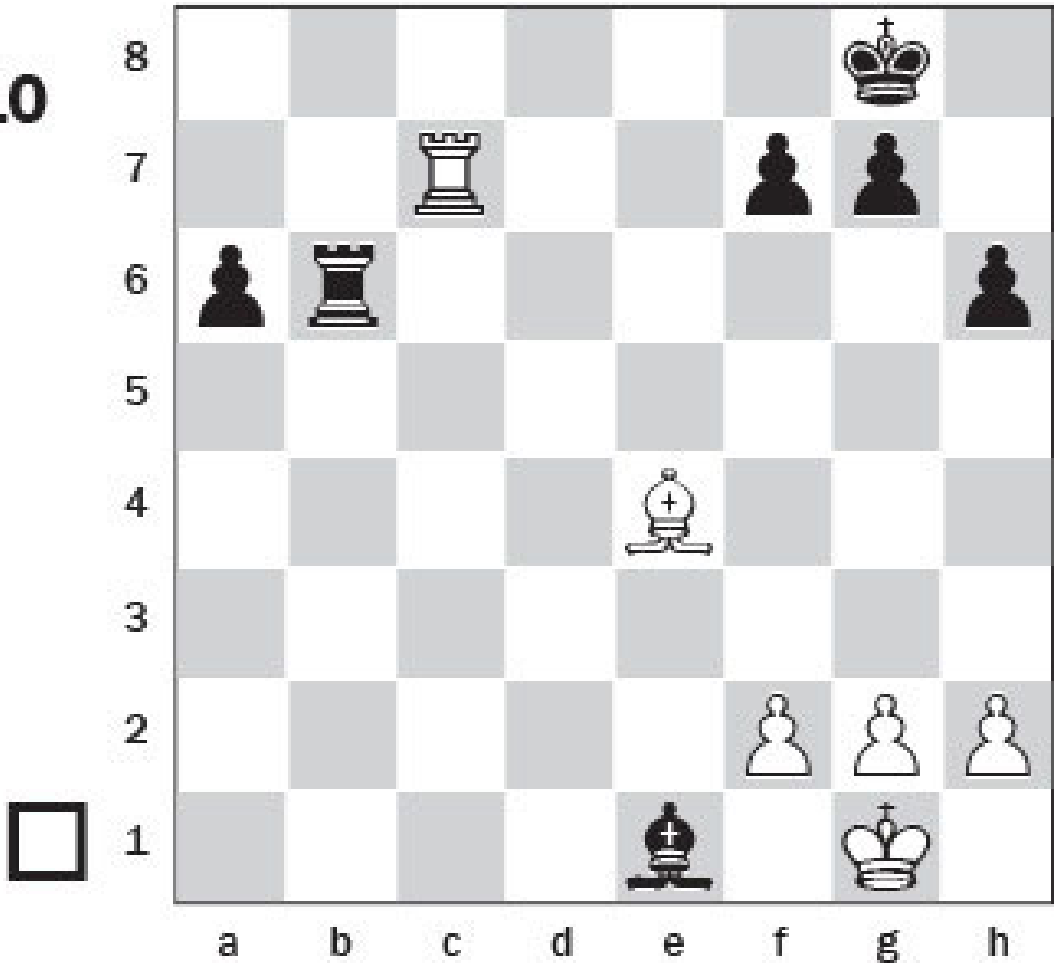
Answer:

1. Rc8# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 110

**110**



Answer:

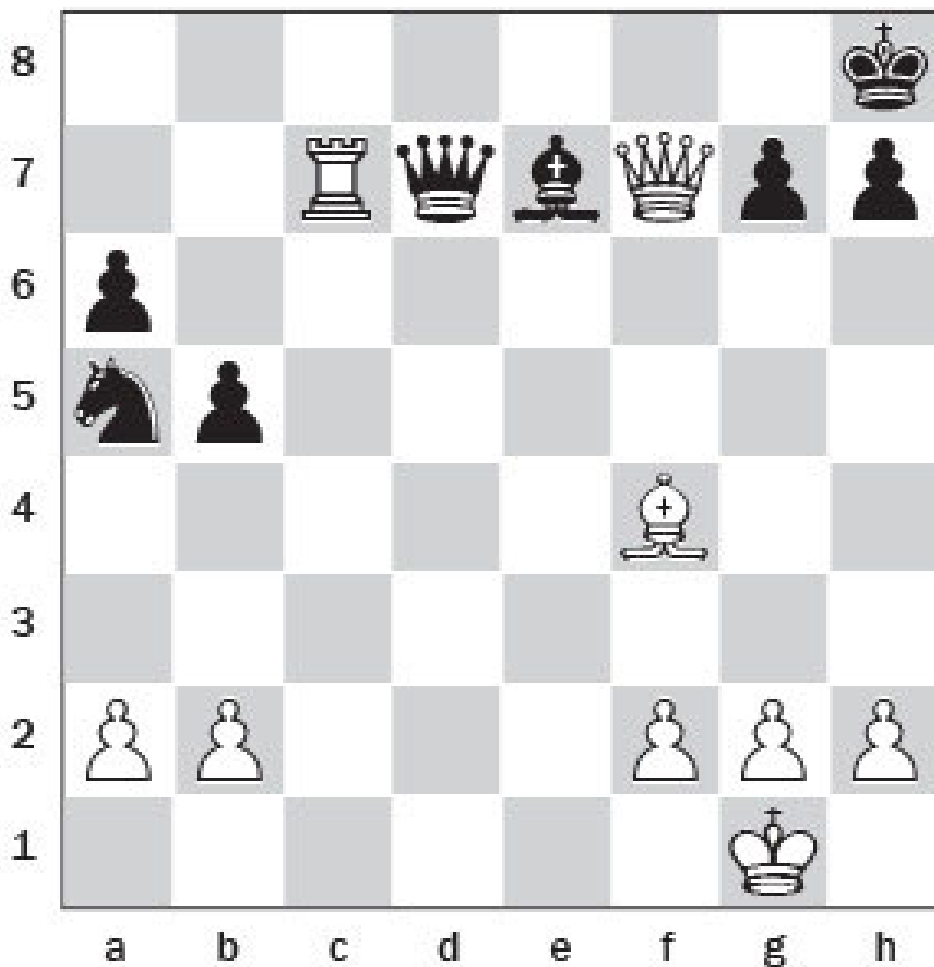
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the bishop on e4 is controlling the h7 escape square.

### Exercise 111

**111**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

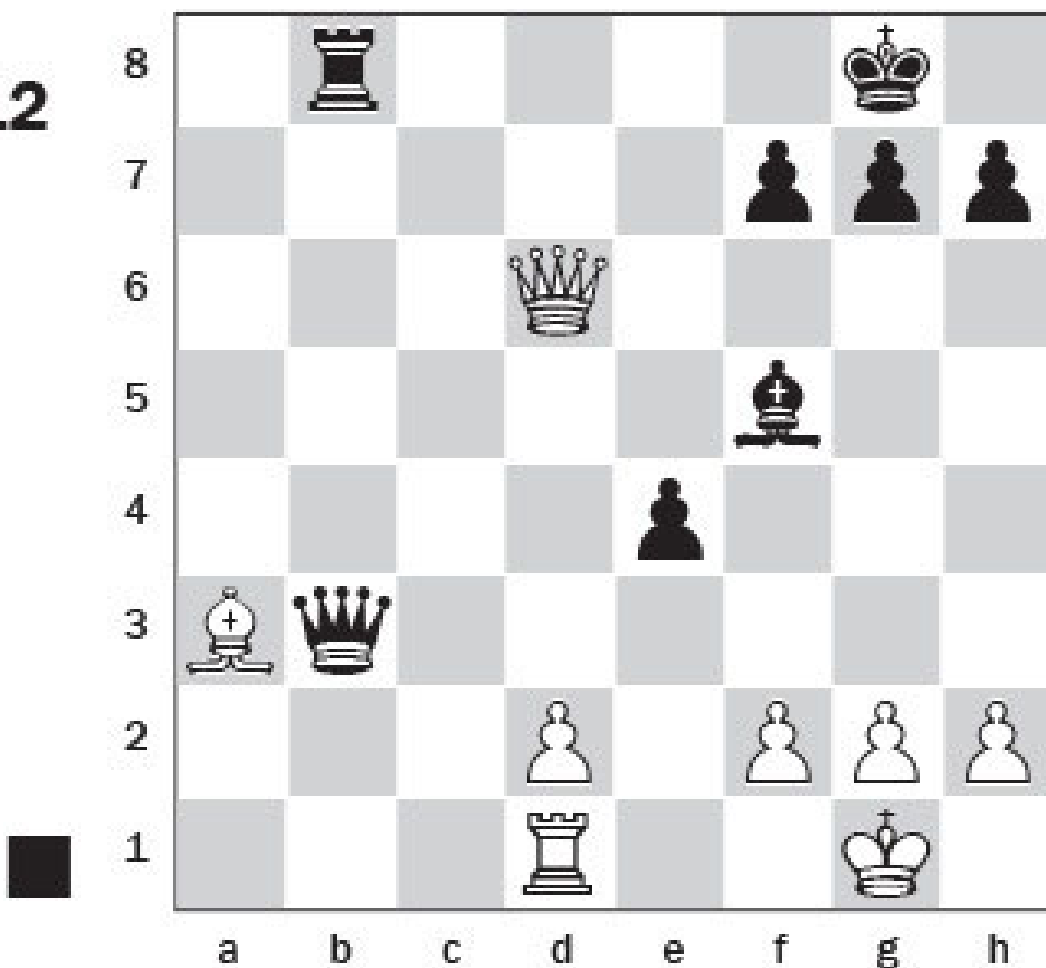
## **HINT**

Just like rooks, queens can also attack on the back rank.

# Back Rank Checkmates in One – Test

## Exercise 112

**112**



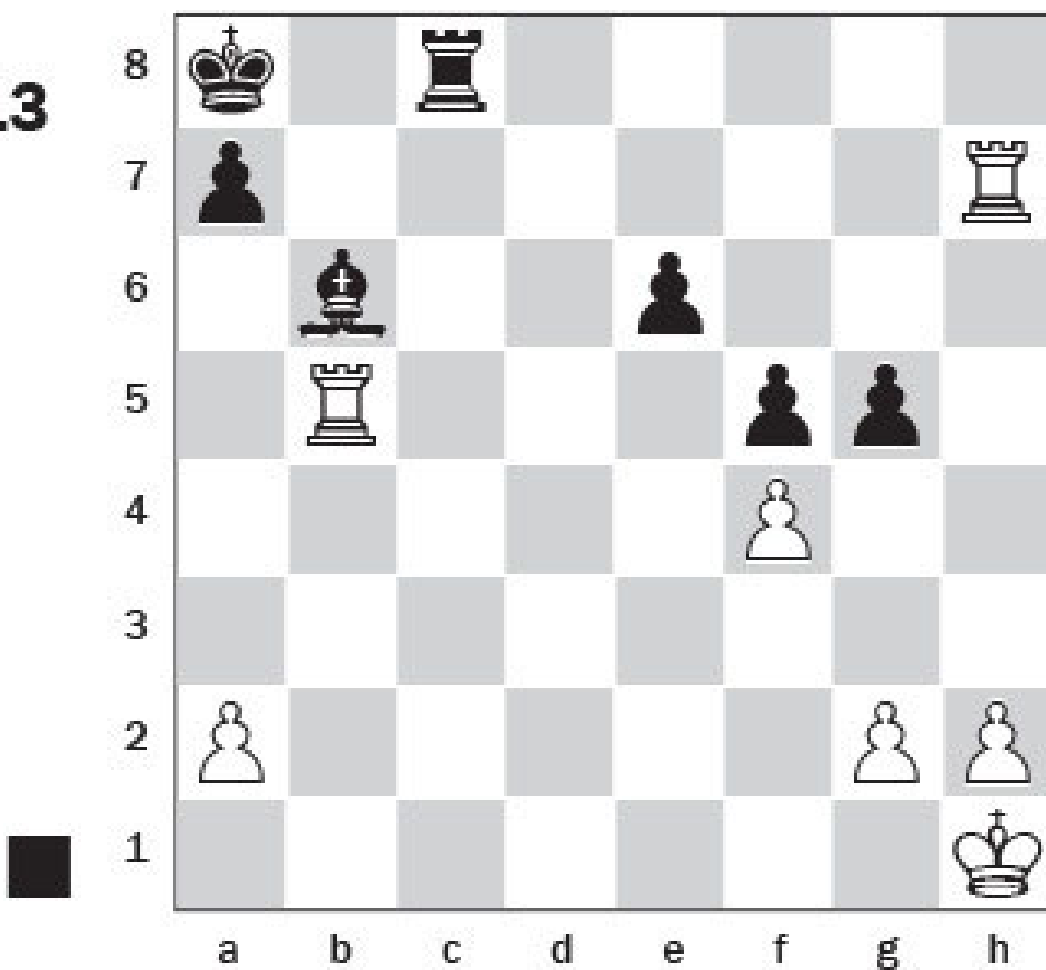
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



### Exercise 113

**113**

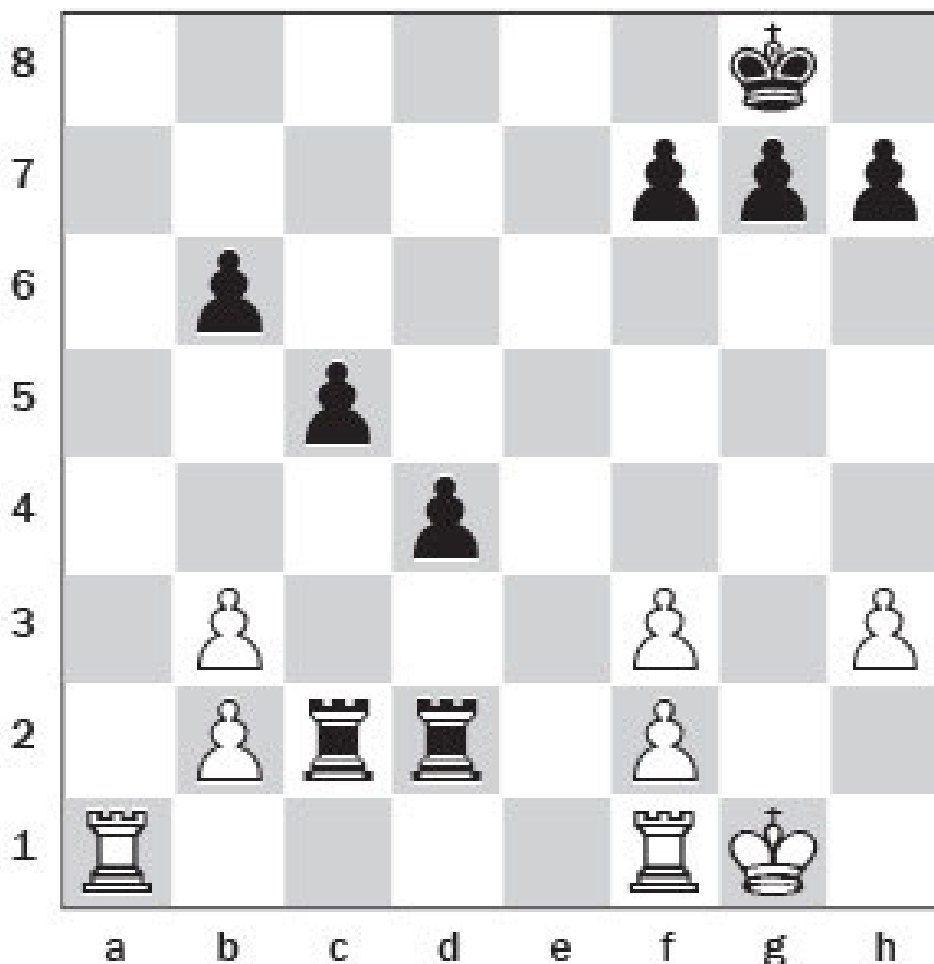


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 114

114



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## **PART II**

# **Introduction to Chess Tactics**

This section of the workbook primarily deals with ‘chess tactics’. Chess tactics are extremely important to the game of chess. Tactics are moves that enable you to gain a winning advantage of sorts. A winning advantage could mean material gain or even checkmate. So that you do not get carried away with all the ways you can win, the final chapter in this section is defending against tactics and threats.

Because tactics are not always obvious at first sight it is best to learn them by theme. Each tactical theme is assigned its own chapter along with puzzles that represent the concept.

**Remember that when solving the puzzles in this section, look for all forcing moves:**

- Checks;
- Captures;
- Threats.

*In addition, keep a close eye out for undefended pieces.*

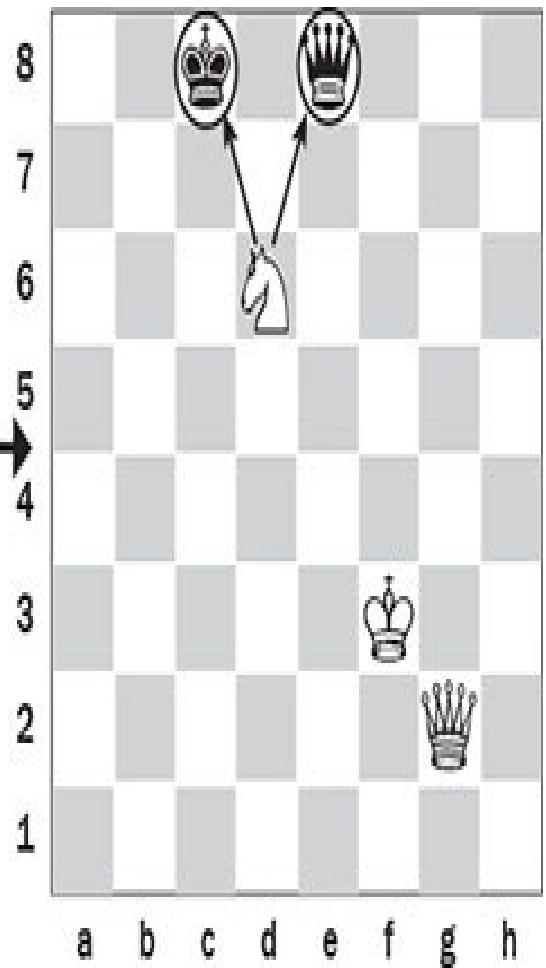
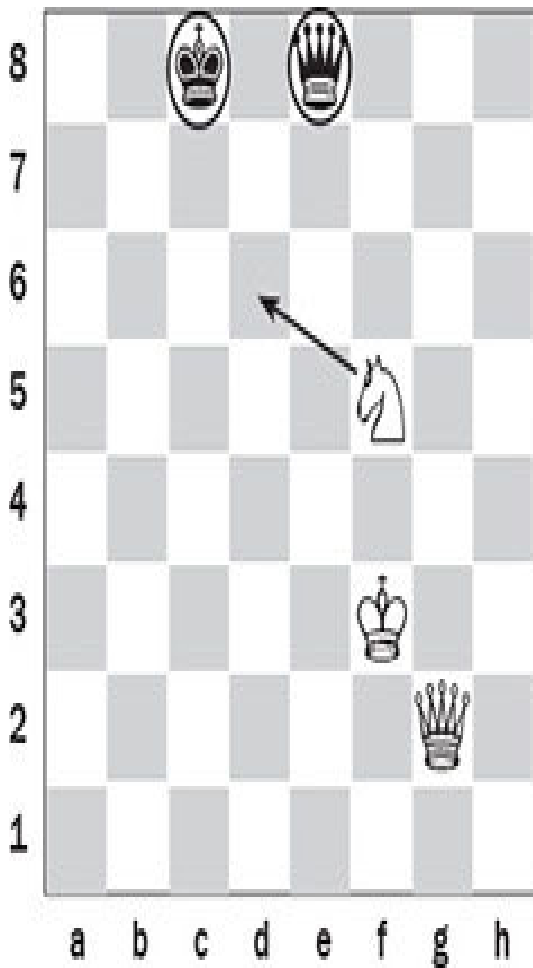
*For a more thorough explanation refer to the 'Workbook Solving Tips' section in the Introduction.*

## CHAPTER 5

# Forks

A fork is when one piece attacks two or more enemy pieces at the same time. The unique thing about this motif is that every single piece on the board, including the king, can issue a fork. In this chapter, we break down forks according to the piece giving them. Before you begin solving, take a look at the following basic examples:

### Knight Forks



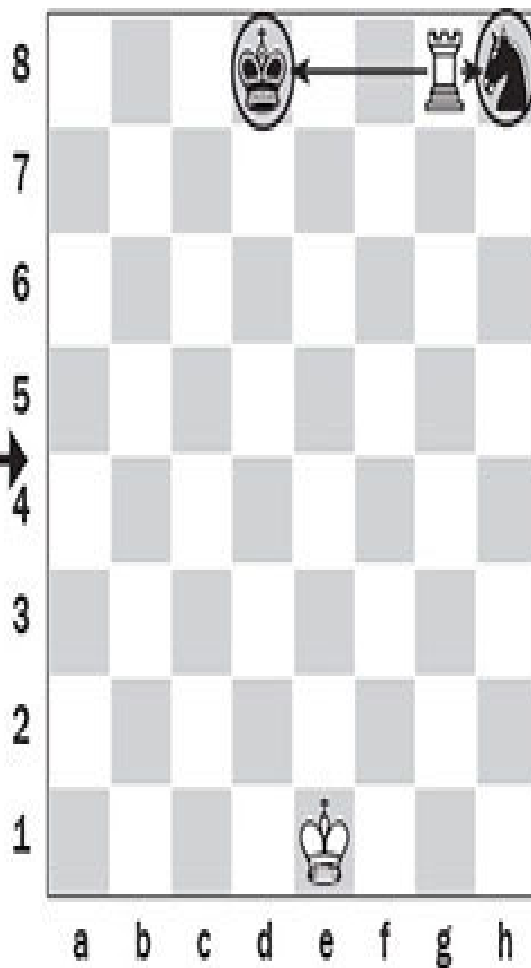
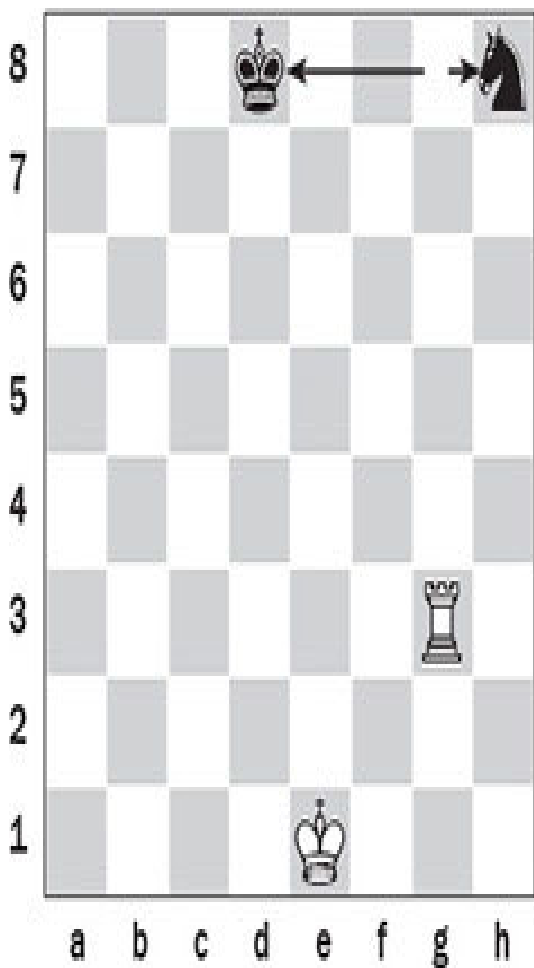
The knight could move to d6 and fork the king and the queen. That would be an extremely powerful move since White would win a queen for only a knight...

**1.Nd6+ (see diagram 2) 1...Kd7 2.Nxe8.**

... while White would end up losing a knight. It's important to remember that the goal of any chess tactic is to gain an advantage, material or otherwise, and Nd6+ certainly does that. White wins a queen (9) and Black only gets the knight (3) in return. Knight forks are the trickiest of them all, and we will begin with those first.

Before you begin solving, take a look at some examples of how other pieces can fork:

## Rook Forks

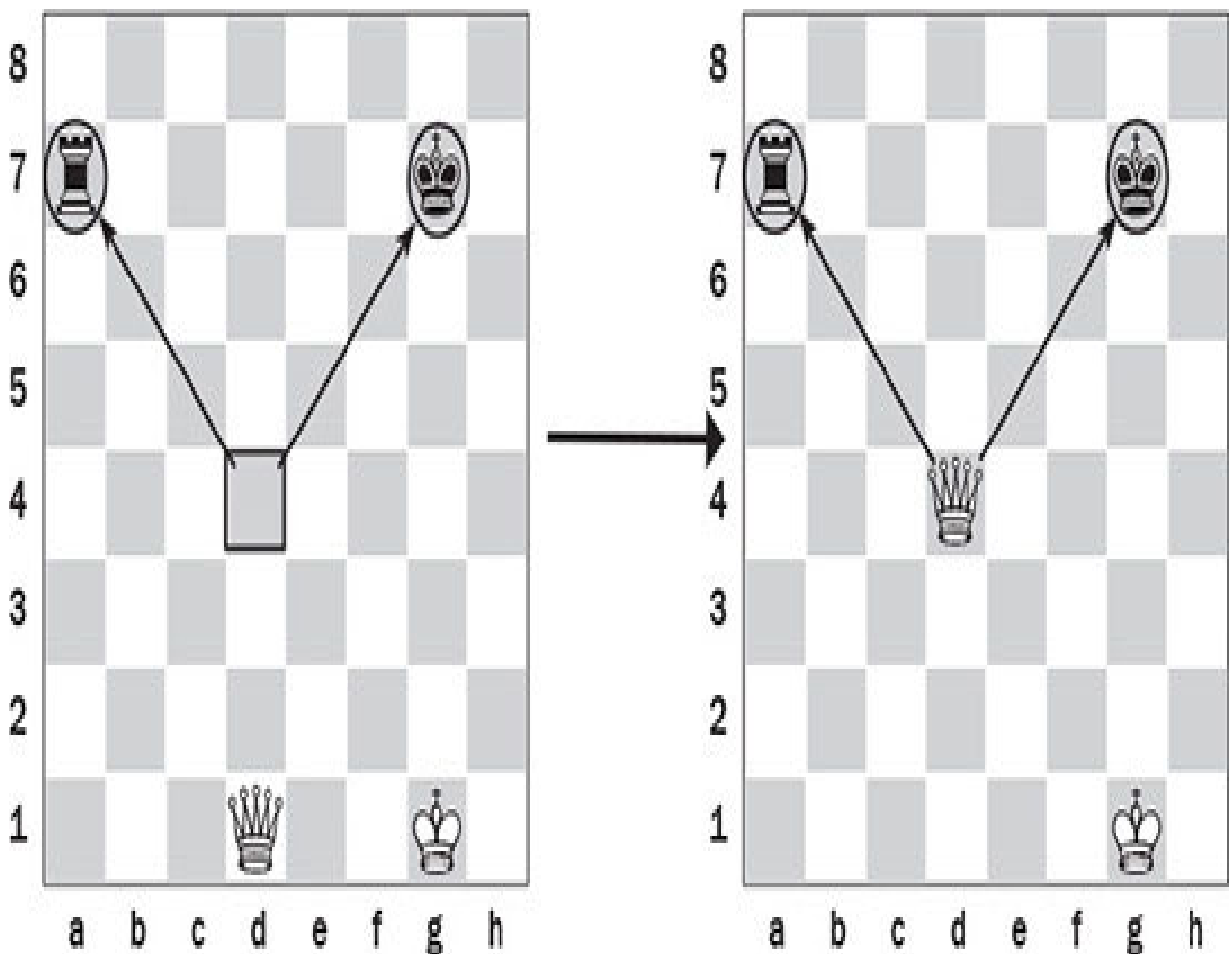


Notice the king and the knight are on the same rank. White can use the rook to fork:

**1.Rg8+ (see diagram 2) 2...Ke7 2.Rxh8.**

White wins a knight (3 points) for nothing and should go on to win the game.

## Queen Forks



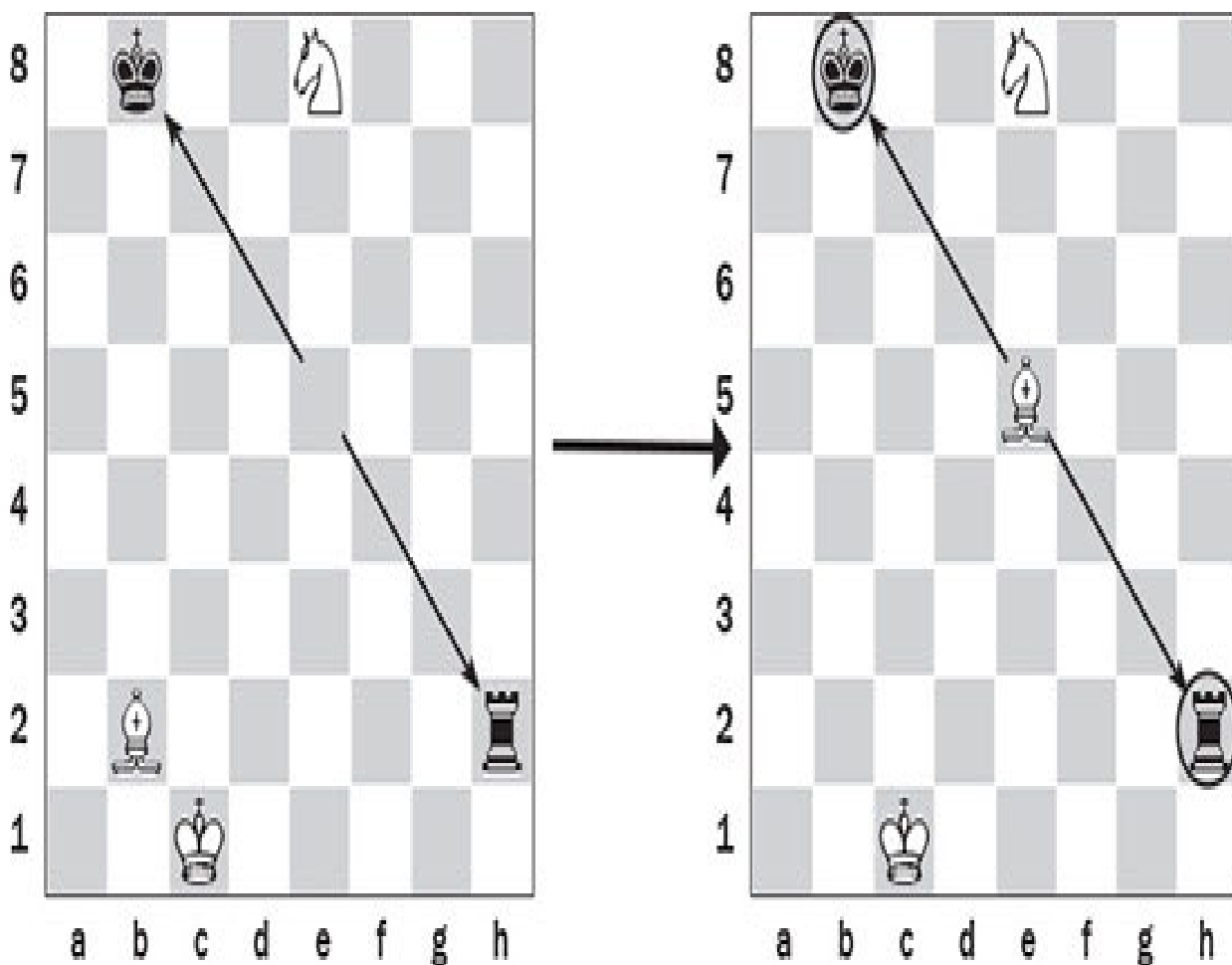
Notice that the rook is unprotected on a7. Rooks do not like to be attacked on diagonals. White can fork the king and rook:



1.Qd4+ (see diagram 2) 1...Kh7 2.Qxa7+.

White wins a rook (5 points) and should go on to win the game.

## Bishop Forks

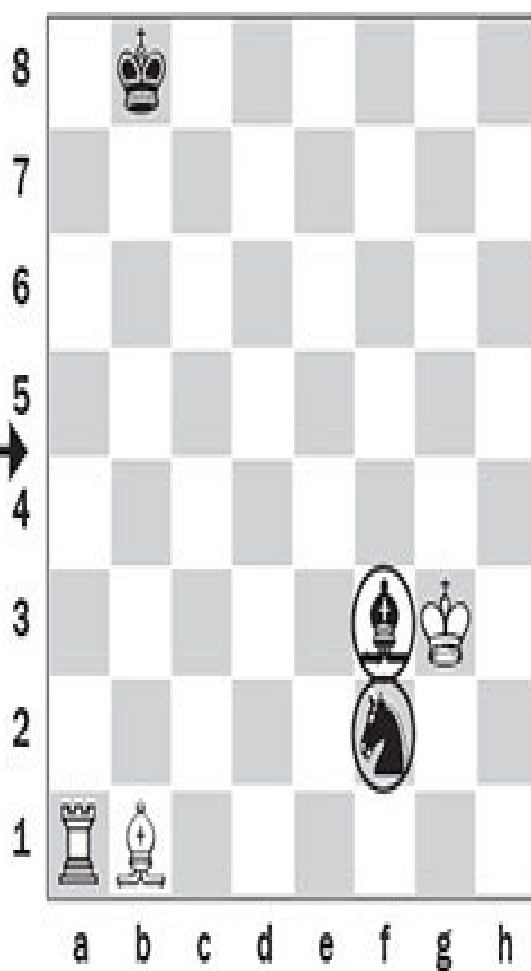
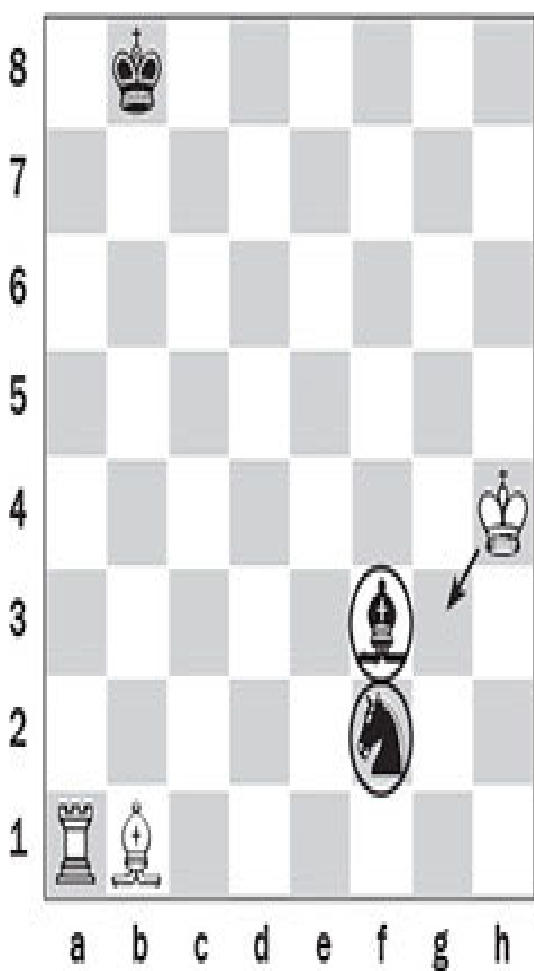


Rooks do not like to be attacked on diagonals, since they only move vertically and horizontally. White can win the rook on h2:

**1.Be5+ (see diagram 2) 1...Kc8 2.Bxh2.**

White wins a rook (5 points) for free and should go on to win the game.

## King Forks

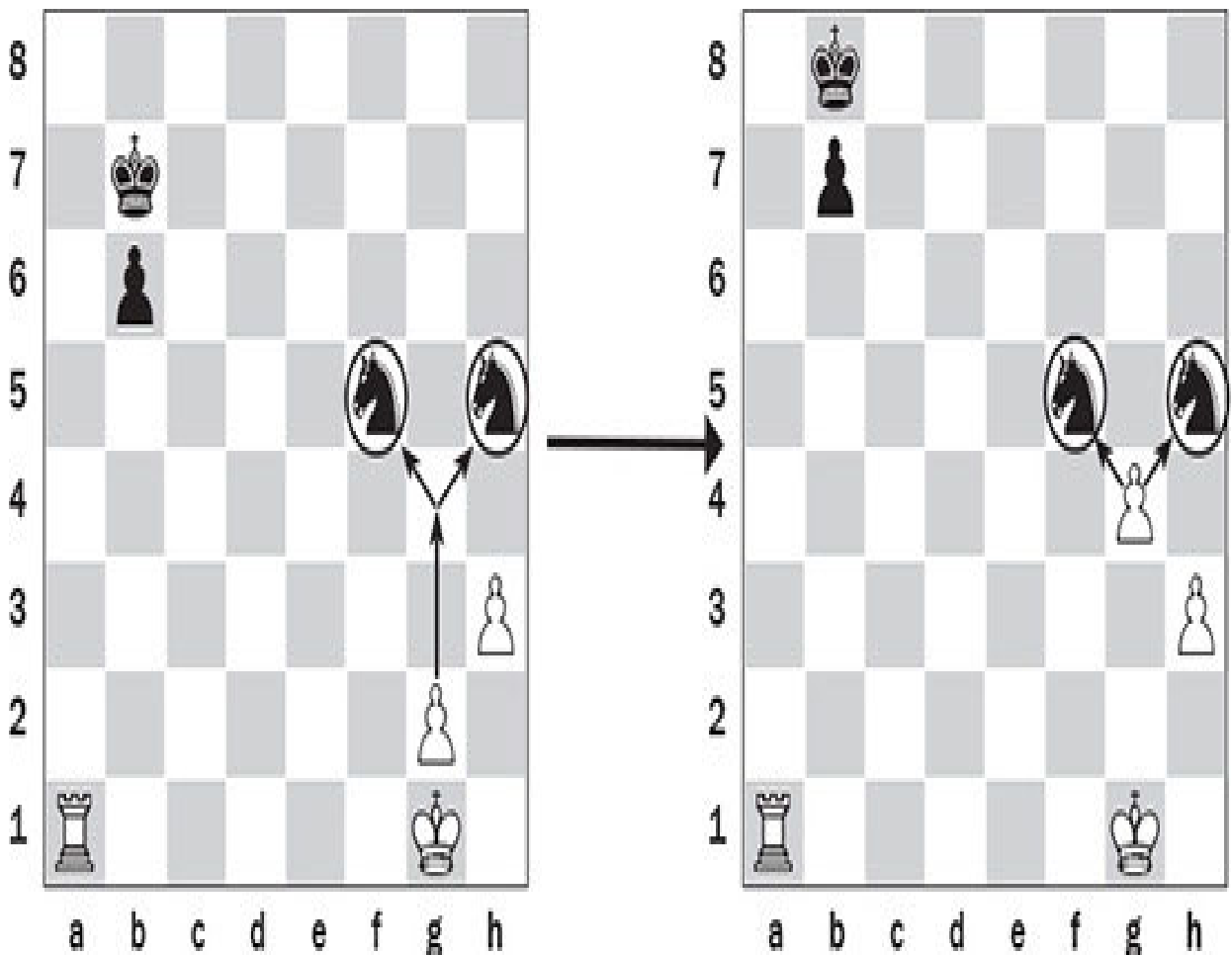


Kings can fork pieces too,;they just have to be one square away!  
White can fork the bishop and knight:

**1.Kg3 (see diagram 2)**

White will win one of the minor pieces (3 points) and should go on to win the game.

### Pawn Forks



Pawns can fork pieces but only pieces that are diagonally apart.  
White can play...

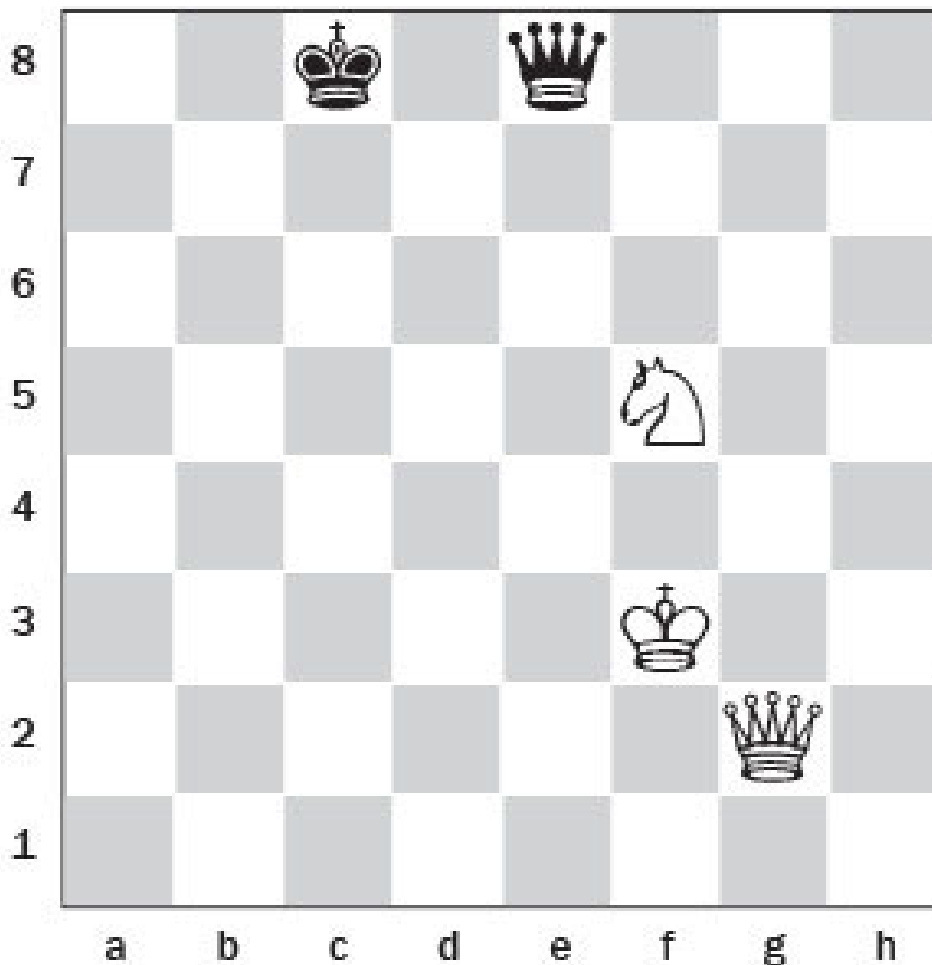
**1.g4 (see diagram 2)**

... which forks the knights. White will win one of the knights (3 points) for a pawn (1 point) and should go on to win the game.

All-in-all there are 40 fork puzzles in the chapter. In order to better solve the problems, look for all checks and undefended pieces.

# Knight Forks – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

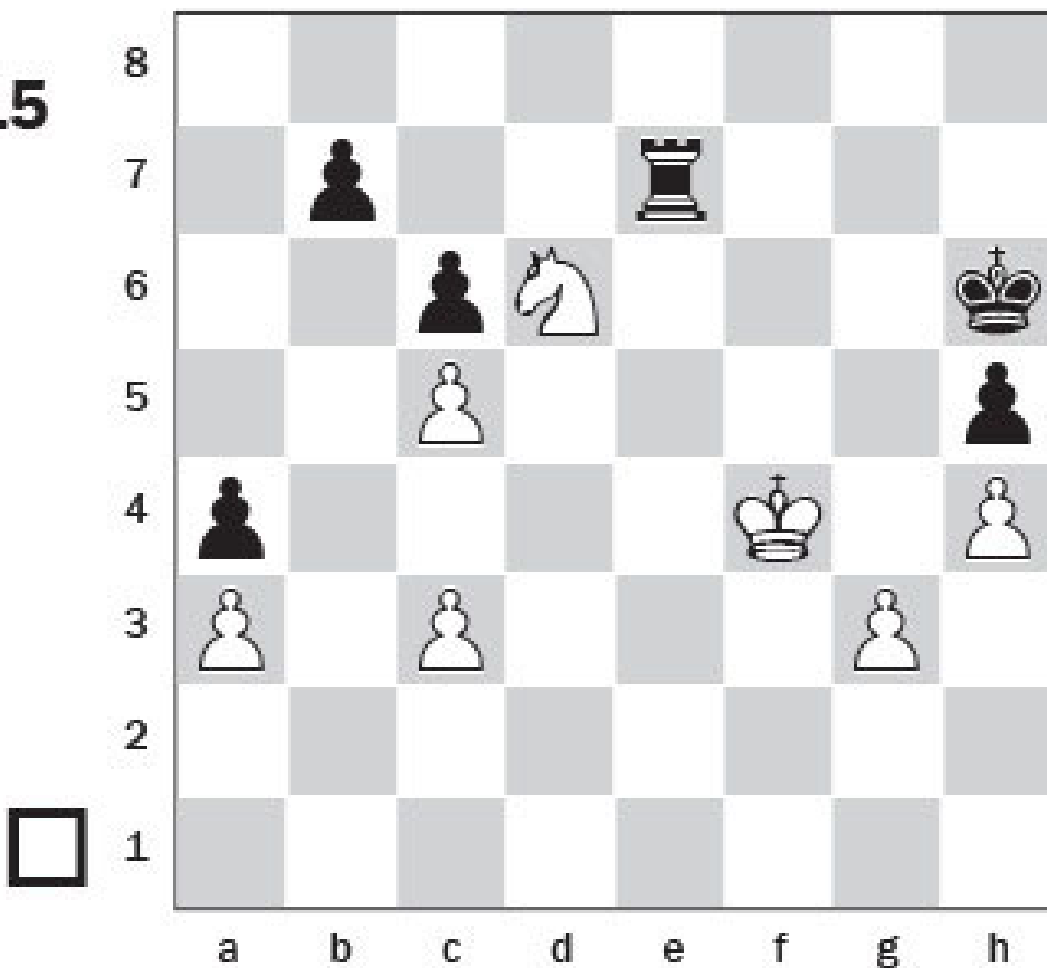
1. Nd6+ Kd7

2. Nxe8 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 115

**115**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a knight fork to win a rook.

### Exercise 116

**116**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

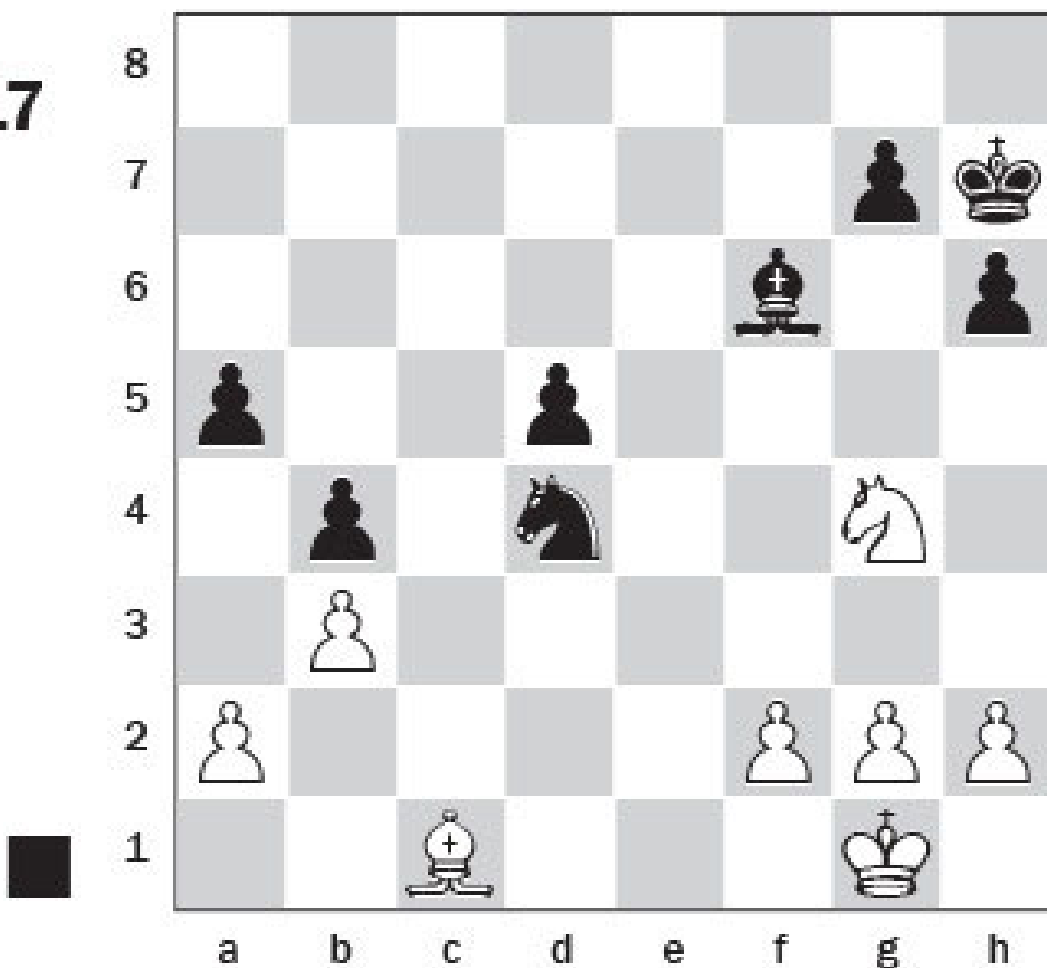
Use a knight fork to win a queen for a knight.



# Knight Forks – Test

## Exercise 117

**117**



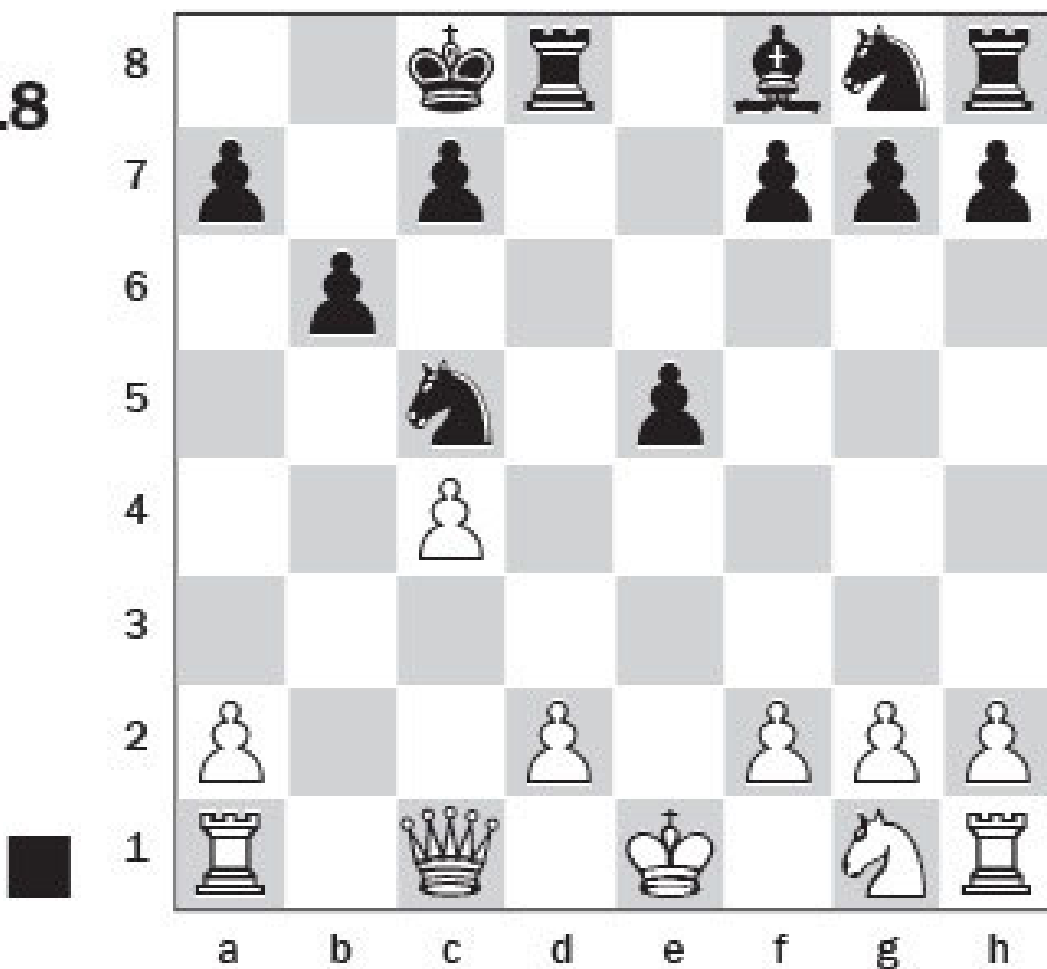
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 118

**118**



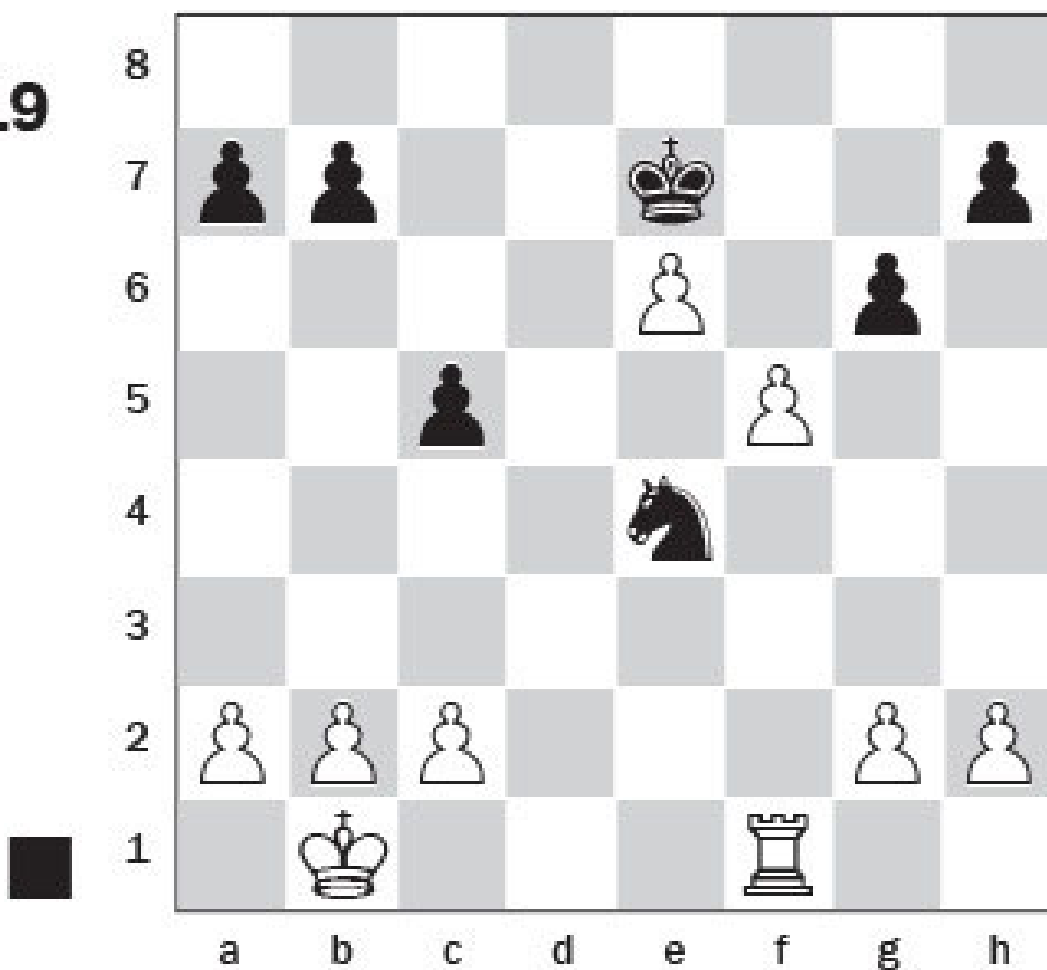
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 119

**119**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 120

**120**



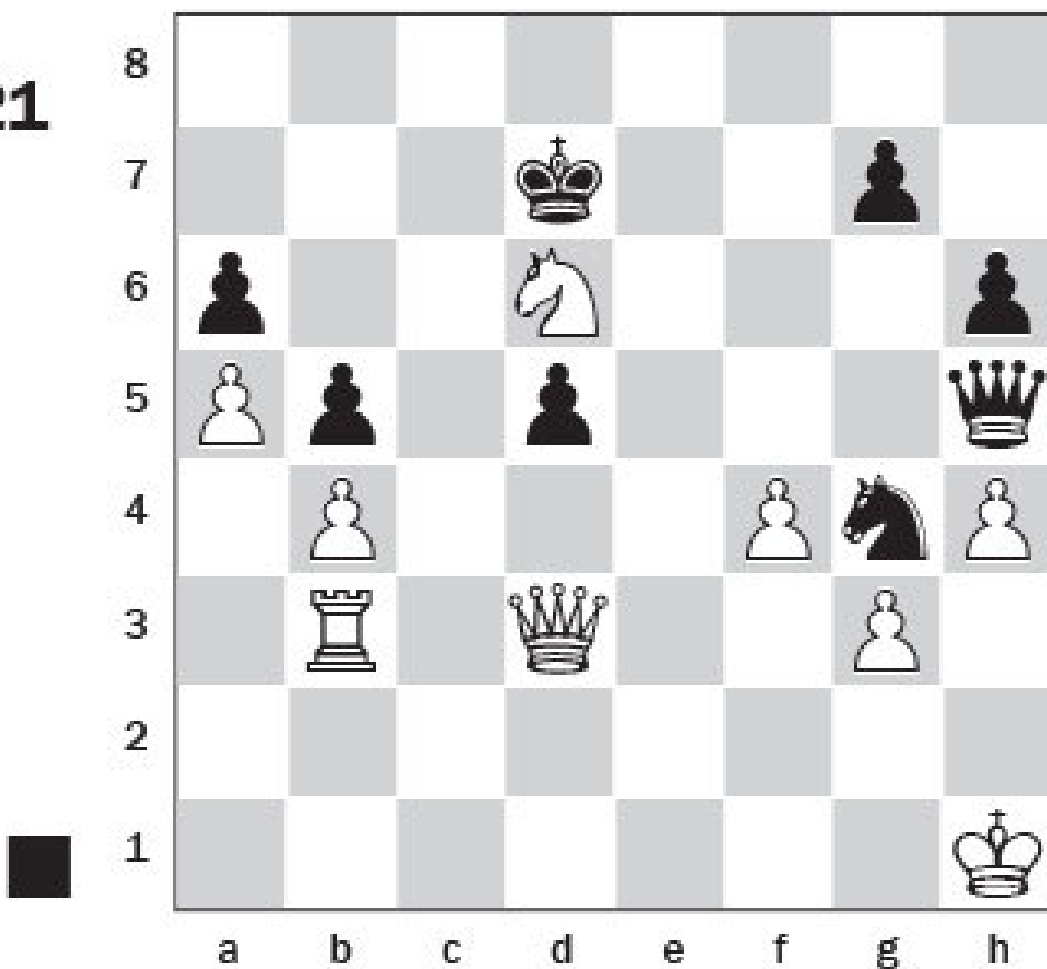
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 121

**121**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 122

**122**



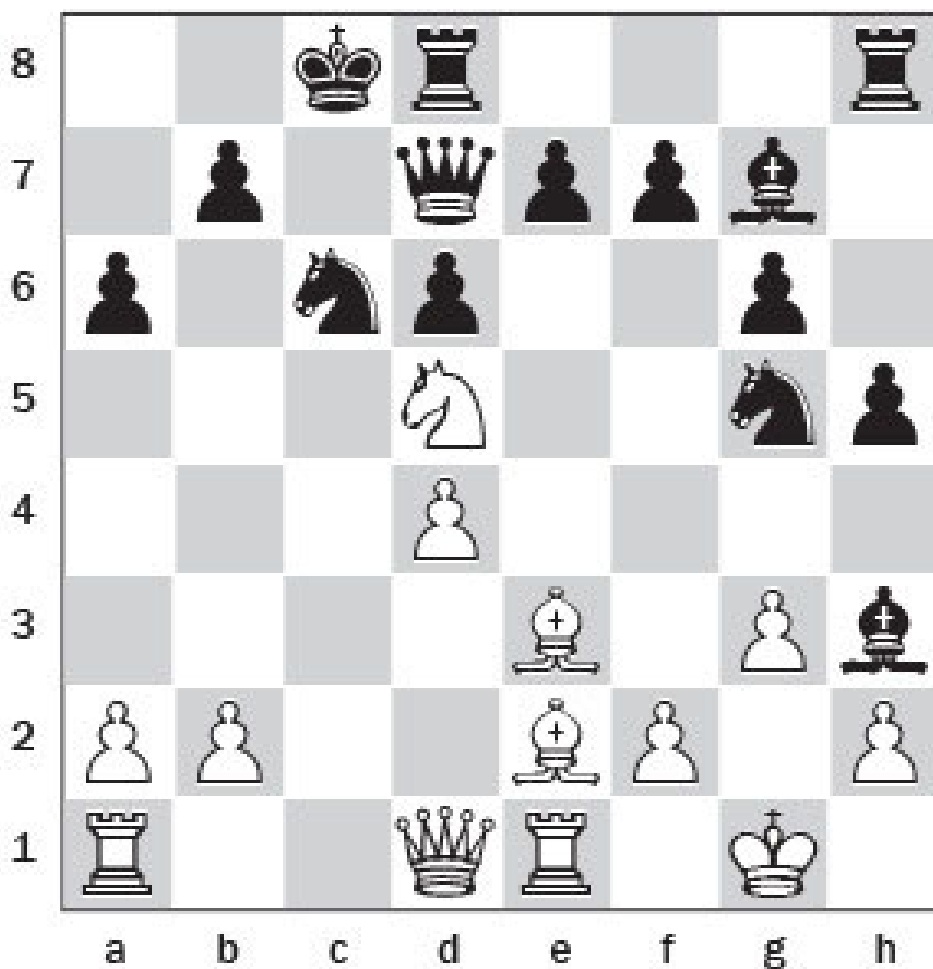
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 123

**123**



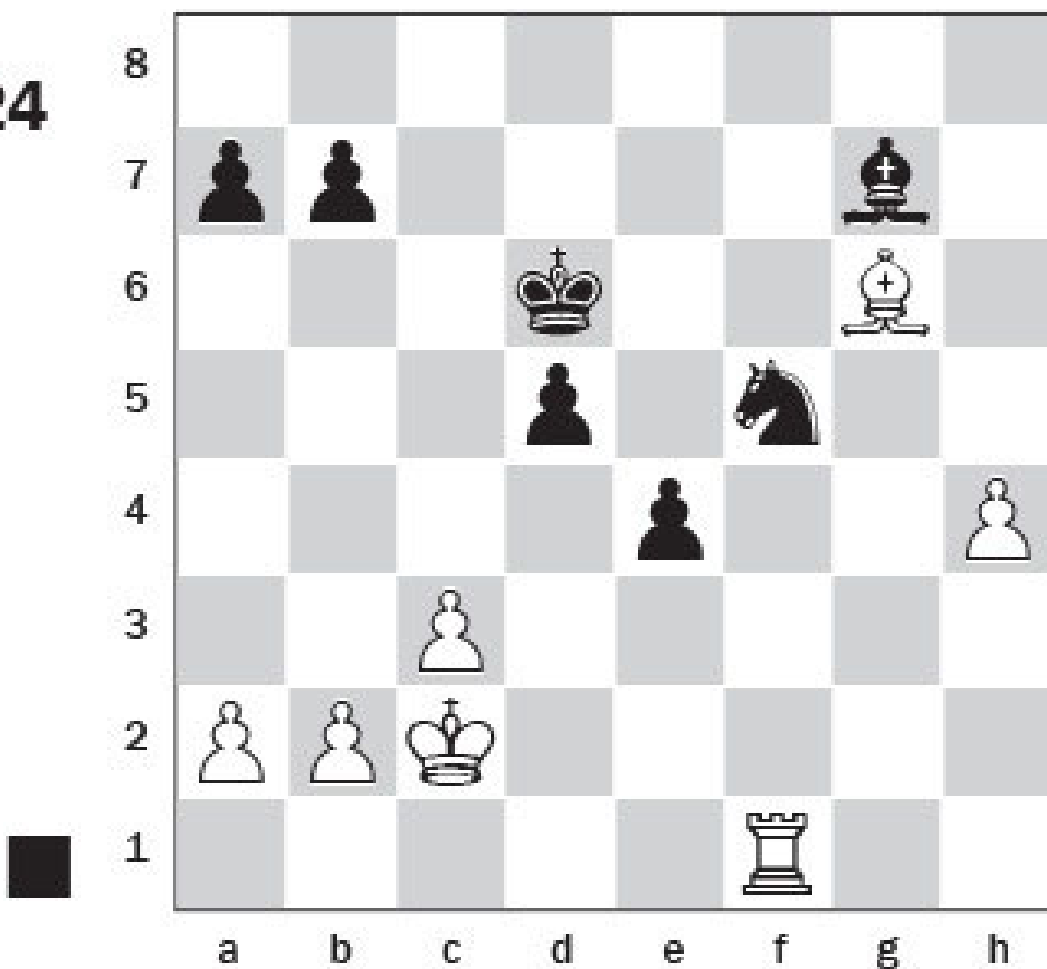
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 124

**124**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 125

**125**



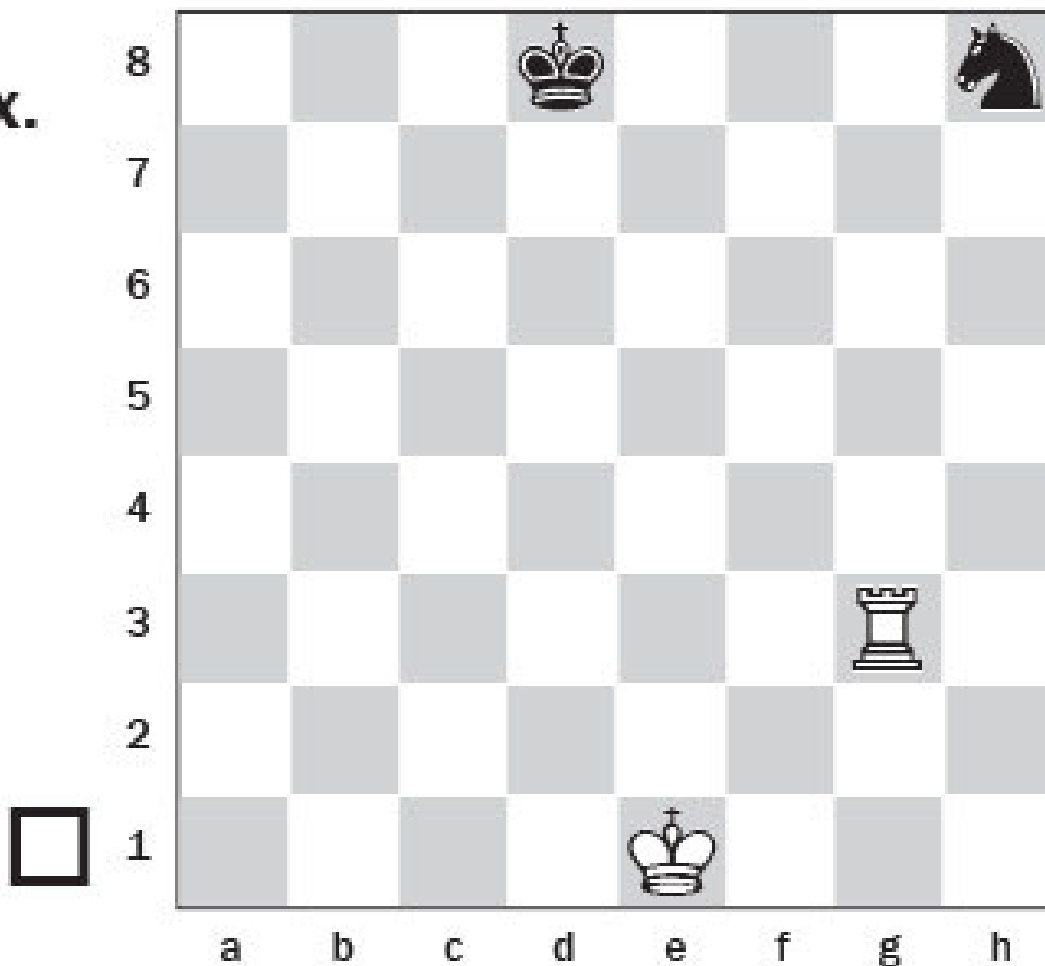
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

# Rook Forks – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

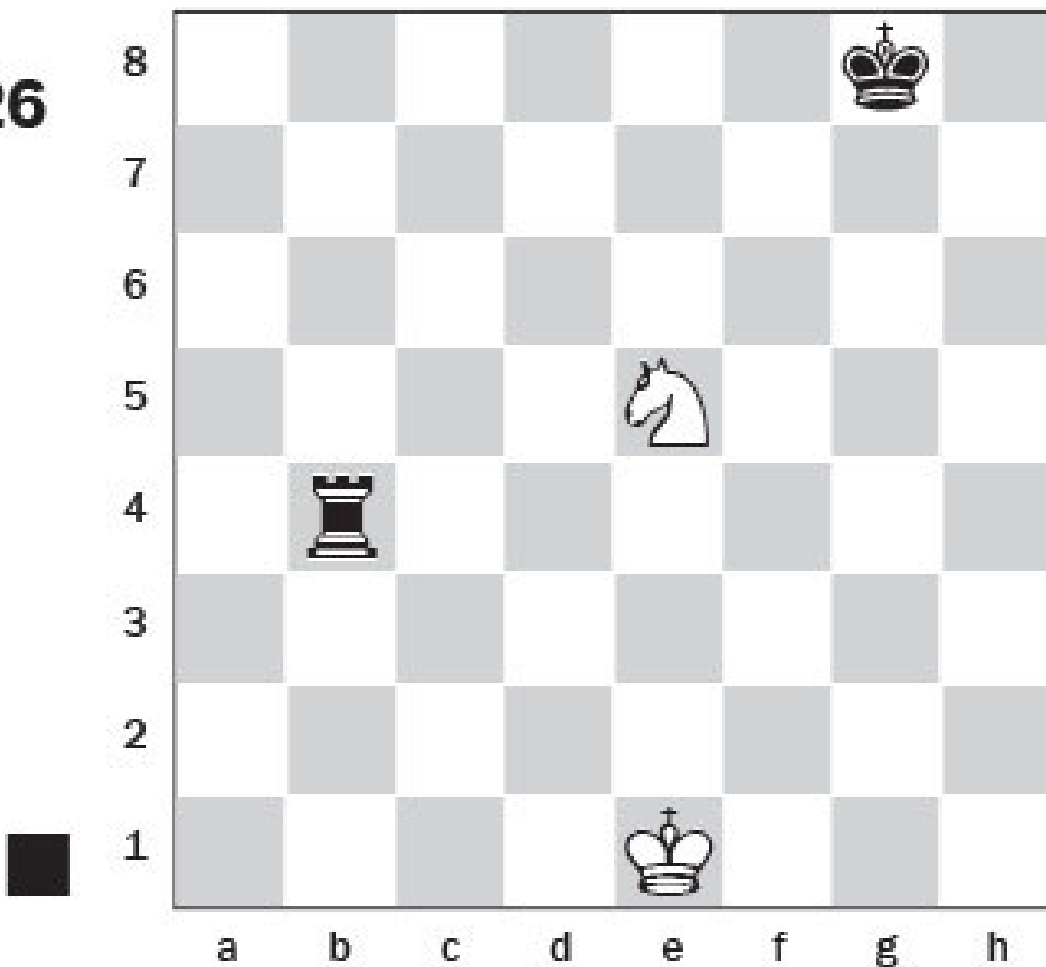
1. Rg8+ Ke7

2. Rxh8 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 126

**126**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

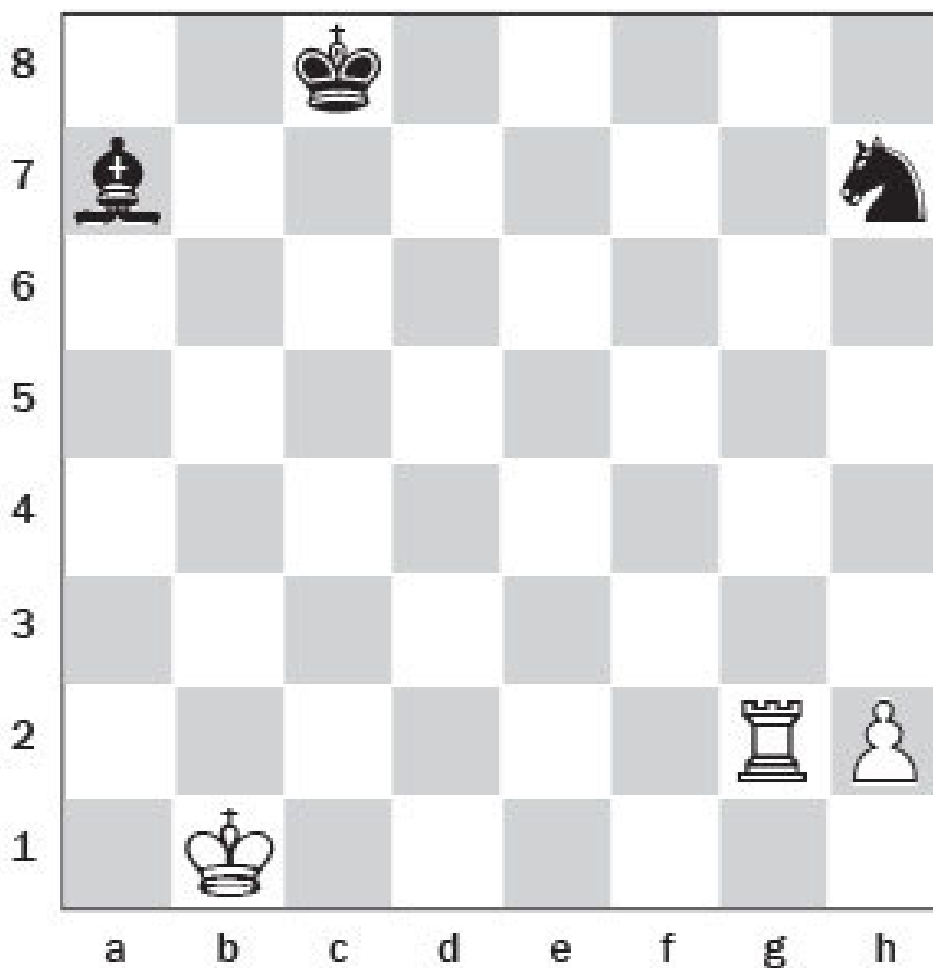
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice the king and the knight are on the same file. Win the knight using a rook fork.

### Exercise 127

**127**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Notice that the bishop and knight are both unprotected and on the same rank. Use a rook fork to win one of the pieces.

# Rook Forks – Test

## Exercise 128

128



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 129

**129**



Answer:

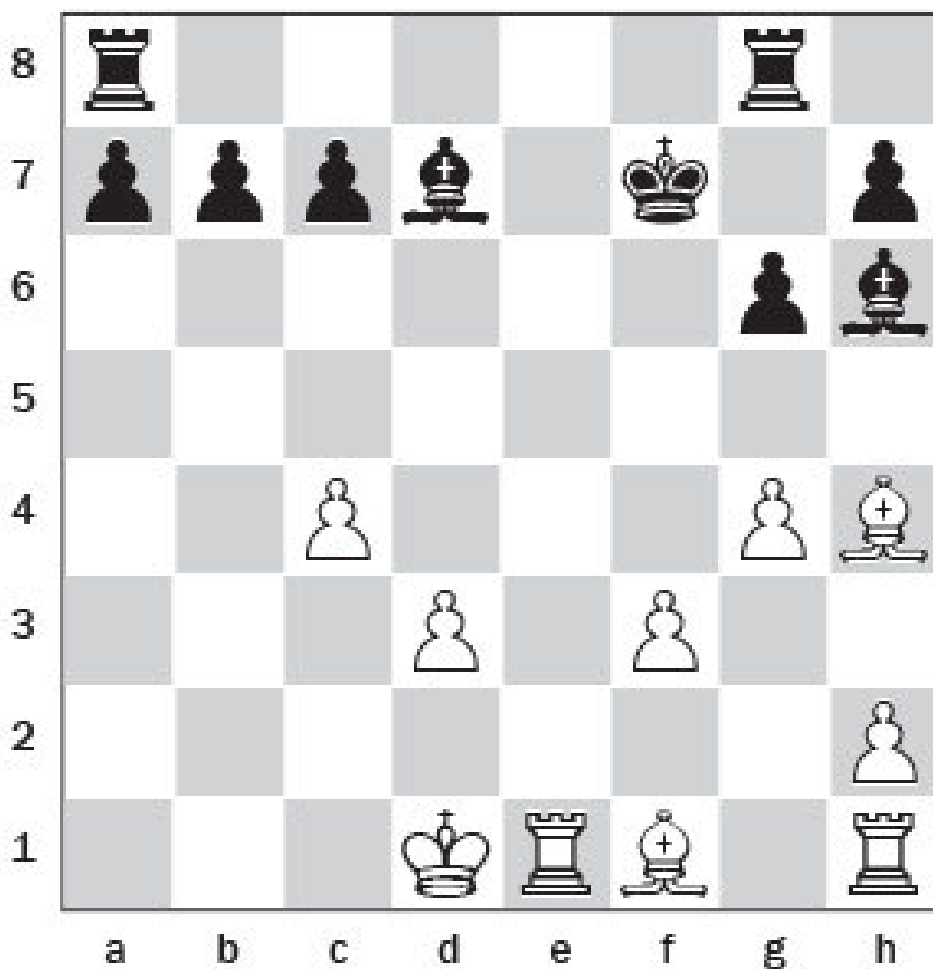
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 130

**130**



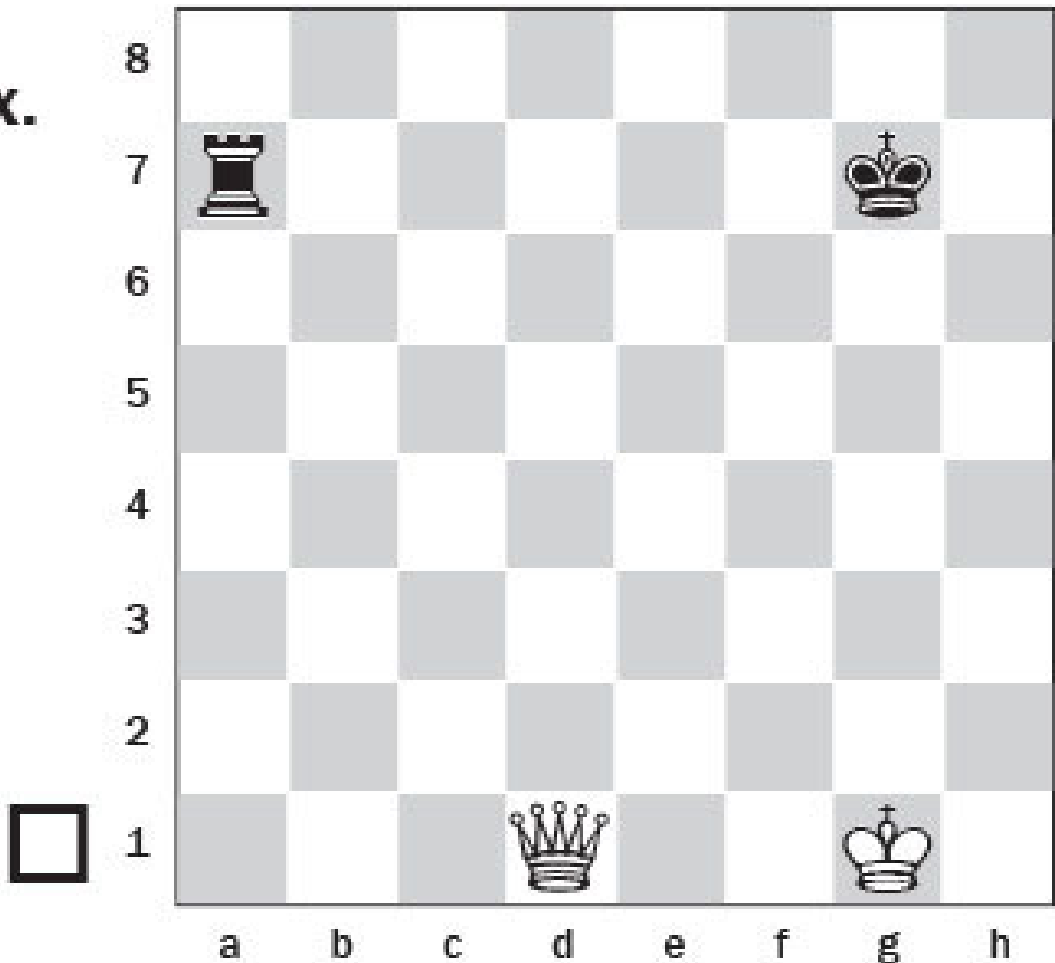
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

# Queen Forks – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

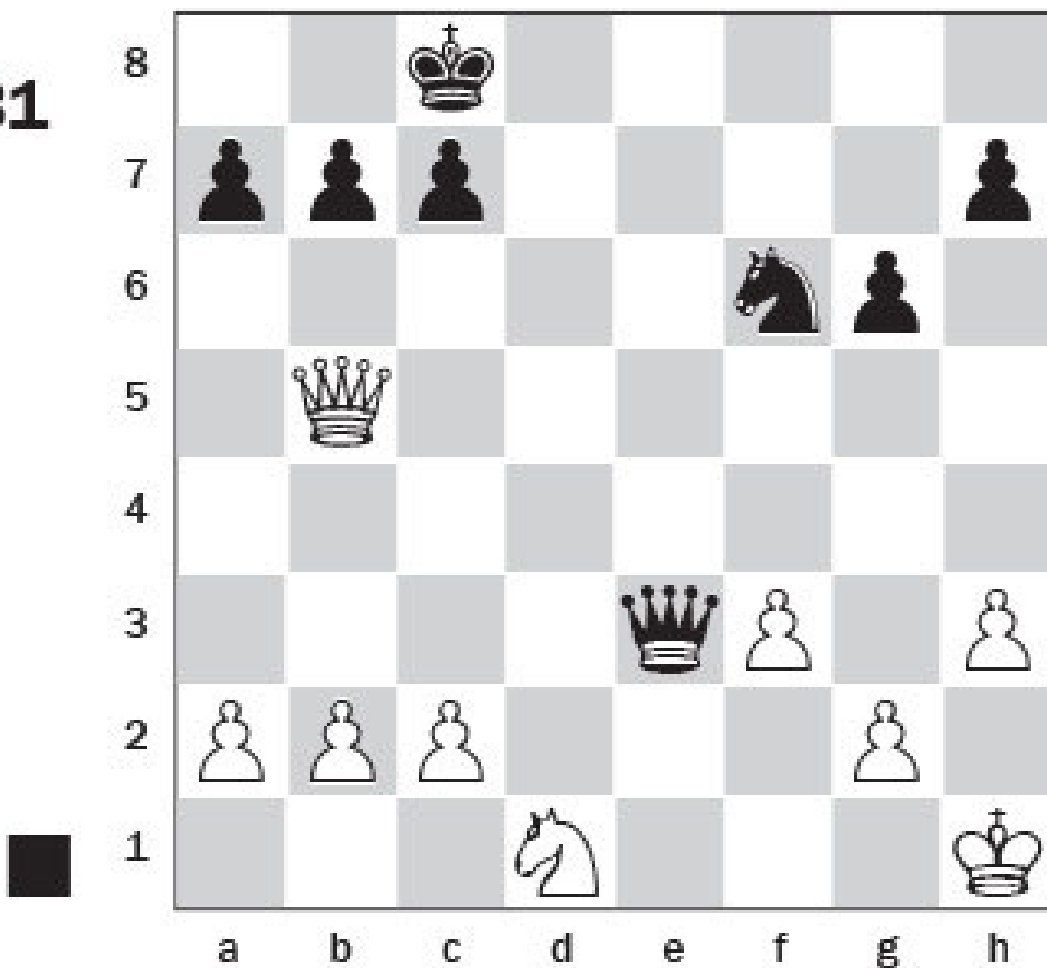
1. Qd4+ Kh7

2. Qxa7+ \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 131

**131**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

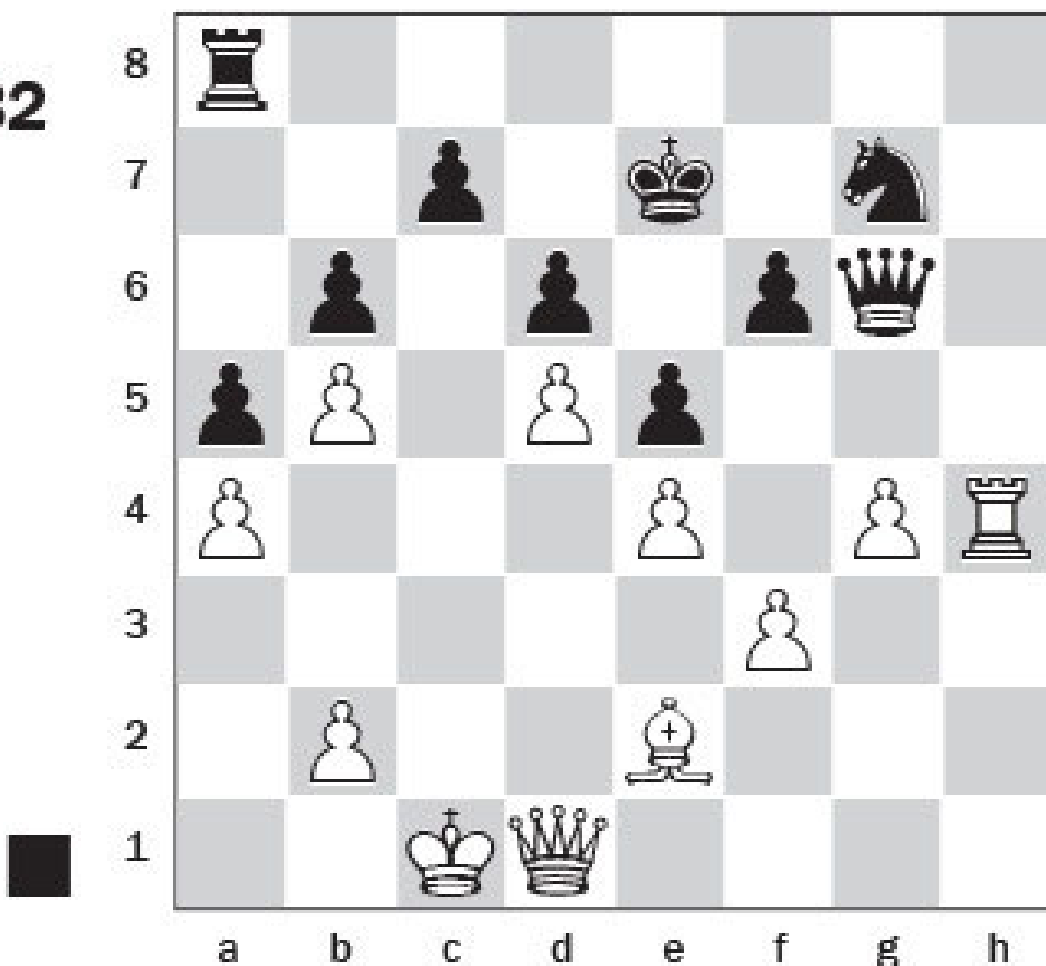
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The king and knight are both on the back rank. In addition, the knight is unprotected.

### Exercise 132

**132**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

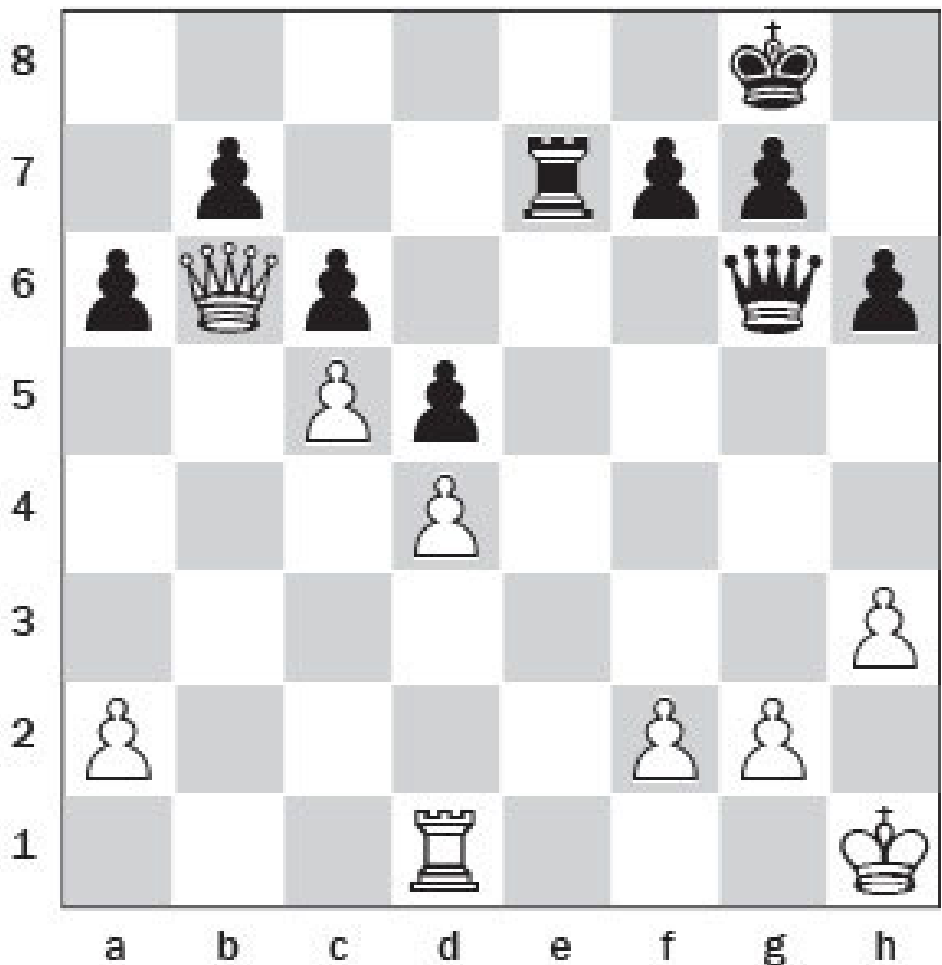
### HINT

The rook on h4 is unprotected, use a queen fork to take advantage of this!

# Queen Forks – Test

## Exercise 133

**133**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 134

**134**



Answer:

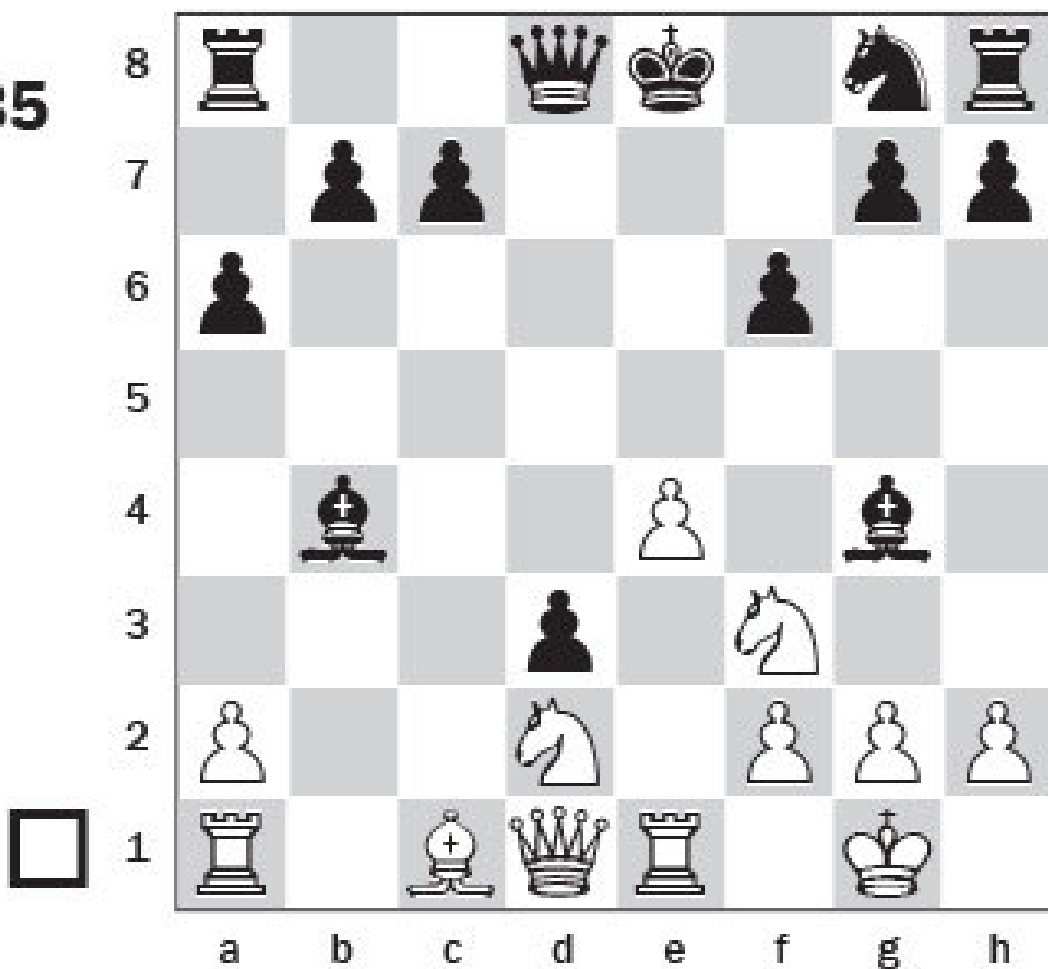
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 135

135



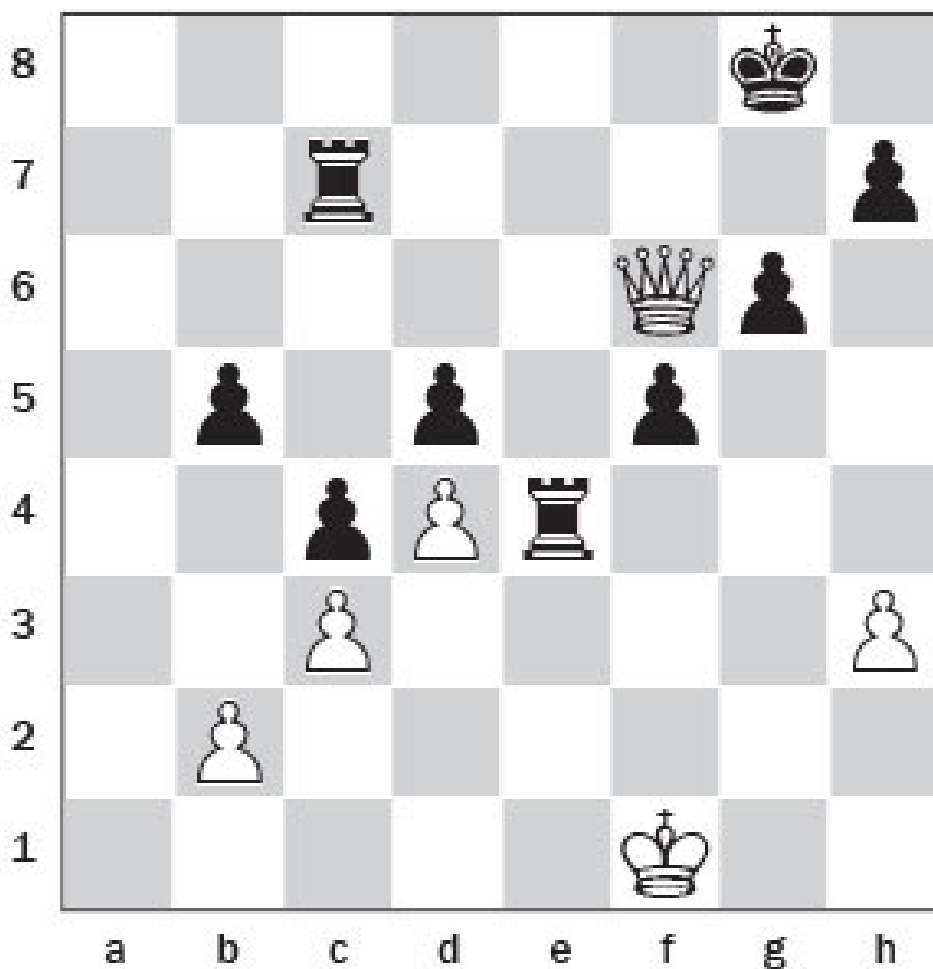
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 136

**136**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 137

**137**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 138

**138**



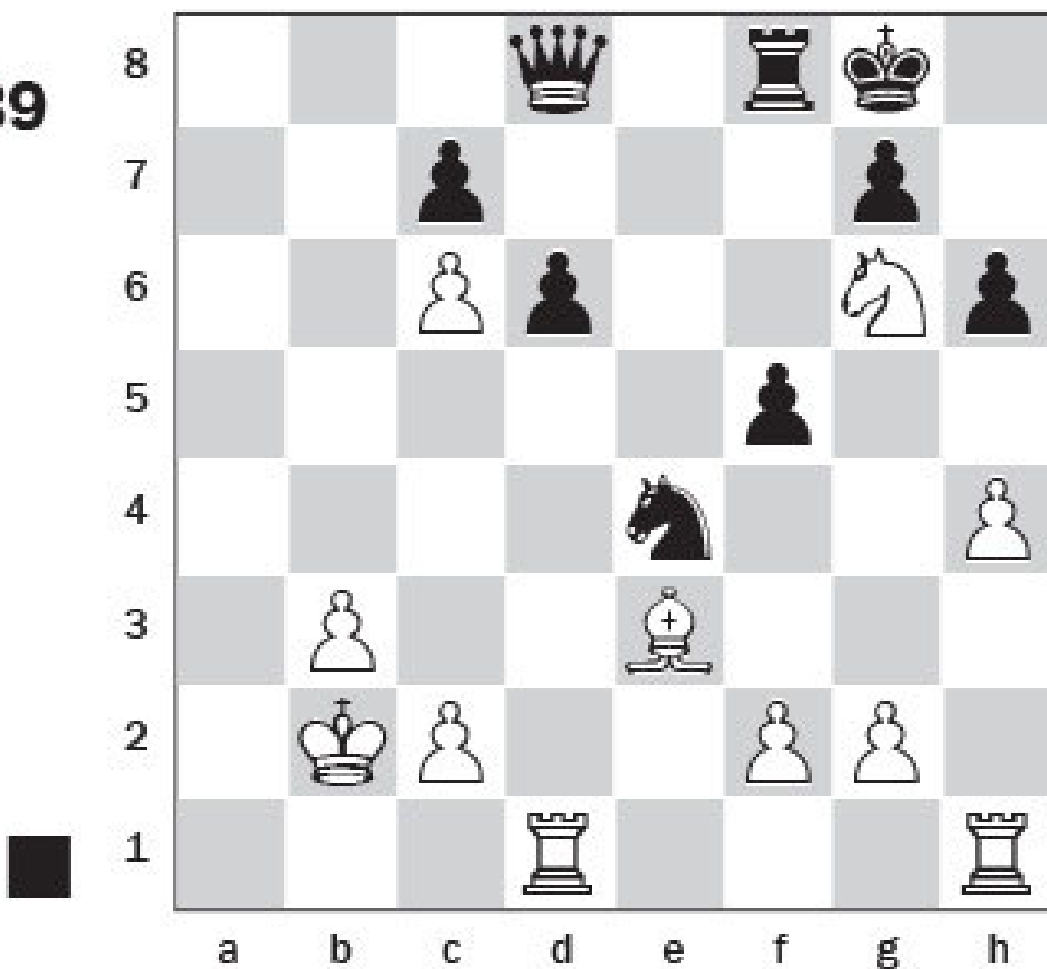
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 139

**139**



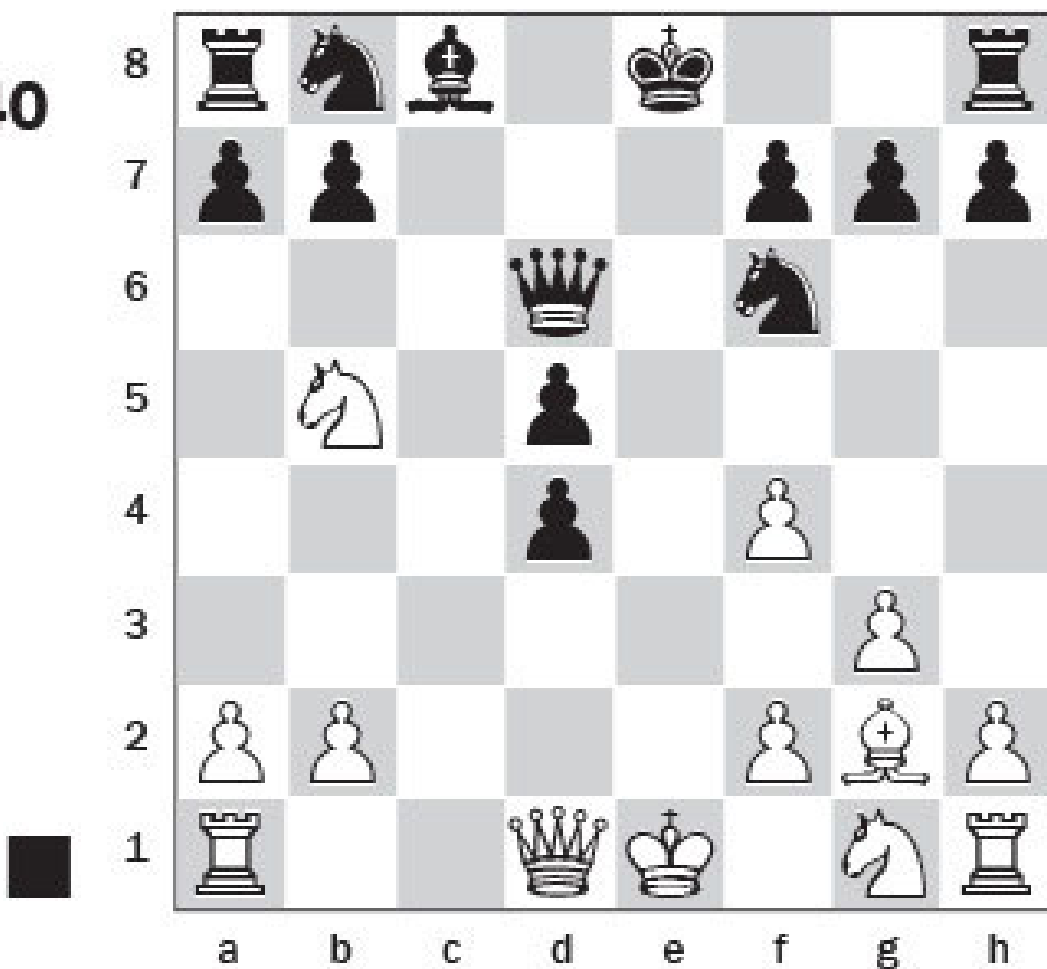
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 140

**140**



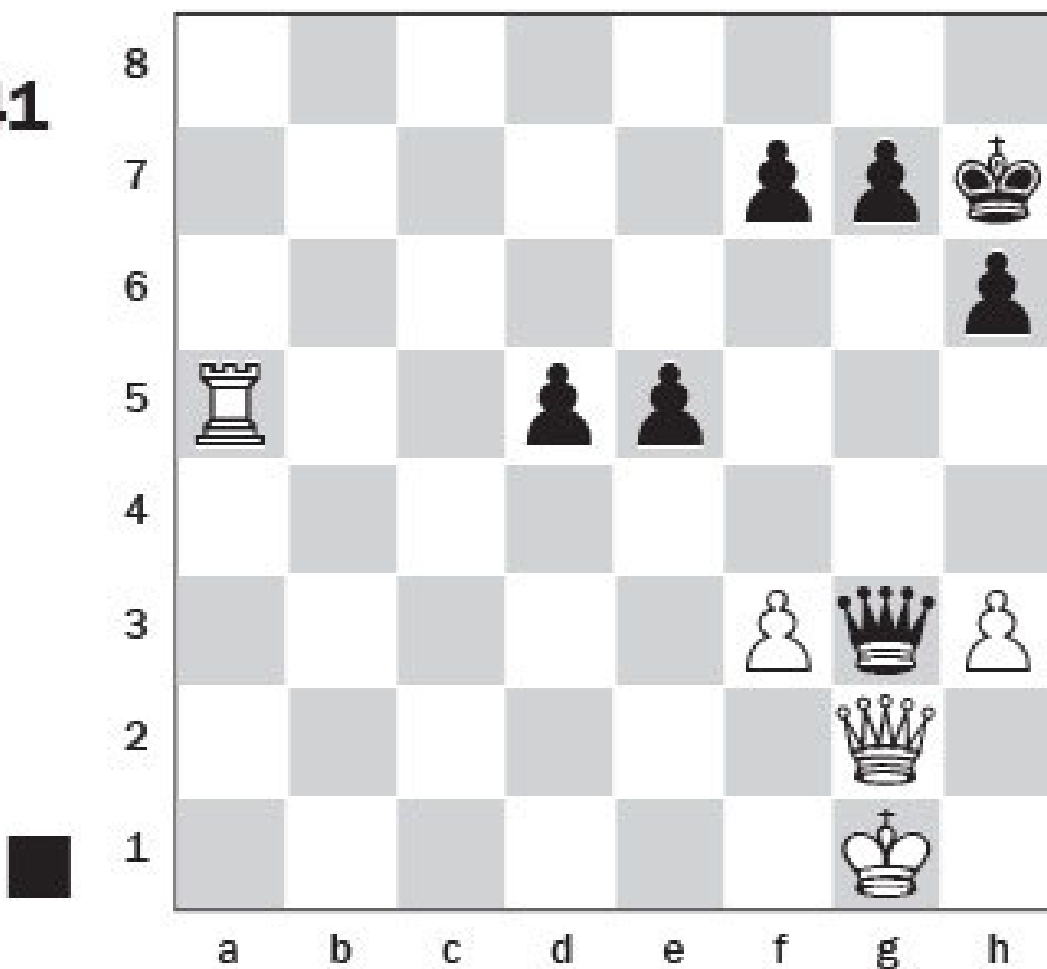
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 141

**141**



Answer:

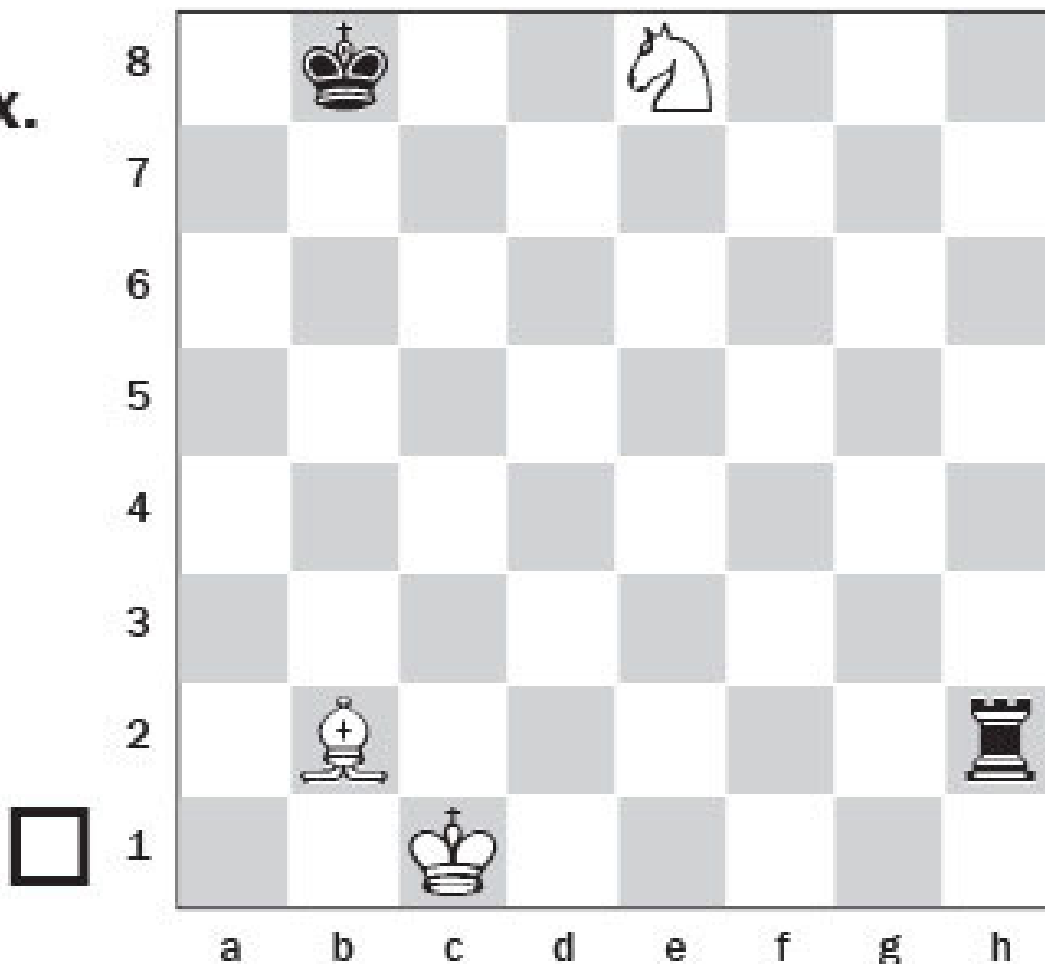
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Bishop Forks – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

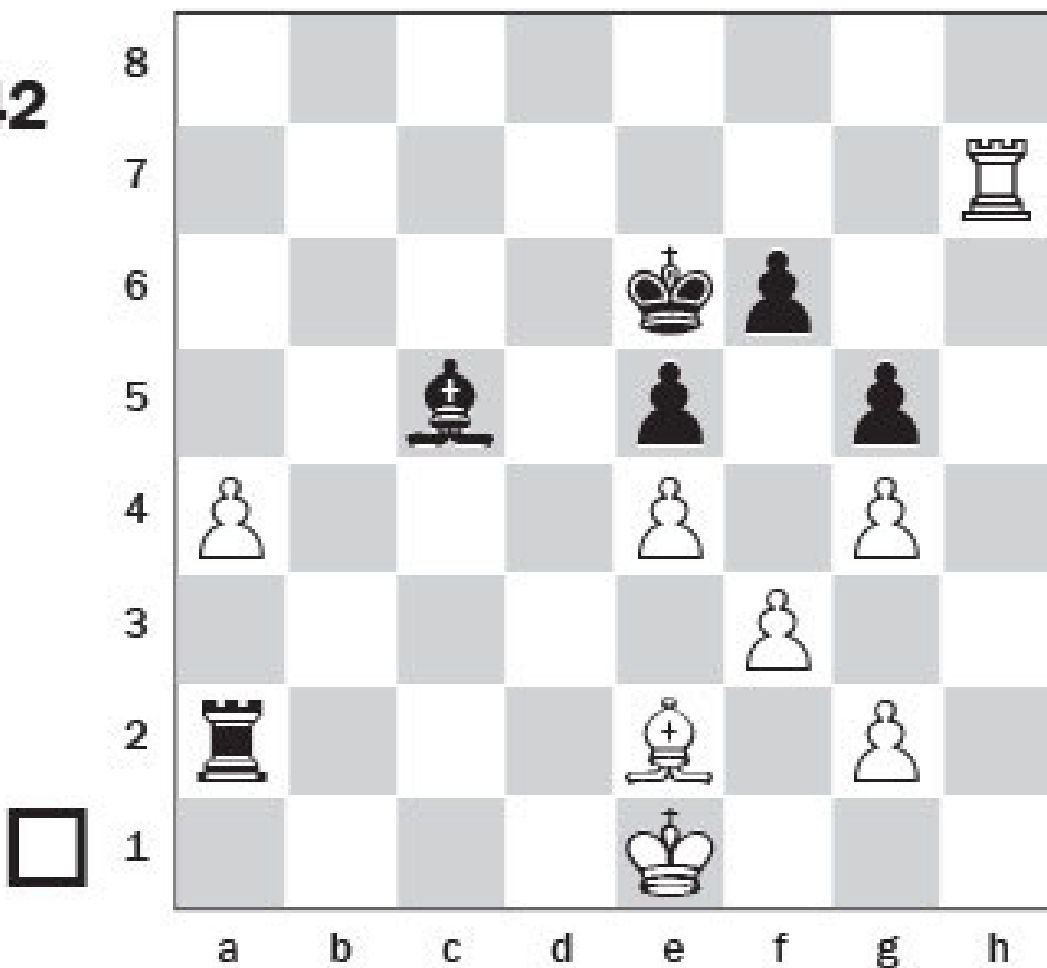
1. **Be5+ Kc8**

2. **Bxh2** \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 142

**142**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

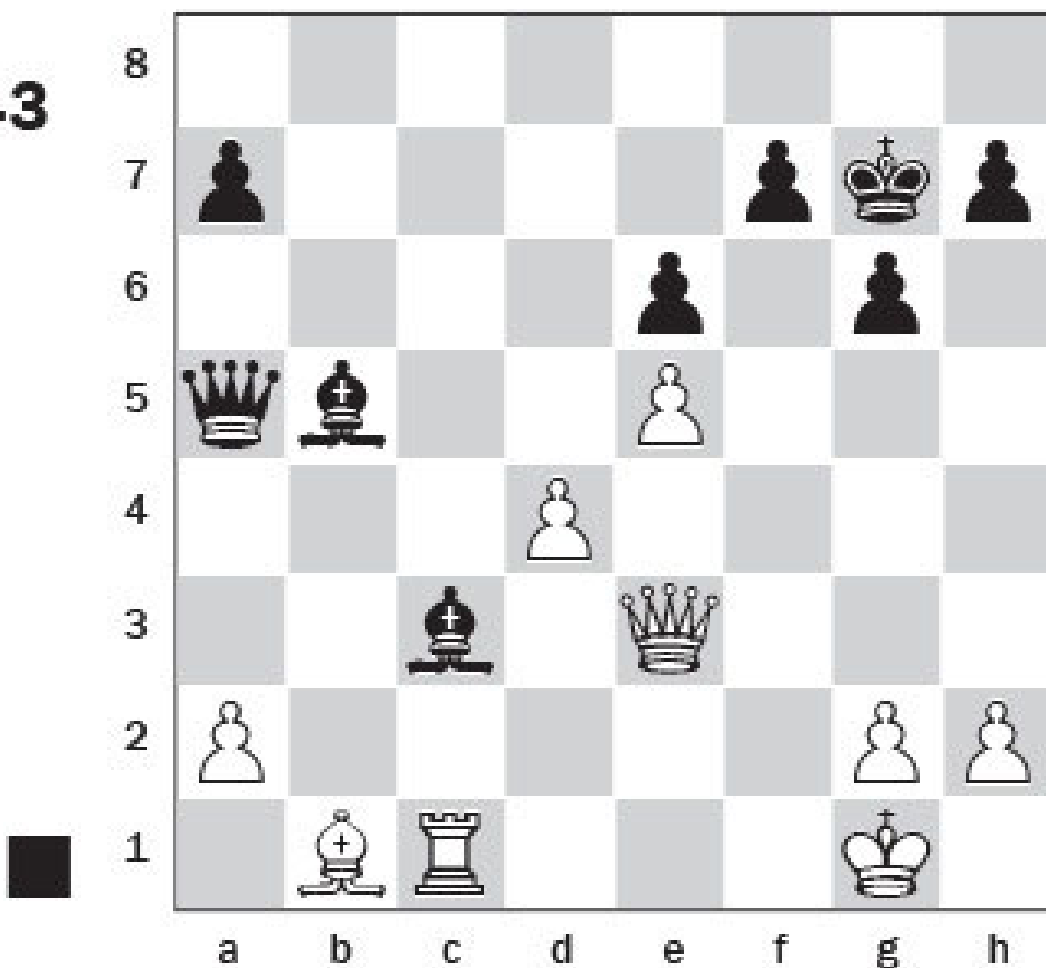
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the rook and king are on the same diagonal.

### Exercise 143

**143**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

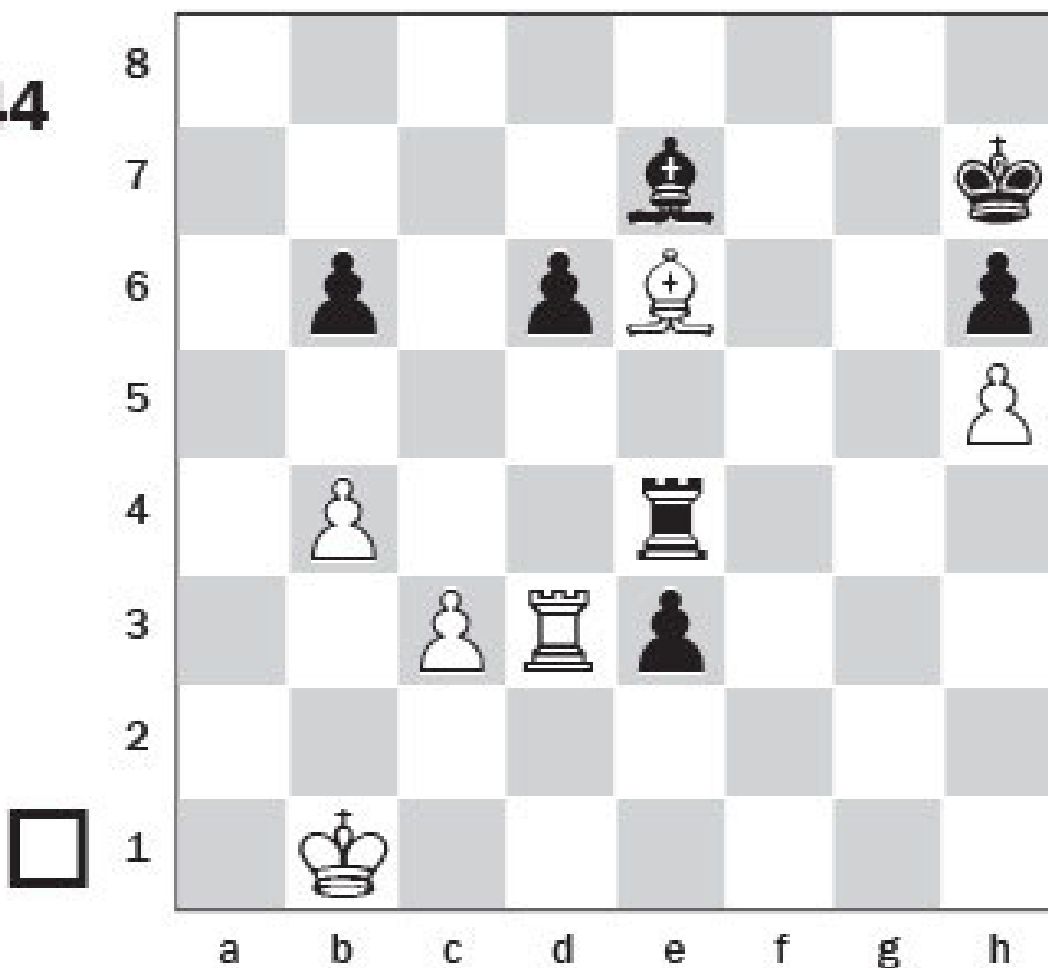
### HINT

Black has a bishop and queen battery. White's queen and rook are diagonally apart from each other. Use a bishop fork to win the rook on c1.

# Bishop Forks – Test

## Exercise 144

144



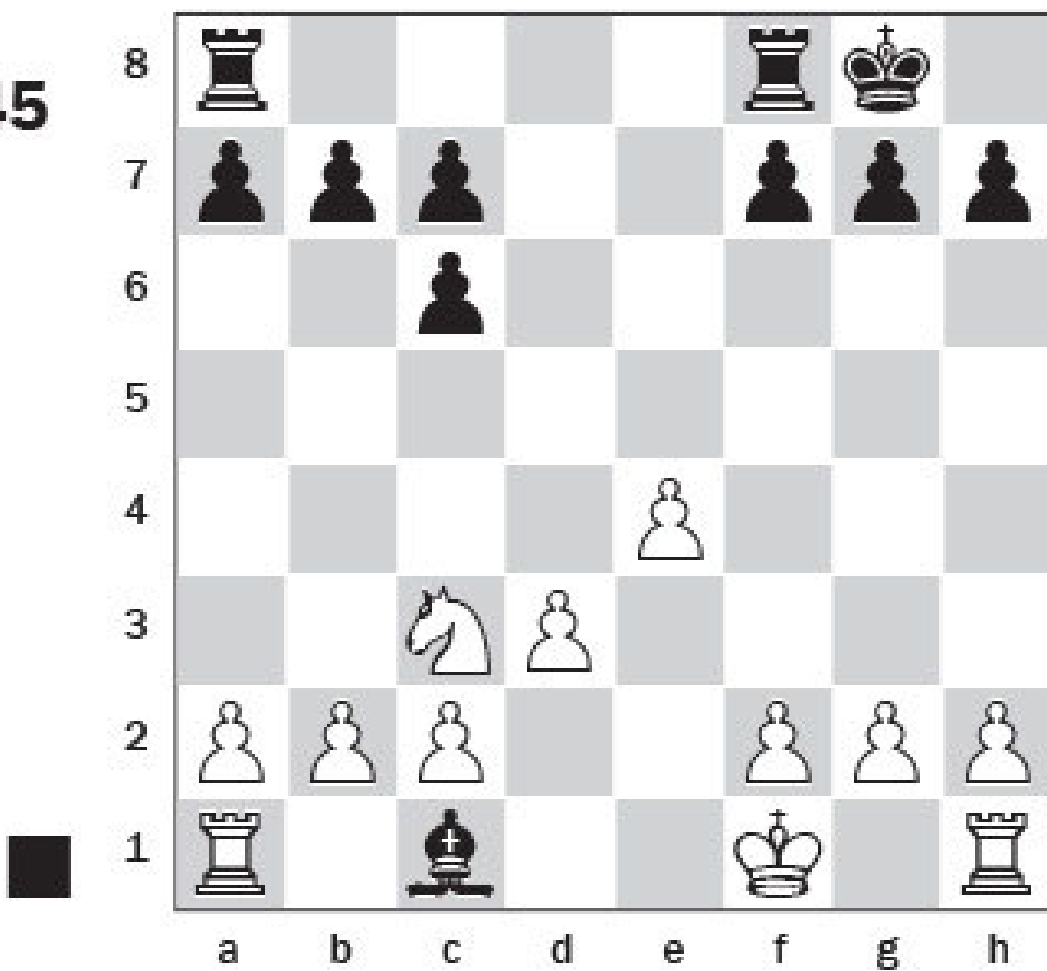
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 145

145



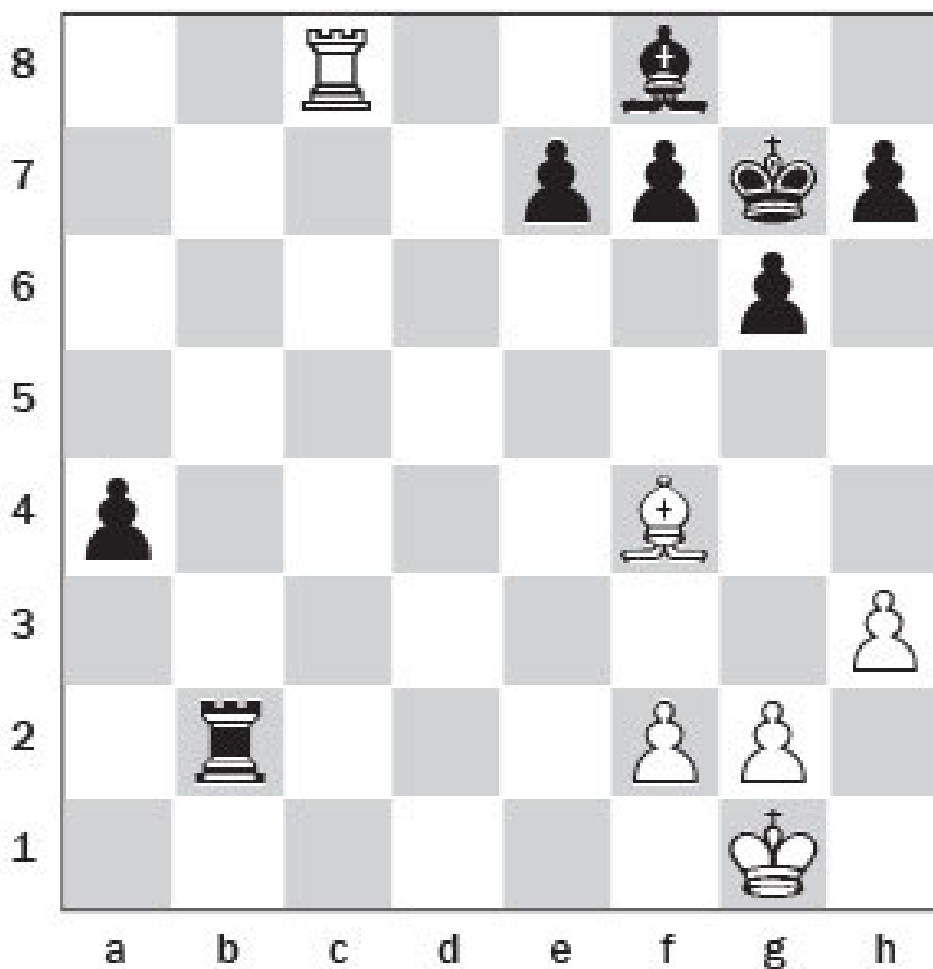
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 146

**146**



Answer:

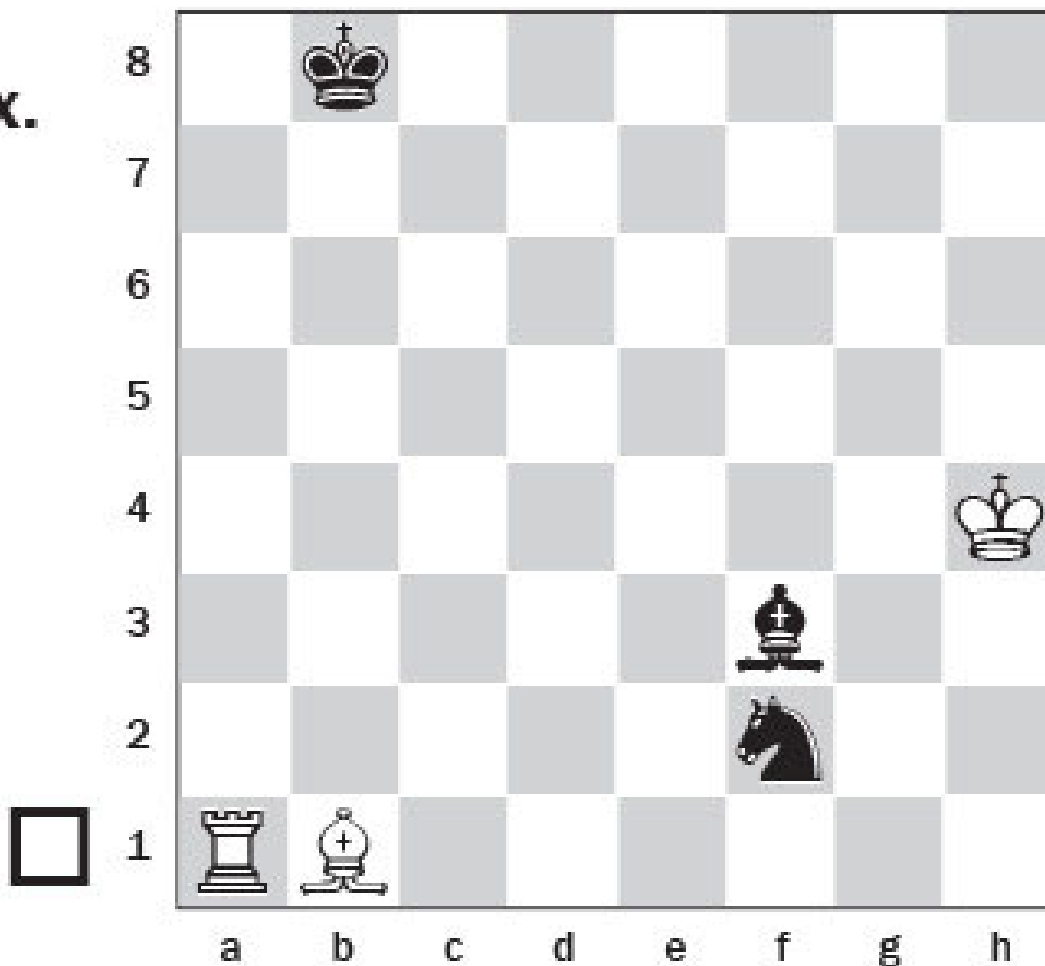
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# King Forks – Guided Practice

Ex.



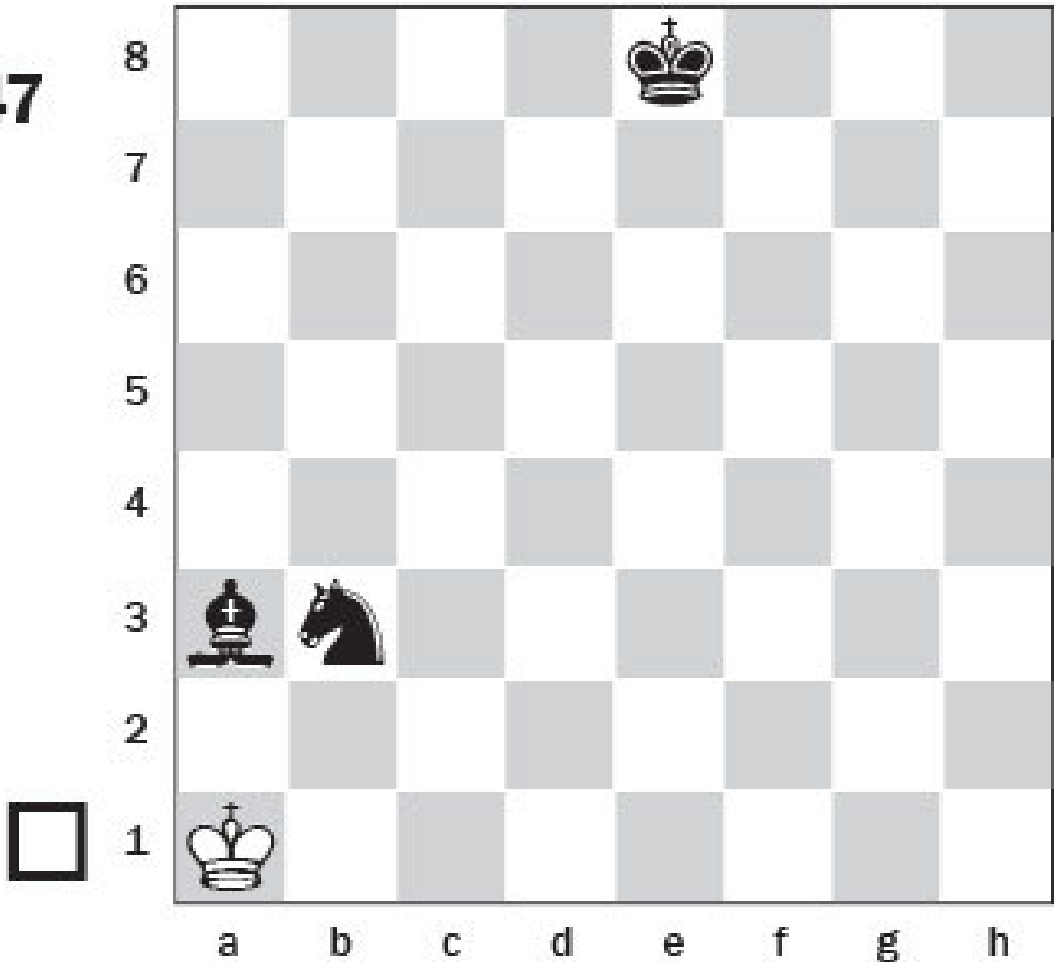
Answer:

1. Kg3 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 147

**147**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

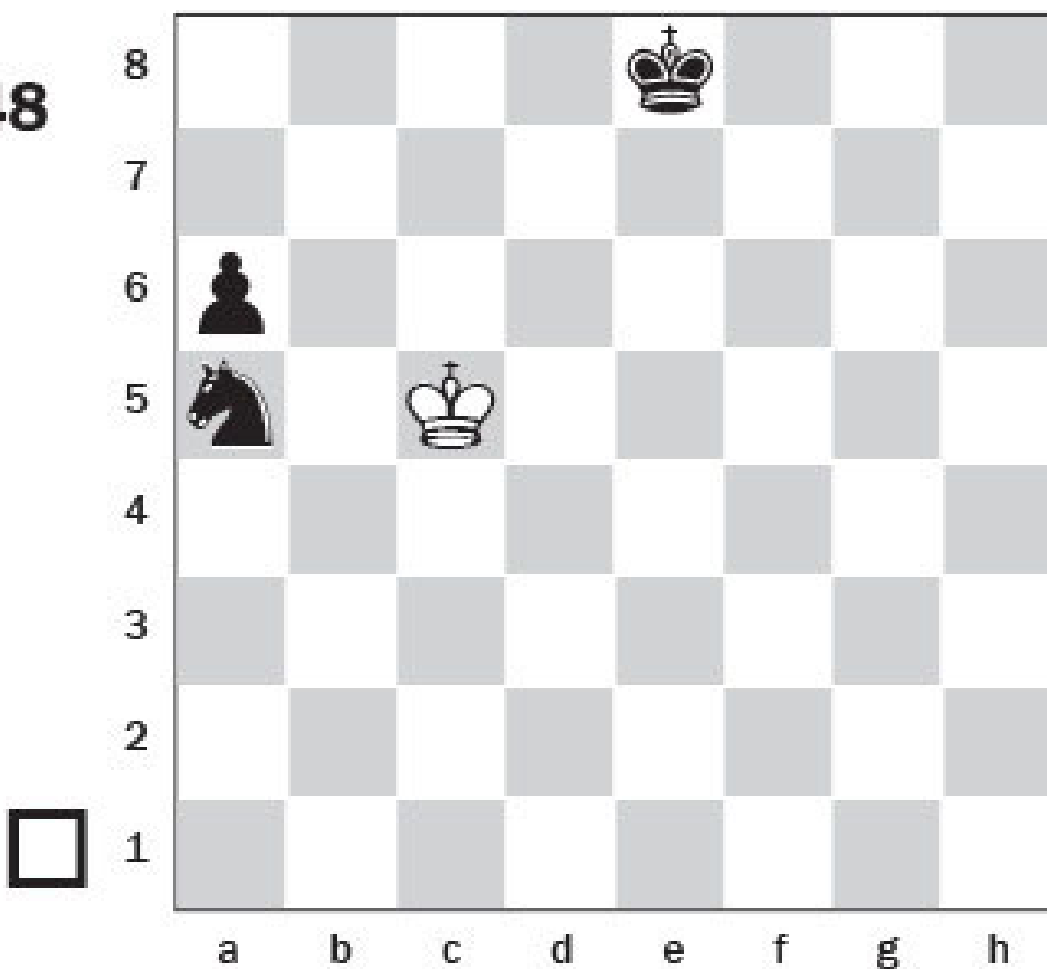
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Bishop and knight checkmate is possible. Use a king fork to win one of the pieces and save the game.

### Exercise 148

**148**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

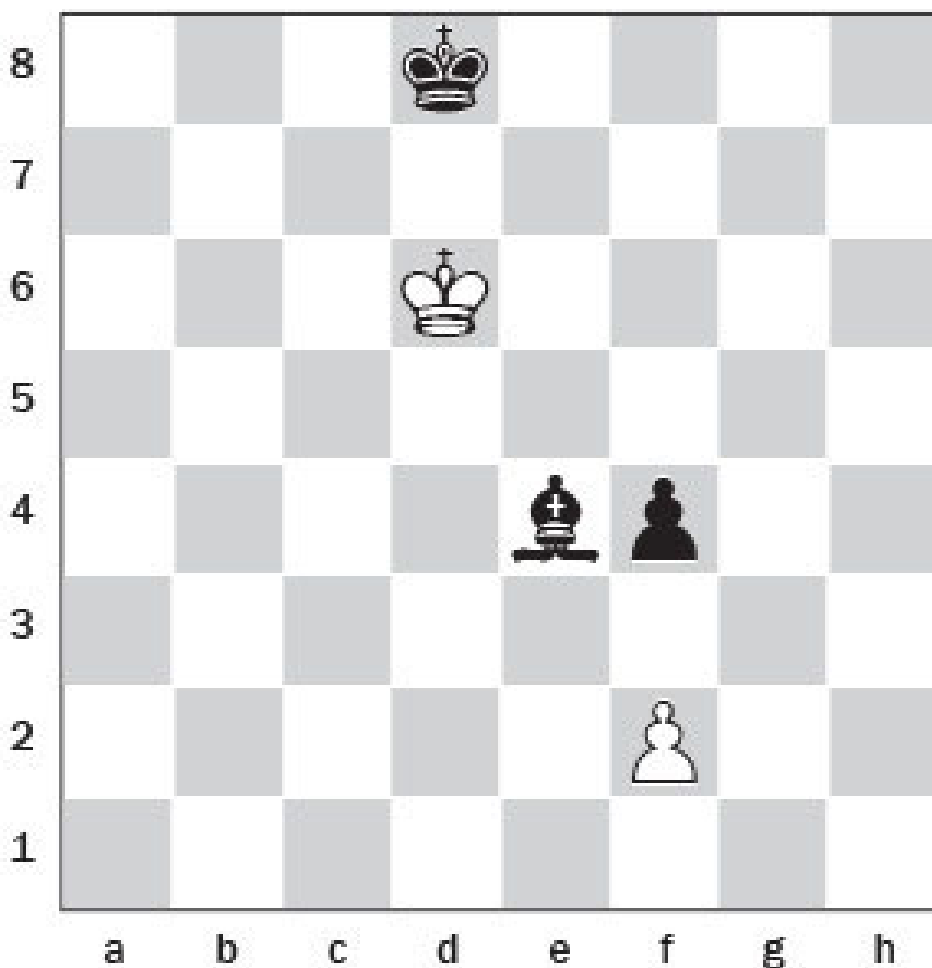
## HINT

Black can only win the game if the pawn promotes. Use a king fork to make sure that does not happen.

# King Forks – Test

## Exercise 149

**149**



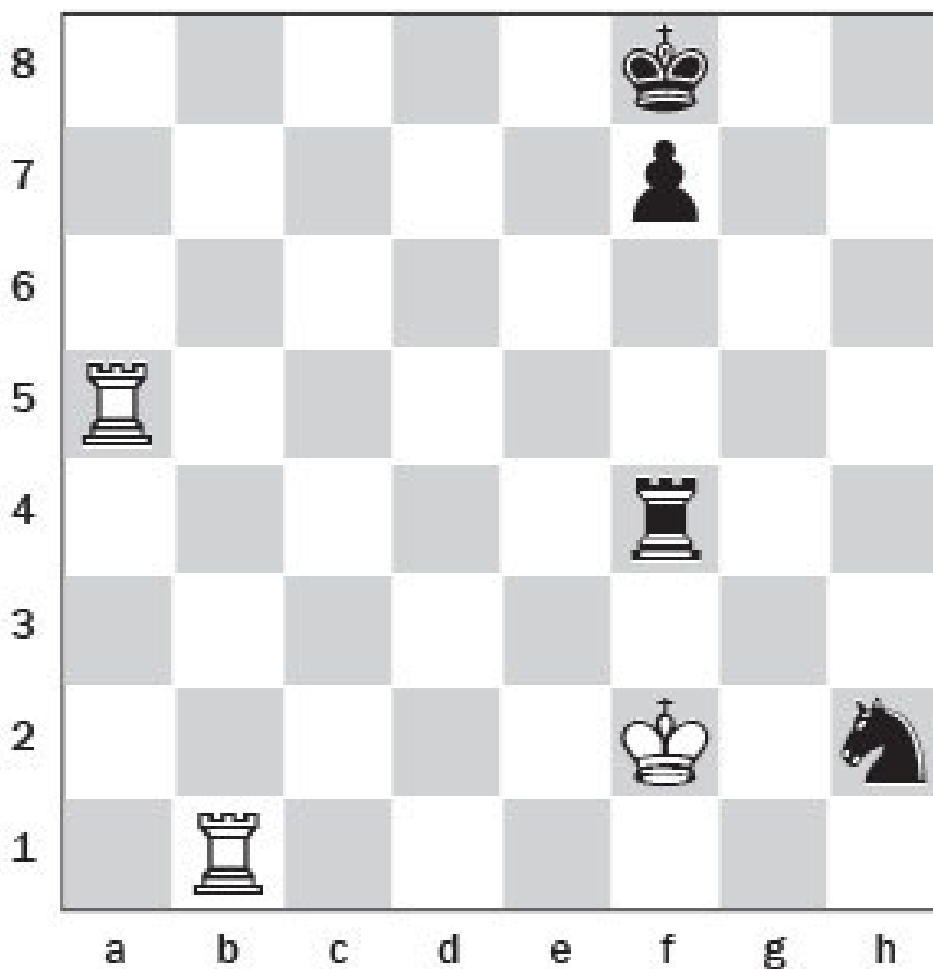
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 150

**150**



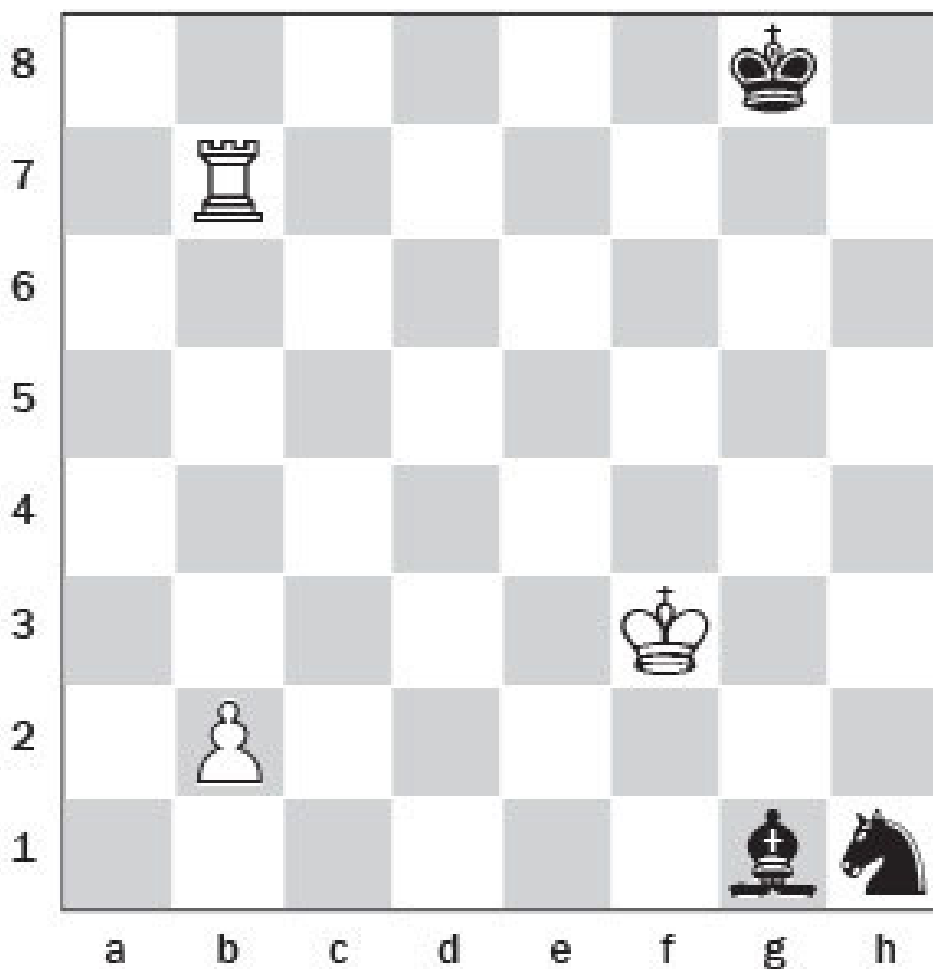
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 151

**151**



Answer:

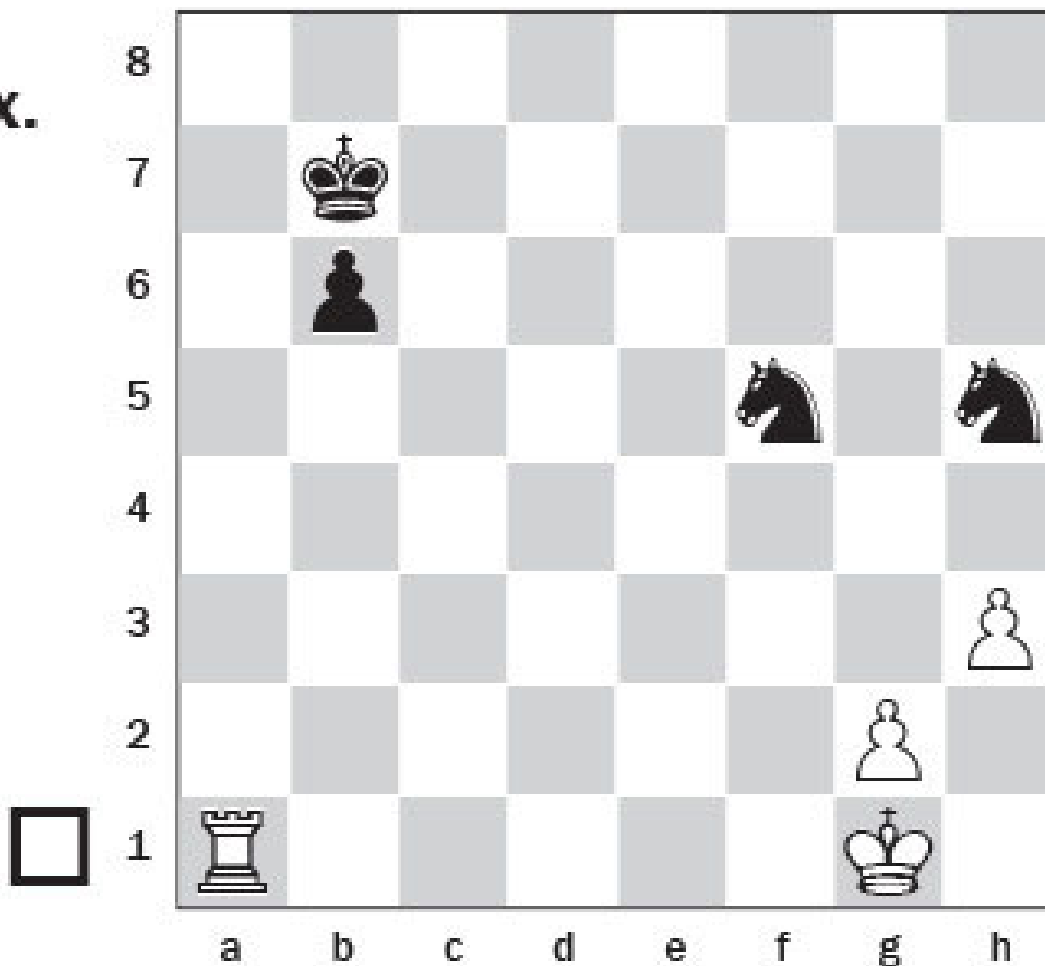
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Pawn Forks – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



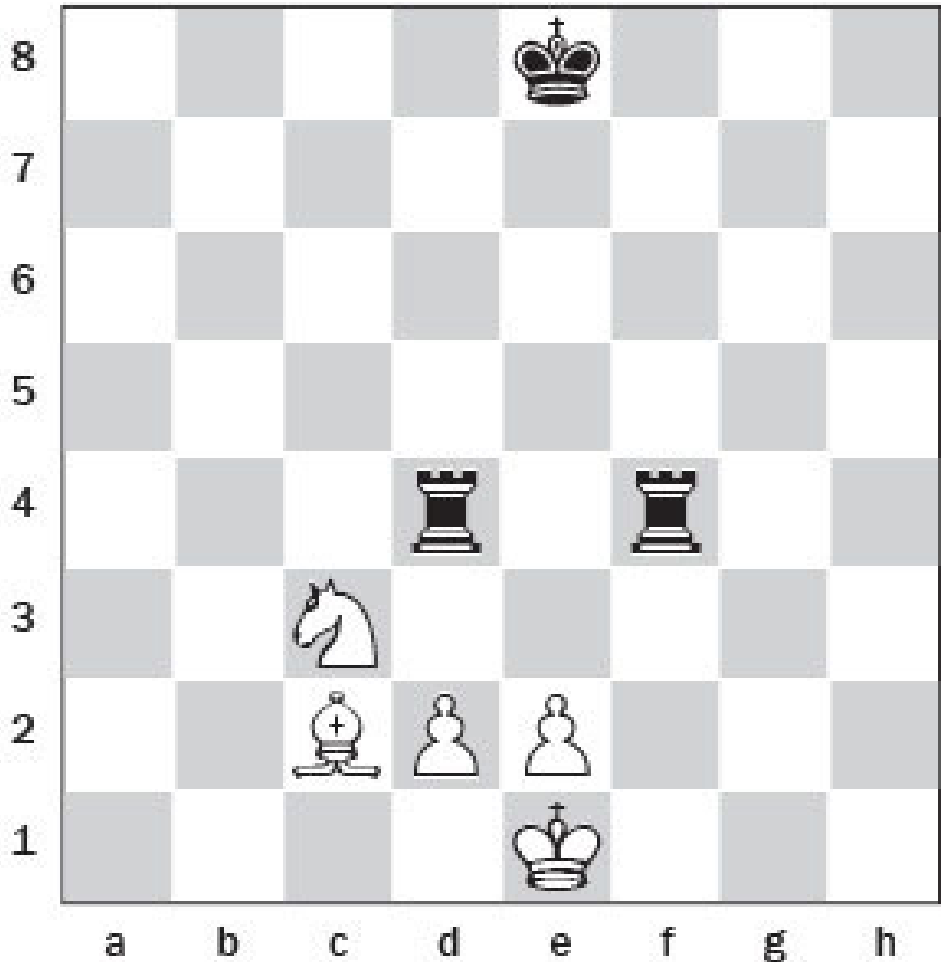
Answer:

1. g4 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 152

**152**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

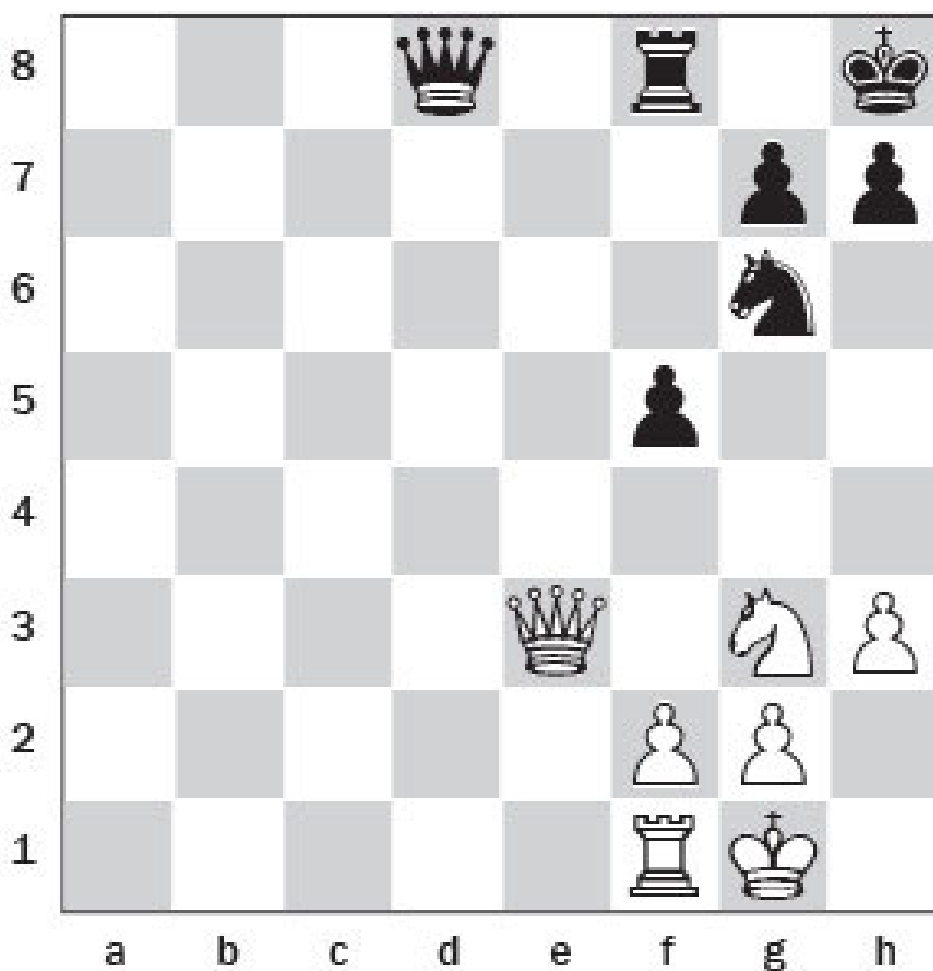
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a pawn fork to win one of the rooks.

### Exercise 153

**153**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a pawn fork to win the knight.

# Pawn Forks – Tests

## Exercise 154

154



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 155

**155**



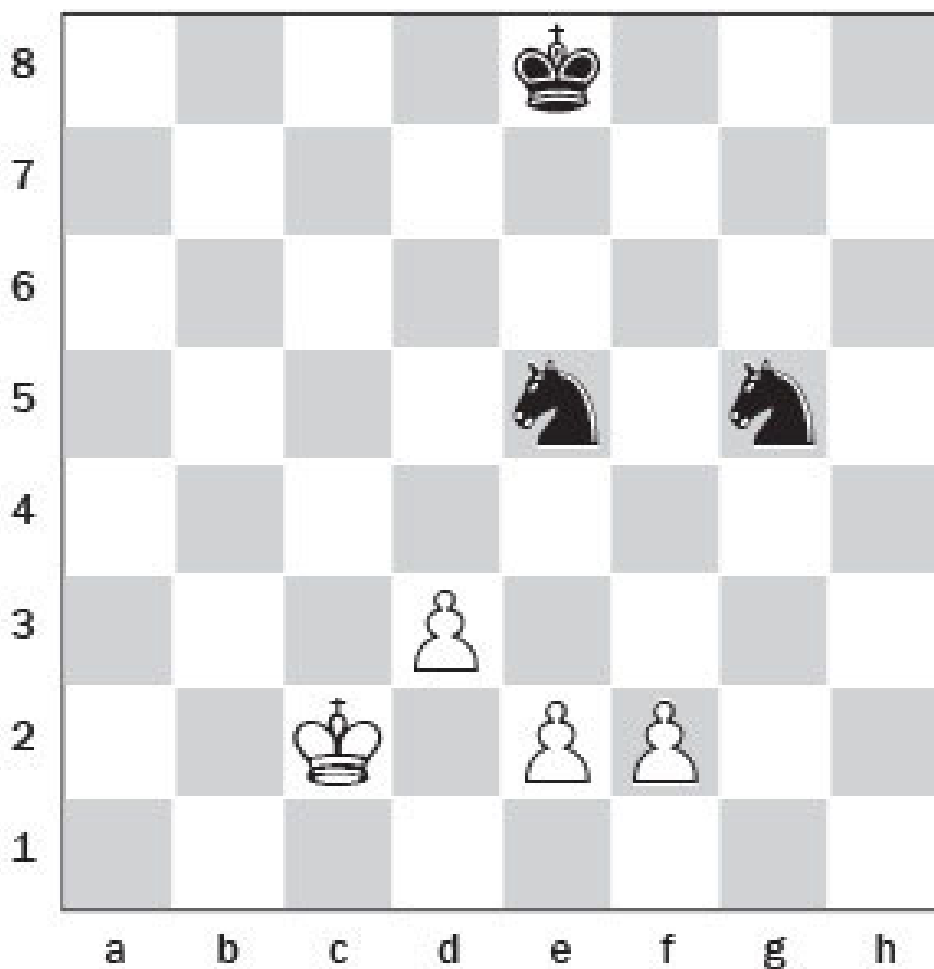
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 156

**156**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



## CHAPTER 6

# Pins

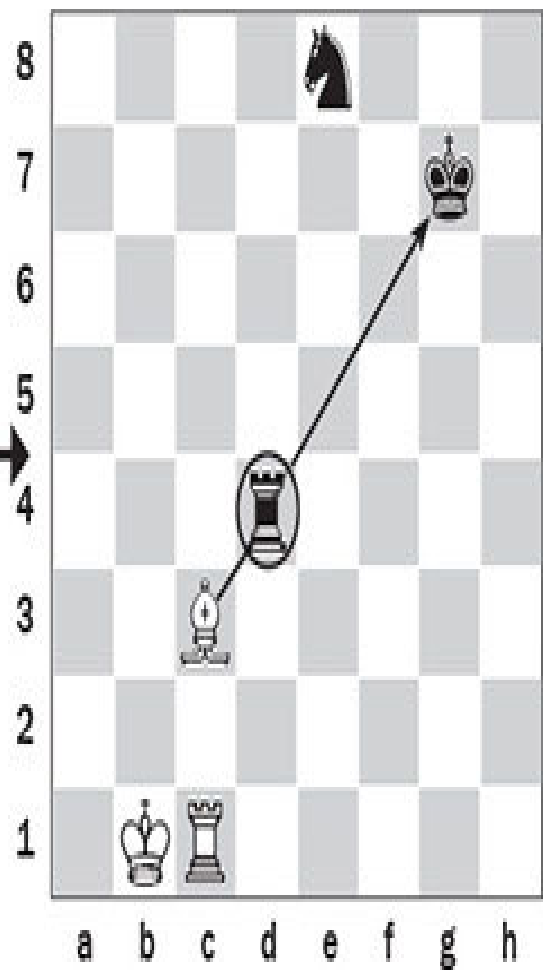
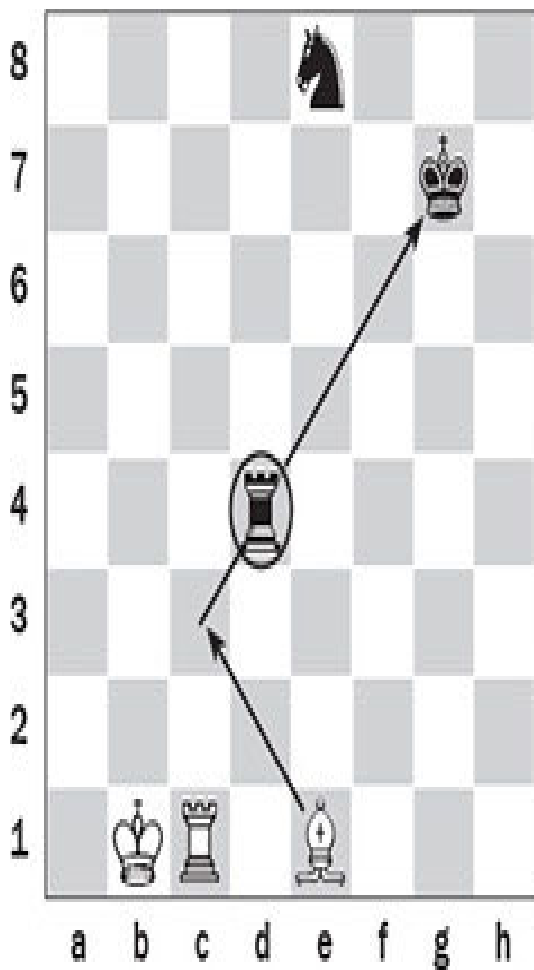
A pin occurs when a linear moving piece (rook, queen, bishop) attacks an enemy piece, and if the piece moved, there would be an attack on a piece of greater value beyond it.

We break down pins into two categories:

1. Absolute pin;
2. Relative pin.

### **Absolute Pin**

An absolute pin occurs when the piece that's first being attacked cannot move since it would place the king in danger. Moving a piece that's in such a situation would be illegal, hence the name 'absolute pin'.



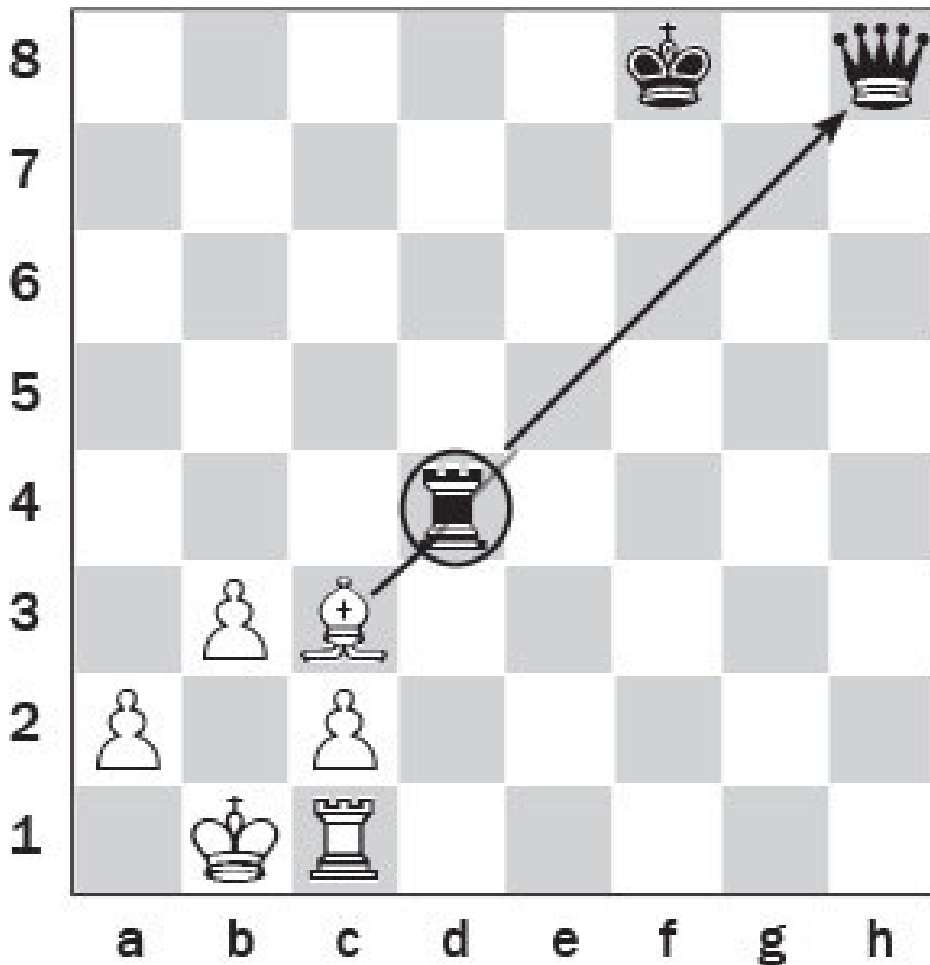
White could play 1.Bc3, 'pinning' the rook to the king. This would be an example of an absolute pin, since it would be illegal to move the rook (see diagram 2).

White is now attacking the rook, and Black is unable to move away from the attack – an absolute pin. No matter what Black plays here, the black rook is lost:

**1...Kg6 2.Bxd4**

**Relative Pin**

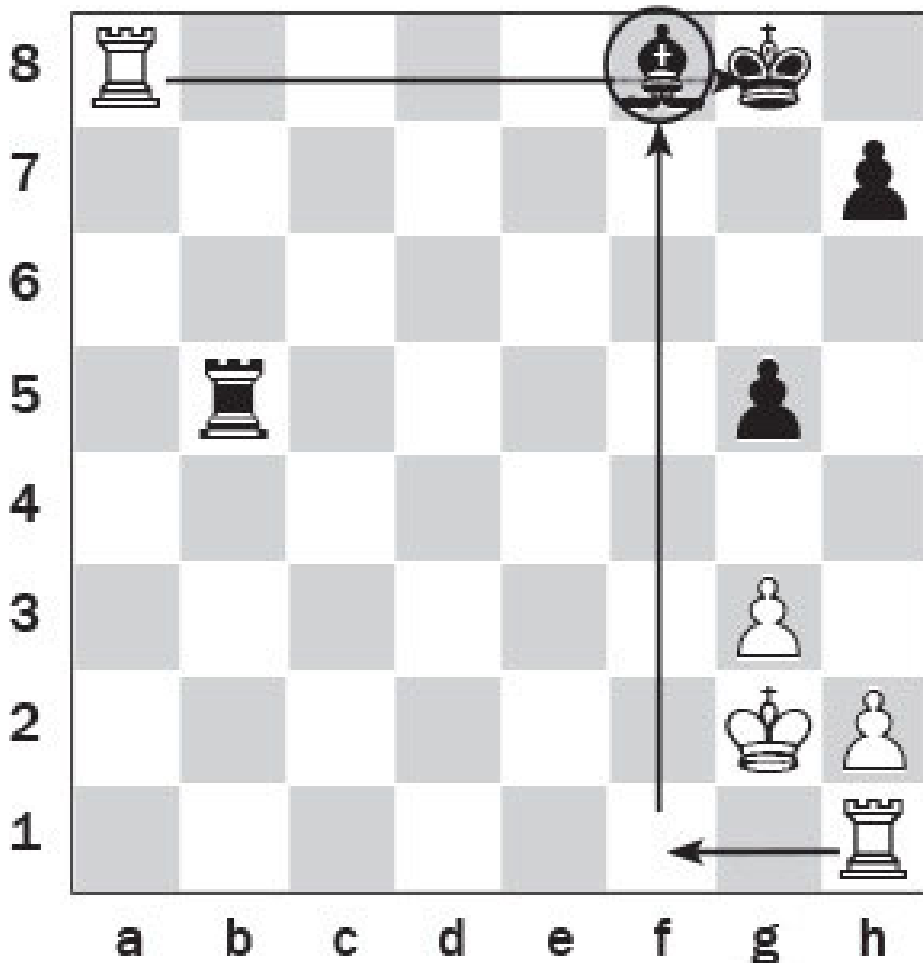
A relative pin is when a piece is attacked, and if it moves, a piece of greater value would be endangered. While in most cases, it's not a good idea to move the piece which is being pinned, there are times when it's possible; that is what makes the relative pin different from the 'absolute pin'.



In this chapter, you will solve a variety of pin problems. To better solve the problems in this chapter, look for pieces aligned on the same line (diagonal, rank, or file).

### Attacking the Pinned Piece

An important concept regarding pins is 'attacking the pinned piece'. Increasing the number of attackers on a pinned piece may allow for you to win the piece outright. Let's take a look at the following example:



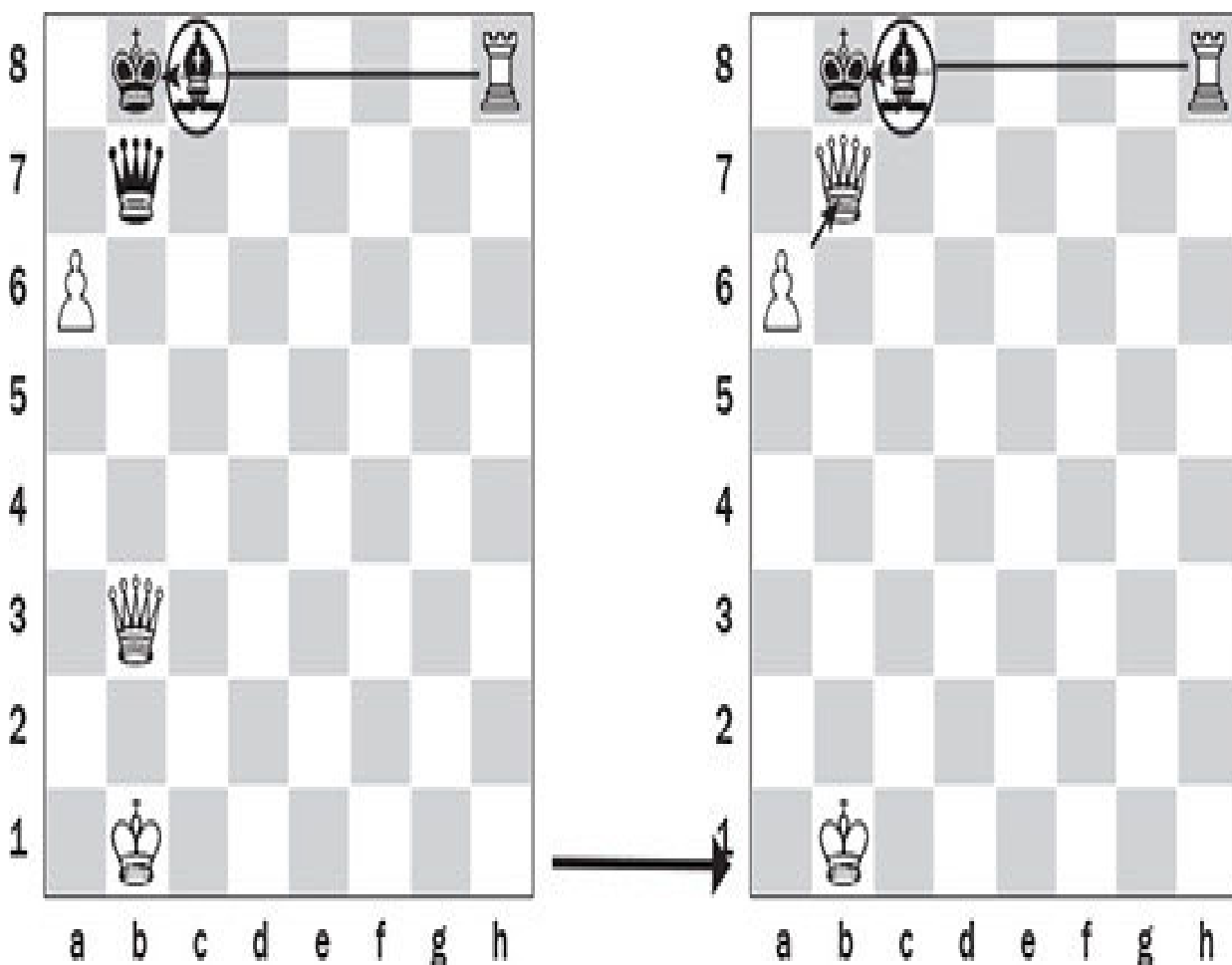
White's rook on a8 is pinning the bishop to the king. At the present moment, White has one attacker on the bishop (Ra8), and Black one defender (Kg8). White would not get the better of the immediate trade, so it would be best for White to add another attacker (Rh1) on the bishop, which Black can otherwise not move. White could bring the rook from h1 to f1, and attack the bishop for the second time. Black would be unable to run away from the threat due to the pin, and would be unable to add an additional defender, which would lead to the loss of the bishop. The next puzzles involve 'attacking the pinned

piece'. To better solve these problems, it would be useful to find the pinned piece first, then see how to best attack it.

## Pin Protection

The last important concept involving a pin is regarding the usefulness of a pinned piece in the defence. This section of the pins chapter displays that 'pinned pieces do not protect'. In the case of an absolute pin, the pinned piece does not protect at all.

The following is an example of a helper checkmate, which took advantage of the fact that the bishop on c8 was in an absolute pin and could not capture the queen.



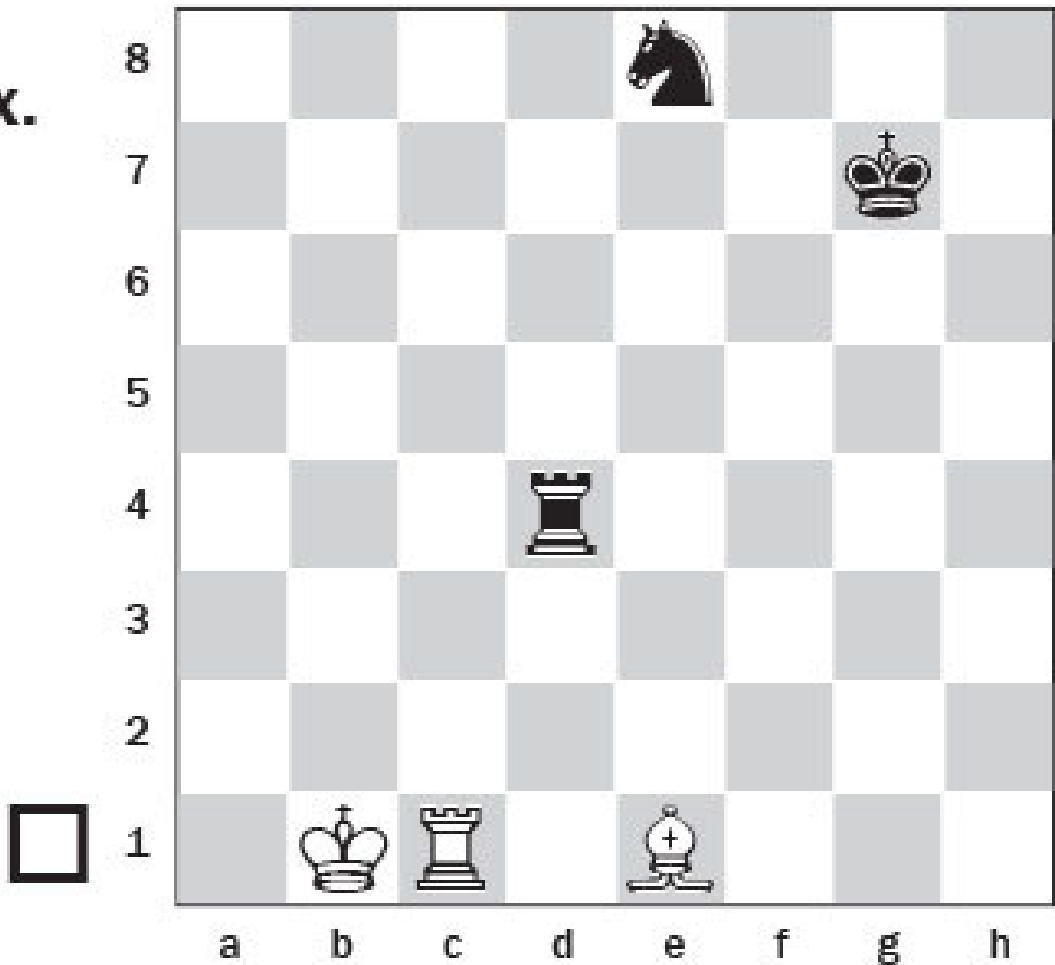
The best move for White is 1.Qxb7# (see diagram 2).

The pawn on a6 defends the queen and thus Black is in checkmate.

The last problems in the pins Chapter will feature examples of 'attacking the pinned piece'. To better solve these problems, it would be useful to find the pinned piece first, then see how to best take advantage of it.

# Pins – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

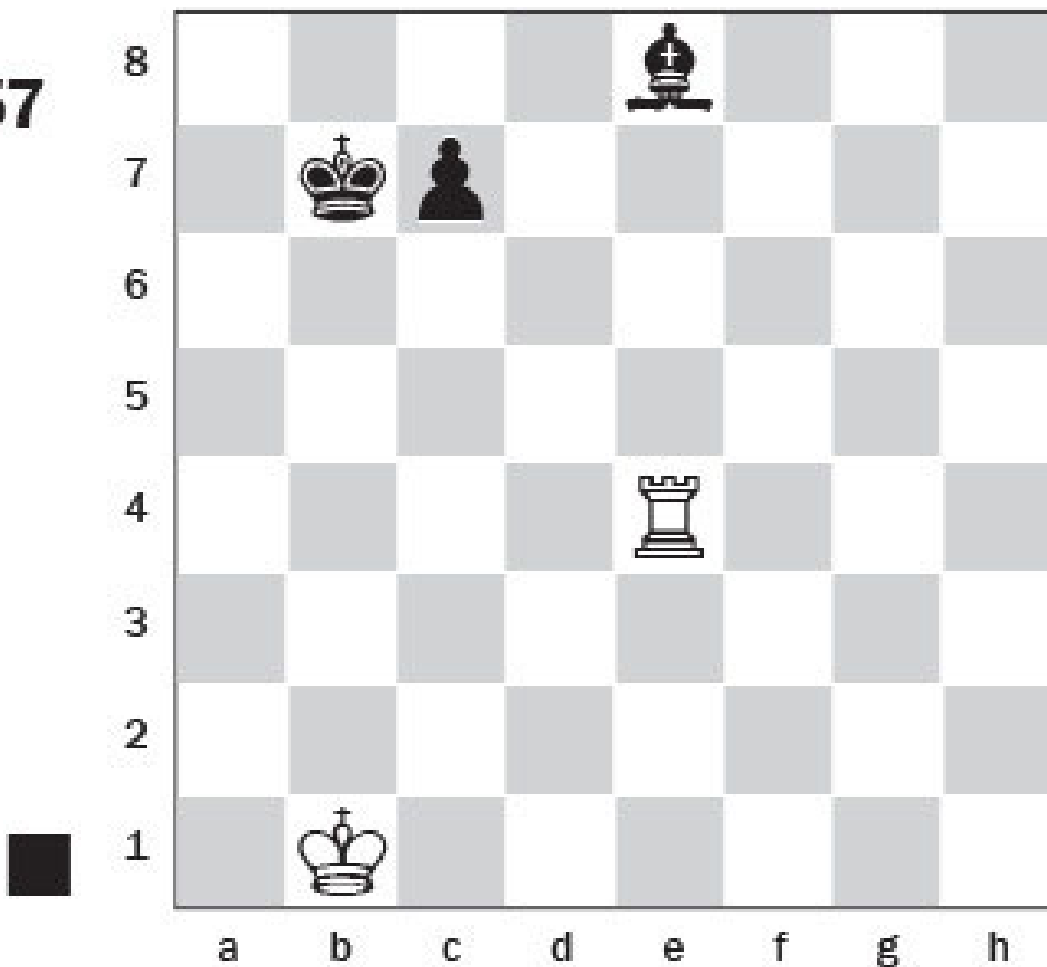
1. Bc3 Kg6

2. Bxd4 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 157

**157**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



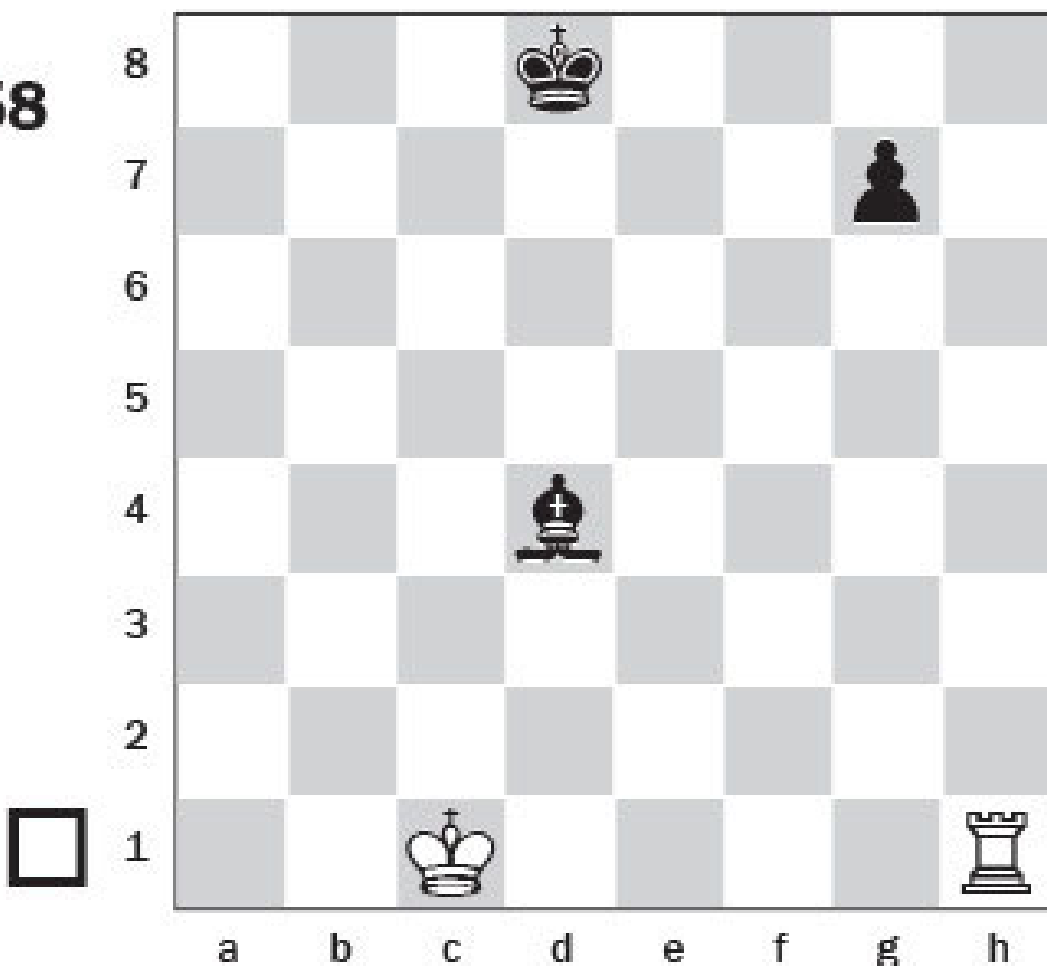
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the rook and king are on the same diagonal. Put White's rook in an absolute pin.

### Exercise 158

**158**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

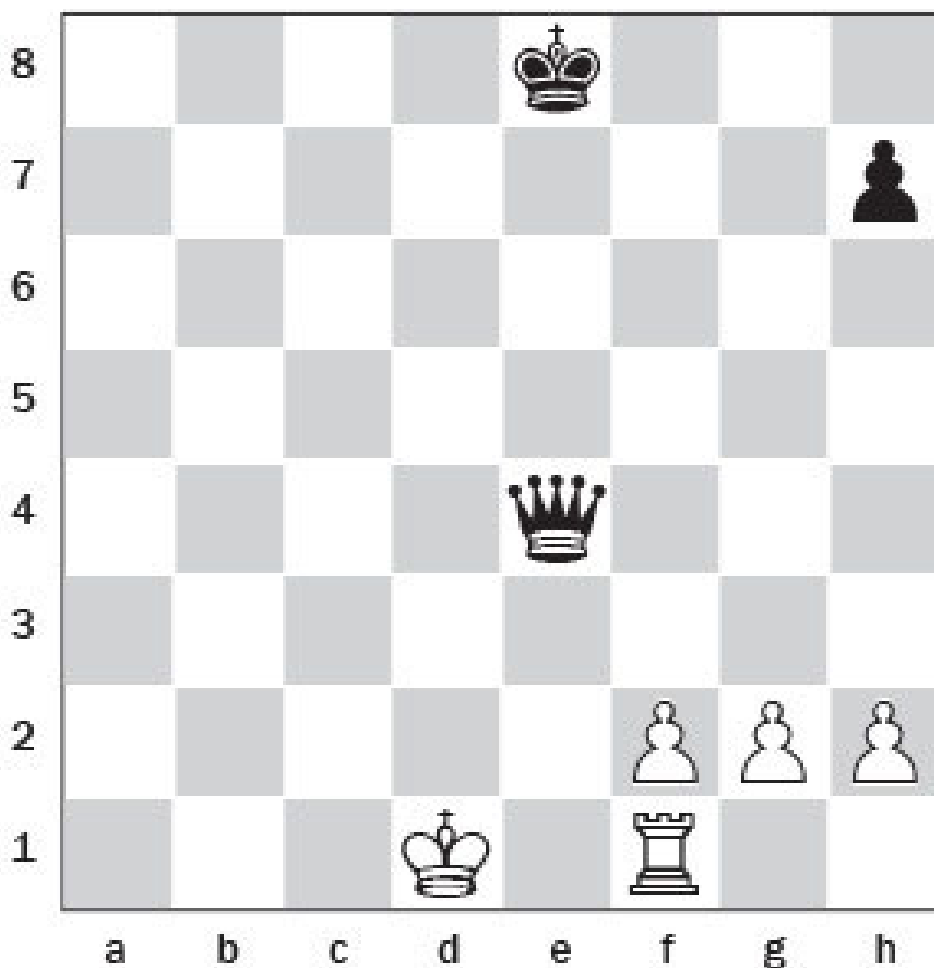
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Notice that the bishop and king are on the same file. Put Black's bishop in an absolute pin.

### **Exercise 159**

159



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

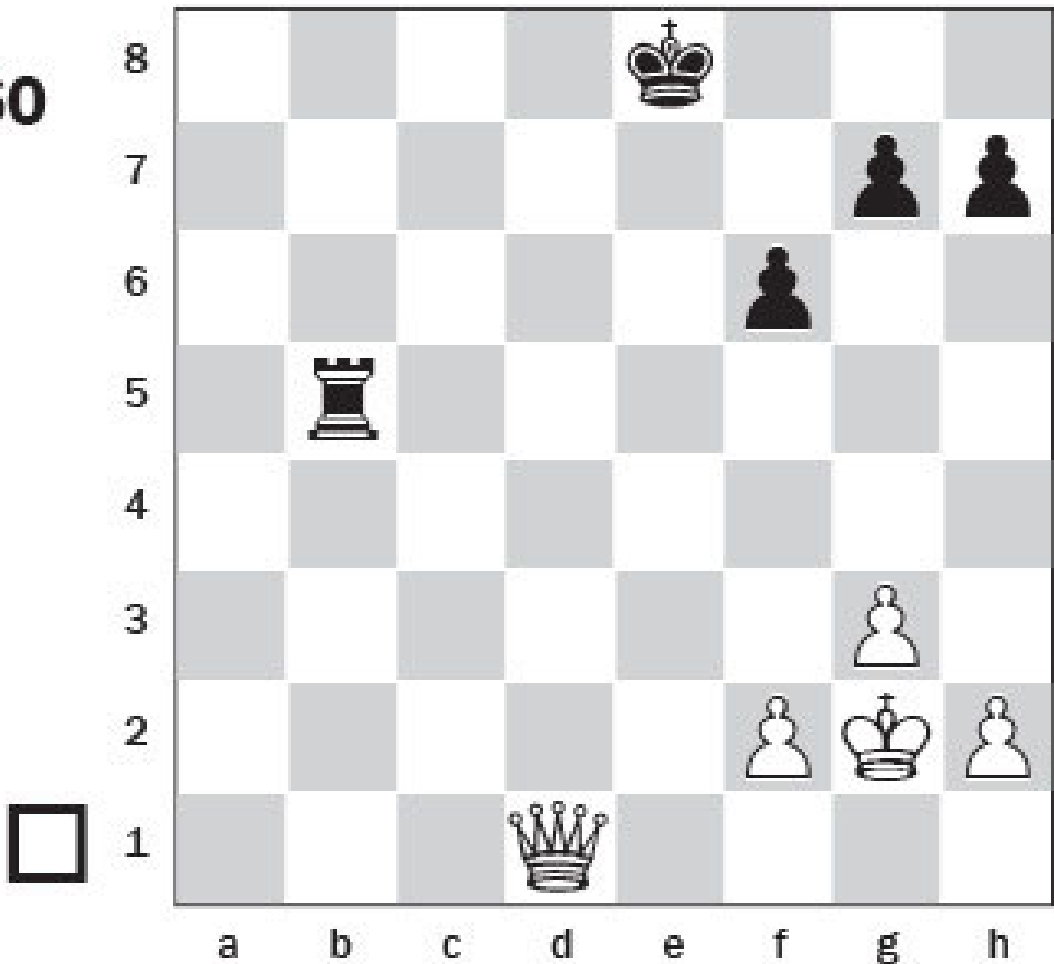
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

This is a common one. The queen and king lined up on the same file – rooks love that!  
– rooks love that!

### Exercise 160

**160**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

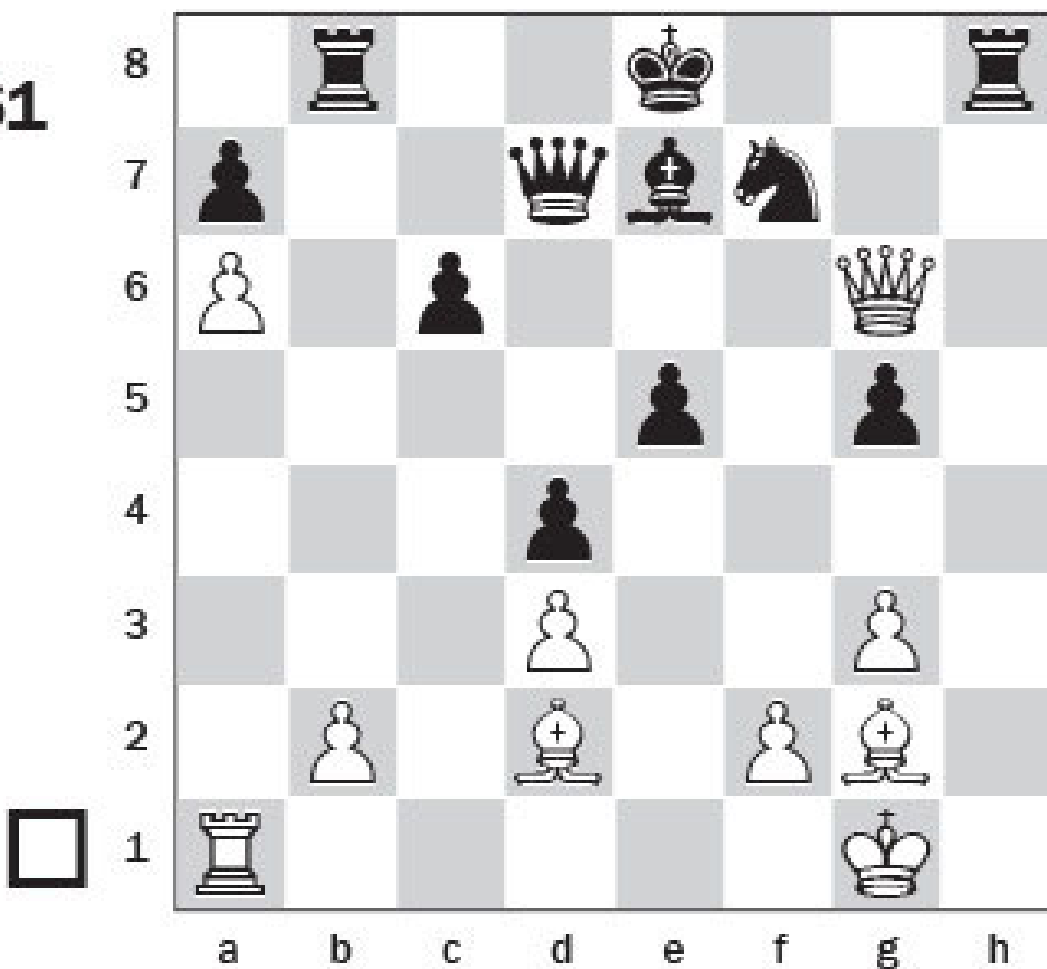
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook and king are on the same diagonal – use a pin to win!

### Exercise 161

**161**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

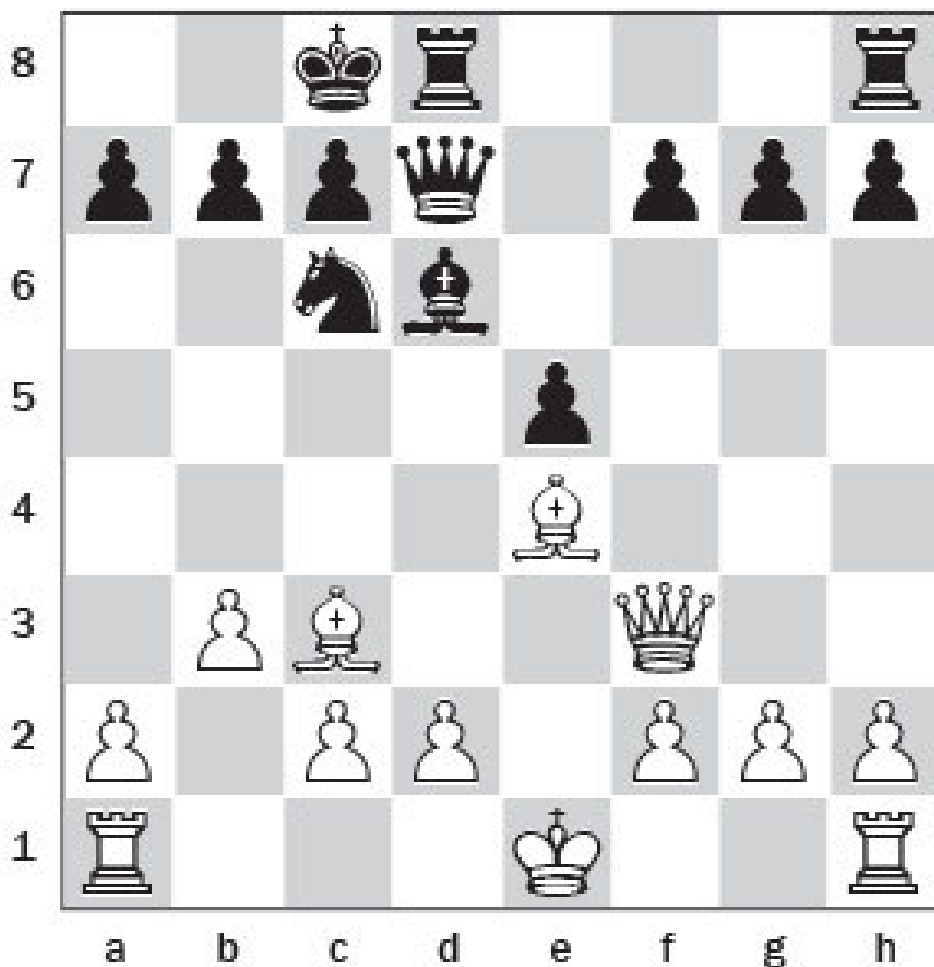
## HINT

Notice that the queen and king are on the same diagonal. Win the queen for only a bishop.

# Pins – Test

## Exercise 162

162



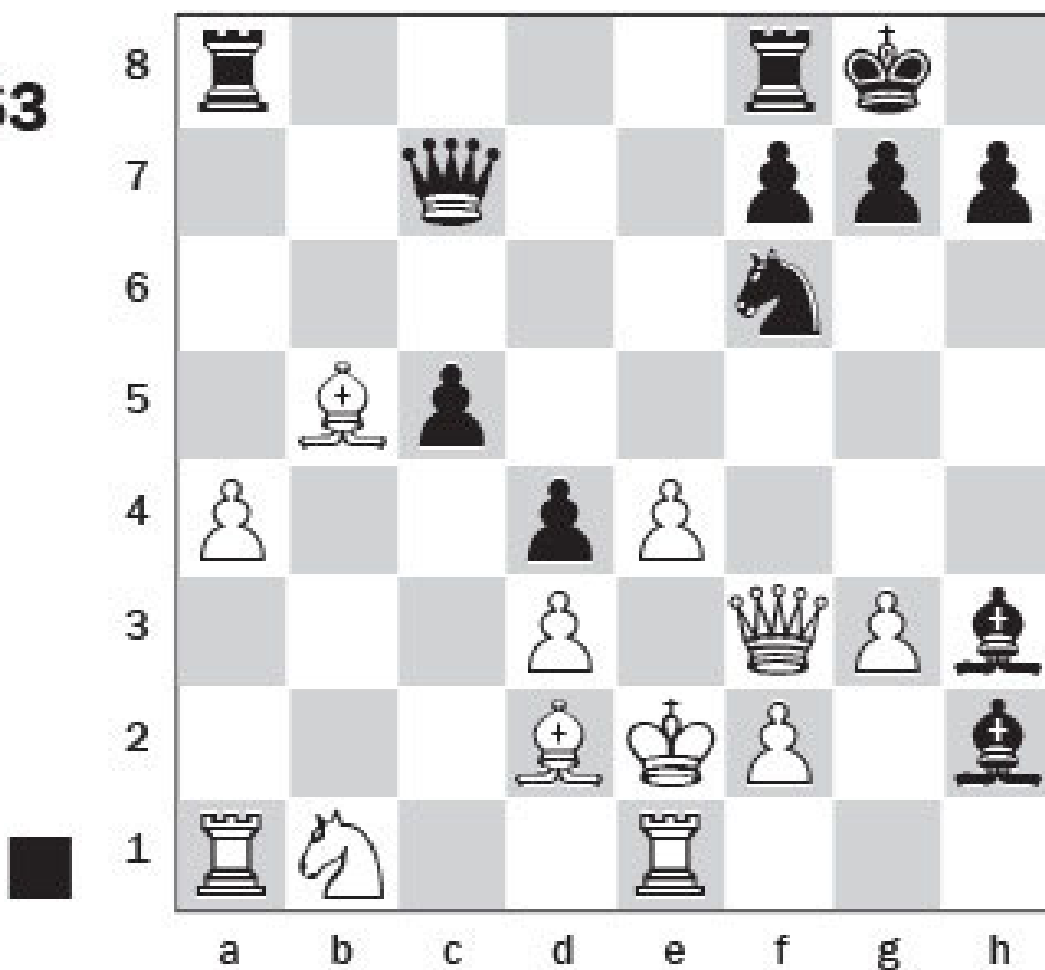
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 163

**163**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 164

**164**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 165

**165**



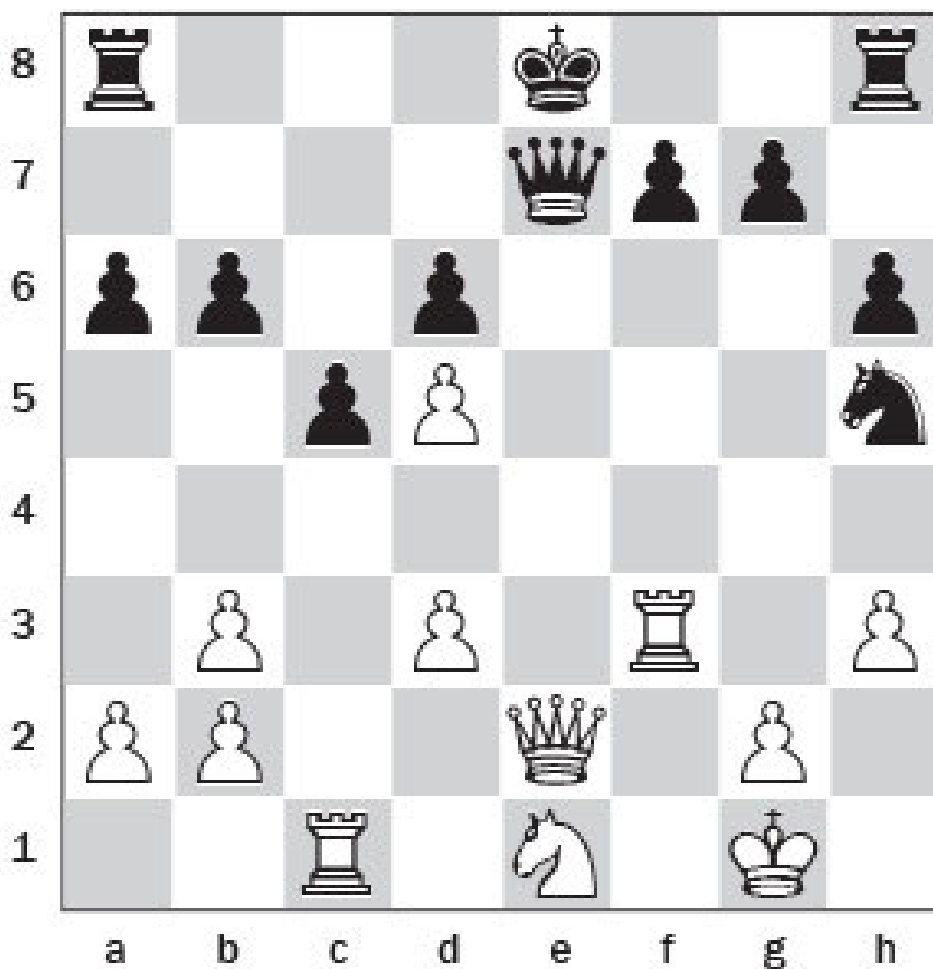
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 166

**166**



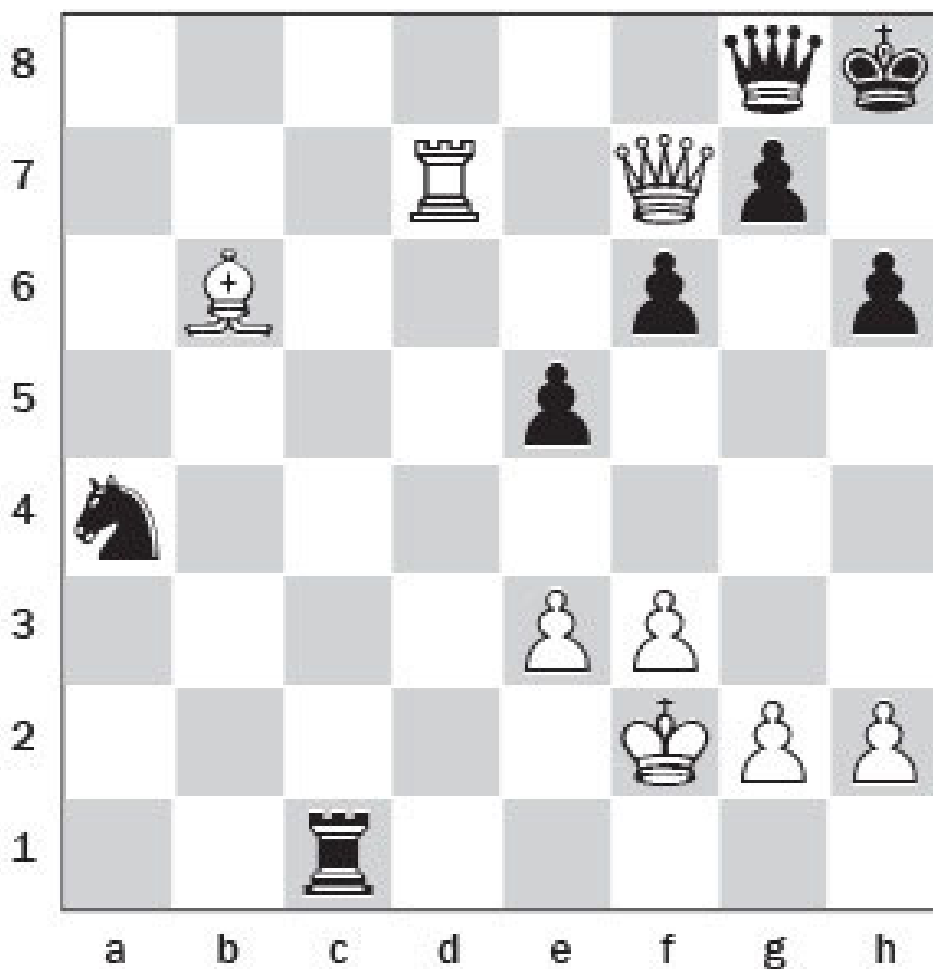
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 167

**167**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 168

**168**



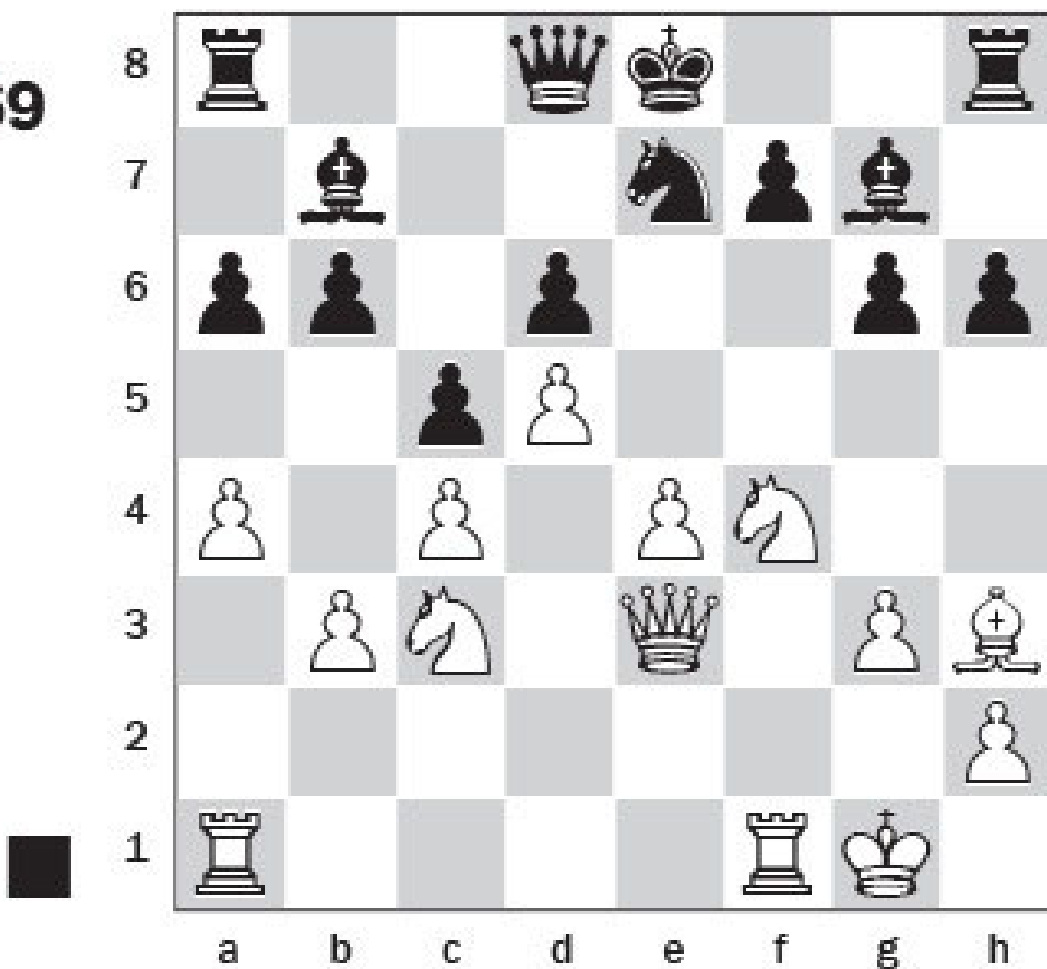
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 169

**169**



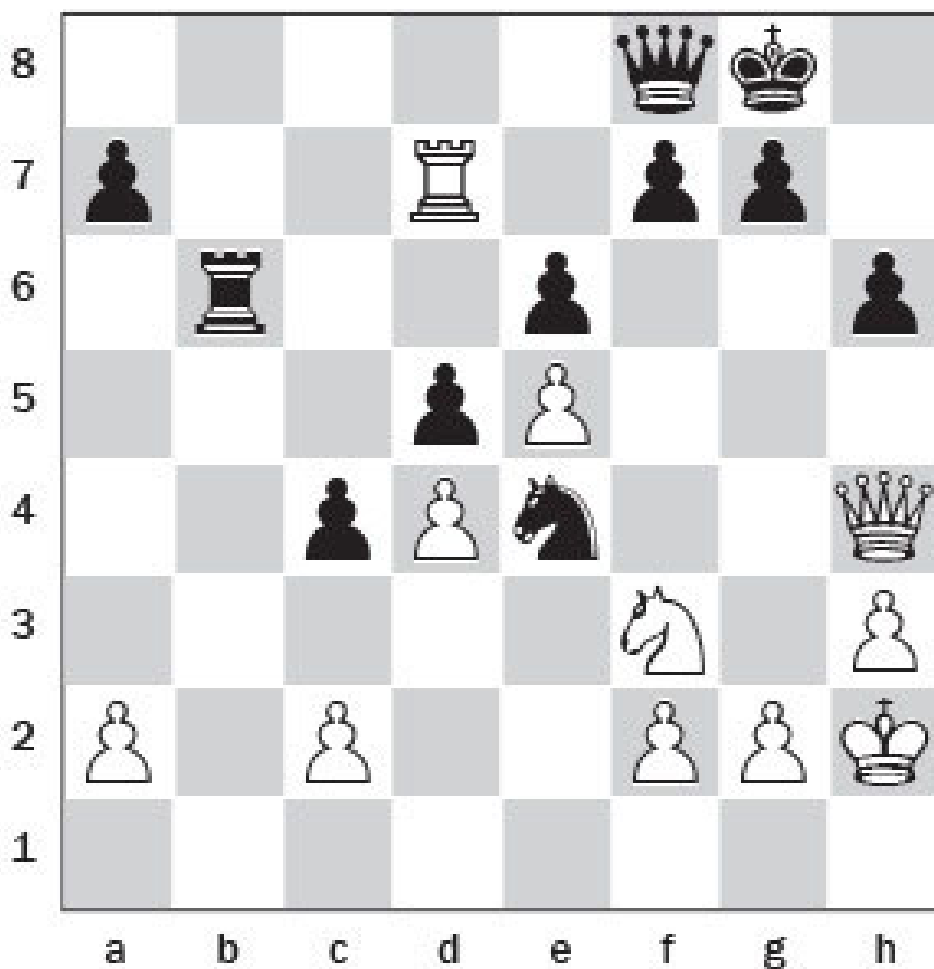
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 170

**170**



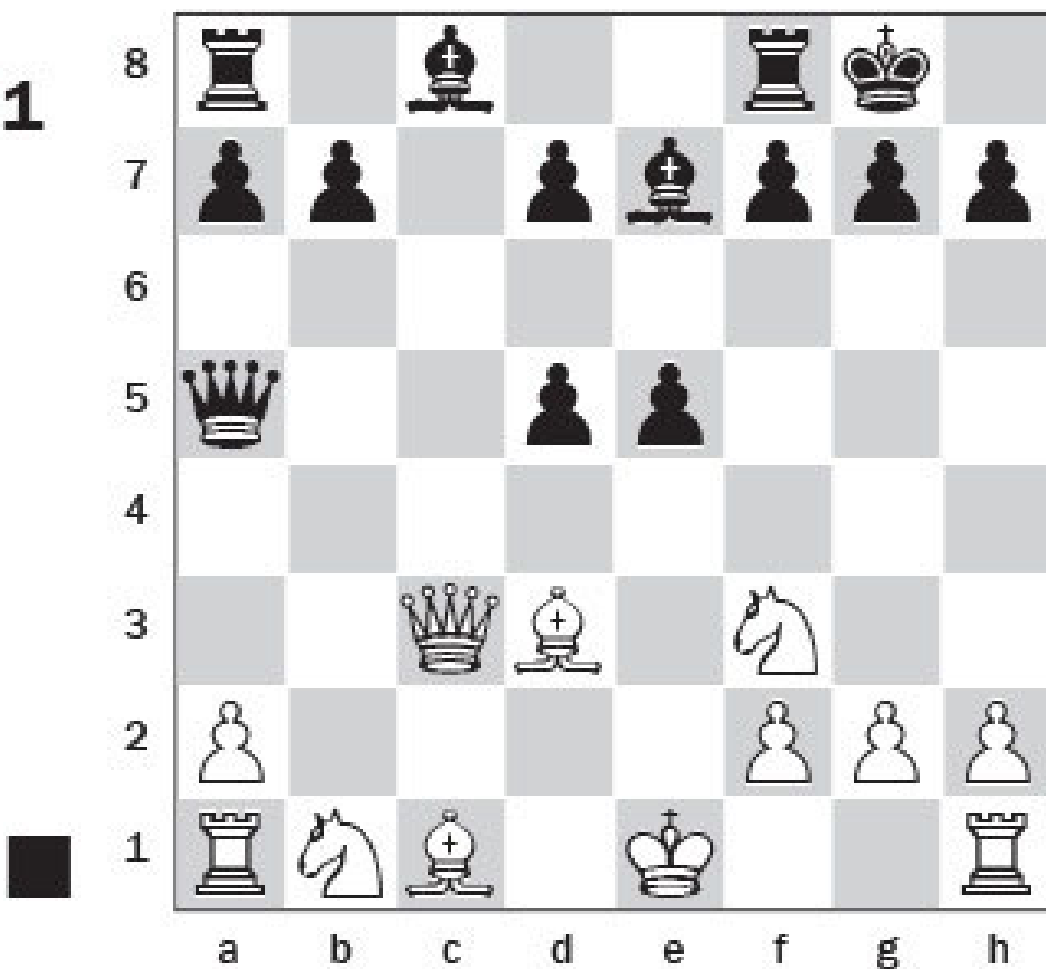
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 171

171



Answer:

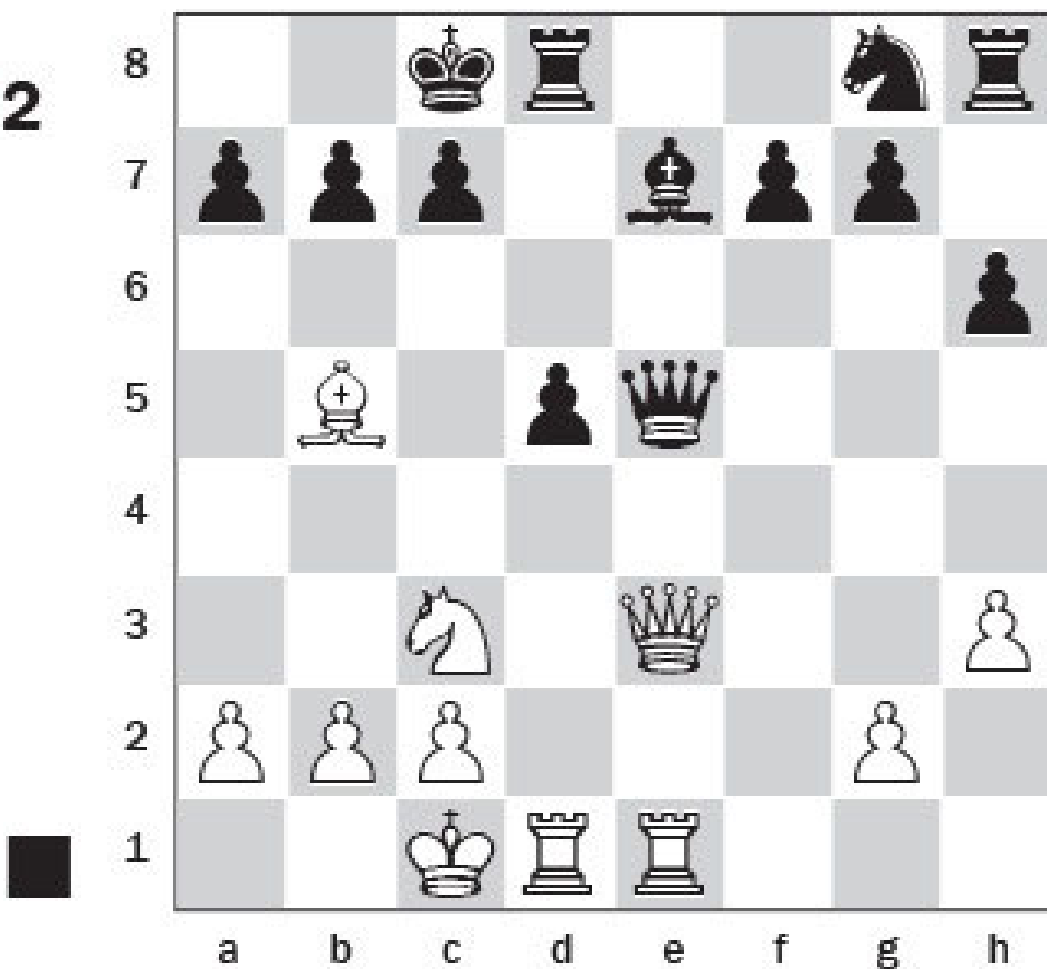
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 172

**172**



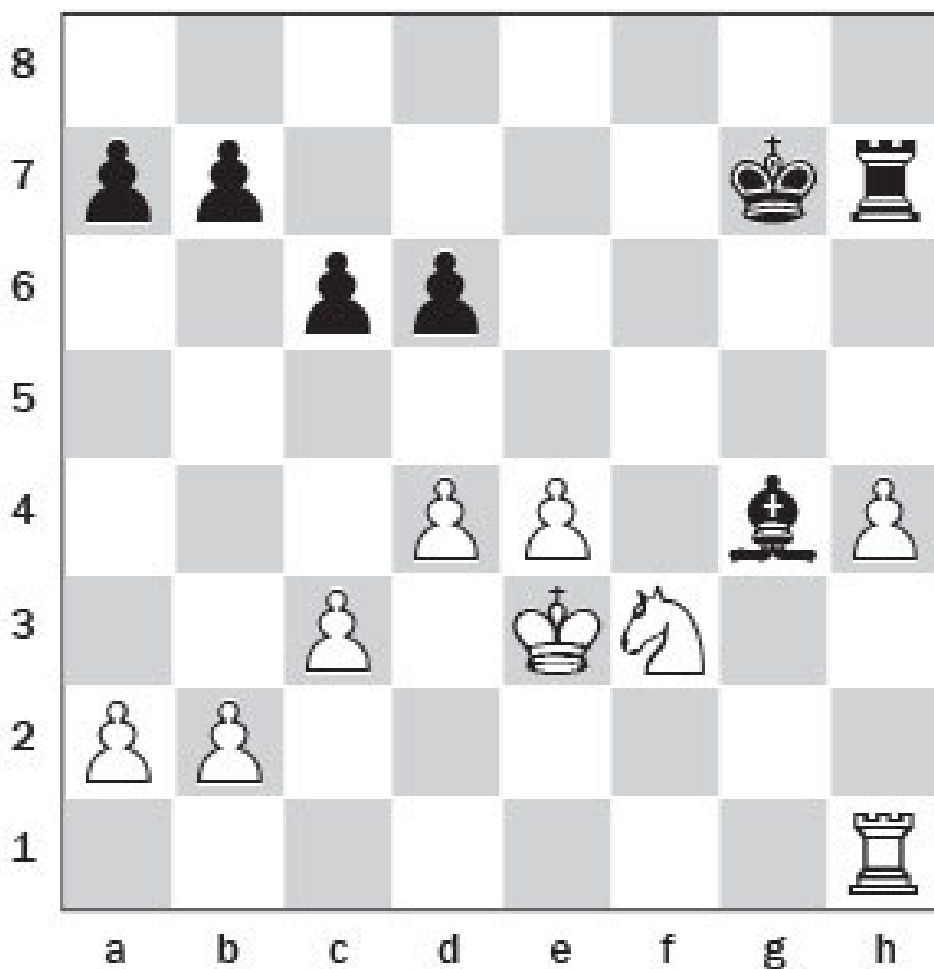
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 173

**173**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 174

**174**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 175

**175**



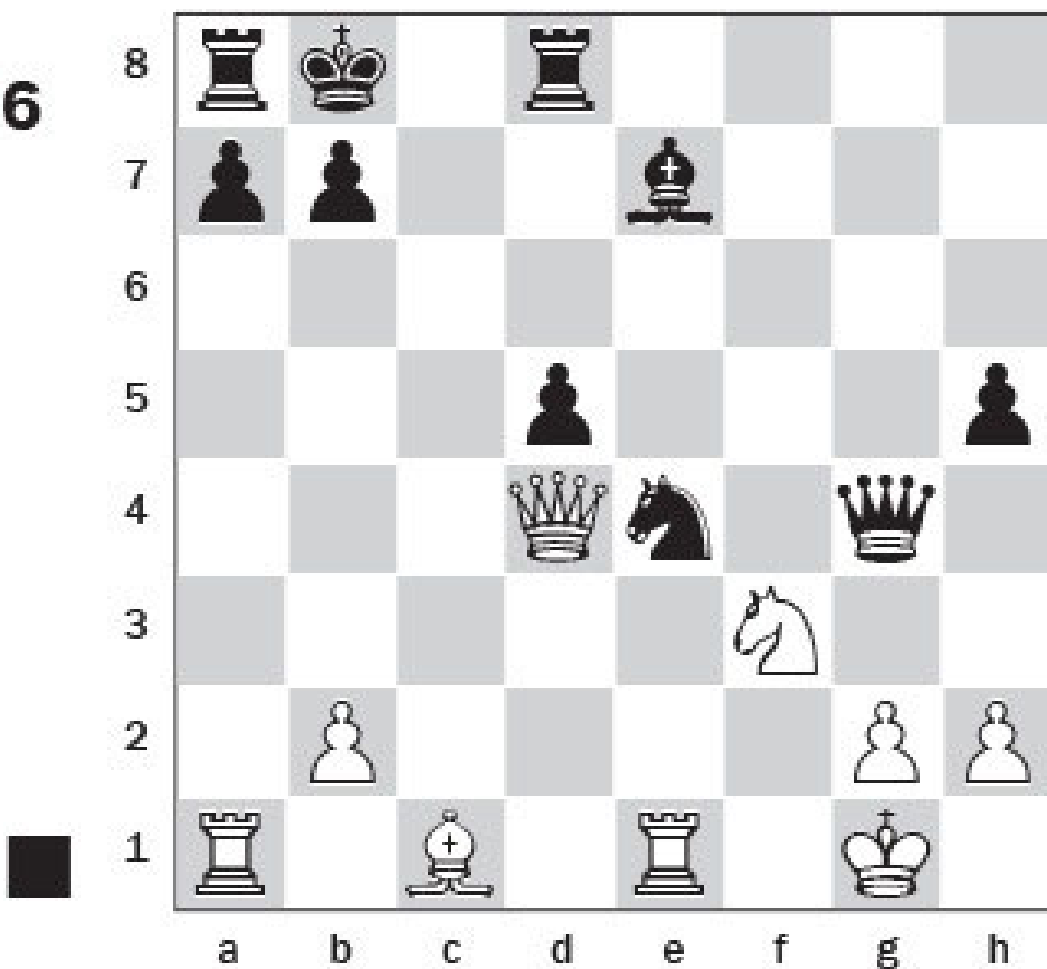
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 176

**176**



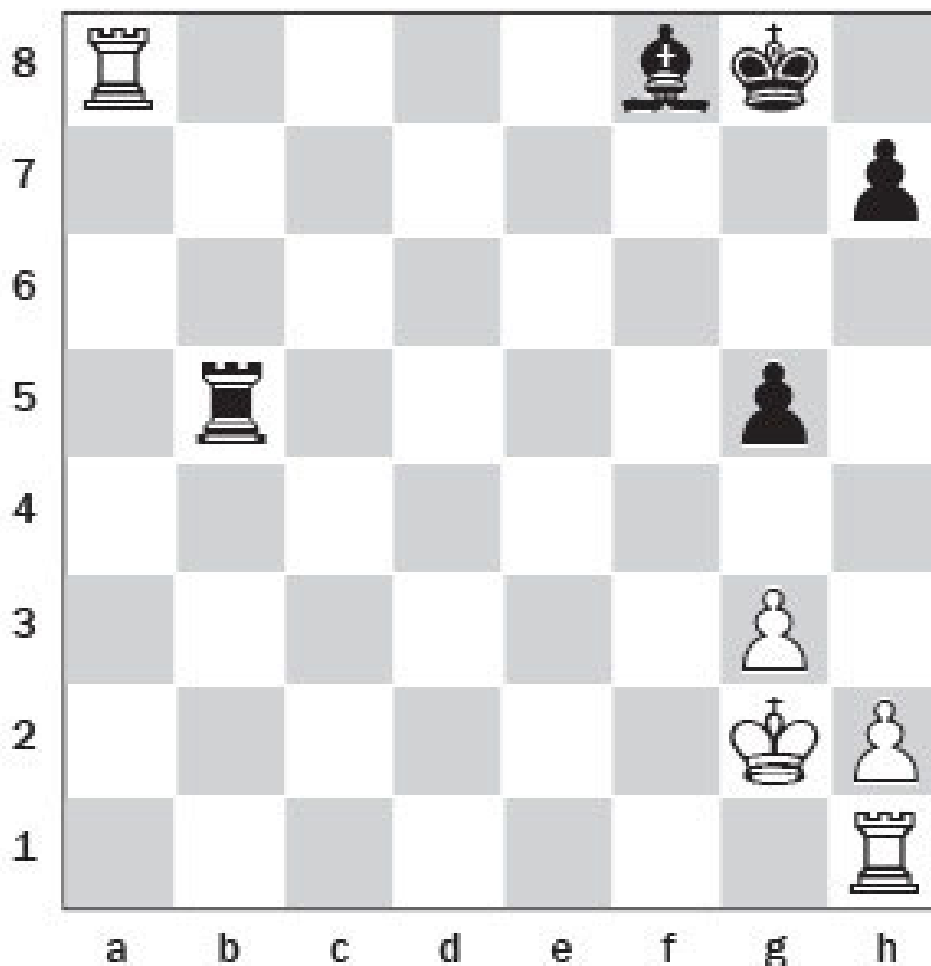
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

# Attacking the Pinned Piece – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

**1. Rf1 Kg7**

## 2. Rf/axf8 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 177

177



Answer:



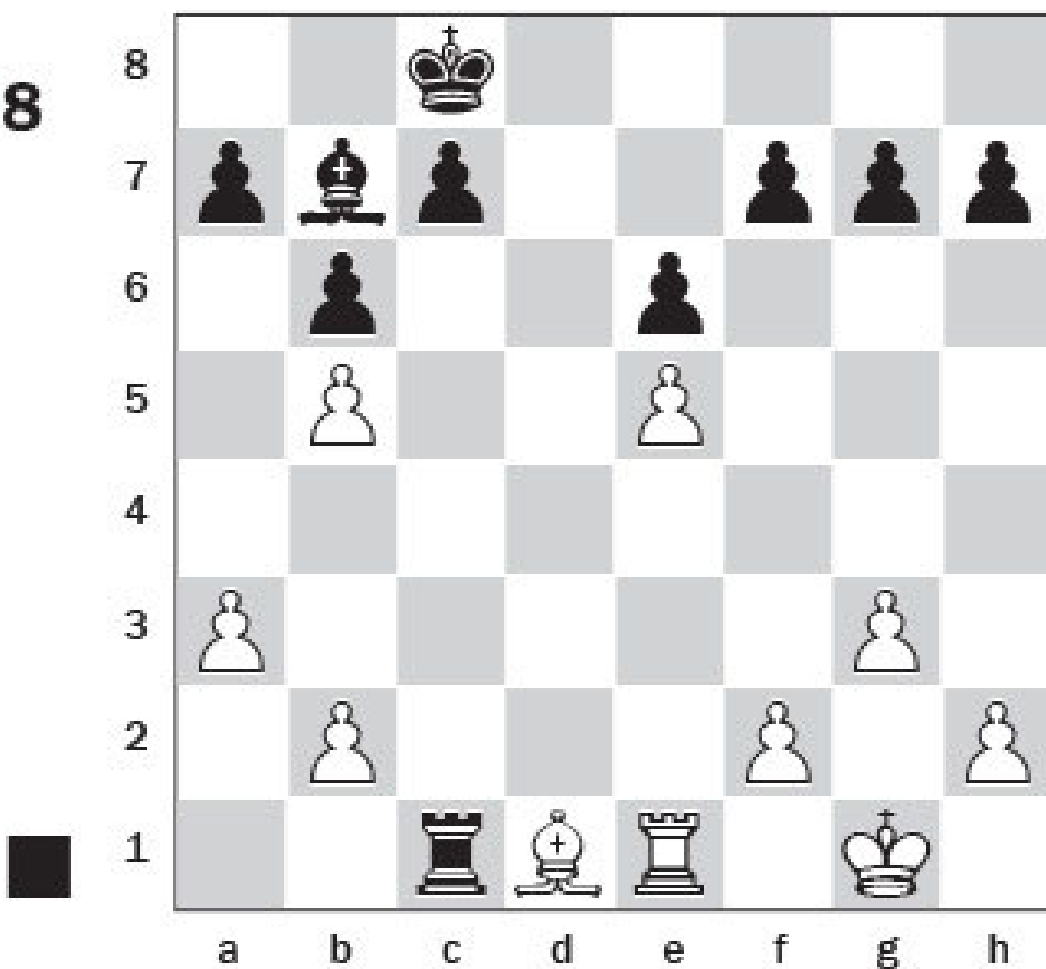
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook is pinning the bishop on f8. How can you attack the pinned bishop?

### Exercise 178

**178**



Answer:

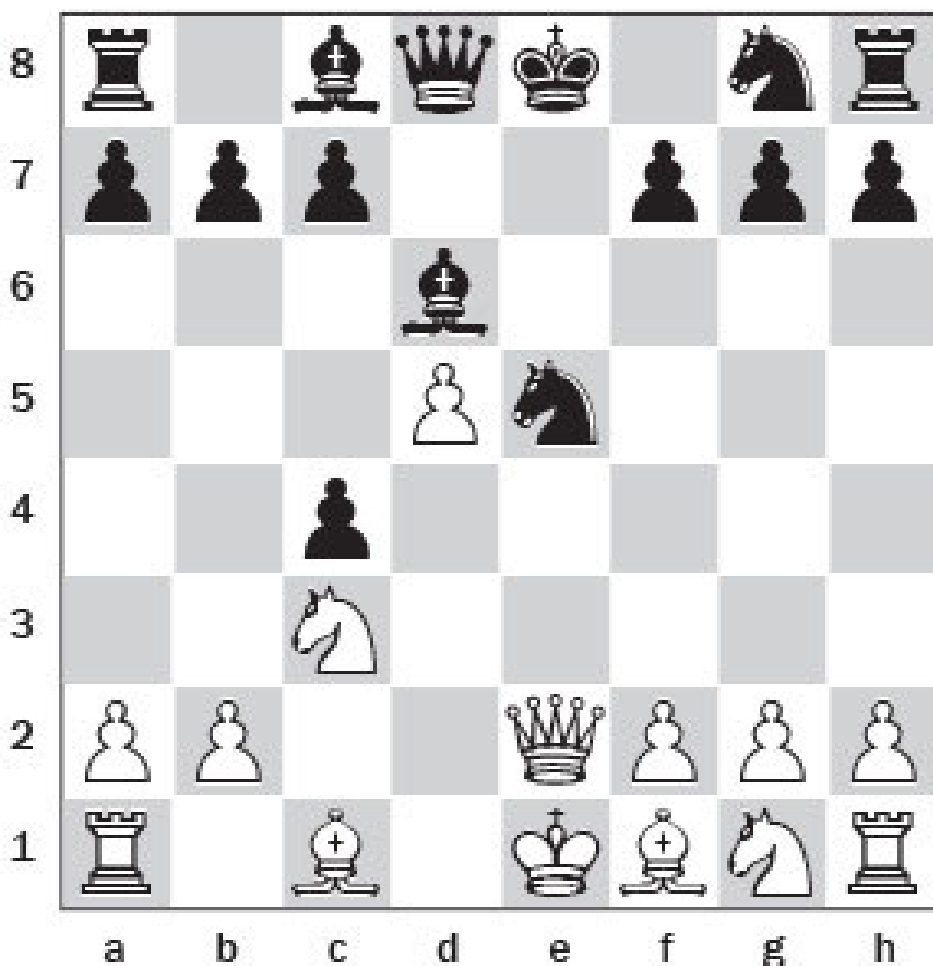
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on d1 is in a relative pin. How can you attack the pinned bishop?

### Exercise 179

**179**



Answer:

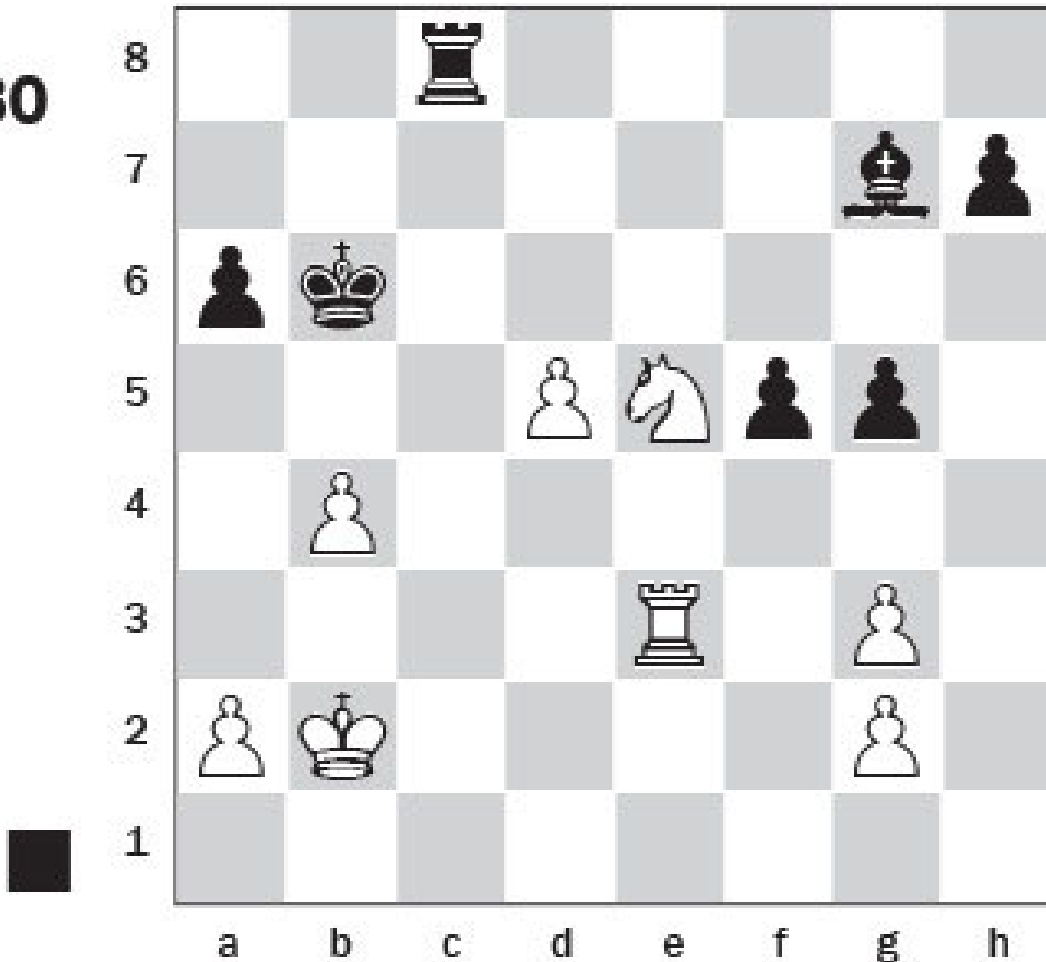
1. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

The queen is pinning the knight to the king. Attack the knight with the weakest piece possible to win material.

### **Exercise 180**

180



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on e5 is in an absolute pin but is protected by the rook. How can Black add another attacker?

## Exercise 181

181



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

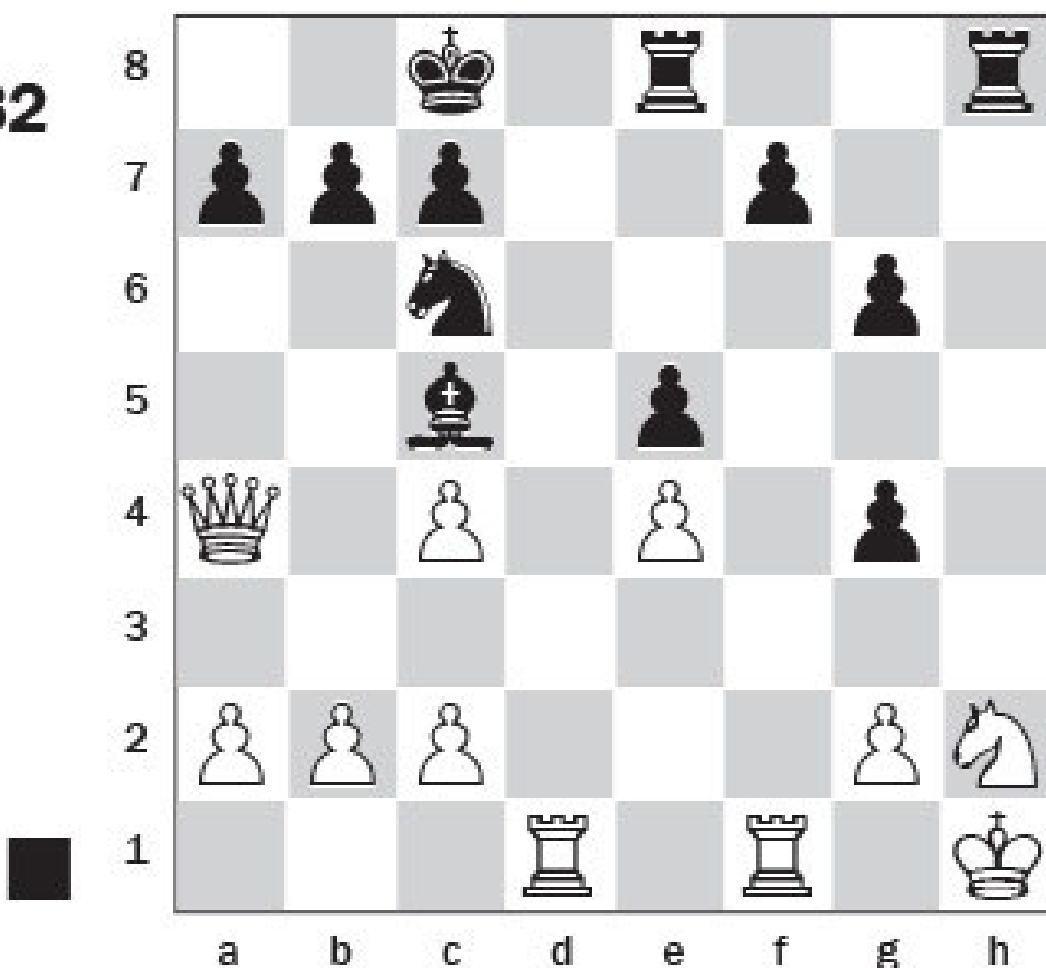
### HINT

The knight on c6 is in an absolute pin – attack the pinned piece.

# Attacking the Pinned Piece – Test

## Exercise 182

182

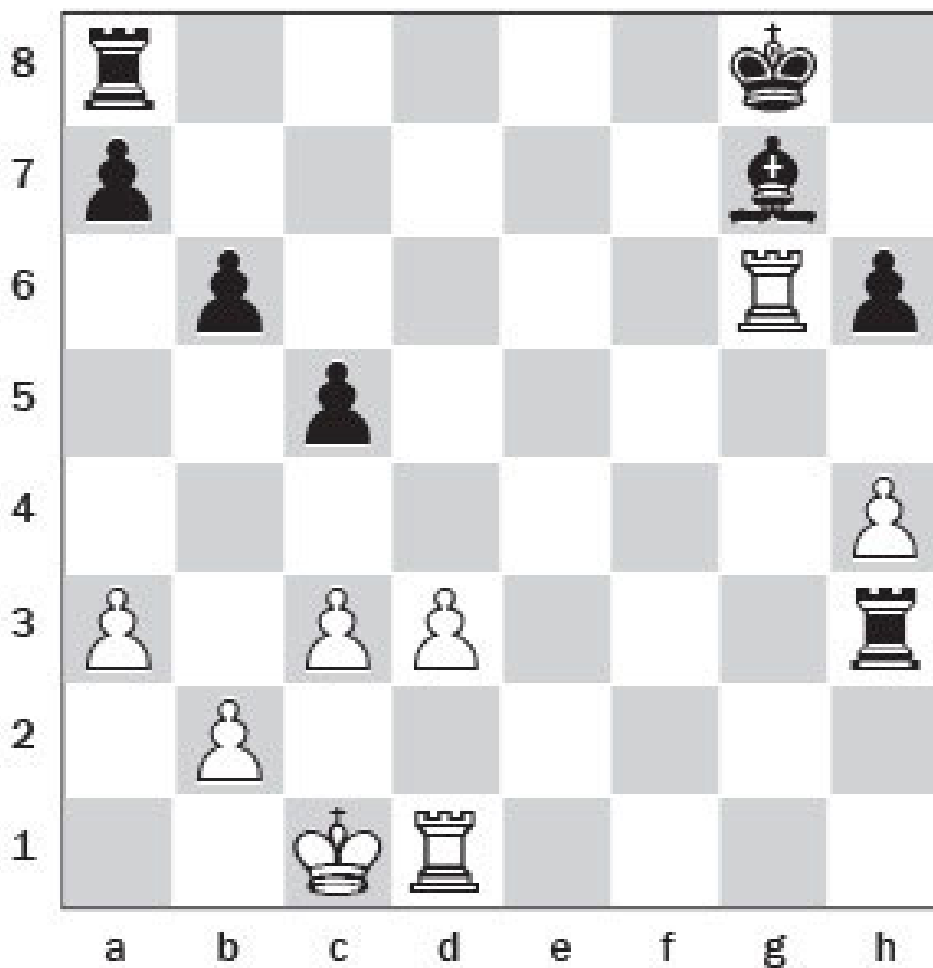


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 183

183

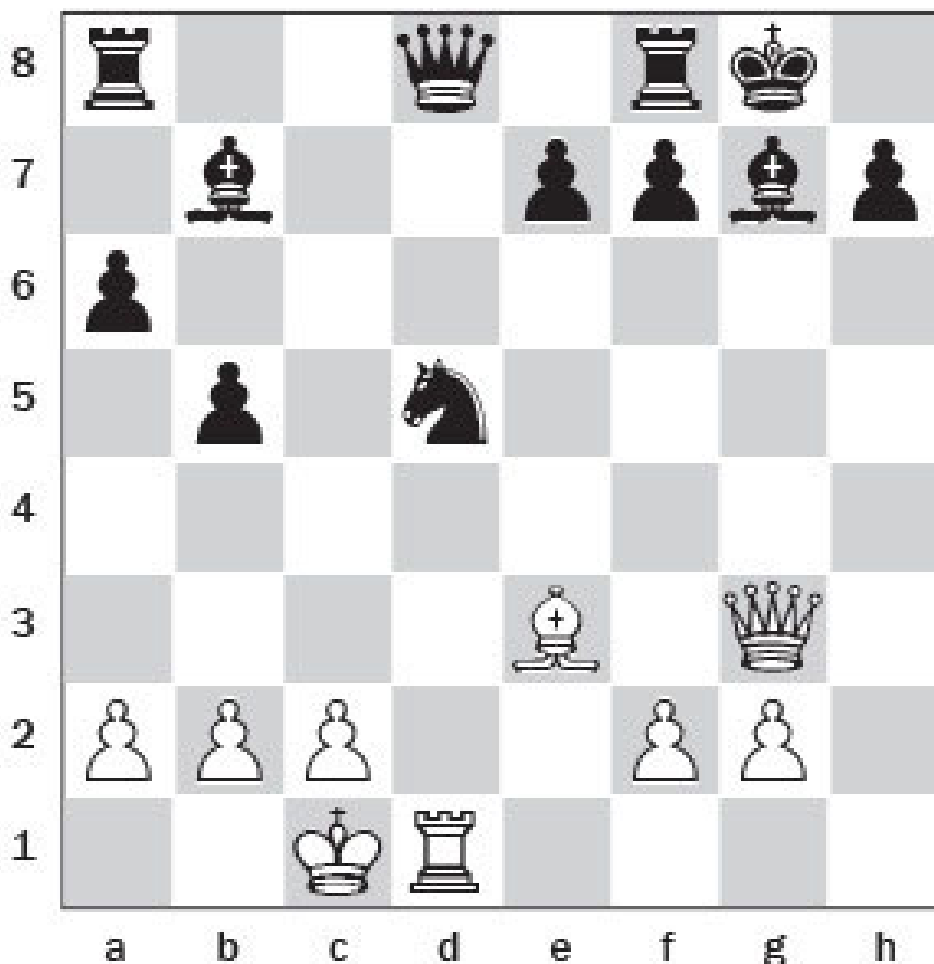


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 184

184



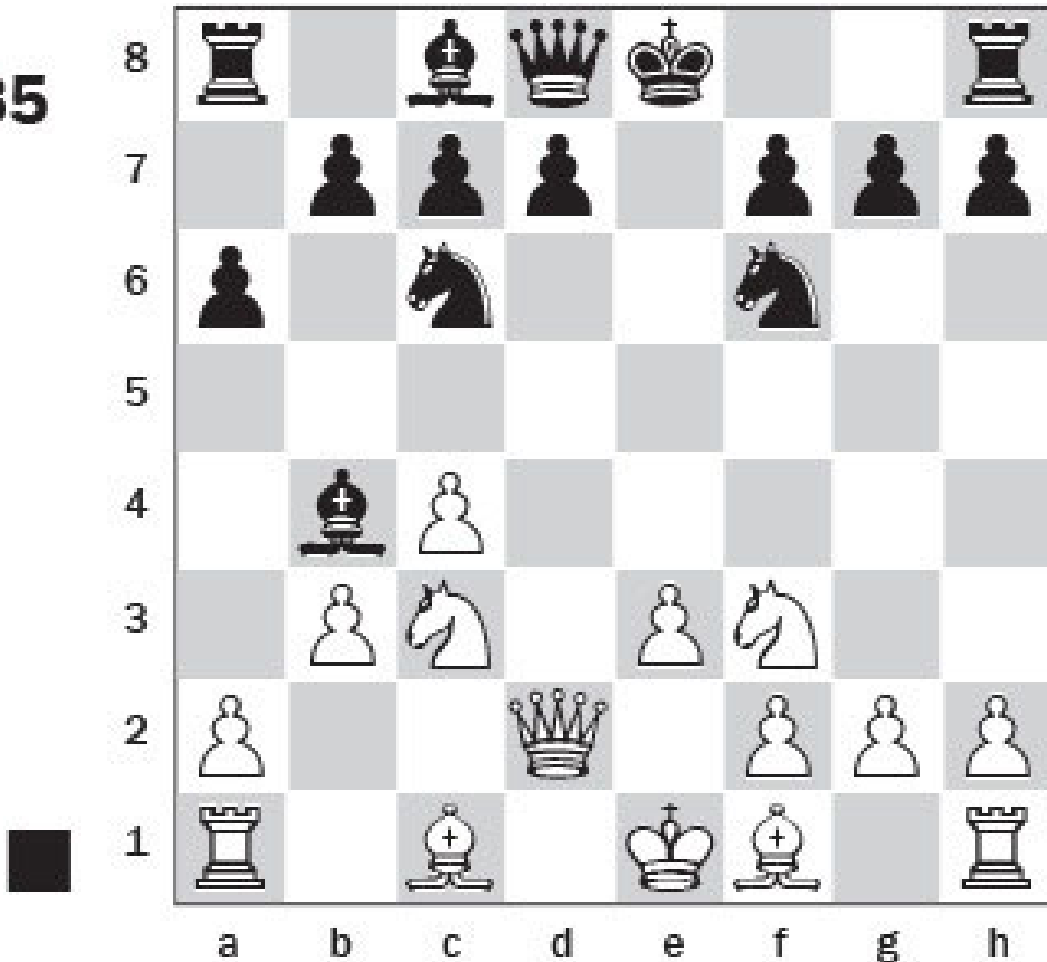
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 185](#)



185

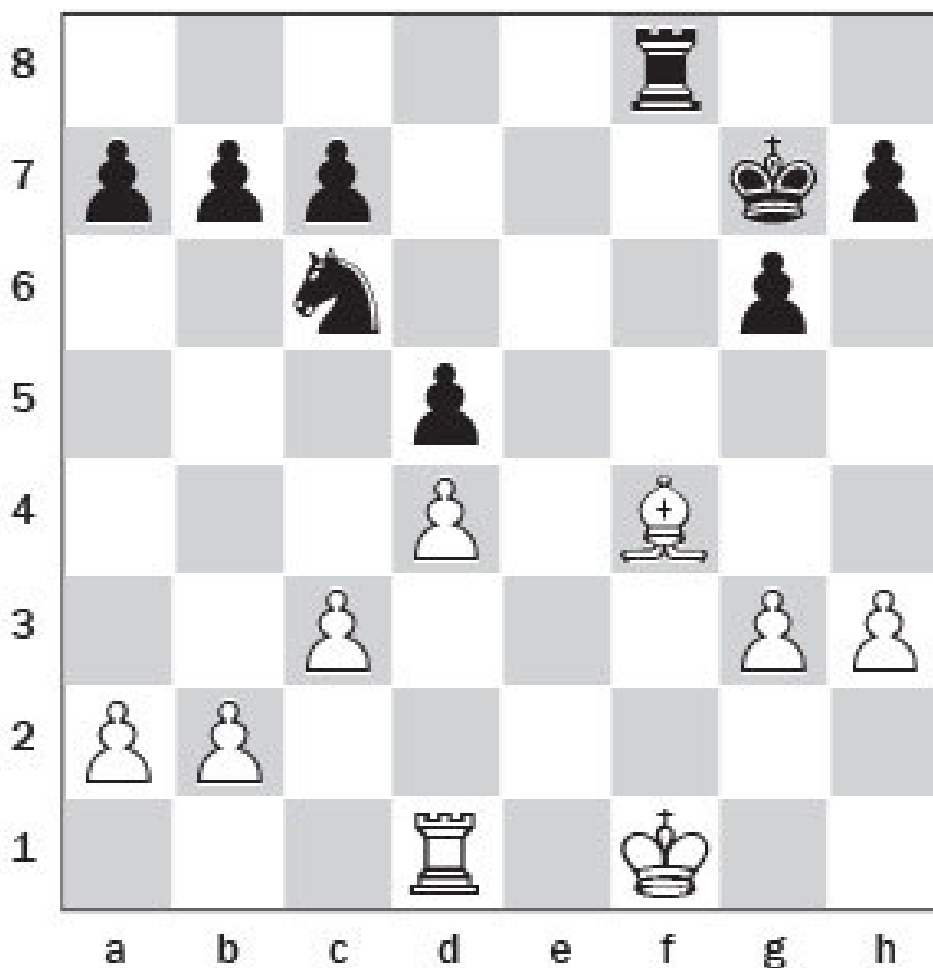


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 186](#)

186



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 187](#)

187

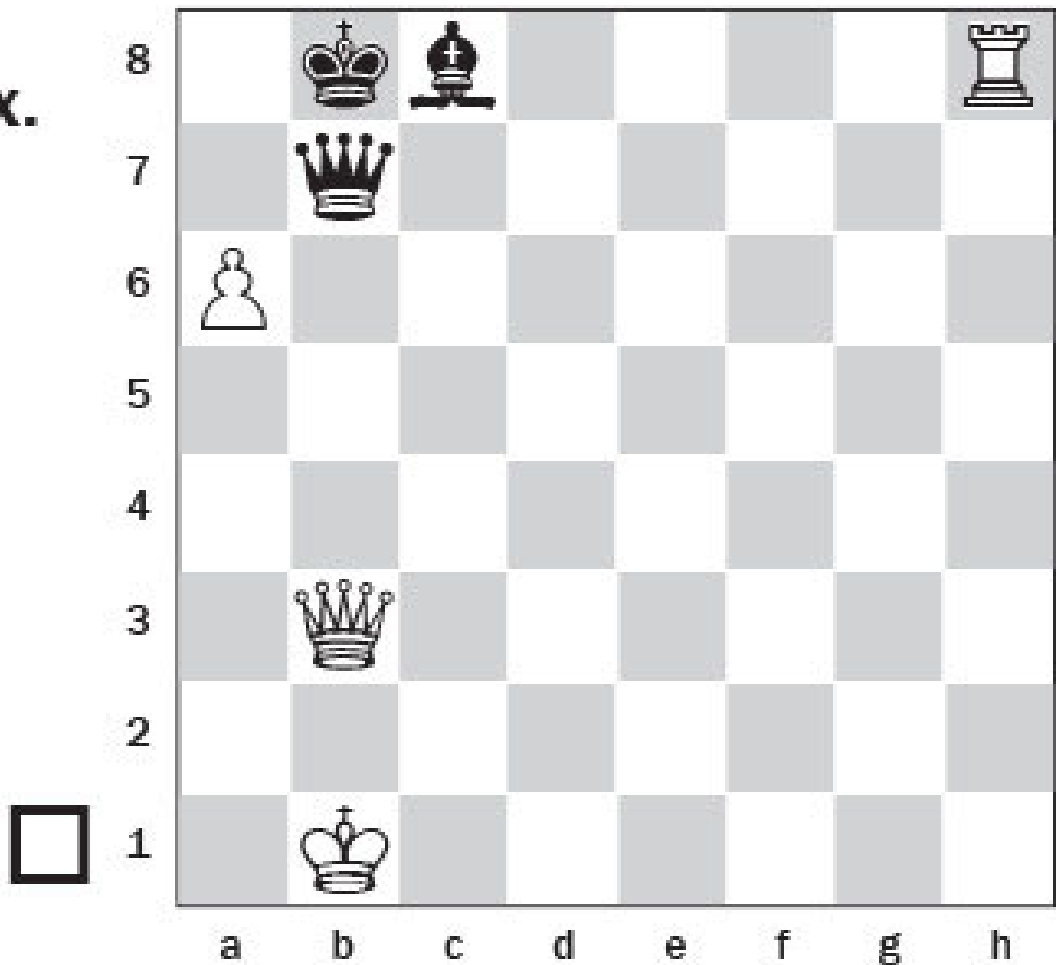


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

# Pinned Pieces Do Not Protect – Guided Practice

Ex.



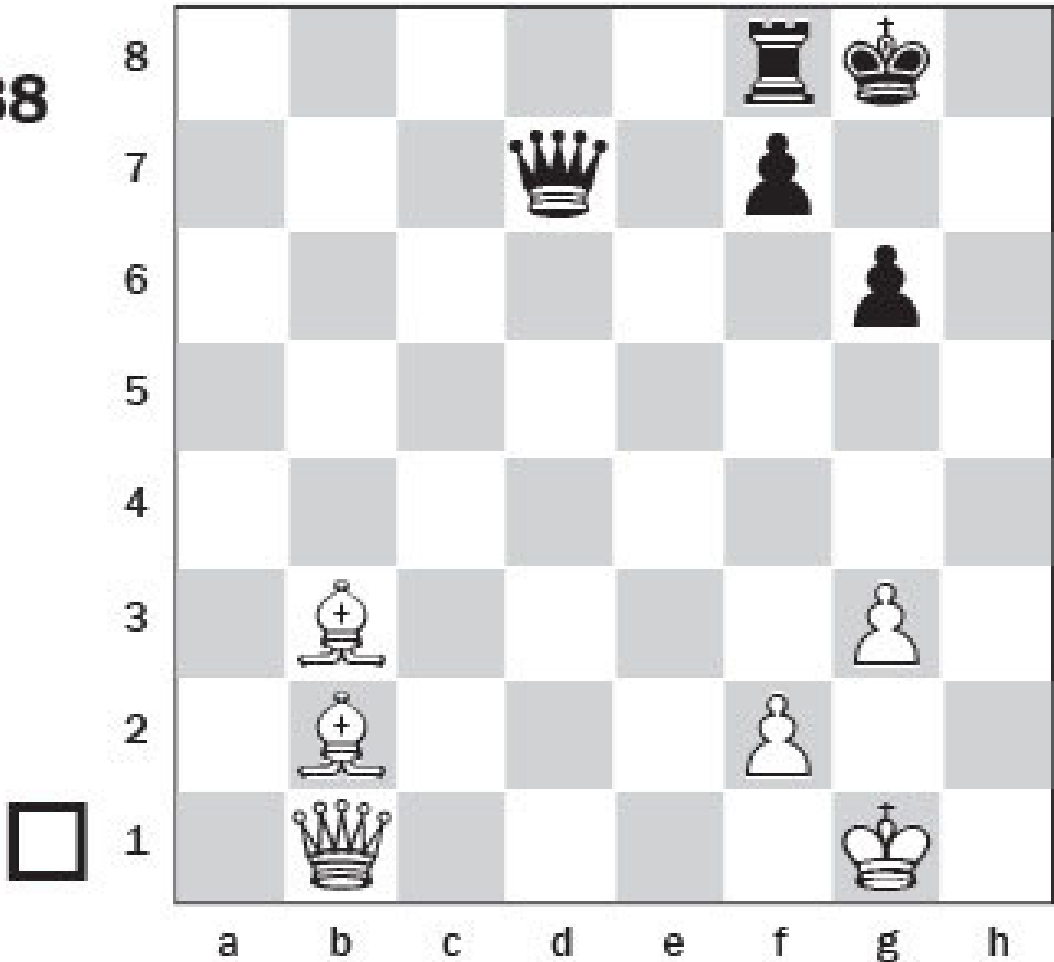
Answer:

1. Qxb7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 188

**188**



Answer:

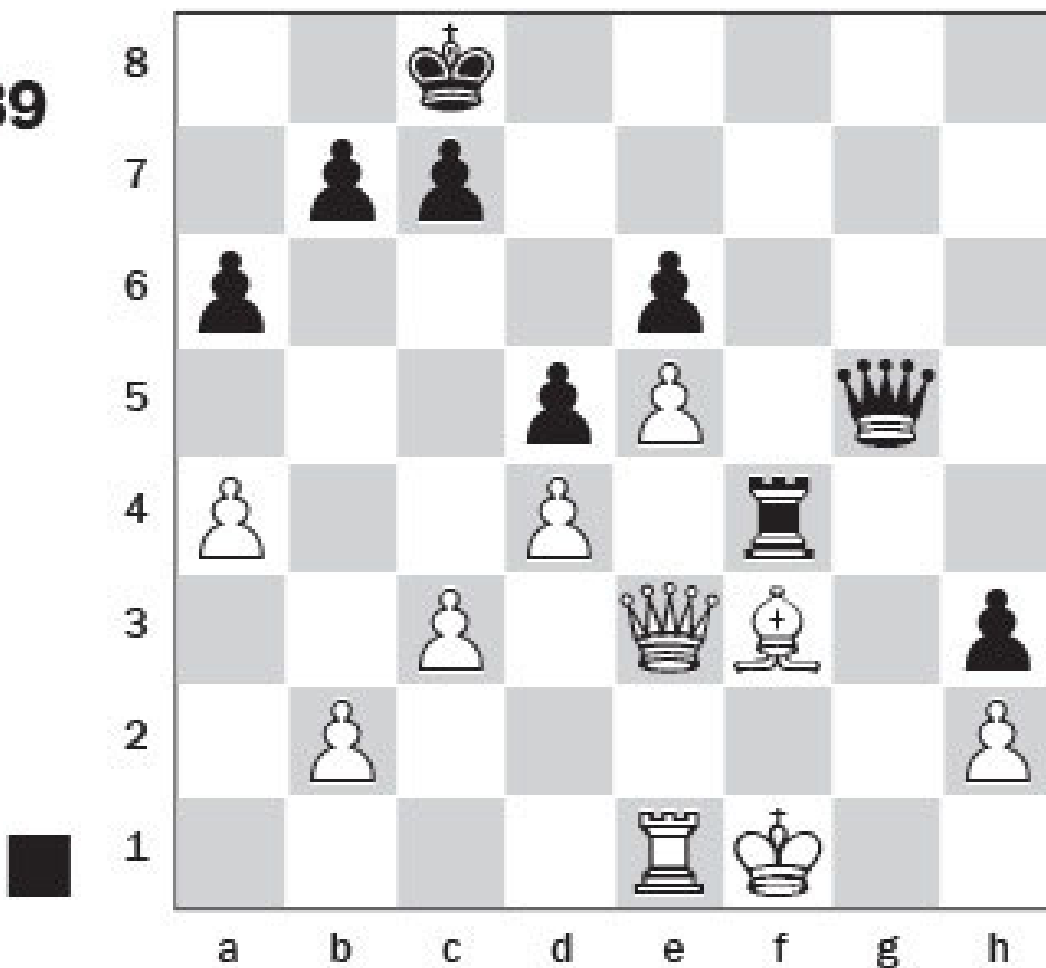
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The pawn on f7 is in an absolute pin by the bishop on b3. What shocking move can White play?

### Exercise 189

**189**



Answer:

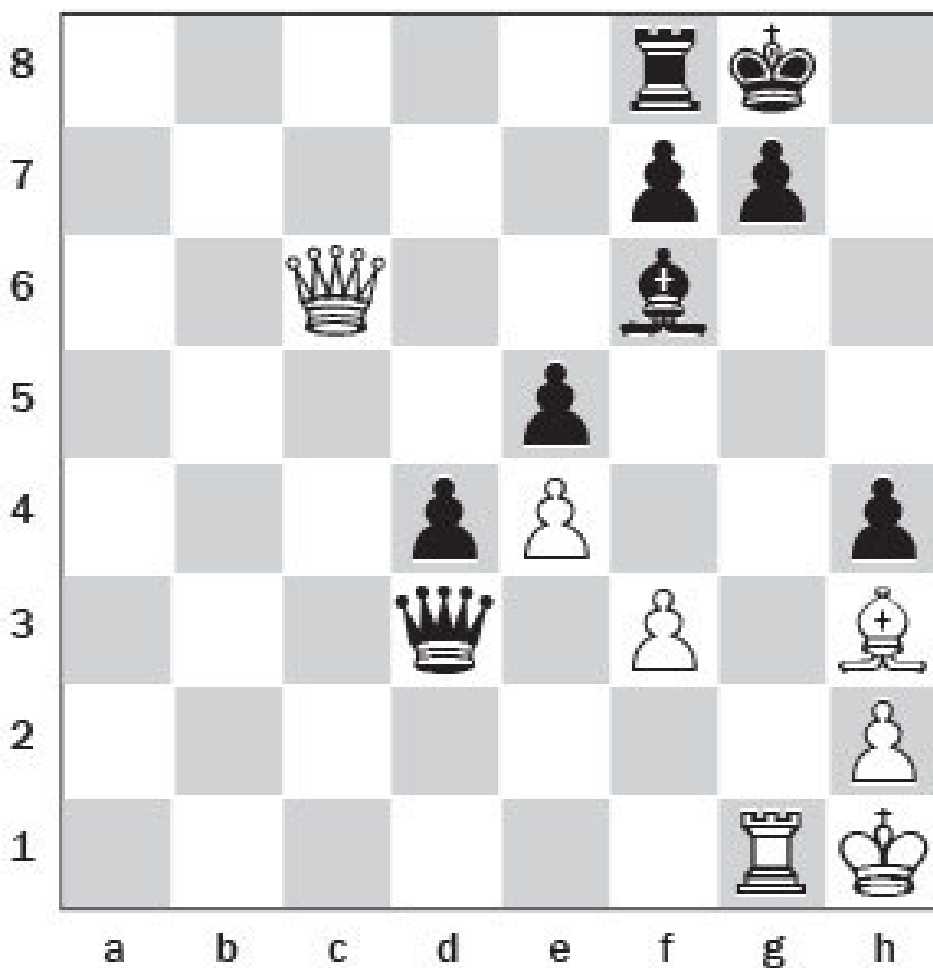
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on f3 is in an absolute pin. Use the pawn on h3 for a helper checkmate.

### Exercise 190

**190**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on g1 is pinning the pawn on g7. How can White win material?

### Exercise 191

**191**



Answer:



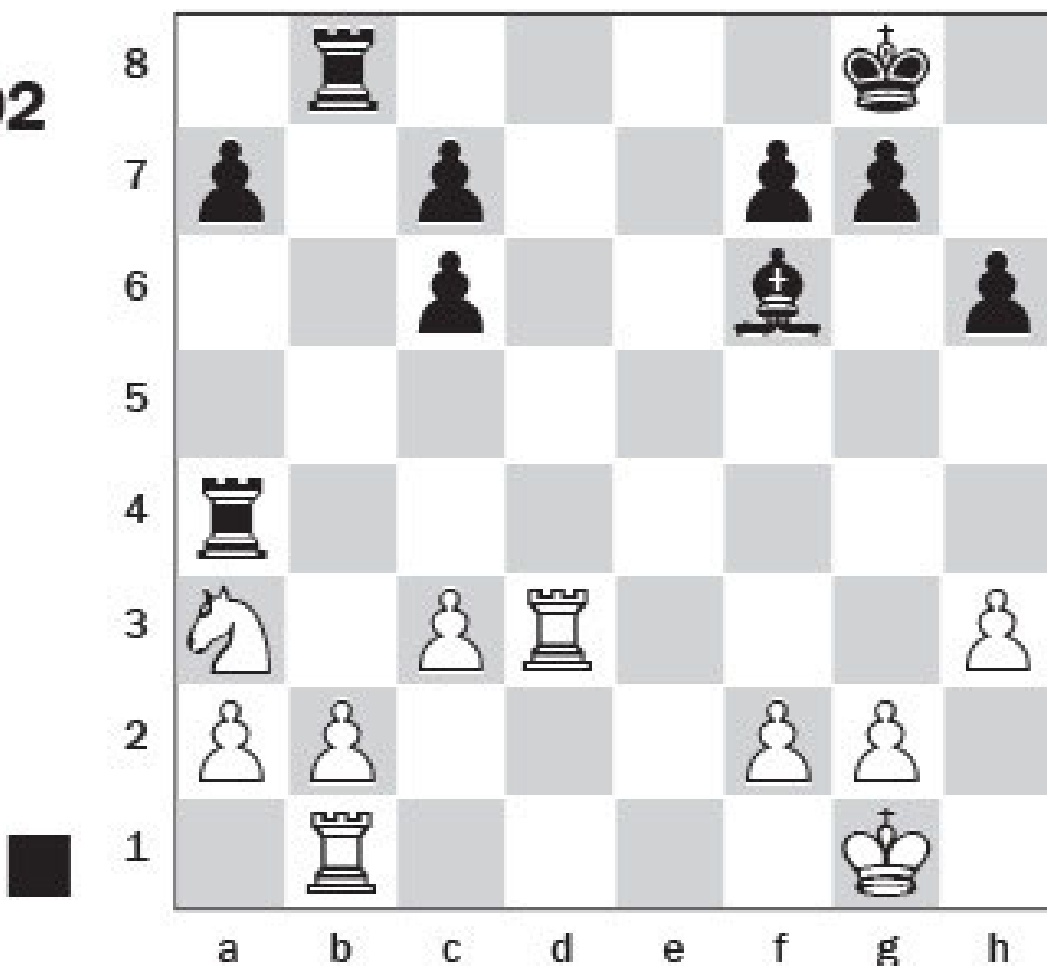
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The f7-pawn is being pinned by the bishop on b3. How can White win material?

### Exercise 192

**192**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

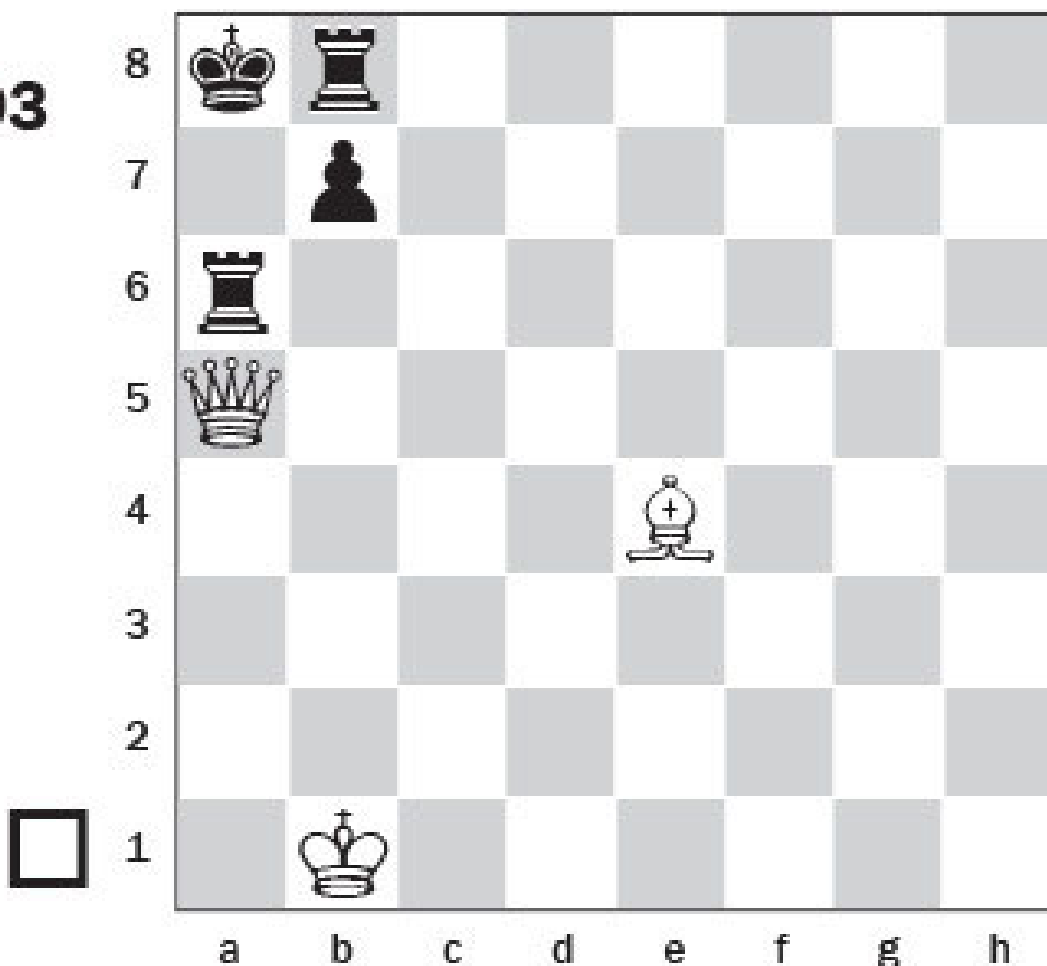
### **HINT**

The pawn on b2 is in a relative pin by the rook on b8. How can Black win material?

# Pinned Pieces Do Not Protect – Test

## Exercise 193

**193**

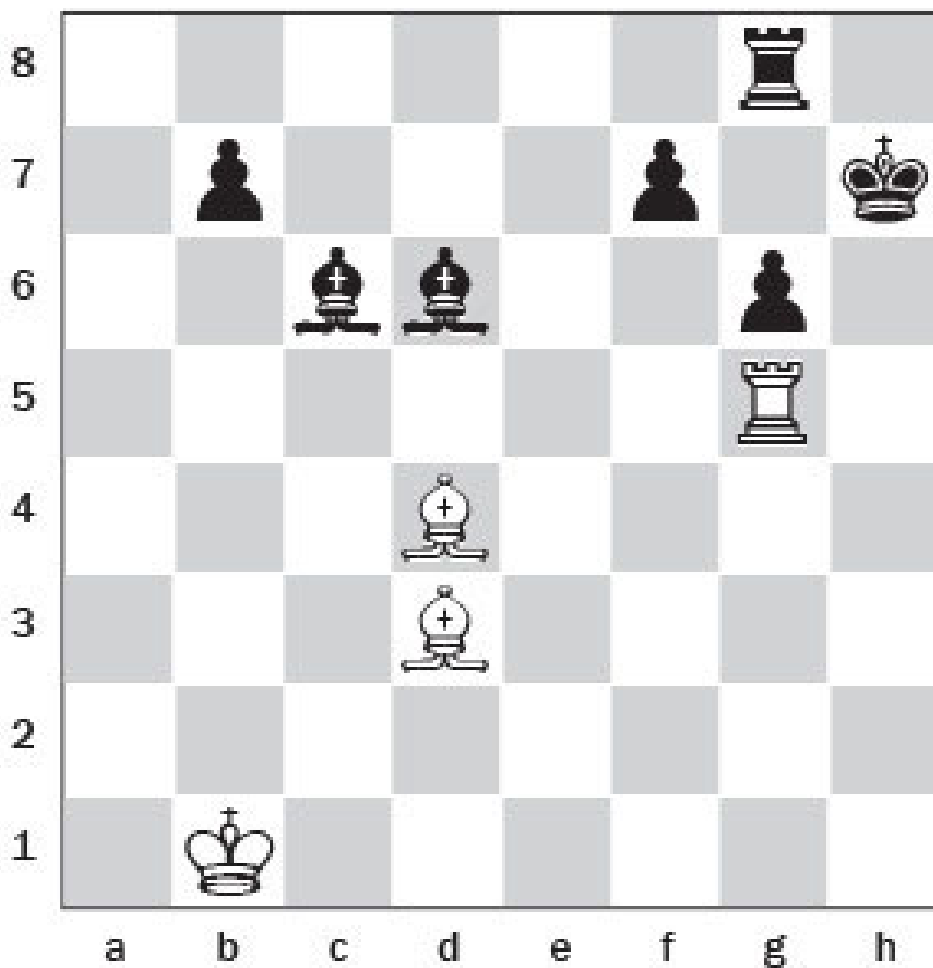


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 194

194

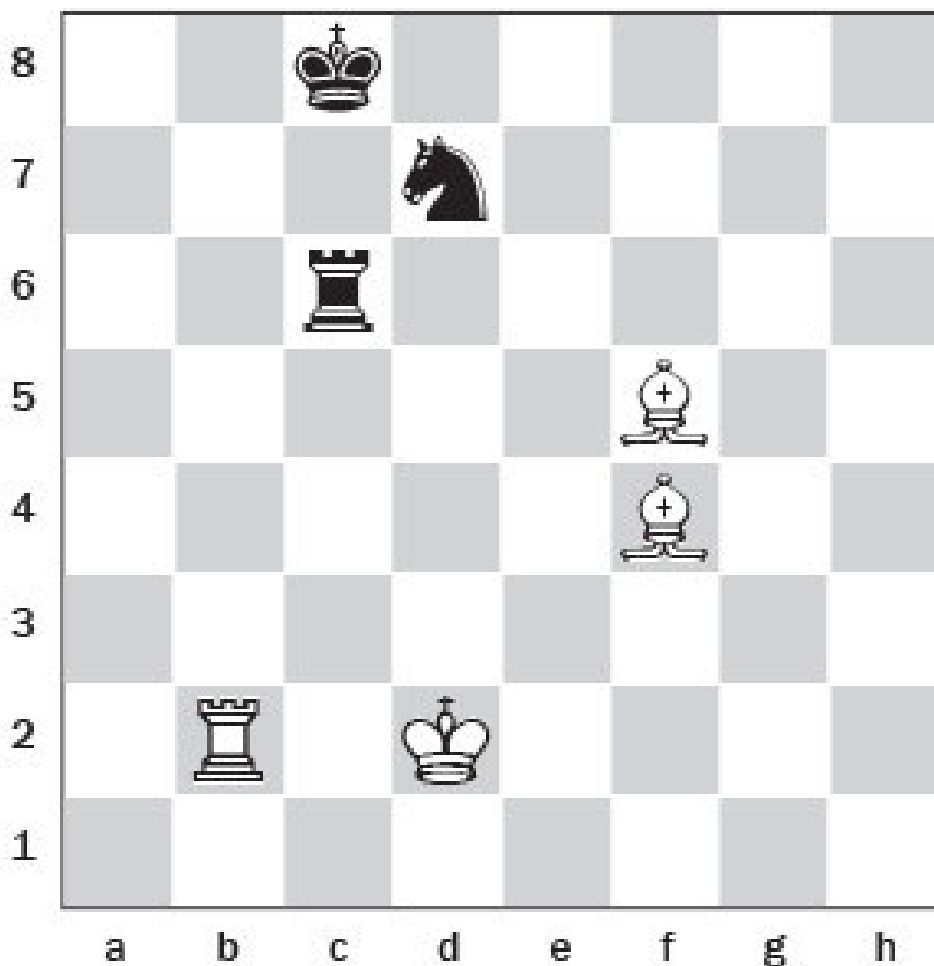


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 195

195

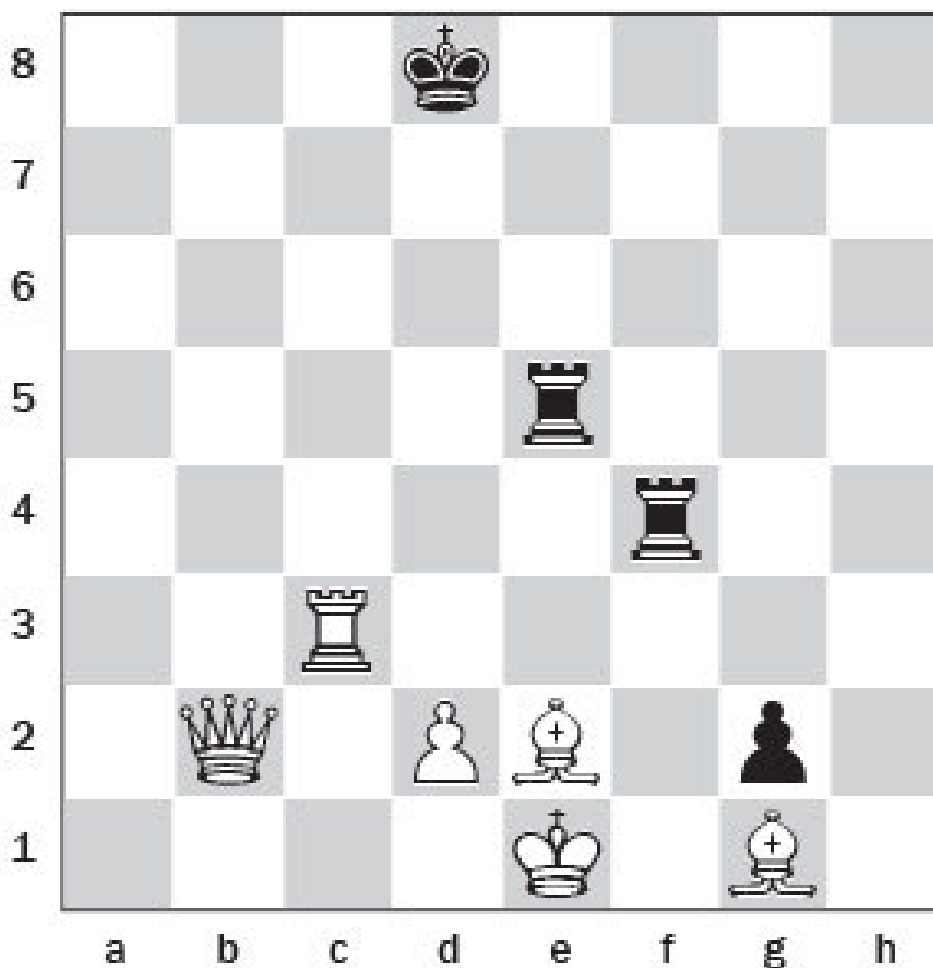


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 196](#)

196

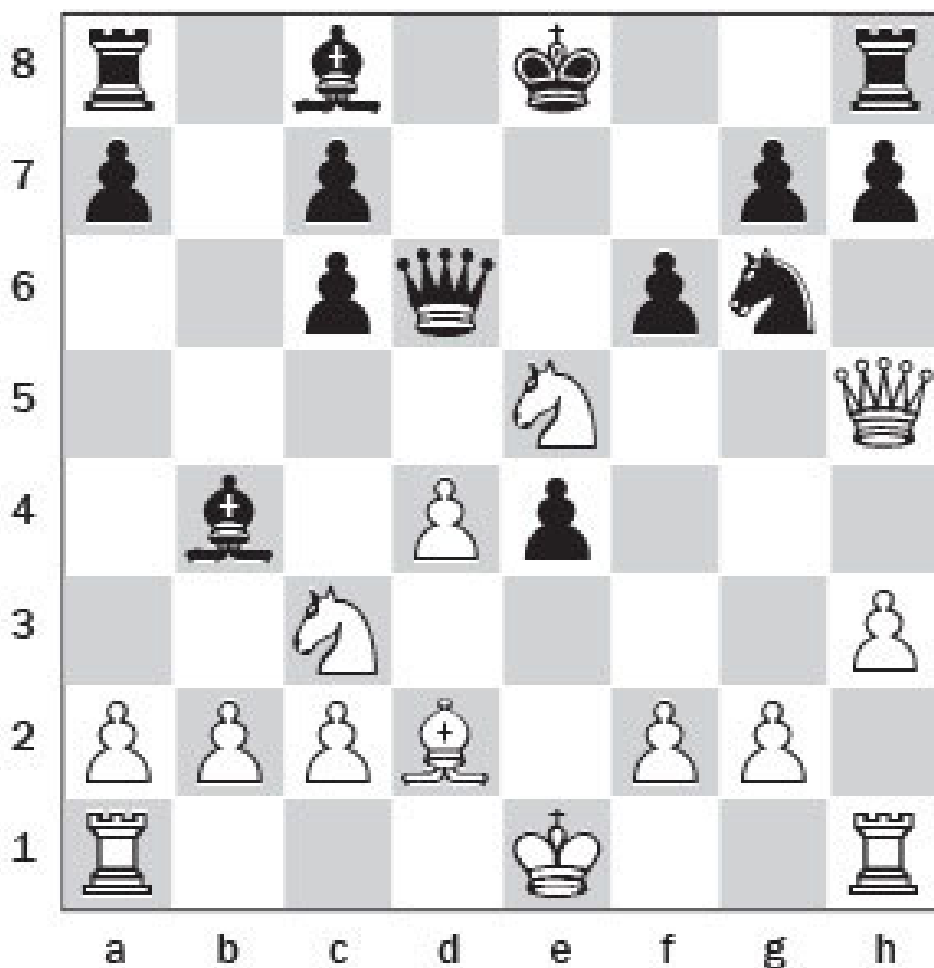


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 197](#)

# 197

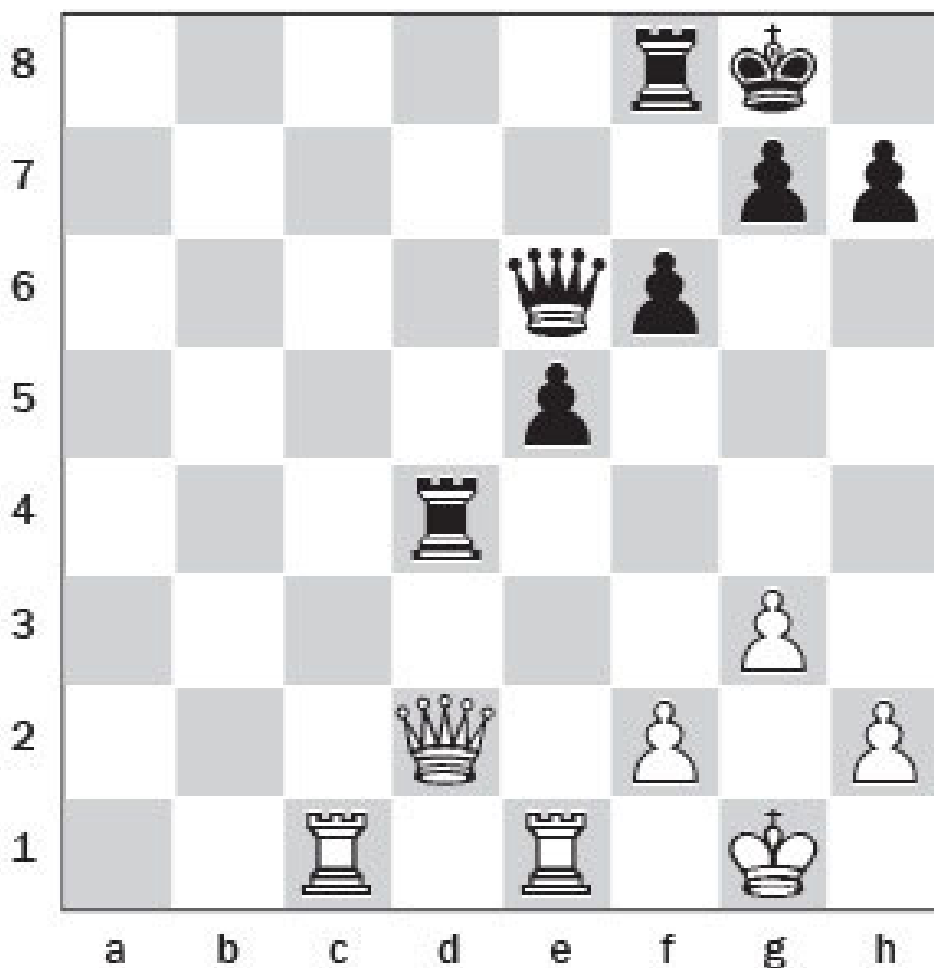


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 198](#)

198



Answer:

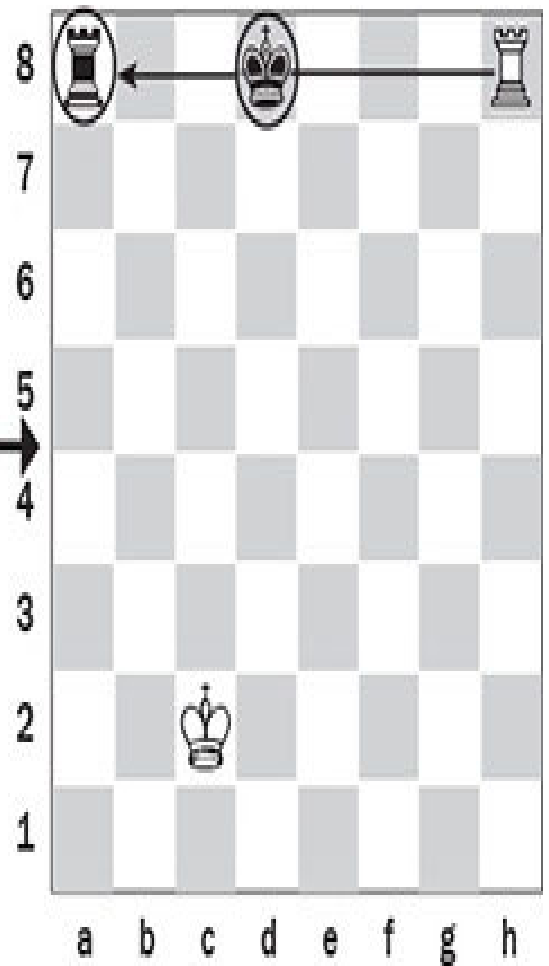
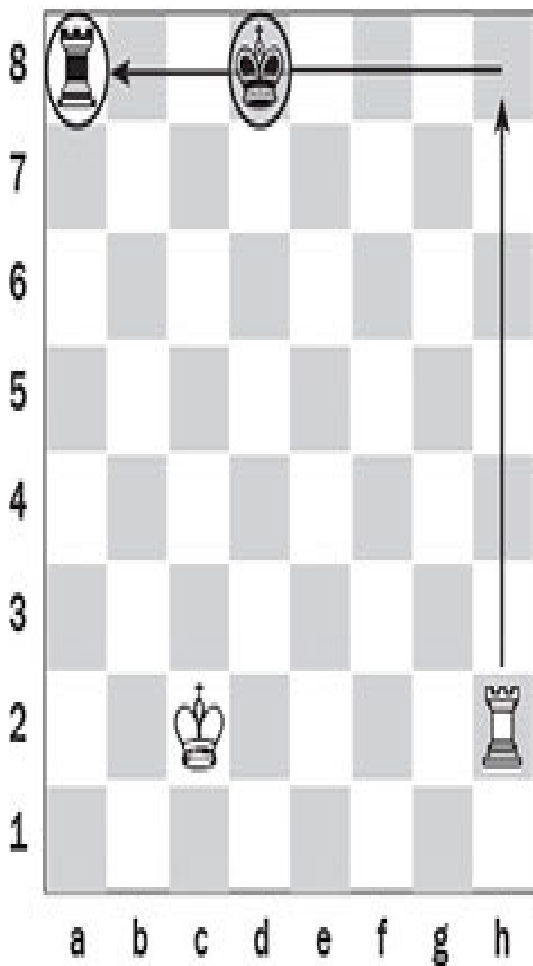
1. \_\_\_\_\_



## CHAPTER 7

# Skewer

A skewer occurs when a linear moving piece (queen, rook, or bishop) attacks an enemy piece and if that piece moves away there would be an attack on a less valuable piece beyond it. Sometimes a skewer is referred to as a 'reverse pin' since a pin occurs when a piece of less value is attacked, and if it moves, a piece of greater value would be in danger. A skewer is the opposite; the more valuable piece is the one first attacked.



Notice that the black king and rook are aligned on the 8th rank. White could move the rook to h8, skewering the king and rook.

The best move for White is 1.Rh8+ (see diagram 2).

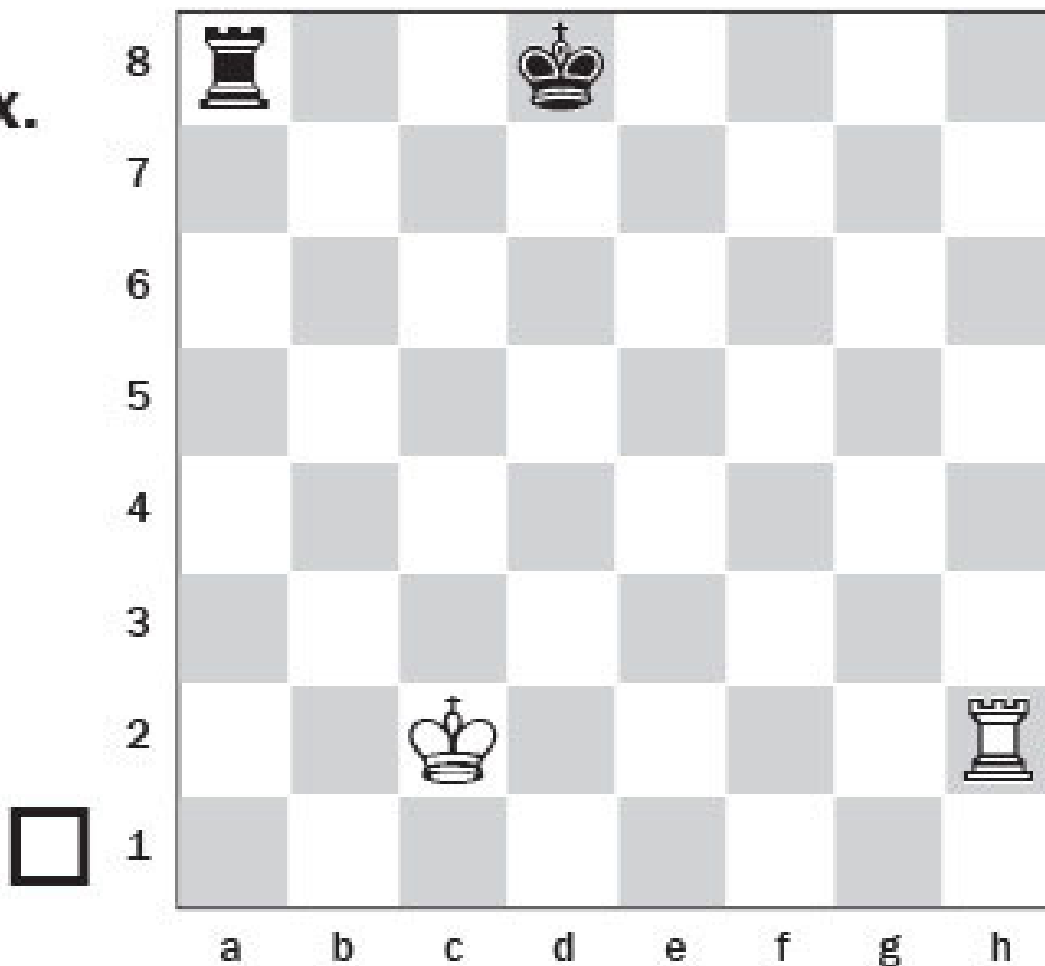
The king (the most valuable piece) is attacked first. The king has to dodge the attack but then the rook on a8 is lost.

**1...Kc7 2.Rxa8**

In order to solve the problems in this chapter, look for enemy pieces aligned on the same file, rank or diagonal.

# Skewer – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



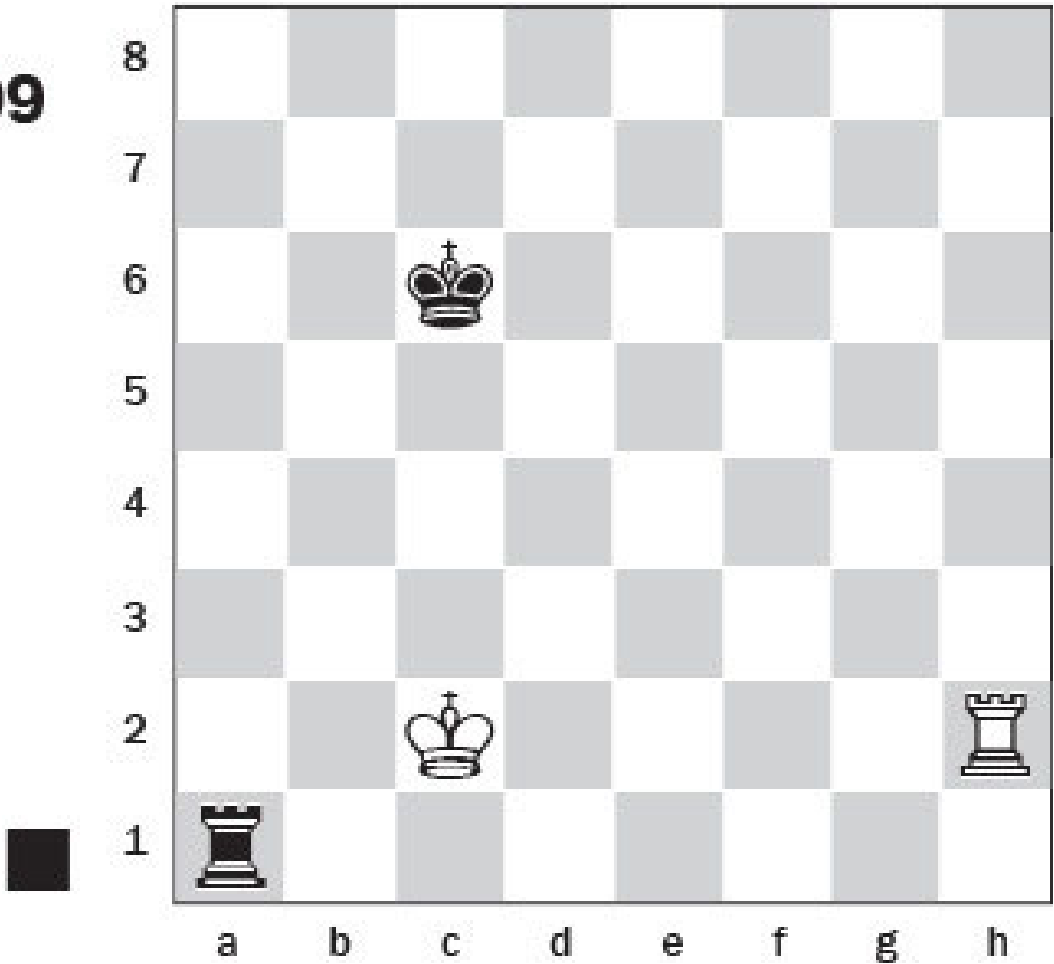
Answer:

1. Rh8+ \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 199

**199**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

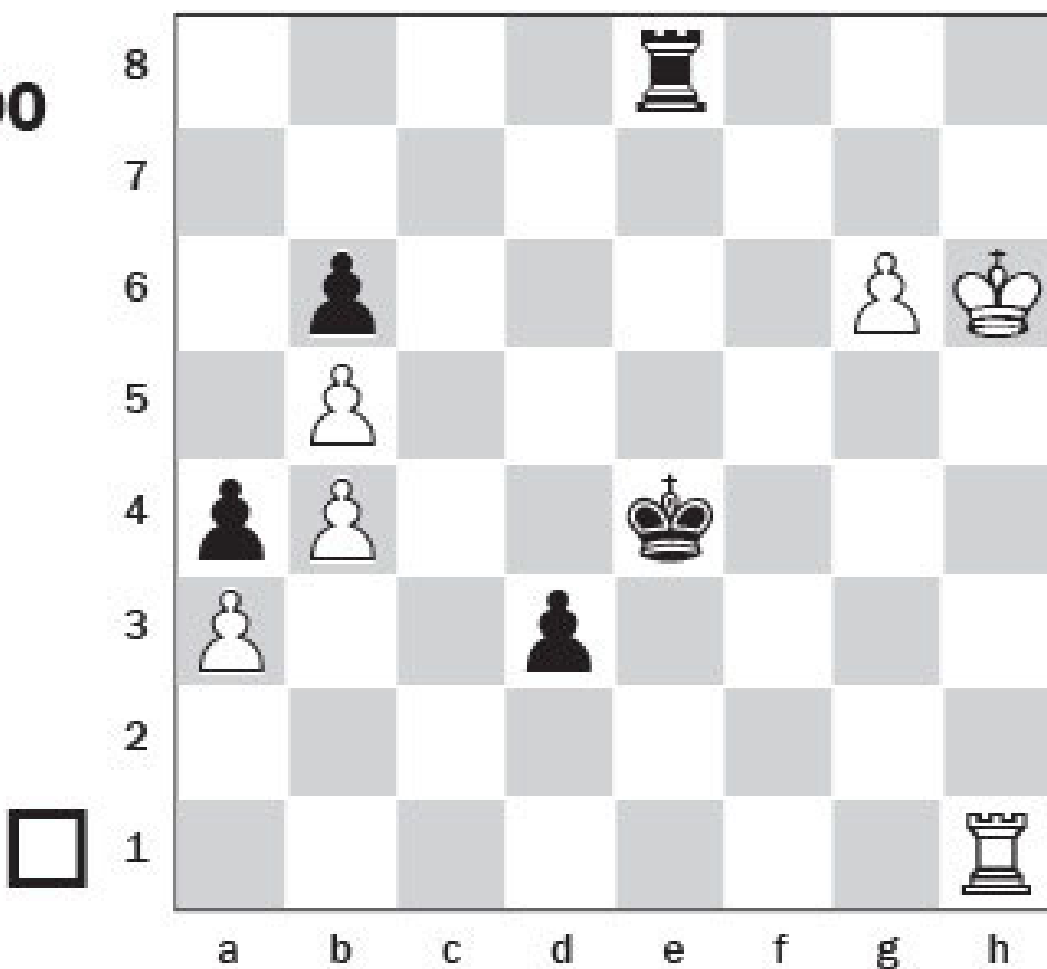
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the king and rook are on the same rank. Use a rook skewer to win material.

### Exercise 200

200



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that White's king and rook are on the same file. Use a rook skewer to win material.

## Exercise 201

201



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

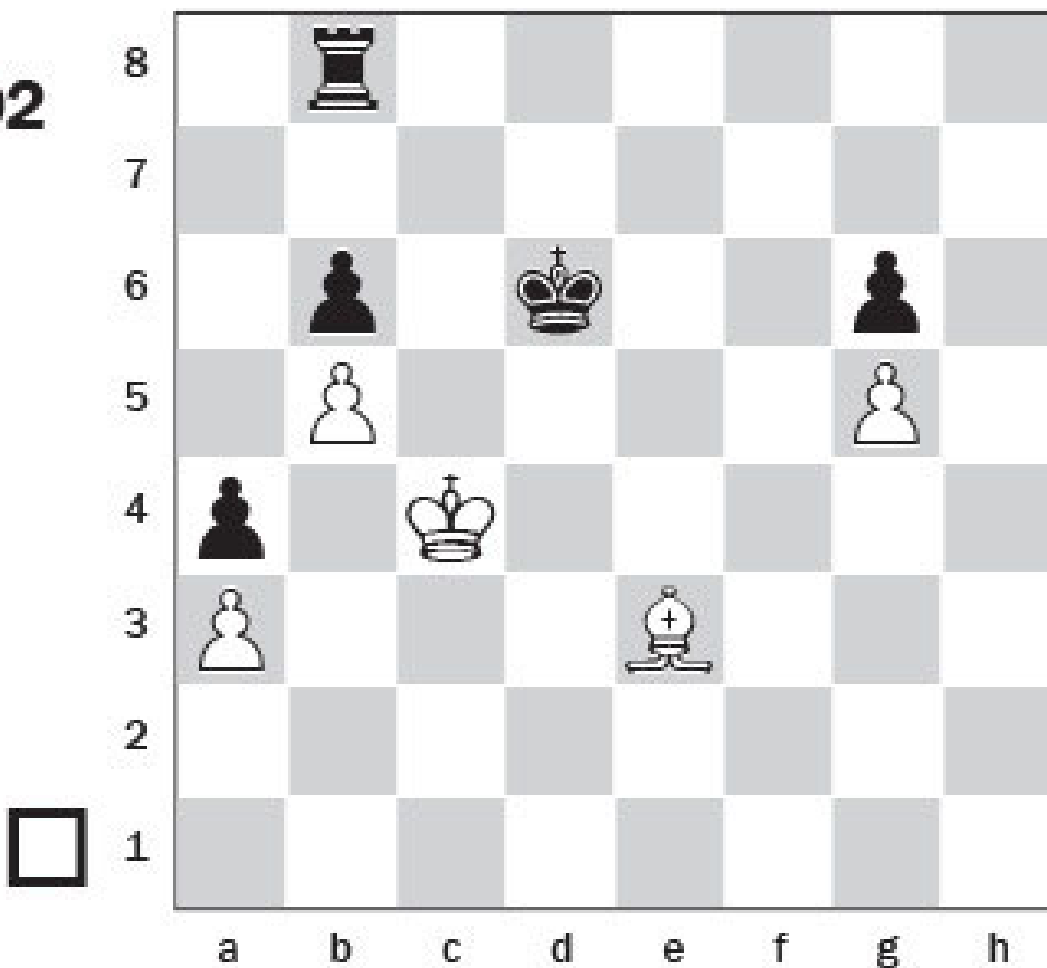
HINT



The king and rook are both on the 8th rank. Use a queen skewer to win material.

### Exercise 202

202



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

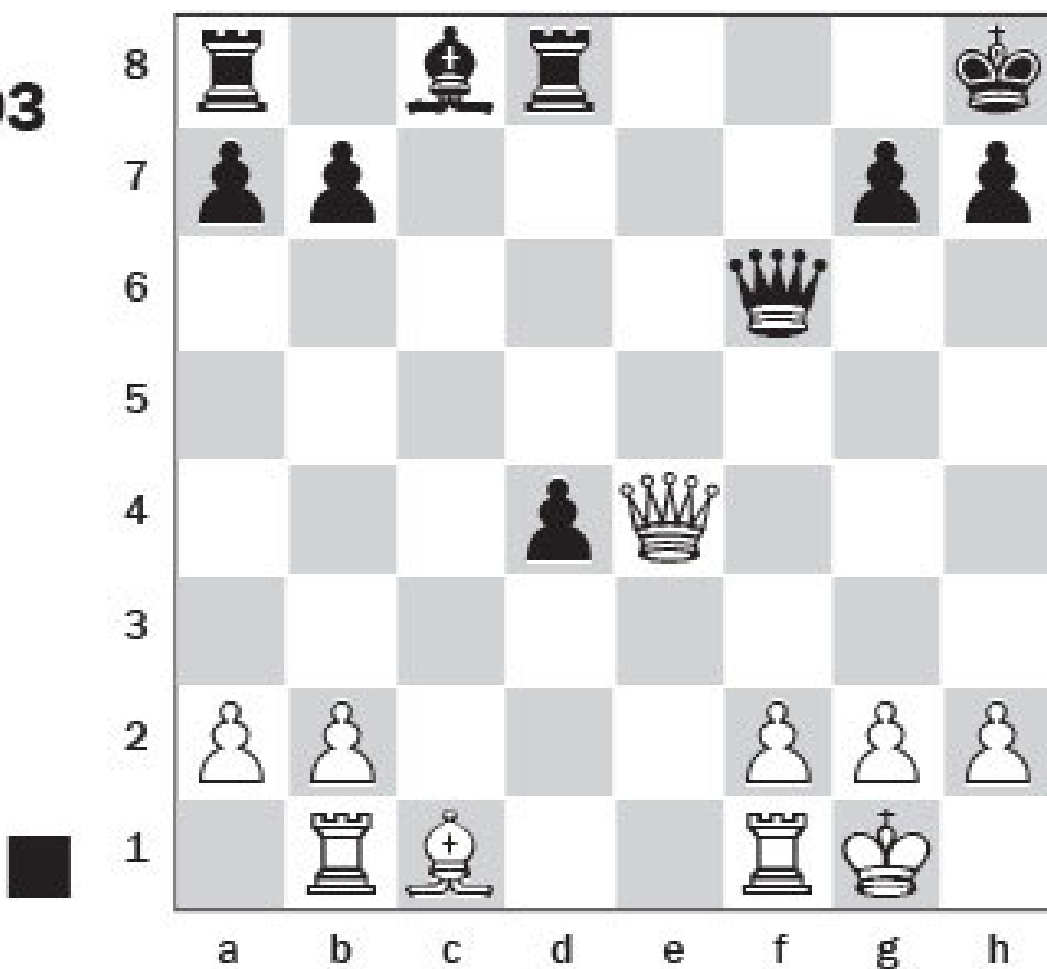
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the king and rook are on the same diagonal. Use a bishop skewer to win the rook.

### Exercise 203

203



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

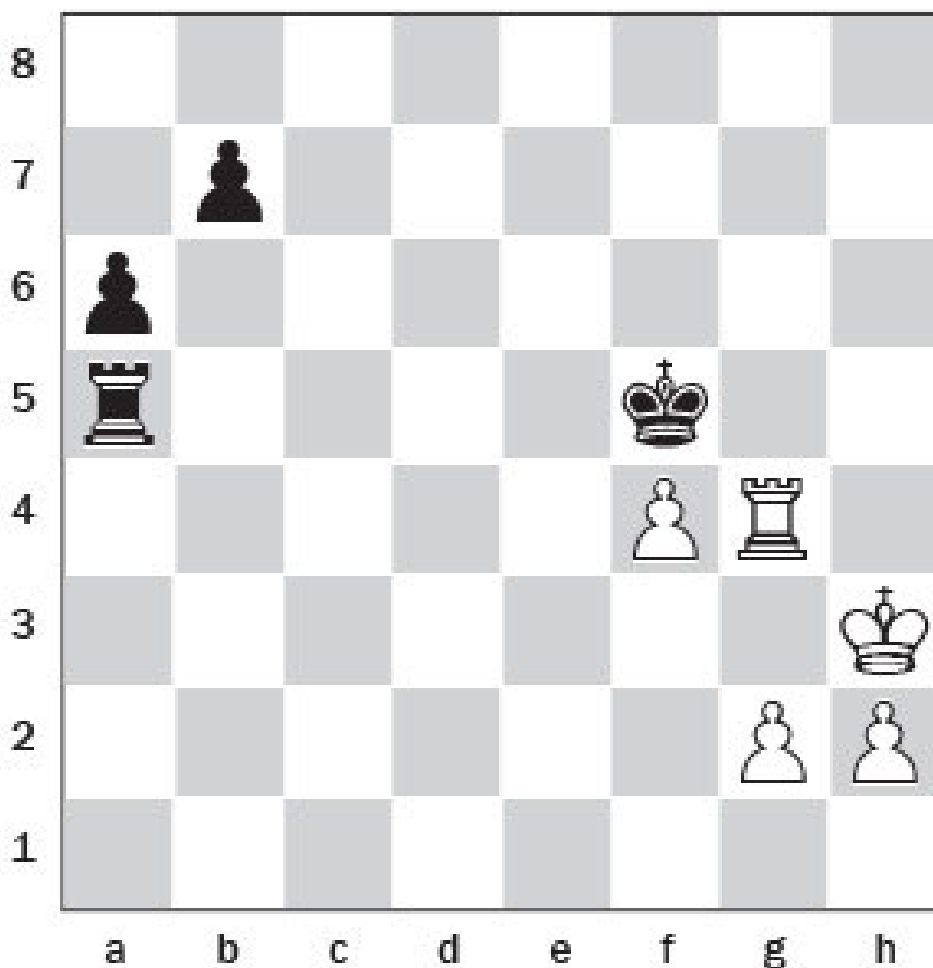
## HINT

Notice that the queen and the rook are on the same diagonal. Use a bishop skewer to win the rook.

# Skewer – Test

## Exercise 204

204



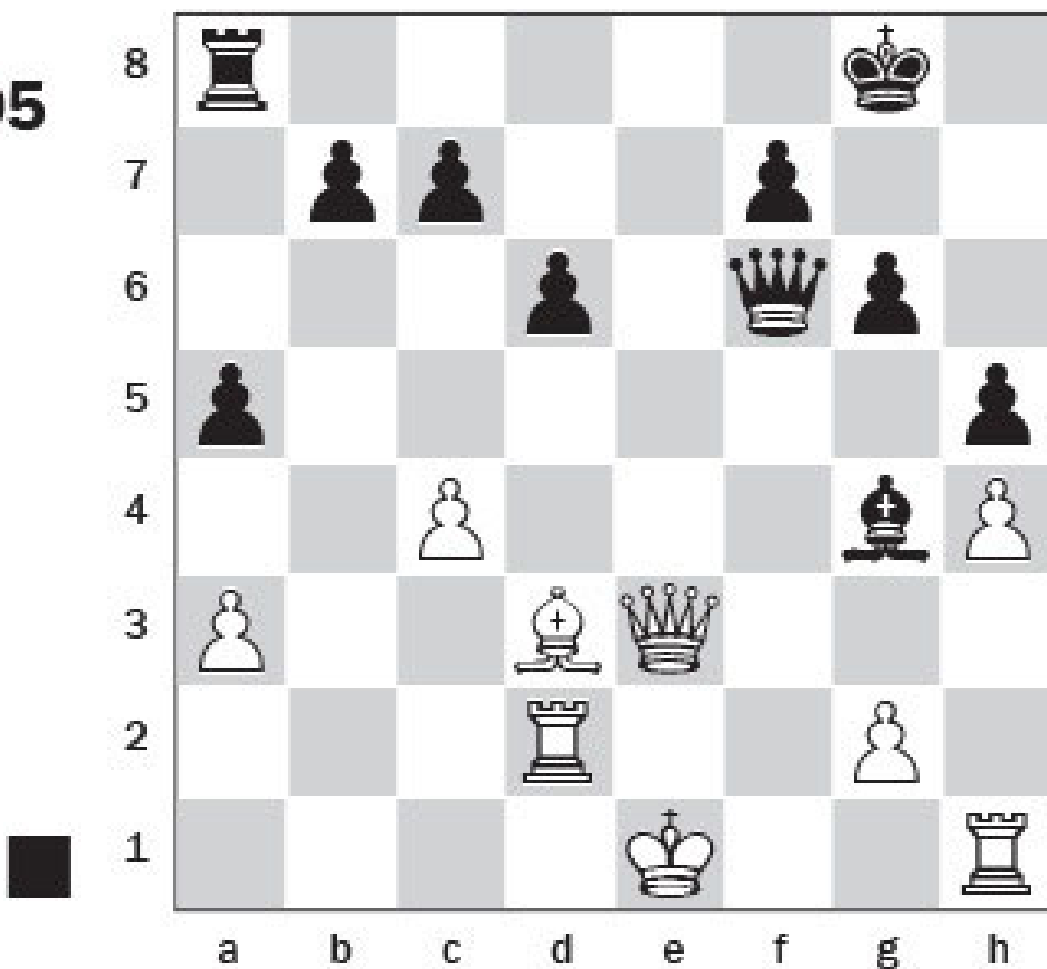
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 205

205



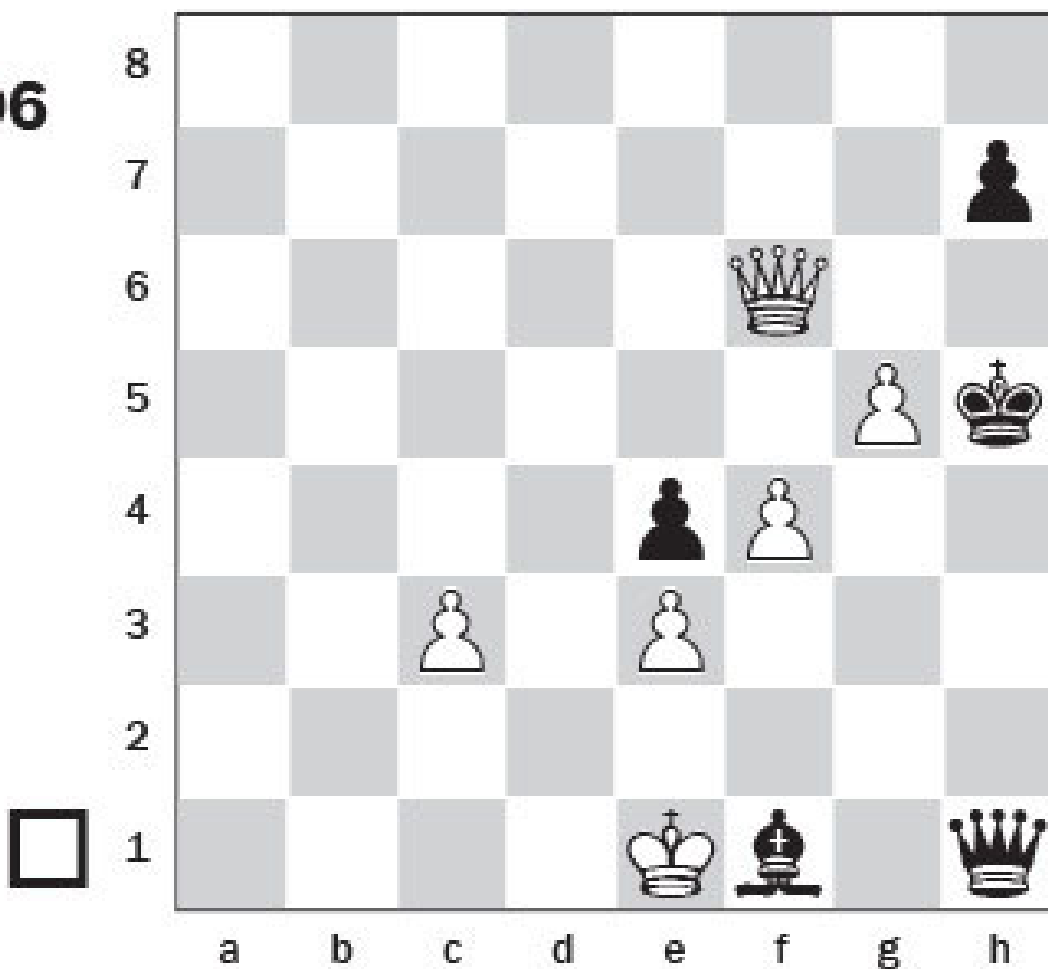
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 206

**206**



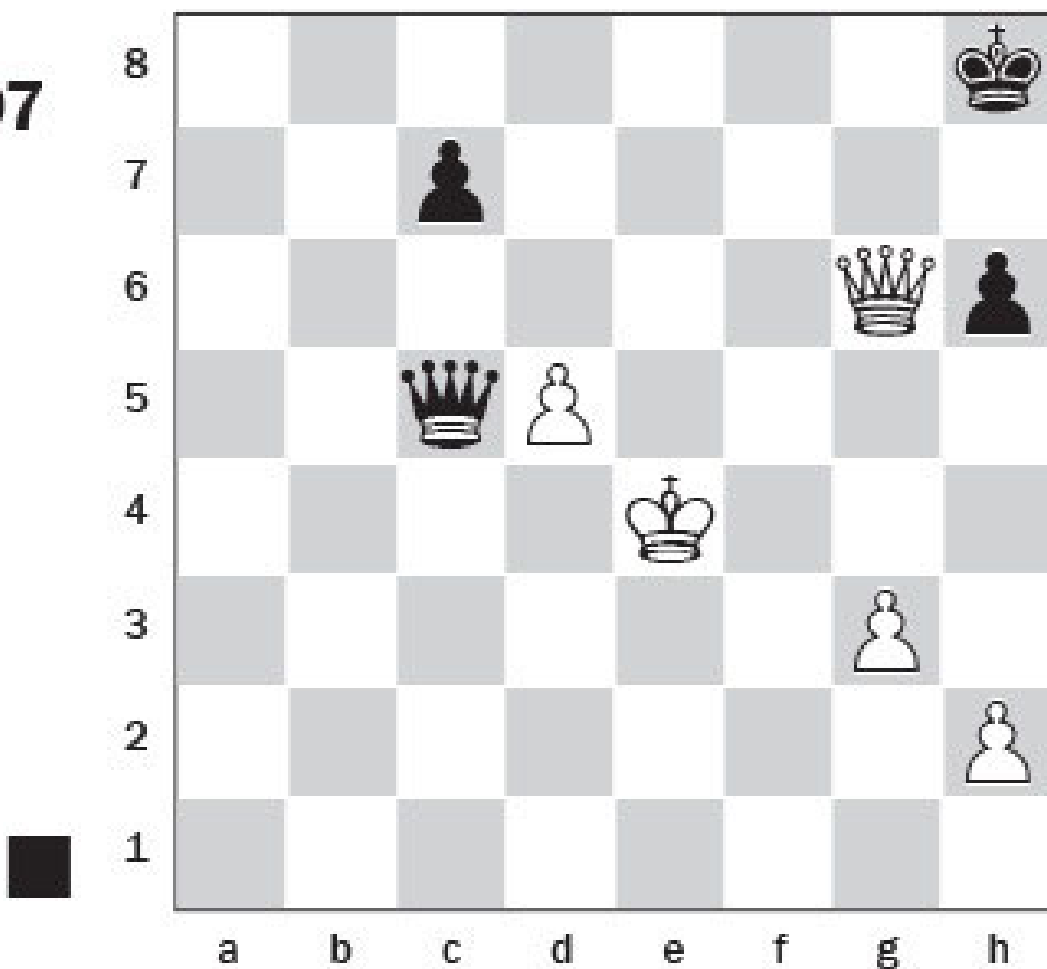
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 207

**207**



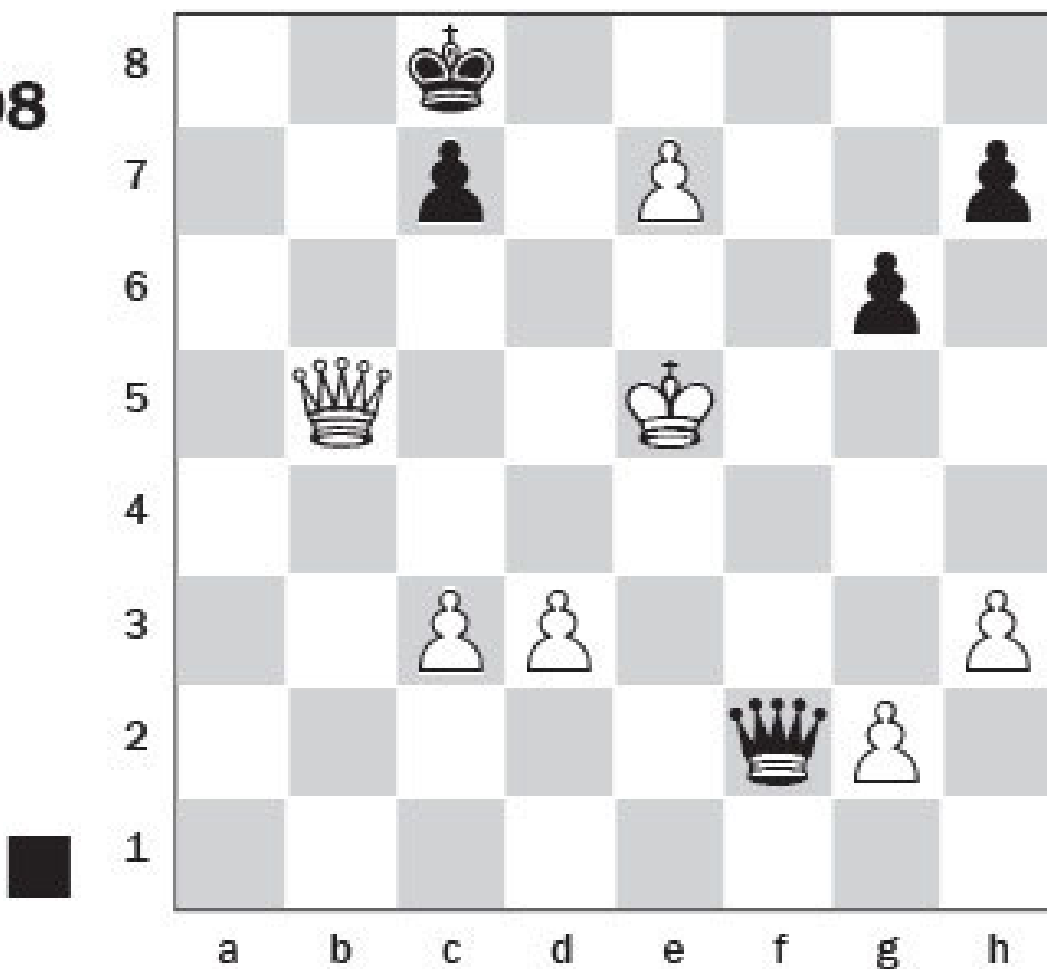
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 208

**208**



Answer:

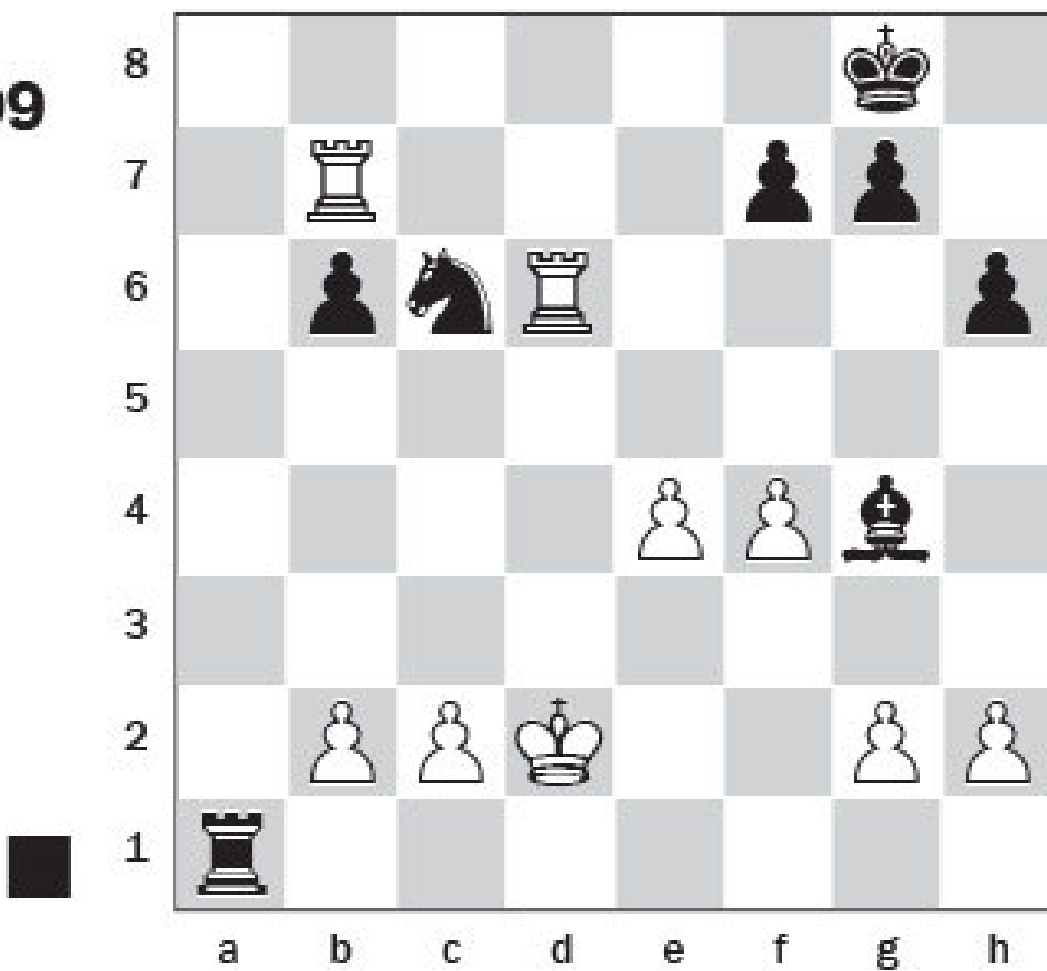
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 209

209



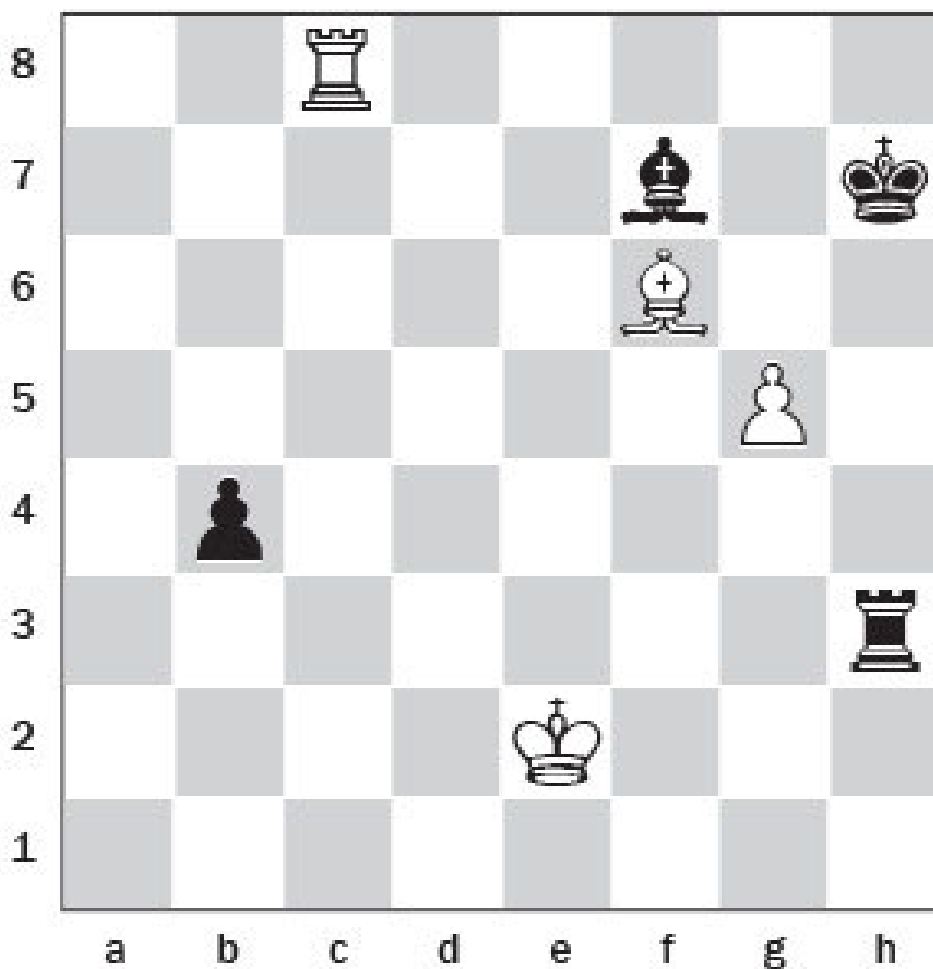
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 210

**210**



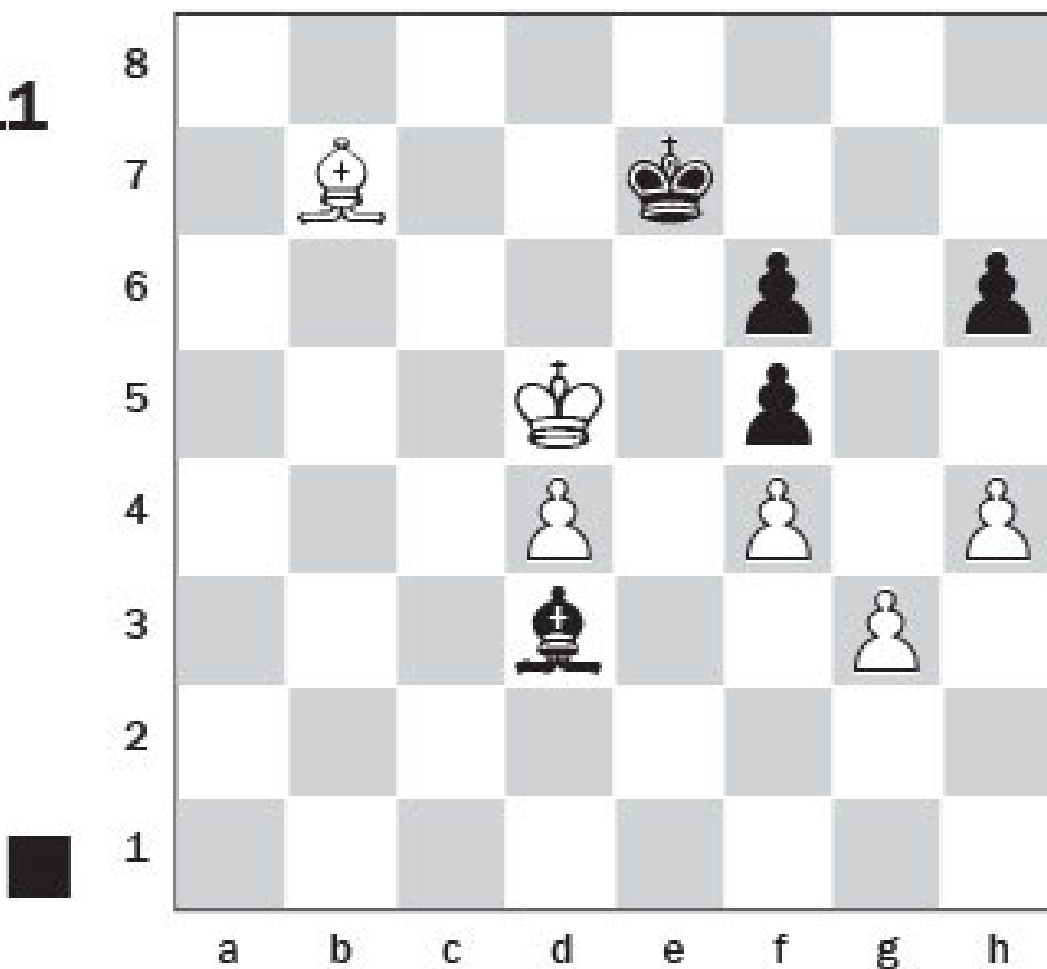
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 211

**211**



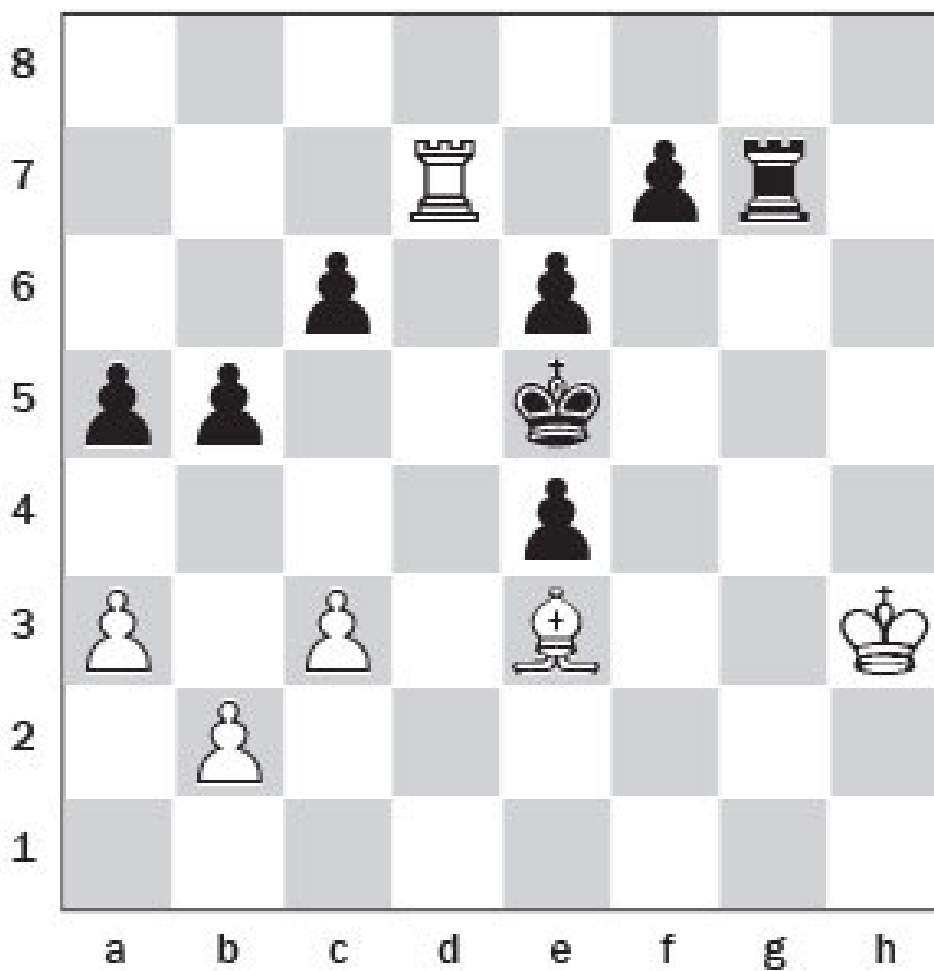
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 212

**212**



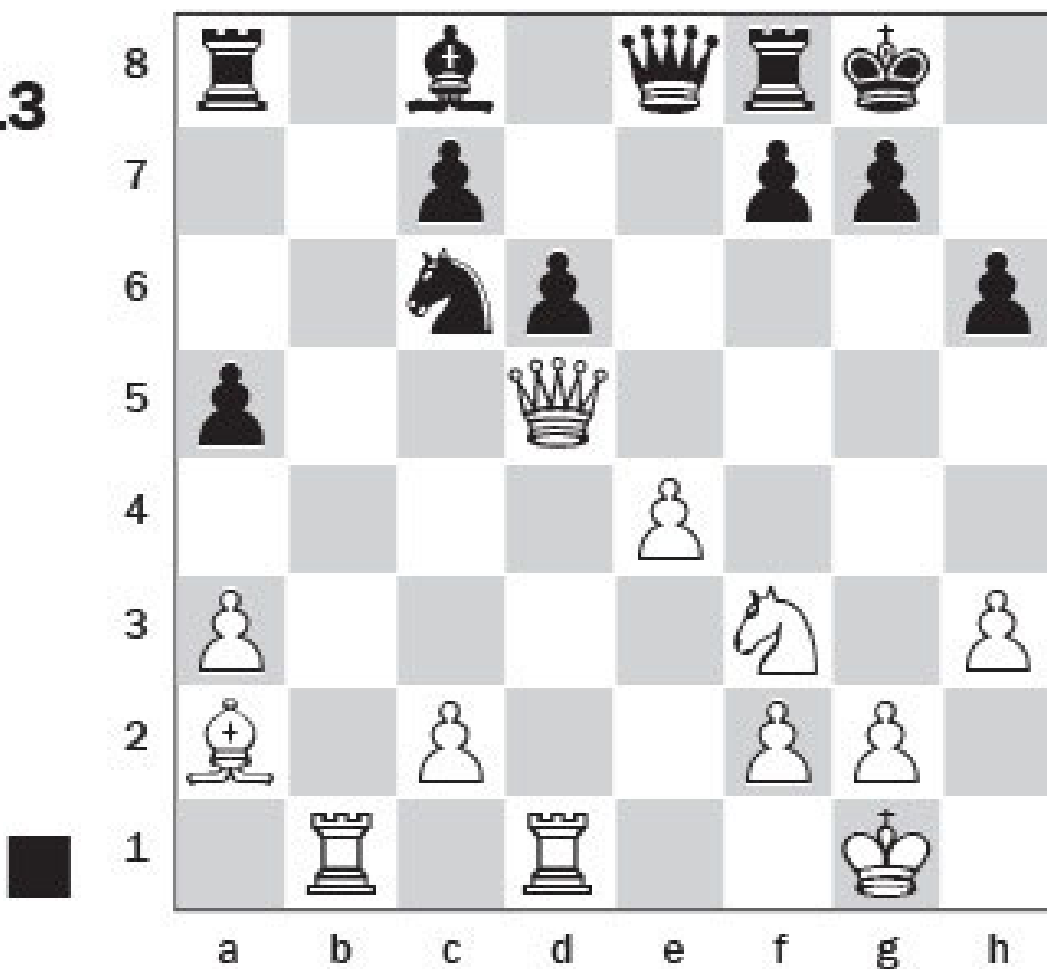
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 213

213



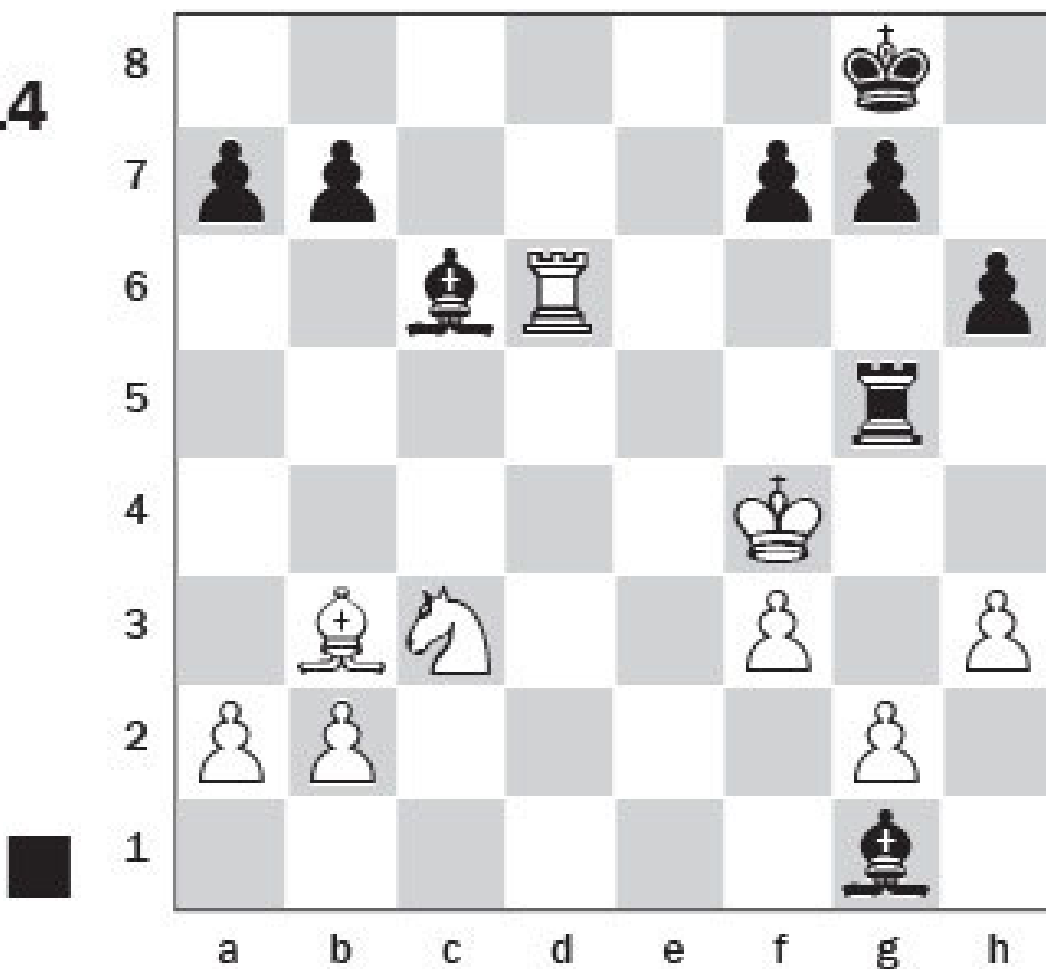
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 214

214



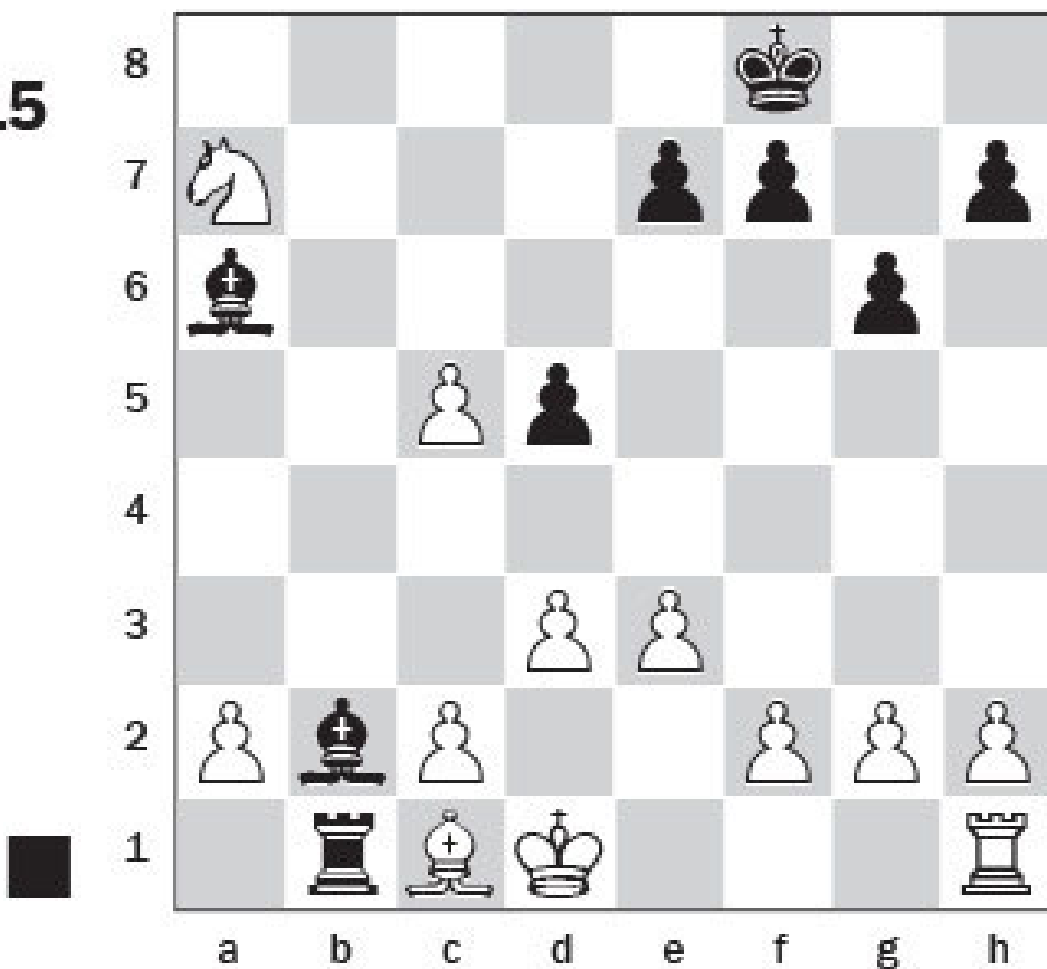
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 215

215



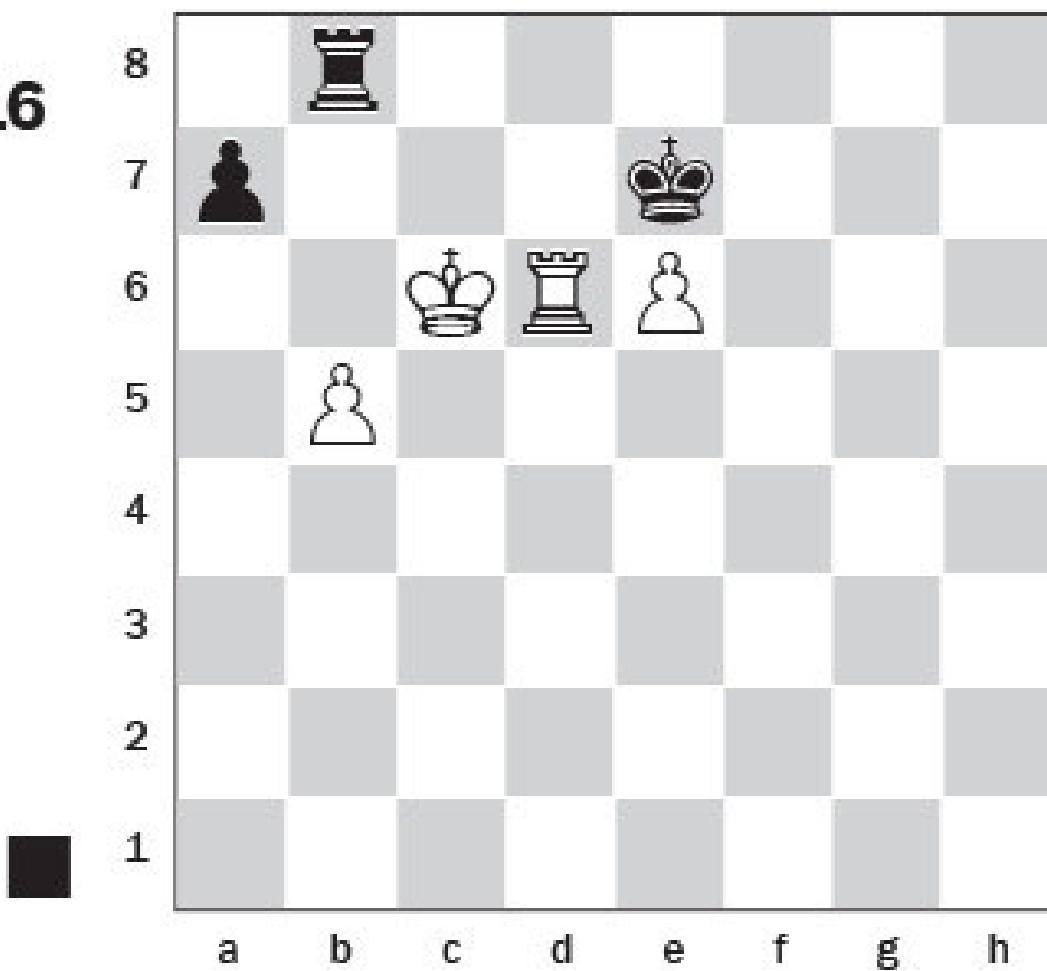
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 216

**216**



Answer:

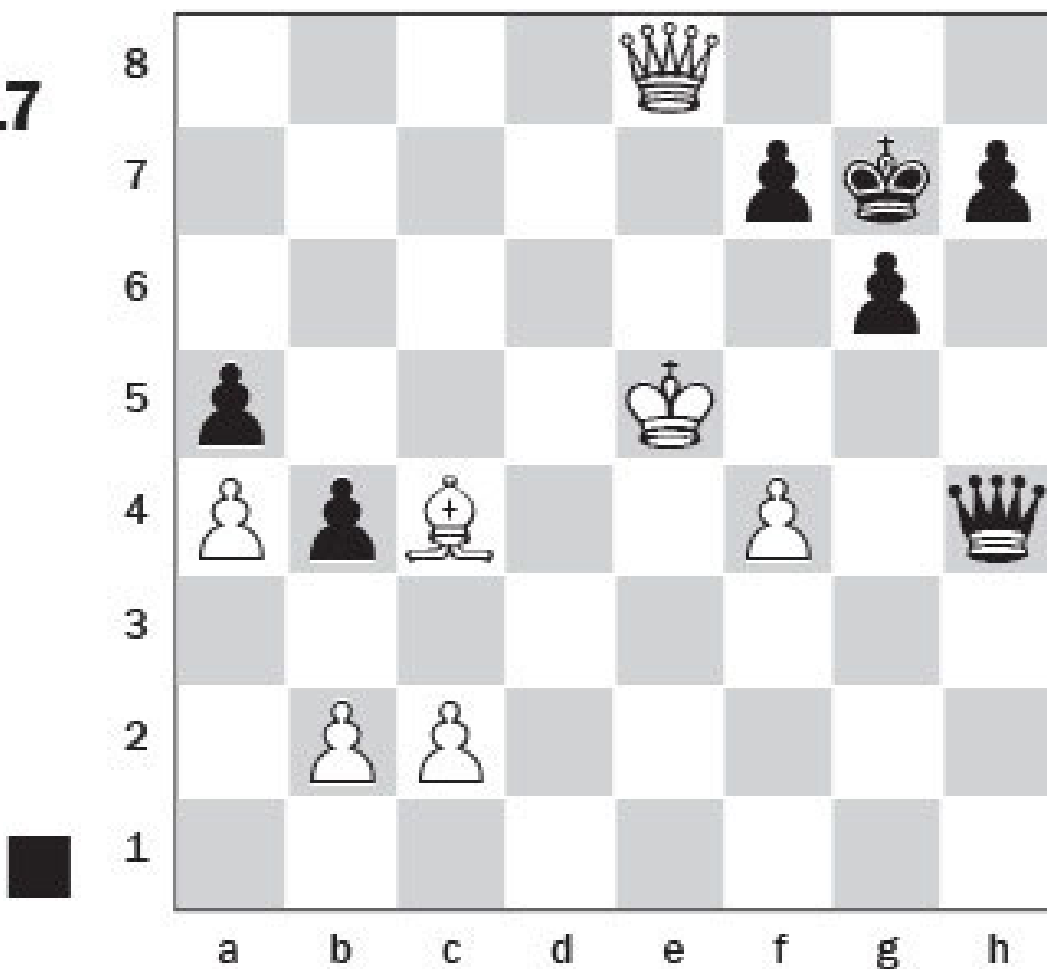
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 217

**217**



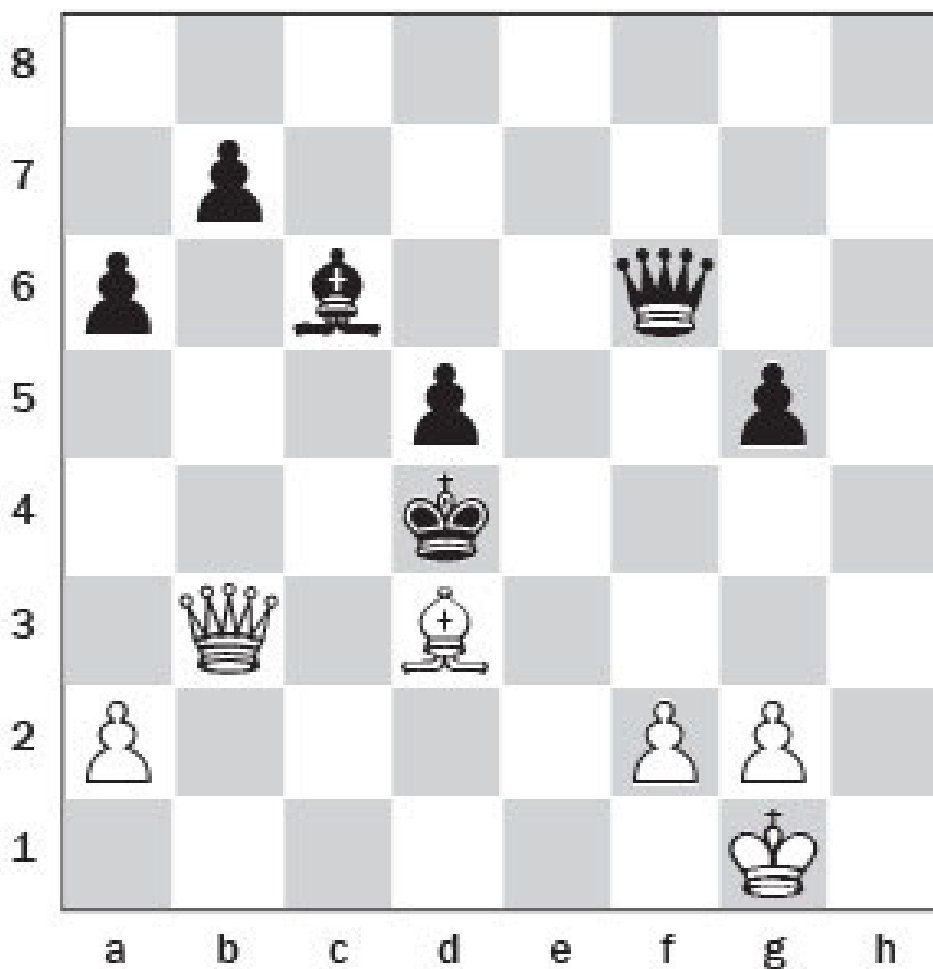
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 218

**218**



Answer:

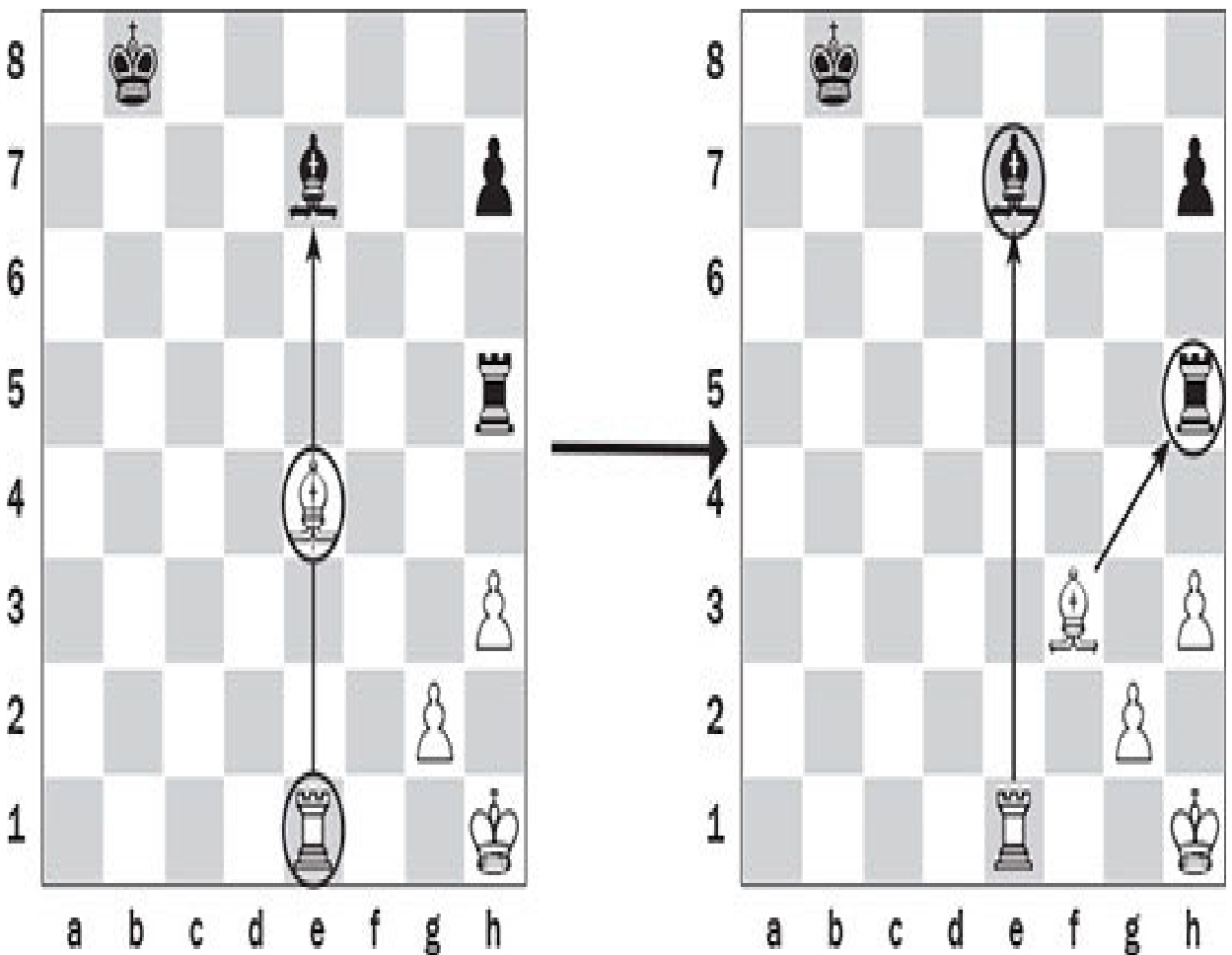
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 8

# Discovered Attack

A discovery or discovered attack, is when you move one of your pieces out of the way, revealing an attack from a different one of your pieces.



White's rook is aligned with the bishop on e7; only White's own bishop on e4 separates the rook from capturing the bishop on e7. Any move by the bishop on e4 would issue a discovered attack on the e7-bishop, but one is particularly strong:

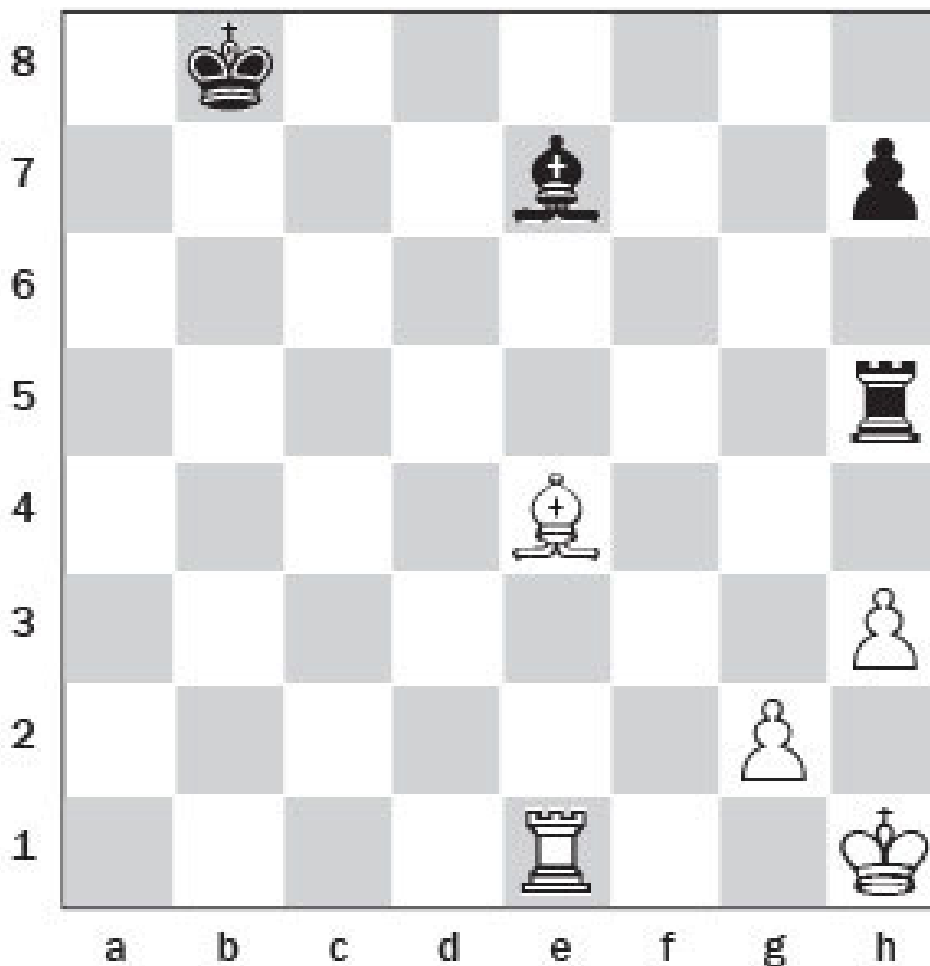
### **1.Bf3 (see diagram 2)**

White attacks both the bishop on e7, by discovery, and the rook on h5. In this position Black would be forced to lose either a bishop or a rook; in either case, White obtains a big advantage.

To better solve the puzzles, look for enemy pieces aligned on the same files, ranks, and diagonals, where only your own piece separates them.

# Discovered Attack – Guided Practice

Ex.



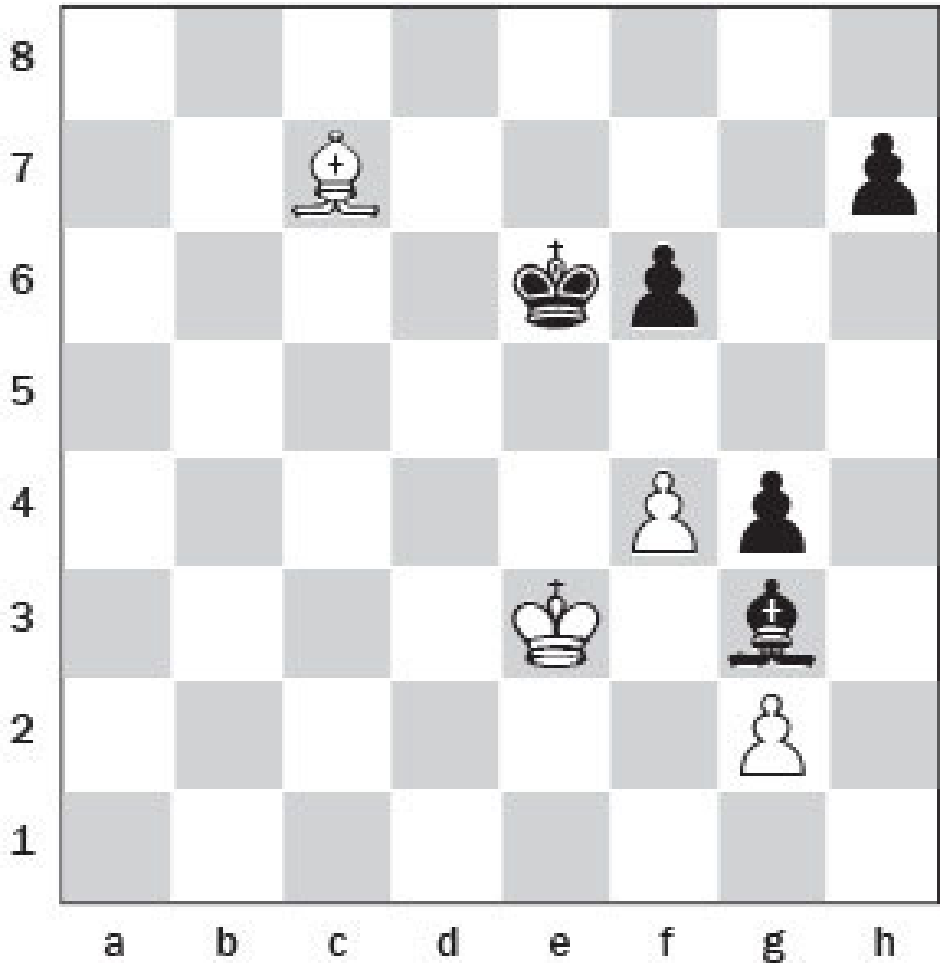
Answer:

1. Bf3 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 219

**219**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

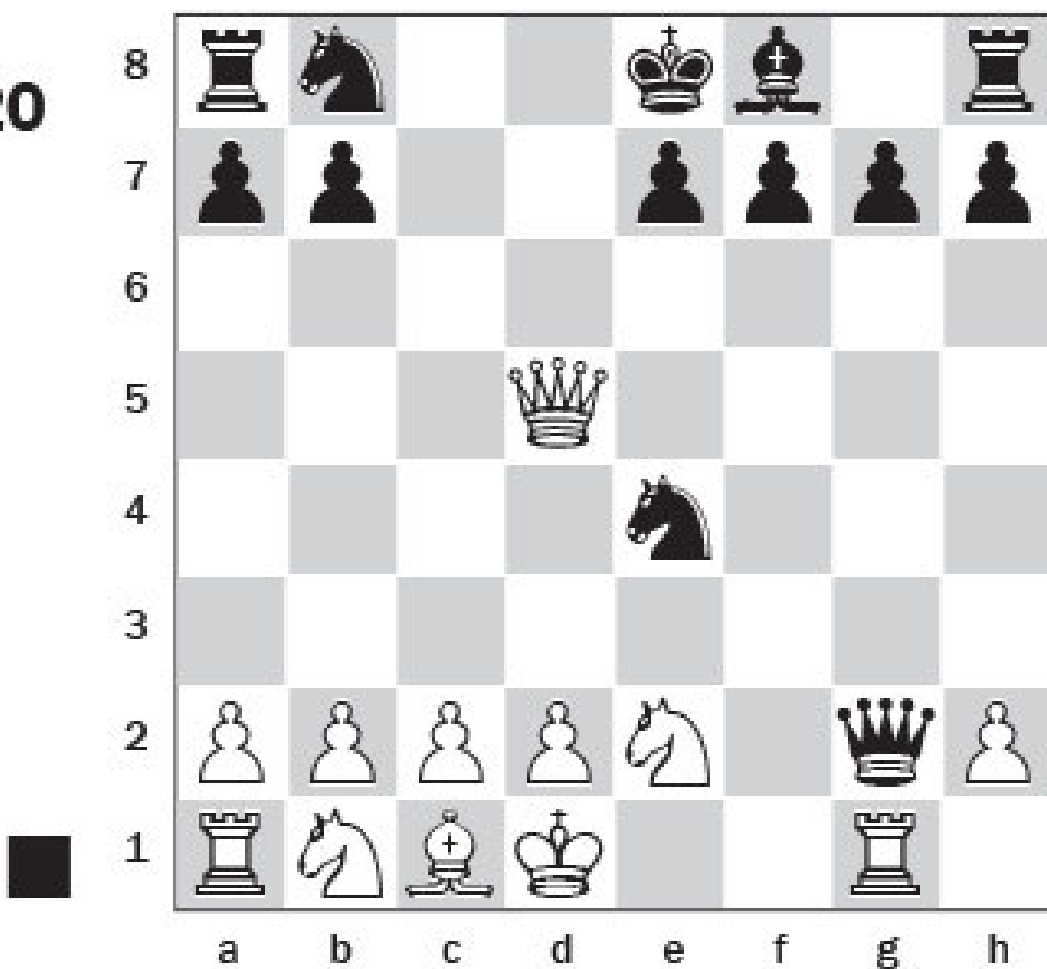
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's bishop on c7 is aligned with the bishop on g3; only the pawn separates them. Use a discovery to win Black's bishop.

### Exercise 220

220



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Only the knight on e4 separates the queens from each other. Notice that White's queen on d5 is unprotected.

### **Exercise 221**

221



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

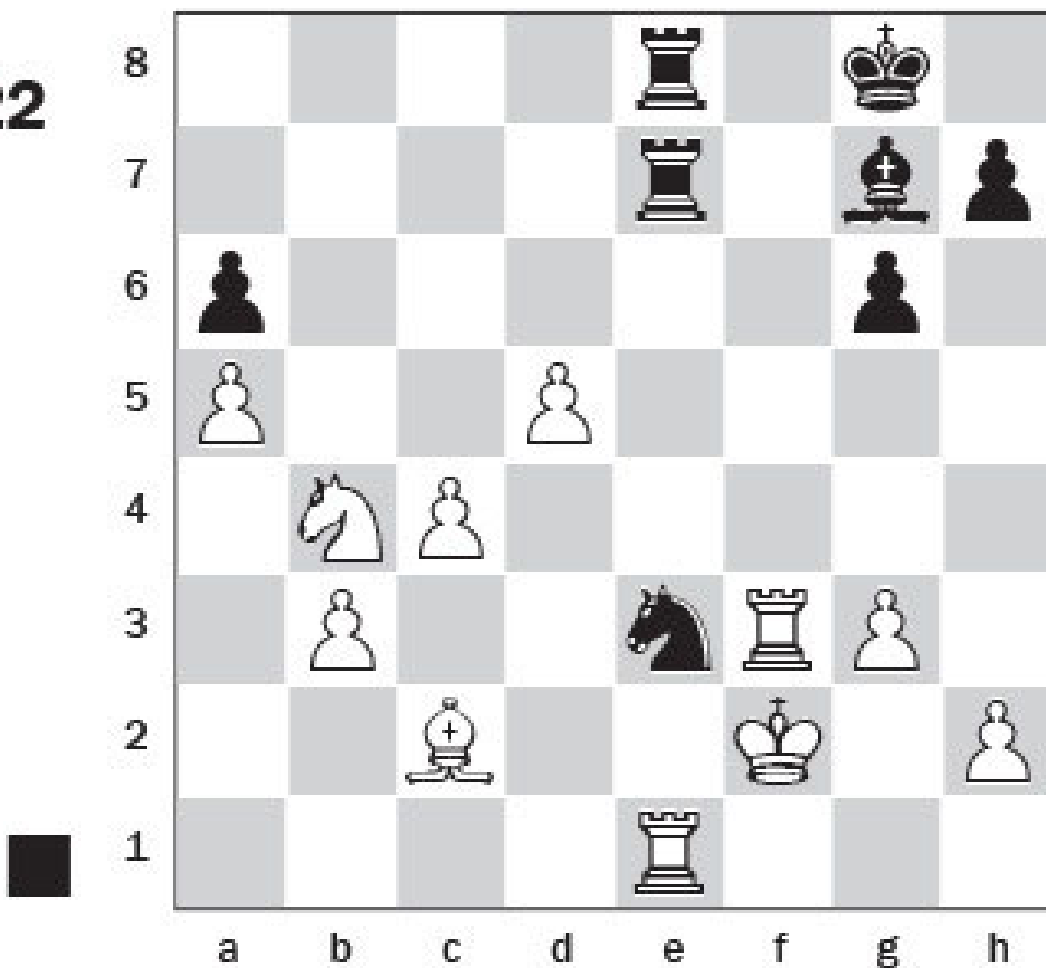
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

This move saves Black's queen and creates a discovered attack from the bishop on e7.

### Exercise 222

222



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

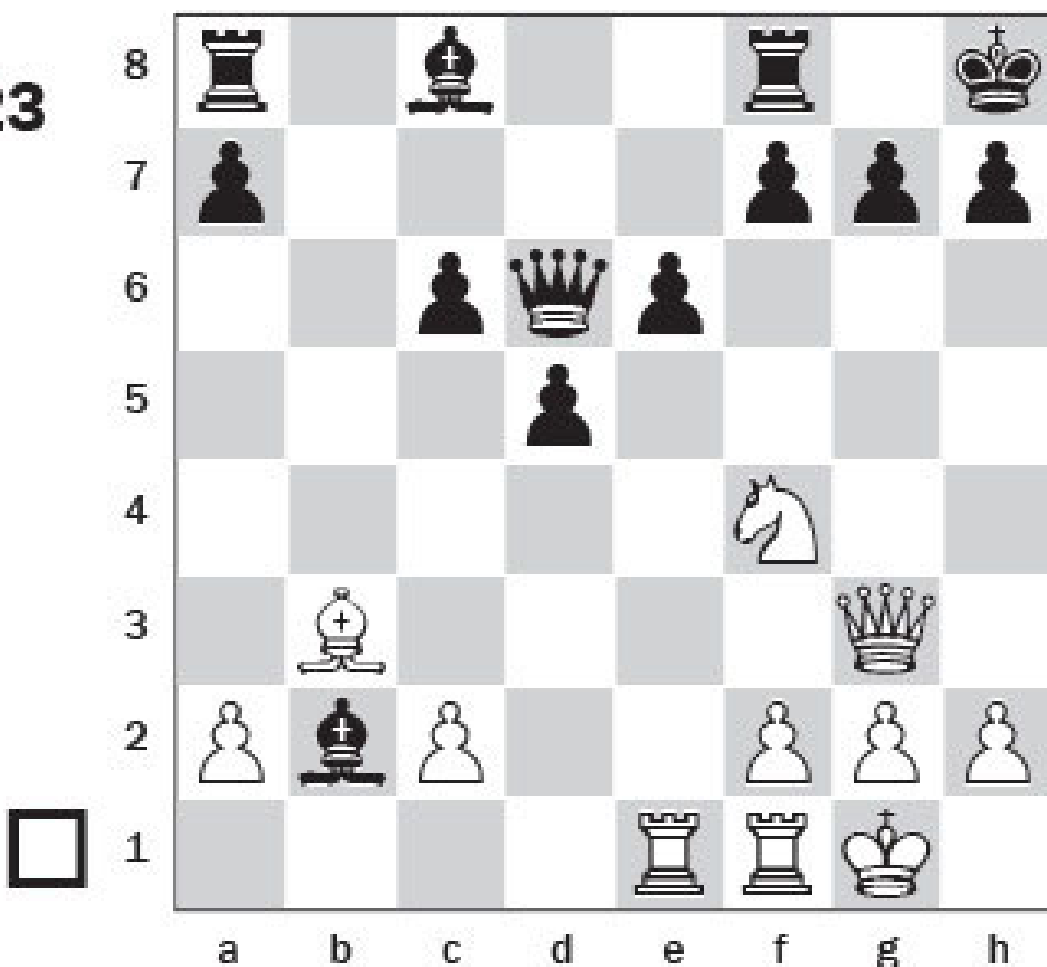
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black has a battery lined up on the e-file. The rook on e1 is not very well protected. How can Black use a discovery to win a rook?

### Exercise 223

223



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

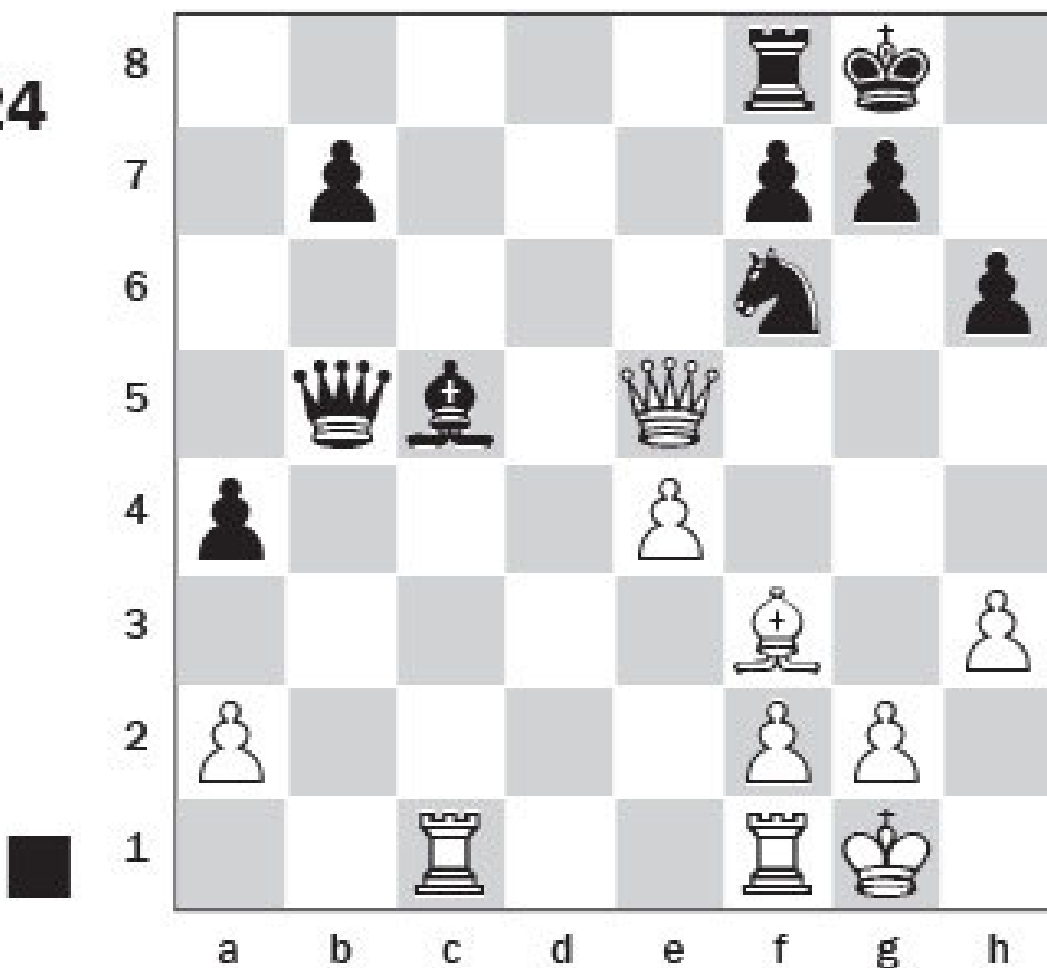
## HINT

The queen on g3 has its eyes on Black's queen on d6. Give away your knight to win the queen on d6.

# Discovered Attack – Test

## Exercise 224

224



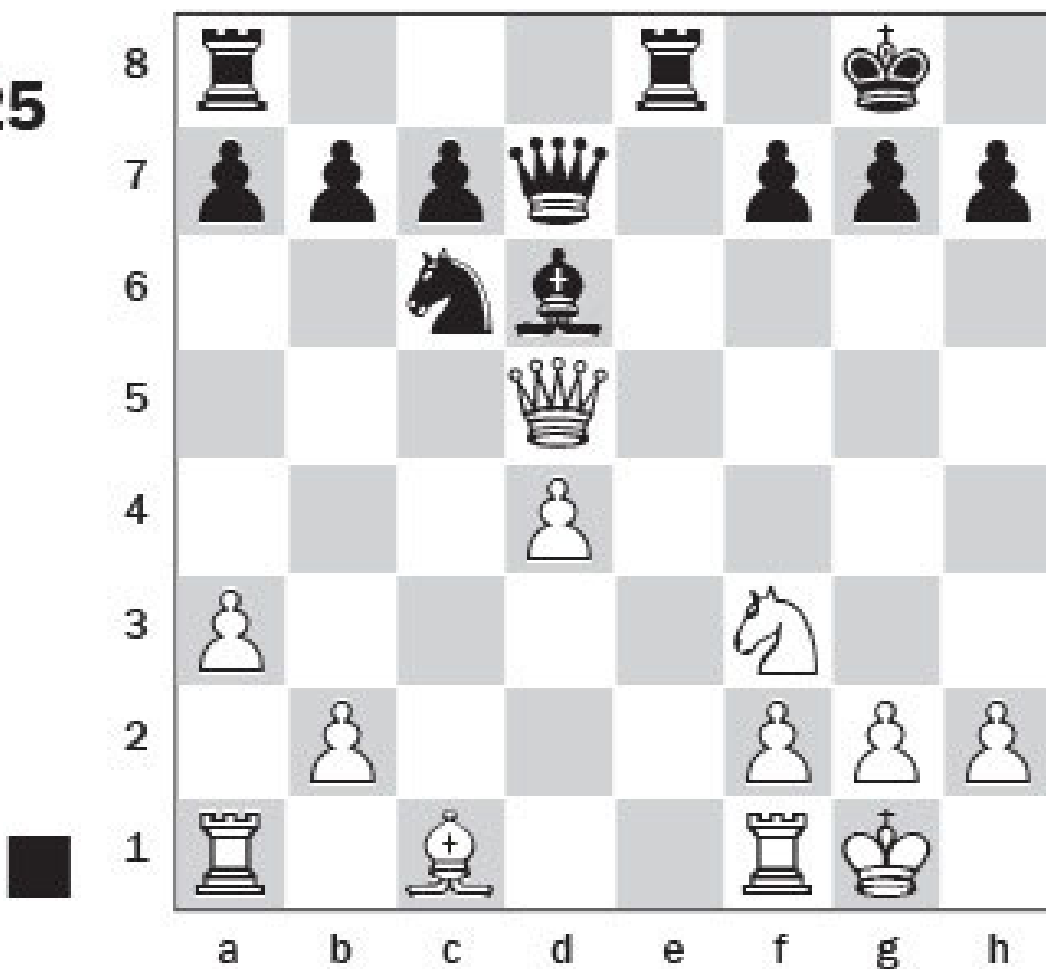
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 225

225



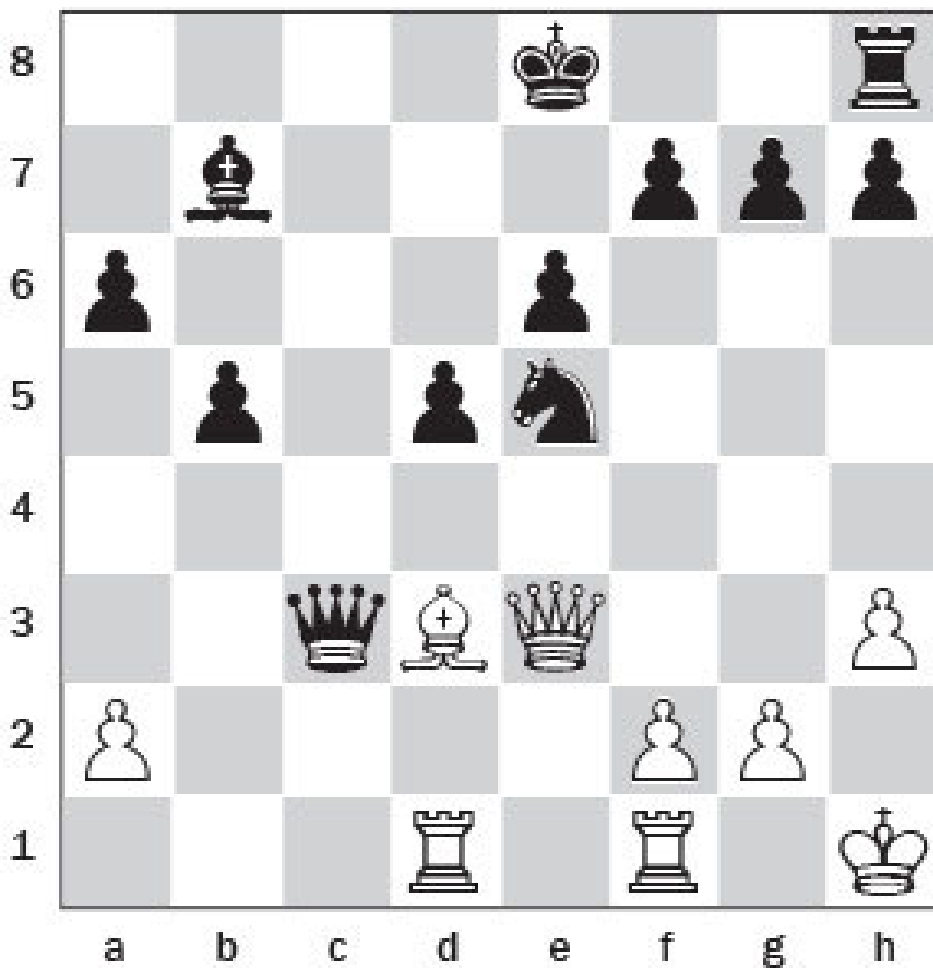
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 226

226



**Answer:**

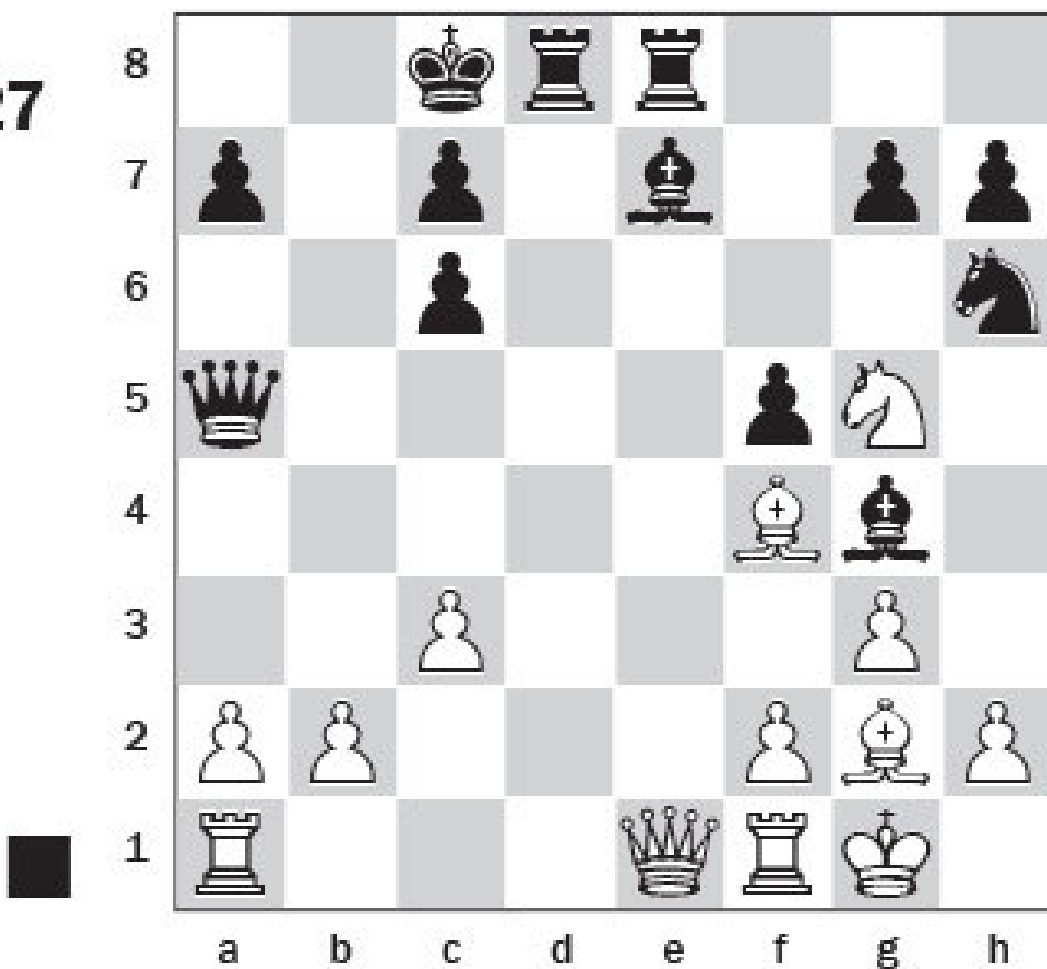
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 227

227



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 228

228



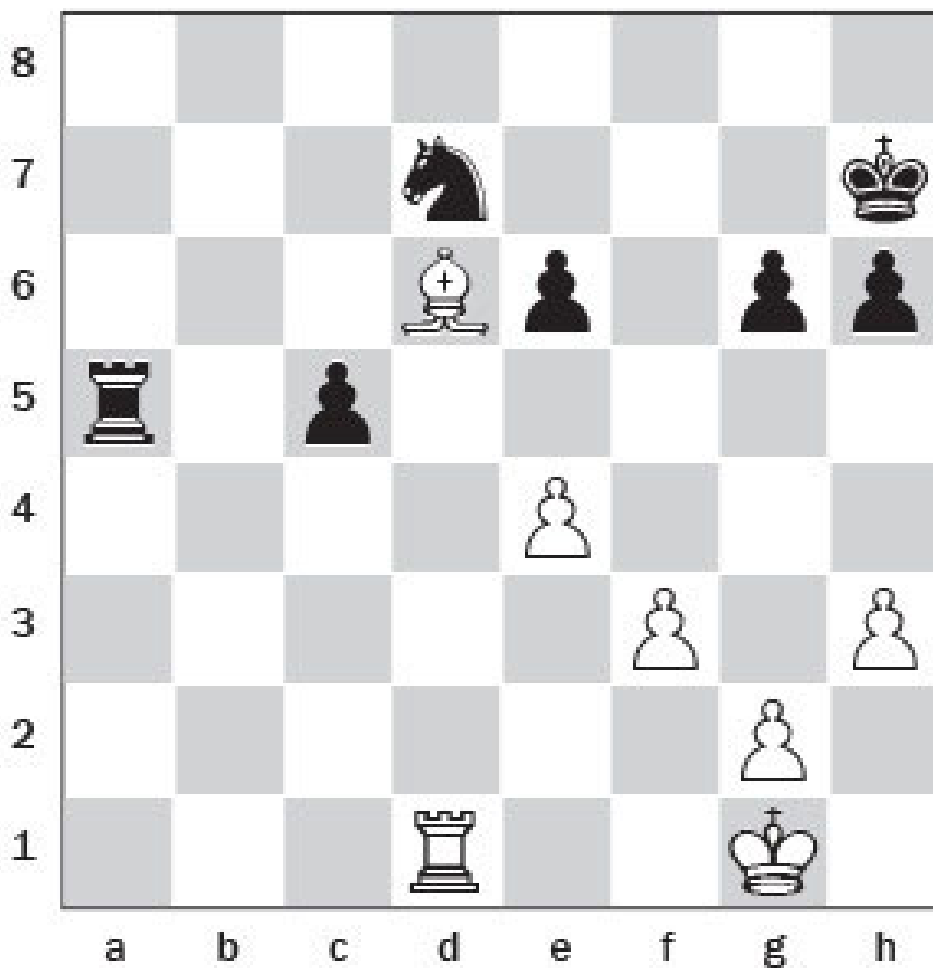
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 229

229



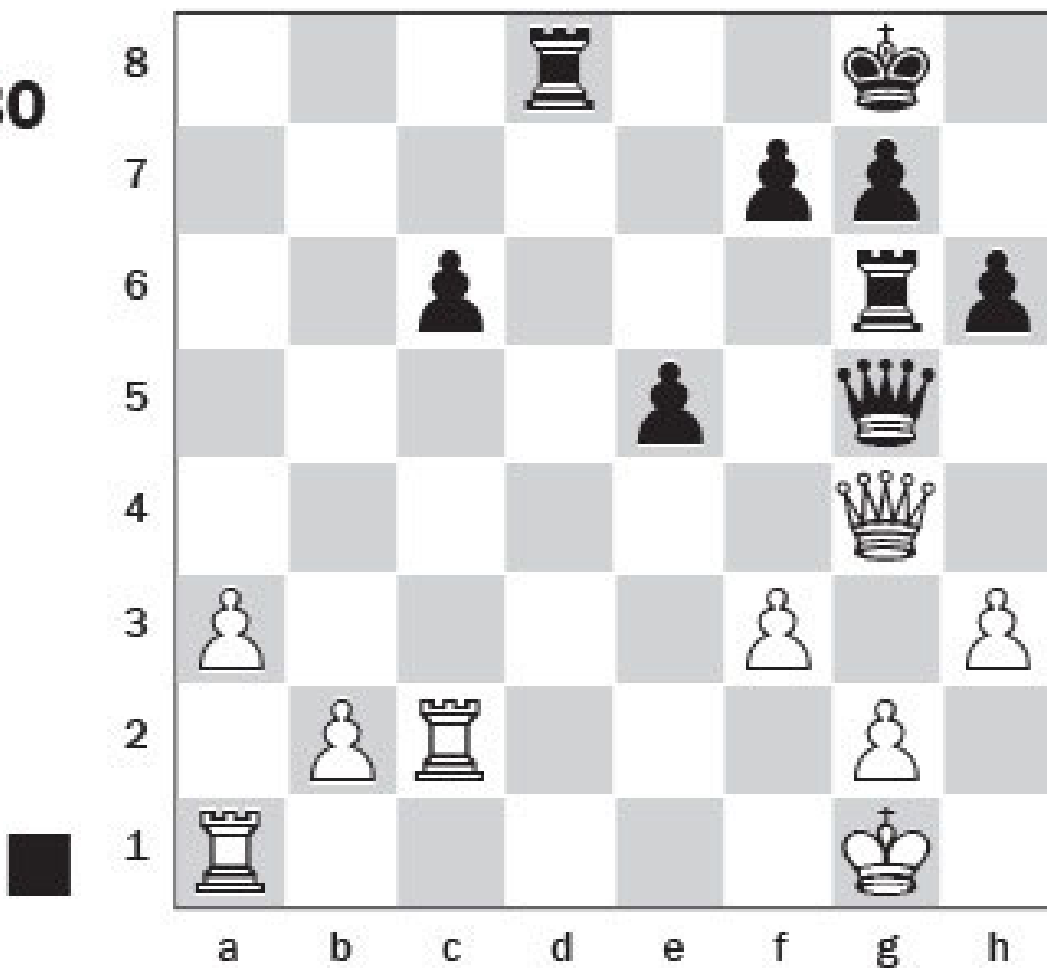
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 230

230



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 231

231



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 232

232



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 233

233



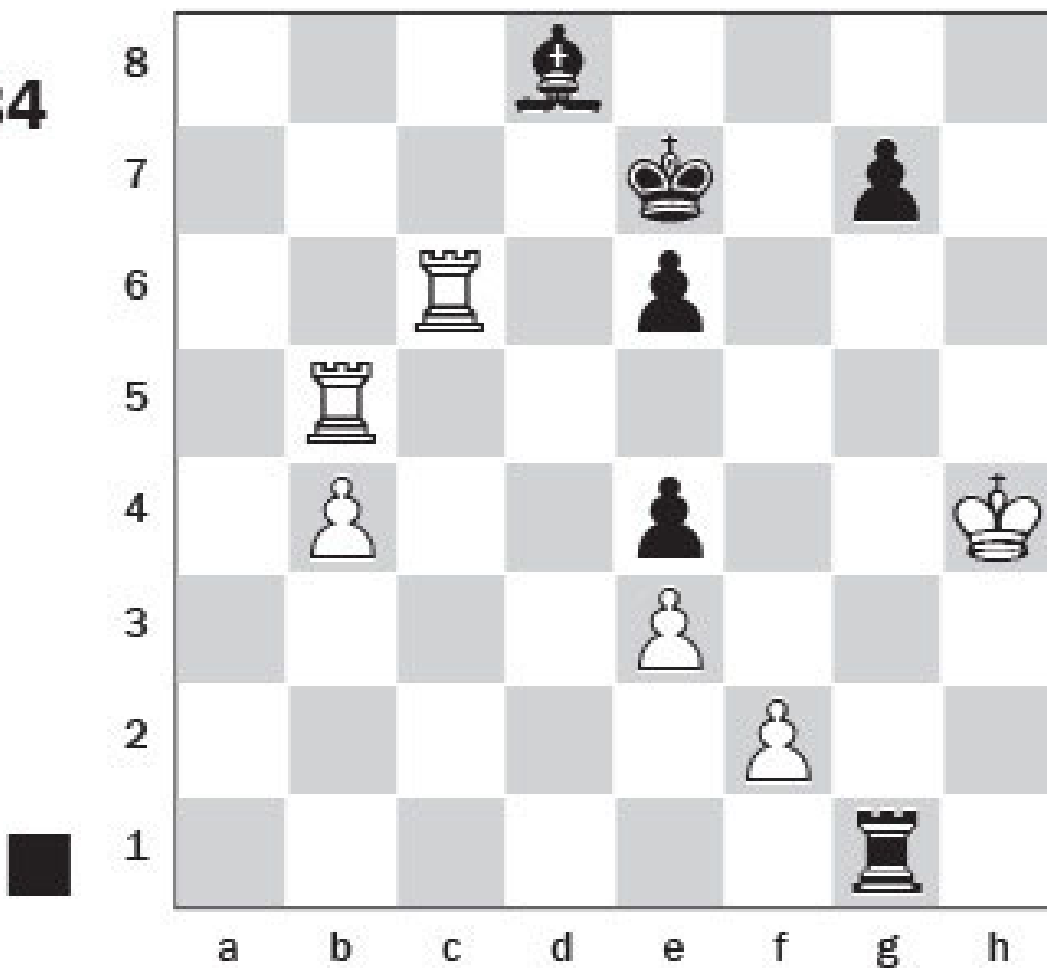
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 234

234



Answer:

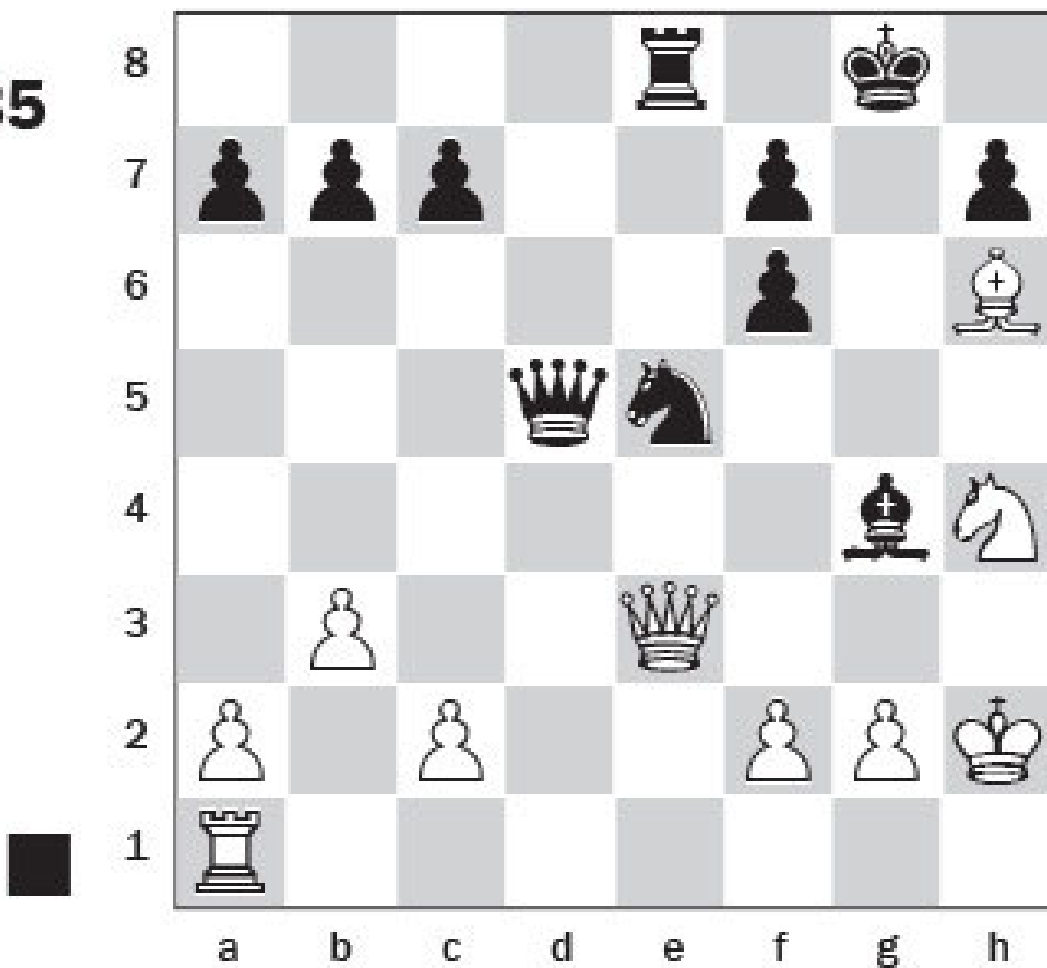
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



## Exercise 235

235



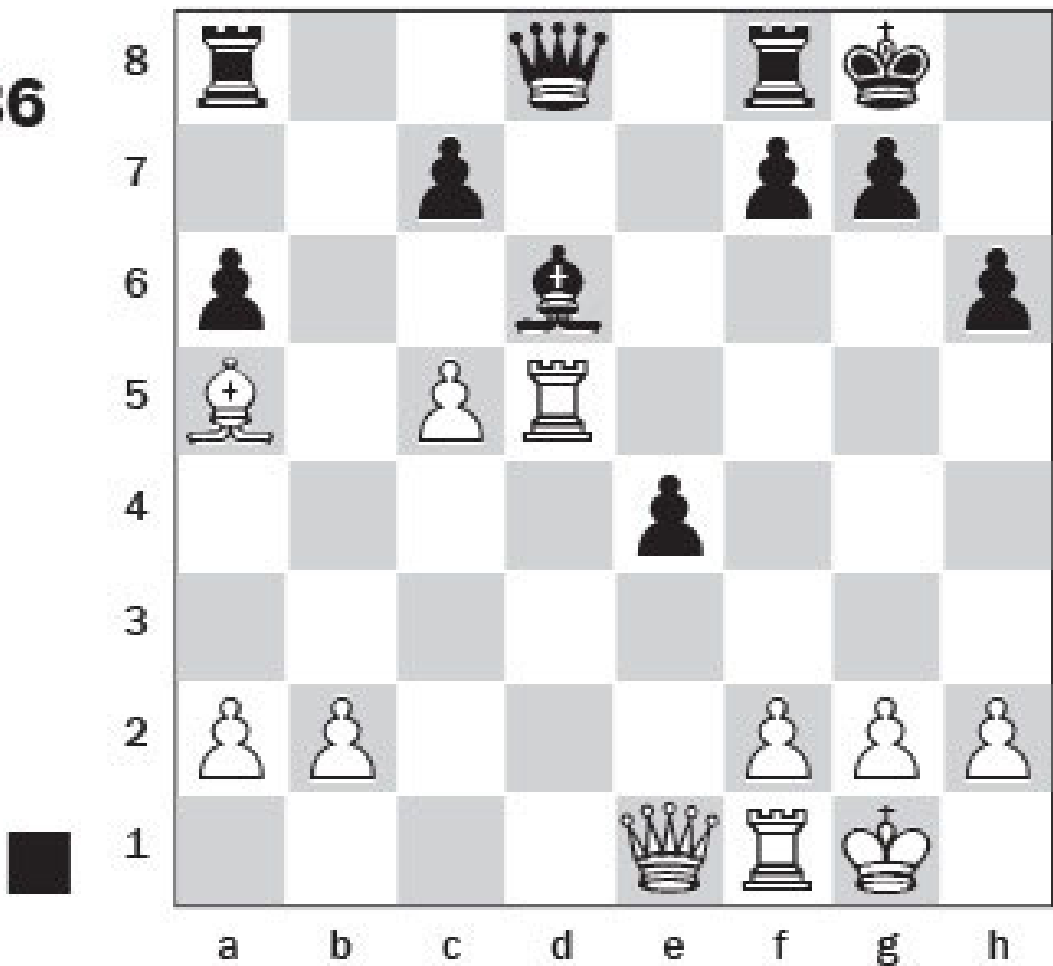
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 236

236



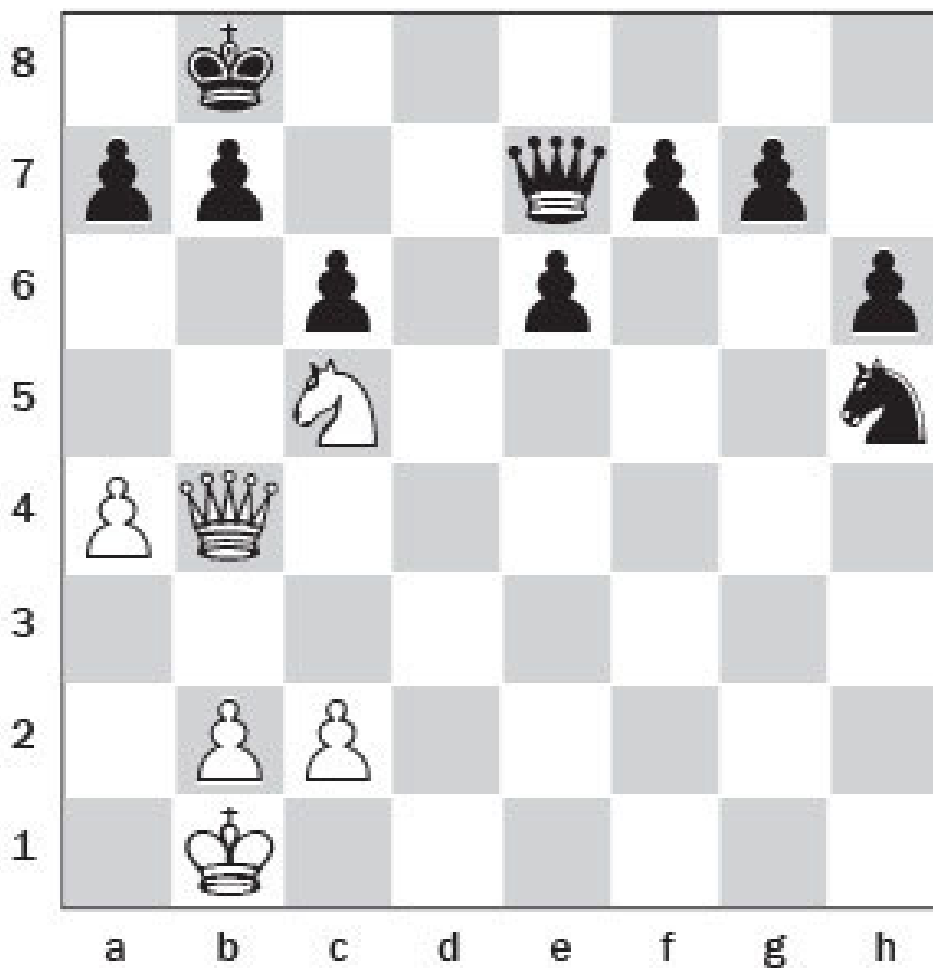
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 237

237



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 238

238



Answer:

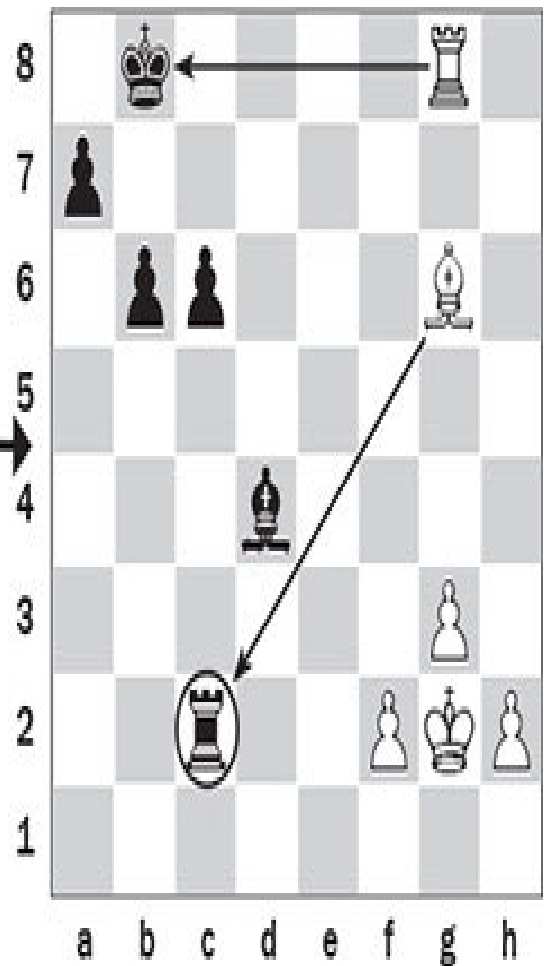
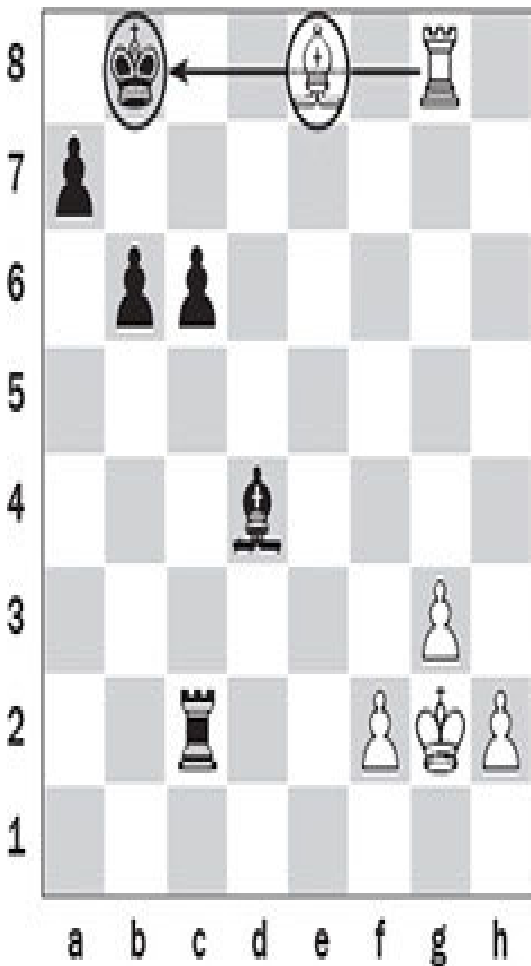
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 9

# Discovered Check and Double Check

Discovered check is a tactical theme based on a discovery. A discovered check occurs when the discovery yields a check to the enemy king.



The rook on g8 is aligned with the enemy king on b8. White could move the bishop anywhere and issue a discovered check; however one of the moves is particularly strong:

### **1.Bg6+ (see diagram 2)**

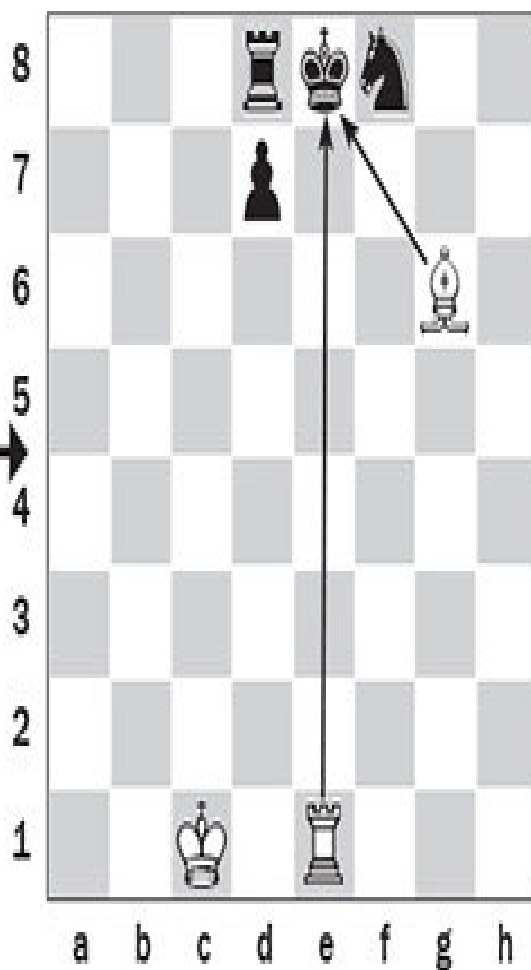
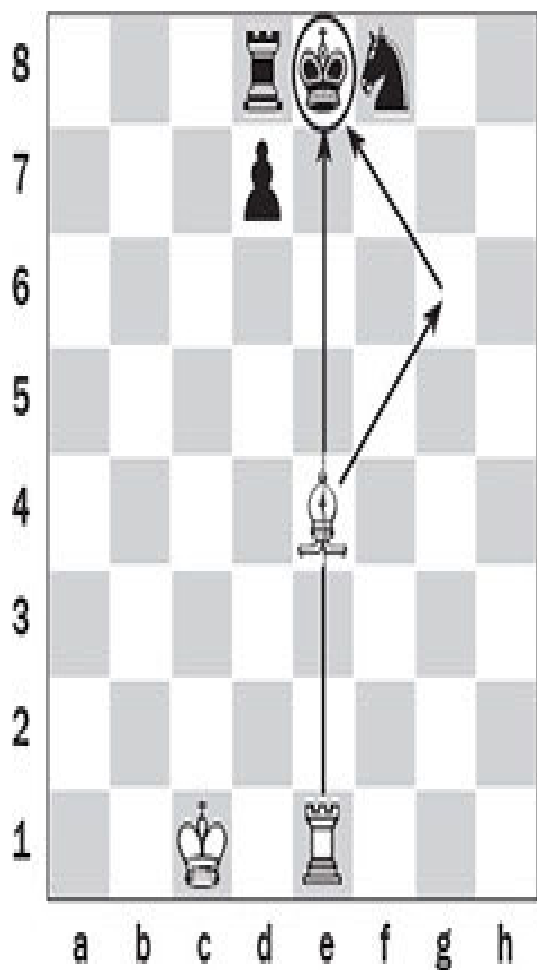
White's rook issues the discovered check to the king, while the bishop attacks the rook on c2. Black must get out of the check and then loses the rook on c2. Other discovered checks were possible, but remember that the objective of a tactic is to gain the maximum advantage possible!

### **1...Kb7 2.Bxc2**

Discovered checks are very powerful. When a discovery creates a check to the king, the piece moving out of the way can move virtually anywhere safely. In order to better solve the problems in this chapter, look for your pieces that are aligned with the enemy king.

### **Double Check**

Double check is when a player uses a discovery to place the opponent in check by two different pieces. Double checks are extremely powerful moves, since when the king is in check by two different pieces, the king **MUST** move.



Notice that White's rook is aligned with the black king. White now has the ability to place Black into check, twice!

The best move for White is 1.Bg6# (see diagram 2).

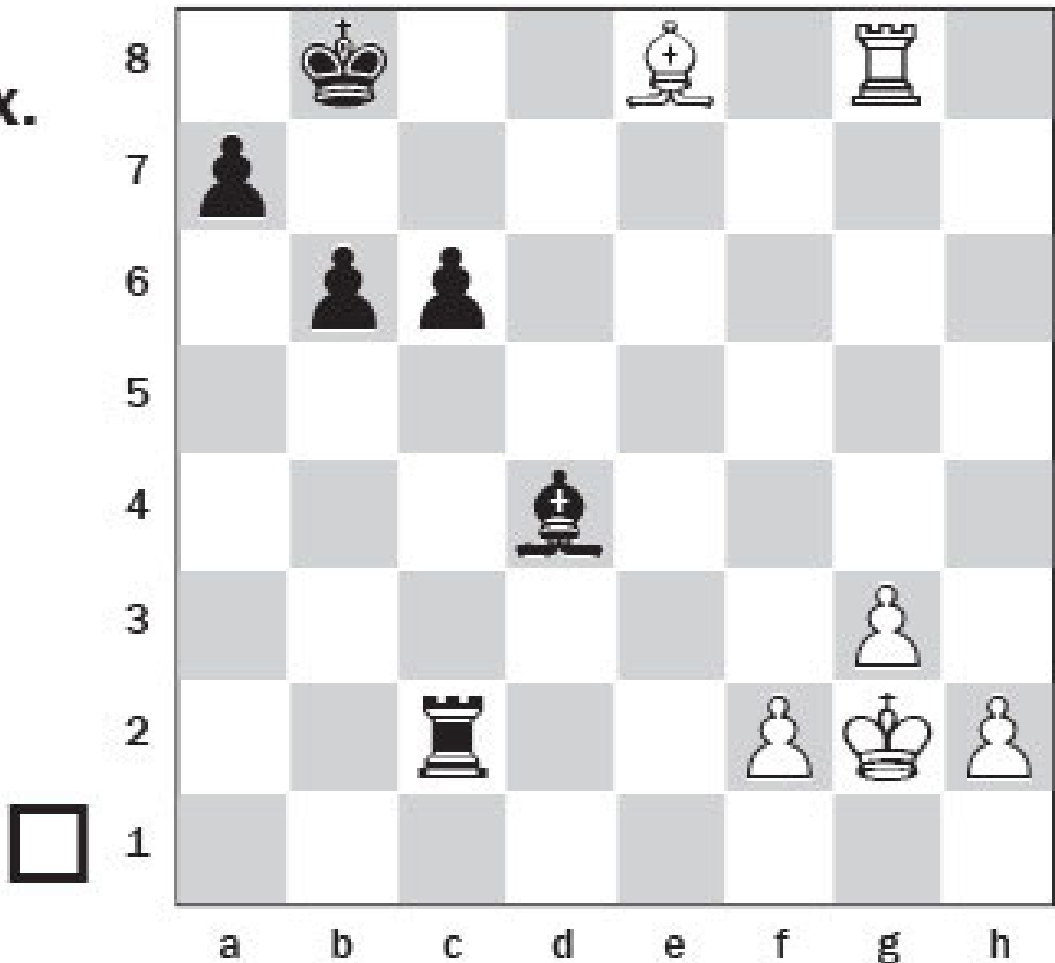
Now both the rook and the bishop attack the king. Notice that the knight on f8 can not both block the rook and capture the bishop. On top of that the king has no safe place to move. Double checks are important to spot in your own games. Later in the book, we will use double checks for checkmates and combinations in two moves or

more. To better solve the double check problems, look for both discovered attacks and checks.



# Discovered Check – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

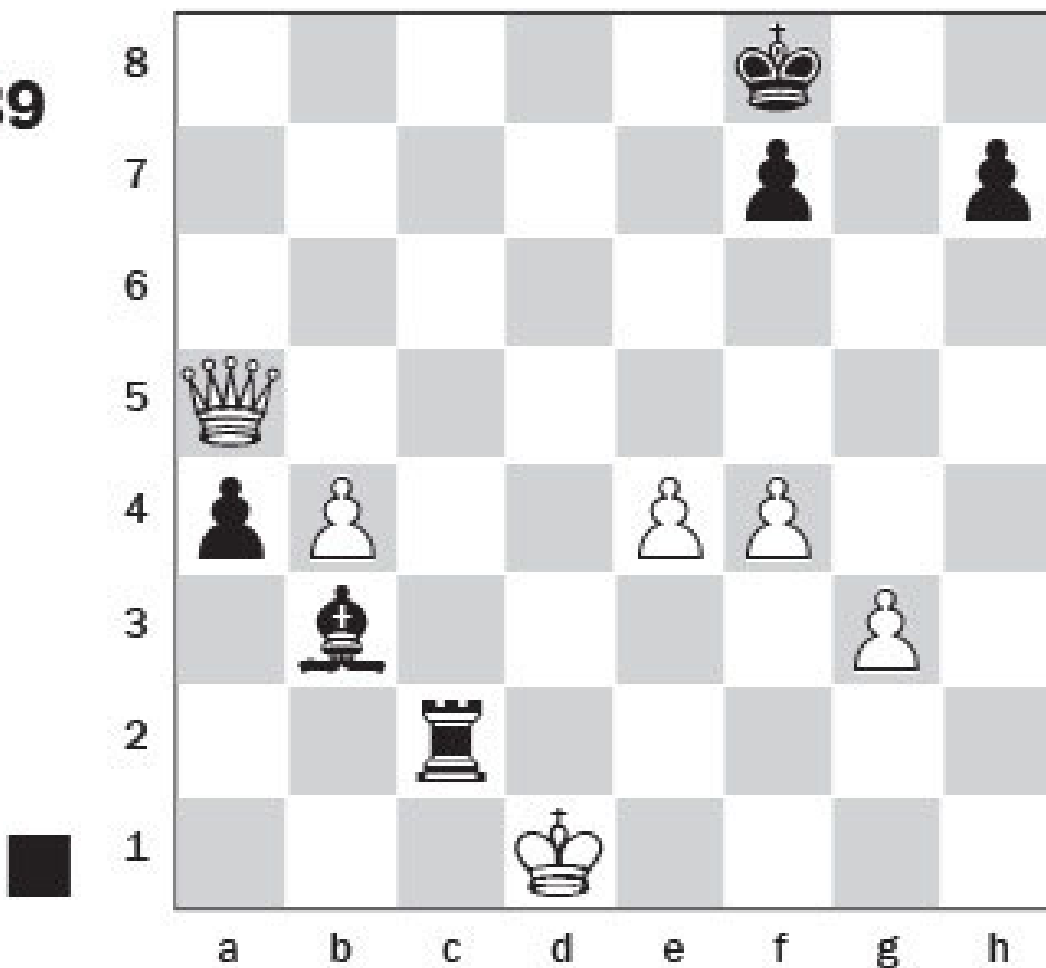
1. Bg6+ Kb7

2. Bxc2 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

**Exercise 239**

**239**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

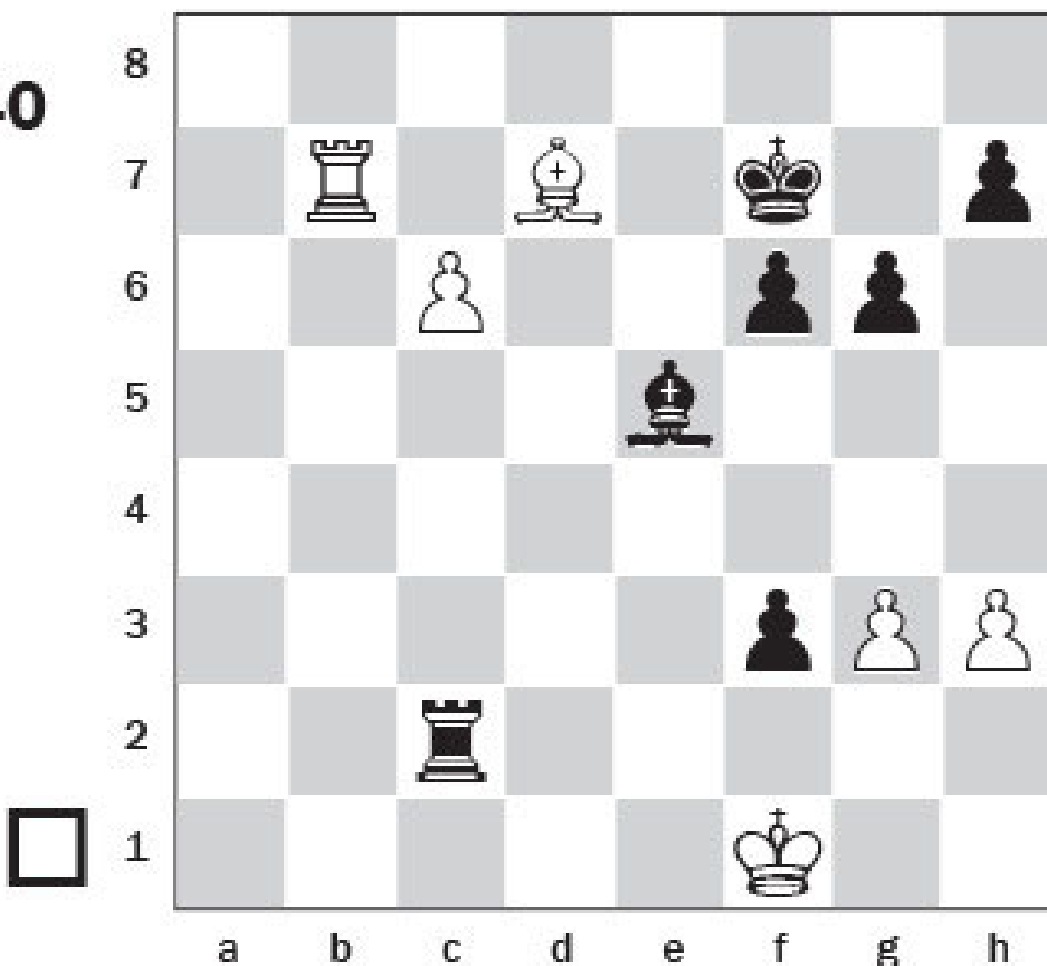
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black could move the rook anywhere and put White in check. Use the discovered check to win White's queen.

### Exercise 240

**240**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

White's rook is lined up with Black's king. Win a rook by using a discovered check.

### [Exercise 241](#)

241



8  
7  
6  
5  
4  
3  
2  
1



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

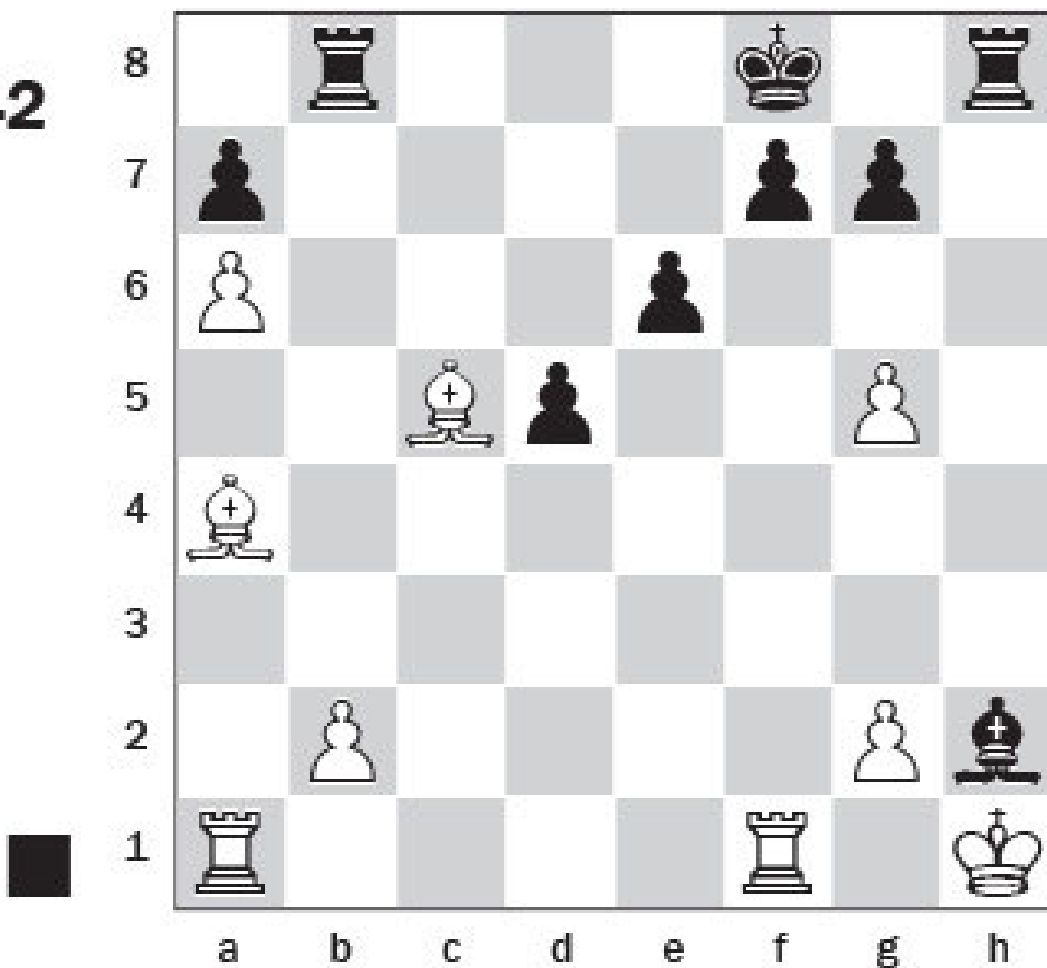
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

White is attacking Black's bishop on e2. How can Black both block the attack and win White's rook?

### Exercise 242

242



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

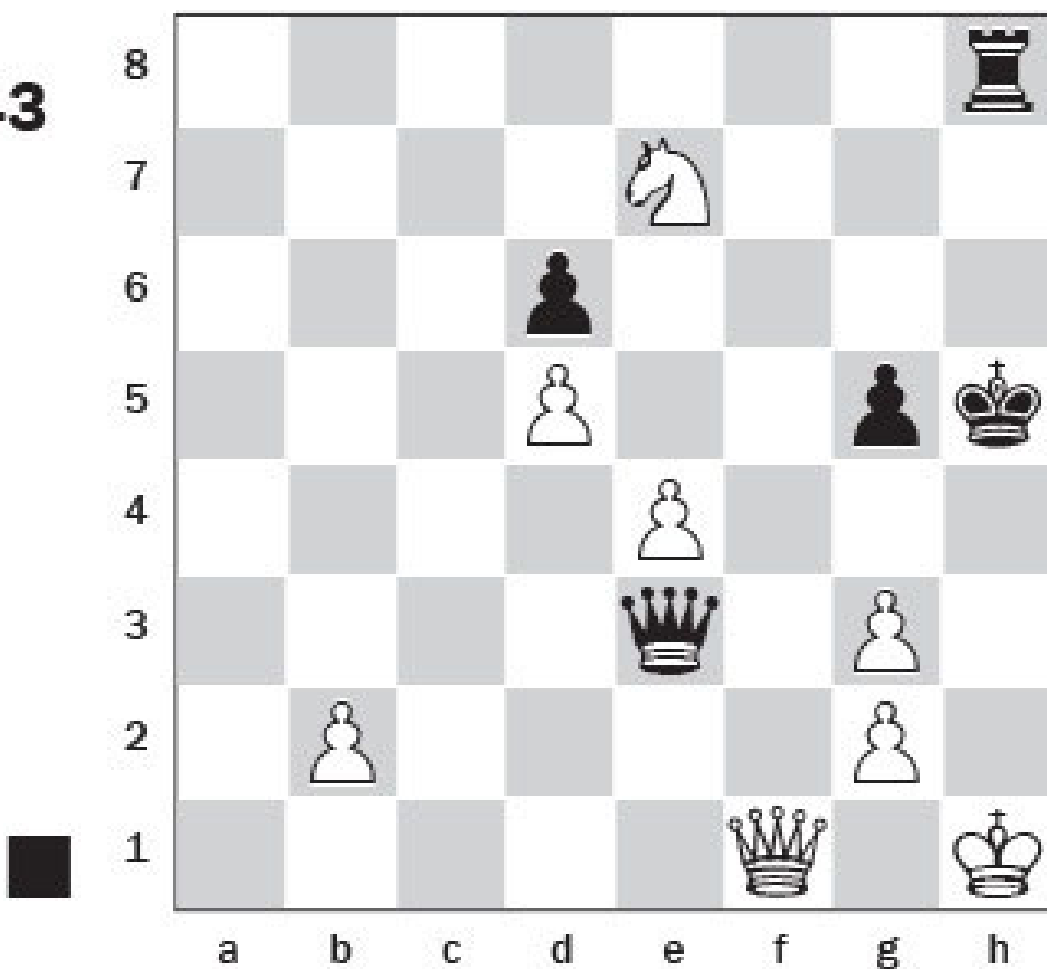
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black is in check by the bishop on c5. How can Black use a discovered check to win the bishop on c5 and escape from danger?

### Exercise 243

**243**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

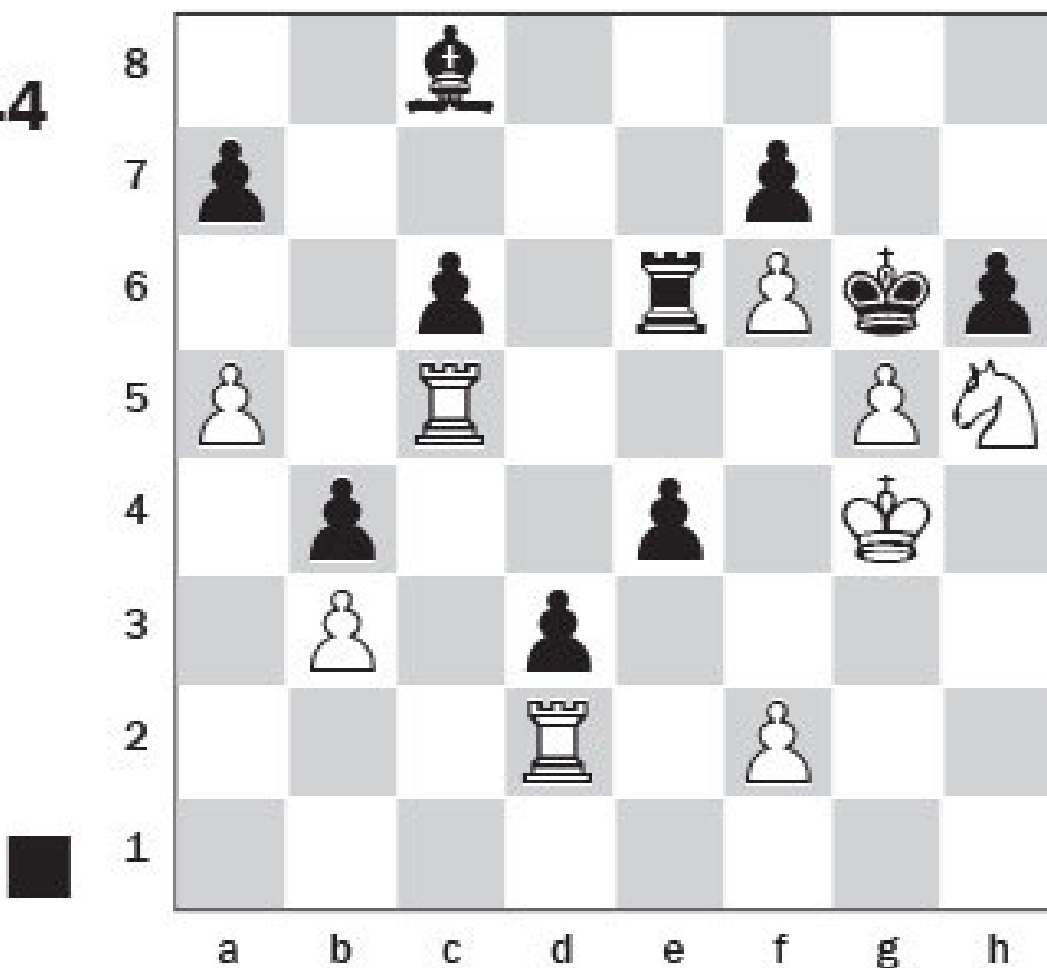
Black's rook on the h-file is well placed. In addition, the queen on e3 stops White's queen from leaving the h-file. Use a discovered check to win the game.



# Discovered Check – Test

## Exercise 244

244



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 245

**245**



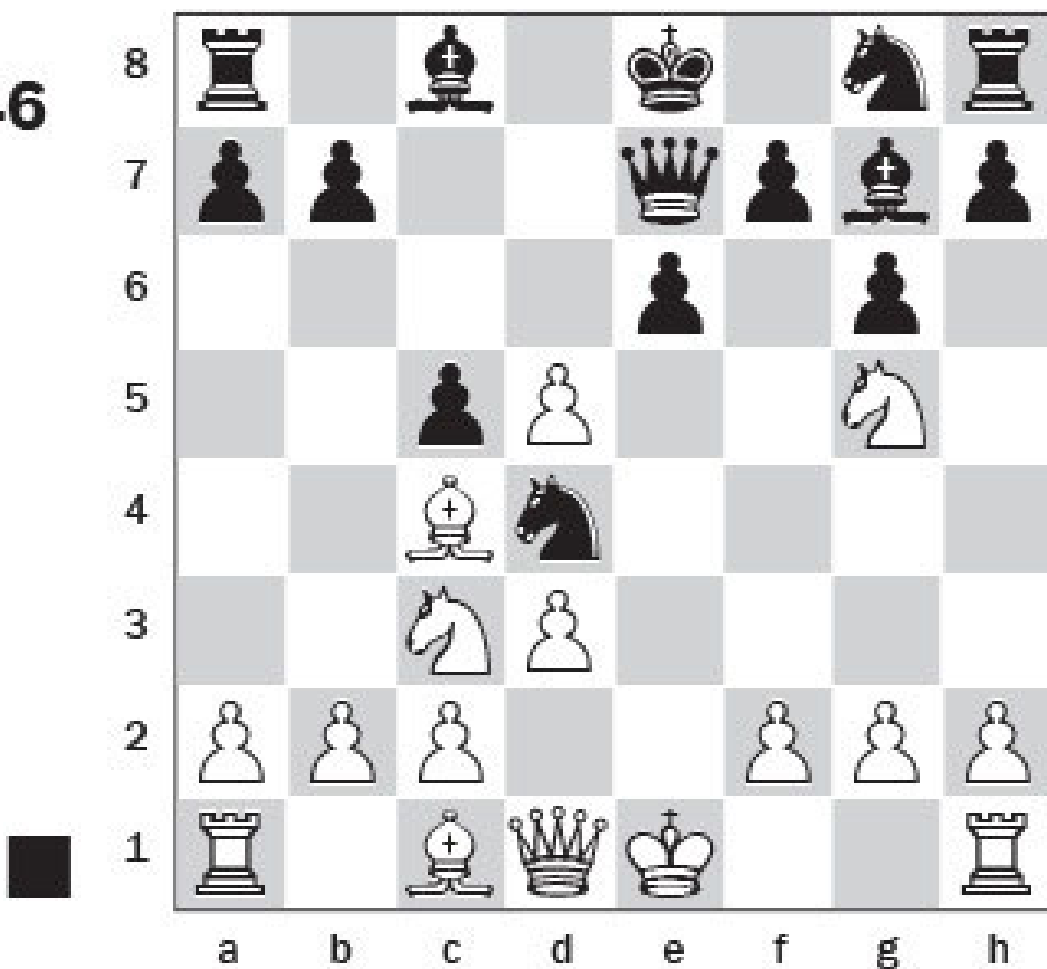
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 246

246



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 247

**247**



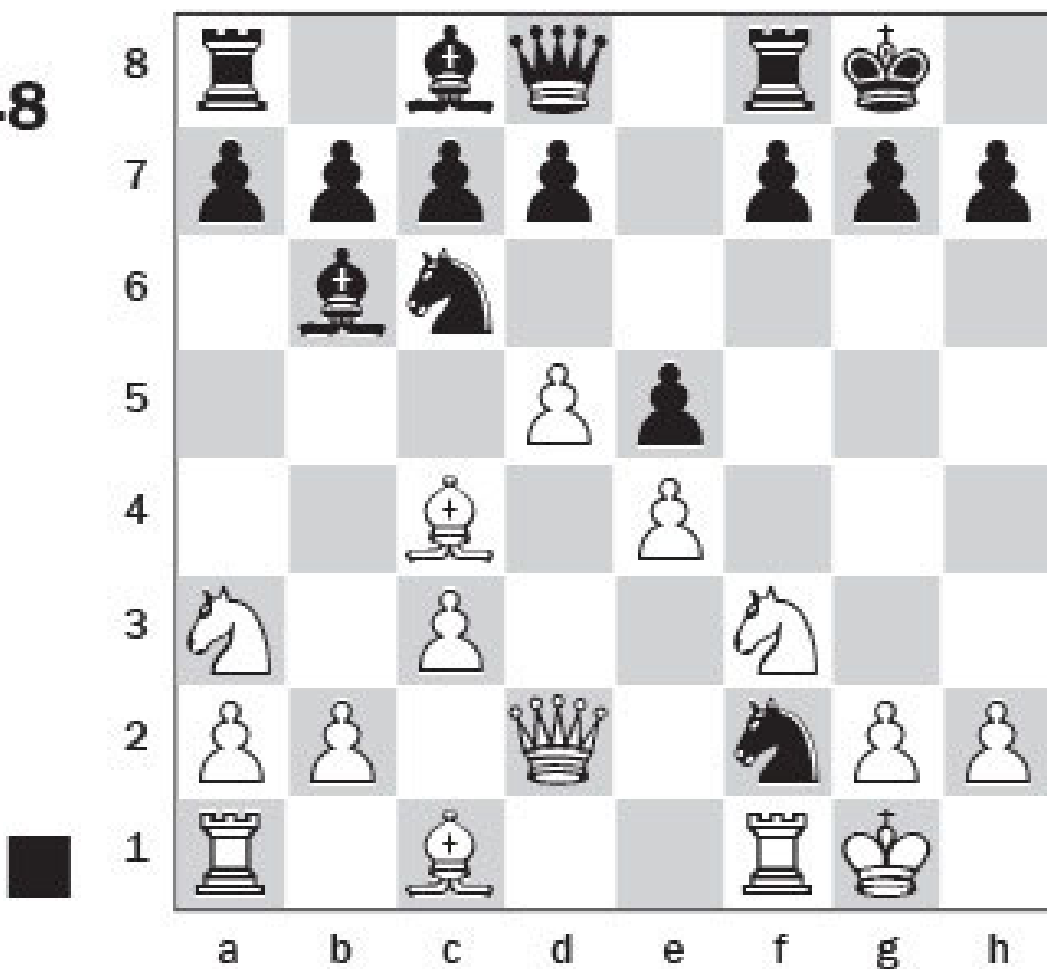
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 248

248



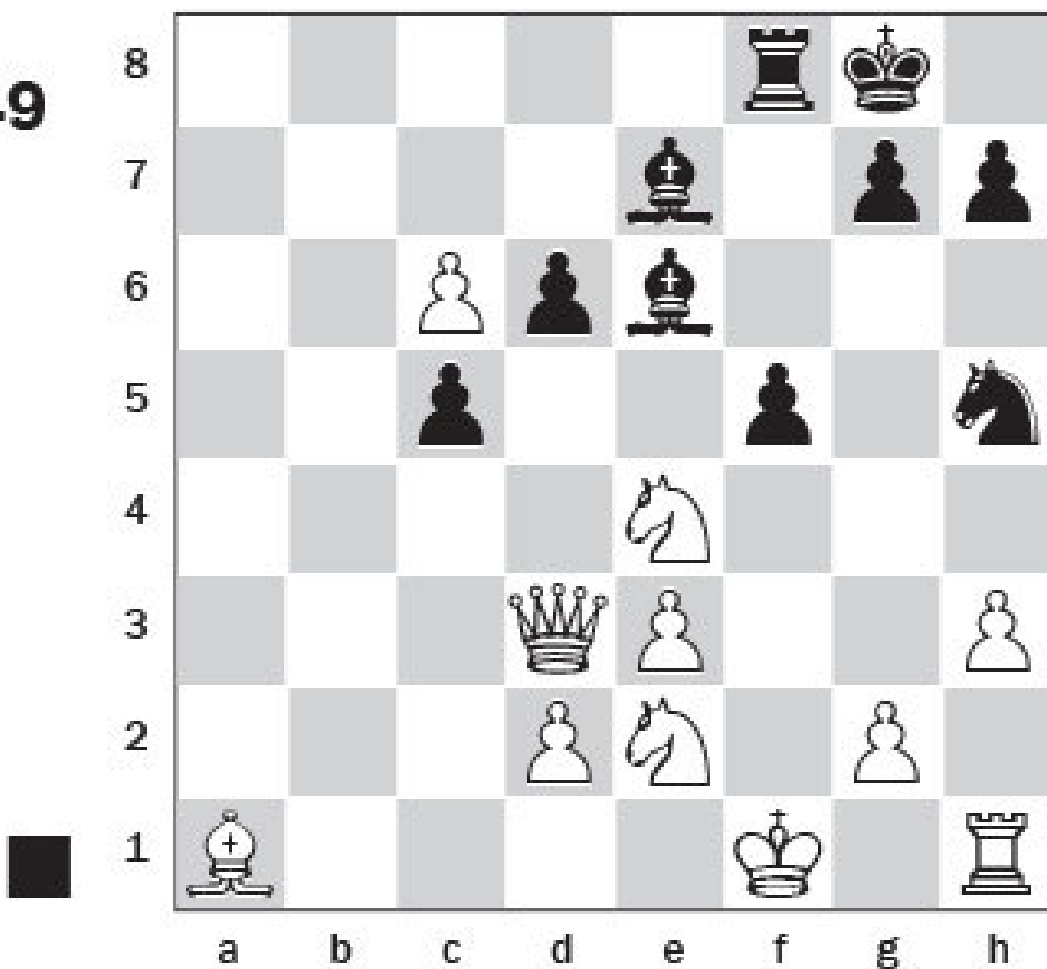
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 249

249



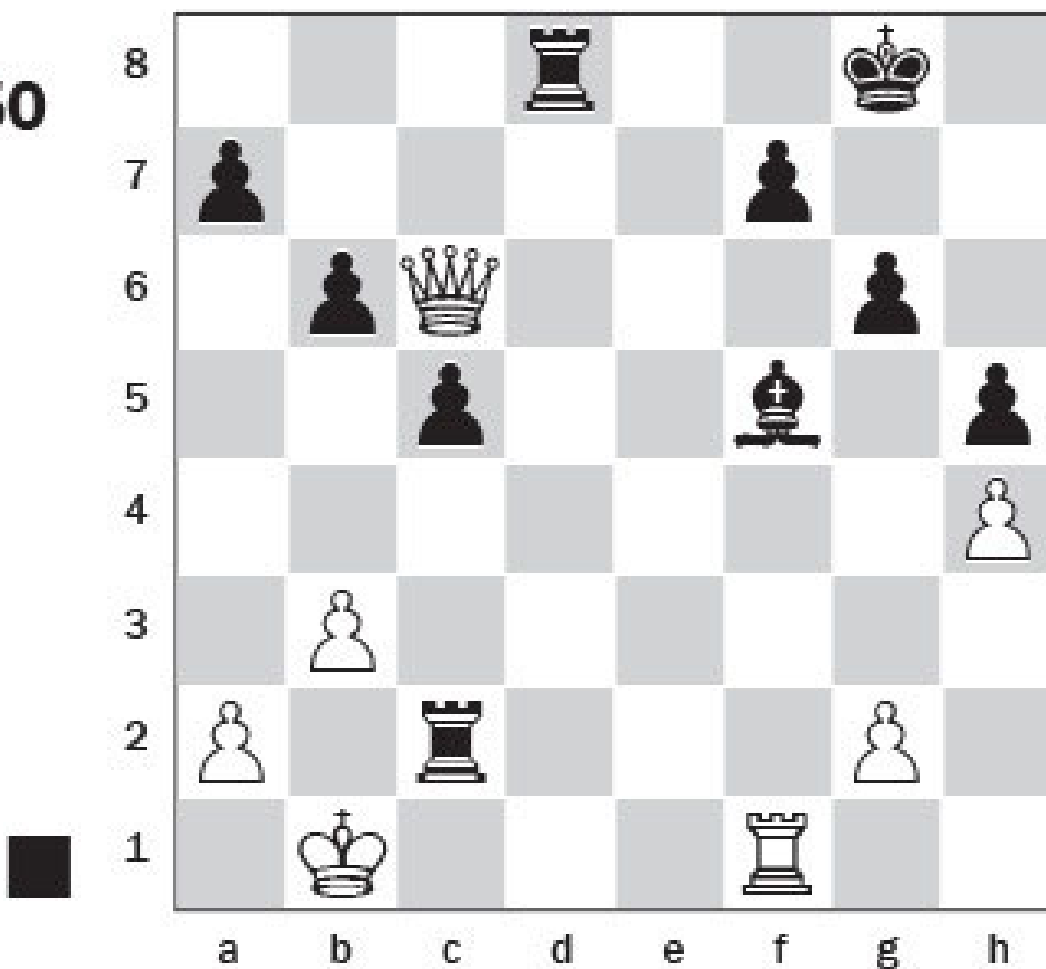
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 250

**250**



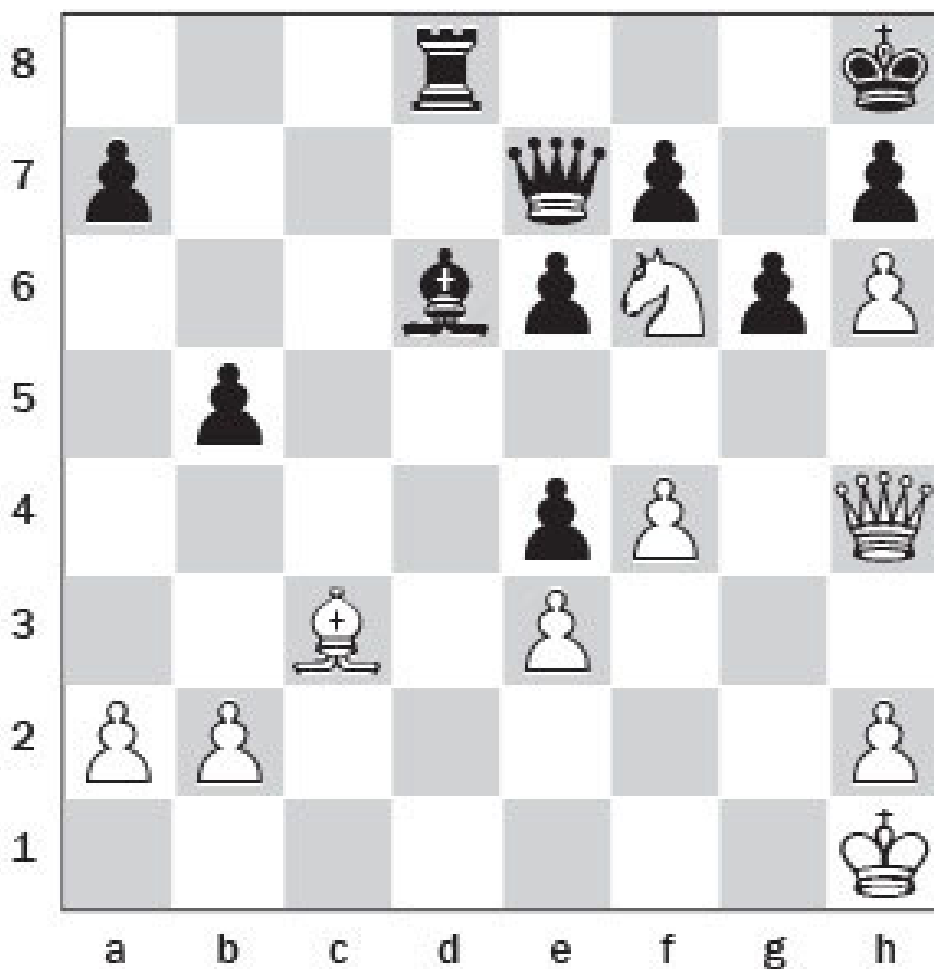
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 251

**251**



Answer:

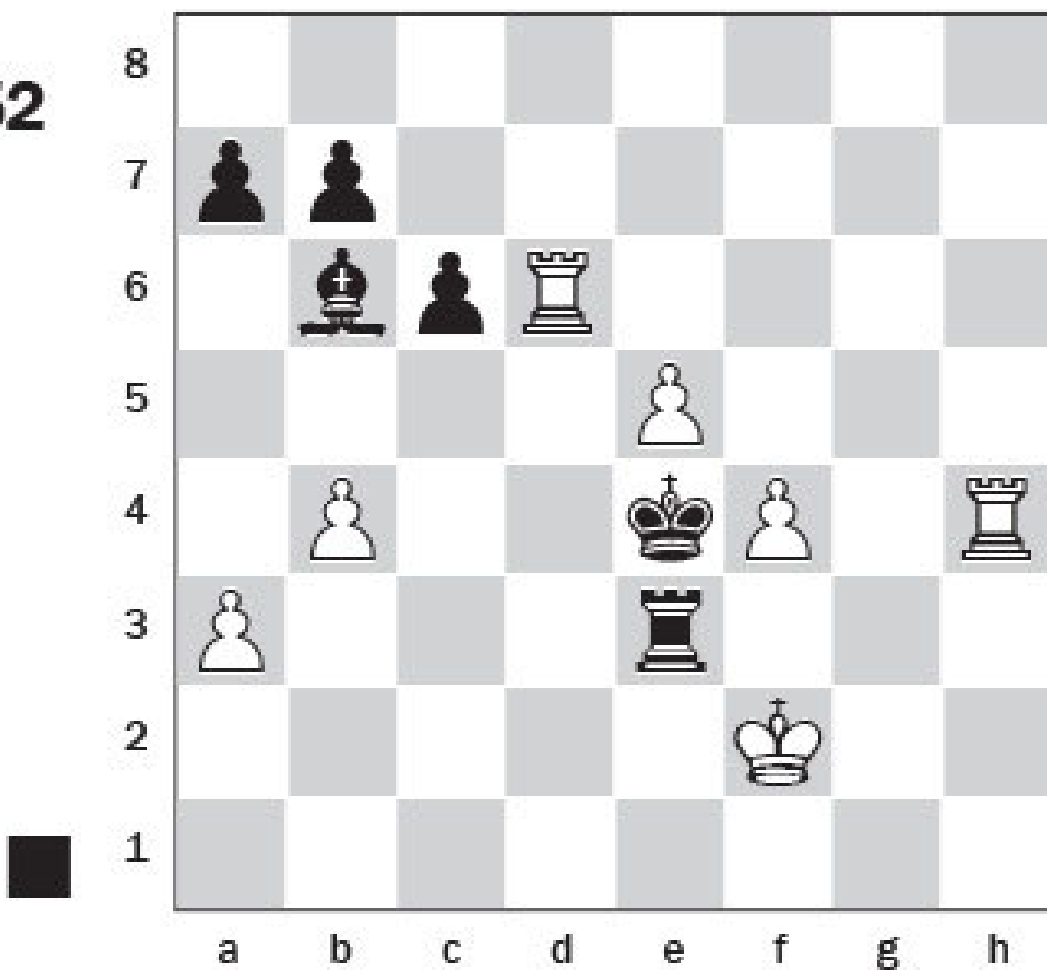
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 252

**252**



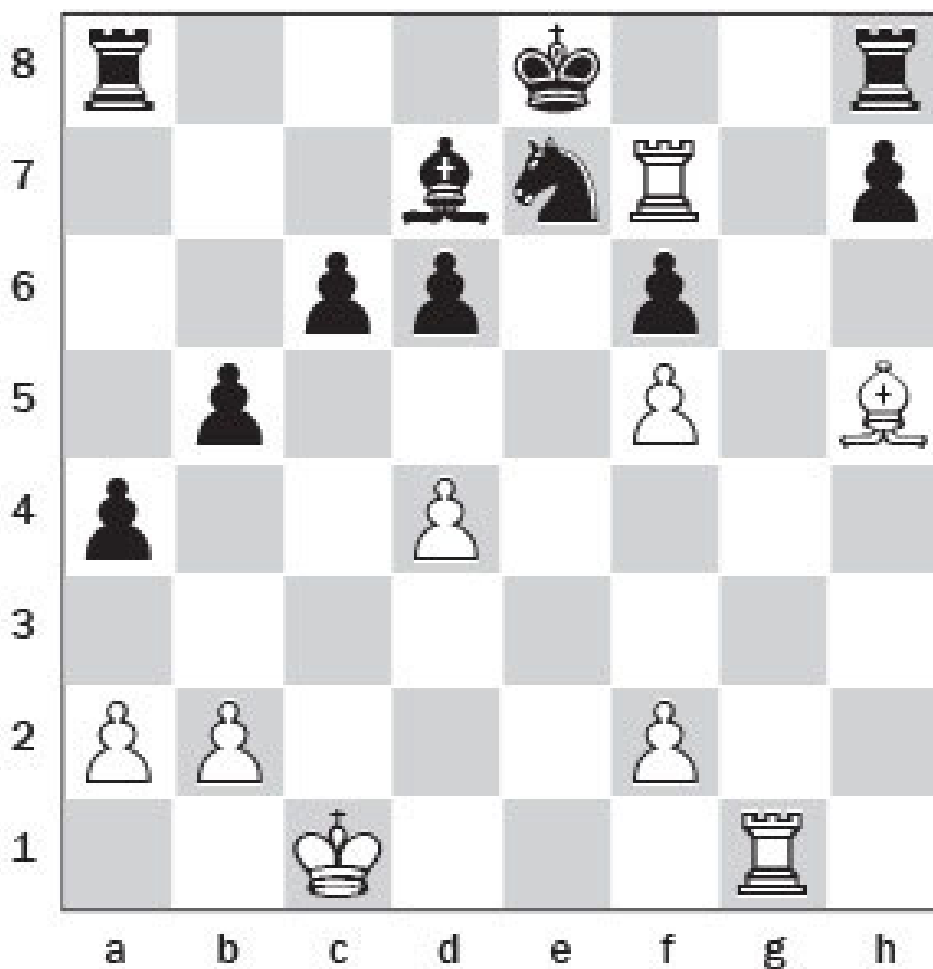
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 253

253



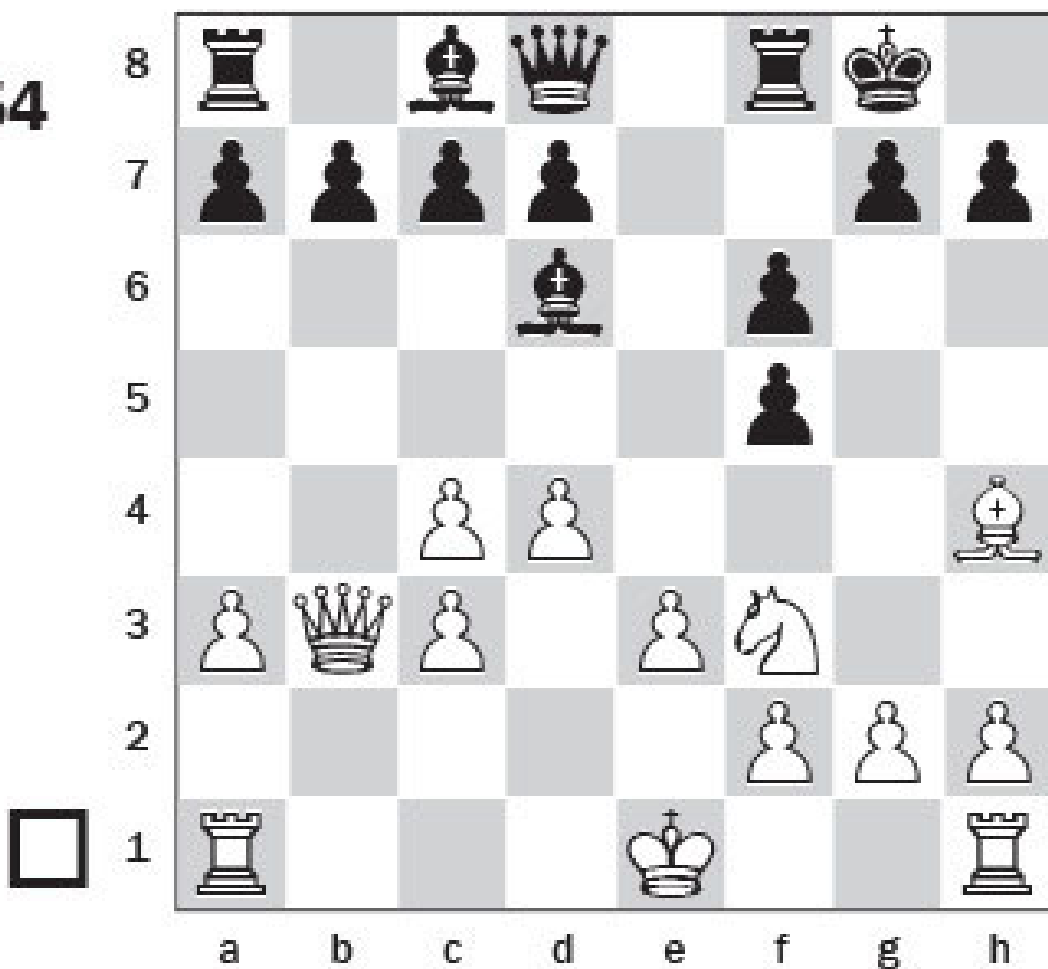
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 254

254



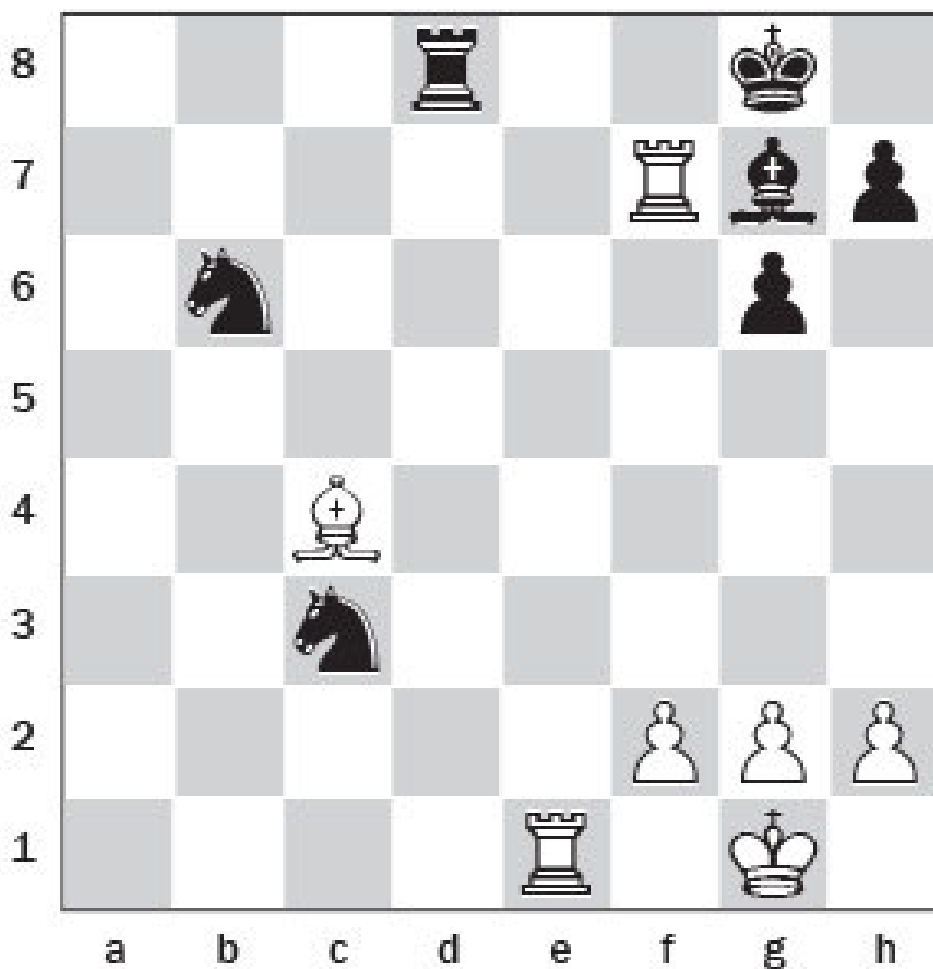
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 255

**255**



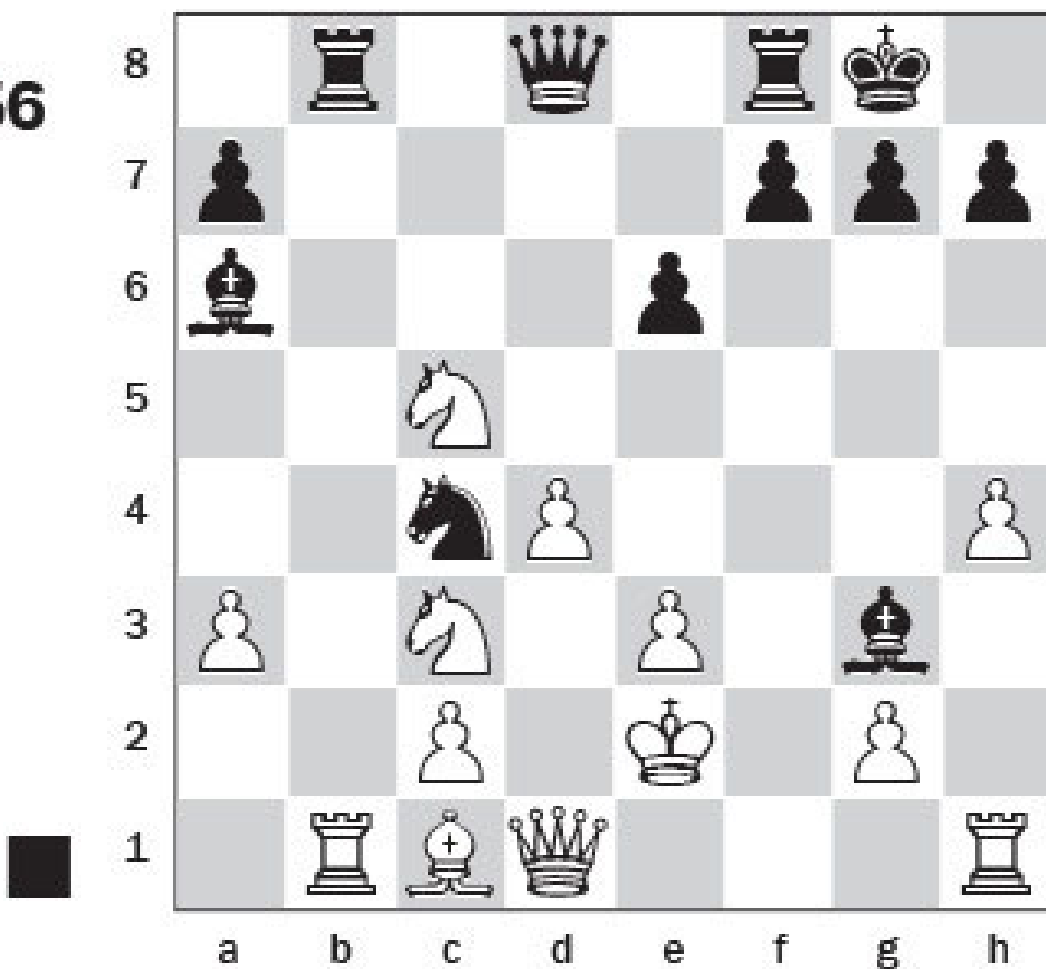
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 256

256



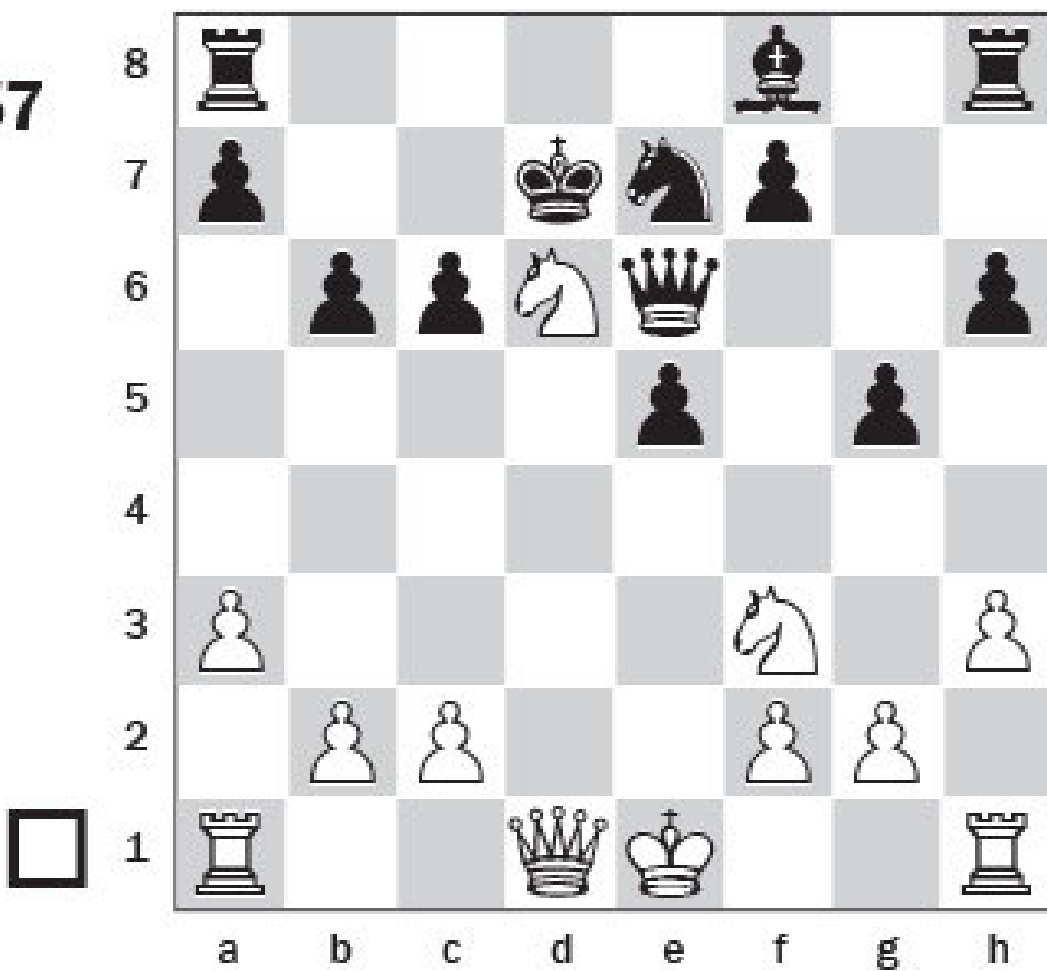
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 257

**257**



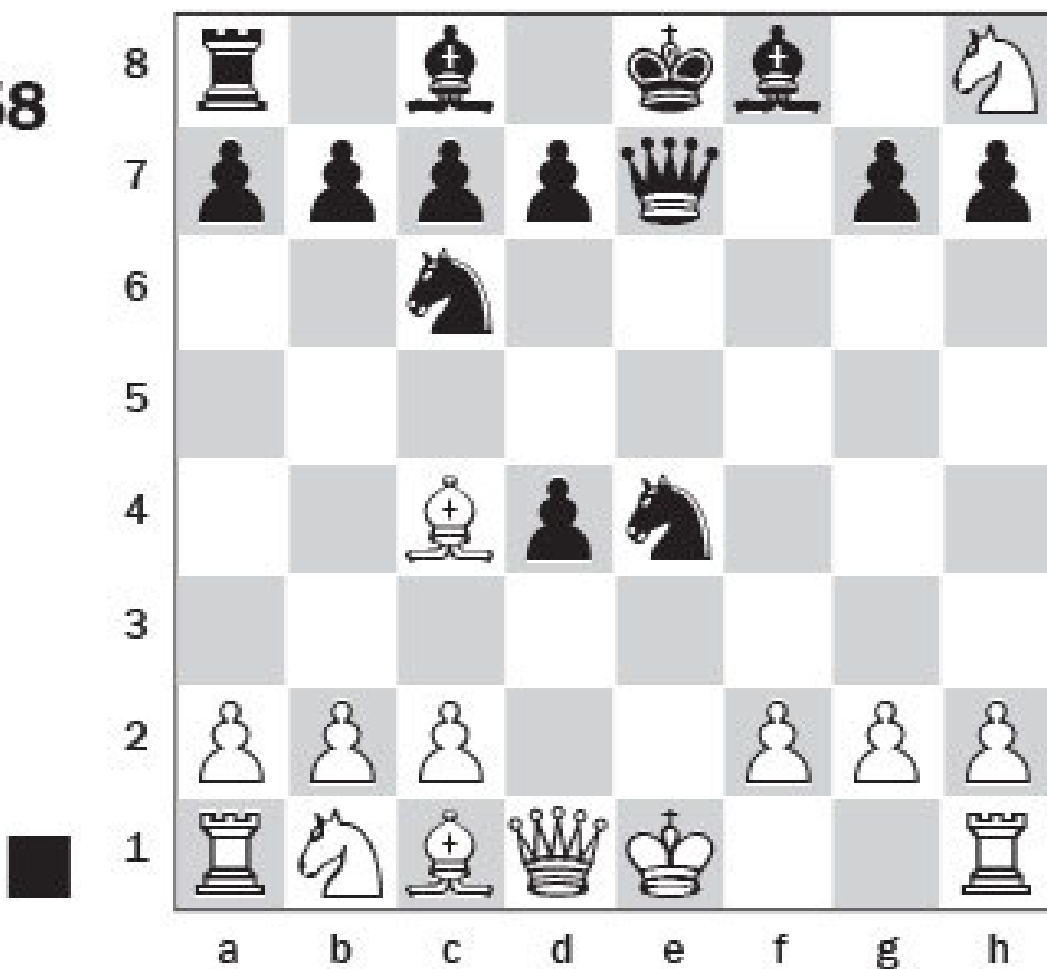
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 258

**258**



Answer:

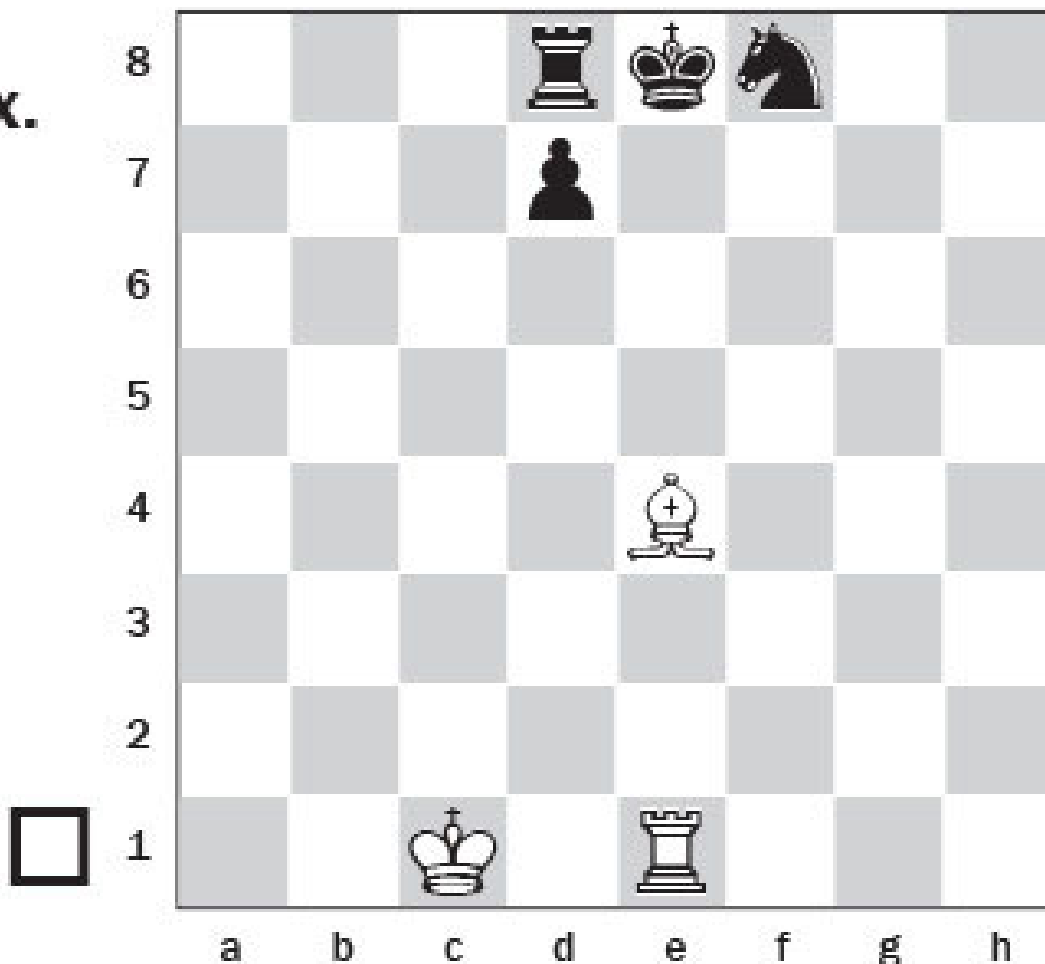
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Double Check – Guided Practice

Ex.



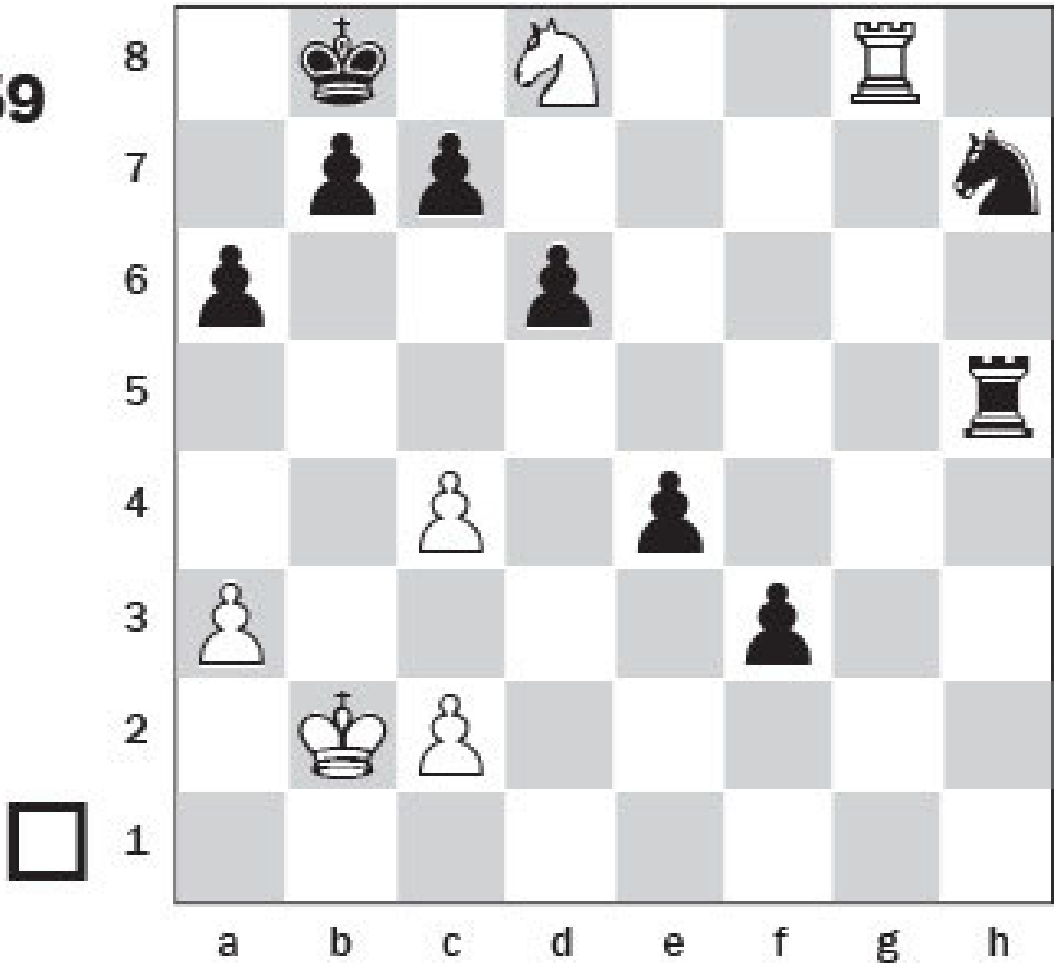
Answer:

1. Bg6# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 259

259



Answer:

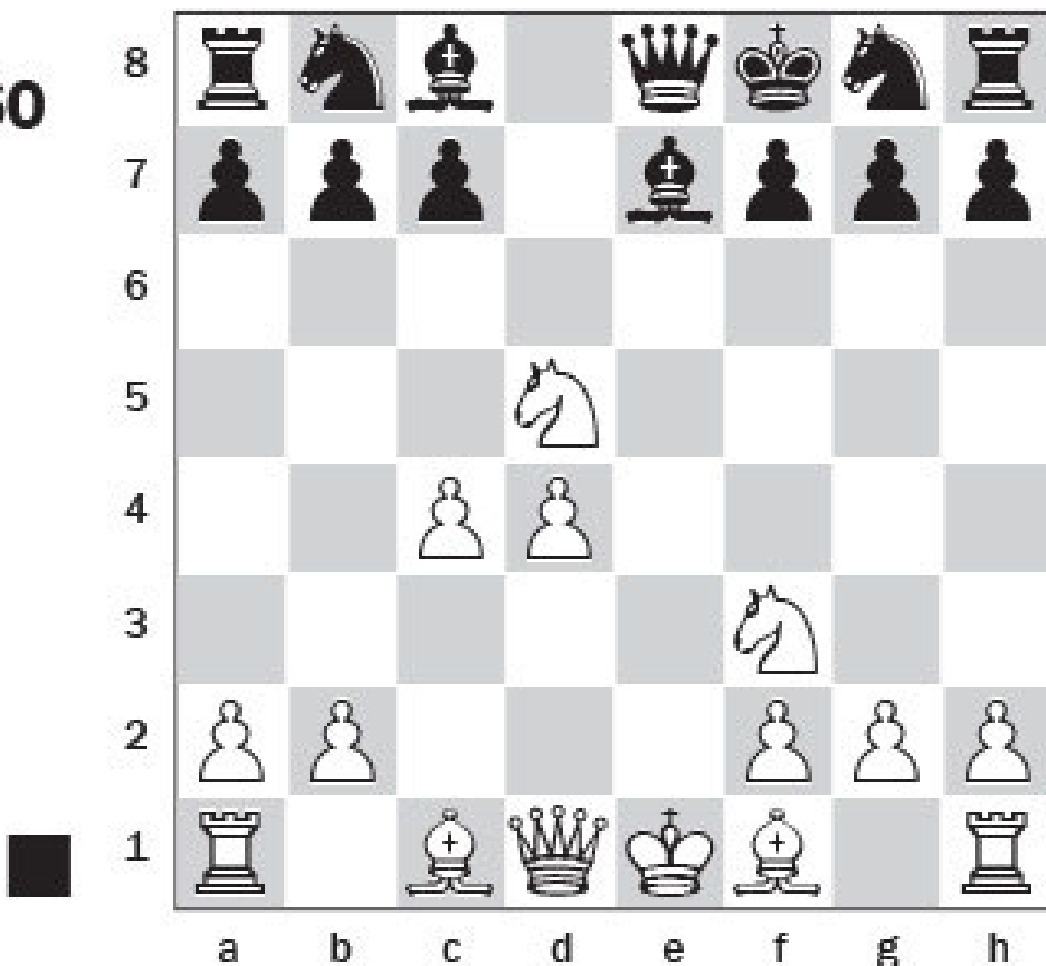
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the rook on g8 is ready to deliver a discovered check. Find a double check to end the game.

### Exercise 260

260



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

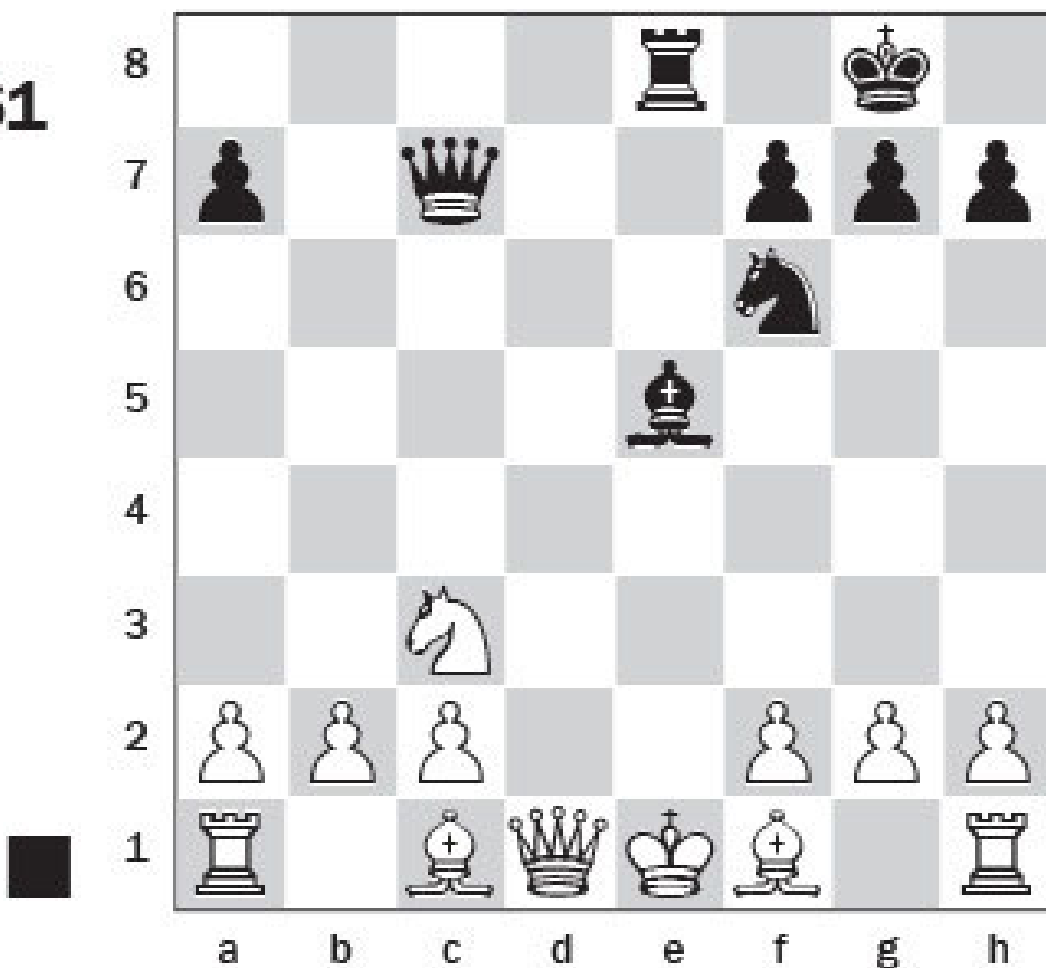
## HINT

Notice the queen on e8 is ready for the discovered check on the king.  
Find a double check and you win the game!

# Double Check – Test

## Exercise 261

**261**

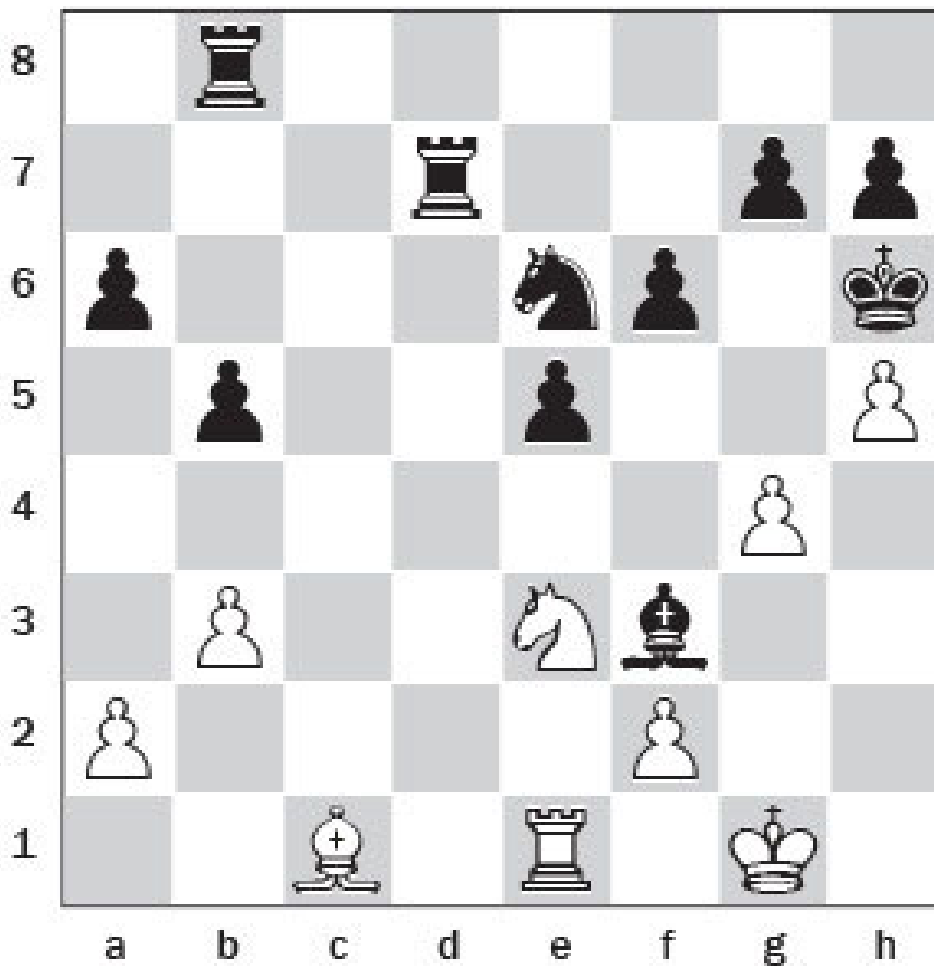


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 262

262

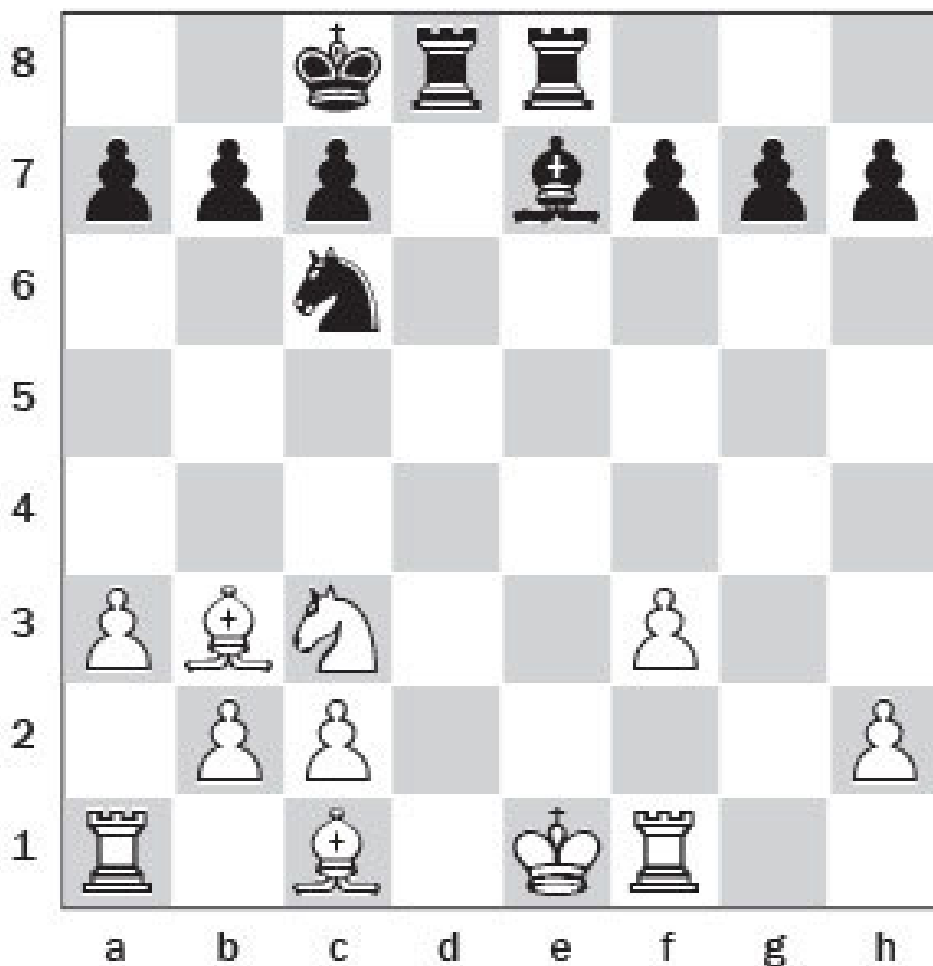


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 263

263



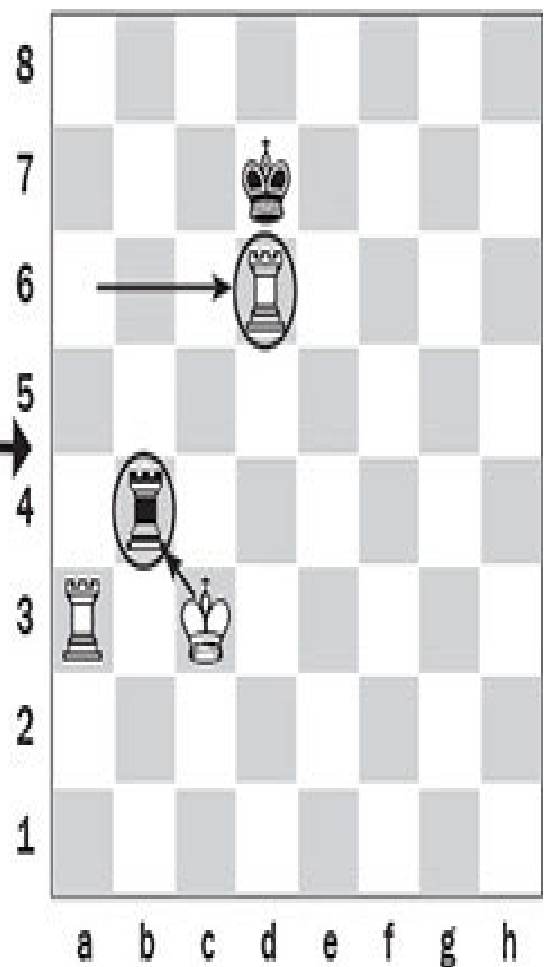
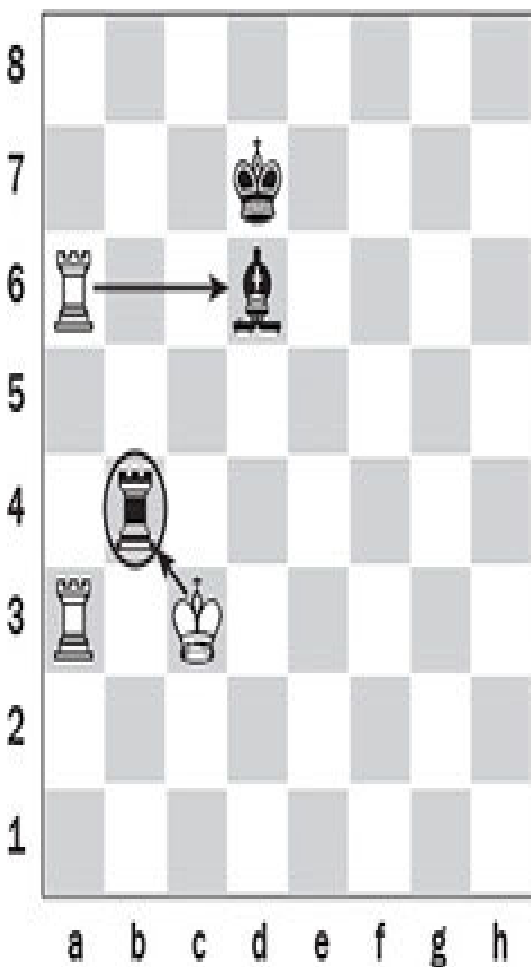
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 10

# Removing the Guard

Sometimes referred to as ‘removing the defender’, removing the guard is another very important tactical concept in chess. Fortunately, this concept is relatively self-explanatory. Removing the guard involves capturing an enemy piece that is defending a piece or defending against a threat.





White would like to capture the black rook on b4 with the king, but that is not possible as Black's bishop is protecting the rook. Having said that, the white rook on a6 has the ability to capture the bishop on d6, eliminating the guard of the rook. Initially, that may not seem like a good trade, as White is giving away a rook (5 points) for a bishop (3 points). However, in the end White's king will be able to capture the rook on b4 as well.

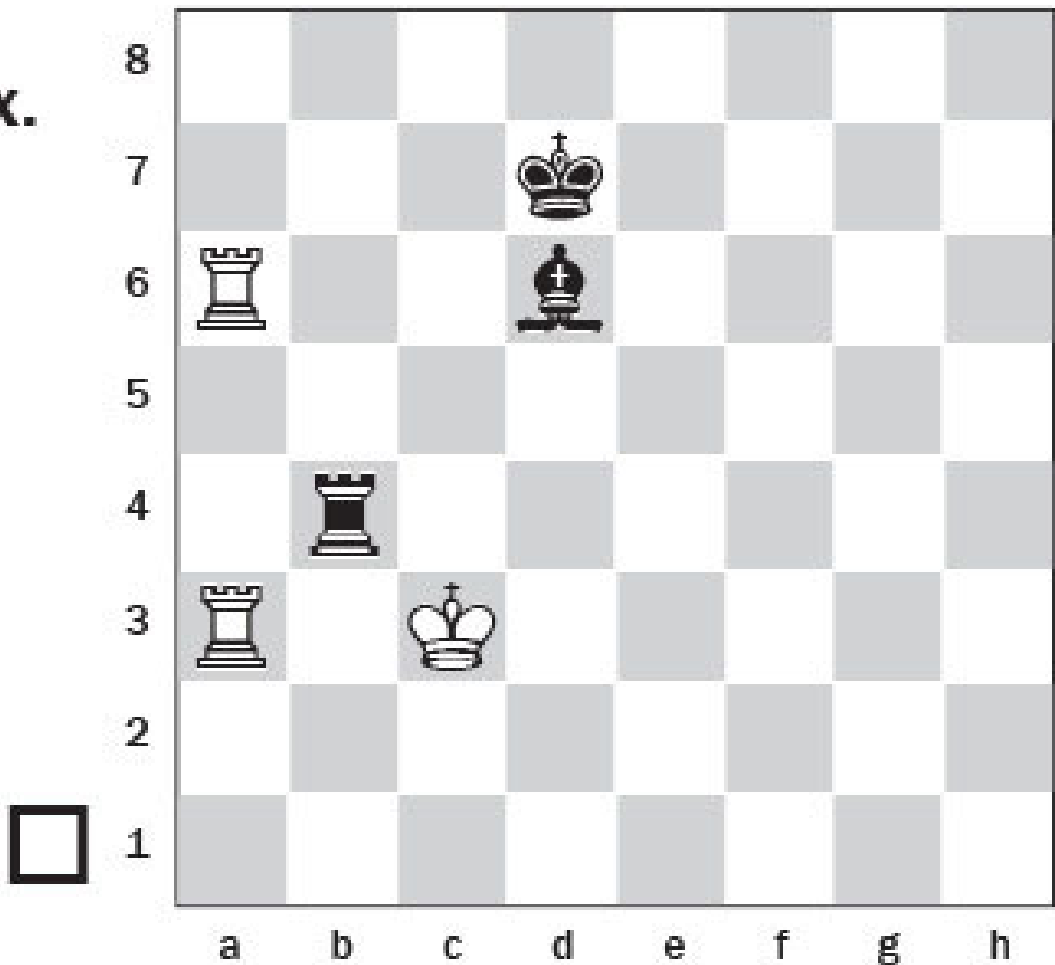
The best move for White is 1.Rxd6+ (see diagram 2).

After 1...Kxd6 2.Kxb4 the dust has settled and White is up a rook (5 points). This is a prime example of what we mean by 'removing the guard'.

In order to better solve the problems, try to find an enemy piece which is guarding a piece or guarding against a threat.

# Removing the Guard – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

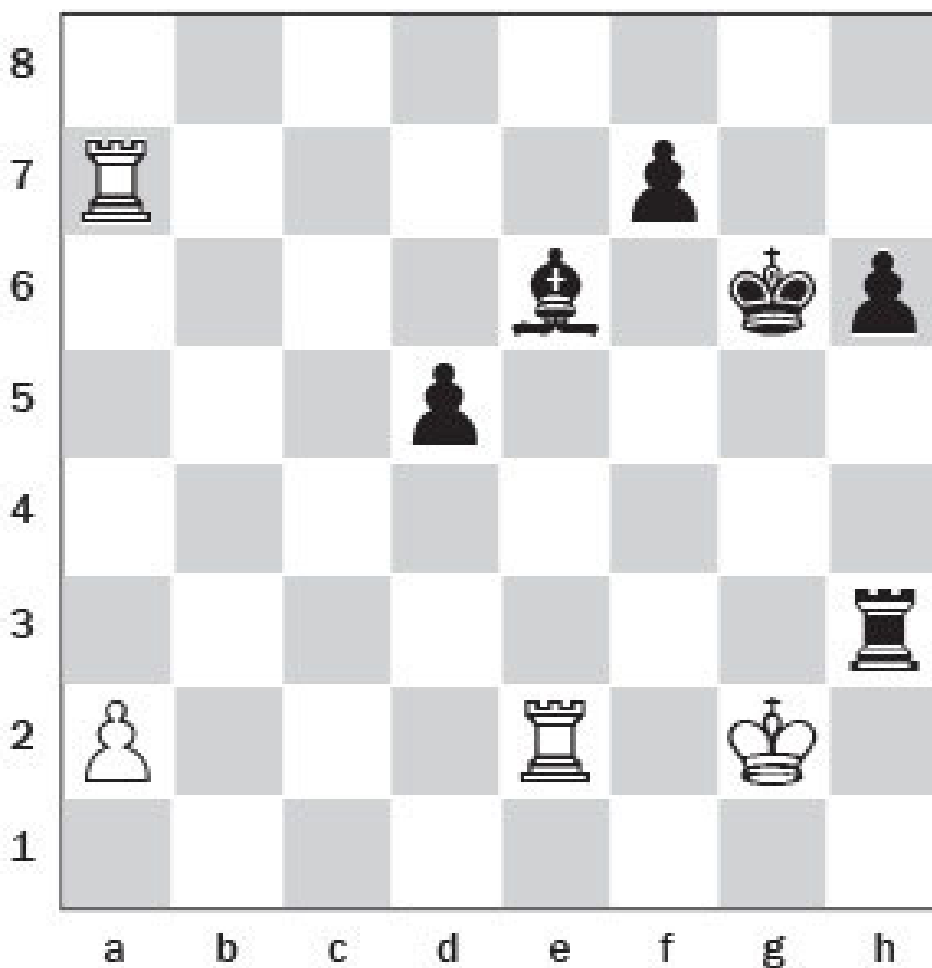
**1. Rxd6+ Kxd6**

## 2. Kxb4 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 264

**264**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

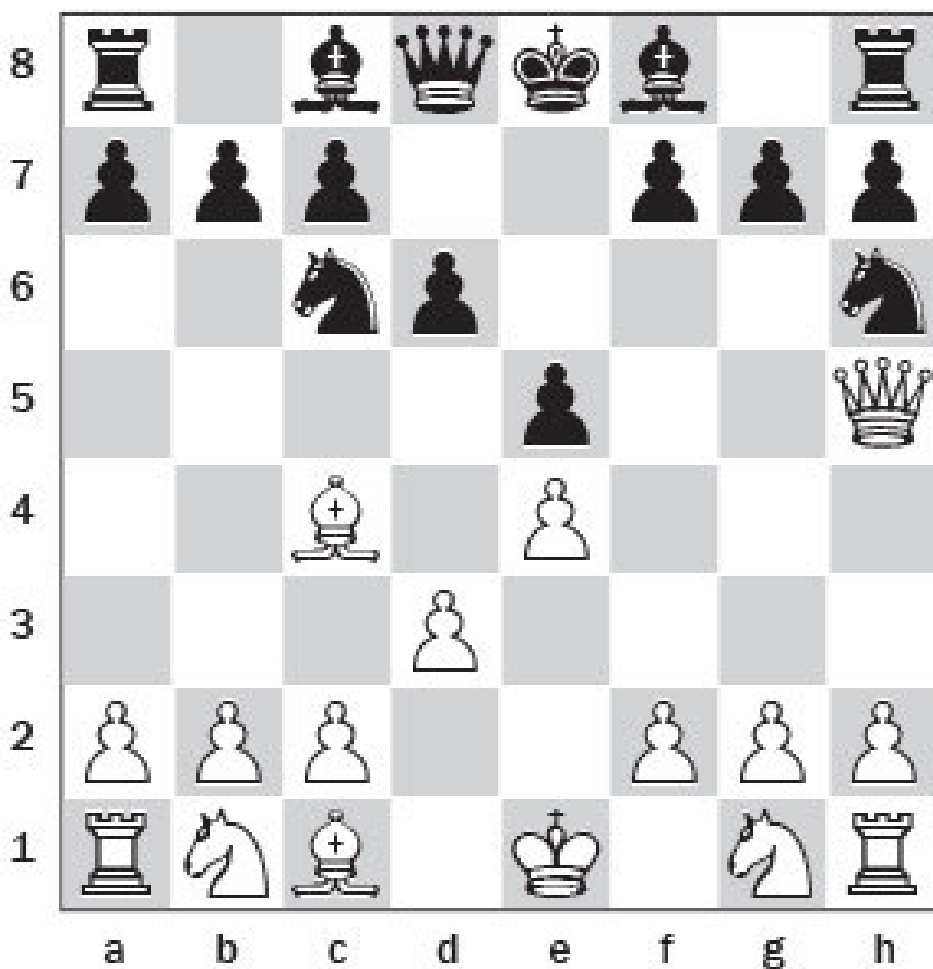
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook at h3 is being attacked by the king. What's protecting it?

### Exercise 265

265



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

White is threatening checkmate on f7. There's only one thing stopping it!

### **[Exercise 266](#)**

266



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

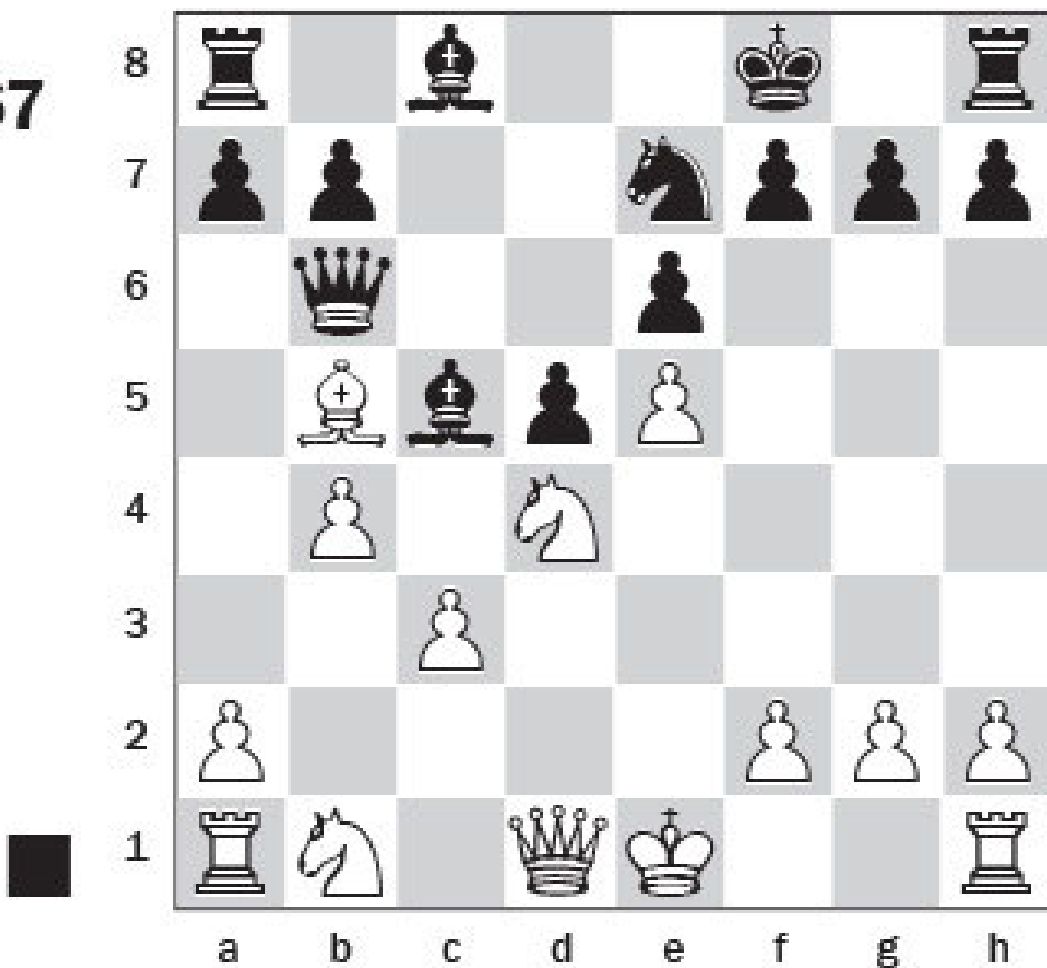
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The knight on g5 is only protected by the bishop. Win material by removing the guard.

### Exercise 267

267



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

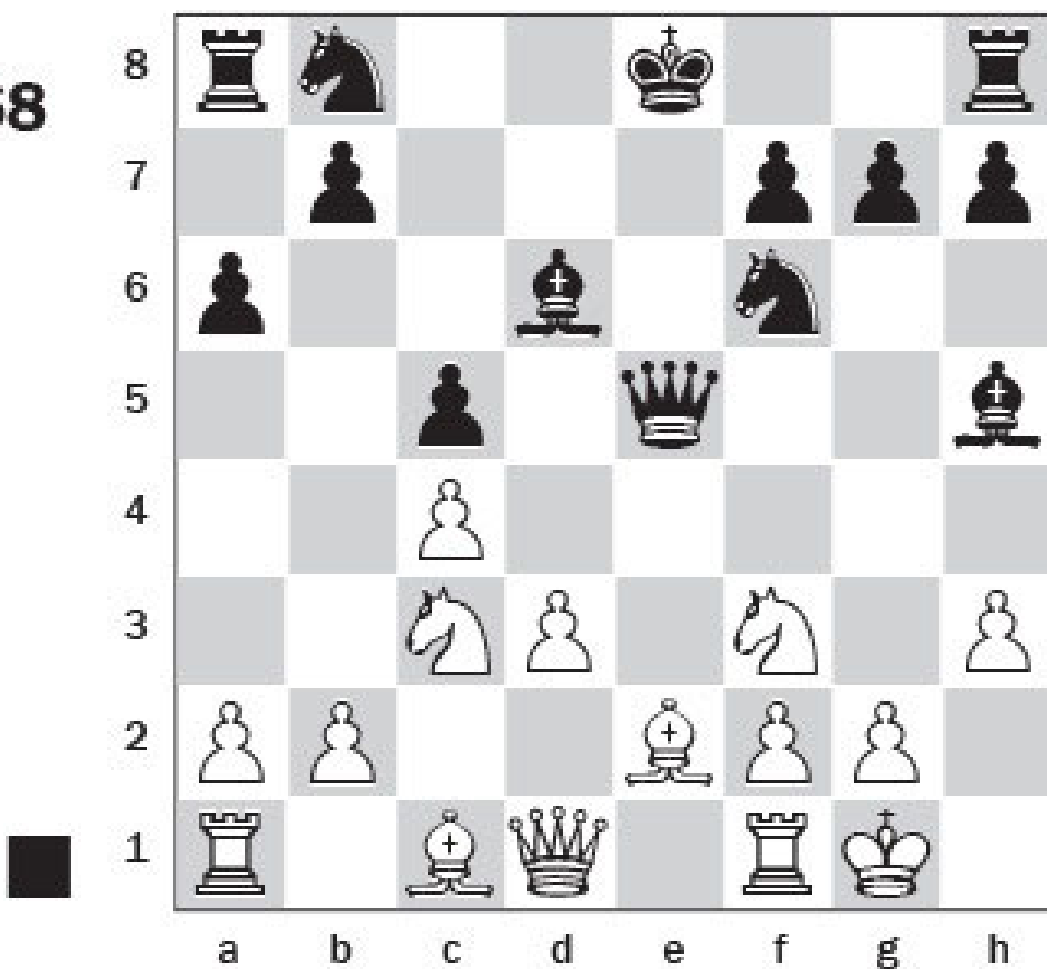
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's bishop on b5 is only protected by the knight. Use removing the guard to win material.

### Exercise 268

268



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

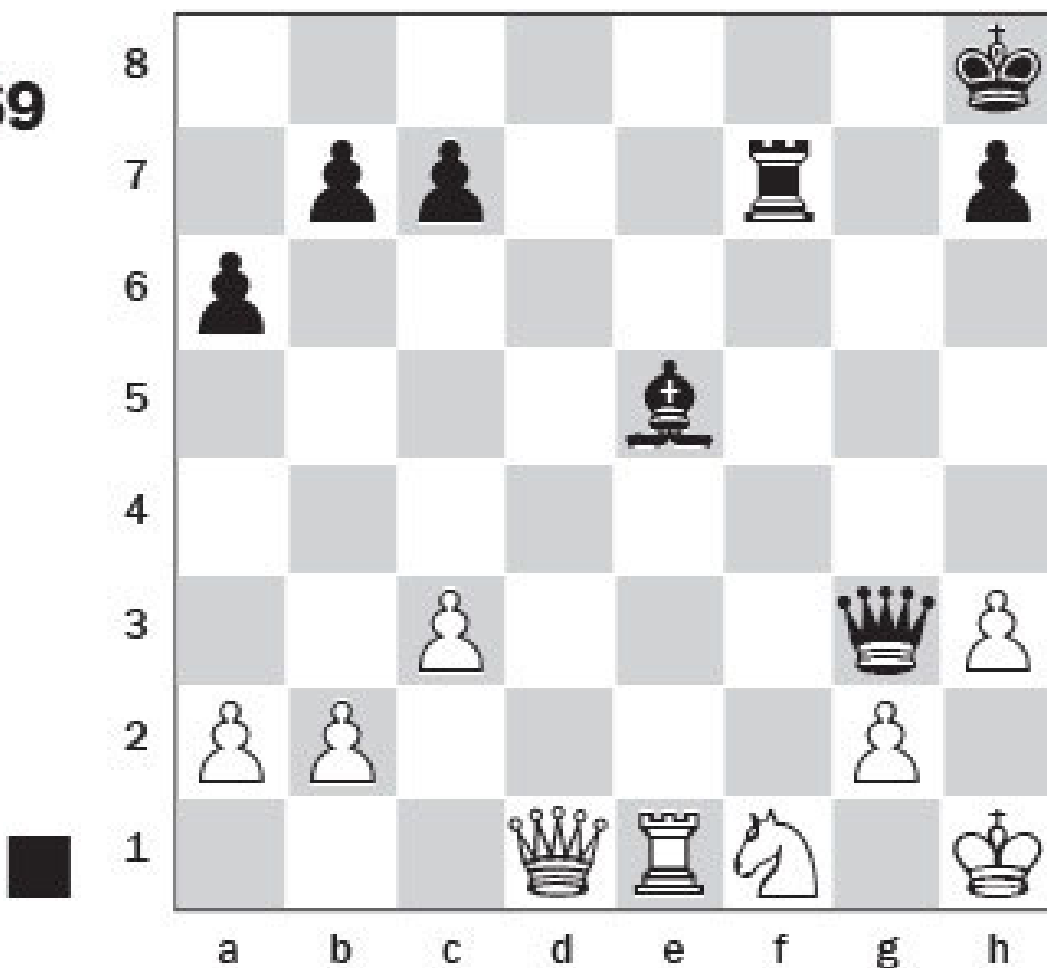
## HINT

Black's queen and bishop battery is pointed at the king. Only one thing is stopping checkmate.

# Removing the Guard – Test

## Exercise 269

**269**



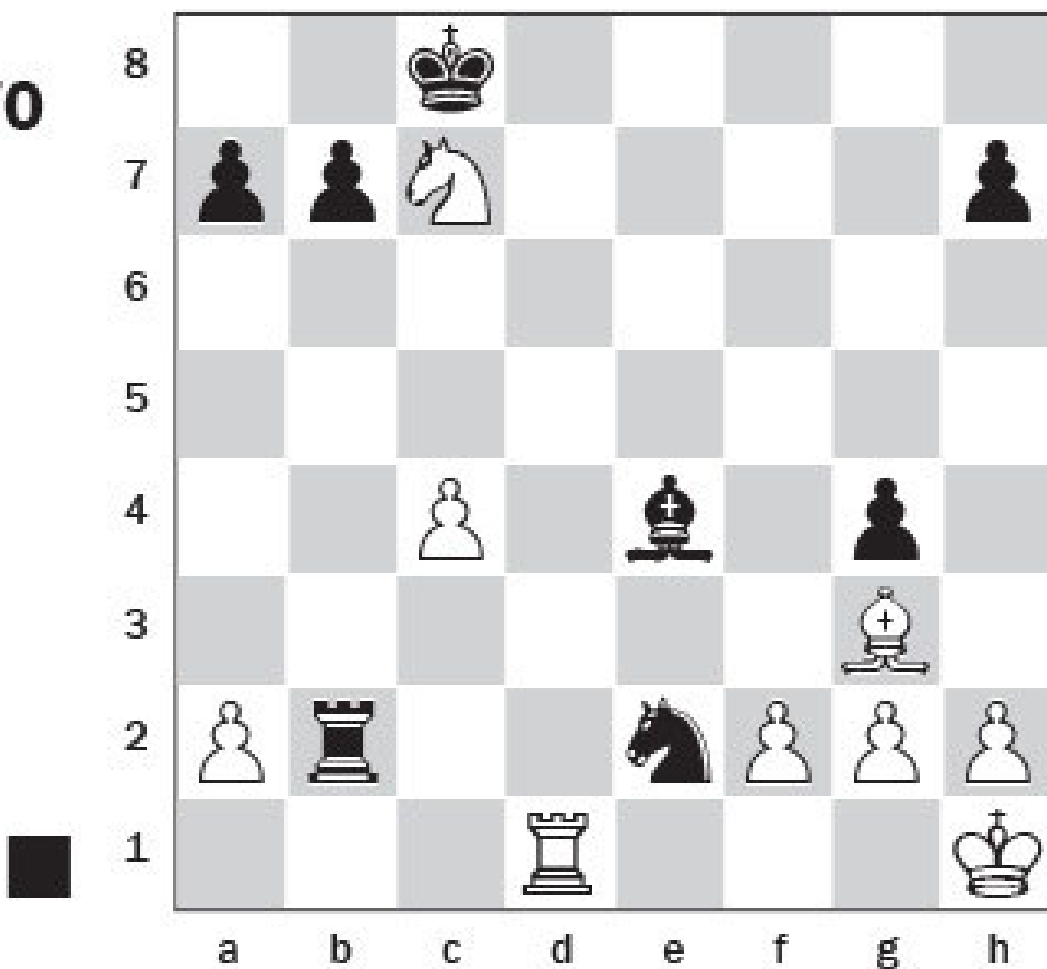
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 270

**270**



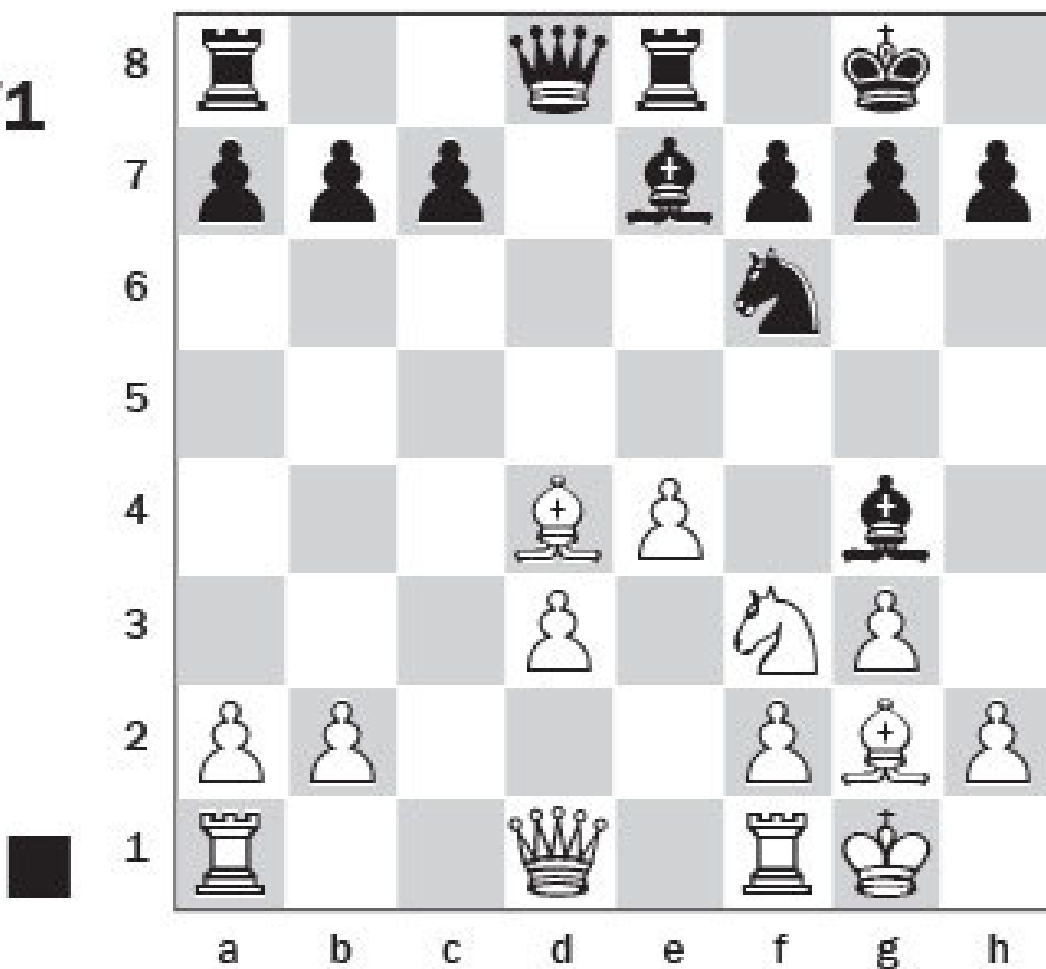
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 271

**271**



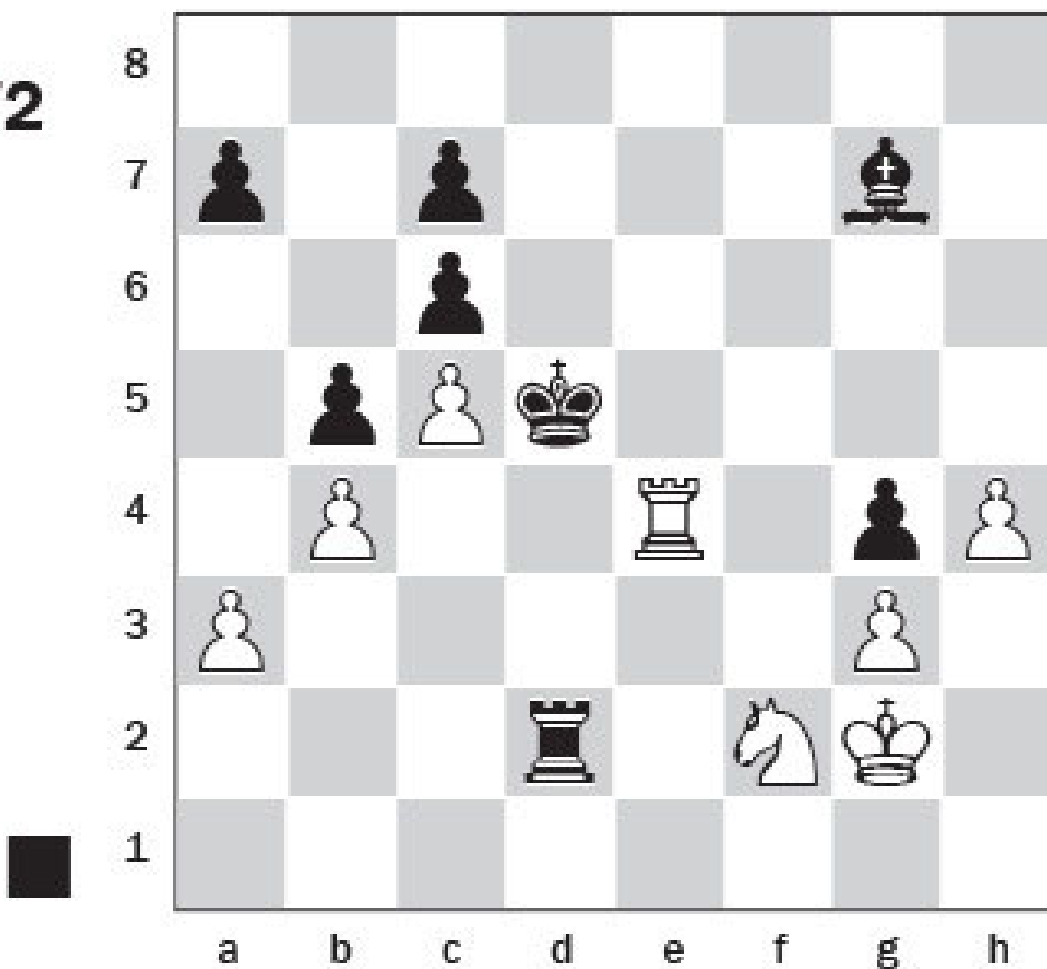
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 272

**272**



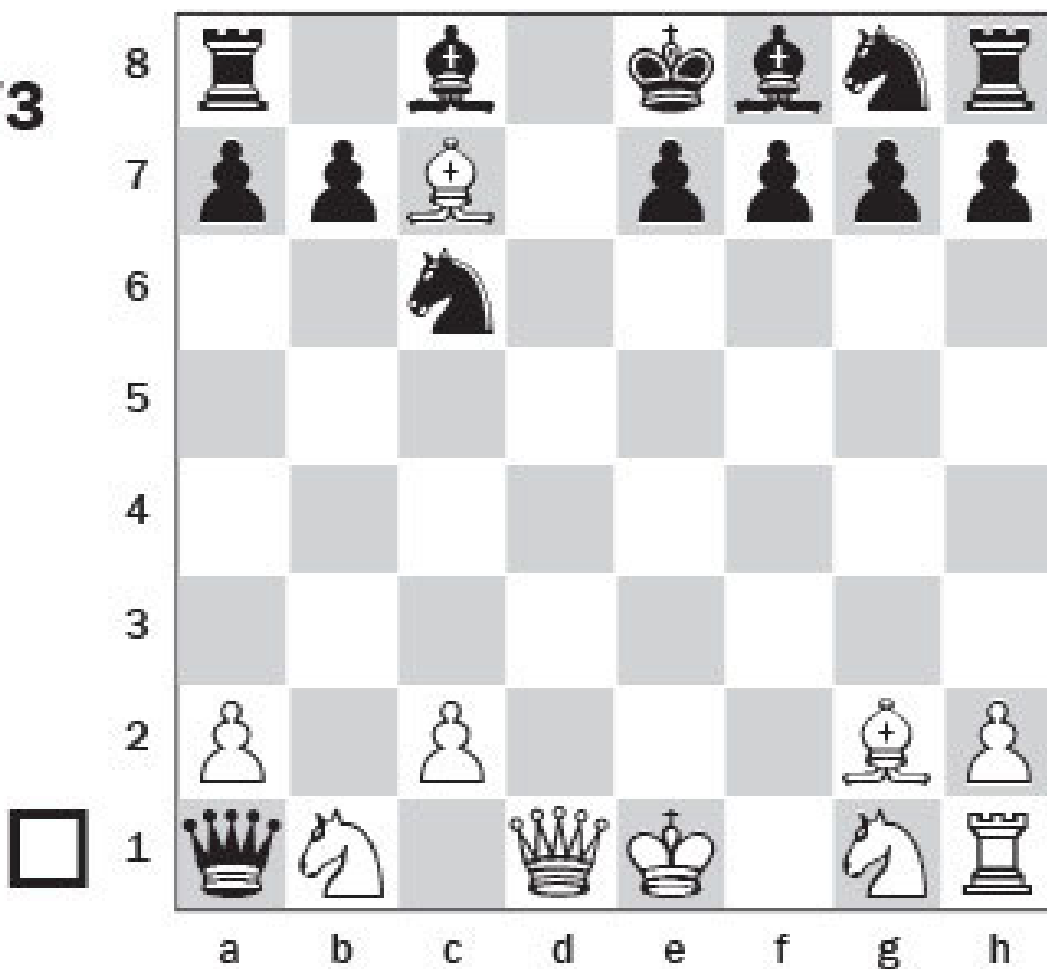
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 273

273



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 274

274



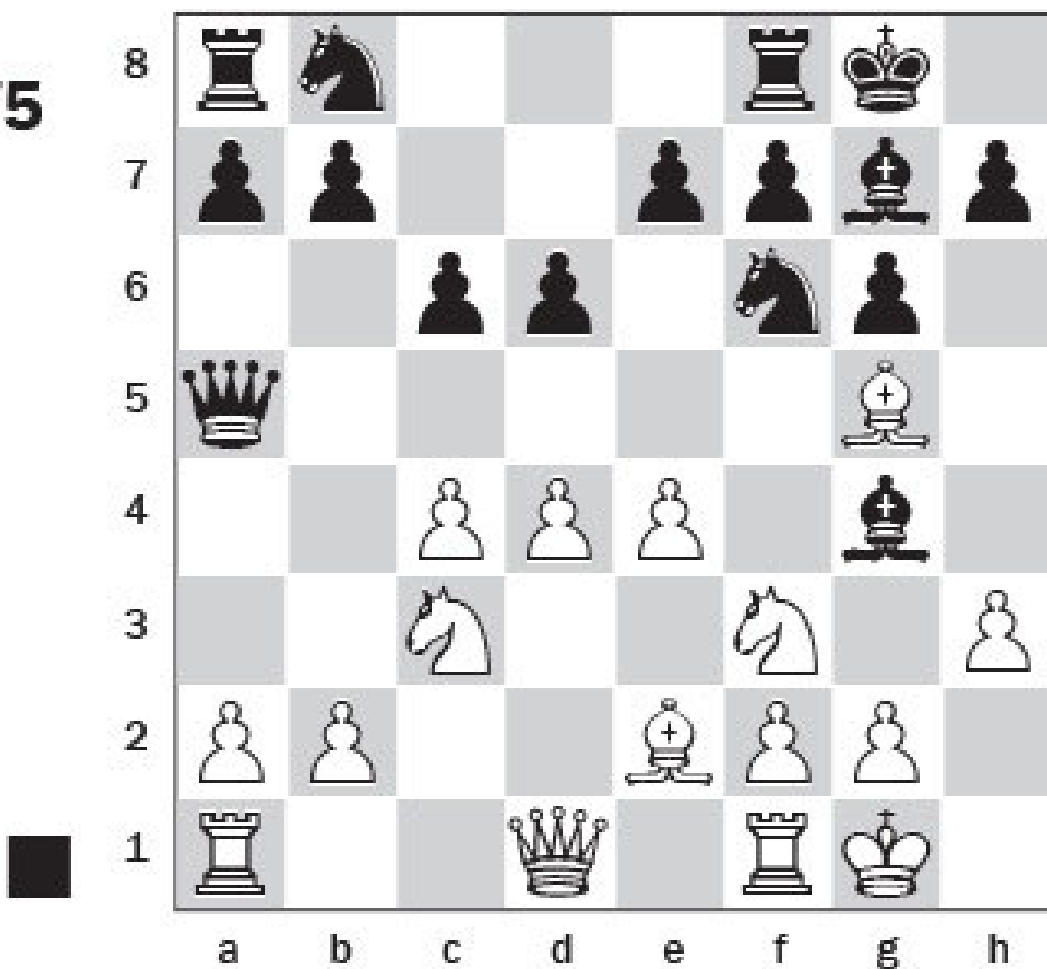
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 275

275



Answer:

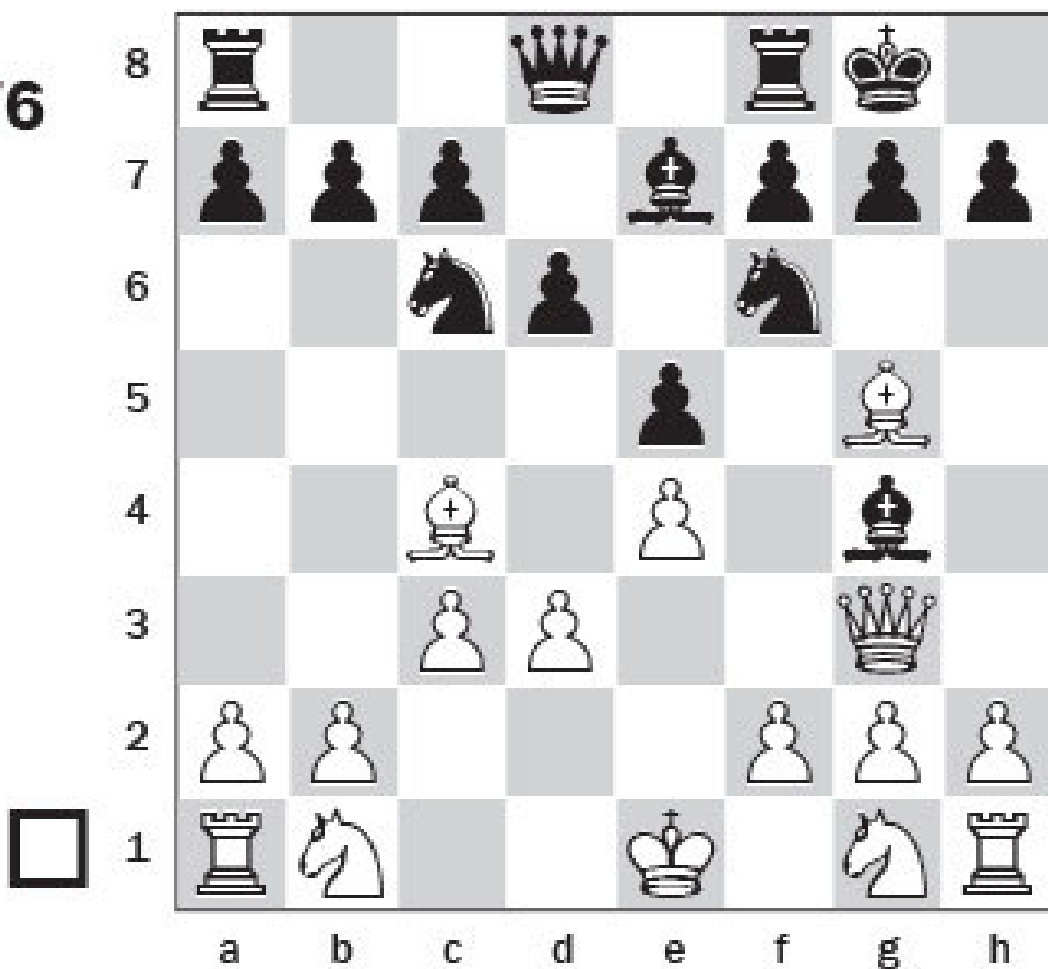
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 276

276



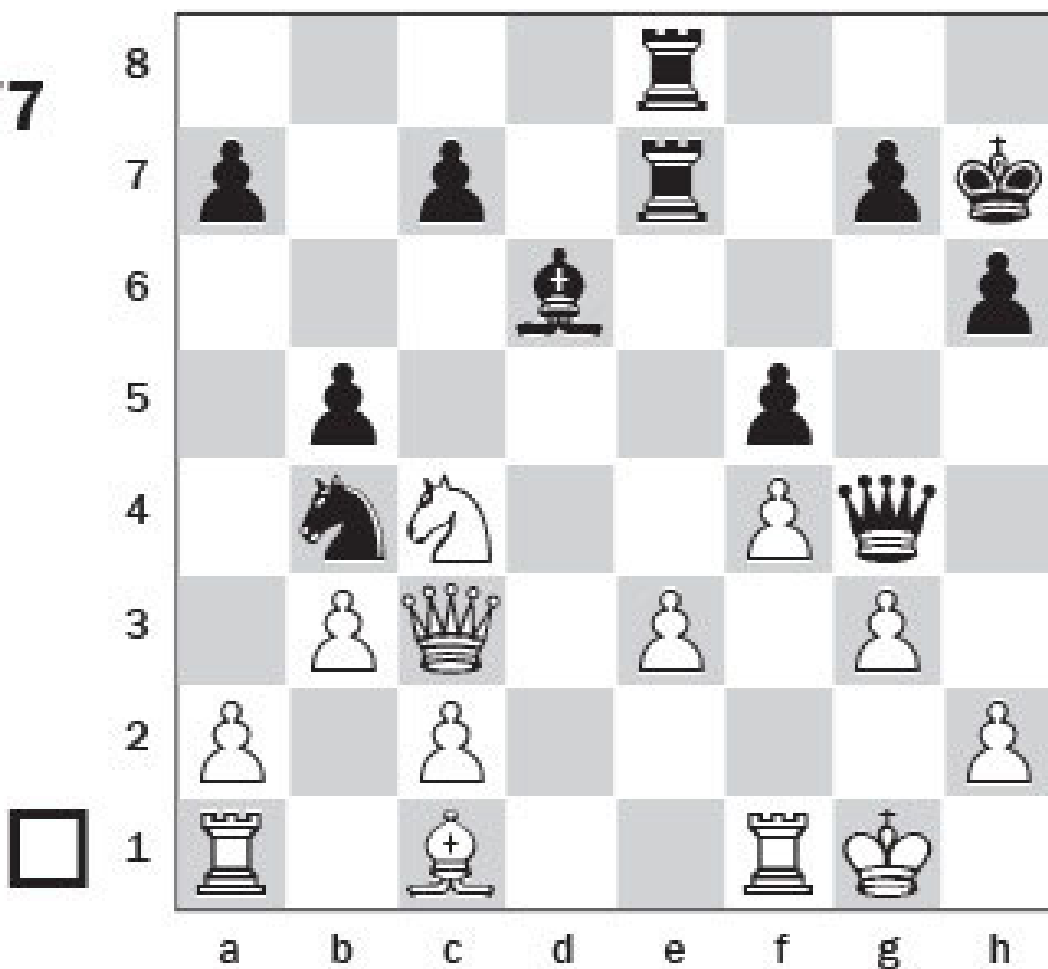
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 277

**277**



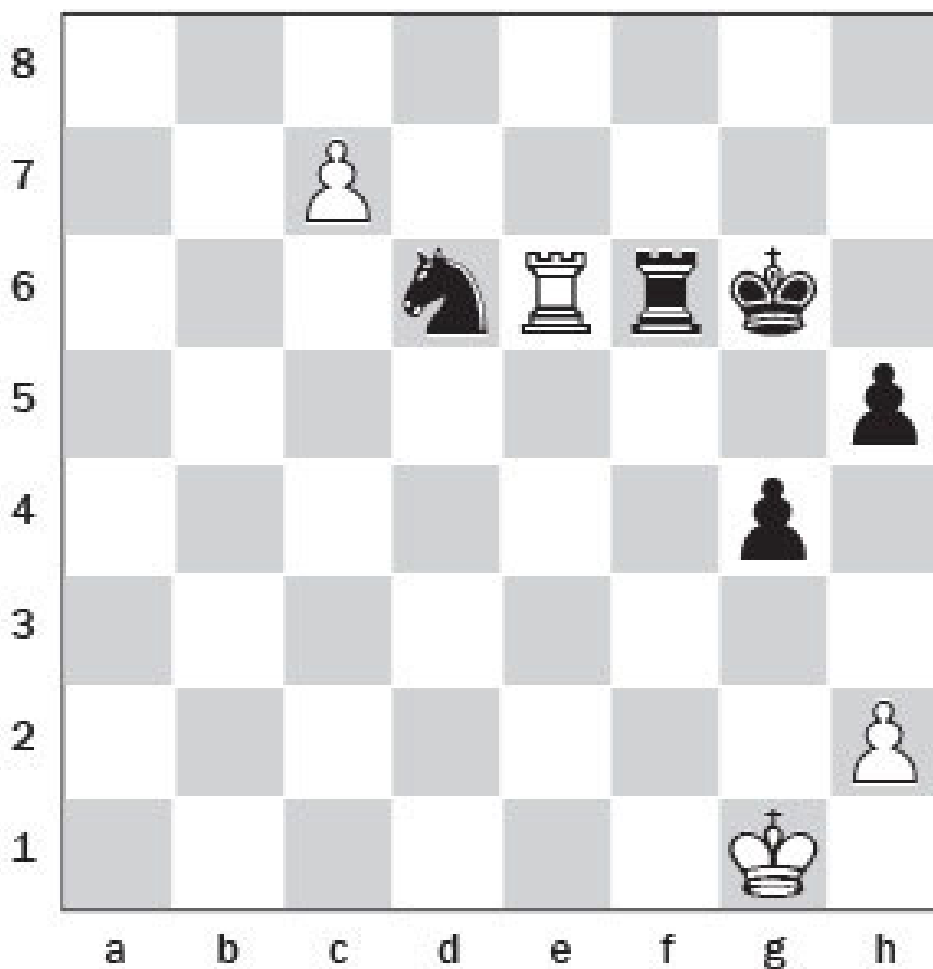
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 278

**278**



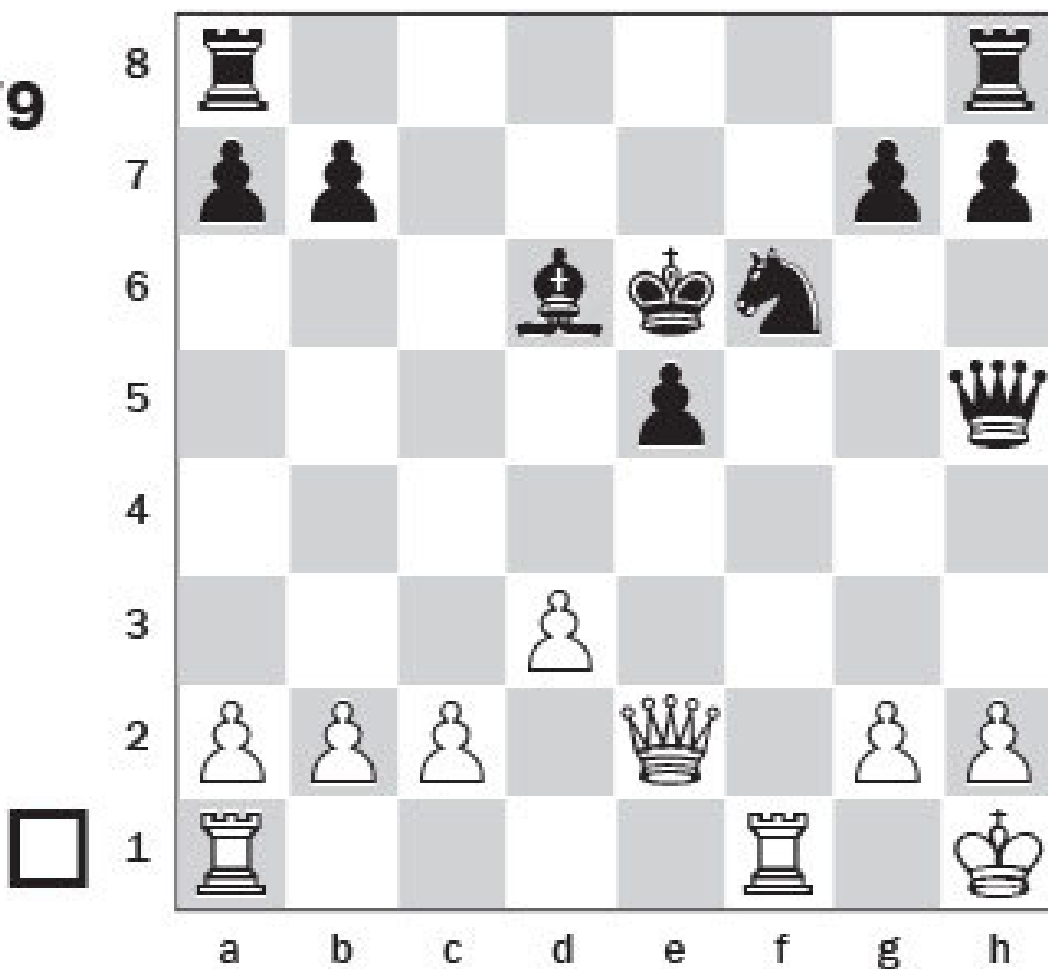
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 279

279



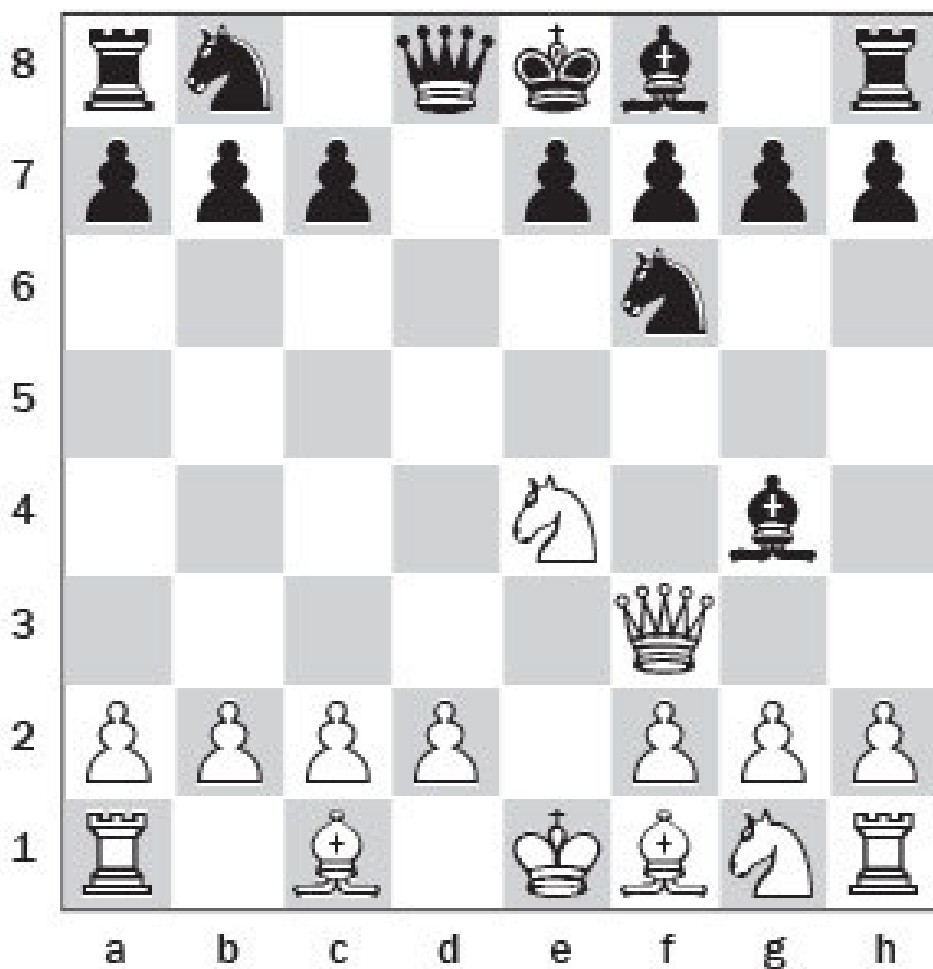
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 280

280



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 281

**281**



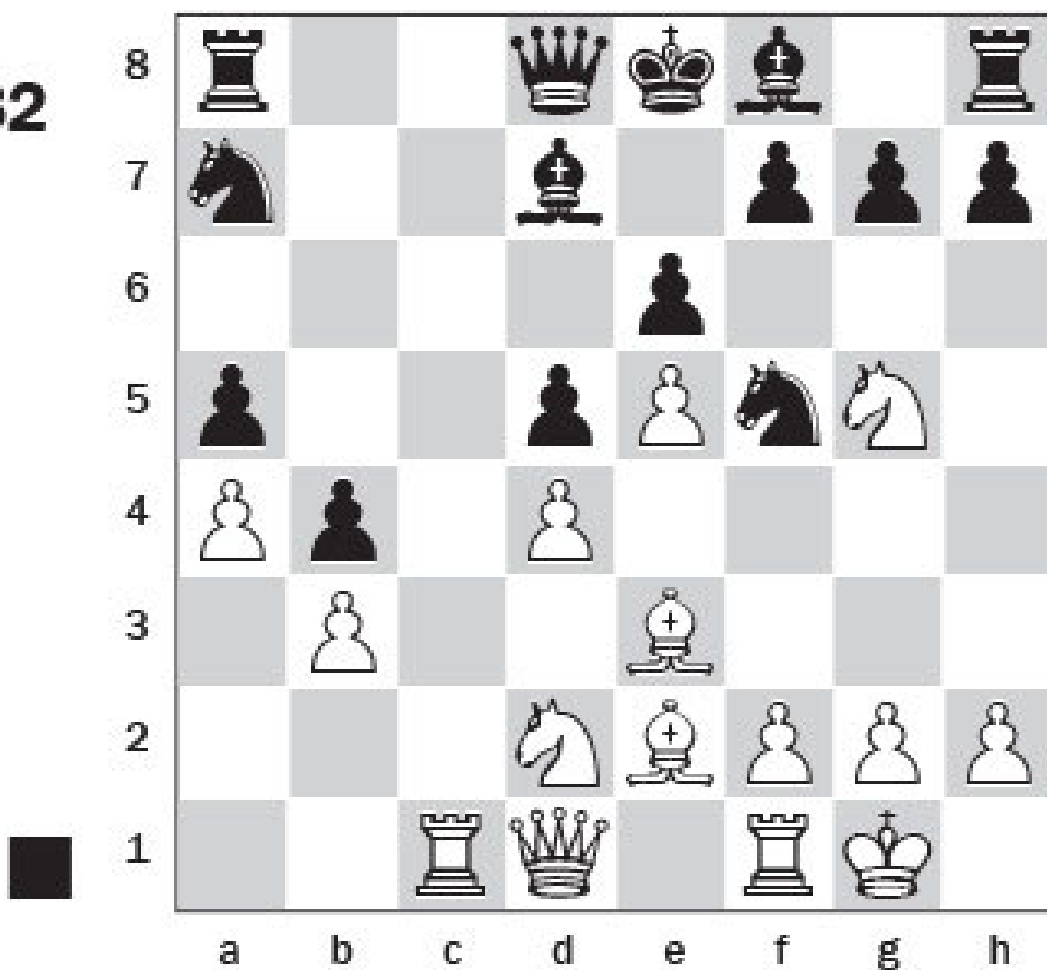
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 282

**282**



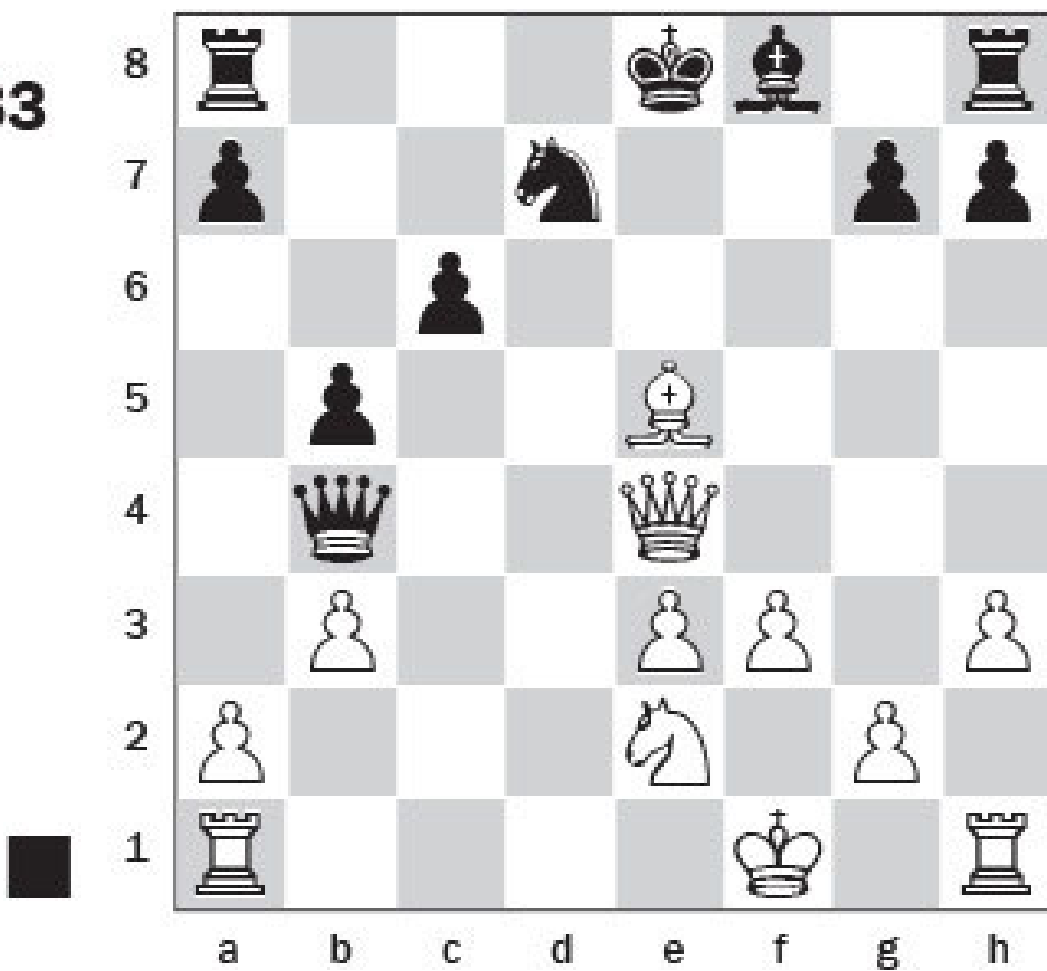
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 283

283



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



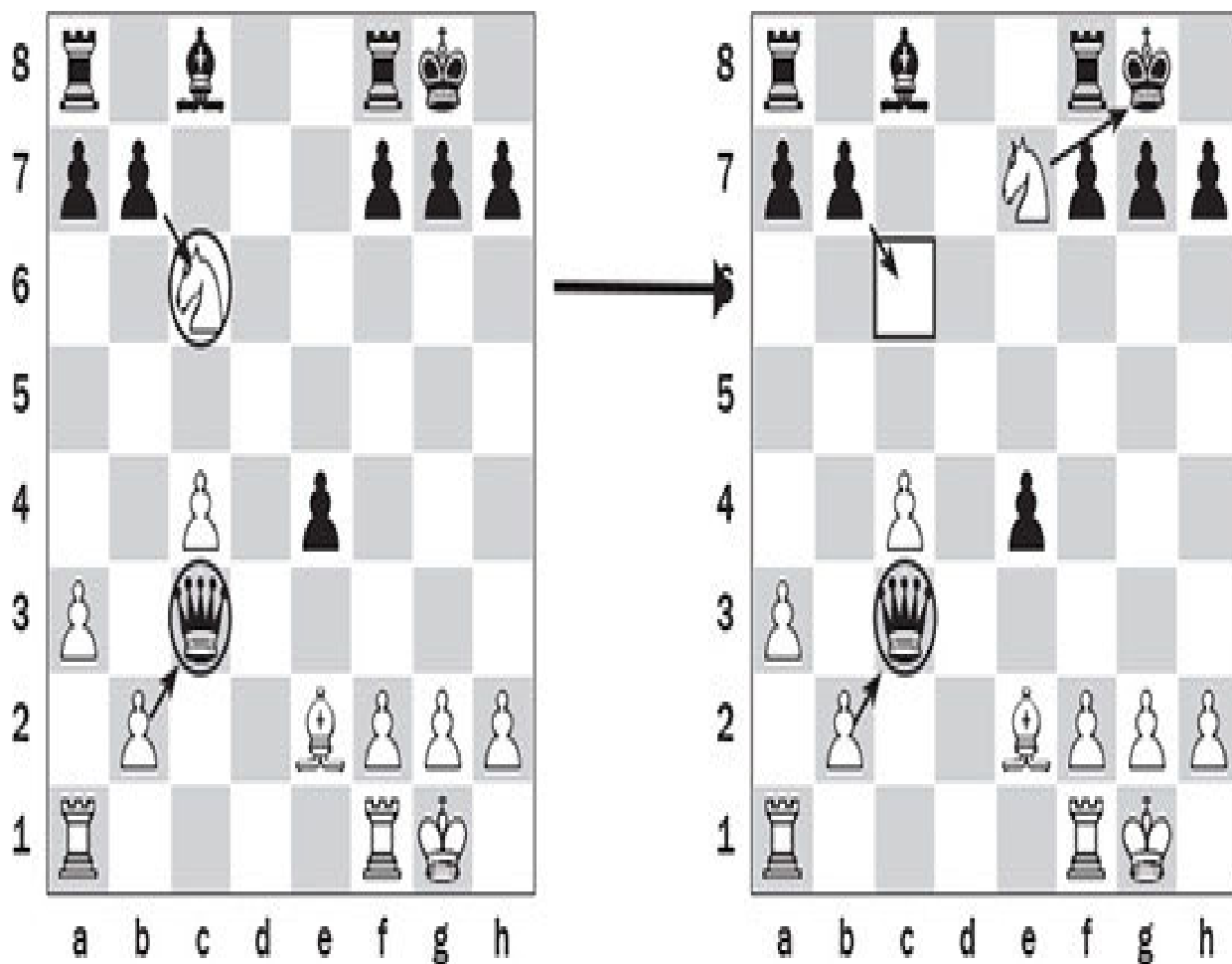
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 11

# In-Between Move

An in-between move is a tactic that occurs when, instead of the playing the anticipated move, we first play a move which creates an equal or greater danger to the opponent.

Note to the student: an in-between move may also be known as a zwischenzug (German), intermezzo (Italian) or intermediate move.



In this position, Black had just captured White's queen on c3. Naturally, Black thought White would take back immediately and then would be able to recapture the knight on c6. However, by using an in-between move, White was able to save the knight!

The best move for White is 1.Ne7+ (see diagram 2).

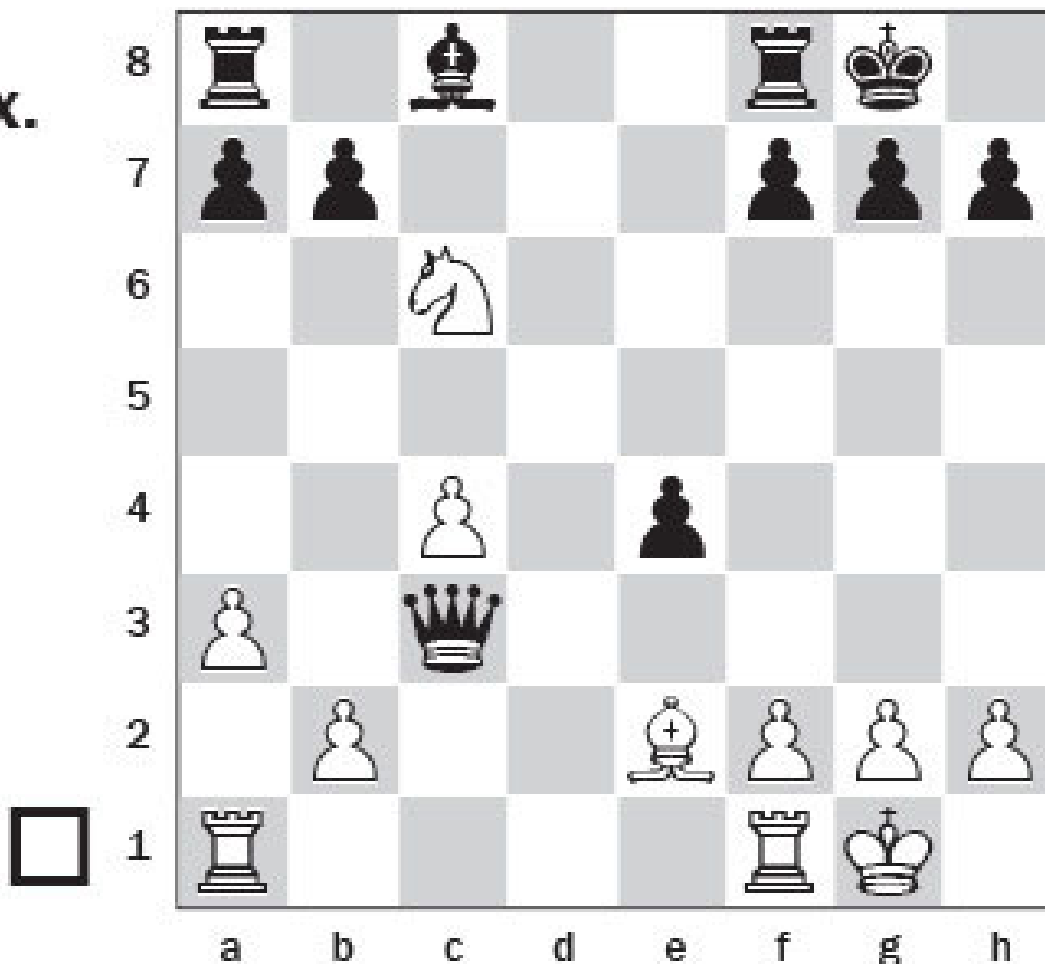
White saves the knight by playing this check first. Now once Black's king moves, White will recapture the queen:

## **1...Kh8 2.bxc3**

In-between moves are quite often missed in practice so it's important to familiarize yourself with them. In order to better solve the problems in this chapter, you should keep a close eye out for all checks possible before recapturing a piece. In addition, look for your opponent's threats.

# In-Between Move – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

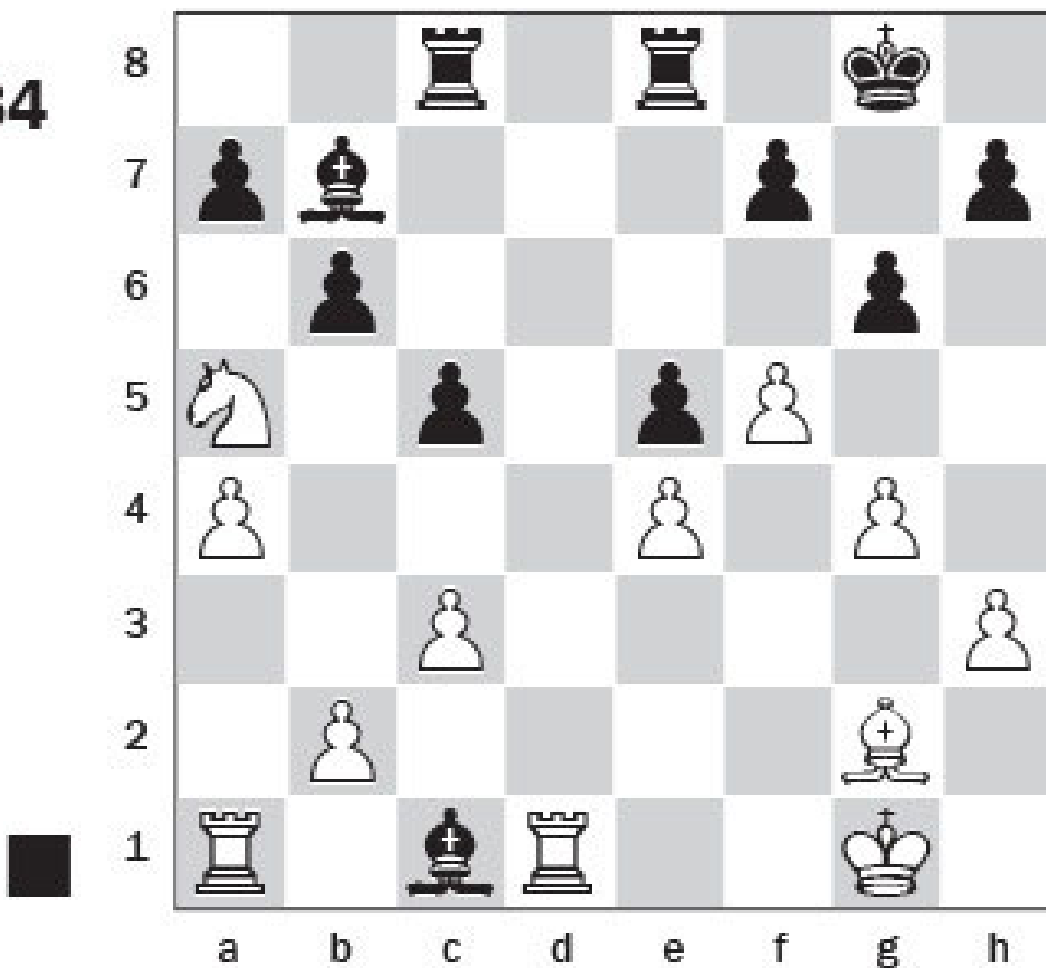
1. Ne7+ Kh8

2. bxc3 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 284

284



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

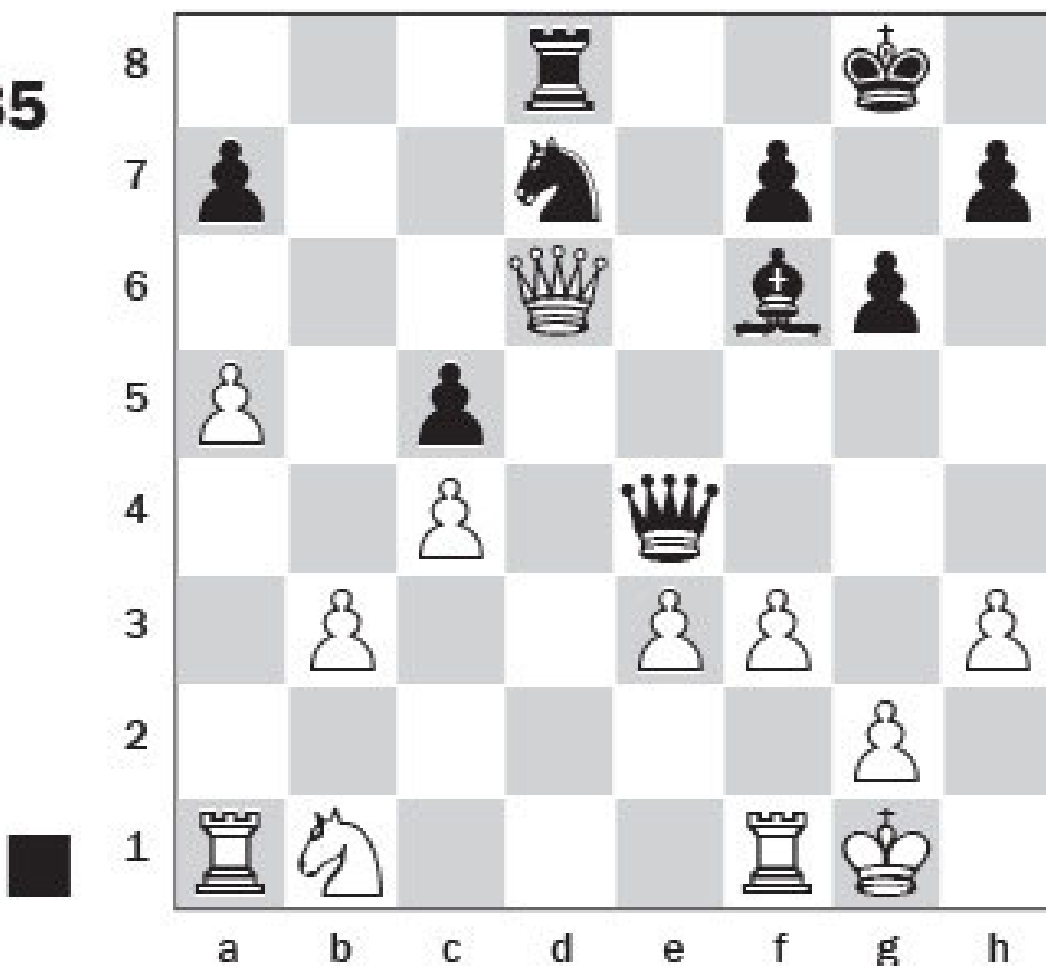
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's knight on a5 is hanging but so is Black's bishop on c1. How can Black save the bishop and then capture the knight?

### Exercise 285

**285**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Black would like to capture the rook on a1 but the queen on e4 is in danger. What should they do first?

### [Exercise 286](#)



286



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

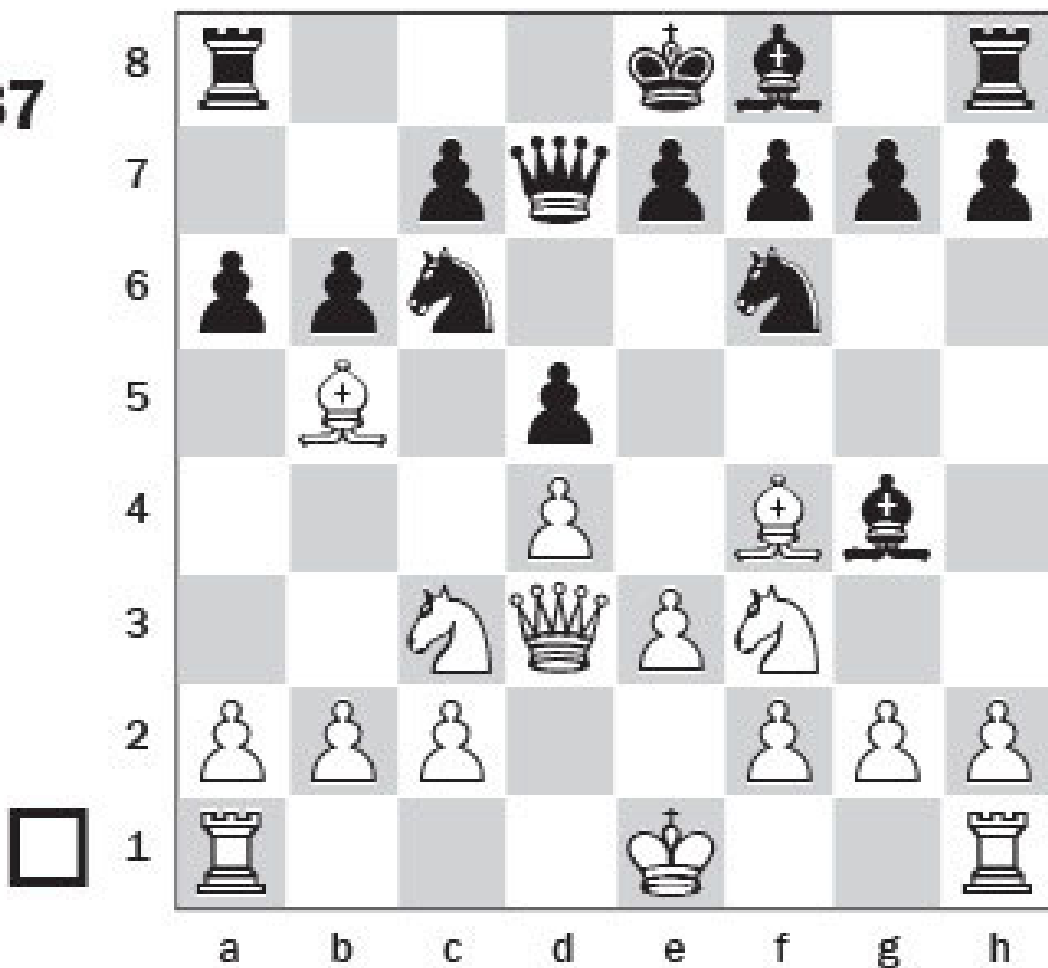
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

White could capture the bishop on g4 but then would lose the knight on c3. What could White do first?

### Exercise 287

287



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

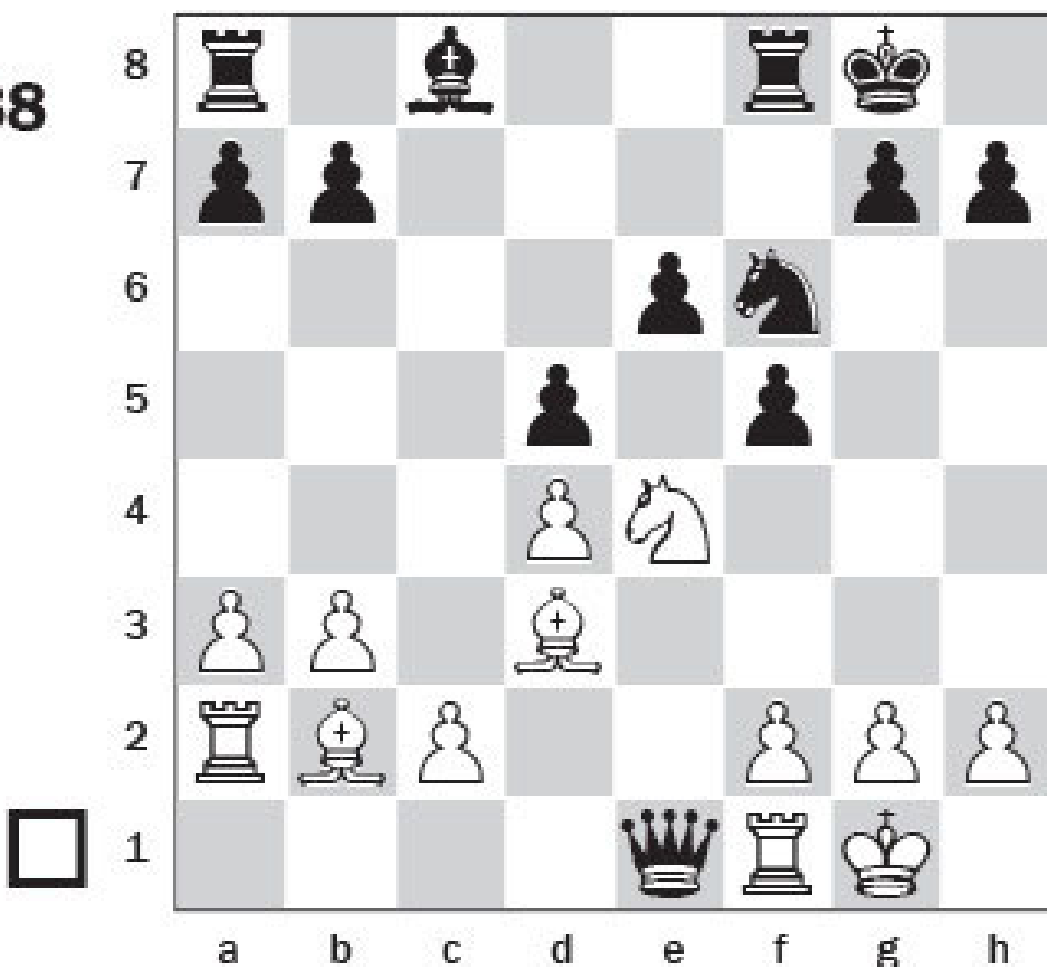
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on b5 is being attacked by the pawn on a6. Can you use an idea from the Forks and Pins chapters to win material?

### Exercise 288

288



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

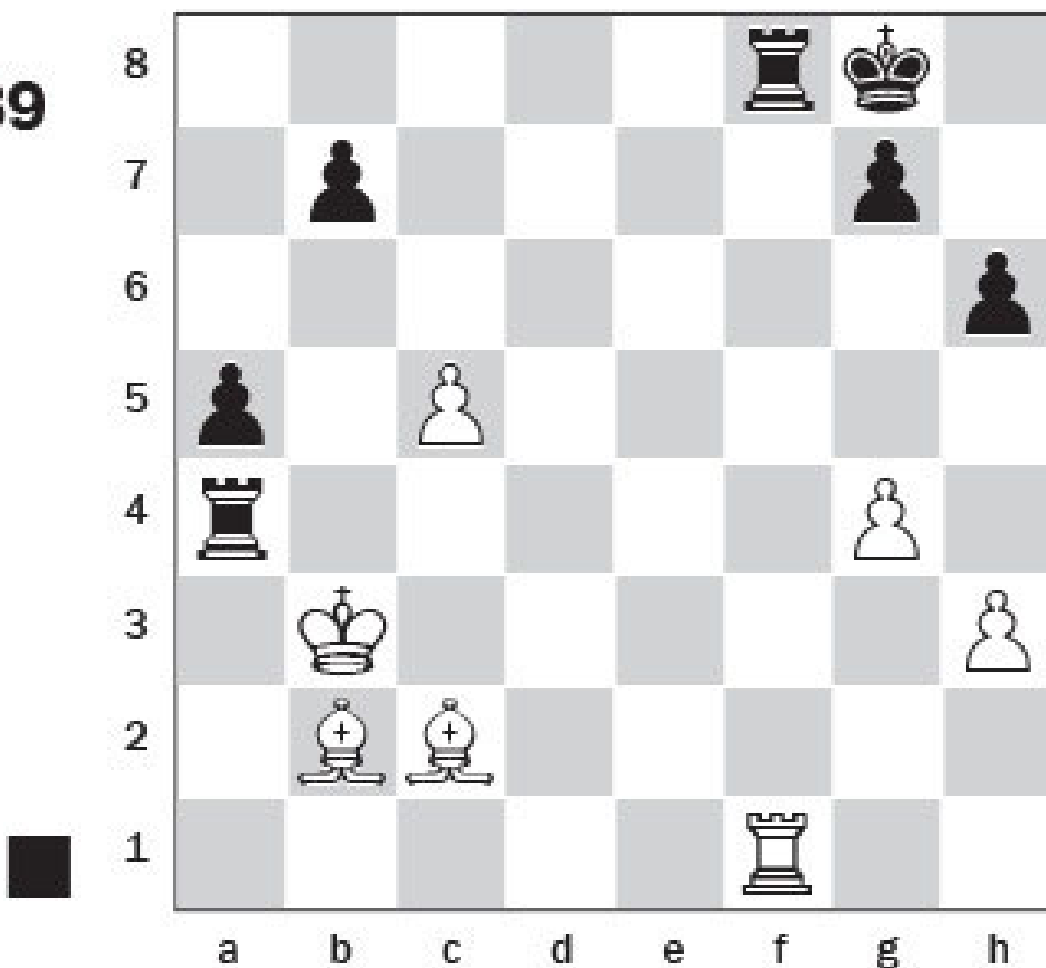
## HINT

White certainly needs to capture Black's queen, but can the knight on e4 be saved first?

# In-Between Move – Test

## Exercise 289

289



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 290

**290**



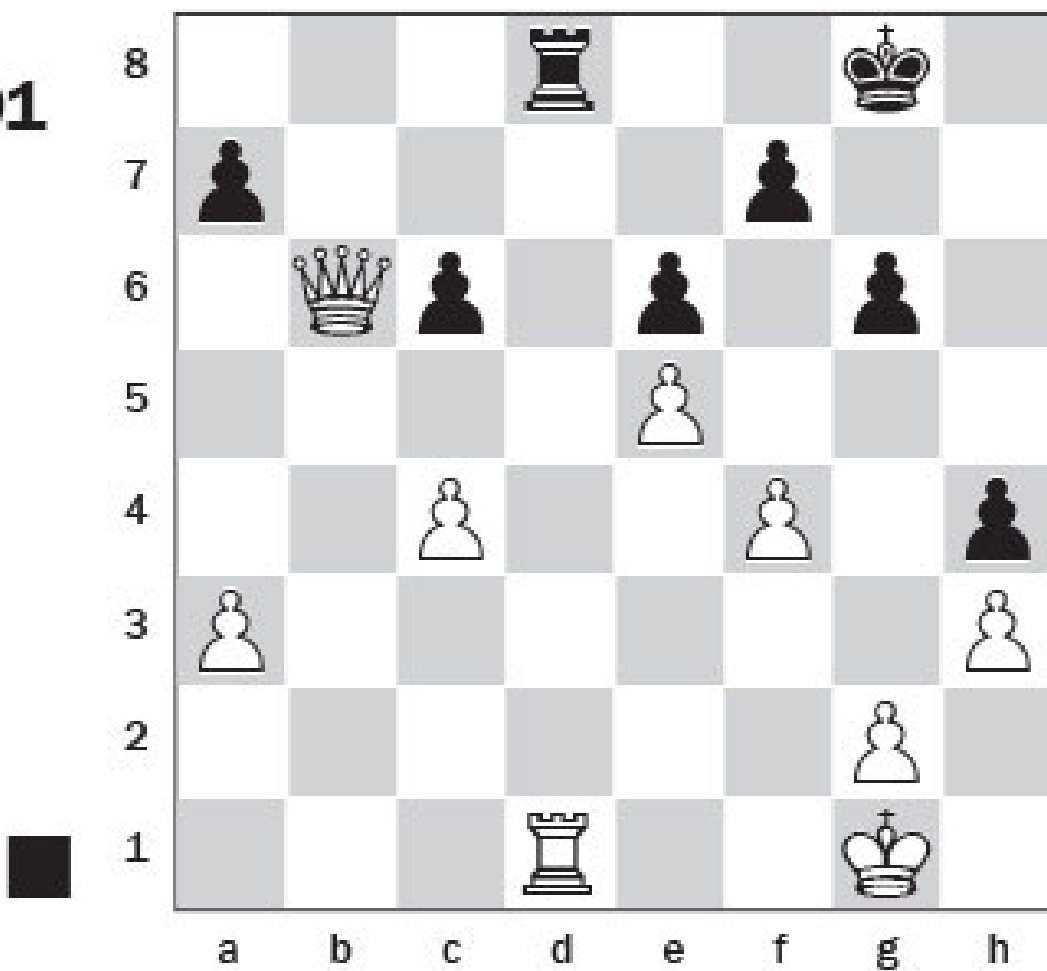
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 291

**291**



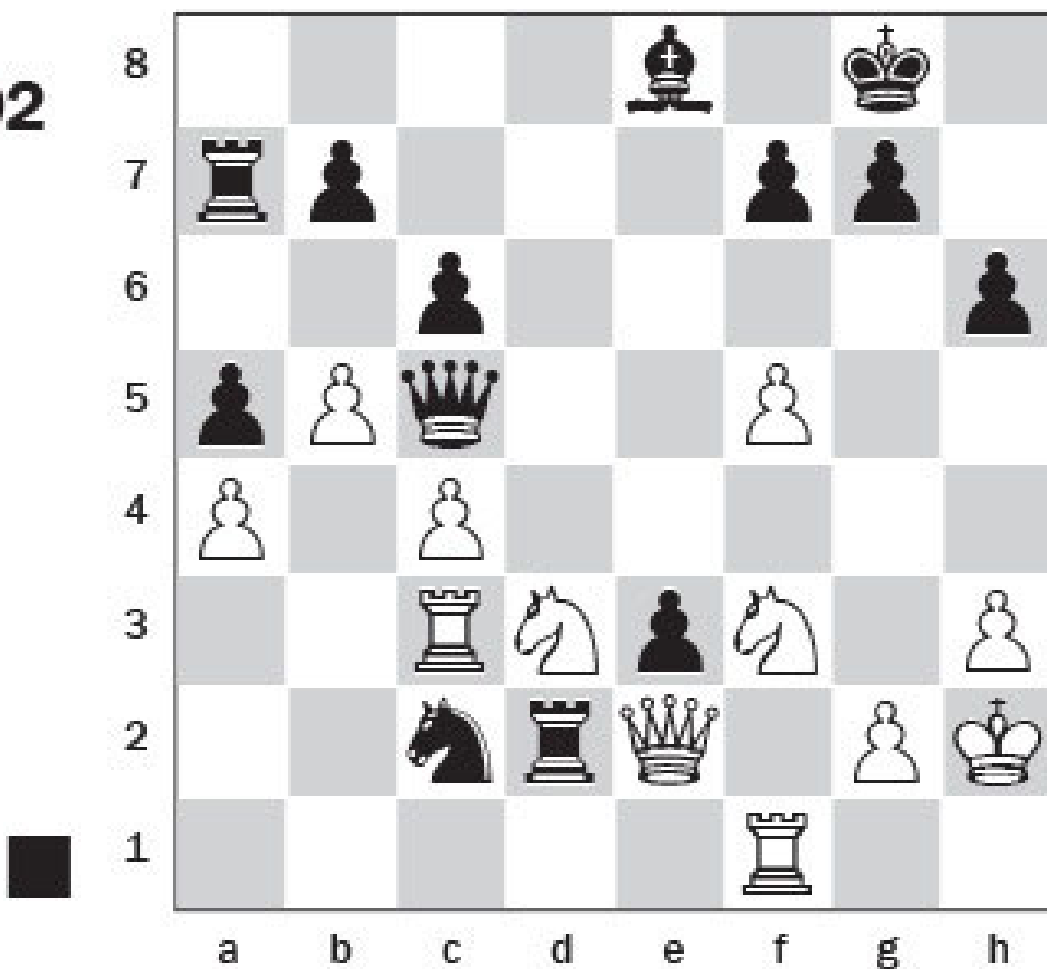
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 292

292



Answer:

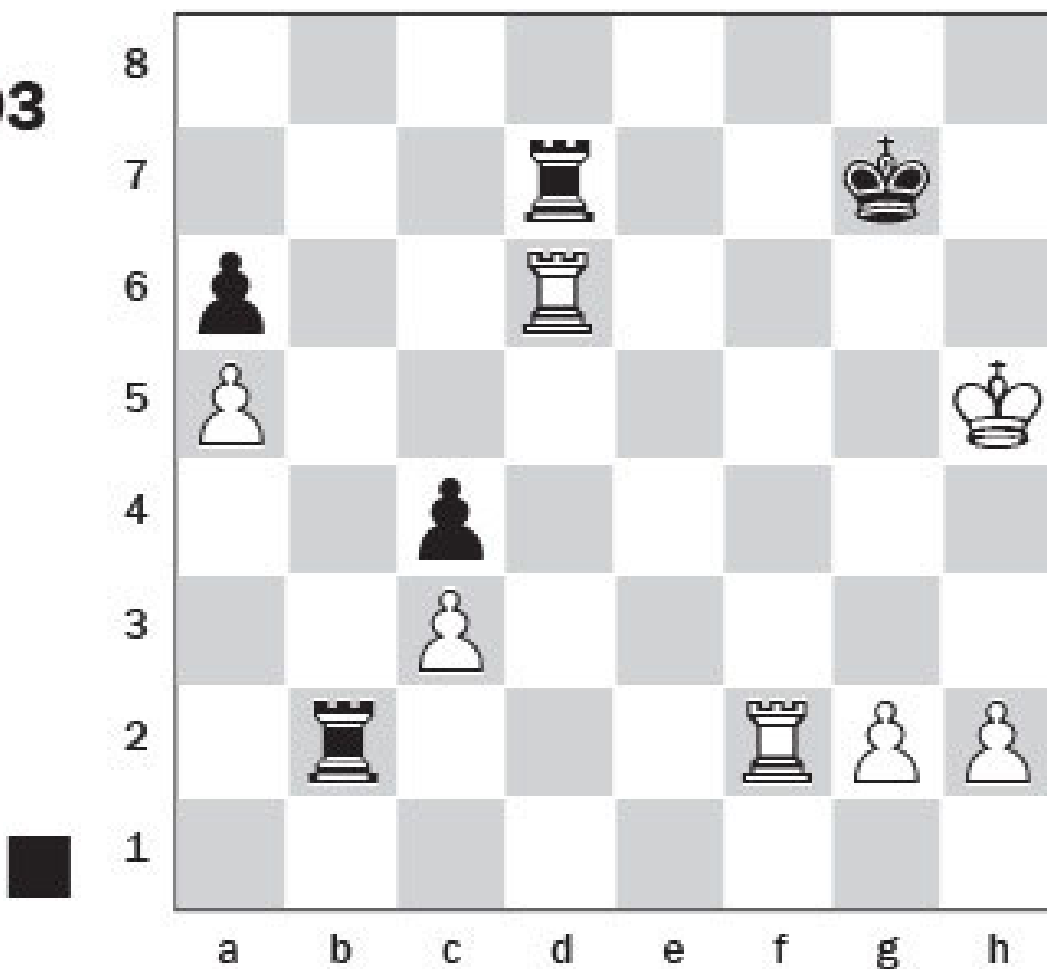
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 293

**293**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 294

**294**



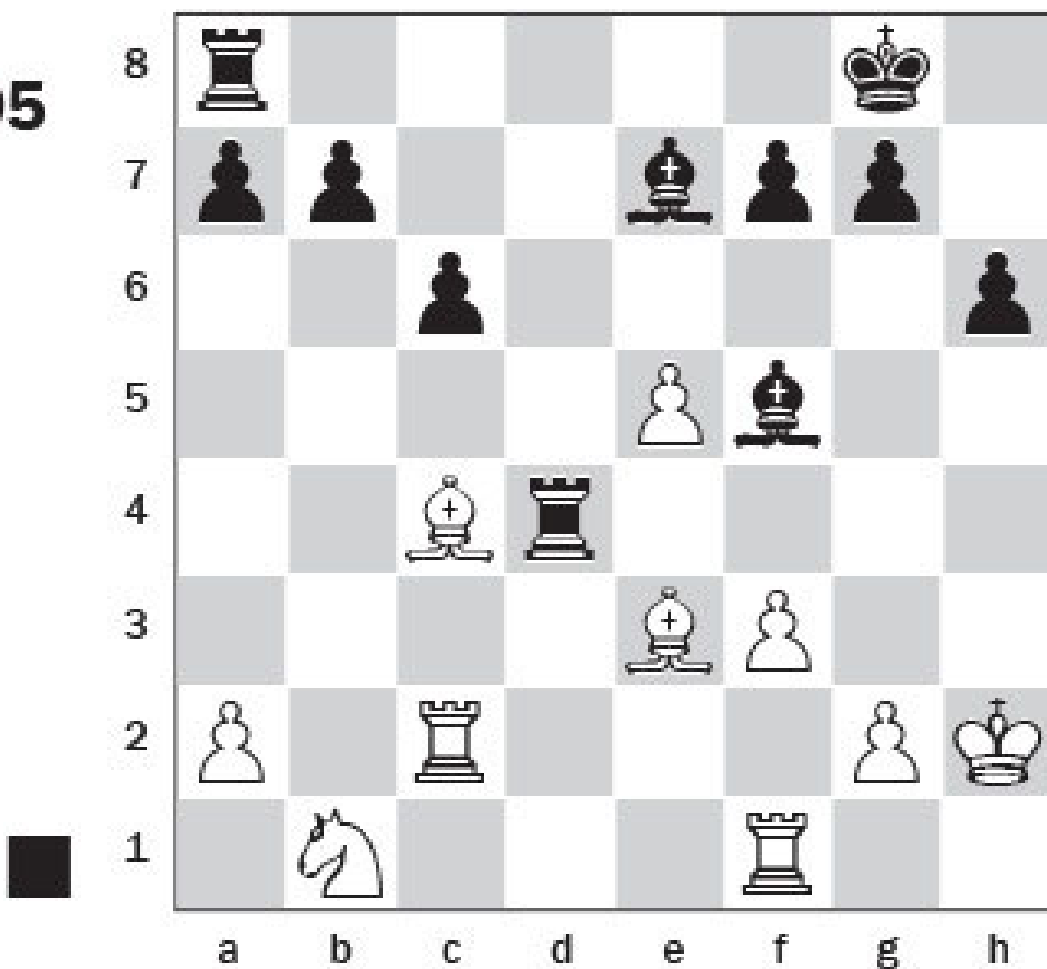
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 295

295



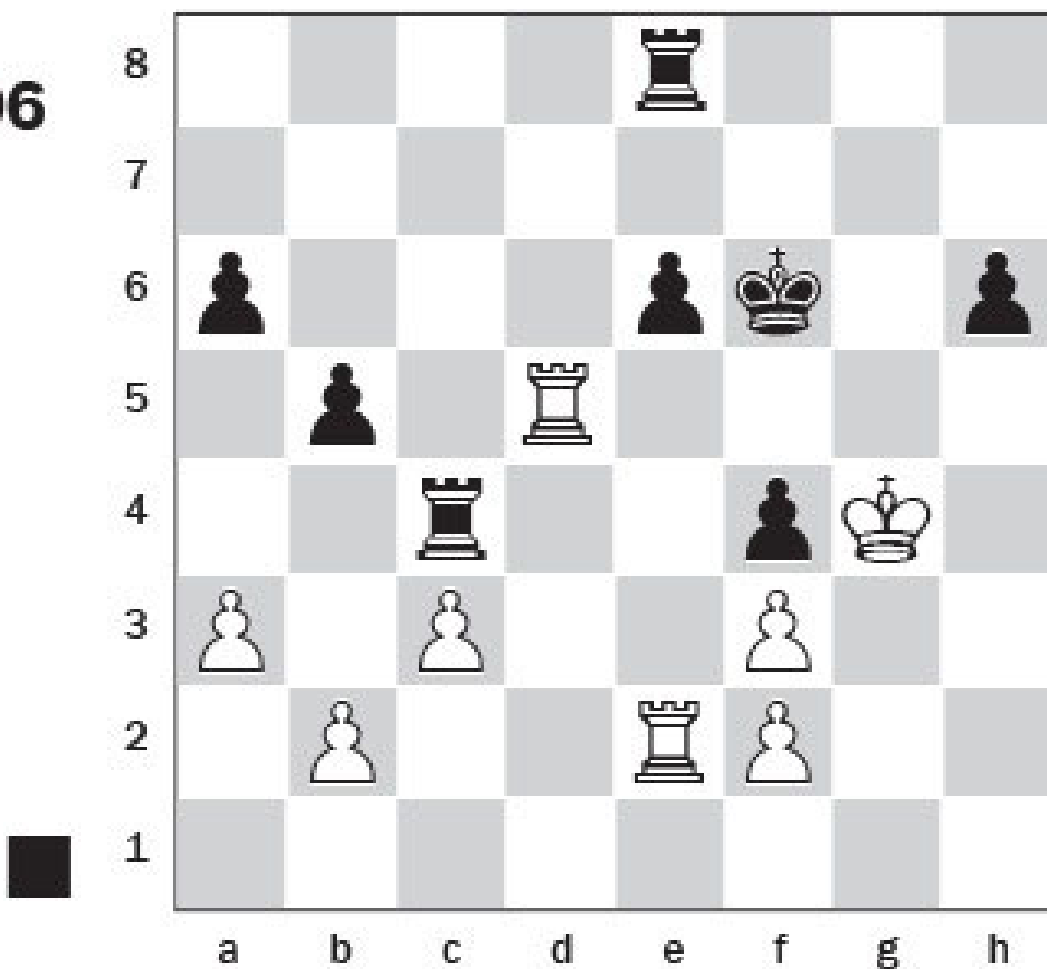
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 296

**296**



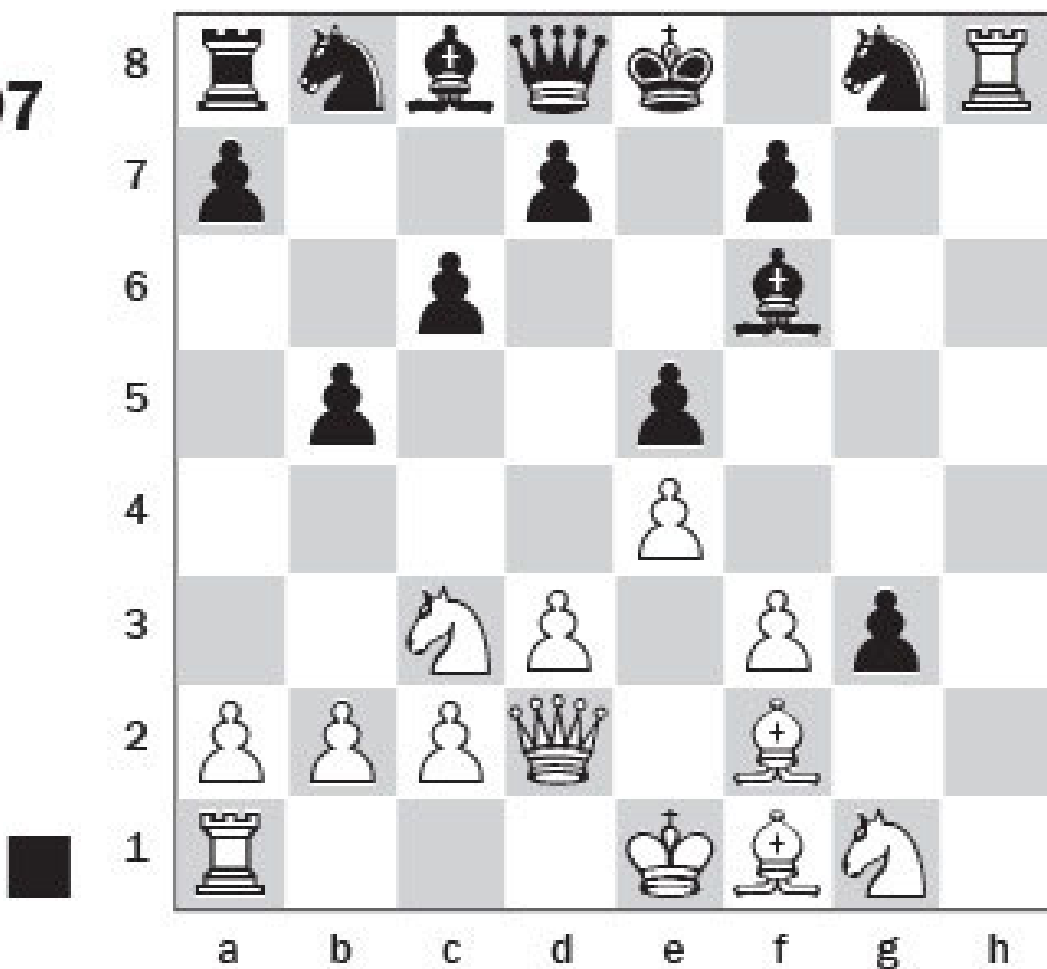
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 297

**297**



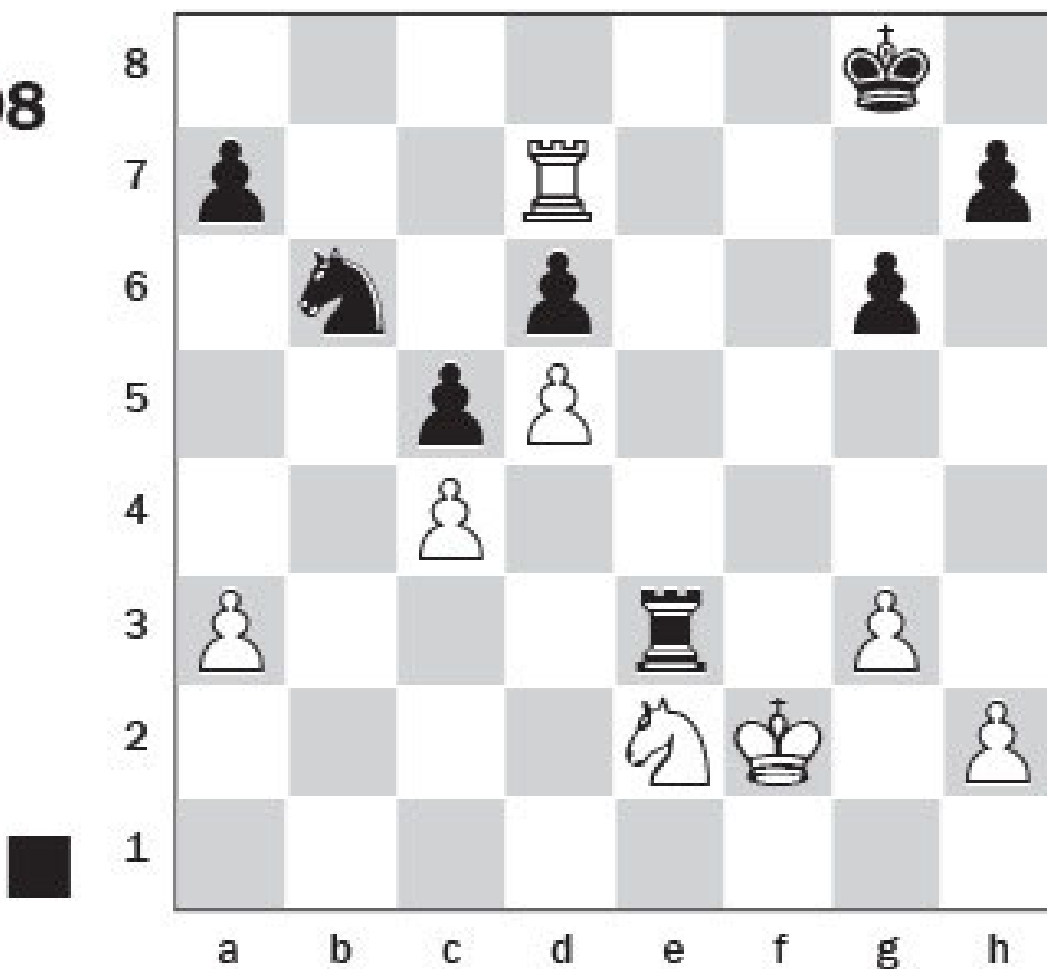
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 298

**298**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 299

299



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 300

300



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 301

**301**



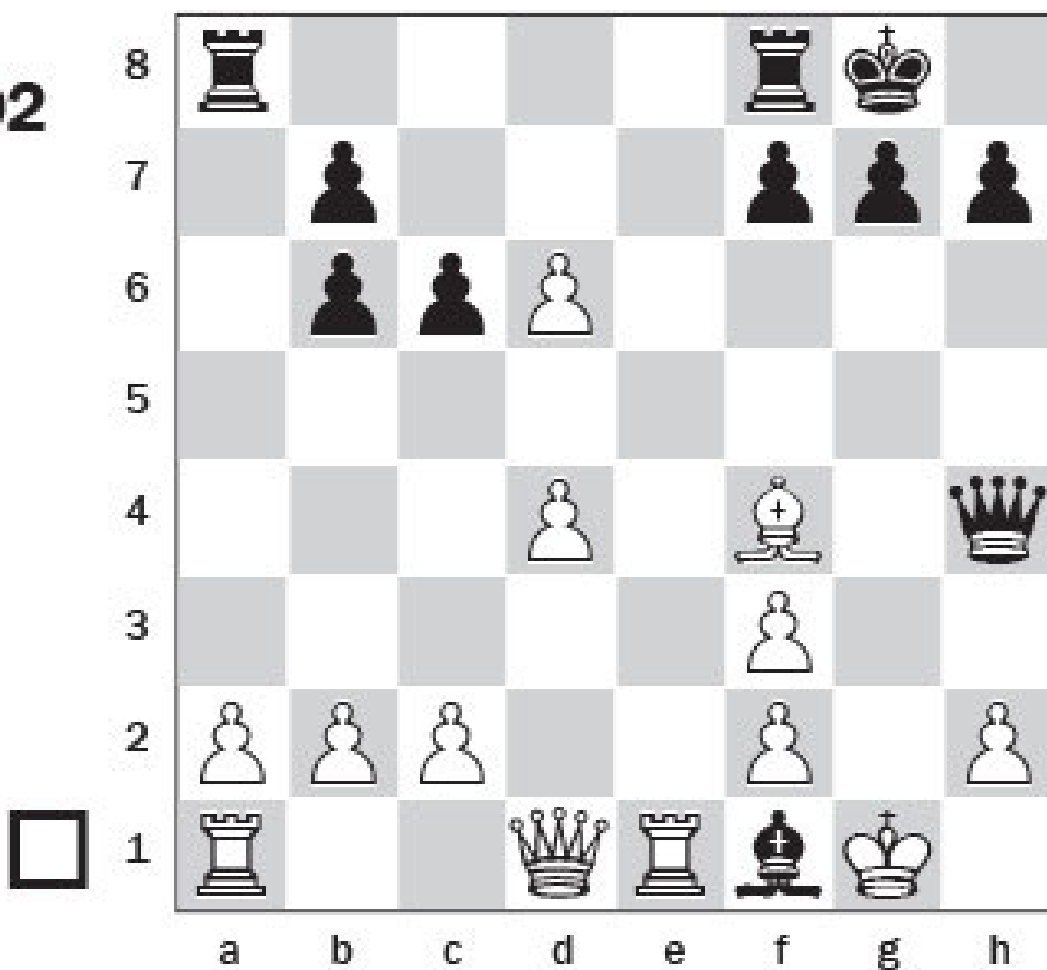
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 302

302



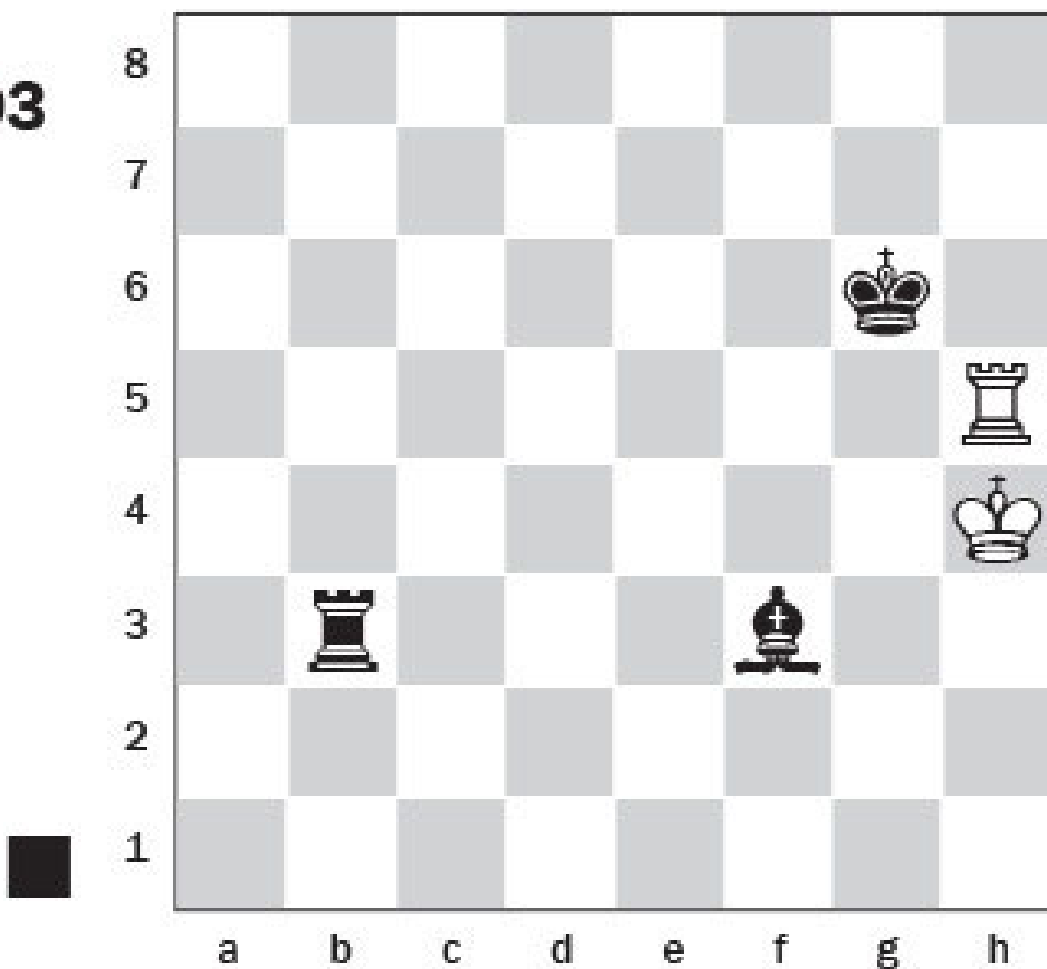
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 303

**303**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

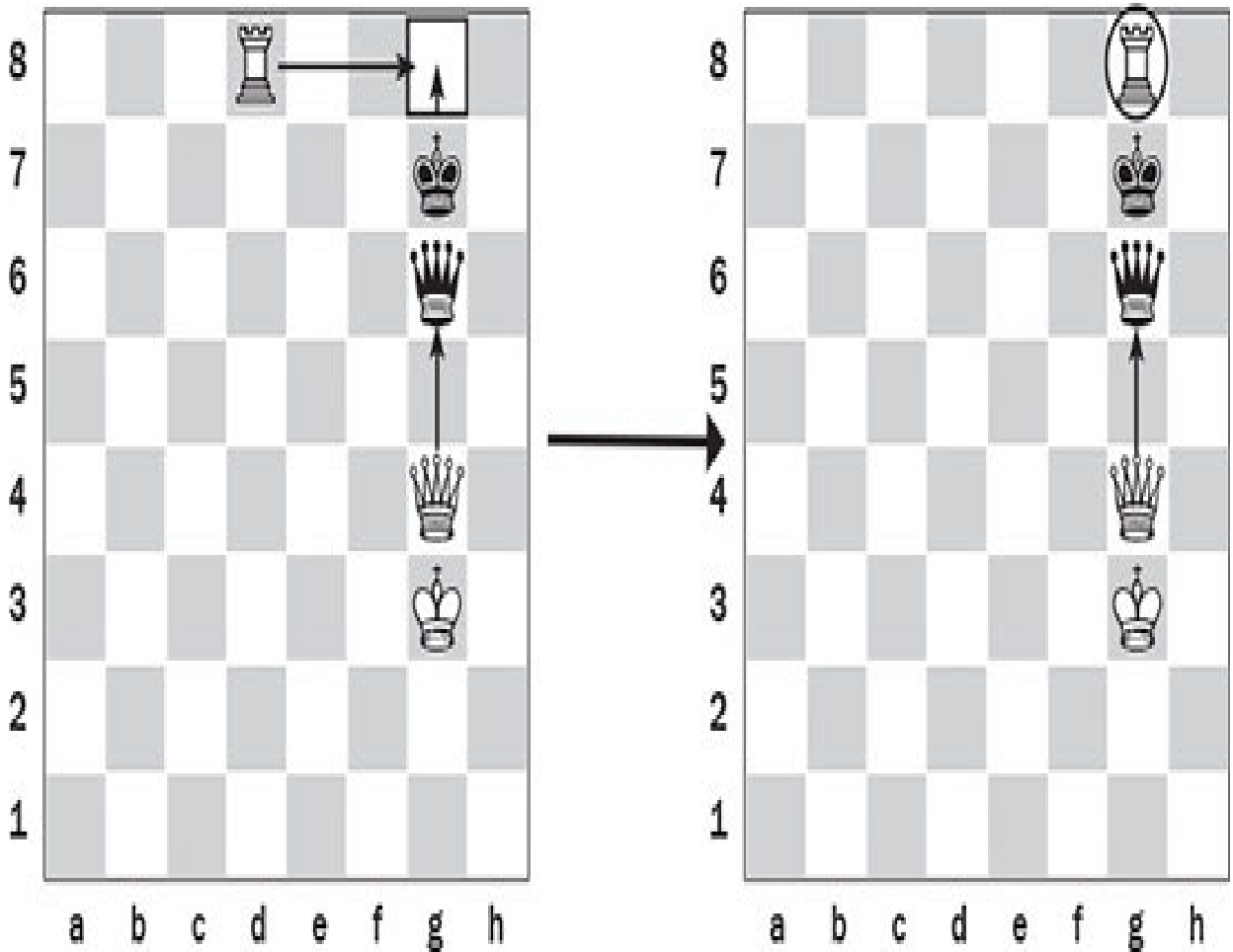
## CHAPTER 12

# Decoy

A decoy tactic involves distracting or luring away the defender from its defensive position. There are two types of decoy tactics and for simplicity I have included them both in this chapter. Deflection and attraction are both types of decoy chess tactics designed to distract a piece away from a particular square. To help better understand the differences between them, I will define them here and show an example of each.

## Deflection

The first type of decoy tactic is a 'deflection'. A deflection is a sacrifice designed to lure a piece **AWAY** from the defense of another piece or against a threat.



Here, White is attacking the black queen, but it's protected by the king. White can distract the black king away from the queen by sacrificing the rook with...

**1.Rg8+ (see diagram 2)**

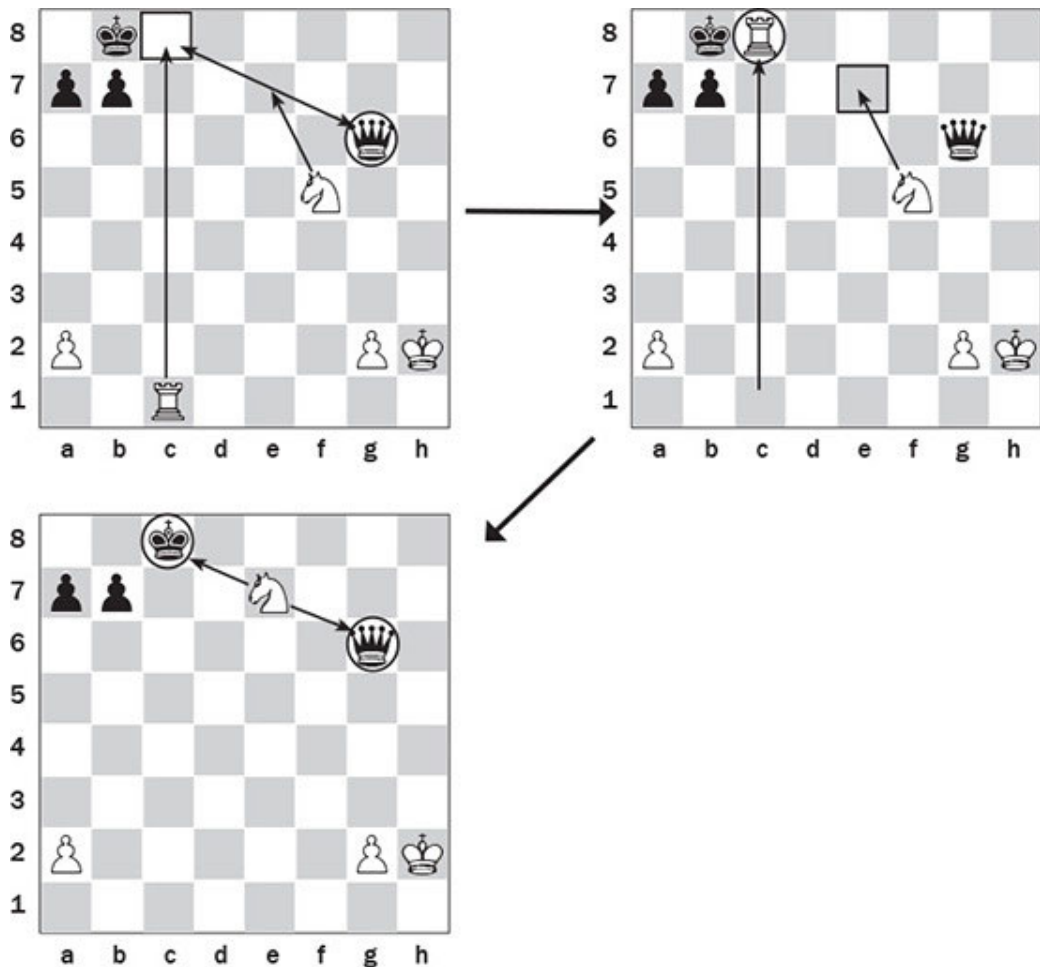
... which skewers the king and queen. Initially this may not be a move on your radar, but once you notice that it distracts the king away from the queen, you will recognize its strength.

1...Kxg8 2.Qxg6+

Here White has won a queen for a rook and has a winning advantage.

## Attraction

Attraction is also a form of decoy tactic but is a little different from a deflection. In attraction, you are trying to lure a piece TO a particular square, so that you can set up a tactic on the piece thereafter.



Here White recognizes that if the black king were on the c8-square, the white knight would be able to fork the king and queen by using the knight. Therefore White played:

**1.Rc8+ (see diagram 2)**

An alarming move! White wants to 'attract' the king to the c8-square where then it will be vulnerable to the fork.

**1...Kxc8 2.Ne7+ (see diagram 3) 2...Kd7 3.Nxg6**

The attraction tactic won Black's queen for only a rook. White now has a winning advantage.

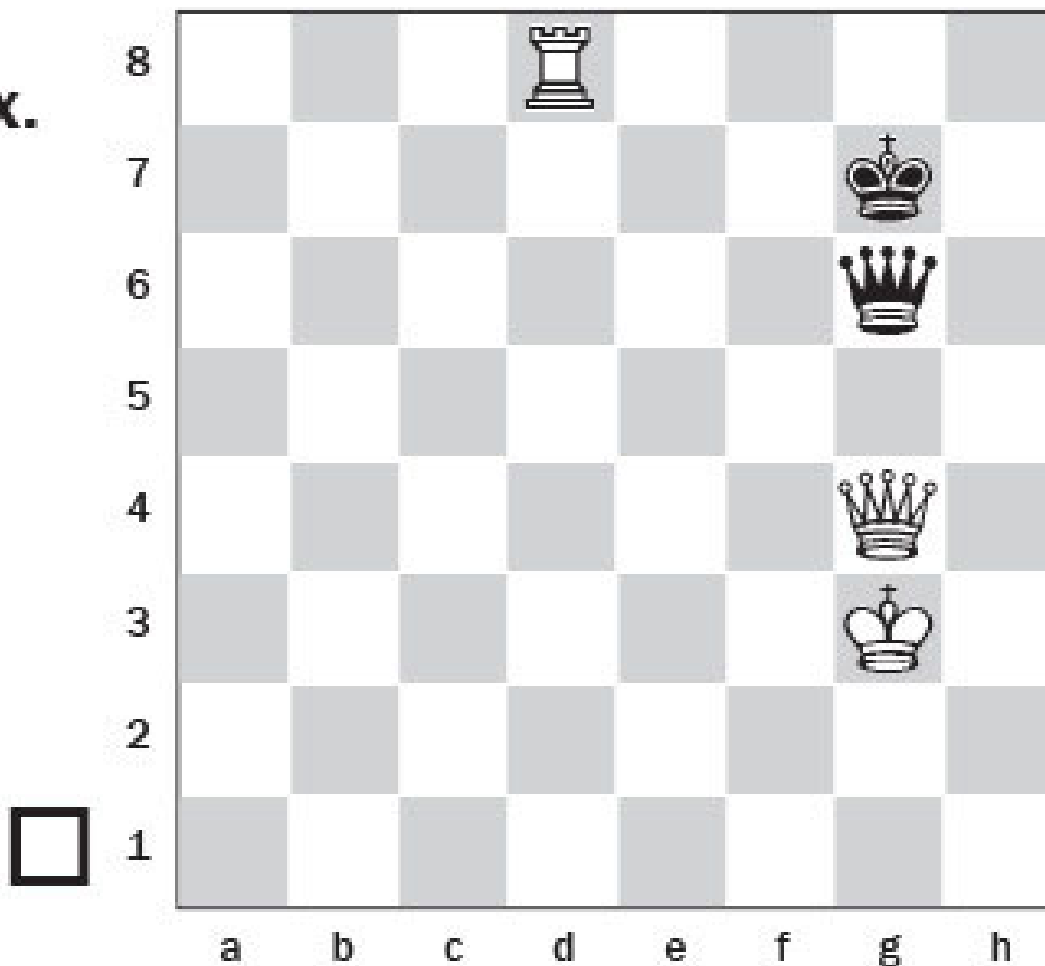
Because the chapters in Part II of this book are tactics in one move, we will not see attraction tactics until Part III. Attraction tactics need to be set up first, and thus must take more than one move. Having said that, I wanted to be sure that you understand the difference between a deflection and an attraction tactic. Both of them are forms of distraction or decoy tactics.

To better solve the puzzles in this chapter, look for a piece that's guarding another and try to distract it away from the defense.



# Decoy – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

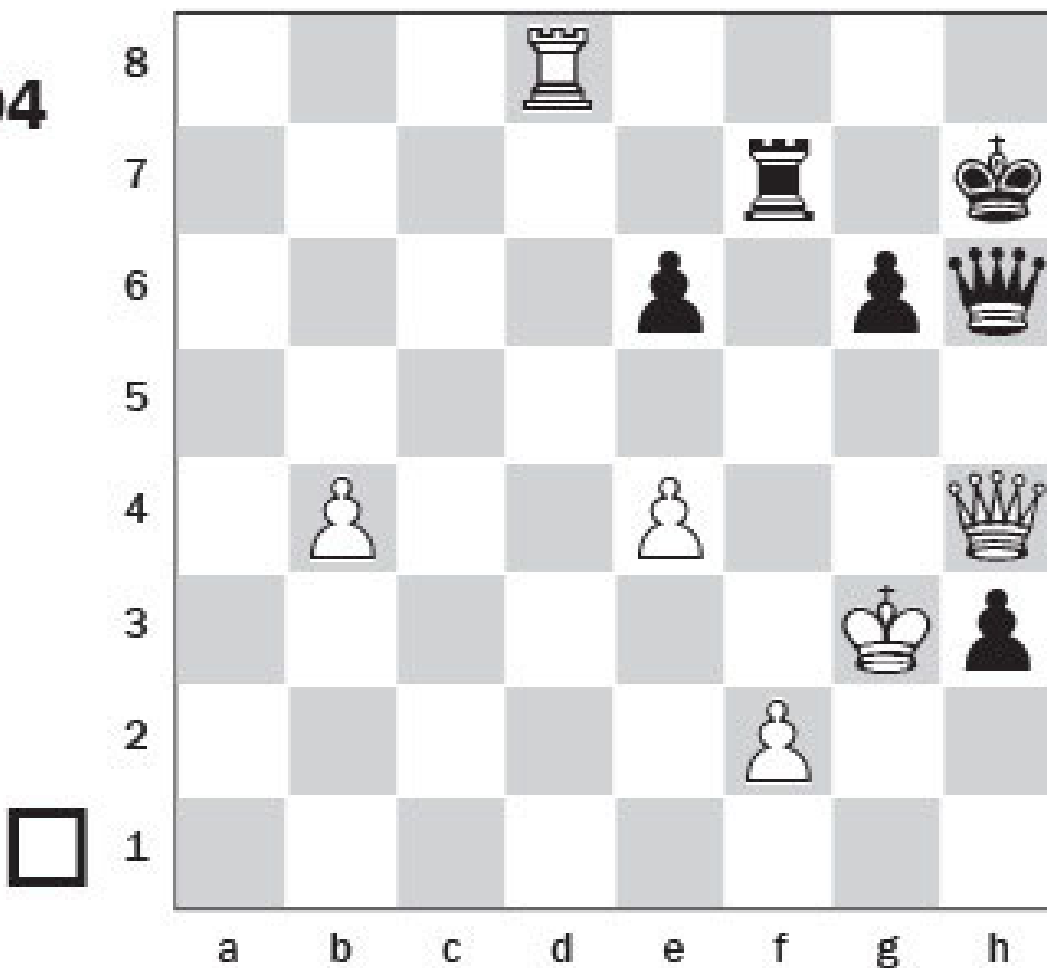
1. Rg8+ Kxg8

2. Qxg6+ \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 304

**304**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

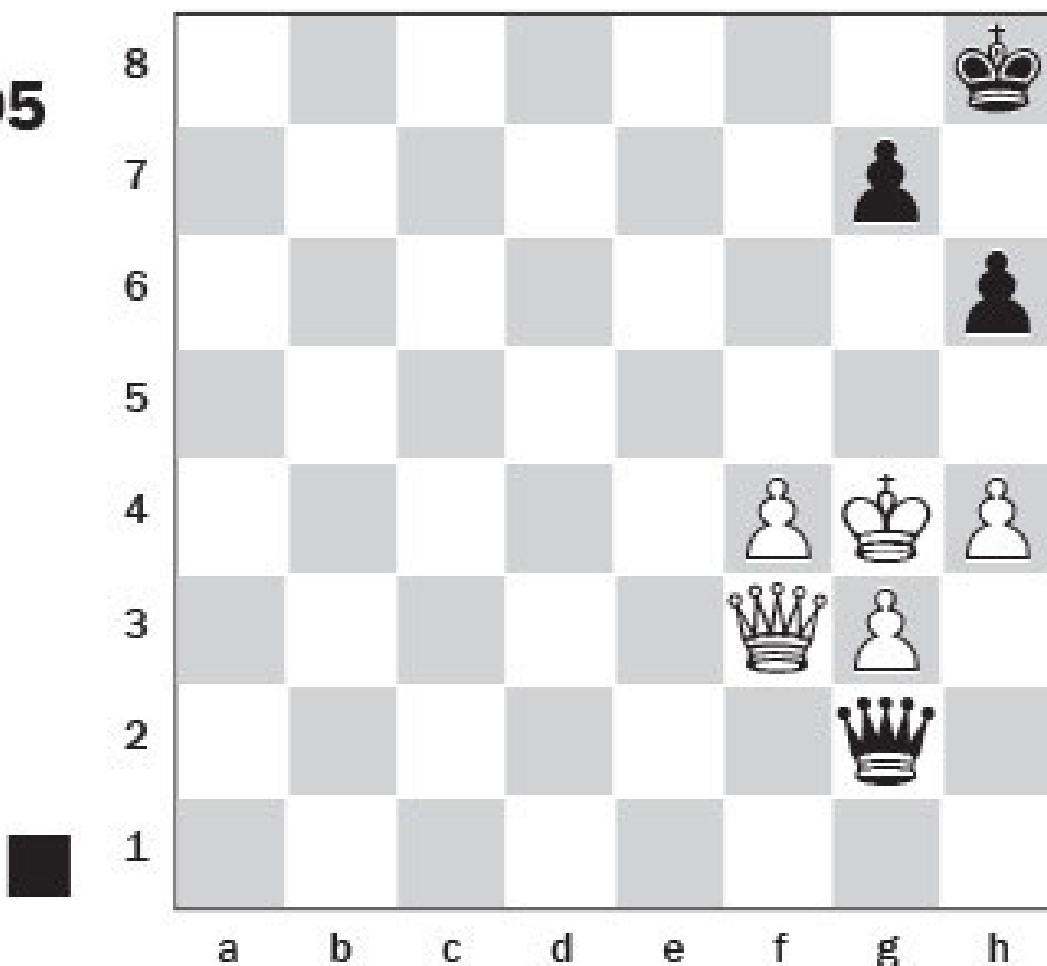
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Only Black's king guards the queen. Is there a way White can deflect the king?

### Exercise 305

**305**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Only the king guards the queen. How can Black distract the king?

### [Exercise 306](#)

306



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

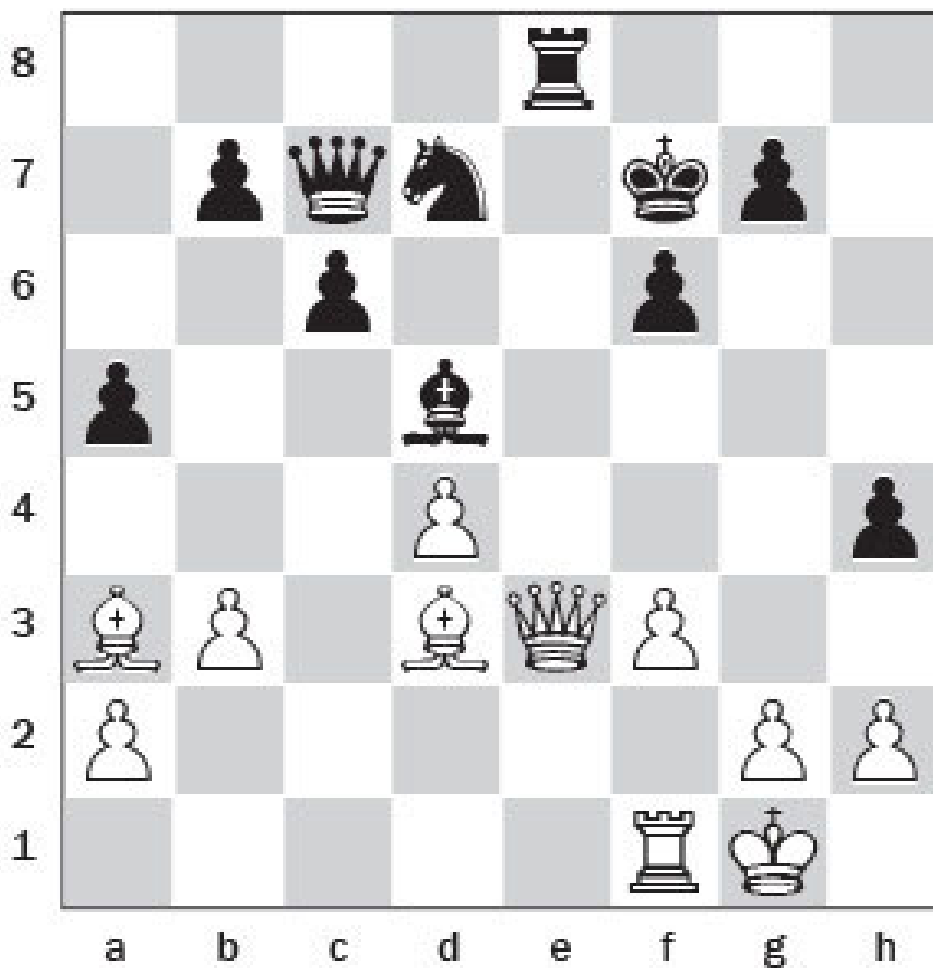
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

The king guards the queen on d8. How can White deflect the king?

## Exercise 307

307



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

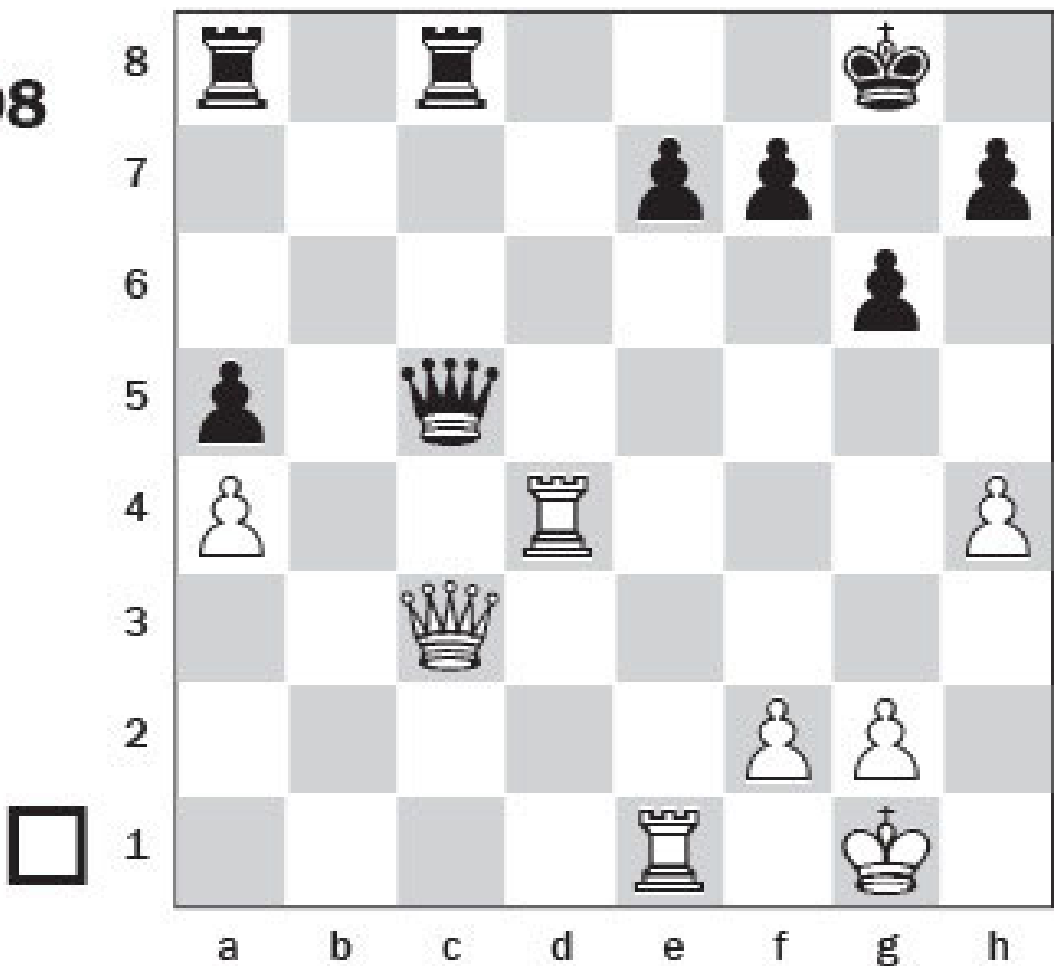
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The king on f7 guards the rook on e8. Use a deflection and give away a bishop to win the rook.

### Exercise 308

308



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on c8 is guarding the queen. Is there any way White can distract the rook?



# Decoy – Test

## Exercise 309

309



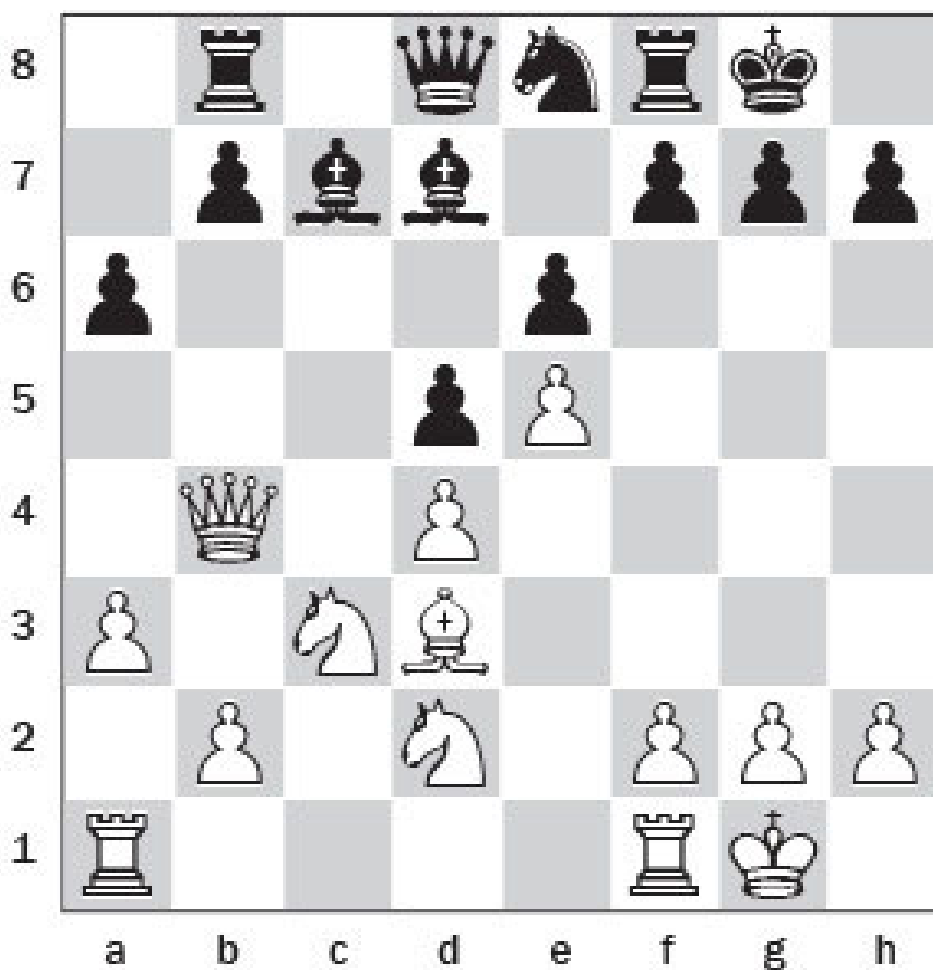
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 310

310



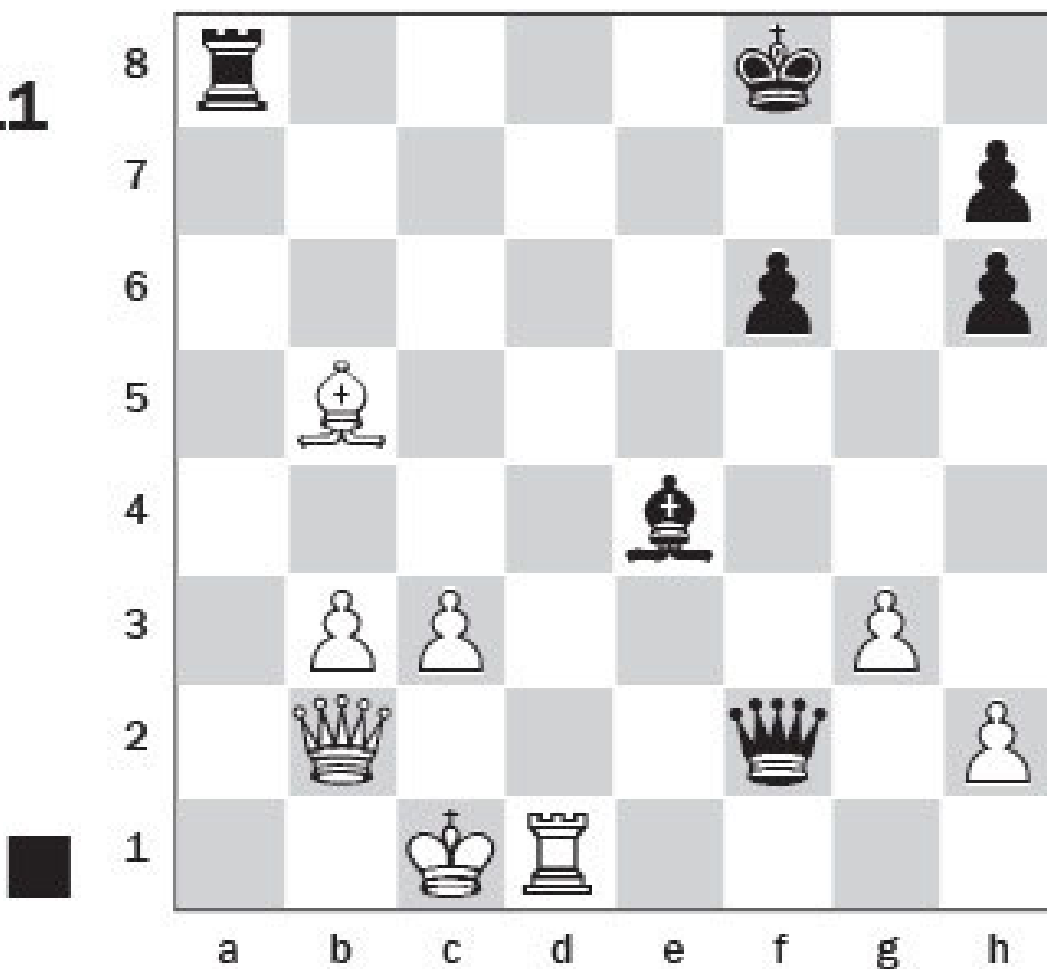
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 311

**311**



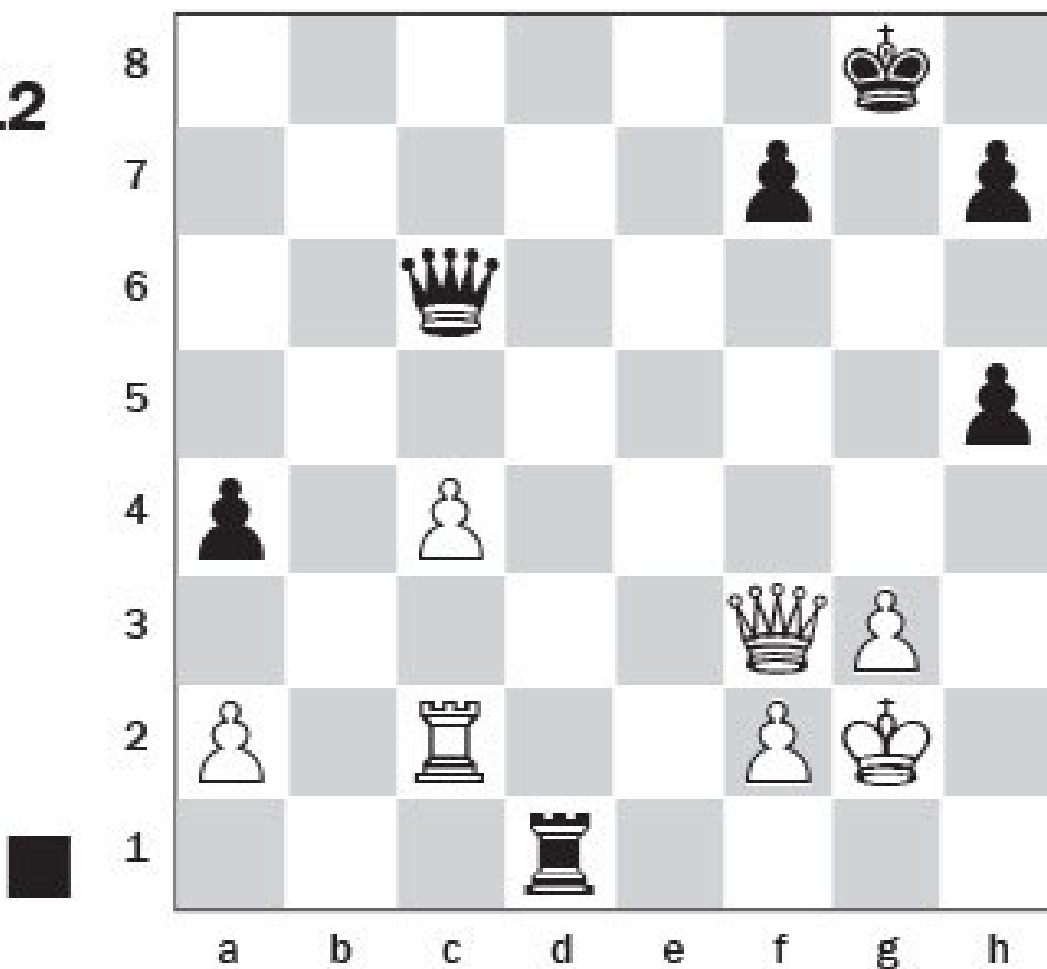
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 312

**312**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 313

**313**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 314

**314**



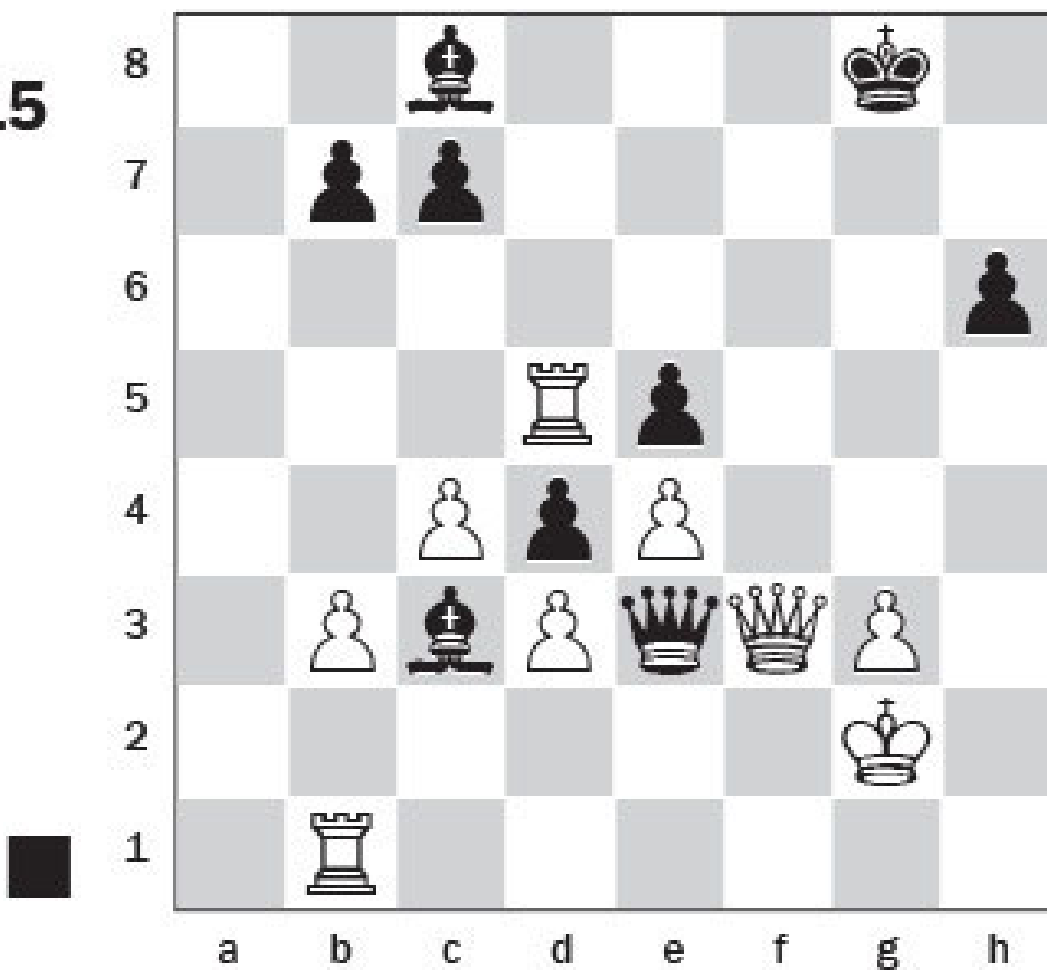
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 315

**315**



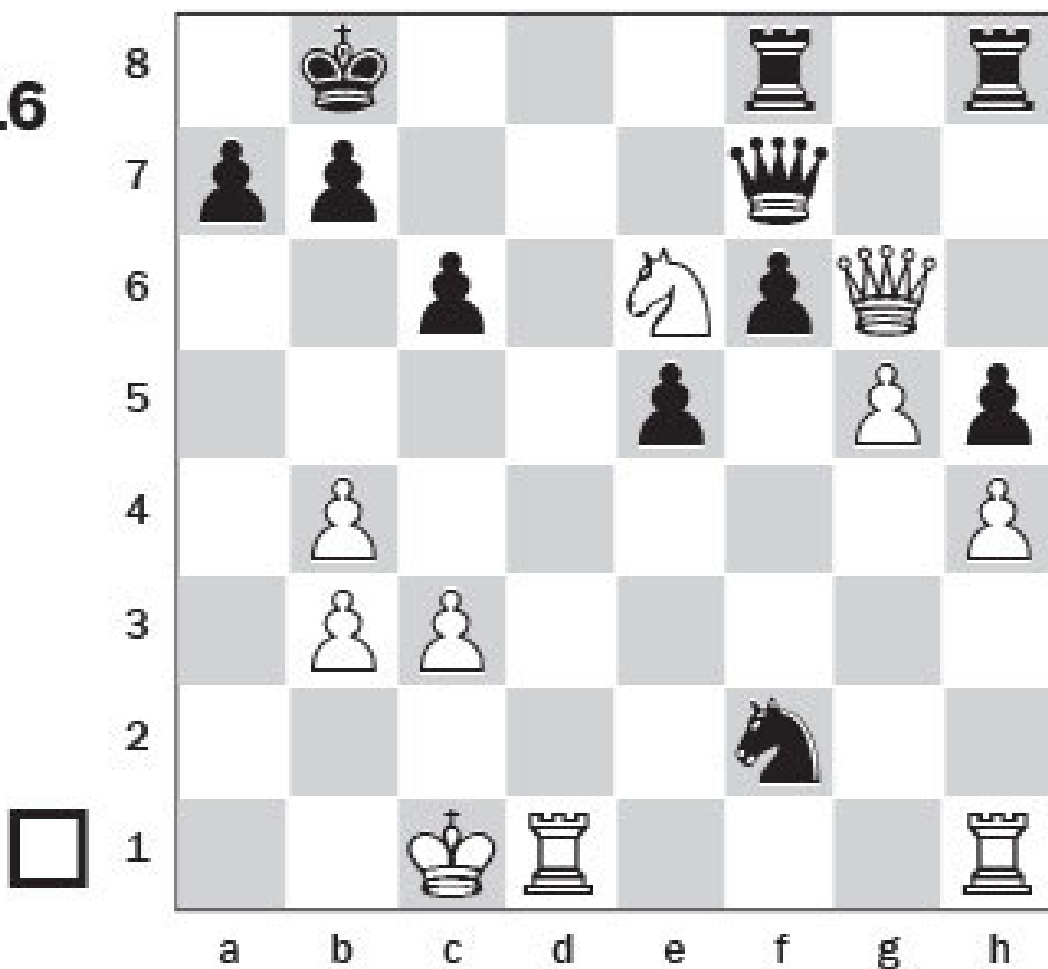
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 316

**316**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 317

**317**



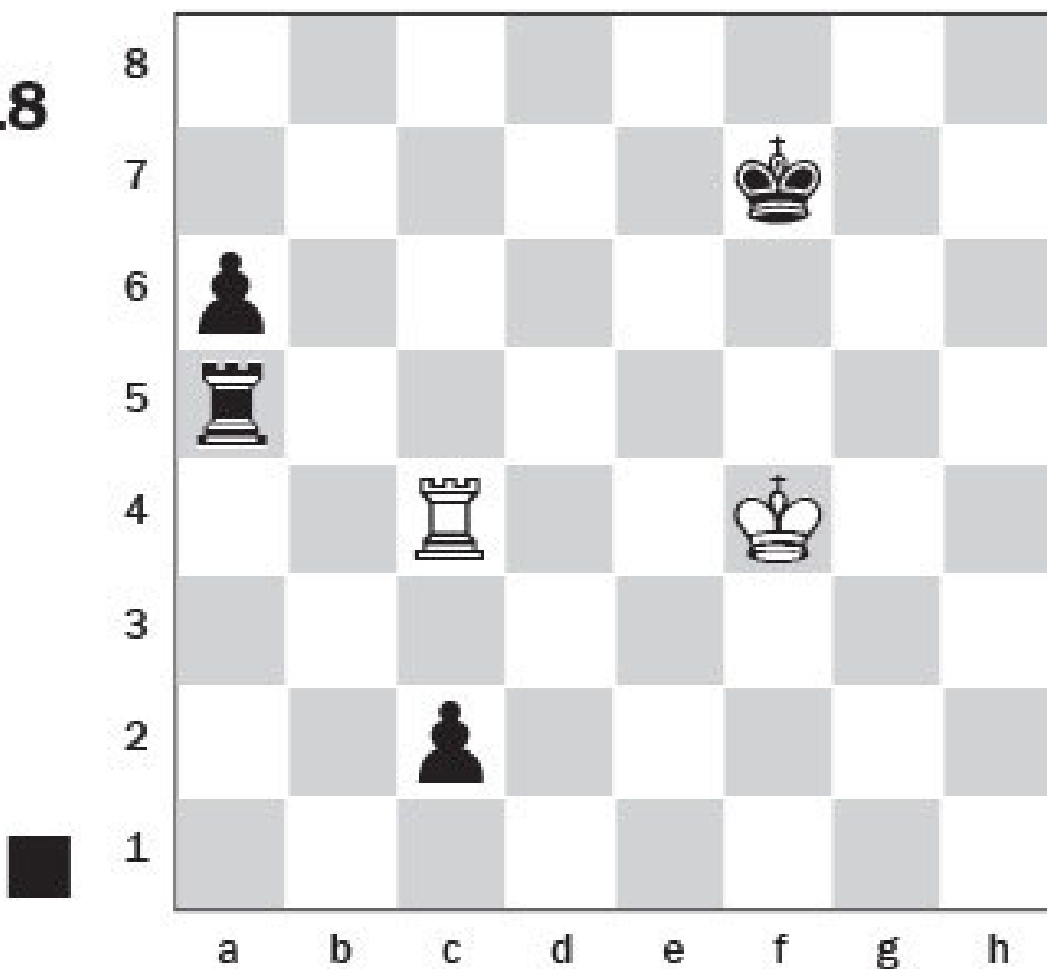
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 318

**318**



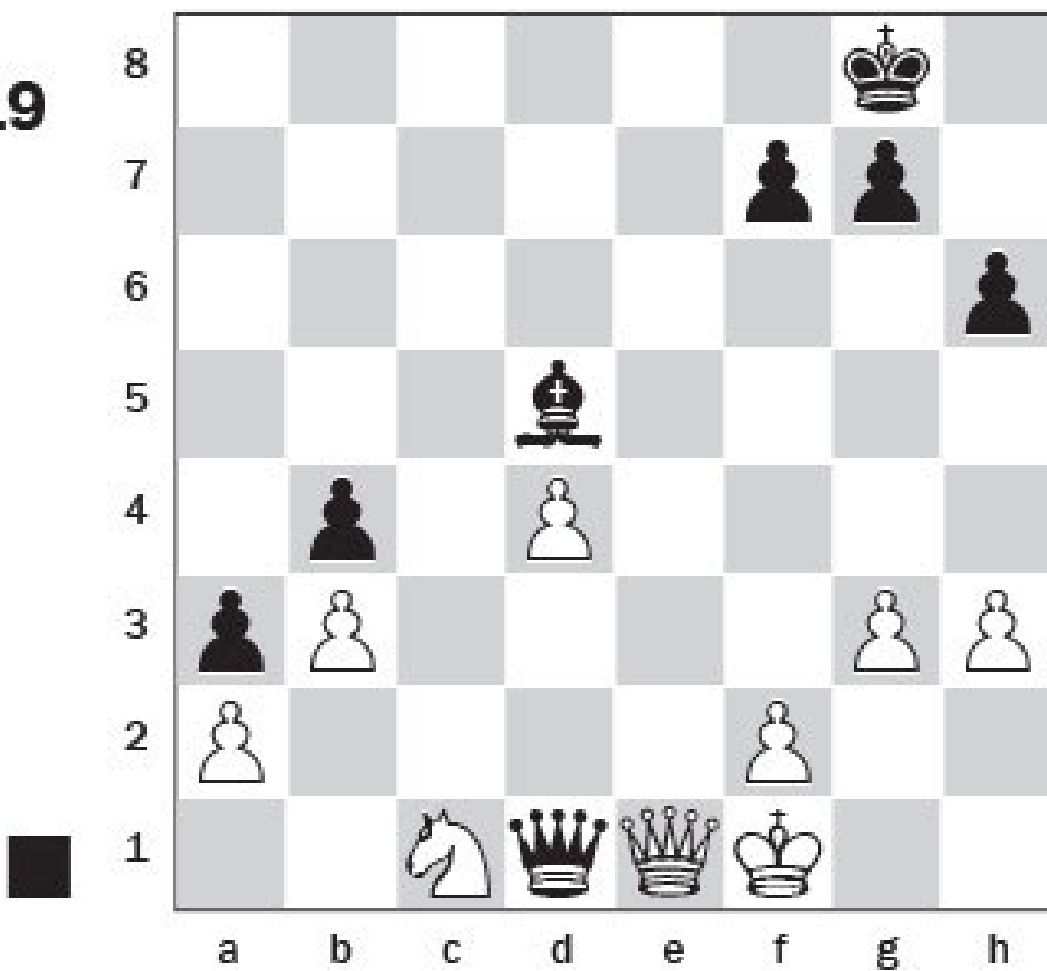
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 319

**319**



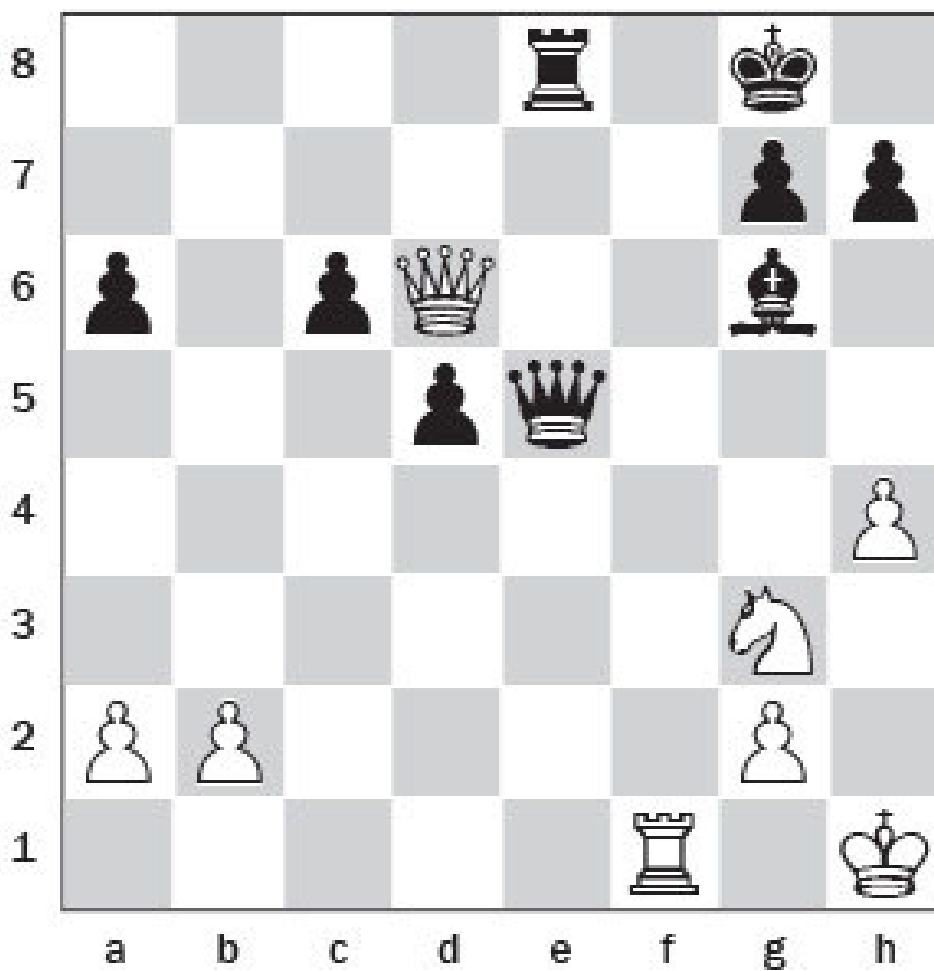
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 320

**320**



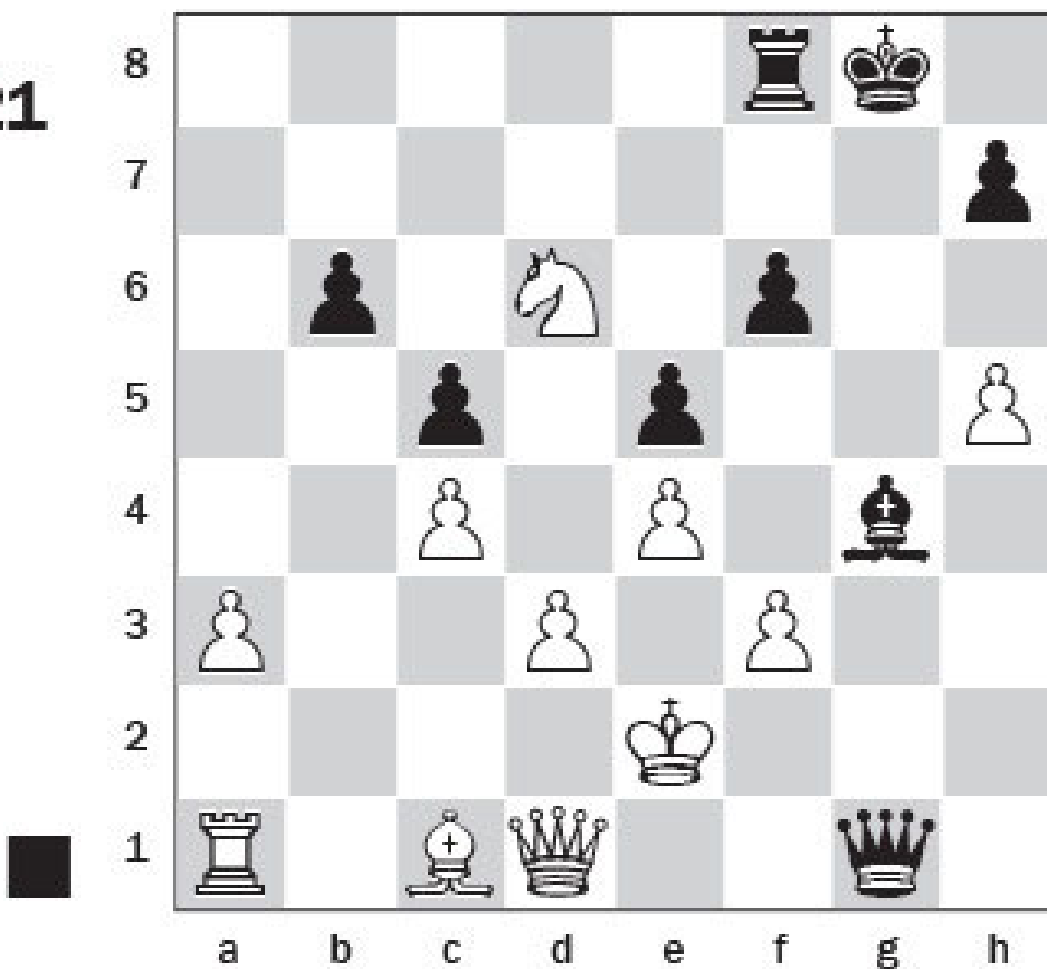
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 321

**321**



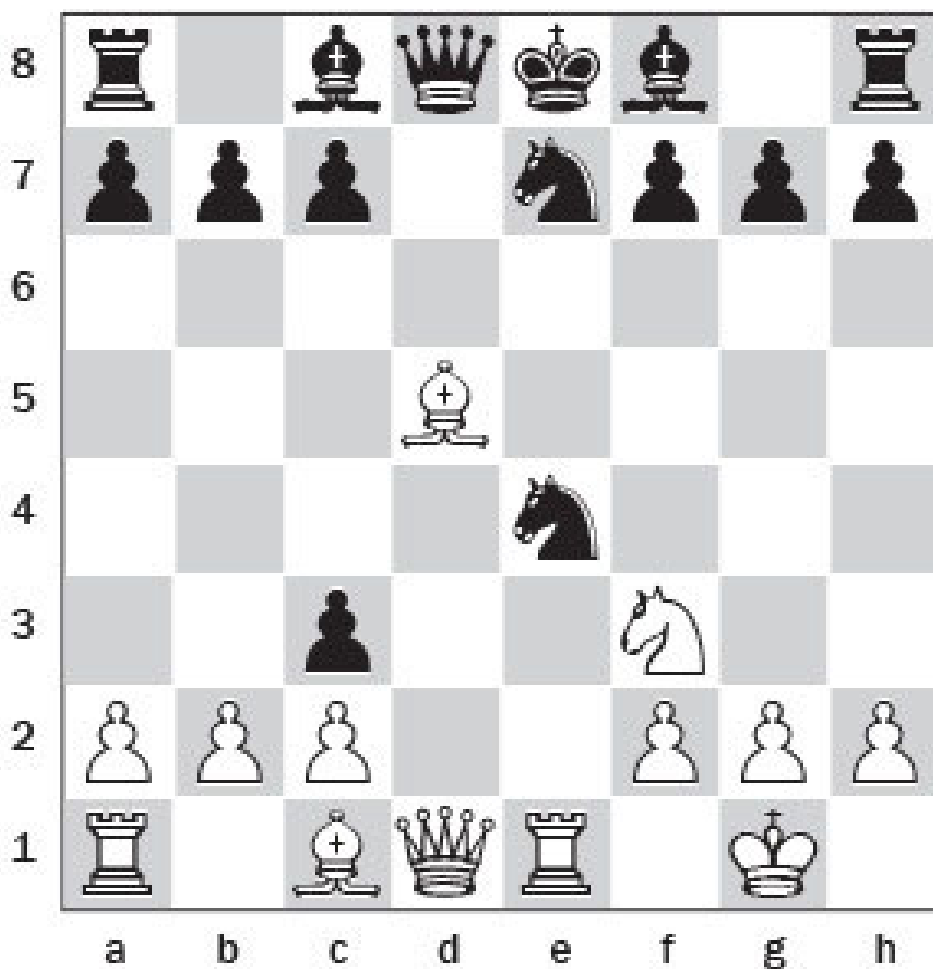
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 322

322



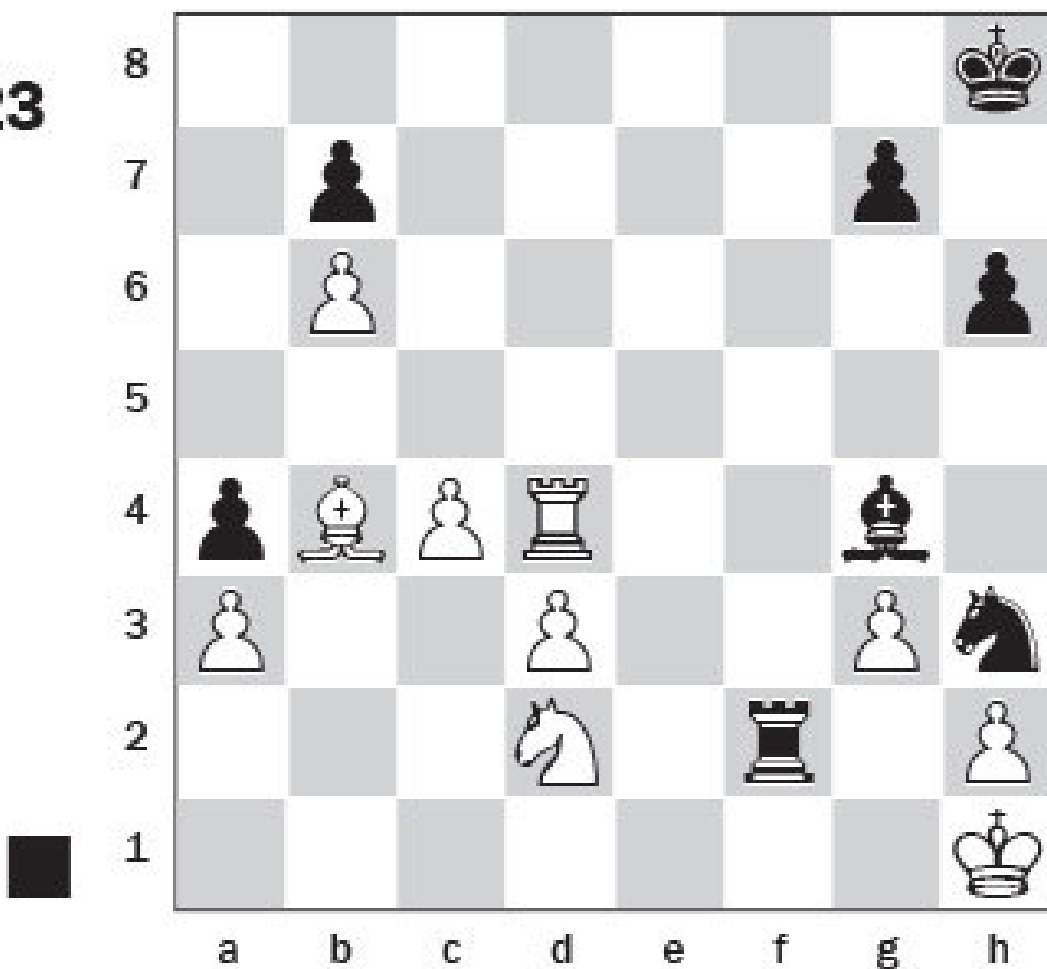
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 323

**323**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

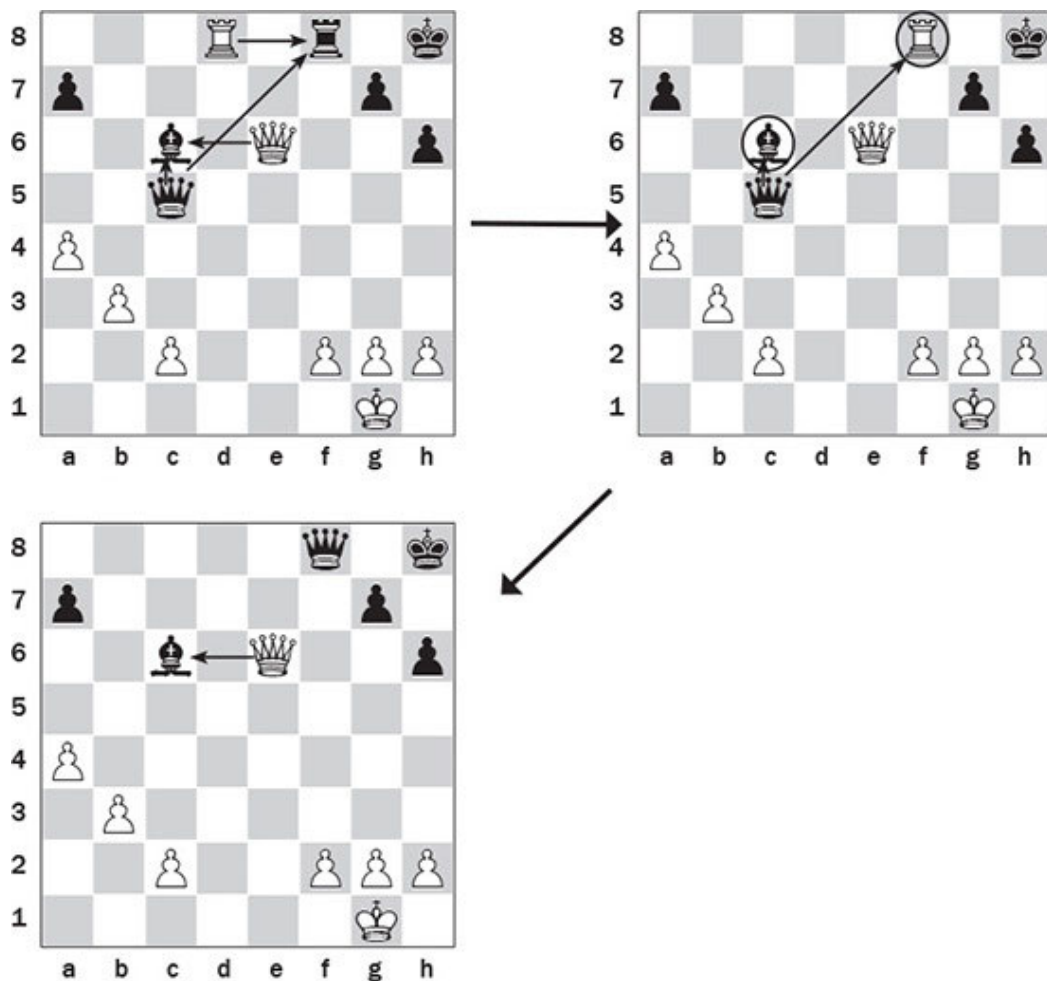
2. \_\_\_\_\_



## CHAPTER 13

# Overloaded

An overloaded or overworked piece is a piece which is performing too many defensive tasks. This could be a piece that's defending other pieces, or defending against threats.

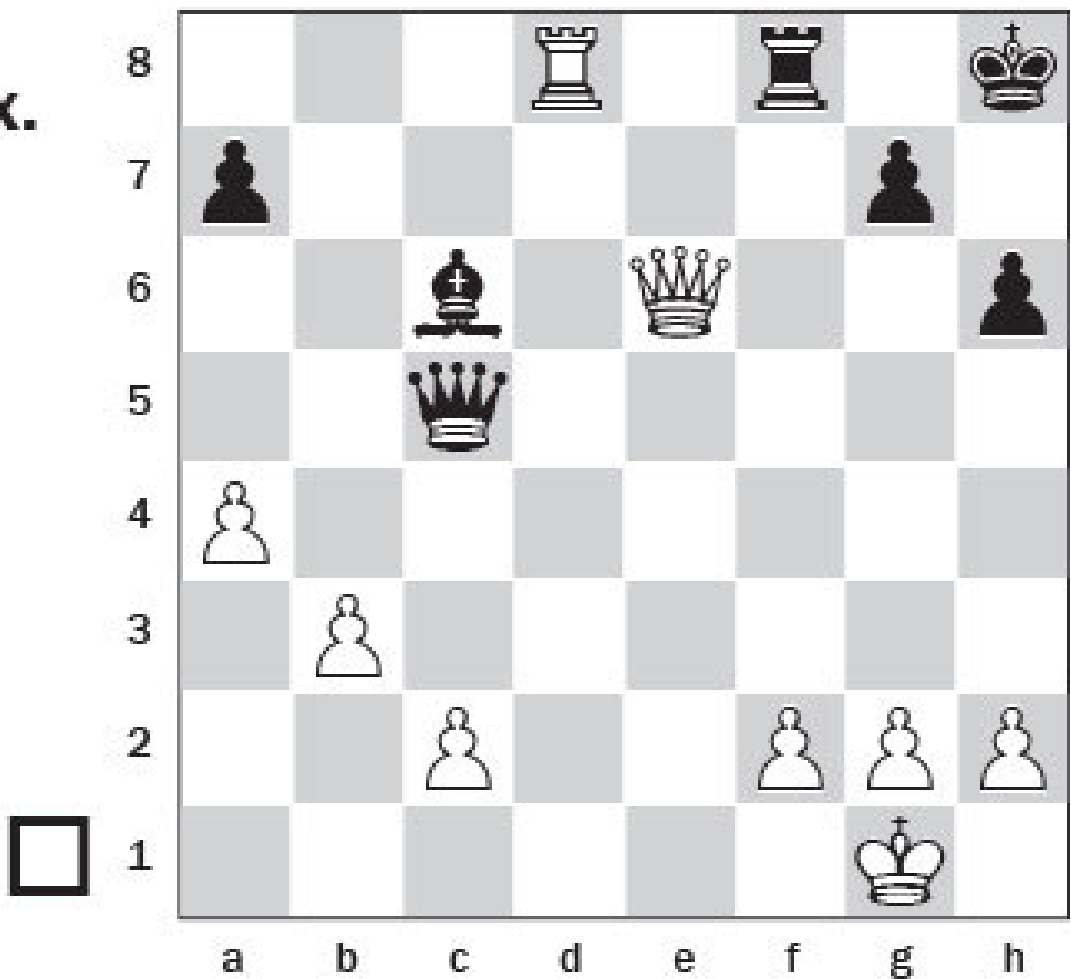


In this example, the queen on c5 is the overloaded piece. The queen is defending both the rook on f8 and the bishop on c6. White can take advantage of the overloaded queen by first capturing the rook on f8: 1.Rxf8+ (see diagram 2). Black's queen would likely capture back: 1...Qxf8 (see diagram 3), which would leave the bishop on c6 unprotected. After 2.Qxc6 White wins the bishop as the queen cannot defend the bishop as well.

To better solve the problems, first try to identify which piece is the one performing too many defensive tasks.

# Overloaded – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

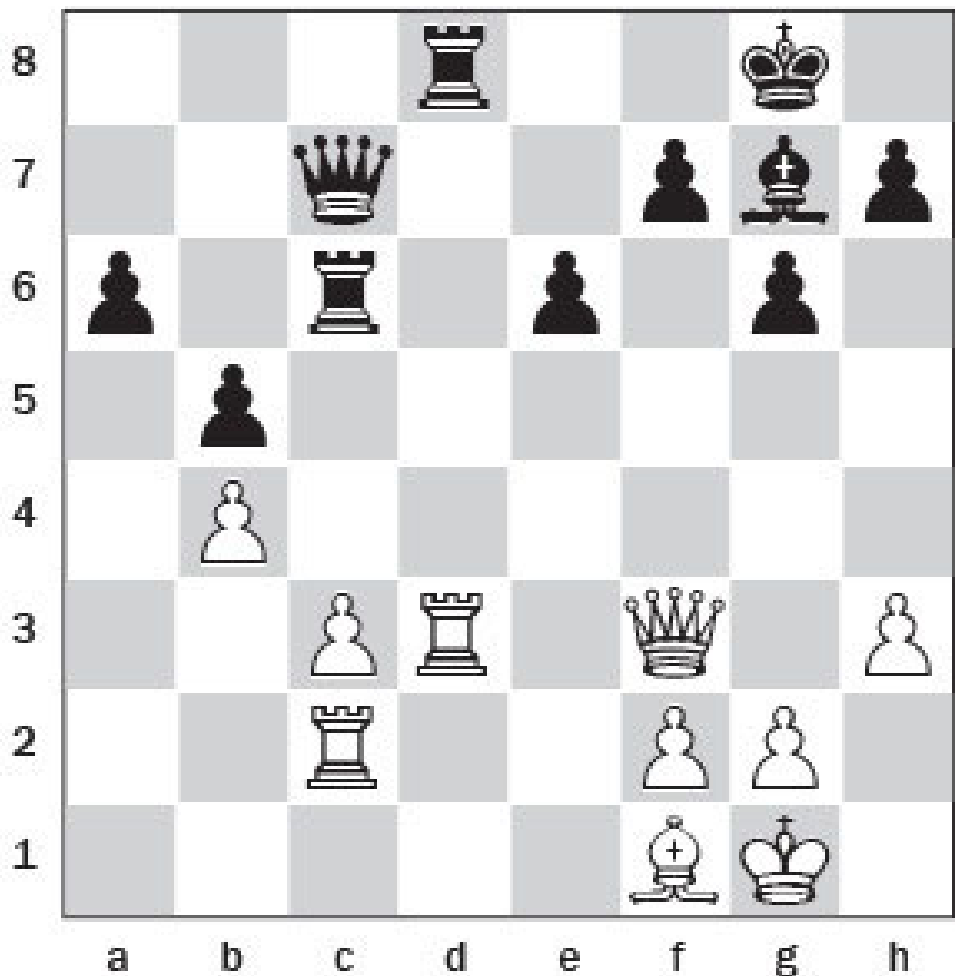
1. Rxf8+ Qxf8

2. Qxc6 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 324

**324**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

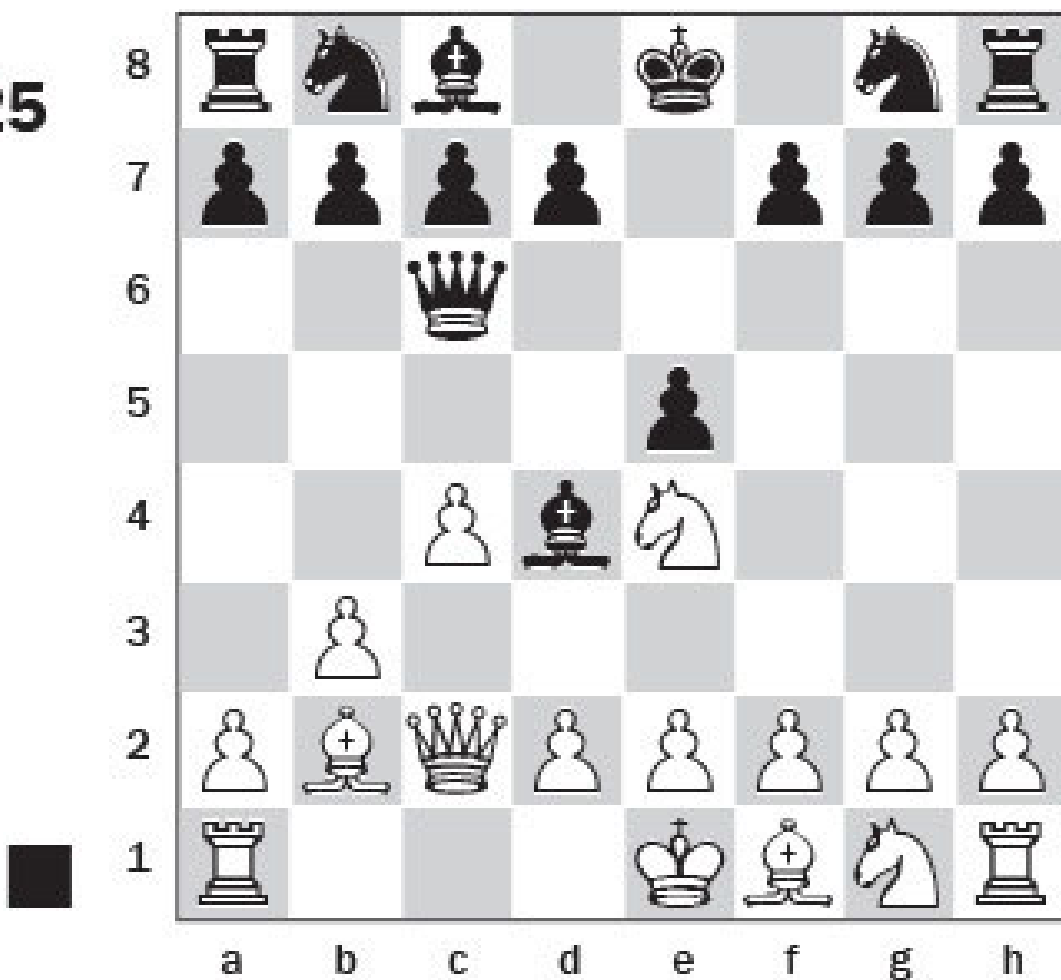
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The queen on c7 is guarding both rooks. How can White win material?

### Exercise 325

325



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

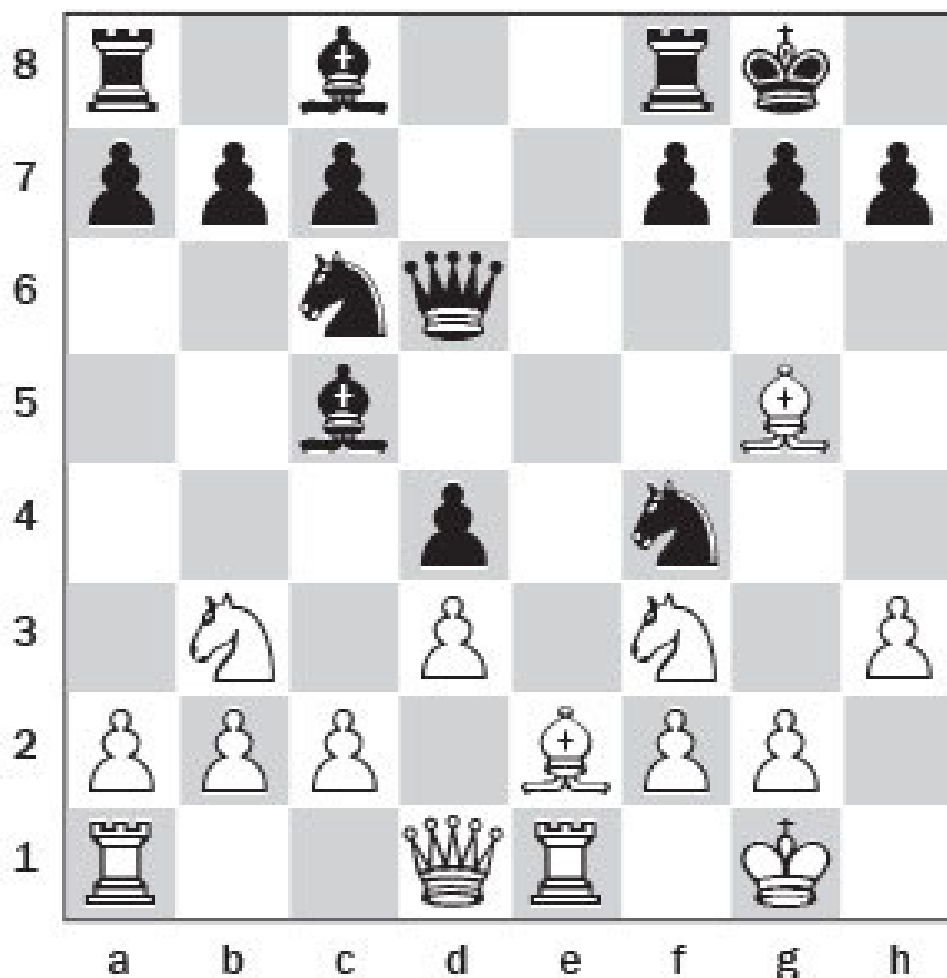
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

White's queen is guarding both the bishop on b2 and the knight on e4. How can Black win material?

### [Exercise 326](#)

326



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

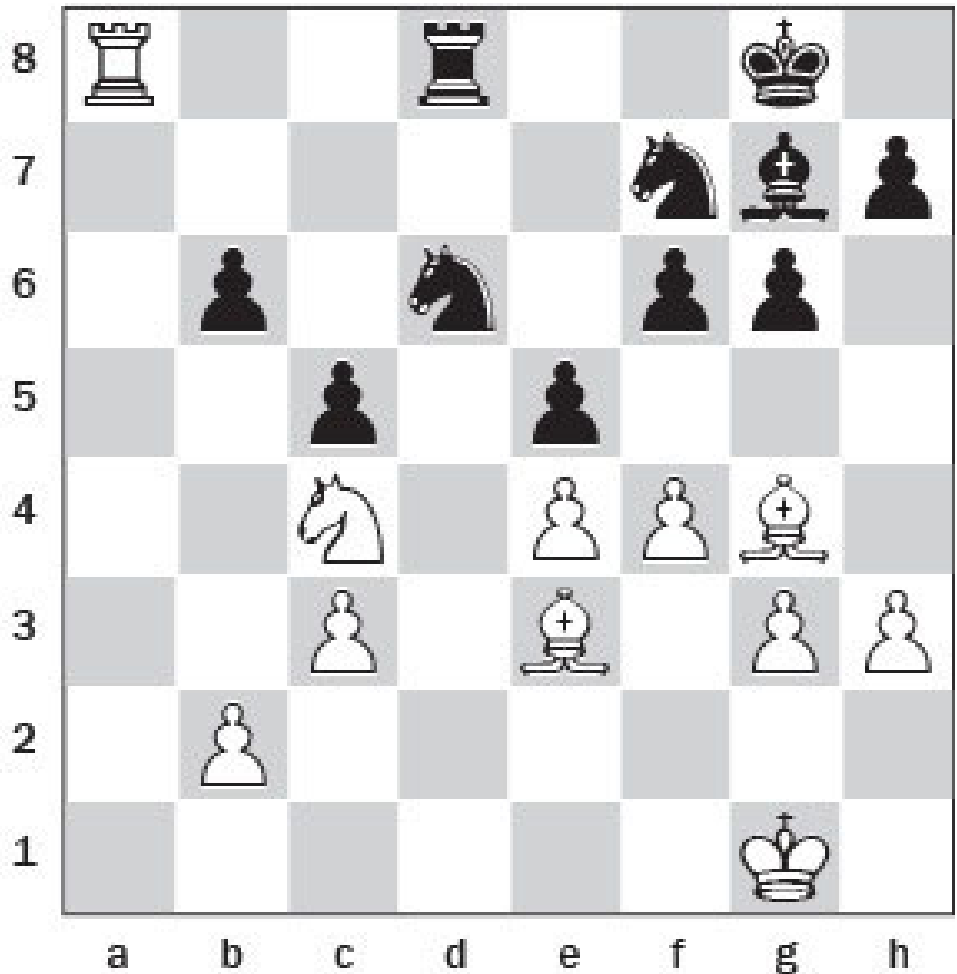
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The queen is guarding both the knight on f4 and the bishop on c5.  
Use the most forcing capture to win material.

**Exercise 327**

**327**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



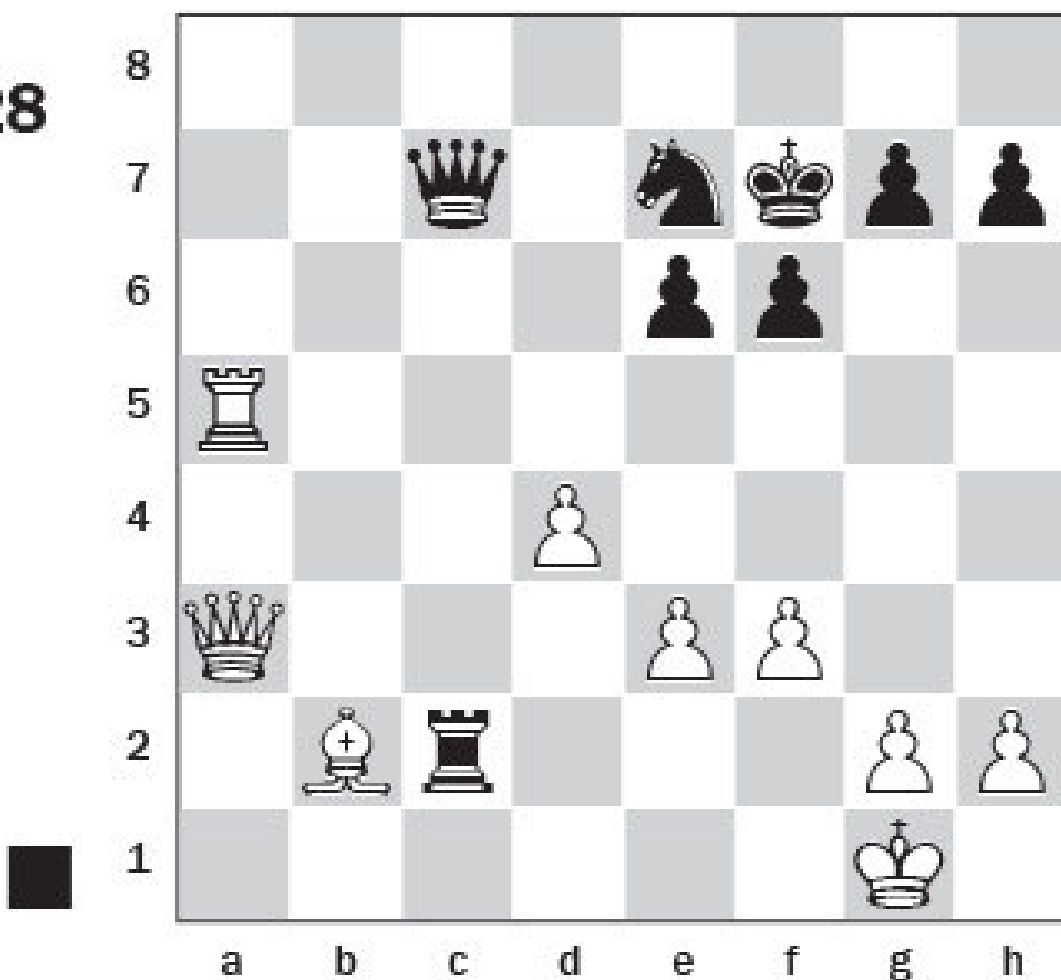
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on f7 is guarding both the rook on d8 and the knight on d6. How can White win material?

### Exercise 328

328



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

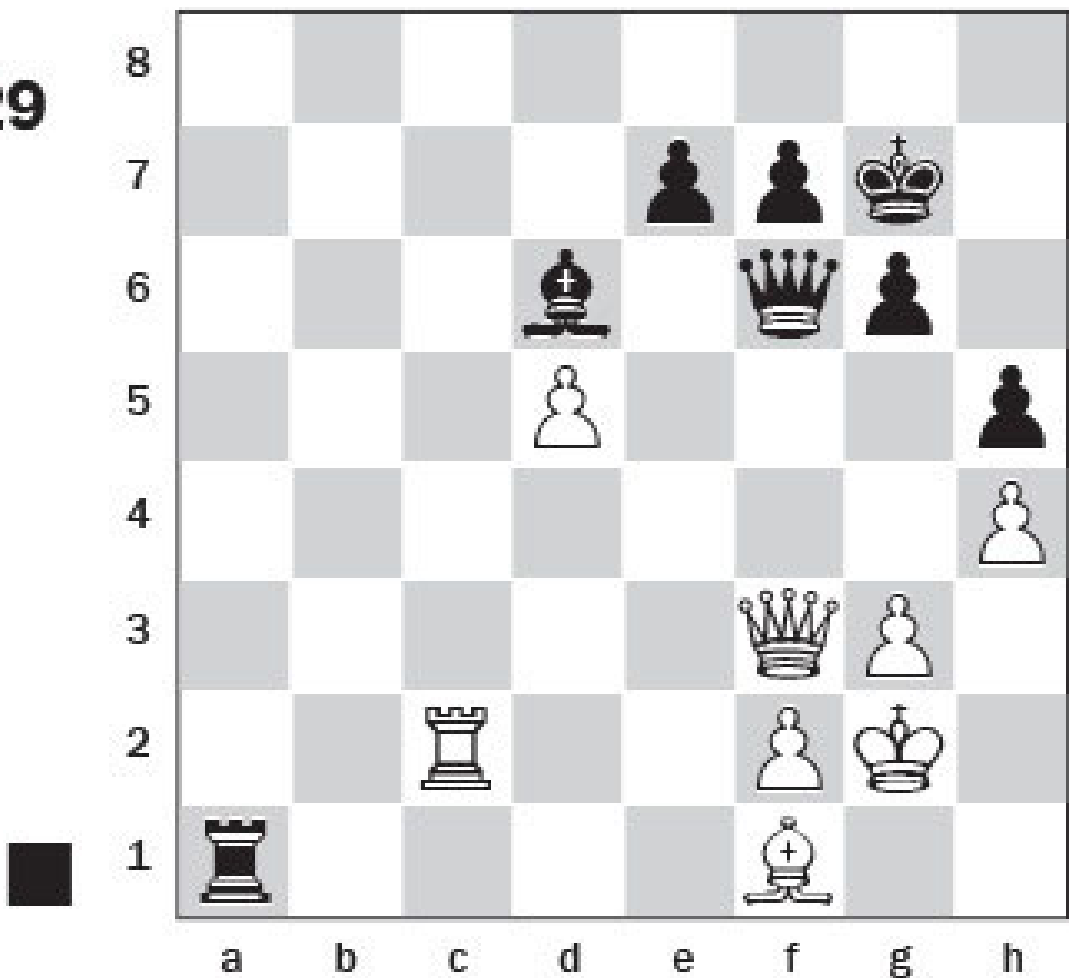
## HINT

The queen on a3 is guarding both the bishop on b2 and the rook on a5. How can Black win material?

# Overloaded – Test

## Exercise 329

329



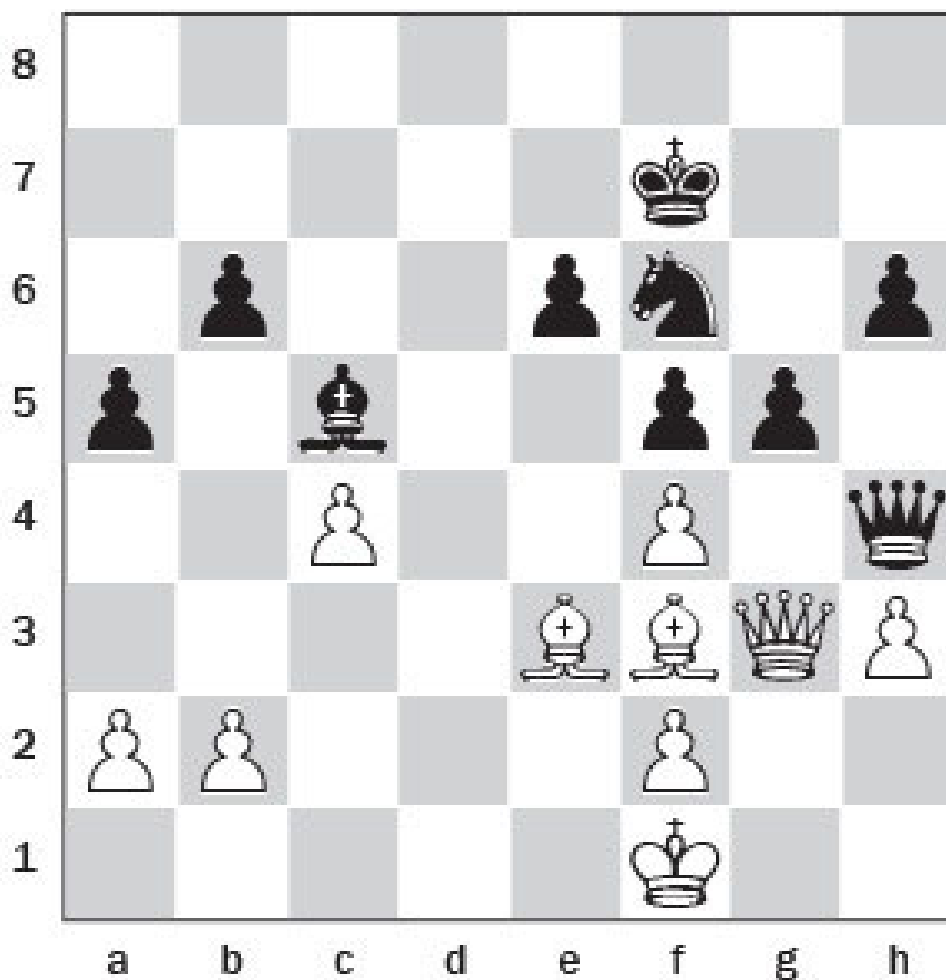
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 330

**330**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 331

**331**



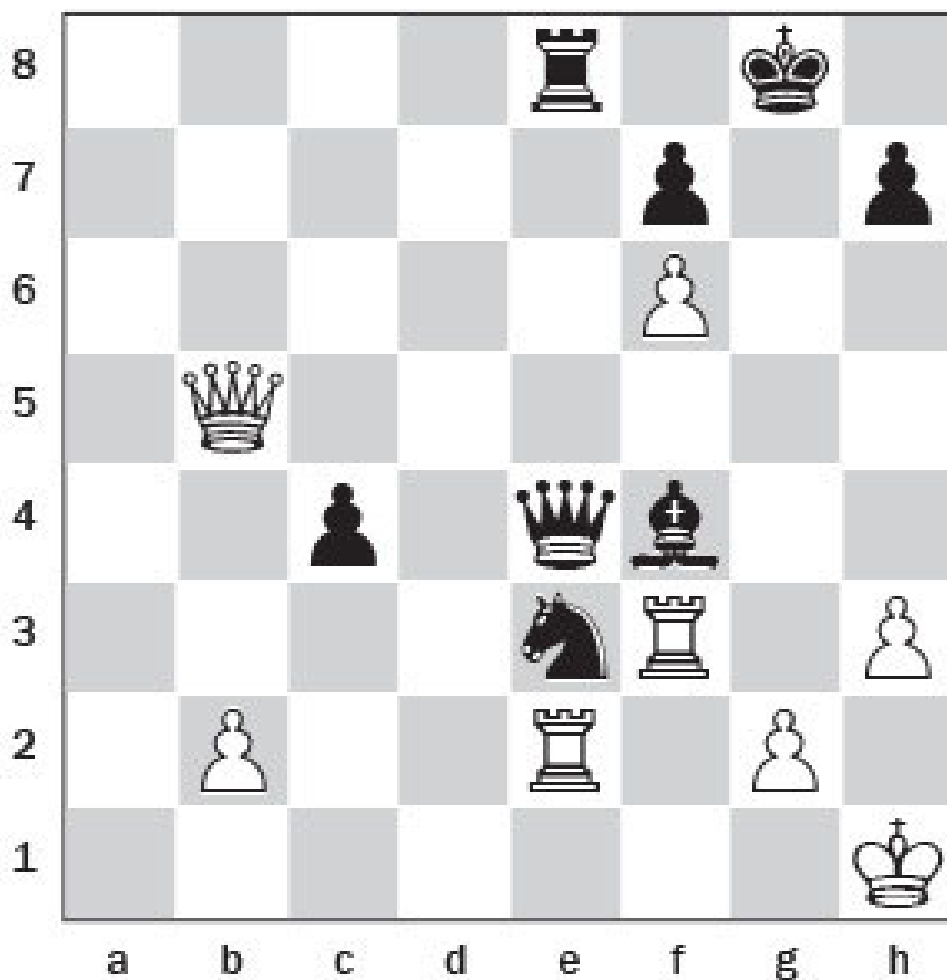
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 332

**332**

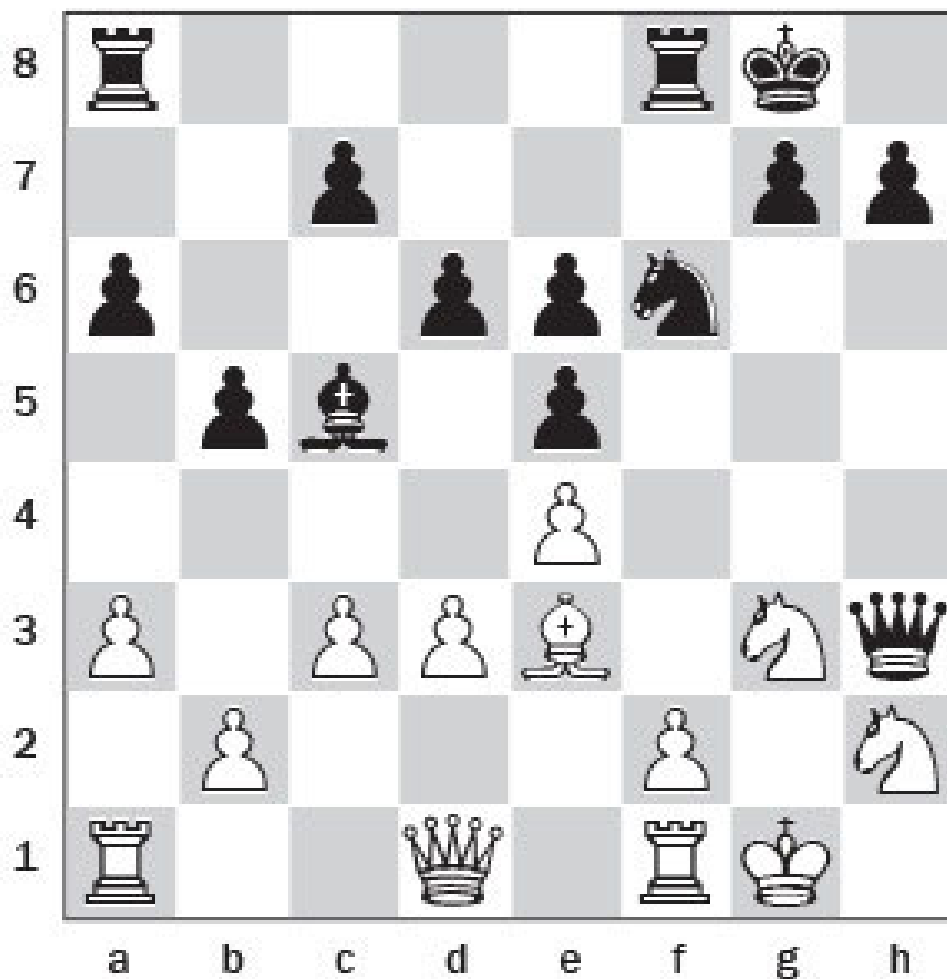


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 333

333



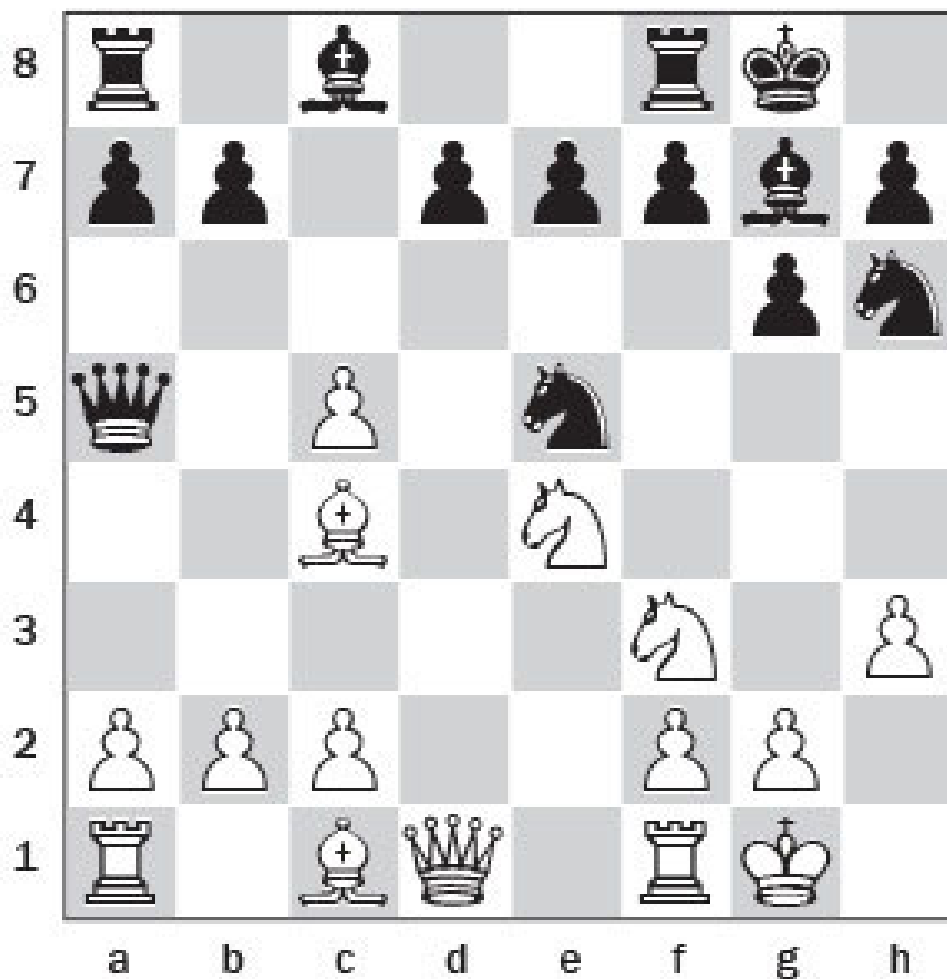
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 334

334



Answer:

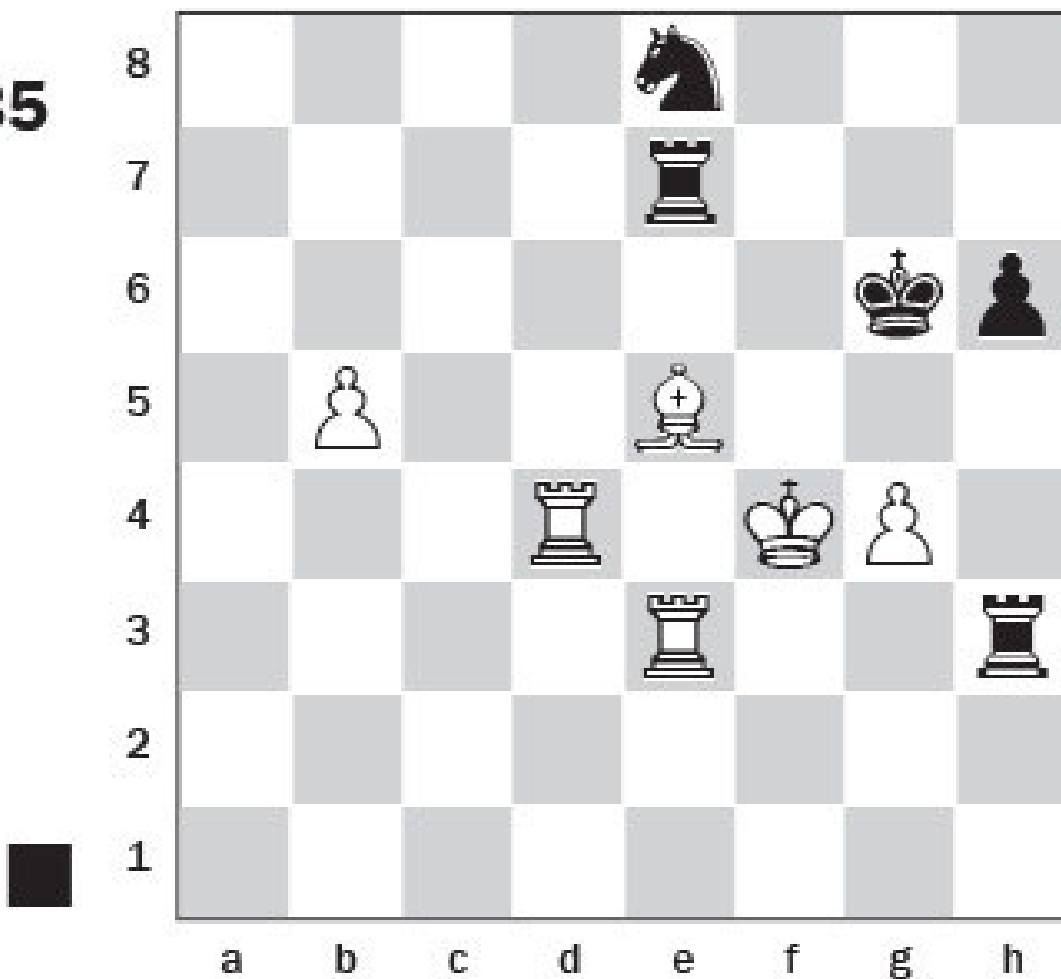
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



## Exercise 335

335



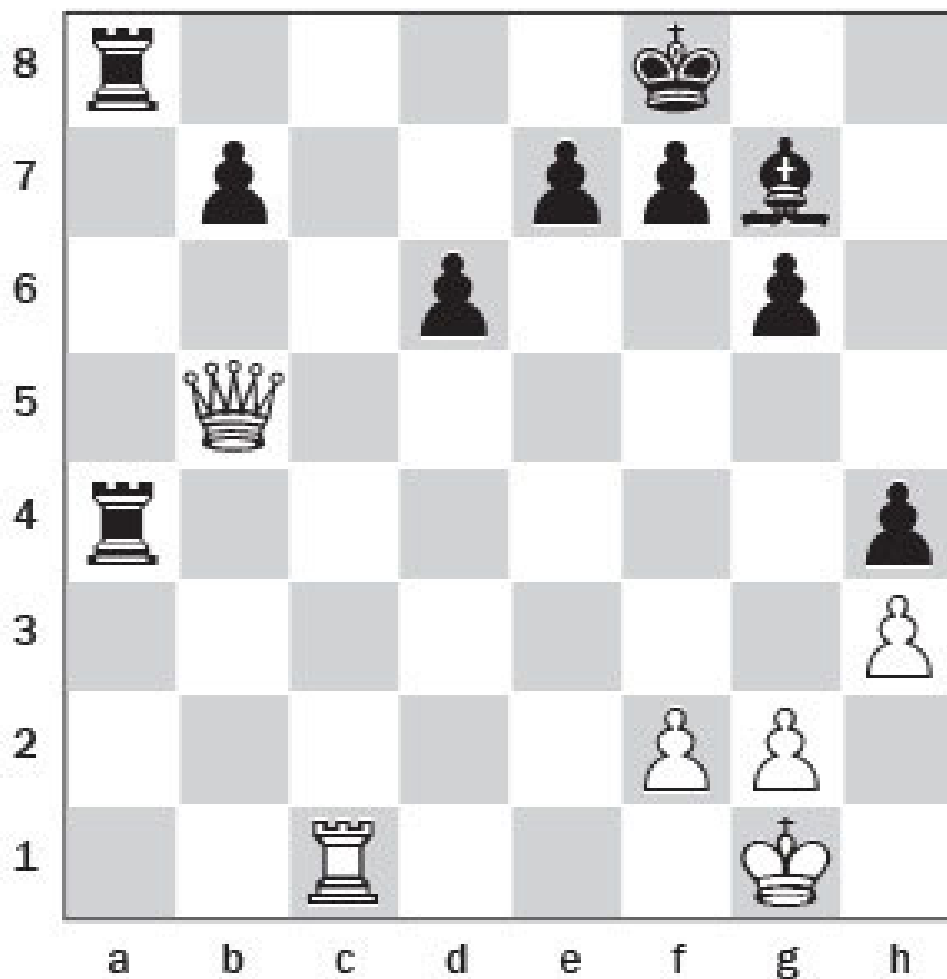
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 336

336



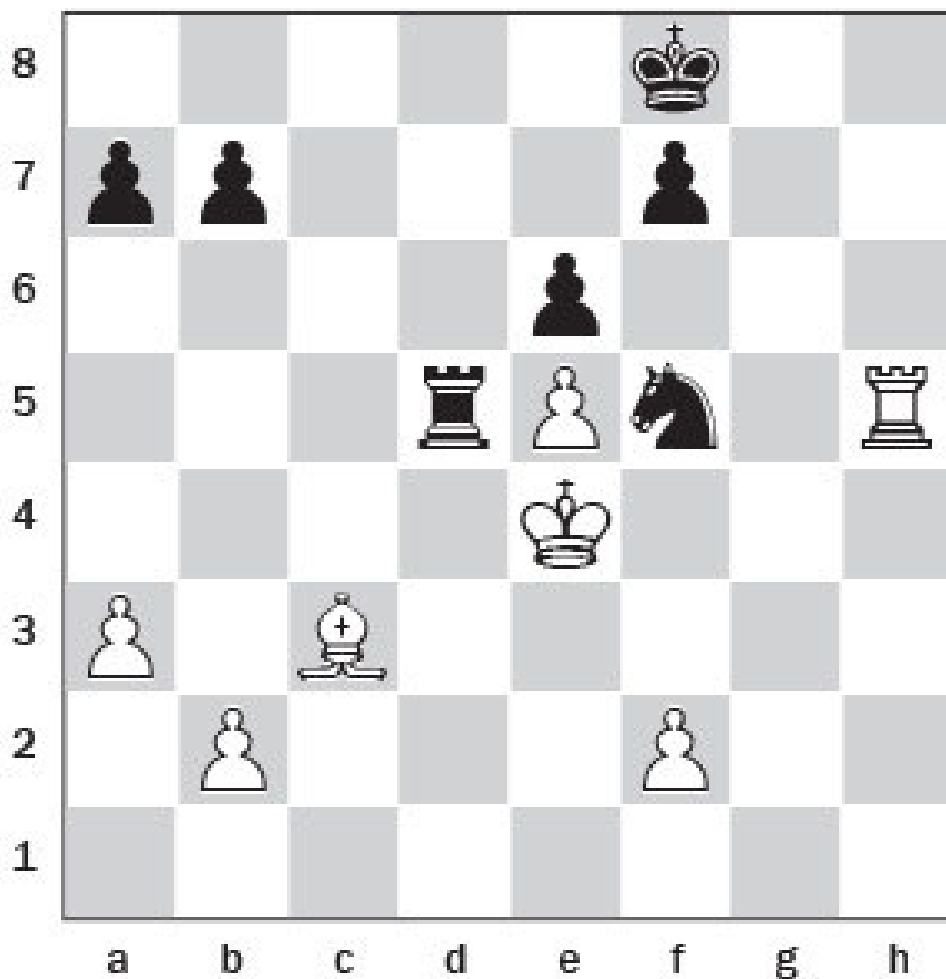
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 337

337



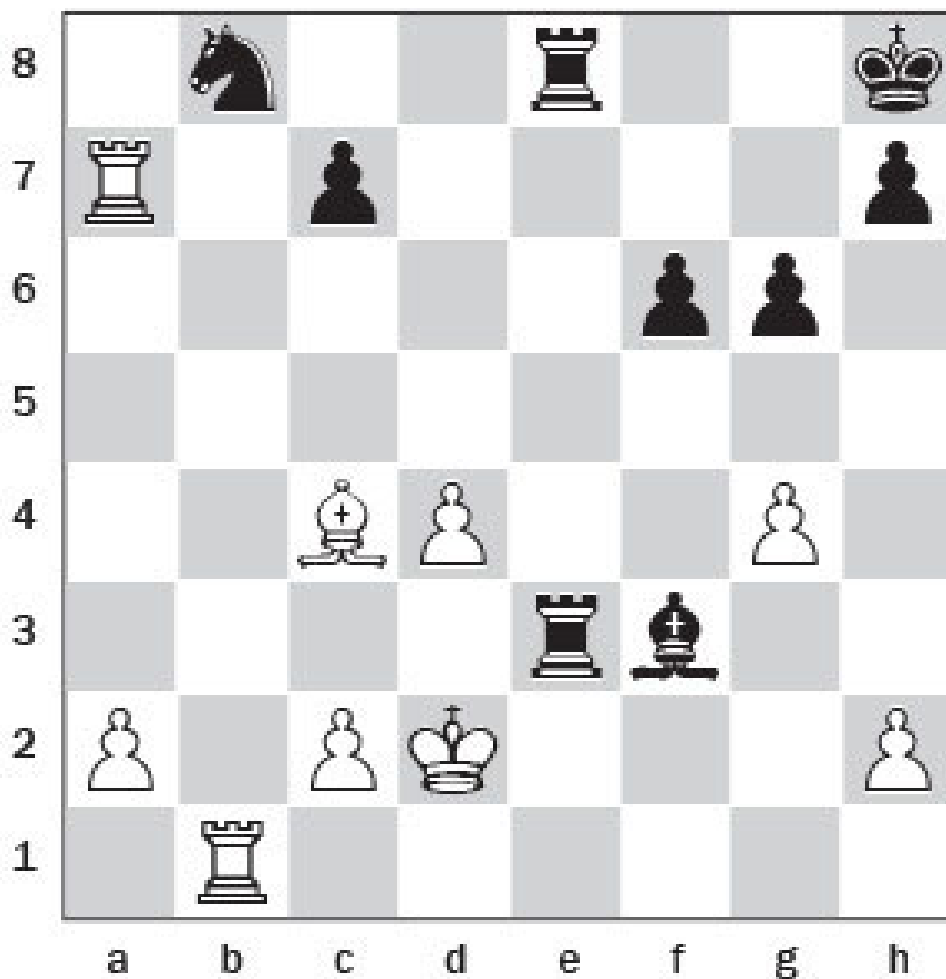
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 338

338



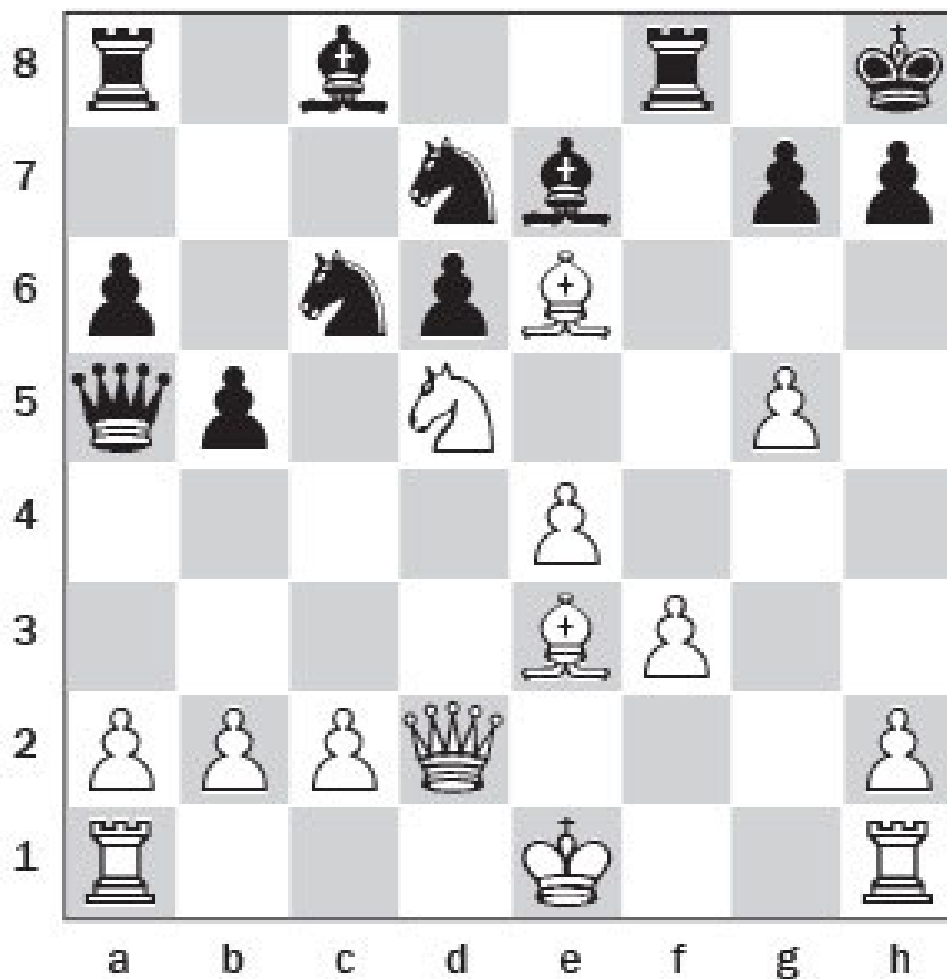
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 339

339



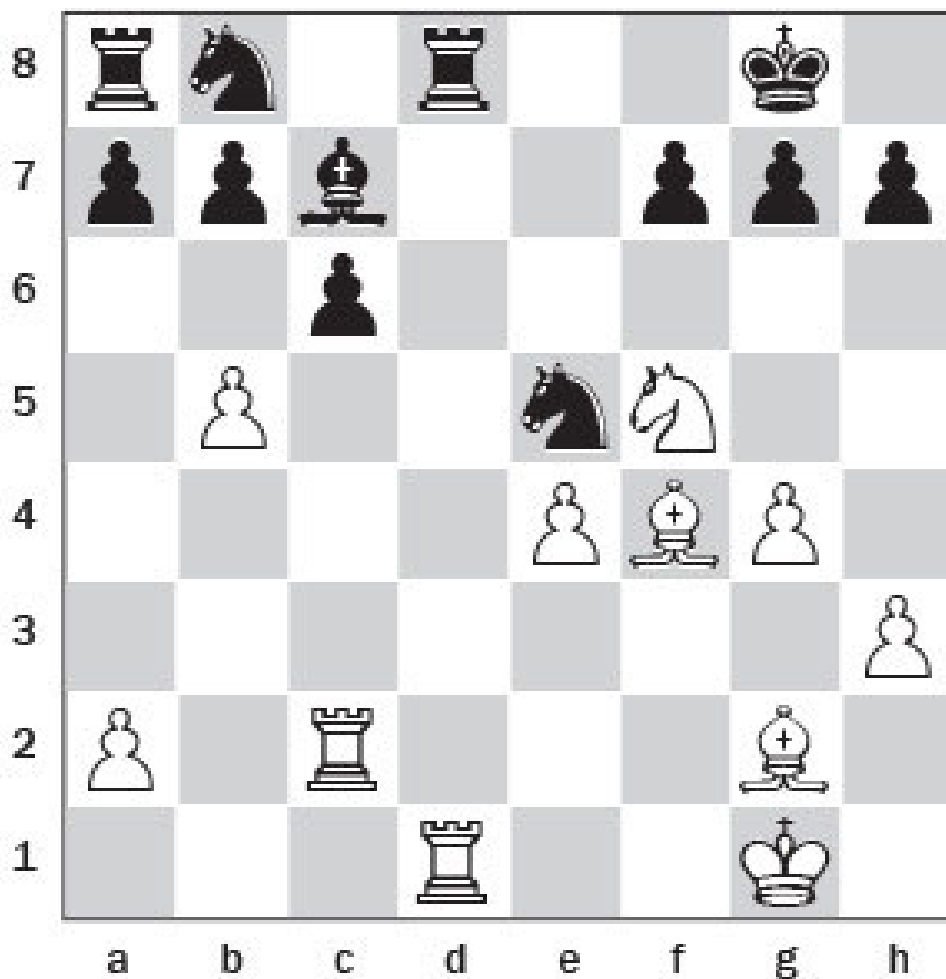
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 340

340



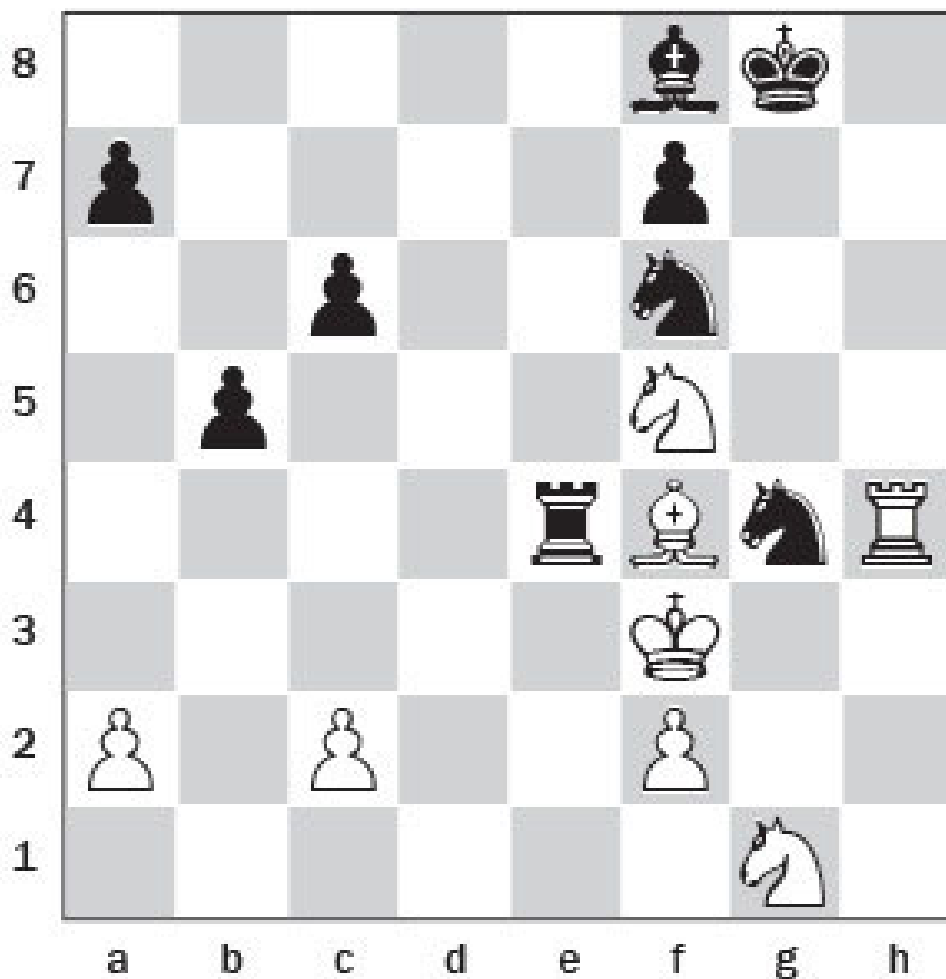
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 341

341



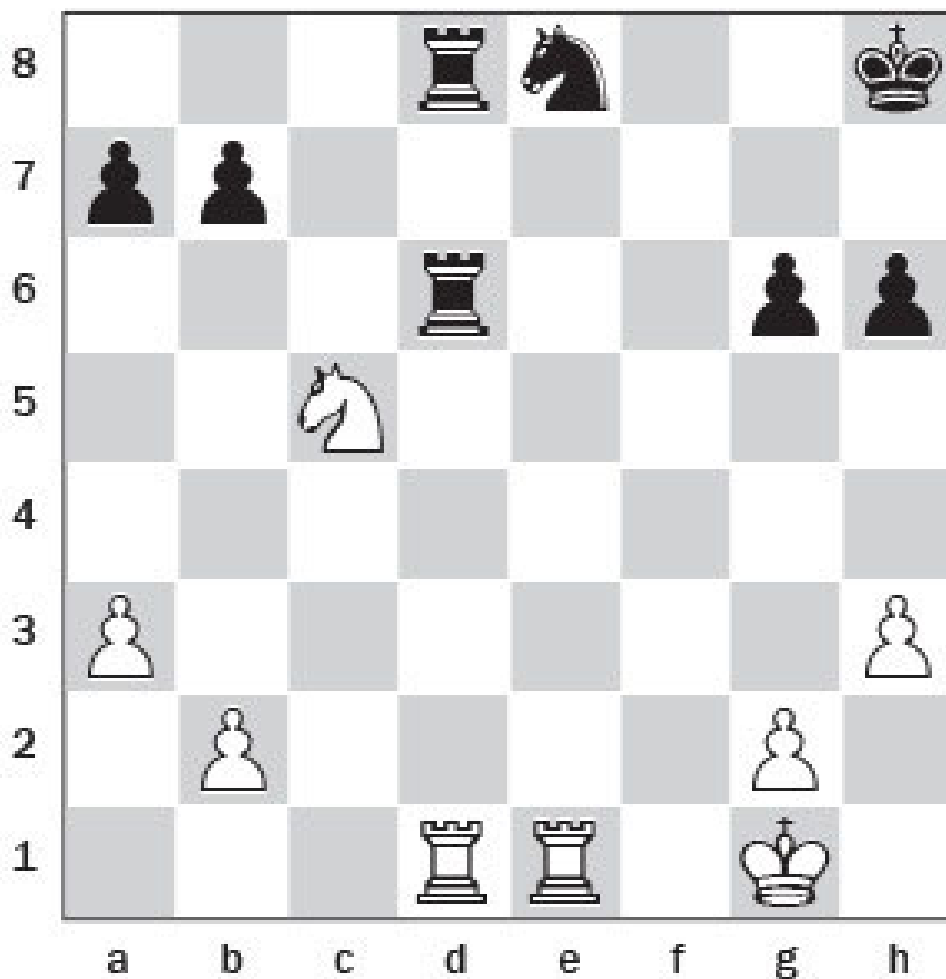
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 342

342



Answer:

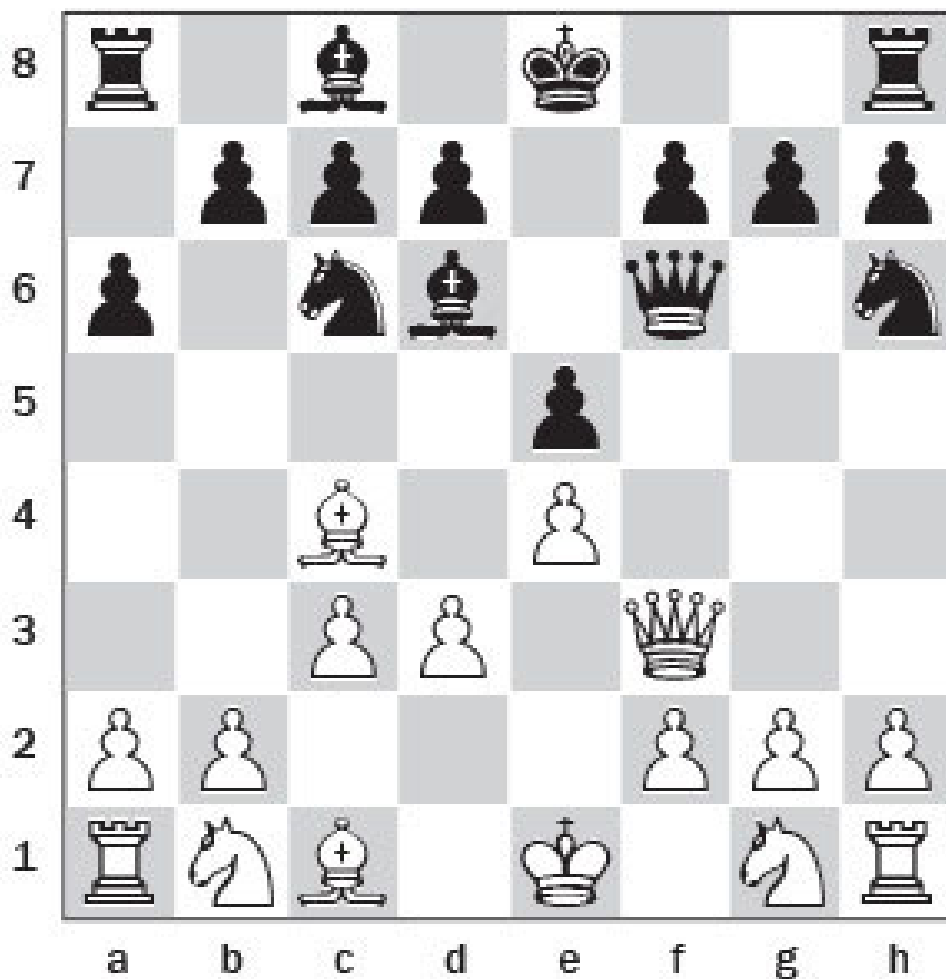
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



### Exercise 343

343



Answer:

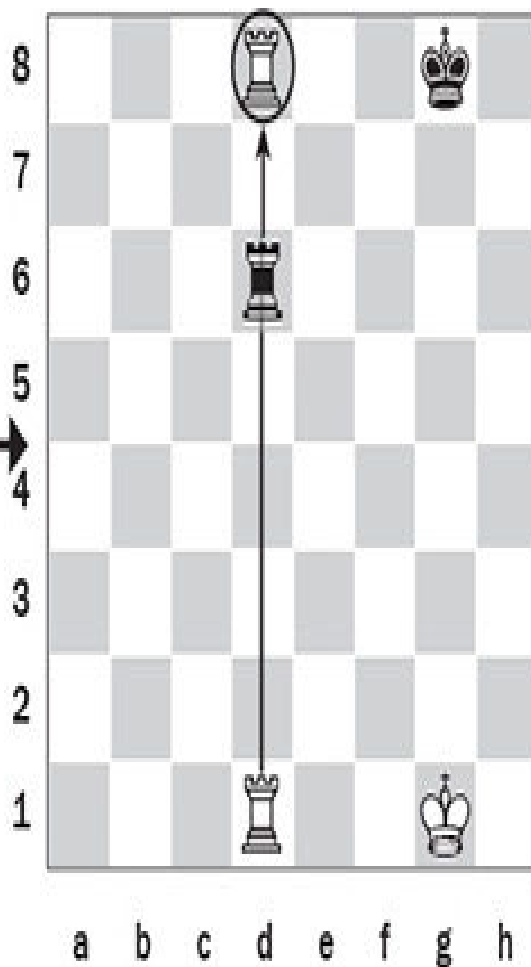
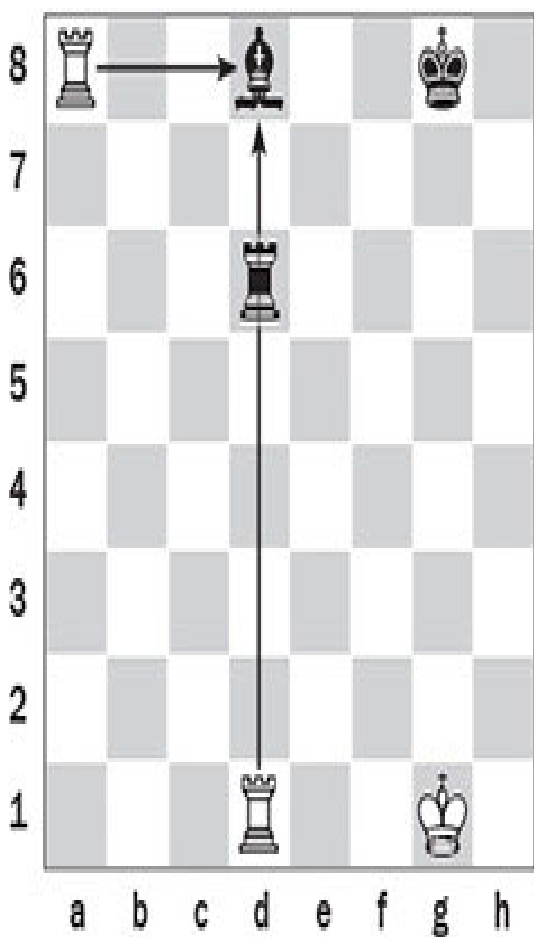
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 14

# X-Ray

An X-ray is when a piece attacks or defends through a piece that moves in the same direction.



White's rook on a8 is directly attacking the bishop on d8. The rook on d6 is protecting the bishop on d8; however because the rook on d1 moves in the same direction as the rook on d6, it also serves as an attacker on the bishop. After

## **1.Rxd8+ (see diagram 2) 1...Rxd8**

we can see that as the rook on d6 moves along the d-file, the rook on d1 follows or 'X-ray' attacks since both rooks move along the same line:

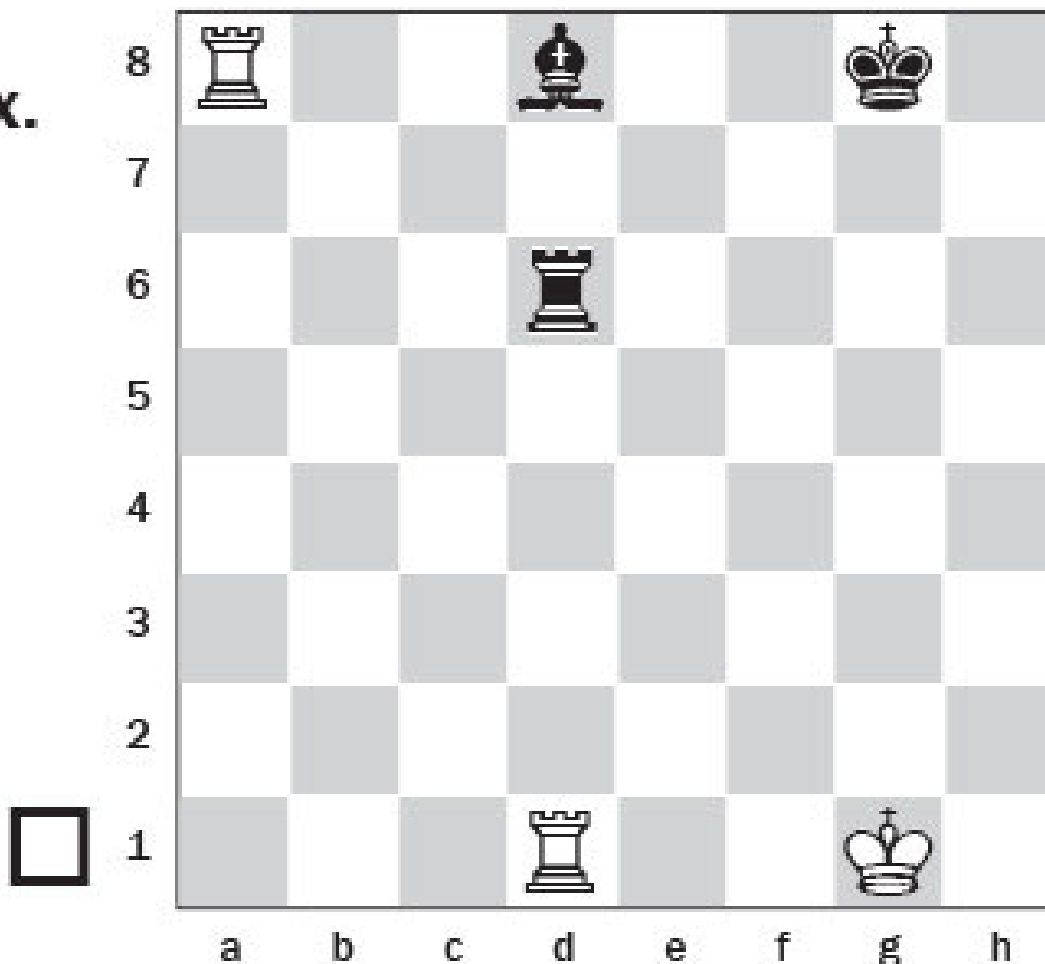
## **2.Rxd8+**

White is able to win a rook due to an X-ray attack!

In order to better solve the problems, look for pieces on the same line (diagonal, file, or rank) that move in the same direction.

# X-Ray – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

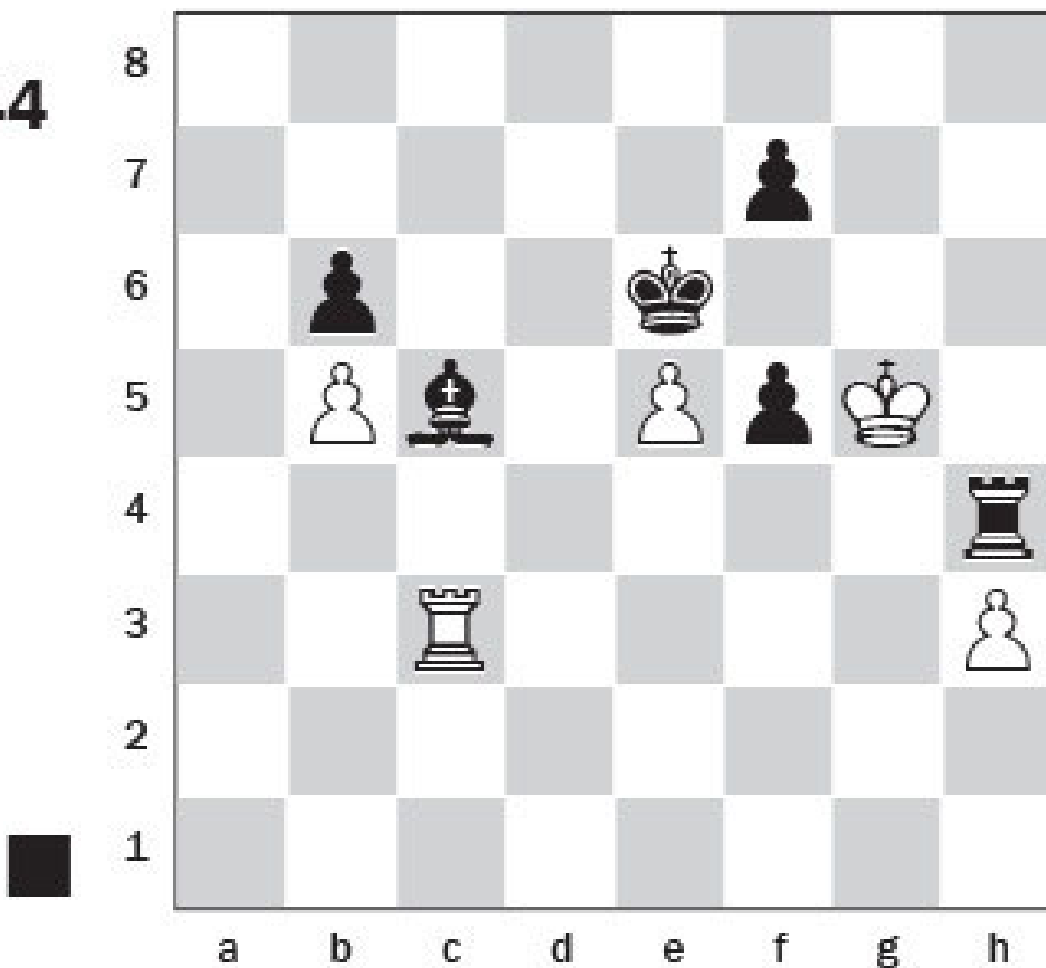
1. Rxd8+ Rxd8

2. Rxd8+ \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 344

**344**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

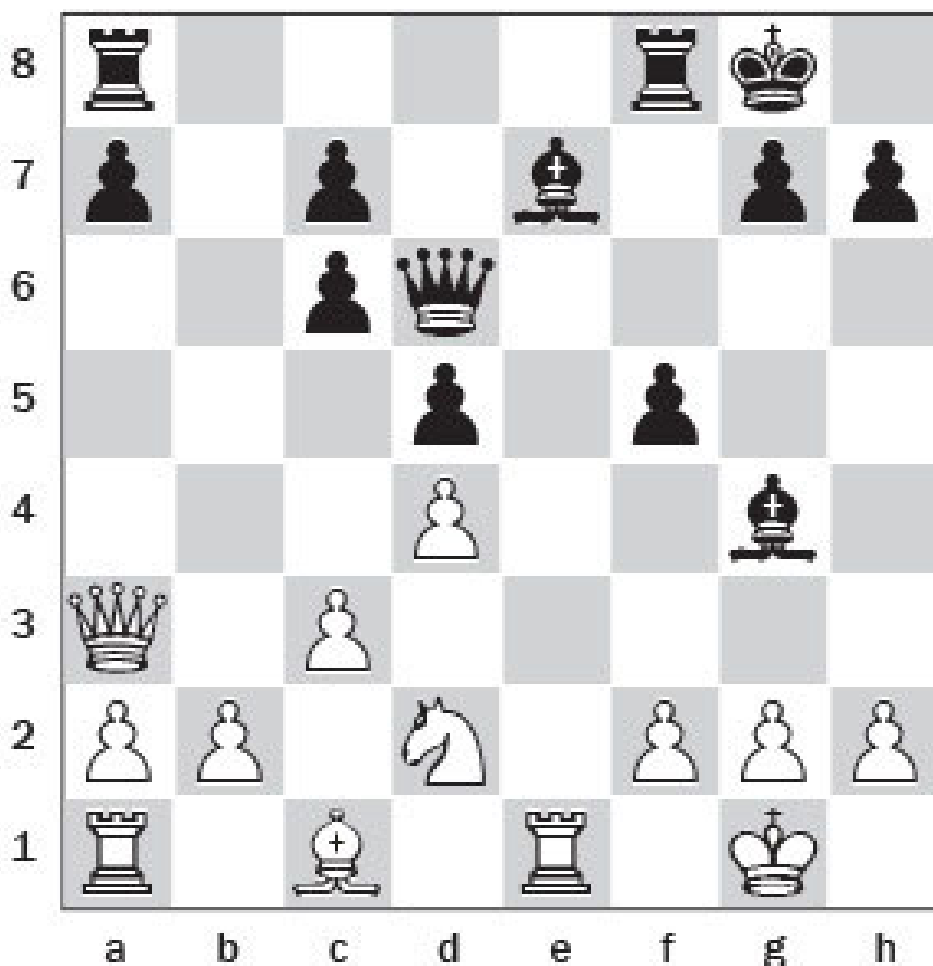
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use an X-Ray defense to guard the rook on h4 and issue a checkmate!

### Exercise 345

**345**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

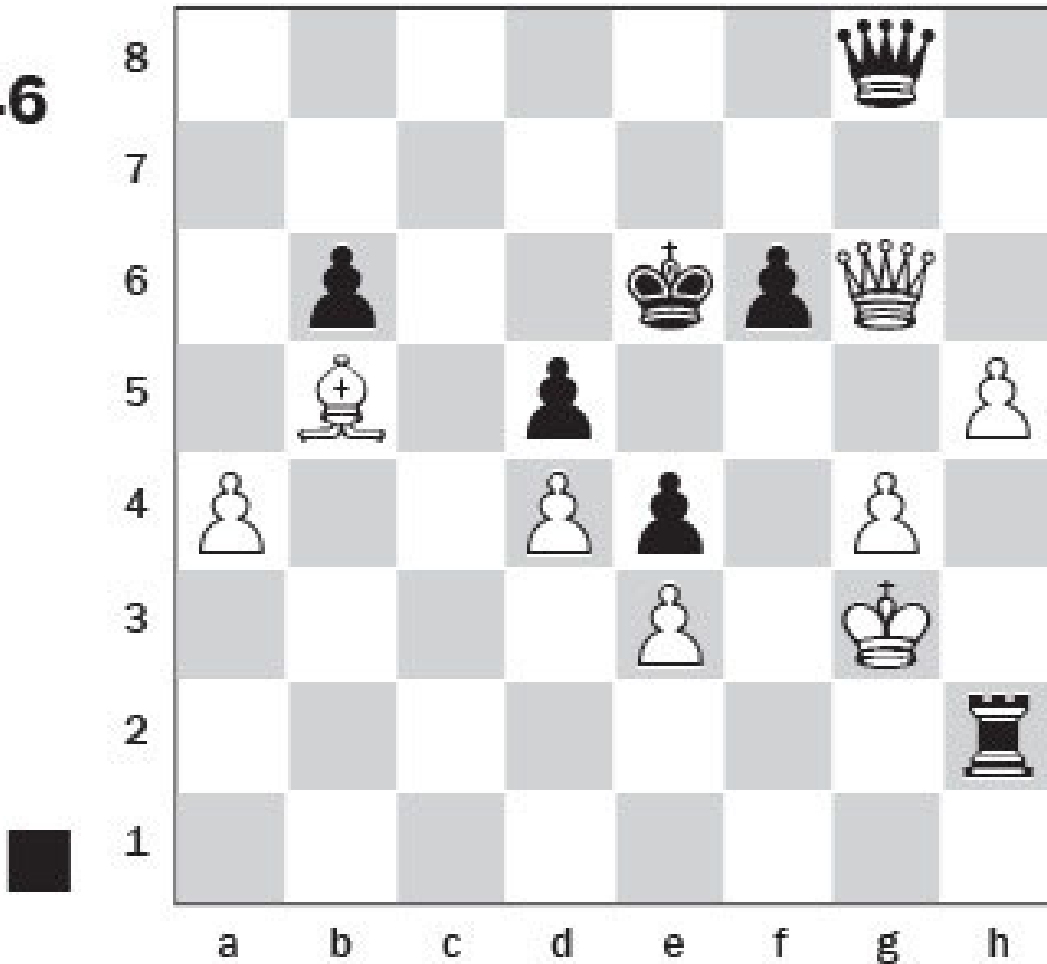
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The queen on a3 is X-Ray attacking the bishop on e7 through the queen on d6. How can White win material?

### Exercise 346

346



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

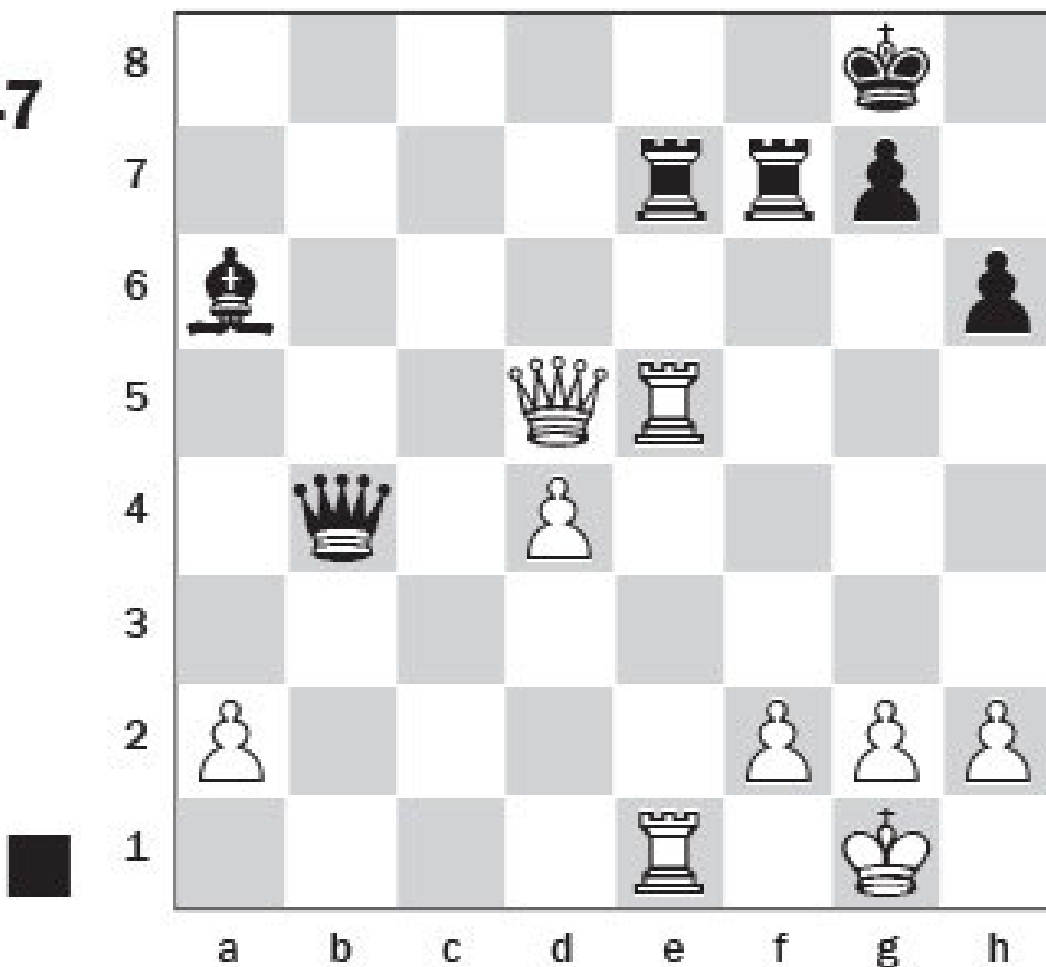
HINT



The rook on h2 is being attacked by the king. Use an X-Ray to guard the rook and create checkmate!

### Exercise 347

**347**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

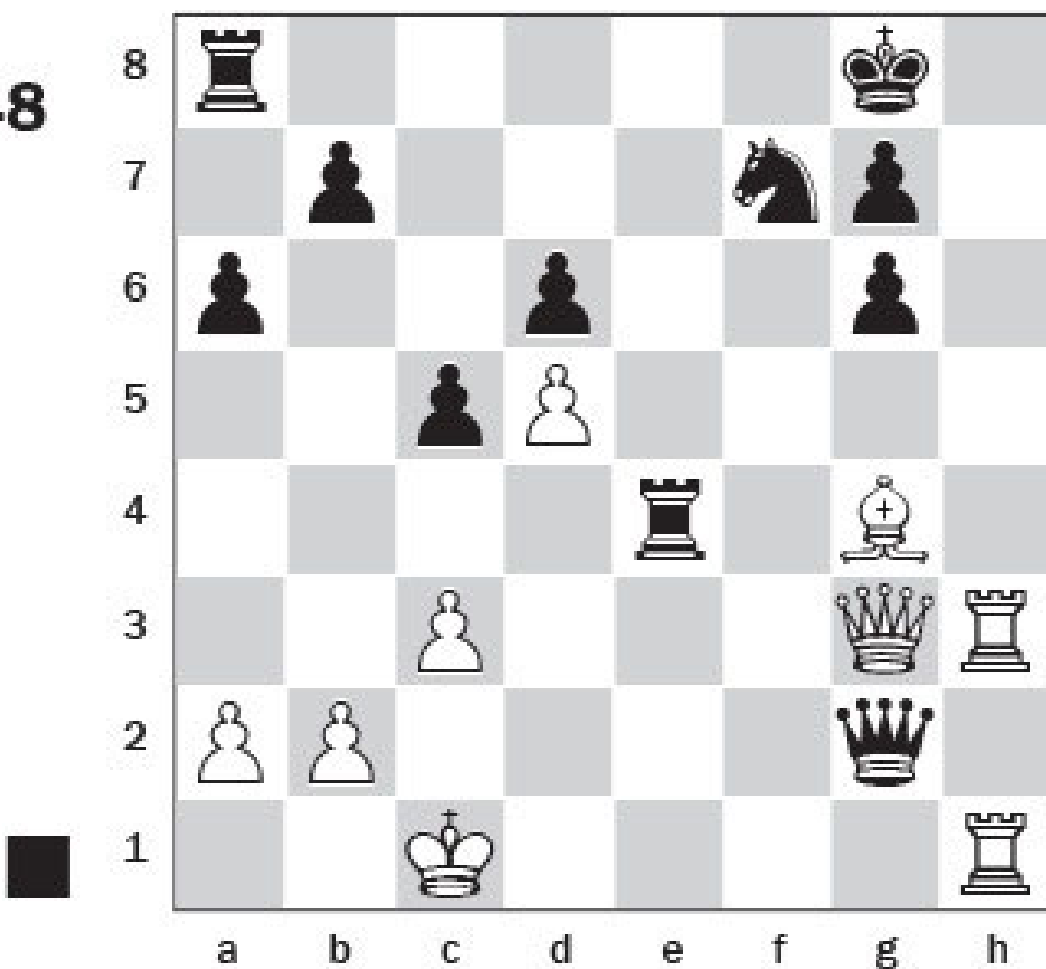
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black's rook on e7 is X-Ray attacking the rook on e1 through the rook on e5. How can Black force checkmate?

### Exercise 348

**348**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

The queen on g2 is X-Ray attacking the bishop on g4 through the queen on g3. Win material using an X-Ray attack.

### **Exercise 349**

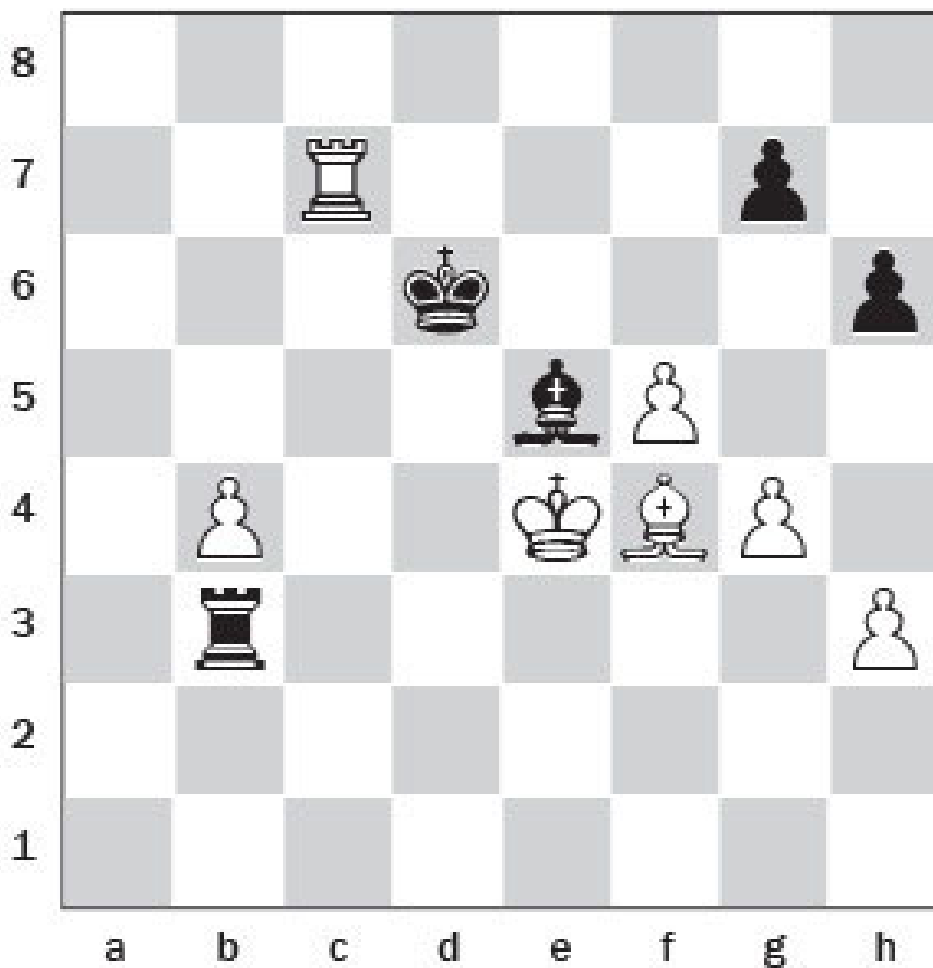


2. \_\_\_\_\_

Play for checkmate.

## Exercise 350

350



Answer:

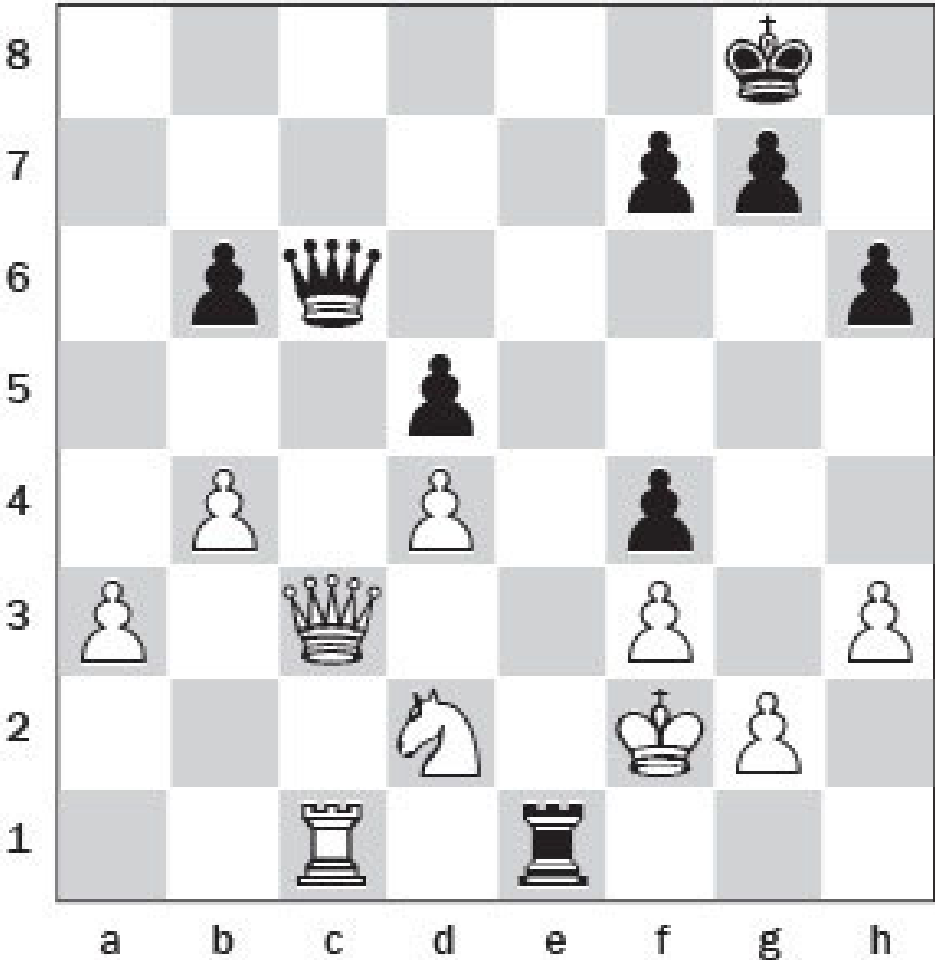
1. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

After your next move, the game will end.

Exercise 351

351



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Is White's rook really safe?

# X-Ray – Test

## Exercise 352

352



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



## Exercise 353

353



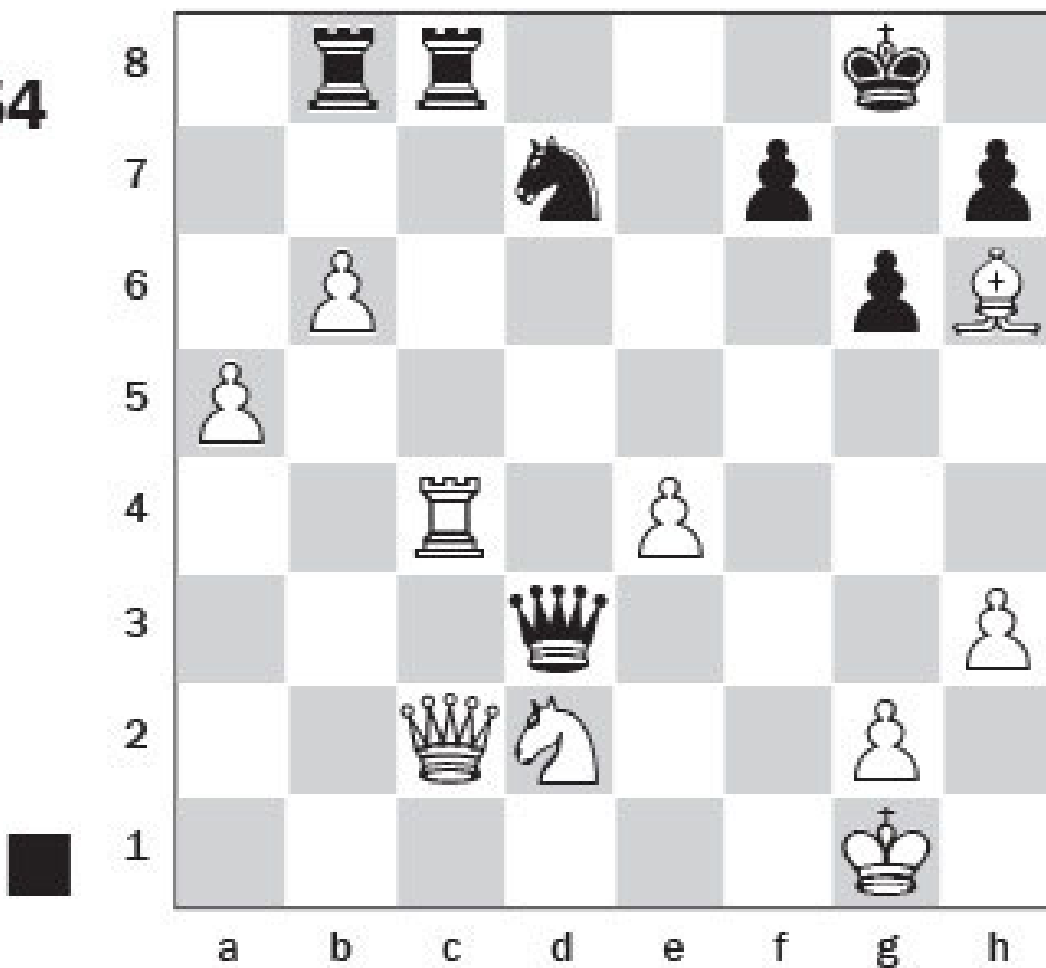
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 354

354



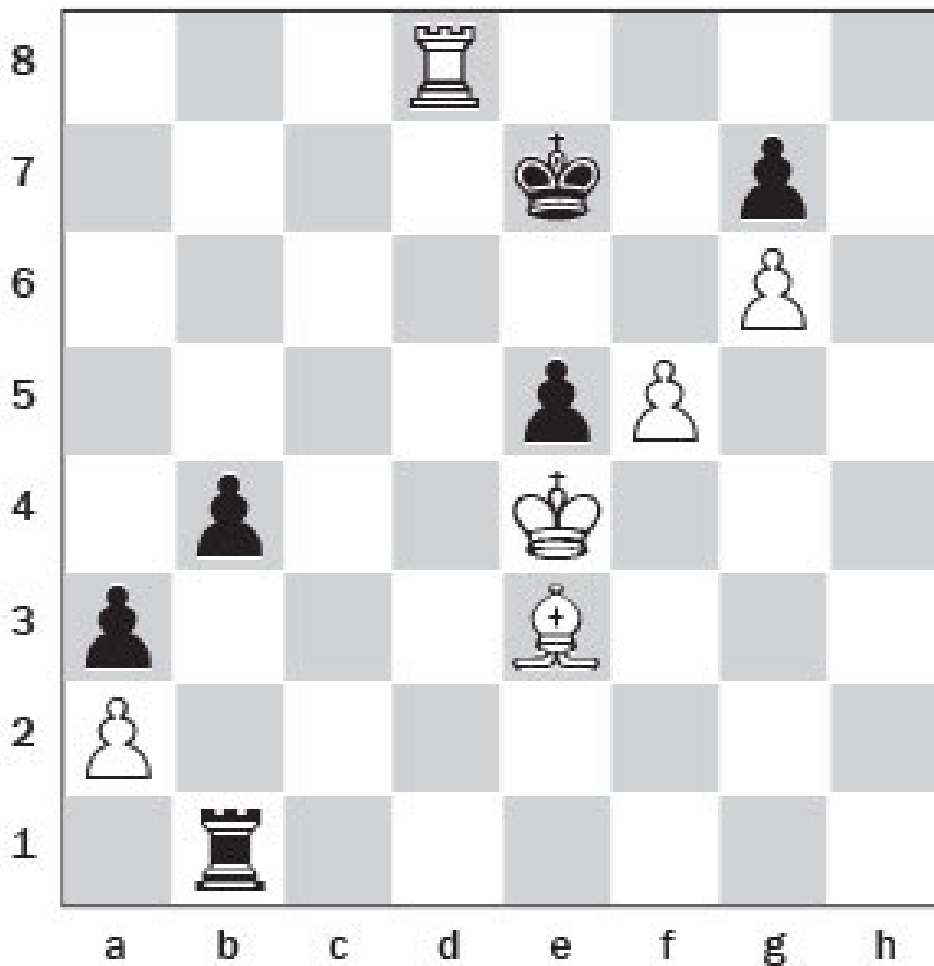
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 355

**355**

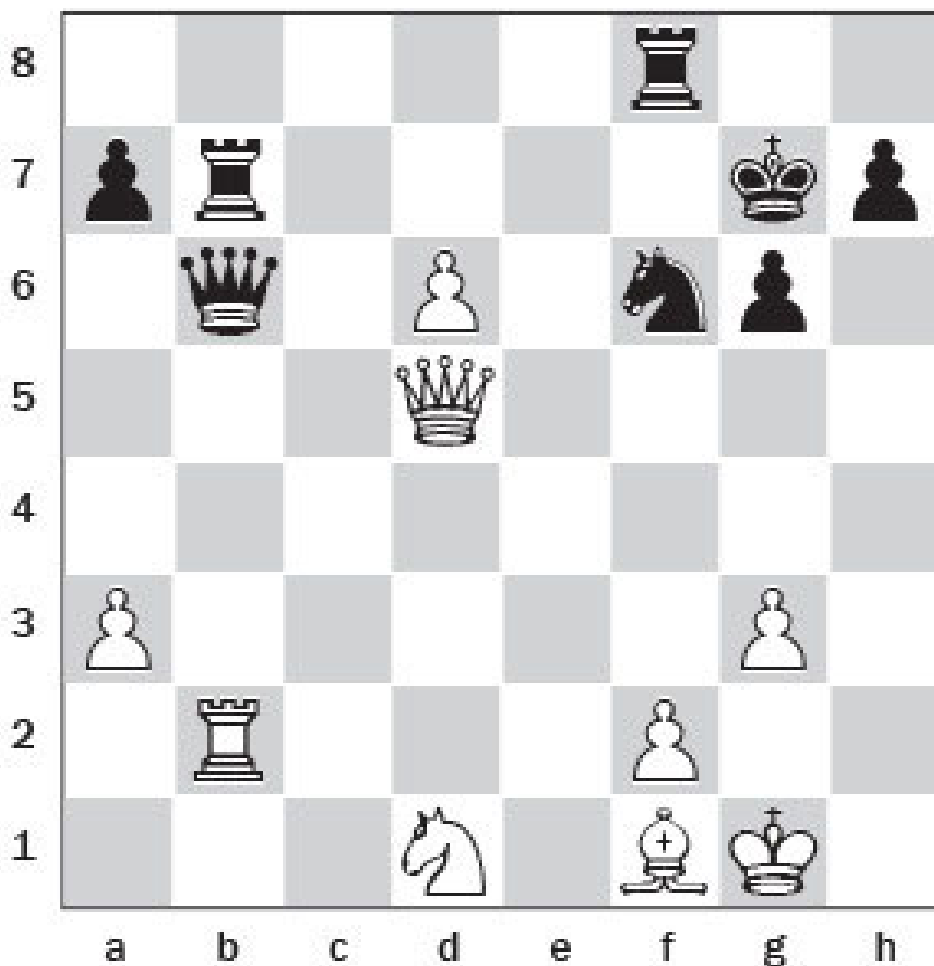


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 356

356



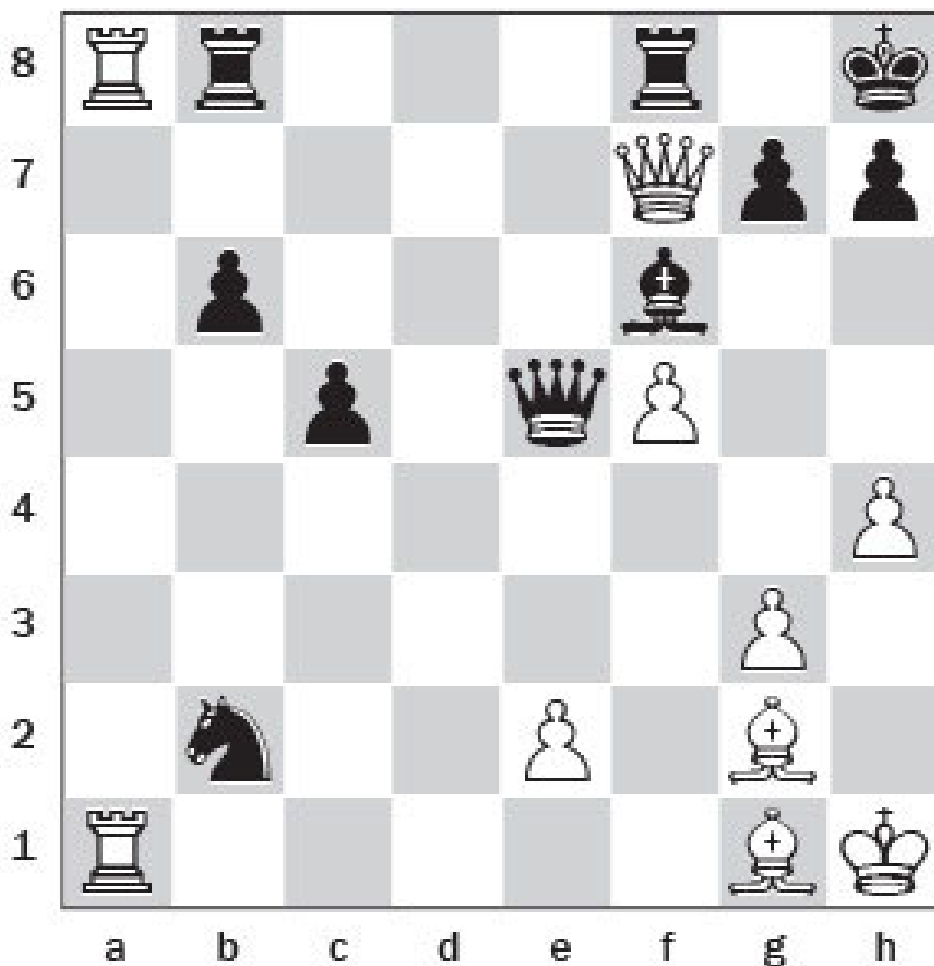
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 357](#)

357



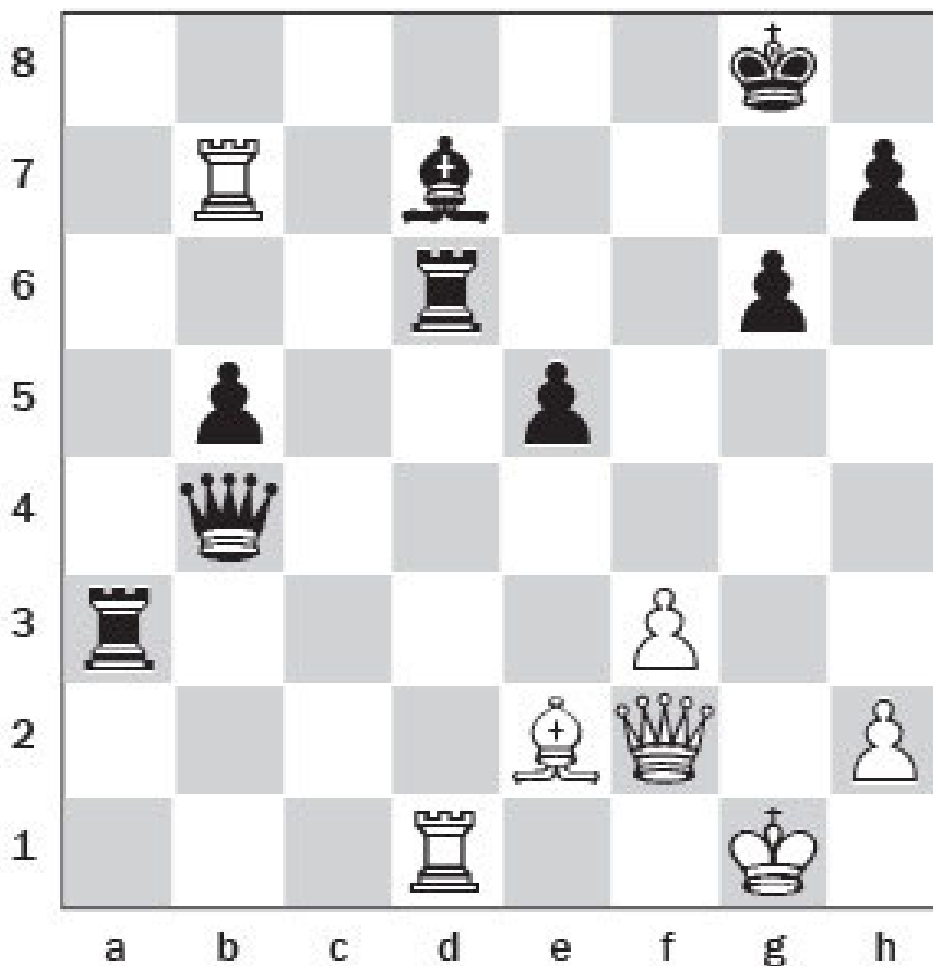
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 358](#)

358



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 359](#)

359



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 360](#)

360



Answer:

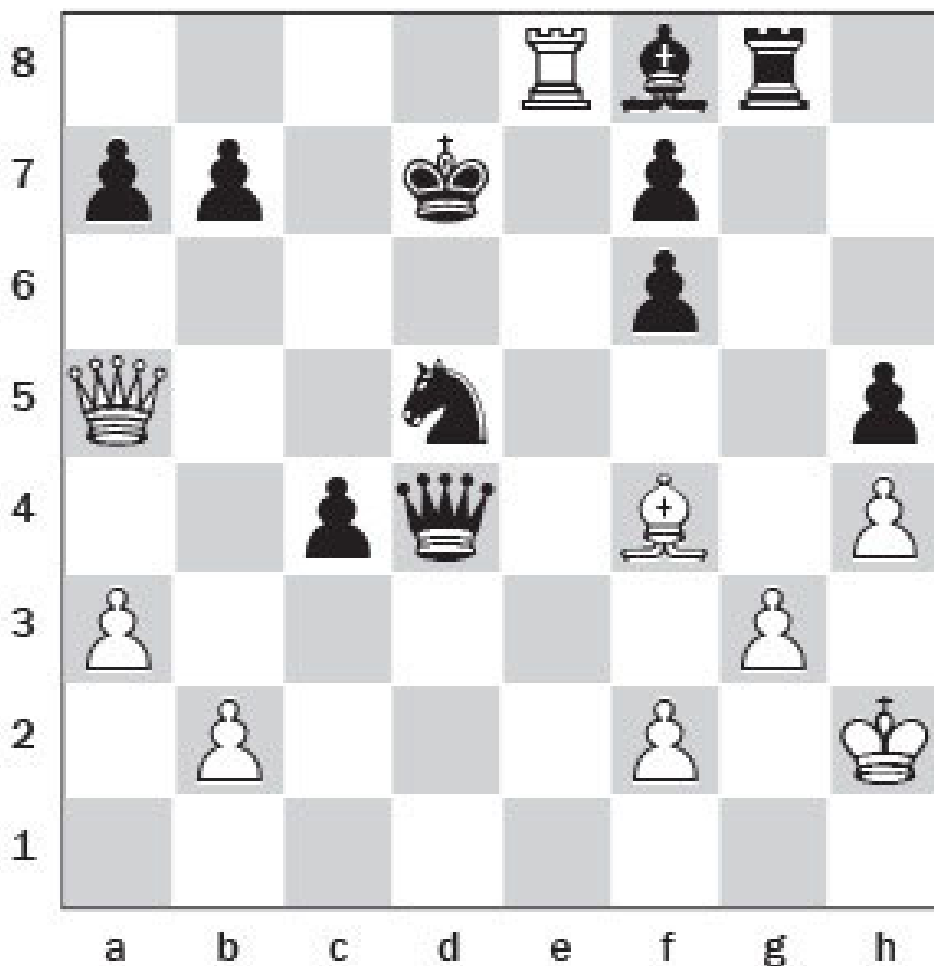
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 361](#)



361



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 362](#)

362

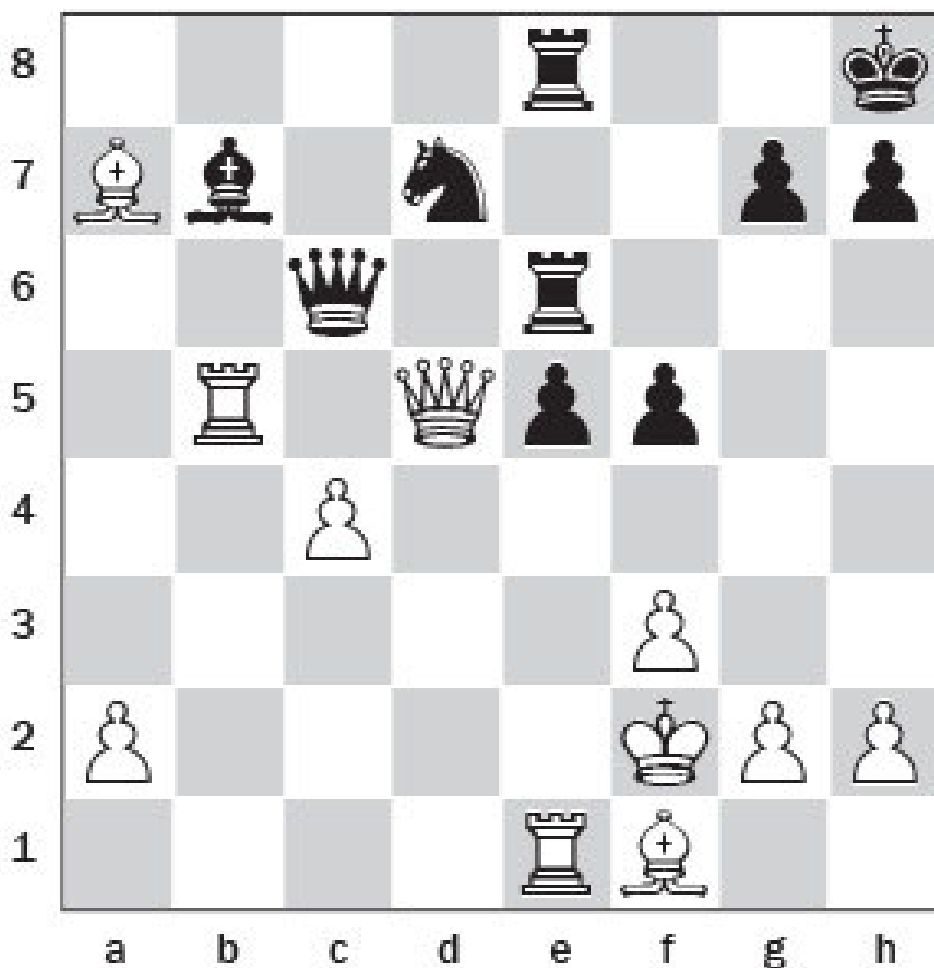


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 363](#)

363



Answer:

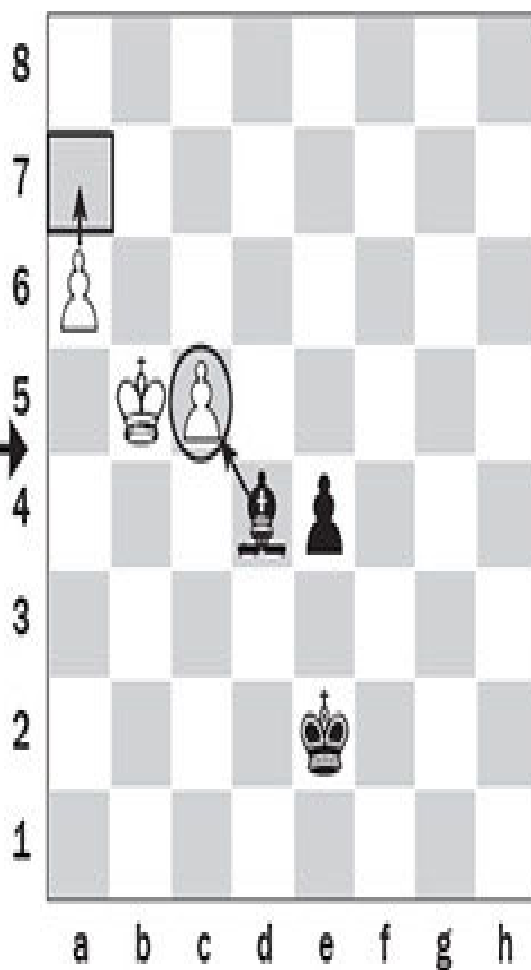
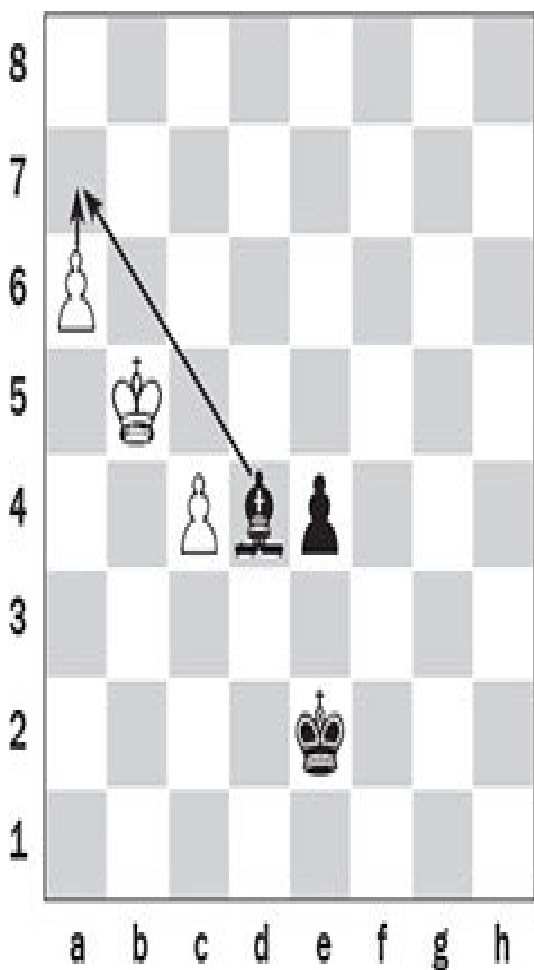
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 15

# Interference

Interference or obstruction is a tactic which occurs when a piece is placed or forced in-between the enemy line of defense. In the following position, White would like to promote their passed pawn on a6; after all it's only two squares away from promotion.



At the moment, Black's bishop on d4 is preventing the pawn from safely advancing, so White played:

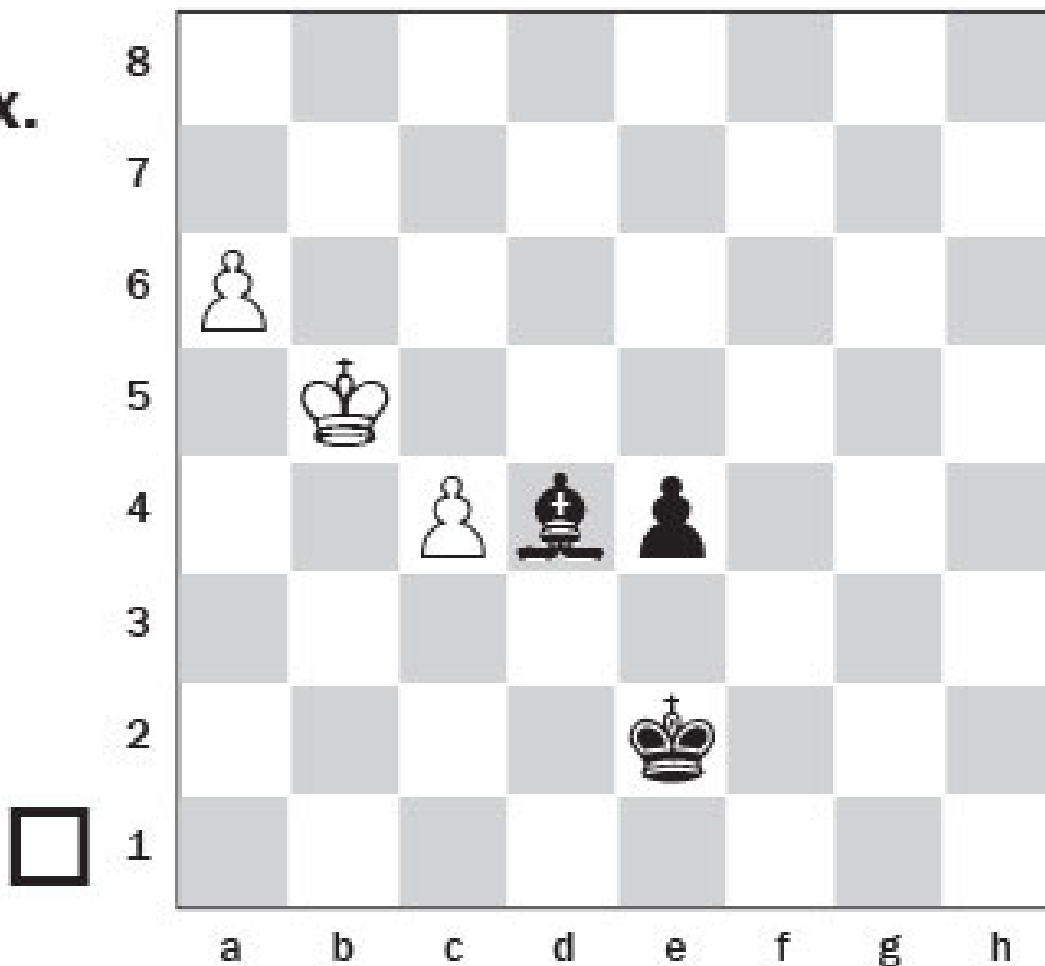
### **1.c5 (see diagram 2)**

Blocking the line of defense and allowing the pawn to promote. This is a relatively simple example to show the objective of an interference tactic.

To better solve the problems in this chapter, you will need to figure out what the opposing side is trying to defend against. Once you figure that out, see if there is a way you can get in the way of the defense.

# Interference – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



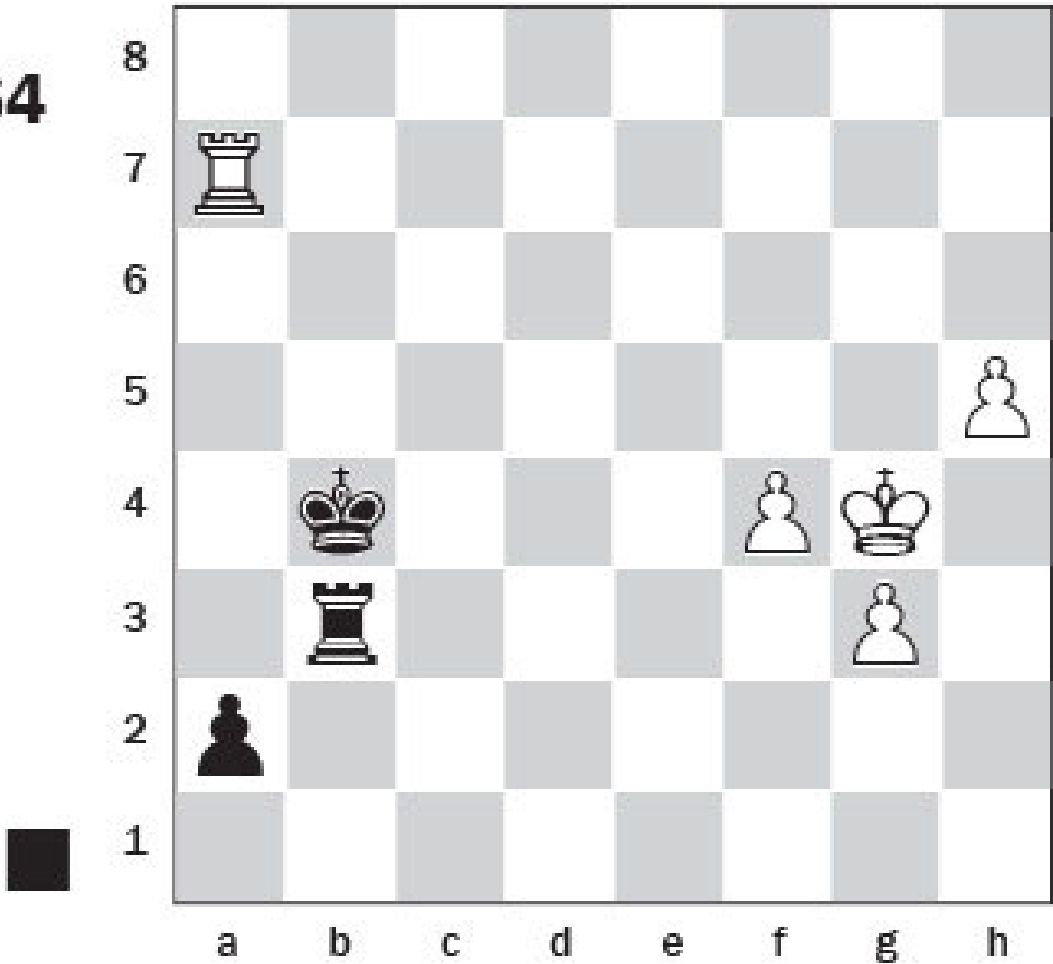
Answer:

1. c5 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 364

**364**



Answer:

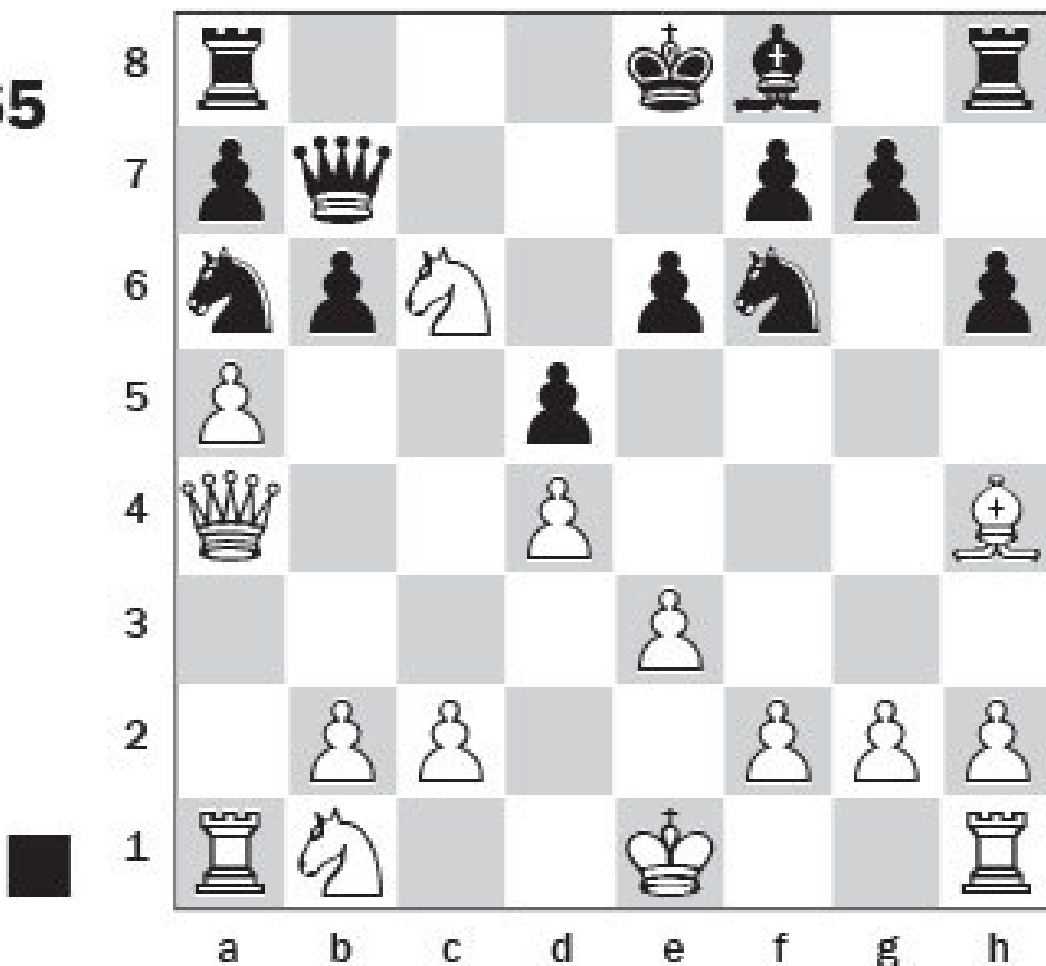
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black would like to promote the pawn but the white rook is preventing that. How can Black block, or interfere with, the rook's defense?

### Exercise 365

365



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_



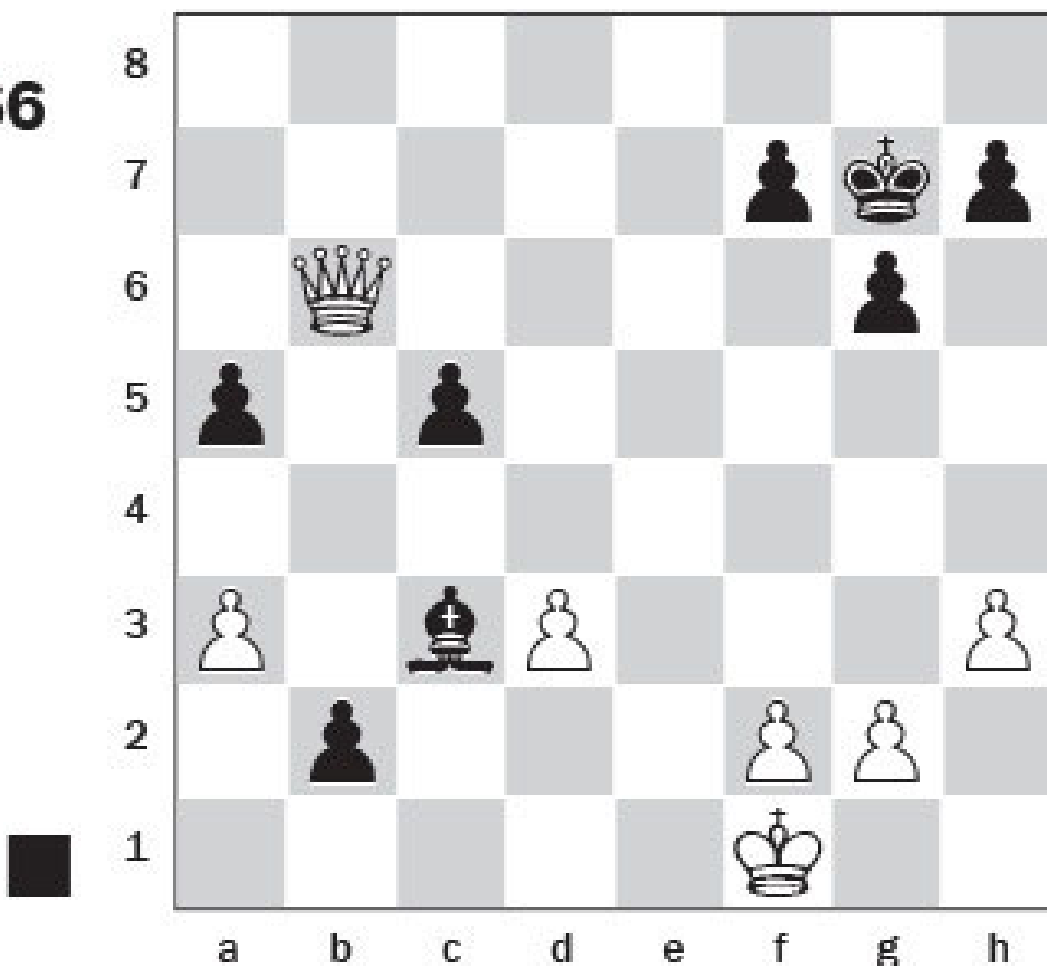
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's queen is guarding the knight on c6. How can Black interfere with the knight's protection?

### Exercise 366

**366**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

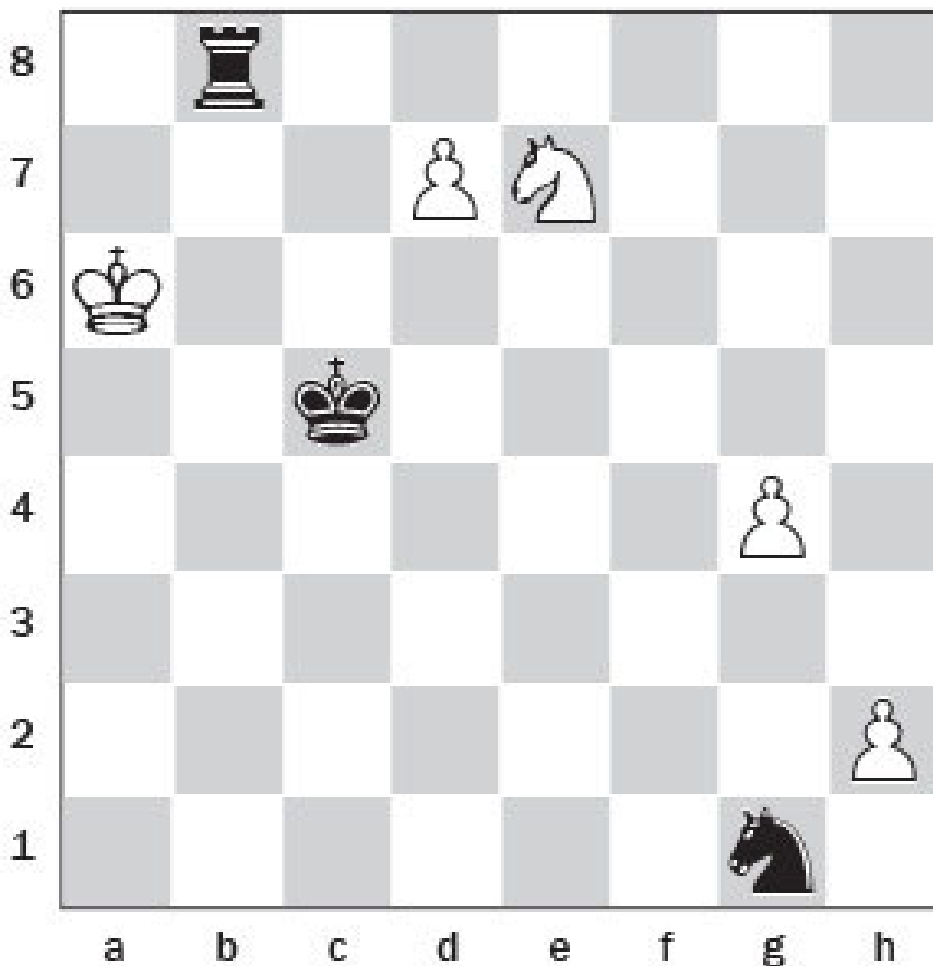
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Black wants to promote the pawn but the white queen is defending against it. Can you find a way to give away a bishop but promote the pawn?

### [Exercise 367](#)

367



Answer:

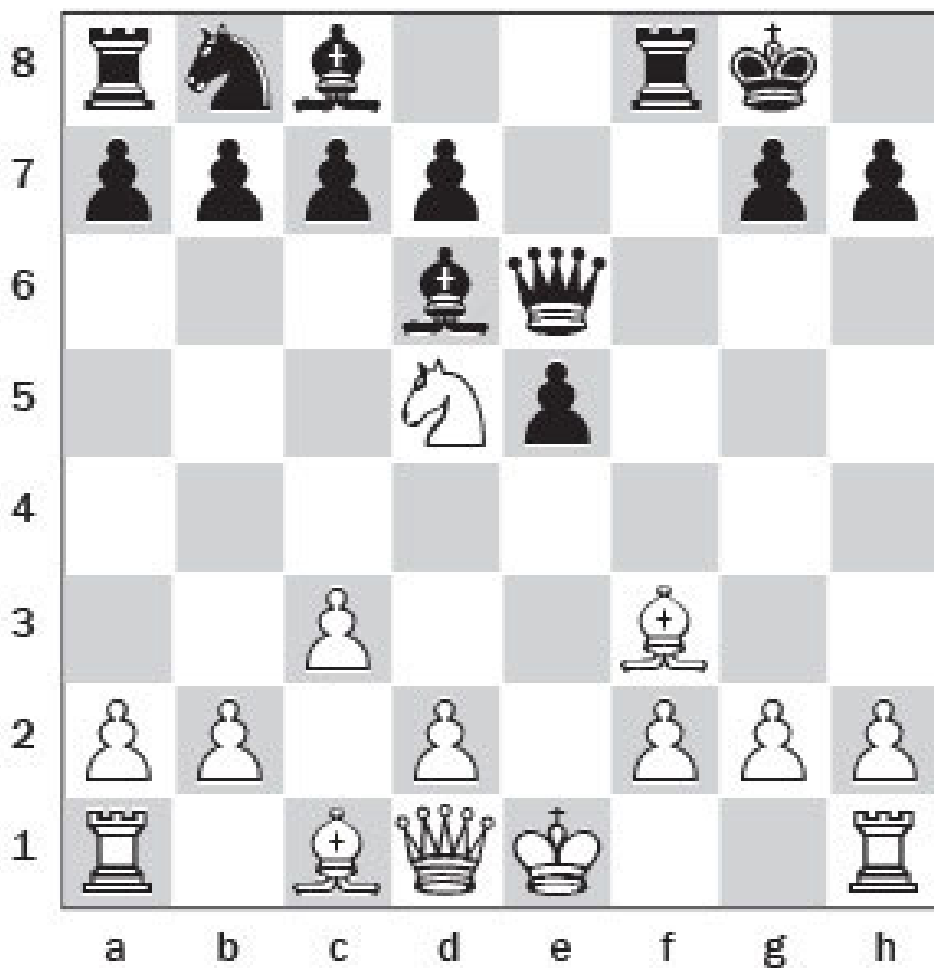
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White wants to promote the pawn on d7 but the black rook is preventing that. How can White interfere?

## Exercise 368

368



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

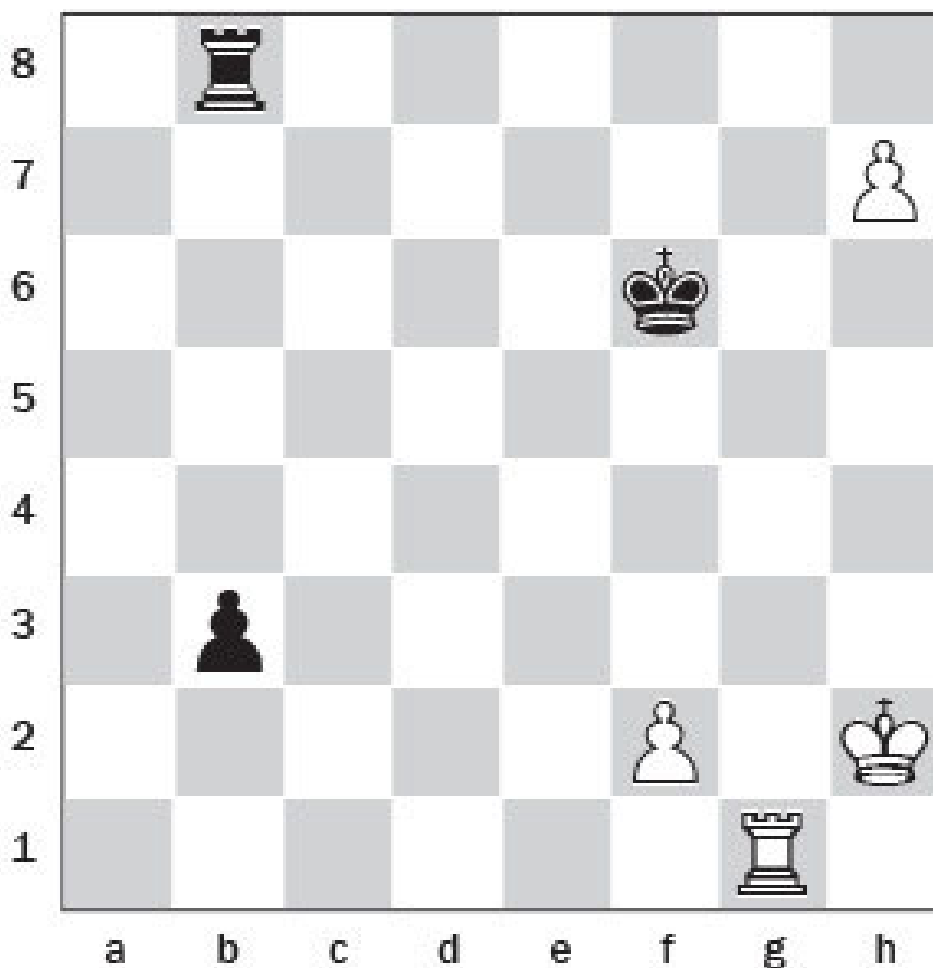
## HINT

The knight on d5 is protected by the bishop on f3. Is there a way to interfere with the defense?

# Interference – Test

## Exercise 369

**369**

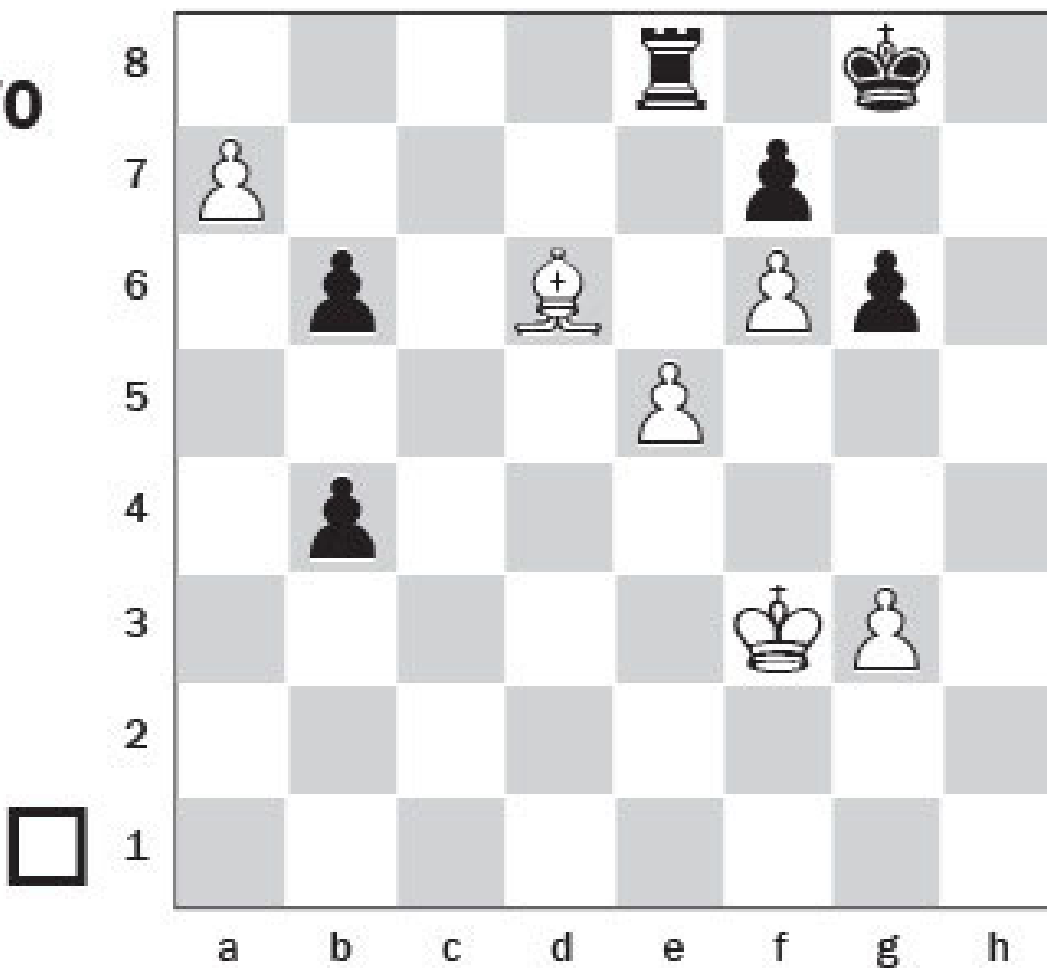


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 370

**370**

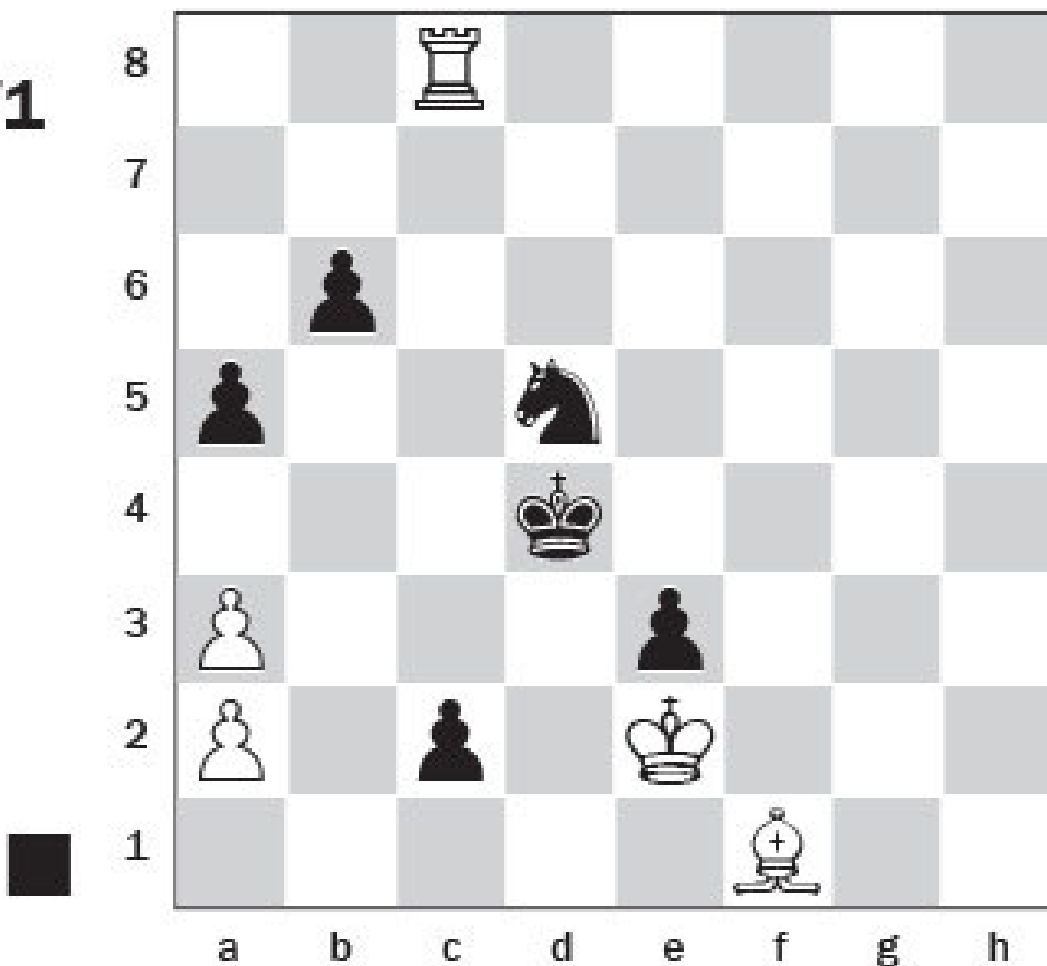


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 371

371



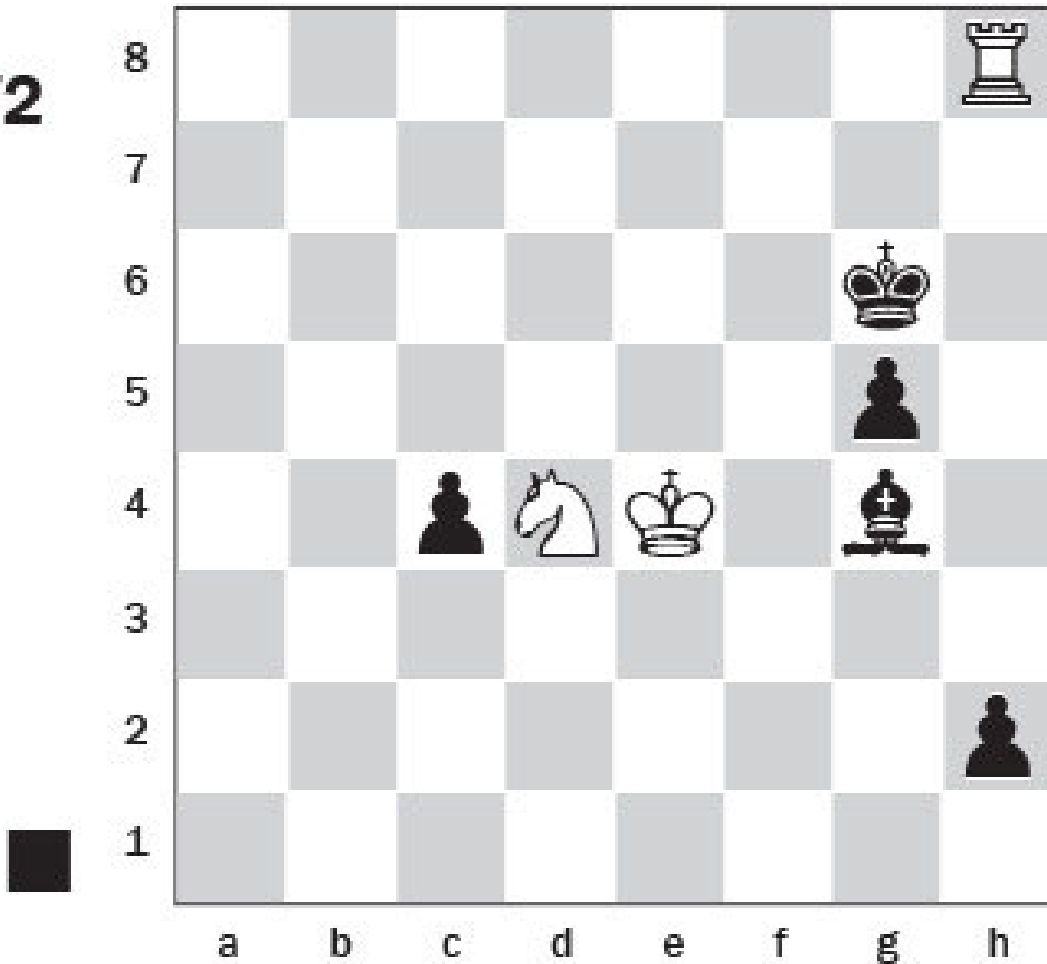
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 372](#)



372



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 373](#)

# 373

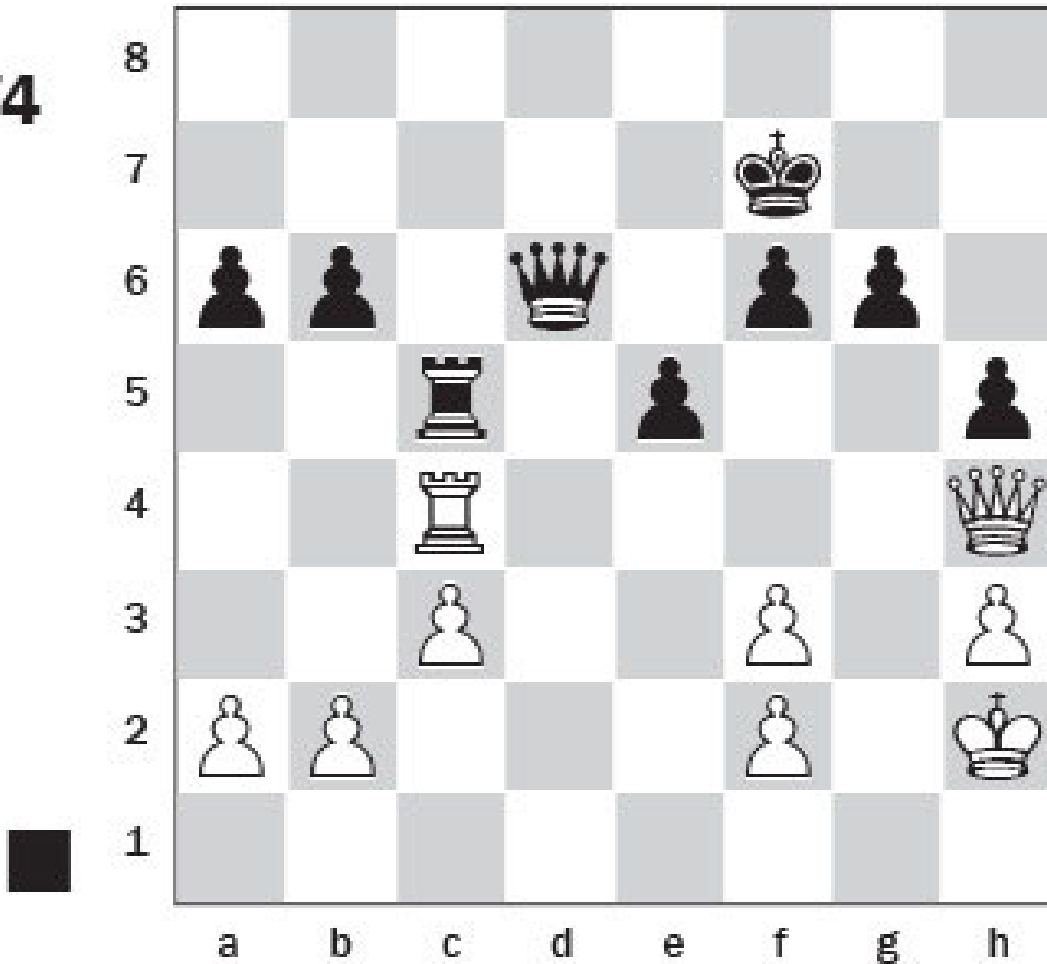


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 374](#)

# 374



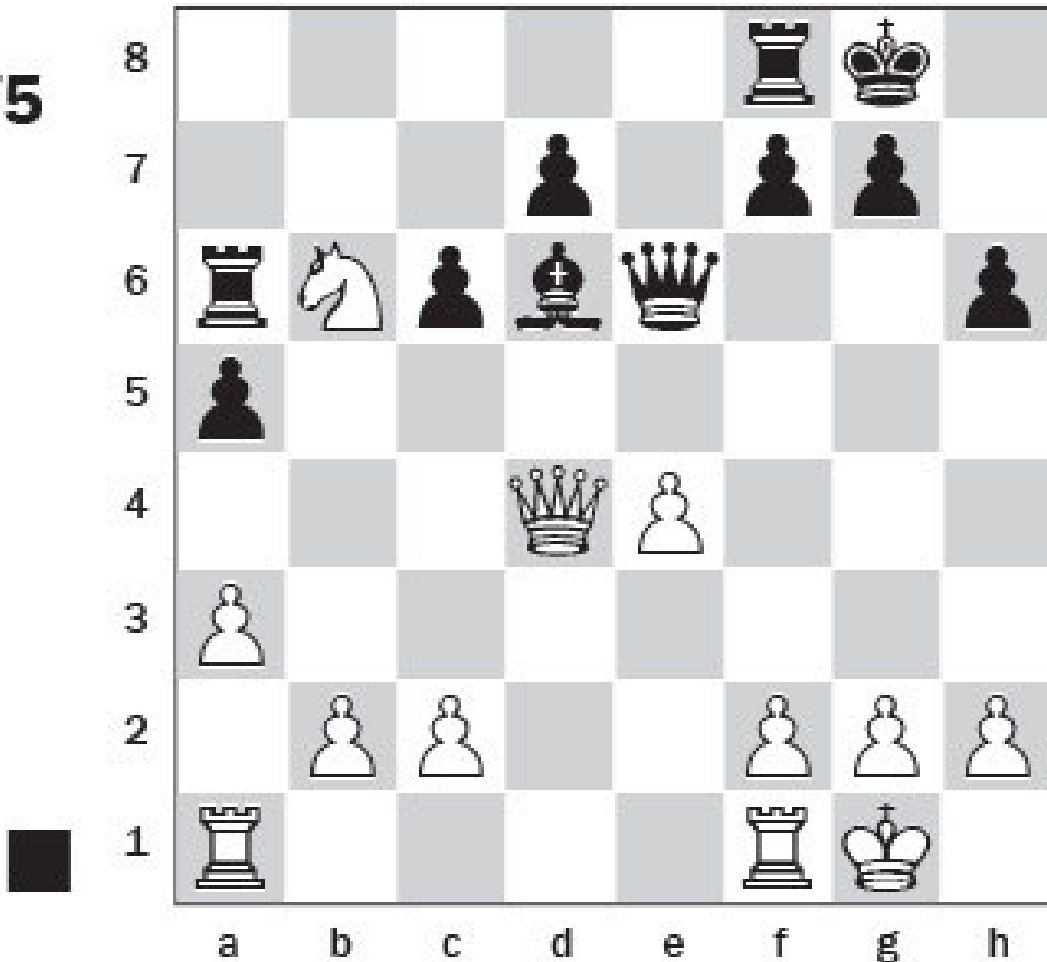
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 375](#)

375



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 376](#)

376



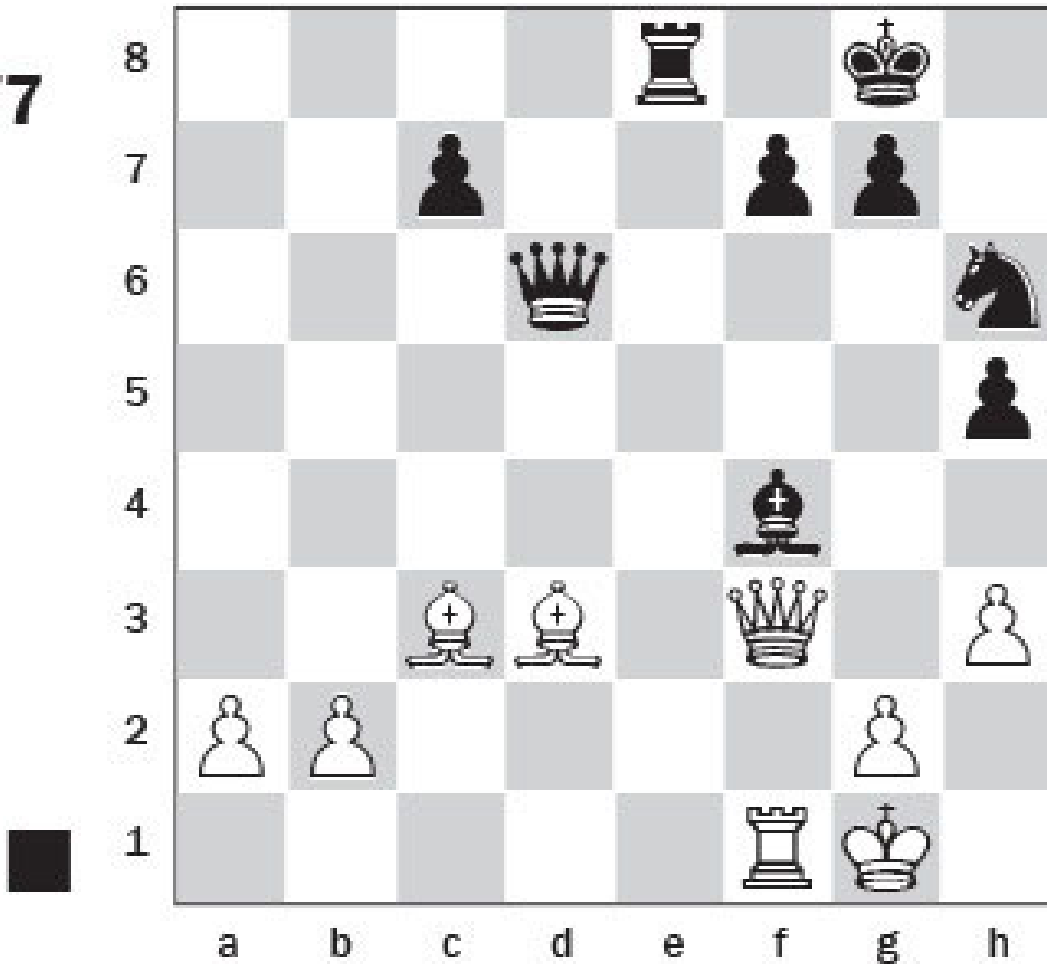
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 377](#)

377



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 378](#)

# 378



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 379](#)

379



Answer:

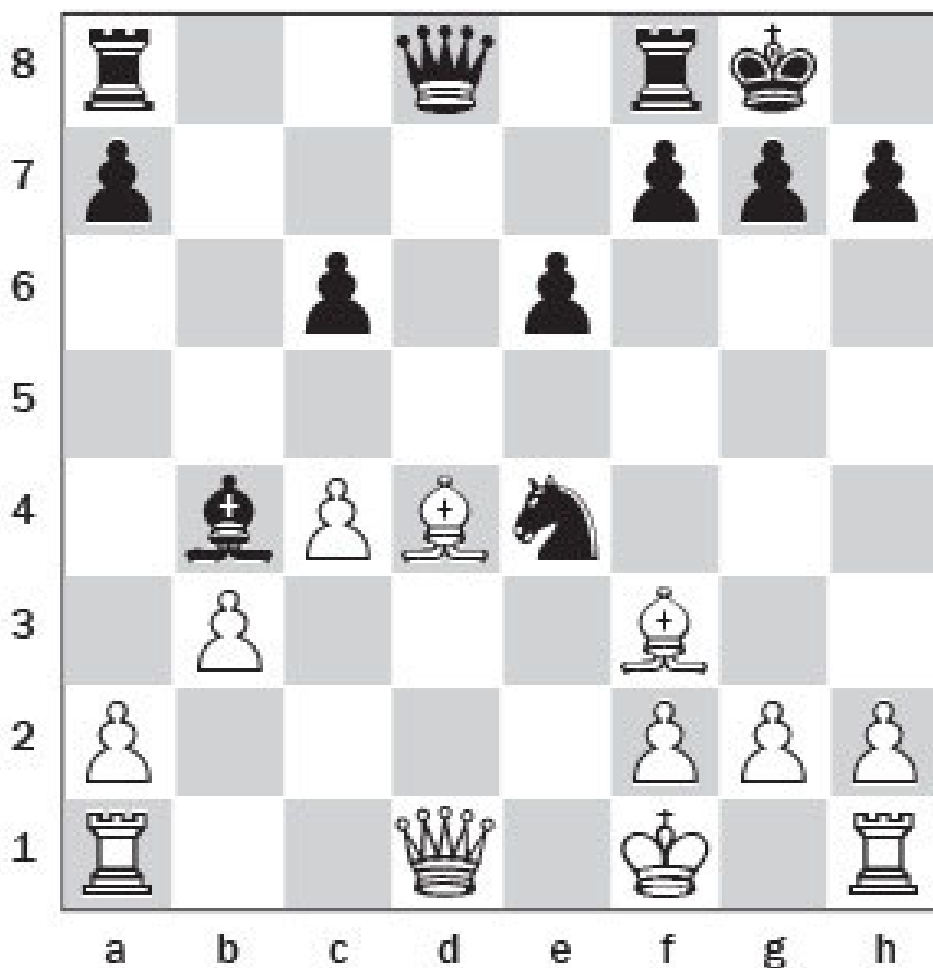
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 380](#)



380



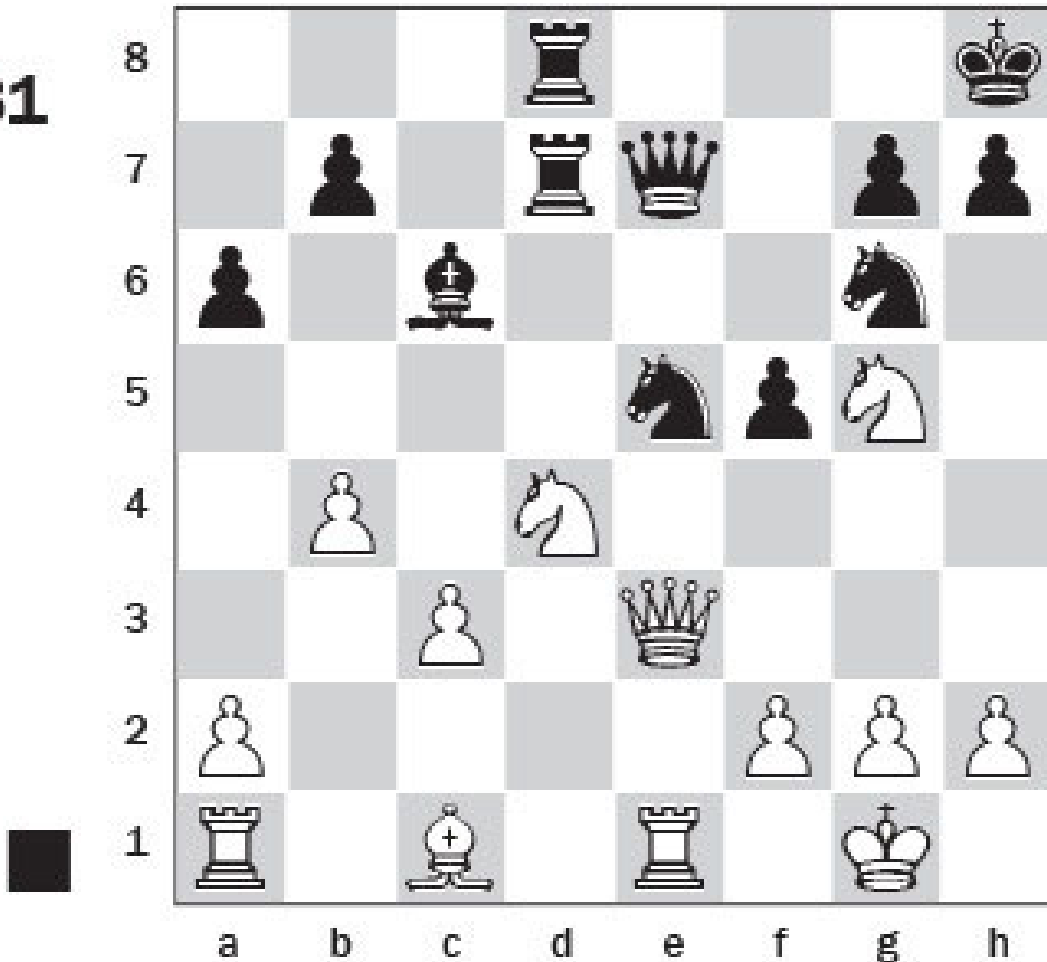
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 381](#)

381

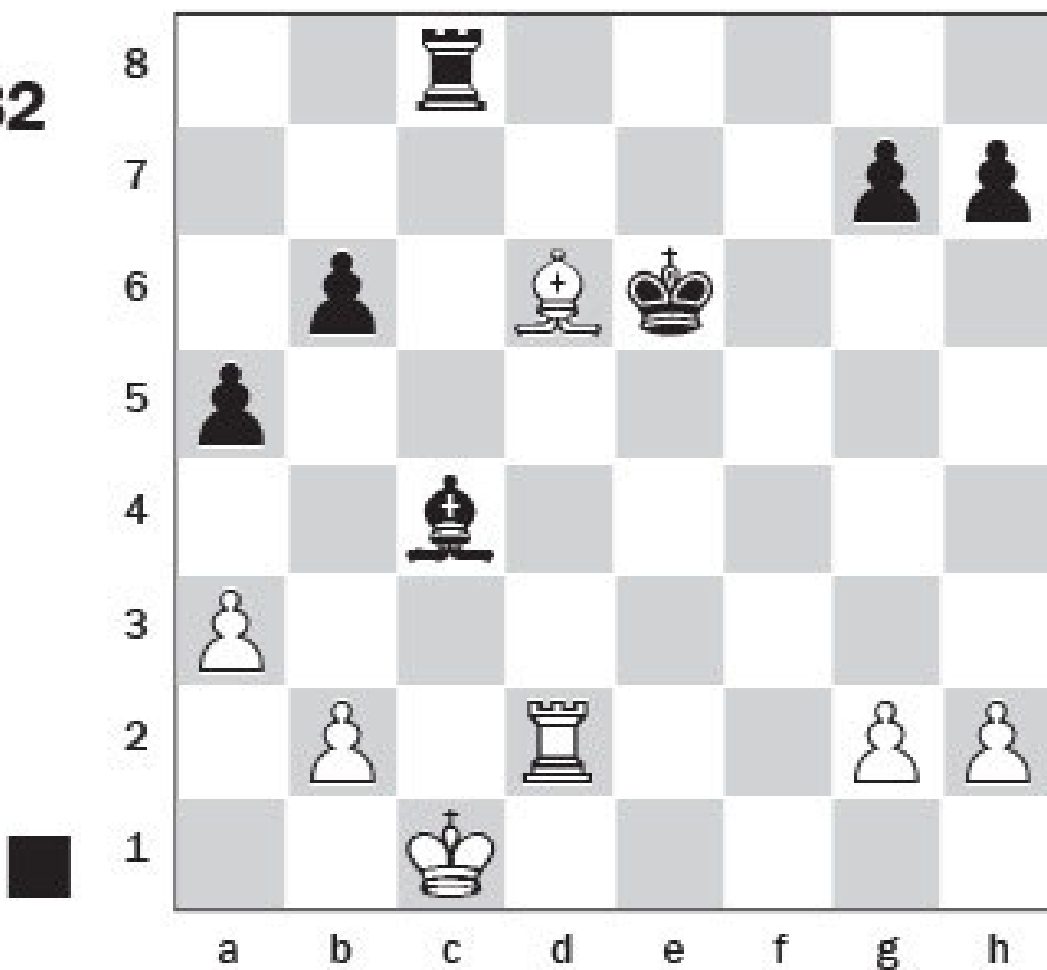


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 382](#)

382



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 383](#)

383



Answer:

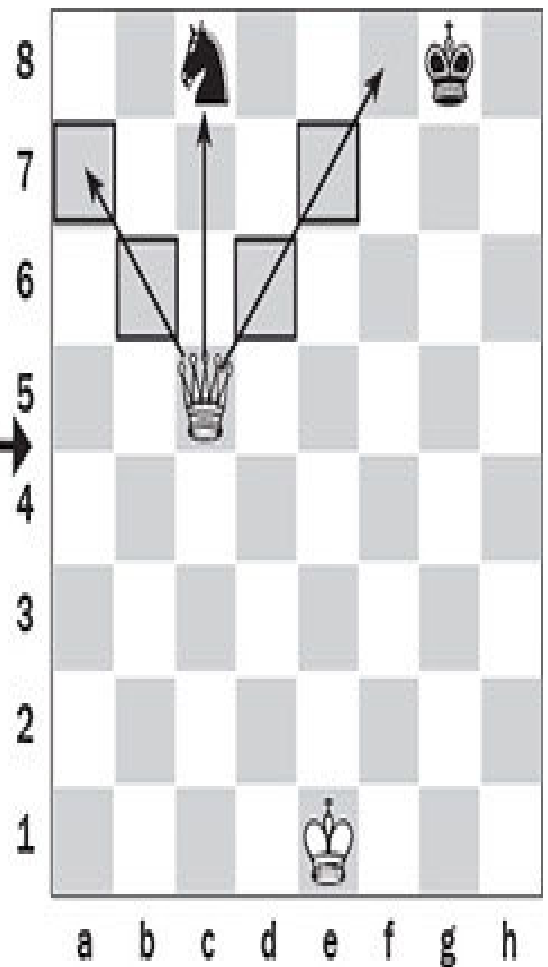
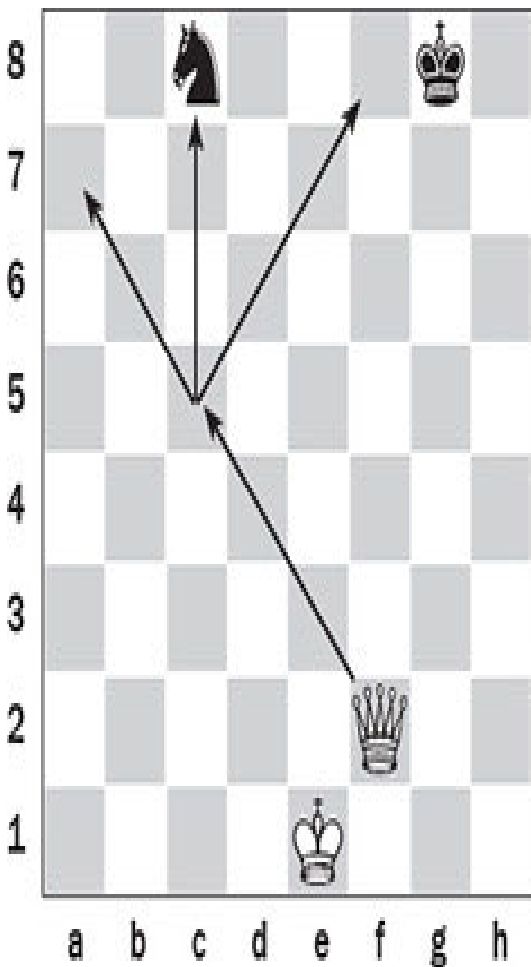
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 16

# Trapping Pieces

In this chapter we will look at attacking pieces in such a way that there is no escape without losing material. Trapping pieces is not always an easy task and requires you to have full vision of the chess board.



White has a queen and is looking to take advantage of the knight on the rim. White could play the move 1.Qc5 and attack the knight and take away all of its flight squares. After

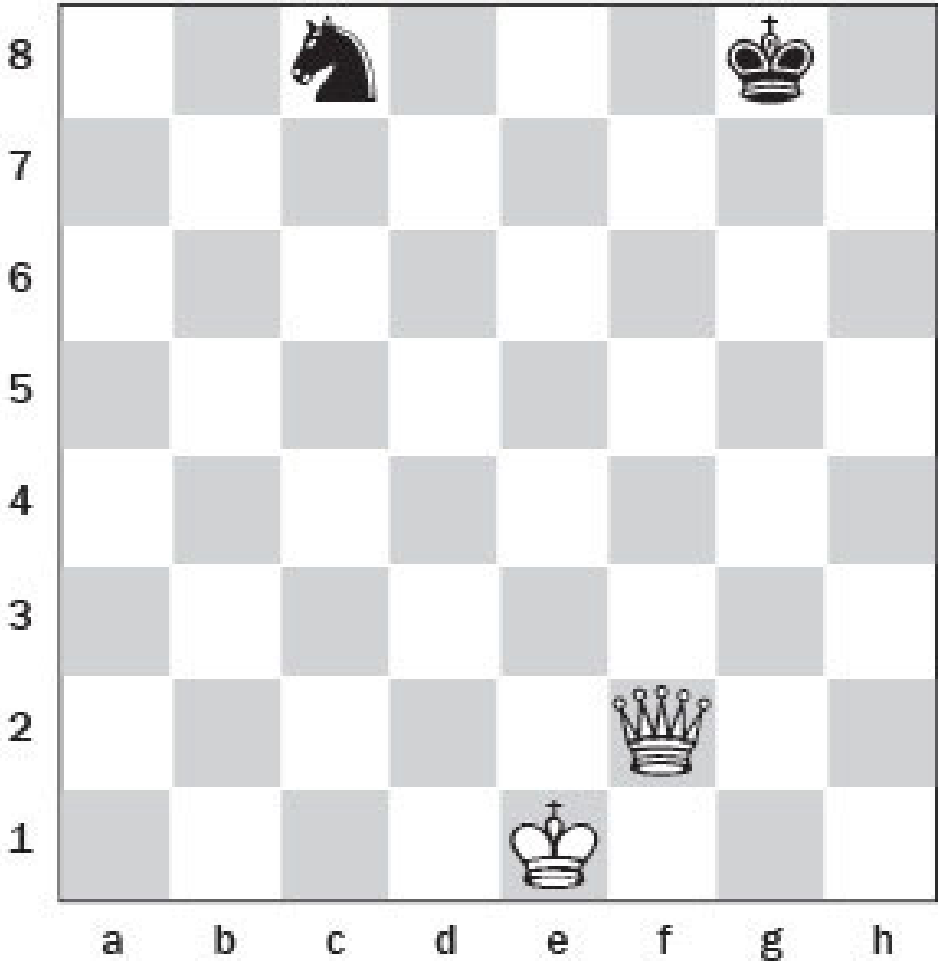
**1.Qc5 (see diagram 2)**

the black knight is trapped and will be captured on the next turn.

To better solve the problems in this chapter, look for pieces that have limited moves, and pieces that are alone in enemy territory.

# Trapping Pieces – Guided Practice

Ex.



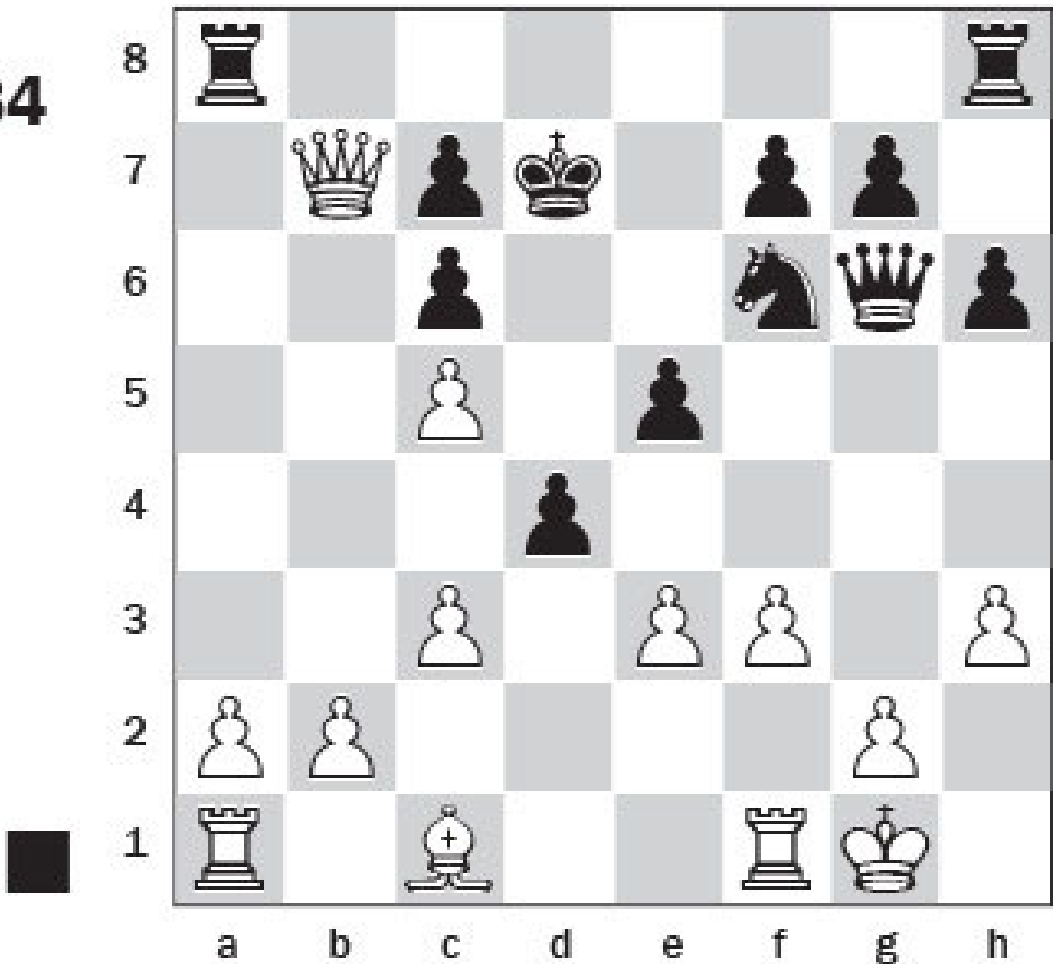
Answer:

1. Qc5\_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 384

384



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

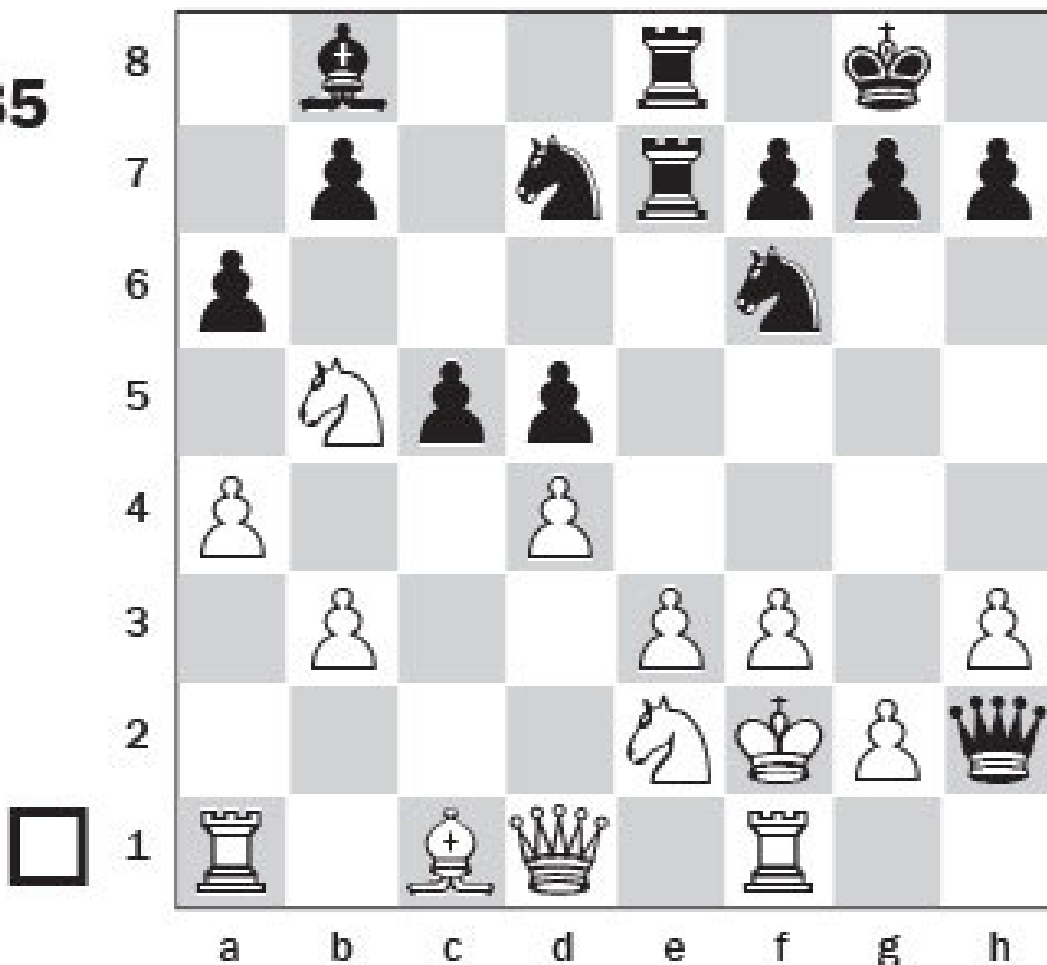


## HINT

White's queen on b7 is all alone, deep in Black's territory. How can Black win the queen for a rook?

### Exercise 385

**385**



Answer:

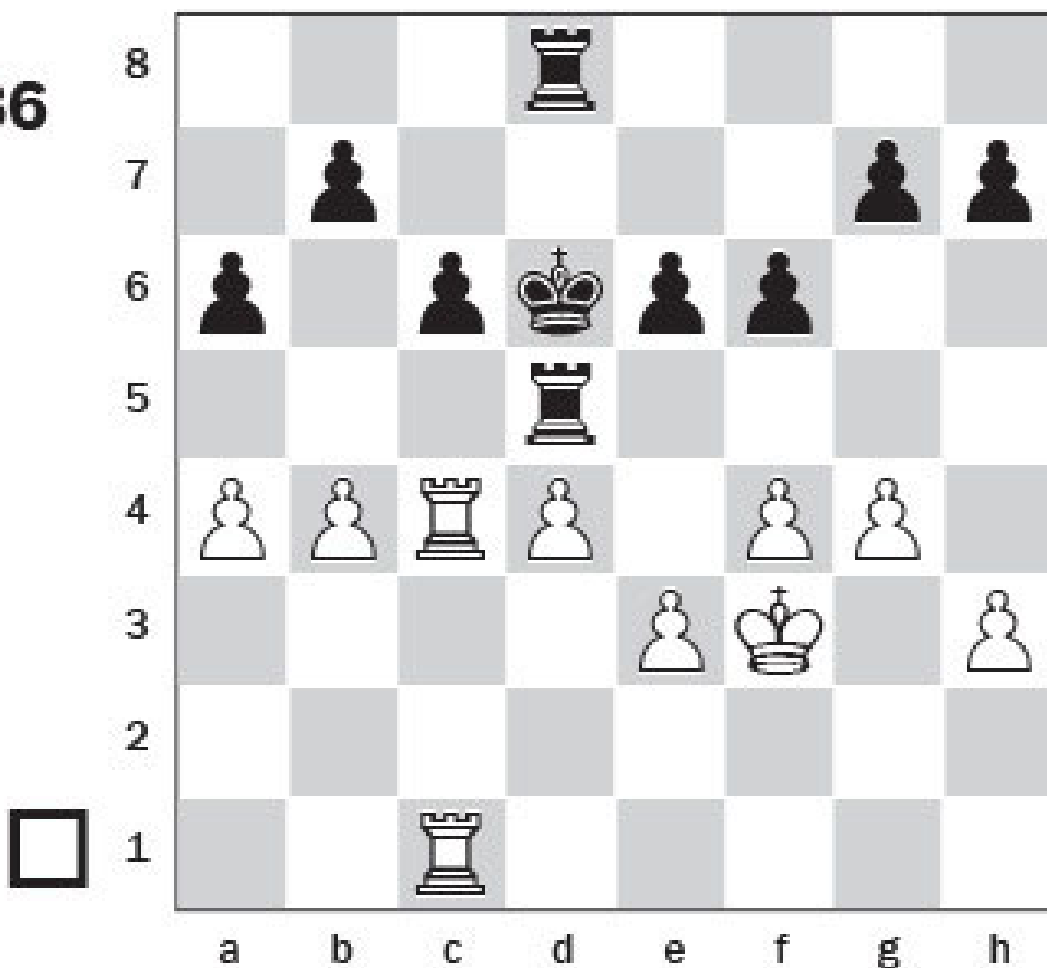
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black's queen is close to White's king, but is it really safe on h2?

### Exercise 386

**386**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

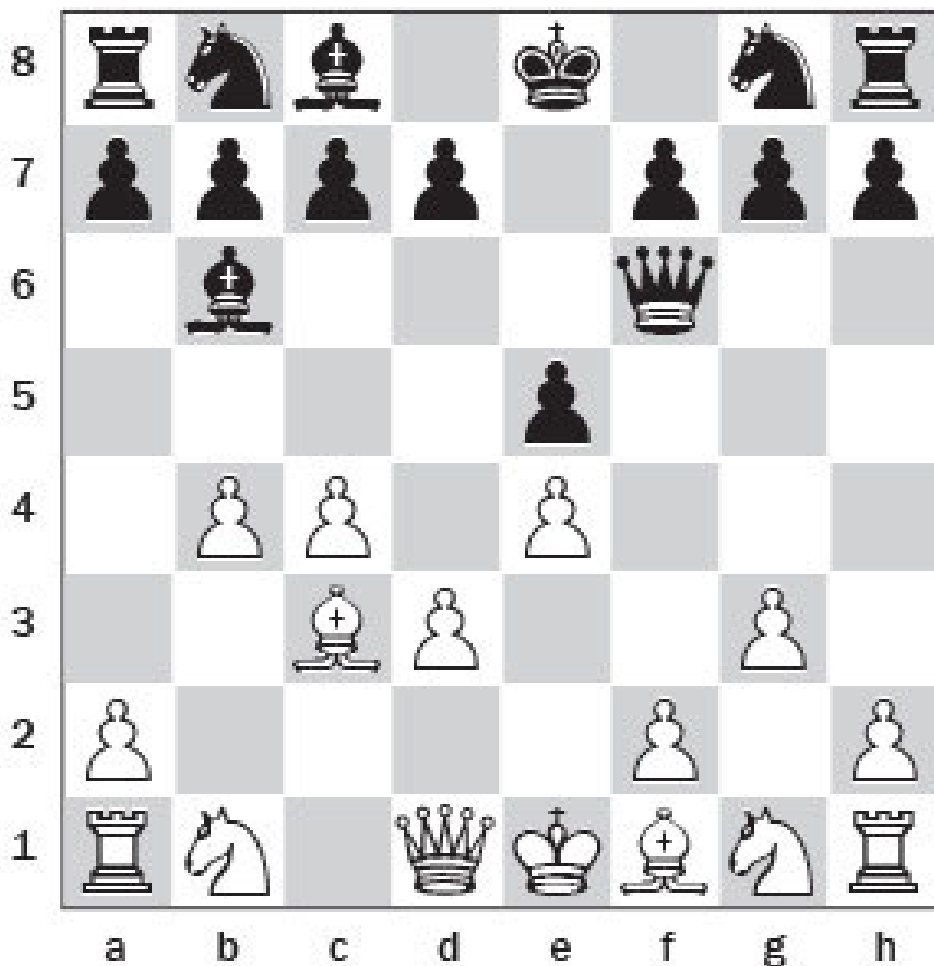
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Notice that Black's rook on d5 has no safe place to move. What can White do?

### **Exercise 387**

387



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

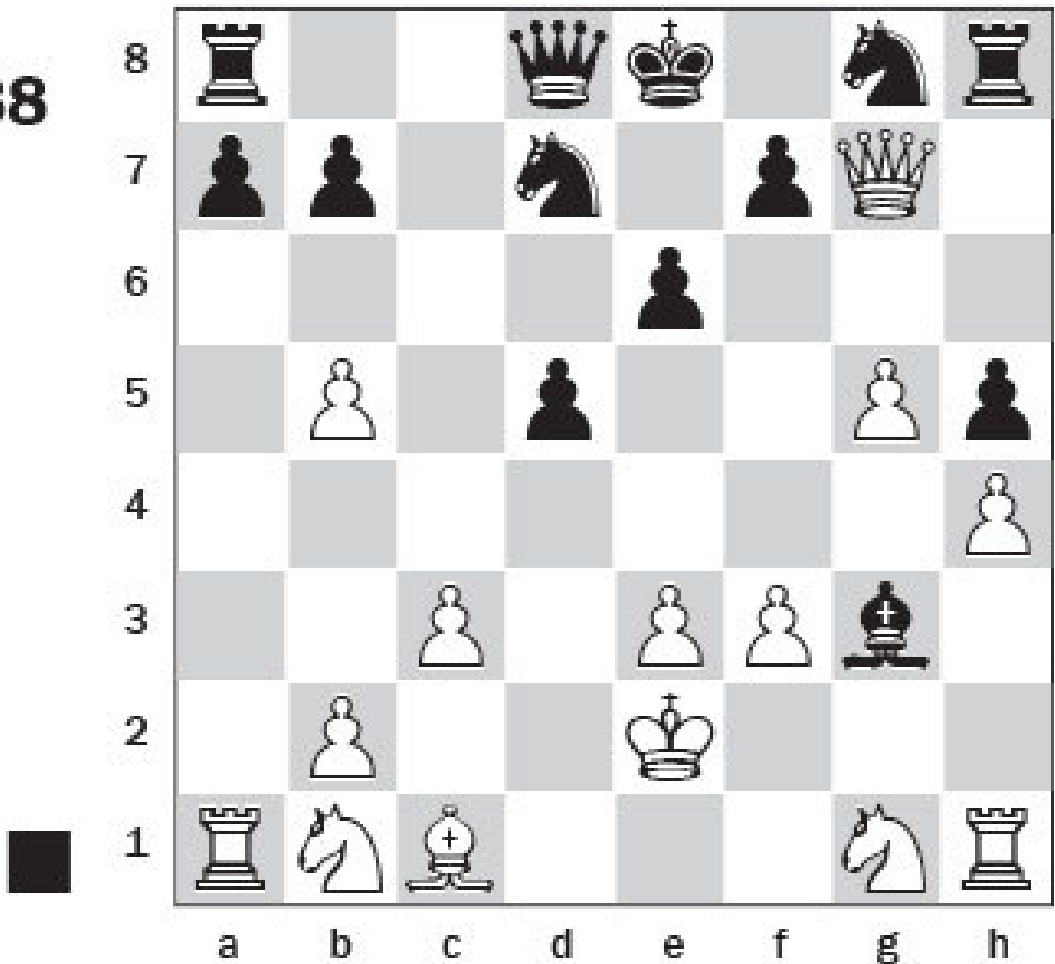
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

Black's bishop on b6 has its eyes on the f2 square. What can White do to block the attack?

### Exercise 388

**388**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

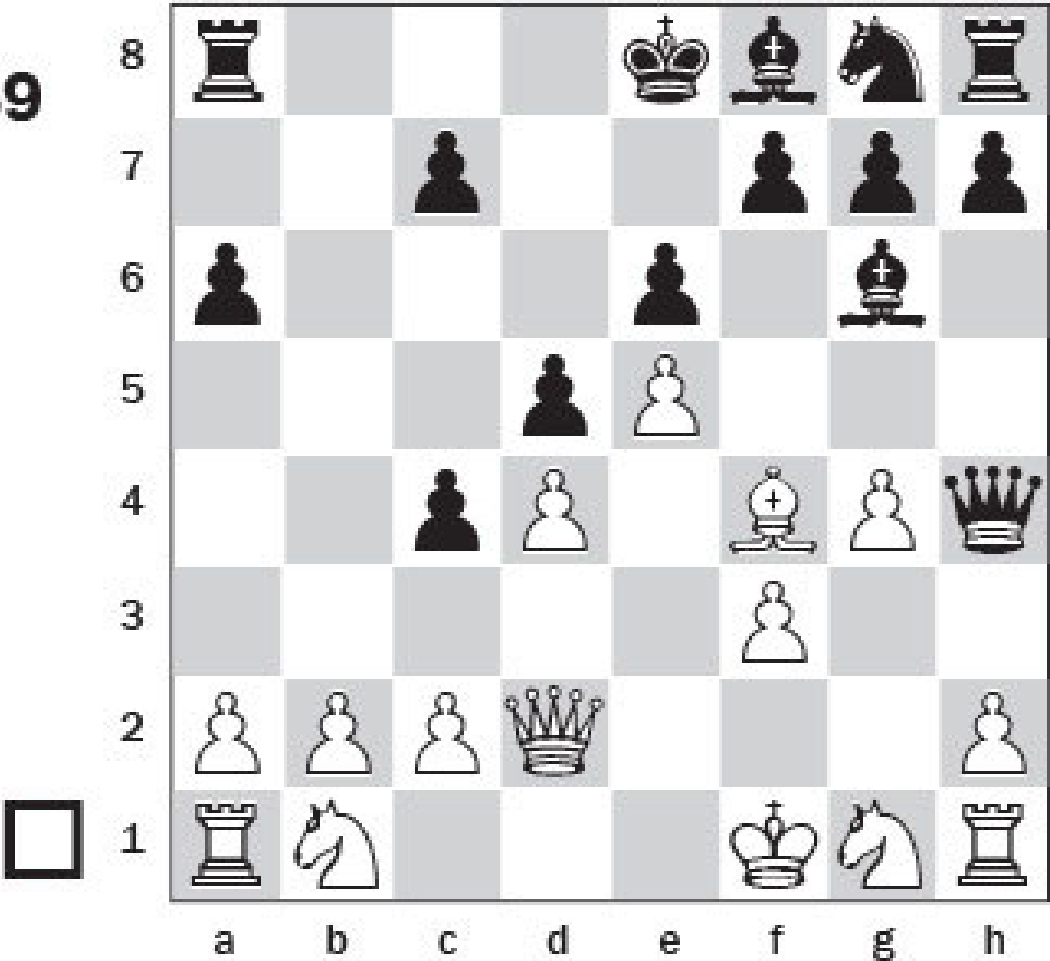
### **HINT**

Use an X-ray to both defend the threat and trap a piece!

# Trapping Pieces – Test

Exercise 389

389

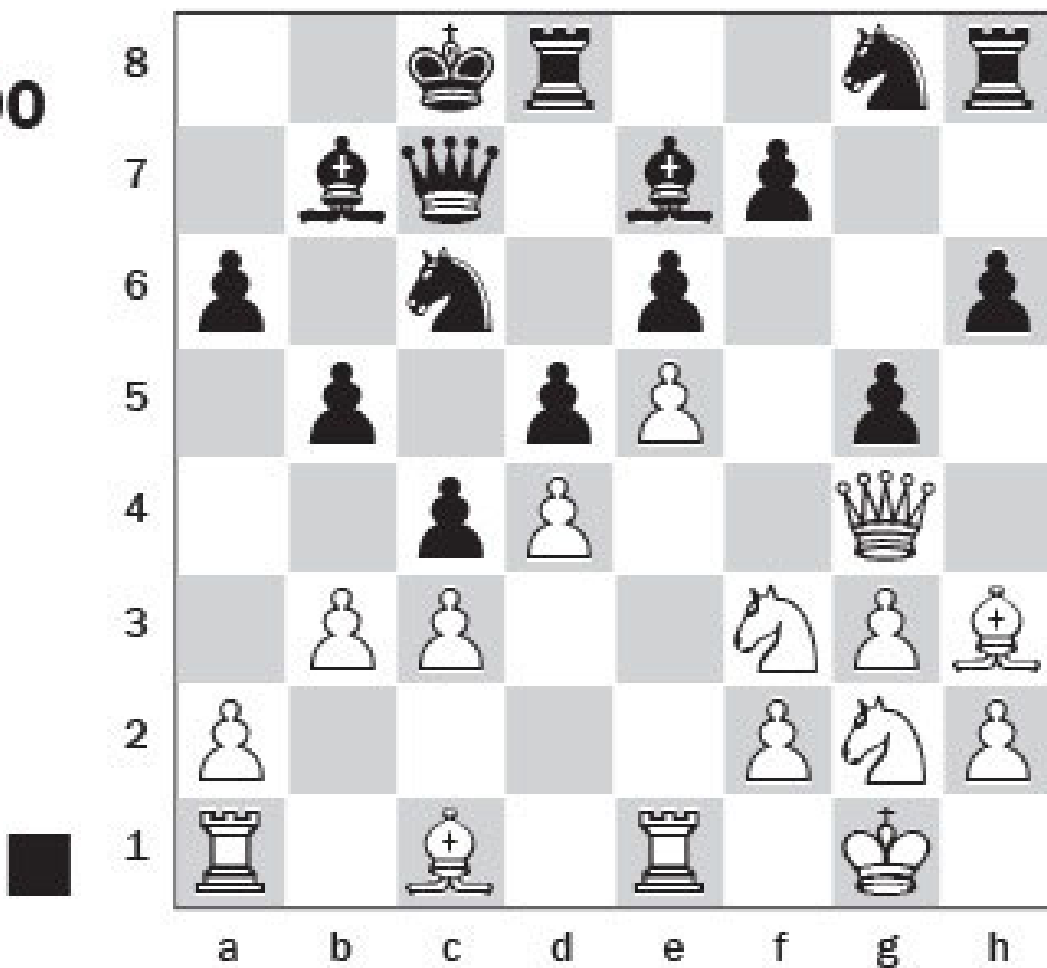


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 390

390



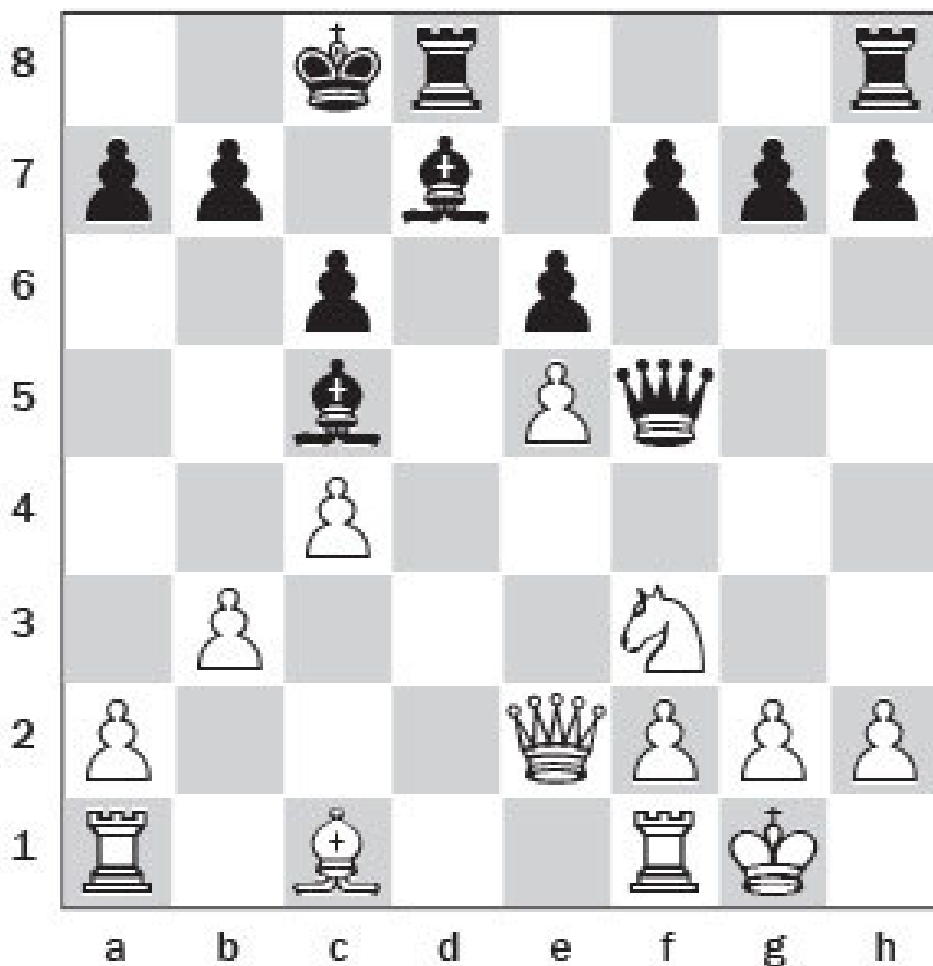
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 391



391



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 392](#)

392

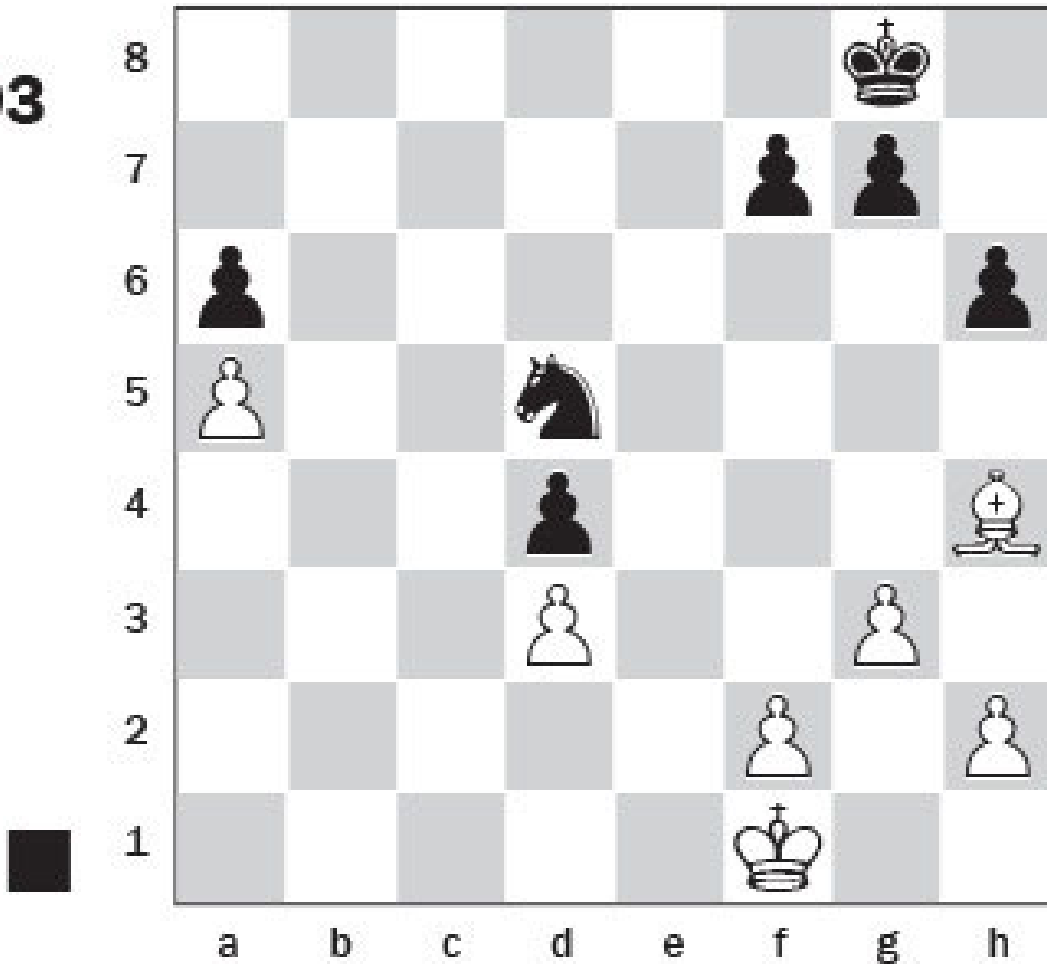


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 393](#)

393

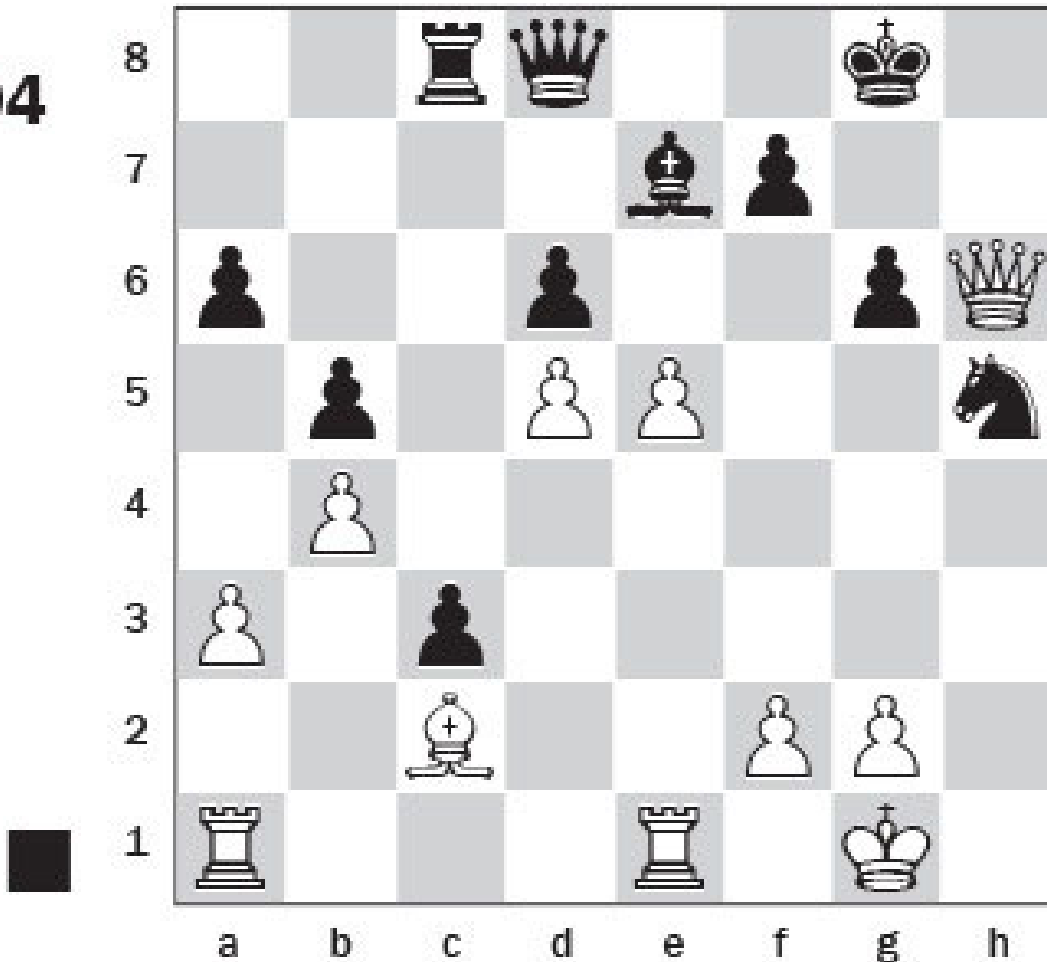


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 394](#)

394

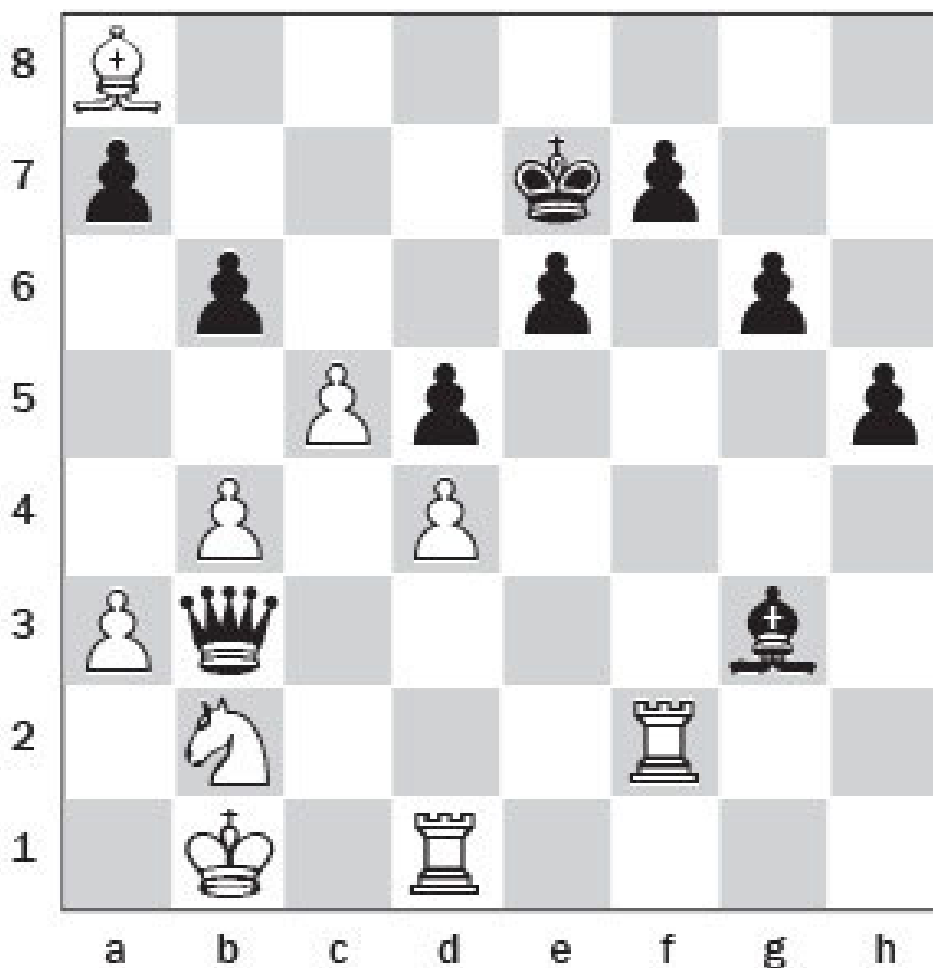


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 395](#)

# 395



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 396](#)

396

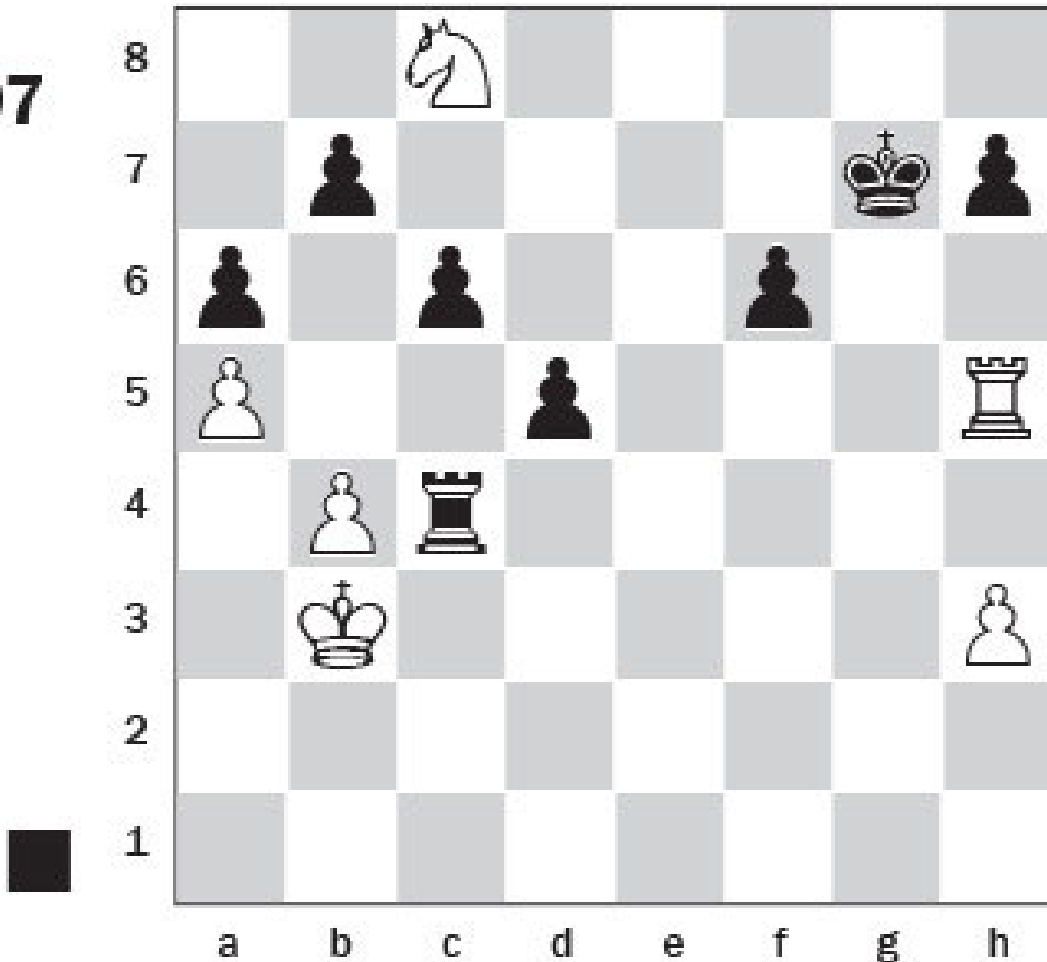


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 397](#)

# 397



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 398](#)

398



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 399](#)



399



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 400](#)

400

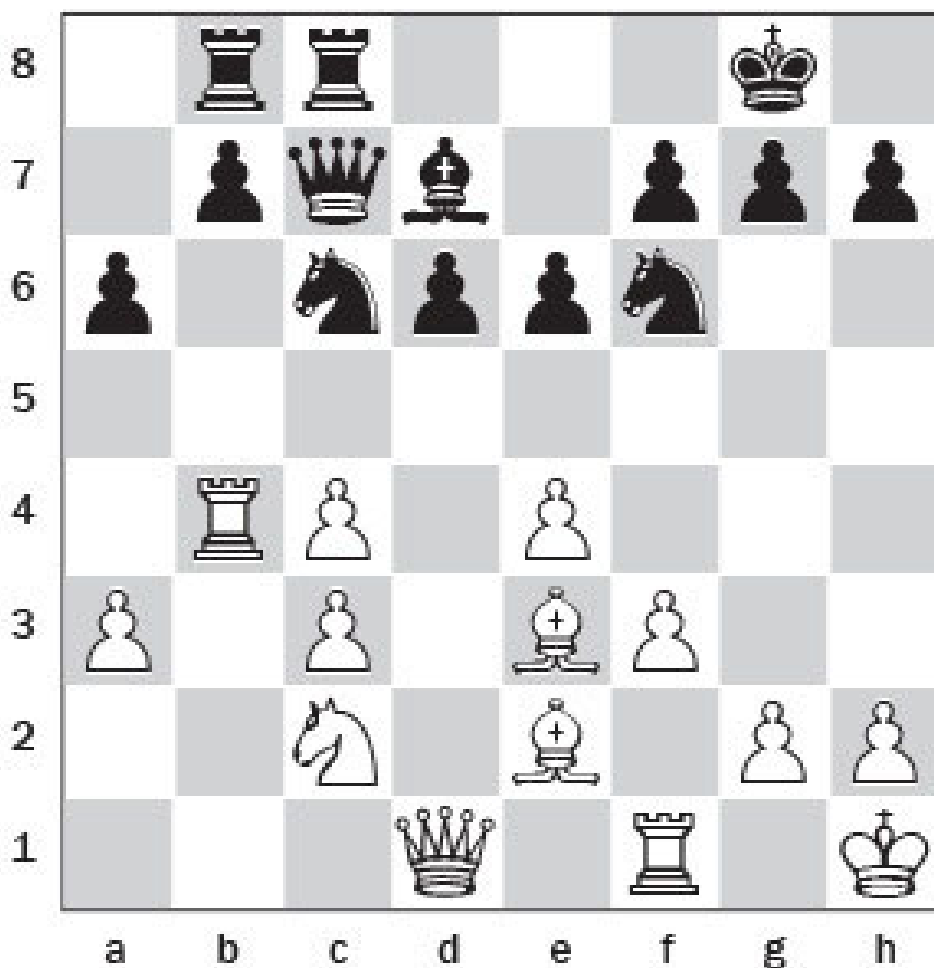


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 401](#)

401



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 402](#)

402



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 403](#)

403



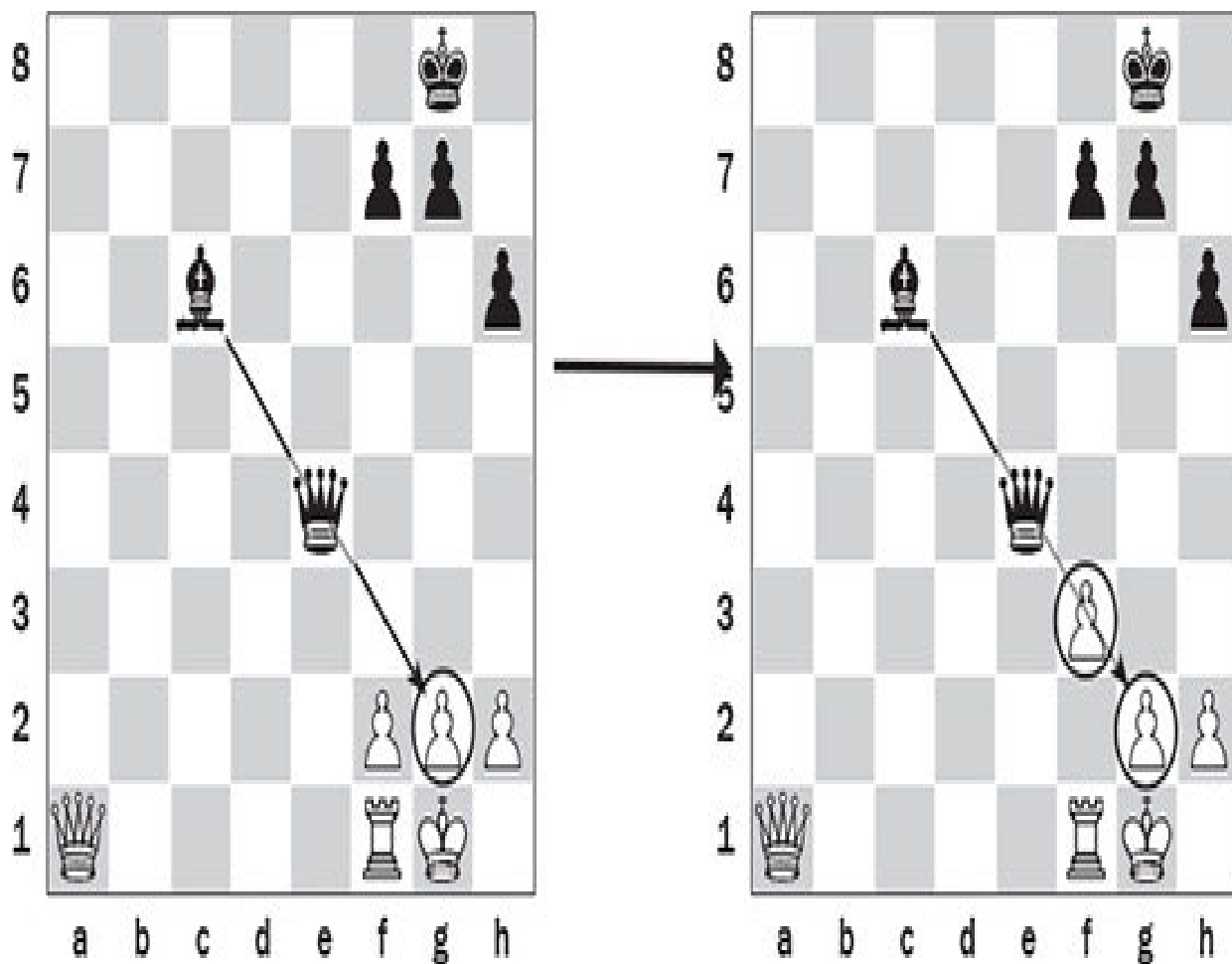
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 17

# Defense/Recognizing Threats

Defense is a very important aspect in chess. When you first begin learning chess, you are generally more focused on what you are doing as opposed to your opponent. Of course, in a two player game, recognizing what your opponent's motives are is very important! In this chapter, we will look at best ways to respond to your opponent's threats. A 'threat' is what your opponent would do if they had the next move.



In the example above, Black's bishop and queen are aligned in a battery formation. Together they act as two attackers against the pawn on g2, which is only protecting the white king. Black is threatening a battery checkmate in one. What is the most logical way for White to prevent checkmate, without having to sacrifice material?

The best move for White is 1.f3 (see diagram 2).

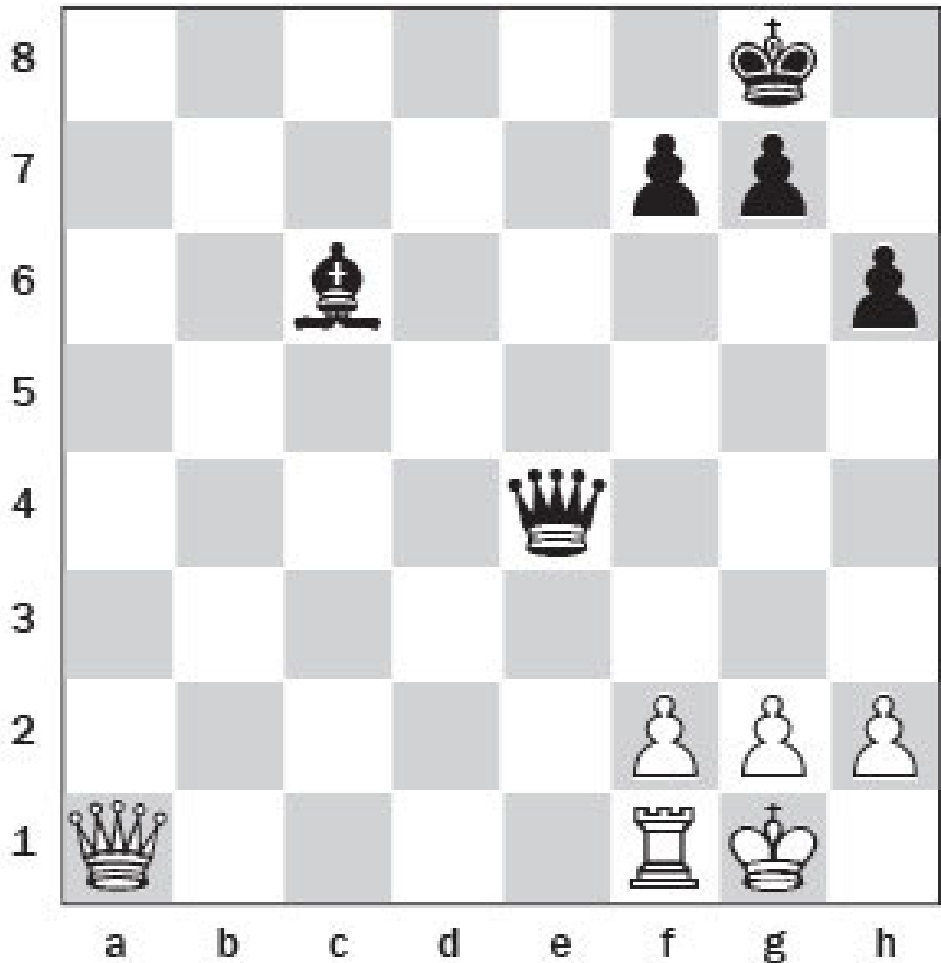
This is not only a good move, but the only move in the position which defends against the threat. Identifying threats your opponent has is an extremely important aspect of chess.

To better solve the problems in this chapter, you must first identify the threat, that is, what your opponent would do if they had the next move.



# Defense/Recognizing Threats – Guided Practice

Ex.



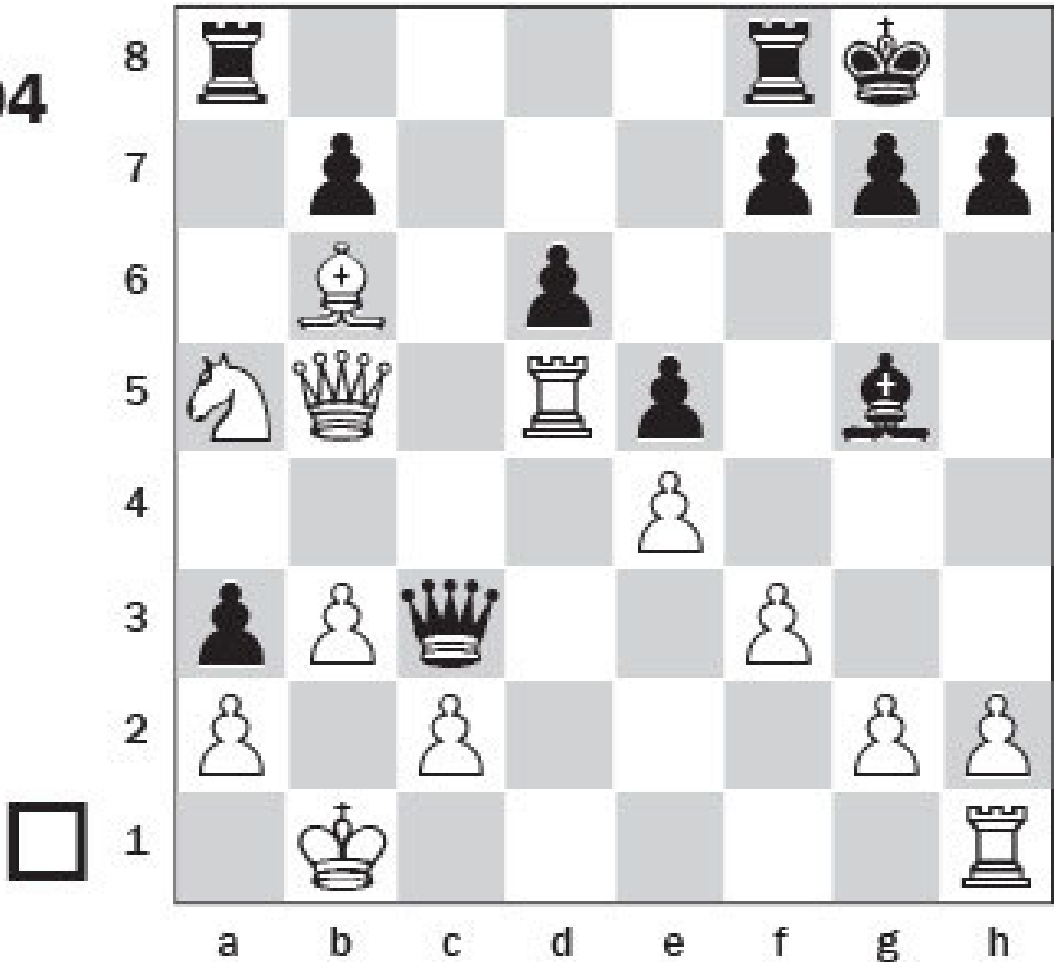
Answer:

1. f3 \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 404

404



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

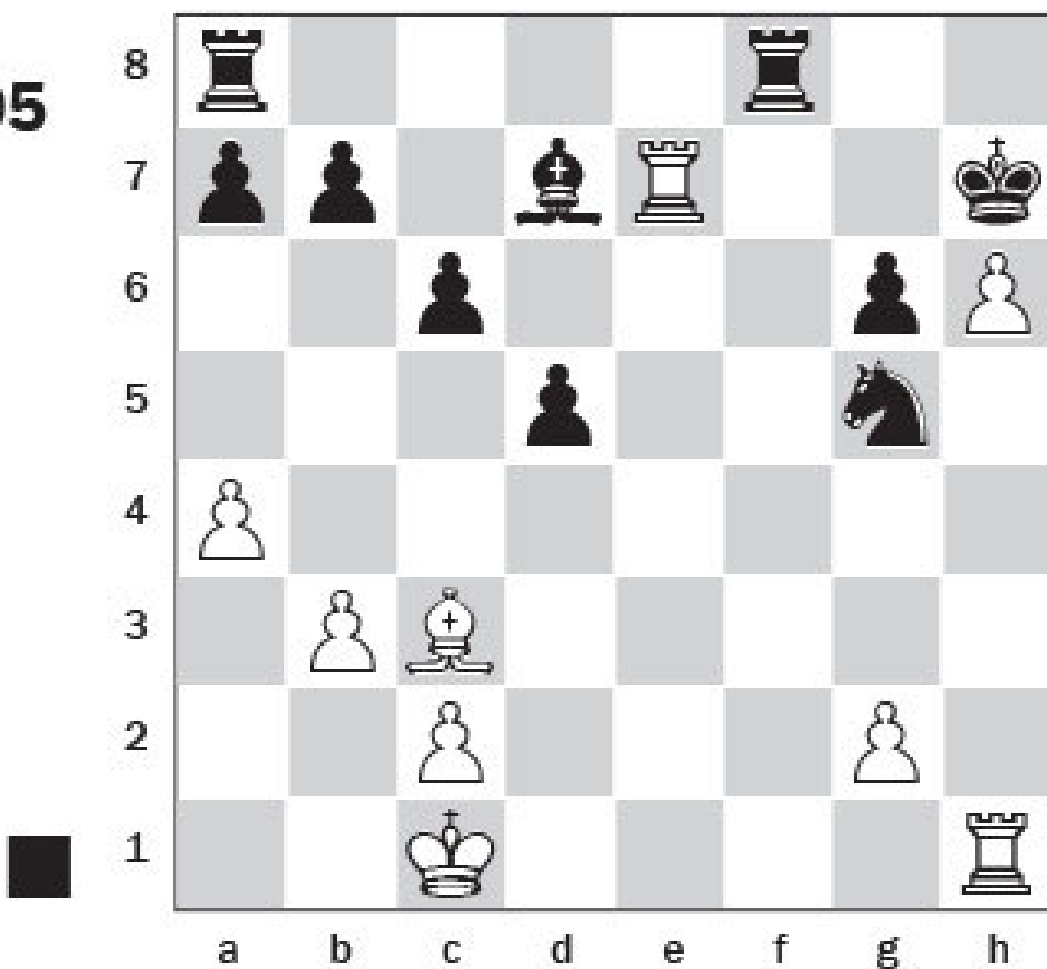
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black is threatening a helper checkmate on b2. How can White stop that without losing material?

### Exercise 405

405



Answer:

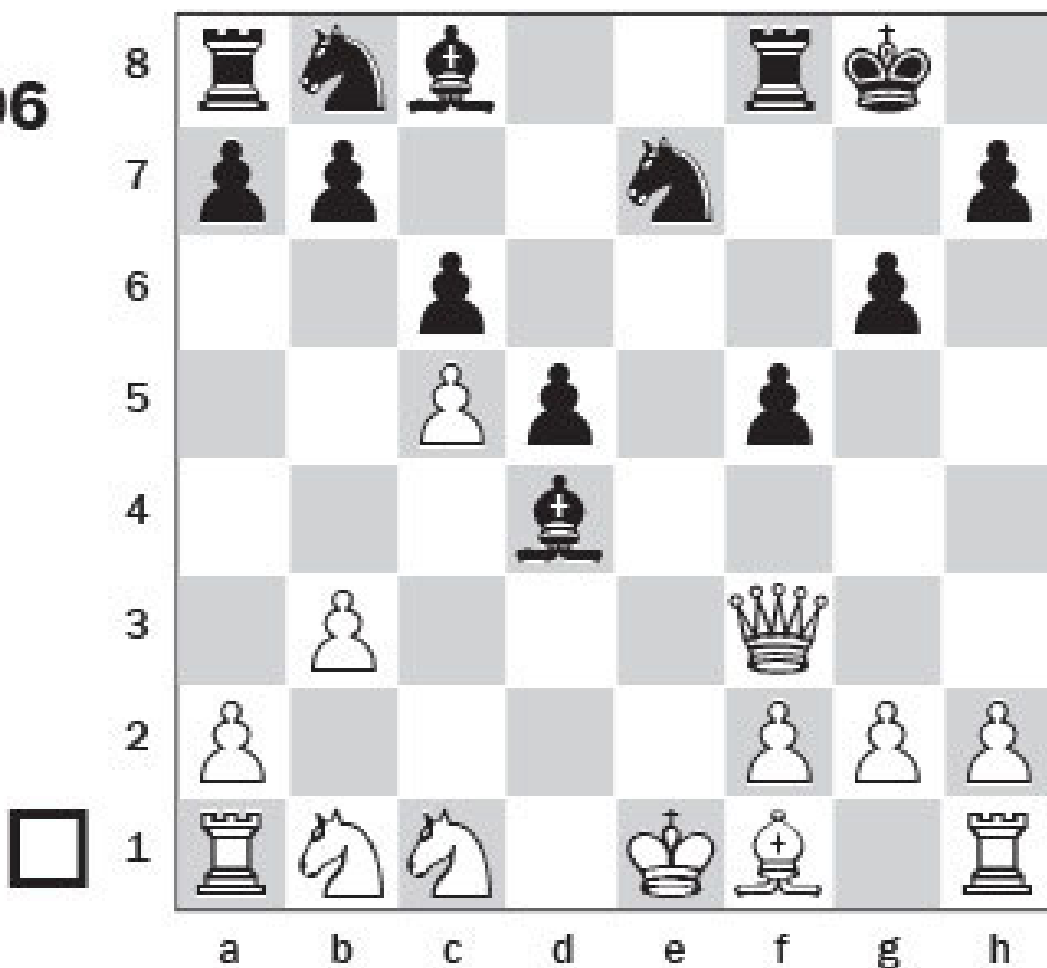
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is forking the king and the bishop. How can Black defend both?

### Exercise 406

406



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

The rook on a1 is being attacked by the bishop on d4. How can White save material?

### **Exercise 407**

407



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is pinning the queen to the king. How can Black 'break the pin' without losing material?

## Exercise 408

408



Answer:

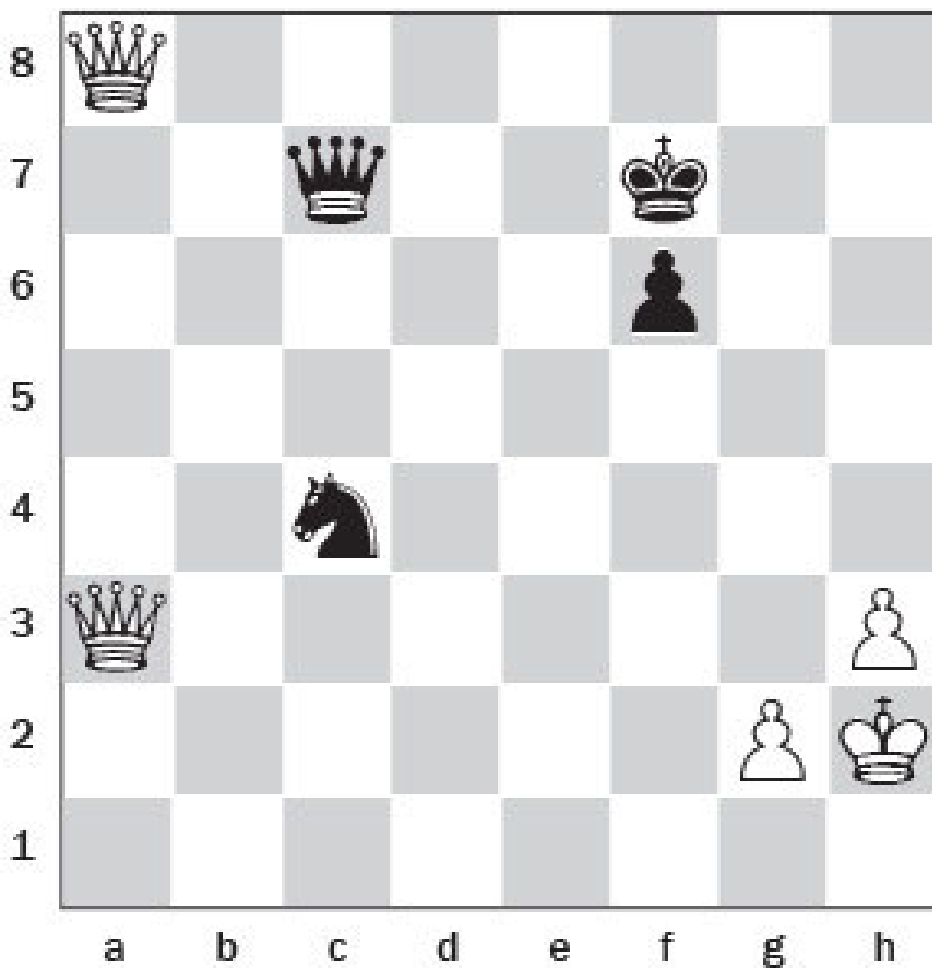
1. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Black's queen is forking the king and the bishop on c5. How can White defend?

## Exercise 409

409



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

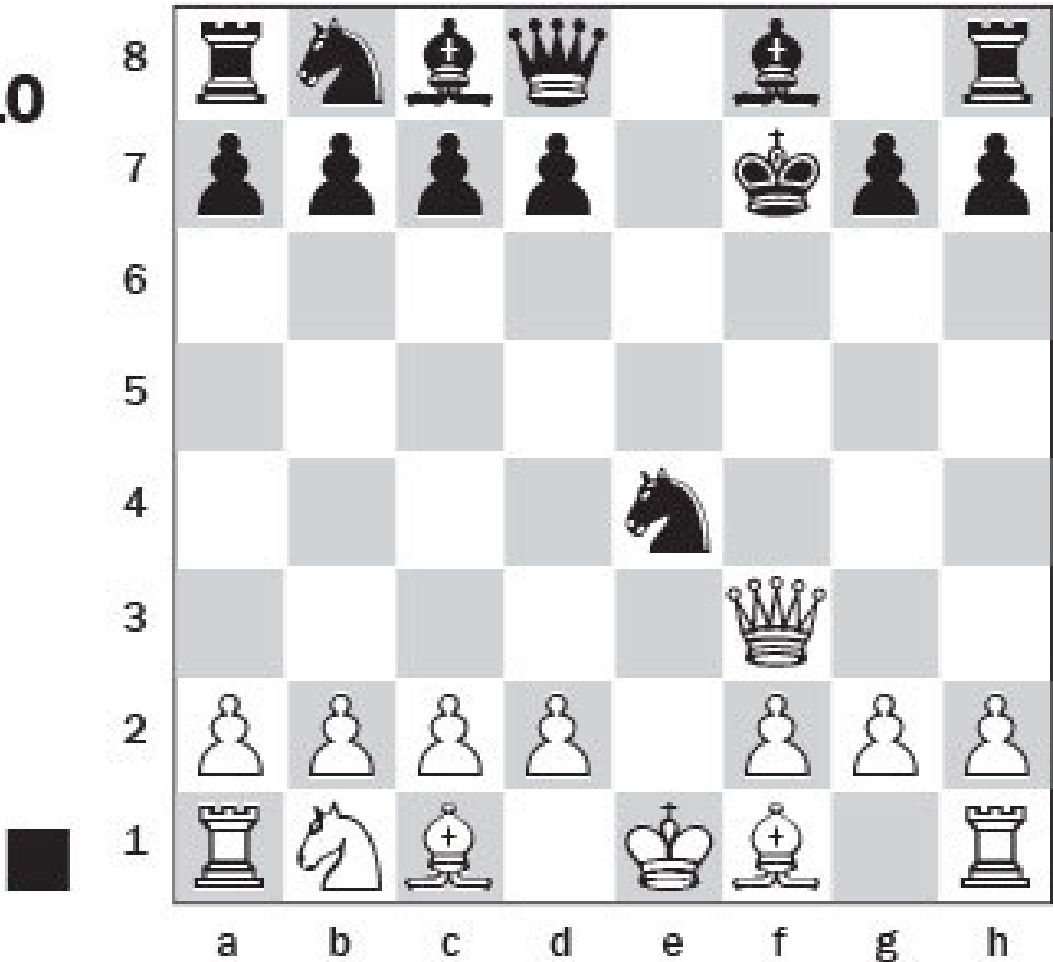
HINT



White is in check by the queen on c7. In addition, White's queen on a3 is being threatened by the knight. How can White defend both?

### Exercise 410

410



Answer:

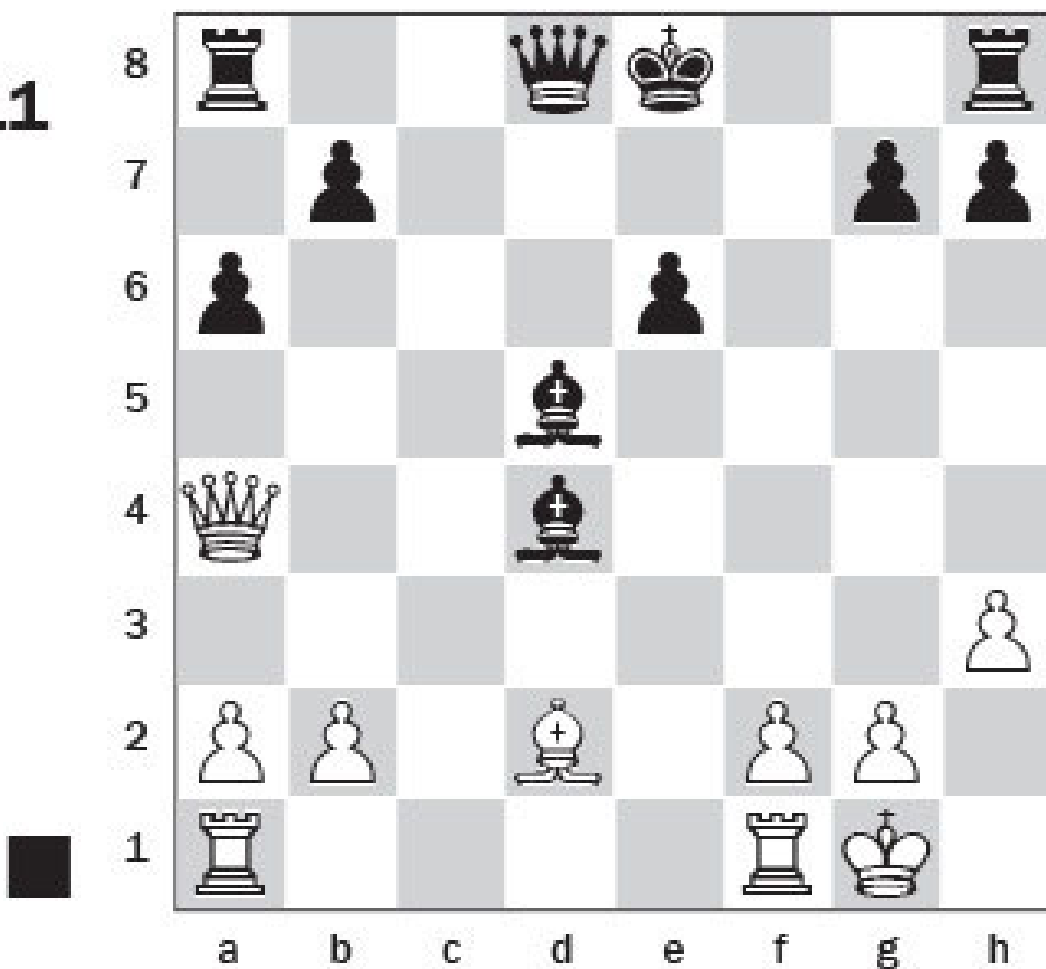
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is forking the knight and the king. What's Black's best defense?

### Exercise 411

411



Answer:

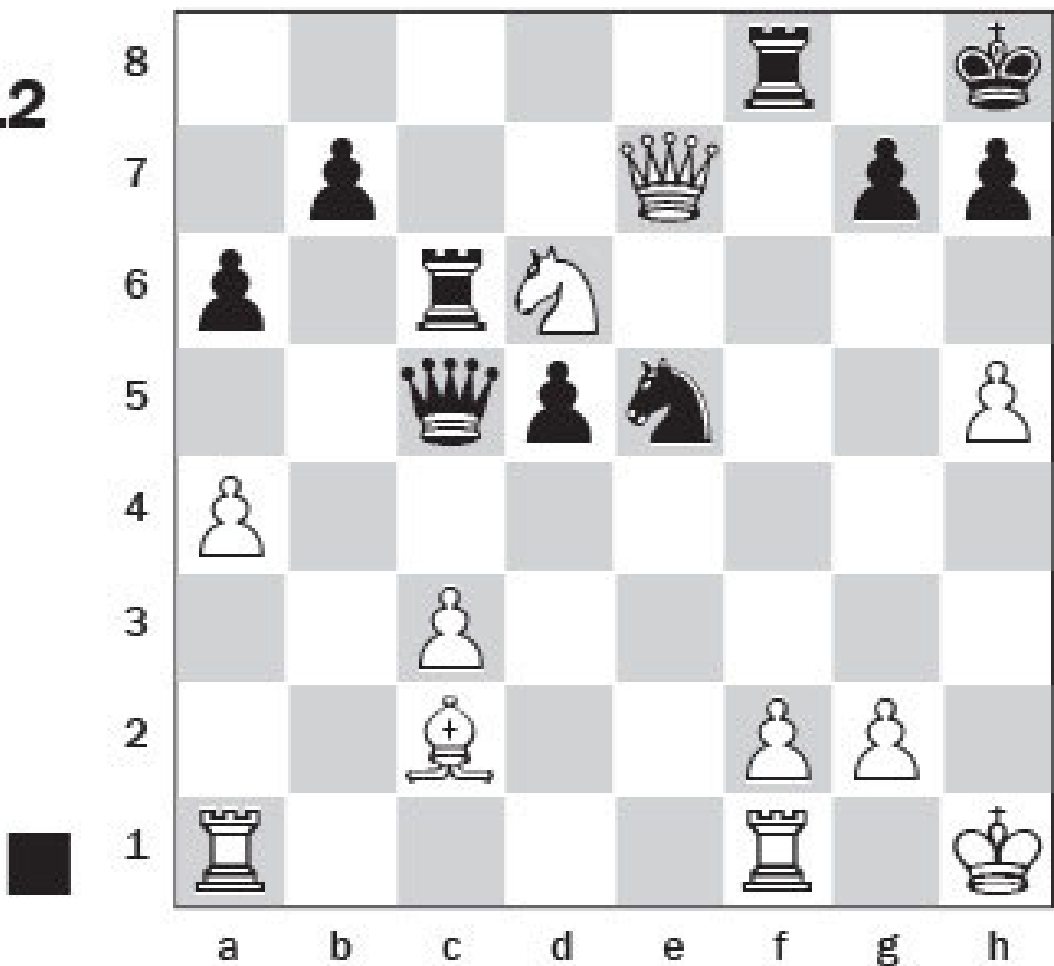
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is forking the king and the bishop on d4. Black can defend by blocking the check, and using a discovery to defend.

### Exercise 412

412



Answer:

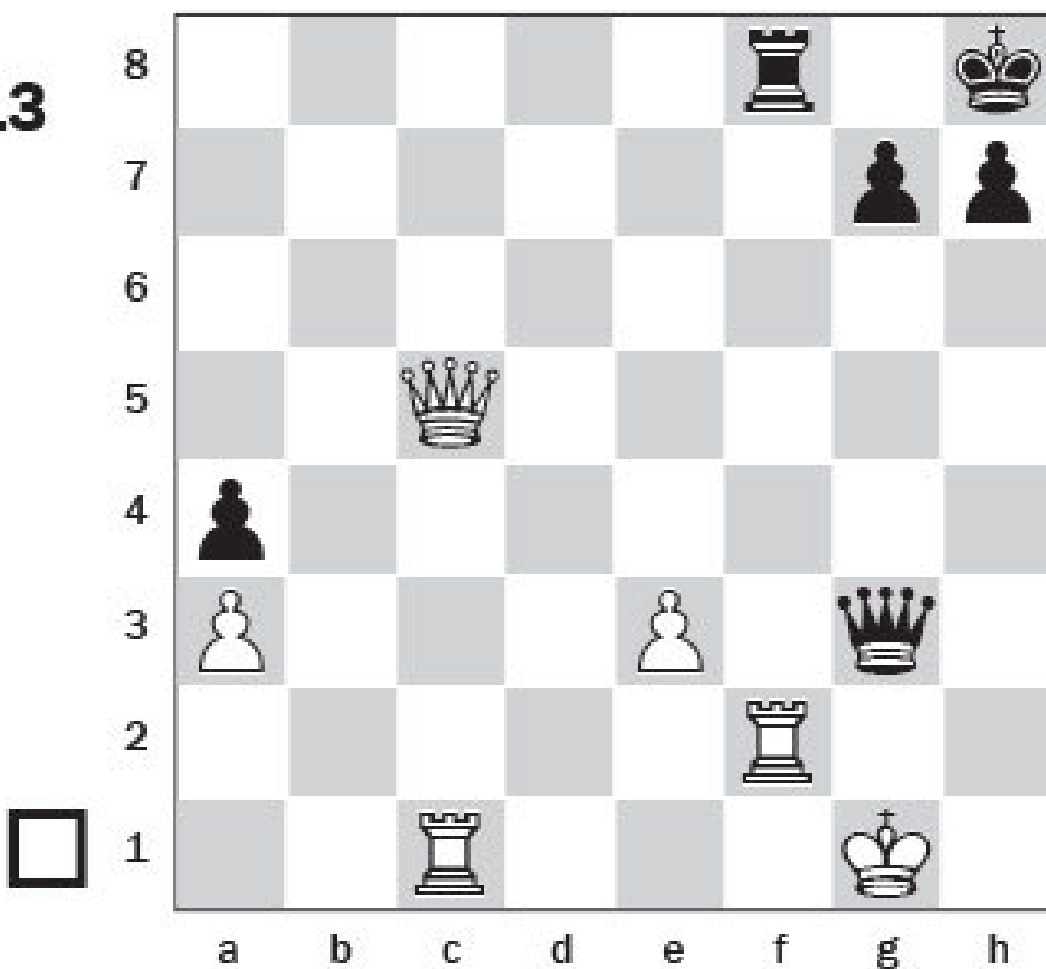
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is forking both the knight on e5 and the rook on f8. How can Black defend them both without losing material?

### Exercise 413

**413**



Answer:

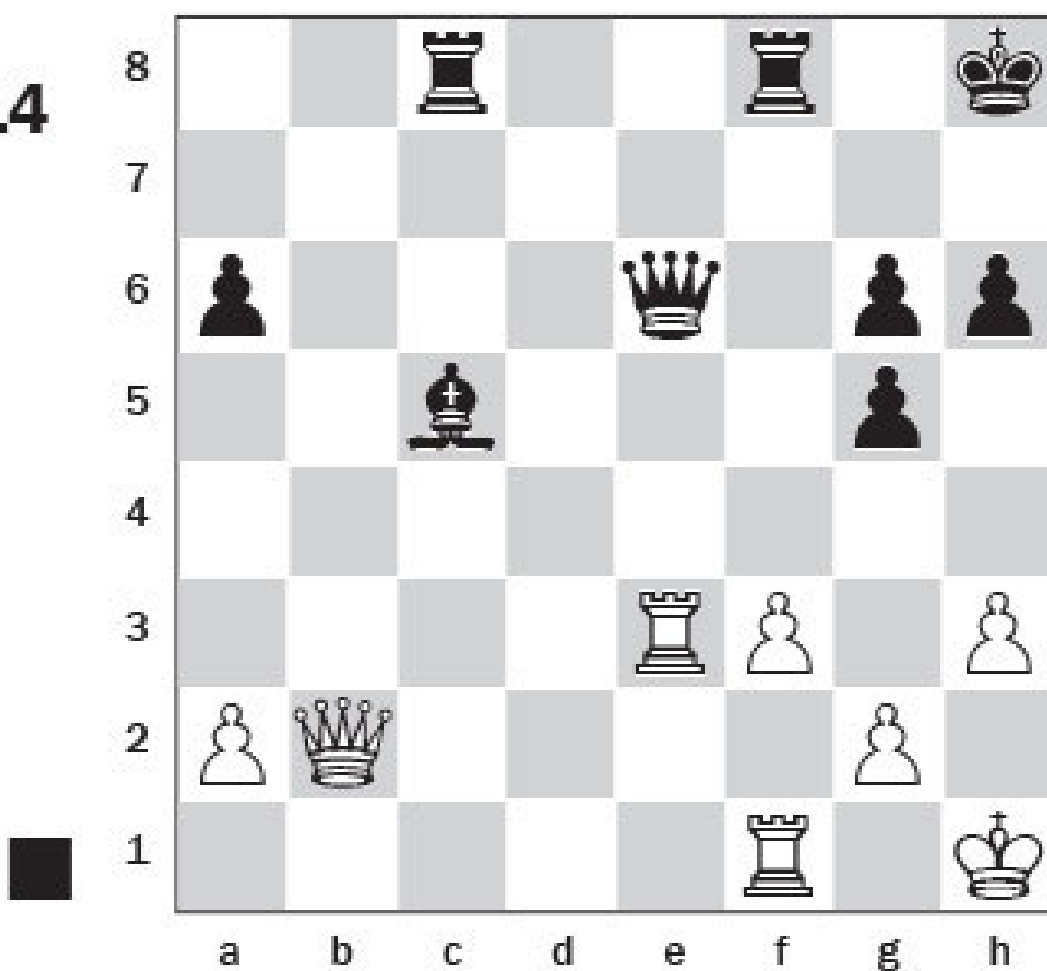
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White is in check and Black is attacking the rook on f2 twice. How can White defend both?

### Exercise 414

**414**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Black is in check by the queen on b2. White is also attacking the queen on e6. How can Black defend?

# Defense/Recognizing Threats – Test

## Exercise 415

415

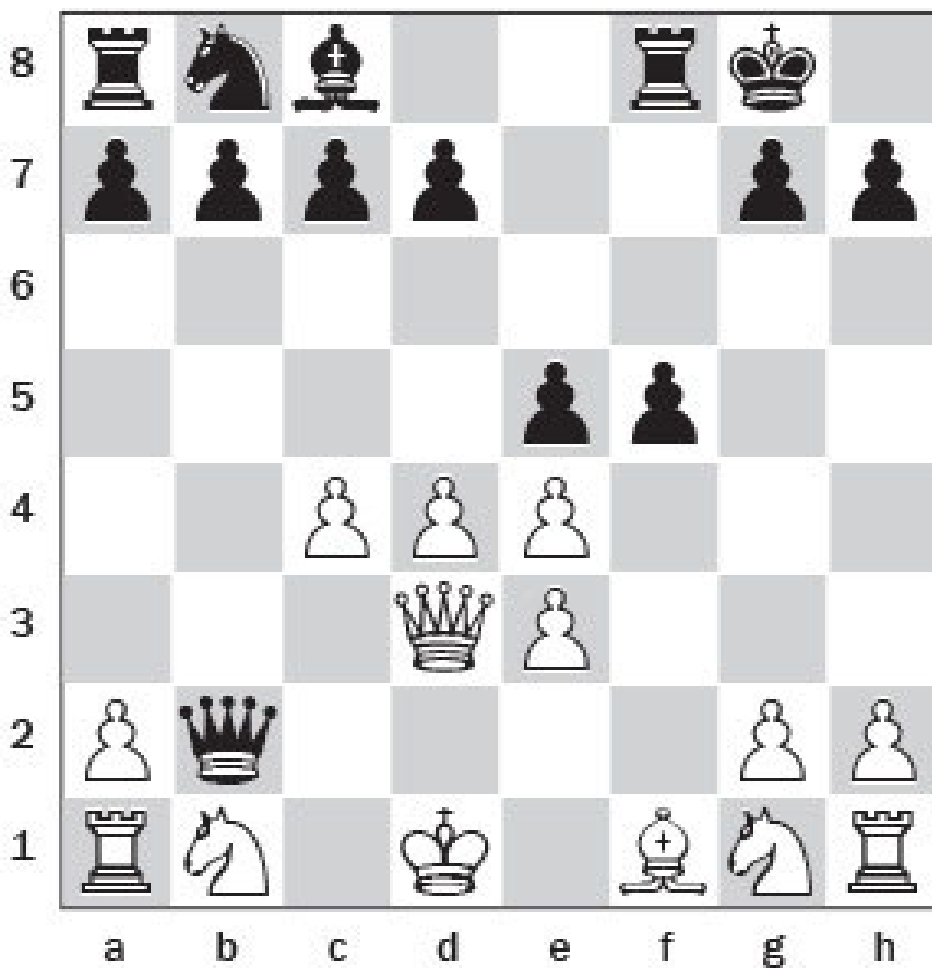


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 416

416



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 417



417



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 418](#)

418



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 419](#)

419

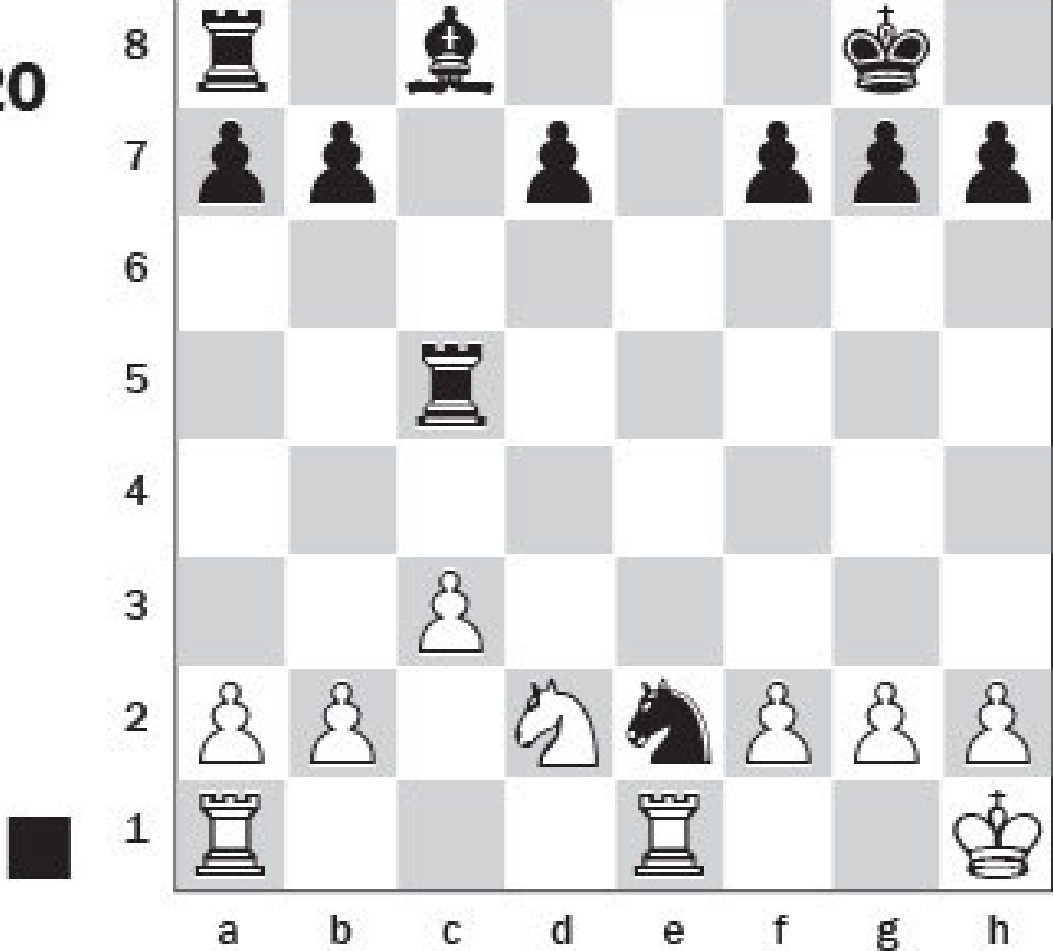


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 420](#)

420



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 421](#)

421



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 422](#)

422

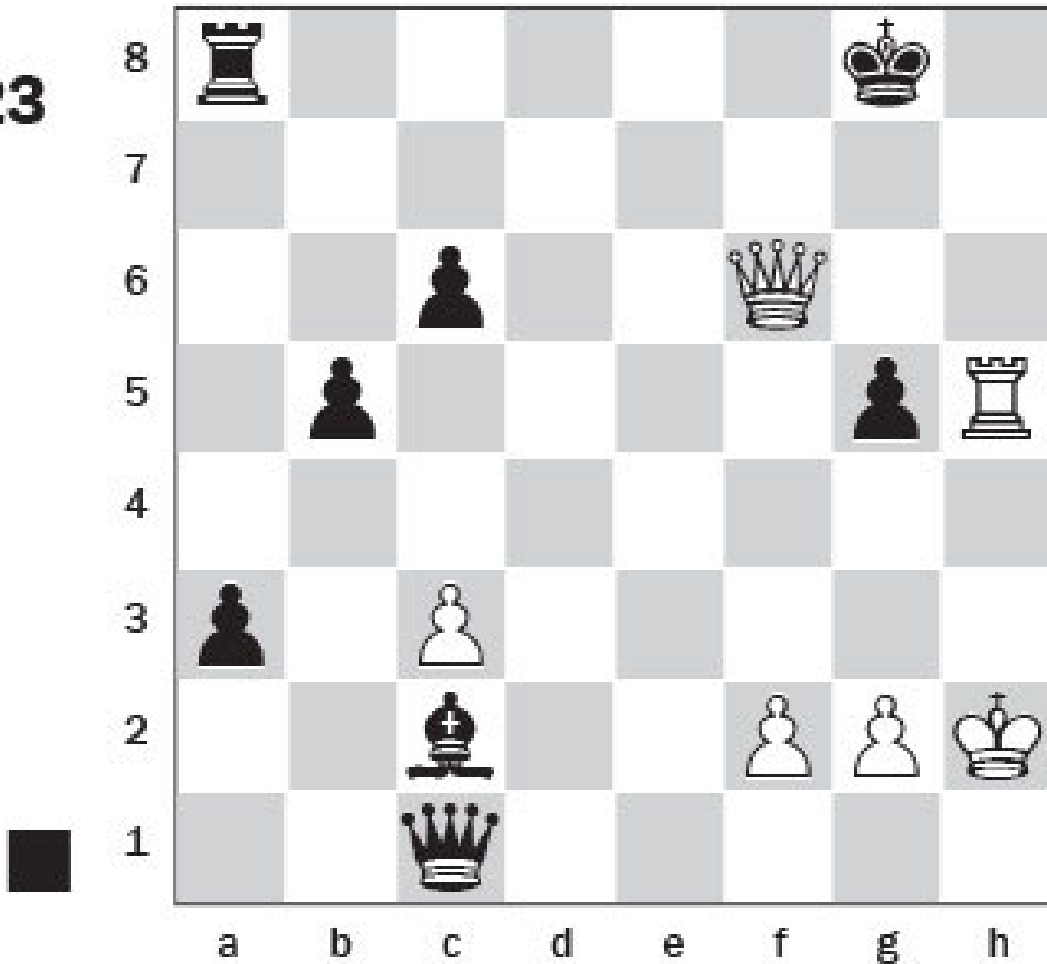


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 423](#)

423



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 424](#)

424



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

Exercise 425



425

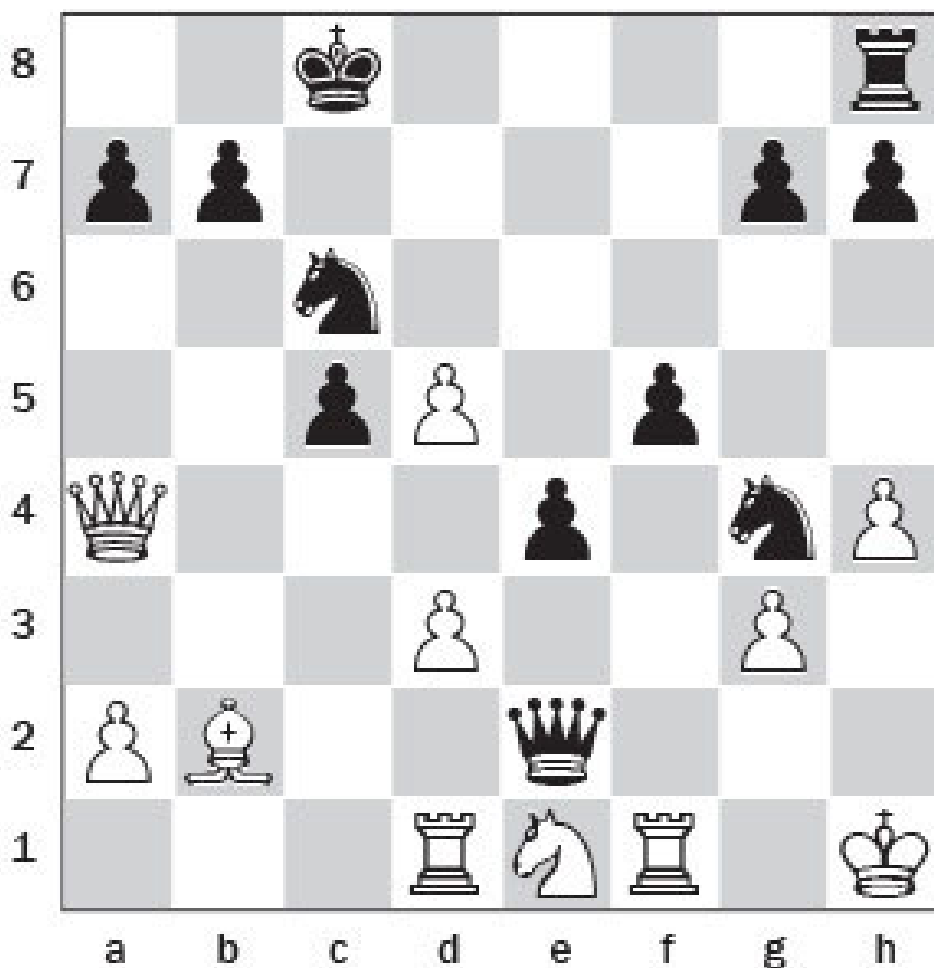


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 426](#)

426

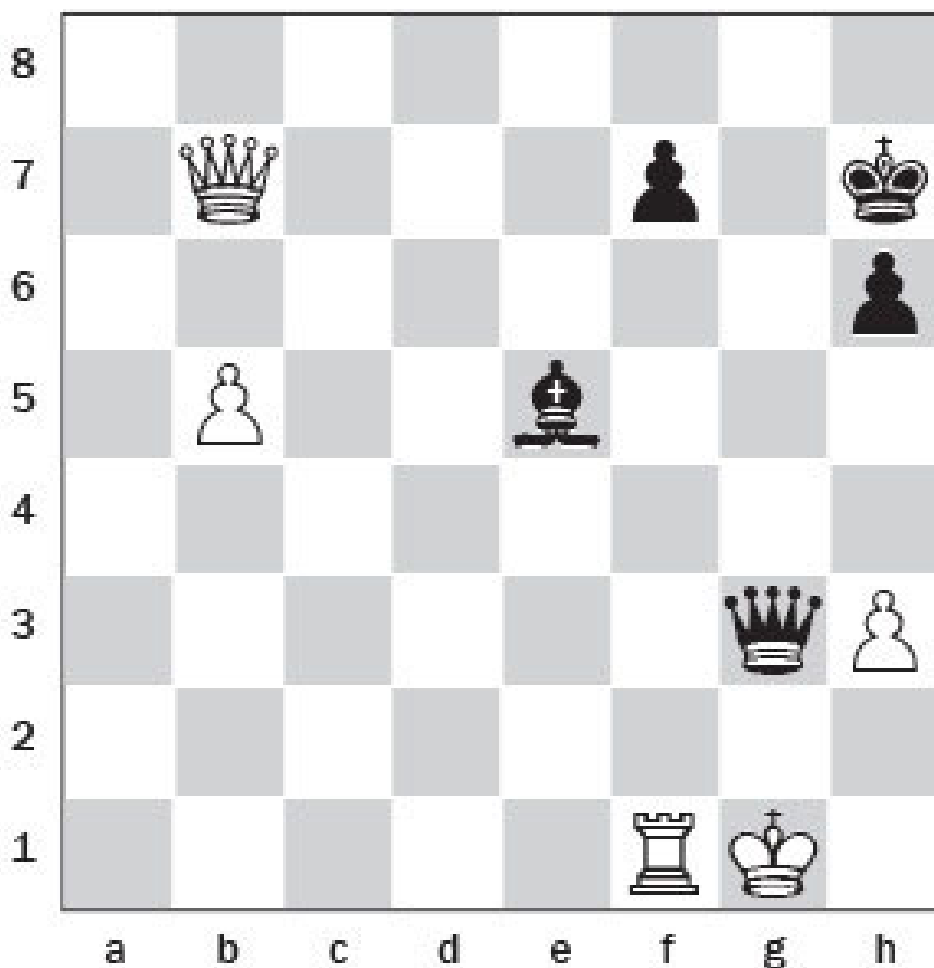


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 427](#)

427



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 428](#)

428

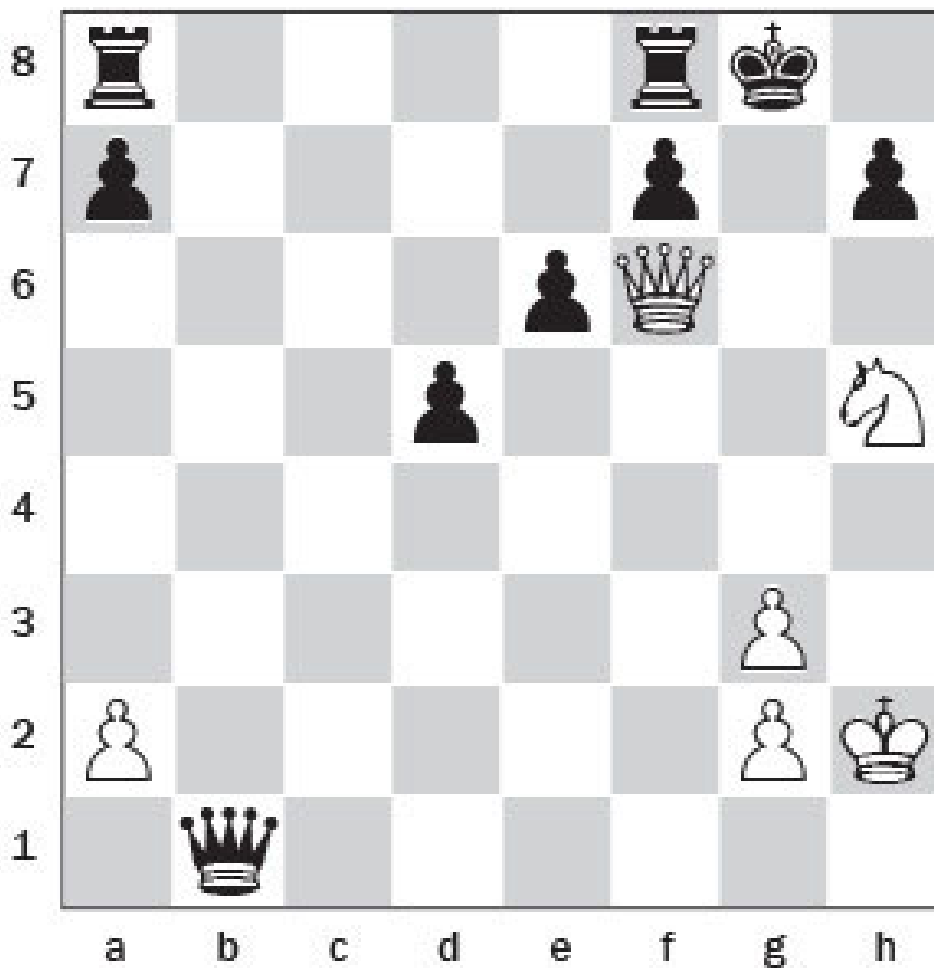


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 429](#)

429

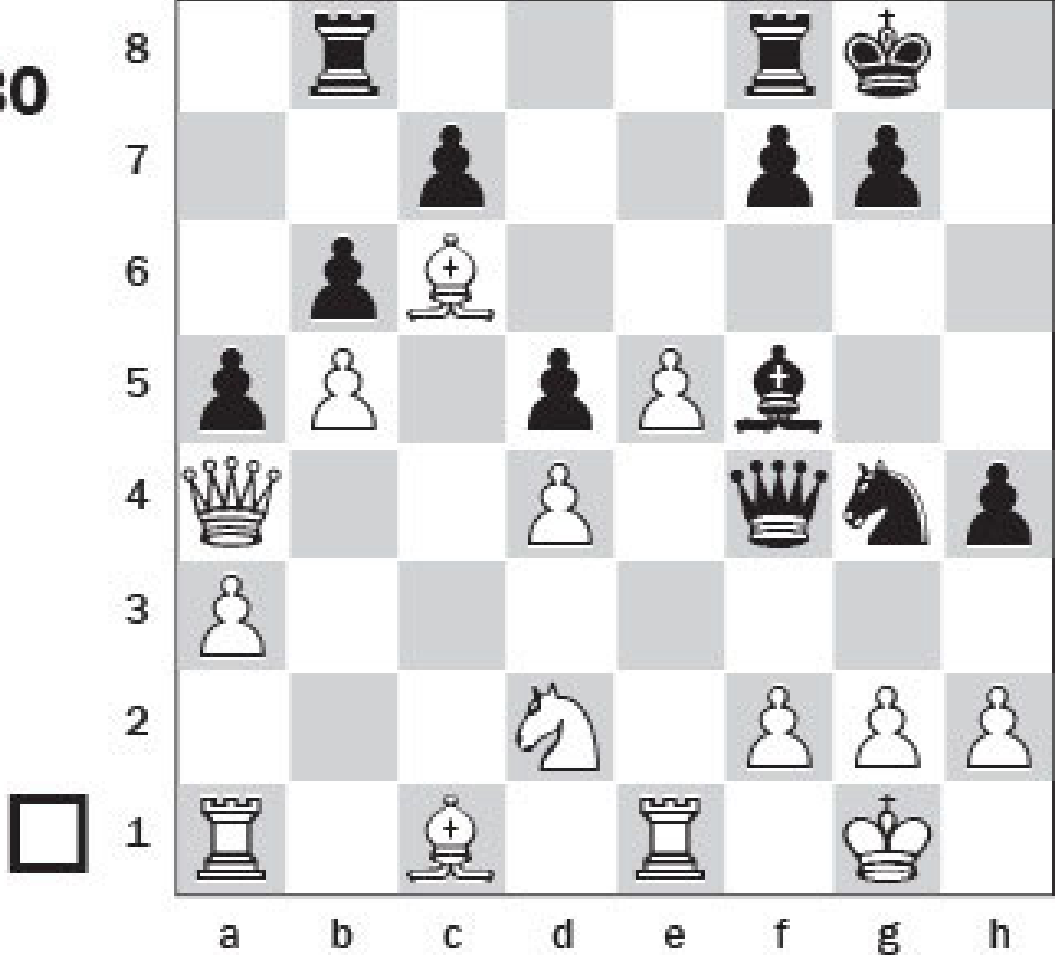


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 430](#)

430

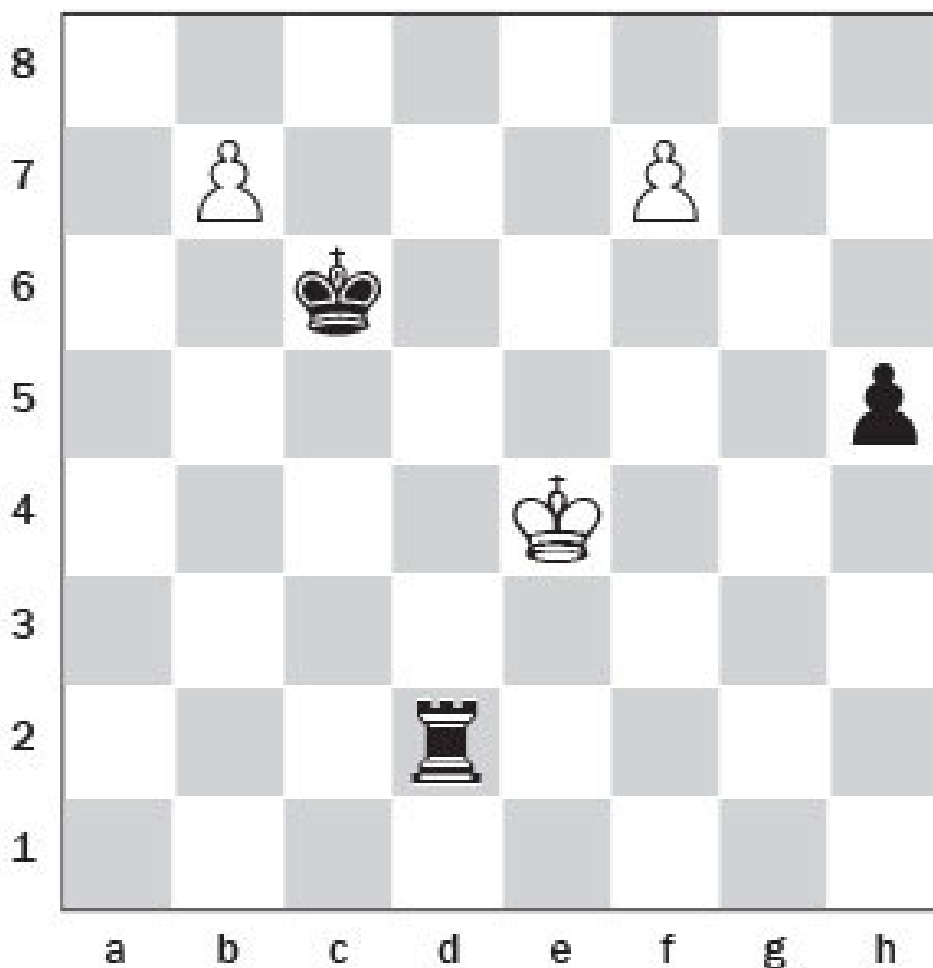


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

Exercise 431

431

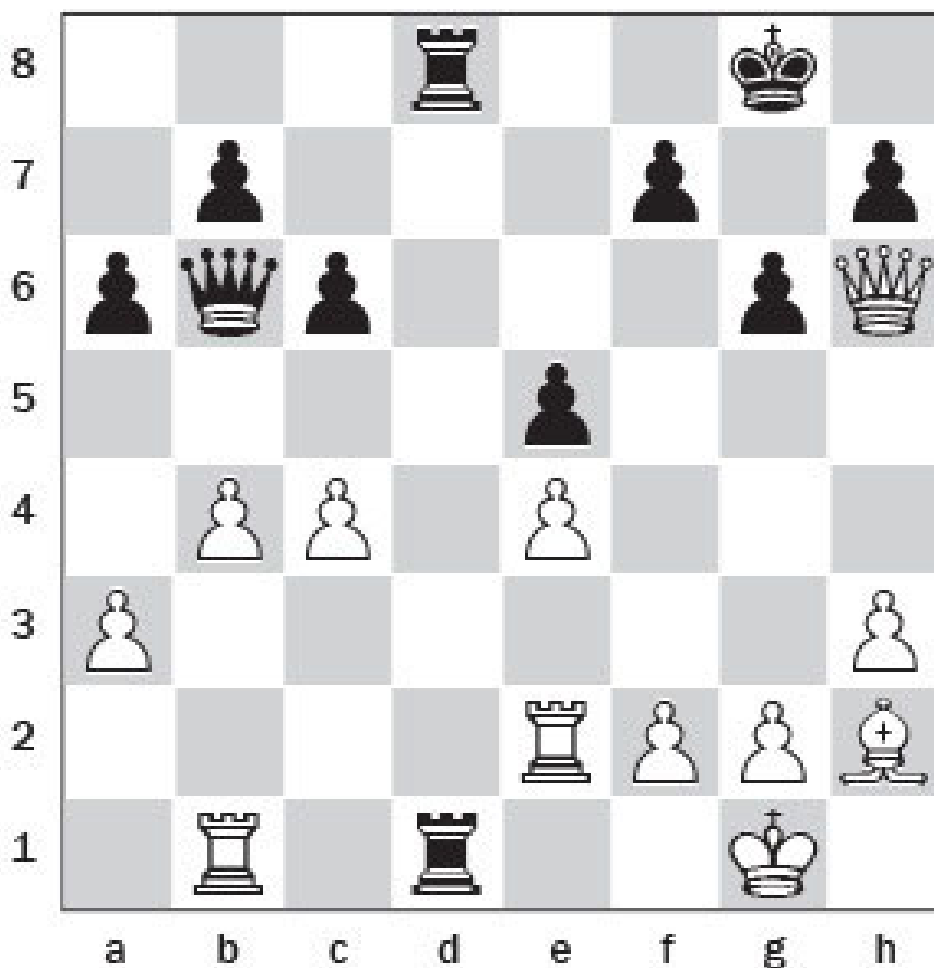


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 432](#)

432



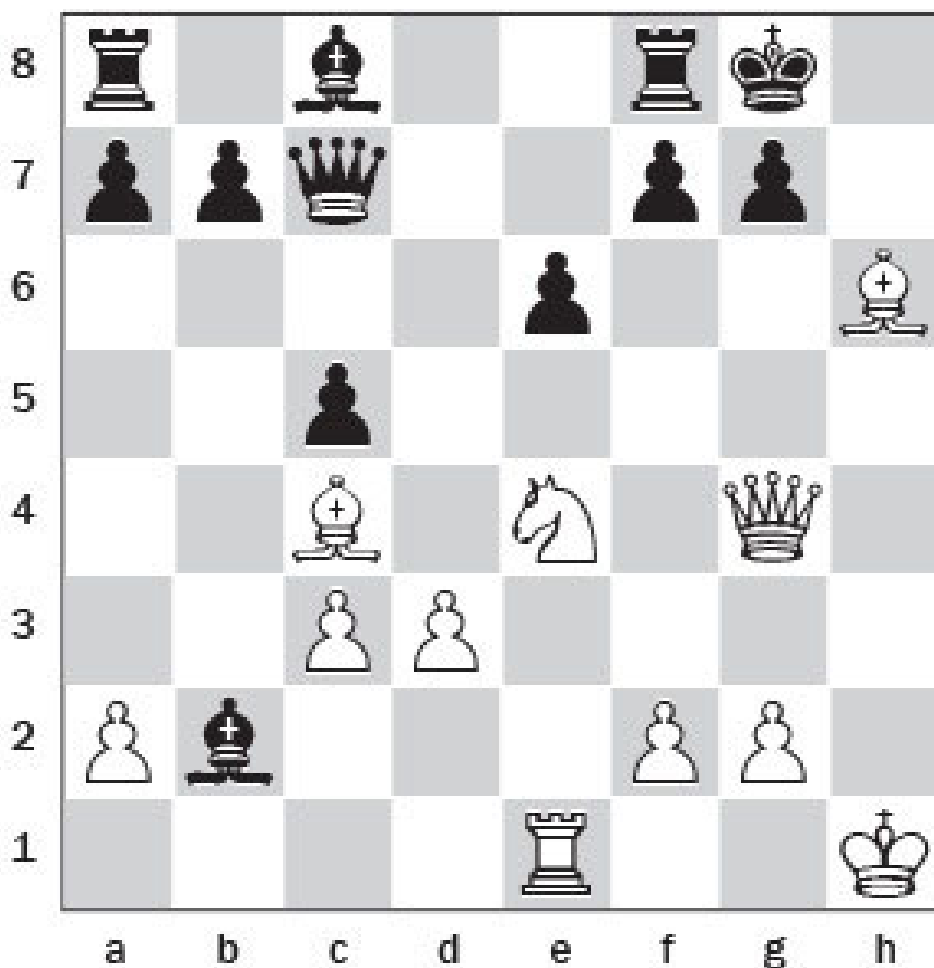
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 433](#)



433



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 434](#)

434

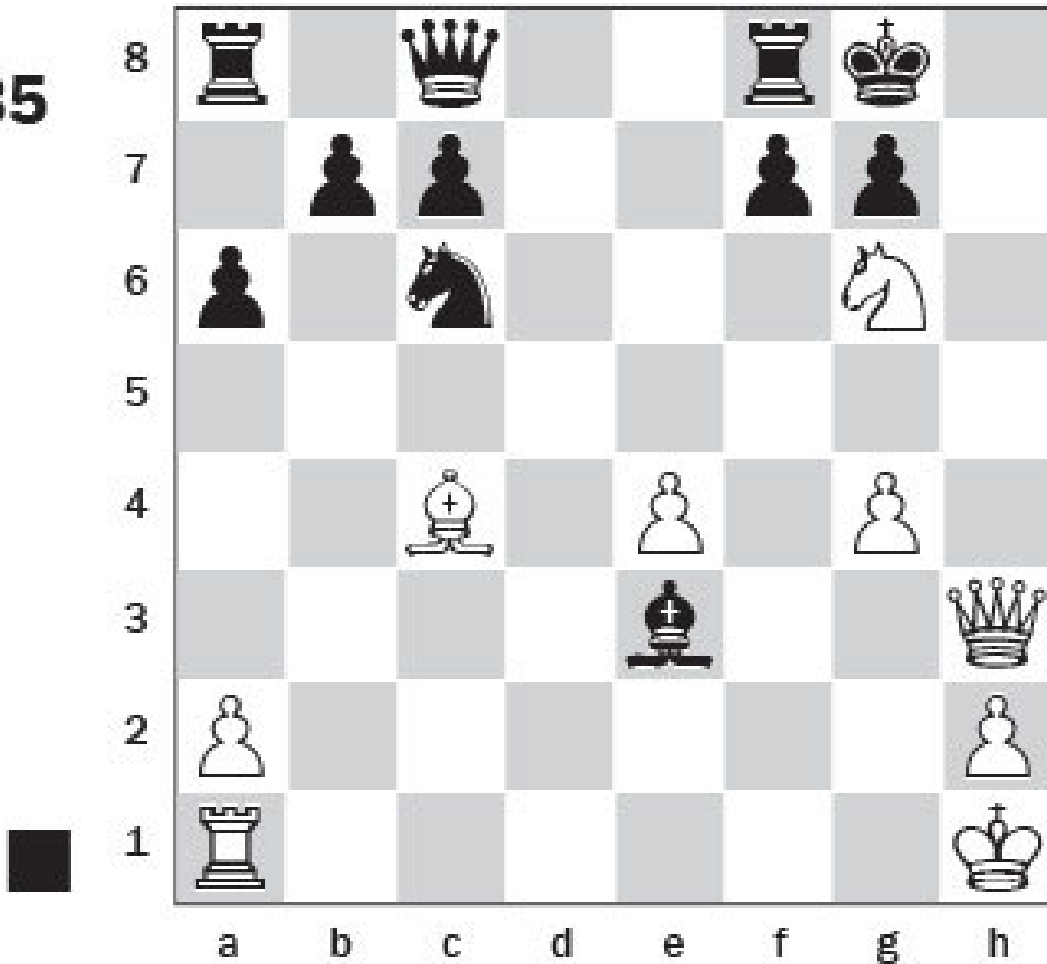


Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

[Exercise 435](#)

435



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## PART III

# Intermediate Checkmates and Combinations

By this point, you should be comfortable looking for forcing moves (checks, captures, and threats), unprotected pieces, and the different tactical patterns available in a position. This section of the workbook brings together all of the things you've learned earlier in the book and pushes you to the next threshold, 2-3 move sequences.

Since this section deals with tactics and checkmates displayed in more than one move, you must not stop looking for checks, captures, and threats after your first move. To assist your thought process for these puzzles, here are some techniques to use when solving:

- I check, they escape from check, then.....
- I take, they take back, then.....
- I threaten them, they stop the threat, then.....

In other words, you must force yourself to look beyond the first move since, in this section, the concepts are displayed on the second move. This way of thinking is something you will continue to build upon for the rest of your chess improvement journey.

The ability to combine different patterns, tactical themes, and concepts into winning sequences of moves is the final step for a player moving from beginner to intermediate tournament player. This section is certainly the most challenging in the workbook but also the most rewarding. If you grow to feel comfortable with forced sequences that occur in more than one move, then you will become a much stronger player.

This section is broken down into the following chapters:

- Checkmates in two;
- Themed checkmate patterns;
- Combinations;
- Finish like the World Champions.

The format of this section is like the others, except that in the 'Combinations' chapter, I give you a guided hint for all problems.

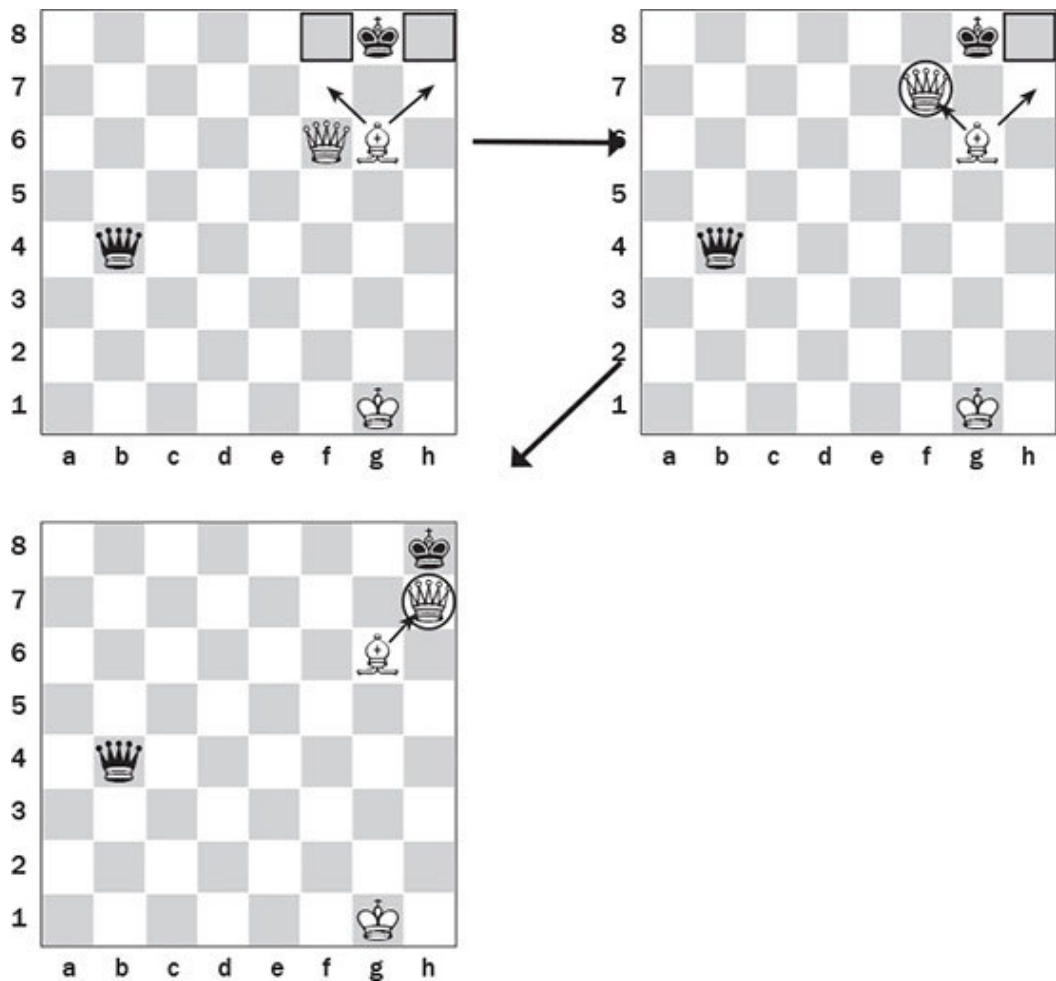
Don't worry; you'll get a chance to prove yourself in the 'Finish like the World Champions' chapter, which is essentially a test to see if you can find forced sequences on your own.

## CHAPTER 18

# Assorted Checkmates in Two

In this chapter you will learn to give checkmate in two moves. That is, you make a move, your opponent makes a move, and then on your second turn you finish the game with checkmate. Every puzzle in this chapter features two consecutive checks which end the game in checkmate. You will not have to find checkmates which use 'quiet moves' or non-checks.

The following is a helper checkmate that takes two moves to execute. Notice that the bishop guards two very important squares around the black king.



The best move for White is 1.Qf7+ (see diagram 2).

Using the bishop to get the queen close to the king.

**1...Kh8 2.Qh7# (see diagram 3)**

And finally using the bishop to deliver helper checkmate.

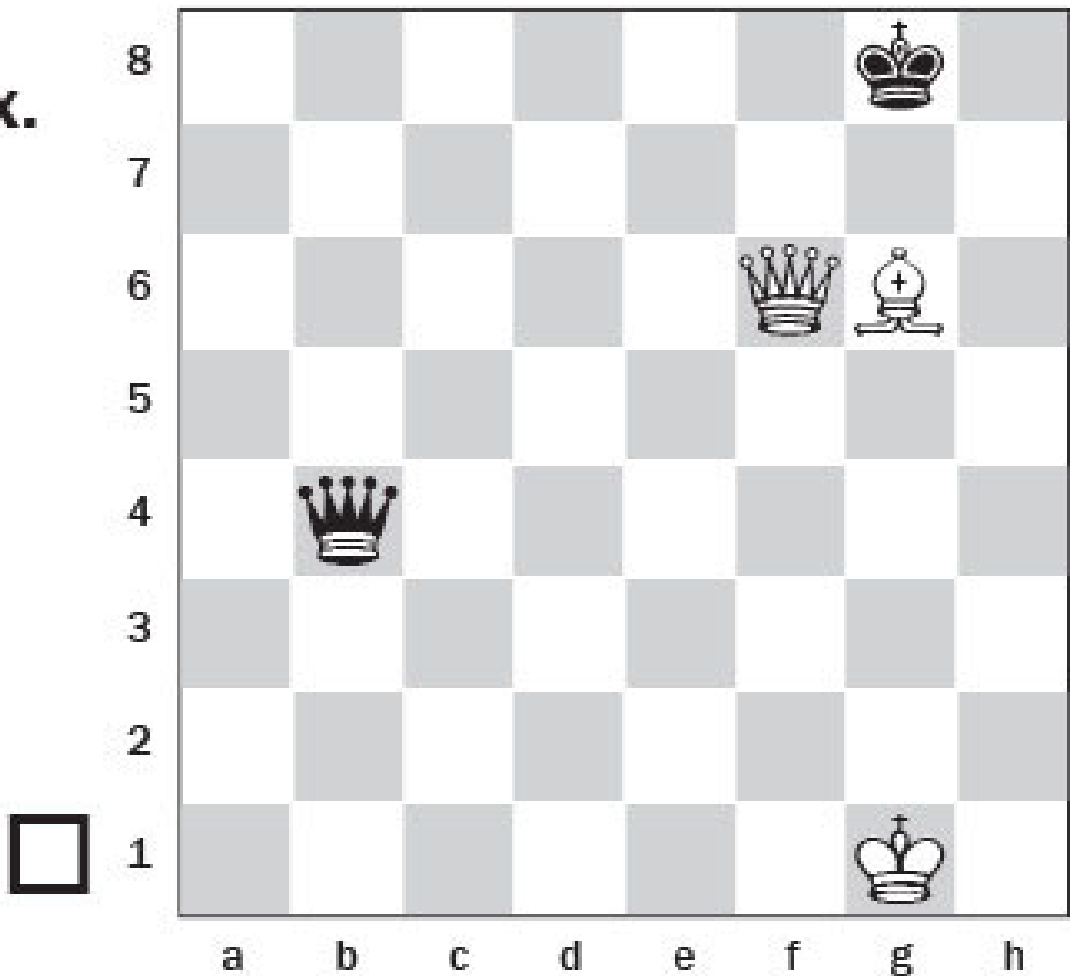


Good luck with the rest of the checkmate in two puzzles! Remember that you must start by looking for all checks in the position. Don't forget to look for some of the tactics you learned earlier in the book – pins, decoys, discovered checks, double checks, as they can be extremely helpful in checkmating your opponent!

Once again, in this chapter, every move of the sequence will be check. Analyze each check until you see how the game will end.

# Assorted Checkmates in Two – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

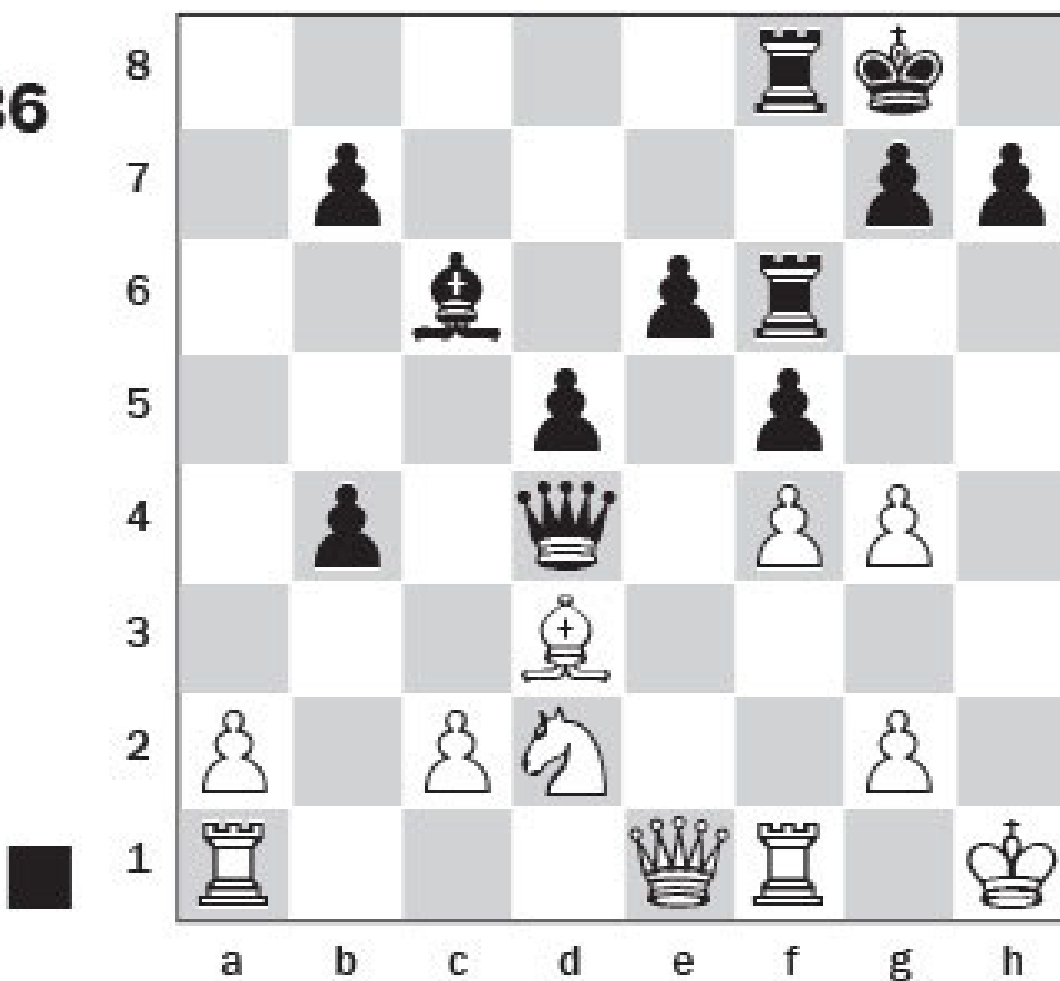
1. Qf7+ Kh8

## 2. Qh7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 436

436



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

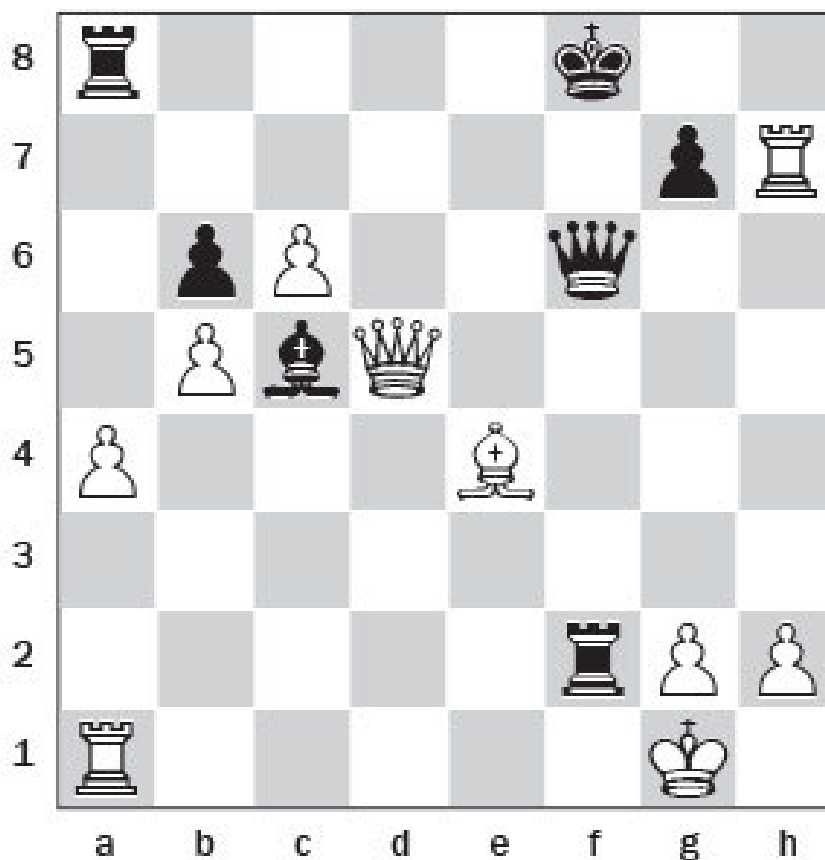
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

The queen is covering the g1-square. In addition, the h-file is completely open. Use it for checkmate!

### **[Exercise 437](#)**

437



214

Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

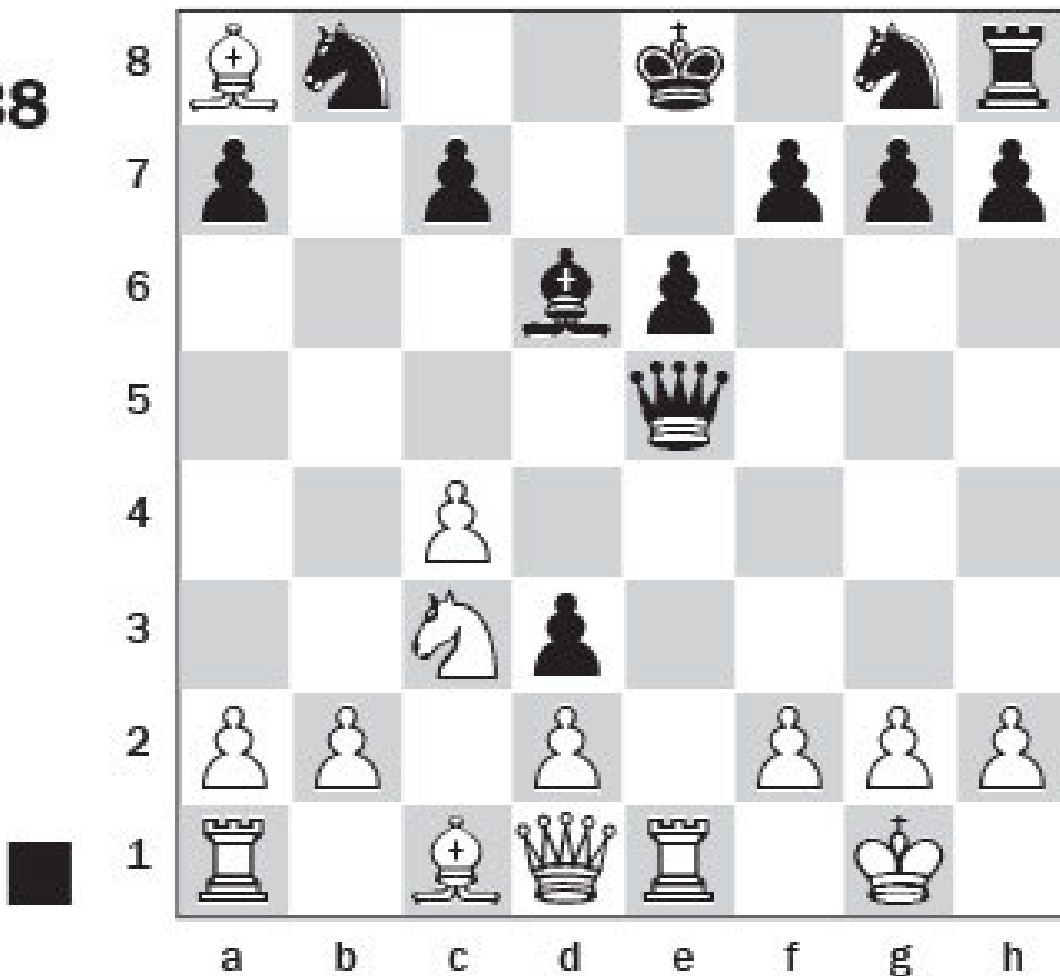
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The pawn on c6 will help you give a helper checkmate on move 2.  
Start with a rook check.

### Exercise 438

438



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

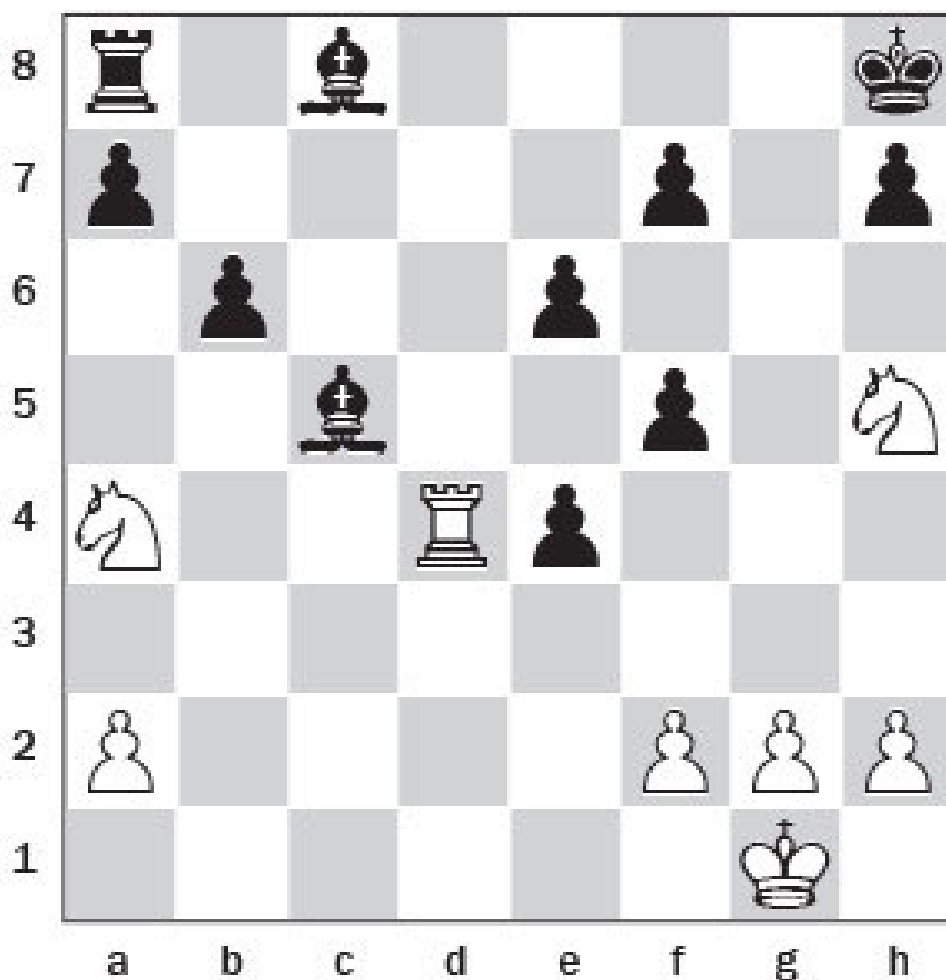
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The queen and bishop battery is very strong. In addition, the pawn on d3 stops the king from running too far!

### Exercise 439

439



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on h5 is stopping the king from leaving the back rank;  
force checkmate!

## Exercise 440



440



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

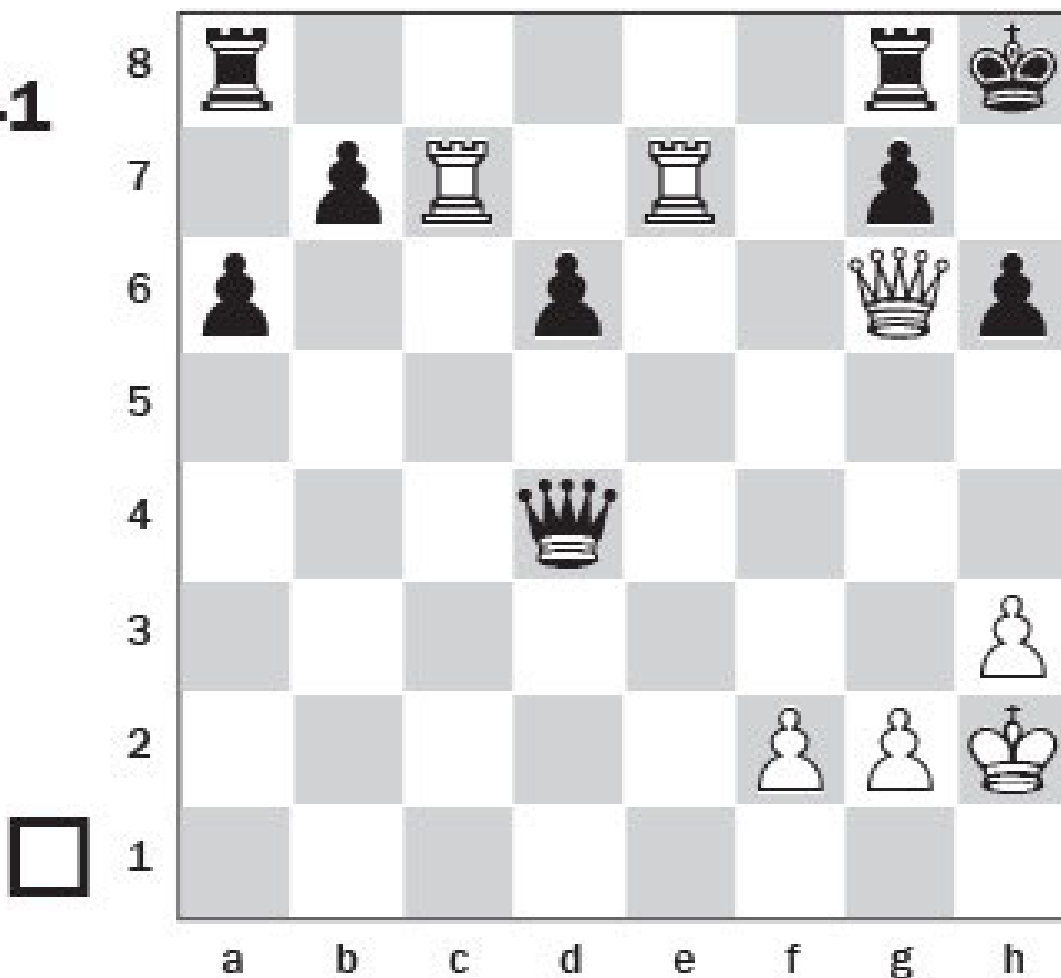
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The bishop on b8 is stopping the king from using the h2-square. The back rank is very weak.

### Exercise 441

441



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

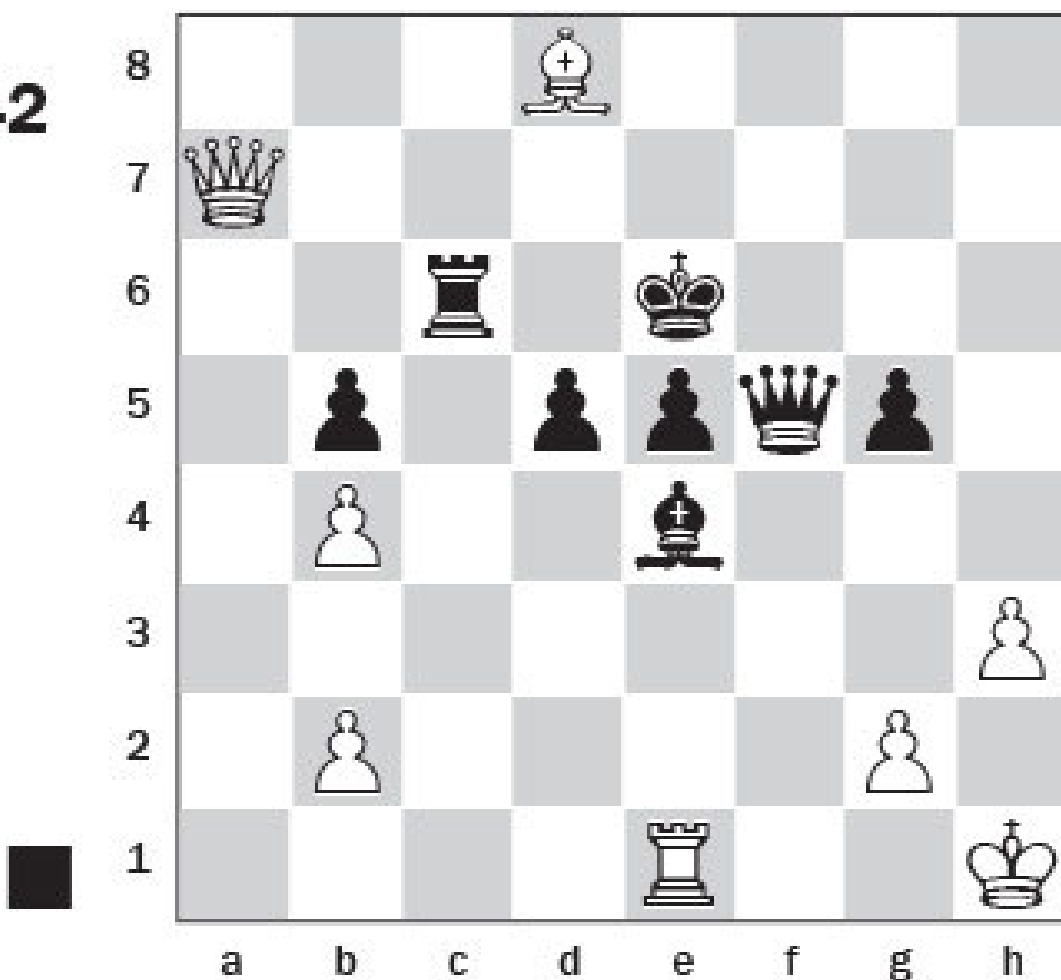
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

If White could play Rh7 it would be checkmate. How can White make that happen?

### Exercise 442

442



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

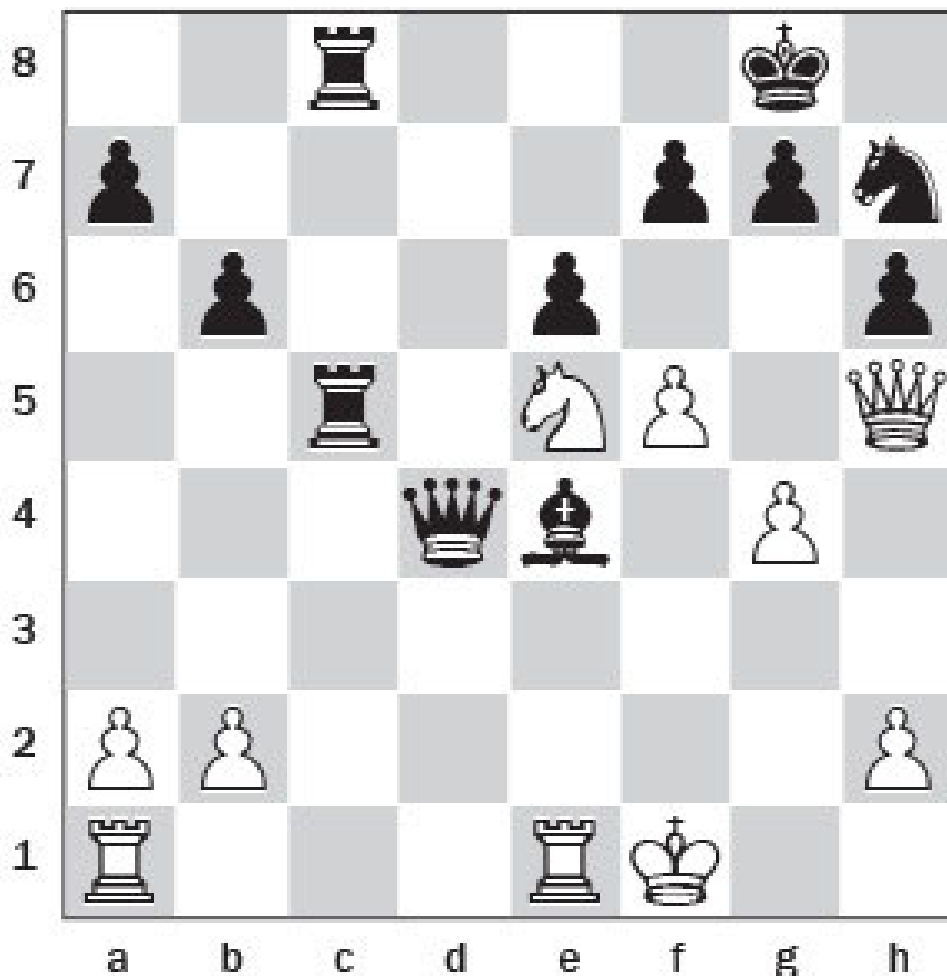
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on e4 is pinning the pawn on g2. Remember, pinned pieces do not protect.

## Exercise 443

443



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

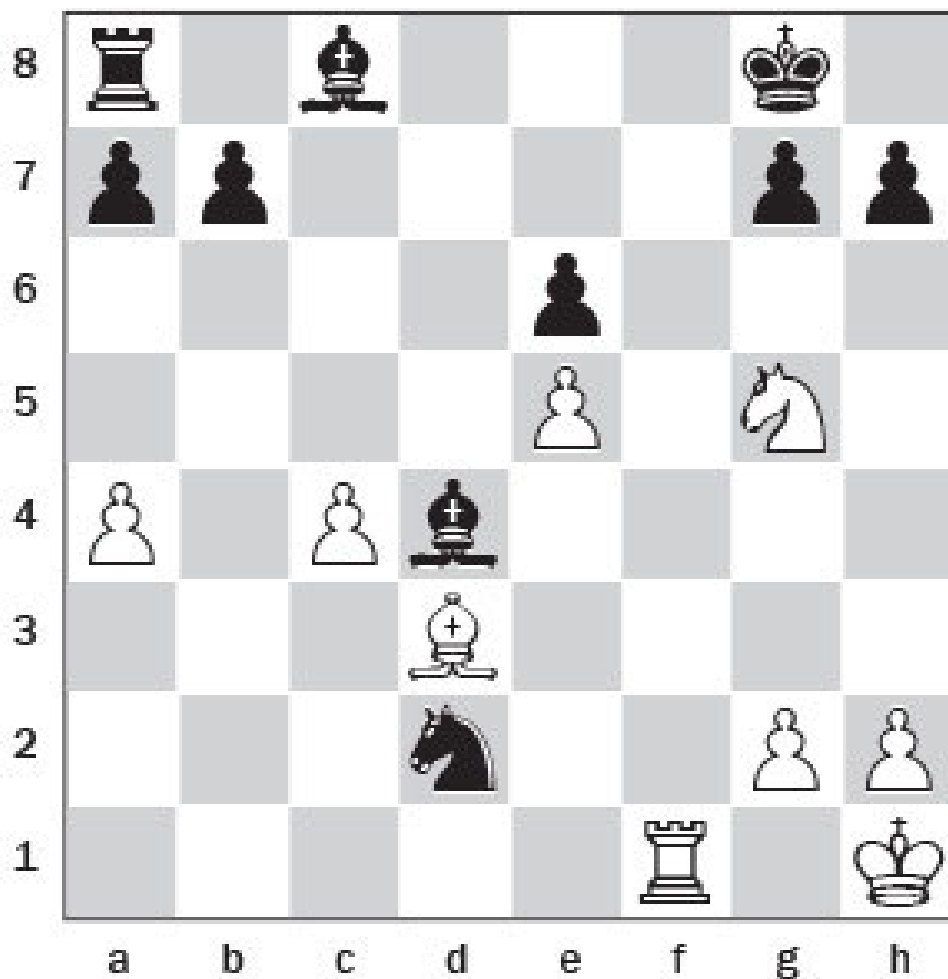
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

Use the knight on e5 as a helper to capture the pawn safely.

## Exercise 444

444



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

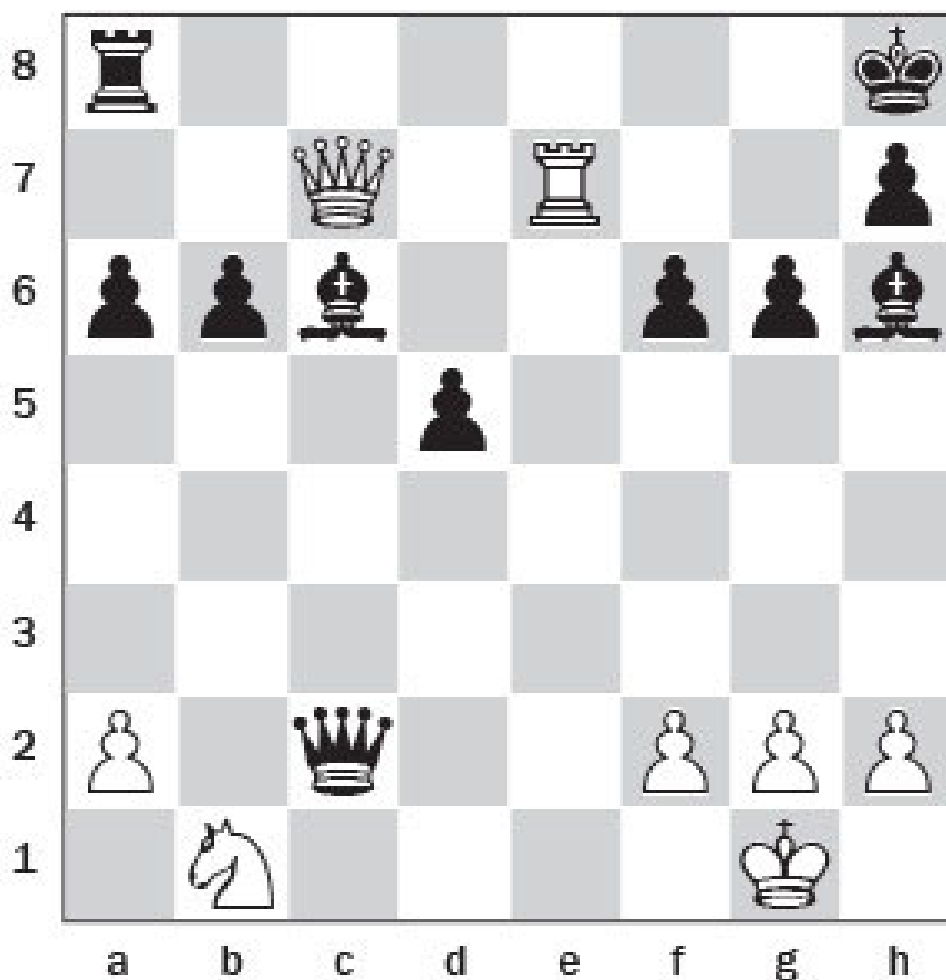
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Push the king to the corner and bring the rook to the back rank.

### Exercise 445

445



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

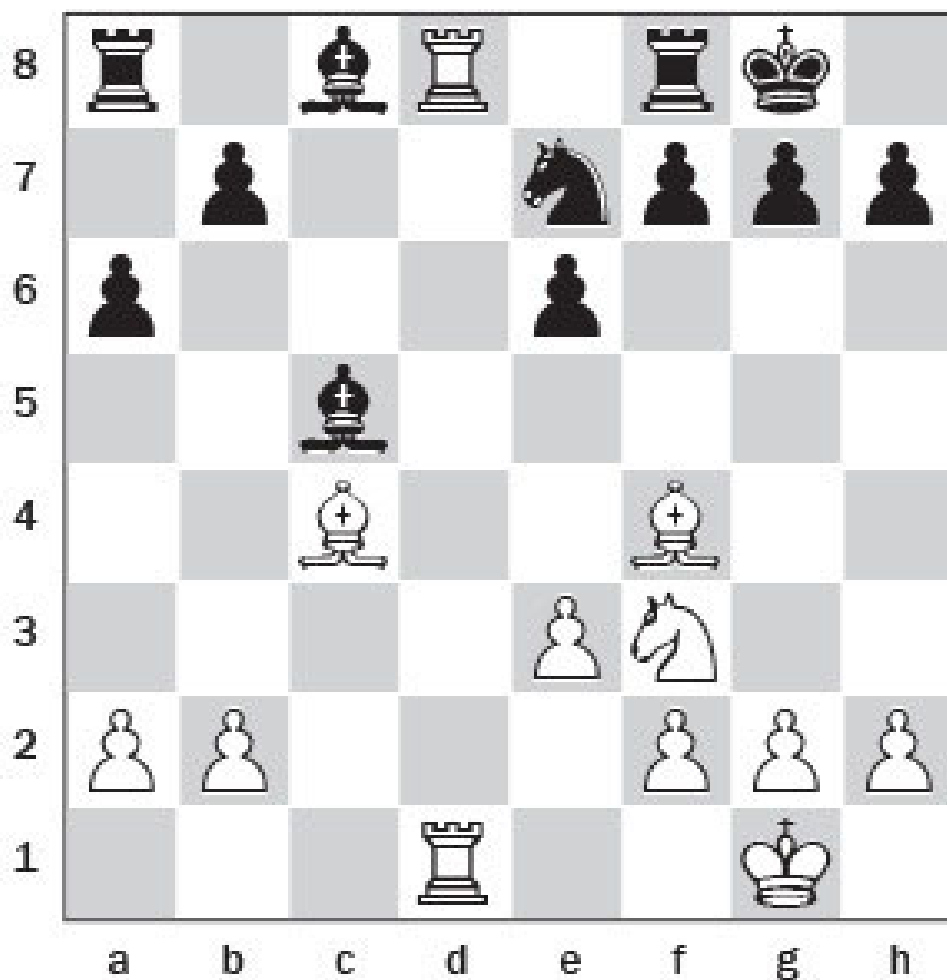
### **HINT**

The rook and queen battery on the 7th rank is very strong. The bishop on h6 protects the g7-square but not the f7- square.

### **Exercise 446**



446



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

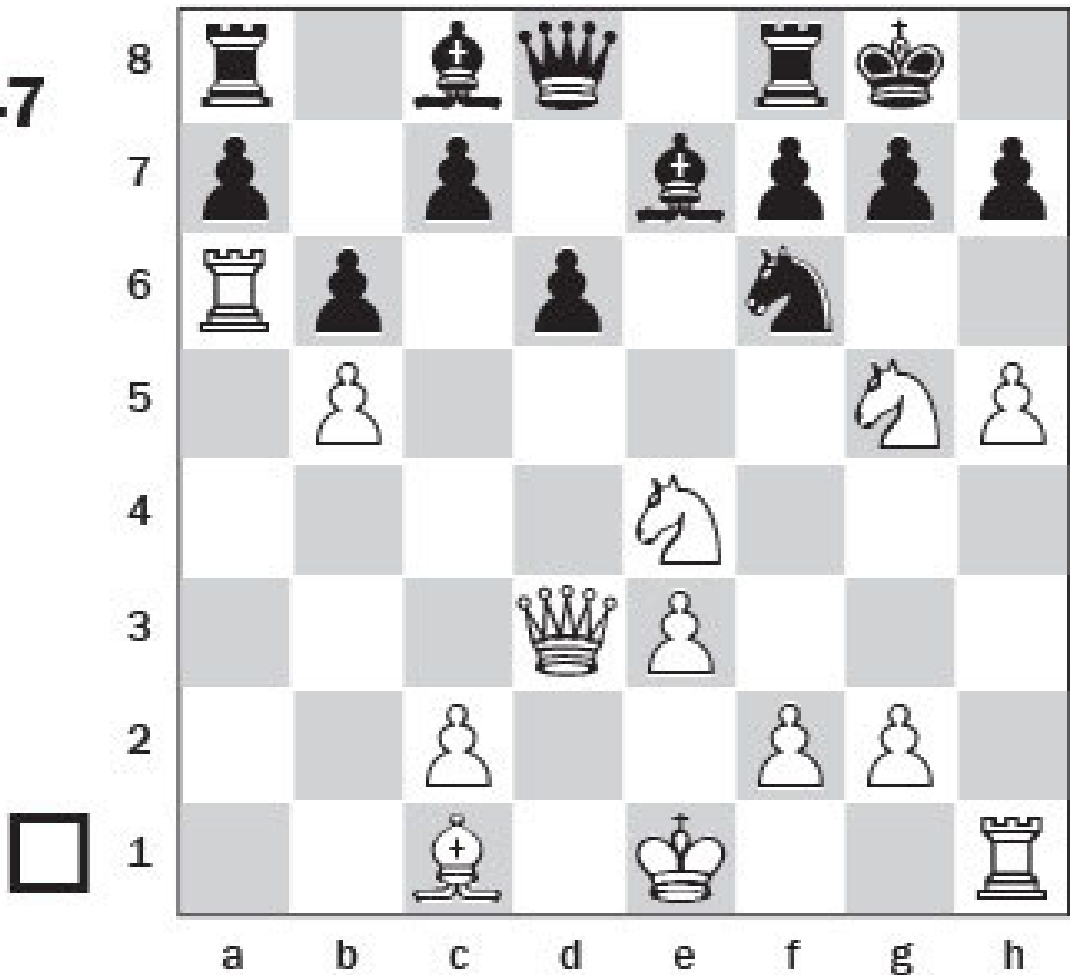
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The back rank is weaker than it looks, mainly because Black's knight is blocking the e7-square.

### Exercise 447

447



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

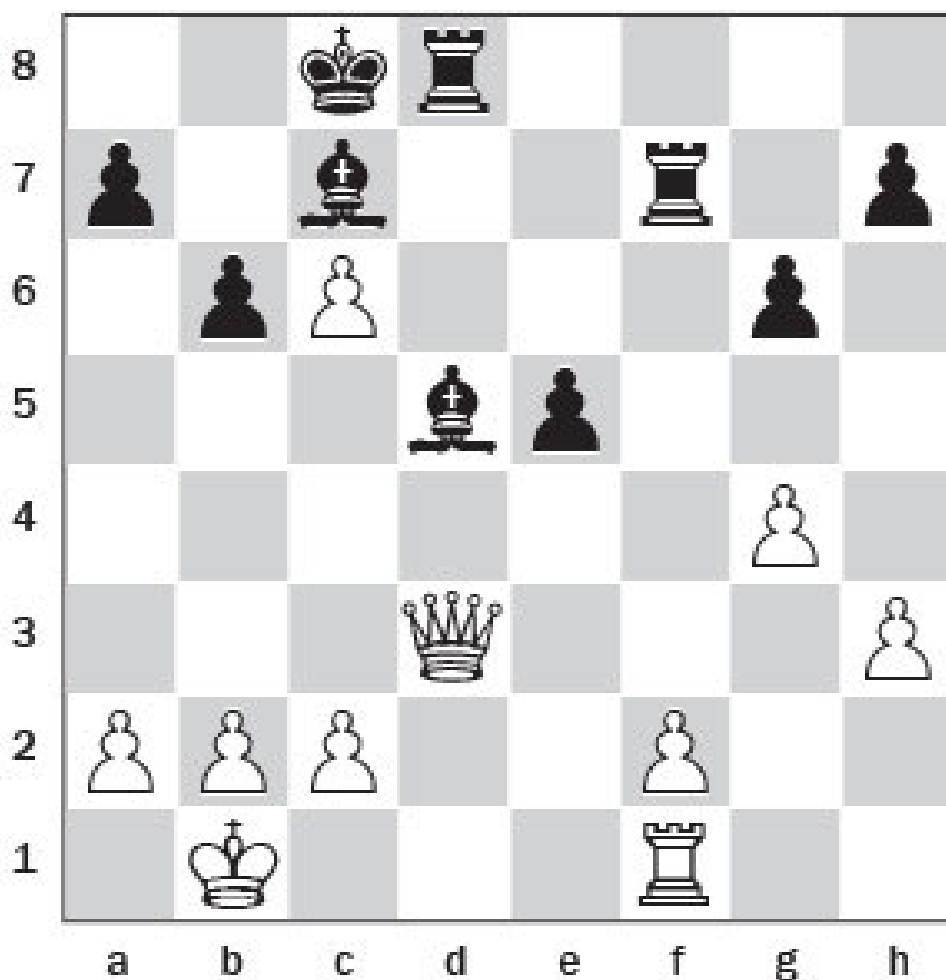
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's queen has eyes on the h7- square. How can White remove the guard and use a discovery to force checkmate?

### Exercise 448

448



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

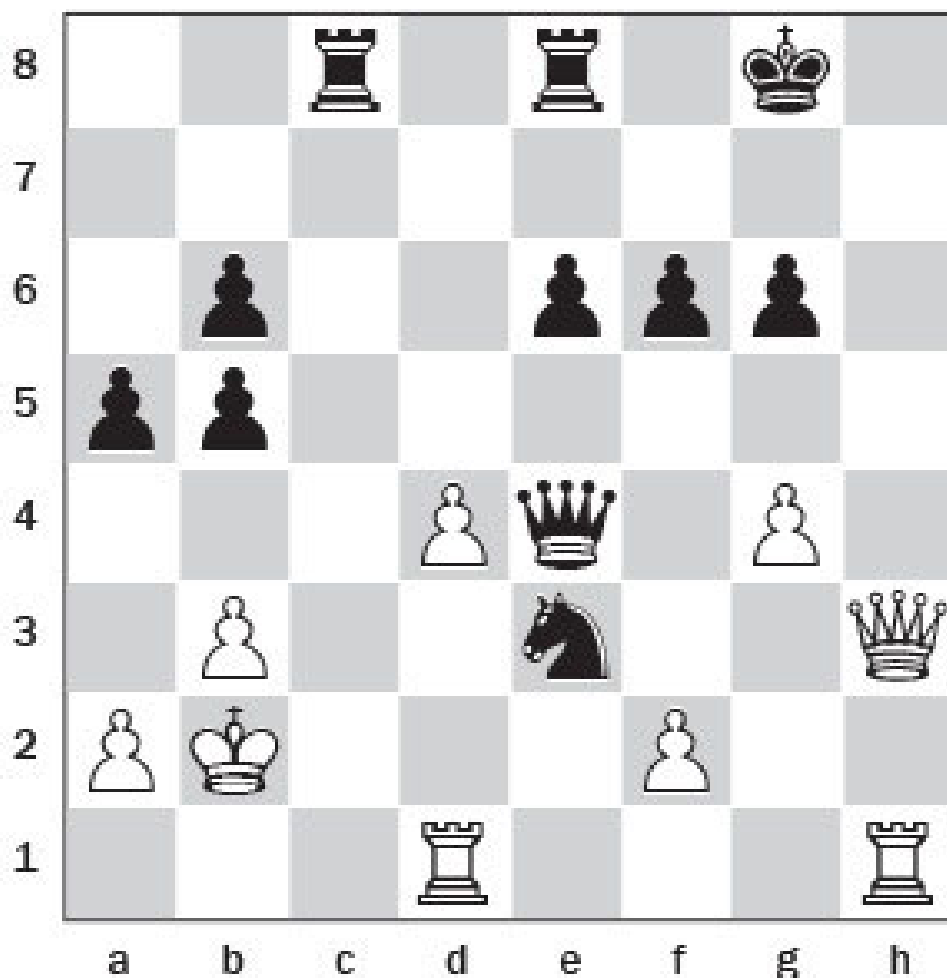
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The pawn on c6 is a very useful attacker. The pawn stops the king from moving forward and will soon be a helper.

## Exercise 449

449



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

### Exercise 450

☐

1. \_\_\_\_\_

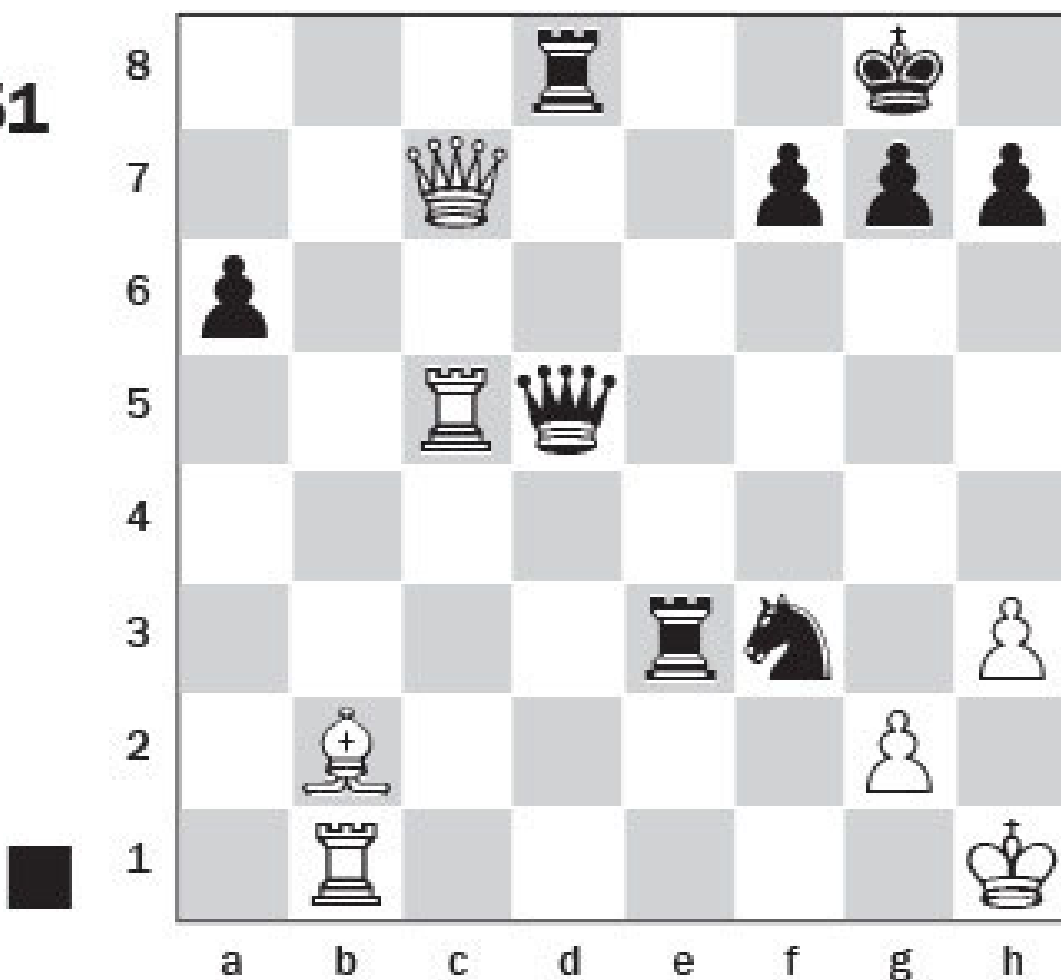
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

When the f-pawn is missing, the king can be very weak on the h5-e8 diagonal.

### Exercise 451

**451**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

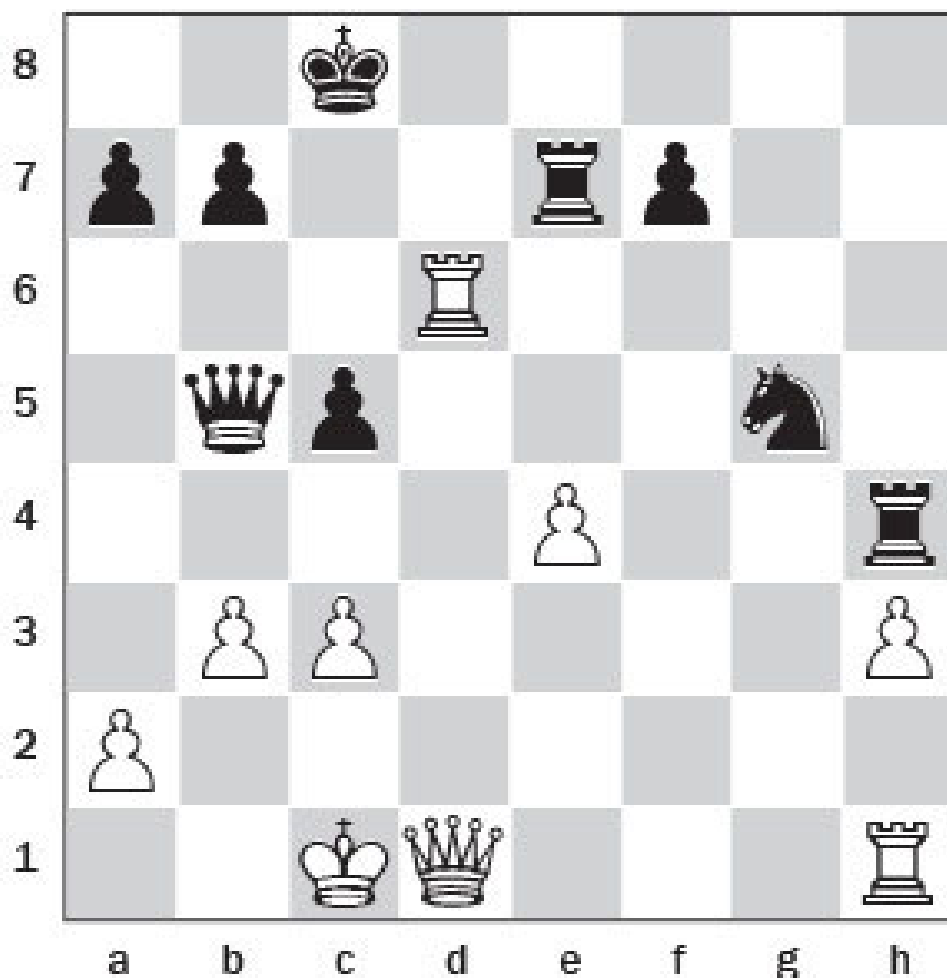
### **HINT**

The knight on f3 stops the king from moving to h2. The back rank is very weak.

### **Exercise 452**



452



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

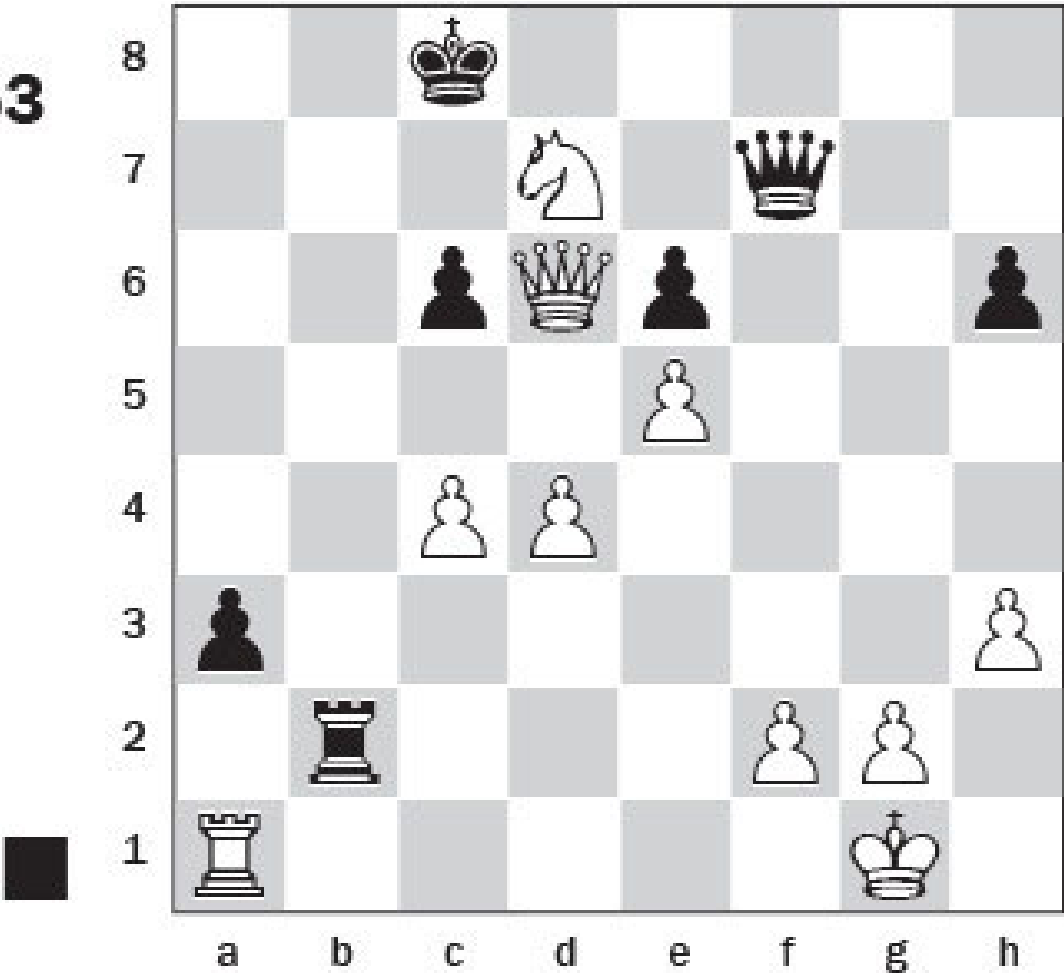
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The queen and rook battery are very strong. In the end, the queen will take the rook's place.

Exercise 453

453



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

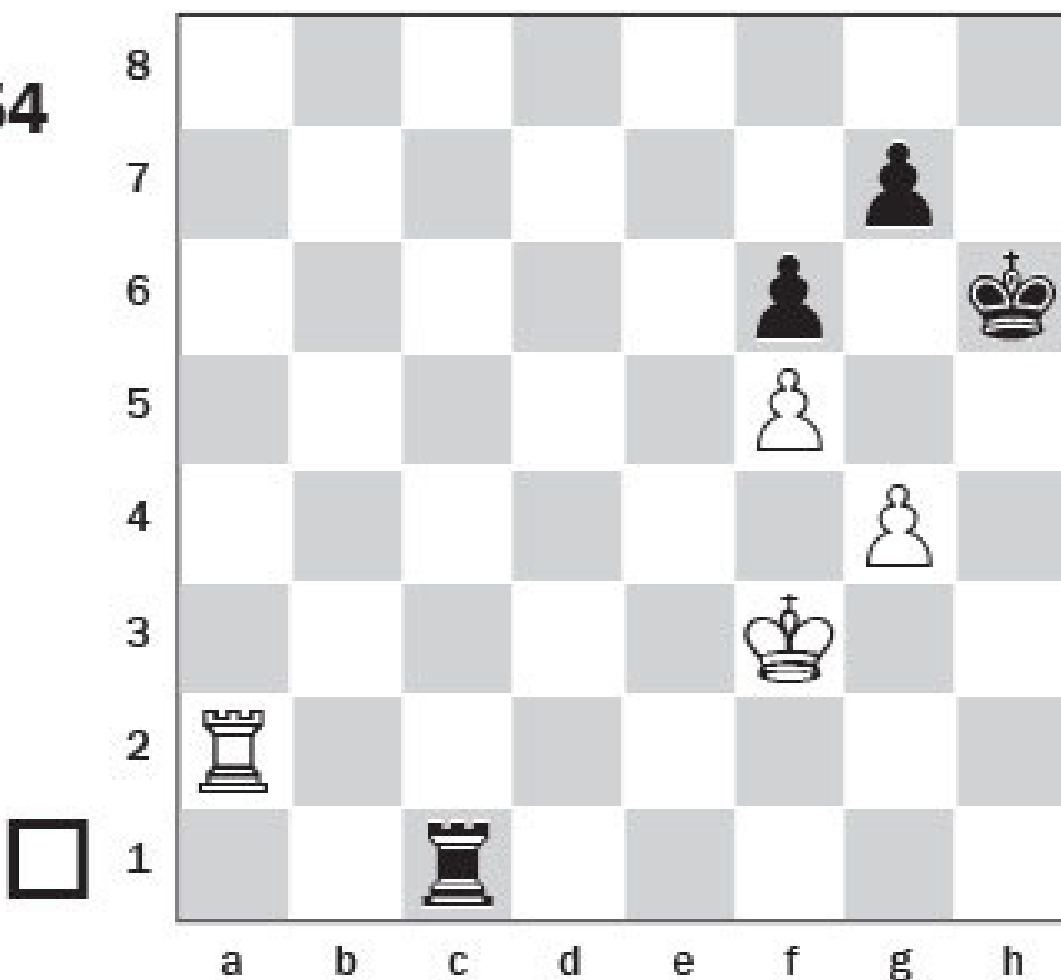
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

A rook on the 2nd rank is always very strong. Find a way to bring the queen into the attack for a helper checkmate.

### Exercise 454

**454**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

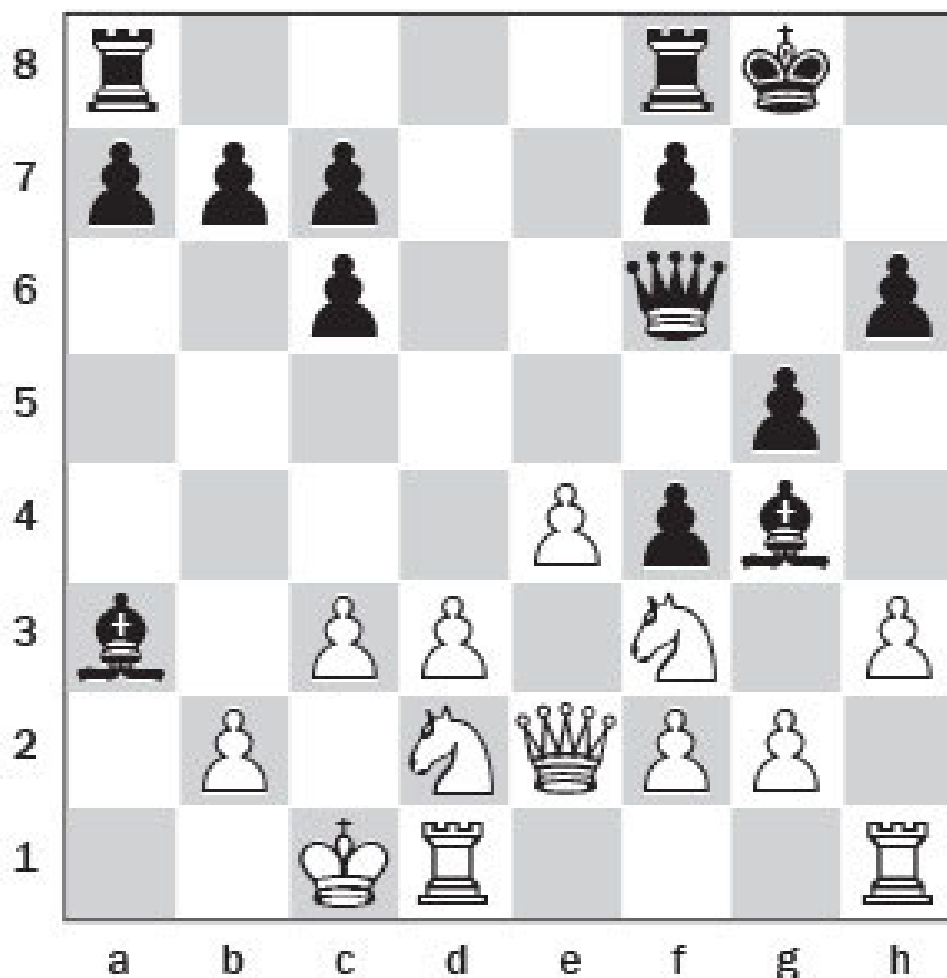
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

There are not many pieces on the board, but Black's king is still weak. Use the pawn on g4 as a helper in the end.

### Exercise 455

455



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

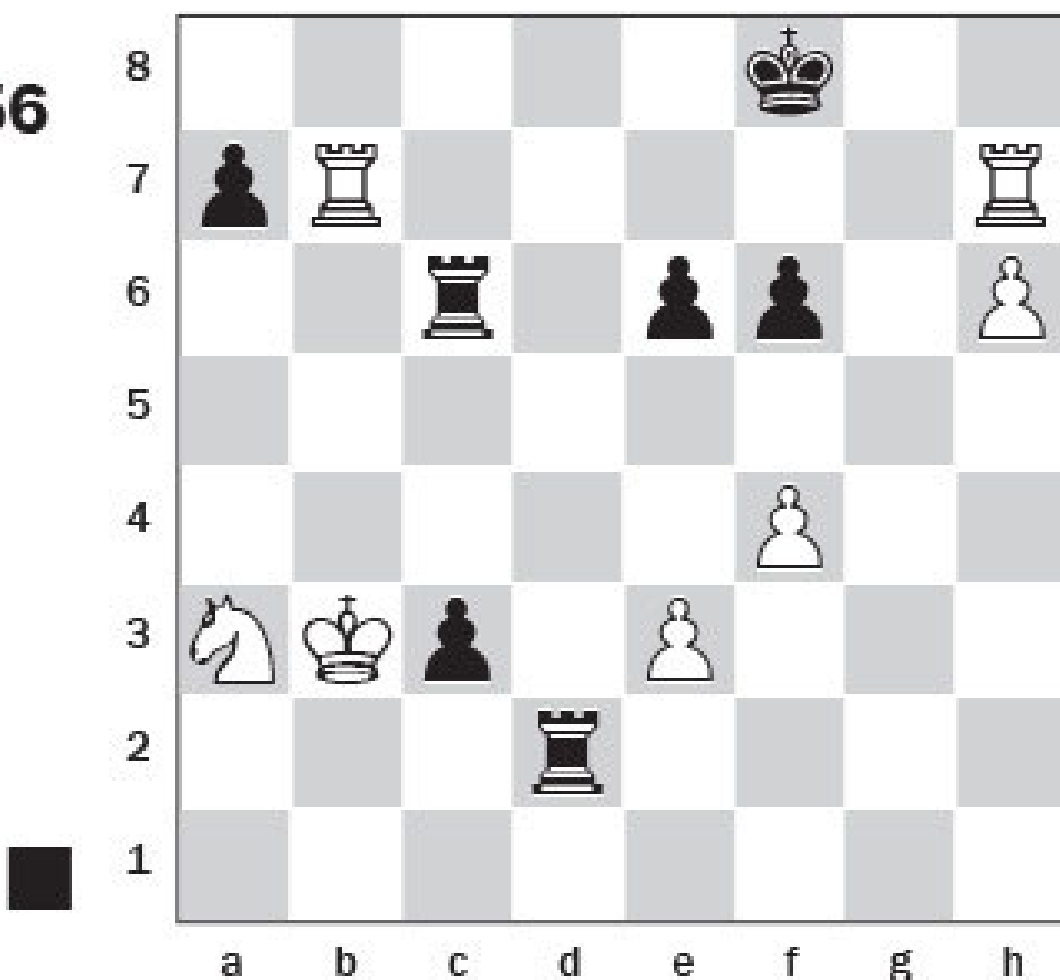
HINT

The bishop on a3 is pinning the b2- pawn. Remember that 'pinned pieces do not protect'.

# Assorted Checkmates in Two – Test

## Exercise 456

456



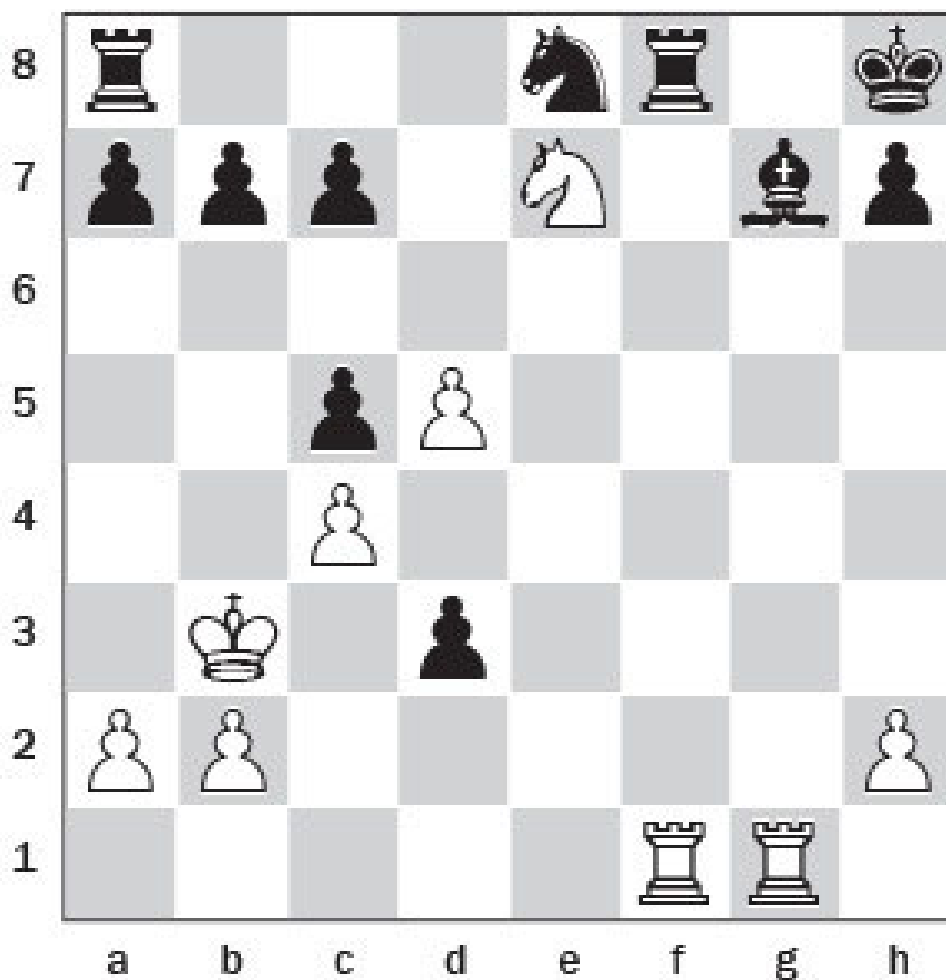
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 457

457



Answer:

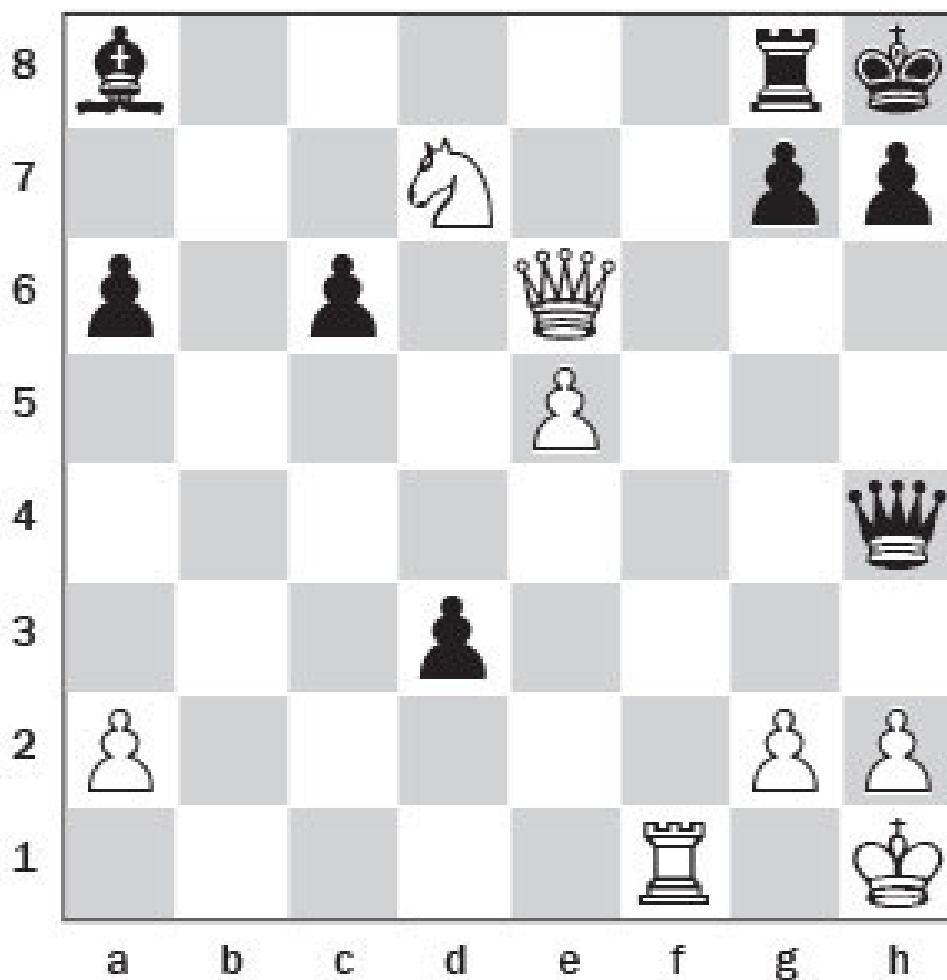
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 458

458



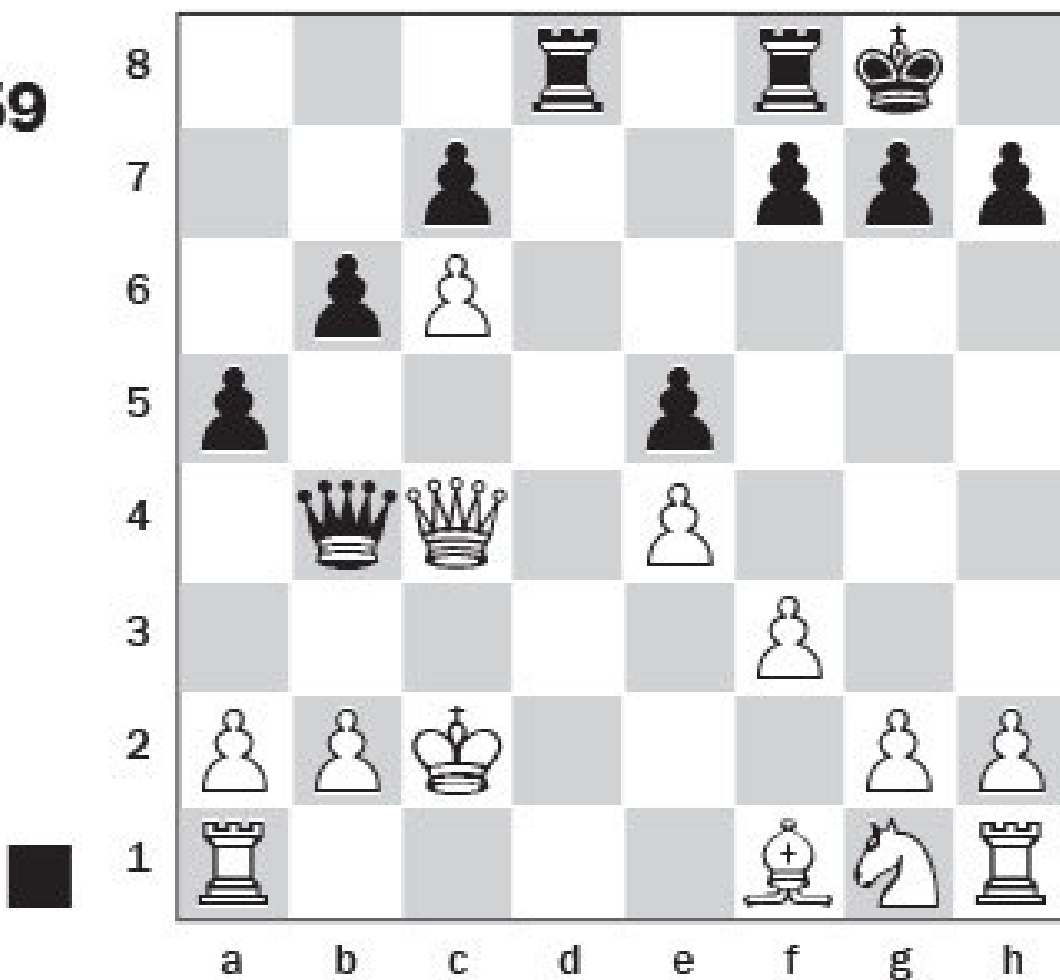
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 459

459



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 460

460



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 461

461



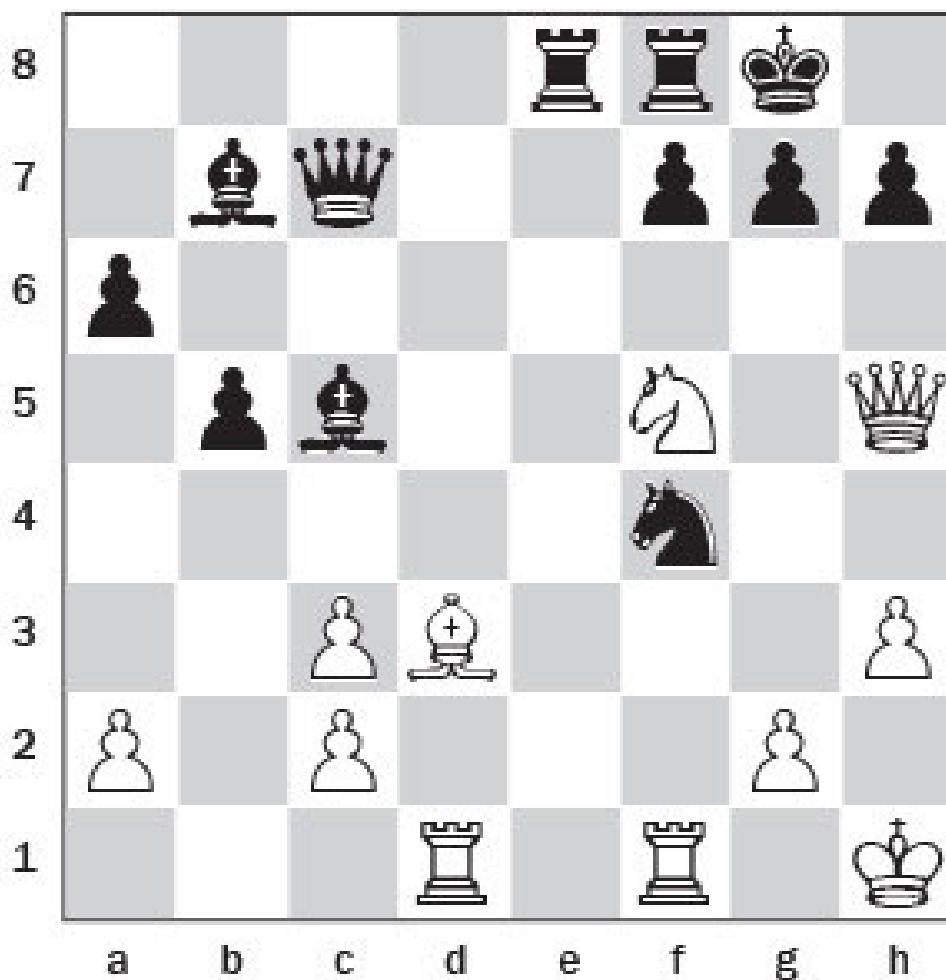
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 462

462



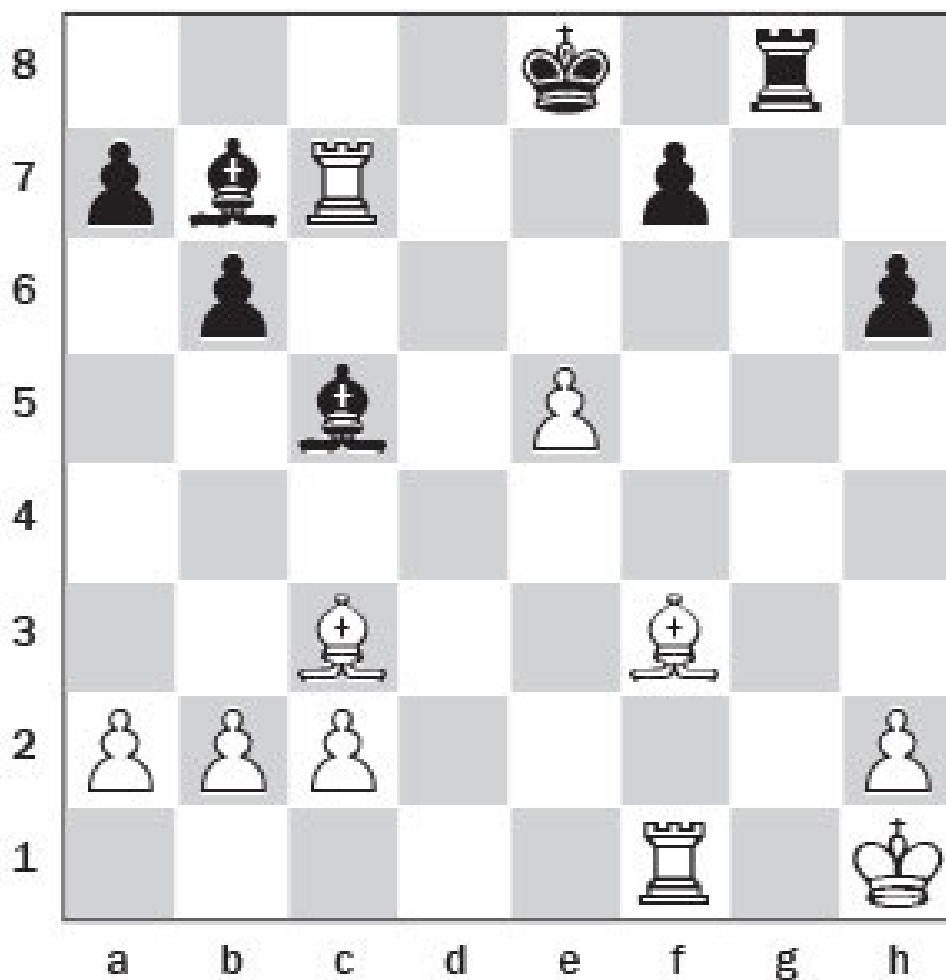
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 463

**463**



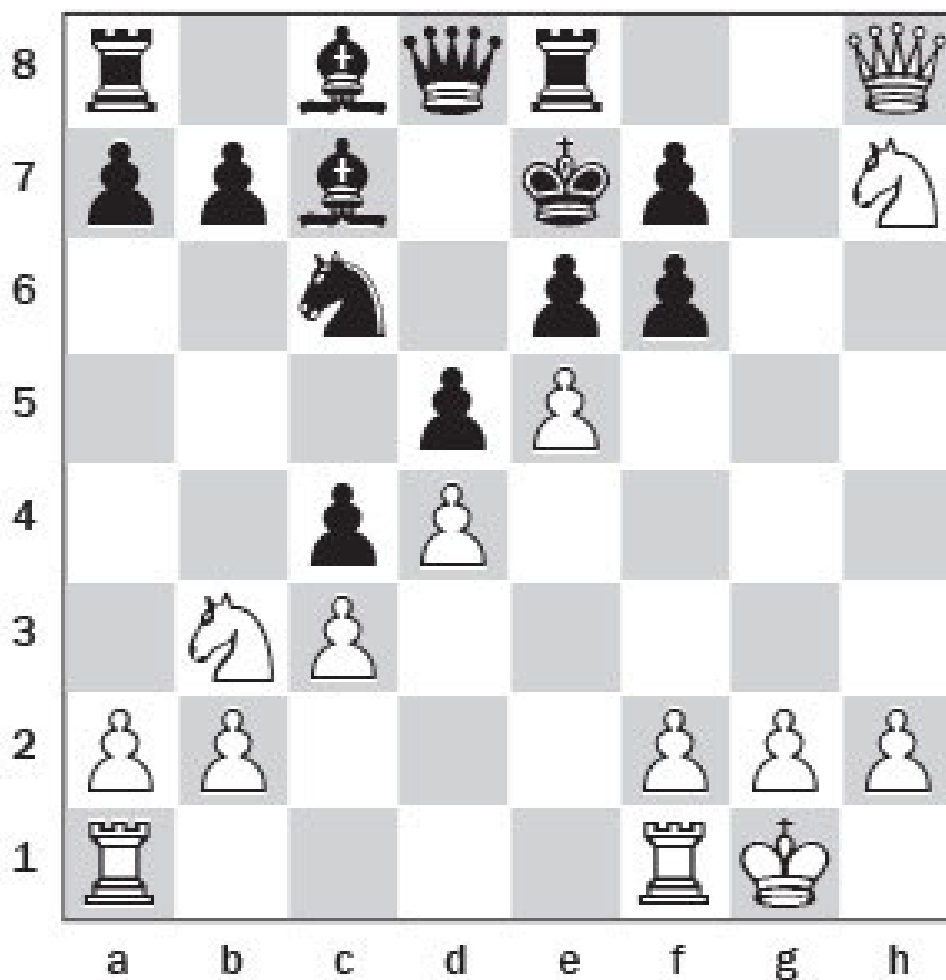
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 464

464



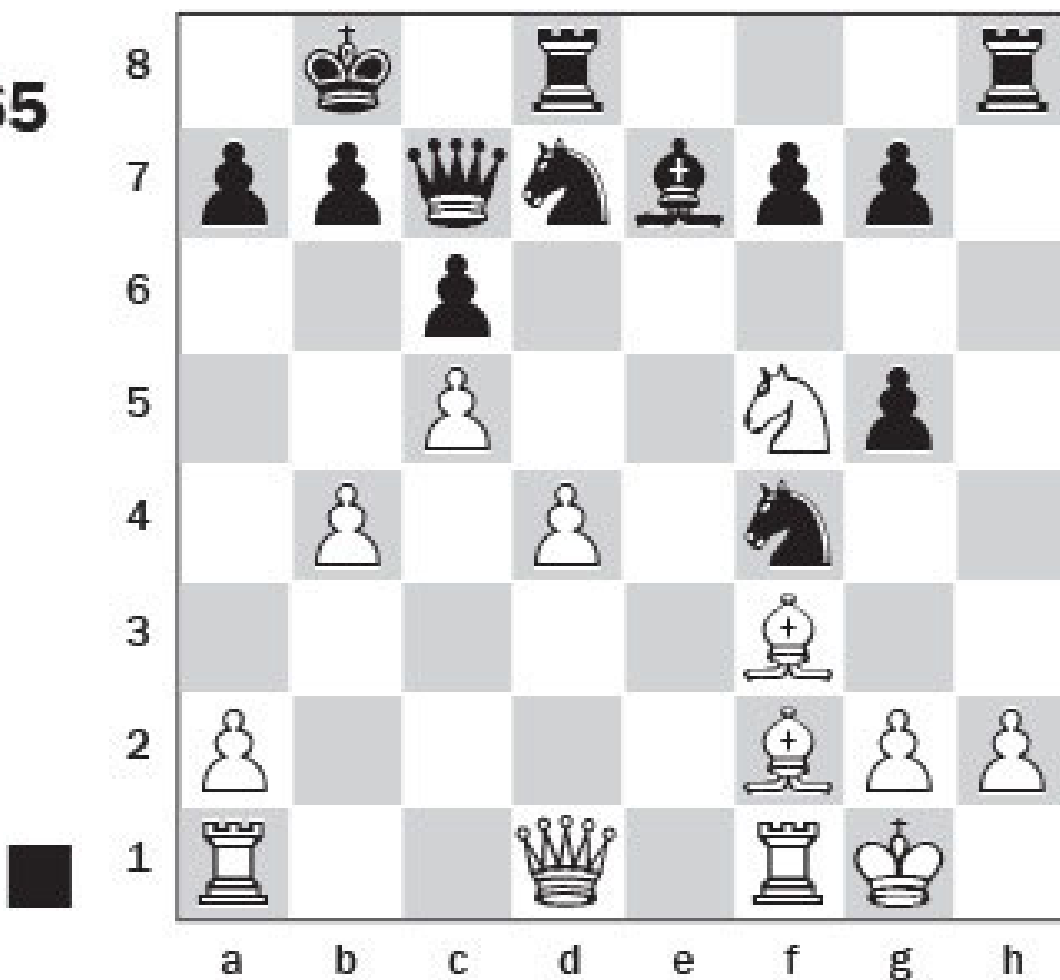
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 465

465



Answer:

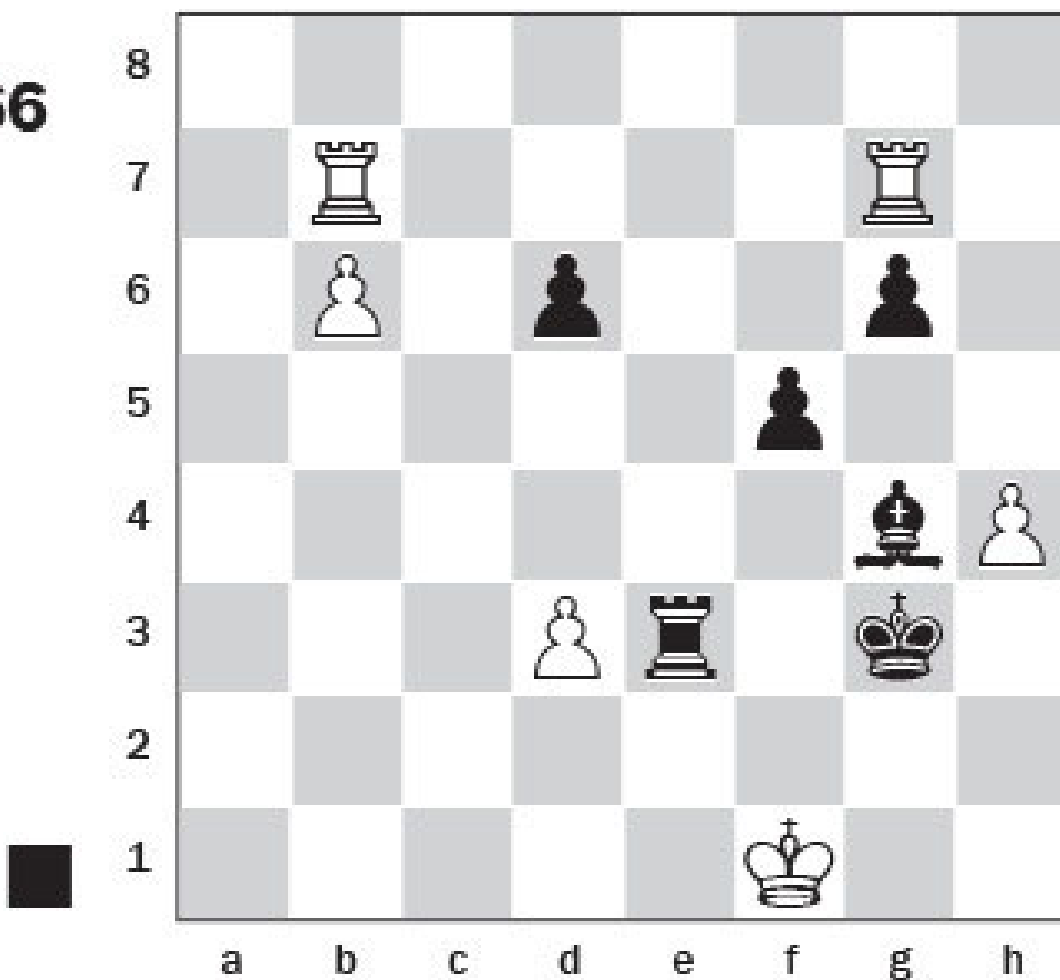
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 466

**466**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 467

467



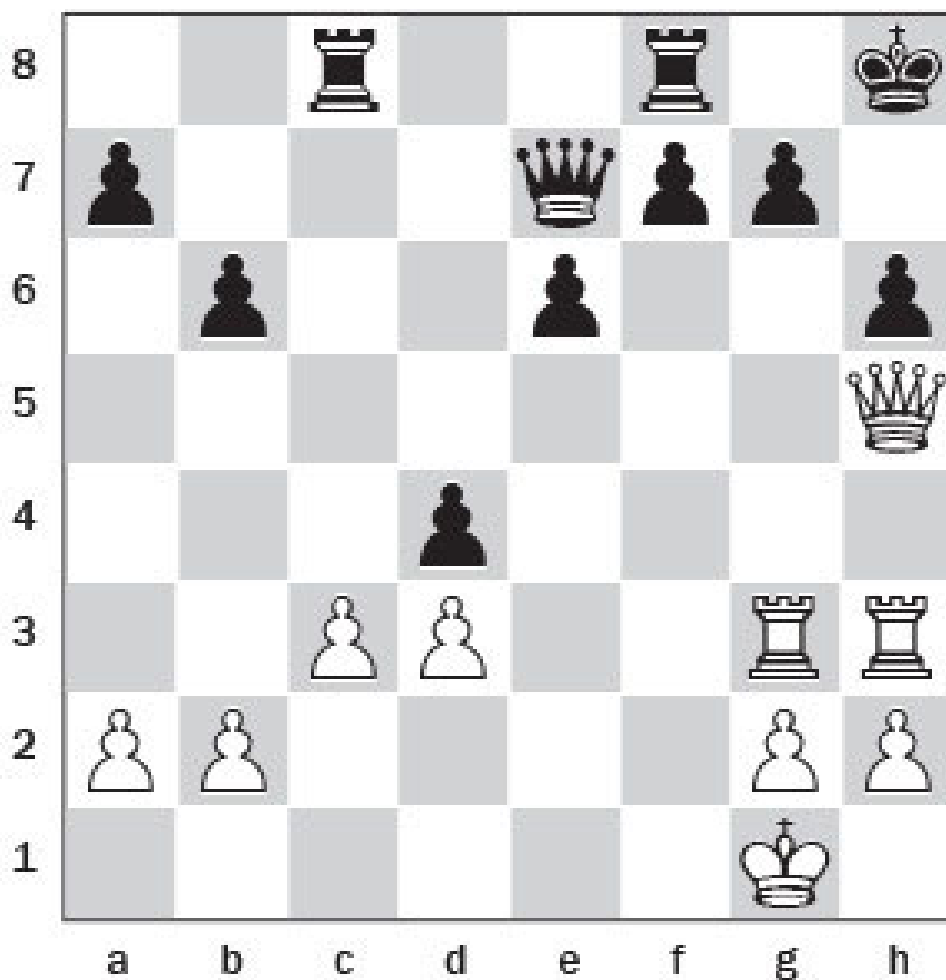
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 468

468



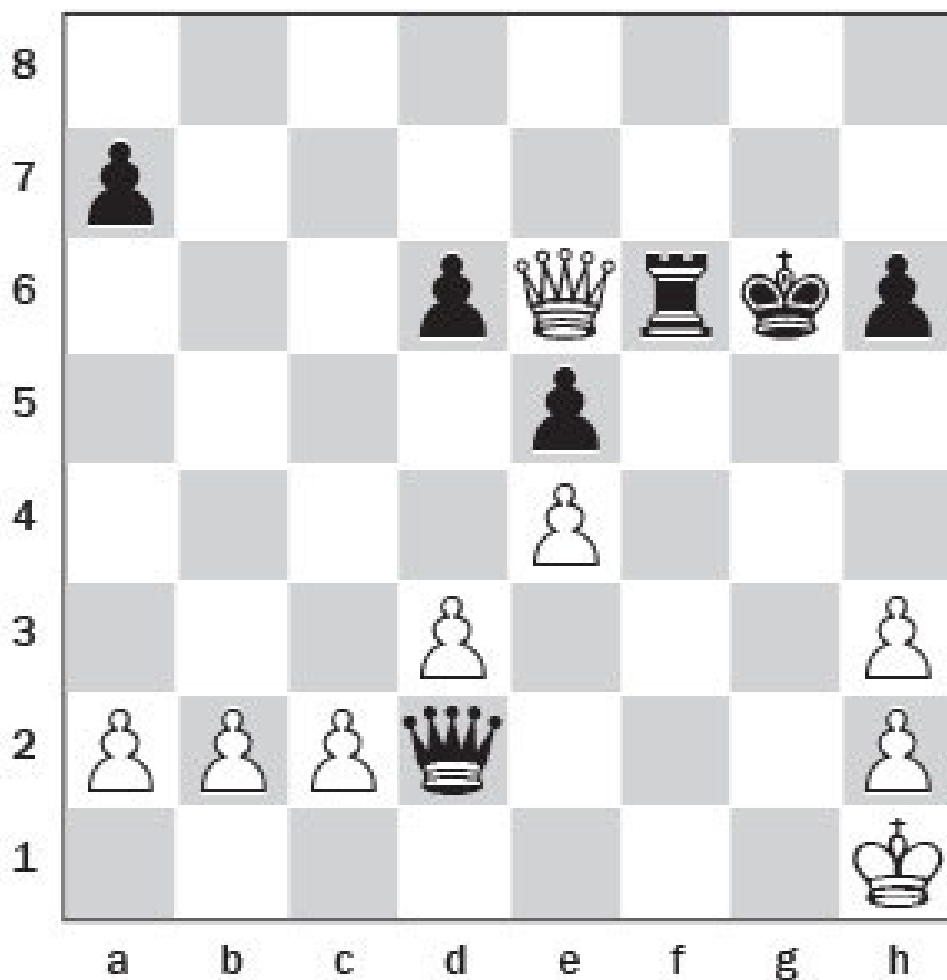
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 469

**469**



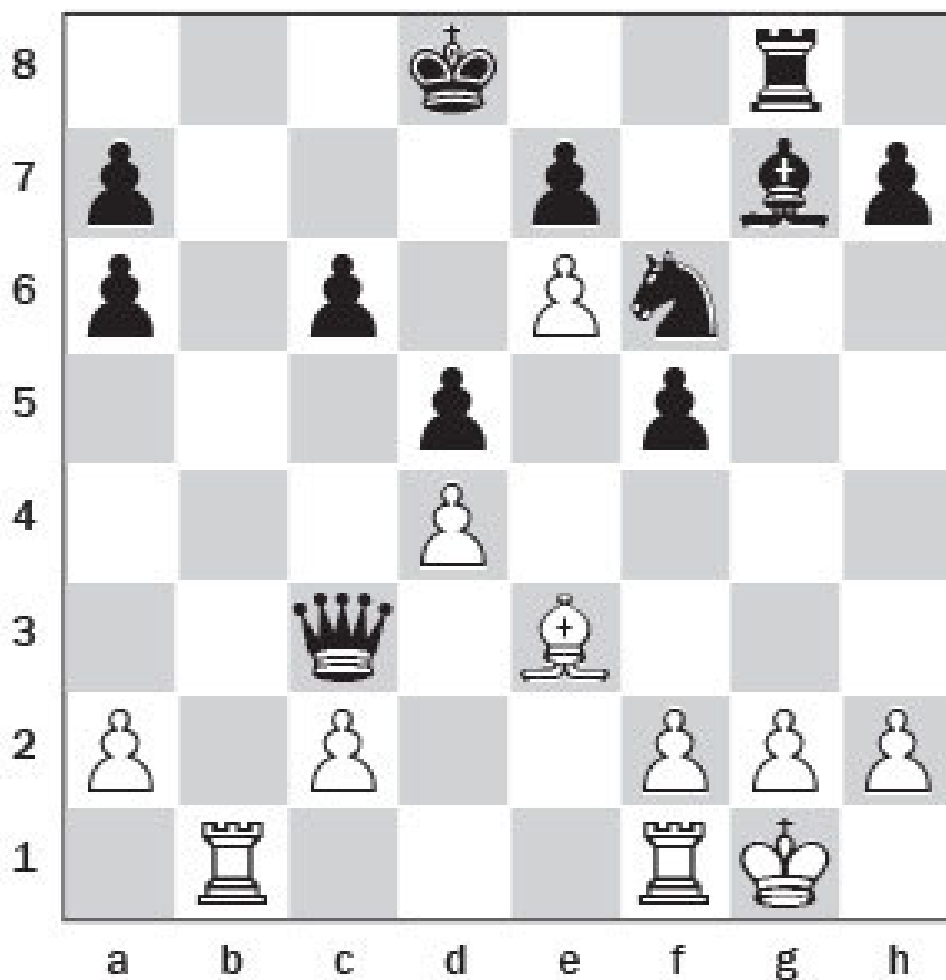
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 470

470



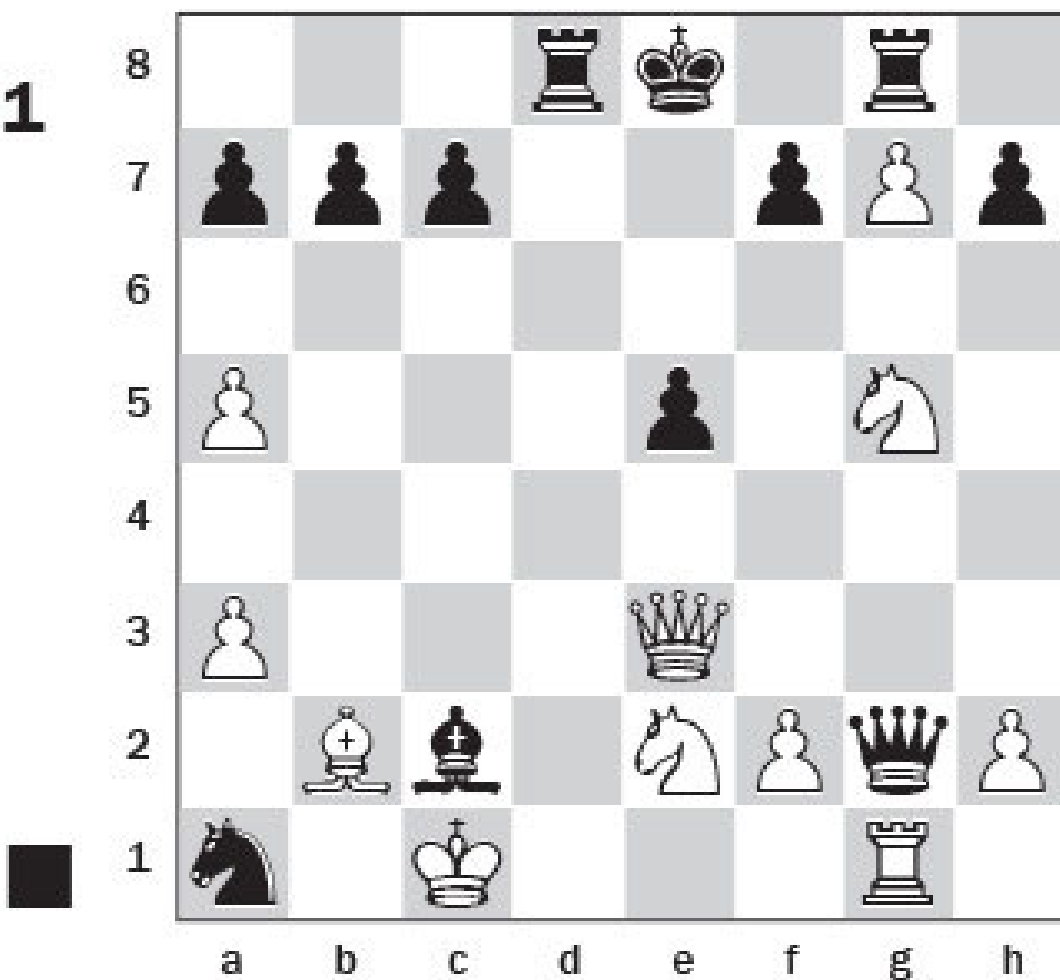
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 471

**471**



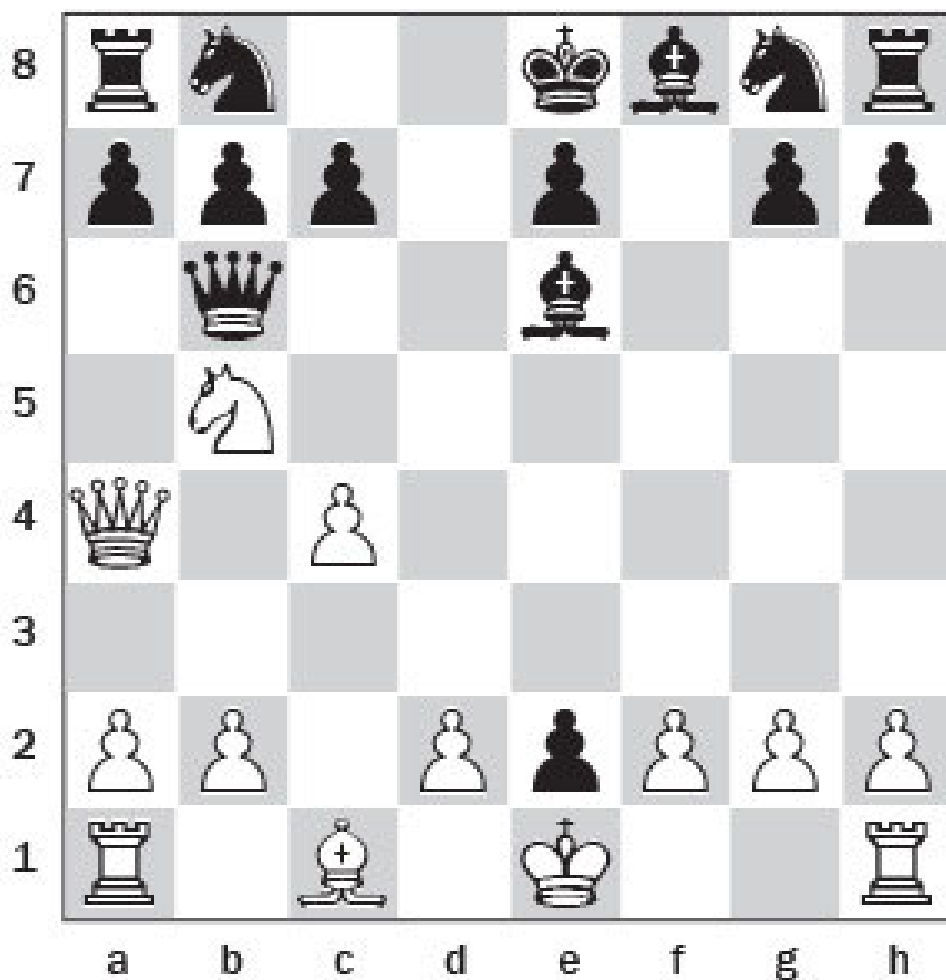
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 472

472



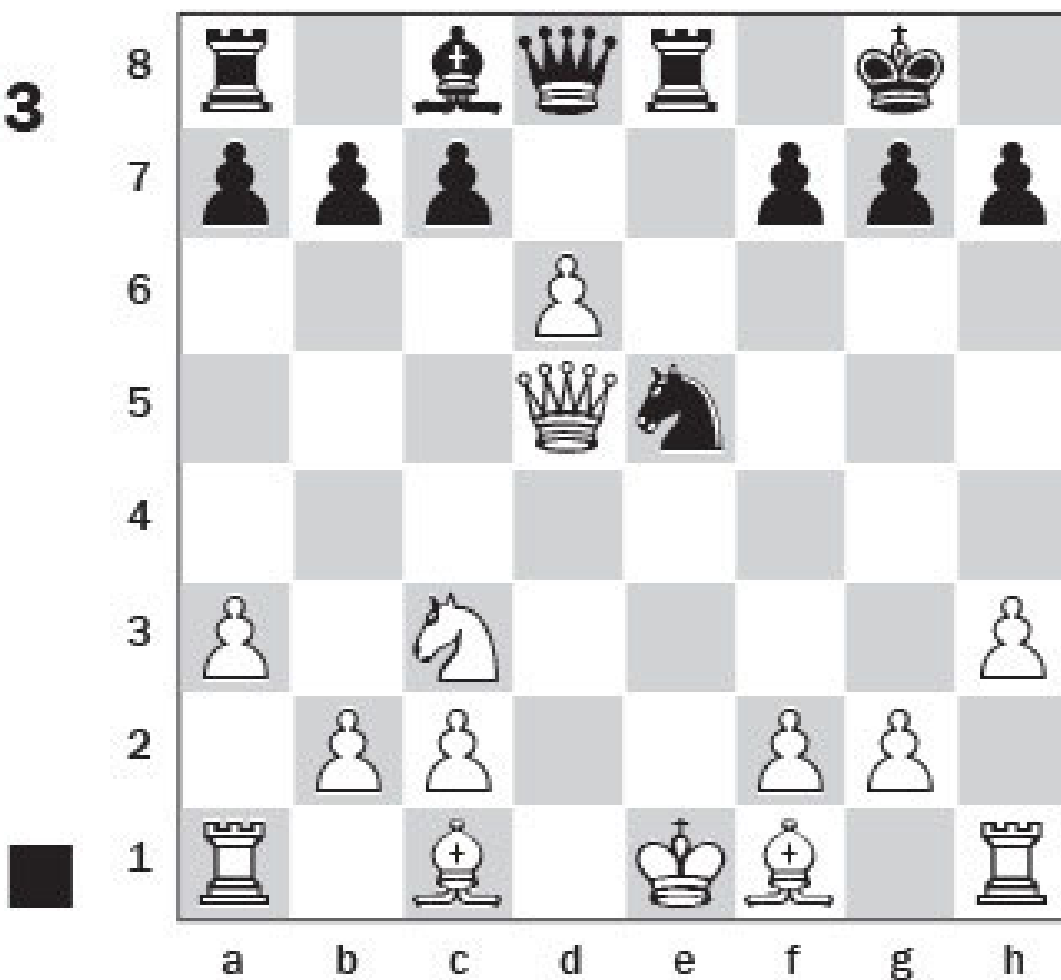
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 473

473



Answer:

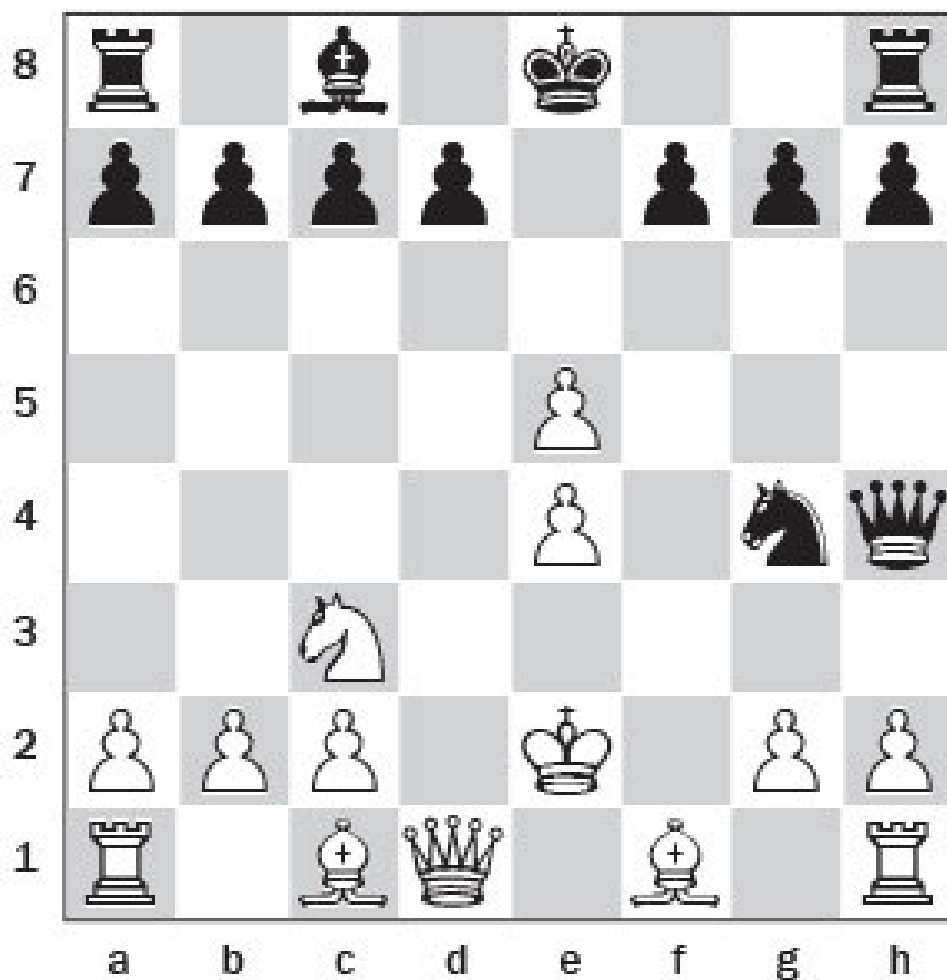
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 474

474



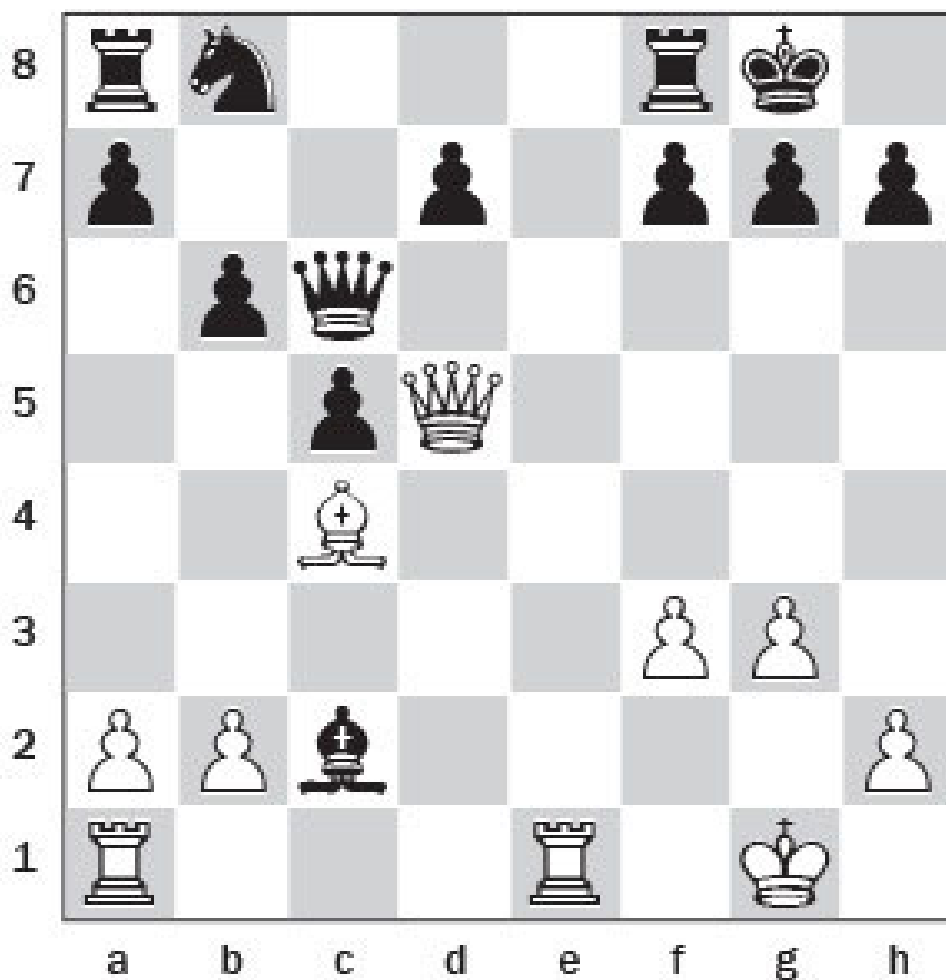
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 475

475



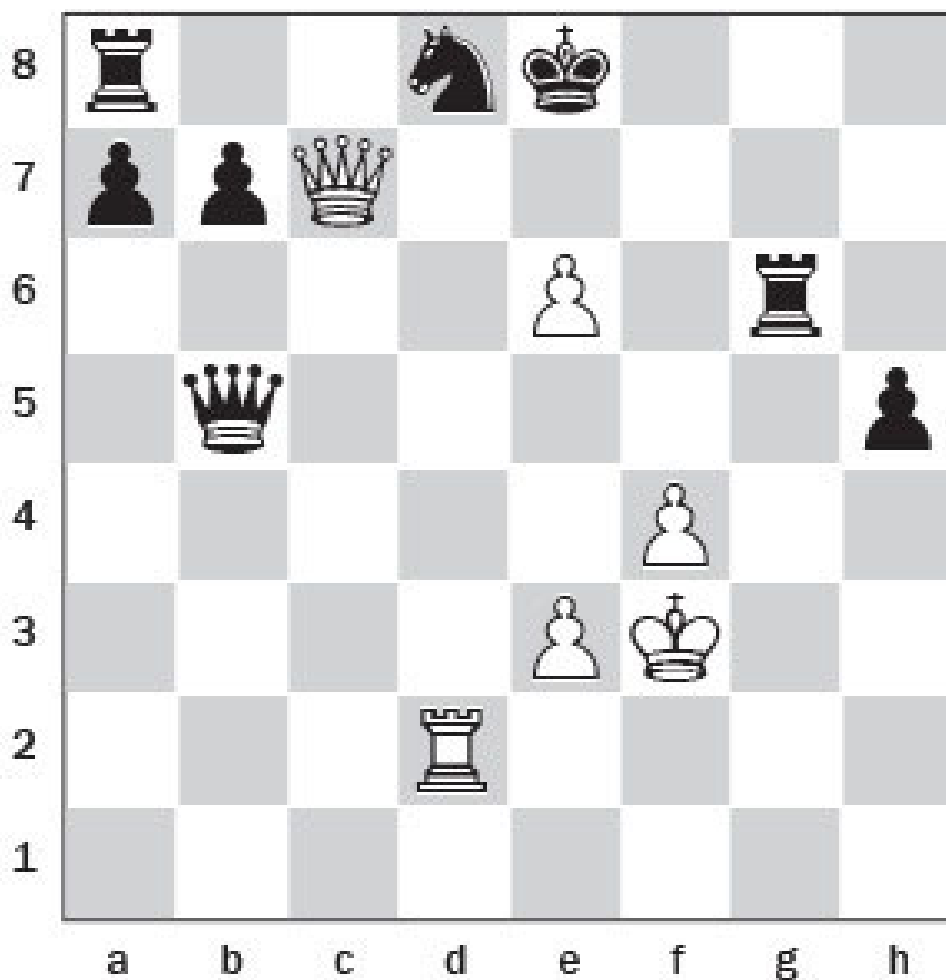
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 476

476



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 477

477



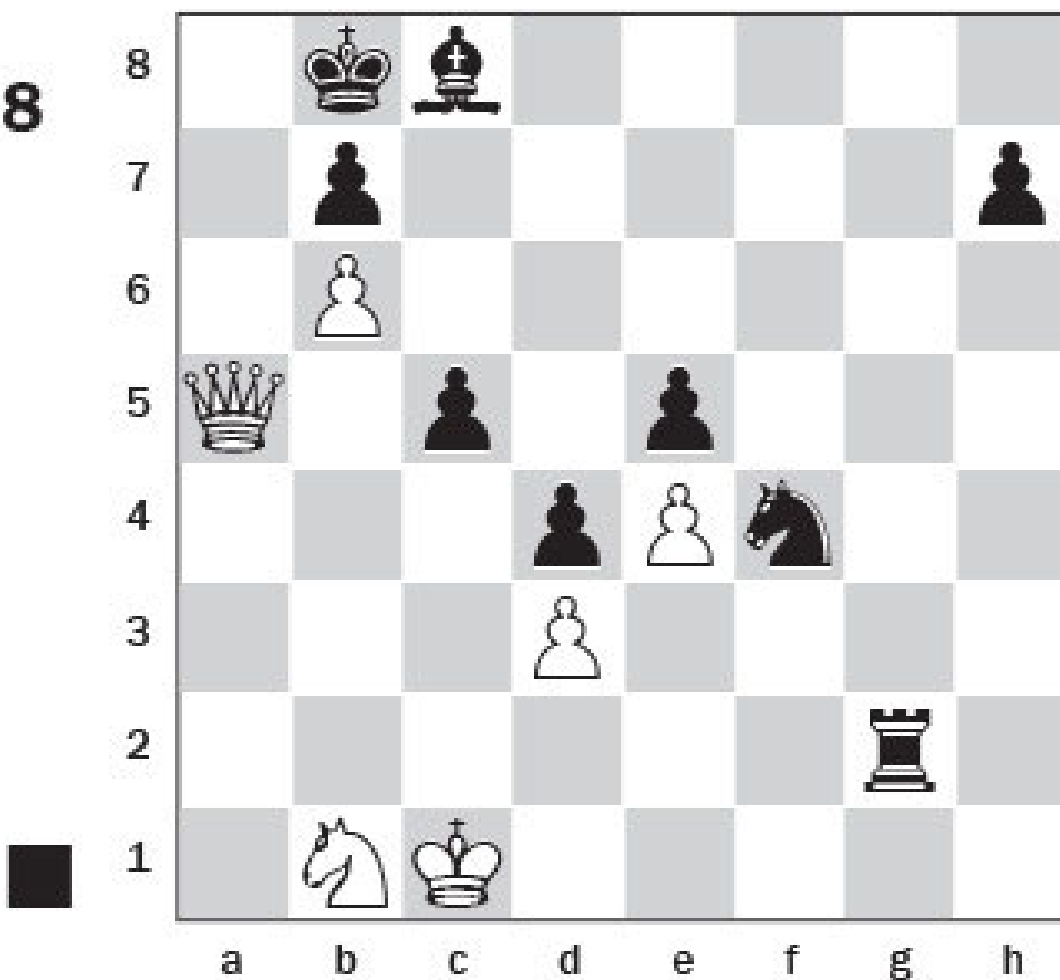
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 478

478



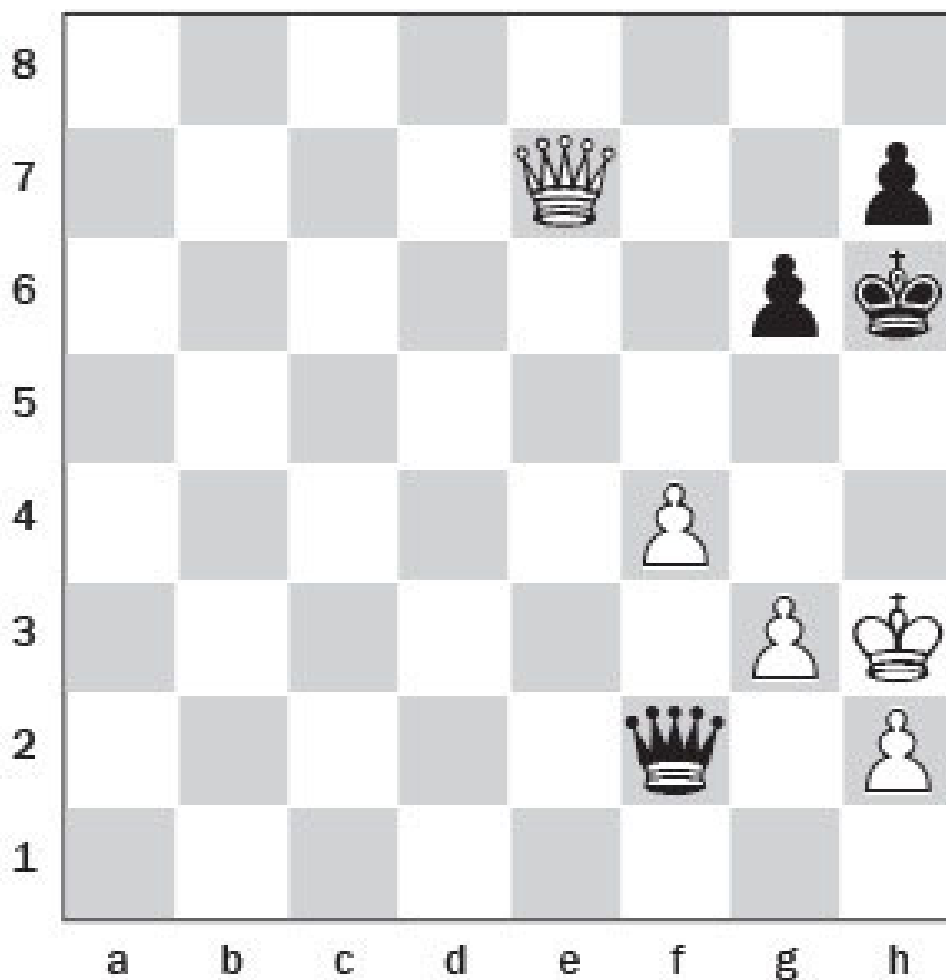
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 479

**479**



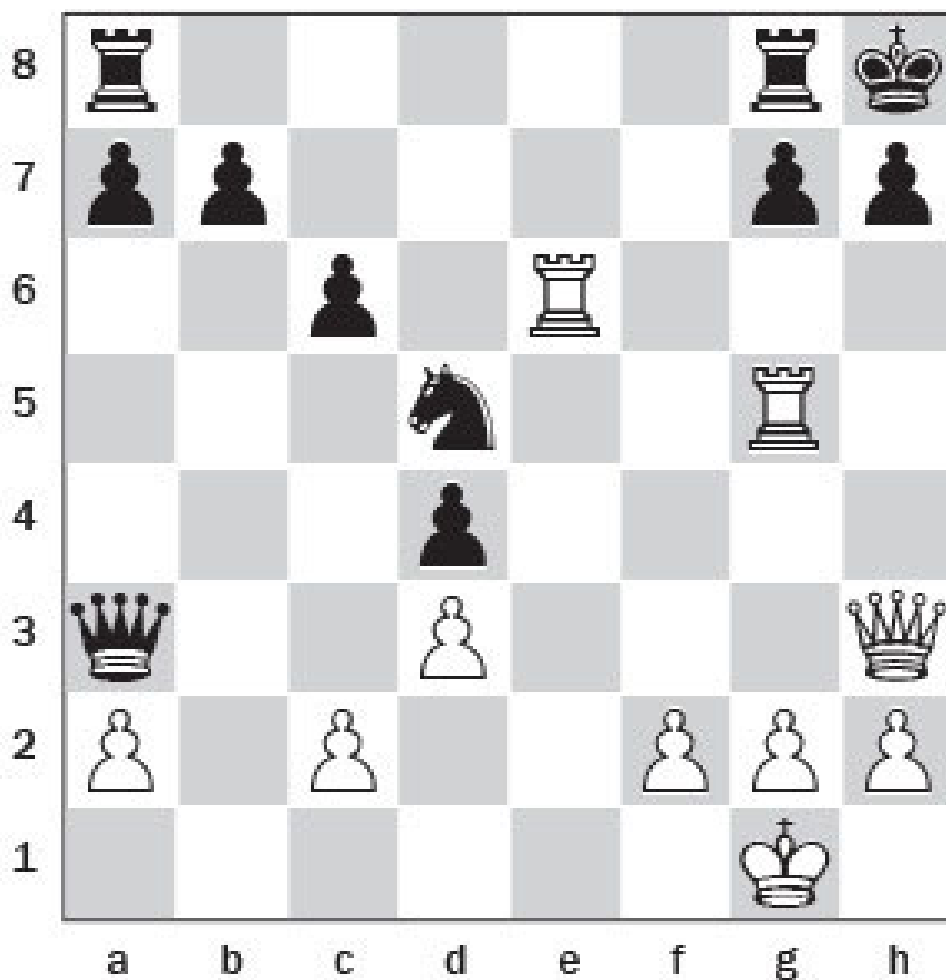
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 480

480



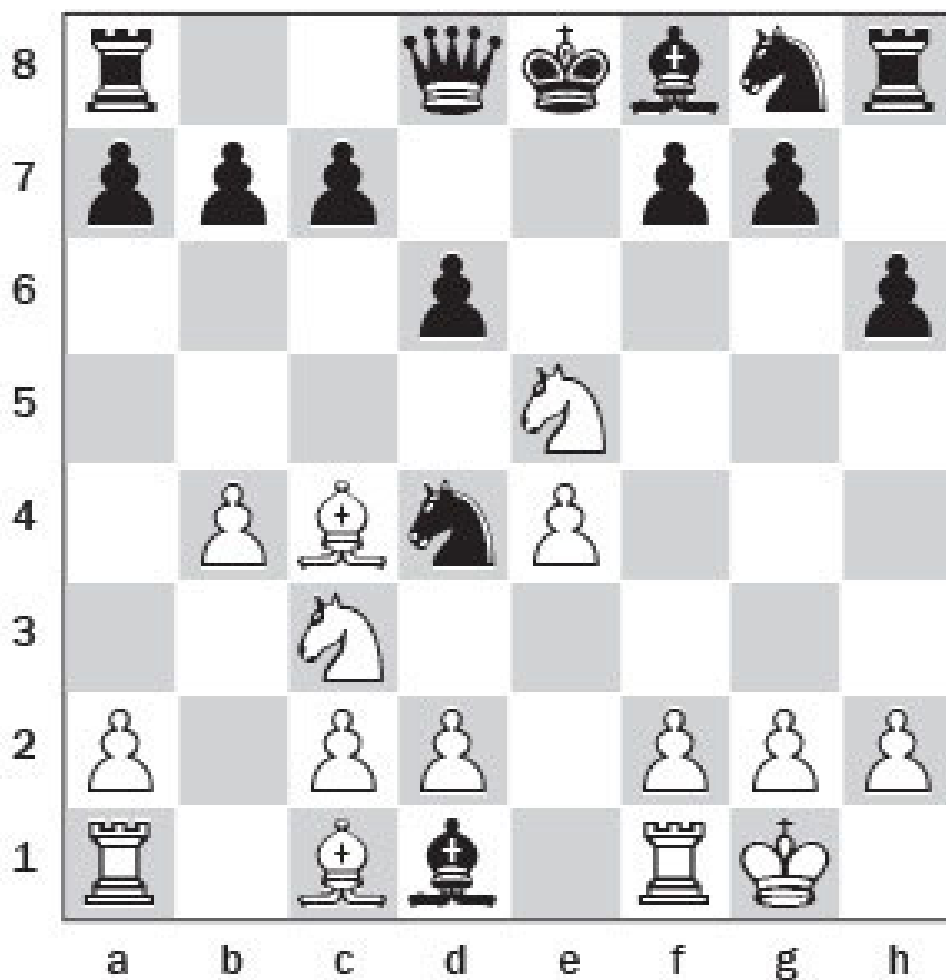
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 481

481



Answer:

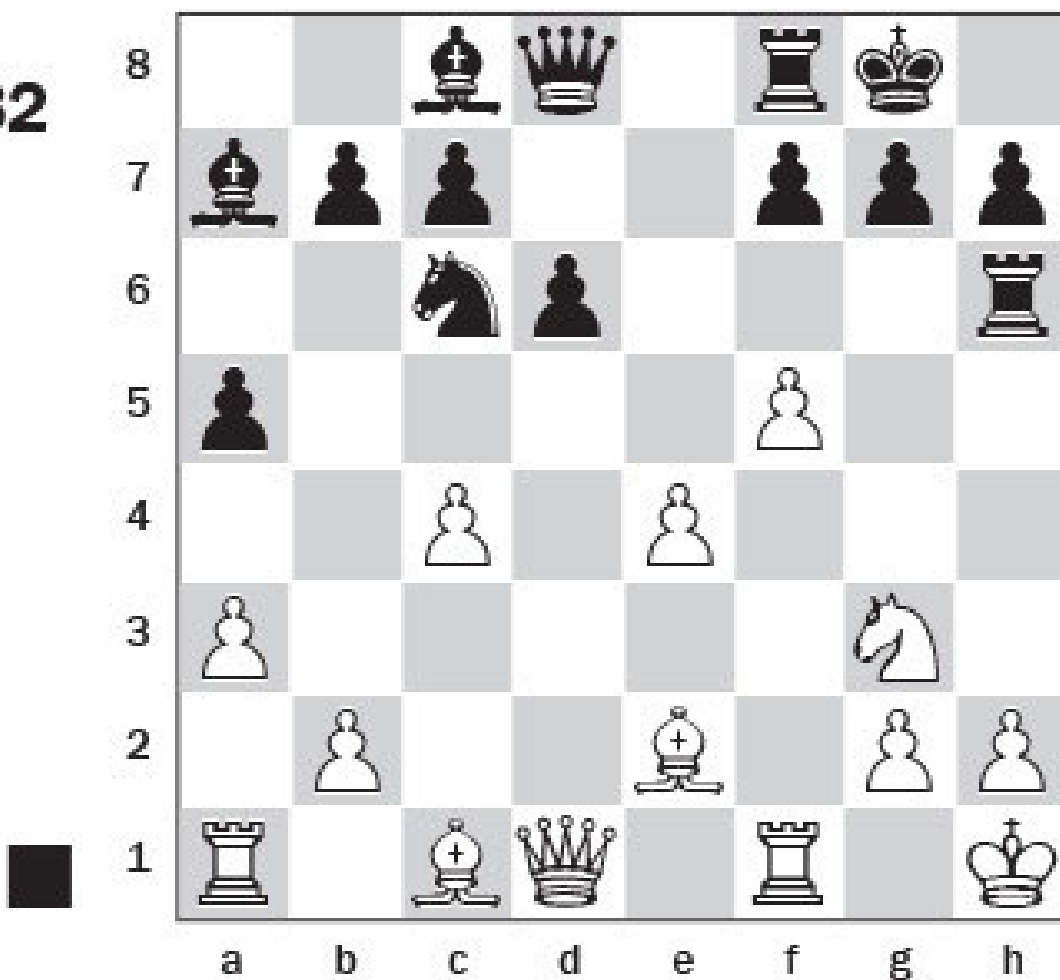
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 482

482



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 483

483



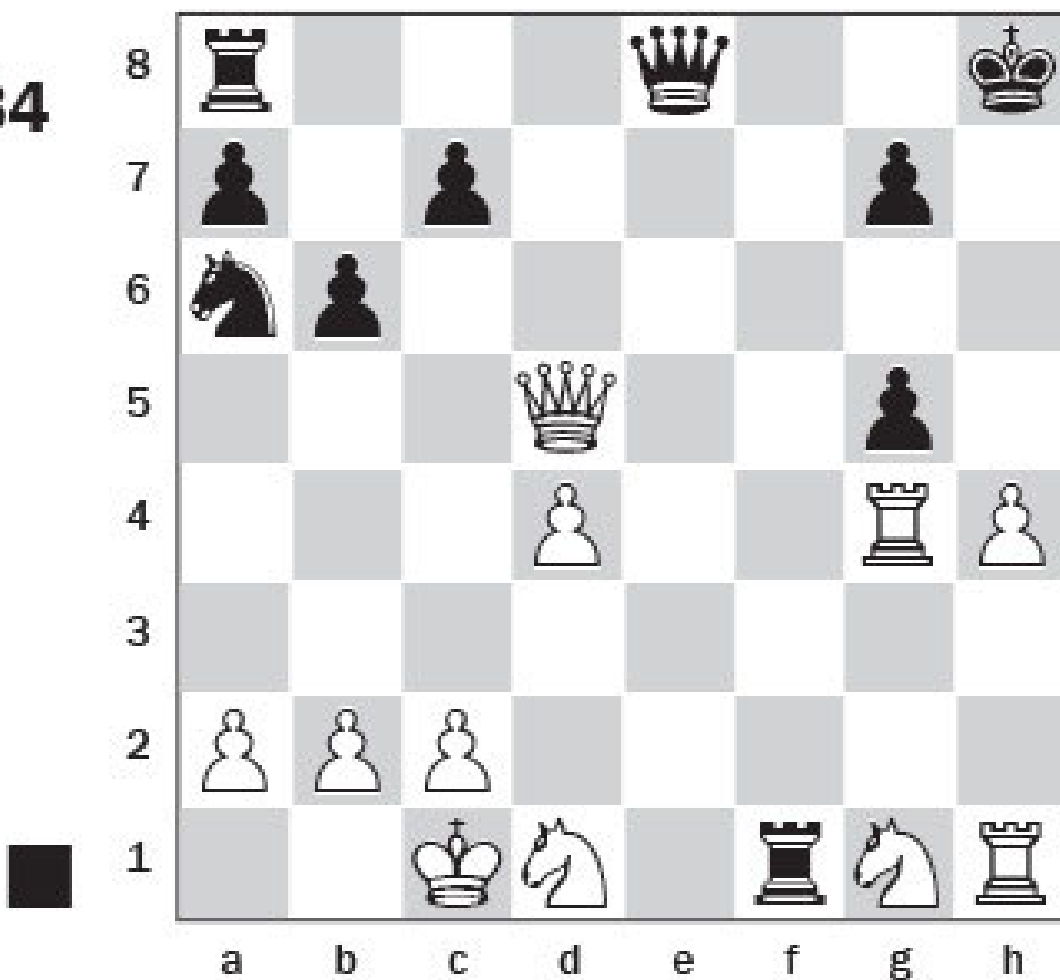
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 484

484



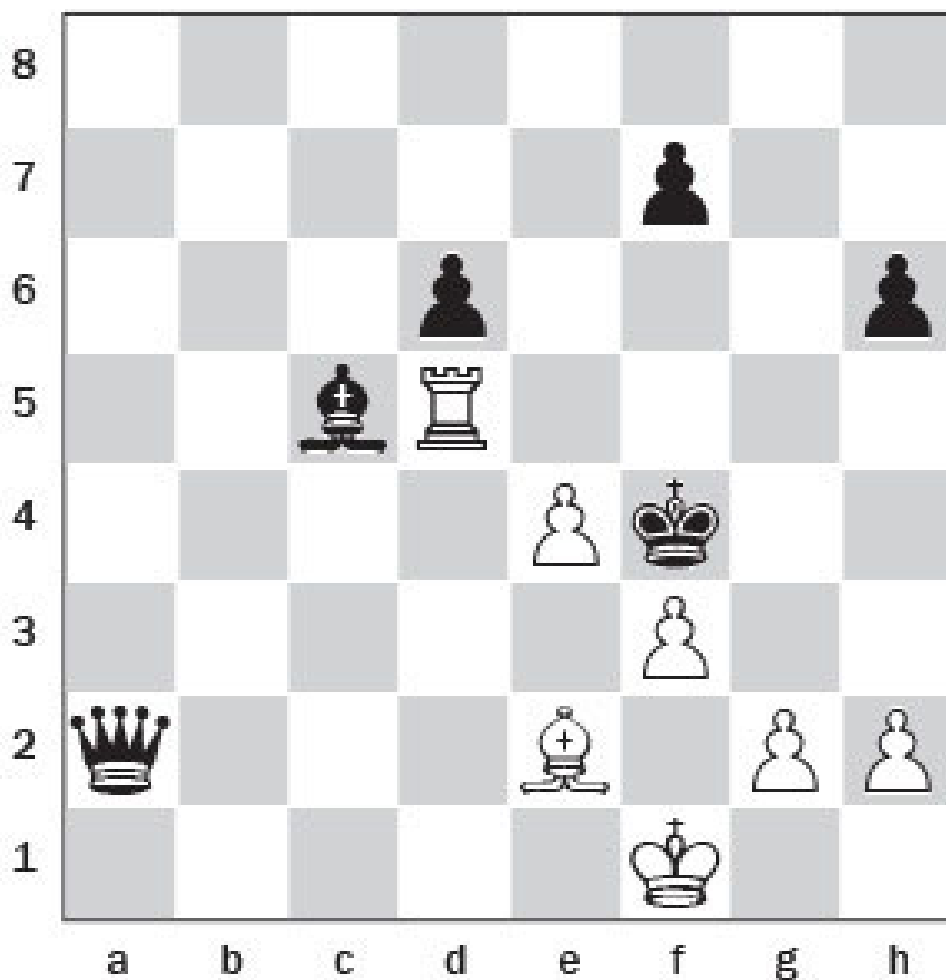
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 485

485



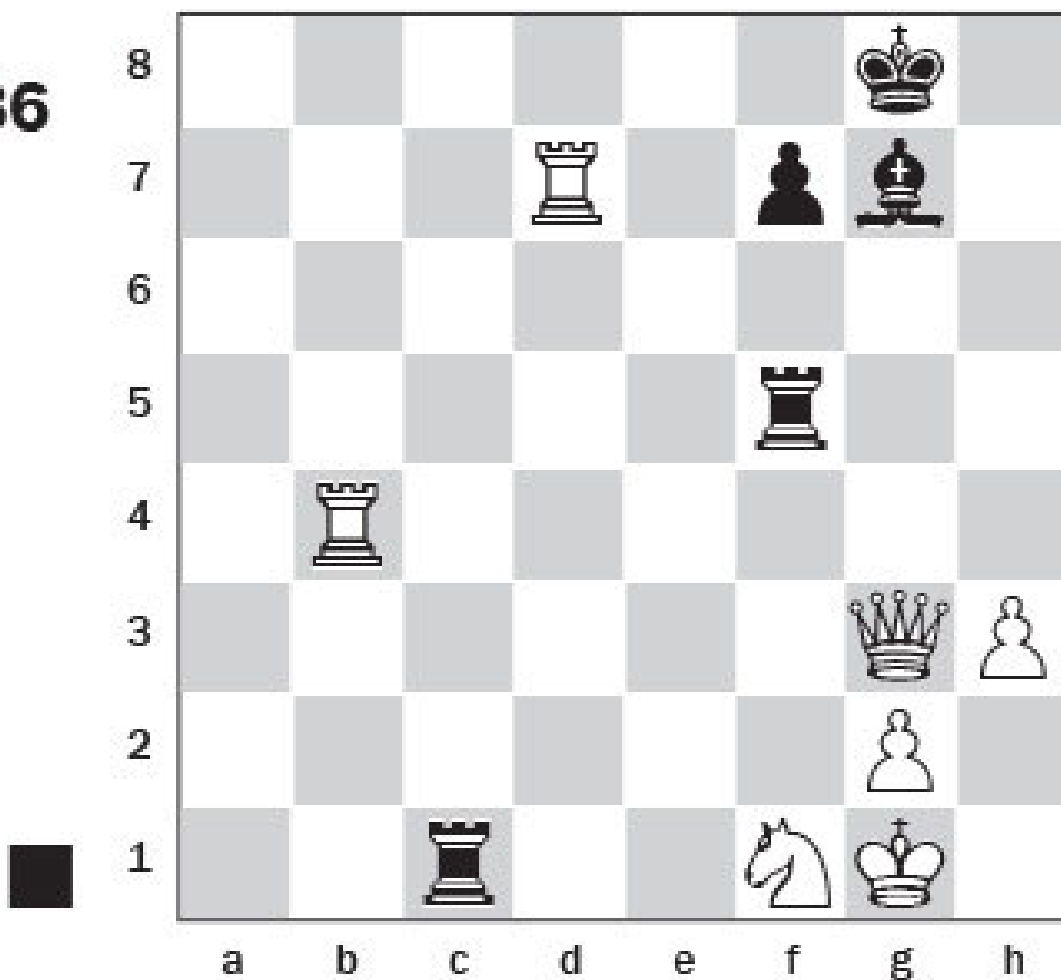
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 486

486



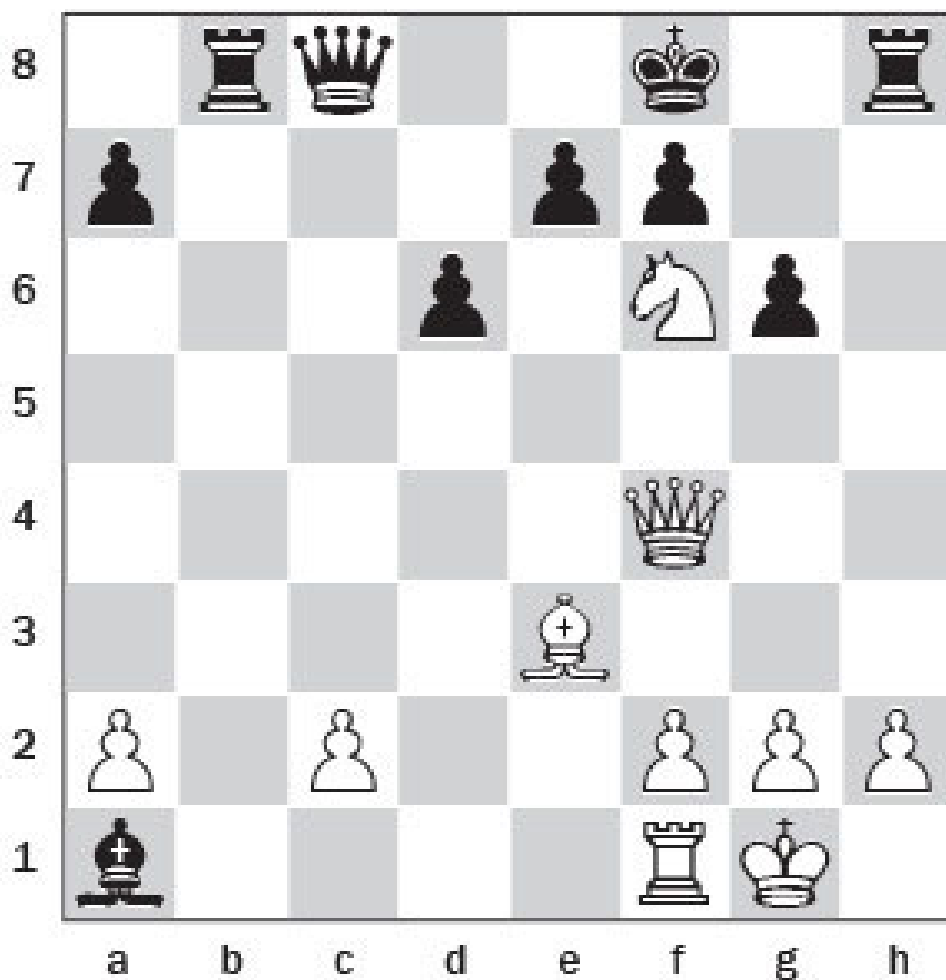
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 487

487



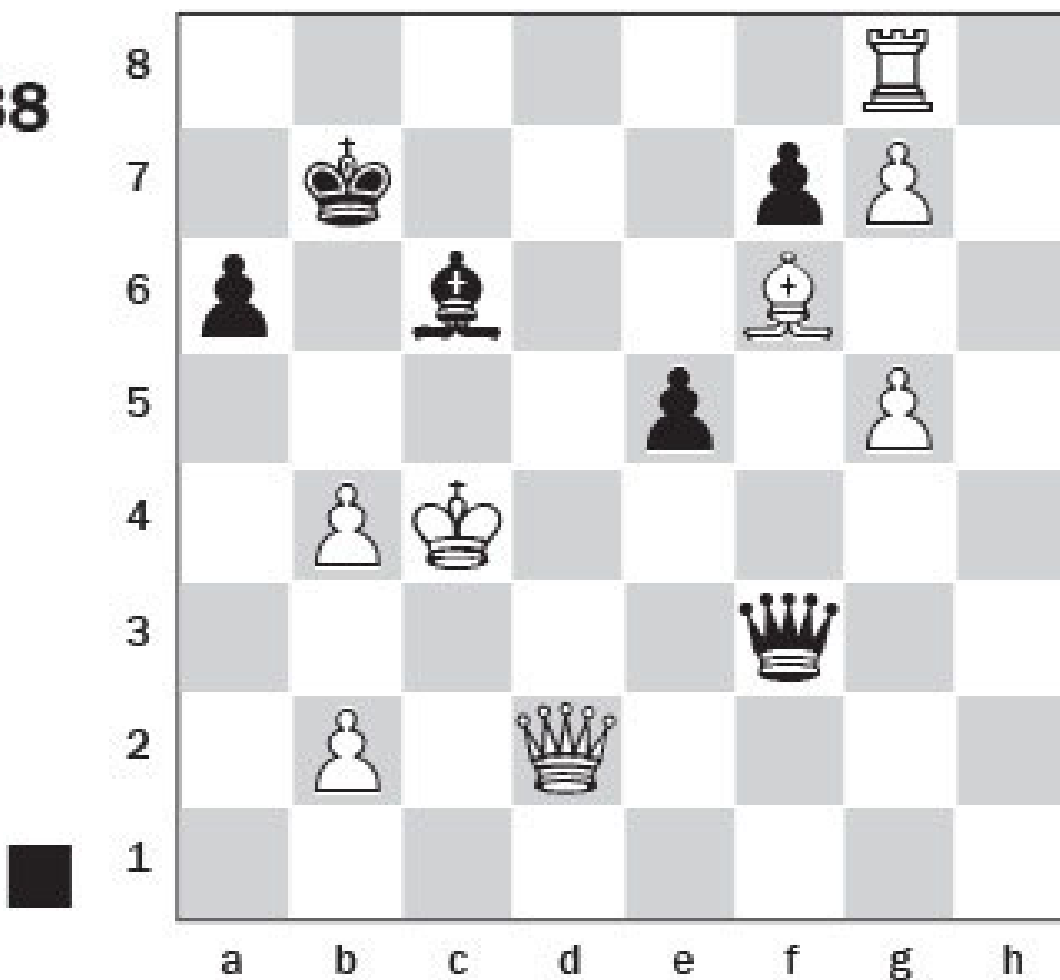
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 488

488



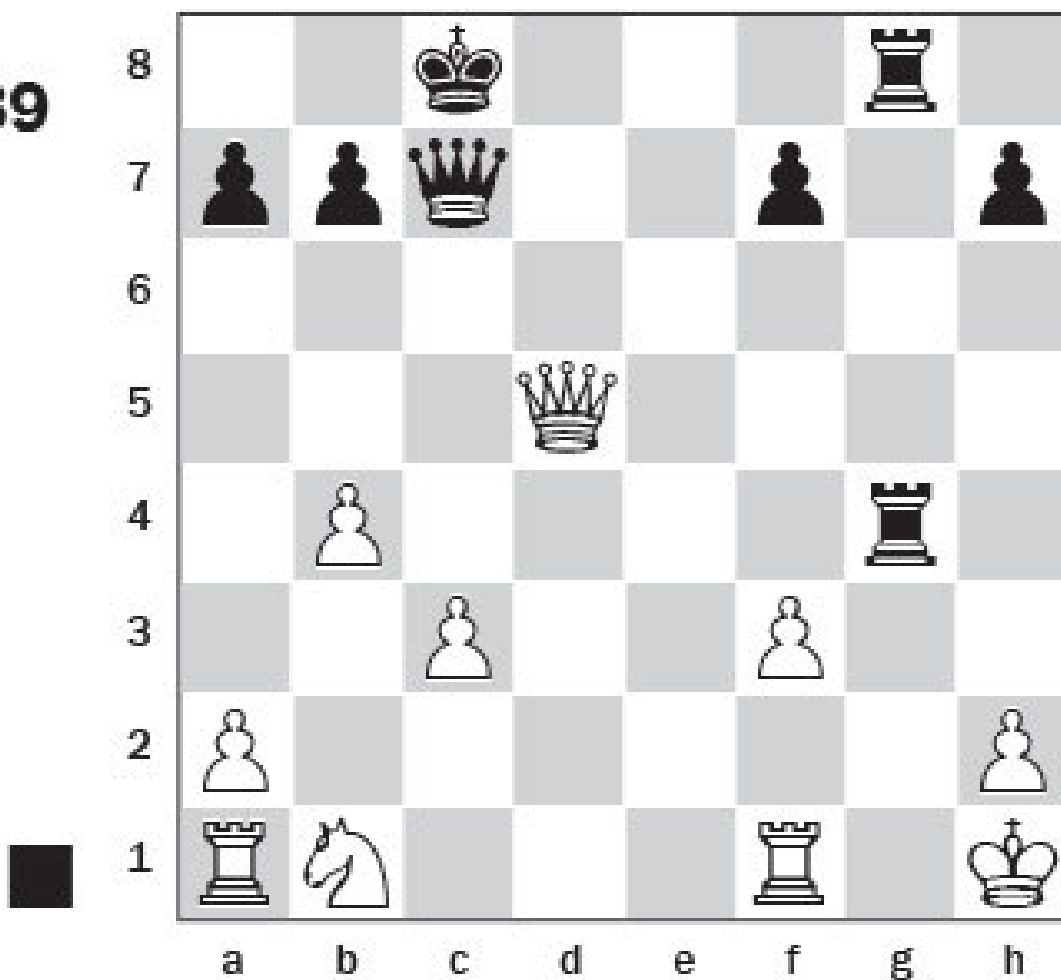
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 489

489



Answer:

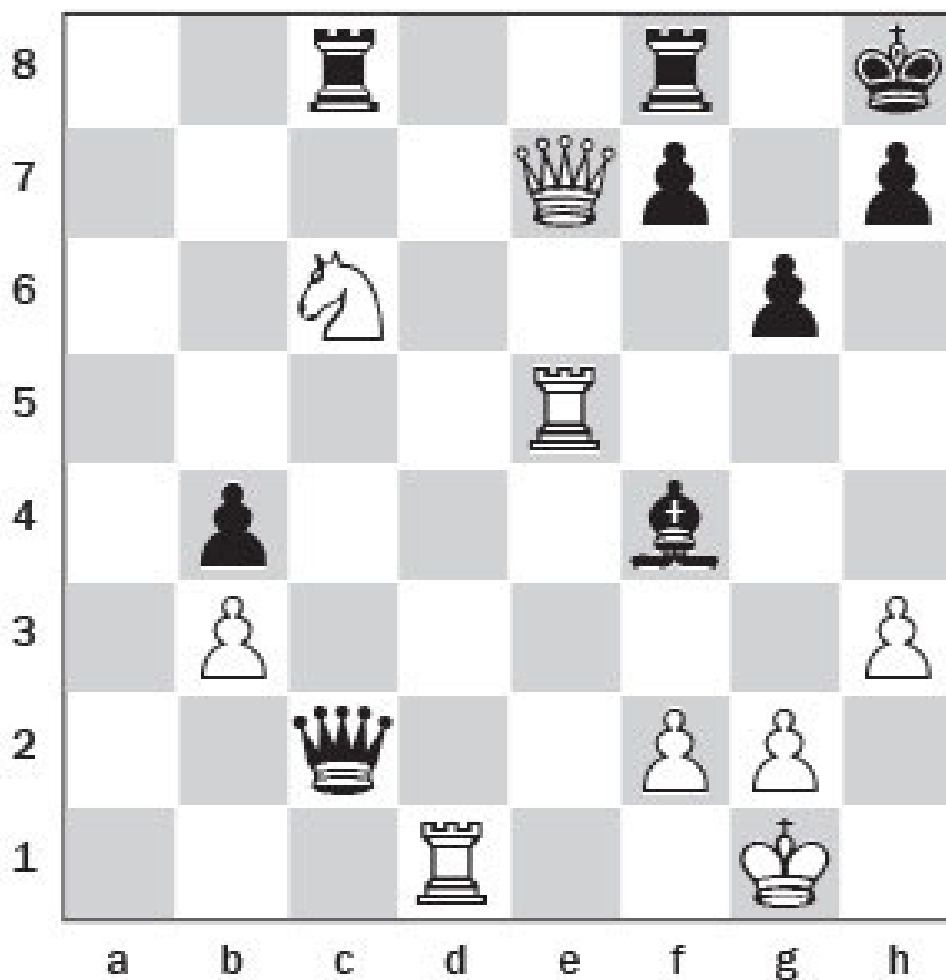
1. \_\_\_\_\_



2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 490

490



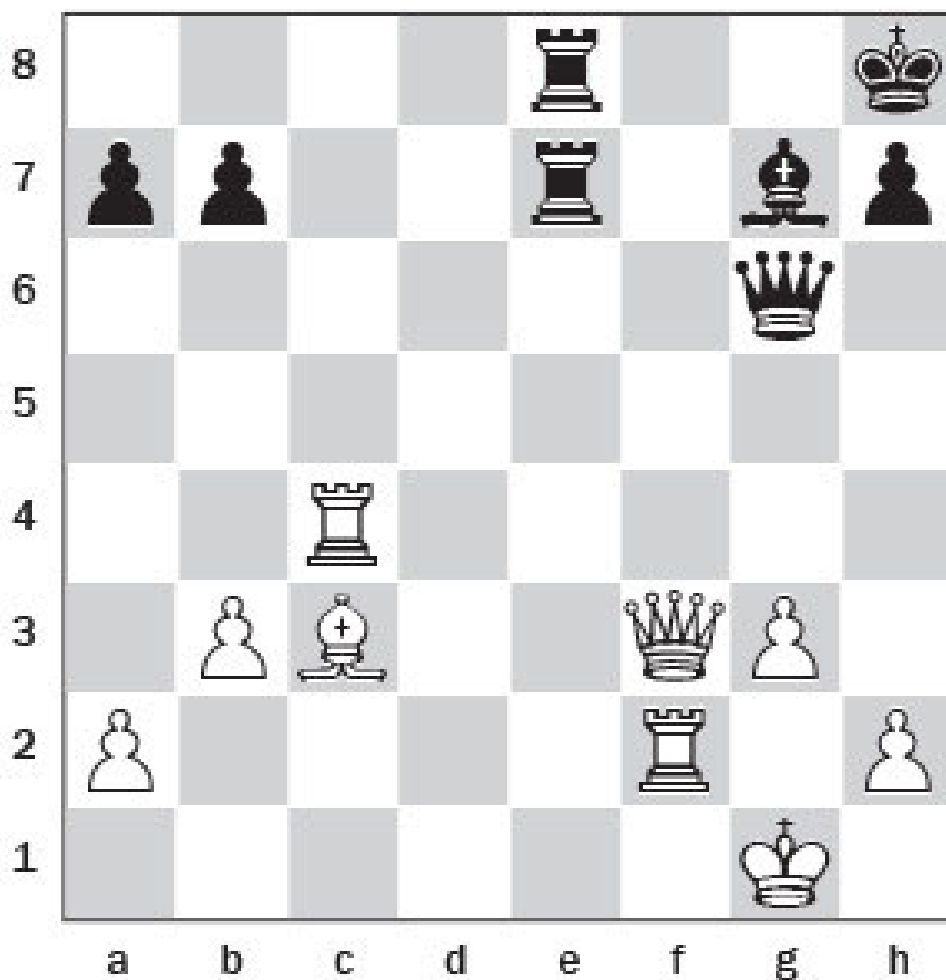
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 491

491



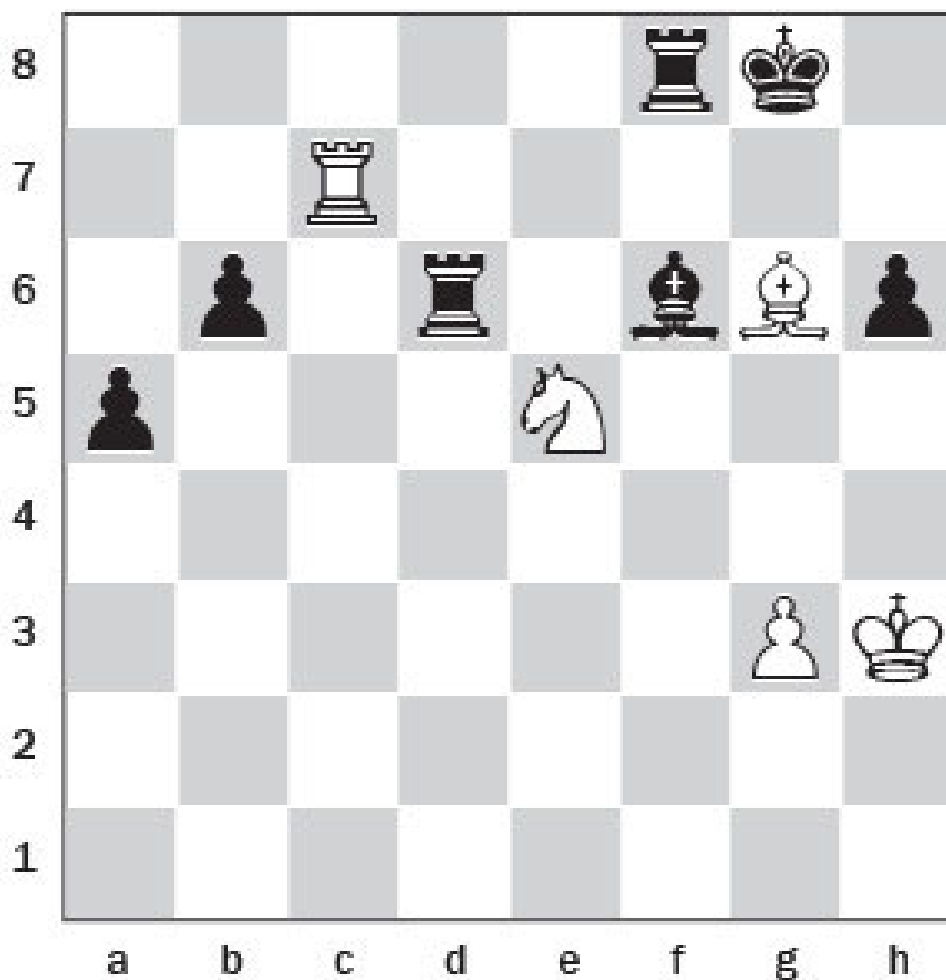
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 492

492



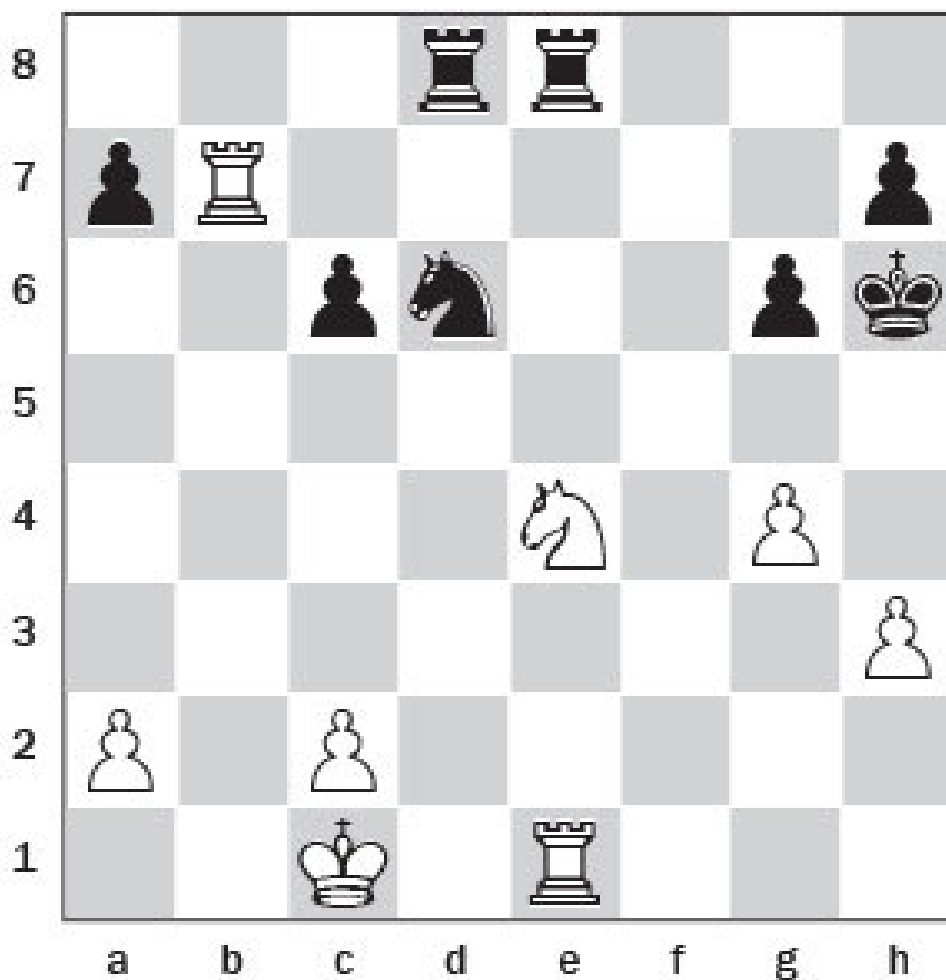
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 493

493



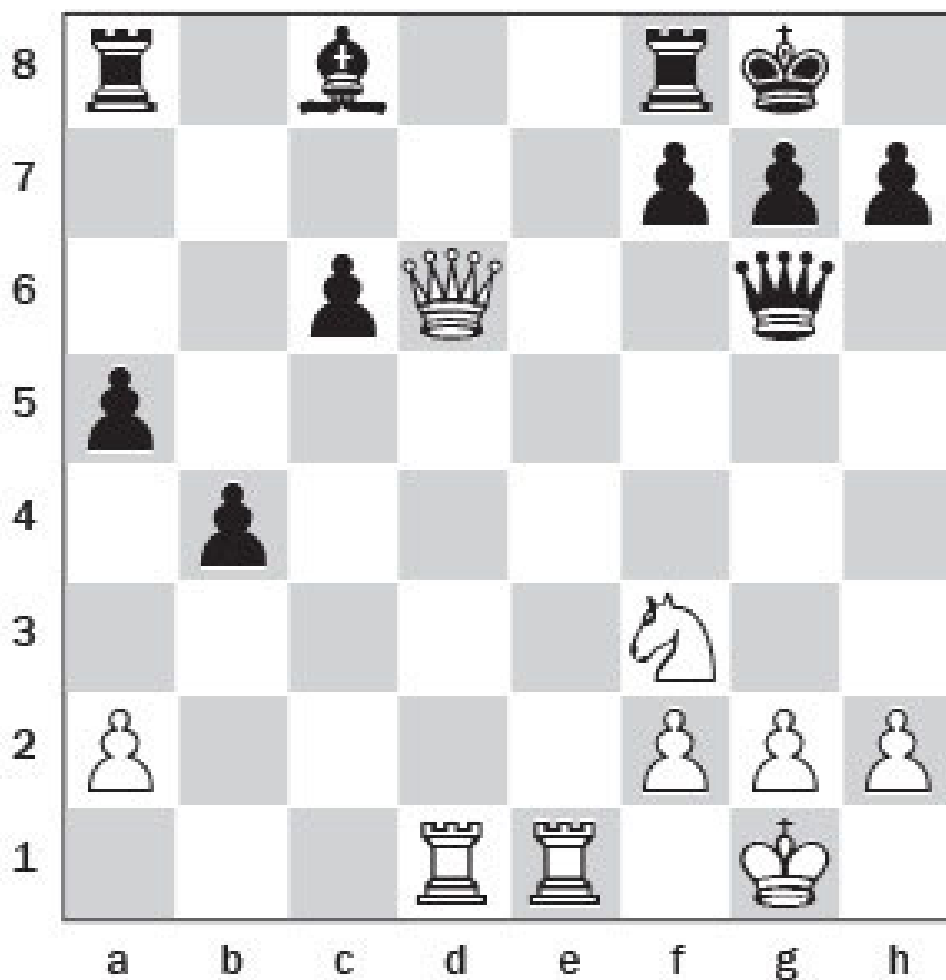
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 494

494



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

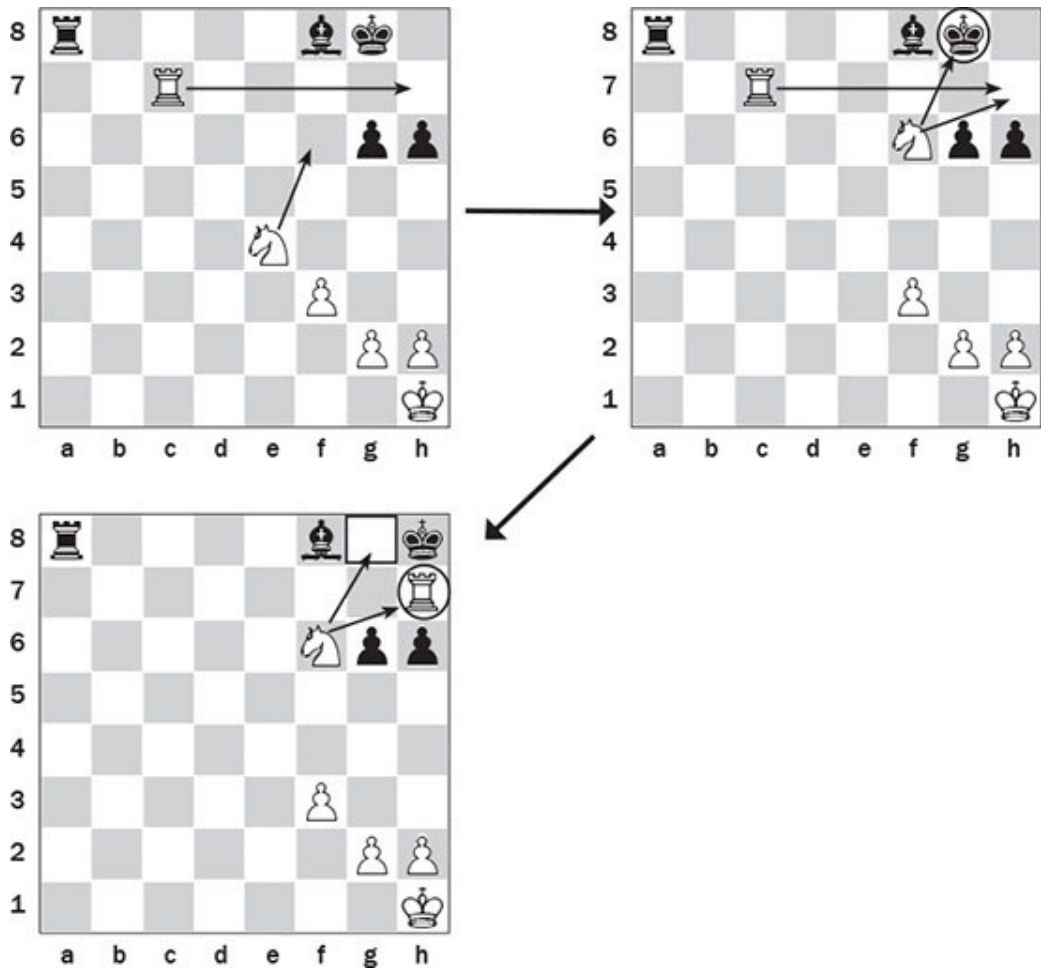
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 19

# Themed Checkmate Patterns

### Arabian Checkmate

The Arabian checkmate is a checkmate pattern which uses the knight and rook in coordination to deliver checkmate. Typically this checkmate takes place when the king is in the corner and the enemy rook is on the 2nd/7th.



Here White can checkmate Black in two moves using the Arabian checkmate pattern. White first plays:

**1.Nf6+ (see diagram 2)**

This pushes the king into the corner and now the knight assists the rook in delivering a helper checkmate.

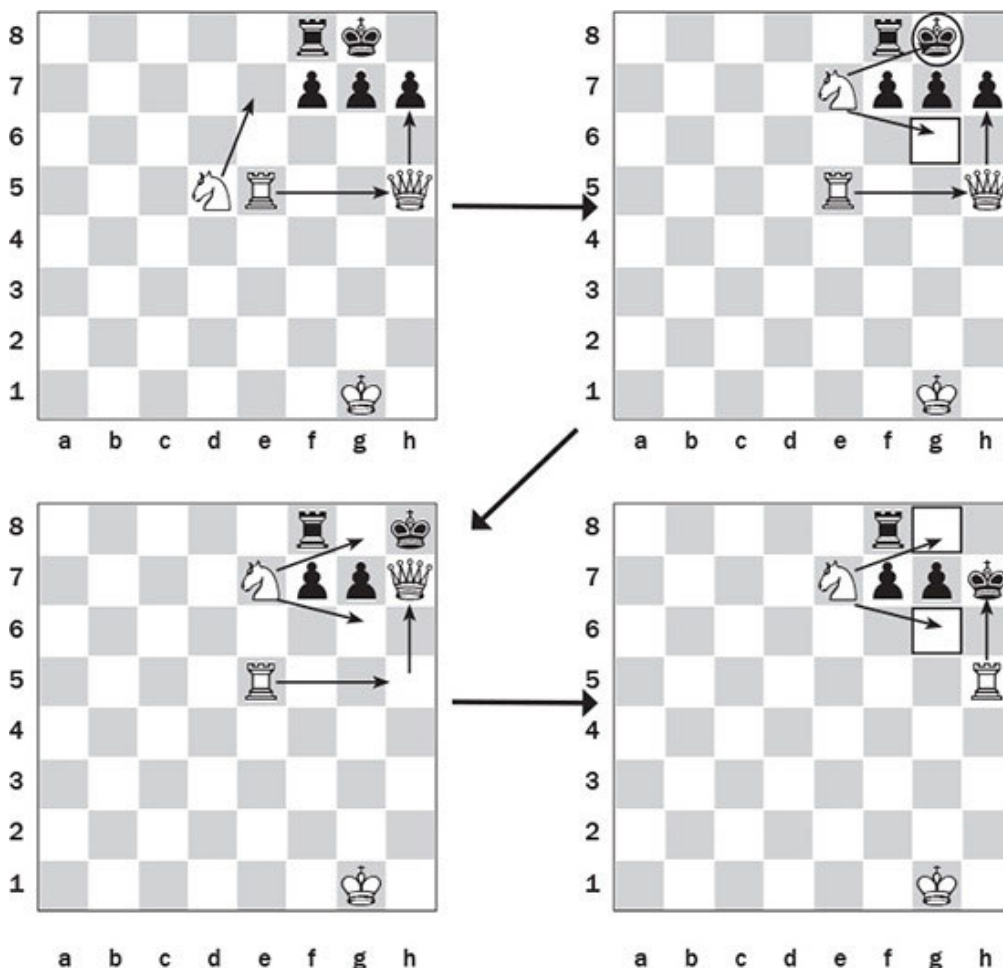
**1...Kh8 2.Rh7# (see diagram 3)**



I've assigned you five Arabian checkmate puzzles. They start easy, and then get progressively harder. Keep an eye out for the knight and rook combination!

## Anastasia's Checkmate

Anastasia's checkmate is a pattern involving a knight and rook (or queen) delivering a checkmate to king on the a- or h-file. In this pattern, typically the king is pushed to the end of the board by a knight check and then a sacrifice opens a line of attack along the file toward the king. Let's see how this looks in practice:



First White issues a check with the knight to push the king to the corner. The knight is very important as you will see in a few moves.

**1.Ne7+ (see diagram 2) 1...Kh8**

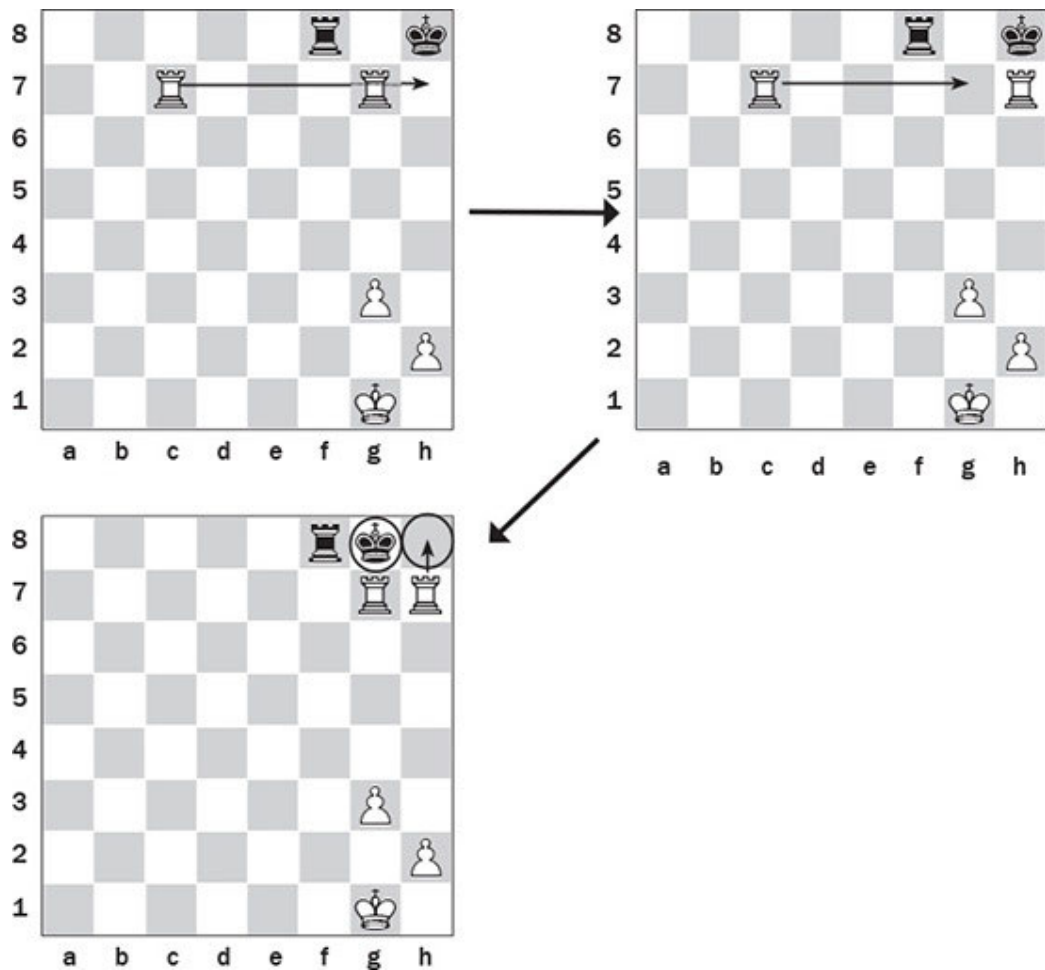
Now White sacrifices the queen to pry open the h-file:

**2.Qxh7+ (see diagram 3) 2...Kxh7 3.Rh5# (see diagram 4)**

Notice the importance of the knight on e7. If it were not for the knight on e7 Black's king would be able to escape to the g8- or g6-square. This is a very fun checkmate to play since often times you are able to sacrifice your queen! I've devoted five problems to Anastasia's Checkmate. Each one gets progressively harder but once you recognize the pattern, you will be able to see it coming several moves ahead!

## **Blind Swine Checkmate**

The blind swine checkmate is when a pair of rooks on the 2nd or 7th rank deliver checkmate against the king. When two rooks are aligned in a battery on the 2nd or 7th ranks, they can be extremely strong! White can force a checkmate in two moves with the right sequence of moves.

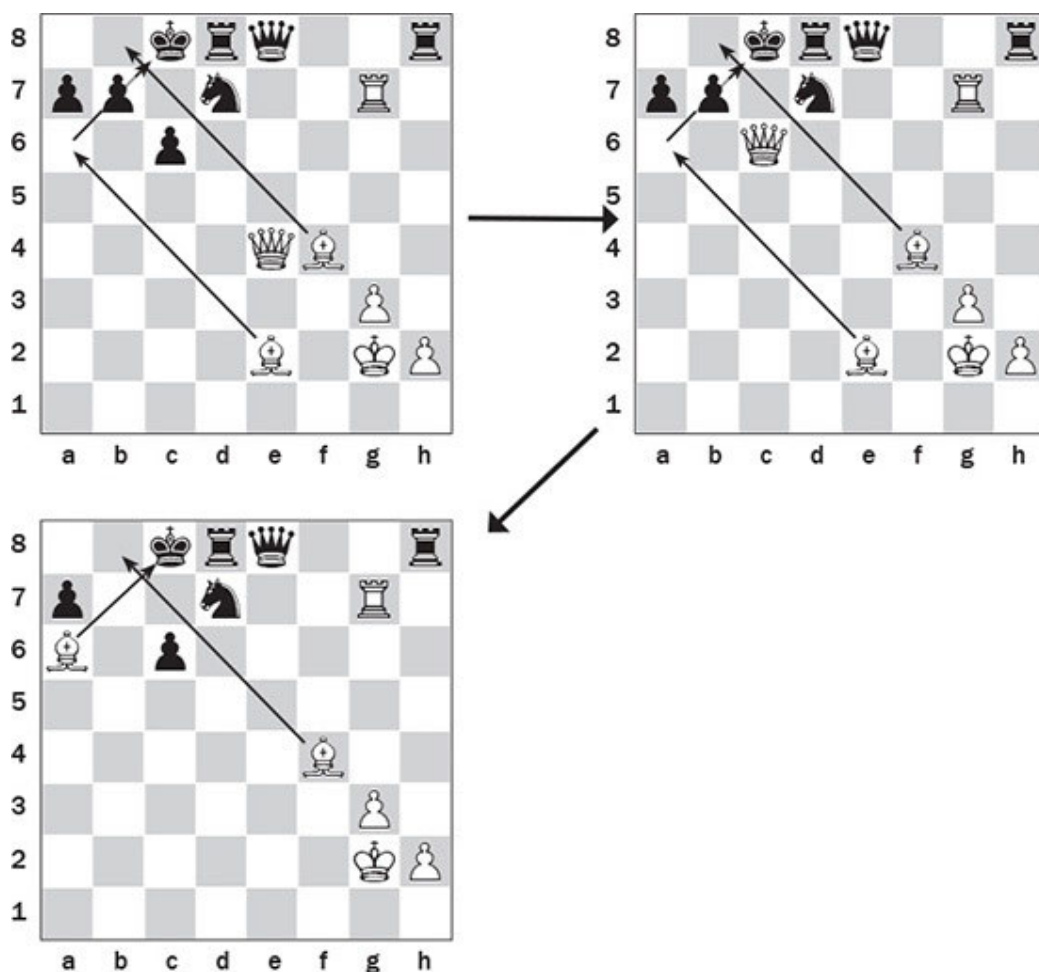


**1.Rh7+ (see diagram 2) 1...Kg8 2.Rcg7# (see diagram 3)**

Notice that the black king cannot continue to run since its own piece, the rook, is obstructing its flight squares. This is an extremely common type of blind swine checkmate. This checkmate pattern happens quite often in chess games and it's useful to grow comfortable with the pattern. I have devoted five problems to this theme.

## **Boden's Checkmate**

Boden's checkmate is a pattern where the king gets caught in the crossfire of two bishops. Usually the king's own pieces are blocking some of the escape squares that the bishops do not attack. This checkmate is named after Samuel Boden (1826-1882). This checkmate typically starts with a sacrifice to open up the position of the king. This checkmate may also be referred to as the 'criss-cross checkmate' since the bishops form an x-like attack around the the king. Let's see this checkmate in action:



White's bishop on f4 is an extremely strong piece which cuts through the black king's position. White recognized that if the a6-c8 diagonal was open, there would be a 'Boden's checkmate' pattern. So first White sacrifices the queen to open up the diagonal!

## **1.Qxc6+ (see diagram 2)**

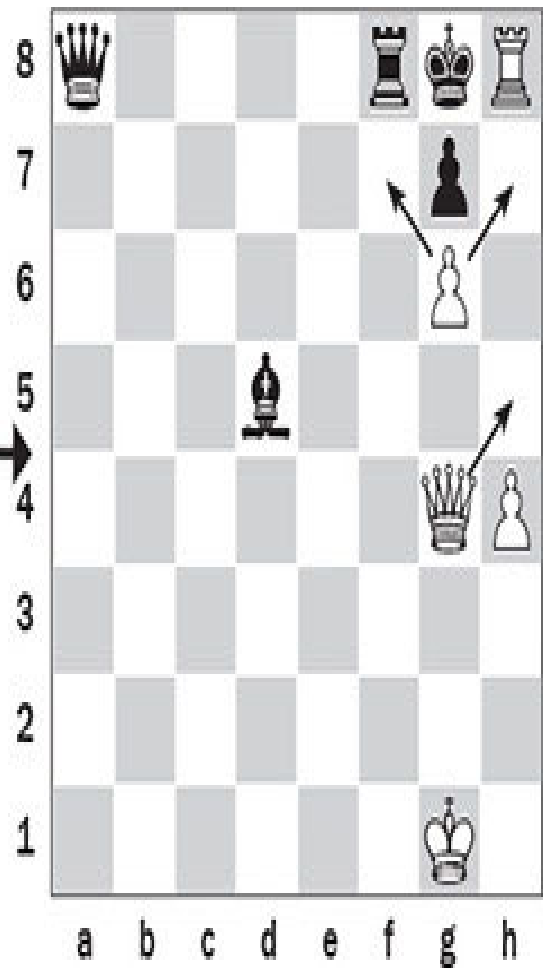
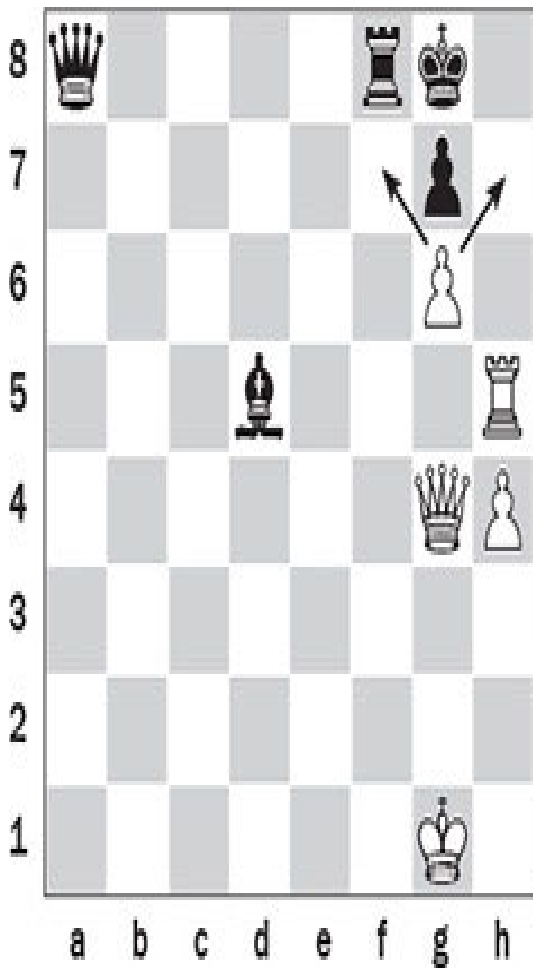
Black has no choice but to capture the queen.

## **1...bxc6 2.Ba6# (see diagram 3)**

White is able to finish the game with Boden's checkmate. This is a pattern worth knowing in chess. It's not overly common, but it certainly does happen. I have devoted five puzzles to this particular topic.

## **Damiano's Checkmate**

Damiano's checkmate is when a pawn is wedged into the kingside and used as support to bring the queen in for a checkmate. In most cases, a rook sacrifice is made first to bring the king into the open, so that the queen is able to come in with a check (tempo). This checkmate is named after Pedro Damiano (1480-1544).

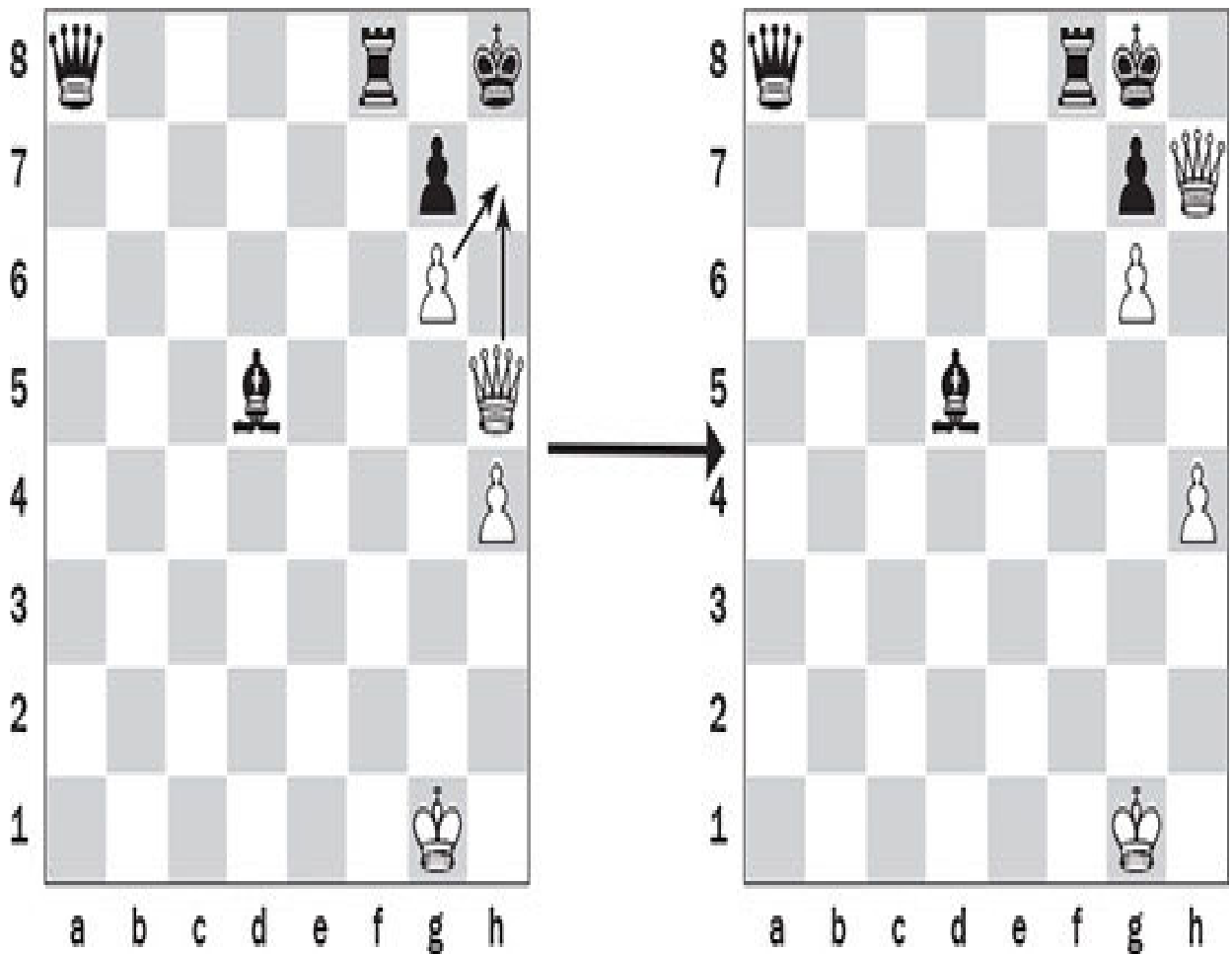


White noticed that if the queen could get to the h7-square that would be checkmate thanks to the pawn on g6. First White sacrifices the rook to bring the king to the open file and allow the queen to take the rook's spot.

### 1.Rh8+ (see diagram 2)

This type of move, luring a piece to a square so that it can be taken advantage of is called an 'attraction' tactic.

**1...Kxh8 2.Qh5+ (see diagram 3 on the next page)**



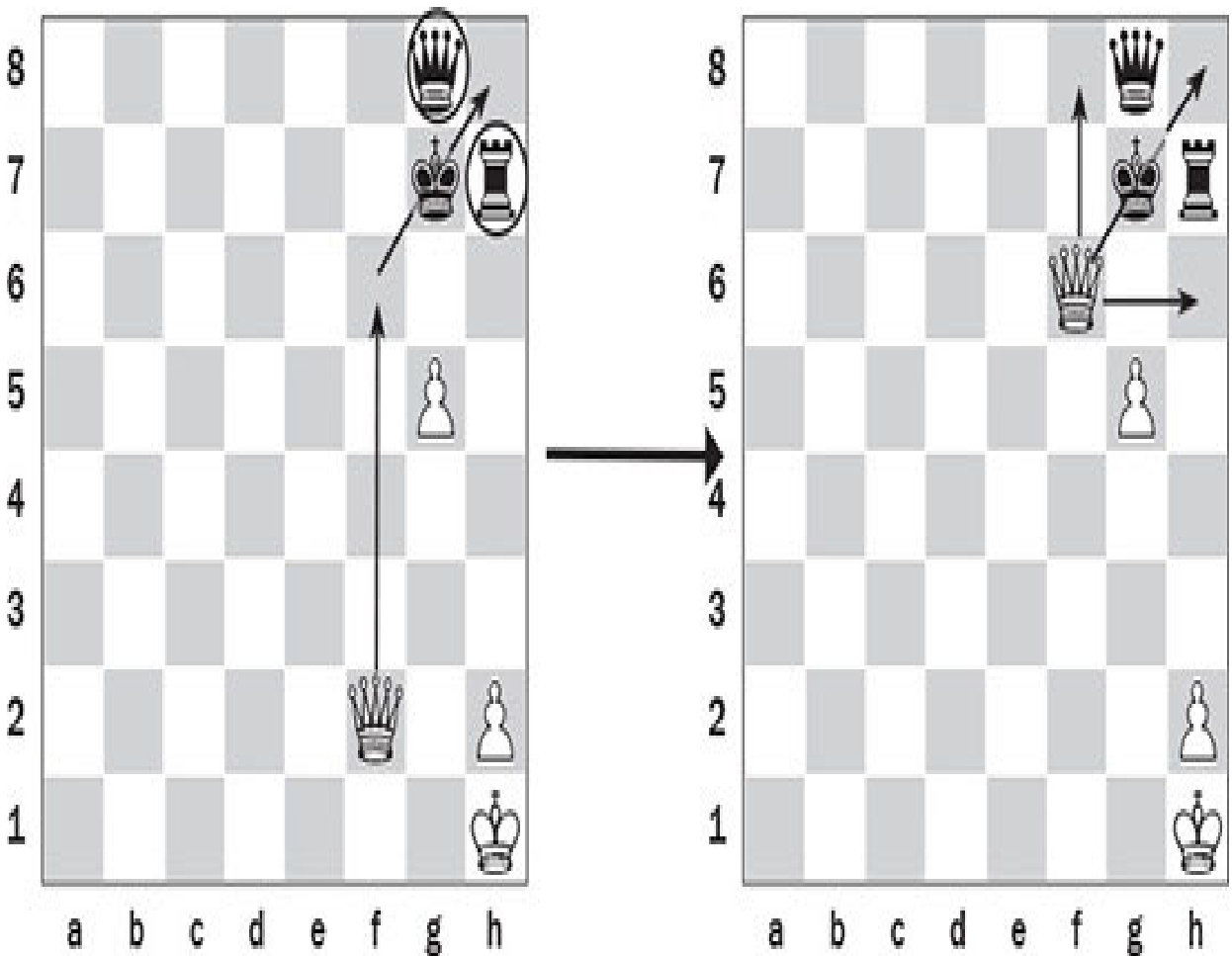
Now the queen is able to come over with check. Black is forced to move the king but then checkmate will follow.

**2...Kg8 3.Qh7# (see diagram 4)**

This is a very common type of pattern and certainly a useful one to know. I have devoted five puzzles to Damiano's checkmate.

## Dovetail Checkmate

A dovetail checkmate occurs when the enemy queen attacks the king one square away on a diagonal and the king's flight squares are blocked by his own pieces. Sometimes this checkmate is known as Cozio's checkmate.



White's pawn on g5 supports the queen to f6. Once the queen arrives on the f6- square, Black's own queen and rook will be blocking his king from escaping.

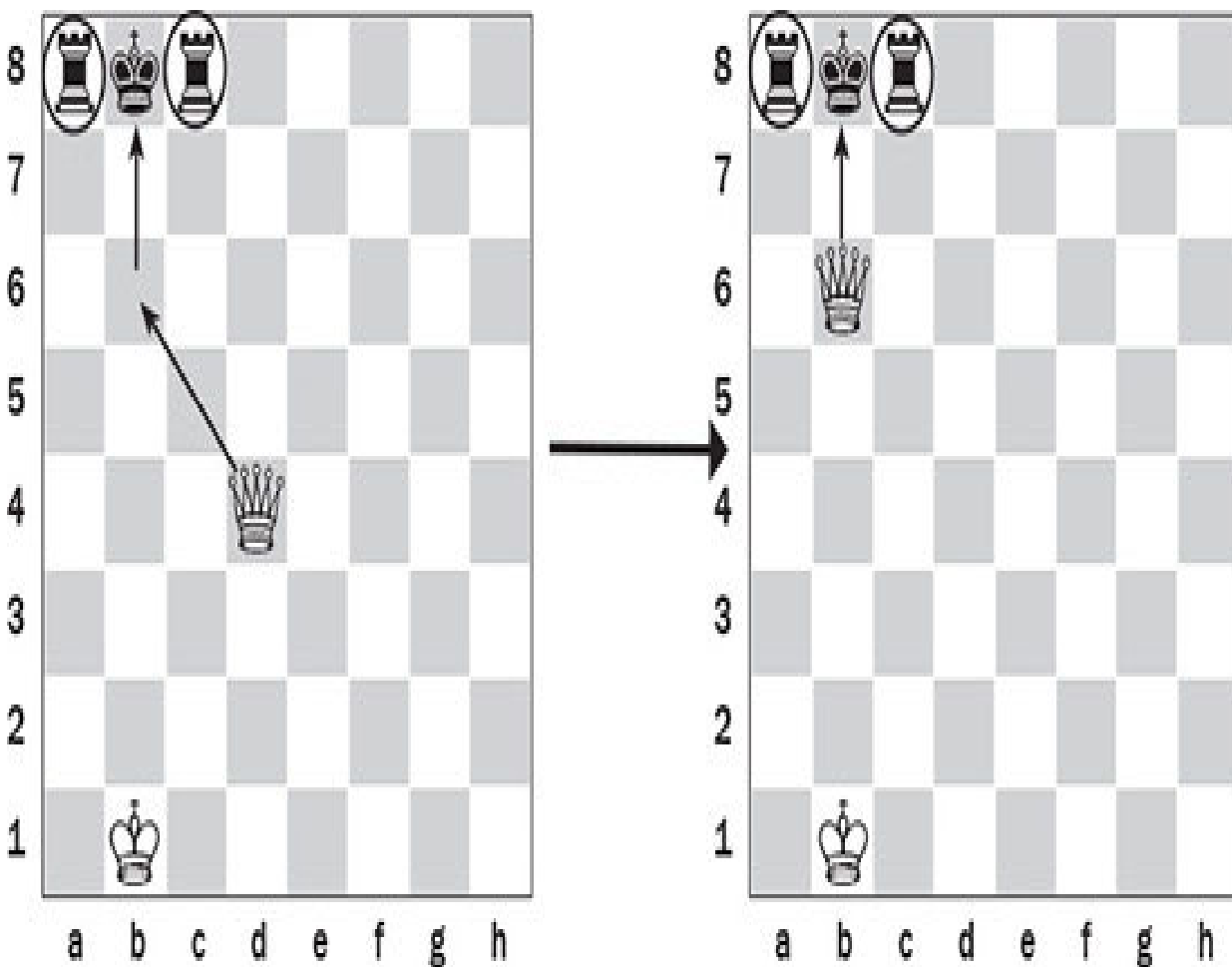


## 1.Qf6# (see diagram 2)

I have devoted five problems to the dovetail checkmate.

### Epaulette Checkmate

The epaulette checkmate is a checkmate where two parallel flight squares prevent the king's escape. The most common type of epaulette checkmate is seen in the following example.



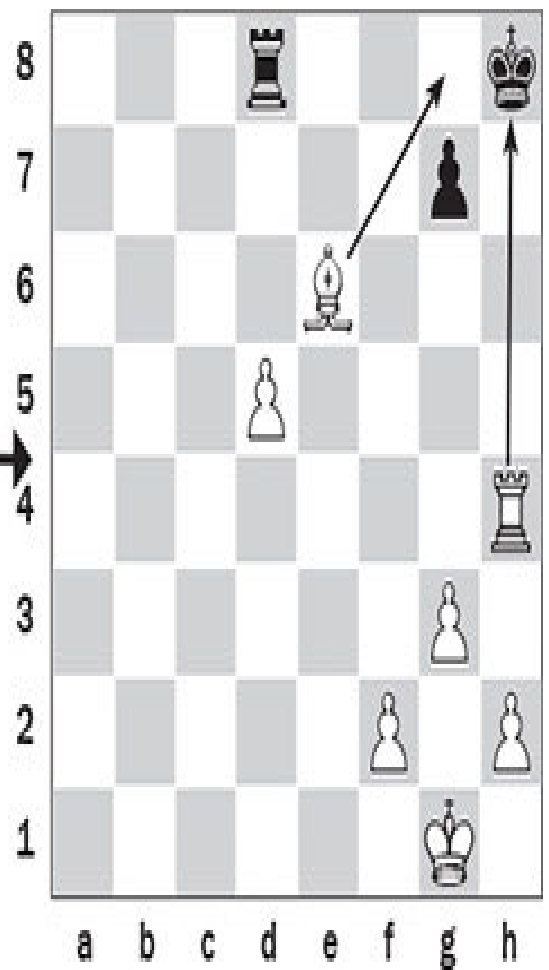
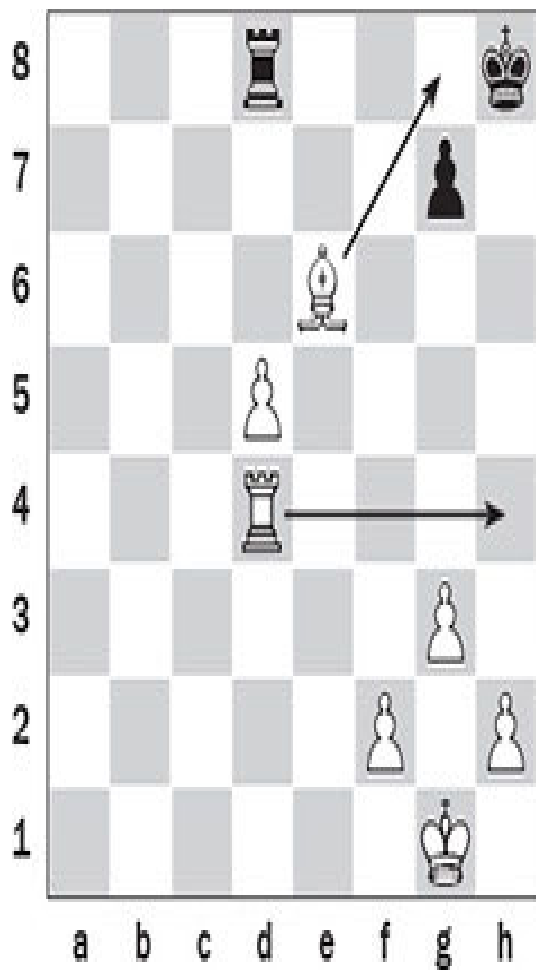
Black's two rooks are taking away the a8- and c8-squares from the king. This sets up a classic epaulette checkmate:

**1.Qb6# (see diagram 2)**

Since the black rooks prevent the black king's mobility, White found the perfect way to attack the king where they can not assist in the defence. I have devoted five problems to the epaulette checkmate.

## **Greco's Checkmate**

Greco's checkmate is characterized by using a bishop to stop the king from escaping the corner, then a checkmate is given by a rook or a queen along the flank (side) of the board. This checkmate is named after Gioacchino Greco (1600-1634).



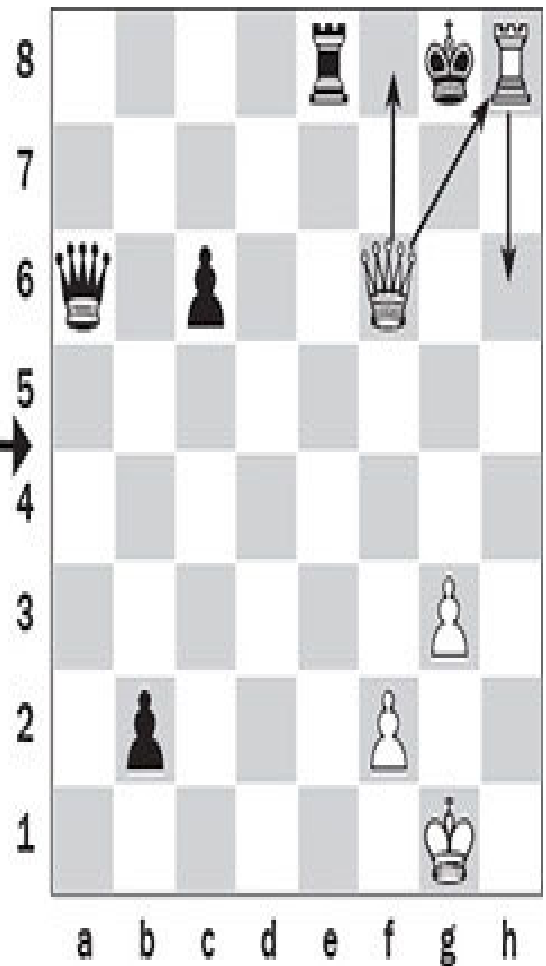
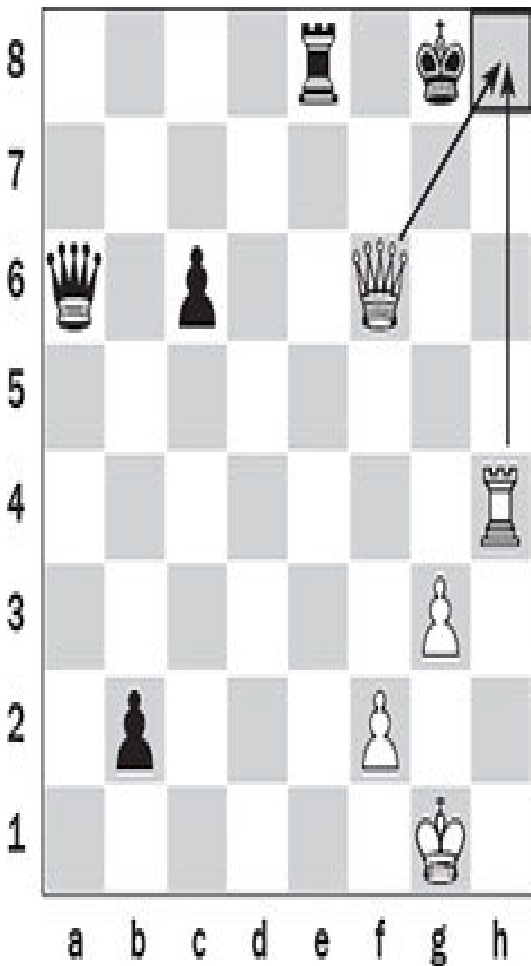
Notice that the bishop on e6 is stopping the king from escaping toward the center. Now White needs to issue an attack along the h-file to finish the game.

### 1.Rh4# (see diagram 2)

This is a basic example of Greco's checkmate. This is a very common pattern in chess and is important to learn. I have devoted five problems to Greco's checkmate.

## Kill Box Checkmate

The kill box checkmate is a pattern which occurs when the queen and rook work together to checkmate the king. Usually, the rook is being protected by the queen forming a box around the king. White's queen supports the rook to go to h8 for checkmate. Once the rook is on h8, the queen and rook form a box around the king, stopping the king from escaping.



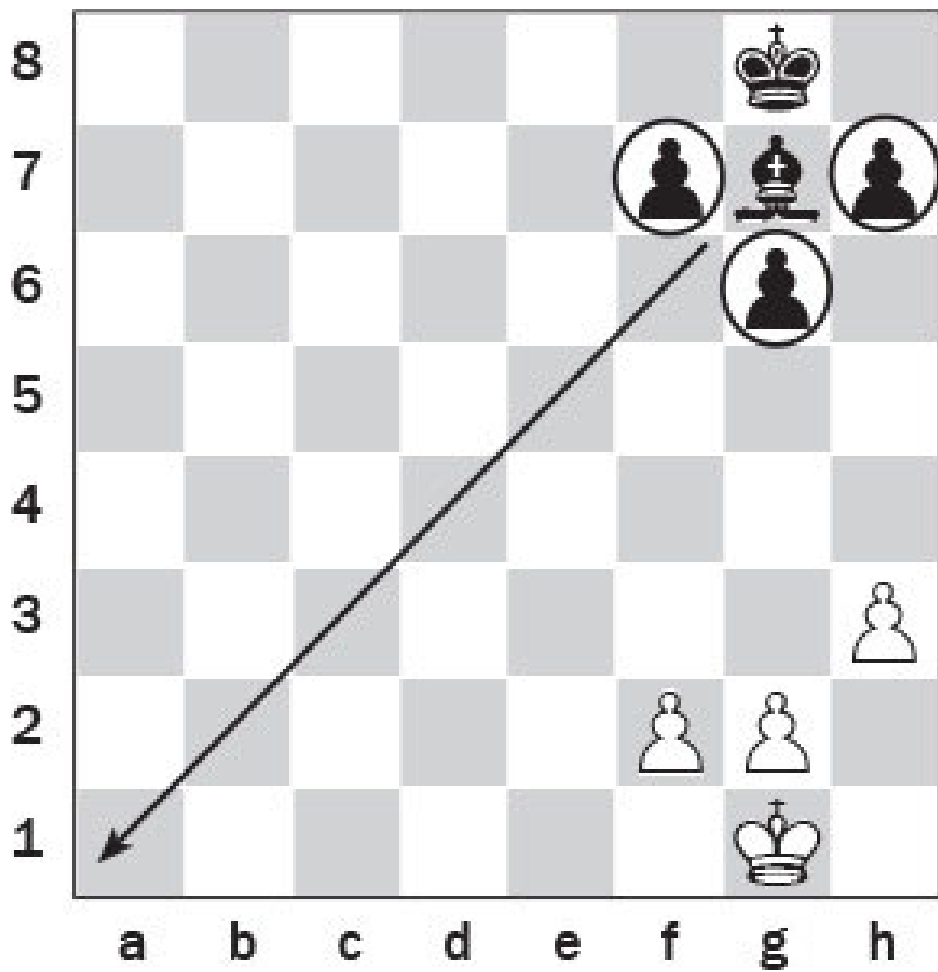
1.Rh8# (see diagram 2)

## Lolli's Checkmate

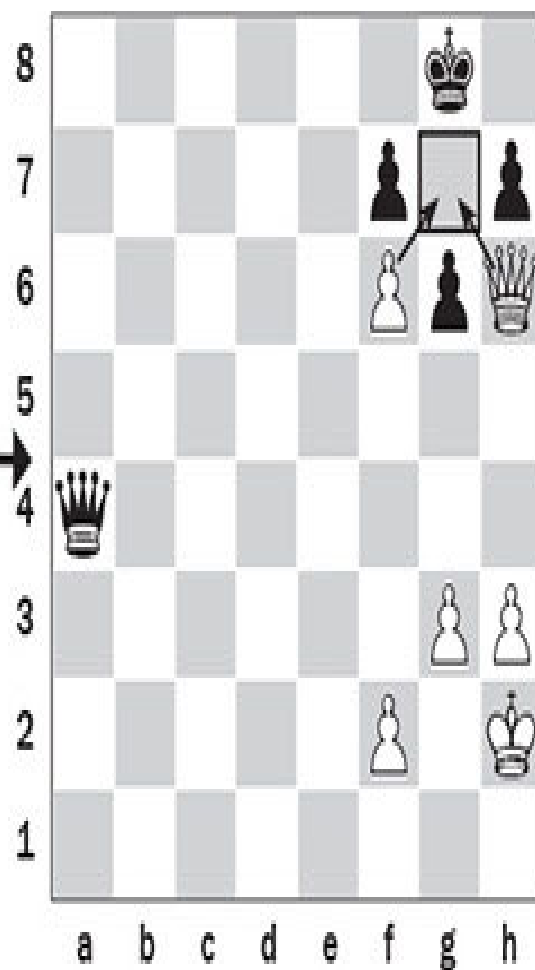
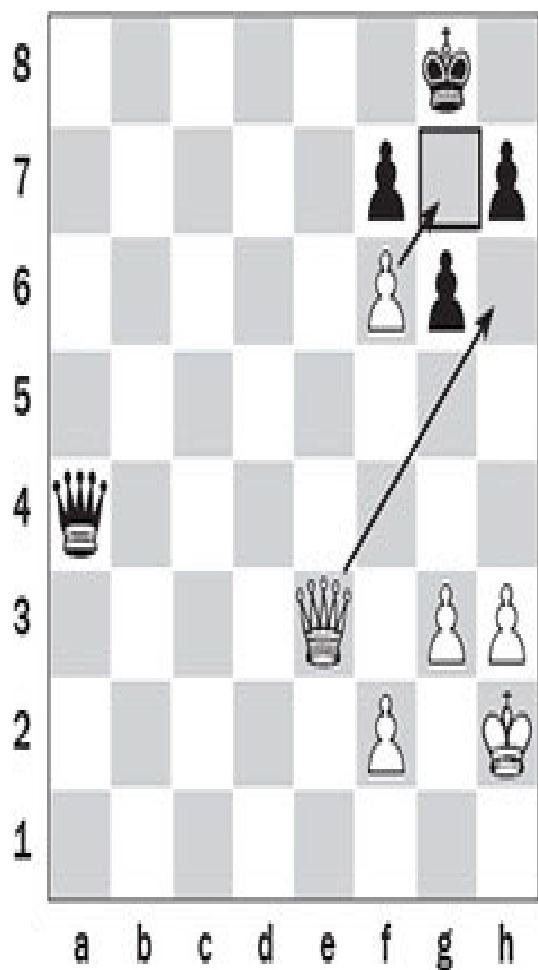
Lolli's checkmate is a checkmate pattern which uses both the queen and the pawn to checkmate the king. Usually, Lolli's Checkmate involves invading the fianchetto position. Lolli's Checkmate is named after Giambattista Lolli (1698-1769).

Note to the student: a fianchetto is a method of getting your bishop into the game on the longest diagonal of the chess board. Sometimes people see it as the top of a house. When the bishop is removed from the fianchetto position, the empty squares can be really weak. We are going to see that in this checkmate pattern!

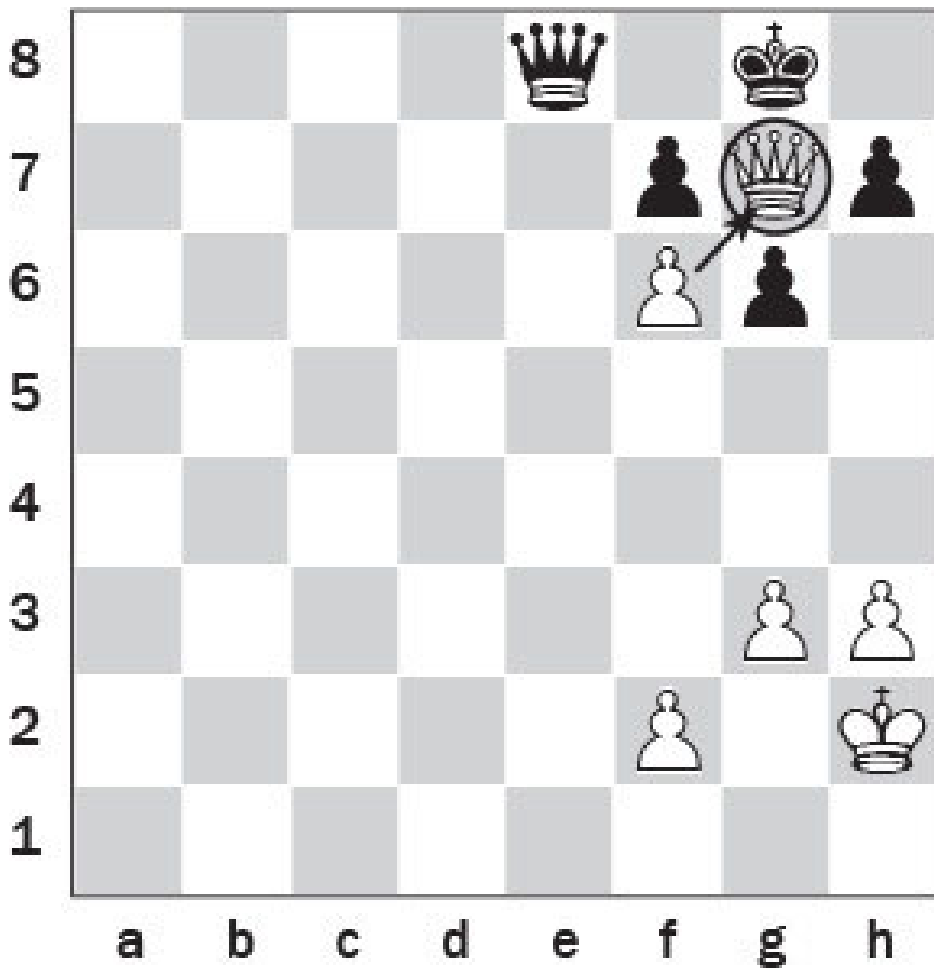
Example of fianchetto structure:



Example of Loli's mate:



1.Qh6 (see diagram 2) 1...Qe8 2.Qg7# (see diagram 3 on the next page)

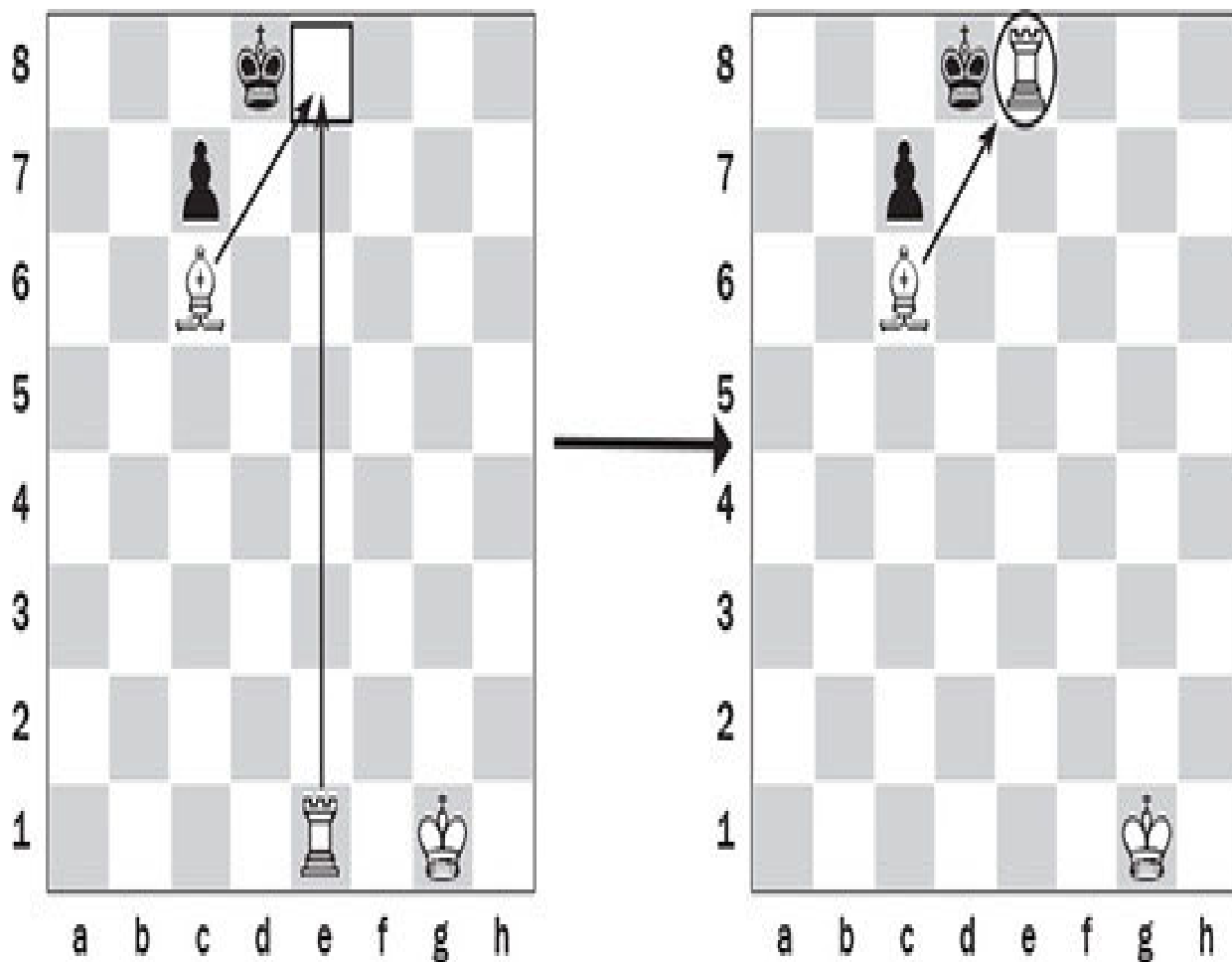


Lolli's Checkmate is quite common and you should be familiar with the pattern. I've assigned you five Lolli's checkmate puzzles.

## Opera House Checkmate

The Opera House checkmate is a coordinated attack on the king using a bishop and a rook. It gets its name from a the classic chess game between Paul Morphy against the Duke Karl of Brunswick and Count Isouard (1858).





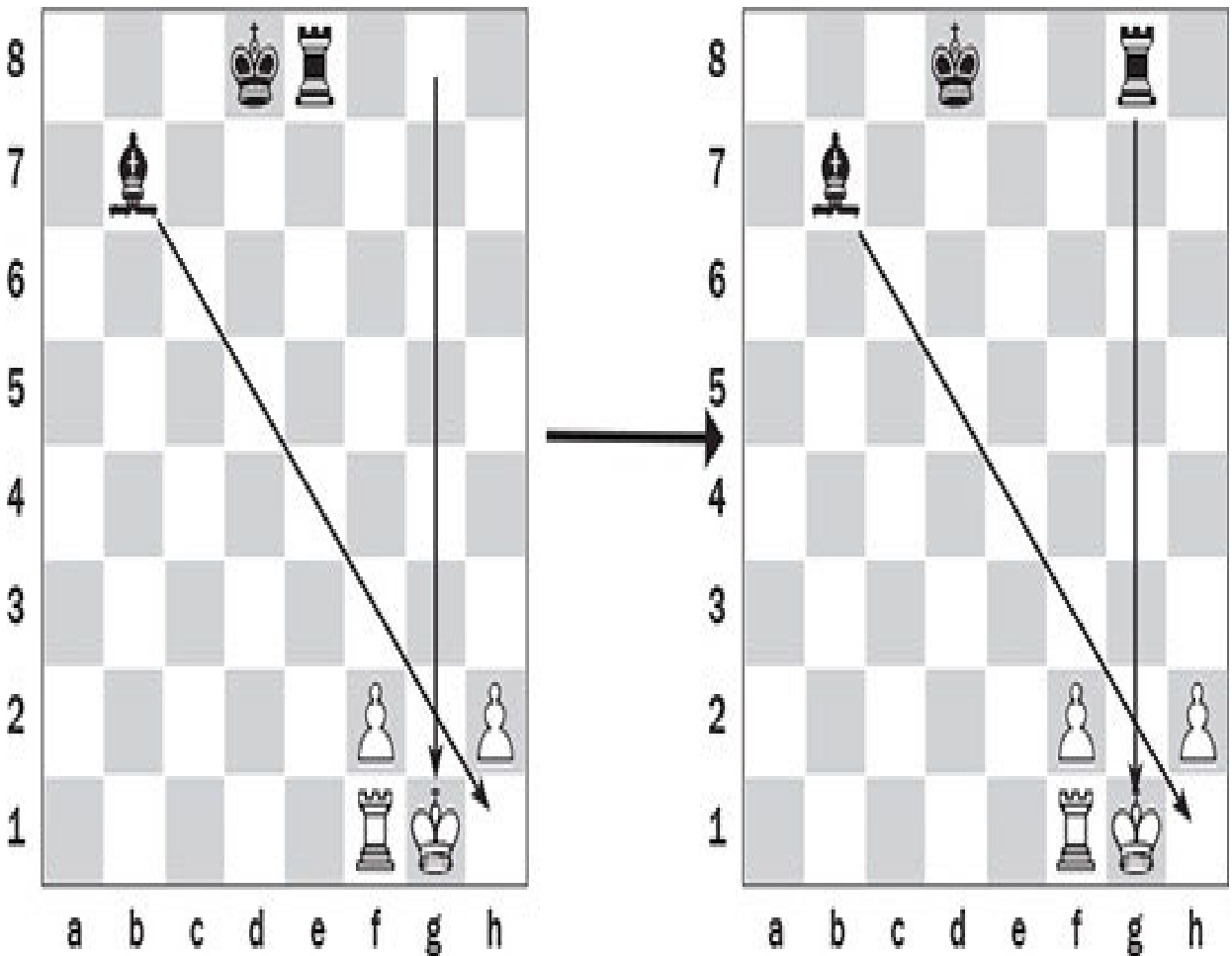
White's bishop and rook are both controlling the vital e8-square.  
White is able to play

### 1.Re8# (see diagram 2)

... which ends the game with checkmate. This, of course, is a very simple example of the Opera House checkmate but one that illustrates the basic concept. I have devoted five problems to this checkmate and included a fragment from the famous Opera House game!

## Pillsbury's Checkmate

Pillsbury's checkmate is a checkmate pattern where a rook attacks the king from afar while the bishop cuts off the diagonal flight square. This checkmate is named after Harry Nelson Pillsbury (1872-1906).



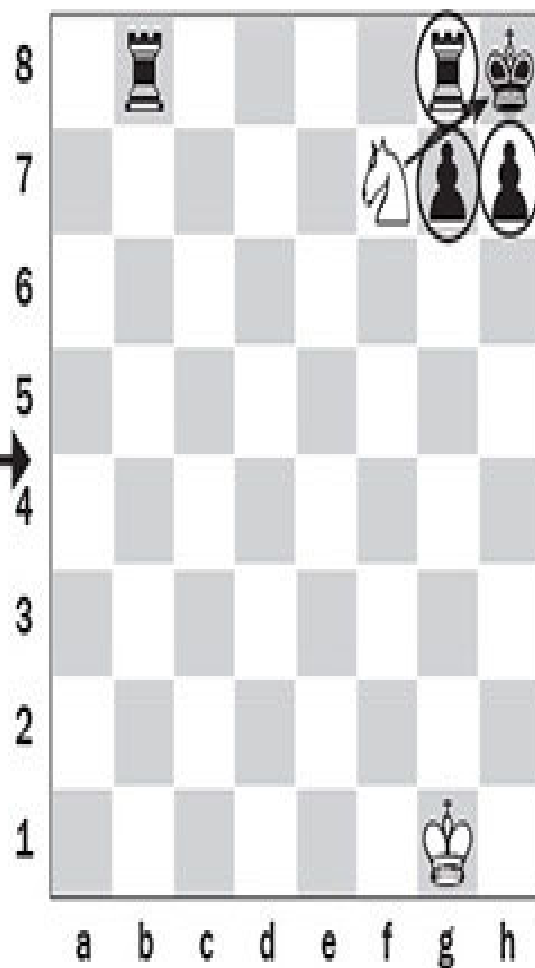
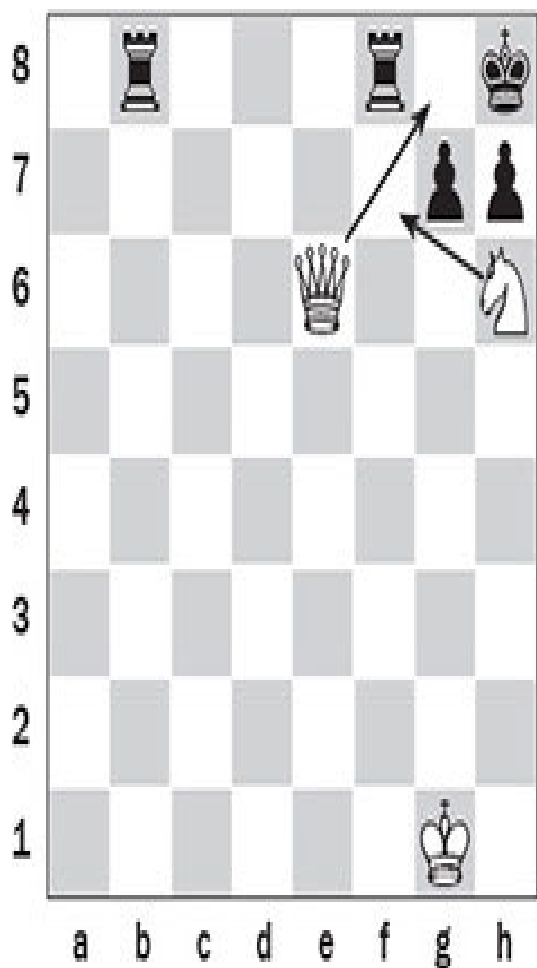
The bishop on b7 is controlling the key a8-h1 diagonal which cuts through the heart of White's position. Black can slide the rook over to g8 to deliver a checkmate:

## **1...Rg8# (see diagram 2)**

As you will see from the example problems in this section, Pillsbury's checkmate is often set up by using a discovery. I have devoted five problems to this theme.

### **Smothered Checkmate**

Smothered checkmate is a very common checkmating pattern. This checkmate occurs when the king is surrounded by its own pieces and an enemy knight delivers the checkmate. I have a funny story about this checkmate which I would like to share with you. I was about 1300 at the time, and was playing one of my first ever open tournaments (where adults can play too). To make a long story short, the pattern came up in my game. I had a position similar to the one in the diagram and was thinking about what my next move would be. To my great surprise, my opponent reached out to shake my hand and resigned the game. He proceed to show me the smothered checkmate pattern. Here's the catch: I didn't know it! Let's just say, I learned the smothered checkmate by not playing it, lucky me!



In the following position, Black's king is not yet smothered. White sets up the pattern by first sacrificing the queen to smother the king. Let's see:

**1.Qg8+**

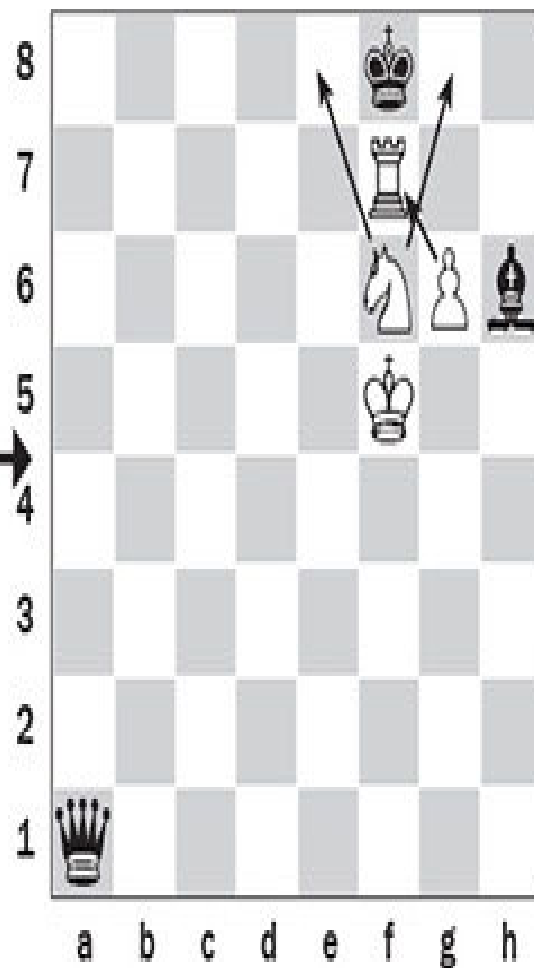
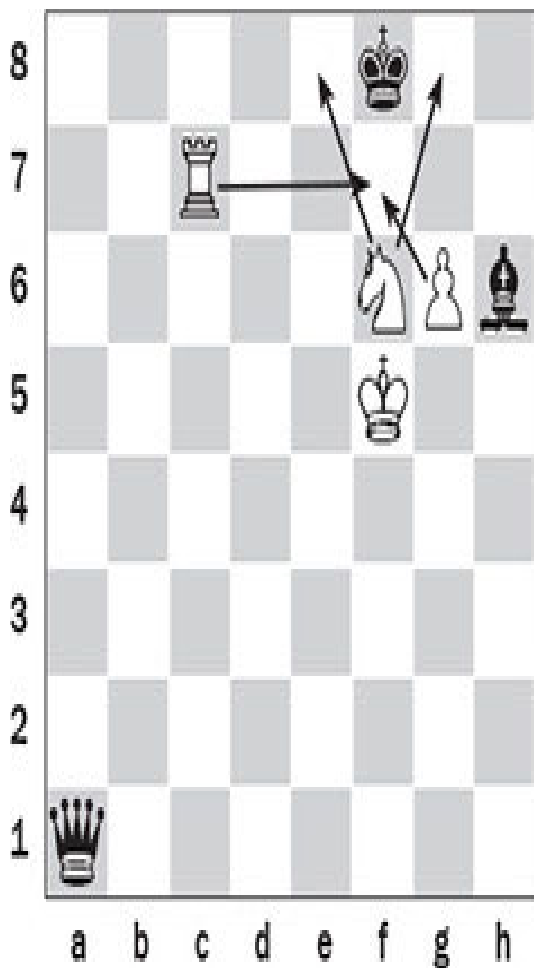
Alarming move! Here, because the knight on h6 protects the queen, the rook must capture. That is a very important point. Once the rook captures, Black's king will be smothered.

## **1...Rxf7 2.Nf7# (see diagram 2)**

The final blow, or, as chess players like to call it, the coup de grâce. Black was forced to block in his king, and the knight was able to finish the game by smothered checkmate. This is a very important pattern and one you should know. As my father always used to tell me as a kid, 'Don't be like me, be better than me.' Learn it here first so that you don't have to rely on your opponent prematurely resigning! I have devoted five problems to smothered checkmate.

## **Vukovic's Checkmate**

Vukovic's checkmate is a checkmate which uses the combination of a rook and knight. It's different from the Arabian checkmate since, in the Vukovic checkmate, the knight doesn't support the rook's check, but rather stops the king's escape. The rook check is usually supported by another piece. This checkmate is named after Vladimir Vukovic (1898-1975).



The knight on f6 stops the black king from moving to g8 and e8. White's rook on the 7th rank does a great job of cutting off the black king and thanks to the support of the pawn on g6, it can also deliver checkmate:

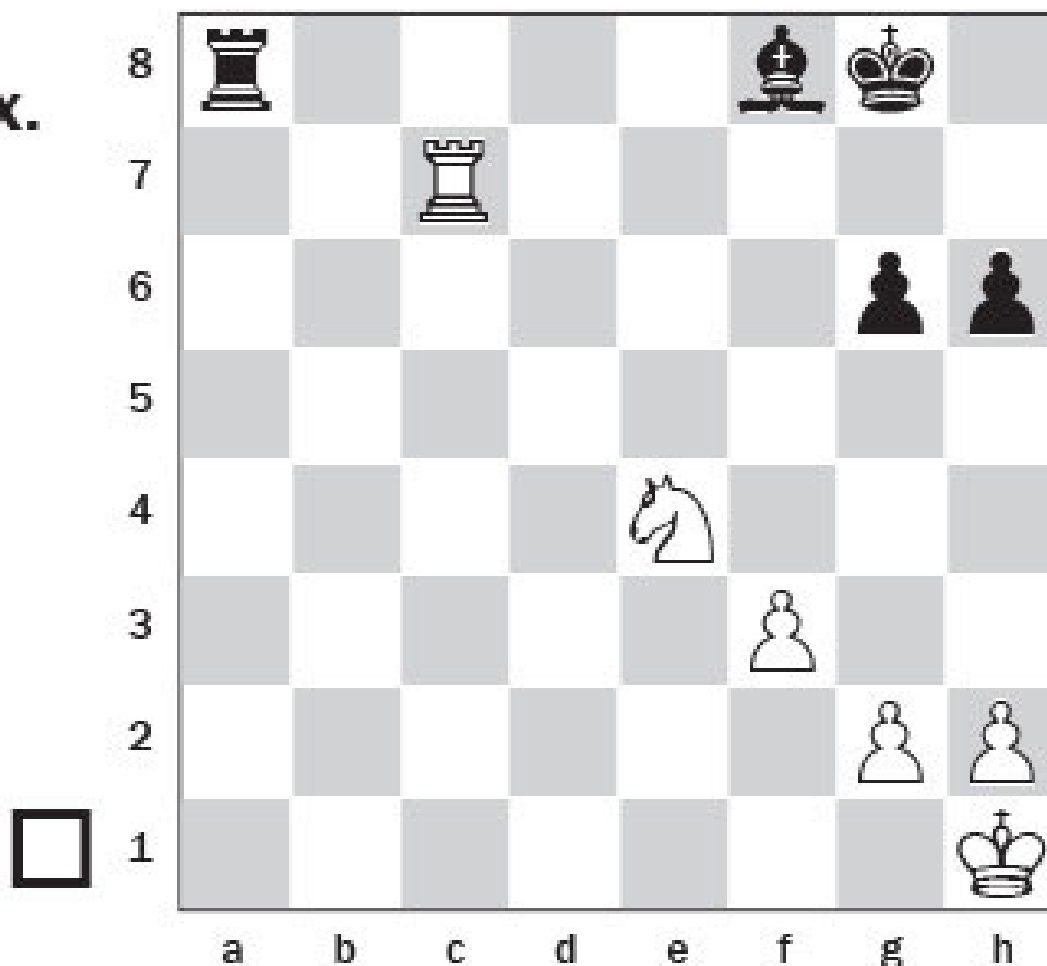
### 1.Rf7# (see diagram 2)

Vukovic's checkmate is quite common in practice. I have devoted five problems to this pattern.

Now you will begin solving these different types of checkmate patterns on your own. Each checkmate pattern has five supplemental puzzles that get progressively harder. Be sure to use the patterns you've learned to solve the puzzles - good luck!

# Arabian Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

1. Nf6+ Kh8

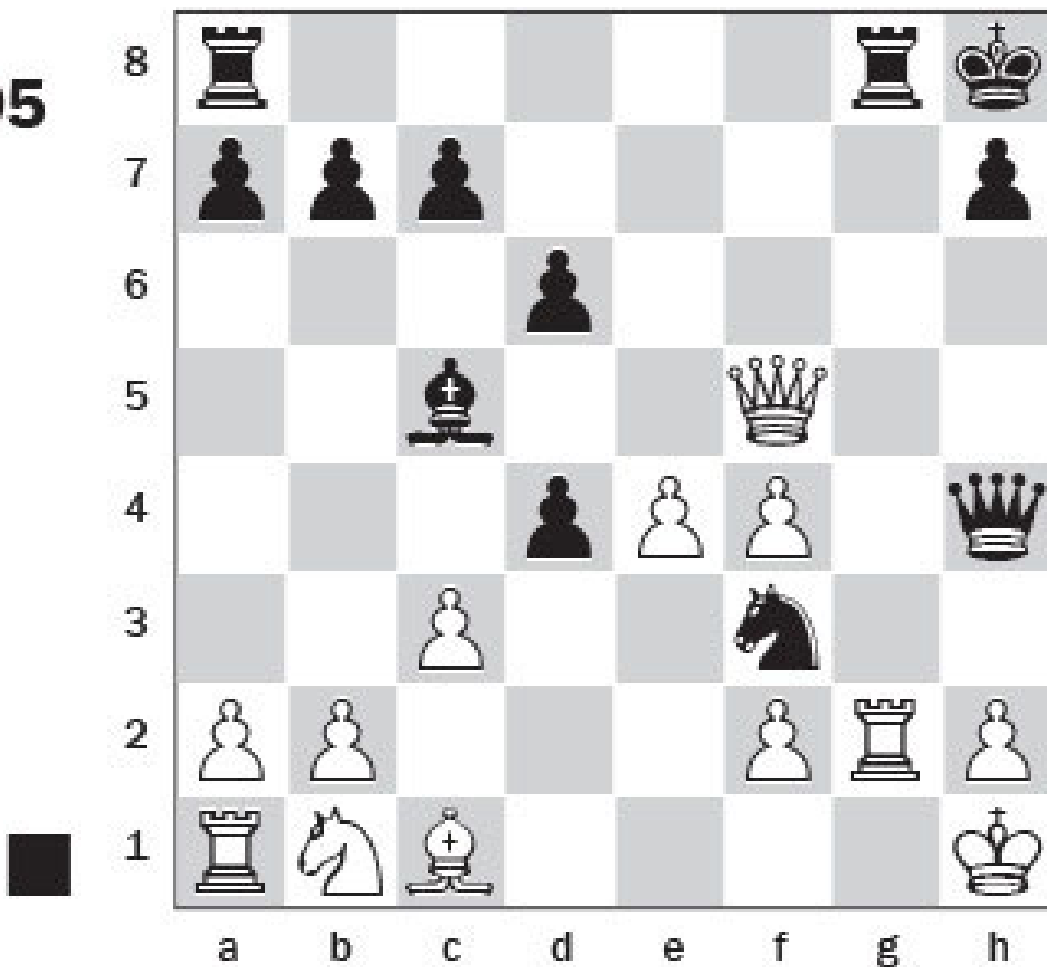
2. Rh7# \_\_\_\_\_



EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 495

495



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

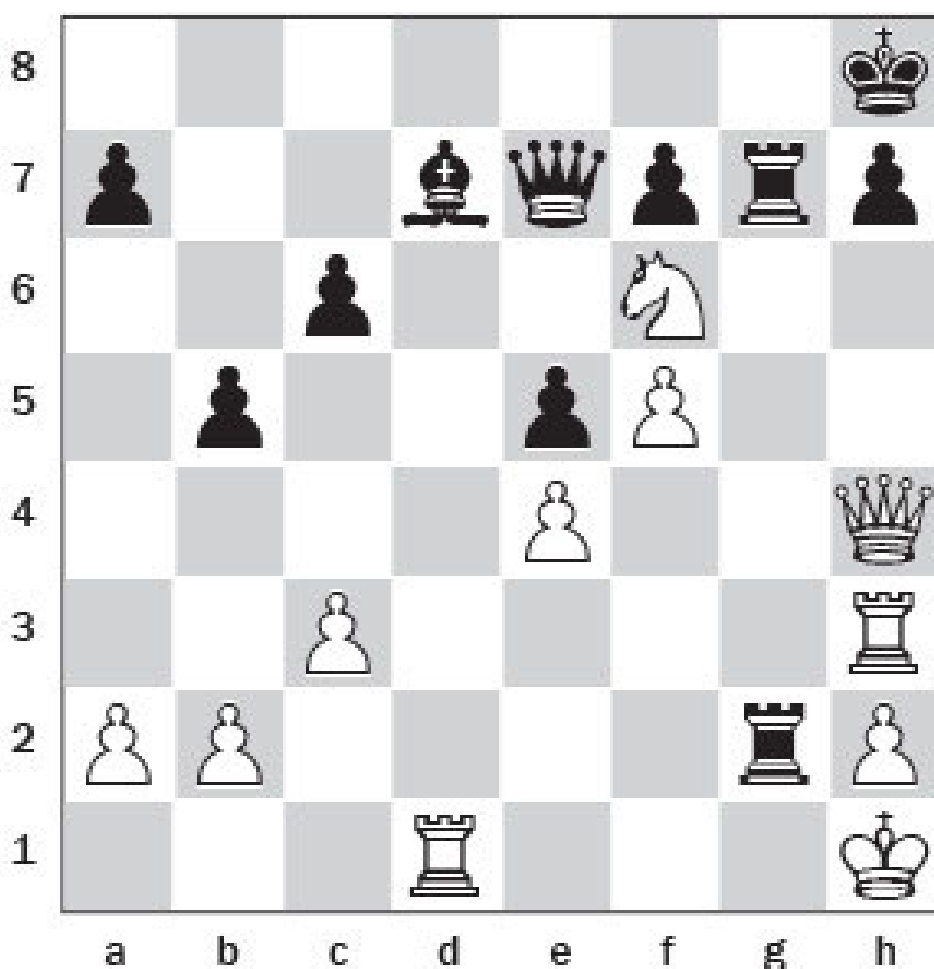
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on f3 sets up Arabian checkmate ideas. Black wants to get the rook to g1. How can Black deflect the rook on g2?

### Exercise 496

496



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

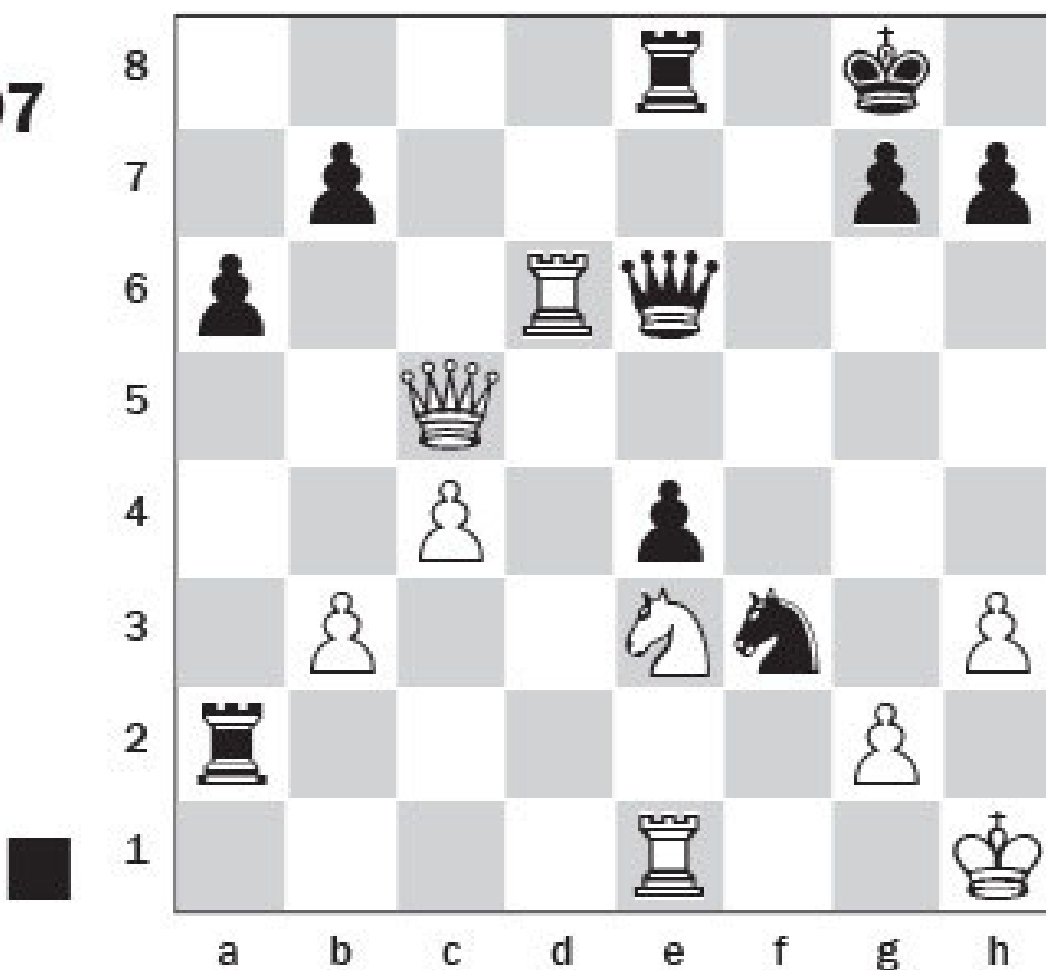
## HINT

The knight on f6 sets up Arabian checkmate ideas. The queen and rook battery have their eyes on the h-pawn.

# Arabian Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 497

**497**



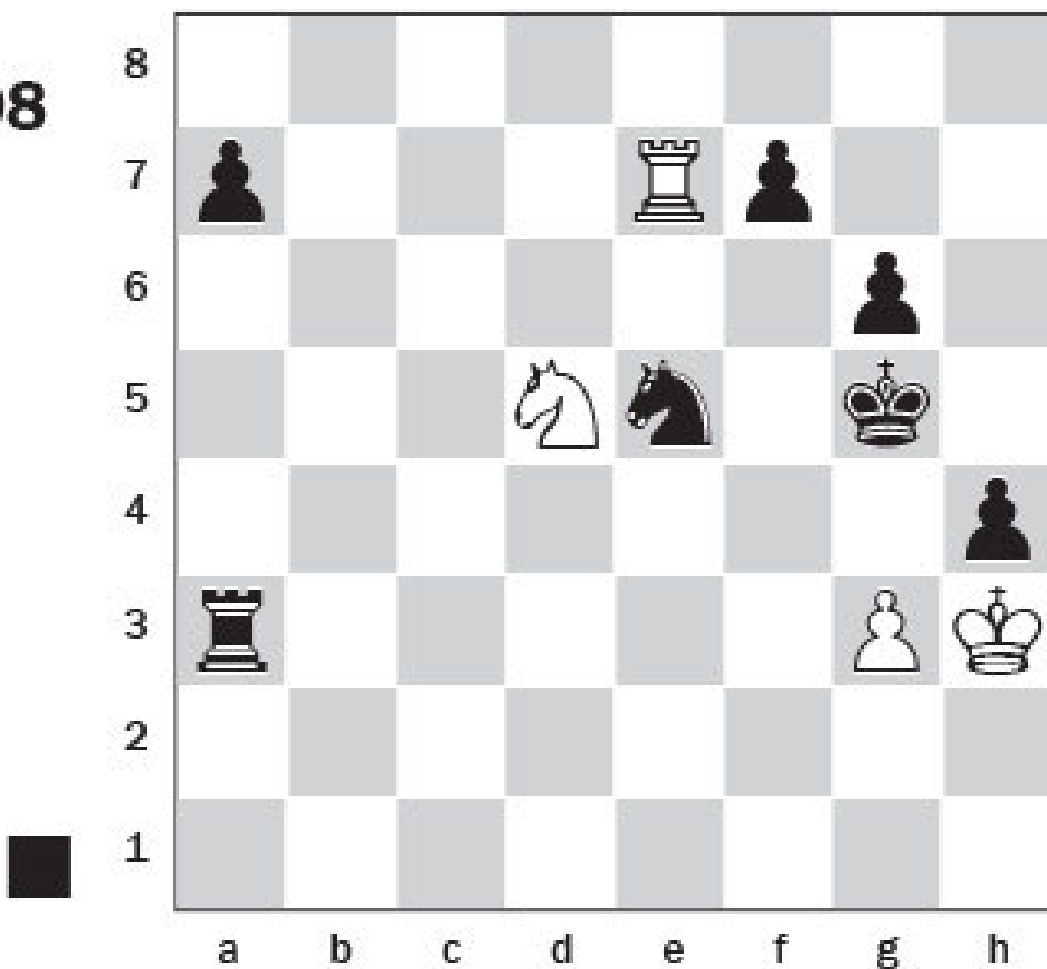
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 498

**498**



Answer:

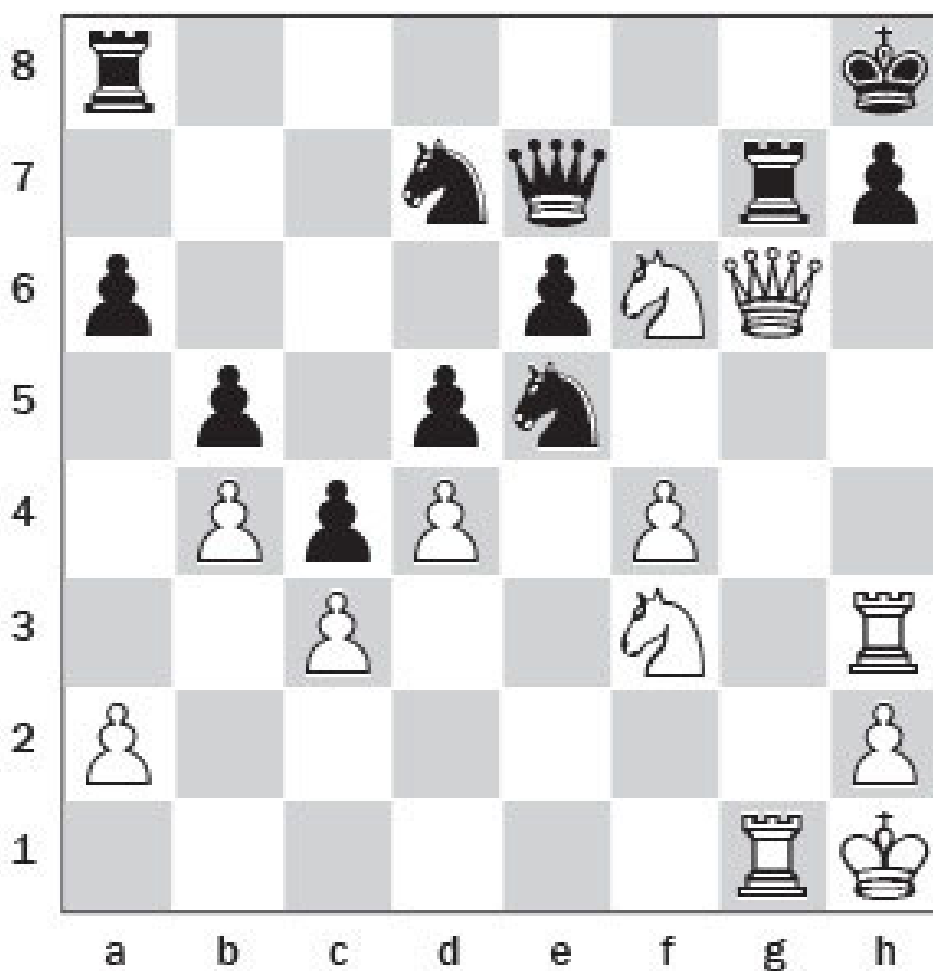
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 499

**499**



Answer:

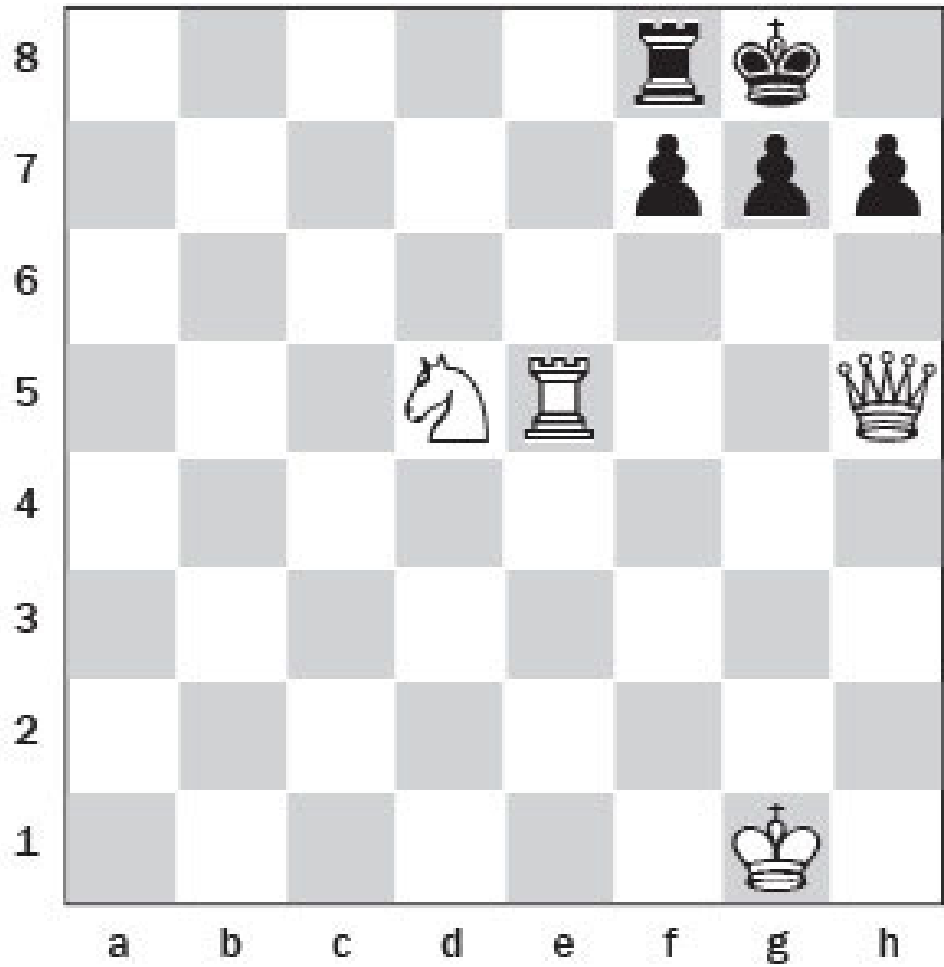
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

# Anastasia's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

1. Ne7+ Kh8



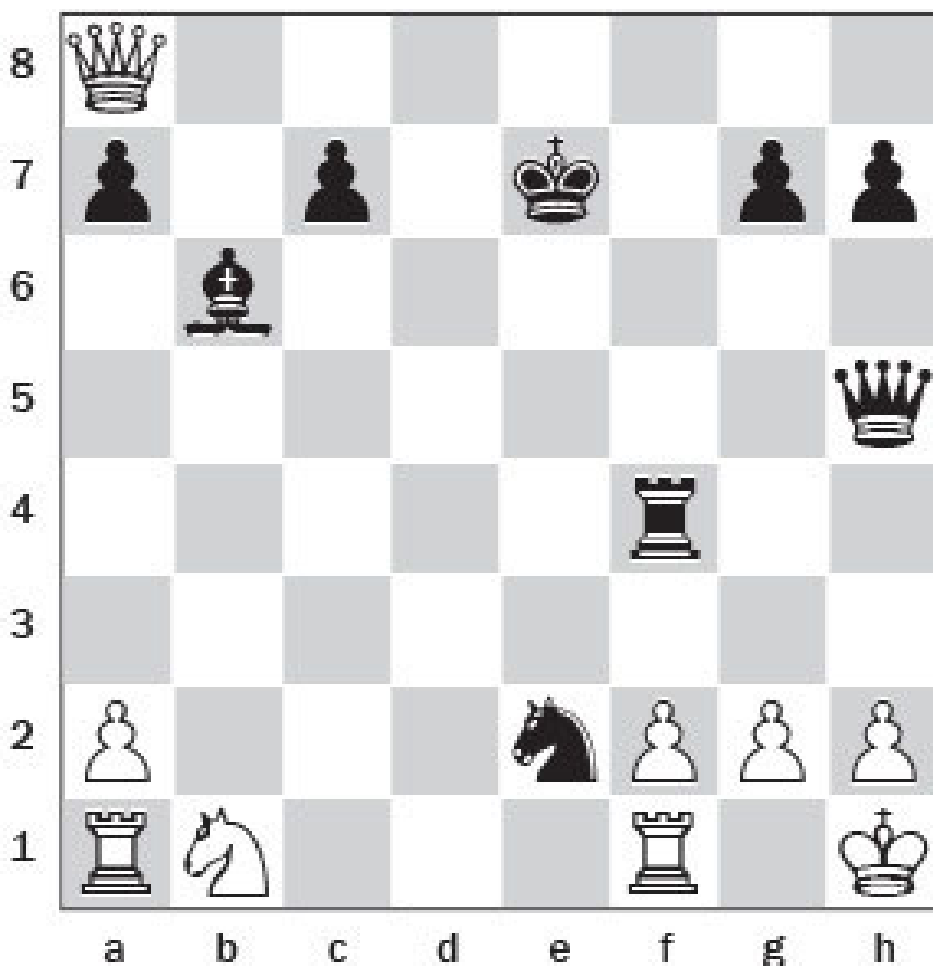
2. Qxh7+ Kxh7

3. Rh5# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 500

500



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The knight on e2 stops the king from going to g1 and g3. How should Black open the h-file?

### [Exercise 501](#)

501



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

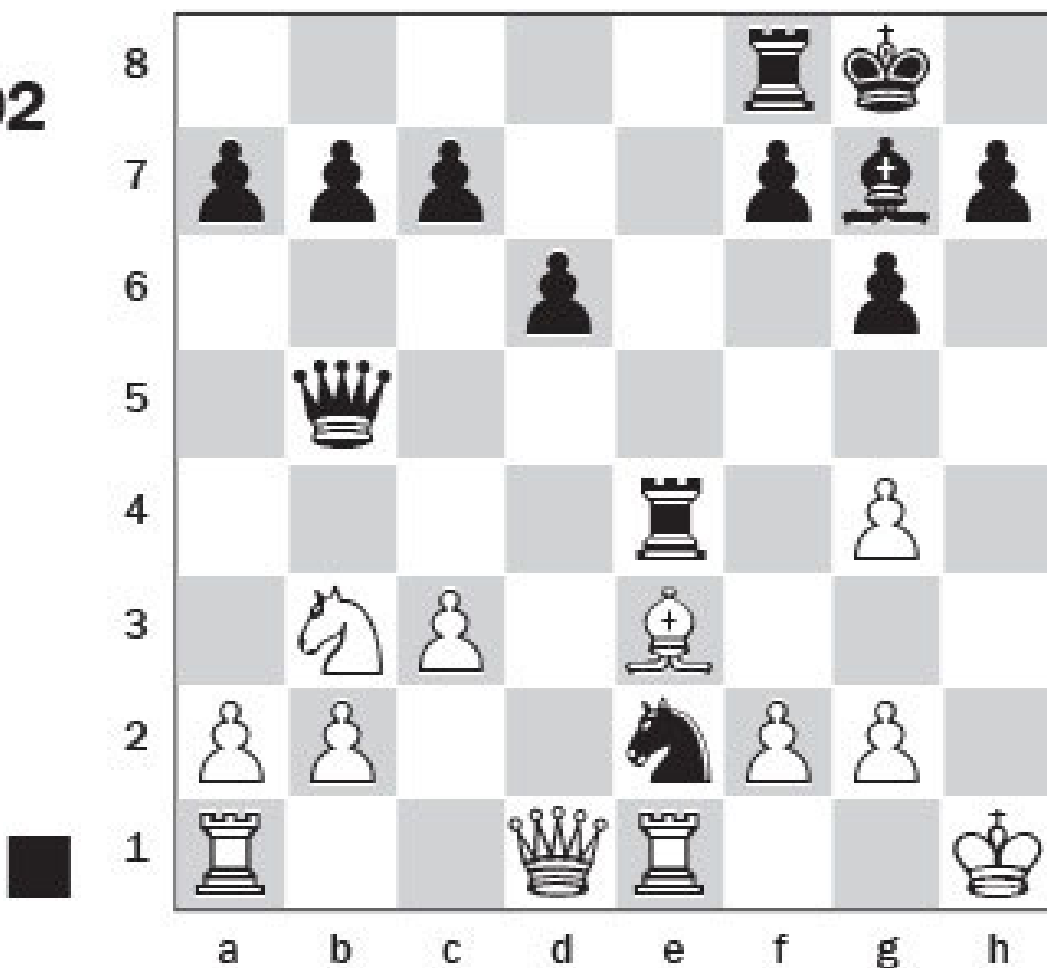
HINT

The knight on e7 controls the g8- and g6-squares. How should White open up the h-file?

# Anastasia's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 502

502



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 503

**503**



Answer:

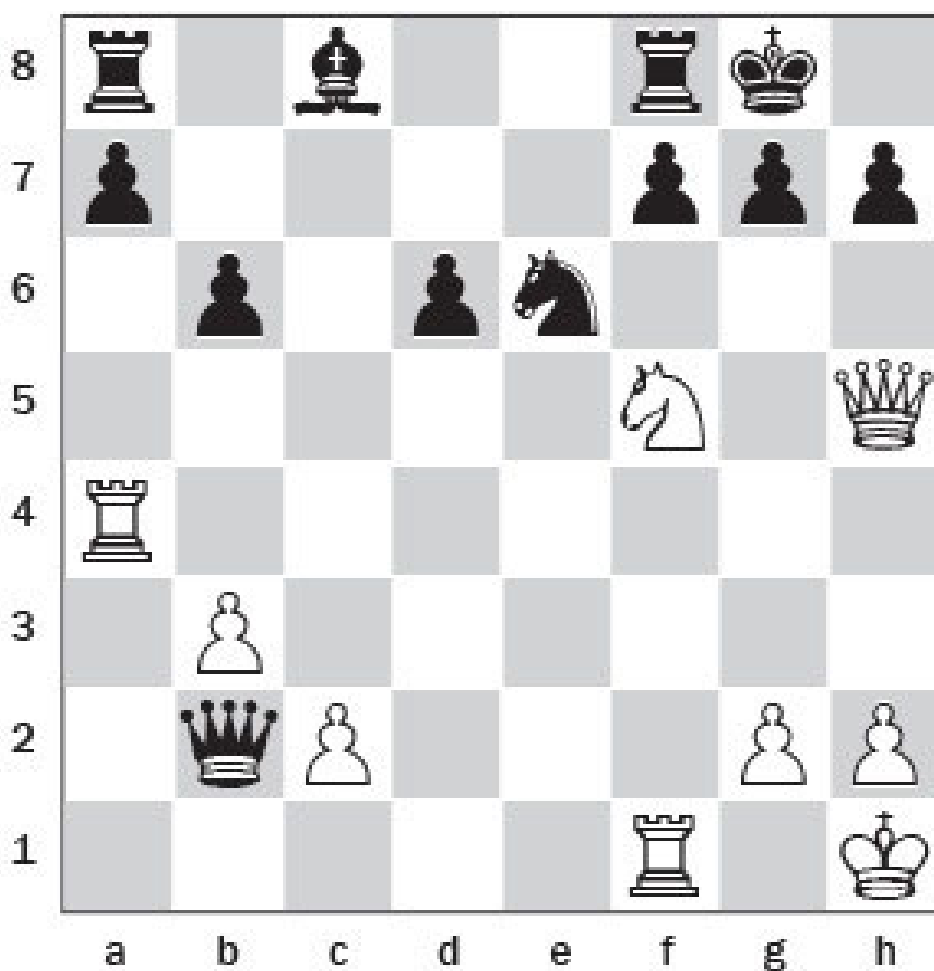
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 504

**504**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

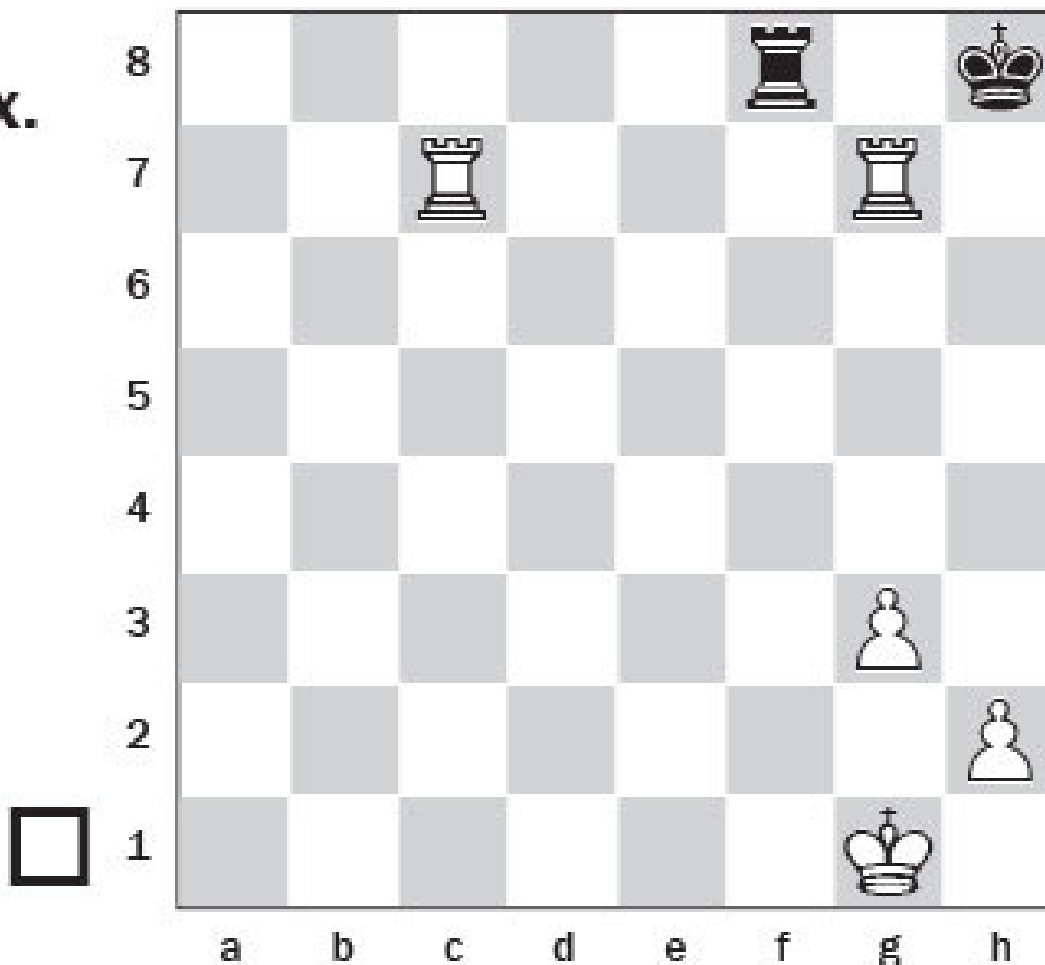
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_



# Blind Swine Checkmate – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



Answer:

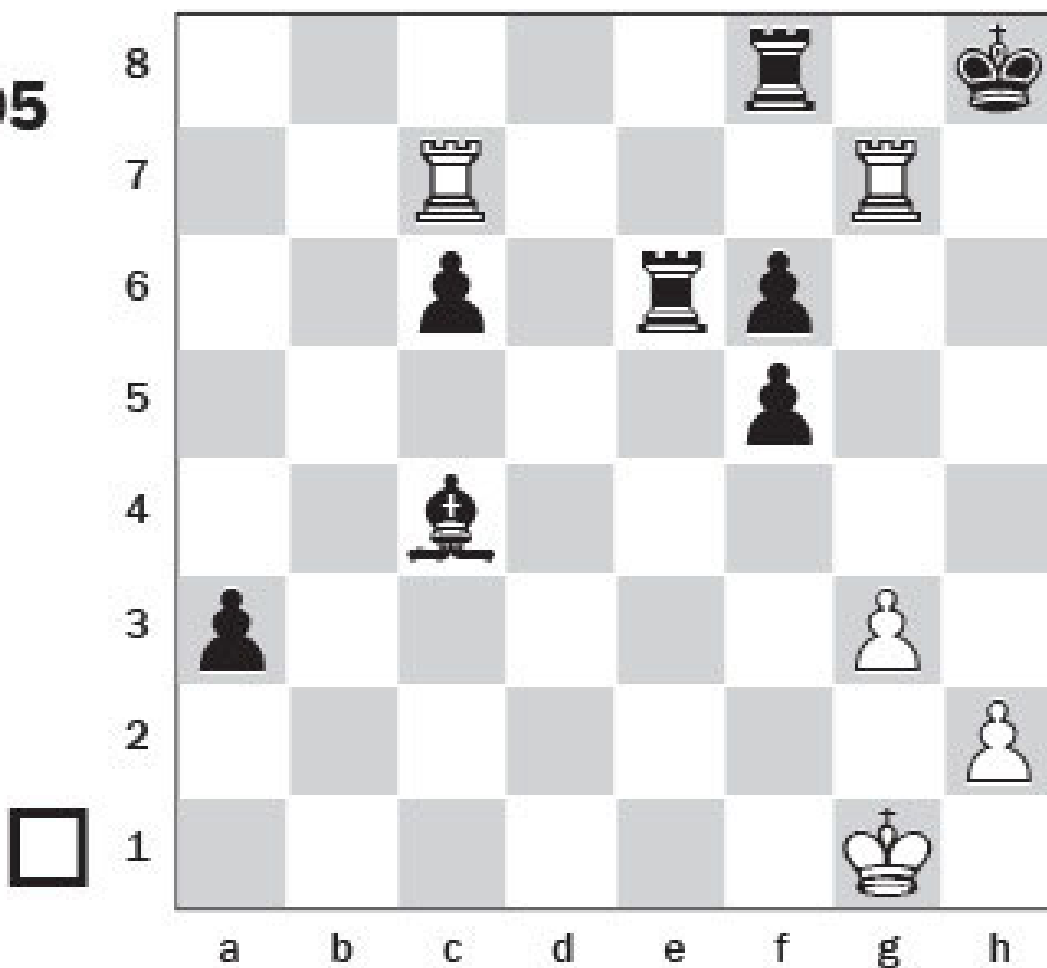
**1. Rh7+ Kg8**

## 2. Rcg7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 505

505



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

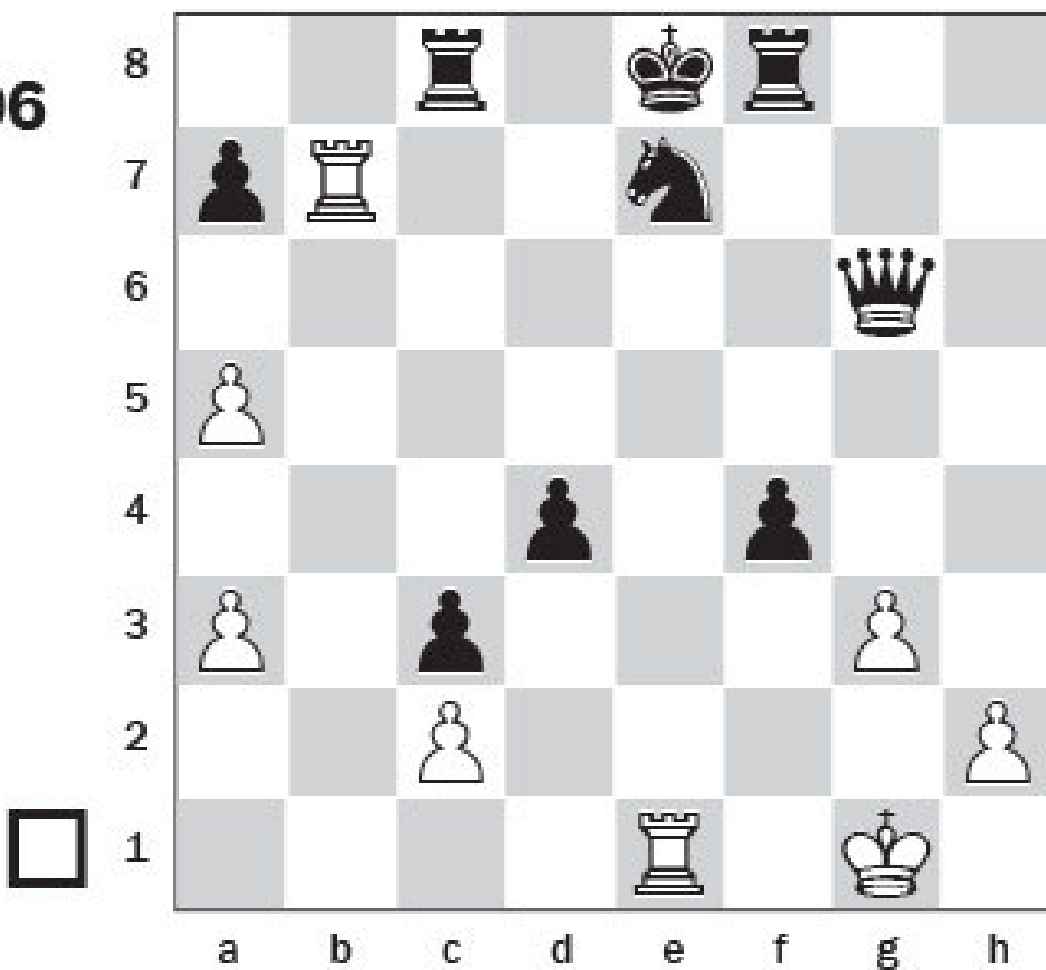
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rooks are in a battery along the 7th rank, that's very strong!

### Exercise 506

**506**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

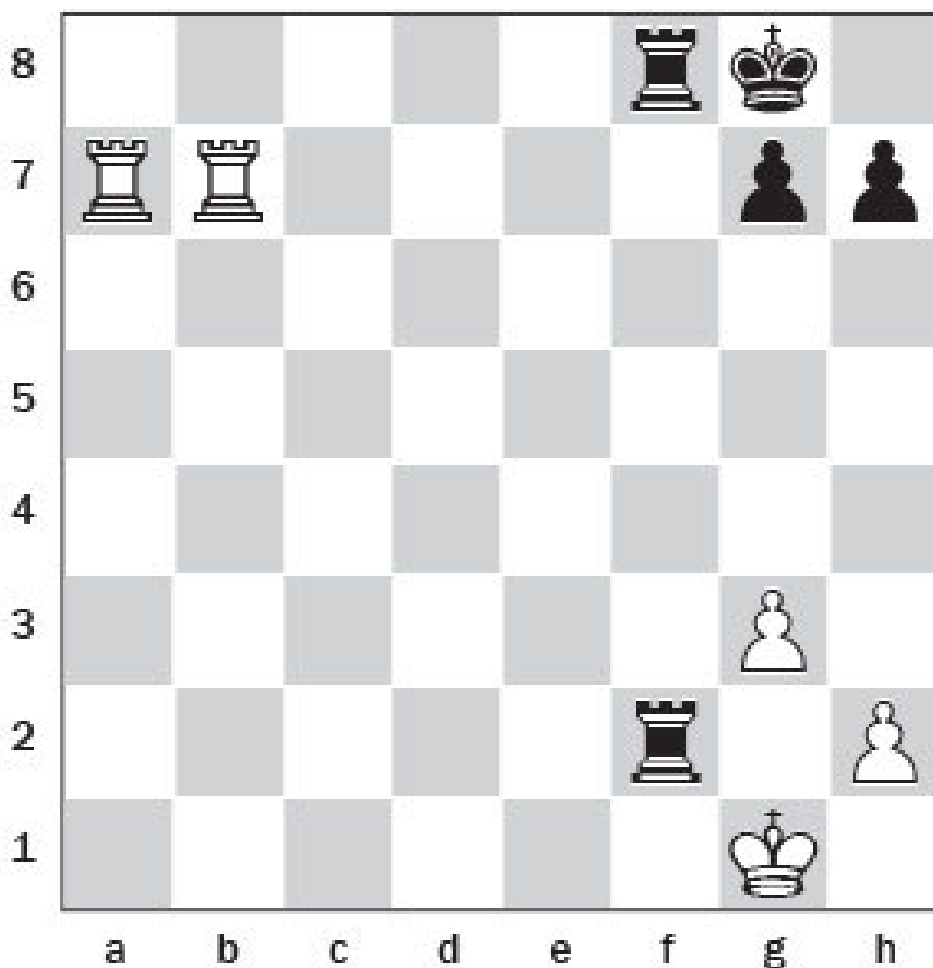
### HINT

How can White get more rooks to the 7th rank?

# Blind Swine Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 507

**507**



Answer:

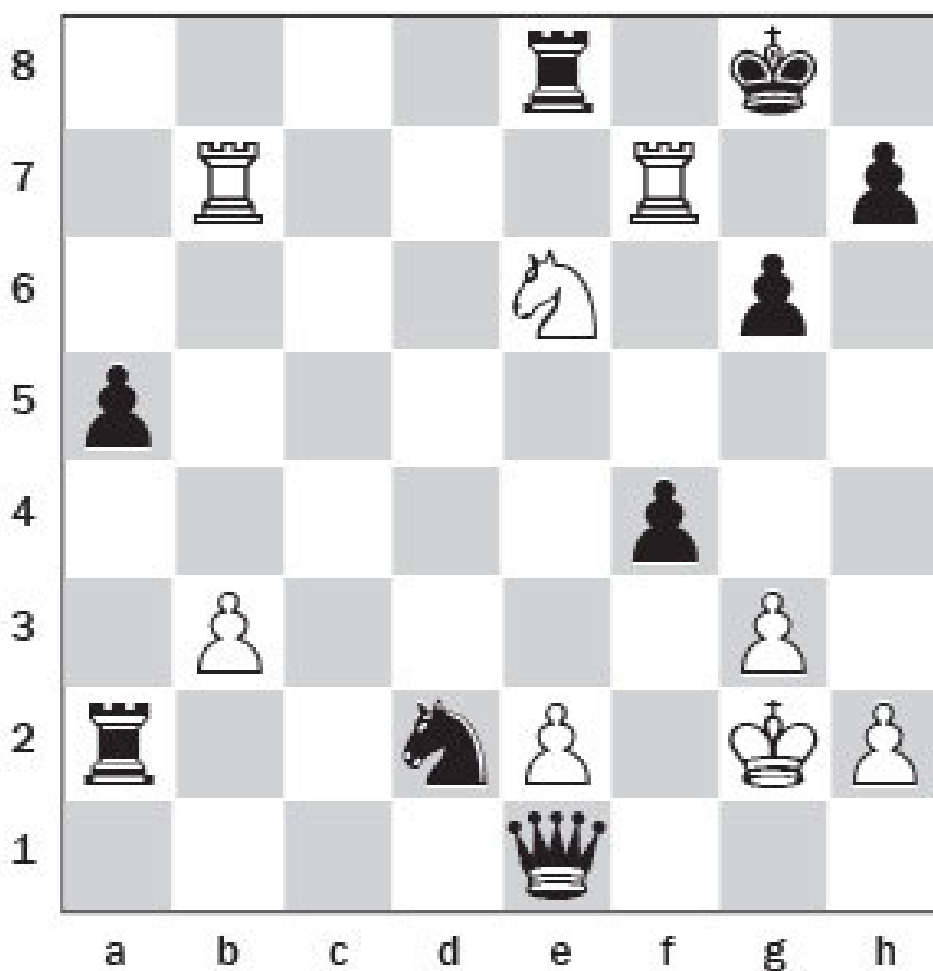
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 508

**508**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 509

**509**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

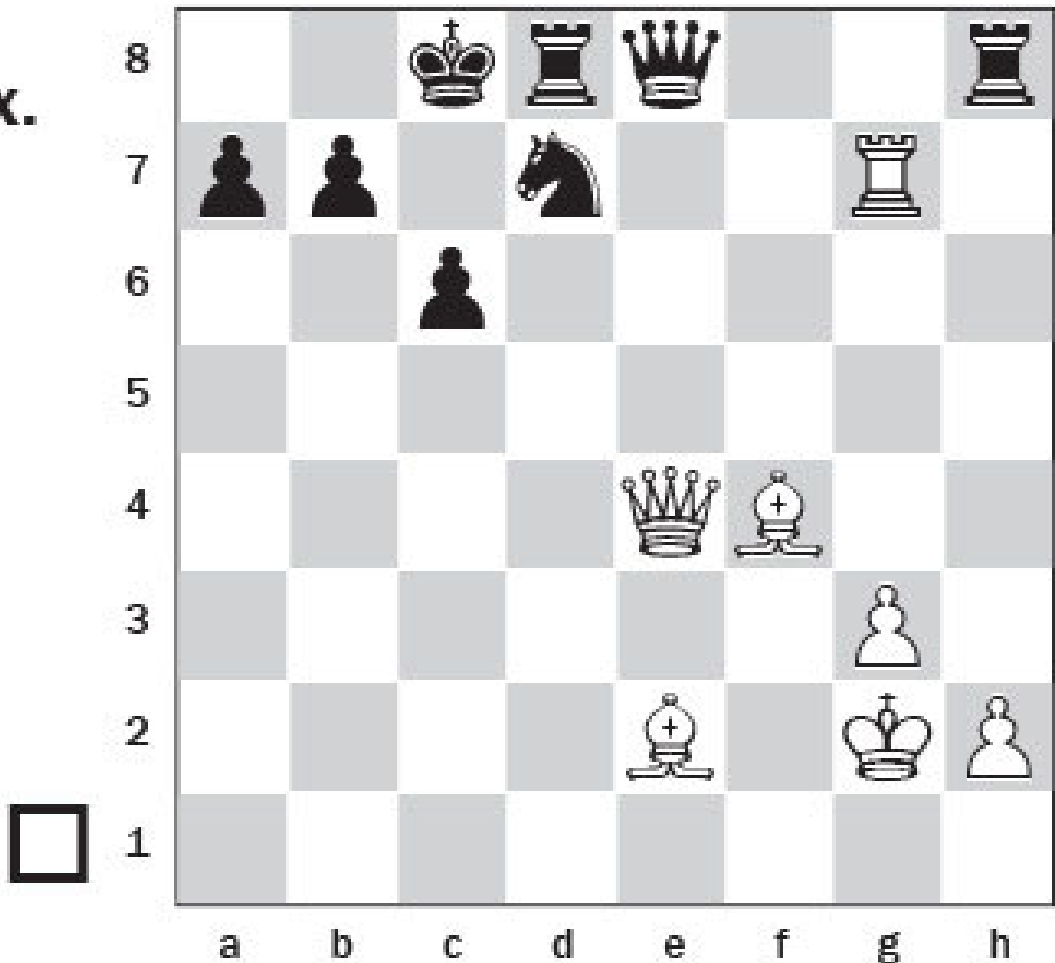
3. \_\_\_\_\_

4. \_\_\_\_\_



# Boden's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

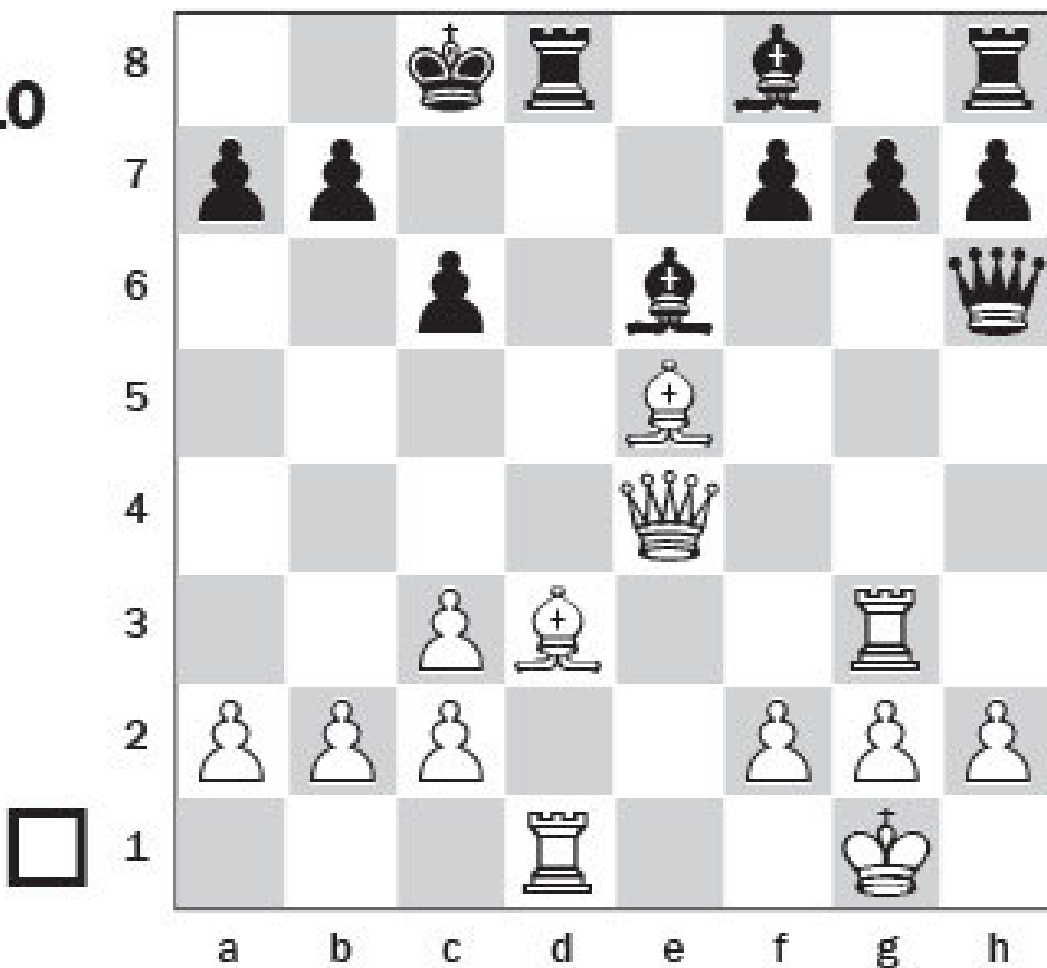
1. Qxc6+ bxc6

2. Ba6# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 510

510



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Typical Boden checkmate. White's bishop on e5 is controlling the dark squares around the king. How should White open the a6-c8 diagonal?

### Exercise 511

**511**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Notice that the bishop on a3 controls the dark squares around the king. How can you open the h5-e8 diagonal for your bishop?

# Boden's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 512

512



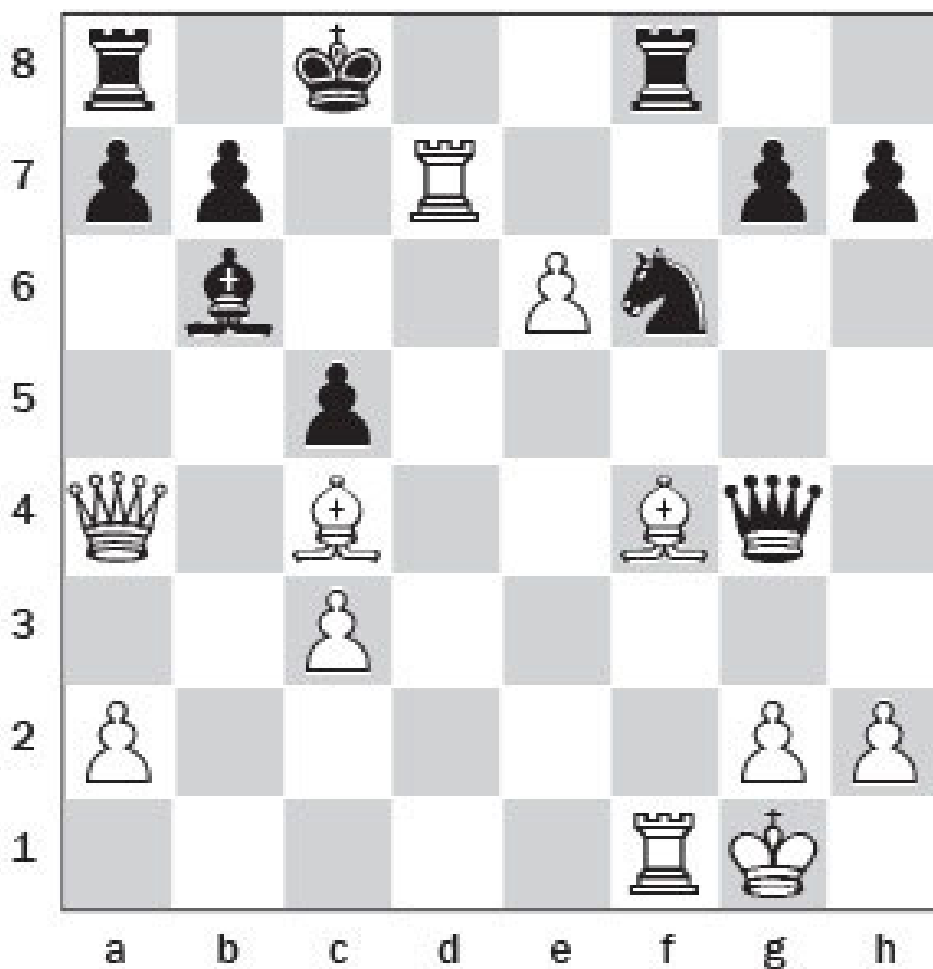
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 513

513



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 514

**514**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

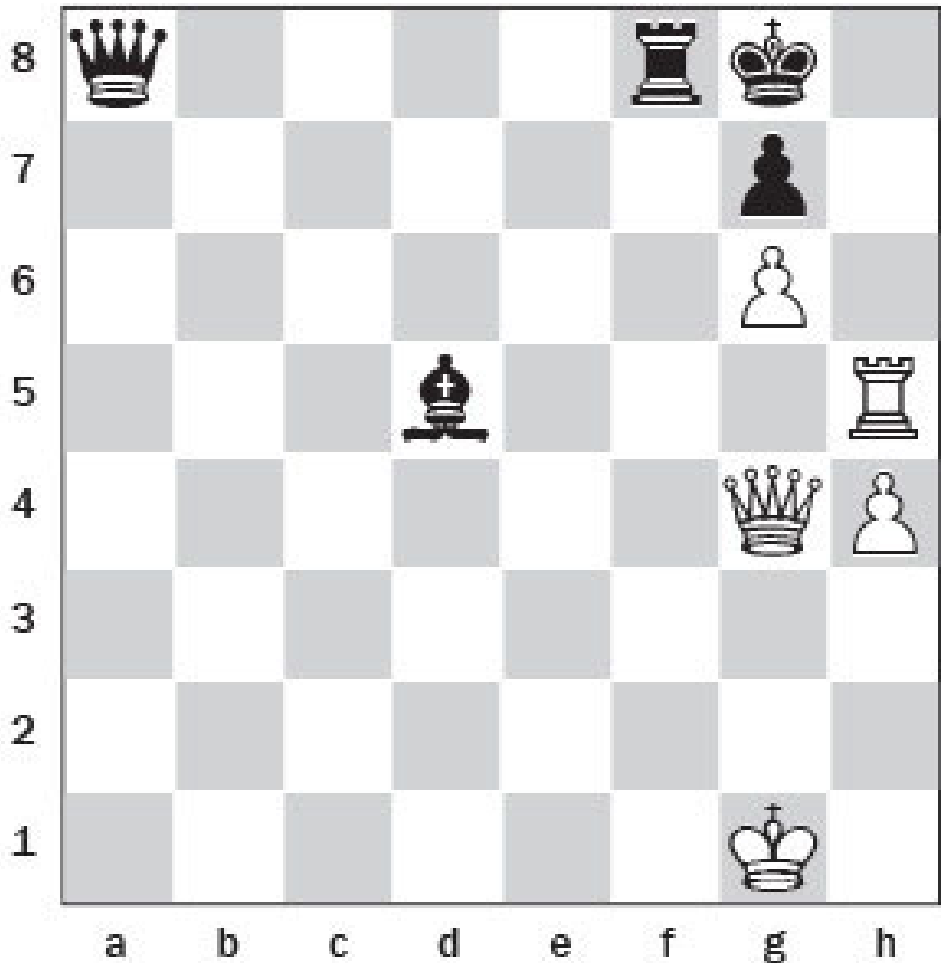
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_



# Damiano's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

1. Rh8+ Kxh8

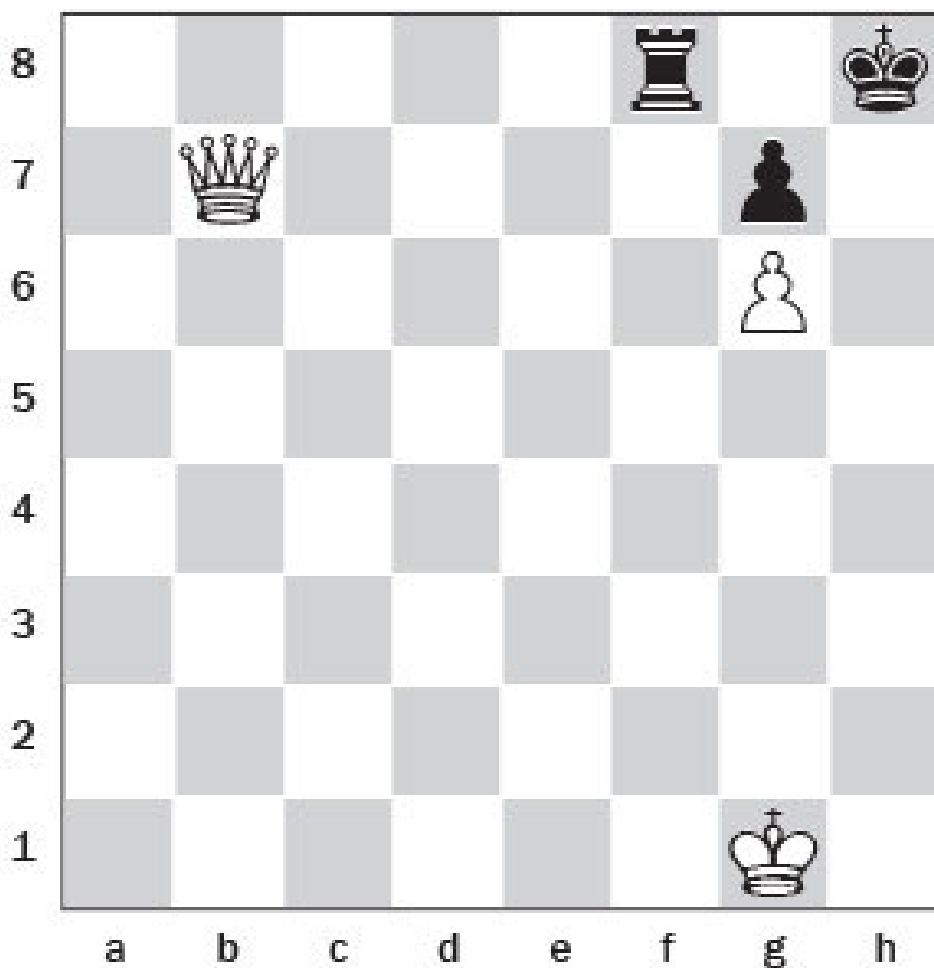
2. Qh5+ Kg8

3. Qh7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 515

**515**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

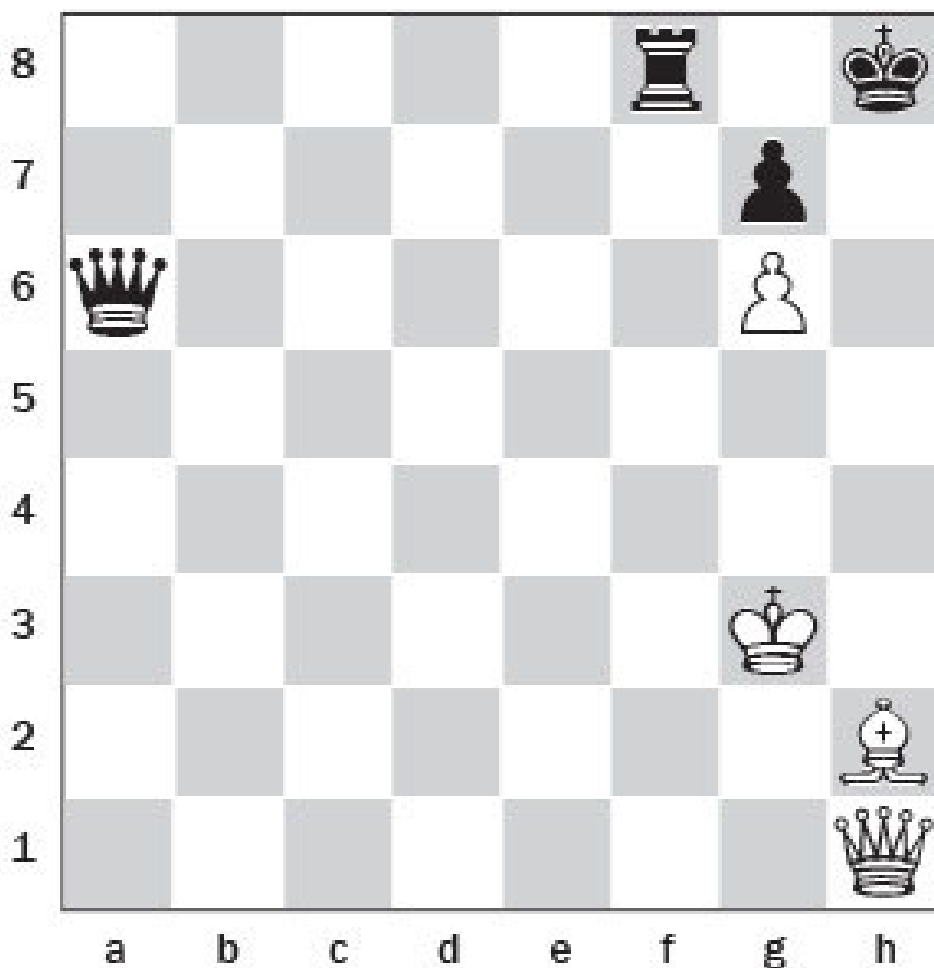
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The pawn on g6 is controlling the escape squares h7 and f7. How can White get to the h-file?

### Exercise 516

516



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

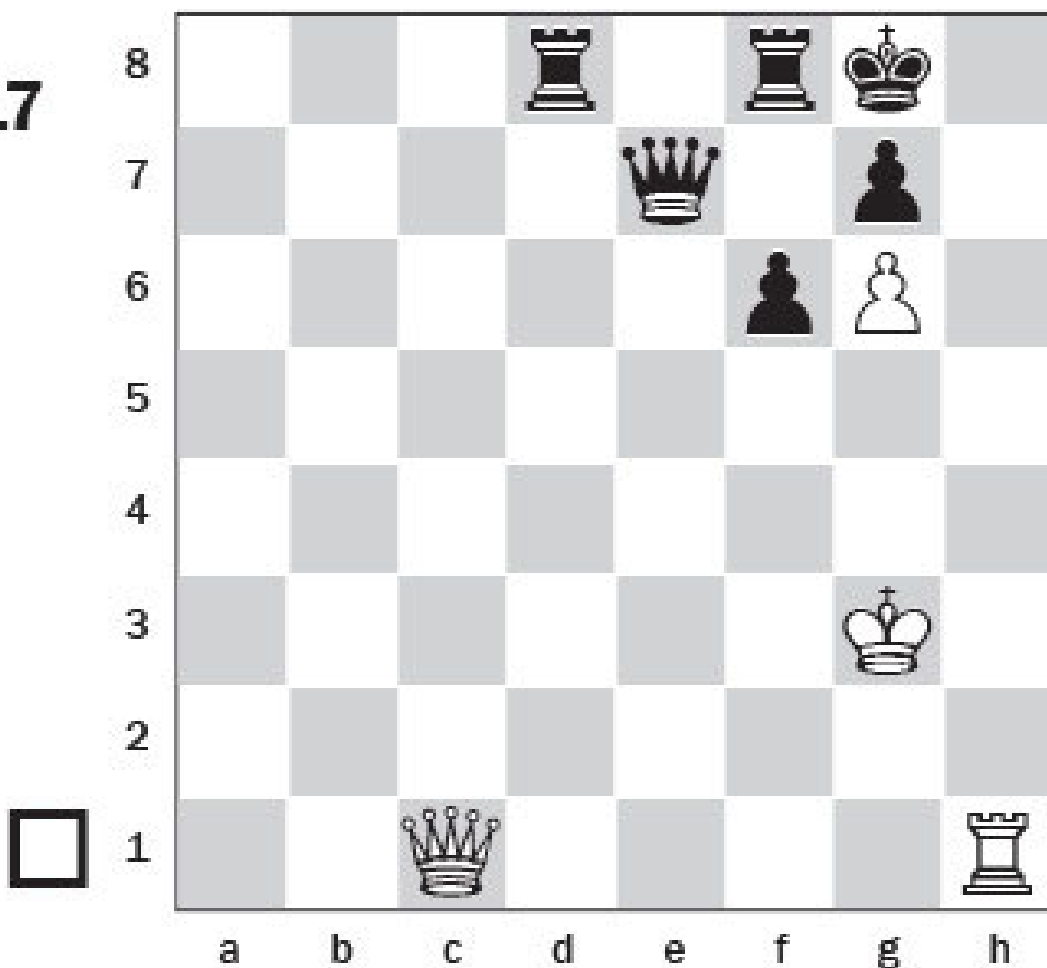
**HINT**

Use a discovered check to finish the game.

# Damiano's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 517

**517**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 518

**518**



Answer:

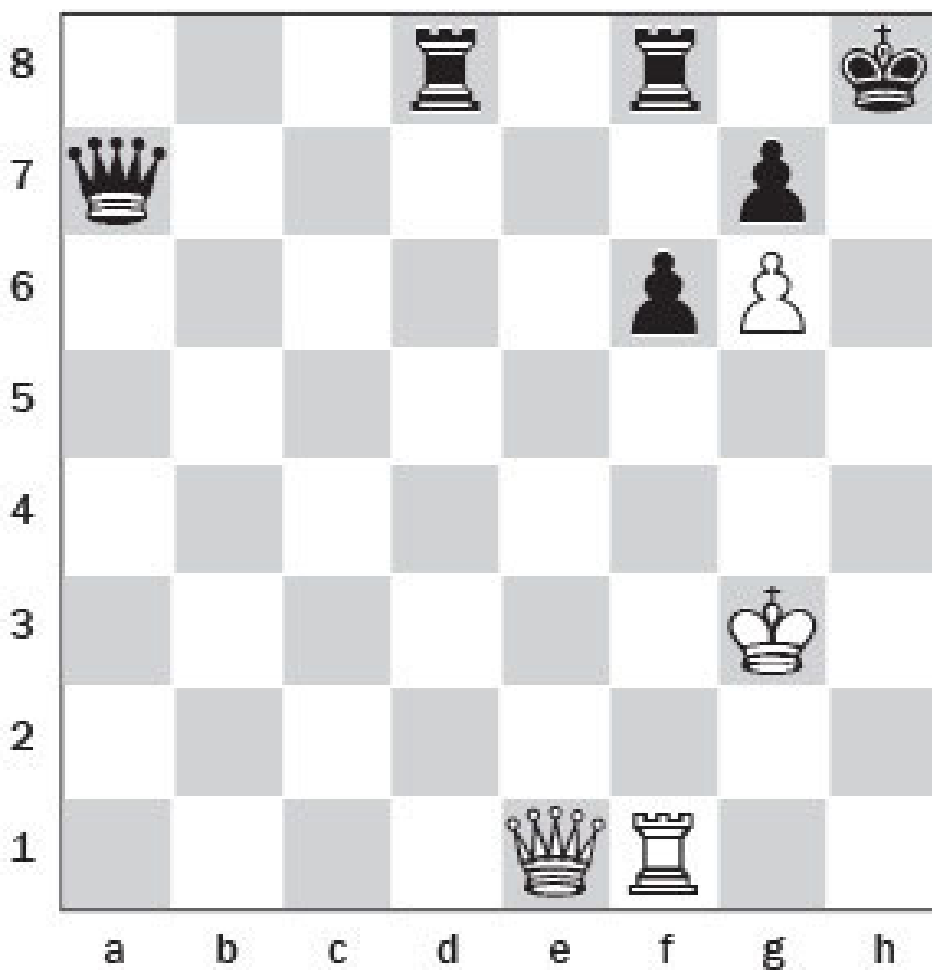
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 519

**519**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

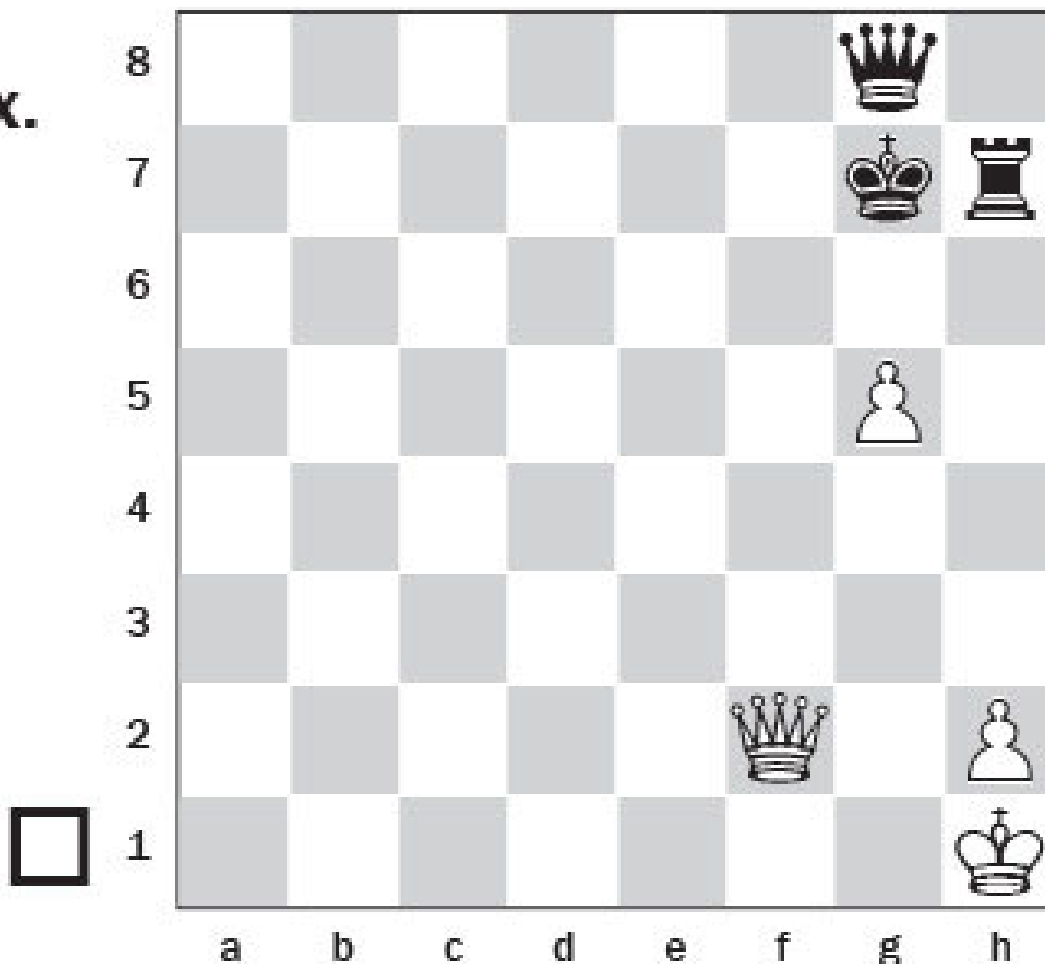
3. \_\_\_\_\_

4 \_\_\_\_\_



# Dovetail Checkmate – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



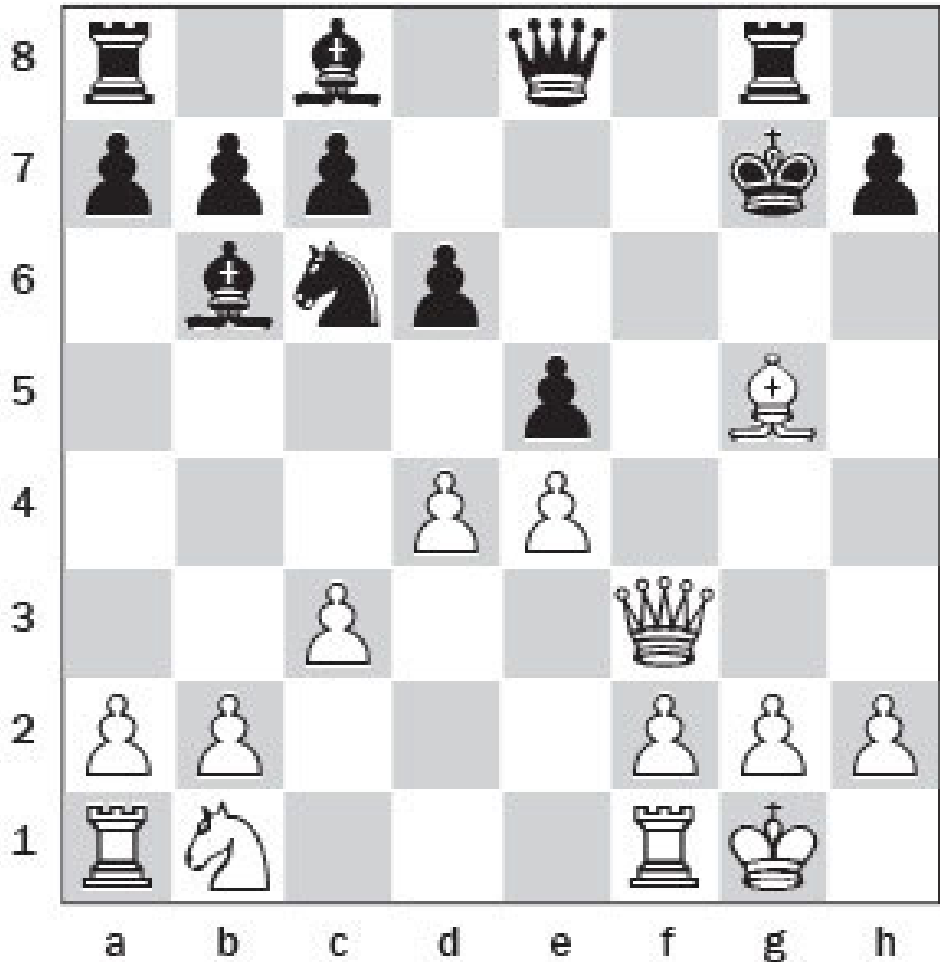
Answer:

1. Qf6# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 520

520



Answer:

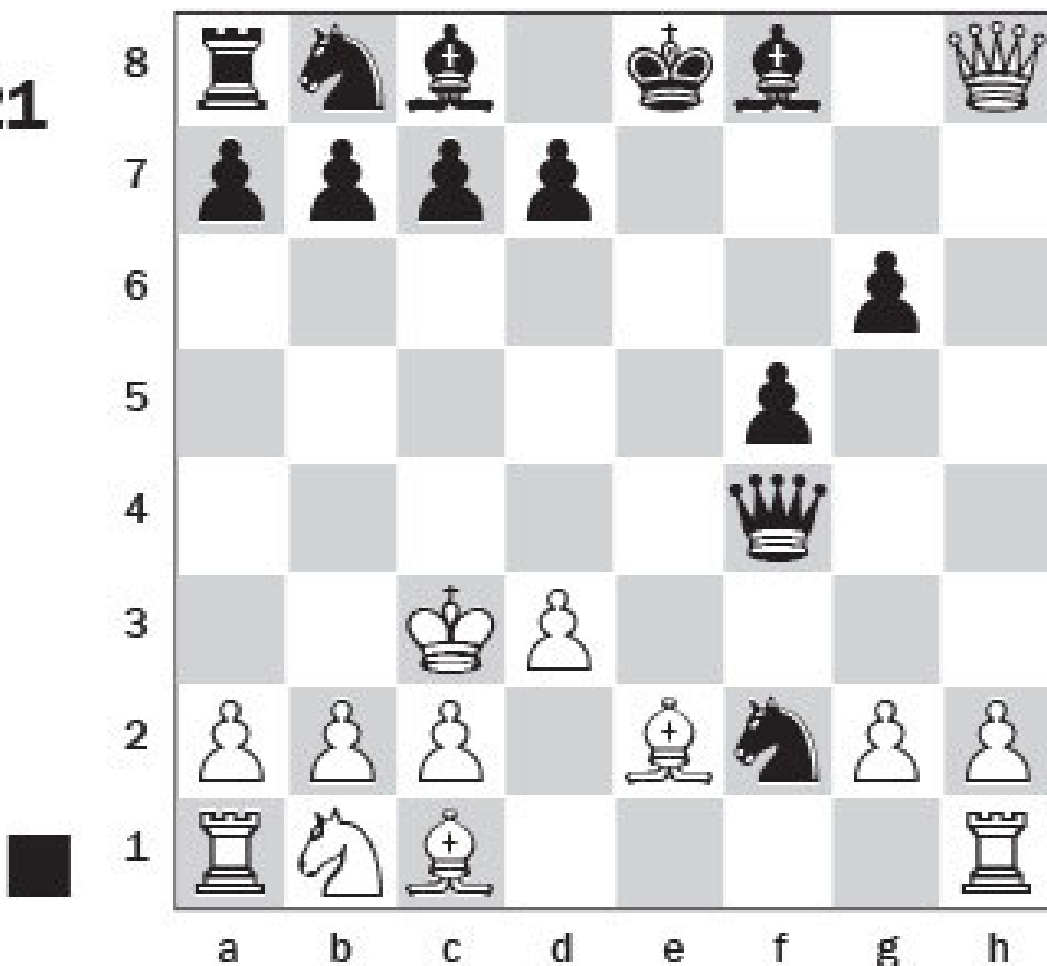
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on g8 and the pawn on h7 are stopping the king from moving (dovetail). Use your queen to finish the game.

### Exercise 521

521



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The pawns on c2 and d3 (dovetail) are limiting the king. Use a helper checkmate to finish the game.

# Dovetail Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 522

522



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 523

**523**



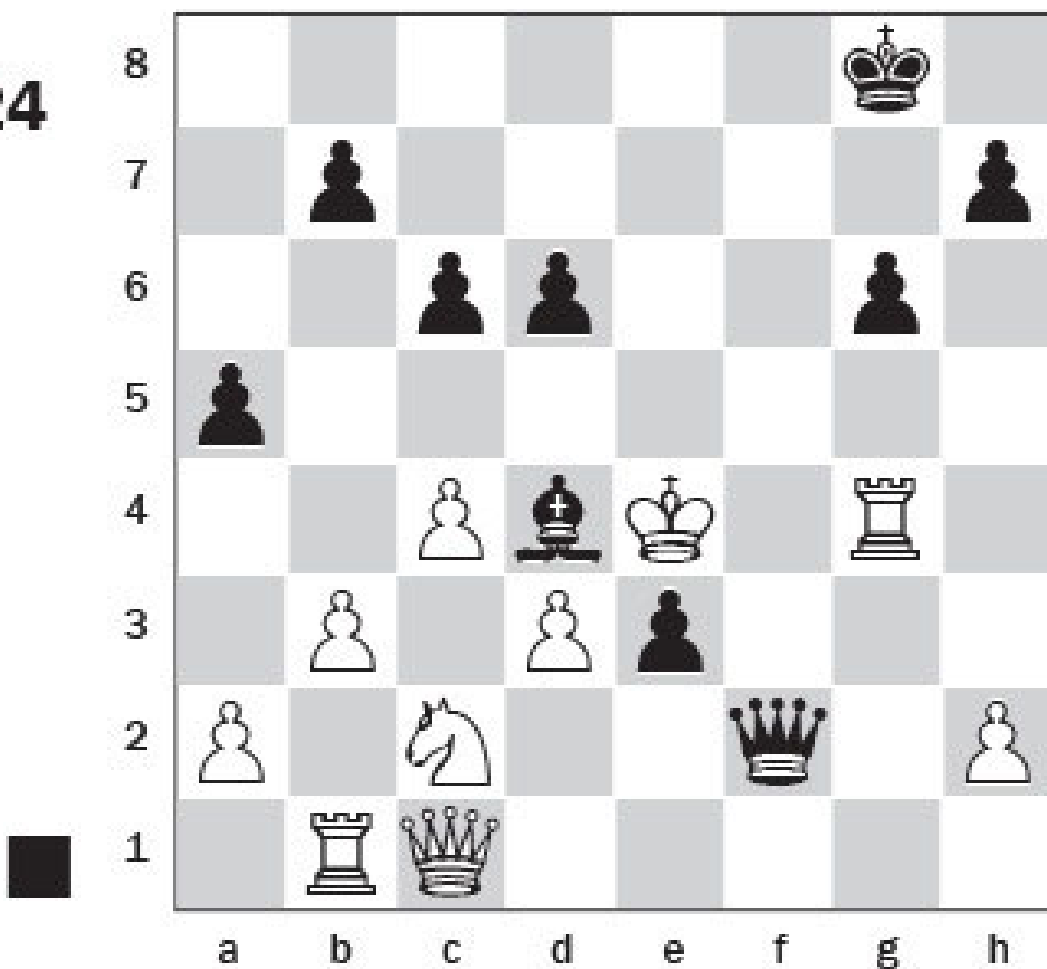
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 524

**524**



Answer:

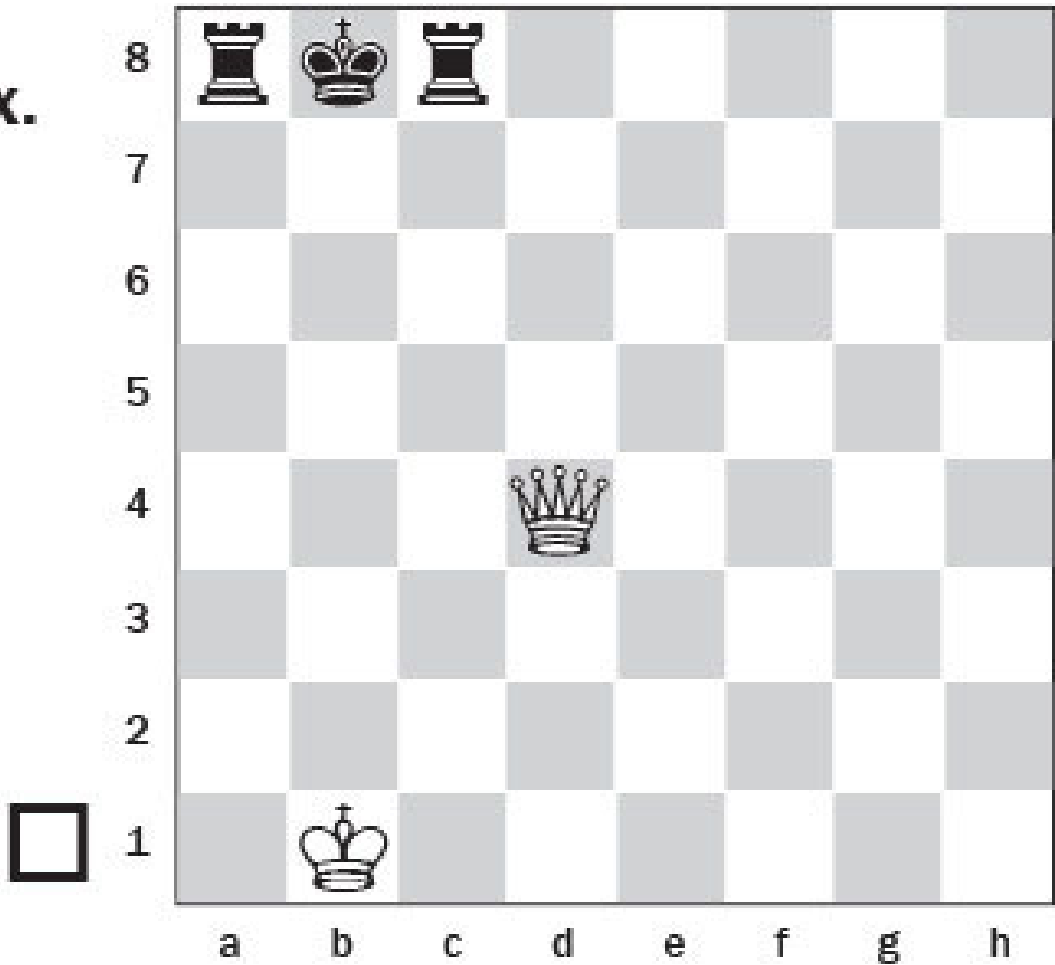
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Epaullette Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



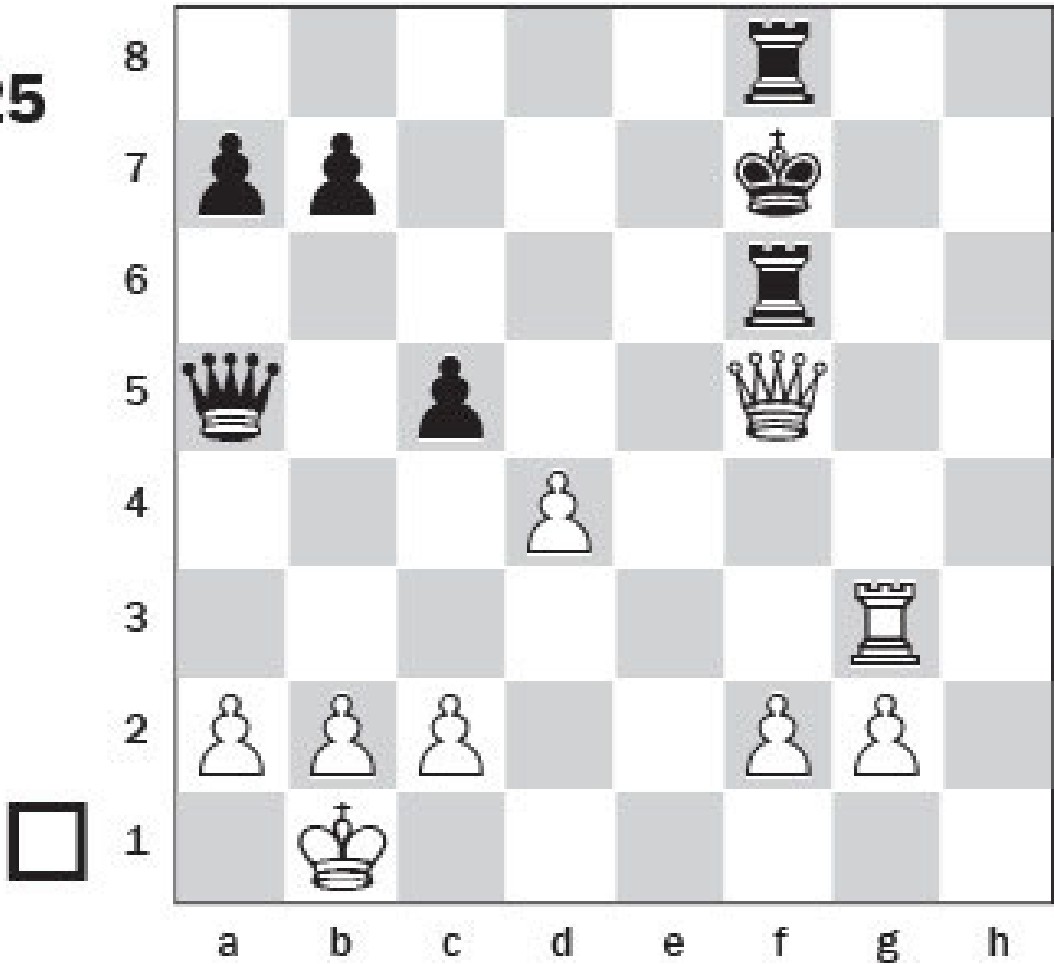
Answer:

1. Qb6# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 525

525



Answer:

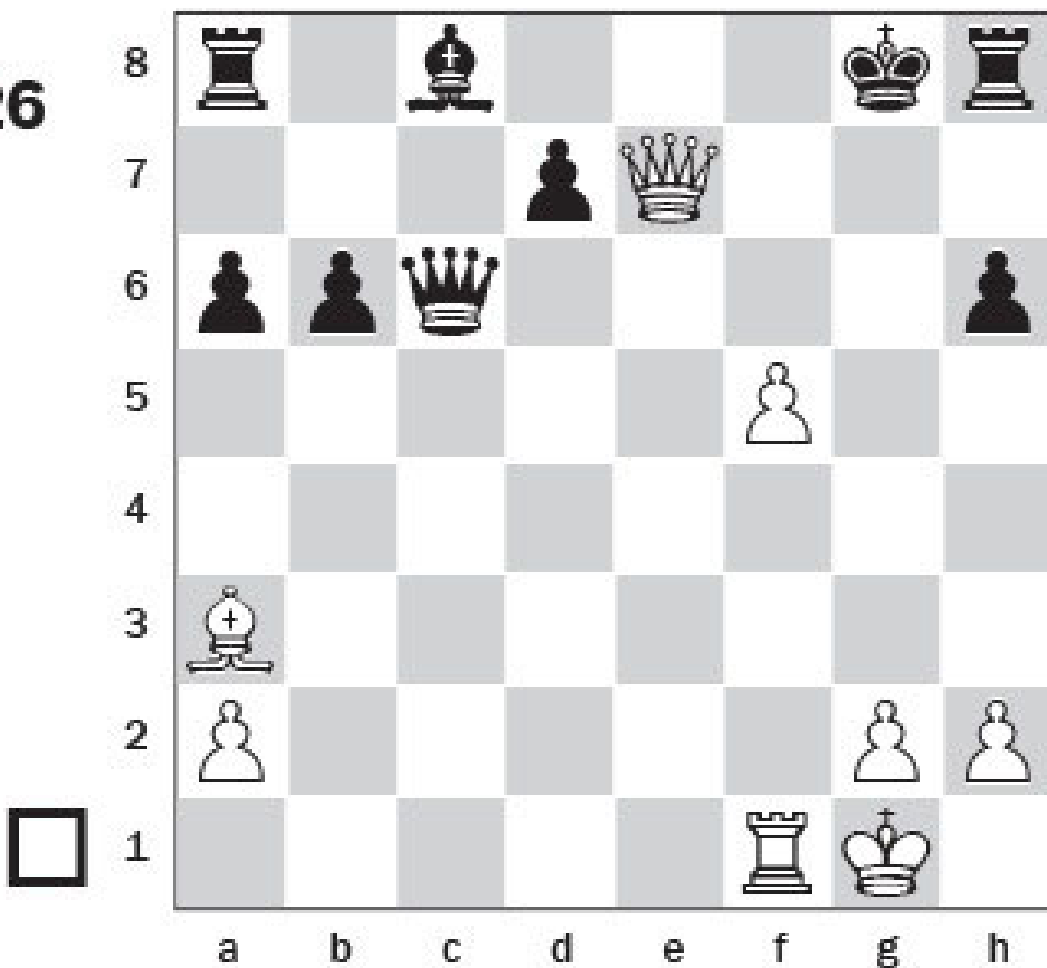
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on g3 is cutting off the g-file. Black's rooks on f8 and f6 block the king. Find the sideways epaulette checkmate.

### Exercise 526

526



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

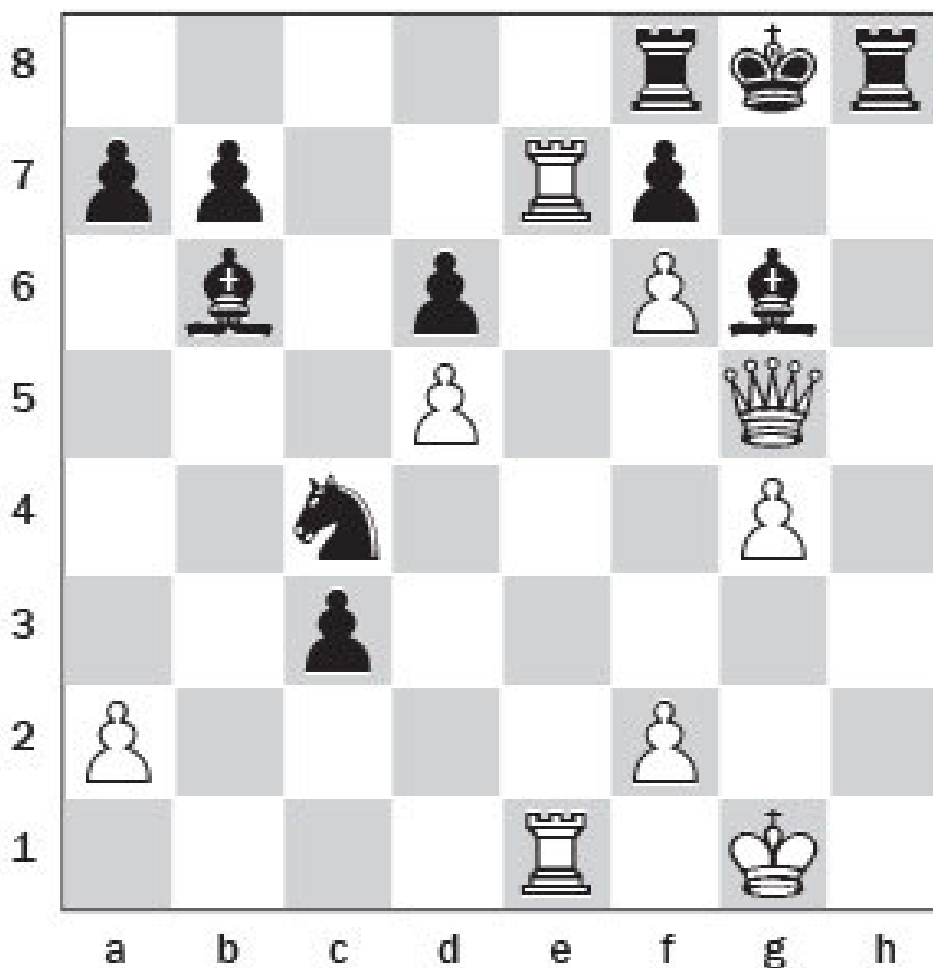
## HINT

Push the king to h7, then the rook and pawn will block the king on the sides – then checkmate on move 2.

# Epaullette Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 527

527



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 528

**528**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 529

**529**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

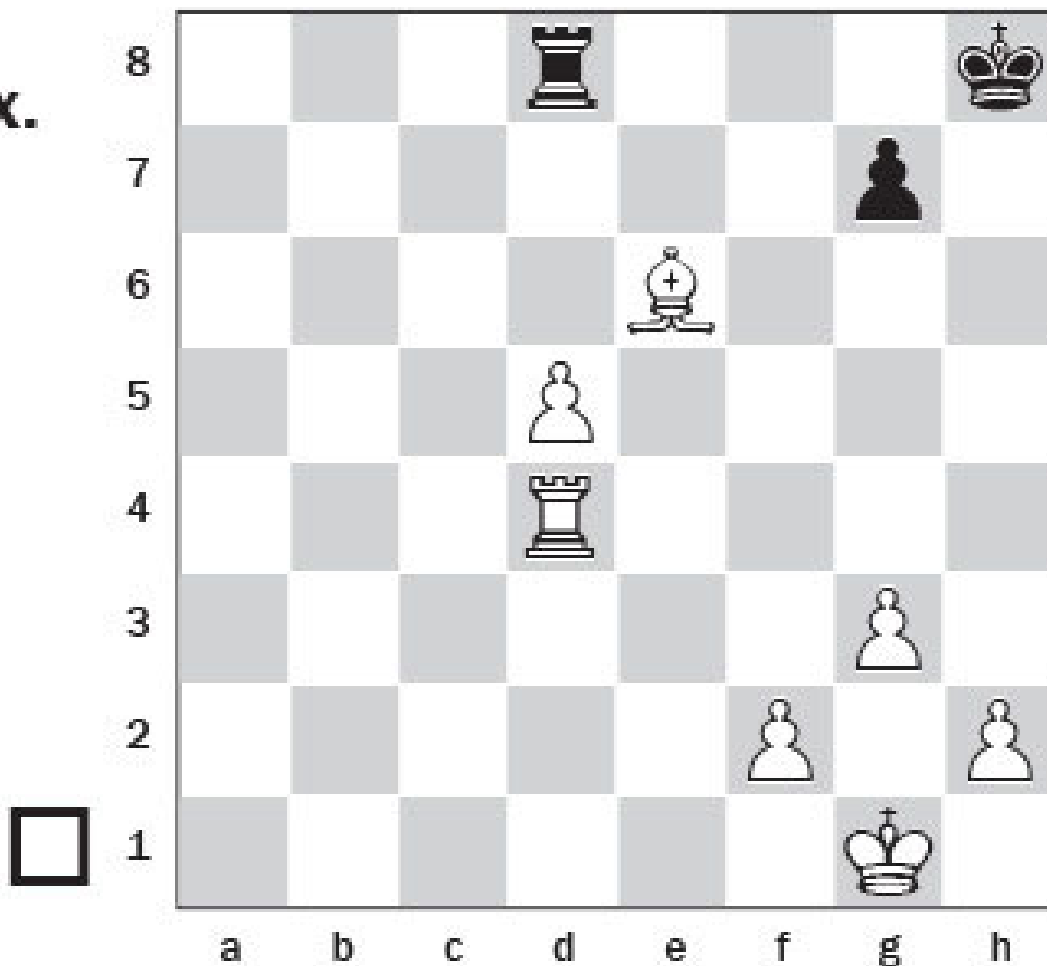
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_



# Greco's Checkmate – Guided Practice

**Ex.**



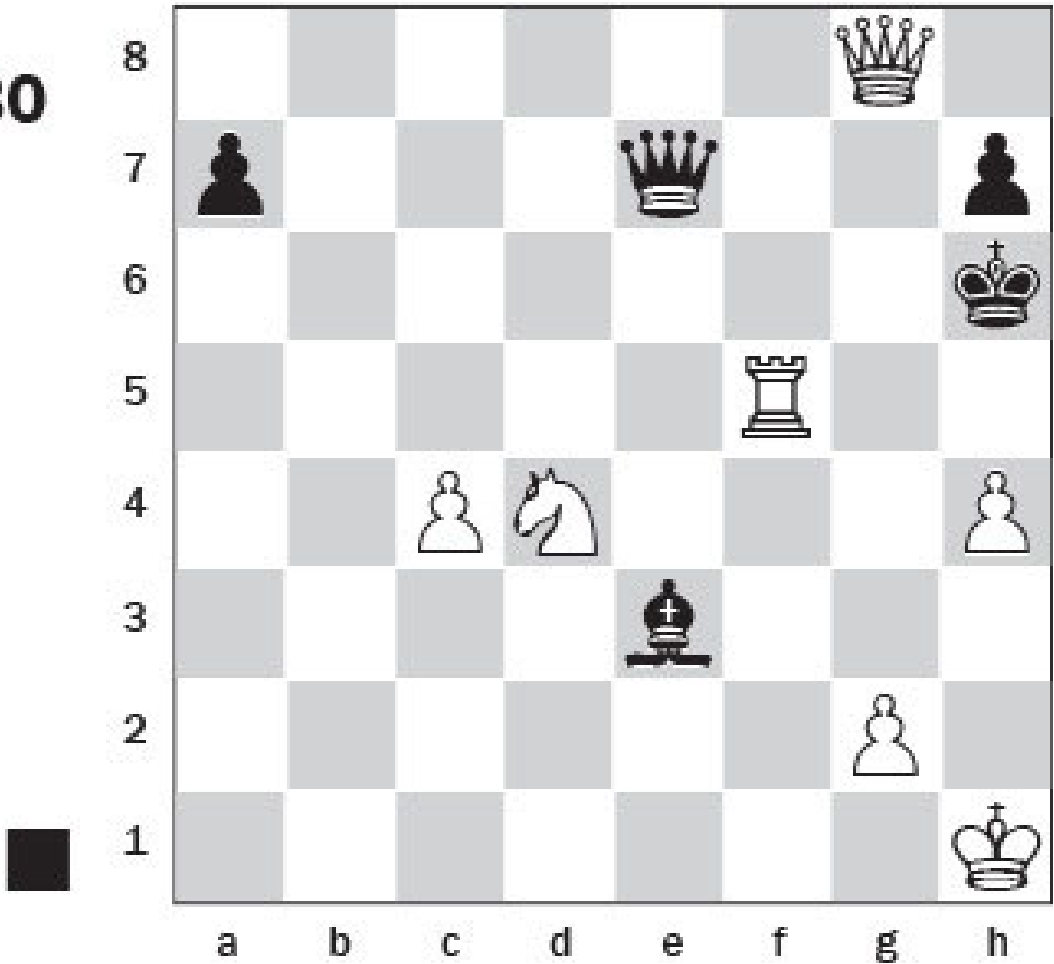
Answer:

1. Rh4# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 530

**530**



Answer:

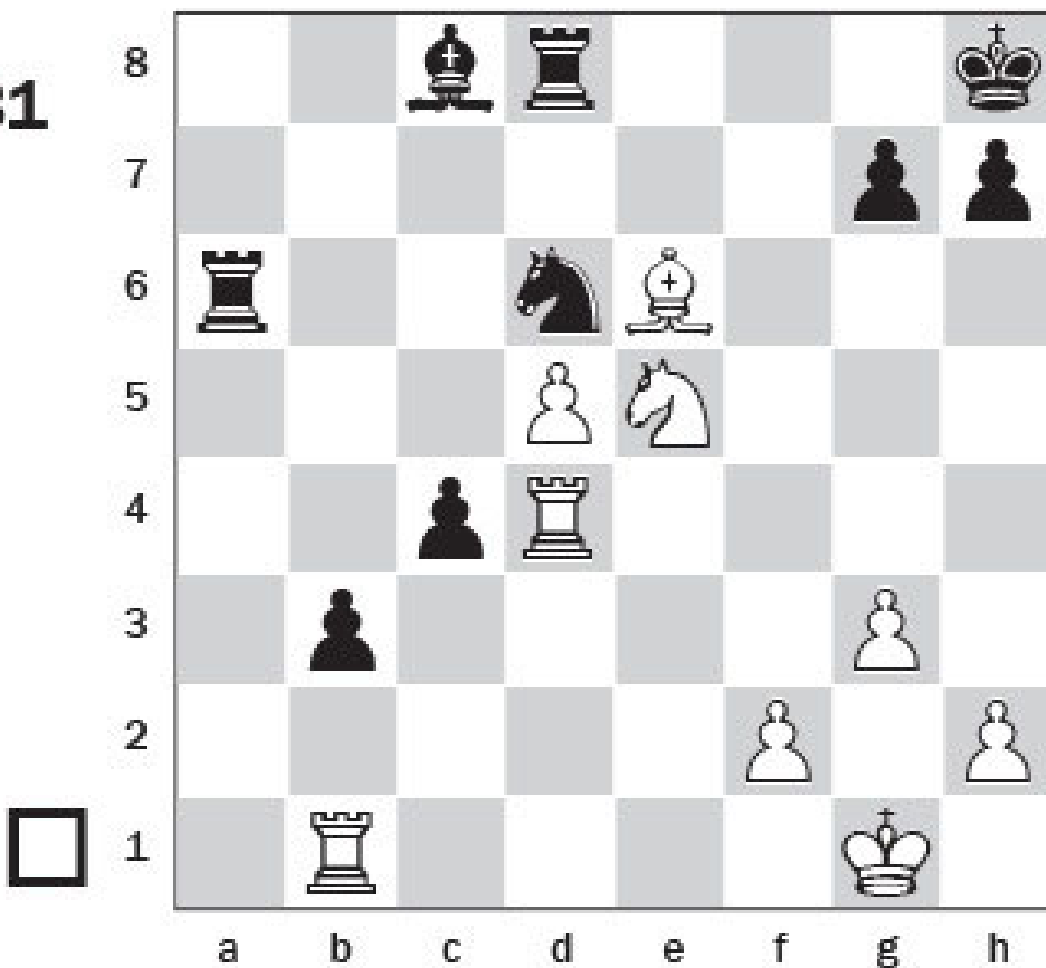
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on e3 is stopping the king from moving to g1. How can Black attack on the h-file?

### Exercise 531

**531**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

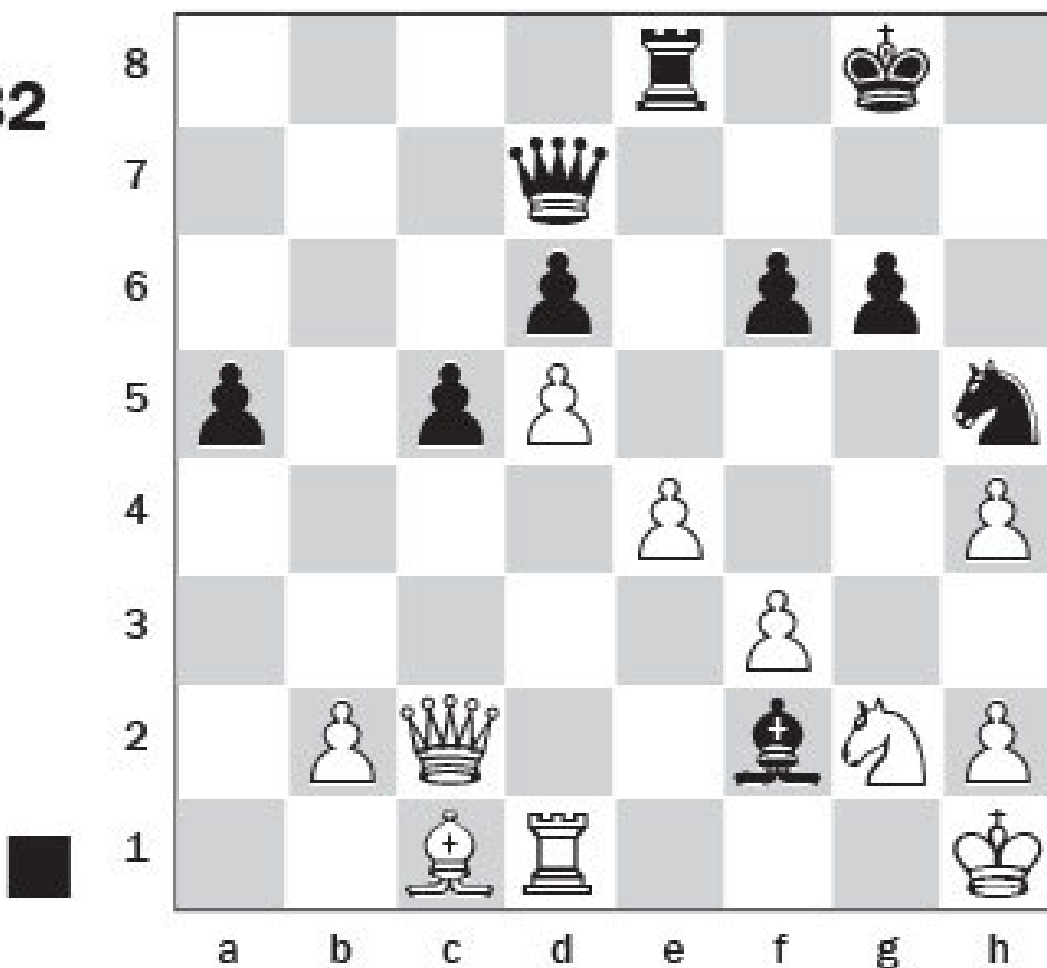
## HINT

The bishop on e6 is attacking the g8-square. White needs to open the h-file. Sacrifice to open the h-file for checkmate.

# Greco's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 532

**532**



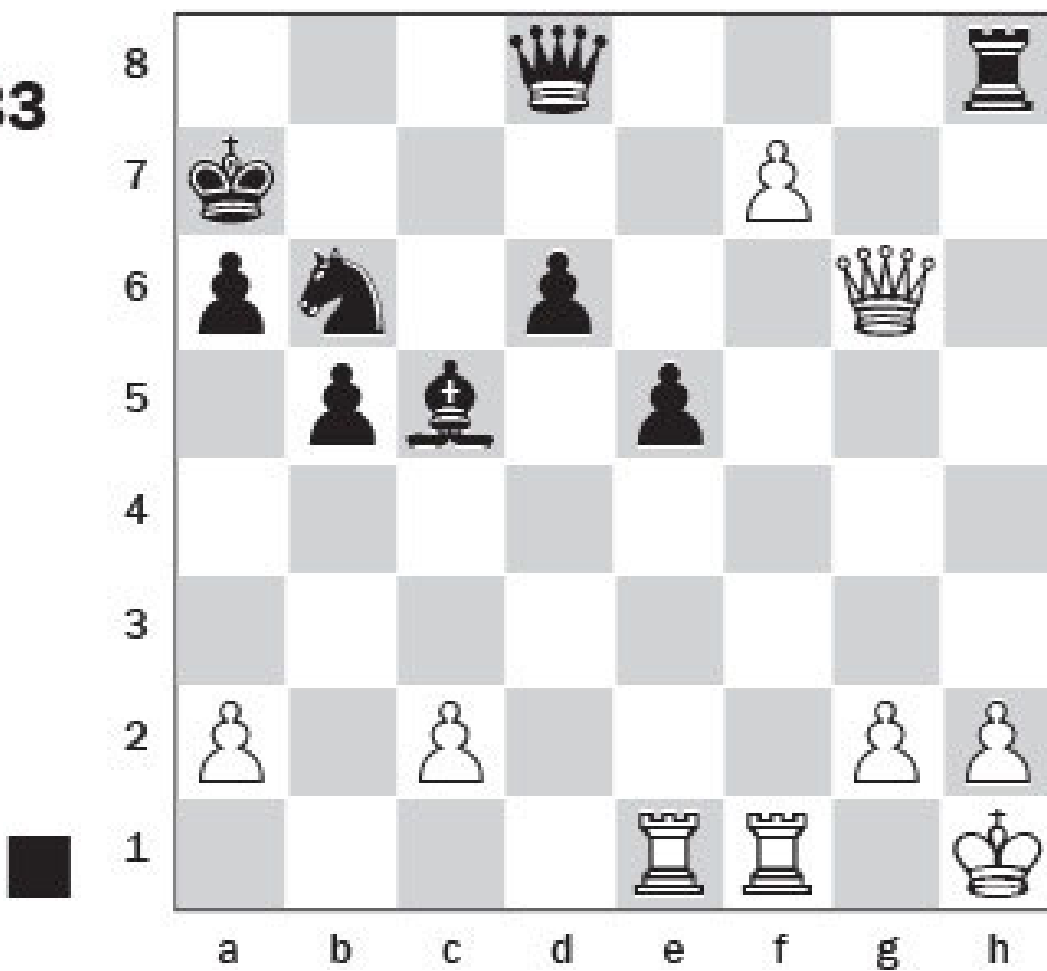
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 533

**533**



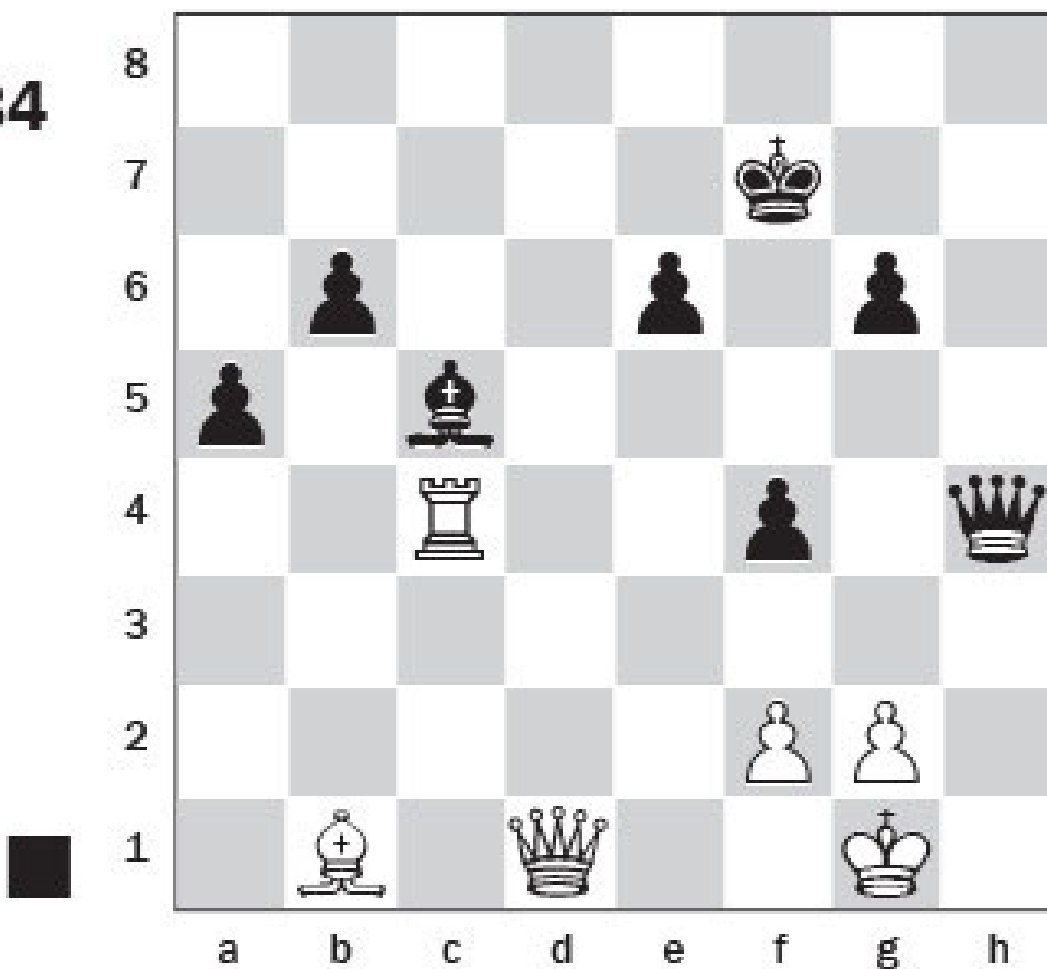
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 534

**534**



Answer:

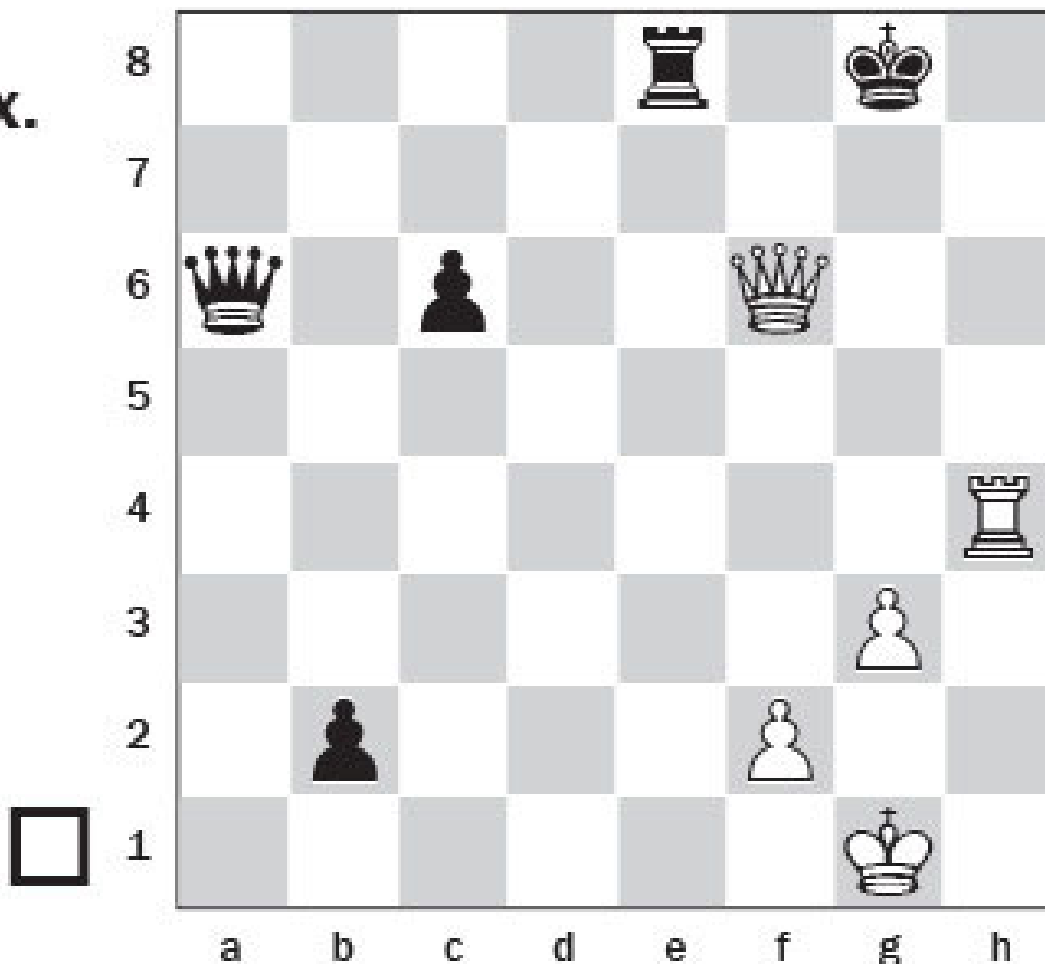
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Kill Box Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



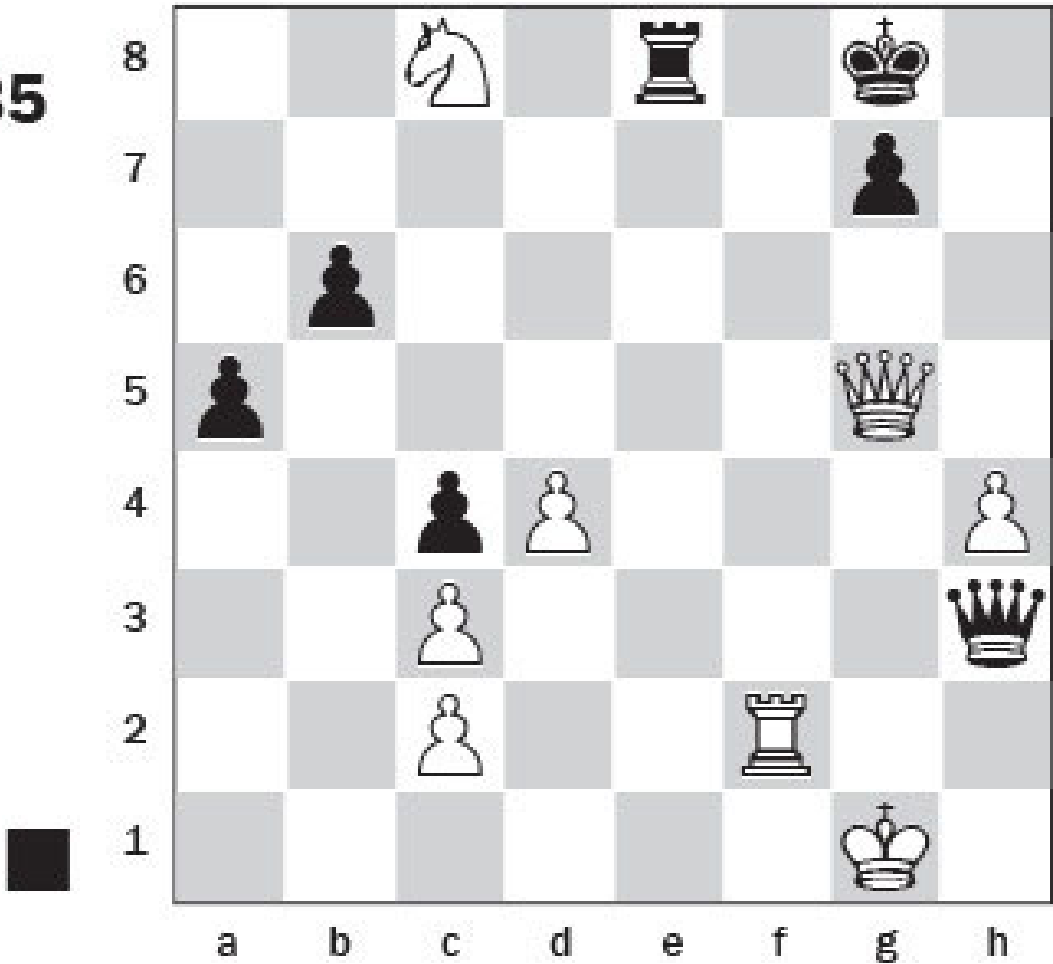
Answer:

1. Rh8# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 535

**535**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

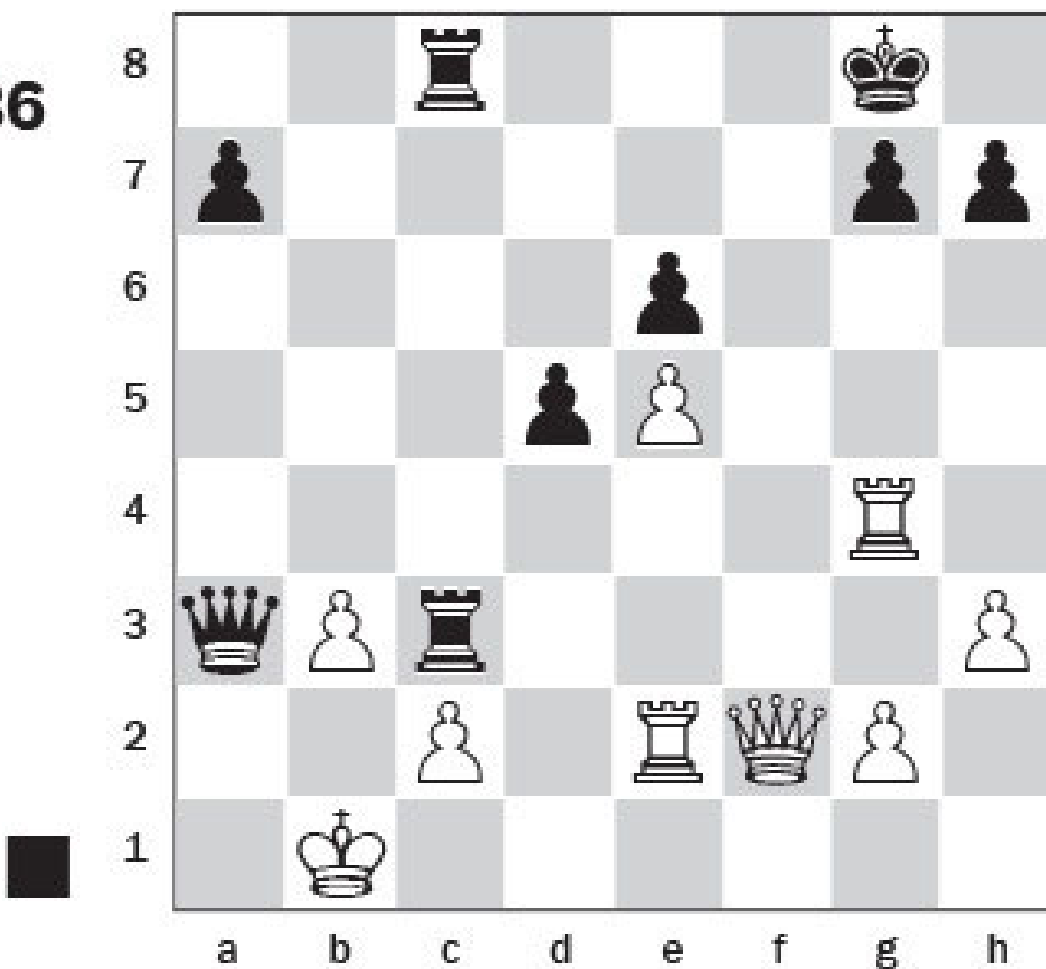
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The queen is boxing in the king. Bring the rook in for the final blow.

### Exercise 536

**536**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

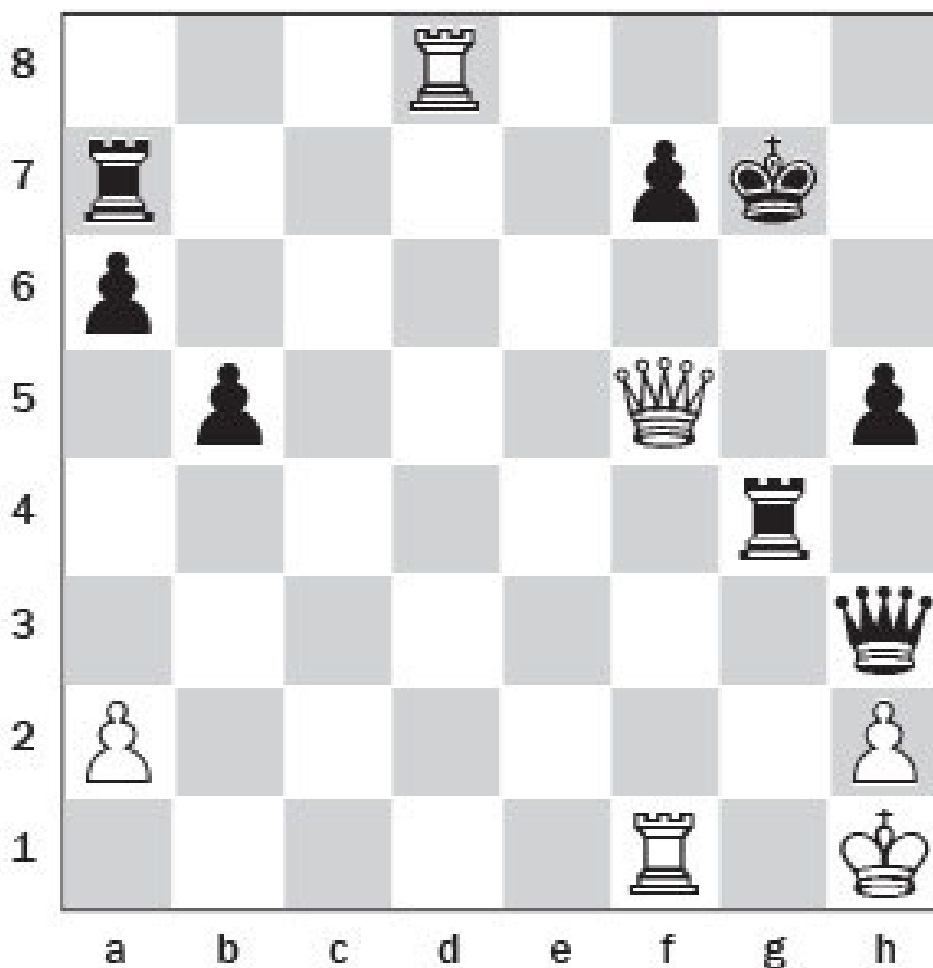
## HINT

If Black could get a rook to c1, that would be a classic kill box checkmate. How can Black do that?

# Kill Box Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 537

**537**



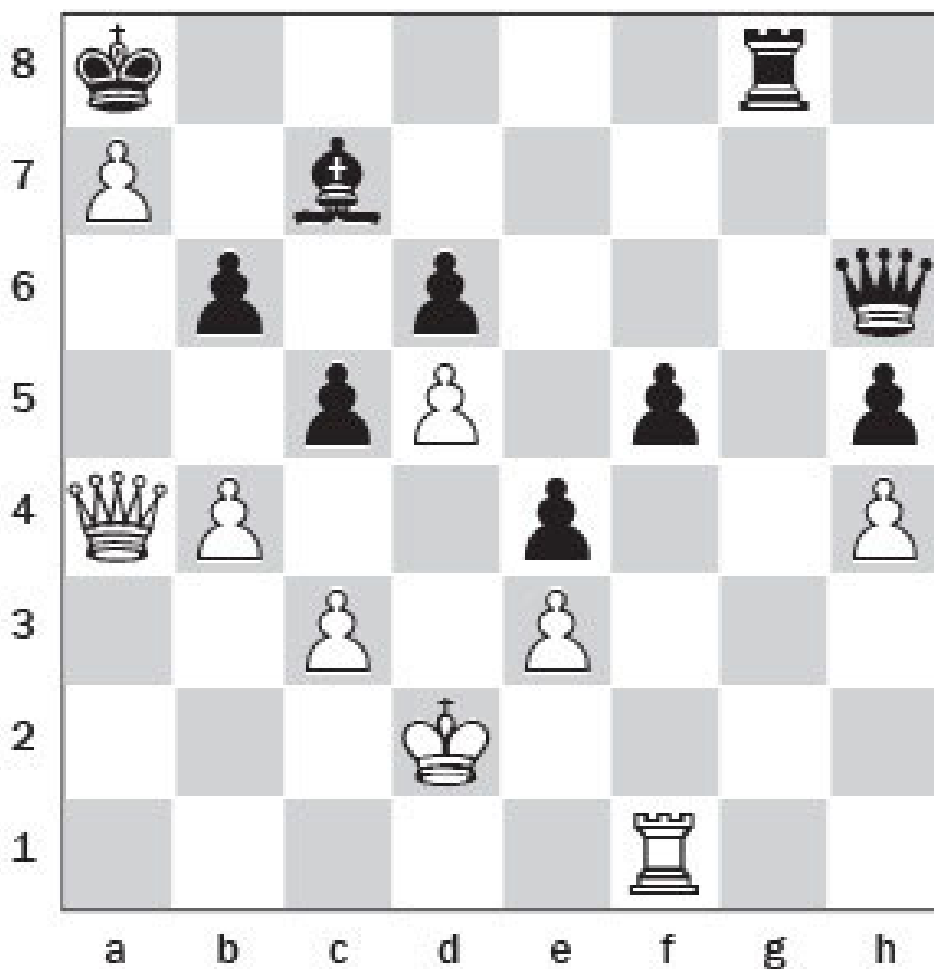
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 538

**538**



Answer:

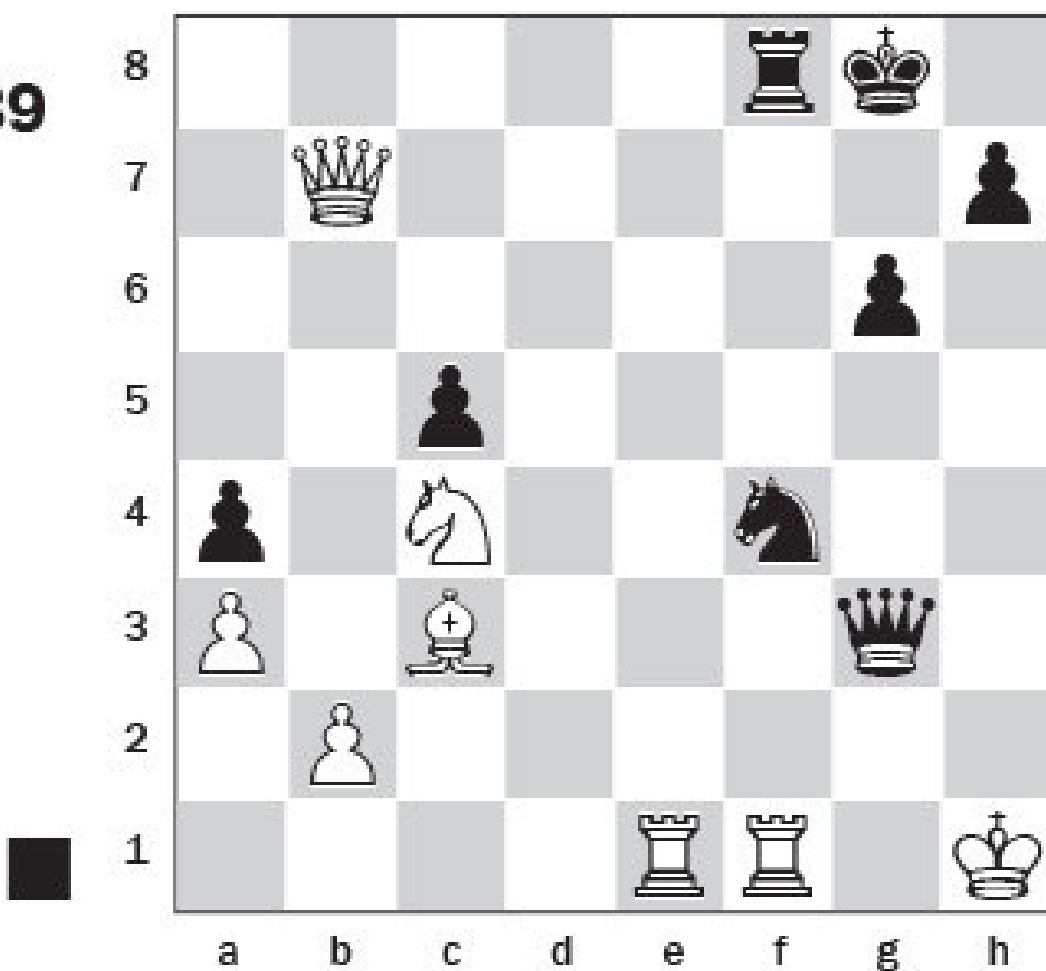
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 539

**539**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

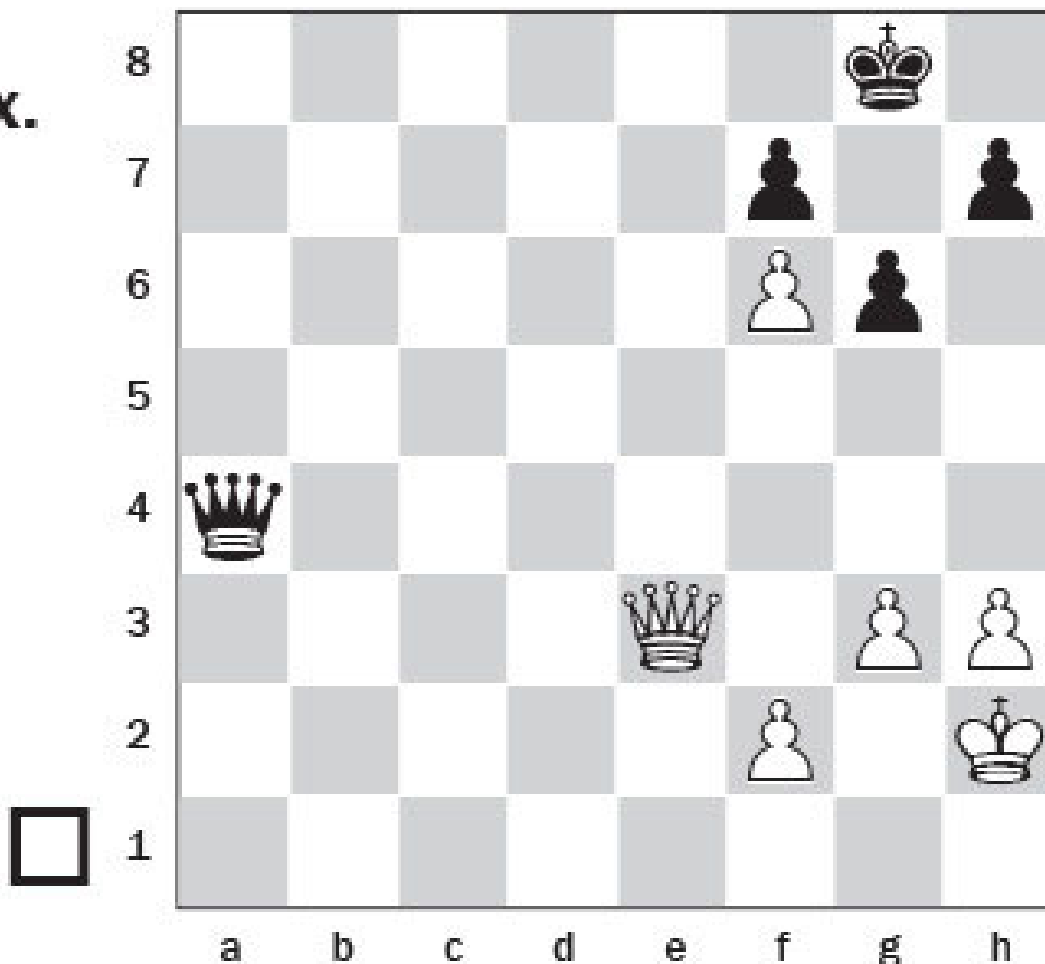
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_



# Lolli's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

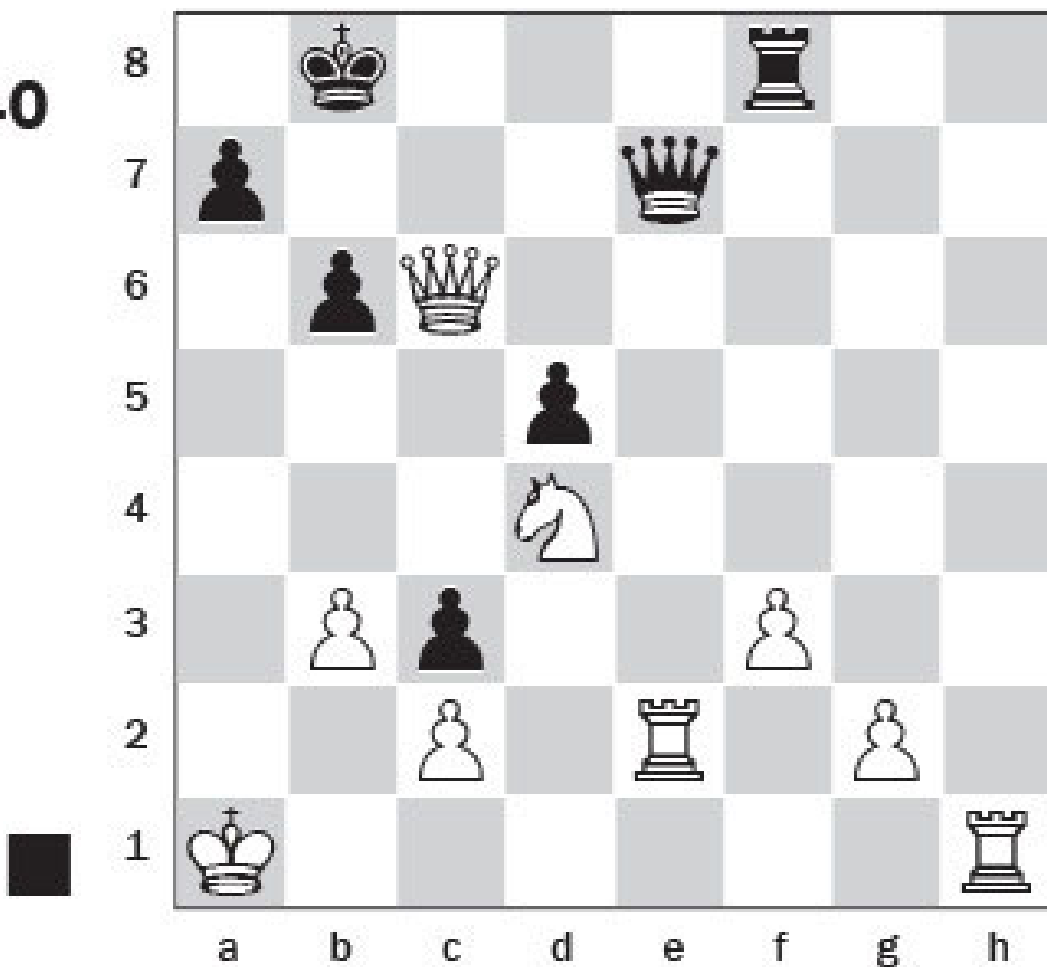
1. Qh6 Qe8

2. Qg7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

**Exercise 540**

**540**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

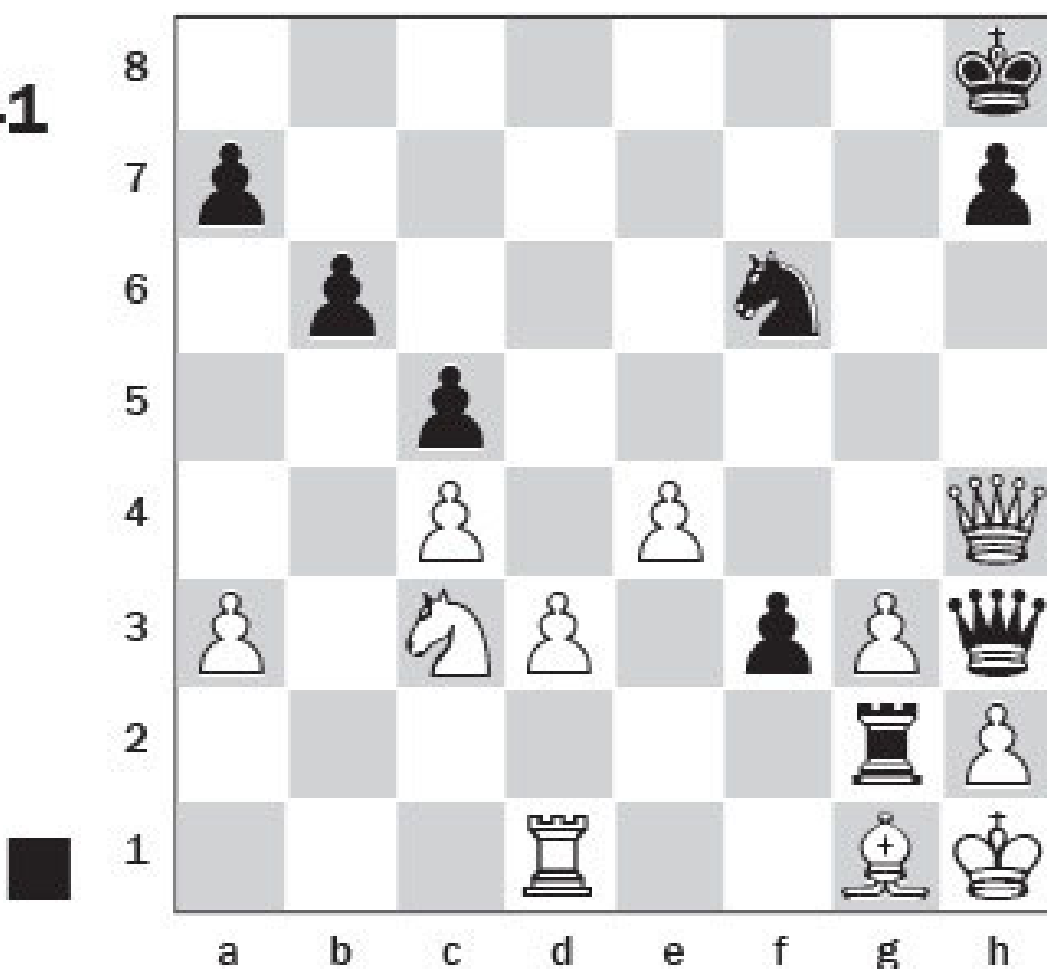
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The pawn on c3 is a thorn in White's side. Bring the queen in for the final blow.

### Exercise 541

**541**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

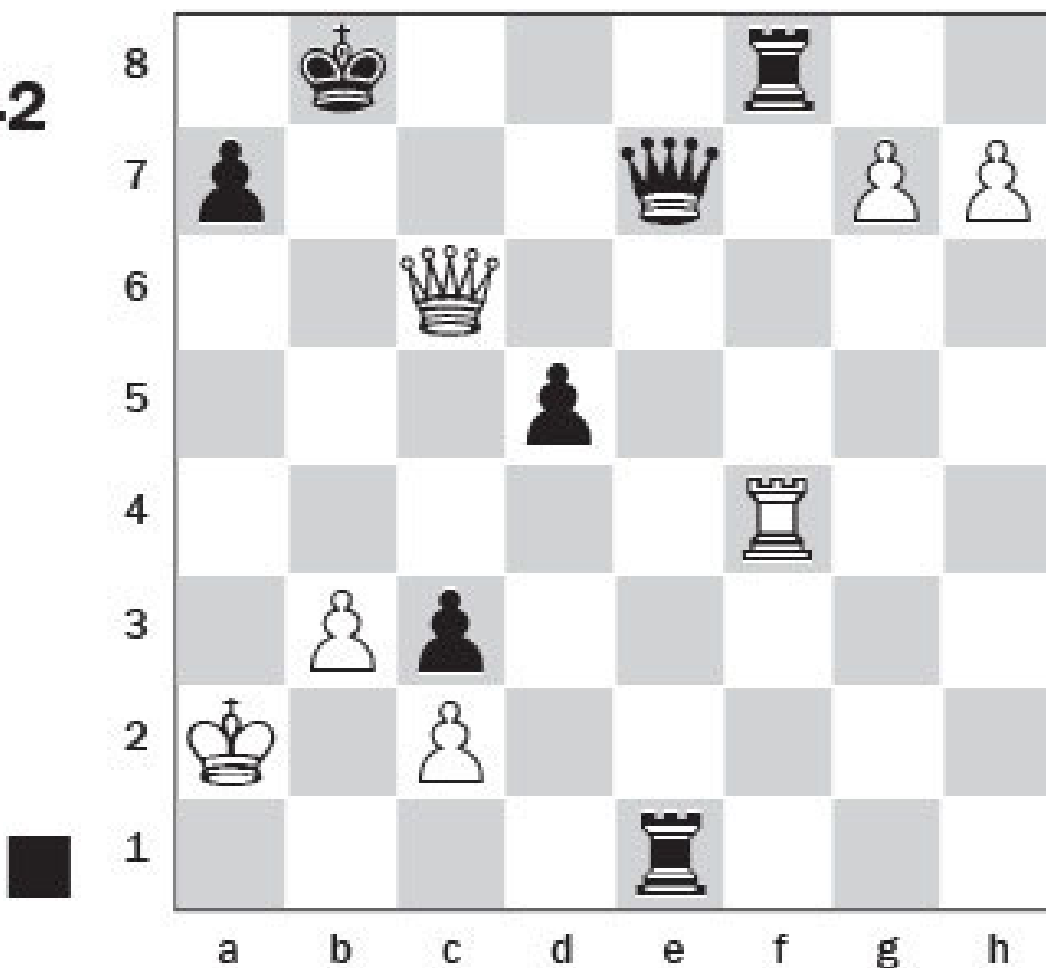
### **HINT**

Black's queen would love to switch places with the rook. Find the best way to do it.

# Lolli's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 542

**542**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 543

**543**



Answer:

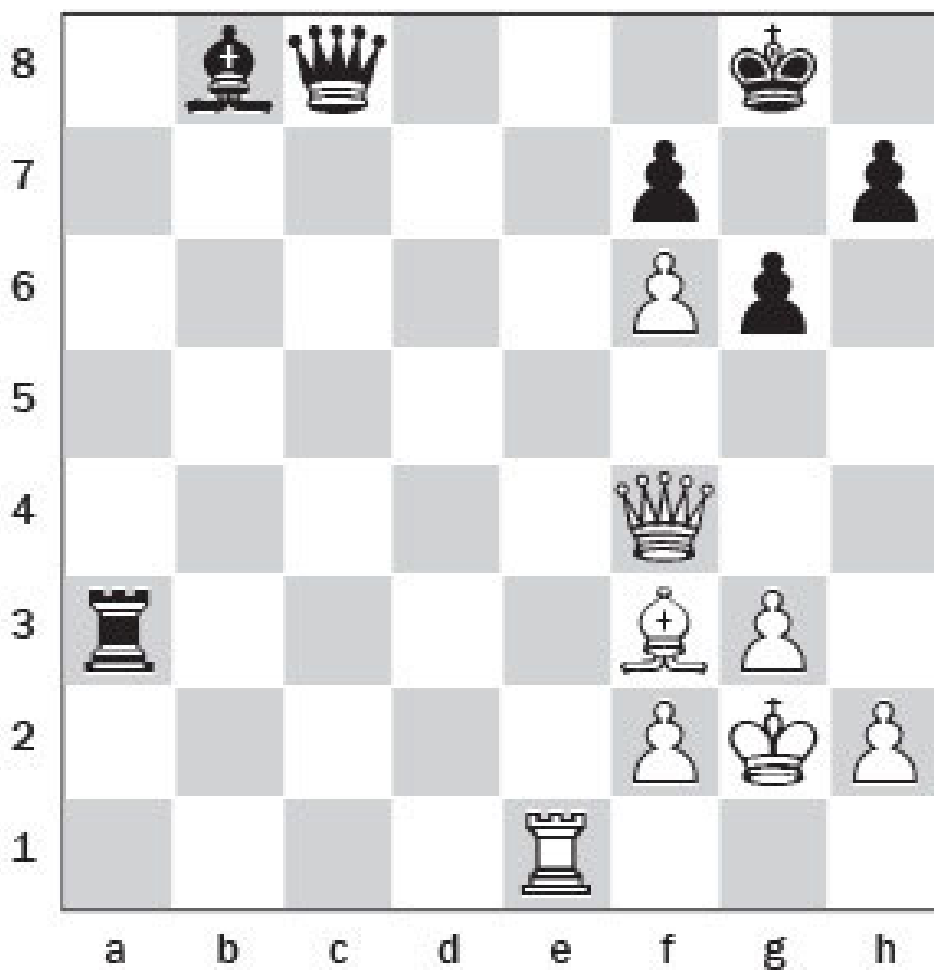
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 544

**544**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

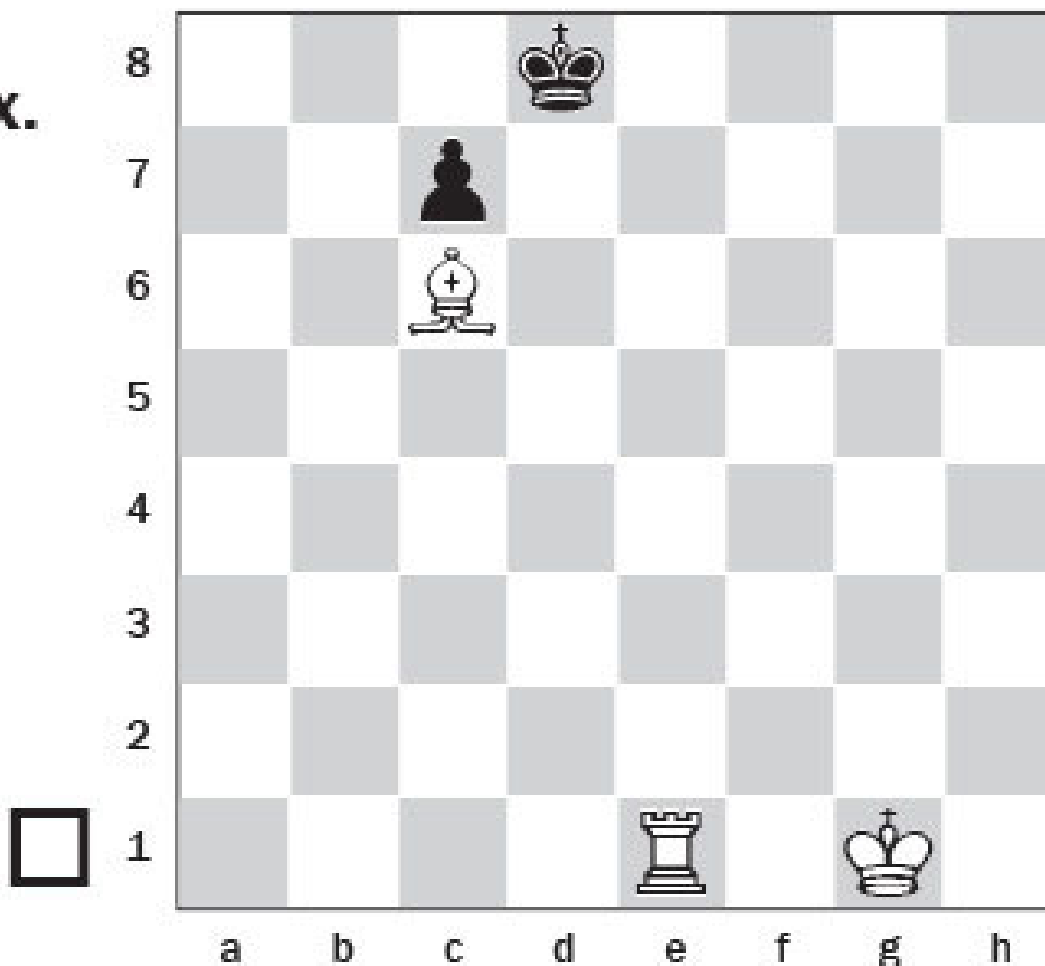
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_



# Opera House Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



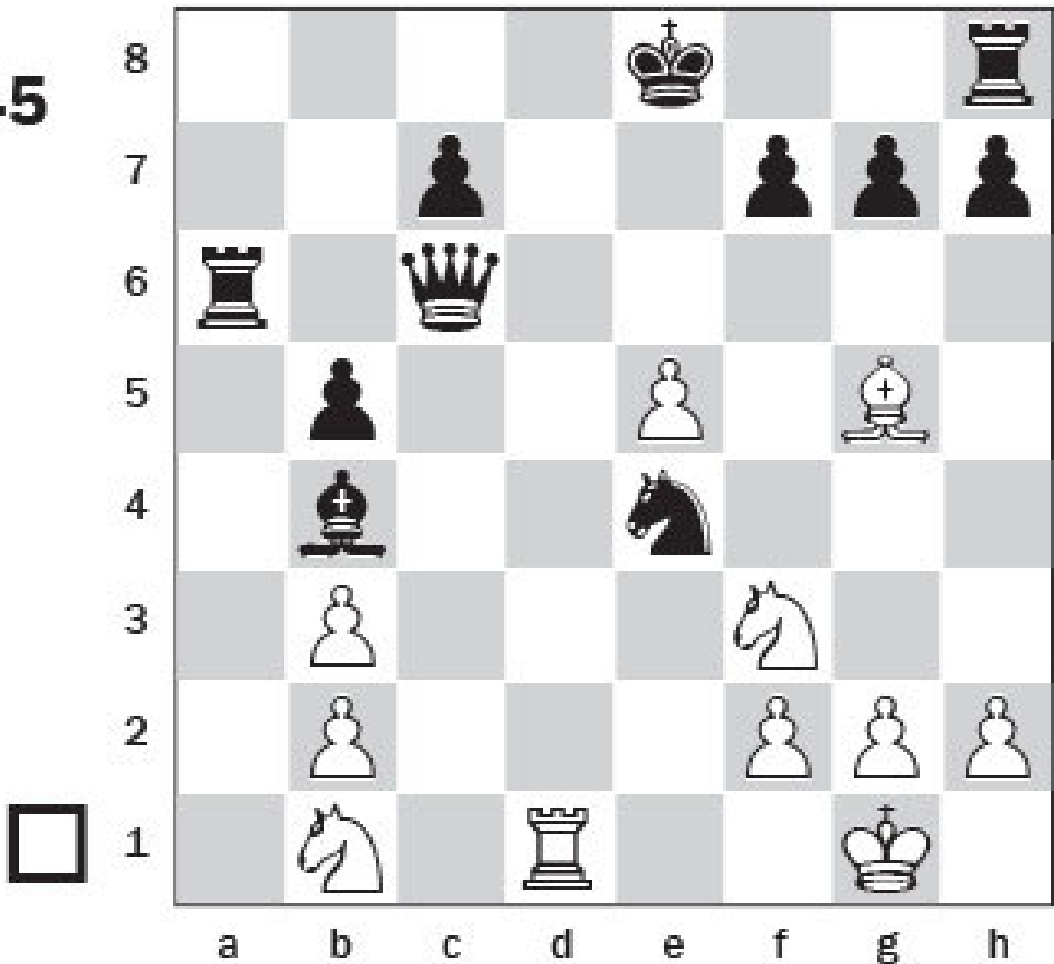
Answer:

1. Re8# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 545

545



Answer:

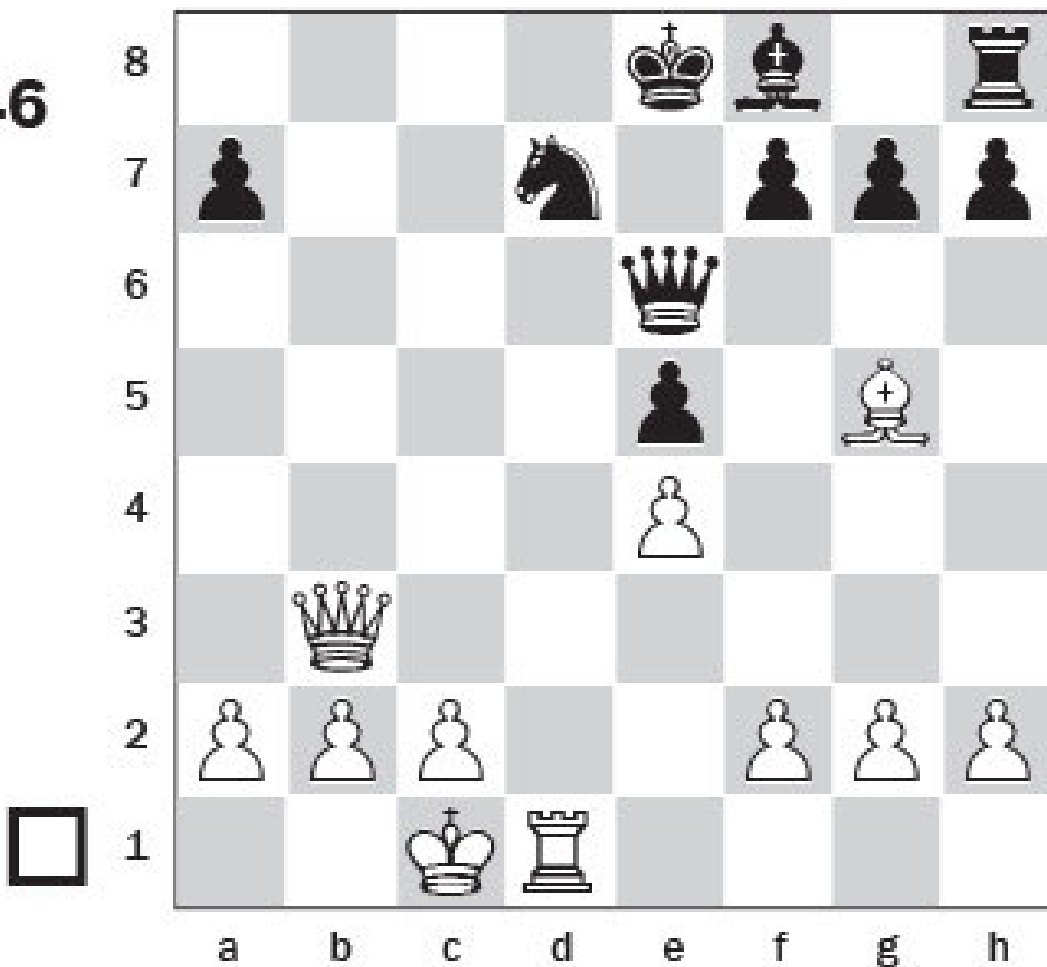
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on the d-file is ready to go, the bishop on g5 is ready to help.

### Exercise 546

546



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

This is a famous position from the Opera House game! White wants to play Rd8# but the knight is in the way. Use a distraction tactic!

# Opera House Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 547

547



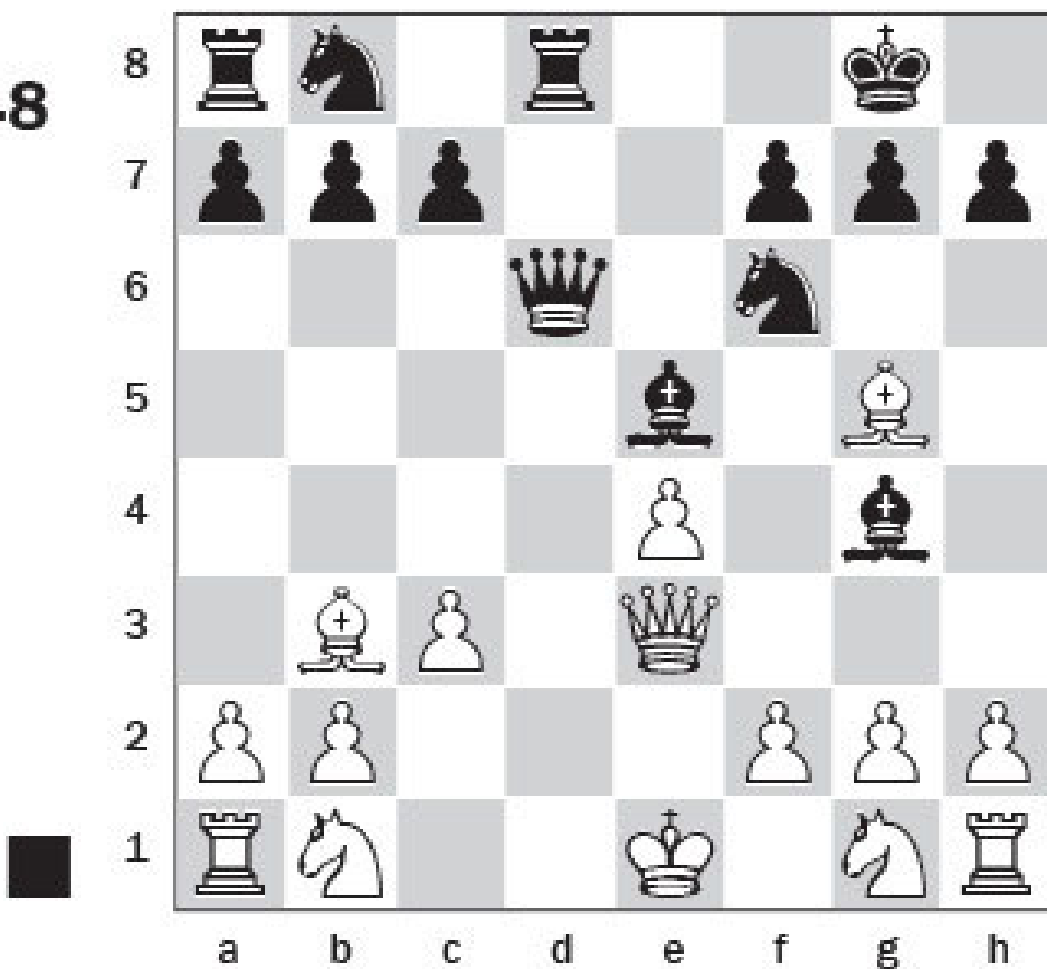
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 548

548



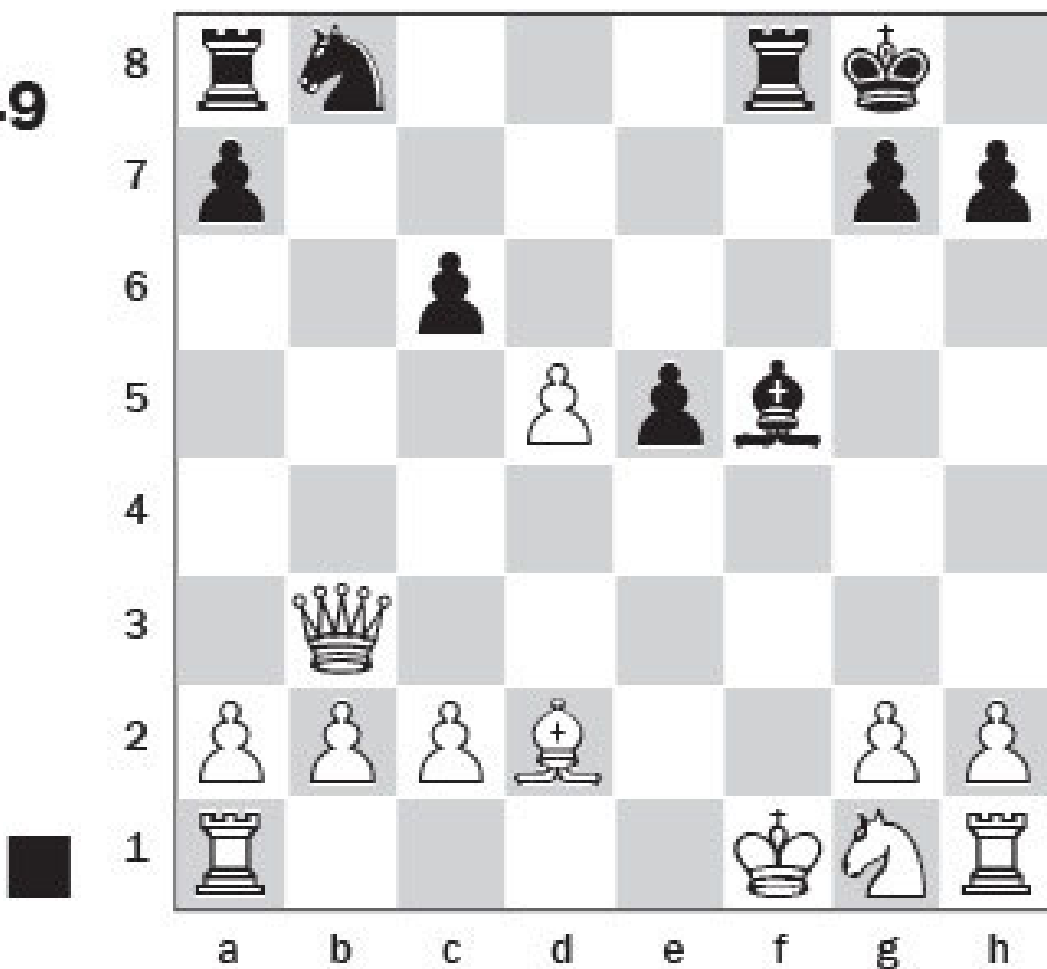
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 549

549



Answer:

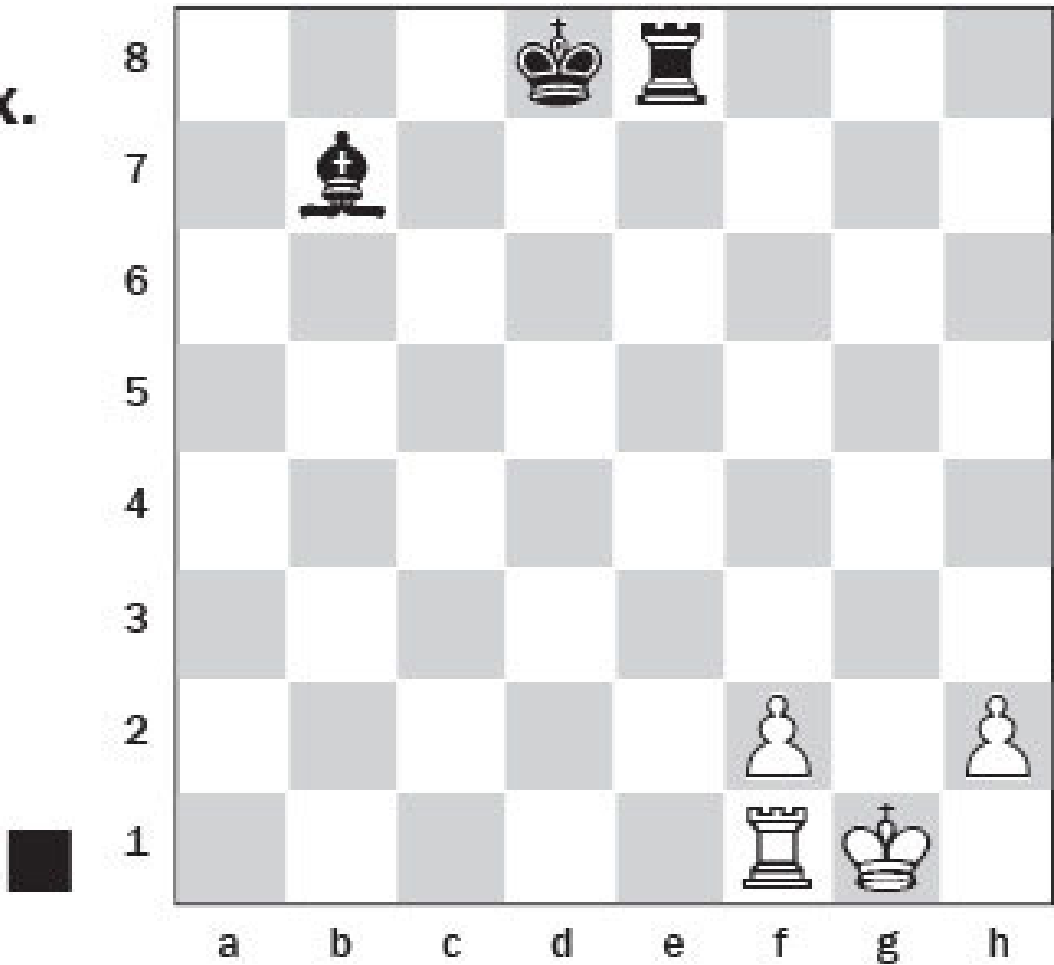
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



# Pillsbury's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



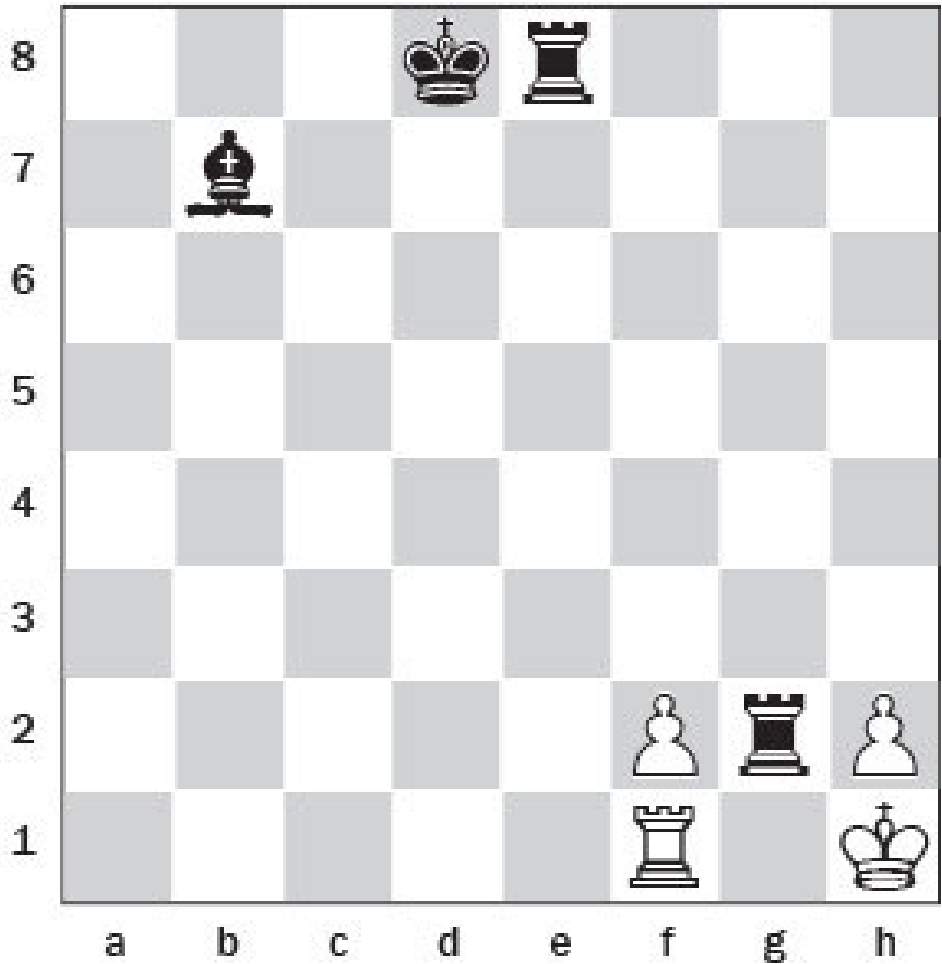
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_ Rg8#

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

Exercise 550

**550**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

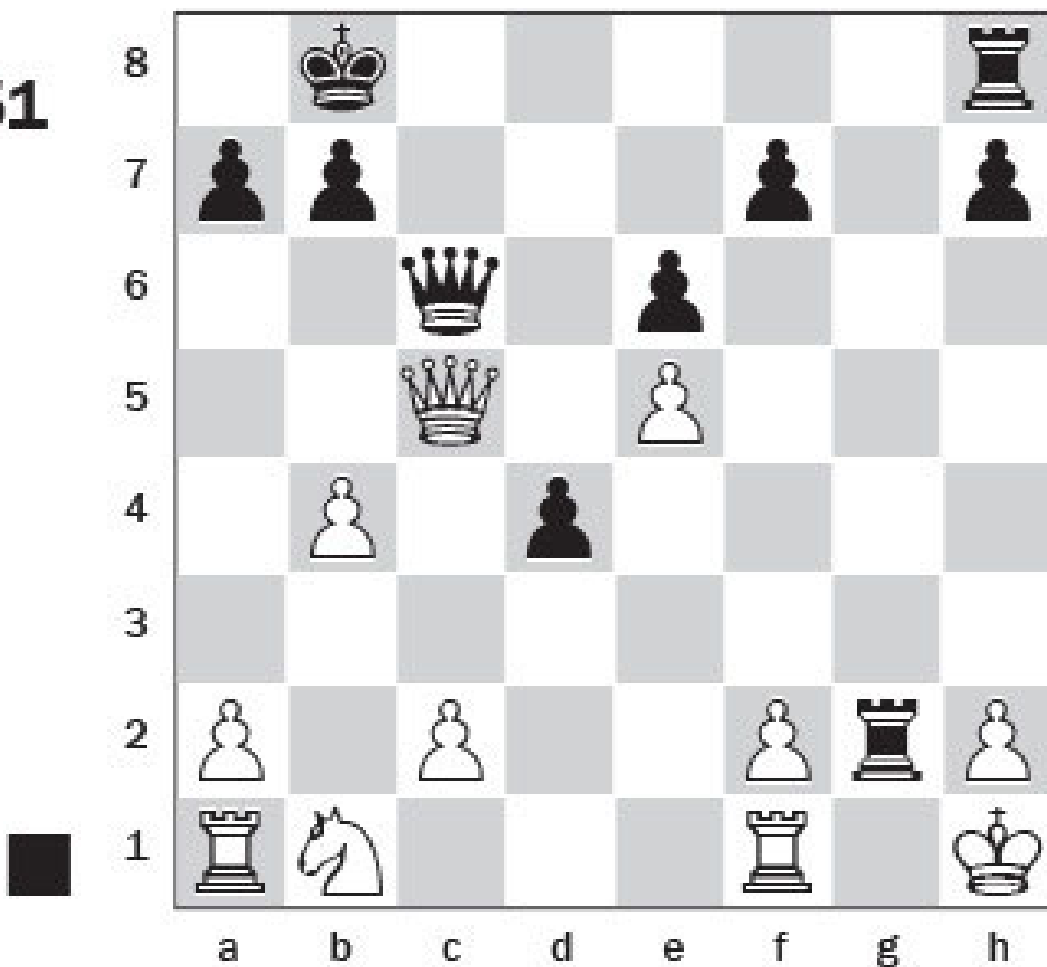
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a double check to force the king to the g-file, then give checkmate.

### Exercise 551

**551**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

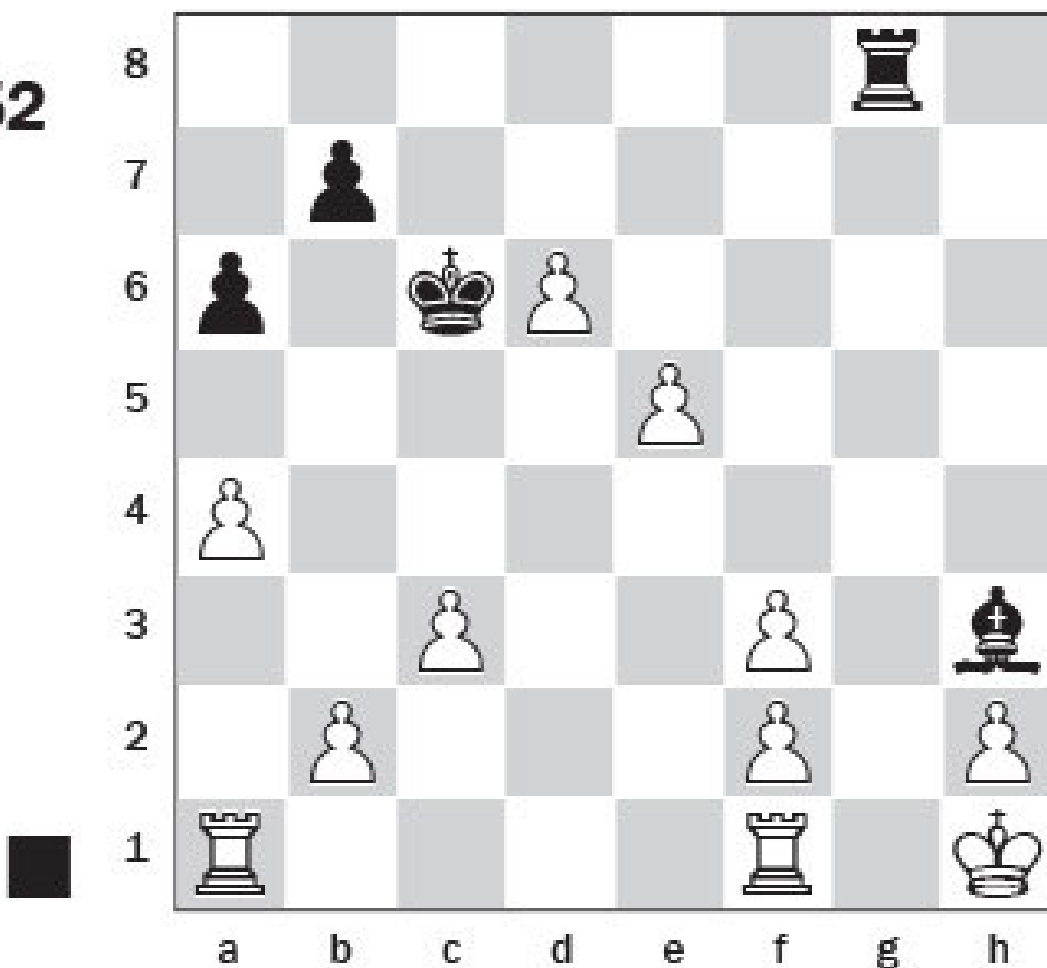
## HINT

Use a double check to force the king to the g-file, then give checkmate.

# Pillsbury's Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 552

**552**



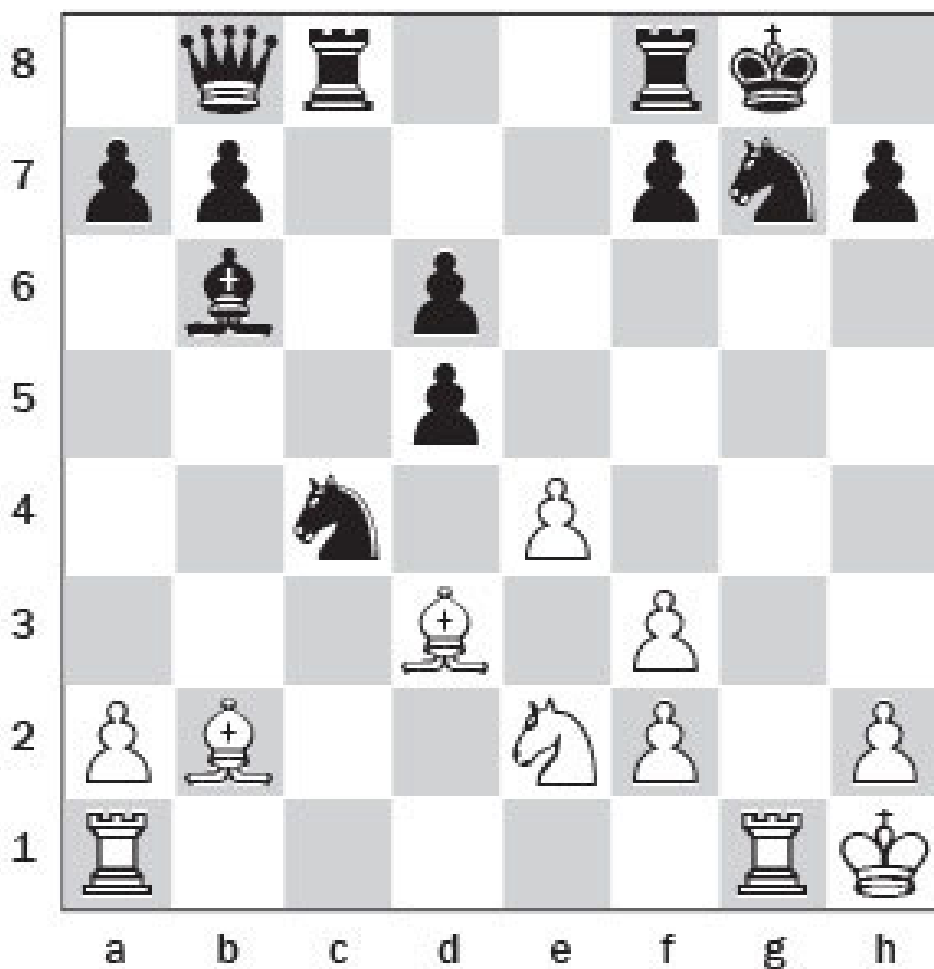
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 553

**553**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 554

**554**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

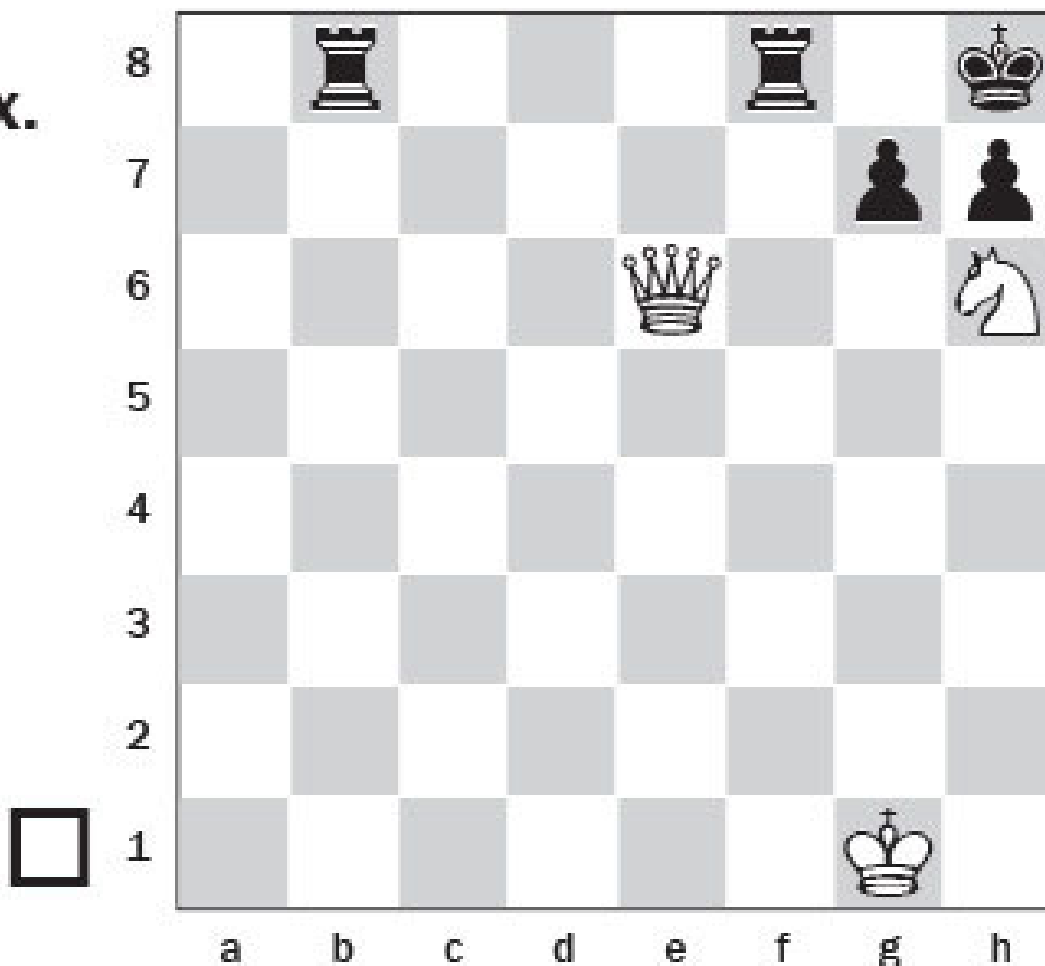
3. \_\_\_\_\_

4. \_\_\_\_\_



# Smothered Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



Answer:

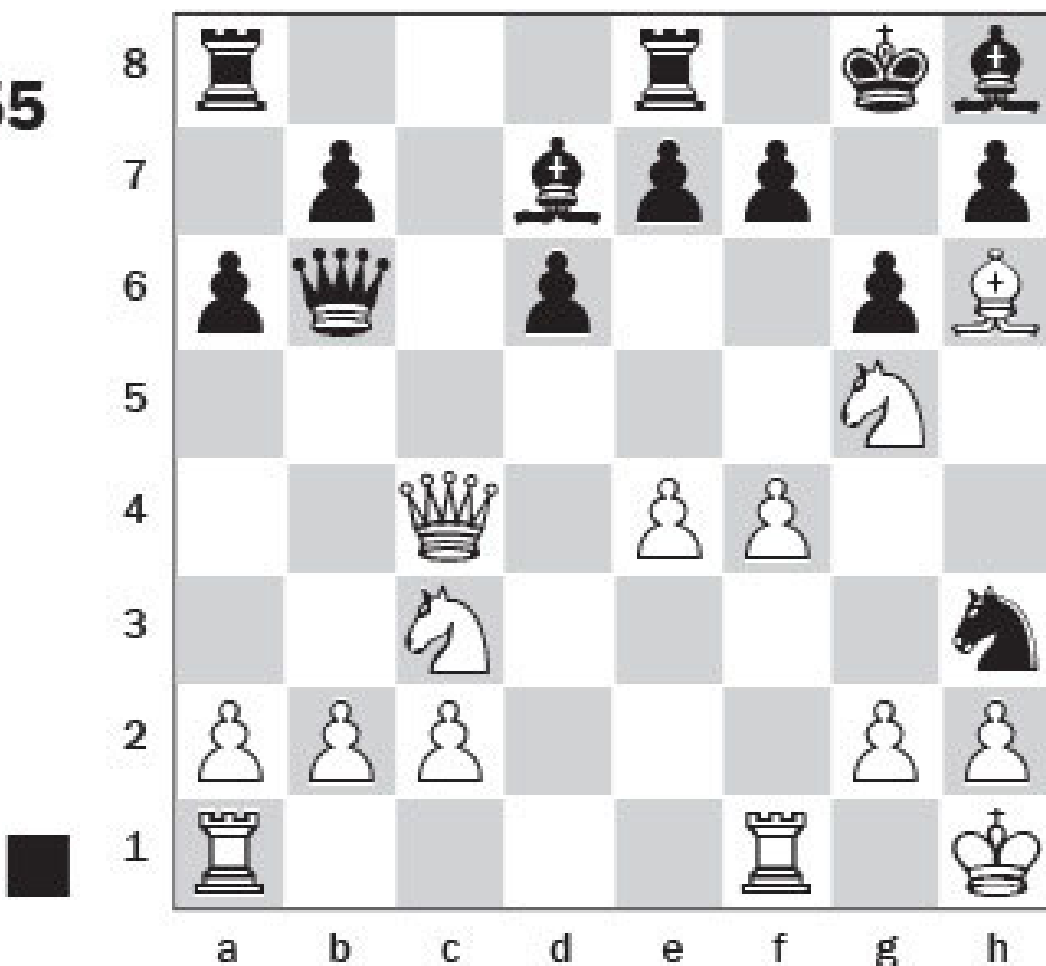
1. Qg8+ Rxg8

## 2. Nf7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

### Exercise 555

**555**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Give away your queen and force White's rook to smother his own king, then use the knight to checkmate.

### **Exercise 556**

556



**Answer:**

1. \_\_\_\_\_

**2. \_\_\_\_\_**

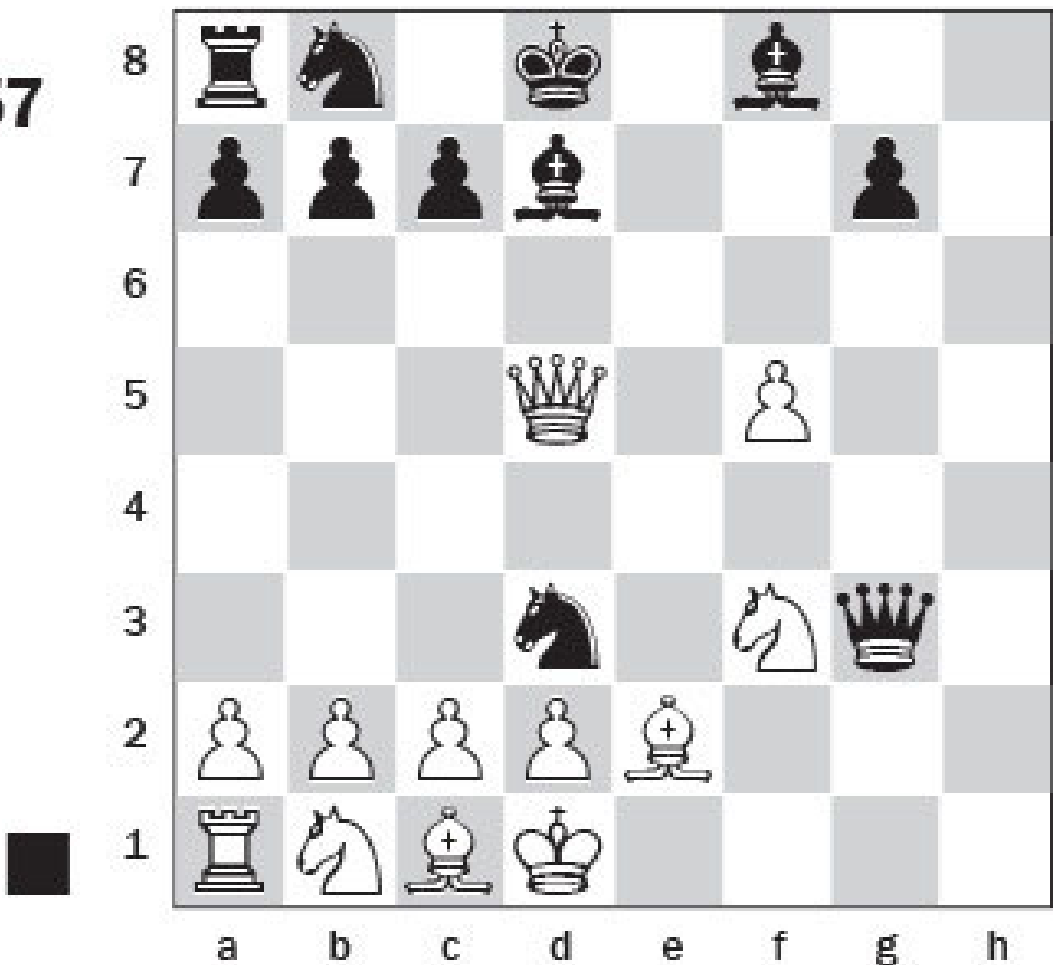
### HINT

The f7-square looks protected by the queen, which stops smothered checkmate. How did White distract the queen?

# Smothered Checkmate – Test

## Exercise 557

**557**



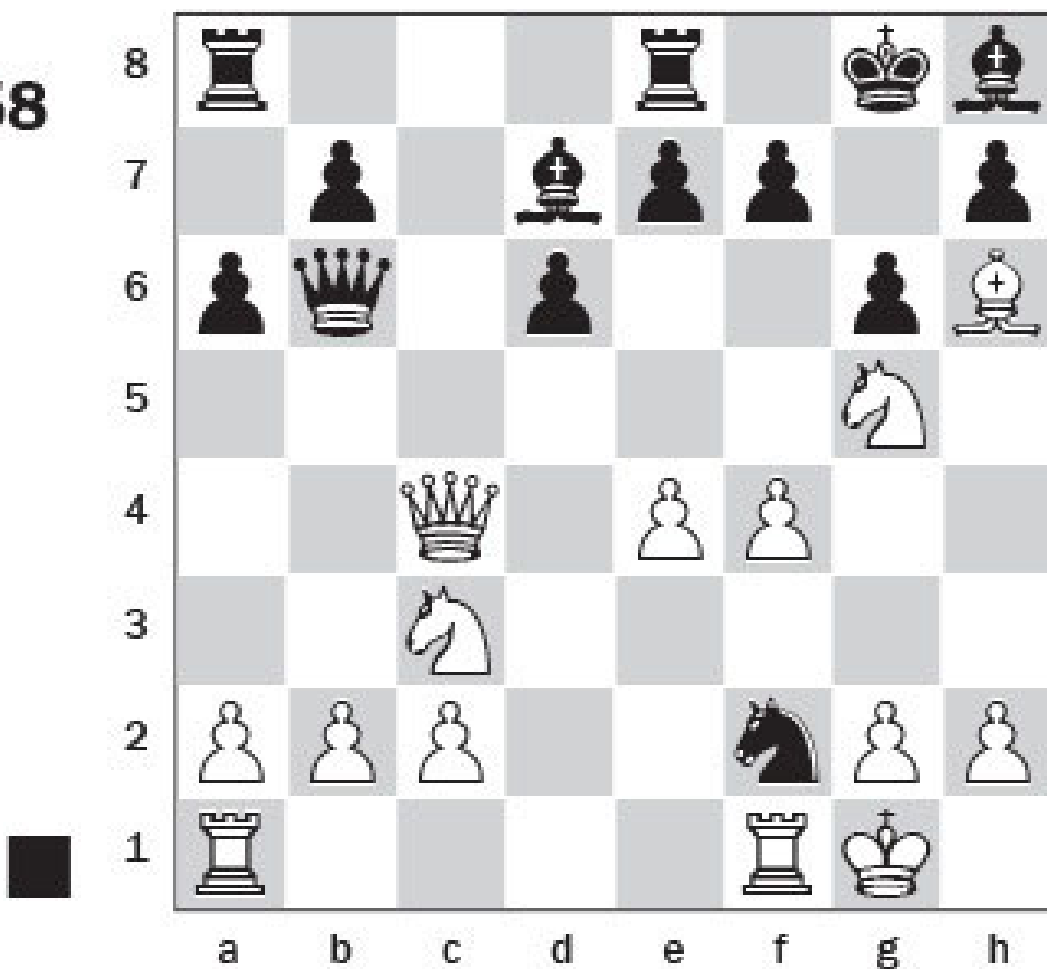
Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 558

558



Answer:

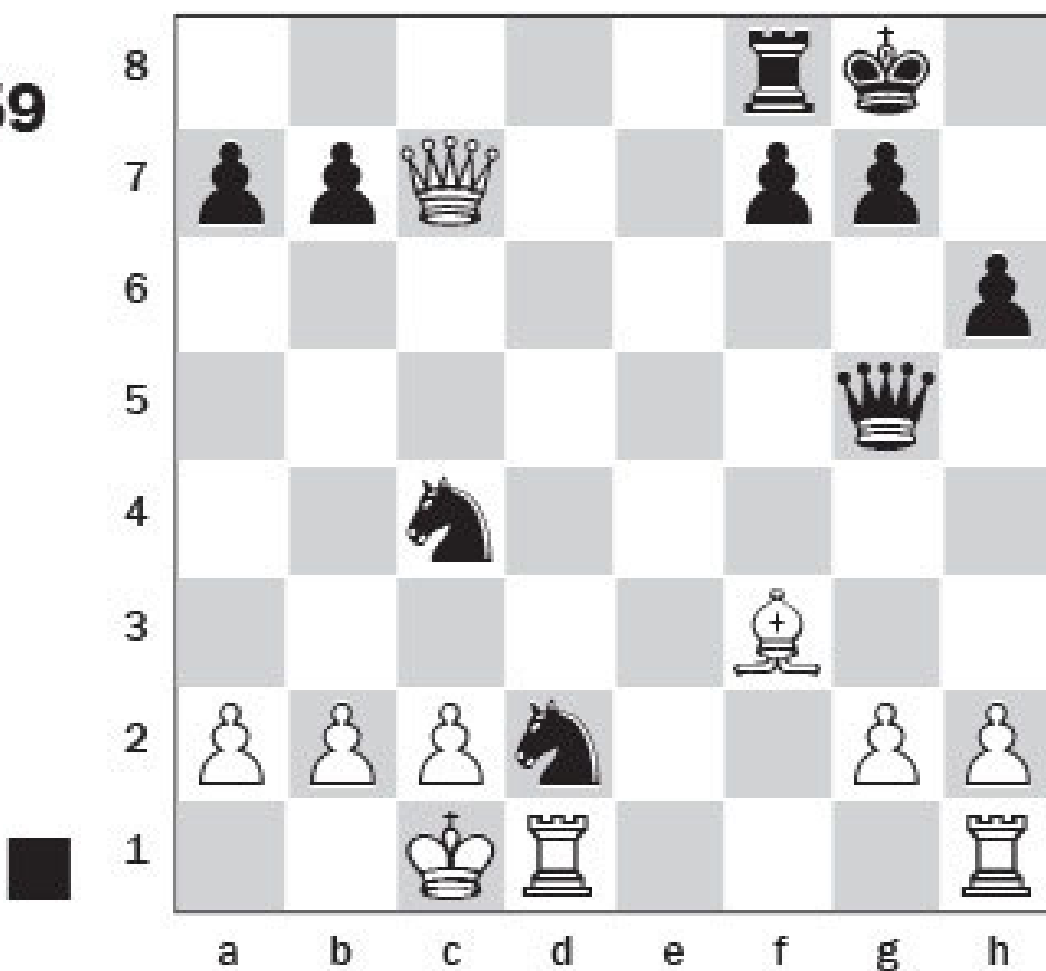
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 559

**559**



Answer:



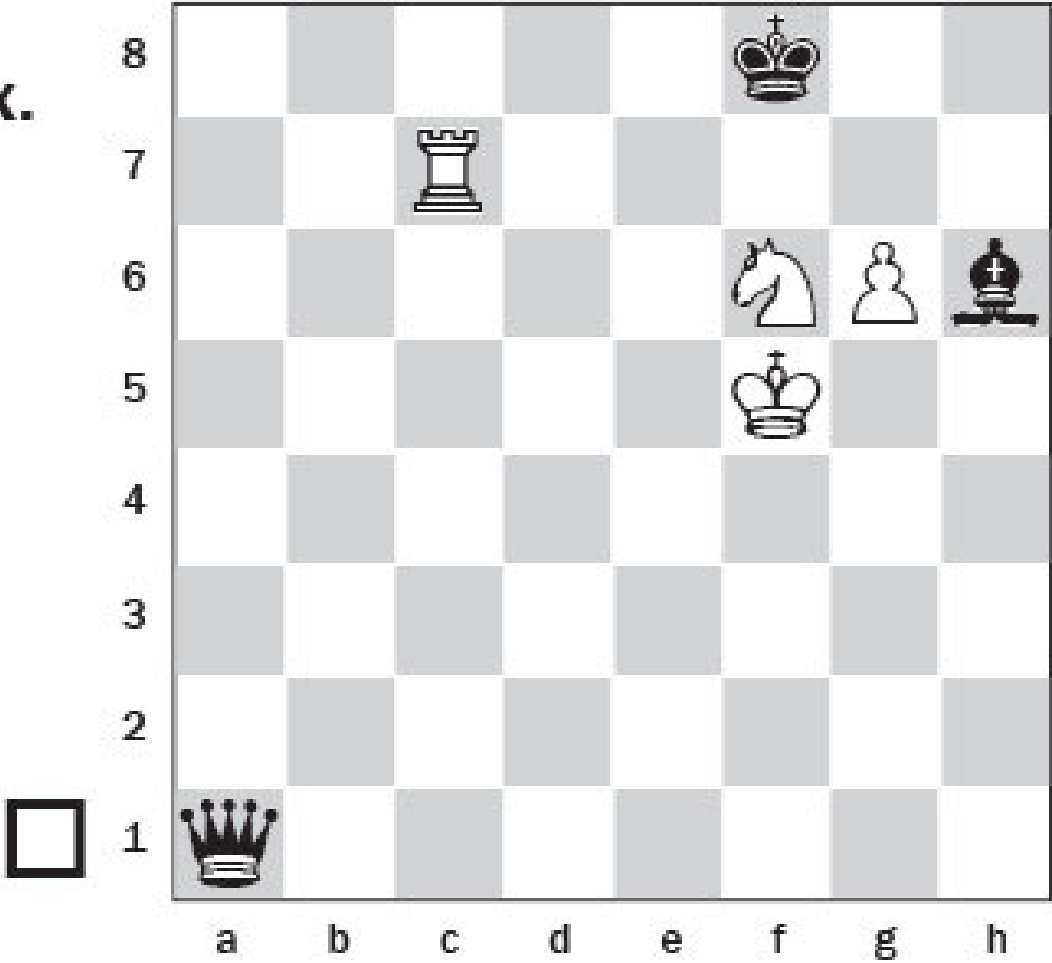
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

# Vukovic's Checkmate – Guided Practice

Ex.



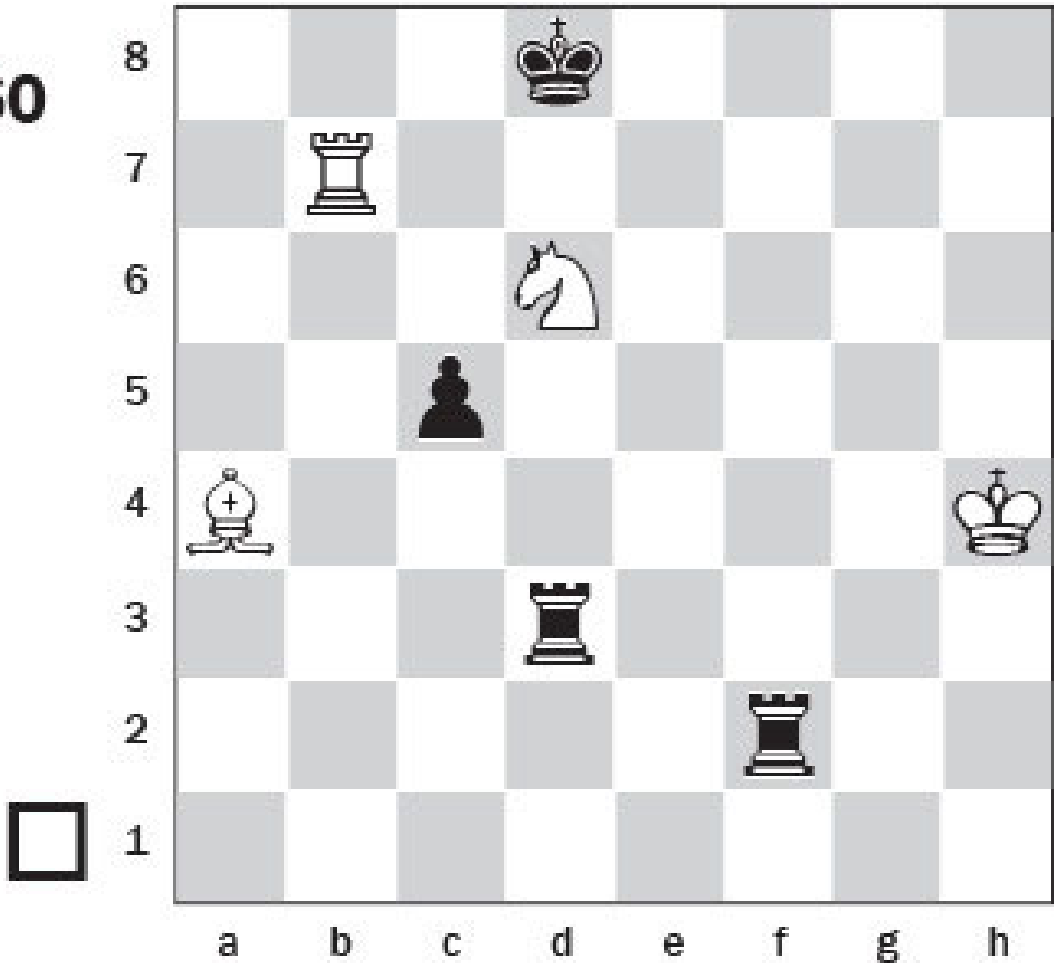
Answer:

1. Rf7# \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

**Exercise 560**

**560**



Answer:

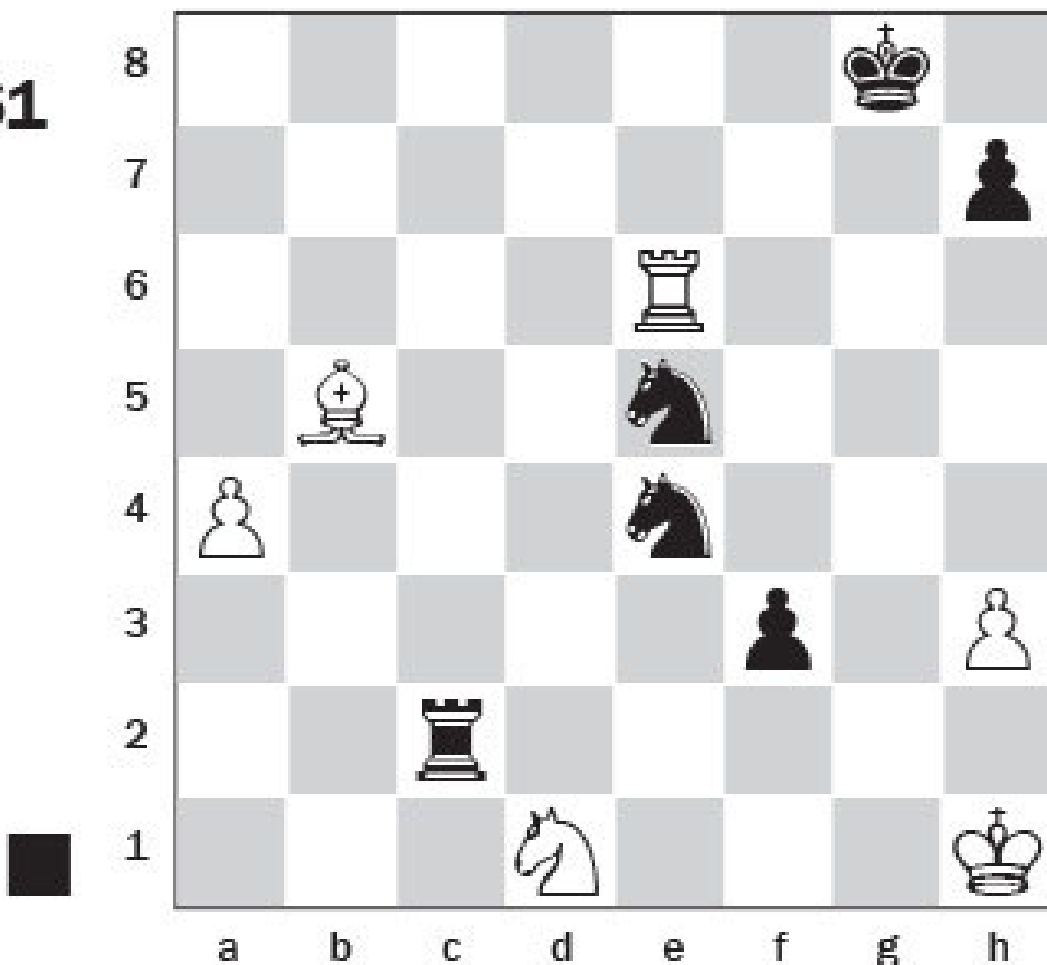
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on d6 attacks the e8- and c8-squares. The bishop on a4 will support the rook.

### Exercise 561

**561**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

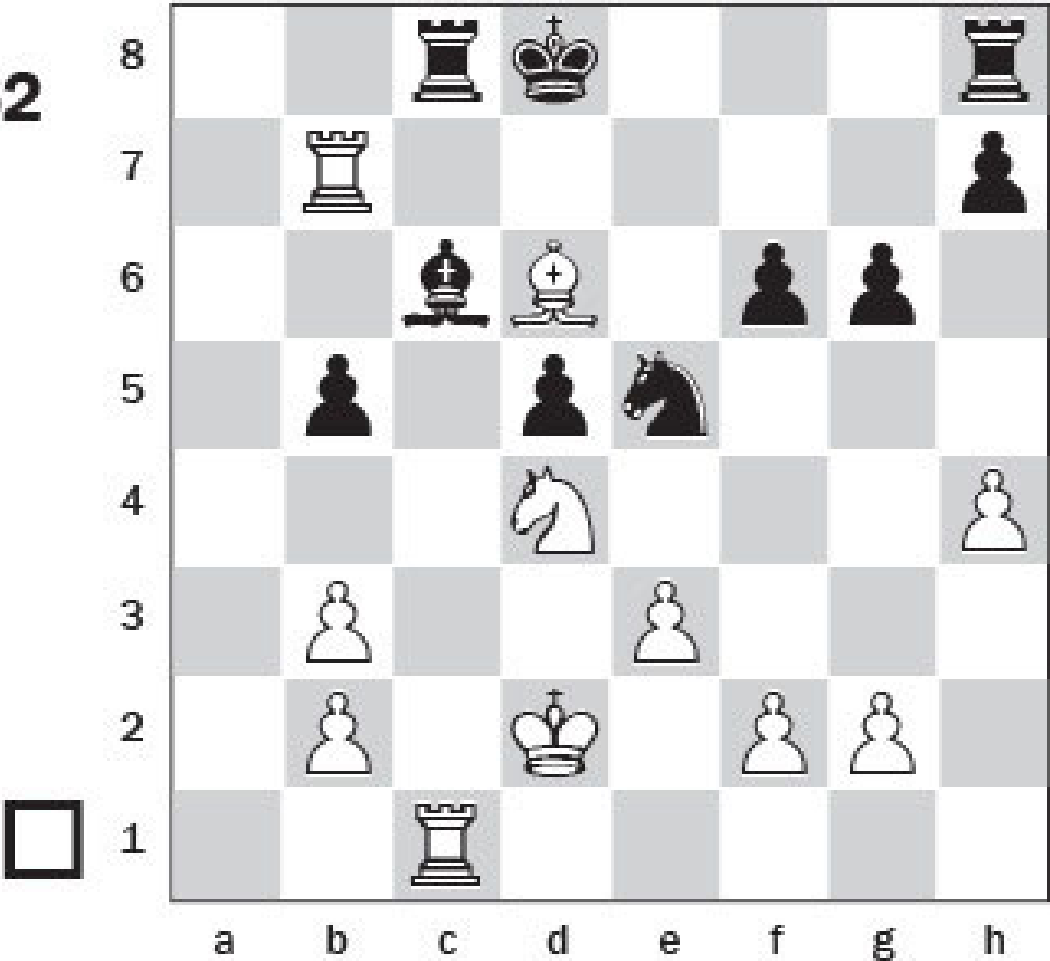
### **HINT**

Bring the knight in, then use the pawn to support the rook checkmate.

# Vukovic's Checkmate – Test

Exercise 562

562



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 563

**563**



Answer:

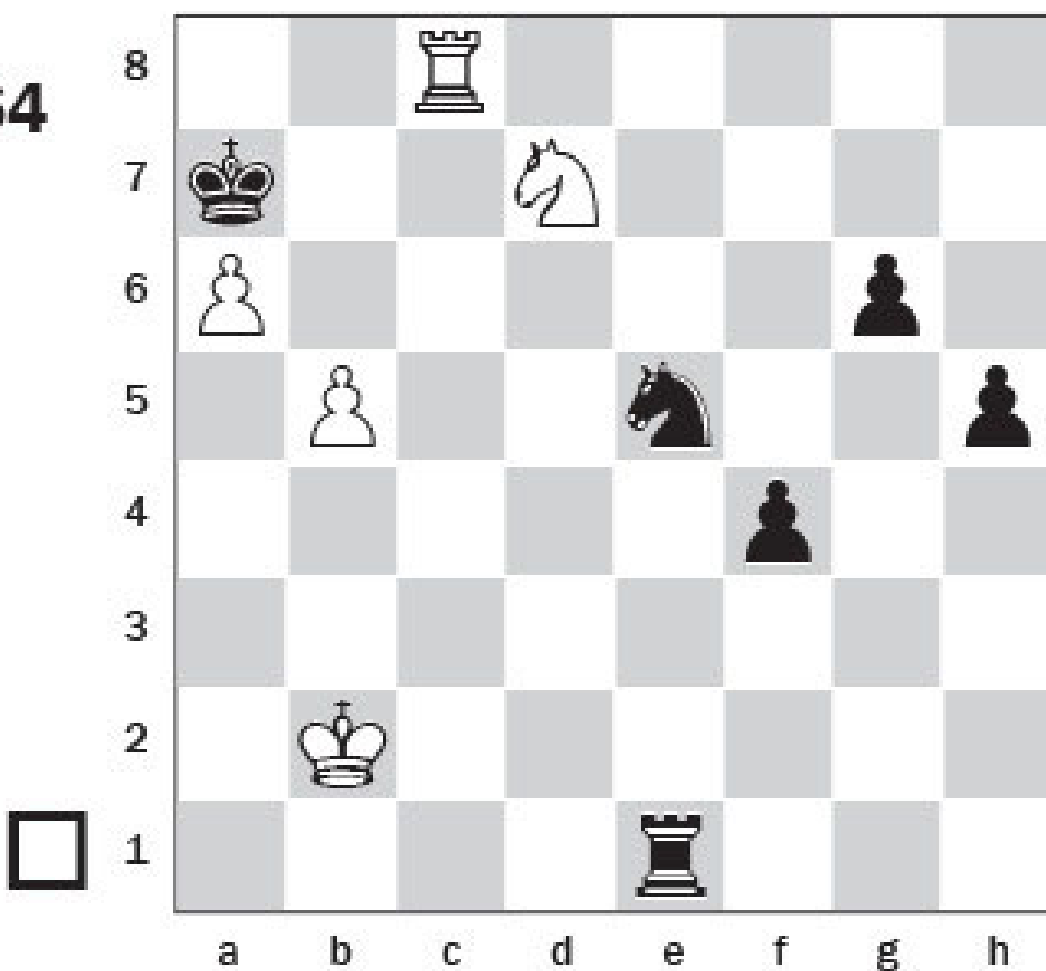
1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Exercise 564

**564**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

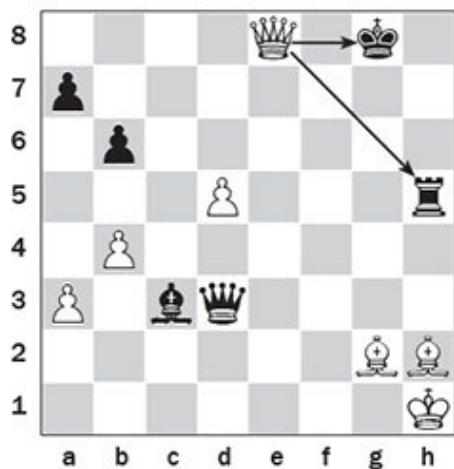
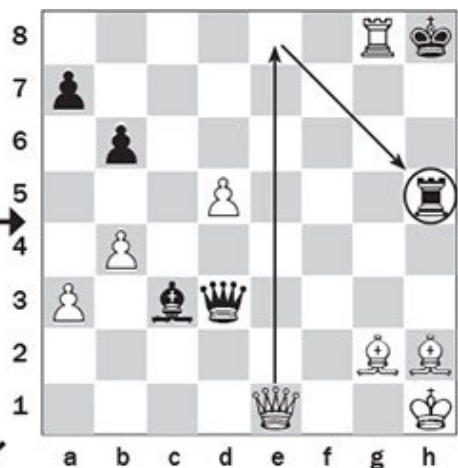
2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHAPTER 20

# Combinations/Setting Up Tactics

This chapter will test to see how all of the ideas, tactics and patterns you've learned come together. In chess, we call the use of multiple themes to gain a winning advantage a 'combination'. In this chapter, you will have to push yourself to a new limit. The goal of every chess player is to continue to increase the depth of their calculation ability. I look to help you with that in this chapter. To assist you with these problems, I have given you a guided hint for each puzzle. Let's take a look at a few examples of the types of problems you will be solving in this chapter:



White noticed that the rook on h5 is unprotected and started with a temporary sacrifice:

**1.Rxg8+ (see diagram 2)**

White wants to lure the king to the g8 to set Black up for a fork.

**2...Kxg8 3.Qe8+ (see diagram 3)**

The whole idea! White gave away a rook (5) for a knight (3), but now gets the whole rook (5) back. When the smoke clears, White will be up a bishop:

**3...Kg7 4.Qxh5**

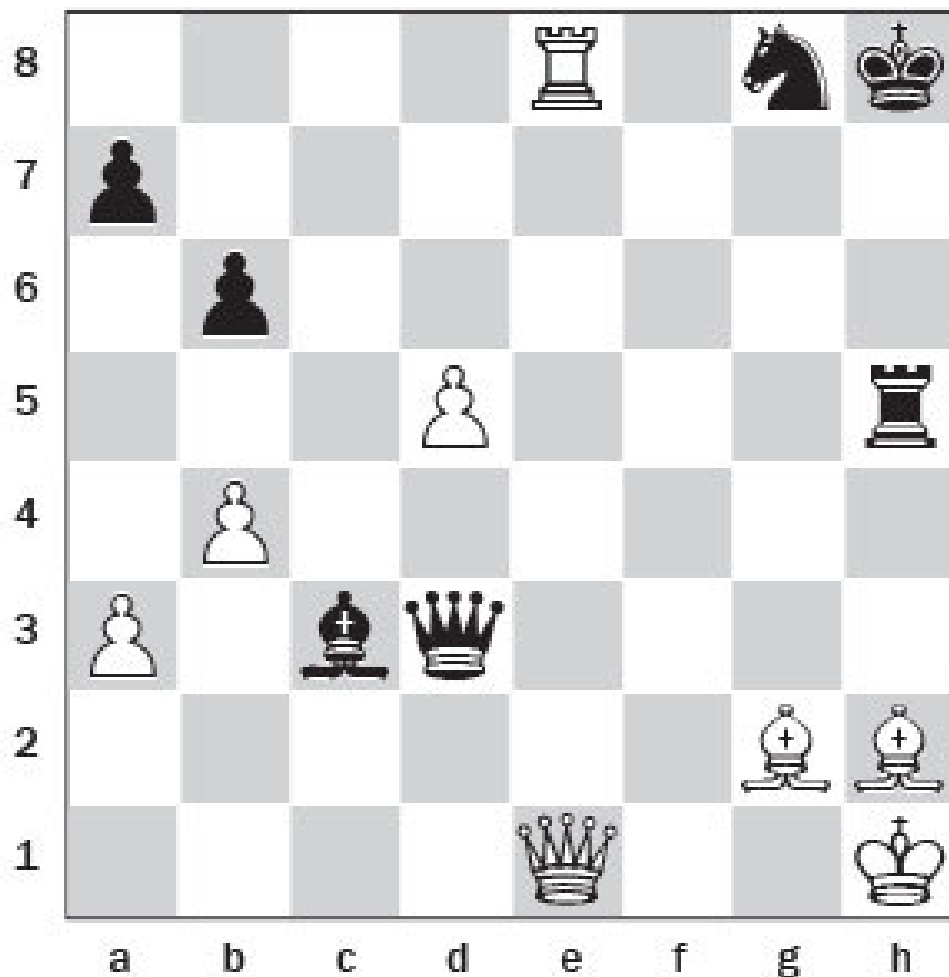
After a decoy setting up a fork, White obtained a winning advantage.

Like in the other chapters, your goal is to gain a winning advantage. Sometimes that means checkmate, but other times that could mean winning material.

This chapter is different than the tactics chapters in Part II of the book. In this chapter, you will have to set the tactic up, it will not be given to you on the first move. Use the guided hints to lead your thinking and remember to be on high alert for your most forcing moves: checks, captures and threats.

# Combinations Setting Up Tactics

Ex.



Answer:

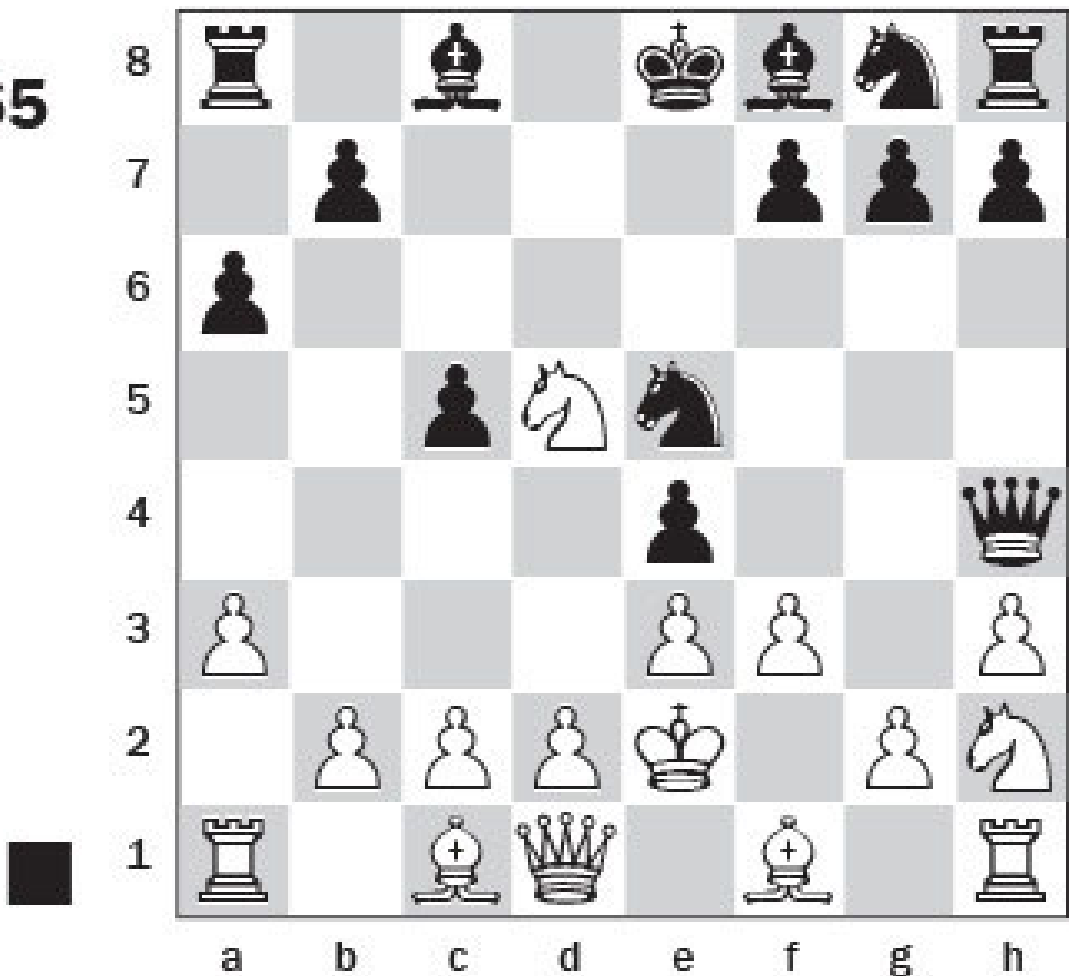
1. Rxd8+ Kxd8

2. Qe8+ \_\_\_\_\_

EXAMPLE: Provide an answer which shows the point of the tactic.  
Use all lines provided.

**Exercise 565**

**565**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Notice that the knight on d5 is unprotected. In addition, the king on e2 is unsafe. Set up a fork to win the knight on d5.

### Exercise 566

☐

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

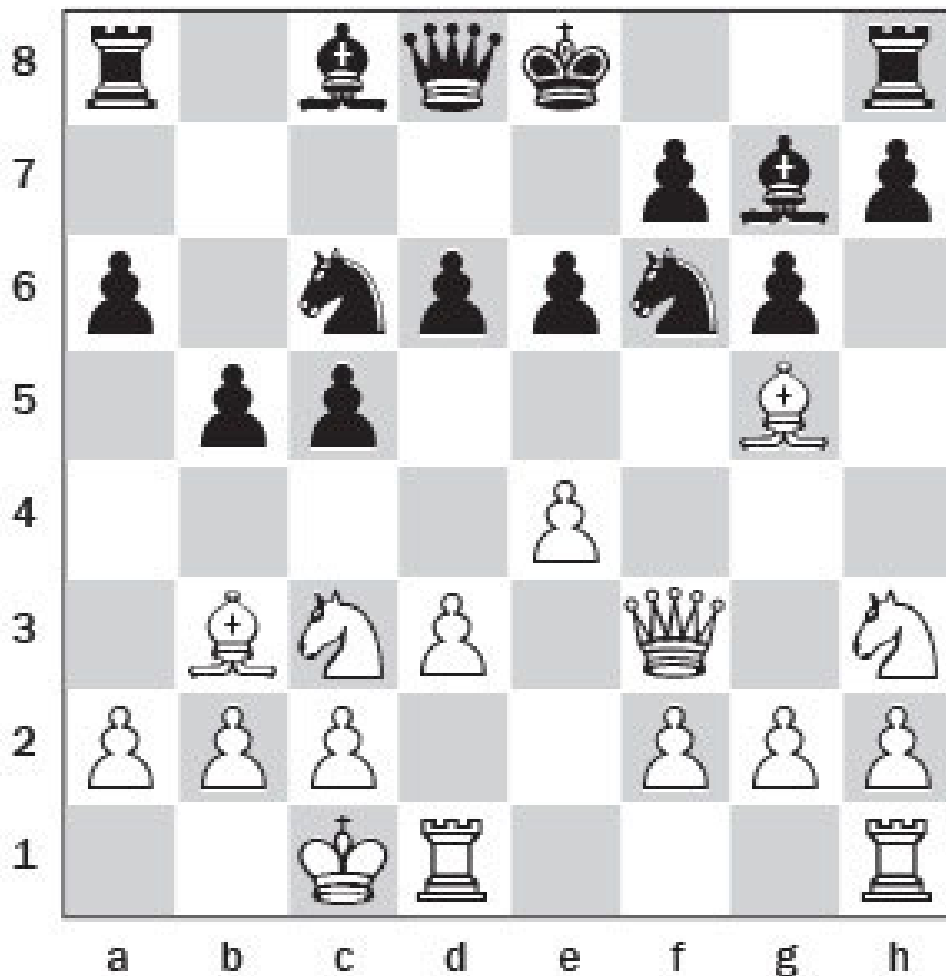
### HINT



The queen on a5 seems a bit misplaced. White's bishops are controlling a lot of queenside squares. Can White trap the queen?

### Exercise 567

567



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

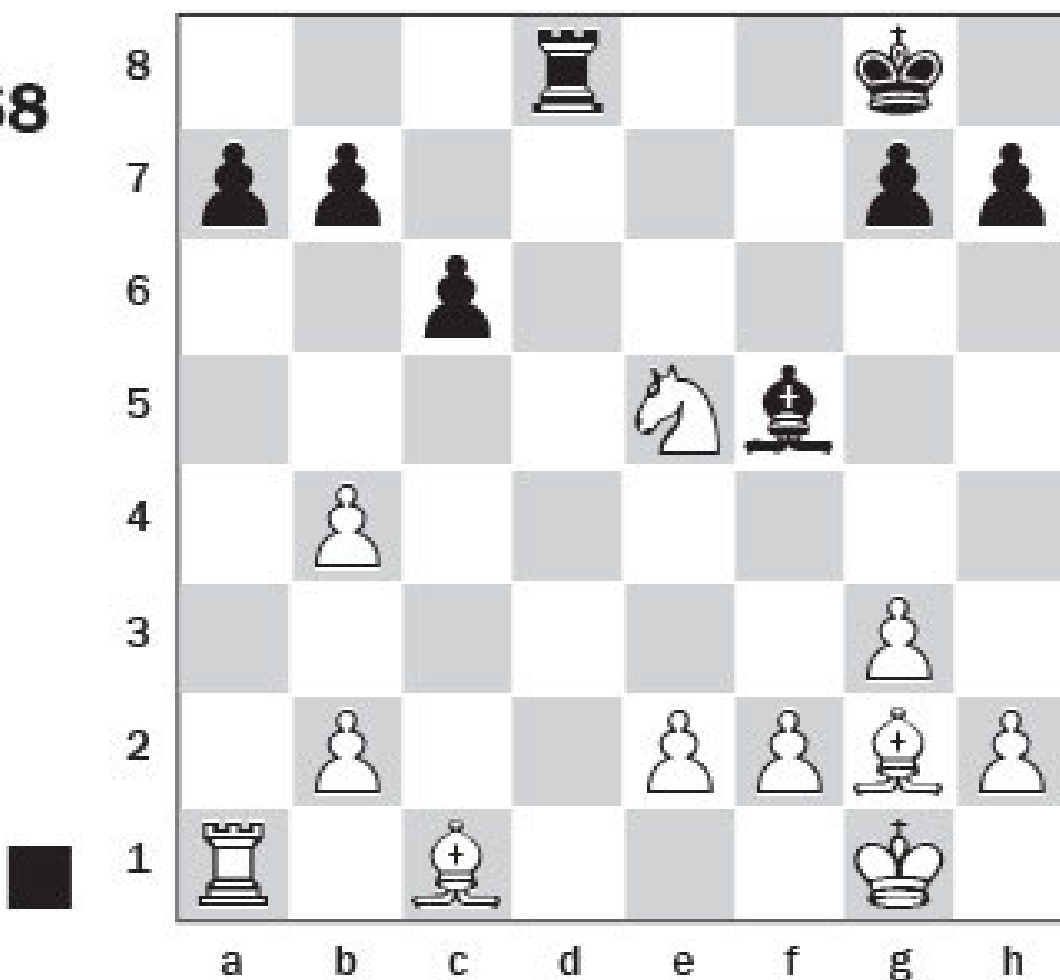
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on c6 is unprotected, and so is the rook on a8! Use a discovered attack to win material.

### Exercise 568

568



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The back rank is weak but the game is not over. Take advantage of the back rank weakness and the concept of 'attacking the pinned piece'.

## Exercise 569

569



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

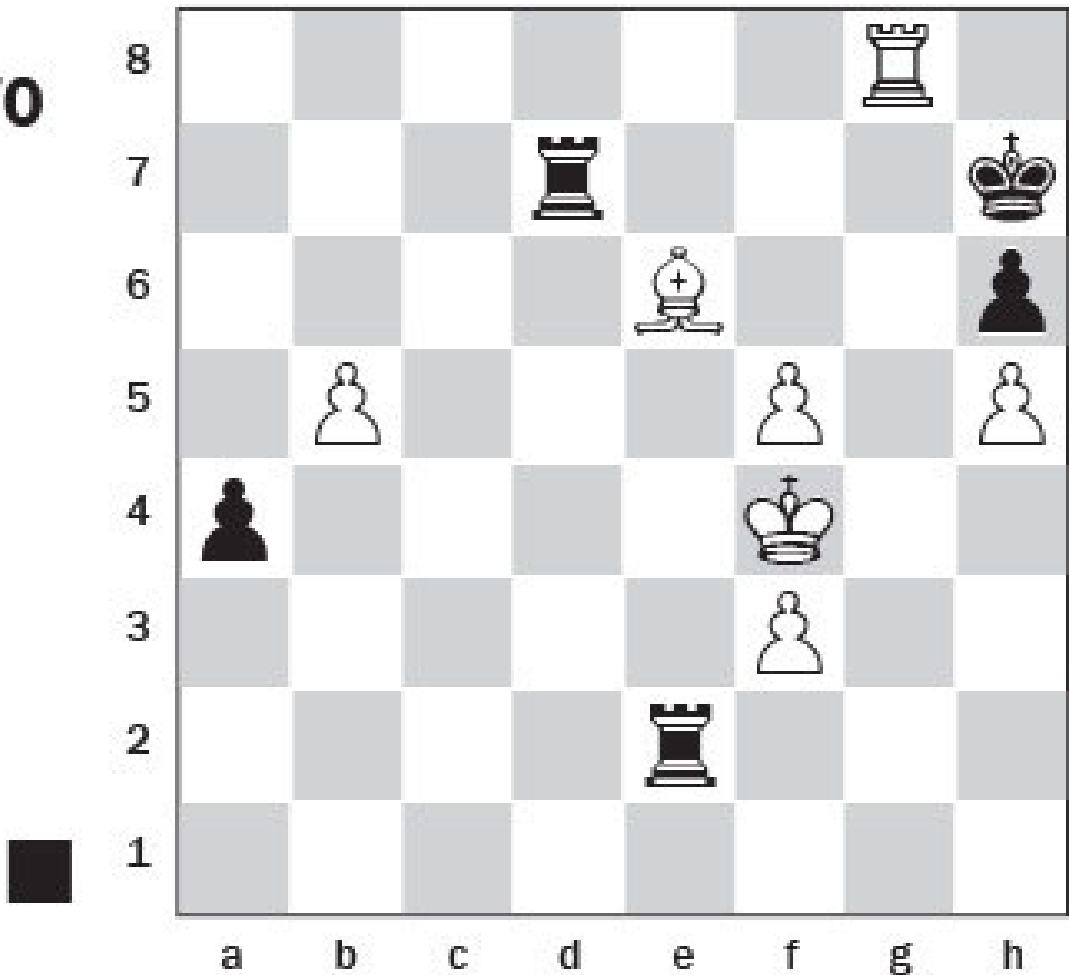
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

White's queen on h7 is certainly misplaced. Can the rooks on the 8th rank trap the queen?

### Exercise 570

**570**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

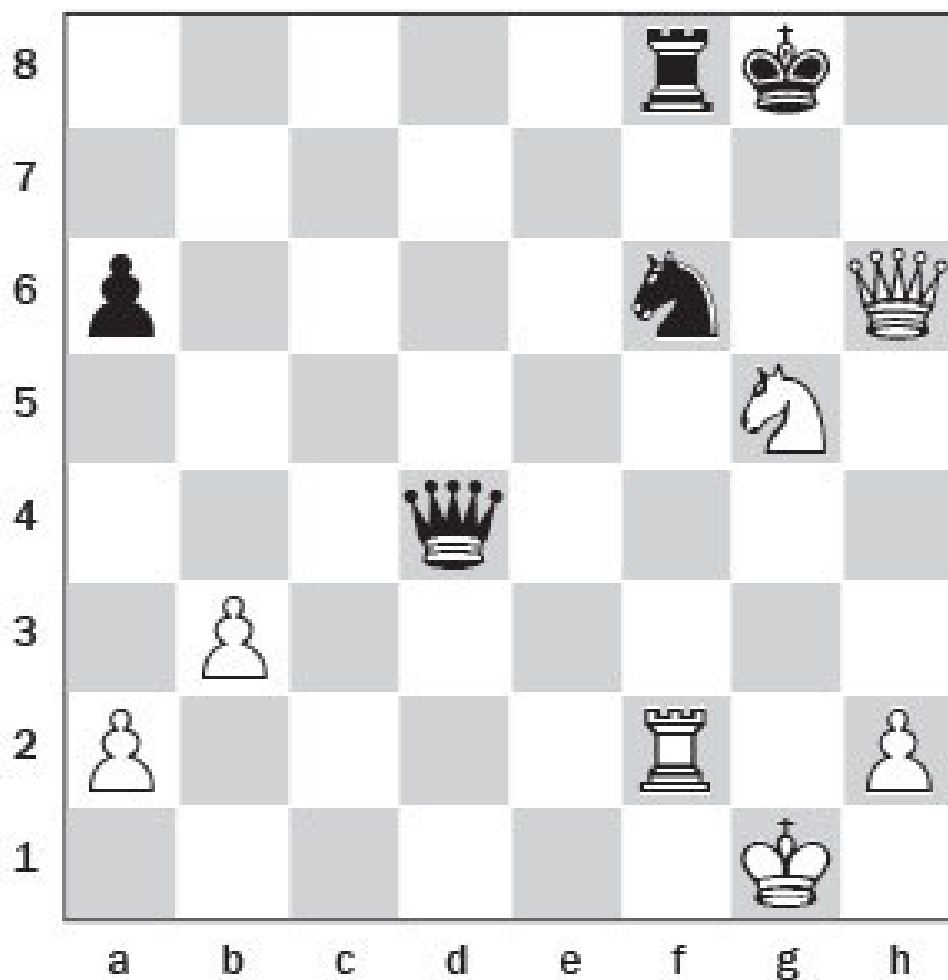
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Removing the guard with ... ♖xe6 doesn't work since the pawn captures and attacks the rook on d7. Can you improve by using an in-between move?

## [Exercise 571](#)

571



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

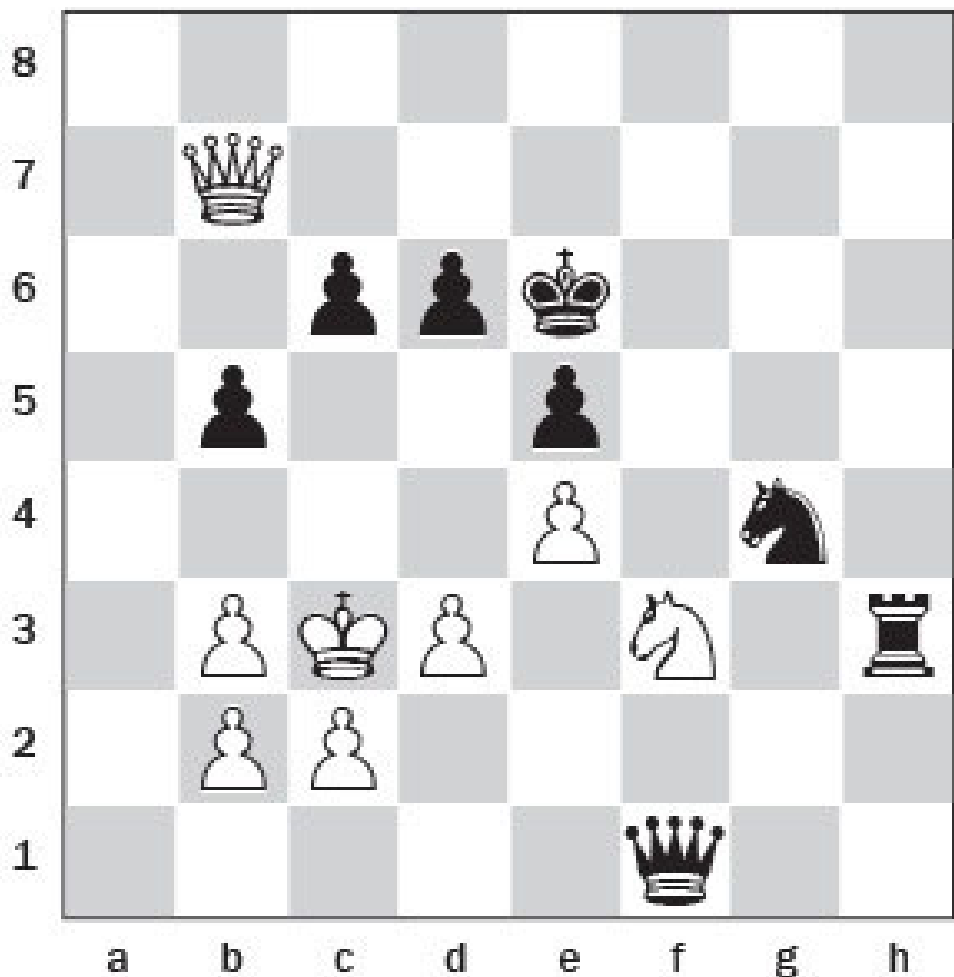
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The white rook on f2 is only protected by the king. In addition, Black's rook on f8 is eyeing the rook. Win material using a decoy, double check, and fork.

### Exercise 572

**572**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

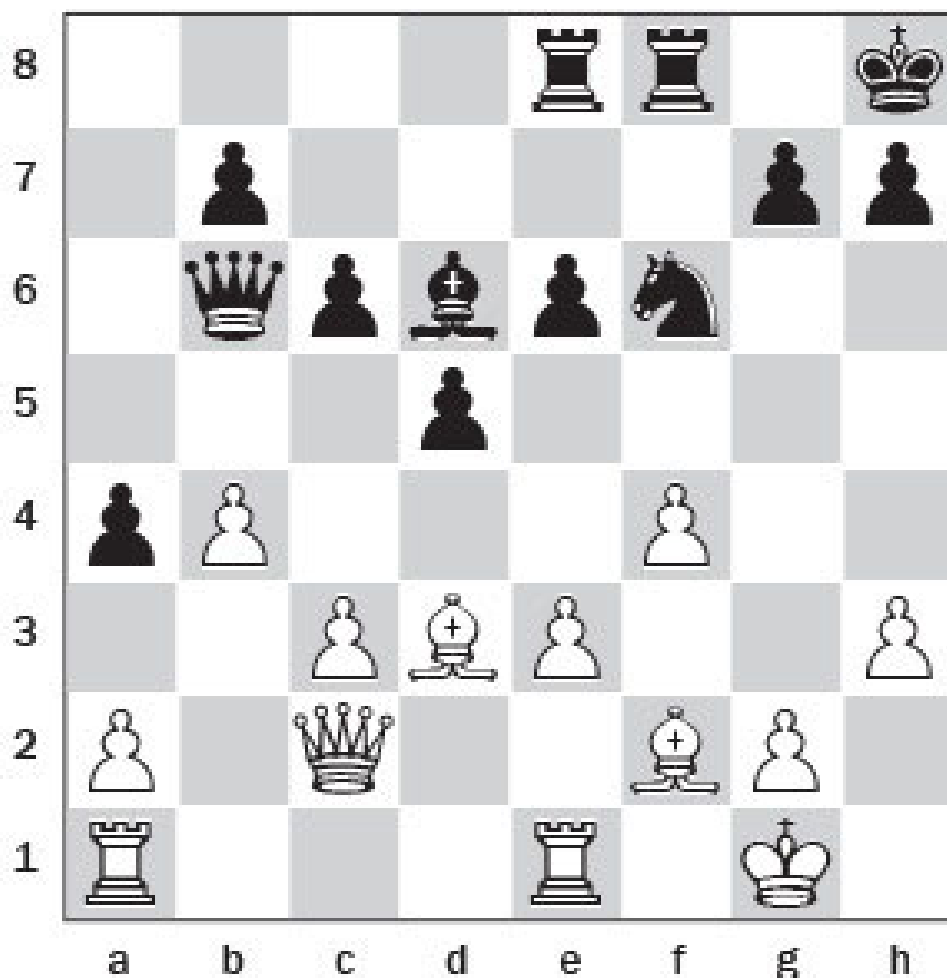
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Notice that the queen on f1 is unprotected. Use a few forcing moves to set up a skewer, winning the queen.

### [Exercise 573](#)

573



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

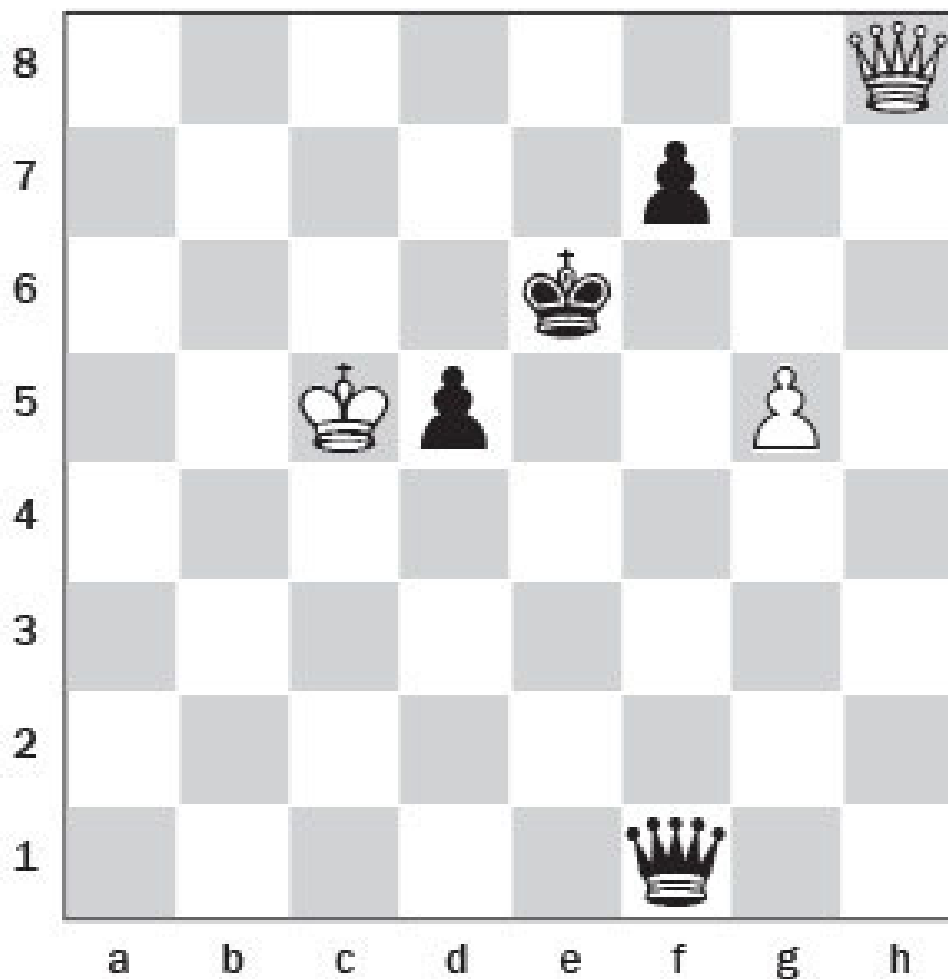
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

Use a discovered attack to set up a pawn fork.

## Exercise 574

574



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The black queen on f1 is unprotected. With a few forcing moves, White can skewer the black king and queen.

### Exercise 575

**575**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

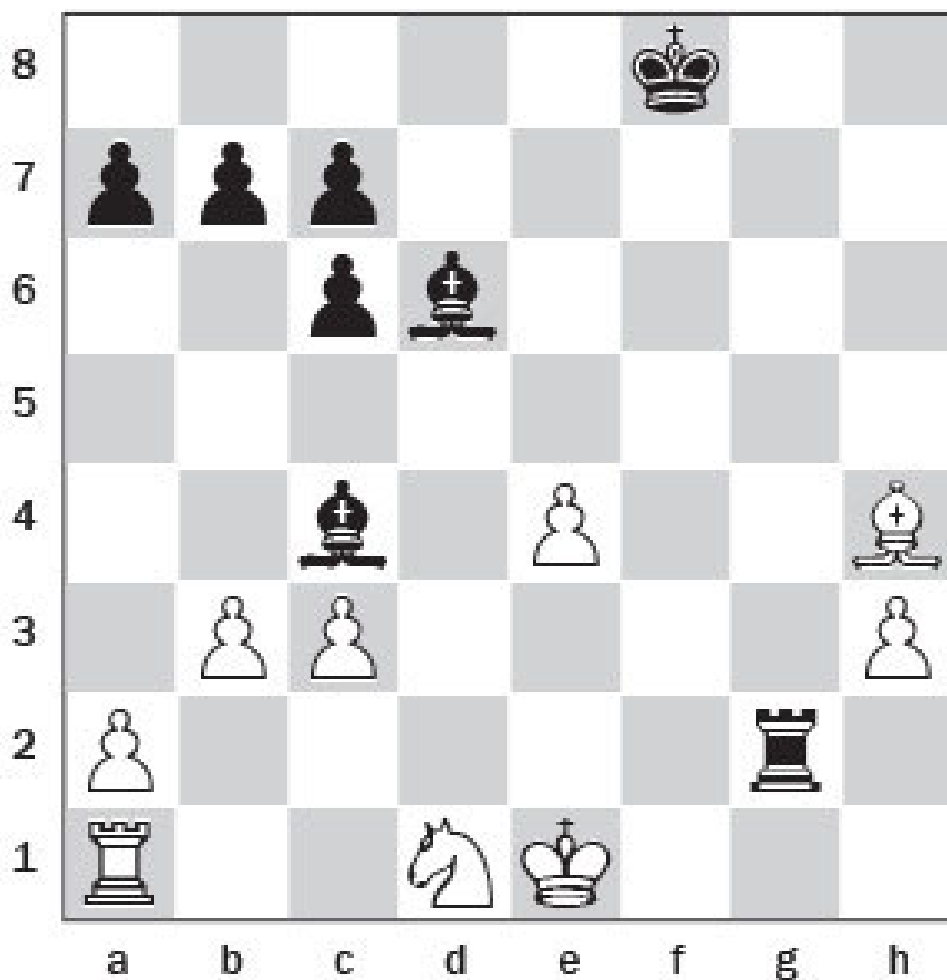
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Notice that the queen on c5 is unprotected. Win a knight by playing a decoy tactic to set up a fork.

### [Exercise 576](#)

576



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

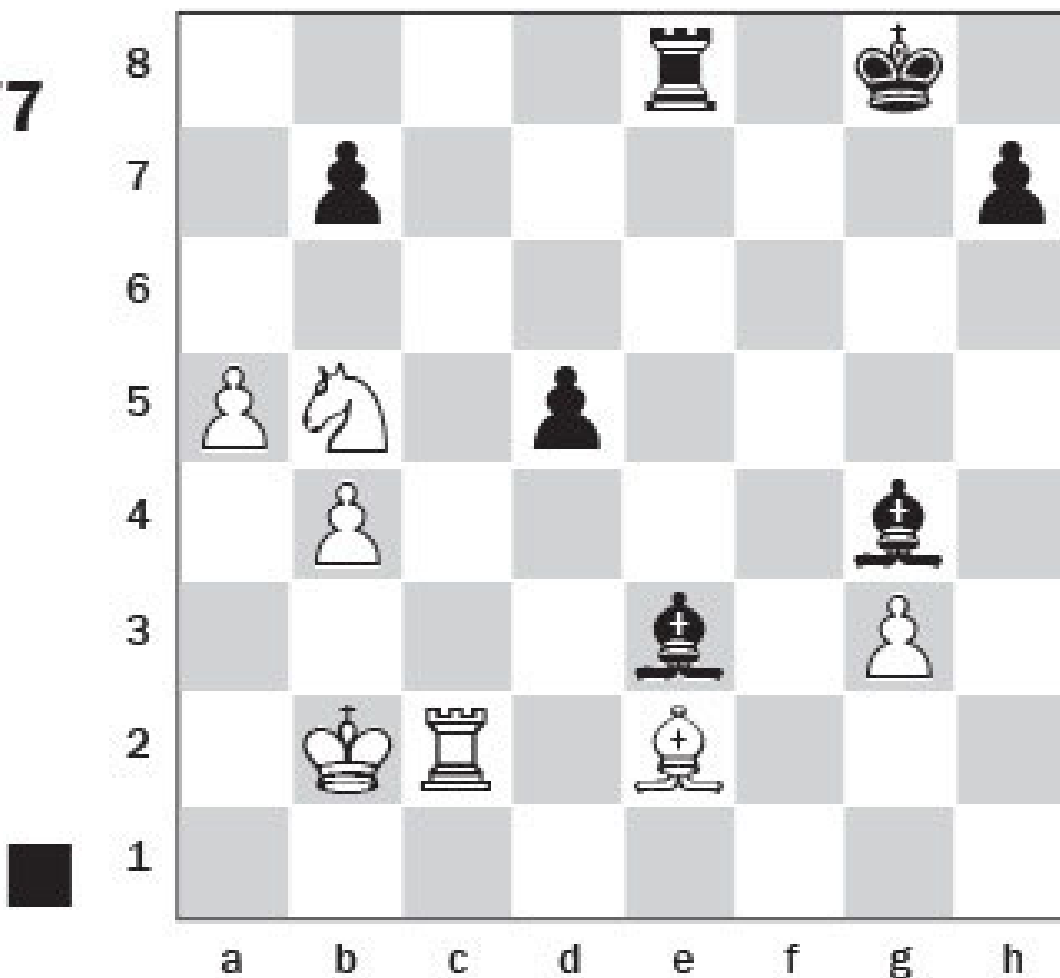
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use the bishop on c4 and the rook to create a discovery. Then use a discovered check to win the rook on a1.

### Exercise 577

**577**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

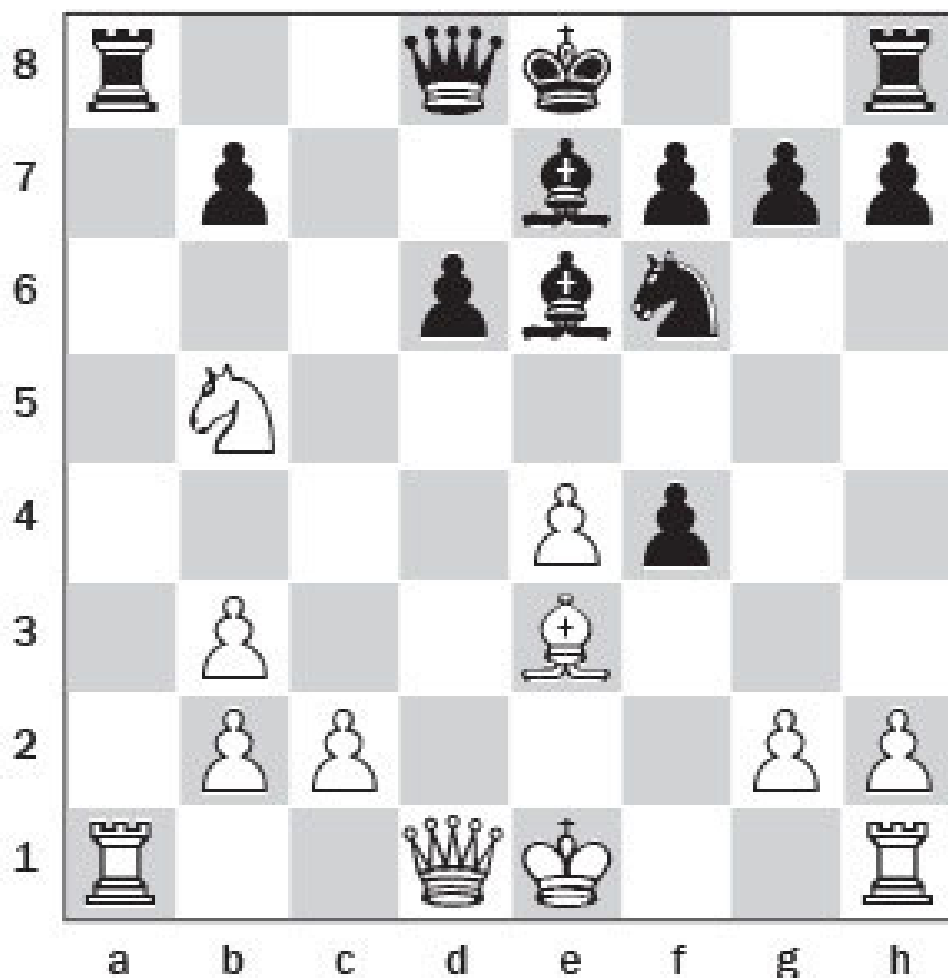
### **HINT**

Win material by setting up White's rook for a discovered attack.

### **Exercise 578**



578



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

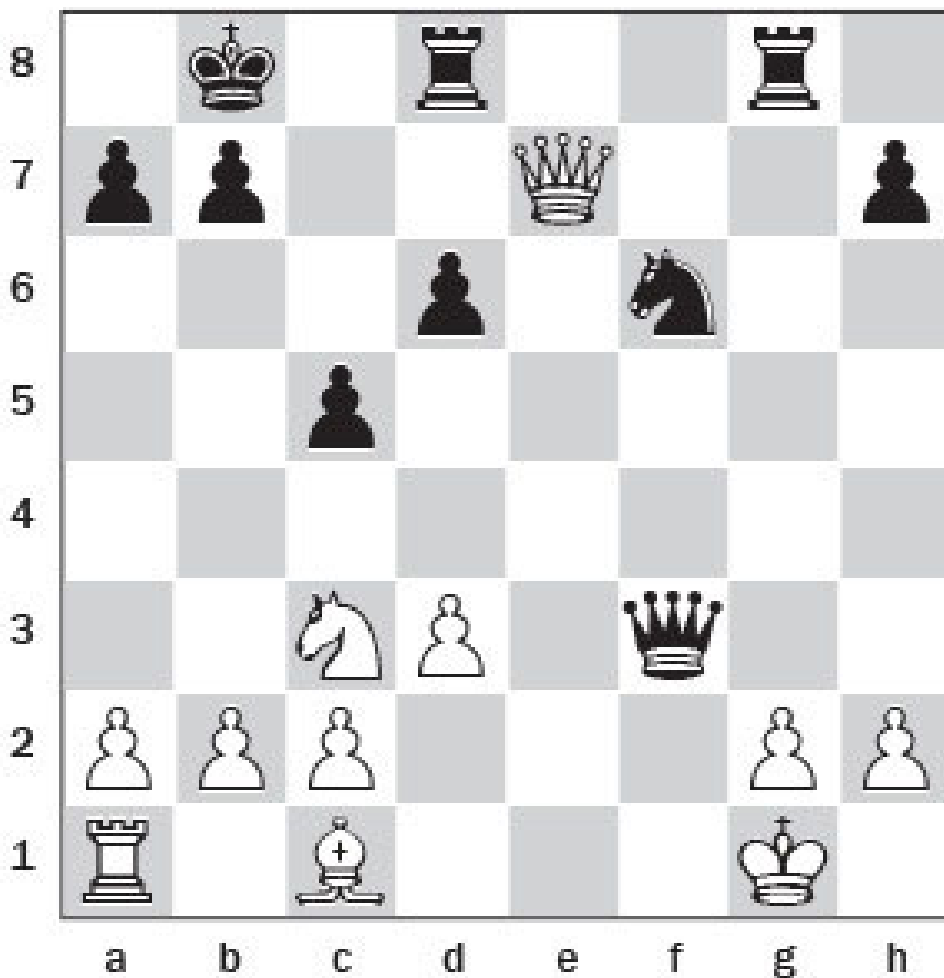
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

With the right capture, White can set up a big fork!

### Exercise 579

579



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

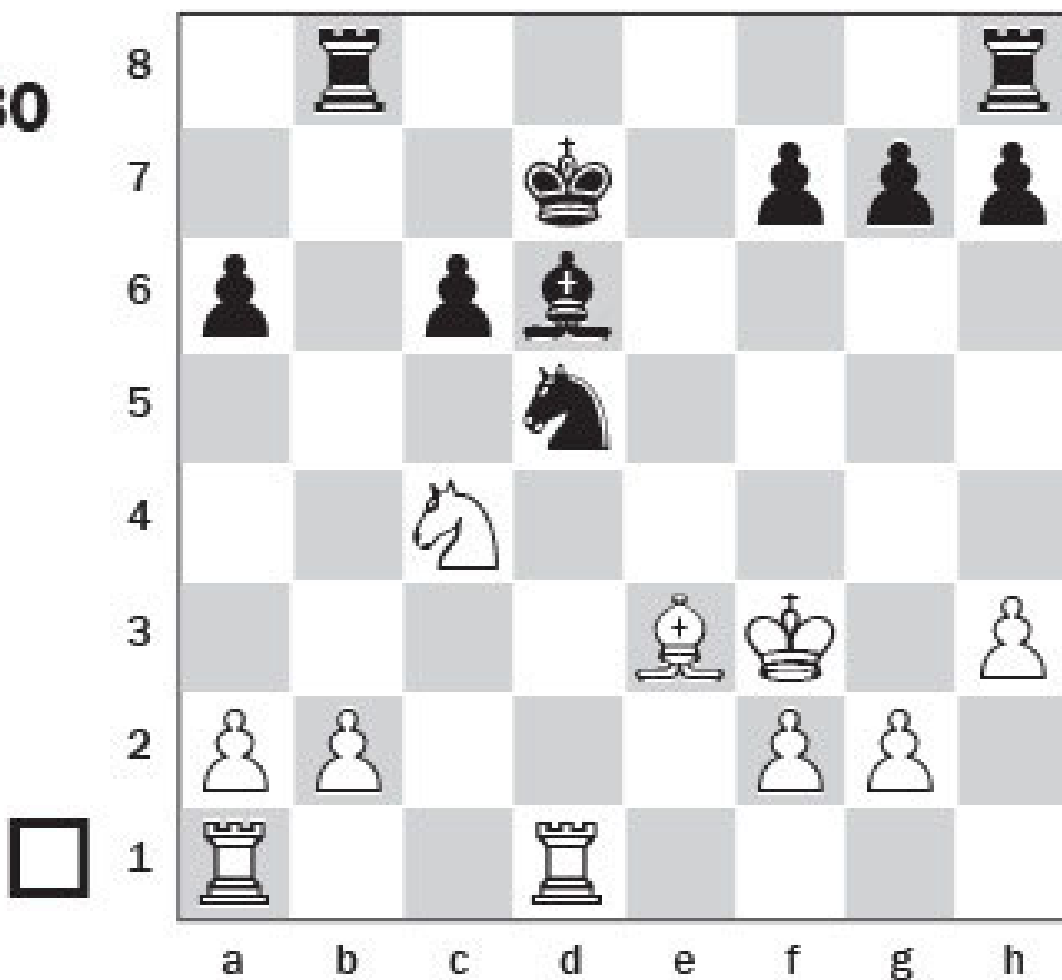
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White would like to take Black's queen on f3, except the pawn on g2 is in a pin. Is there any way White can decoy the rook on g8 first?

### Exercise 580

580



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

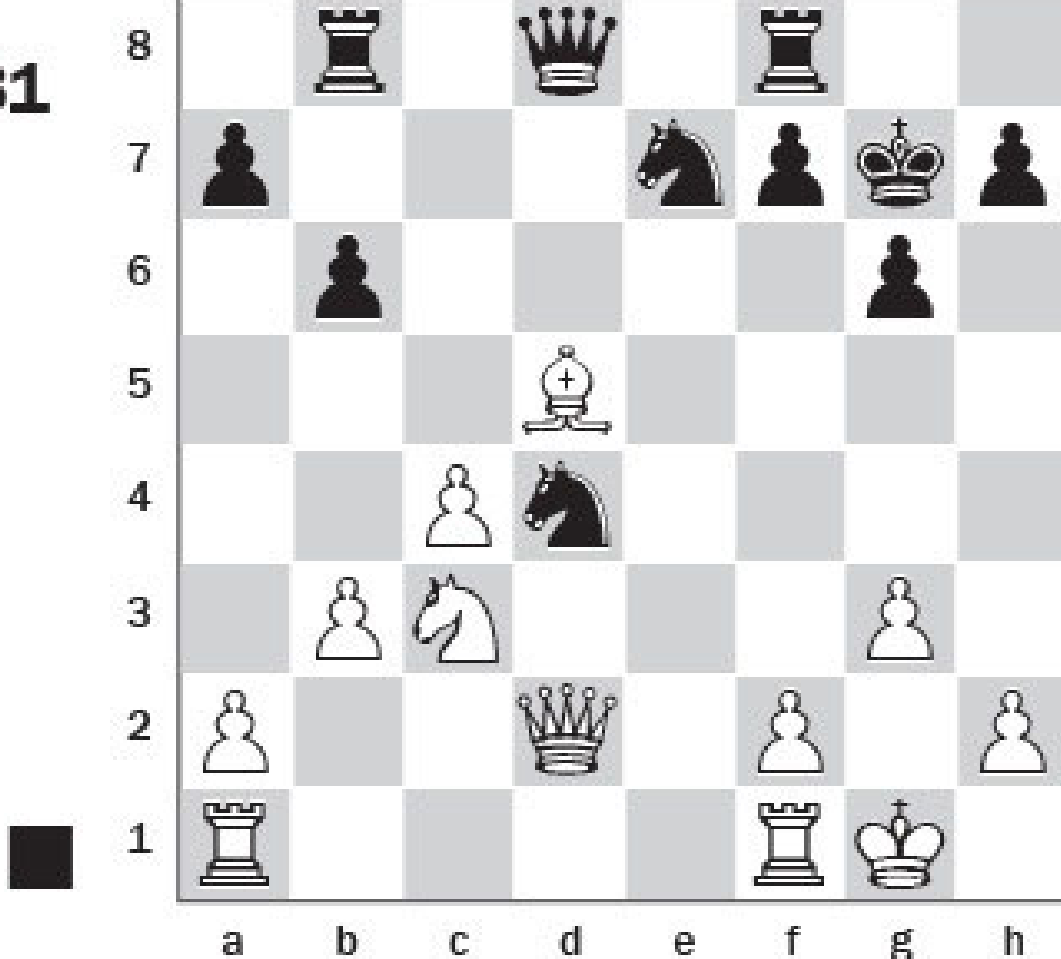
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Exchange a set of pieces and set up a skewer using a pin!

[Exercise 581](#)

581



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

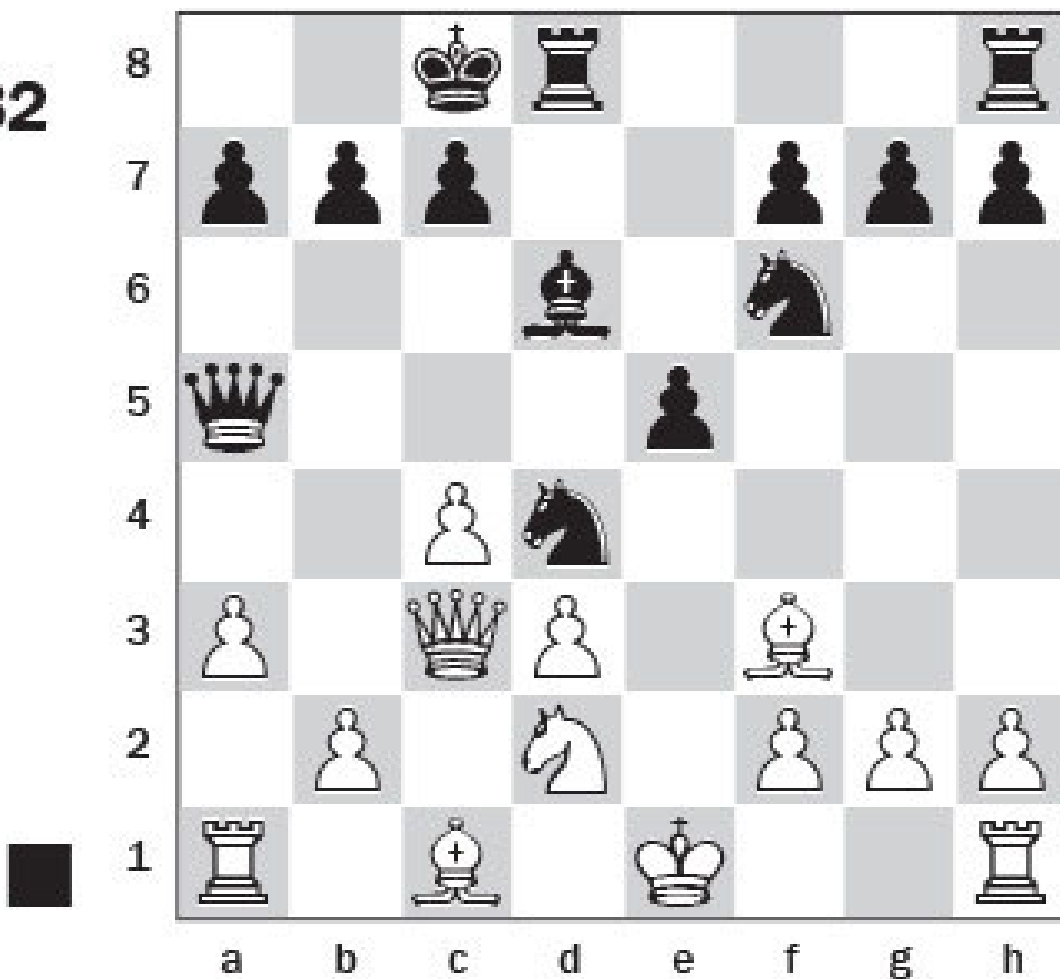
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

Is White really stopping the fork on f3?

## Exercise 582

582



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black would love to play ... ♖c2+ but White's queen is stopping that. Use removing the guard to win material.

### Exercise 583

583



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

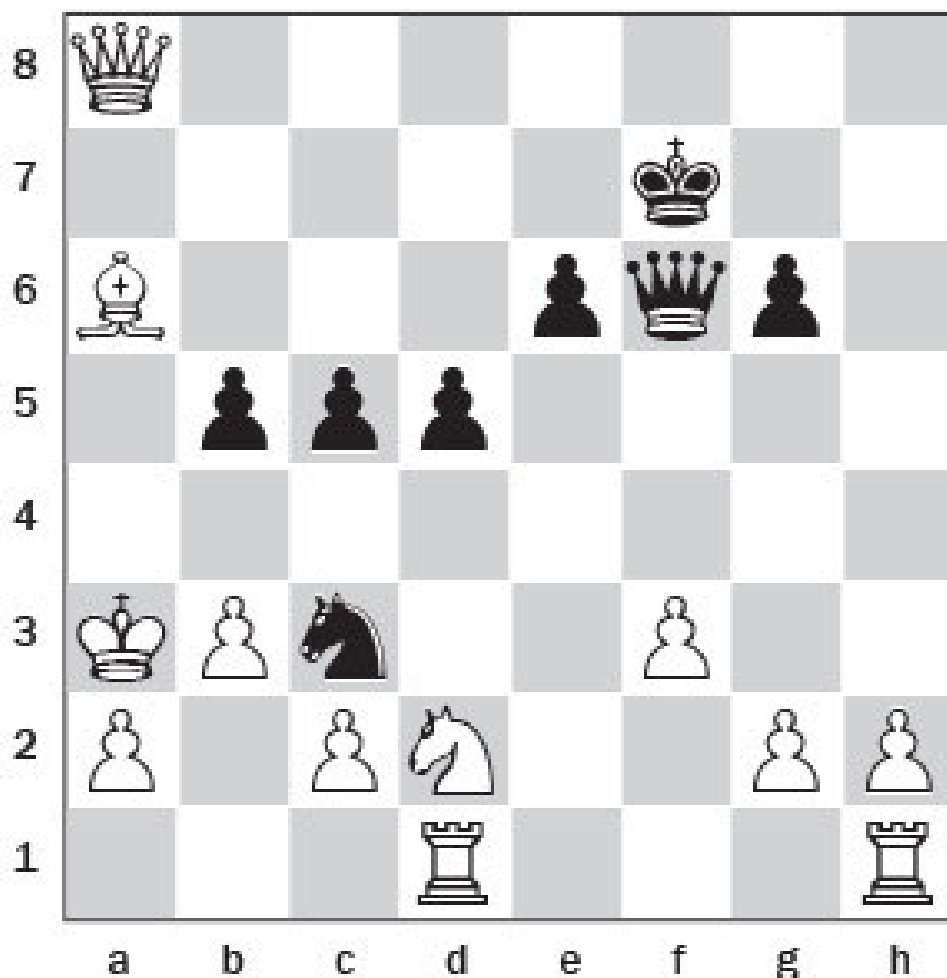
### HINT

The queen on a5 is unprotected. Use a check to set up a discovered attack on the queen.

### [Exercise 584](#)



584



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

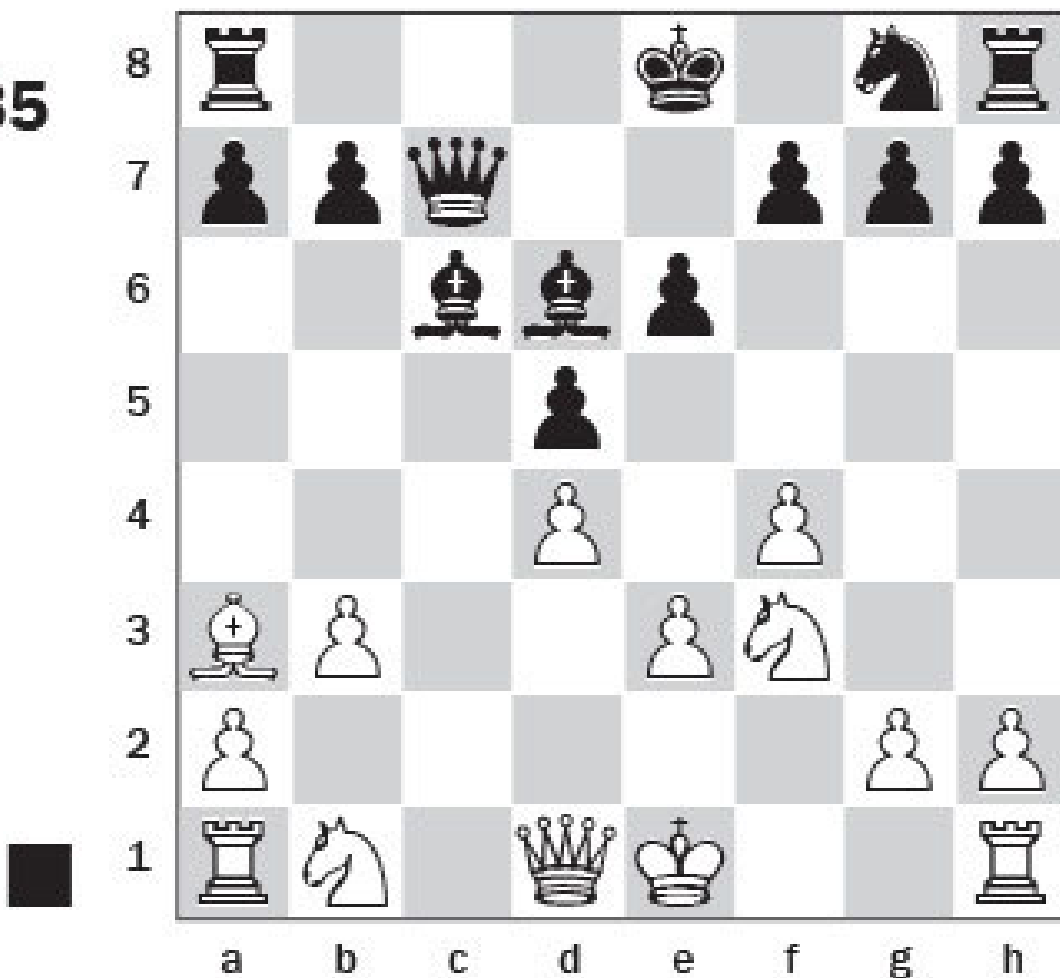
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Force the king to move into a discovered attack. Then use a double check to finish the game by checkmate.

### Exercise 585

585



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

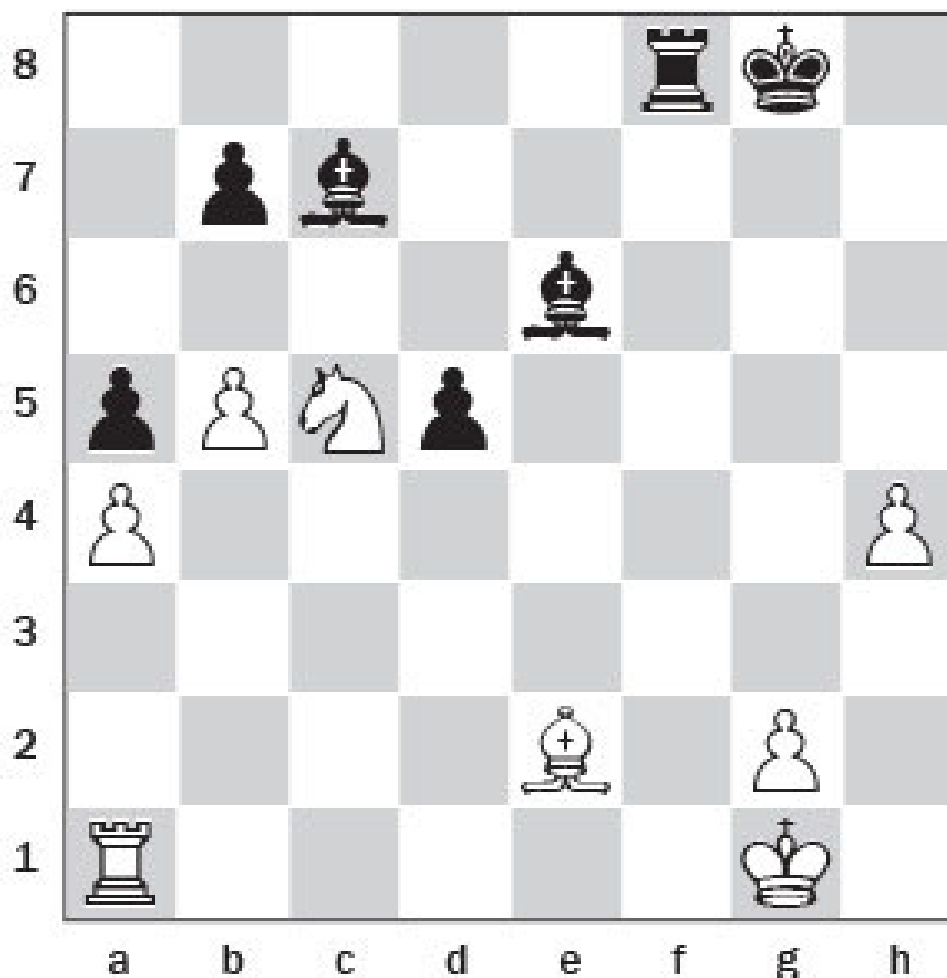
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black could play ... ♔a5+ with a fork on the king and bishop on a3, but White can protect with ♔d2. How can Black improve the sequence?

## Exercise 586

586



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

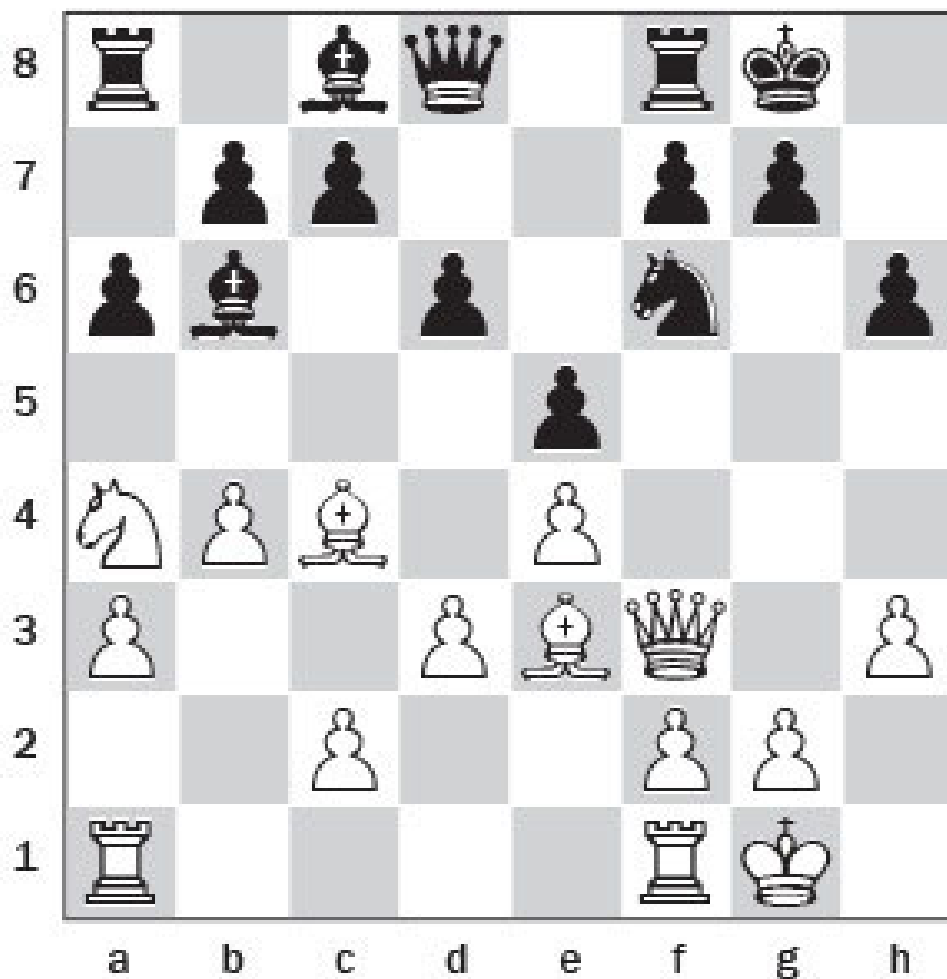
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

Find the pin, find the defense, attack the pinned piece.

## Exercise 587

587



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

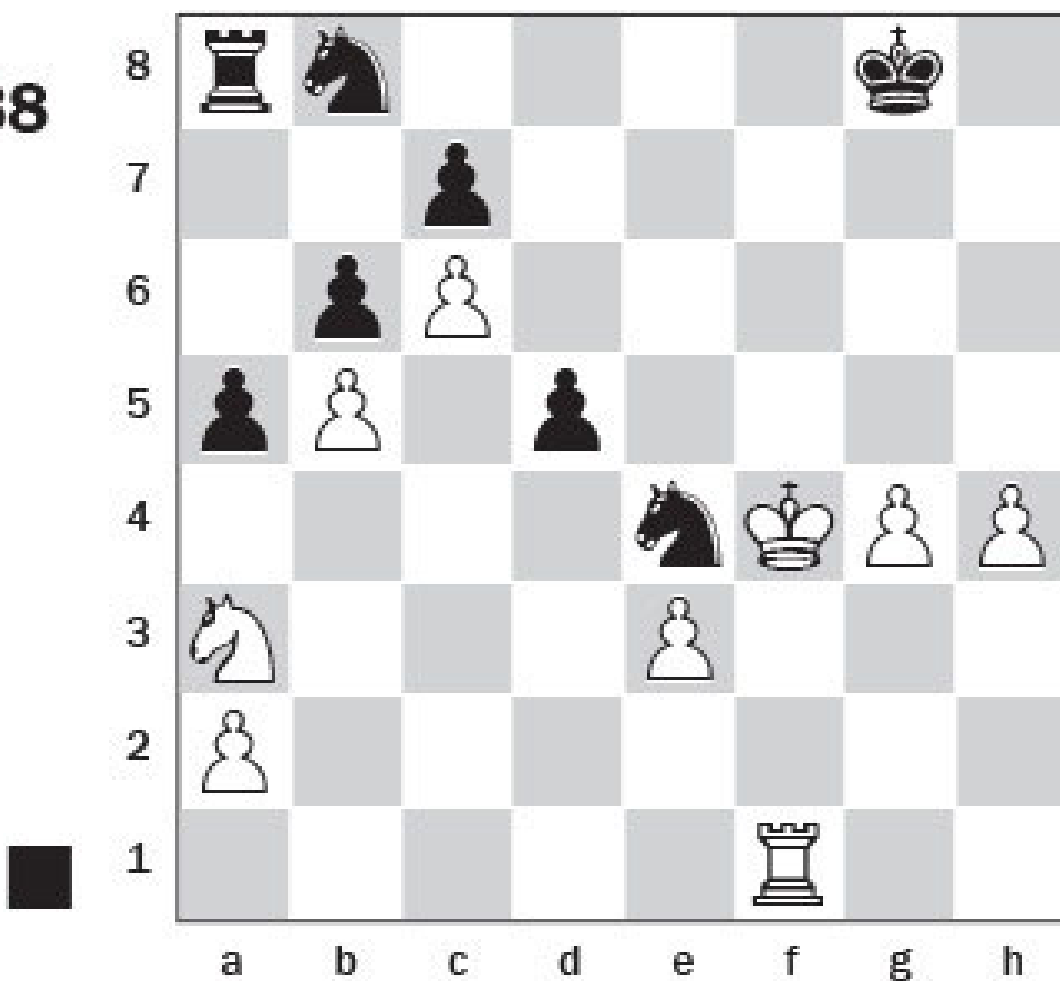
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice the position of the bishop on c4 and the knight on a4. How can Black win material?

### Exercise 588

588



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

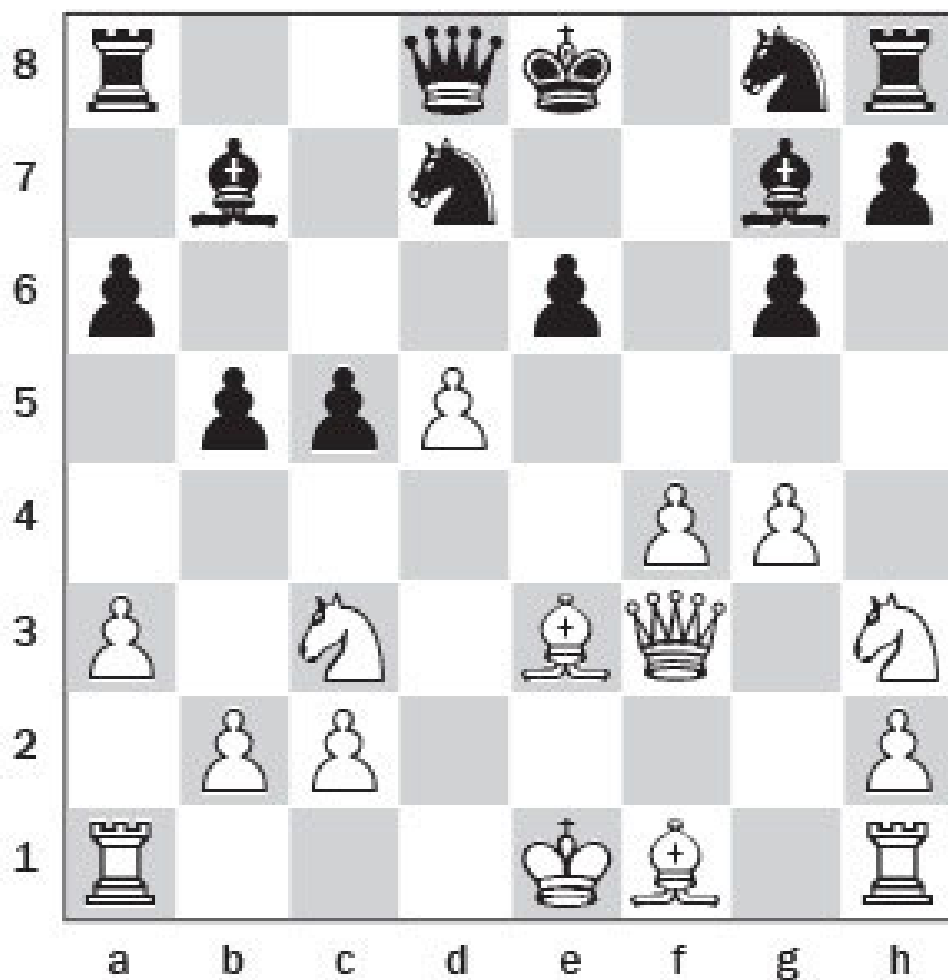
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Black's knight looks trapped on b8. Is there a clever way to free it by threatening a skewer? Notice the white king and rook are on the same file.

### Exercise 589

589



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

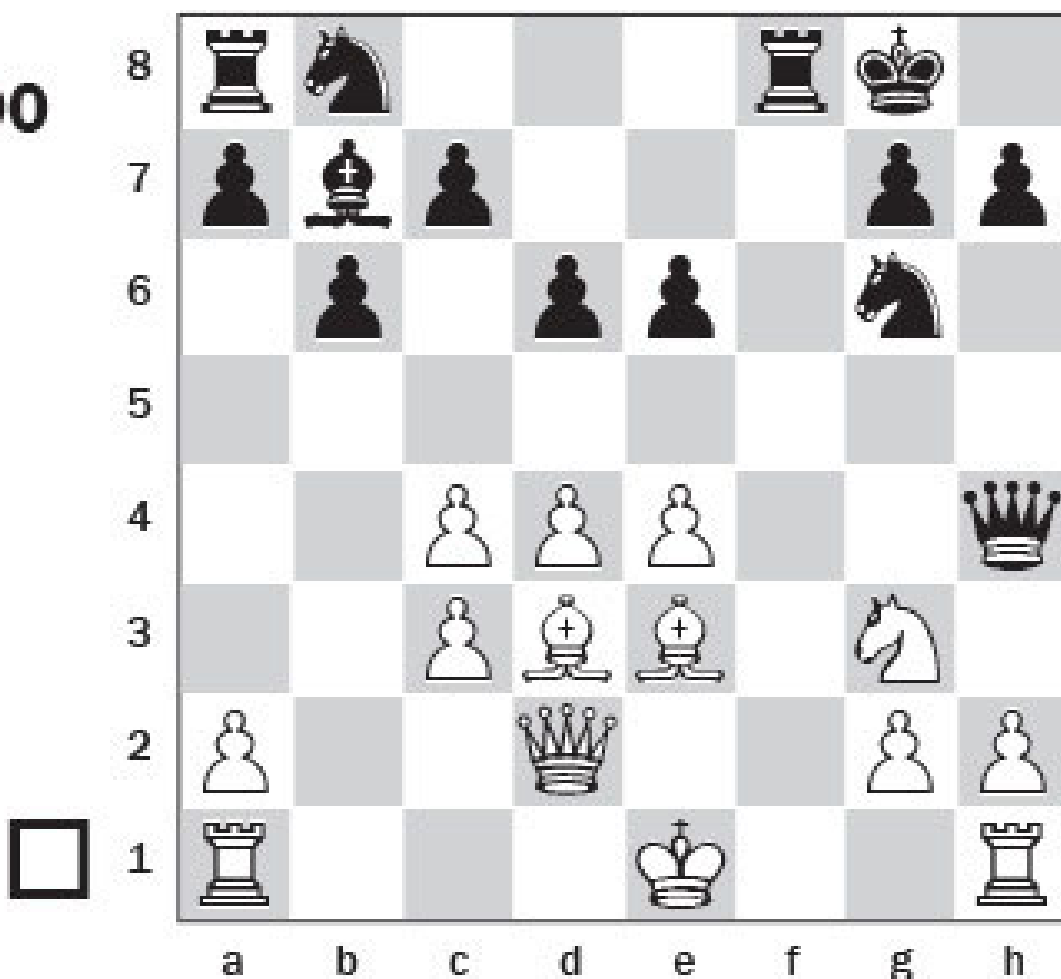


## HINT

Black would love to play ... ♞xd5, skewering the queen and rook, but something needs to be done first.

### Exercise 590

590



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

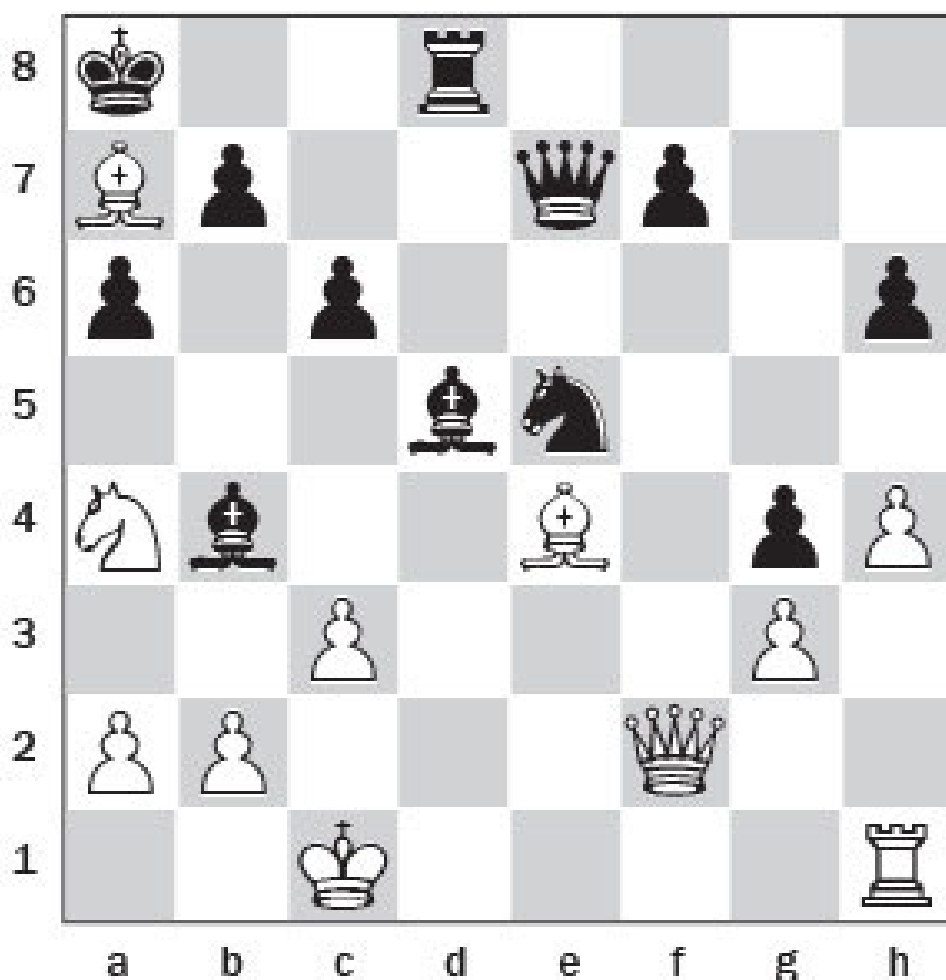
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Has the queen on h4 gone too far?

## Exercise 591

**591**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

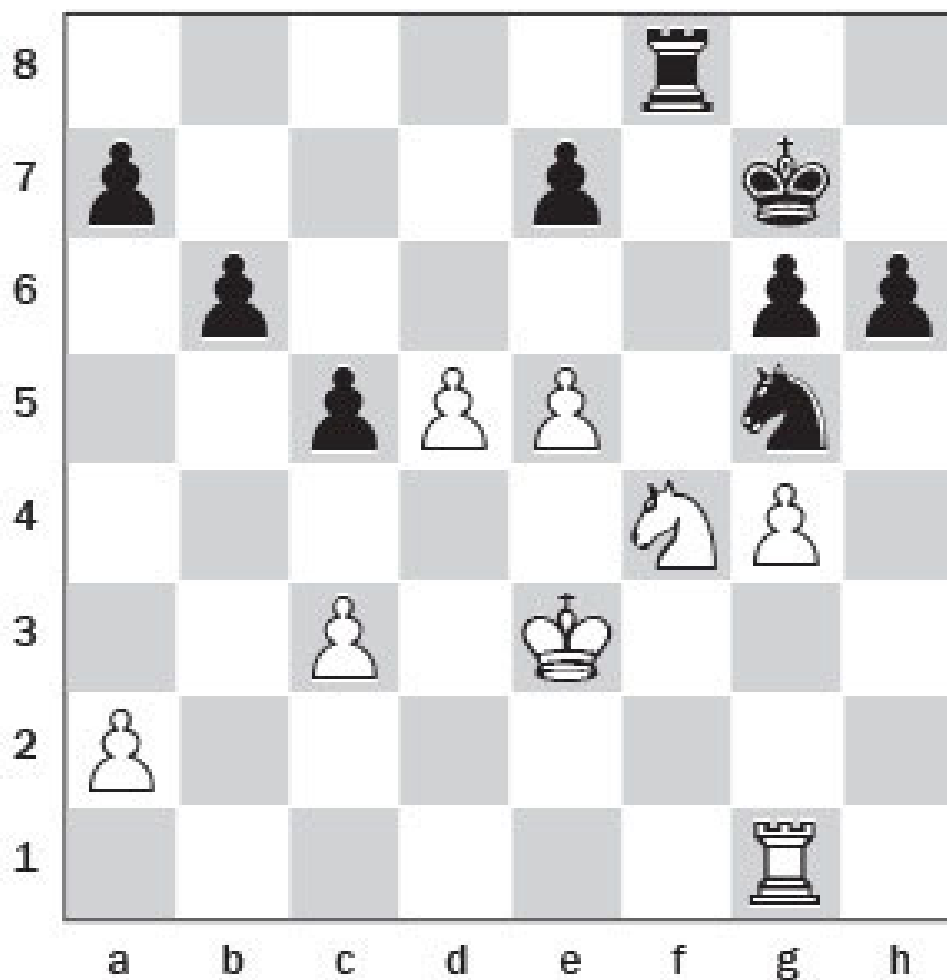
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Force the king into a discovery. Then use a double check and a fork to win the queen on e7.

### Exercise 592

592



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

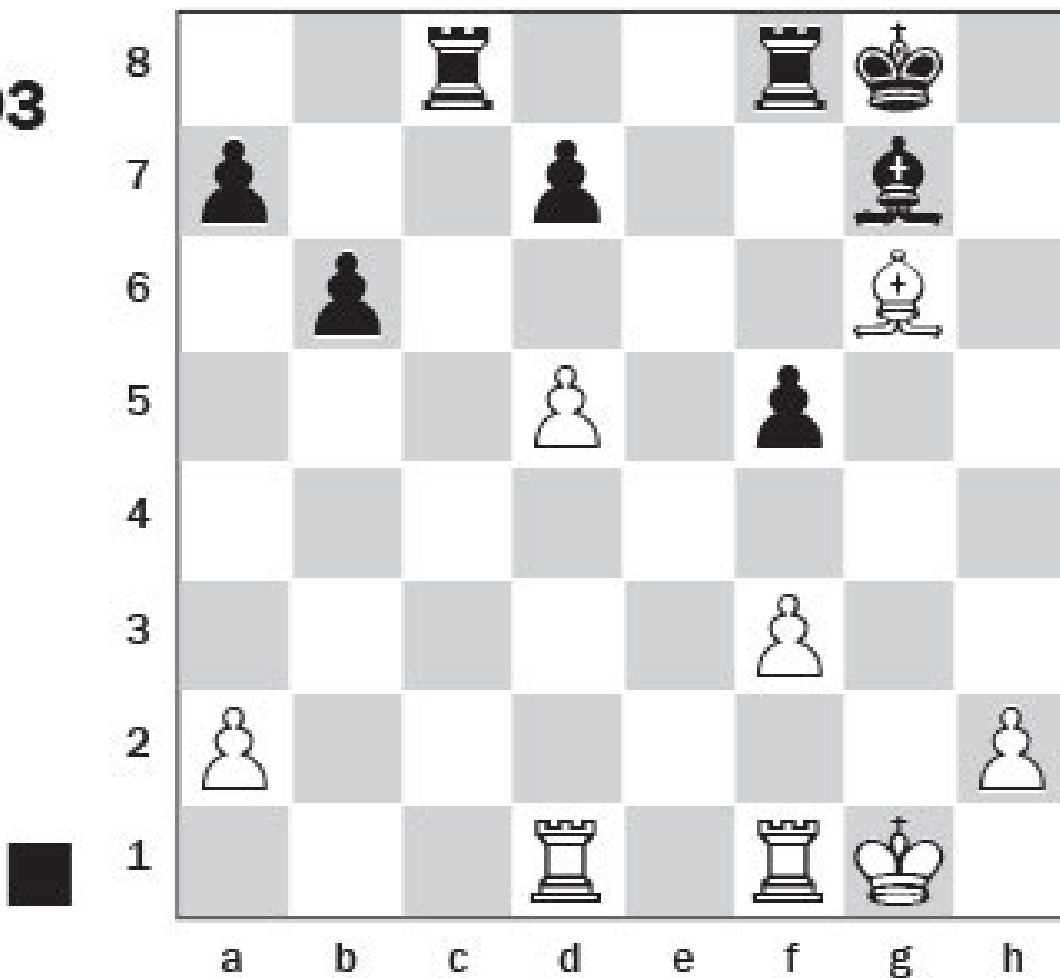
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on f4 seems protected. Can Black capture anyway?

### Exercise 593

593



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

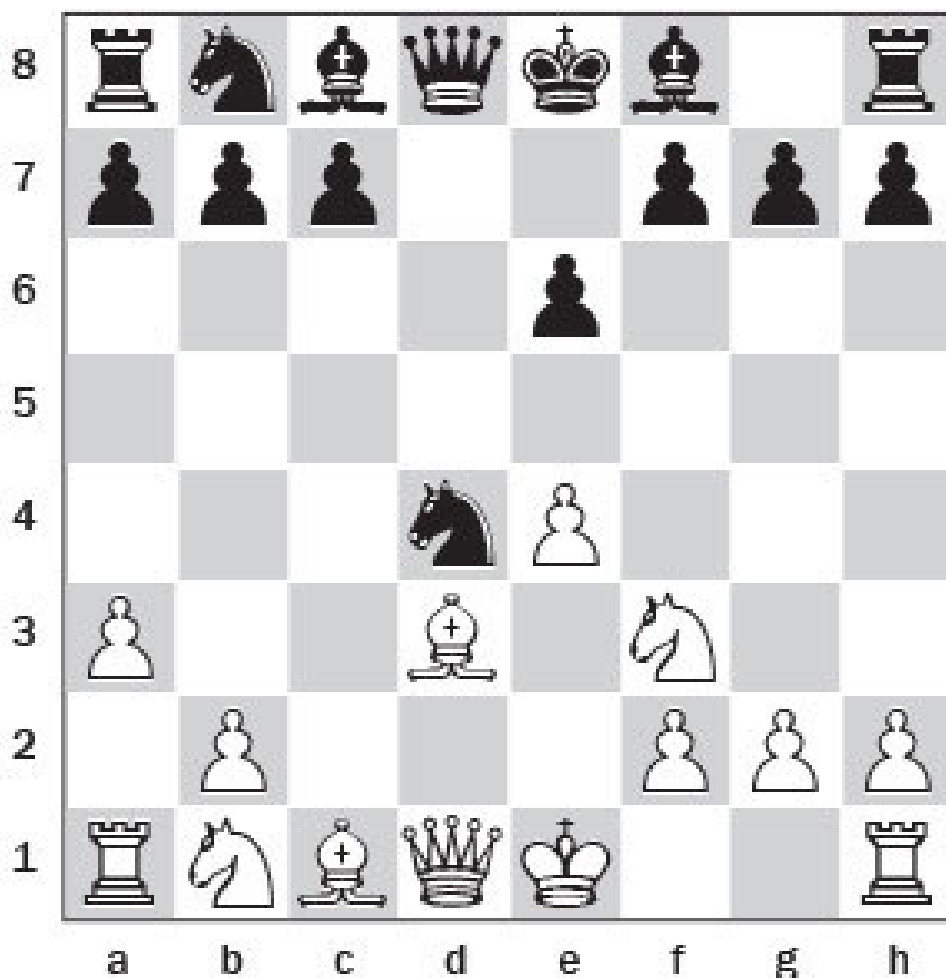
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on g6 is very limited. What can Black do?

### Exercise 594

594



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

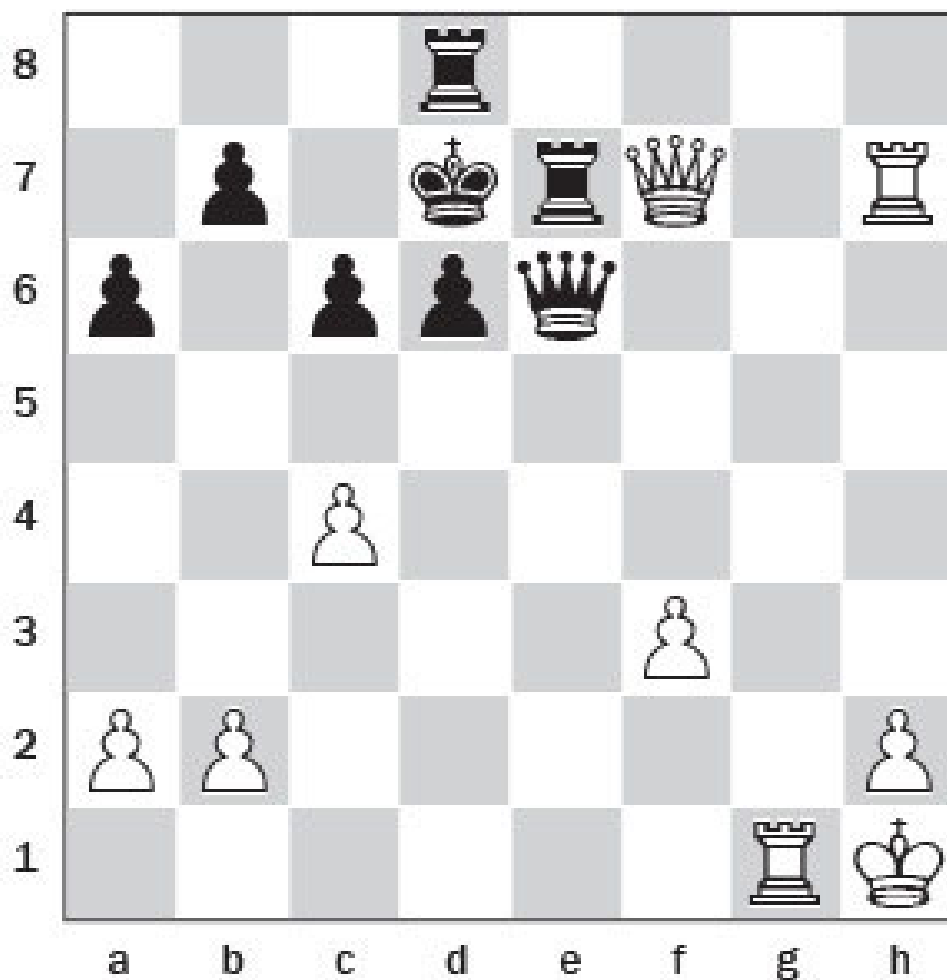
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Is the queen really guarding the knight on d4? If not, give a line, using a discovery, showing why it doesn't.

### [Exercise 595](#)

595



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

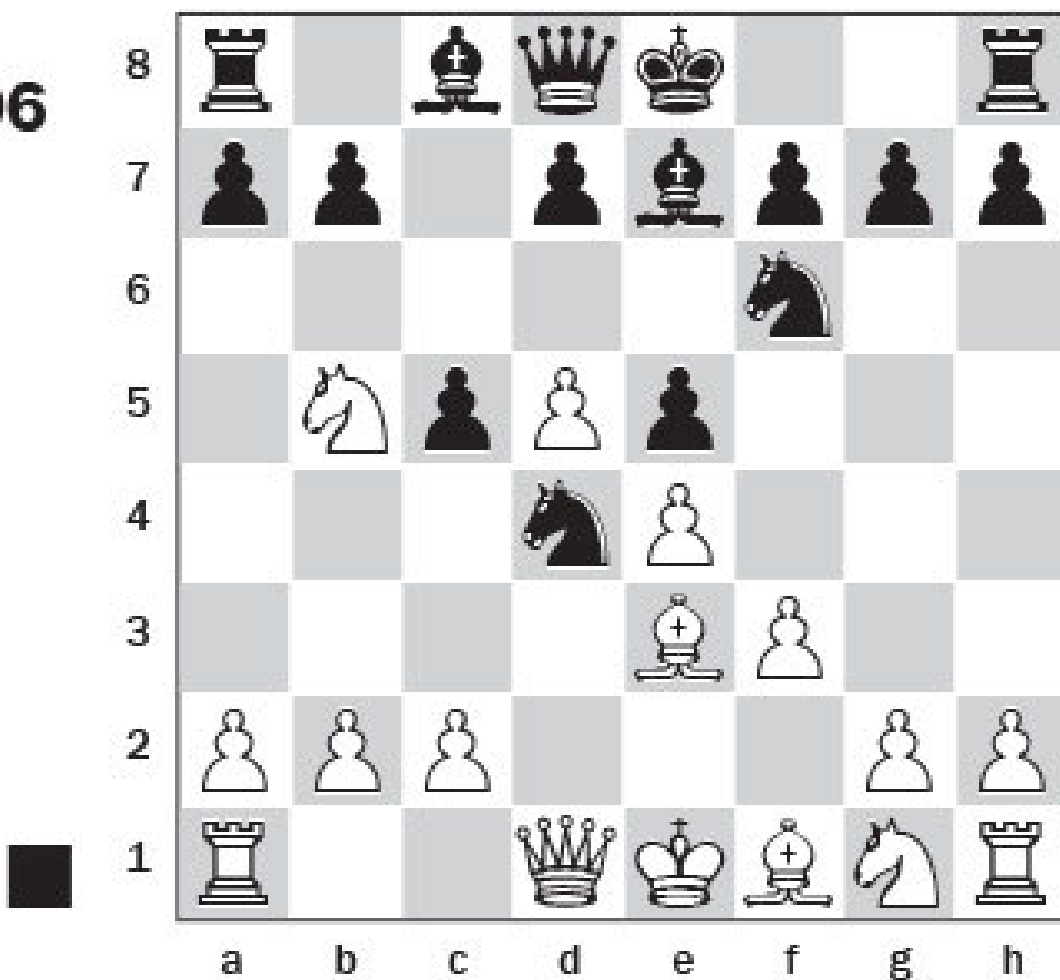


## HINT

With an exchange of pieces, White can set up a nasty skewer.

### Exercise 596

596



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

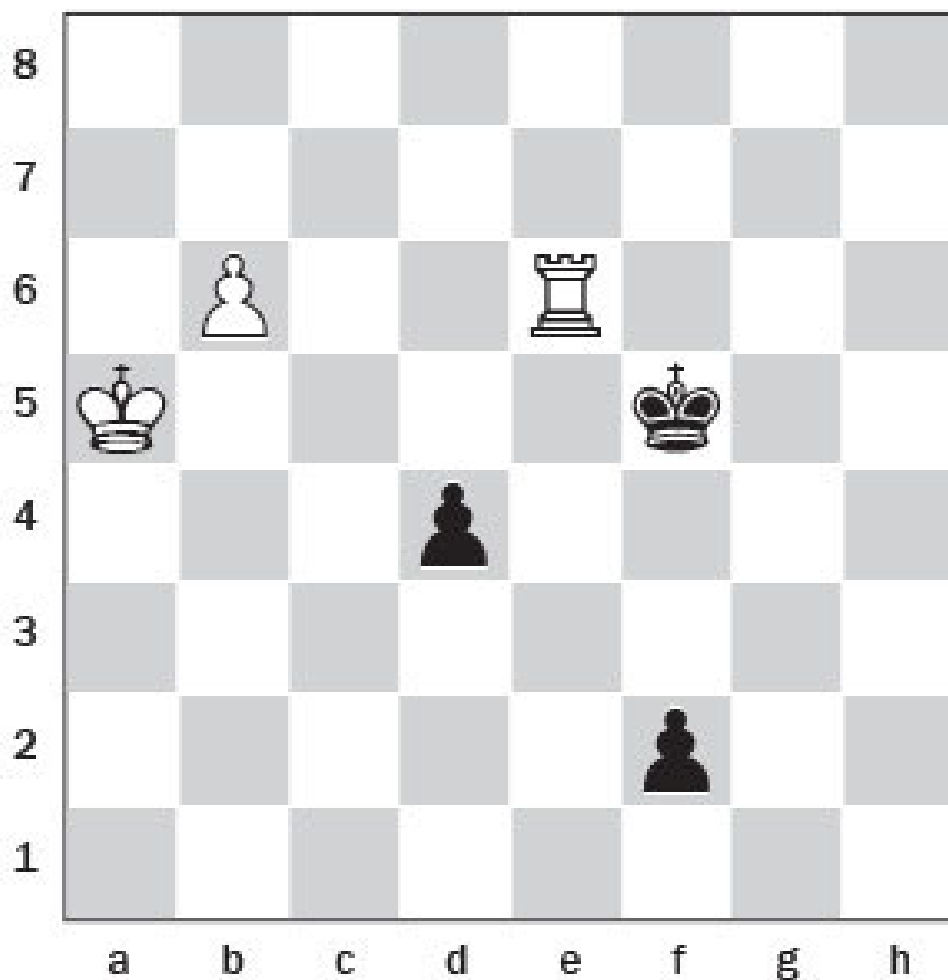
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

...Qa5+ can be met by Nc3 (and other moves), saving the material.  
What should Black do first to set up the fork?

## Exercise 597

597



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

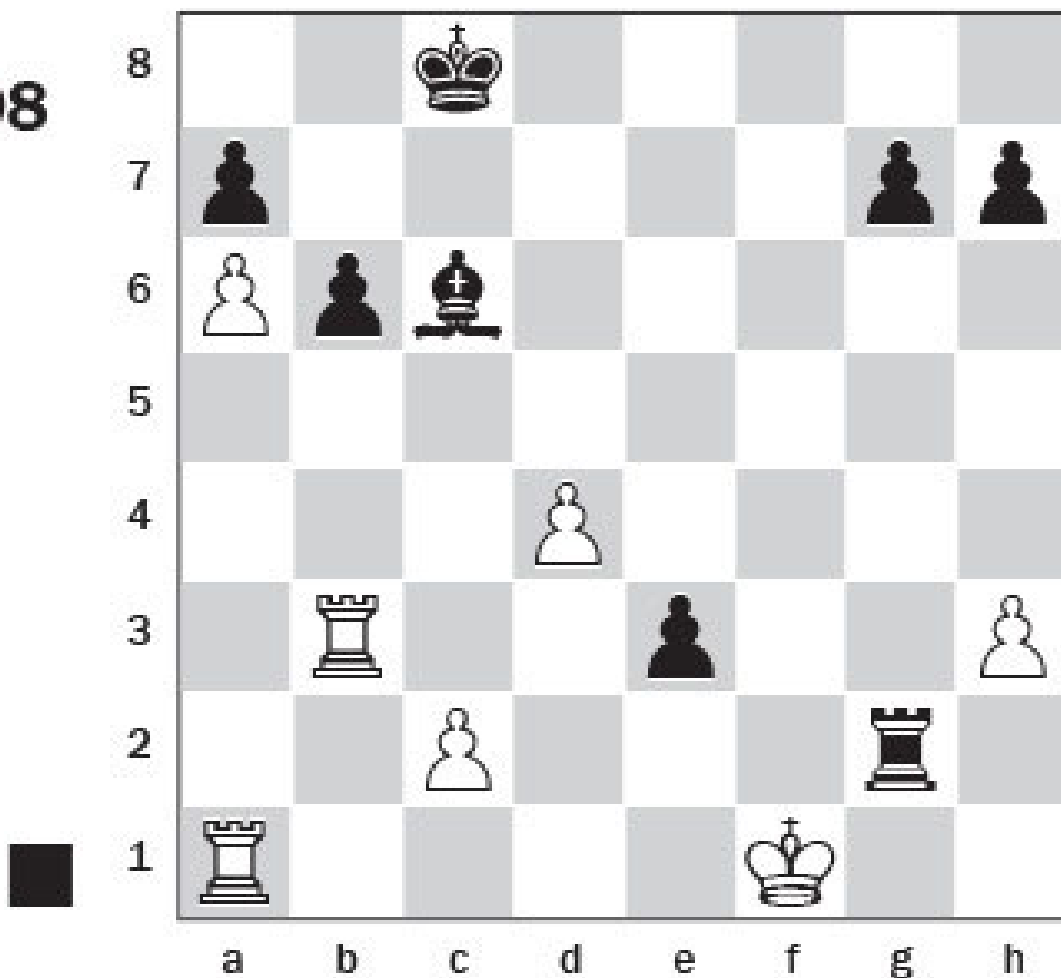
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

It looks like Black is going to promote the pawn on f2. Can you find a defense for White by using a skewer?

### Exercise 598

598



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

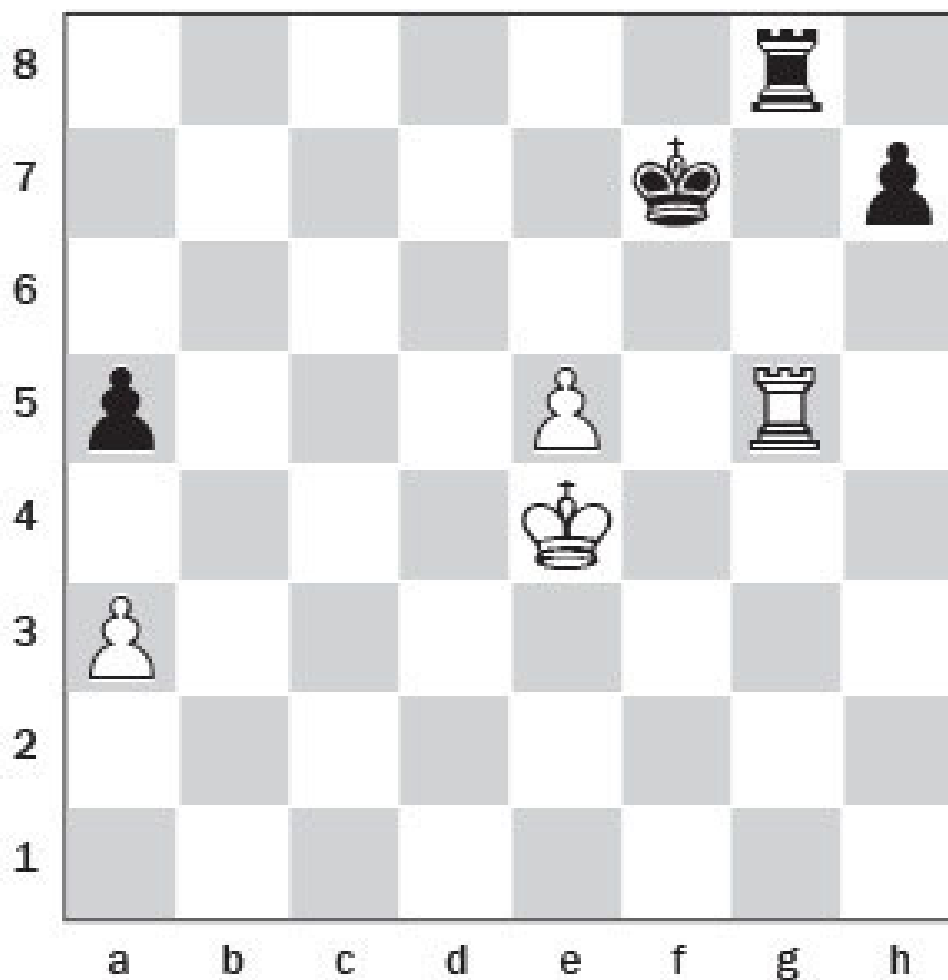
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the king and rook are lined up on the back rank: there is skewer potential. How can Black set it up?

## Exercise 599

599



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

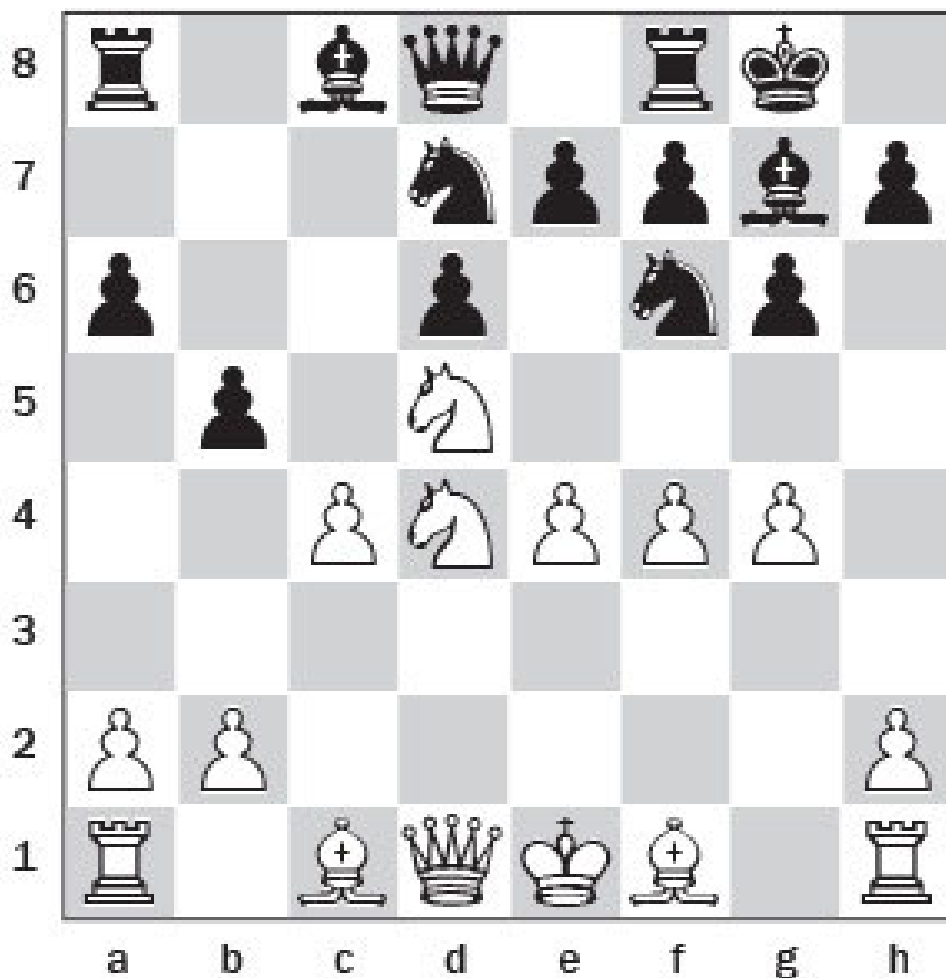
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Only the king guards the rook on g8. Can White use the pawn as a distraction?

### Exercise 600

600



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's knights are very well placed and Black's queen is restricted. Use the knights to trap the queen!

### Exercise 601

601





Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

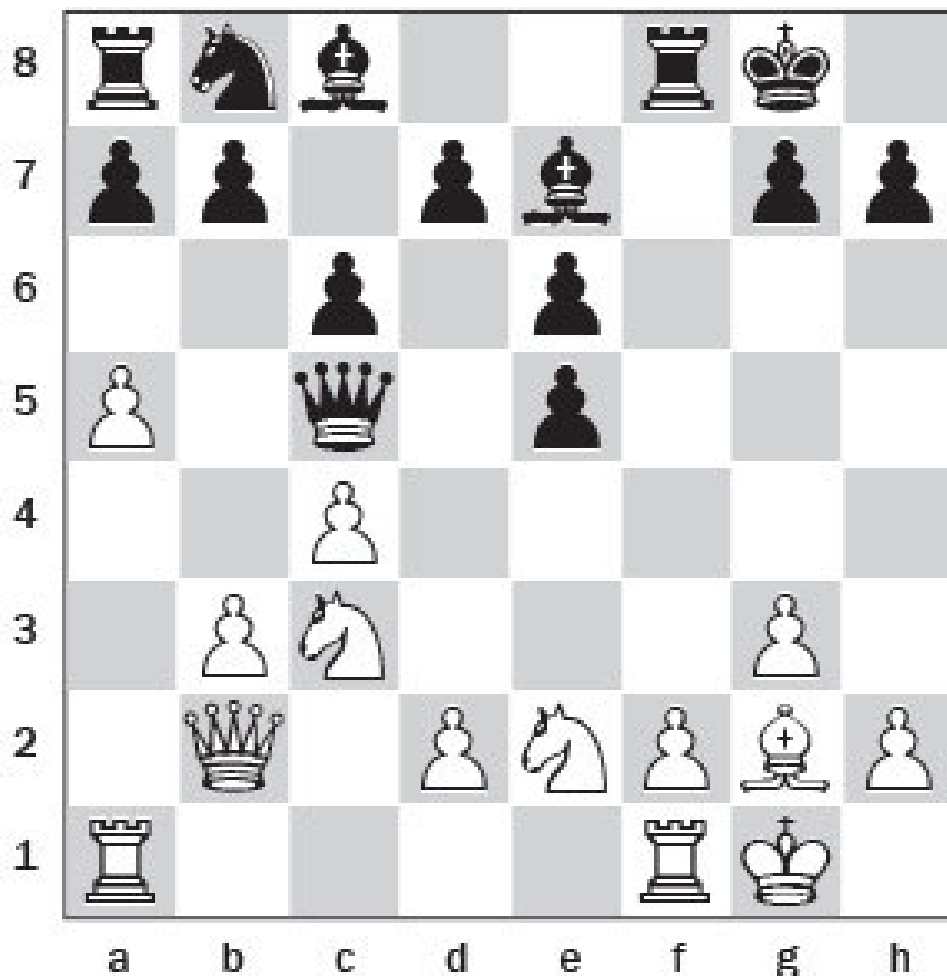
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Is the queen really protecting the bishop on d5? Use a decoy and then a fork to win material.

### Exercise 602

602



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

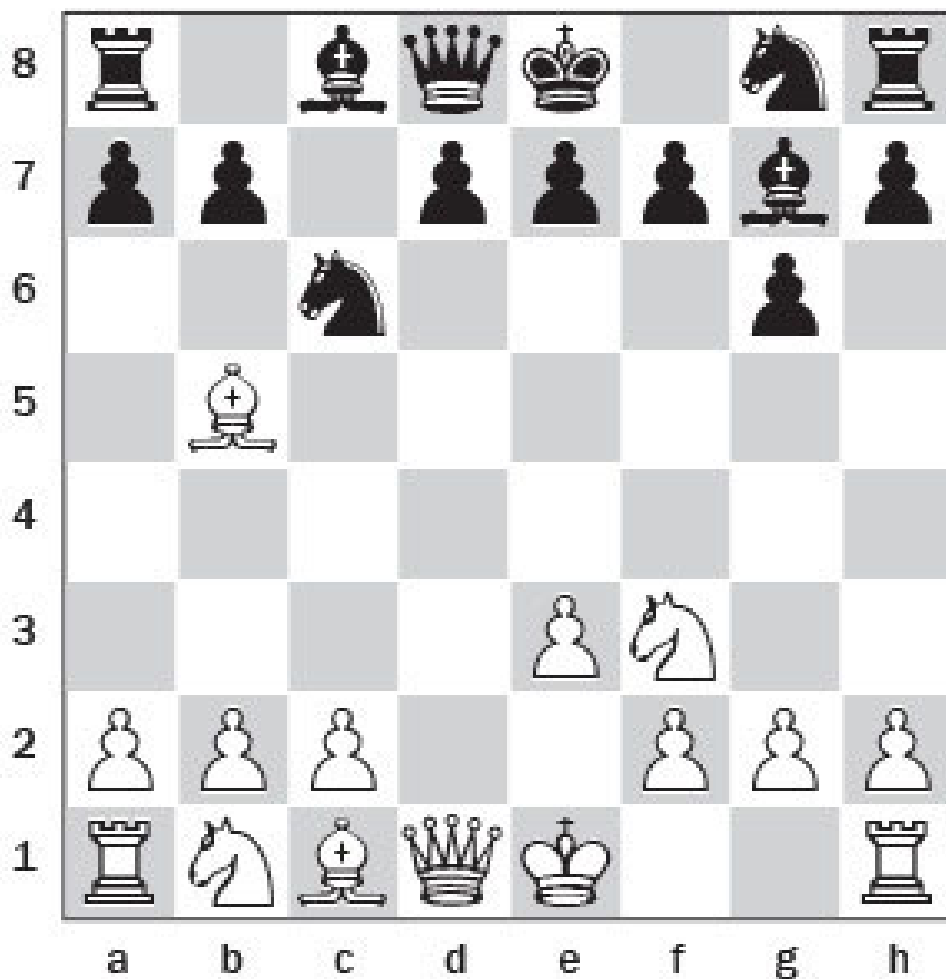
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**HINT**

The queen on c5 has very limited squares, what can White do?

## Exercise 603

603



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

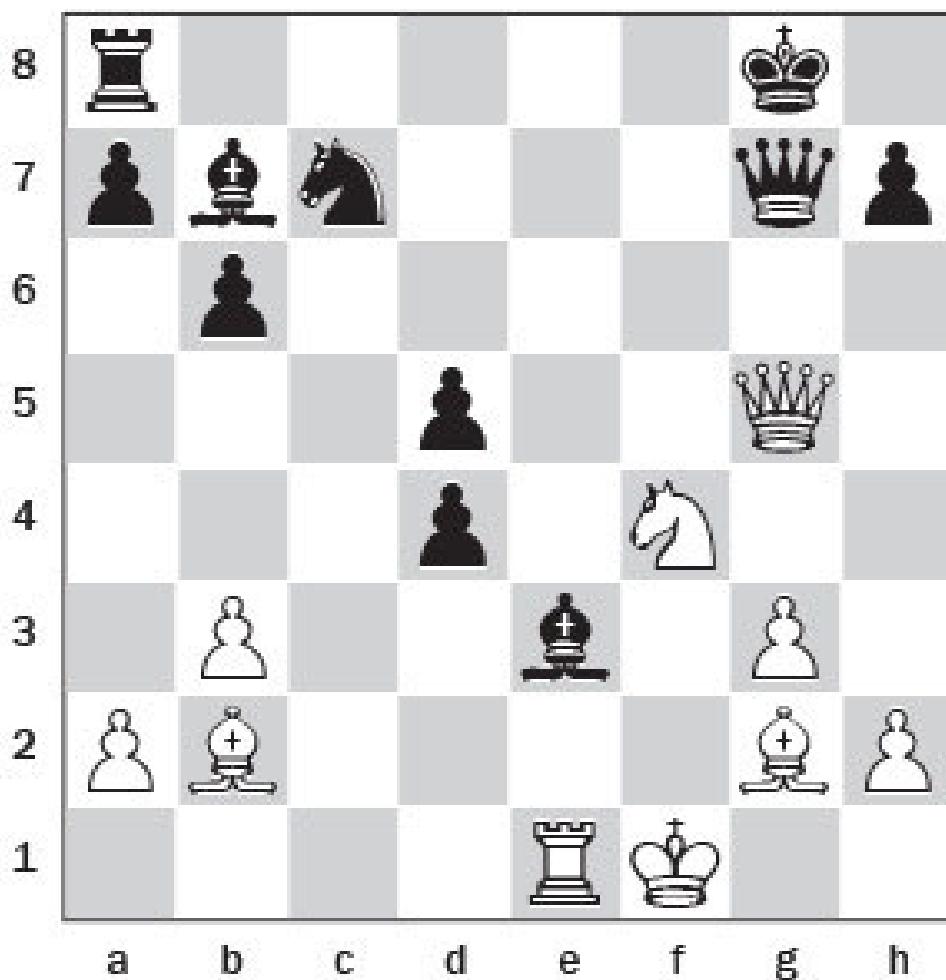
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a queen fork, find White's best defense, then remove the guard to win material.

### Exercise 604

604



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

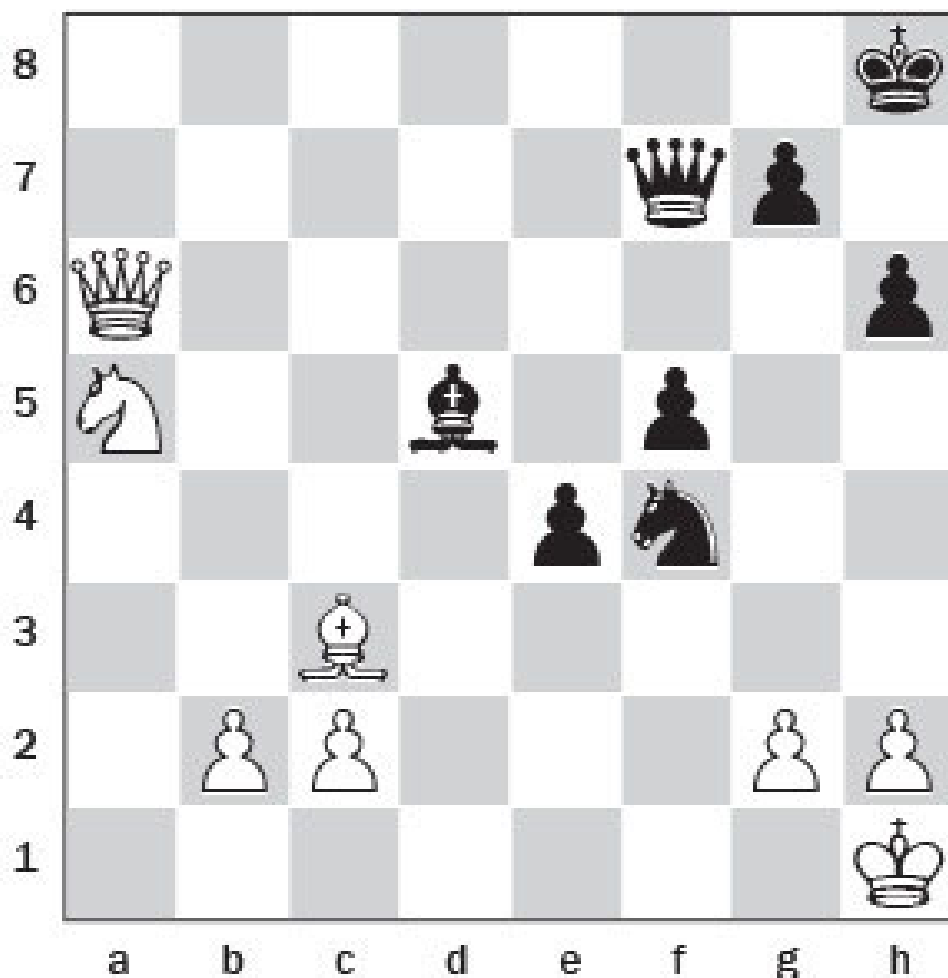
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

Set up a pin to win the bishop on e3. Remember: pinned pieces do not protect.

### **[Exercise 605](#)**

605



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

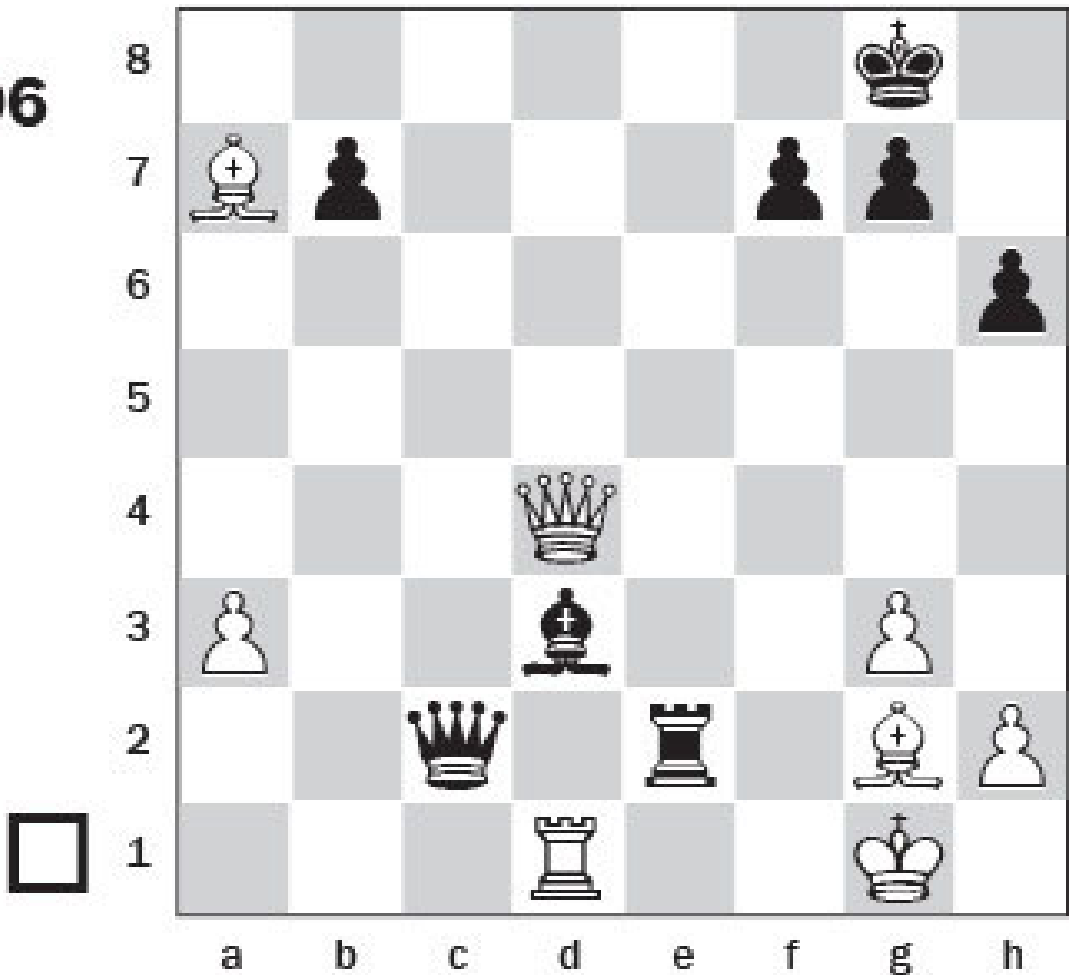
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

Pinned pieces do not protect. Also notice that the knight on f4 is unprotected.

### Exercise 606

**606**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

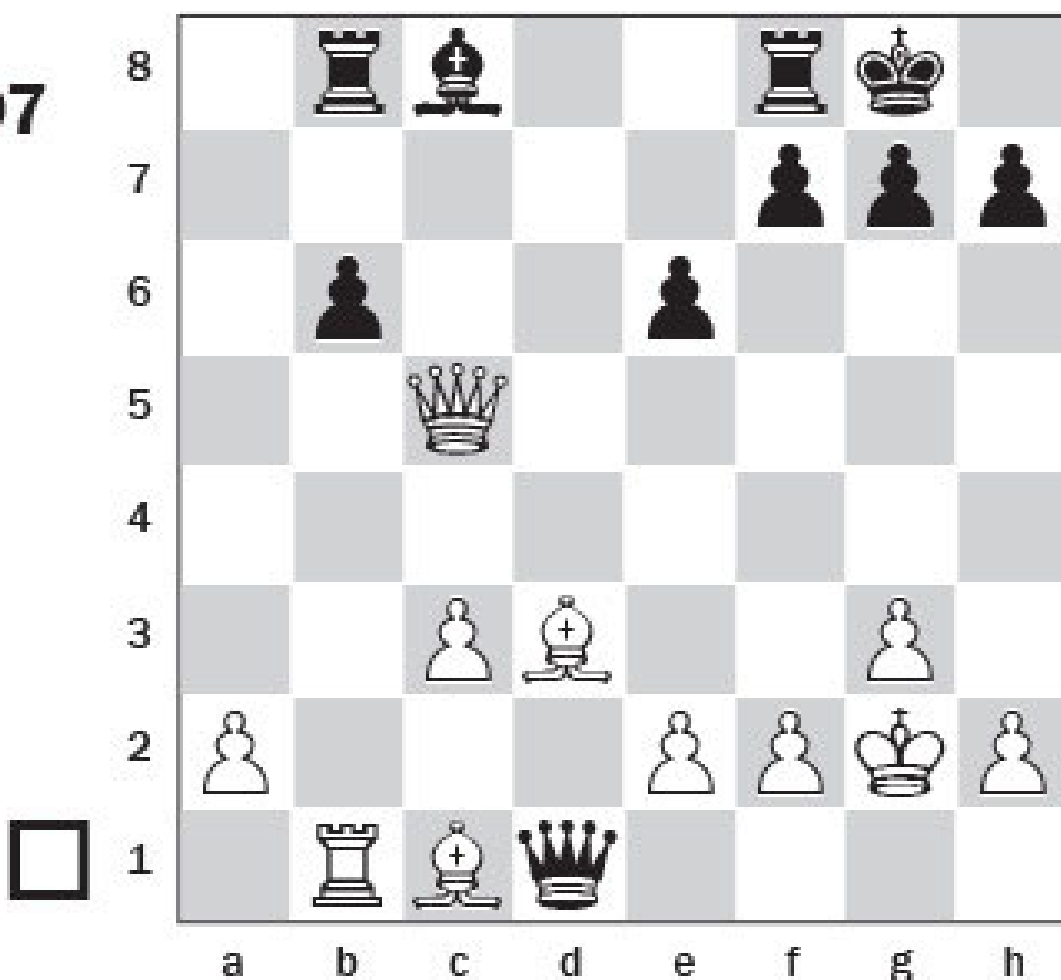
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

If White captures the bishop on d3, Black plays ... ♖xg2+. What can White do first to make capturing the bishop on d3 possible?

### Exercise 607

607



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

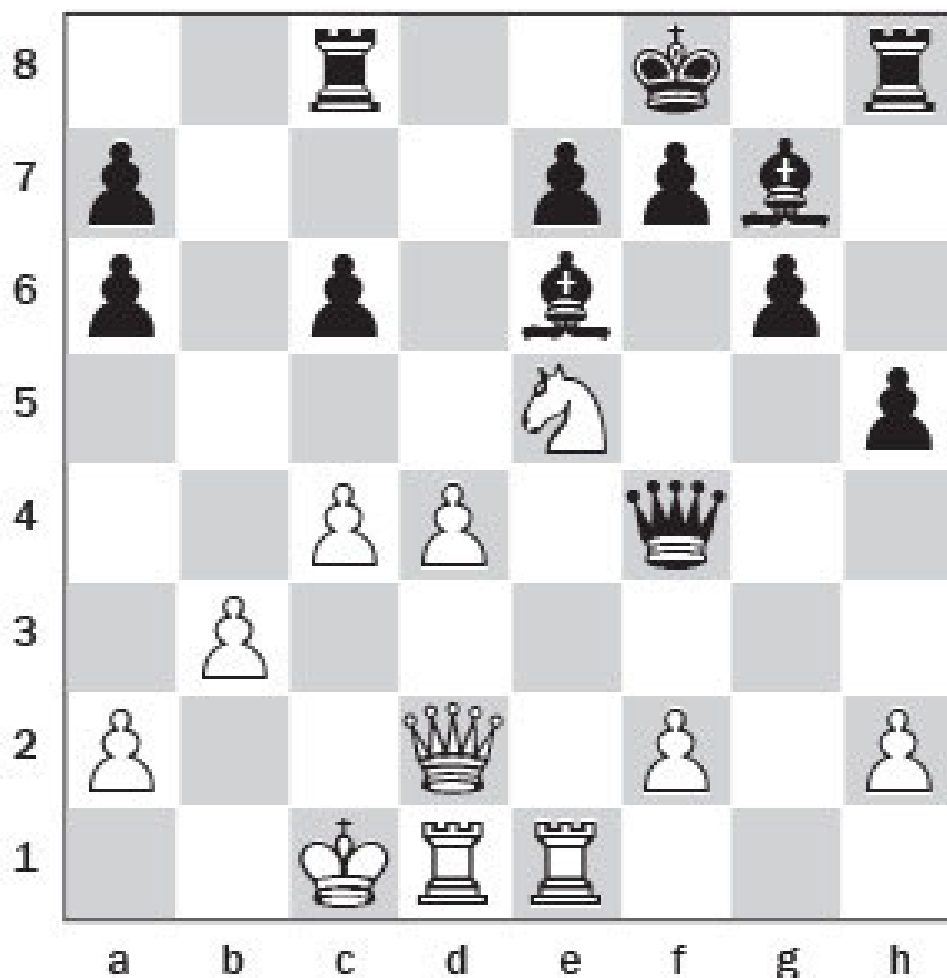
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on b1 is lined up with Black's queen on d1. Win material by using a decoy and then a discovered attack.

## Exercise 608

608



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

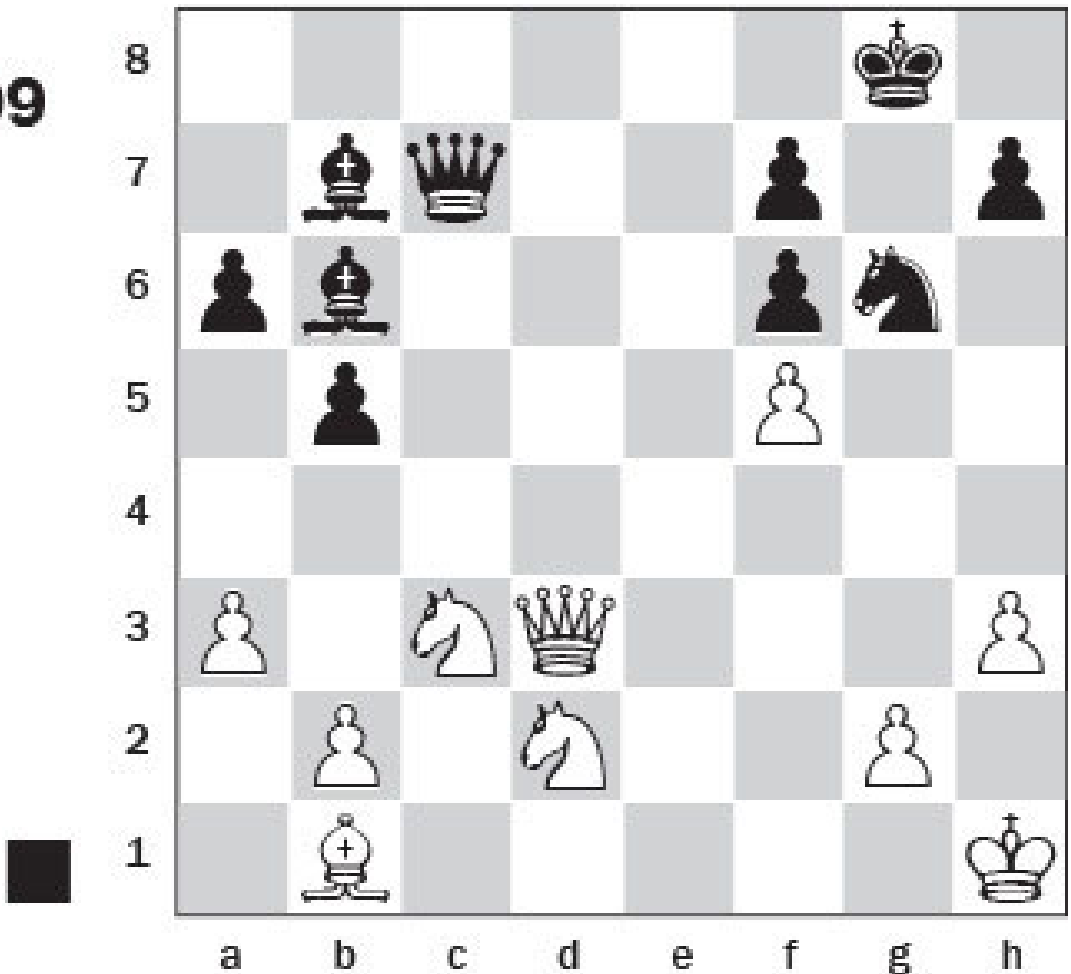
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

If White captures the queen, then Black will play ... ♖h6, pinning the queen to the king. What can White do first, to win the queen with check?

### Exercise 609

609



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

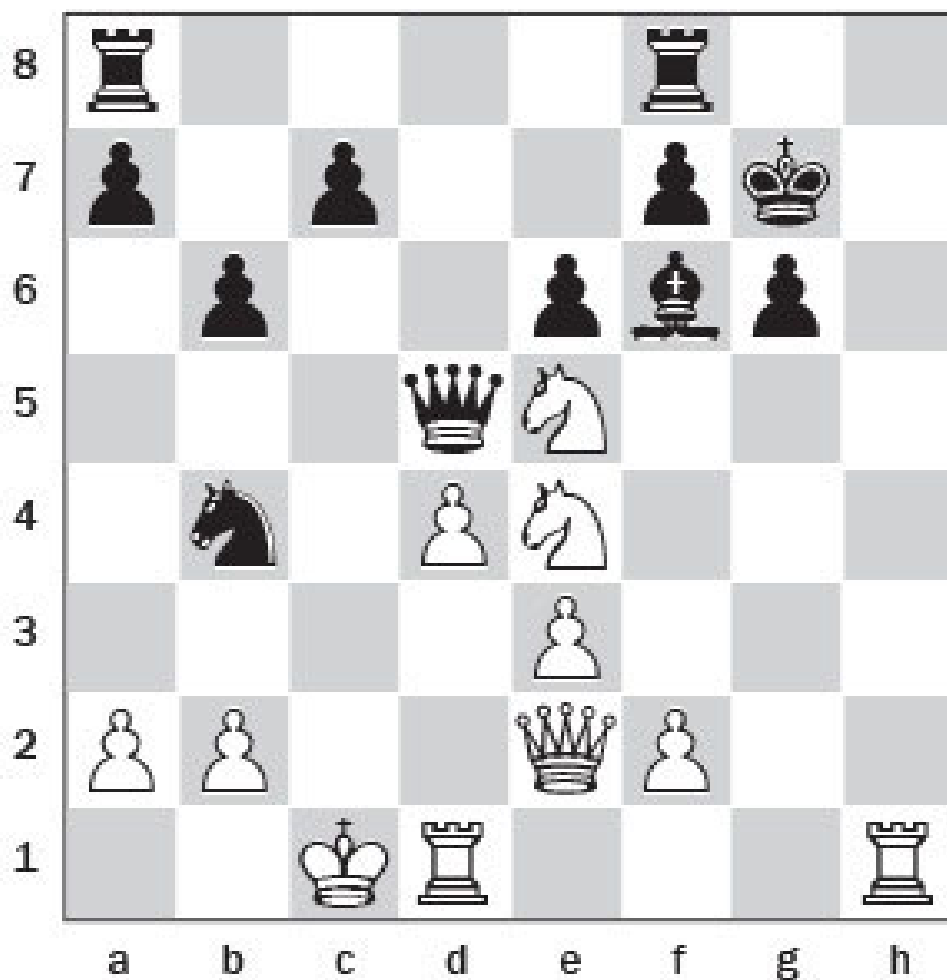
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishops are pointing at the king. Decoy sacrifice a bishop to create a knight Fork.

## Exercise 610

610



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

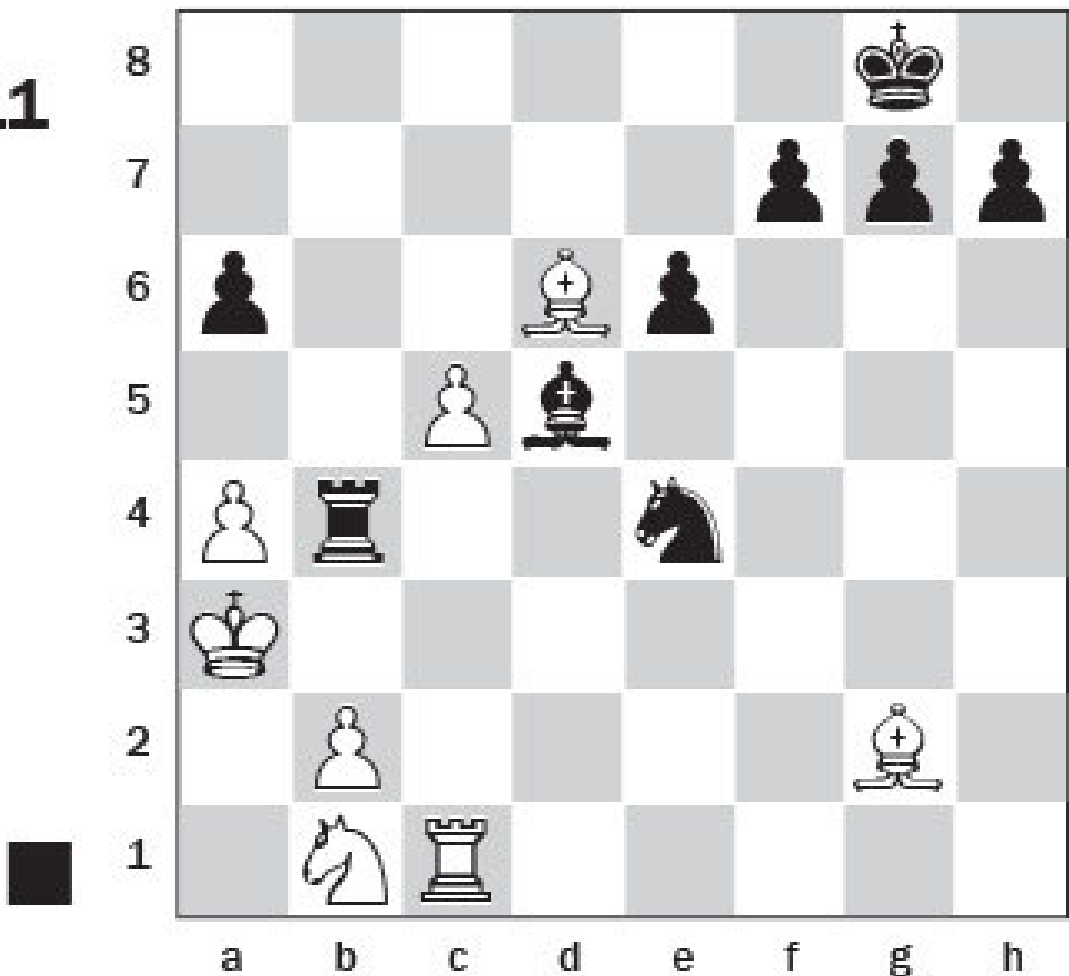
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The bishop on f6 is only protected by the king. Use a decoy to set up a knight fork.

### Exercise 611

**611**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

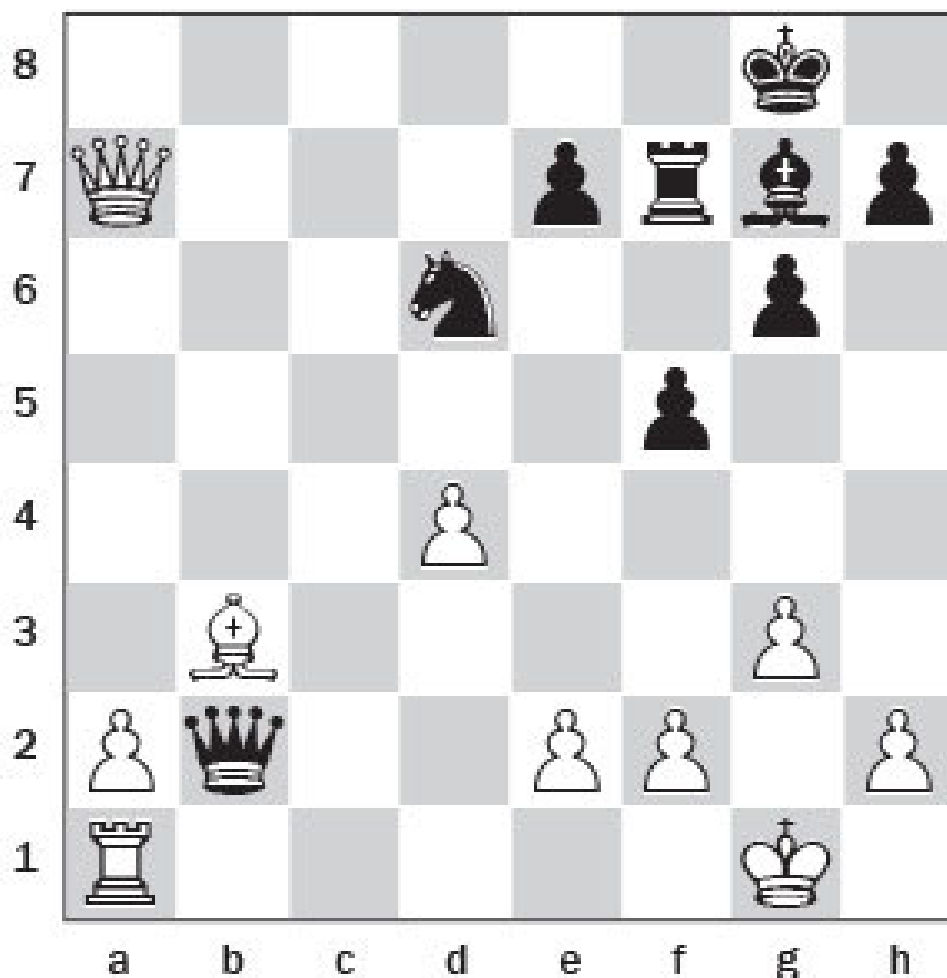
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Set up a discovered check and then win the unprotected rook on c1.

### Exercise 612

612



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

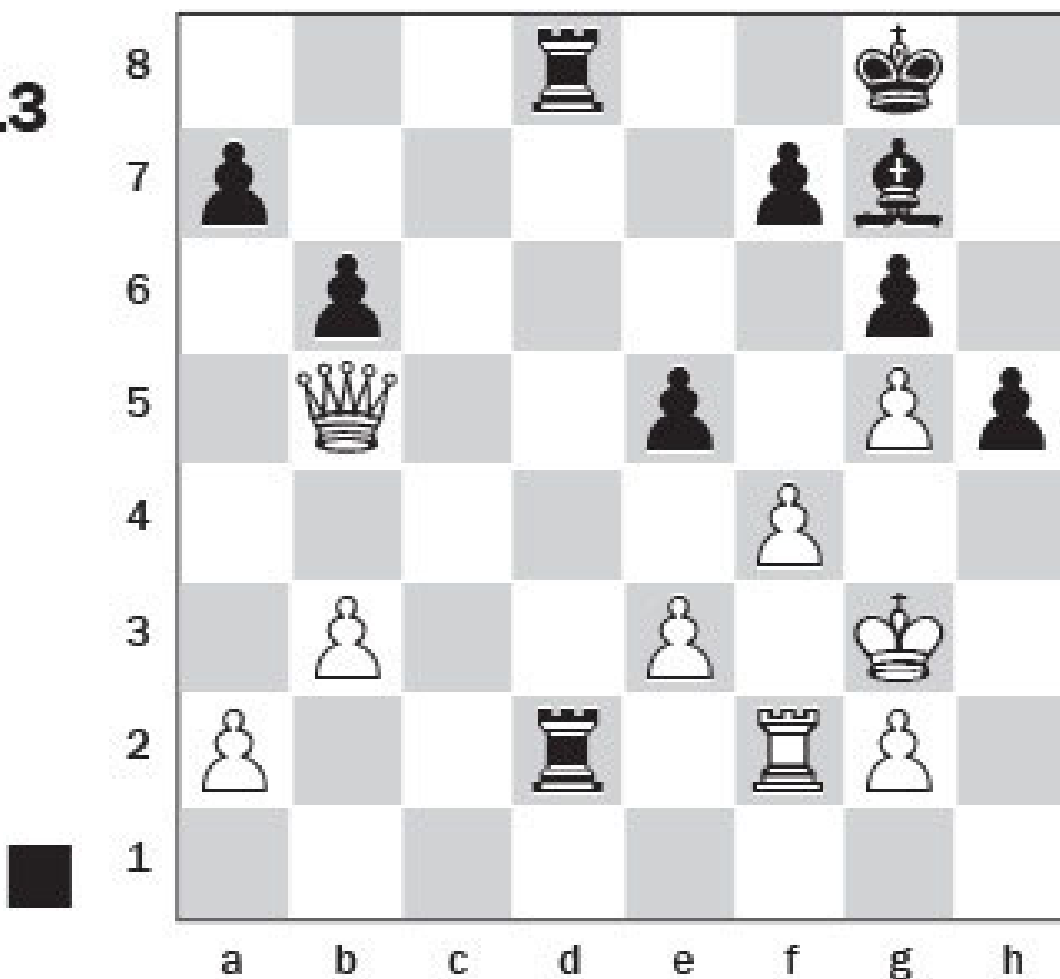


## HINT

Taking the rook on f7 immediately is not necessary since it's pinned. Instead, set up a discovered attack first, and then make the rook capture.

### Exercise 613

**613**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

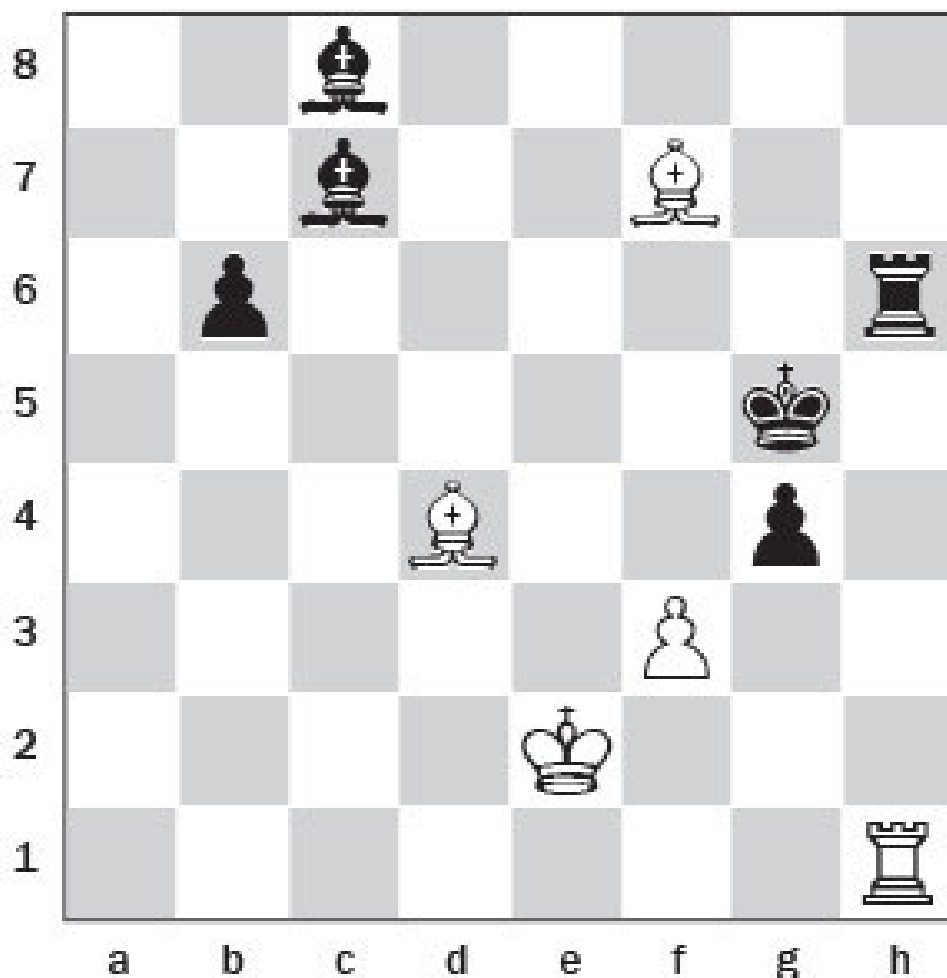
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Only the king guards the rook. Is there a way you can chase the king away with two decoys?

### [Exercise 614](#)

614



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

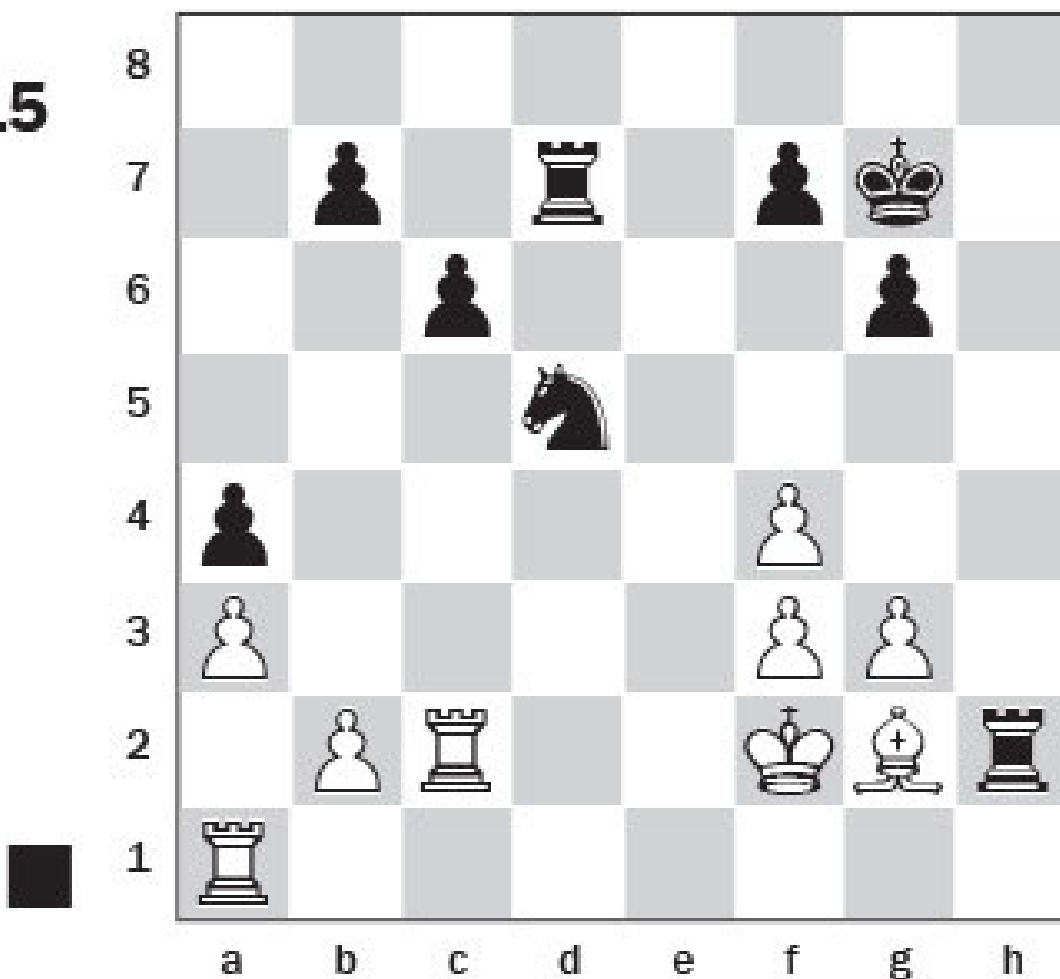
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that Black's king and rook are on the same diagonal. Start with a skewer, once Black defends, then use the overloaded theme to win material.

### Exercise 615

**615**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

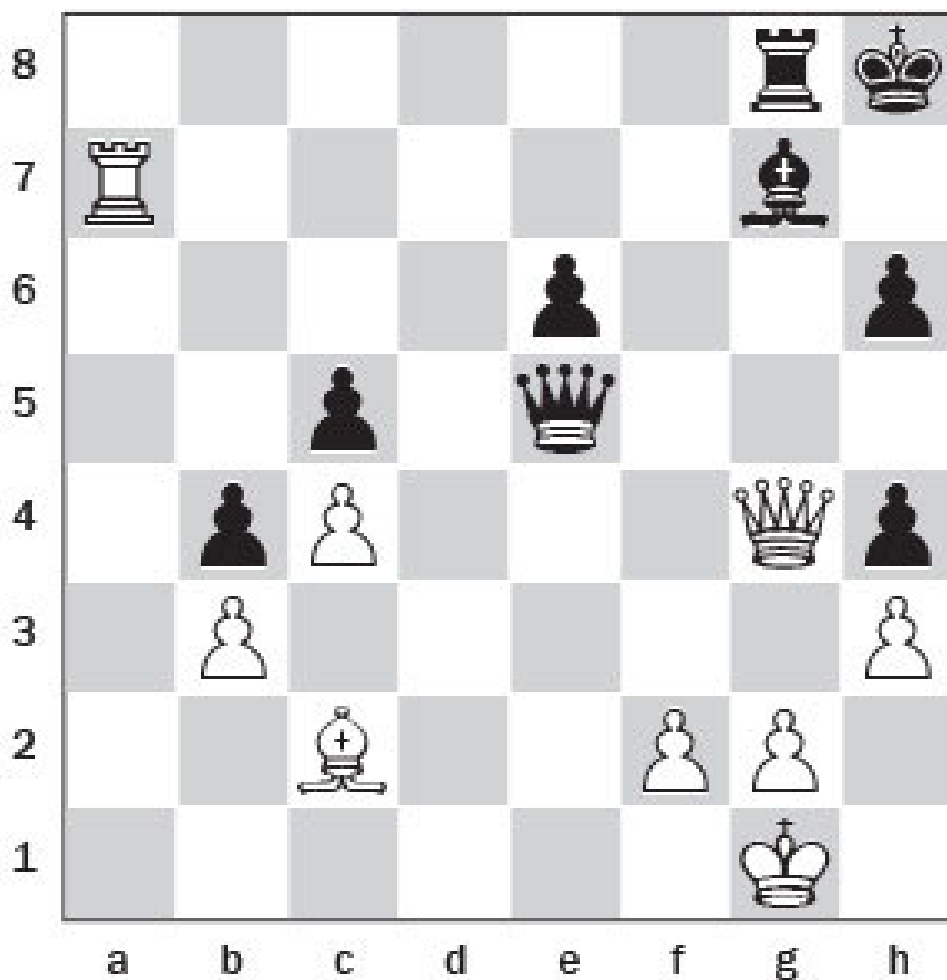
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a decoy to set up a fork.

## [Exercise 616](#)

616



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

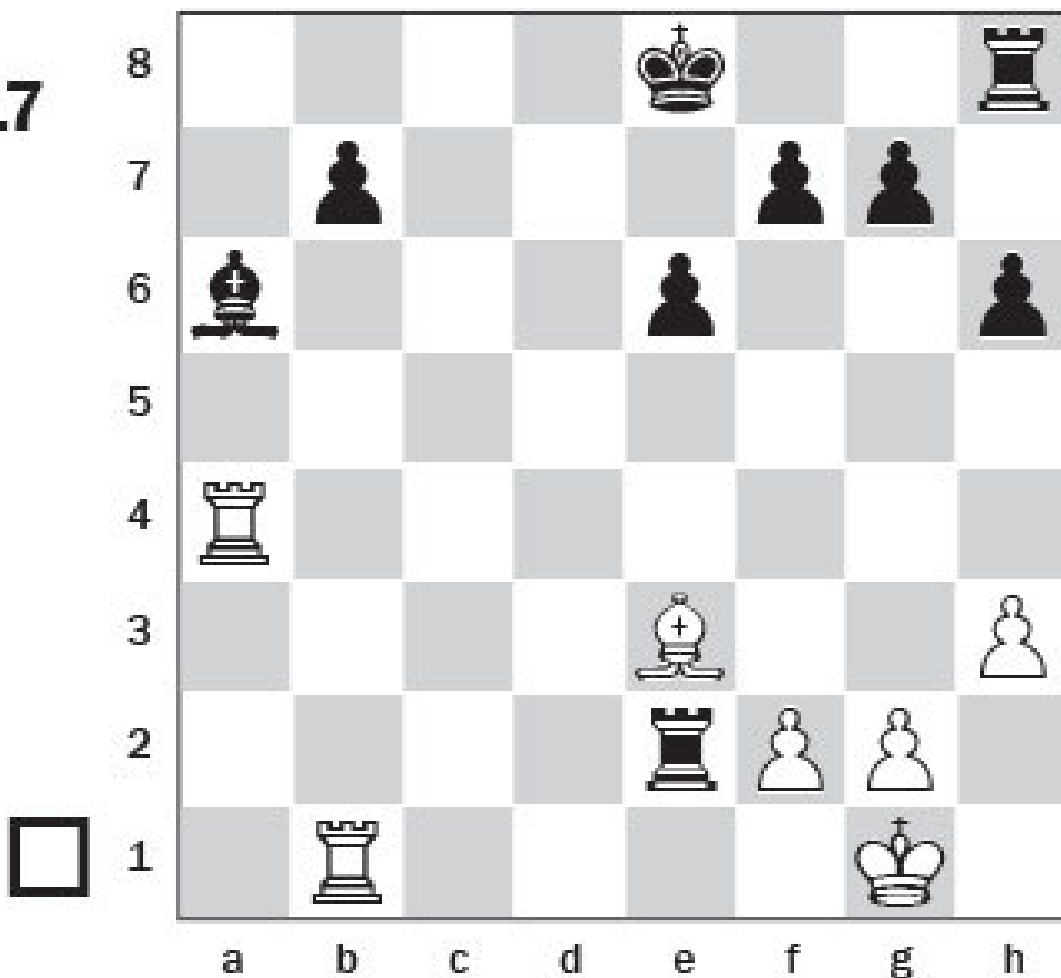
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The rook on g8 is staring at the queen. Set up a discovered attack which wins the queen.

### Exercise 617

617



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

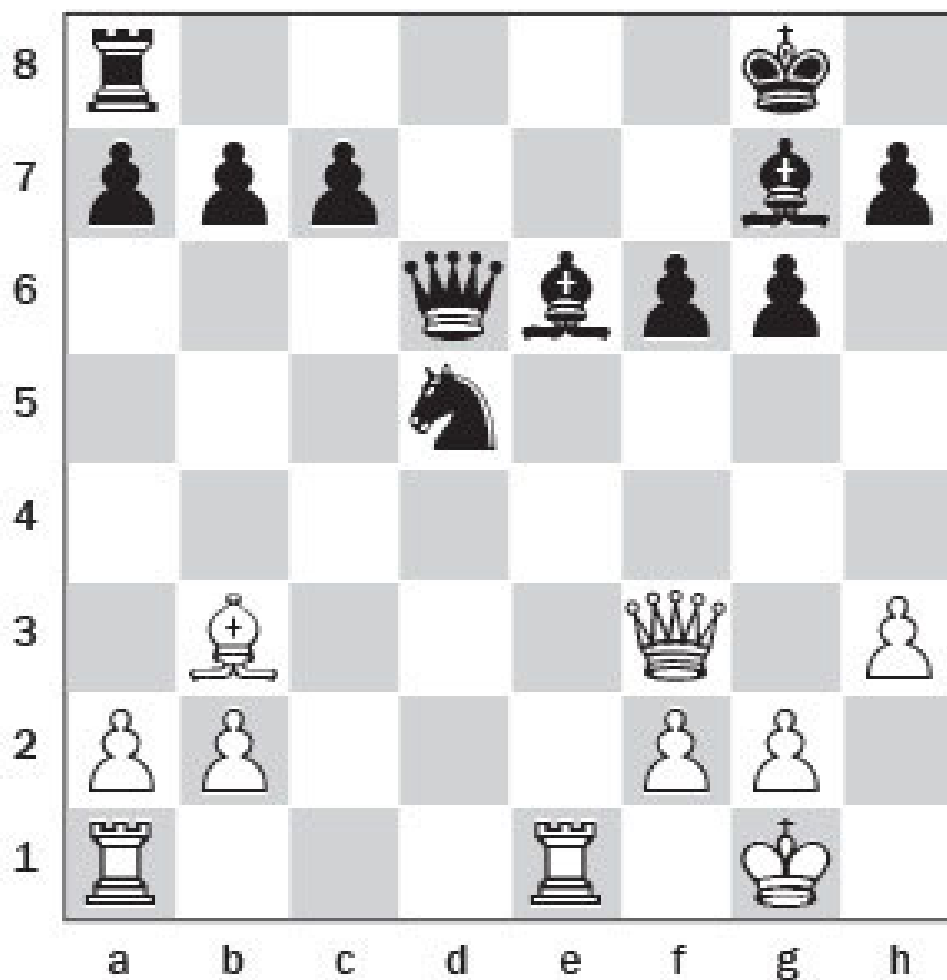
## HINT

Black's back rank is weak since they're not castled yet. Use a decoy to set up a skewer.

## Exercise 618



618



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

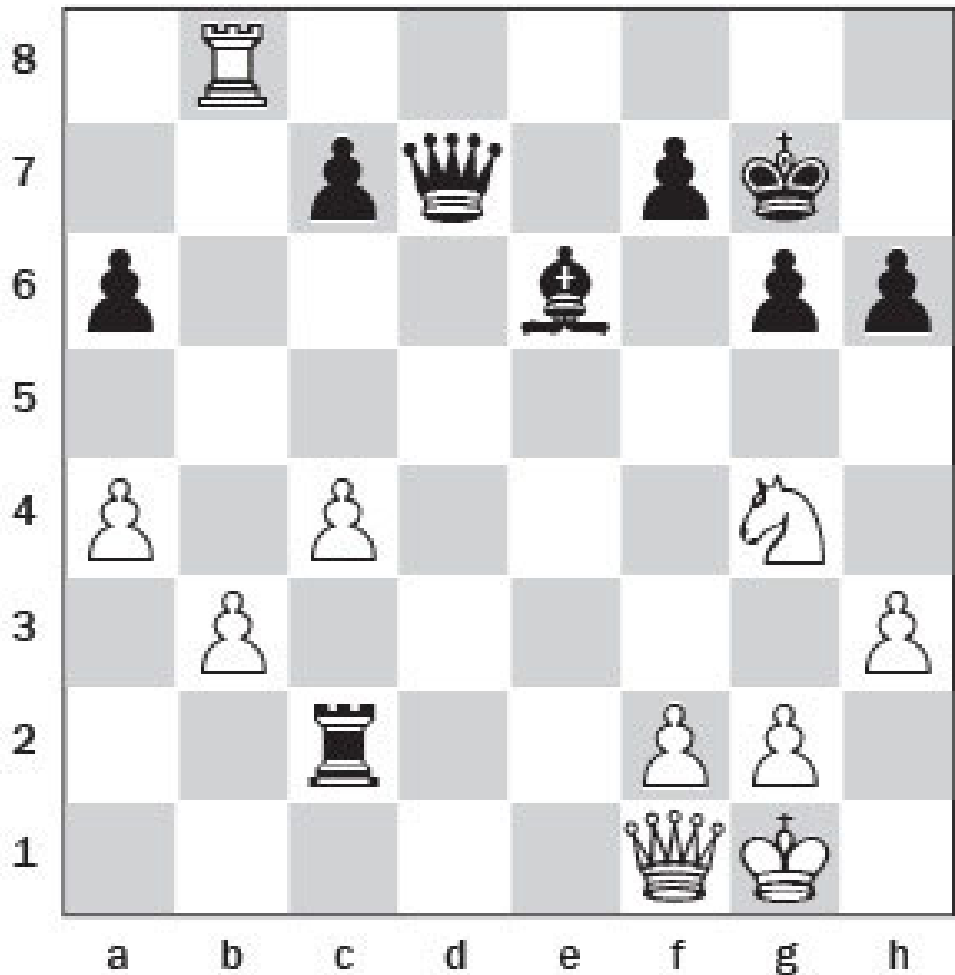
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

A lot of pieces are on the a2-g8 diagonal. Remove the guard then use a pin to win material.

### Exercise 619

**619**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

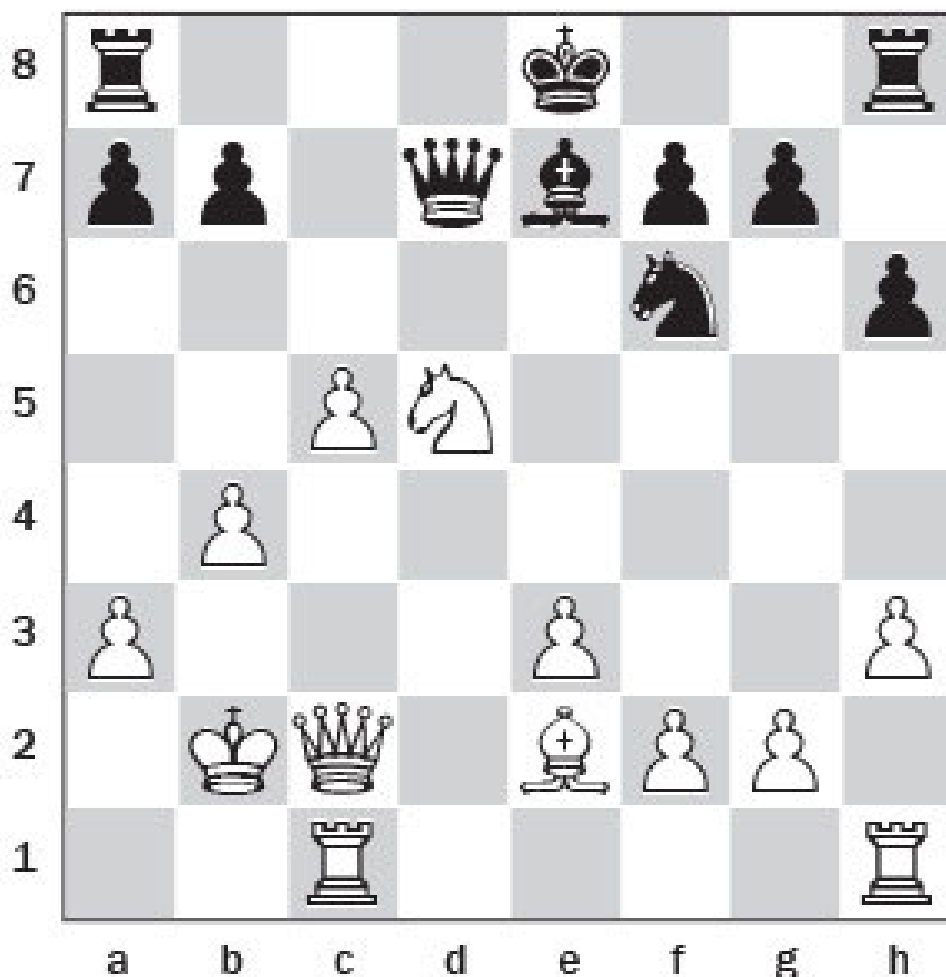
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Use a decoy sacrifice to set up a fork next move.

### Exercise 620

**620**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

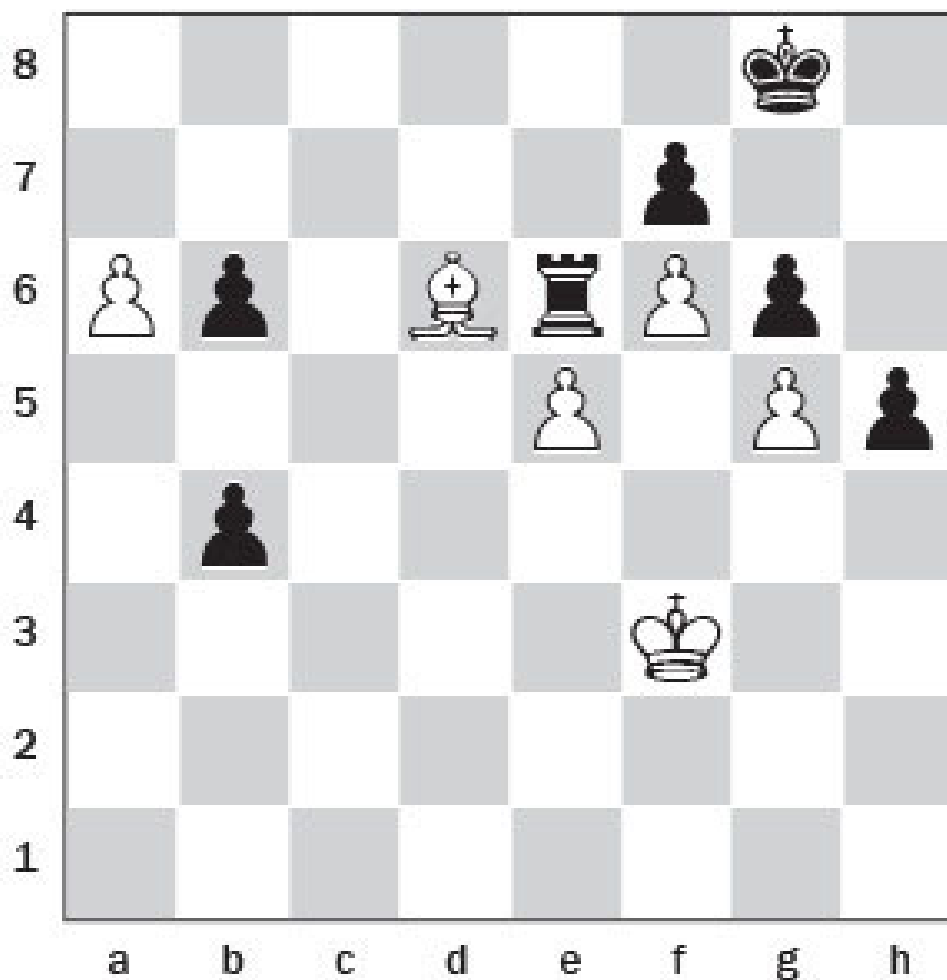
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the queen and king are on the same diagonal. Start with a decoy/pin, then use a knight fork to win material.

## [Exercise 621](#)

621



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

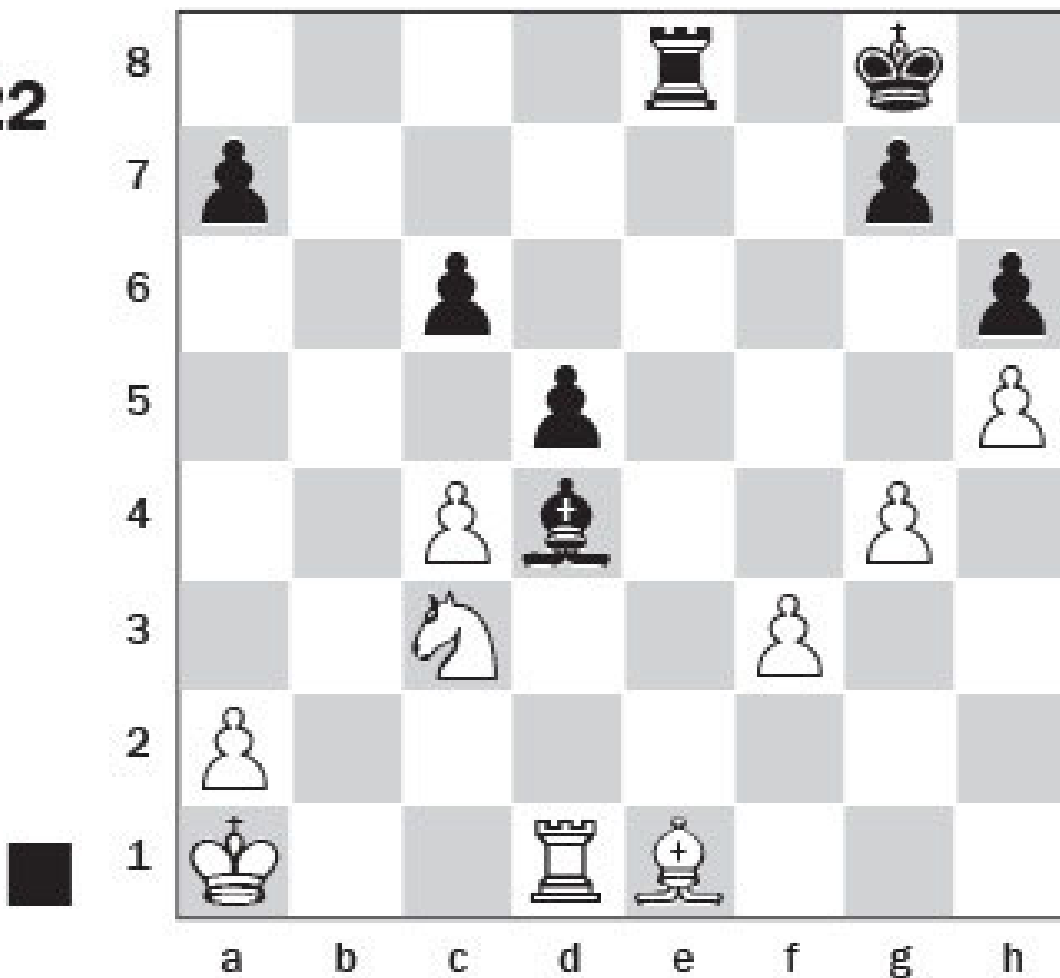
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

White has a nice passed pawn on a6. Promote the pawn by using an interference tactic. Be sure to find Black's initial defense for full credit.

### Exercise 622

622



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

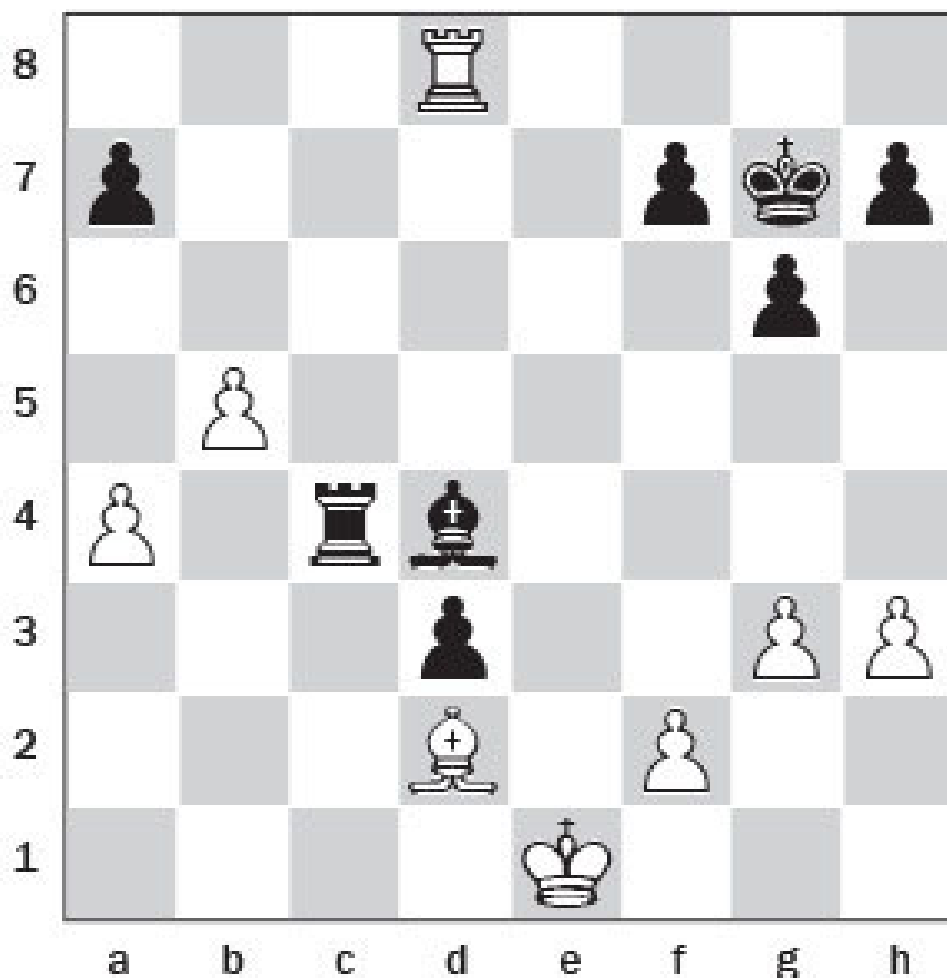
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The knight on c3 is protected by the bishop on e1. What can Black do to win material? Use removing the guard and fork.

## Exercise 623

623



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

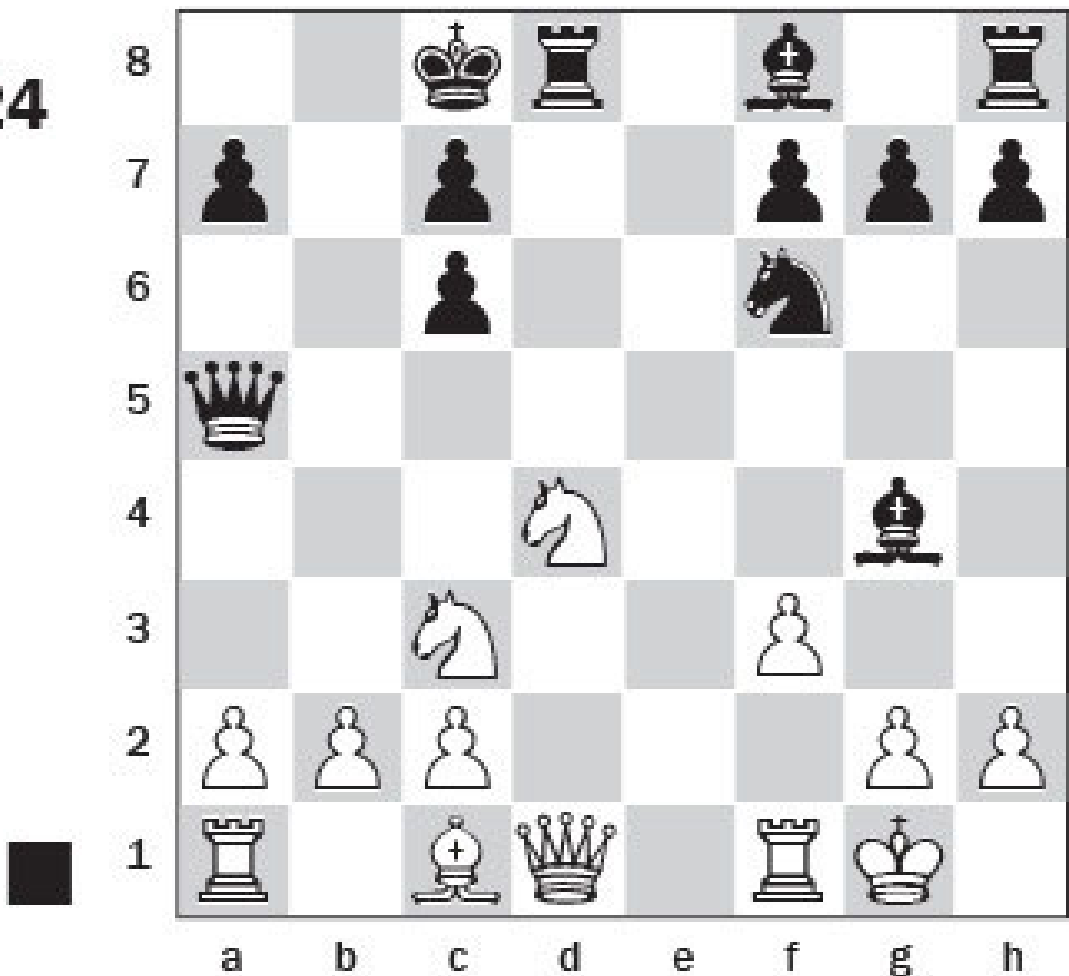


## HINT

The bishop on d2 would love to use the a1-h8 diagonal. Use a decoy and a pin.

### Exercise 624

624



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

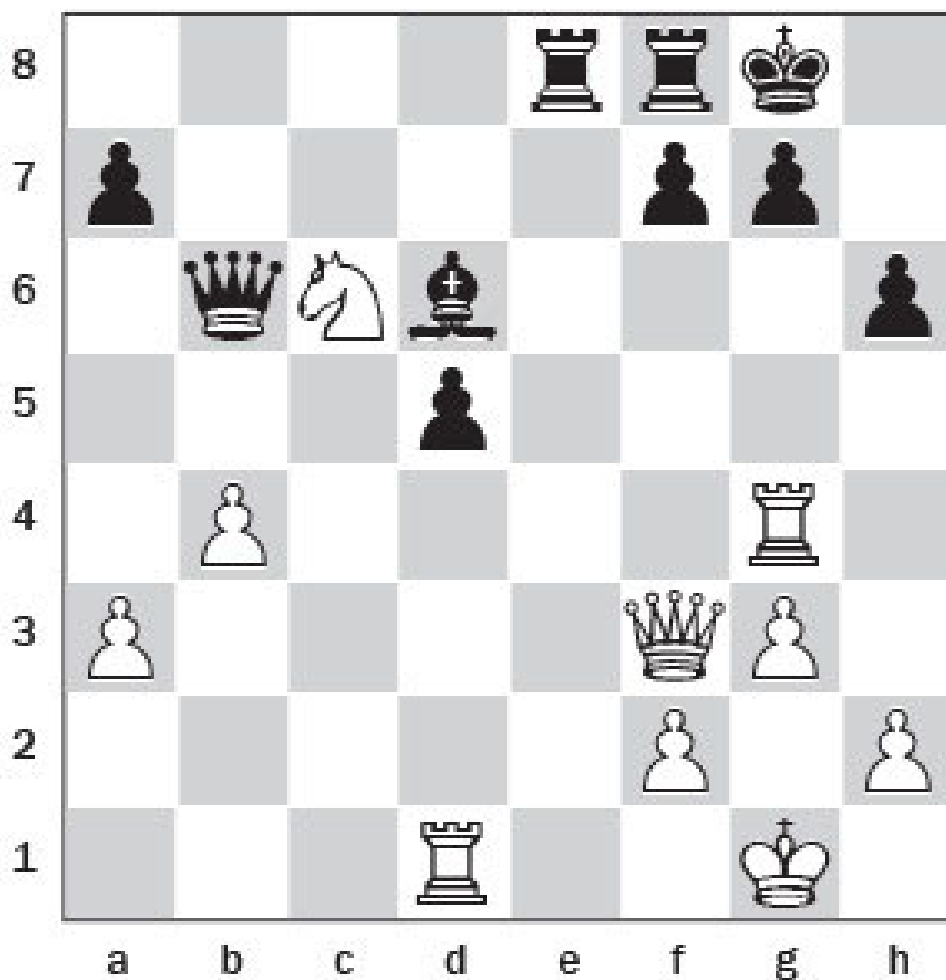
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's f2-pawn has moved which makes the diagonal to the king weak. Use a decoy, followed by a pin, to win material.

### Exercise 625

625



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

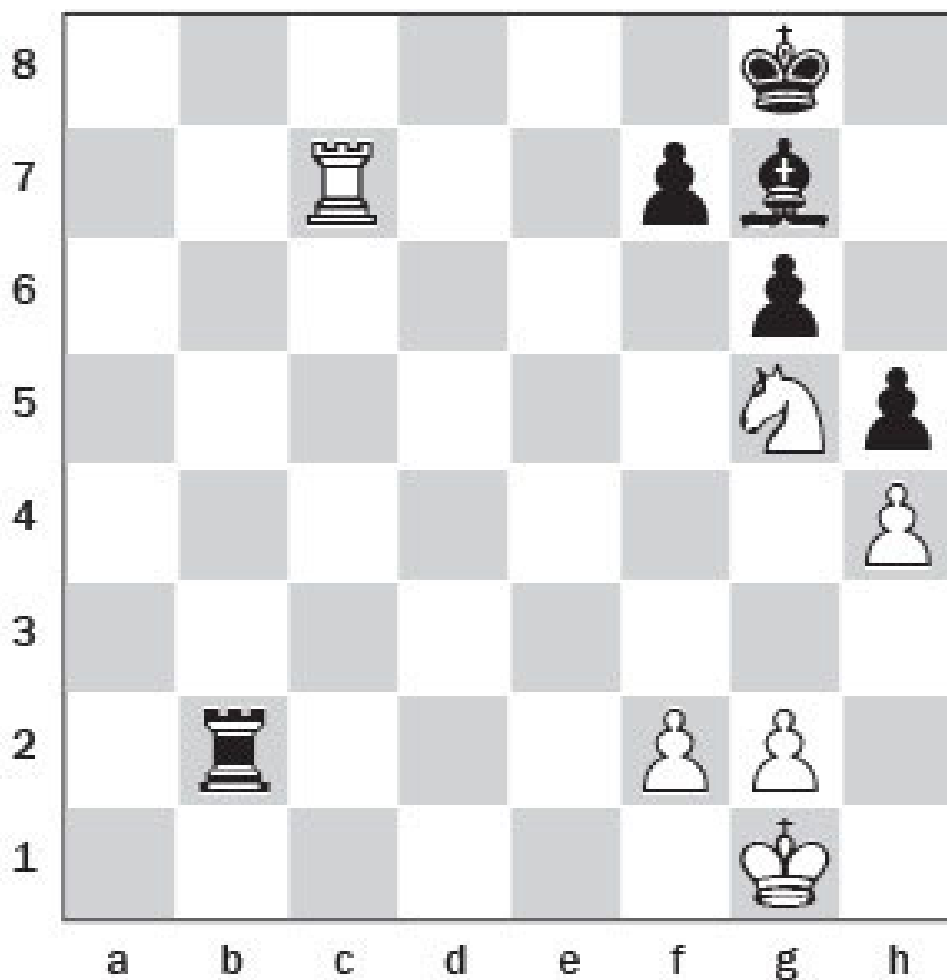
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

Use the pin to threaten checkmate and Black's unprotected piece.

### [Exercise 626](#)

626



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

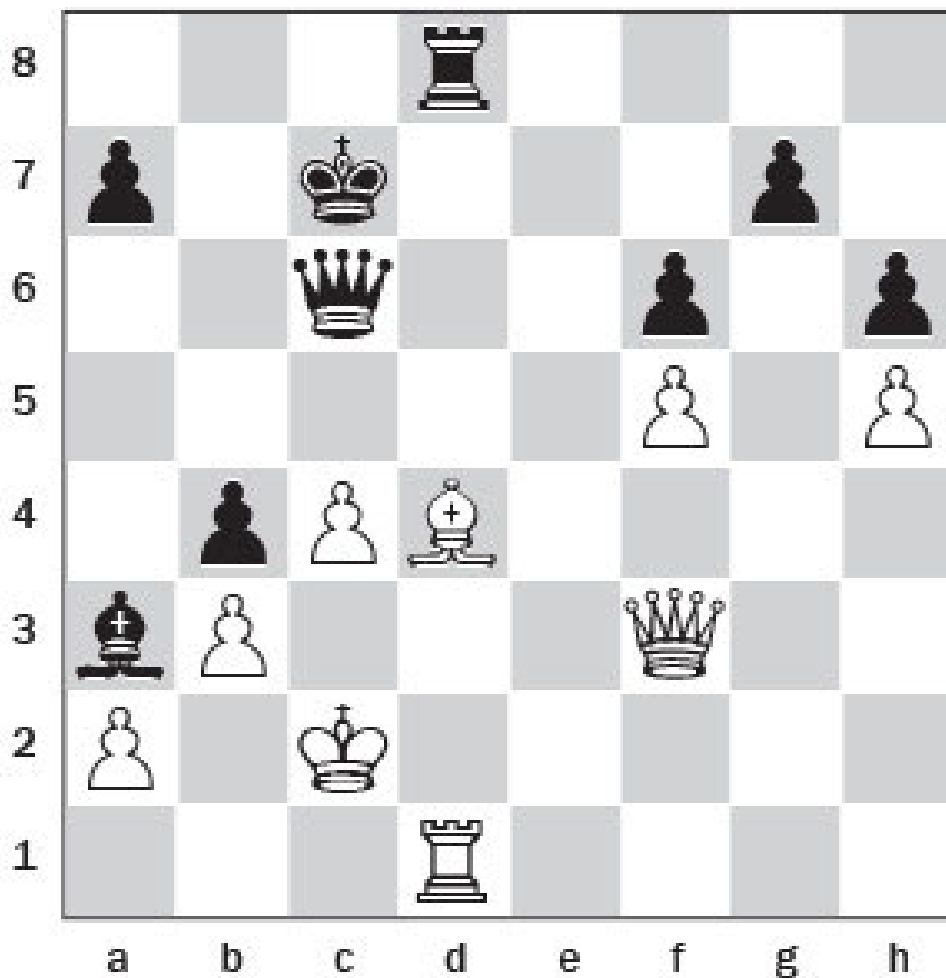
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Set up a bishop fork winning a rook.

### Exercise 627

627



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

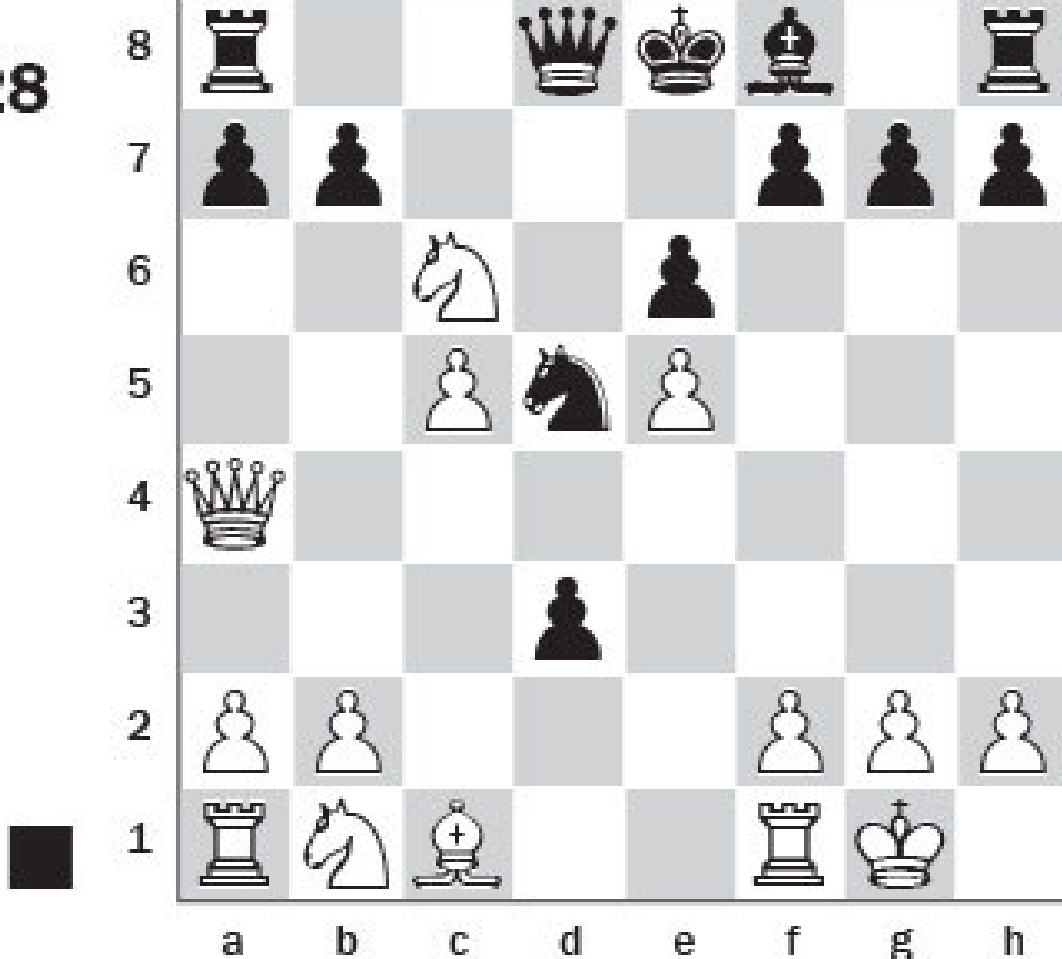
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The king on c7 is trying to guard both c6 and d8. Use a discovered attack to open up the rook on d1 and the overloaded theme to win material.

## Exercise 628

628



Answer:

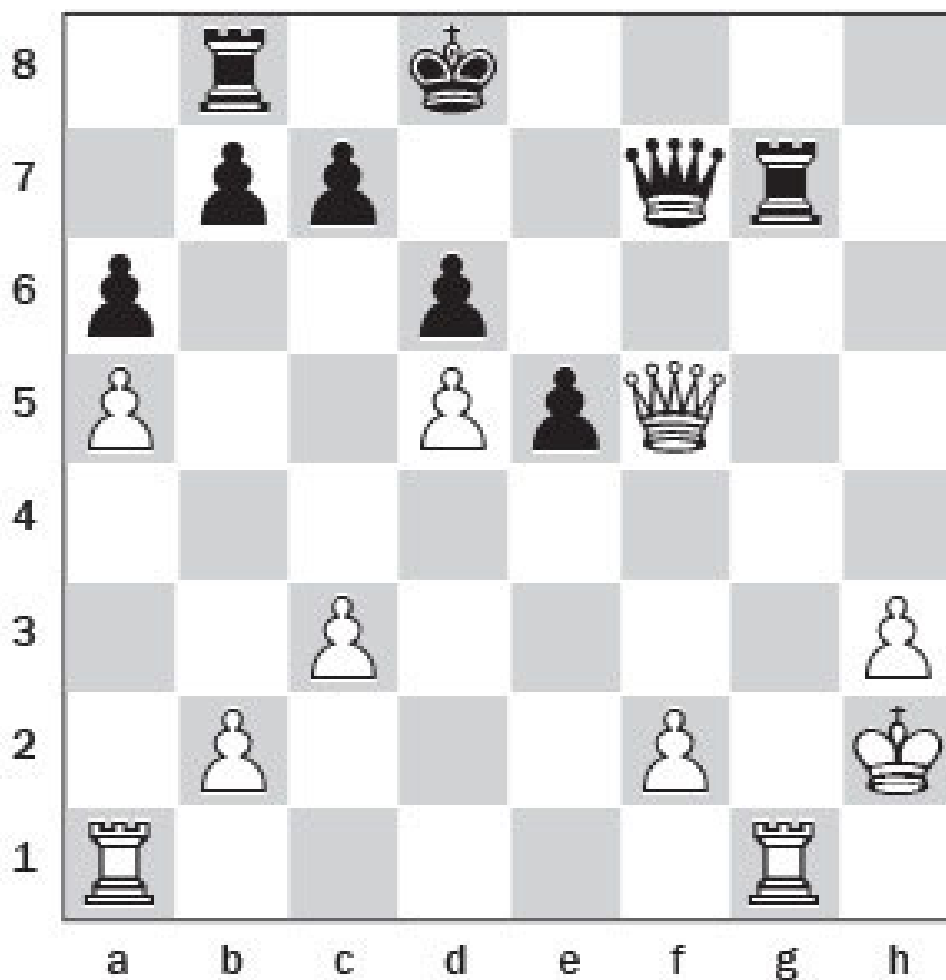
1. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

If Black captures the knight on c6, White's queen comes in with a fork. Can Black use a chess tactic for defense?

## Exercise 629

629



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_



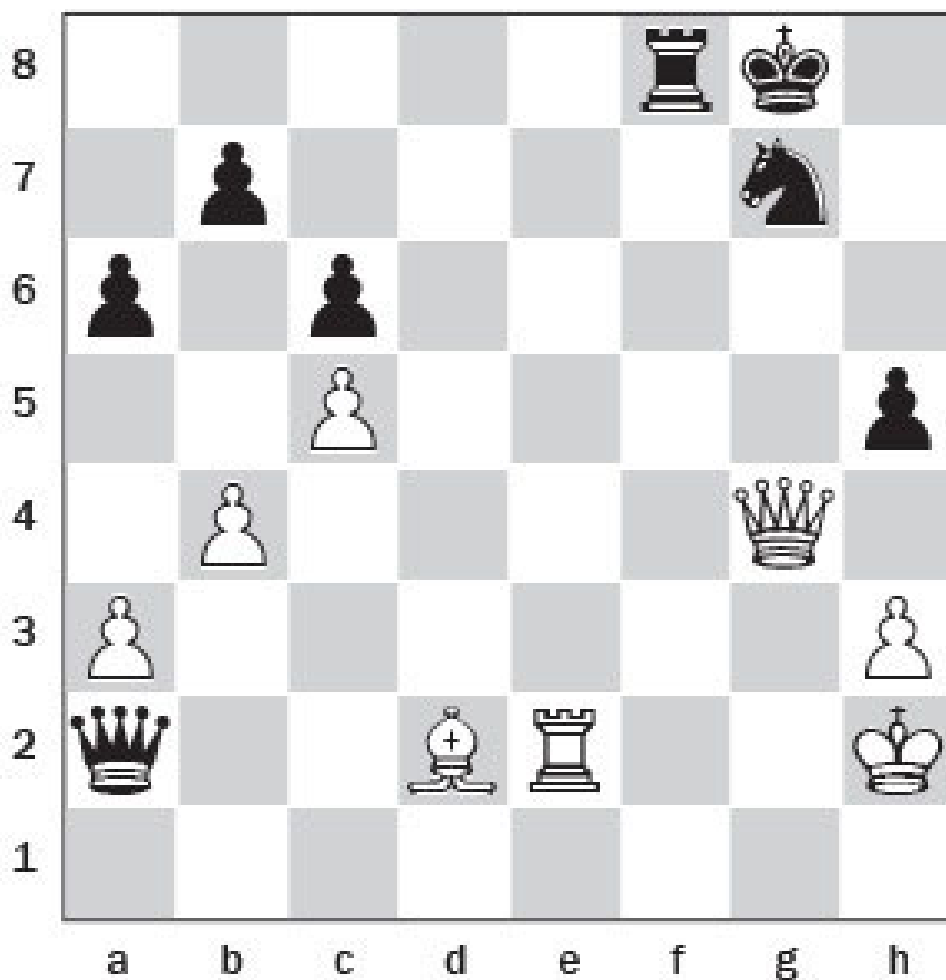
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Set up a skewer on the back rank.

### Exercise 630

**630**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

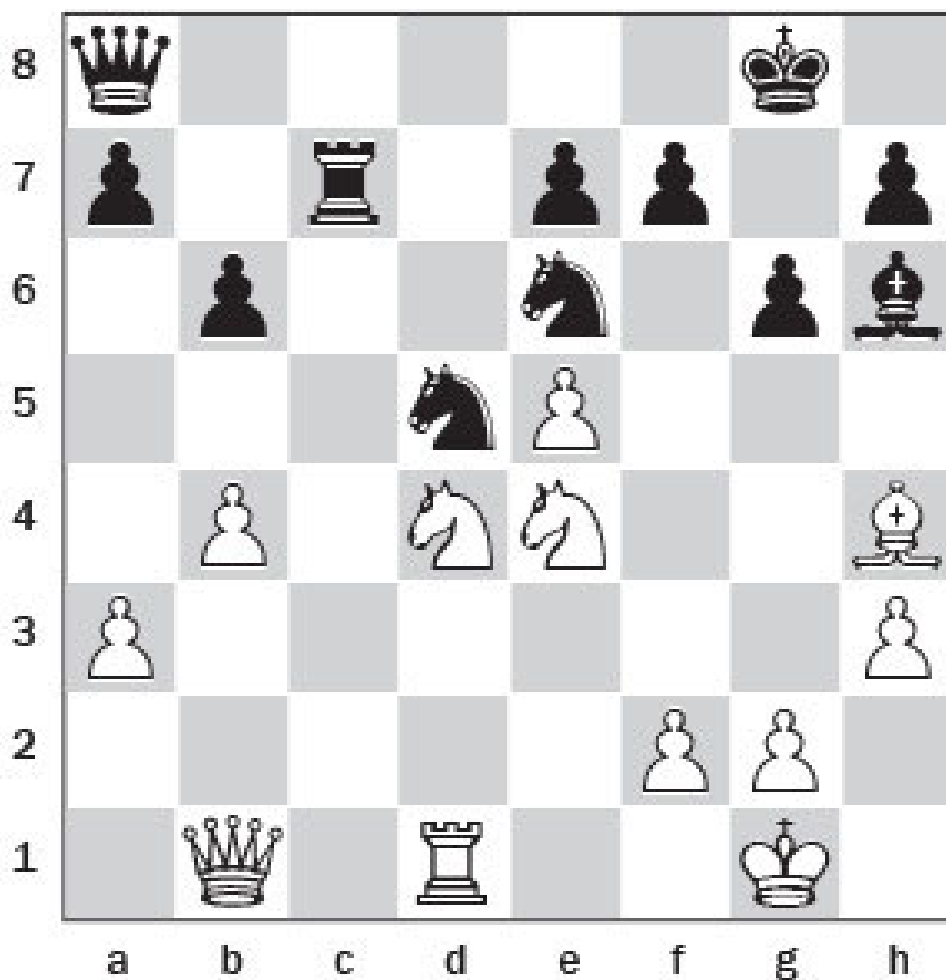
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Notice that the rook on e2 is lined up with the queen on a2. Use a decoy to set up a discovered attack.

## [Exercise 631](#)

631



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

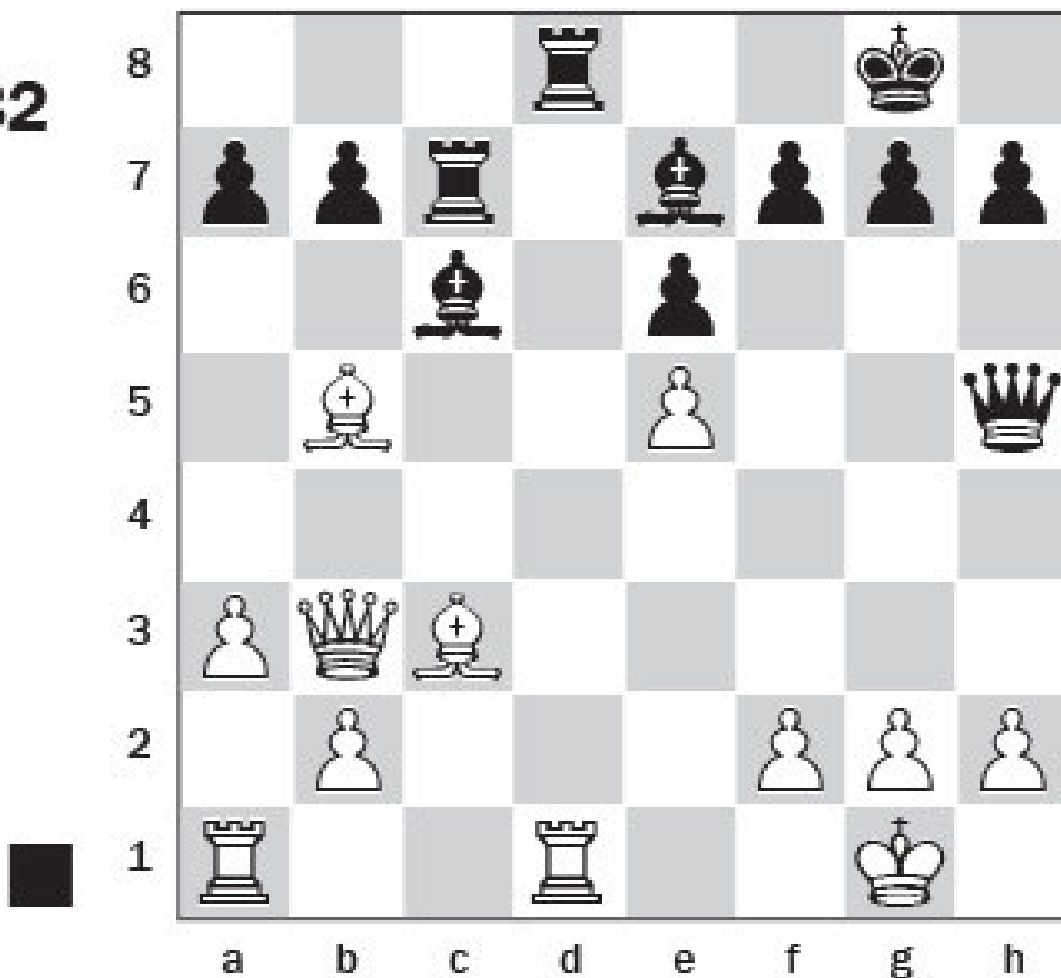
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The bishop and rook have their eyes on the c1-square. Is the rook on d1 a bit overloaded? If so, present a line which shows the idea.

### Exercise 632

**632**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

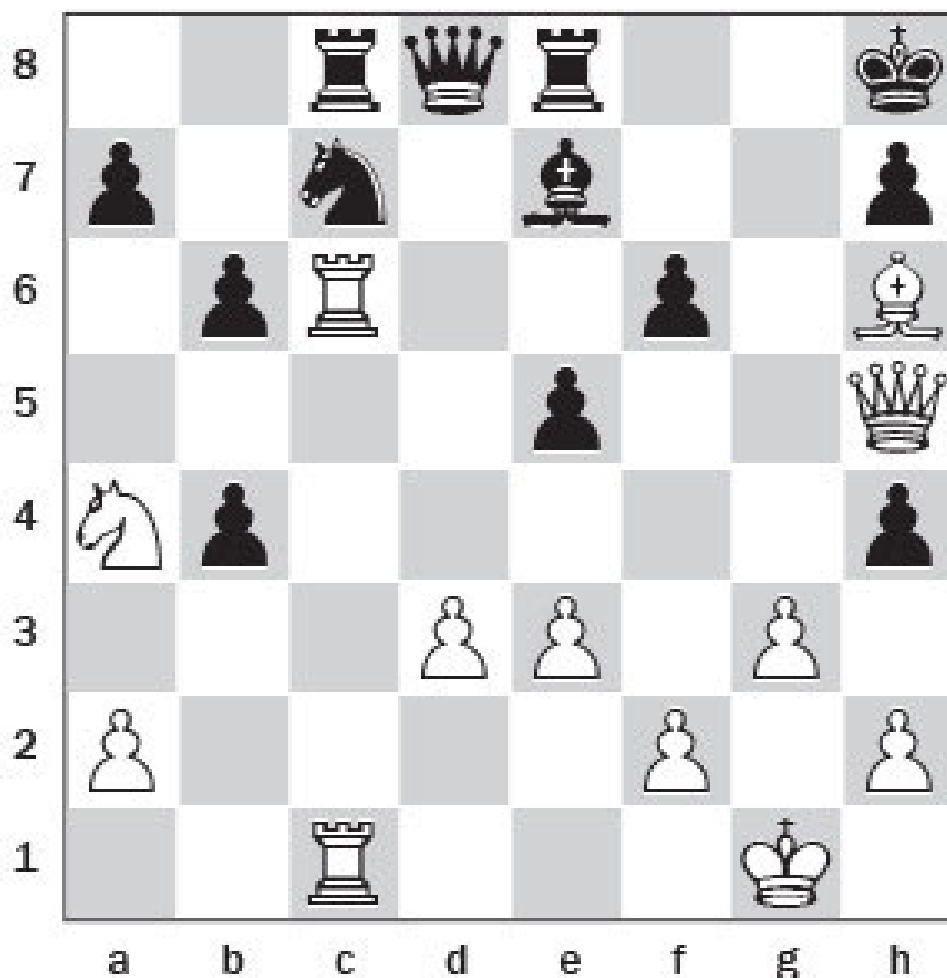
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The queen on b3 is guarding both d1 and b5. How can Black take advantage of the overloaded queen?

### Exercise 633

633



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

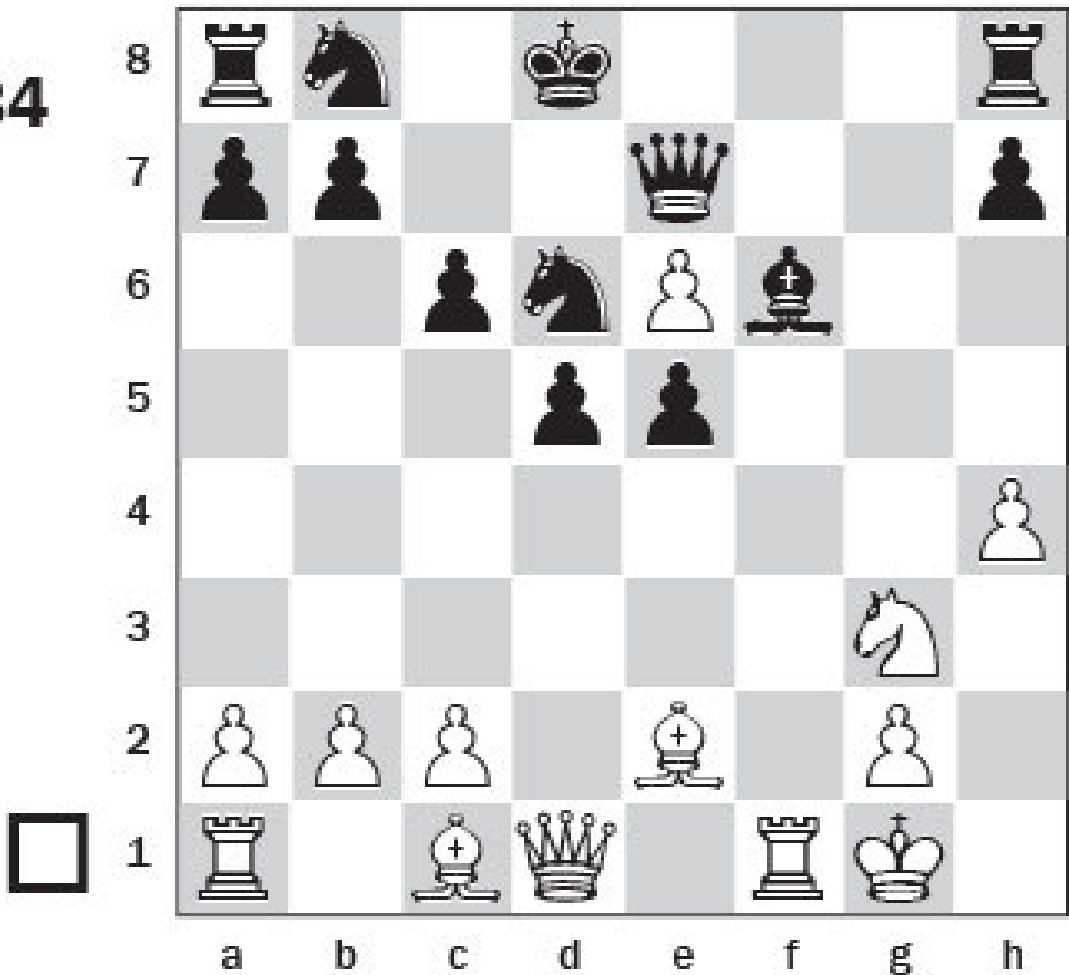
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The queen on d8 is overloaded trying to guard both the c7- and e8-squares. How can White win material?

### Exercise 634

634



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

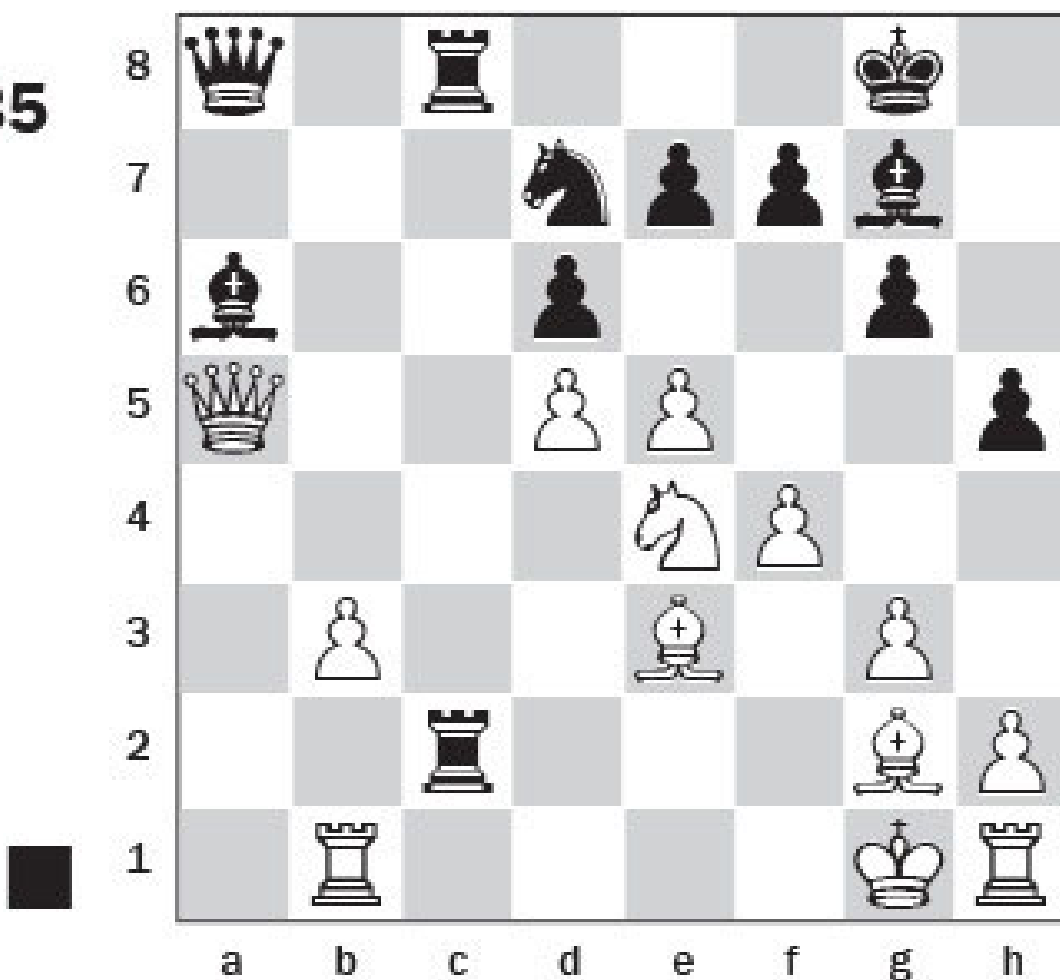
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The king, queen, and bishop are all on the same diagonal. Use a decoy to set up a nasty pin.

### Exercise 635

**635**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

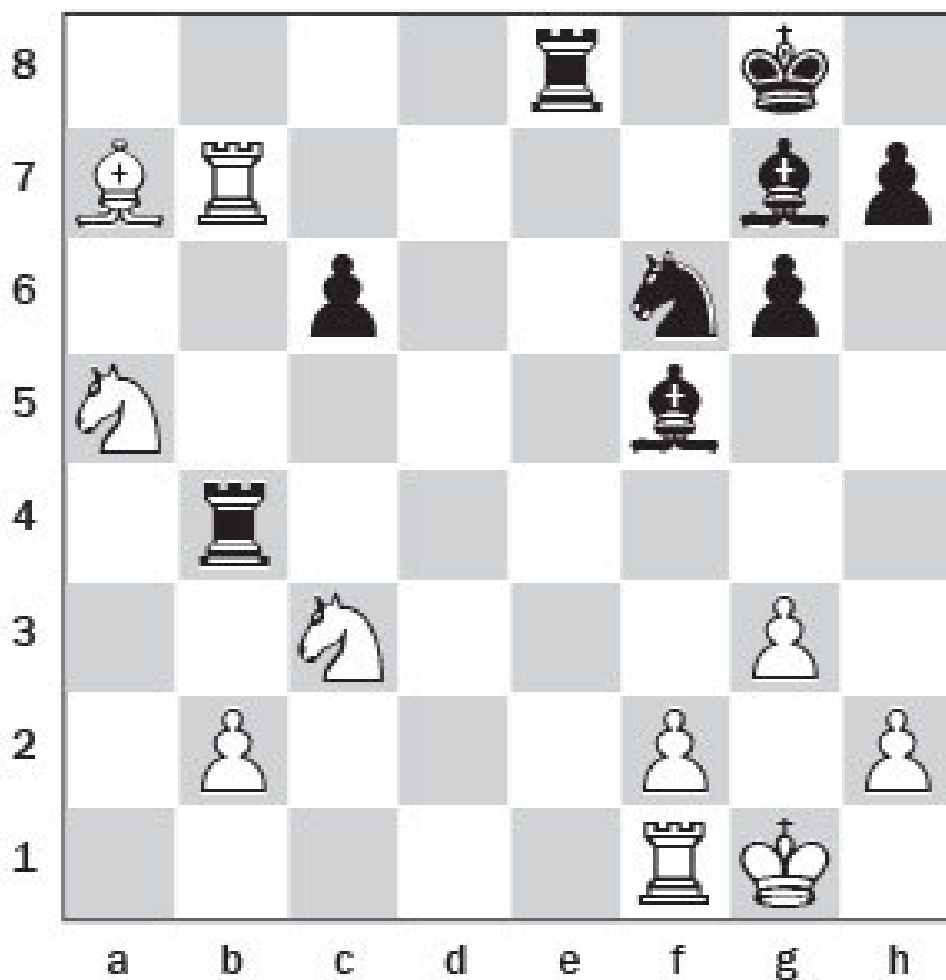
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Only Black's bishop separates the queens from each other. Use a decoy to set up a discovery on the queen.

## [Exercise 636](#)

636



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

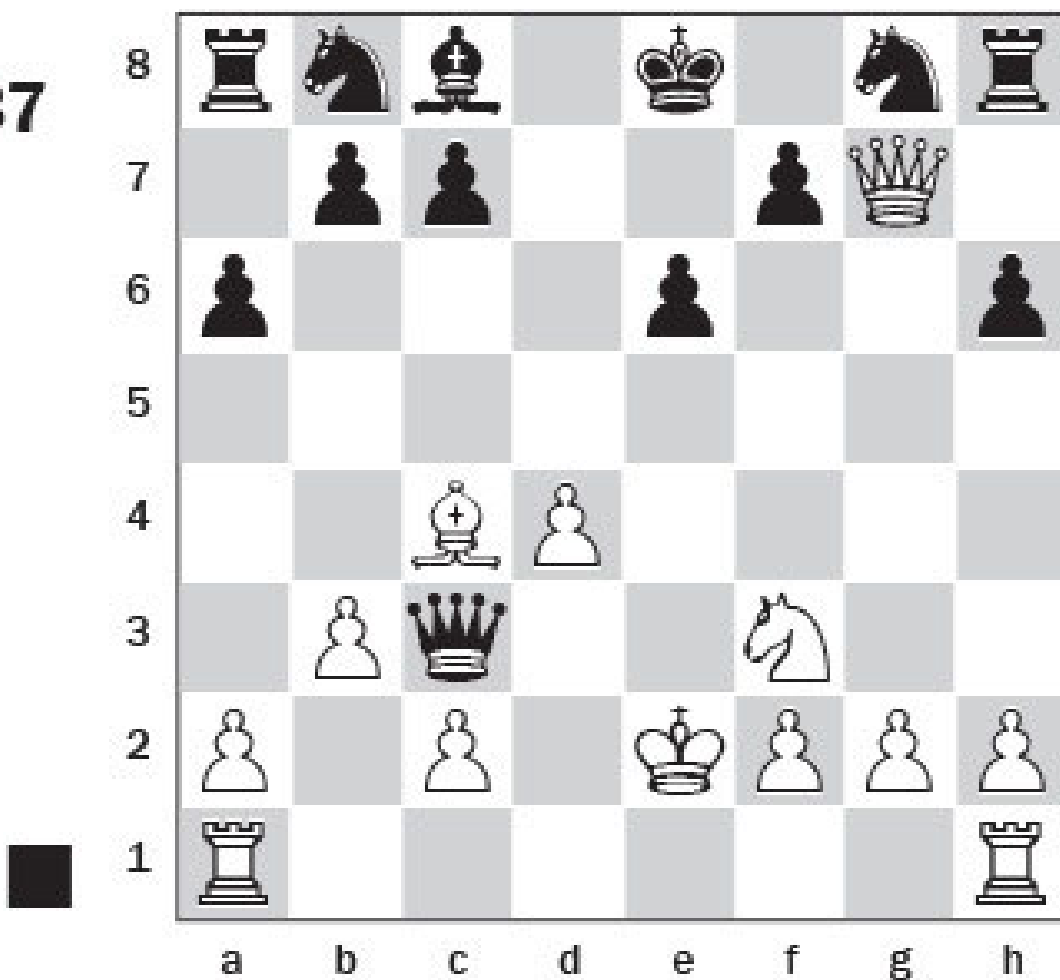
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Set up a skewer along the 7th rank.

### Exercise 637

637



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

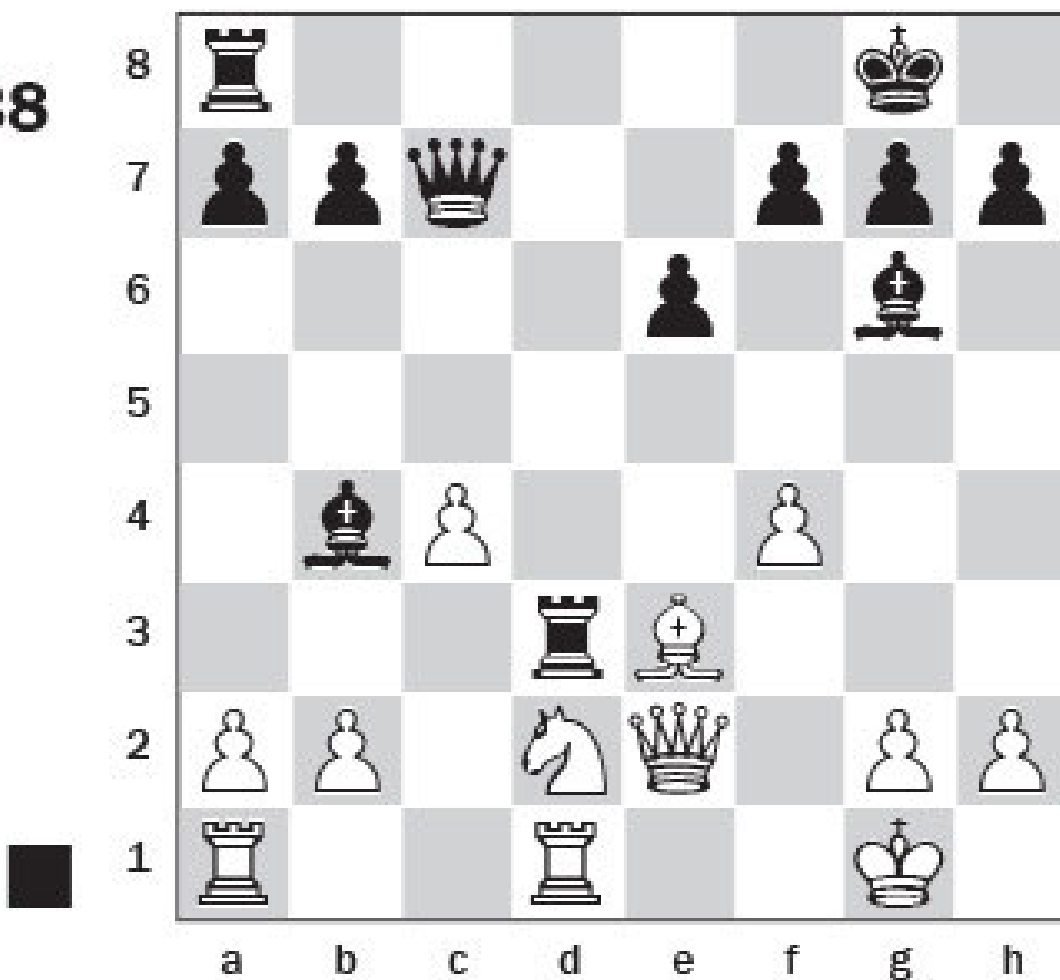
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

Black's rook on h8 looks trapped. Can Black get the queen back to help?

### Exercise 638

638



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

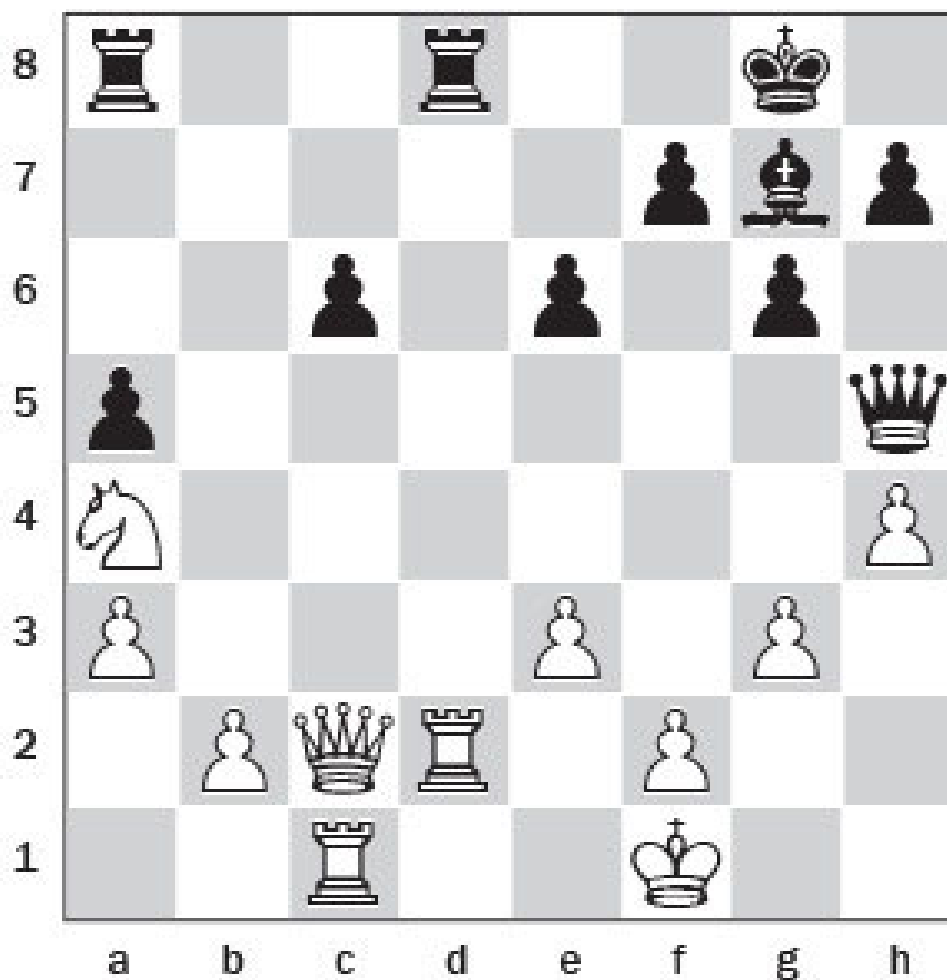
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **HINT**

The a7-g1 diagonal is quite weak. Win material by using a decoy and then a pin.

### **[Exercise 639](#)**

639



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

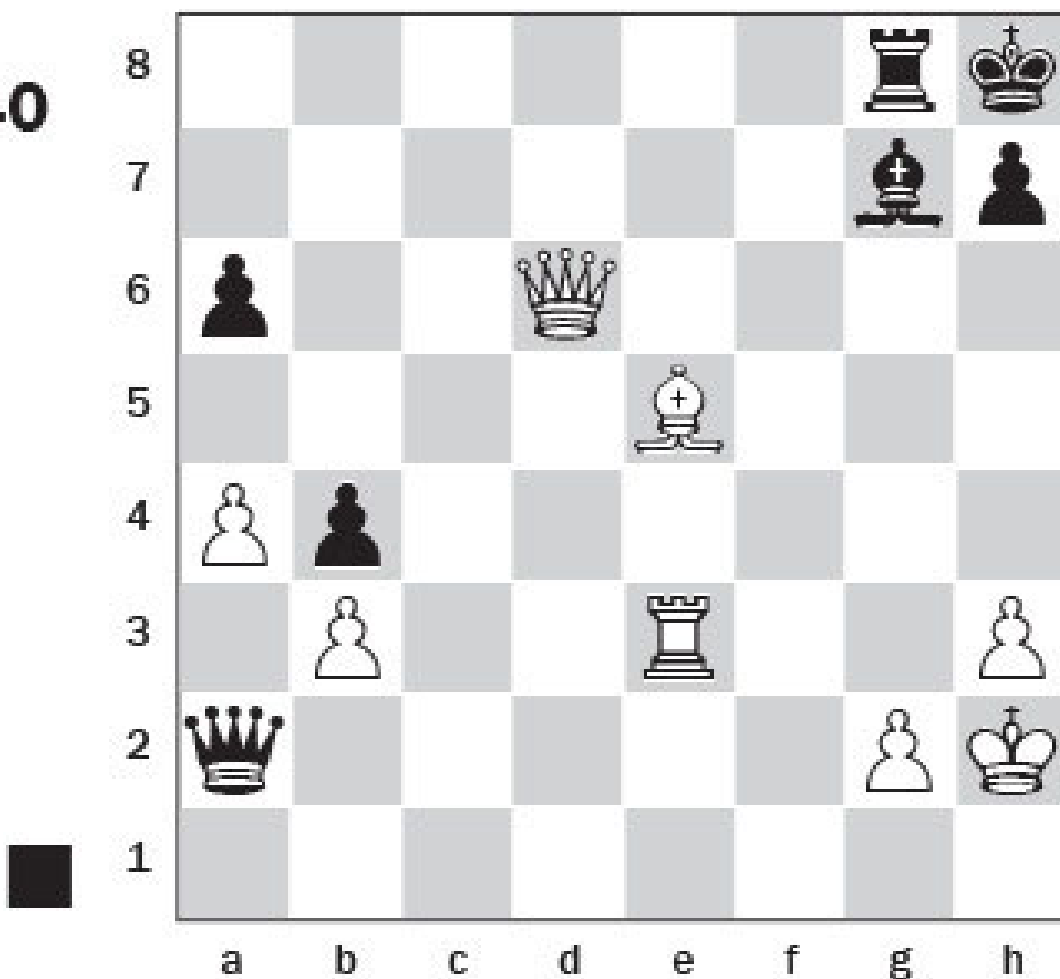
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

The queen on c2 is guarding both the rook on d2 and the knight on a4. Lure the queen away from the knight and then use a fork to win the unprotected piece.

### Exercise 640

640



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

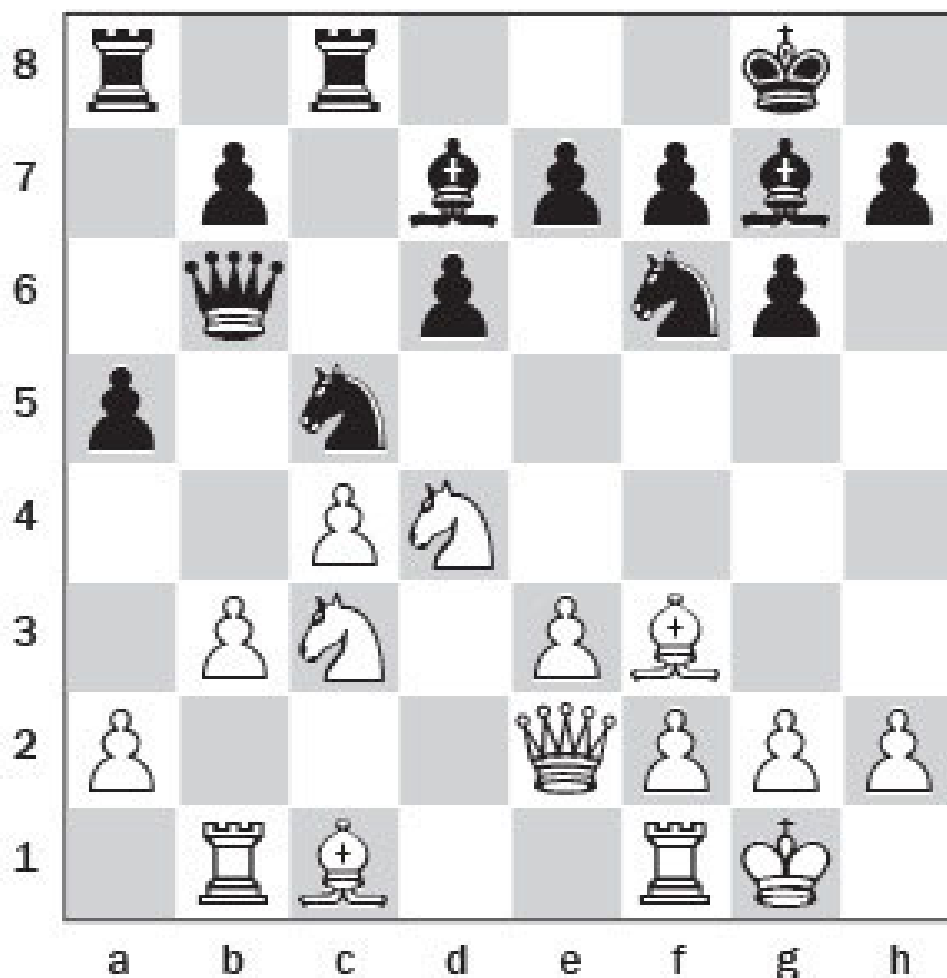
### HINT

Black's rook and queen have eyes on the g2-square. Use a decoy and then a discovered attack to win material.

### [Exercise 641](#)



641



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

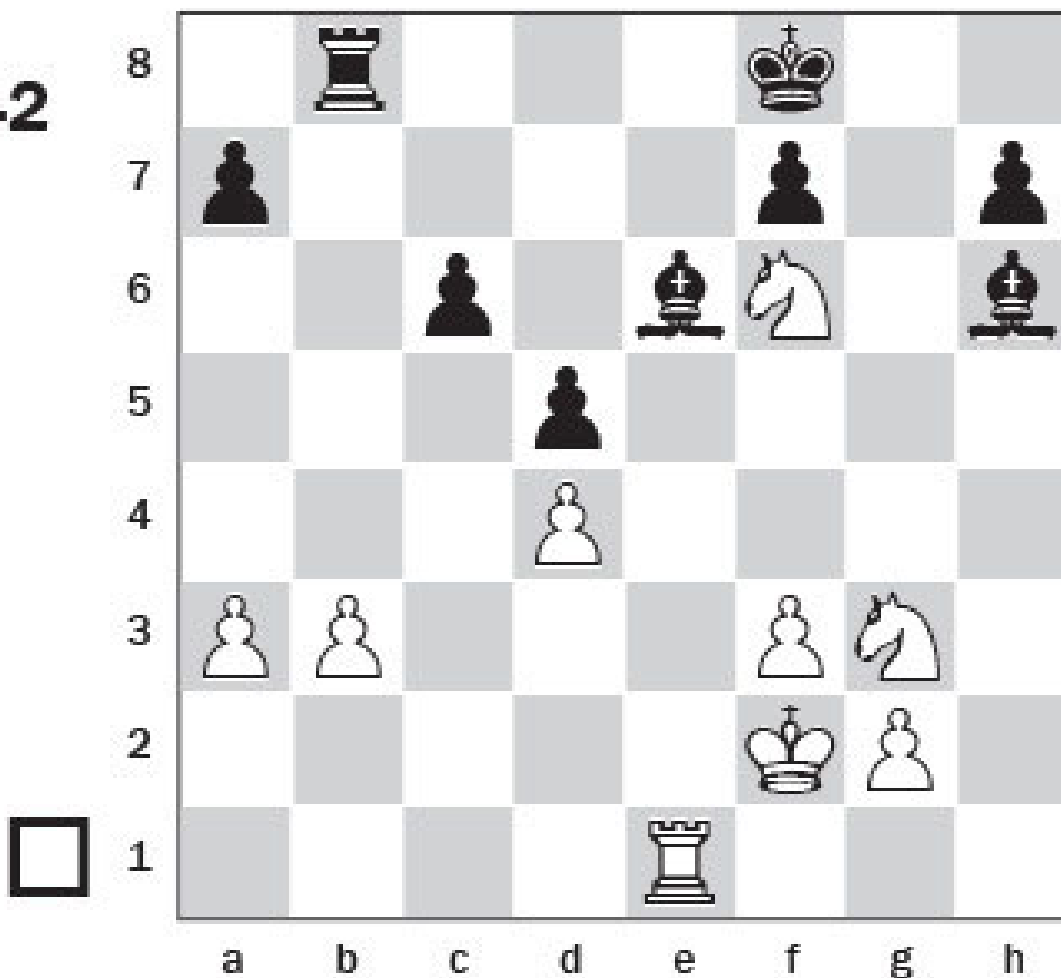
2. \_\_\_\_\_

HINT

The bishop on f3 does not have many safe squares. Use the central pawns to win material.

### Exercise 642

642



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

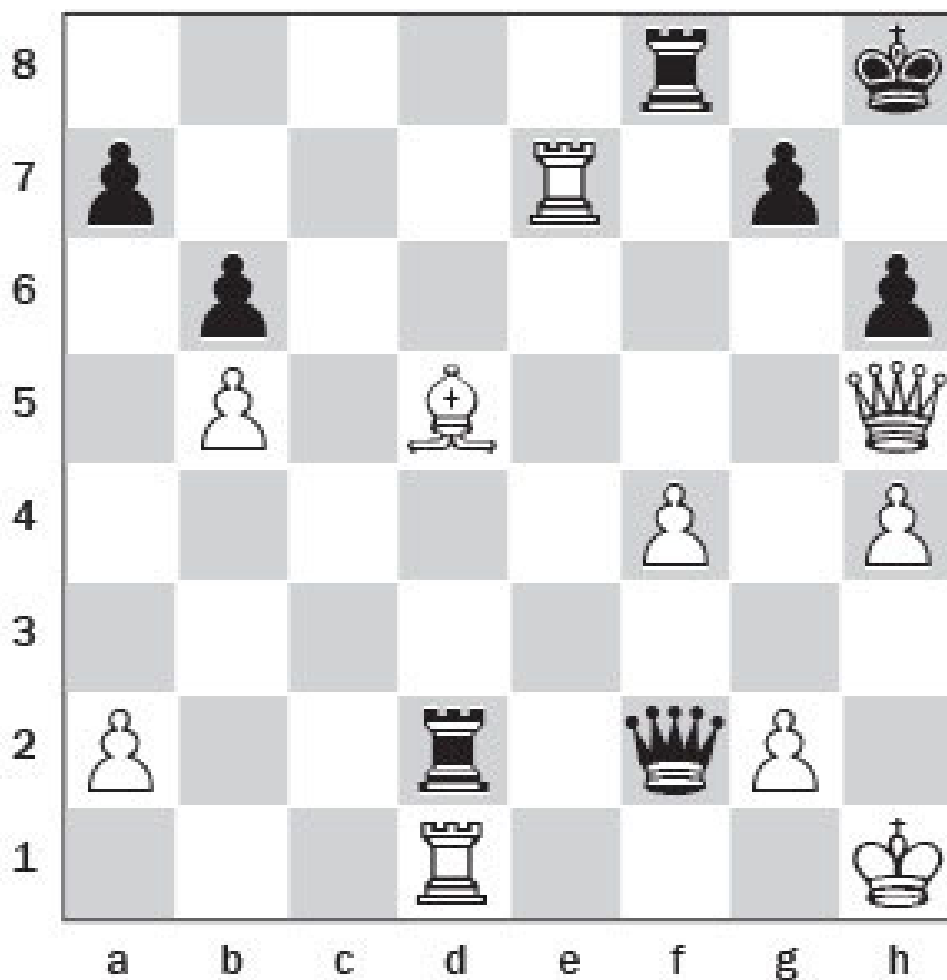
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### HINT

The bishop on e6 is preventing the fork on d7. How can White win material?

### Exercise 643

643



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

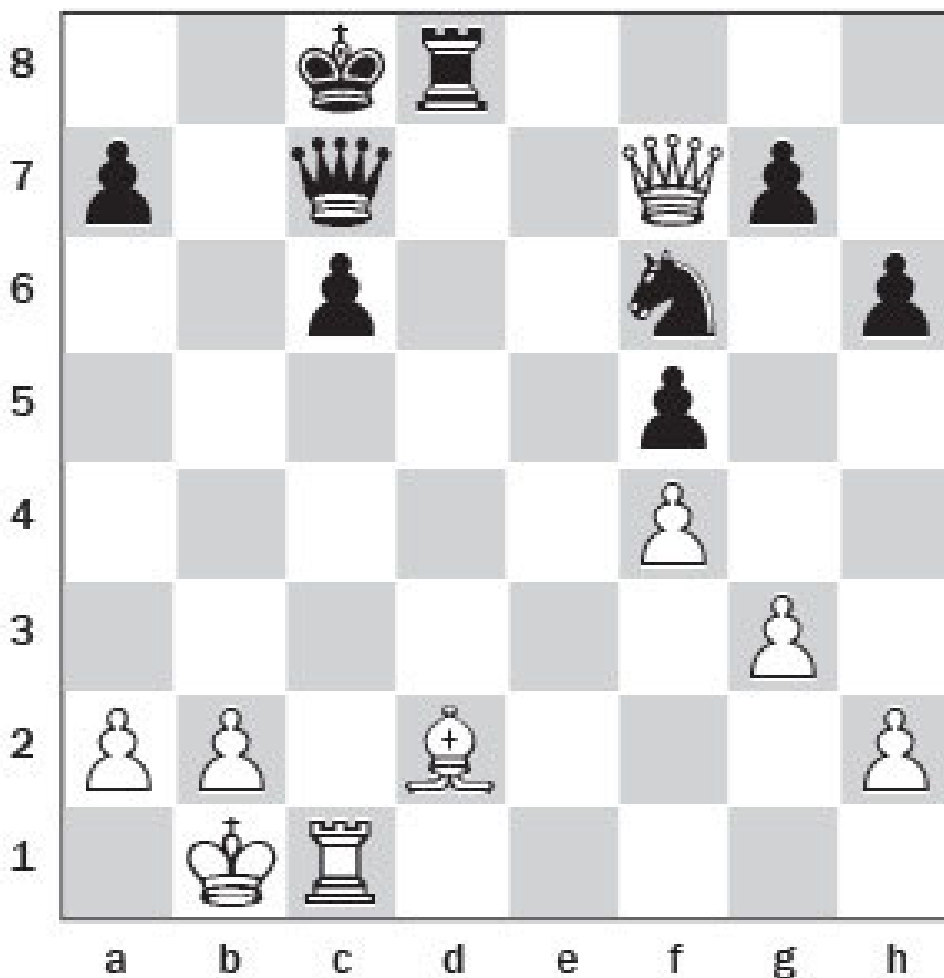
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

White's queen is overloaded. Find a way to take advantage of the overloaded queen and the undefended rook on e7.

### Exercise 644

644



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

## HINT

There are quite a few pieces on the a5-d8 diagonal. Set up a skewer and win the exchange.

## CHAPTER 21

# Finish like the World Champions



Steinitz



Lasker



Capablanca



Alekhine



Euwe



Botvinnik



Smyslov



Tal



Petrosian



Spassky



Fischer



Karpov



Kasparov



Kramnik



Anand



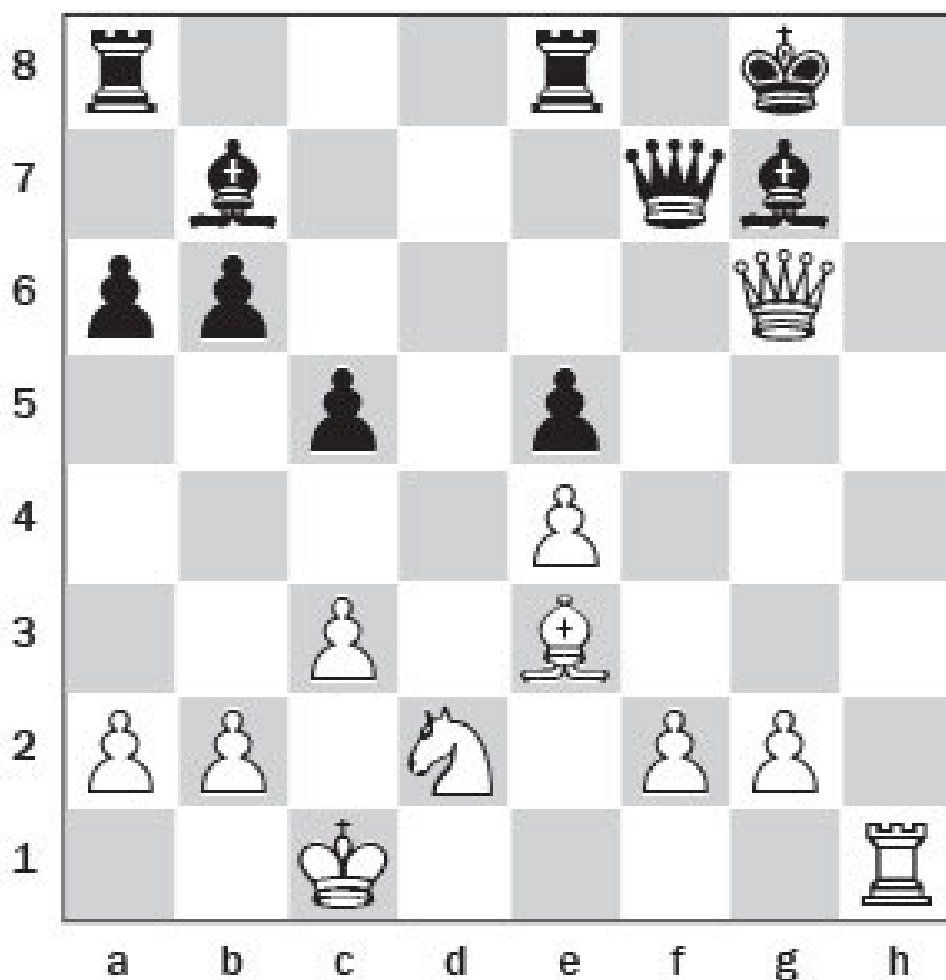
Carlsen

## 1st World Champion: Wilhelm Steinitz (1836-1900)

Steinitz was the World Chess Champion from 1886 to 1894.

### Exercise 645

**645**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

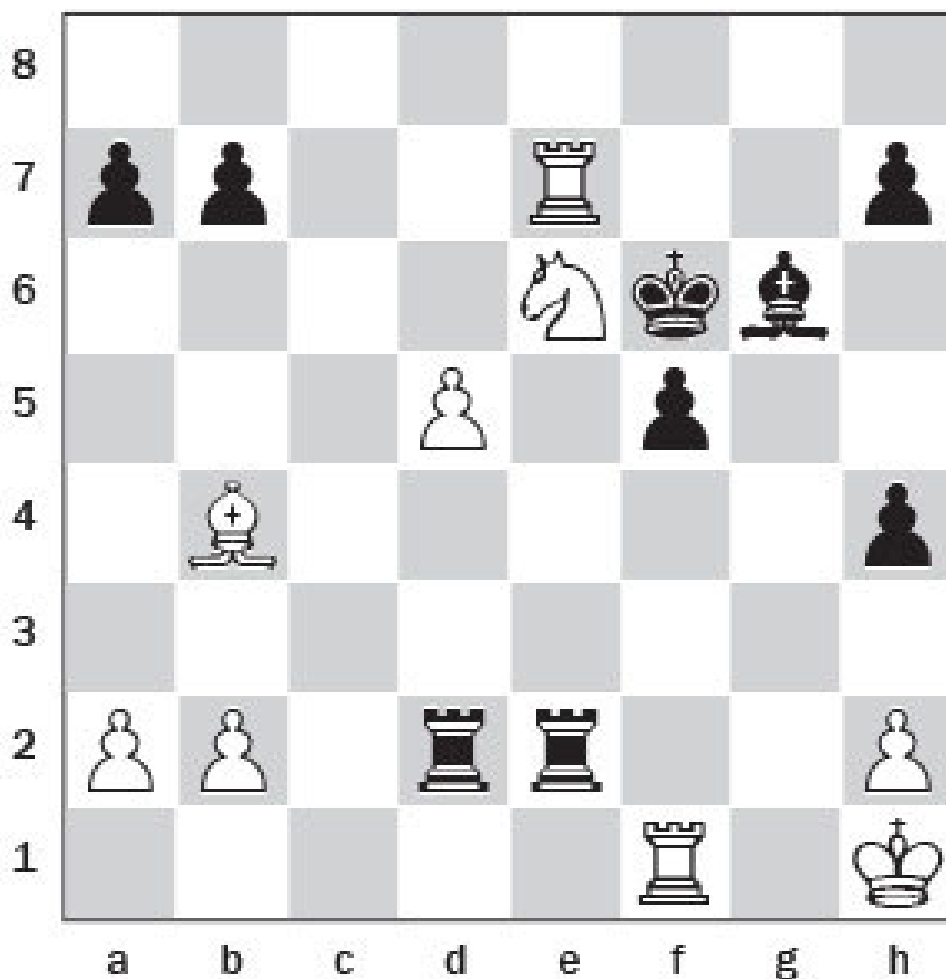
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Deflection) + Pin

### Exercise 646

**646**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

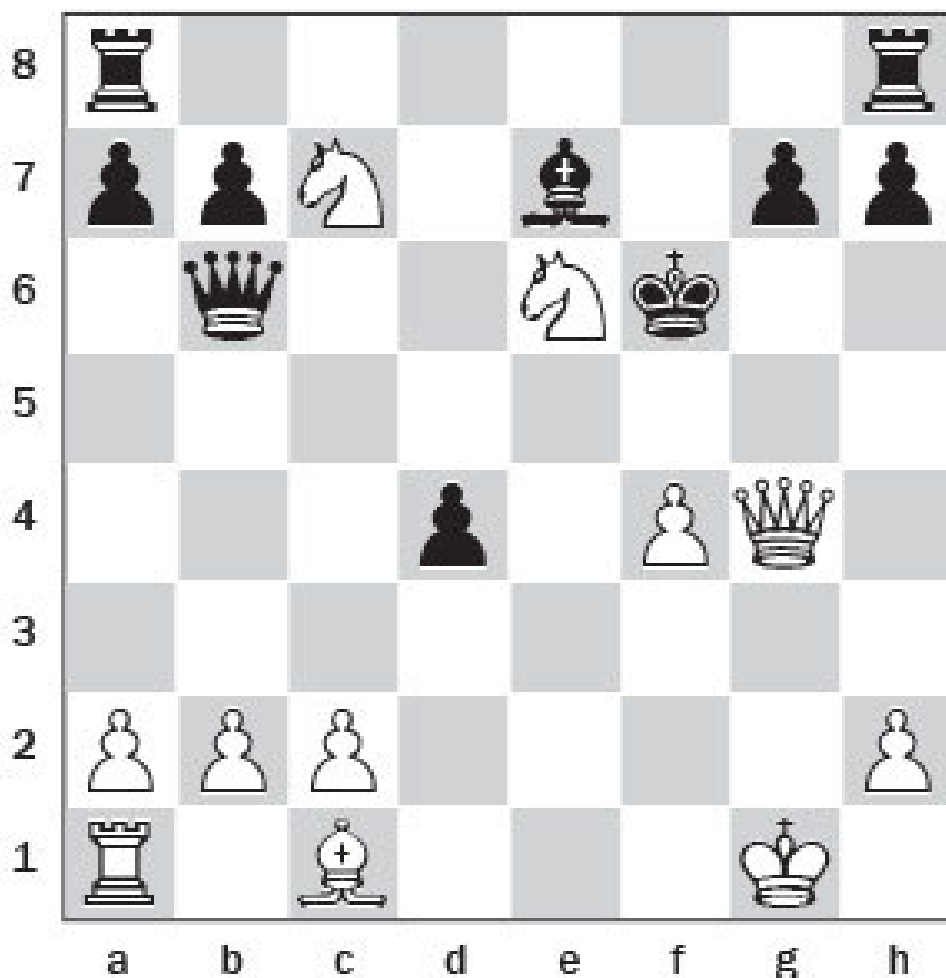
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Blind Swine Checkmate

[Exercise 647](#)

647



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

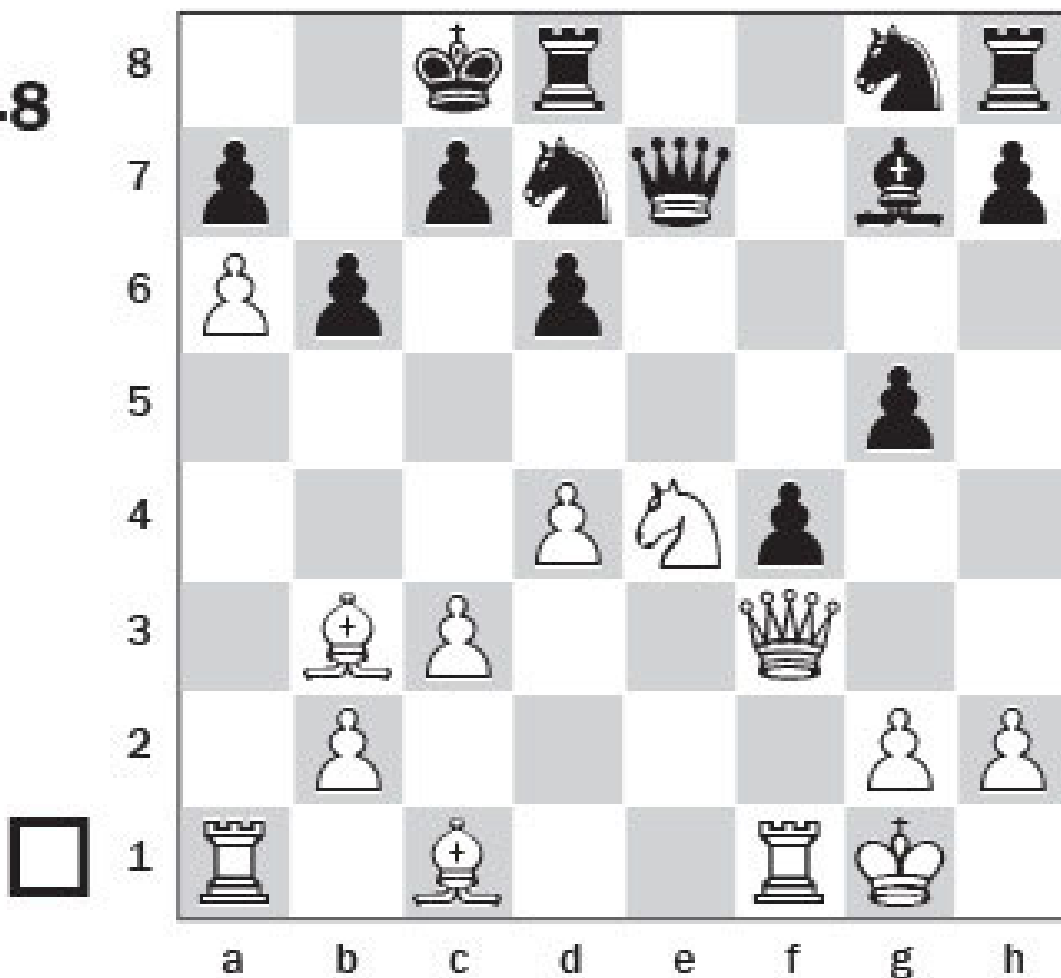
Checkmate in Two

## 2nd World Champion: Emanuel Lasker (1868-1941)

Lasker was the World Chess Champion from 1894-1921.

### Exercise 648

648



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Discovered Attack and Helper Checkmate

### Exercise 649

**649**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

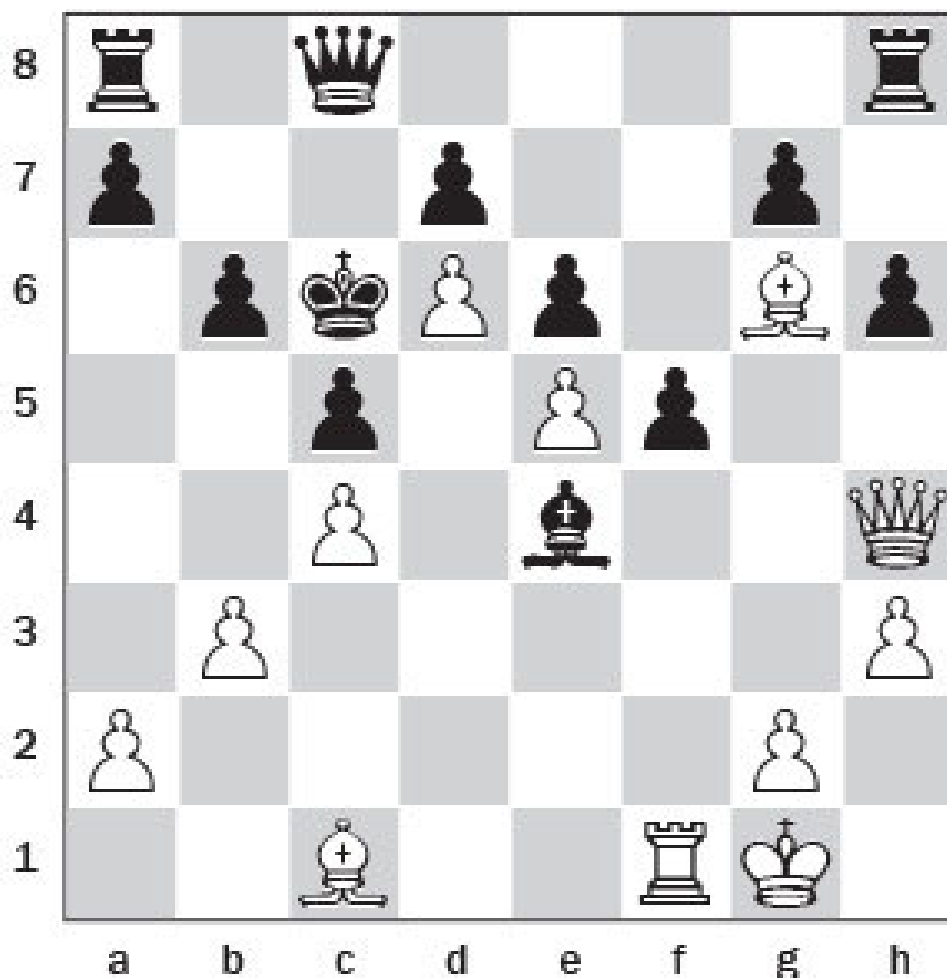
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 650

650



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

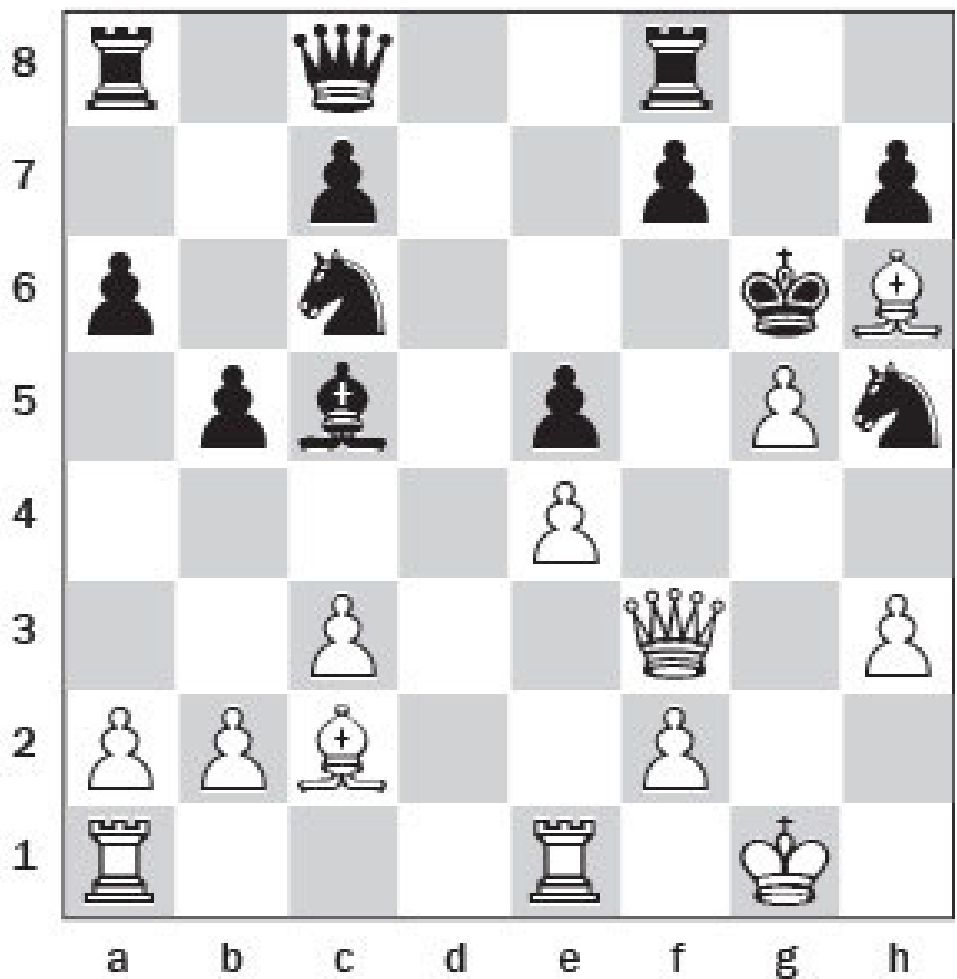
X-Ray + Checkmate in Two

### 3rd World Champion: Jose Raul Capablanca (1888-1942)

Capablanca was the World Chess Champion from 1921 to 1927.

#### Exercise 651

**651**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 652

**652**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

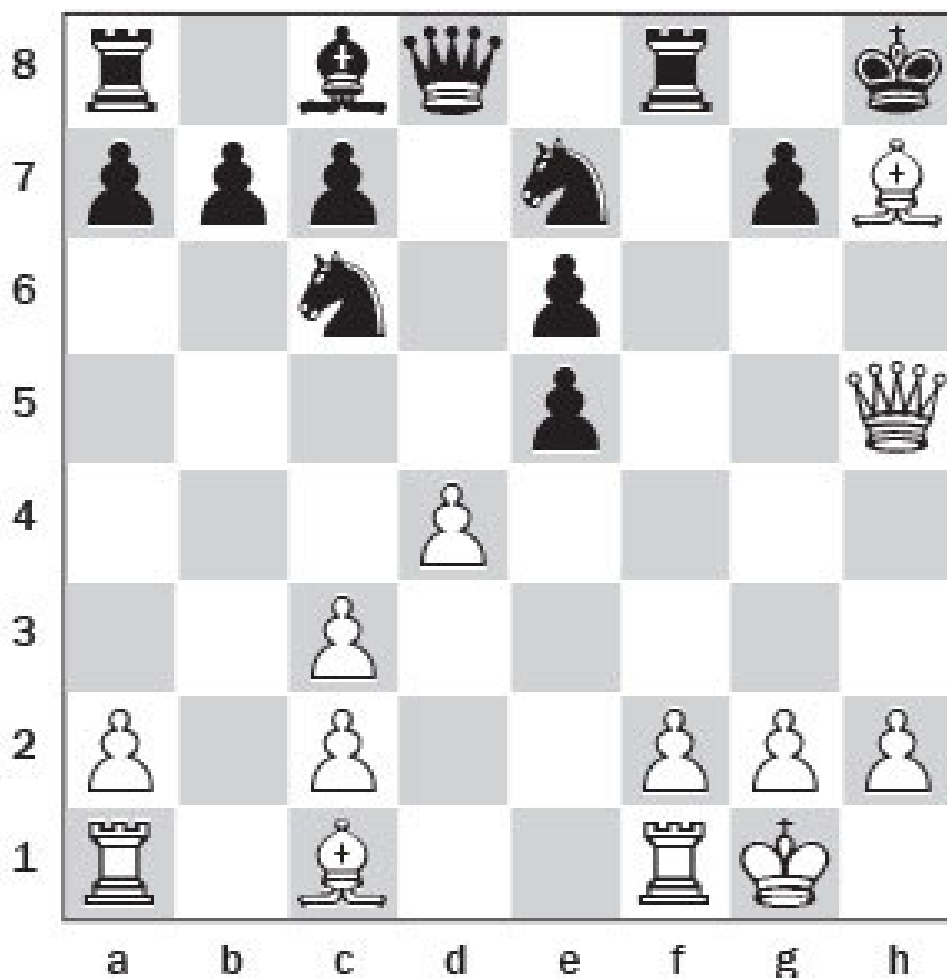
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 653

653



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Discovered Attack + Checkmate in Two

## 4th World Champion: Alexander Alekhine (1892-1946)

Alekhine was the World Chess Champion from 1927-1935 and then regained the title and reigned again from 1937-1946.

### Exercise 654

654



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

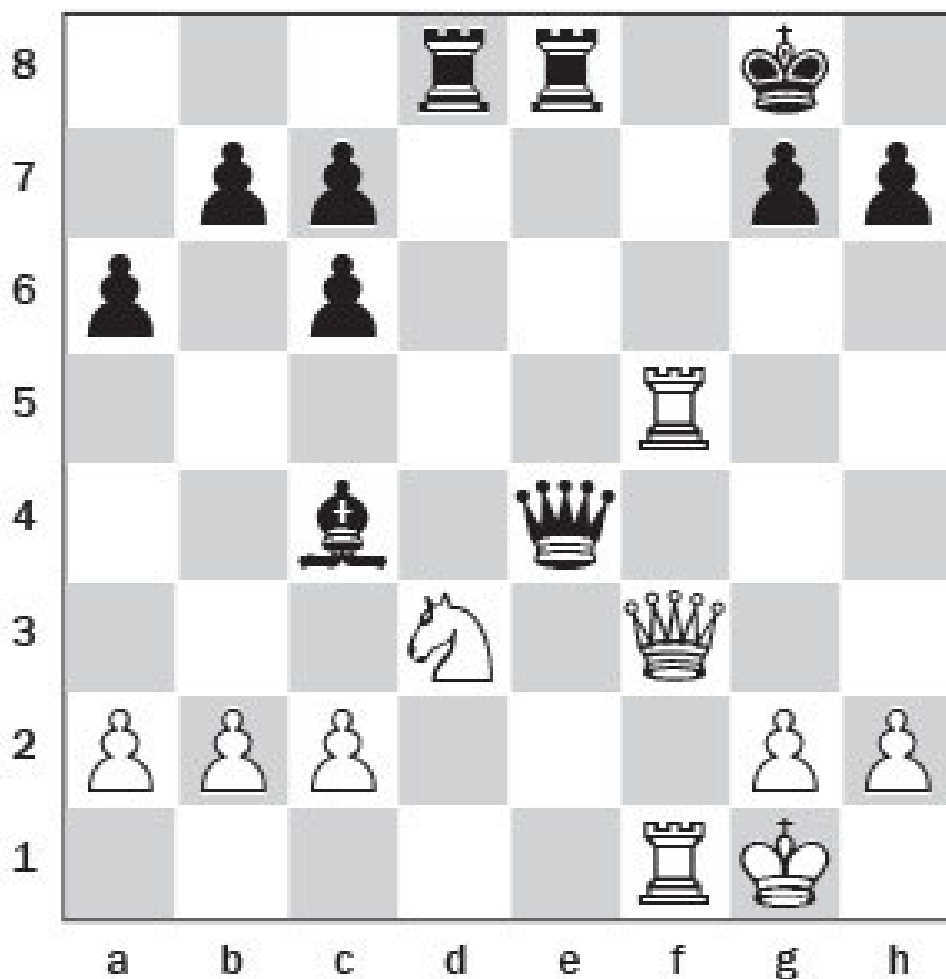
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Anastasia's Checkmate

### Exercise 655

**655**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

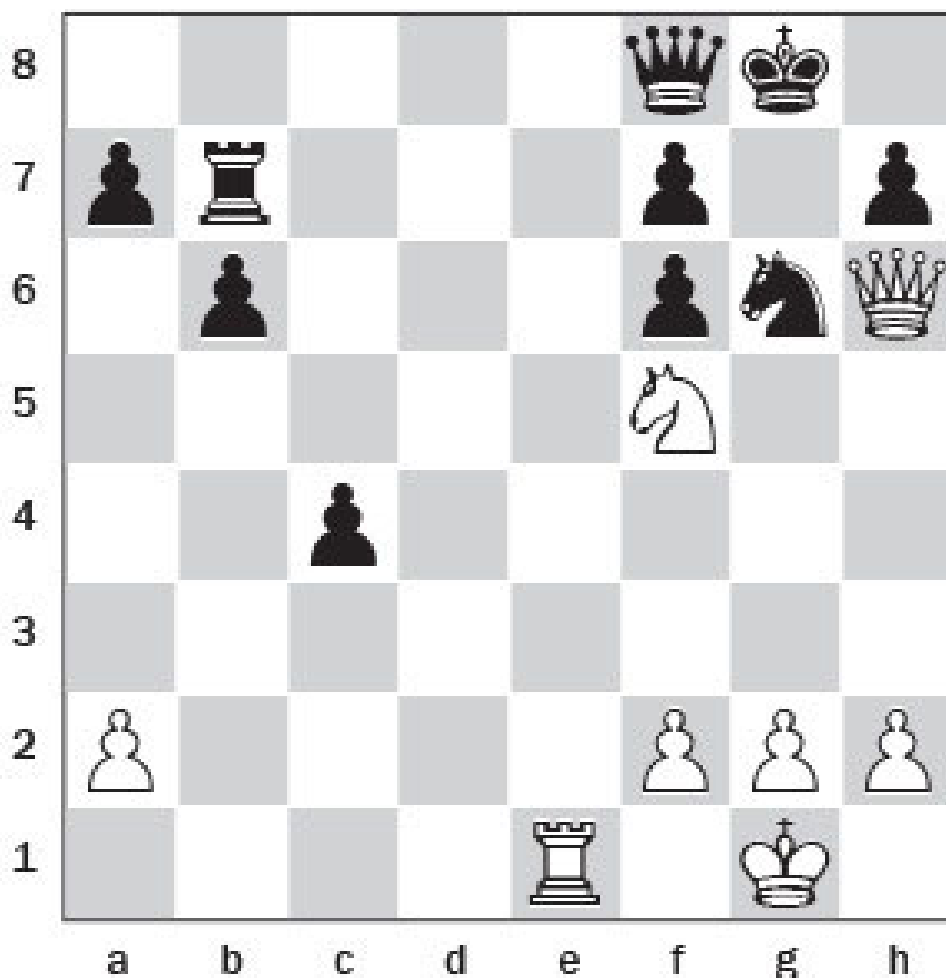
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Deflection)

## Exercise 656

656



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

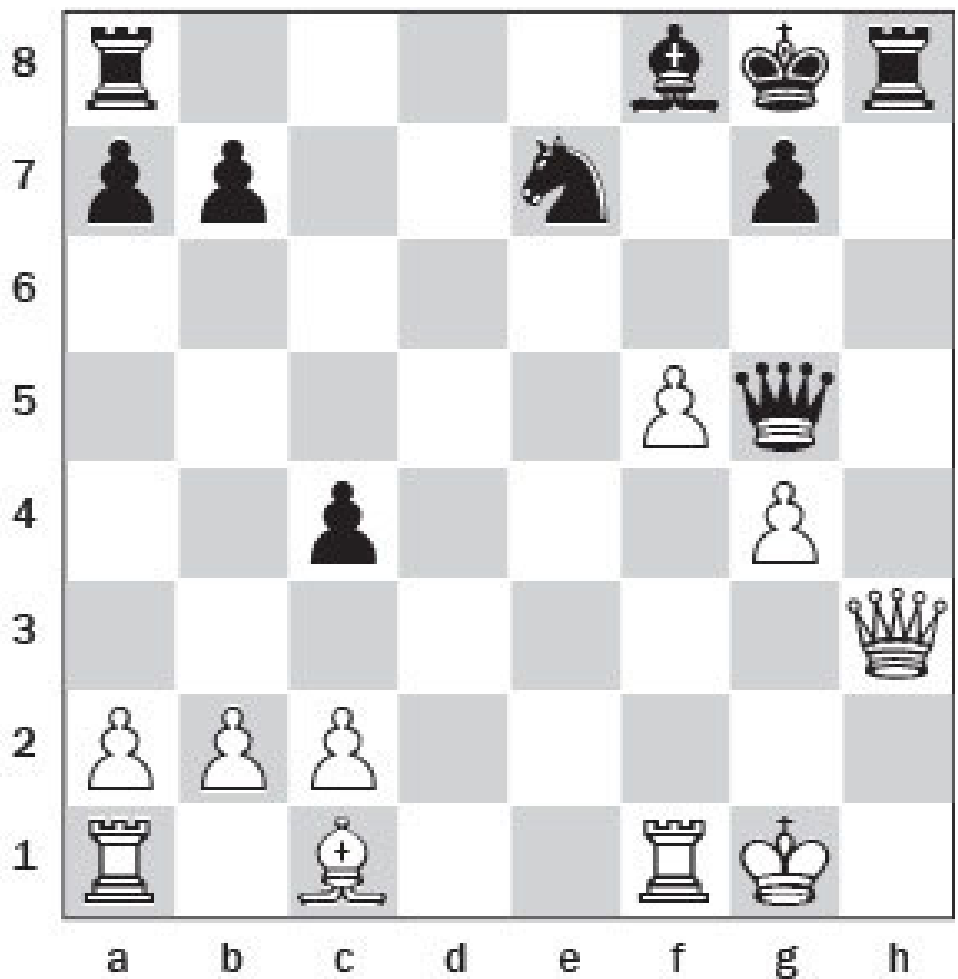
Decoy (Deflection) + Pin

## 5th World Champion: Machgielis 'Max' Euwe (1901-1981)

Euwe was the World Chess Champion from 1935 to 1937.

### Exercise 657

**657**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

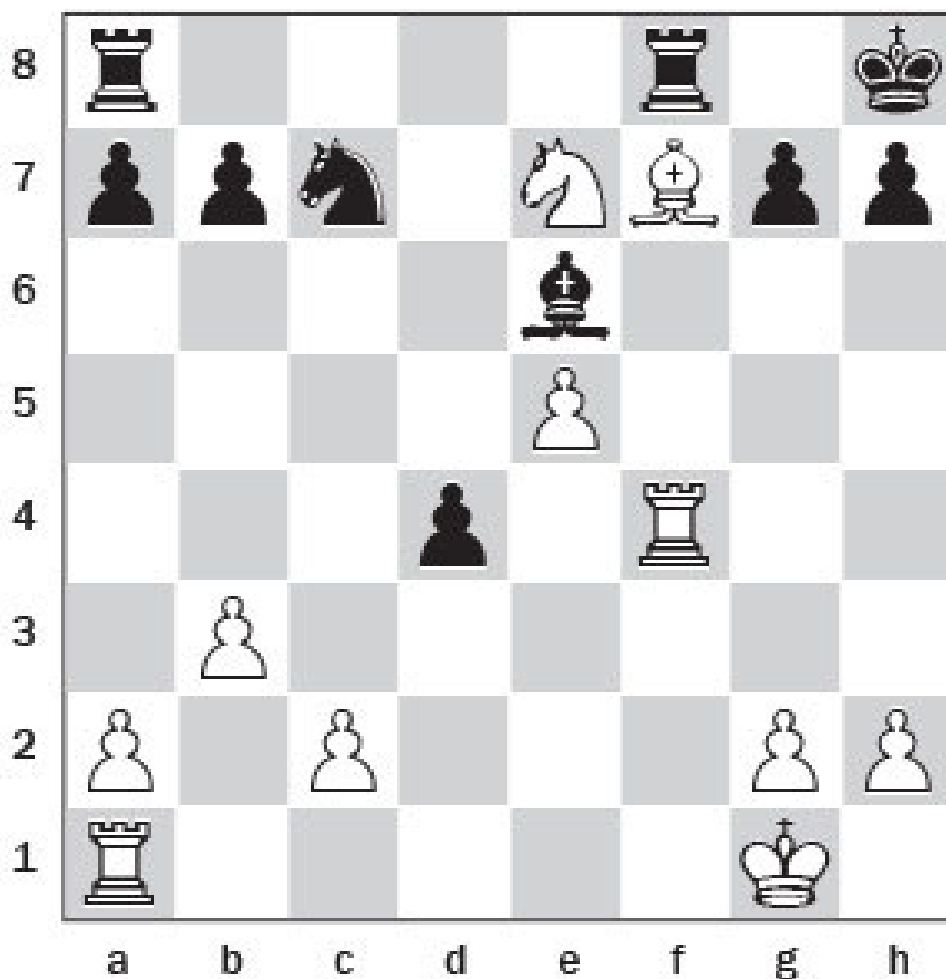
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

In-Between Move

### Exercise 658

**658**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

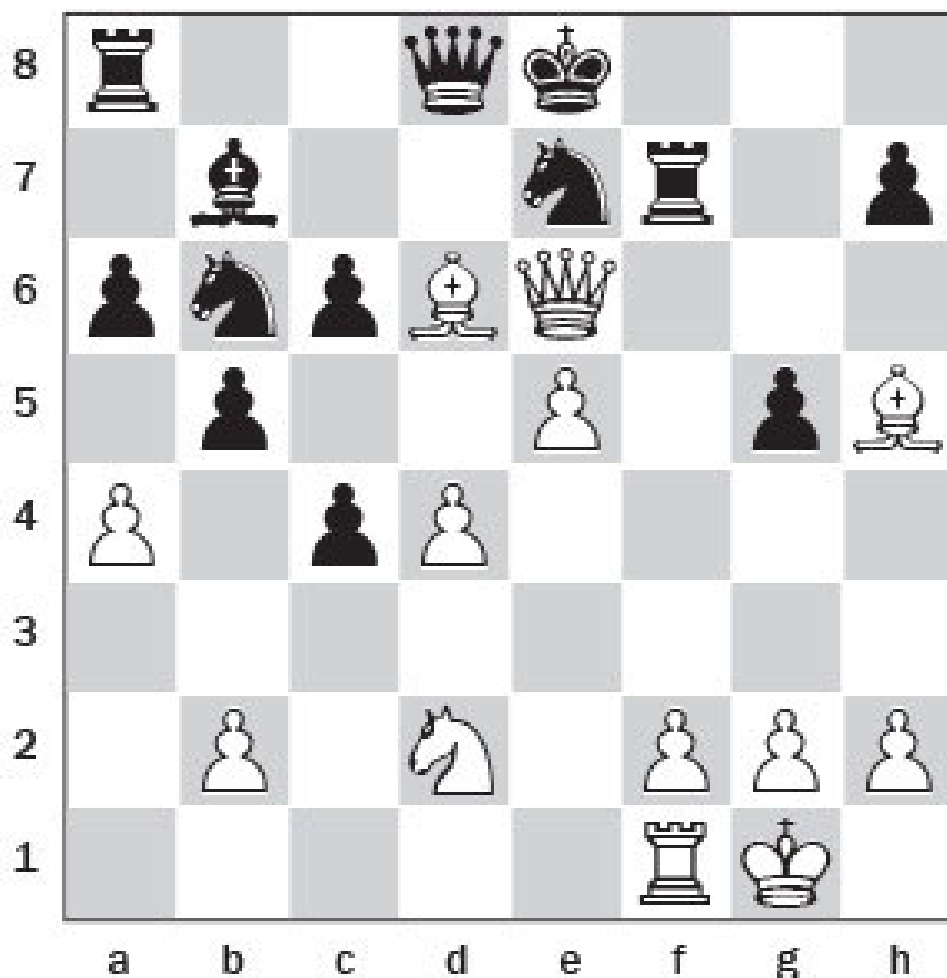
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Greco's Checkmate

## Exercise 659

659



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

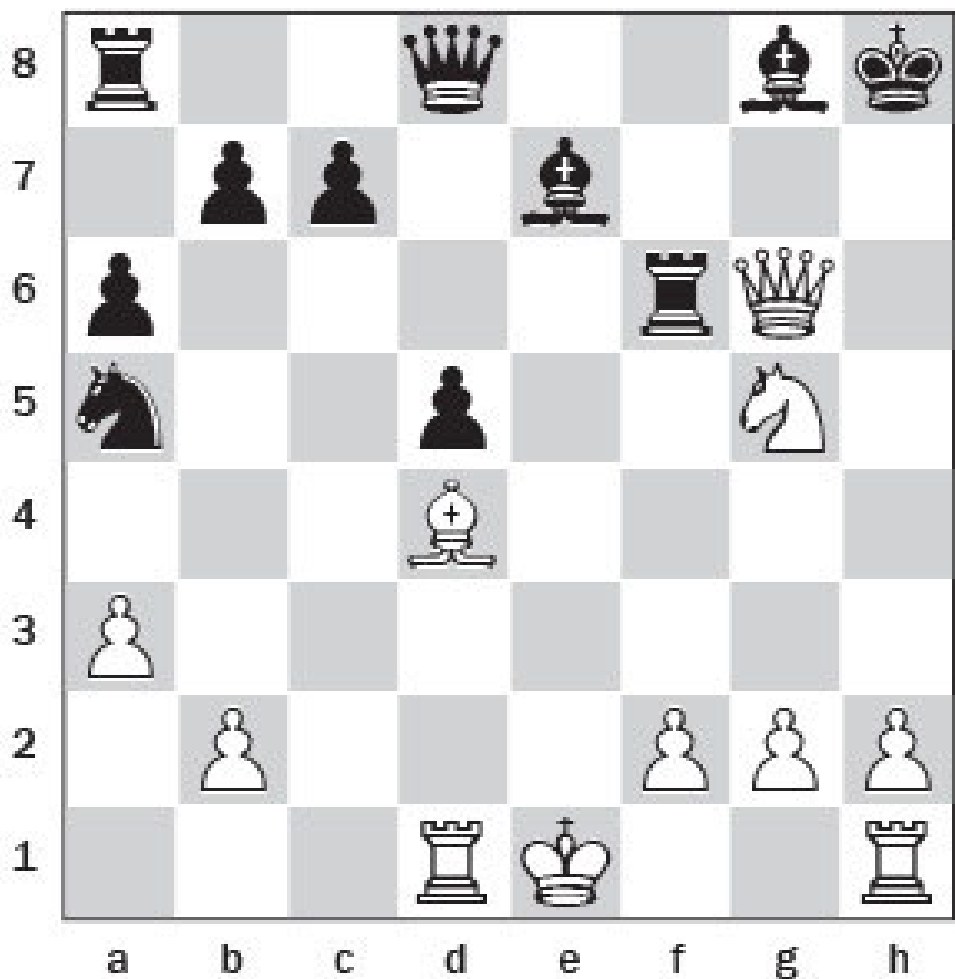
Checkmate in Two

## 6th World Champion: Mikhail Botvinnik (1911-1995)

Botvinnik was the World Chess Champion from 1948-1957, 1958-1960, 1961-1963.

### Exercise 660

660



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

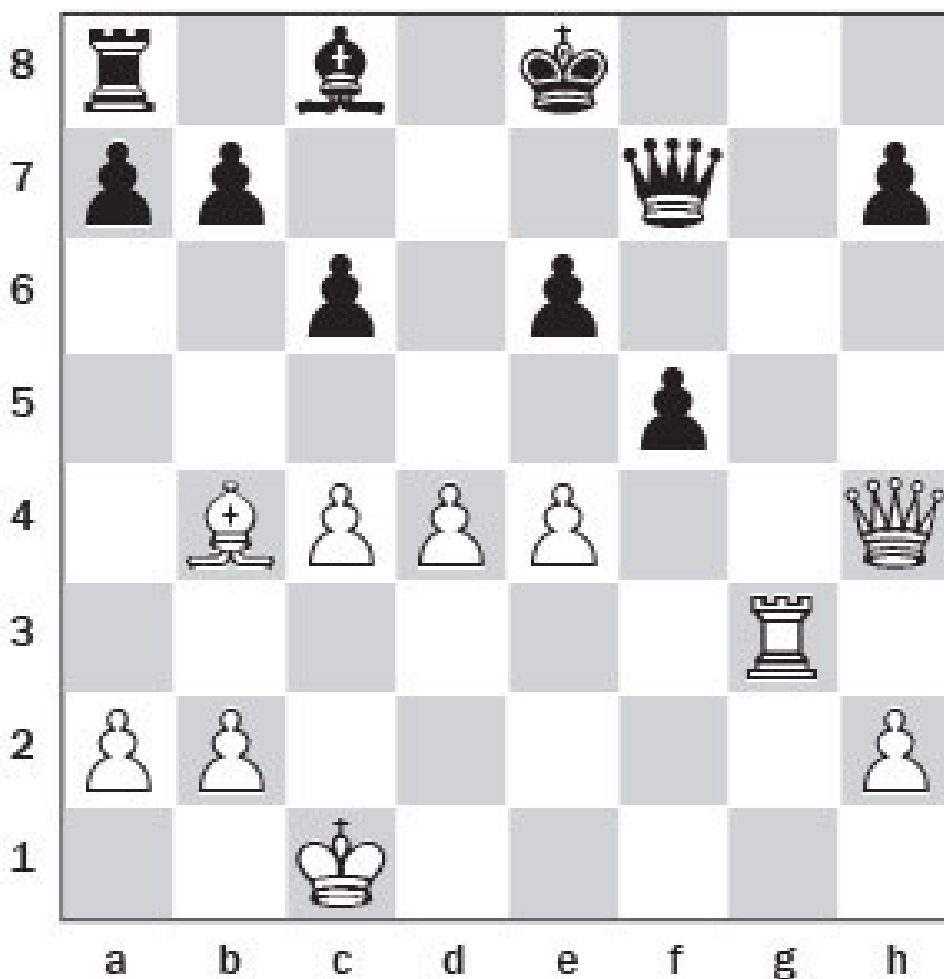
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Pin + Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 661

**661**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

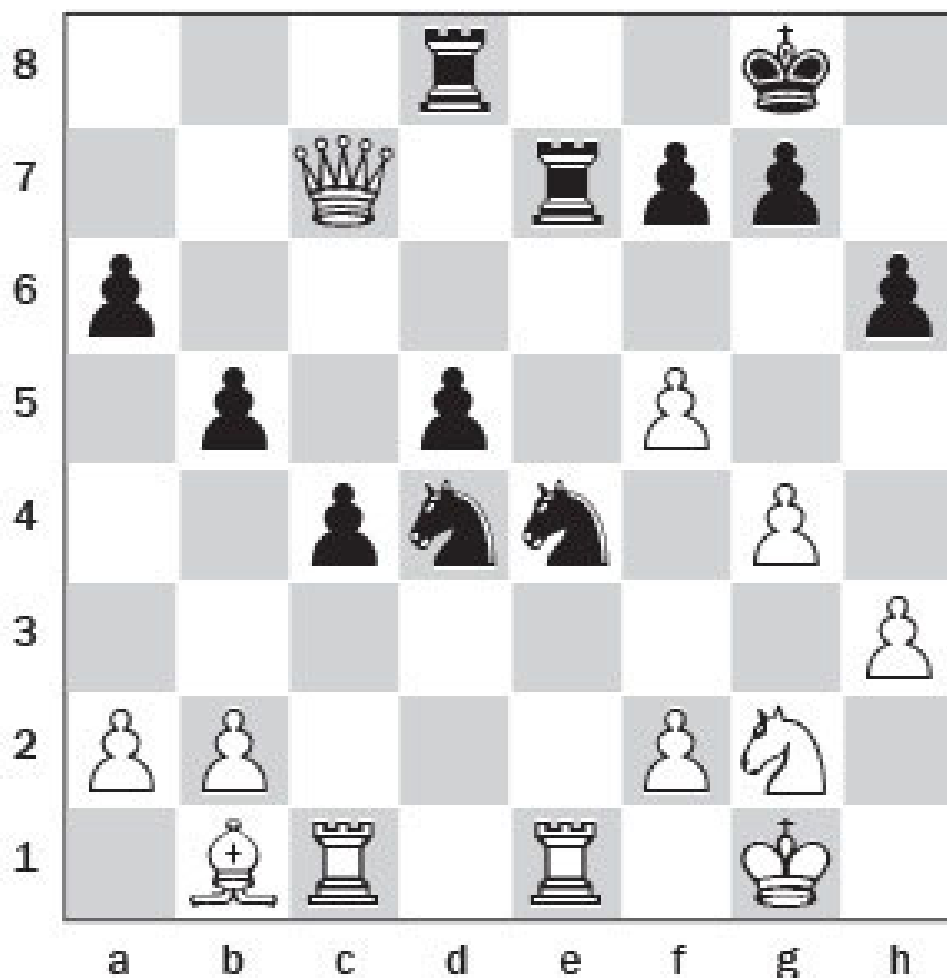
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **CONCEPTS USED**

Decoy (Deflection) + Checkmate in Two

### **Exercise 662**

662



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

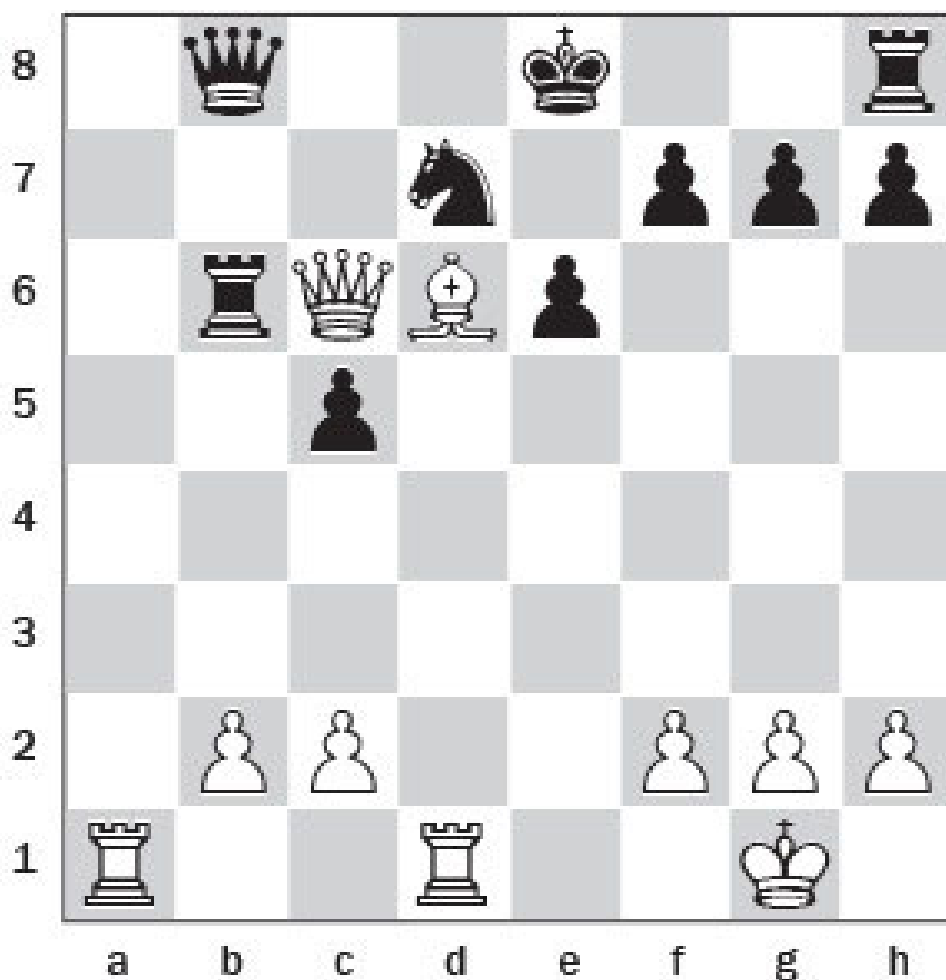
Checkmate in Two

## 7th World Champion: Vasily Smyslov (1921-2010)

Smyslov was the World Chess Champion from 1957-1958.

### Exercise 663

**663**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Attraction) + Discovered Check

### Exercise 664

**664**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

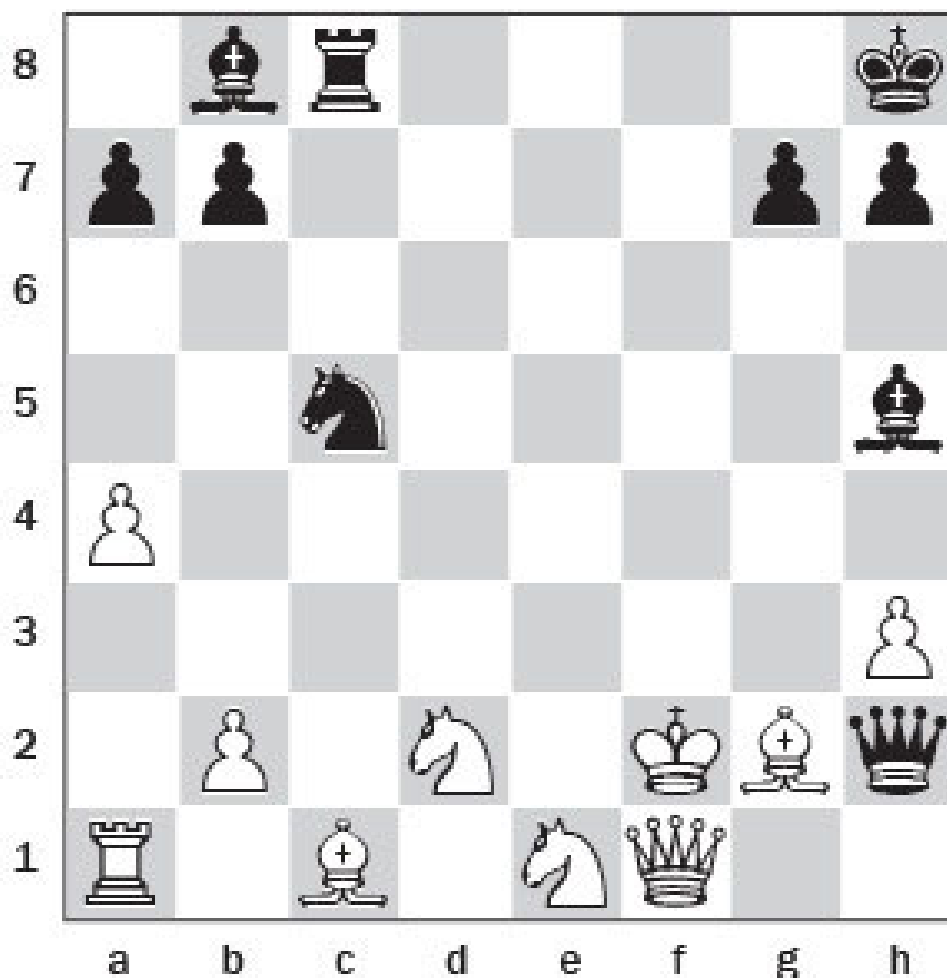
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **CONCEPTS USED**

Defense + Decoy (Attraction) + Fork

### **Exercise 665**

665



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

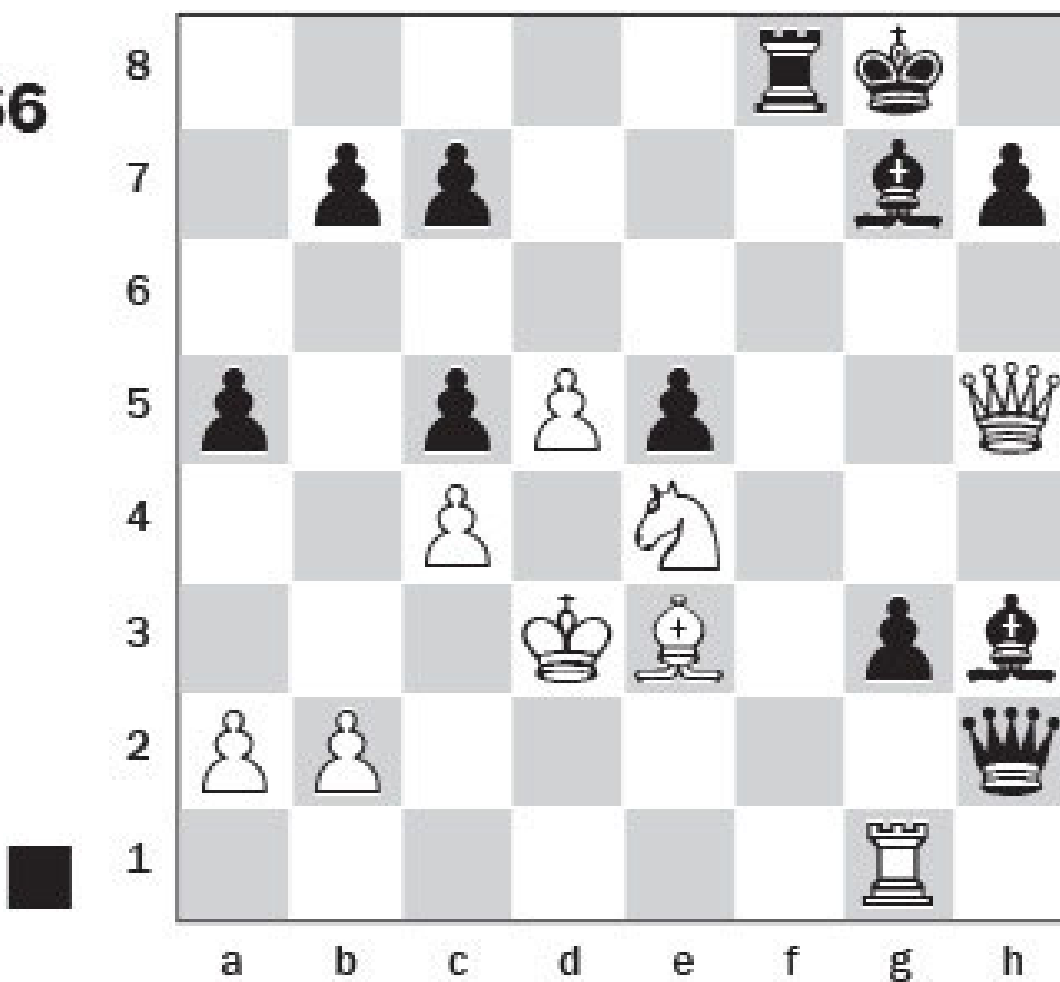
Skewer + Overloaded

## 8th World Champion: Mikhail Tal (1936-1992)

Tal was the World Chess Champion from 1960 to 1961.

### Exercise 666

**666**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

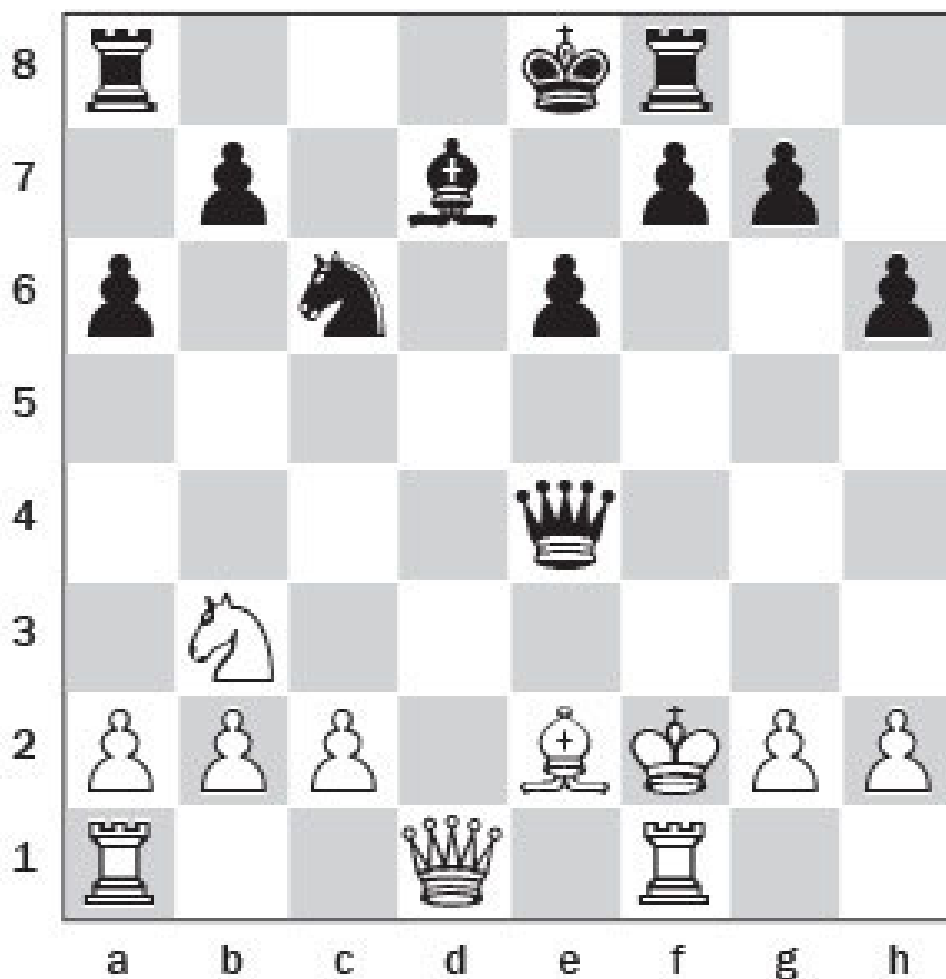
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Discovered Attack

### Exercise 667

**667**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

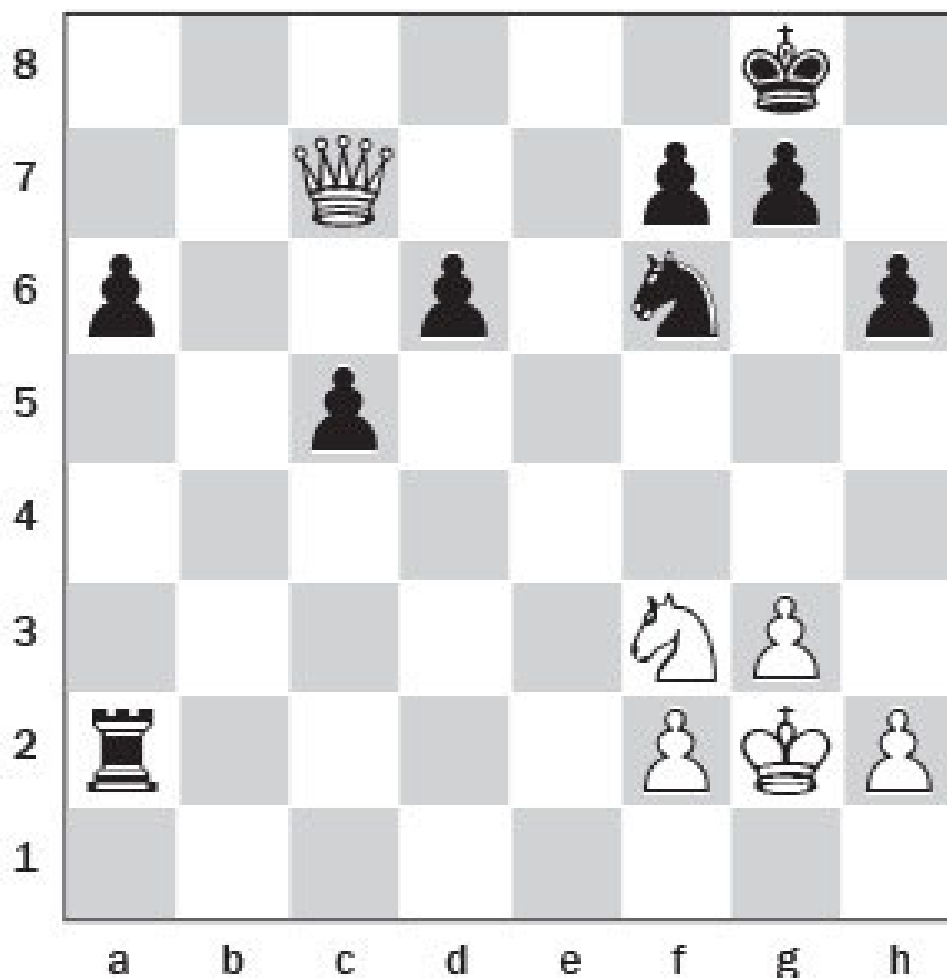
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### **CONCEPTS USED**

Decoy (Attraction) + Fork

### **Exercise 668**

668



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

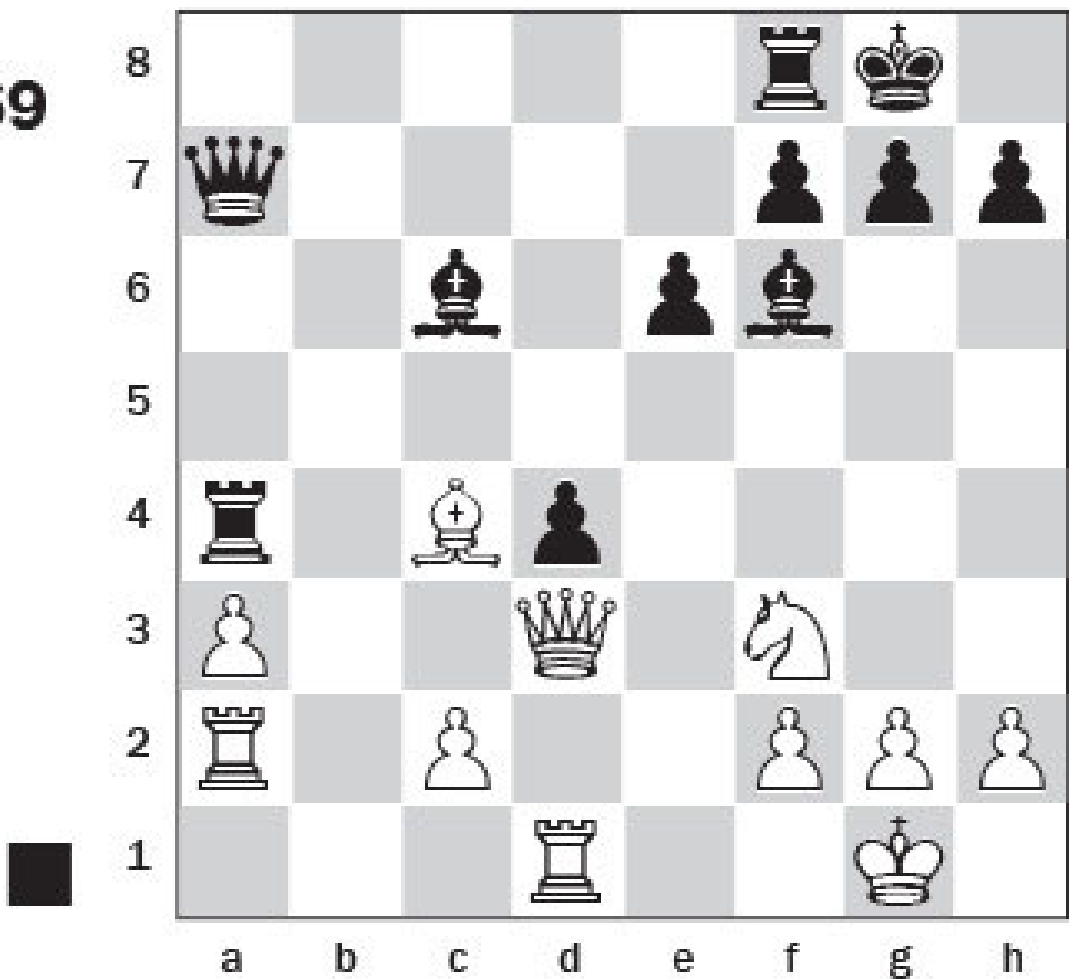
Fork

## 9th World Champion: Tigran Petrosian (1929-1984)

Petrosian was the World Chess Champion from 1963-1969.

### Exercise 669

**669**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Attraction) + Skewer

### Exercise 670

**670**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

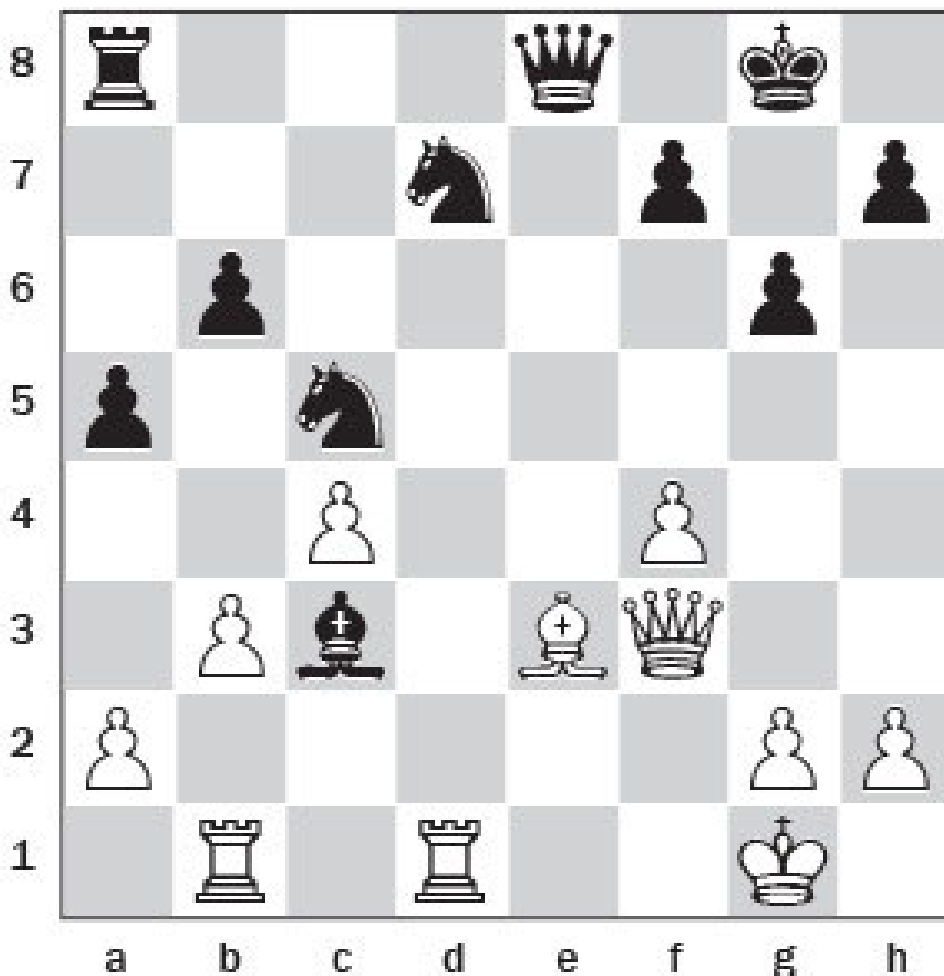
2. \_\_\_\_\_

### CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Attraction) + Fork

### [Exercise 671](#)

671



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

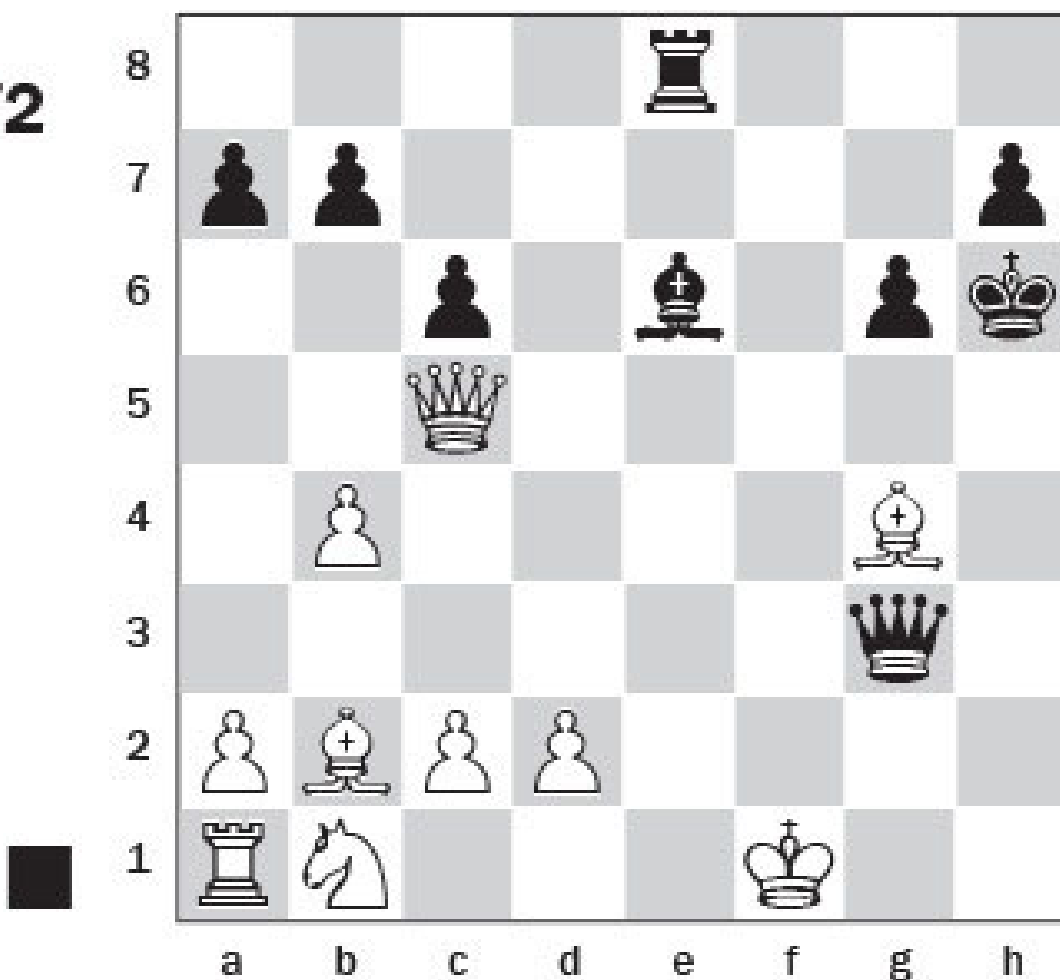
Discovered Attack

## 10th World Champion: Boris Spassky (1937 - )

Spassky was the World Chess Champion from 1969-1972.

### Exercise 672

**672**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

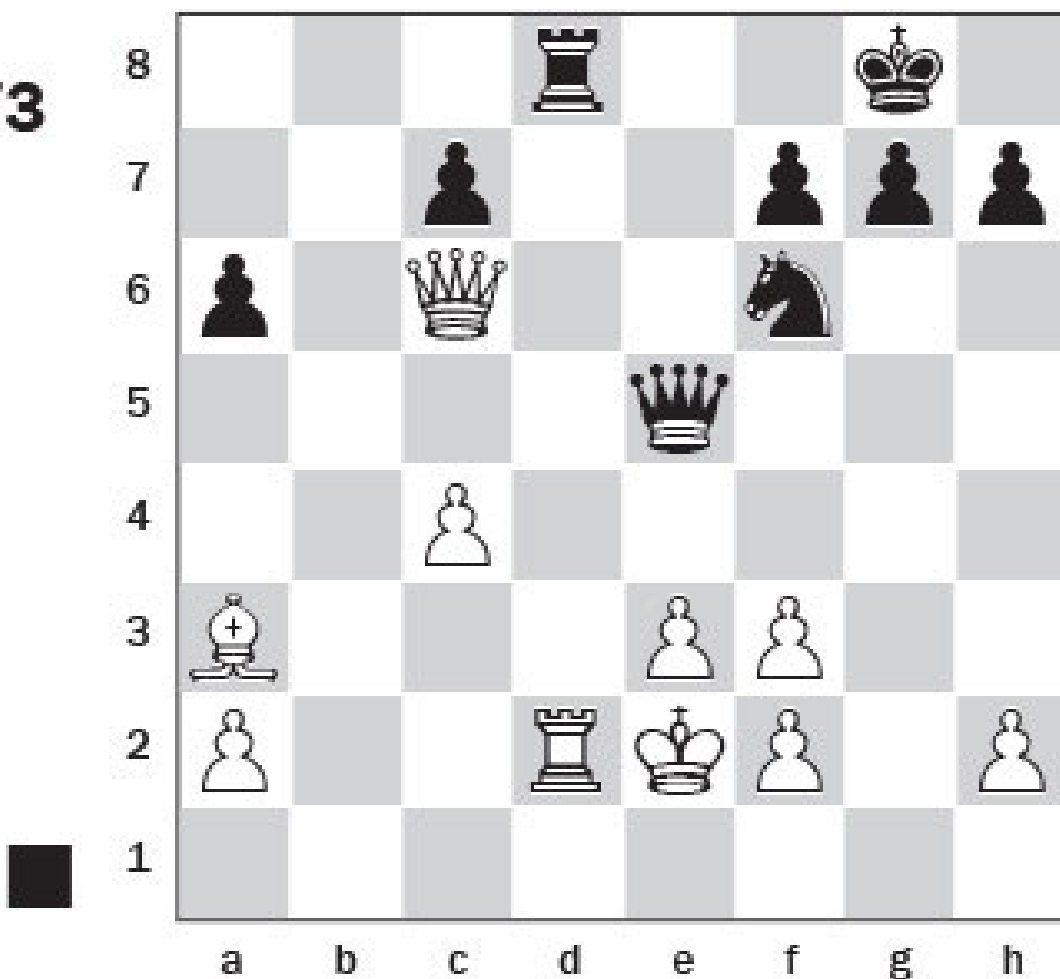
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Discovered Attack + Kill Box Checkmate

### Exercise 673

**673**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

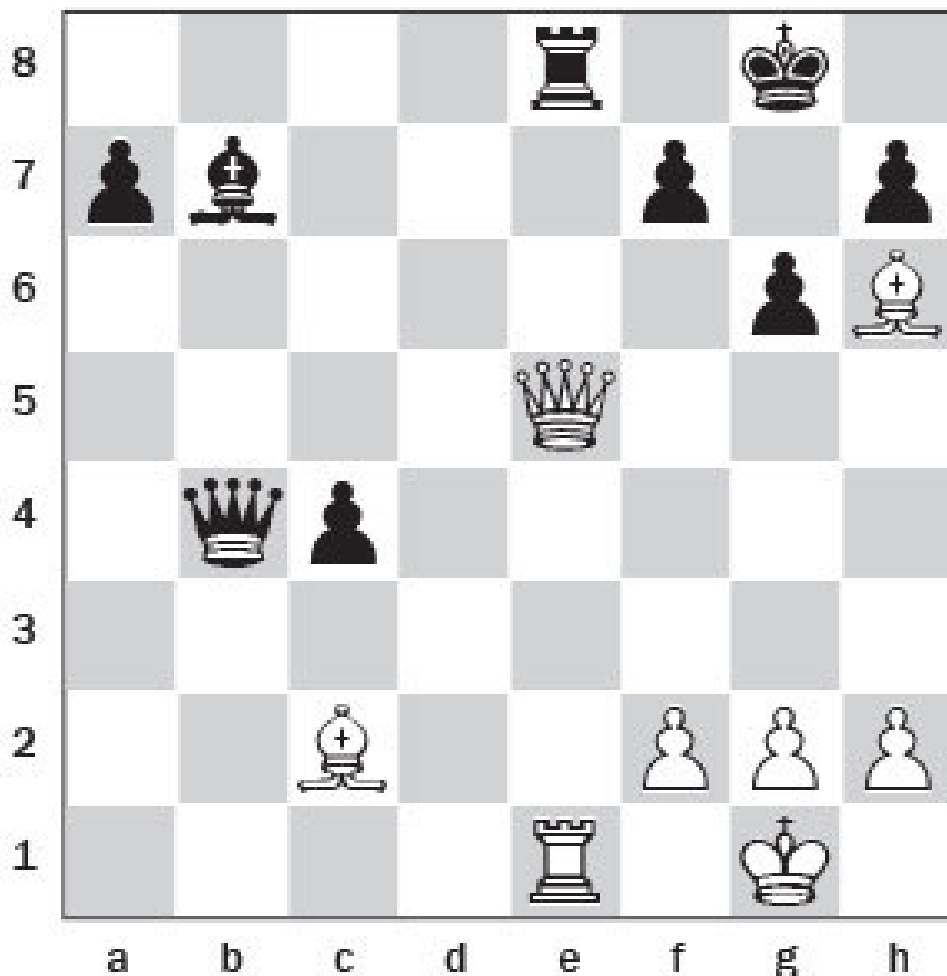
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Fork

[Exercise 674](#)

674



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

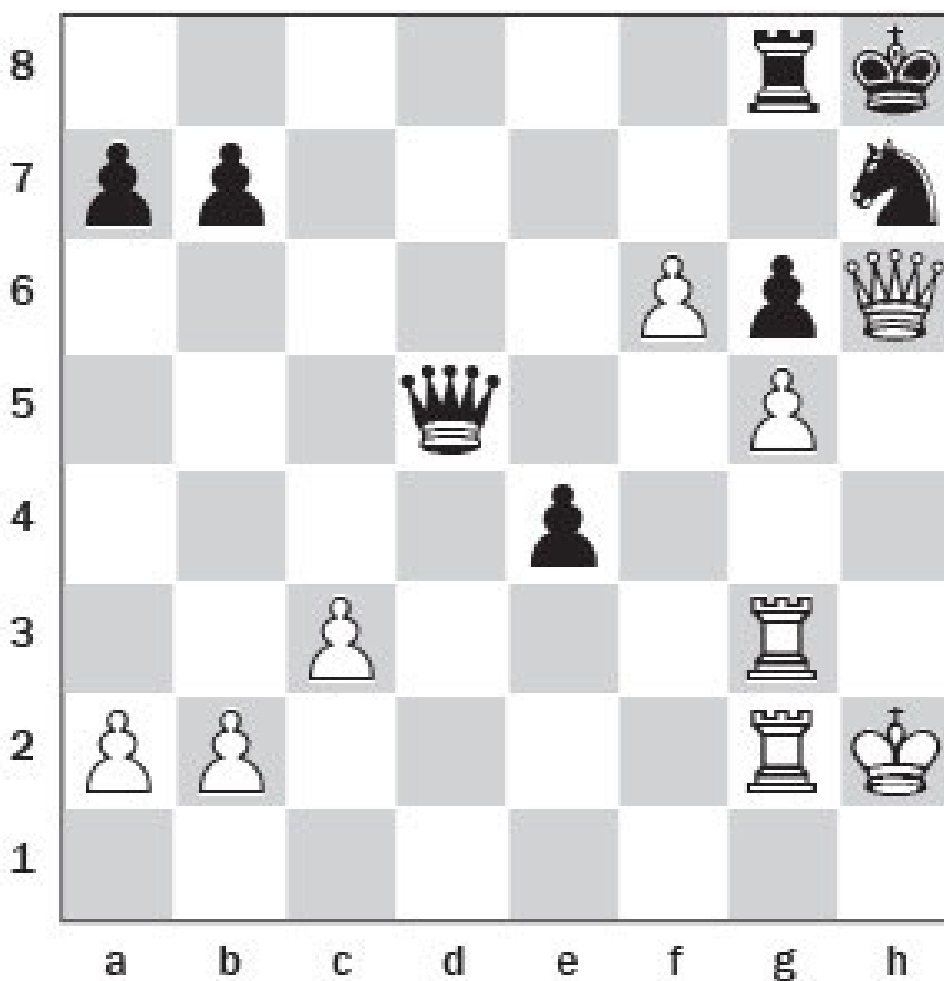
X-Ray + Back Rank Checkmate

## 11th World Champion: Robert James ‘Bobby’ Fischer (1943-2008)

Fischer was the World Chess Champion from 1972-1975.

### Exercise 675

**675**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 676

**676**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

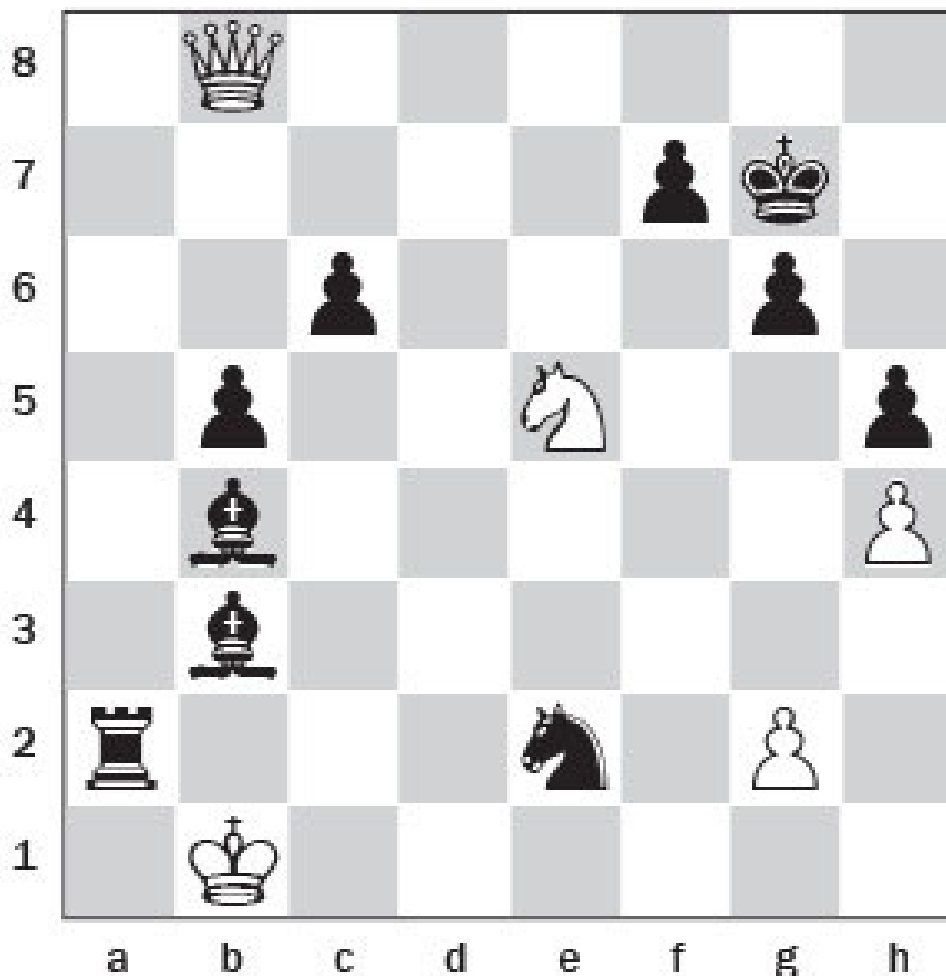
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Fork

[Exercise 677](#)

677



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

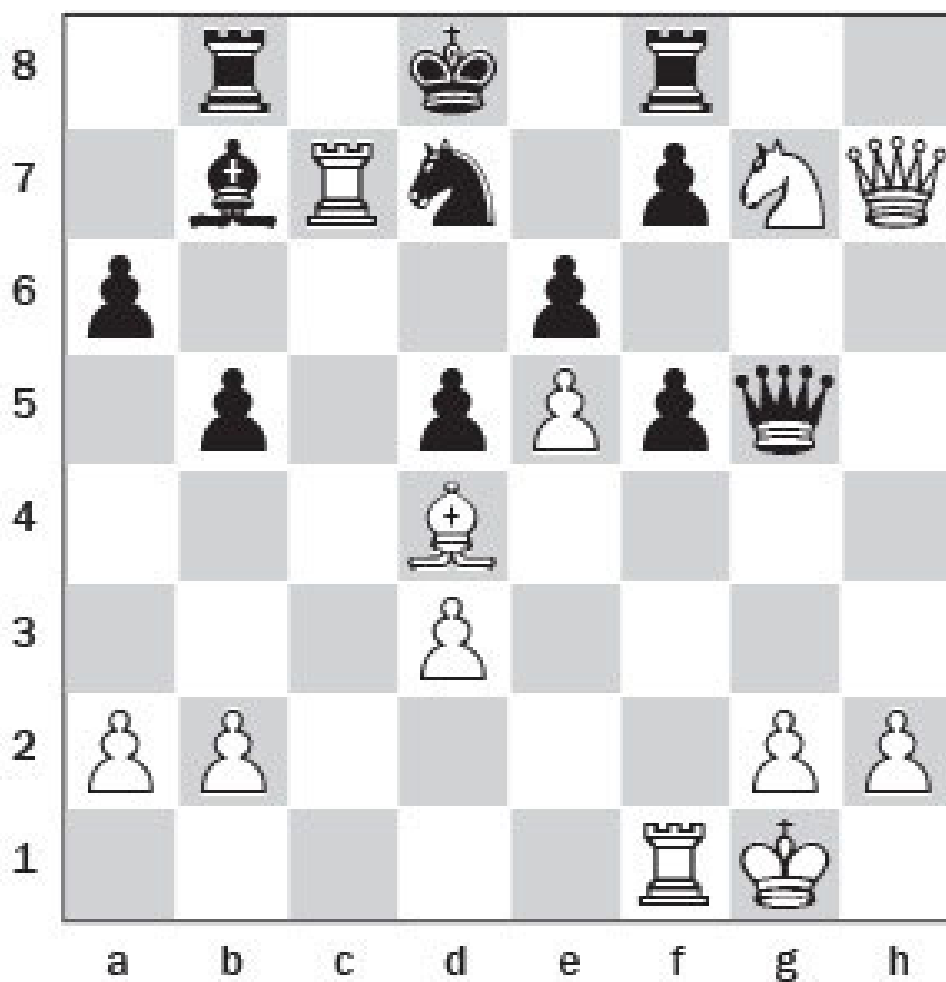
Vukovic's Checkmate

## 12th World Champion: Anatoly Karpov (1951 - )

Karpov was the World Chess Champion from 1975-1985.

### Exercise 678

**678**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

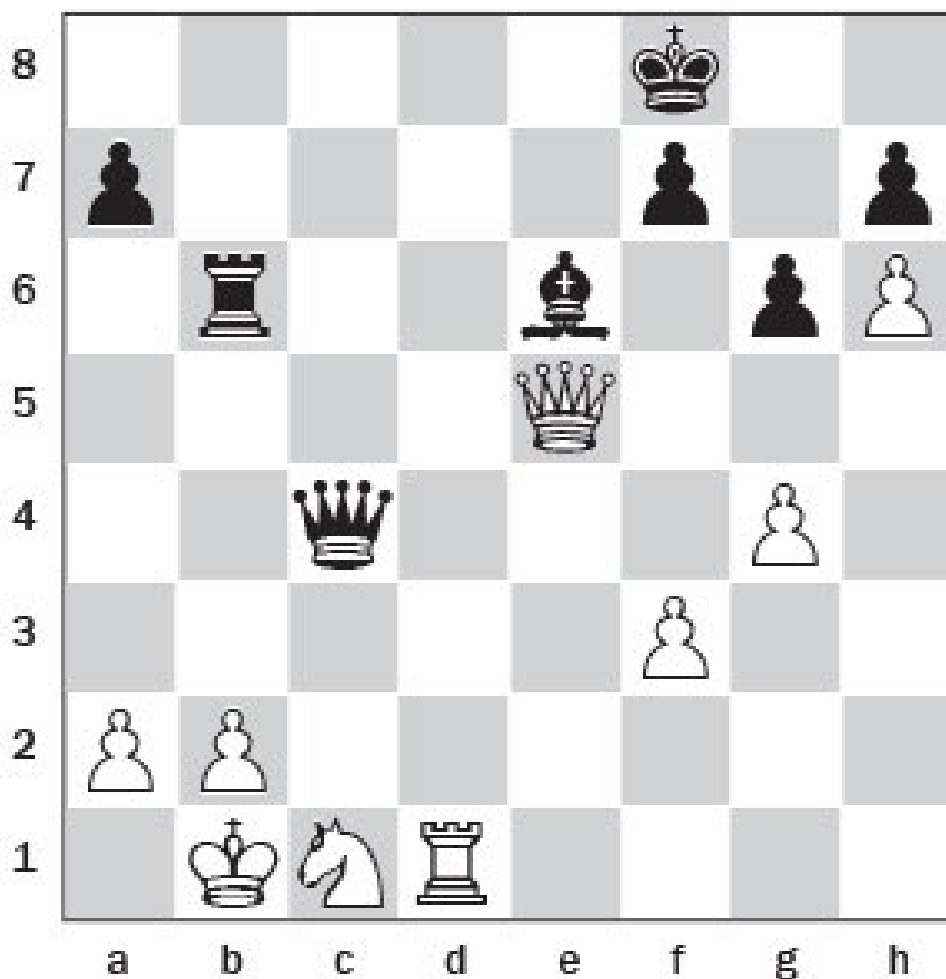
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Fork + Discovered Attack

### Exercise 679

**679**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

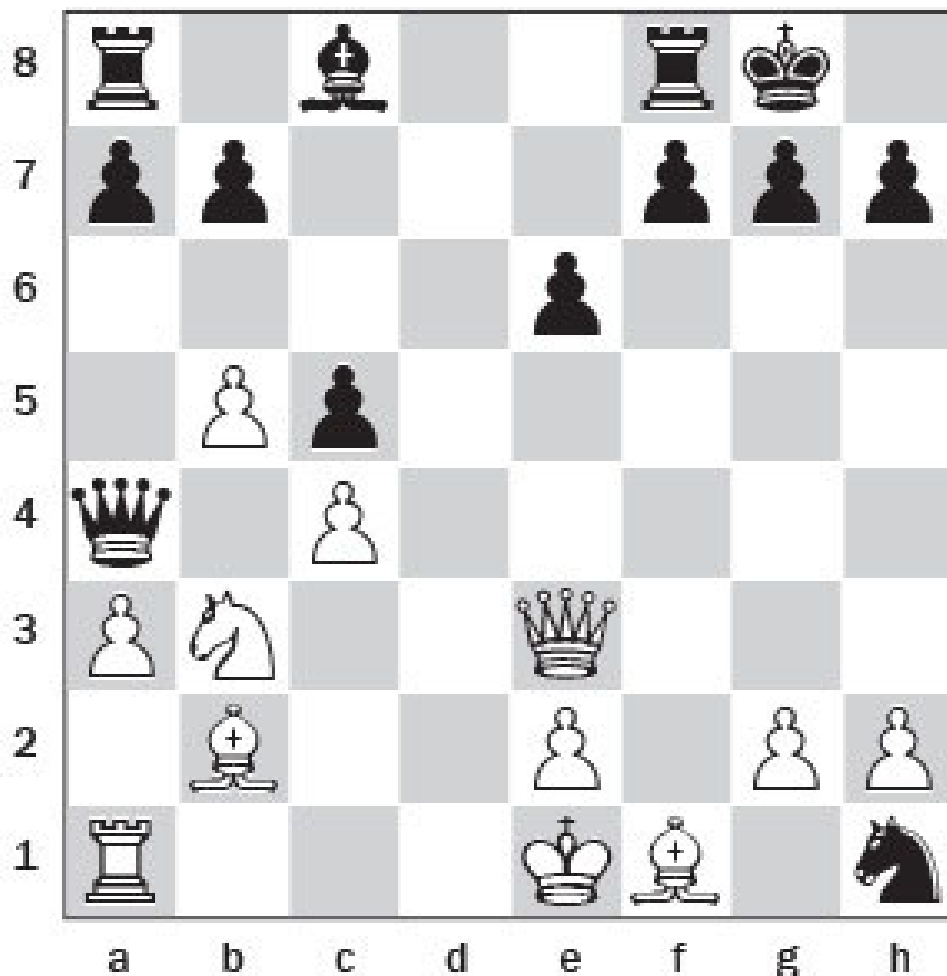
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Dovetail Checkmate

## Exercise 680

680



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

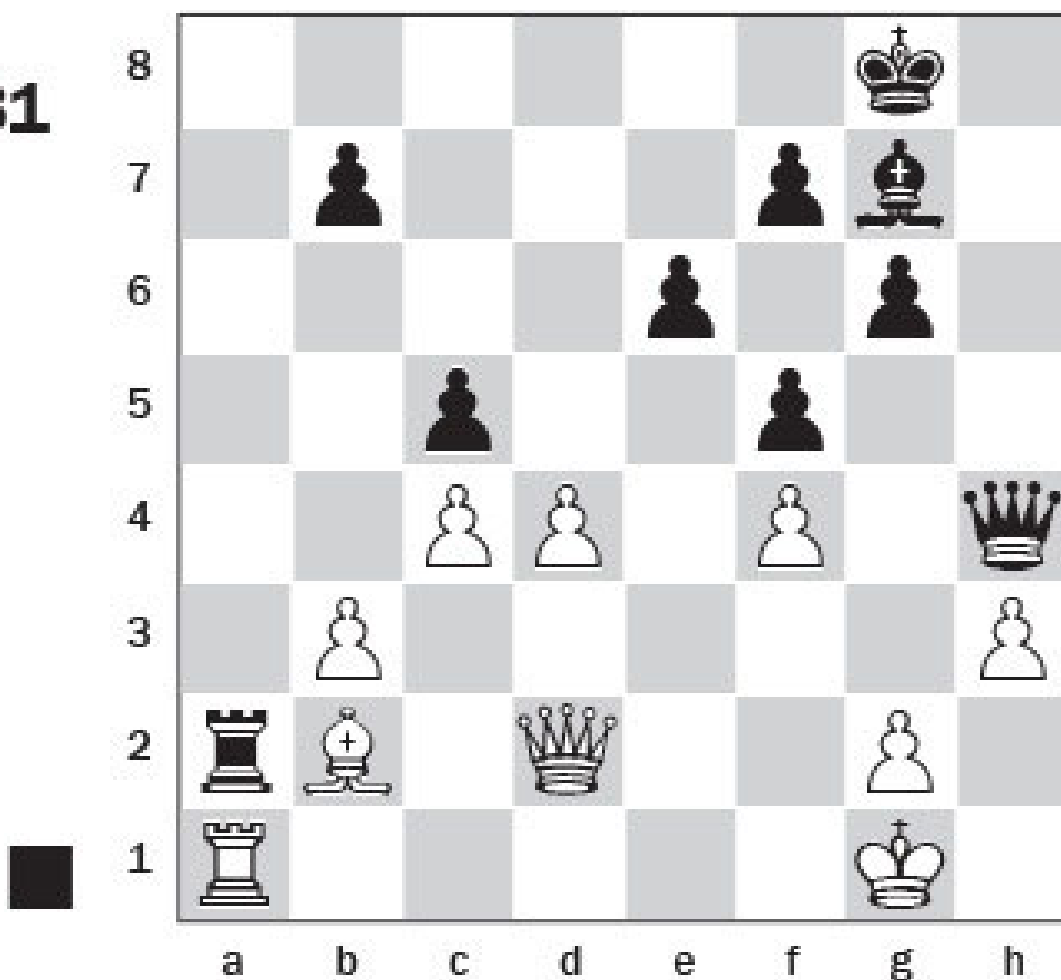
Battery Checkmate + Trapping

## 13th World Champion: Garry Kasparov (1963 - )

Kasparov was the World Chess Champion from 1985-2000.

### Exercise 681

**681**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

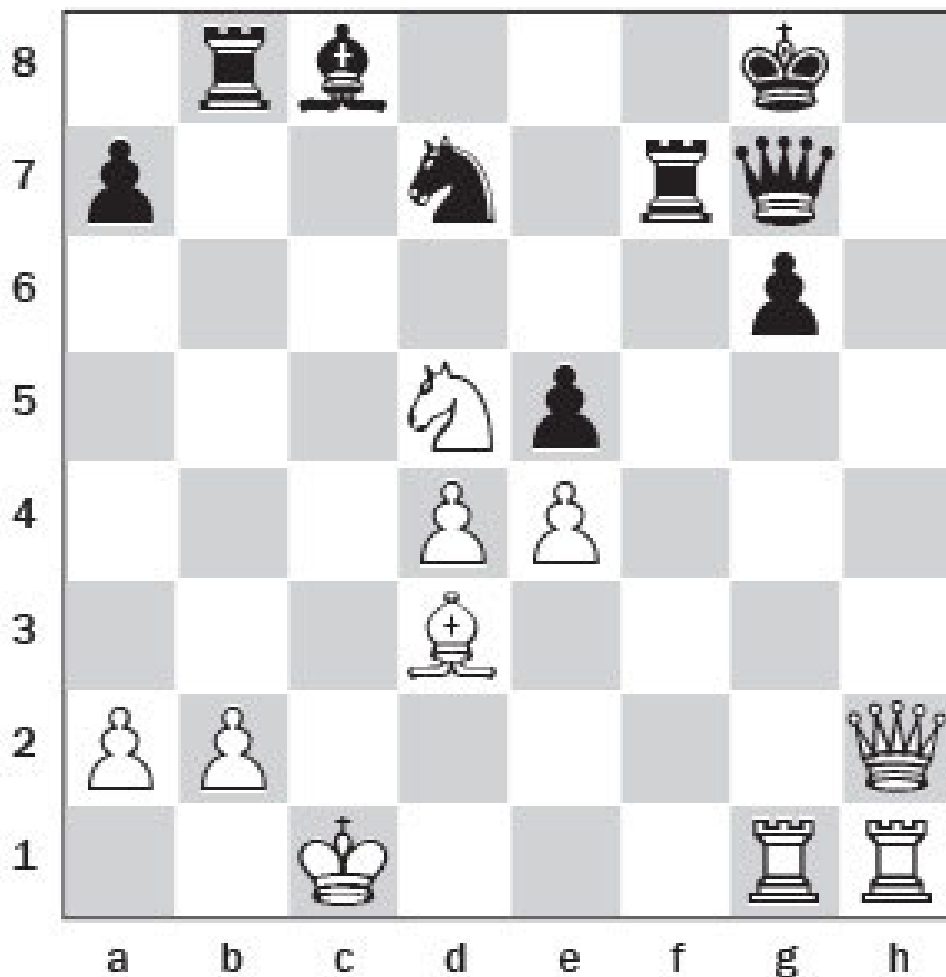
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Removing the Guard + Decoy (Attraction) + Fork

### Exercise 682

**682**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Pin + Decoy (Deflection)

### Exercise 683

683



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

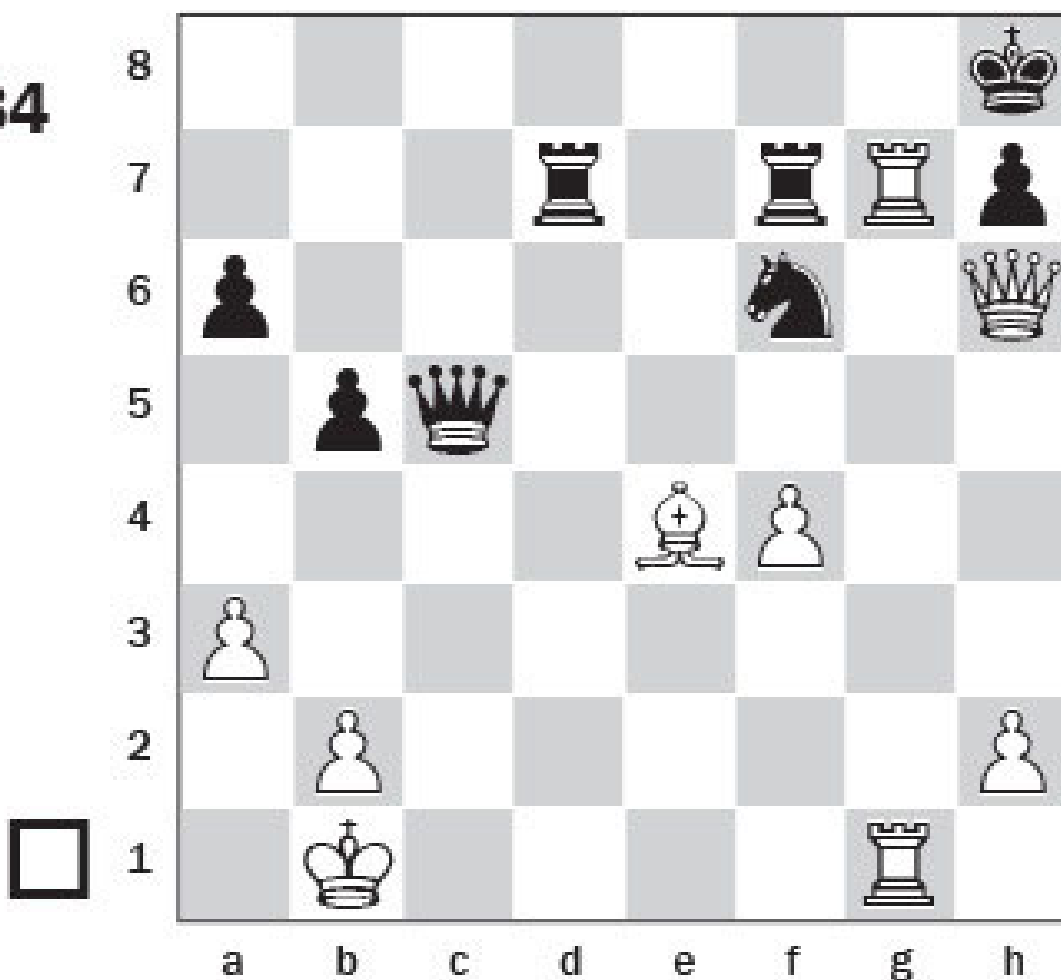
In-Between Move

## 14th World Champion: Vladimir Kramnik (1975 - )

Kramnik was the World Chess Champion from 2000-2007.

### Exercise 684

**684**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

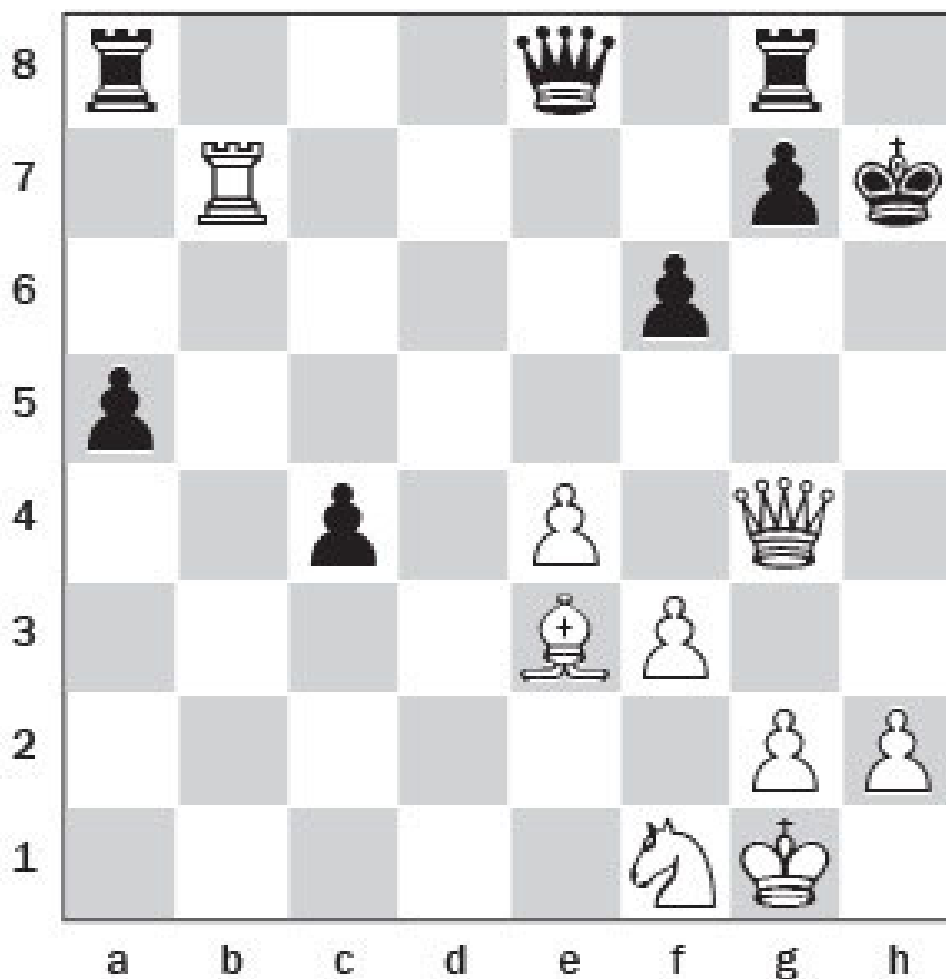
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Deflection + Battery Checkmate

### Exercise 685

**685**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

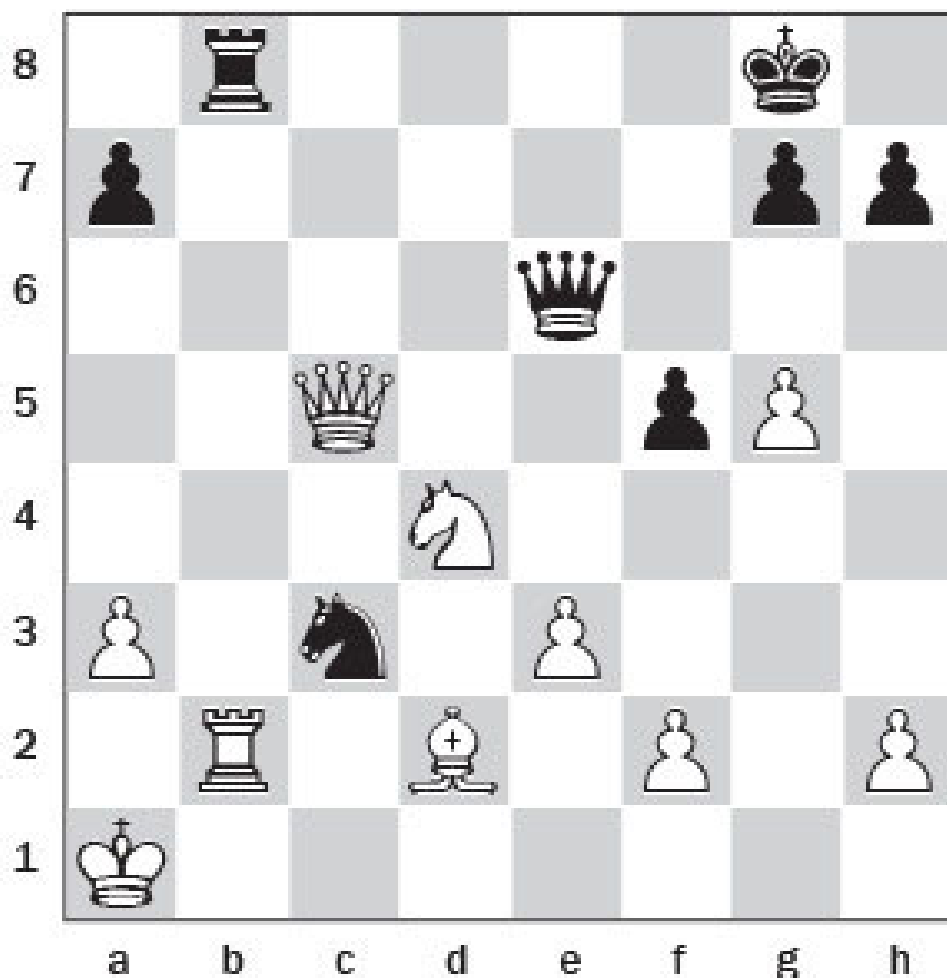
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Checkmate in Two

### Exercise 686

686



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

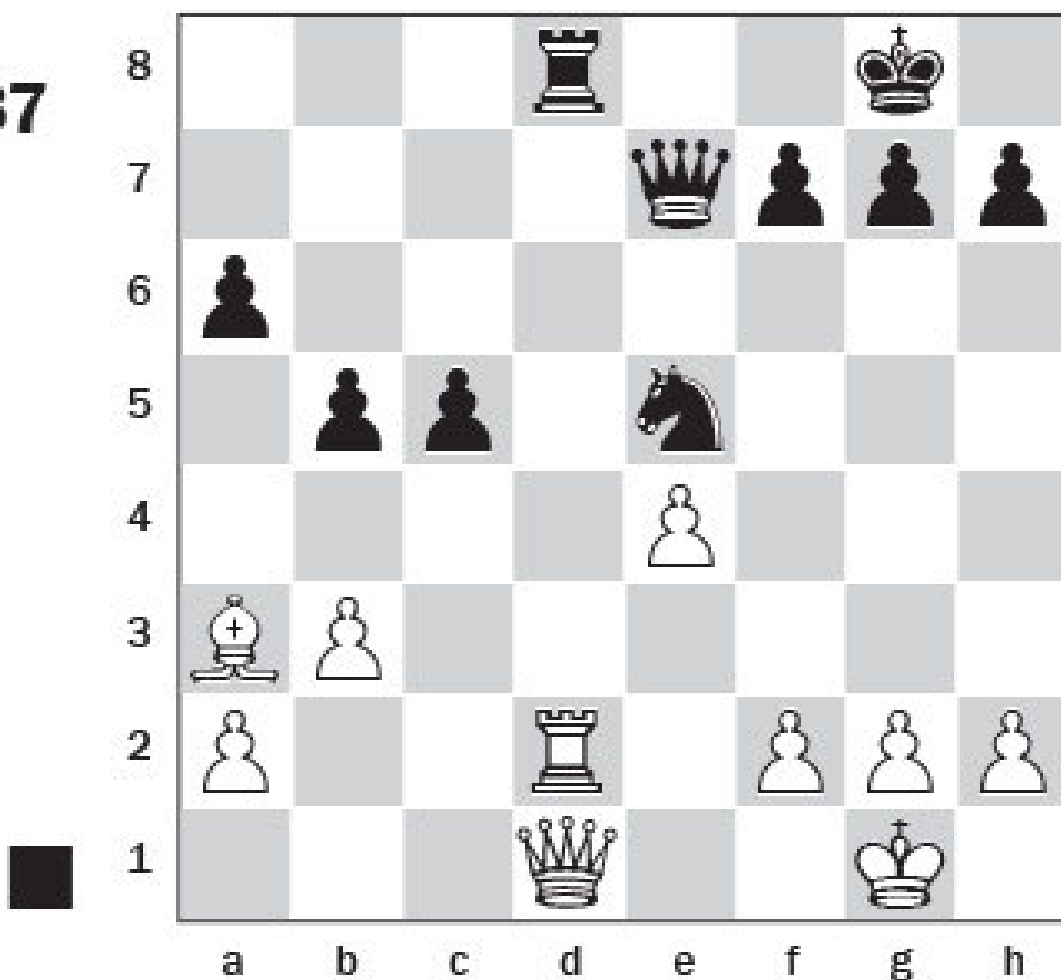
Arabian Checkmate

## 15th World Champion: Viswanathan Anand (1969 - )

Anand was World Chess Champion from 2007-2013.

### Exercise 687

**687**



Answer:



1. \_\_\_\_\_

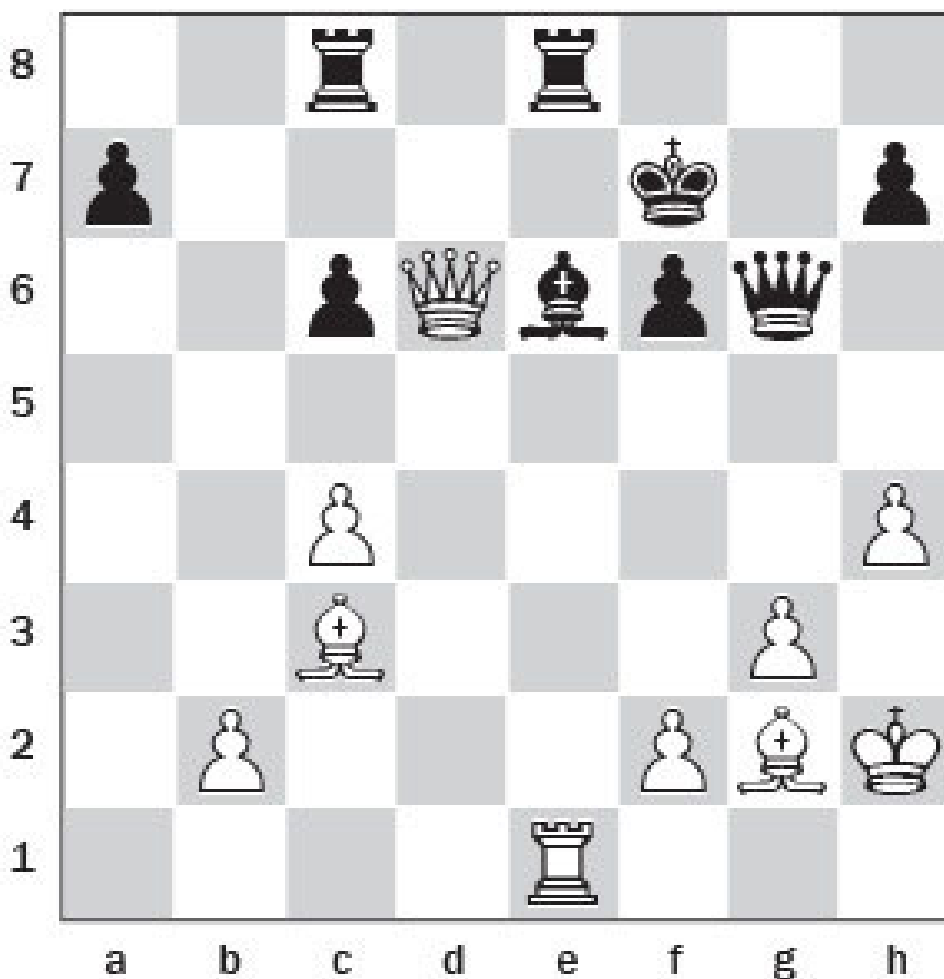
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Fork

### Exercise 688

**688**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

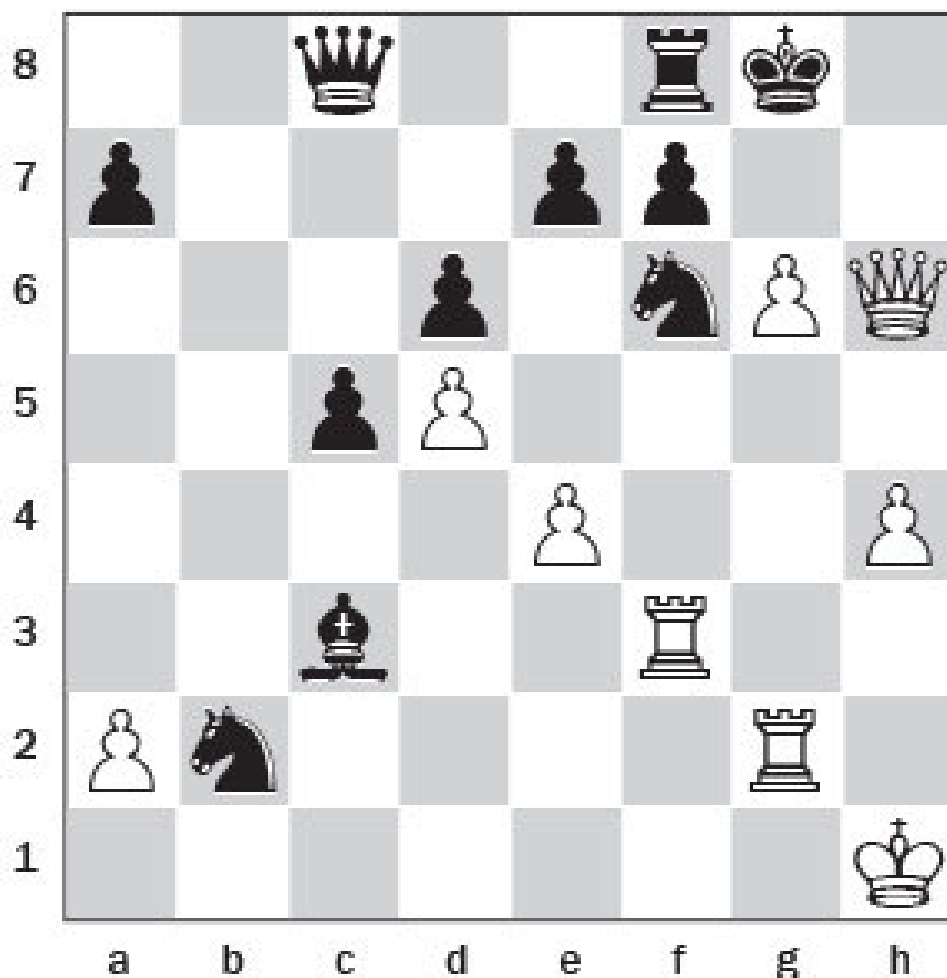
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Fork

## [Exercise 689](#)

689



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

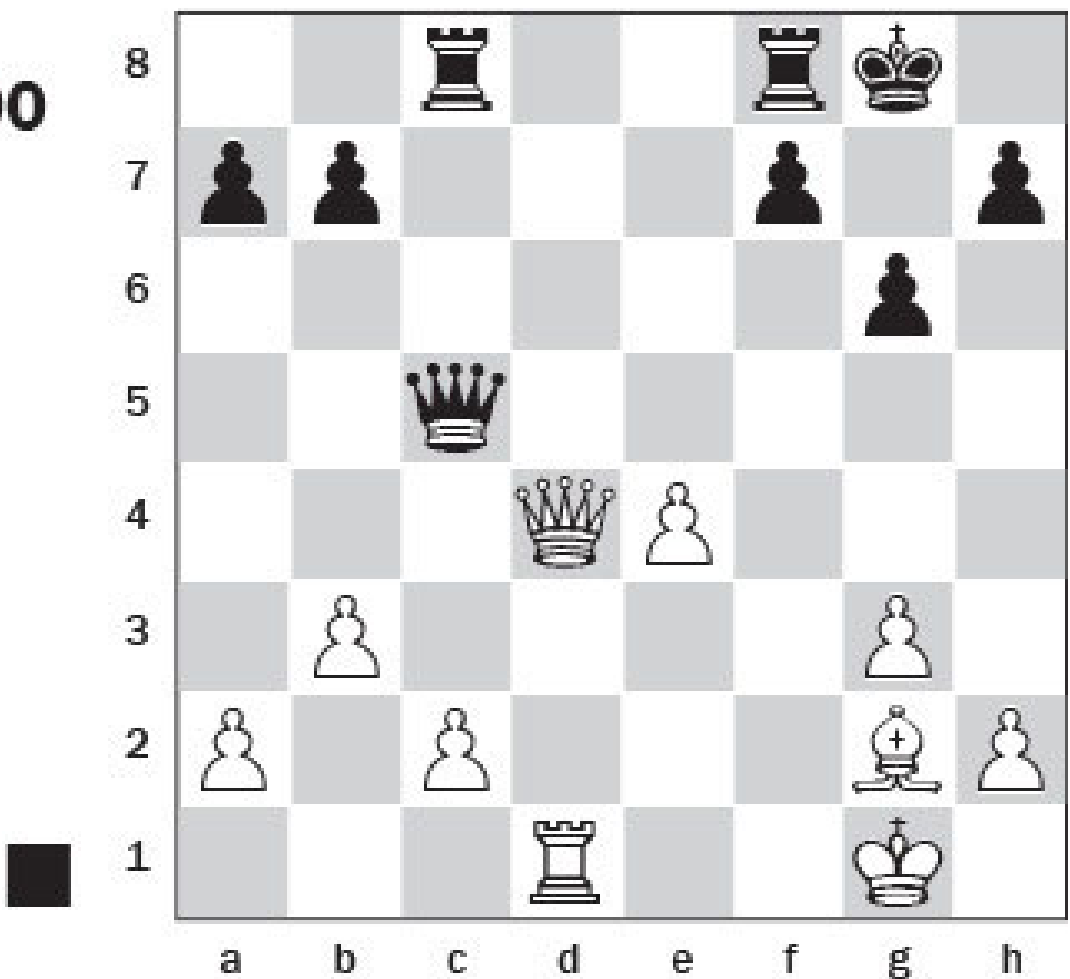
Double Check + Dovetail Checkmate

## 16th World Champion: Magnus Carlsen (1990 - )

Carlsen won the World Chess Championship in 2013 and is the current World Chess Champion.

### Exercise 690

**690**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

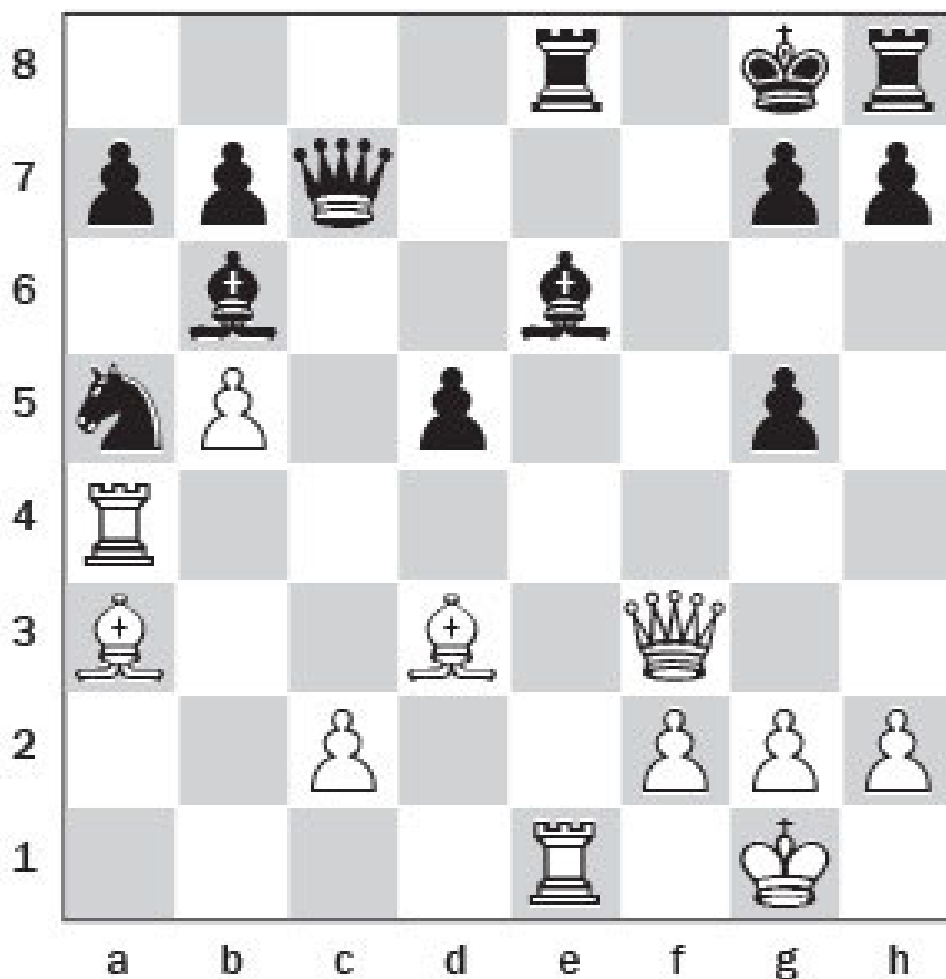
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Pin + Skewer + In-Between Move

### Exercise 691

**691**



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

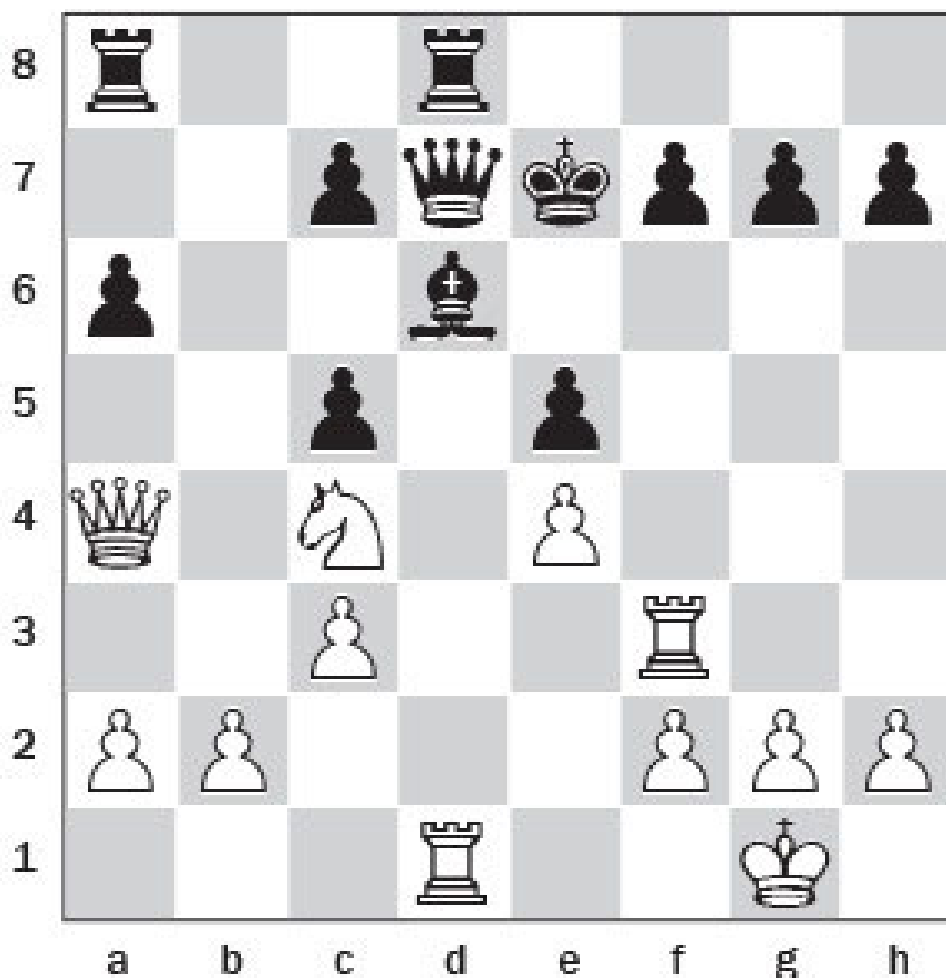
2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Overloaded

[Exercise 692](#)

692



Answer:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

## CONCEPTS USED

Decoy (Attraction) + Fork + Pin

## PART IV

# Solutions to Exercises

### Capturing Free Pieces

■

1 1.Bxa7 White wins the rook (5 points) for free.

■

2 1.Qxb4 White wins the bishop (3 points) for free. 1.Qxc6 is not effective since the queen can simply be captured back: 1...bxc6. Free Piece 2-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 2 (Guided) 2021.

■

3 1...Bxd2 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 3-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 3 2021.

■

4 1...Bxc5 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 4-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 4 2021.

■

5 1.Qxh5 White wins the rook (5 points) for free. Free Piece 5-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 5 2021.

■



6 1...Bxc3 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 6-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 6 2021.

■

7 1.Bxa8 White wins the rook (5 points) for free. Free Piece 7-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 7 2021.

■

8 1.Qxb3 White wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 8-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 8 2021.

■

9 1...Bxd2 Black wins the bishop (3 points) for free. Free Piece 9-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 9 2021.

■

10 1...Qxg5 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 10-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 10 2021.

■

11 1...Qxd5 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 11-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 11 2021.

■

12 1...Nxb6 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 12-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 12 2021.

■

13 1.Qxh5 White wins the bishop (3 points) for free. Free Piece 13-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 13 2021.

■  
14 1.Qxc8 White wins the rook (5 points) for free. Free Piece 14-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 14 2021.

■  
15 1...Qxg5 Black wins the knight (3 points) for free. Free Piece 15-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 15 2021.

■  
16 1...Qxg5 Black wins the bishop (3 points) for free. Free Piece 16-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 16 2021.

■  
17 1...Qxb2 Black wins the bishop (3 points) for free. Free Piece 17-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 17 2021.

■  
18 1...Qxa2 Black wins the rook (5 points) for free. Free Piece 18-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 18 2021.

■  
19 1...Bxg4 Black wins the queen (9 points) for free. Free Piece 19-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 19 2021.

■  
20 1.Nxc5 White wins the bishop (3 points) for free. Free Piece 20-?, Capture the Free Piece: Free 20 2021.

**Counting Attackers and Defenders**

■

21 1.Nxd7 Nxd7 2.Rxd7 White has won a knight (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 1-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 1 - Guided 2021.

■

22 1...Bxa3 2.Nxa3 Qxa3 Black used the battery to win a knight (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 2-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 2 - Guided 2021.

■

23 1.Rxd5 Rxd5 2.Qxd5+ White has won a rook (5 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 3-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 3 - Guided 2021.

■

24 1.Rxf8 The rook was only guarded by the king. Black was not defending the rook enough and lost 5 points of material. Counting 4-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 4 - Guided 2021.

■

25 1.Bxb8 White wins a rook (5 points). It was important for White to take with 'weakest piece' first. Counting 5-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 5 - Guided 2021.

■

26 1...Qxd3 Correct! The queen was being threatened by the pawn on a4. 1...Rxd3 does not work since Black's queen is en prise: 2.axb5. 2.Qxd3 Rxd3 Black wins a knight (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 6-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 6 - Guided 2021.

■

27 1...Nxc3 Correct! White was threatening Black's queen on d8. This move gets rid of the attack and also wins material! 1...Nxc3 would not be as effective since White can simply capture the knight: 2.Rxc3. Black's queen is still under attack. 1...Bxc3 would be a blunder since White would take the queen: 2.Bxd8. 2.Nxc3 Qxc3 Black wins a bishop (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 7-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 7 - Guided 2021.

■

28 1...Qxd3 Correct! The bishop was threatening the queen. By playing this capture, Black wins a bishop (3 points) and also deals with White's threat. 2.Qxd3 Bxd3 Black won a bishop (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 8-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 8 - Guided 2021.

■

29 1...Qxf1+ Black wins the rook for free. Notice that Black's queen and rook are protecting each other (battery). Counting 9-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 9 2021.

■

30 1.Nxe4 Nxe4 Black does not have to trade knights, but in either case he is down material. 2.Qxe4 White wins a knight (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 10-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 10 2021.

■

31 1...Nxc3 2.Nxc3 Kxc3 Black has won a minor piece (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 11-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 11 2021.

■

32 1...Nxe5 Capturing with the weakest piece first. 2.Bxe5 Qxe5 Black won a minor piece (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 12-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 12 2021.

■

33 1.Nxc6 Once again, capturing with the weakest piece first. 1...Bxc6 2.Qxc6 White won a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Counting 13-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 13 2021.

■

34 1.Qxd2 Notice that White's rook and queen protect one another in the form a battery. 1...Qxd2 2.Rxd2 White has won a rook and should go on to win the game. Counting 14-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 14 2021.

■

35 1.Bxe3 Capturing with the weakest piece first. 1...Bxe3 2.Qxe3 White wins a minor piece (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 15-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 15 2021.

■

36 1.Bxe5 Capturing with the weakest piece first. 1...Bxe5 2.Rxe5 White is up a rook (5 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 16-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 16 2021.

■

37 1.Nxb7 White wins a bishop (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 17-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 17

2021.

■

38 1...Bxc3 Black's queen and bishop were aligned in a battery. 2.Bxc3 Qxc3 Black won a minor piece (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Counting 18-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 18 2021.

■

39 1...Qxf2+ Black wins a bishop (3 points) thanks to the queen and rook battery. Counting 19-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 19 2021.

■

40 1.Bxg4 Once again, White wins a minor piece (3 points) due to the queen and bishop battery. 1...Nxb4 2.Qxb4 White should go on to win. Counting 20-?, Counting Attackers: Counting 20 2021.

## **Intro to Defense**

■

41 1.Ba6 Running away – the only option that saves the bishop from being captured. Piece Defense 1-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 1 (Guided) 2021.

■

42 1...Ne6 The only move which avoids losing material. Black blocks the attack and saves the day. White could capture the knight but then Black would take back for an even trade of

pieces. Piece Defense 2-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 2 (Guided) 2021.

■  
43 1...Kb8 Black cannot move the knight since White's pawns stop it from safely moving. Black has to defend the knight with the king. Piece Defense 3-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 3 (Guided) 2021.

■  
44 1.Na3 Good move! White's knight was being threatened by the rook. In addition, the bishop was attacking the other squares. This was the only safe square for the knight. Piece Defense 4-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 4 2021.

■  
45 1.Rg1 Defending the bishop was the only way to prevent the loss of material. Piece Defense 5-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 5 2021.

■  
46 1...Bd5 Defending the knight was the only way to avoid losing material. Piece Defense 6-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 6 2021.

■  
47 1.Nd6 Defending the important center pawn. Piece Defense 7-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 7 2021.

■  
48 1...Ng6 Defending the rook in the corner. This is the only move that avoids the loss of material. Piece Defense 8-?,

## Defending Pieces: Defence 8 2021.

■  
49 1.Qc6 Running away from danger. This is the only safe square for the queen. Piece Defense 9-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 9 2021.

■  
50 1...Nf6 Blocking the attack on the rook in the corner and avoiding the loss of material. Piece Defense 10-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 10 2021.

■  
51 1...Nc2 Running away from the rook's attack. This was the only way to avoid losing material. Piece Defense 11-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 11 2021.

■  
52 1...Bb7 Avoiding the loss of the exchange. Piece Defense 12-?, Defending Pieces: Defence 12 2021.

## **Assorted Checkmates in One**

■  
53 1.Rh8# Checkmate 1-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 1 (2021.

■  
54 1.Qb8# Checkmate 2-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 2 (2021.



■  
55 1.Nf7# Checkmate 3-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 3 (2021.

■  
56 1.Bf6# Checkmate 4-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 4 ( 2021.

■  
57 1.Qg6# Checkmate 5-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 5 ( 2021.

■  
58 1...Ne2# Checkmate 6-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 6 ( 2021.

■  
59 1.Qxh7# Checkmate 7-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 7 ( 2021.

■  
60 1...Nf2# Checkmate 8-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 8 ( 2021.

■  
61 1...Nxc2# The rook cuts off the b-file while the knight attacks the king on a1. Checkmate 9-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 9 2021.

■

62 1.Qxd8# The rook on a6 cuts off the a-file while the queen attacks the king and takes away the c7-square. Checkmate 10-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 10 2021.

■

63 1...Rh5# The bishop on f3 prevents the king from moving off of the h-file. Checkmate 11-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 11 2021.

■

64 1.Ba6# The two bishops finish off the king. Checkmate 12-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 12 2021.

■

65 1.Rh8# The pawn on f6 stops the king from moving forward while the rook on h8 attacks the 8th rank. Checkmate 13-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 13 2021.

■

66 1.Nf6# Notice that Black's own pieces prevent the king from moving. This type of checkmate is called 'smothered checkmate' and will be discussed in detail later in the book. Checkmate 14-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 14 2021.

■

67 1.Rd4# Black's king is trapped and surrounded by all of White's kingside pieces. Checkmate 15-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 15 2021.

■

68 1.Qh8# Notice that Black's queen is preventing the king from escaping. Checkmate 16-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 16 2021.

■

69 1...Qxh3# The queen and pawn corner the king. Checkmate 17-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 17 2021.

■

70 1...Nb4# The pawn on e5 prevents the king from moving to d4, while the queen cuts off the 2nd rank. Checkmate 18-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 18 2021.

■

71 1.Nh6# Very nice move! The knight attacks the king and the f7-square, while the queen attacks the a1-h8 diagonal. Checkmate 19-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 19 2021.

■

72 1.Qa8# The queen attacks the king while the rook on d1 prevents the king from running. Checkmate 20-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 20 2021.

■

73 1.Bd6# The bishop attacks the king while the pawn covers e8 and the rook covers g-file. Checkmate 21-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 21 2021.

■

74 1...Qf1# The king is trapped in the corner. Checkmate 22-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 22 2021.

■

75 1.Rh8# The rook and king checkmate. The white rook attacks the king on the 8th rank, while White's king prevents escape. Checkmate 23-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 23 2021.

■

76 1.Nd6# Another 'smothered checkmate'. The king cannot escape due to its own pieces. Checkmate 24-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 24 2021.

■

77 1...Rh1# The rook attacks and protects the h-file, while the pawns prevent the king from moving to the g-file. Checkmate 25-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 25 2021.

■

78 1...Ra1# The rook attacks the 1st rank while the knights prevents the king's escape to the 2nd. Checkmate 26-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 26 2

■

79 1.Qe8# The king is trapped by its own pieces. Checkmate 27-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 27 2021.

■

80 1...Rc7# The rook attacks the king on the c-file, while Black's rook and pawns take away the flight squares. Checkmate 28-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 28 2021.

■

81 1.Nh6# The knight attacks the king while the queen attacks the diagonal. Checkmate 29-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Checkmate 29 2021.

■

82 1.Rd5# Helper Checkmate 1-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■

83 1.Ra7# This pattern is known as the 'Arabian Checkmate' and will be discussed in further detail later in the book. Helper Checkmate 2-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■

84 1.Rh8# Helper Checkmate 3-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■

85 1.Qf5# The king protects the queen while Black's own pawns prevent its escape. Helper Checkmate 4-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■

86 1.Qc7# Helper Checkmate 5-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■

87 1...Qxf2# The bishop helps the queen and the king has no escape. Helper Checkmate 6-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
88 1...Qg2# The pawn helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 7-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
89 1.Qxg7# The bishop helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 8-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
90 1.Qxf7# The knight helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 9-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
91 1...Rg1# The bishop helps the rook. Helper Checkmate 10-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
92 1.Qg7# The pawn helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 11-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
93 1.Qxf7# The knight helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 12-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
94 1.Qxh7# The knight helps the queen.

■  
95 1.Qg7# The knight helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 14-?,  
Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Helper Checkm 2021.

■  
96 1...Qxf2# The knight helps the queen.

■  
97 1.Qf7# The knight helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 16-?, Additional Helper Checkmates: Helper Ch 2021.

■  
98 1...Qb2# The rook helps the queen. Helper Checkmate 17-?, Additional Helper Checkmates: Helper Ch 2021.

■  
99 1.Qf7# The bishop helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 1-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
100 1.Qxd7# The rook helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 2-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
101 1...Qh1# Battery Checkmat The bishop helps the queen. 3-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.The

■  
102 1.Qh7# The bishop helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 4-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
103 1.Qxf7# The rook helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 5-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
104 1.Qxd7# The rook helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 6-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
105 1...Qxf2# The bishop helps the queen.

■  
106 1...Qxg2# The rook helps the queen. Battery Checkmate 8-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
107 1...Qxg2# The bishop helps the queen.

■  
108 1...Rf1# The queen helps the rook. Battery Checkmate 10-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Battery Check 2021.

■  
109 1...Qxh2# The bishop helps the queen.

■  
110 1.Rc8# Back Rank 1-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Back Rank Che 2021.

■  
111 1...Qd1# Back Rank 2-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Back Rank Che 2021.

■



112 1...Qxd1# Black found an unprotected piece and also a back rank checkmate! Back Rank 3-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Back Rank Che 2021.

■

113 1...Rc1# Black attacks the 1st rank and White's pawn prevents the escape. Back Rank 4-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Back Rank Che 2021.

■

114 1.Ra8# White attacks the 8th rank and Black's own pawns prevent escape. Back Rank 5-?, Checkmate in 1: Assorted: Back Rank Che 2021.

## Forks

■

115 1.Nf5+ Kg6 2.Nxe7+ White is up a knight (3 points) and a pawn (1 point) and should go on to win the game. Knight Fork 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 1 2021.

■

116 1.Nh7+ Kg7 2.Nxf6 Even if Black recaptures the knight on the next move, White is up a queen (9 points) for a knight (3 points) and should go on to win the game. Knight Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 2 2021.

■

117 1...Ne2+ Black uses a knight fork to win a bishop. 2.Kf1 Nxc1 Black is up a minor piece (3 points) and should go on to

win the game. Knight Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 3 2021.

■

118 1...Nd3+ Black uses a knight fork to win a queen for a knight. 2.Ke2 Nxc1+ Black will be up a minor piece once White recaptures and should go on to win. Knight Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 4 2021.

■

119 1...Nd2+ Forking the king and the rook. 2.Kc1 Nxf1 Black is up a knight and should go on to win the endgame quite easily.

■

120 1.Nd5+ White wins the unprotected bishop on c3 with a knight fork. 1...Kb8 3.Nxc3 White is a knight up and should win the game comfortably. Knight Fork 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 6 2021.

■

121 1...Nf2+ Forking the king and queen. 2.Kg1 Nxd3 If White recaptures the knight, Black captures White's knight. Black is up a queen for a rook no matter what, and should win the game from here. Knight Fork 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 7 2021.

■

122 1.Nc7+ Forking the king and rook. 1...Kd8 2.Nxa8 White is currently up a rook, even if Black manages to win the clumsy knight in the corner, White would still be up the exchange and should go on to win regardless. Knight Fork 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 8 2021.

■  
123 1.Nb6+ Forking the king and queen. 1...Kc7 2.Nxd7 White is up a large amount of material and should go on to win the game from here. Knight Fork 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 9 2021.

■  
124 1...Ne3+ Forking the king and rook. 2.Kd2 Nxf1+ Black is up a knight and should win the endgame fairly easily. Knight Fork 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 10 2021.

■  
125 1.Nc7+ Forking the king and rook. 1...Kd8 2.Nxa8 White is currently up a rook. There's no guarantee that Black will recover the knight on a8, but in either case, White is up a significant amount of material. Knight Fork 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Knight Fork 11 2021.

■  
126 1...Re4+ 2.Kf2 Rxe5 Black is up a rook and should win the game using the fundamental rook and king versus king checkmate. Rook Fork 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Rook Fork 1 (G 2021.

■  
127 1.Rg7 Forking the bishop and knight. 1...Bc5 2.Rxh7 White is the exchange and a pawn up. White should win the position quite easily from here. Rook Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Rook Fork 2 (G 2021.

■

128 1.Rf7+ Forking the king and bishop. 1...Ke6 2.Rxg7 White is up a knight and should go on to win the game. Rook Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Rook Fork 3 2021.

■

129 1.Rd5+ Forking the king and queen. Notice that the rooks are in a battery and protect one another. 1...Qxd5 1...Kg6 is also possible but in either case Black loses the queen for a rook. 2.Rxb5 axb5. 2.Rxd5+ White is up a rook and should clean up from here. Rook Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Rook Fork 4 2021.

■

130 1.Re7+ Forking the king and bishop while using the bishop on h4 as a helper. 1...Kf8 2.Rxd7 White is up a minor piece for only a pawn and should win without much trouble. Rook Fork 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Rook Fork 5 2021.

■

131 1...Qe1+ Forking the king and knight. 2.Kh2 Qxd1 Black is up a knight and should go on to win the endgame. Queen Fork 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 1 (2021).

■

132 1...Qg5+ Forking the king and the unprotected rook on h4. 2.Kb1 Qxh4 Black is a rook up and should finish without much trouble. Queen Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 2 (2021).

■

133 1.Qd8+ Forking the king and unprotected rook on e7. 1...Kh7 2.Qxe7 White is up a rook and should go on to win. Queen Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 3 2021.

■  
134 1.Qxd5+ Forking the king and unprotected knight on a5. 1...Kh8 2.Qxa5 White is up a piece and should go on to win, though white should now finish development and get castled quickly. Queen Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 4 2021.

■  
135 1.Qa4+ Forking the king and bishop. 1...Qd7 2.Qxb4 White is up a knight and should go on to win. Queen Fork 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 5 2021.

■  
136 1.Qd8+ Forking the king and rook. 1...Kg7 2.Qxc7+ White has a queen for a rook and is winning. White's queen should be able to round up the queenside pawns fairly easily.

■  
137 1.Qd3+ Kf7 1...Nf5 doesn't help much: 2.Qxf5+ Qxf5+ 3.gxf5+ and White is still up a knight in a more simplified position. 2.Qxd4 White is up a knight and should win the endgame. Queen Fork 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 7 2021.

■  
138 1.Qa4+ Forking the king and knight. 1...Bd7 2.Qxa5 White is up a minor piece and should go on to win. White should now make development and castling a priority. Queen Fork 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 9 2021.

■

139 1...Qf6+ Forking the king and knight. 2.Bd4 2.Ne5 doesn't help much: 2...Qxe5+. 2...Qxg6 Black is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Queen Fork 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 8 2021.

■

140 1...Qb4+ Forking the king and knight. 2.Kf1 2.Nc3 also loses material after 2...dxc3. 2...Qxb5+ Black is up a knight and should go on to win. Queen Fork 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 10 2021.

■

141 1...Qe1+ Forking the king and rook. 2.Kh2 Qxa5 Black is up three pawns in the endgame and should win without much trouble. Queen Fork 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Queen Fork 11 2021.

■

142 1.Bc4+ Forking the king and rook. 1...Kd6 2.Bxa2 White is up a rook and should win this endgame fairly easily. Bishop Fork 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Bishop Fork 1 2021.

■

143 1...Bd2 Using the queen and bishop battery to fork the queen and rook. 2.Qf2 Bxc1 Black is up a bishop and should win the game, though should be careful with the exposed dark squares around the king. Bishop Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Bishop Fork 2 2021.

■

144 1.Bf5+ Forking the king and rook. 1...Kg7 2.Bxe4 White is up a rook in the endgame and should win without much trouble

though rounding up the e-pawn should be a priority. Bishop Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Bishop Fork 3 2021.

■

145 1...Bxb2 Forking the rook and knight. 2.Rb1 White saves the more valuable piece. 2...Bxc3 Black is up a bishop and should win the game. Bishop Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Bishop Fork 4 2021.

■

146 1.Be5+ Forking the king and rook. 1...f6 2.Bxb2 White is up a rook and should win the endgame comfortably. Bishop Fork 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Bishop Fork 5 2021.

■

147 1.Ka2 Forking the knight and bishop. 1...Bd6 1...Nd4 still loses a minor piece. 2.Kxa3. 2.Kxb3 The game ends in a draw. If White had not found the king fork, Black could have performed the bishop and knight checkmate. King Fork 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: King Fork 1 (G 2021.

■

148 1.Kb6 Forking the knight and pawn. 1...Nc4+ 2.Kxa6 White eliminates the pawn and secures a draw! King Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: King Fork 2 (G 2021.

■

149 1.Ke5 Forking the pawn and bishop. 1...Bd3 2.Kxf4 The game should end in a draw as Black can always sacrifice the bishop for the remaining pawn. King Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: King Fork 3 2021.

■

-

150 1.Kg3 Forking the rook and knight. 1...Rf6 Saving the more valuable piece. 2.Kxh2 White is up a rook for only a pawn and should go on to win the game from here. King Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: King Fork 4 2021.

■

151 1.Kg2 Forking the knight and bishop. 1...Bc5 2.Kxh1 White is up the exchange and should try to win for a bit, but this is theoretically a drawn position. King Fork 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: King Fork 5 2021.

■

152 1.e3 Forking the rooks. 1...Rb4 2.exf4 After black recaptures the pawn on f4, White has two minor pieces and a pawn for a rook and should go on to win the game from here. Pawn Fork 1-?, xxx 2021.

■

153 1...f4 Forking the queen and knight. 2.Qe2 fxd3 Black is a knight up and should win the game from here. Pawn Fork 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Pawn Fork 2 (G 2021.

■

154 1.e5 Forking the queen and knight. 1...Qe7 1...Nxe5 is worse since it still allows the fork. Black would lose two pieces this way after 2.fxe5 2.exf6 White is up a minor piece and should win the game from here. Pawn Fork 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Pawn Fork 3 2021.

■

155 1.e5 Forking the bishop and knight. 1...Nd7 1...Be7 2.exf6 Bxf6 should Black prefer to keep the bishop, but in either case



White is up a minor piece.. 2.exd6 White is a knight up and should win the game. Pawn Fork 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Pawn Fork 4 2021.

■

156 1.f4 Forking the knights. 1...Nef7 1...Ngf7 is also possible: 2.fxe5 Nxe5 and the position is similar to the main variation. 2.fxg5 Once Black recovers the pawn, White will have two pawns against the knight. The game should end in a draw, but only White could realistically win (by promotion). Pawn Fork 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Forks: Pawn Fork 5 2021.

## Pins

■

157 1...Bg6 Pinning the rook to the king. 2.Kc1 Bxe4 Black wins a rook and should go on to win the game (by promoting the pawn).

■

158 1.Rd1 Pinning the bishop and king on the d-file. 1...Ke7 2.Rxd4 White is up a rook for a pawn and should go on to win the endgame. Pin 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 2 (Guided) 2021.

■

159 1.Re1 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Qxe1+ 2.Kxe1 White is up two pawns and should go on to win the game. Pin 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 3 (Guided) 2021.

■

160 1.Qa4 Pinning the rook to the king. 1...Ke7 2.Qxb5 White is up a queen and should go on to win without much trouble. Pin 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 4 (Guided) 2021.

■

161 1.Bxc6 Pinning the queen to the king. Notice the queen on g6 is protecting the bishop. 1...Qxc6 2.Qxc6+ White is up material, and has a much safer king. Pin 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 5 (Guided) 2021.

■

162 1.Bf5 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Kb8 1...Qxf5 2.Qxf5+ also loses a queen for a bishop. 2.Bxd7 After Black recaptures, White will be up a queen for a knight and should go on to win. Pin 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 6 2021.

■

163 1...Bg4 Pinning the queen to the king. Notice that the knight protects the bishop. 2.Qxg4 Nxg4 Black is up a queen for a bishop and should go on to win. Pin 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 7 2021.

■

164 1.Bb3 Pinning the queen and king on the diagonal. 1...Qf7 1...Qxb3 2.Qxb3+ doesn't change much. 2.Bxf7+ White has won a queen for a bishop and should go on to win the game without much resistance. Pin 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 8 2021.

■

165 1.Rg3 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Qxg3 Black wants to get the most for the lost queen. 2.hxg3 White is up a queen for a rook and has the safer king. White should go on to win. Pin 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 9 2021.

■

166 1.Re3 Pinning the queen and king along the e-file. 1...Qxe3+ Getting the maximum for the lost queen. 2.Qxe3+ White is up a queen for a rook and has a much safer king. White should go on to win. Pin 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 10 2021.

■

167 1.Rd8 Pinning the queen to the king. Notice how the bishop on b6 supports the rook. 1...Qxd8 Getting the most for the lost queen. 2.Bxd8 White is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Pin 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 11 2021.

■

168 1.Rf1 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Qxf1+ Getting the most for the lost queen. 2.Kxf1 White is up a queen for a rook and should win the game. Pin 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 12 2021.

■

169 1...Bd4 Pinning the queen to the king. 2.Qxd4 cxd4 Black has won a queen for only a bishop and should go on to win without too much trouble. Pin 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 13 2021.

■

170 1.Rd8 Pinning the queen to the king. Notice the queen on h4 supports this move. 1...Qxd8 2.Qxd8+ White is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Pin 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 14 2021.

■

171 1...Bb4 Pinning the queen to the king. 2.Bd2 Bxc3 Winning the queen for a minor piece. Black should go on to win. Pin 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 15 2021.

■

172 1...Bg5 Pinning the queen to the king. 2.Qxg5 Qxg5+ A very important recapture since the queen was being attacked by the rook. Black has won a queen for a minor piece and should win the game without any problems. 2...hxg5 would not be good! 3.Rxe5 and White recovers the queen and some! Pin 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 16 2021.

■

173 1.Rg1 Pinning the bishop to the king. 1...Kf6 2.Rxg4 White is up a knight in the endgame and should win without much resistance. Pin 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 17 2021.

■

174 1.Bb5 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Qxb5 2.Qxb5+ White won a queen for a minor piece and should go on to win. Pin 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 18 2021.

■

175 1.Rf3 Pinning the queen to the king. 1...Ke7 2.Rxf6 After Black recaptures the rook, White will have a queen and two pawns for two rooks. White would have a small material advantage but a bigger advantage with the safer king. Pin 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 19 2021.

■

176 1...Bc5 Pinning the queen to the king. 2.Qxc5 Nxc5 Black is up a queen for a minor piece and should win without too much trouble. Pin 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pin 20 2021.

■  
177 1.Bh6 Attacking the pinned bishop on f8.

■  
178 1...Bf3 Attacking the pinned bishop on d1. Attacking Pin 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■  
179 1.f4 Attacking the pinned piece. Notice that White attacked the pinned piece with the weakest piece possible. Now White will win the knight for only a pawn. 1.Bf4 is not as good since Black can defend the knight and 'break the pin' with 1...Qe7 and avoids losing material. 1.Nf3 is similar to 1.Bf4 in that Black can defend the knight and 'break the pin' with 1...Qe7 and avoids losing material. Attacking Pin 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 20

■  
180 1...Re8 Attacking the pinned knight on e5. Now Black has two attackers and White only has one defender. Black will win the knight and should go on to win the game. Attacking Pin 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■  
181 1.d5 Attacking the pinned knight on c6. 1...0 0 2.dxc6 White wins a knight and should go on to win the game. Attacking Pin 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■  
182 1...g3 Attacking the pinned knight on h2 and is now threatening the unstoppable 2...Rxh2#. Attacking Pin 6-?,

## Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■

183 1.Rdg1 Creating a battery and winning the bishop on g7.

■

184 1.Bh6 Attacking the pinned bishop on g7, with no way to defend, Qxg7# is coming! Attacking Pin 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■

185 1...Ne4 Attacking the pinned knight and forking the queen and knight! Attacking Pin 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■

186 1...g5 Attacking the pinned bishop. actics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■

187 1.c4 Attacking the pinned rook. White will win the rook for only a pawn and should go on to win with the extra rook. Attacking Pin 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Attacking the P 2021.

■

188 1.Qxg6# The pawn on f7 is in a pin by the bishop on b4. It's checkmate since the bishop on b2 controls the a1-h8 diagonal. Pin Protection 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

189 1...Qg2# The pawn on h3 supports the checkmate while the rook on f4 pins the bishop on f3 and prevents it from capturing the queen. Pin Protection 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

190 1.Qxf6 Winning a bishop due to the pin on the g-file. A minor piece up, and a big attack on Black's king, White should go on to win. Pin Protection 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

191 1.Qxg6+ Taking advantage of the pinned f7-pawn. White wins the knight and has a big attack on the black king. Pin Protection 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

192 1...Rxa3 Using the pin against the b2-pawn. Pin Protection 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

193 1.Qxa6# Using the pin against the b7-pawn for checkmate. Pin Protection 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

194 1.Rh5# Using the pin against the g6-pawn for checkmate. Notice that the bishop on d4 controls the important a1-h8 diagonal. Pin Protection 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

195 1.Rb8# Using the pin against the knight on d7 for checkmate while the bishop on f4 helps the rook. Pin Protection 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

196 1...Rf1# The rook on e5 pins the bishop on e2, while the pawn on g2 supports the rook checkmate. Pin Protection 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

197 1.Nxg6 Winning a knight using the pin against the h7-pawn. Pin Protection 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Pins: Pinned Pieces D 2021.

■

198 1.Qxd4 Winning a rook using the pin against the e-pawn.

## Skewer

■

199 1...Ra2+ Skewering the king and rook on the 2nd rank. 2.Kd3 Rxh2 Black wins the rook and should go on to win the game using the rook and king checkmate. Skewer 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 1 (Gui 2021.

■

200 1.Re1+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Kf3 2.Rxe8 White is up a rook and should win. Skewer 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 2 (Gui 2021.

■



201 1.Qh8+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Ke7 2.Qxa8 White is up a knight and should go on to win. Skewer 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 3 (Gui 2021.

■

202 1.Bf4+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Ke6 2.Bxb8 White is up a bishop in the endgame and should win without much trouble. Skewer 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 4 (Gui 2021.

■

203 1...Bf5 Skewering the queen and rook. 2.Qe2 Bxb1 Black wins a rook and should go on to win the game. Skewer 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 5 (Gui 2021.

■

204 1.Rg5+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Kxf4 2.Rxa5 White wins a rook and should go on to win the game. Skewer 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 6 2021.

■

205 1...Qa1+ 2.Kf2 Skewering the king and rook. 2.Rd1 does not help much since 2...Qxd1+ wins both rooks: 3.Kf2 Qxh1. 2...Qxh1 Black is up three pawns and has a much safer king. Black should go on to win. Skewer 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 7 2021.

■

206 1.Qh6+ Skewering the king and queen. 1...Kg4 2.Qxh1 White wins the queen and should win the game. Skewer 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 8 2021.

■

-

207 1...Qc2+ Skewering the king and queen. 2.Kf4 Qxg6 Black wins the queen and should go on to win this endgame quite easily.

■

208 1...Qf5+ Skewering the king and queen. 2.Kd4 Qxb5 Black has won a queen and conveniently stops promotion. Skewer 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 10 2021.

■

209 1...Rd1+ Skewering the king and rook. 2.Ke3 Rxd6 Black wins the rook and is up 2 minor pieces in the endgame. Skewer 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 11 2021.

■

210 1.Rh8+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Kg6 2.Rxh3 White wins the rook and should go on to win the endgame. Skewer 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 12 2021.

■

211 1...Be4+ Skewering the king and bishop. 2.Kc5 Bxb7 Black is up a bishop for a pawn and should go on to win. Skewer 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 13 2021.

■

212 1.Bd4+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Kf5 2.Bxg7 White is up a large amount of material and should win. Skewer 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 14 2021.

■

213 1...Be6 Skewering the queen and bishop. 2.Qd2 Bxa2 Black wins a bishop and should go on to win the game. Skewer 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 15 2021.

■

214 1...Bh2+ Skewering the king and rook. 2.Ke3 2.g3 doesn't change much and gives away an additional pawn: 2...Bxg3+ 3.Ke3 Bxd6. 2...Bxd6 Black is up a rook and should go on to win the game. Skewer 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 16 2021.

■

215 1...Rxc1+ Skewering the king and rook. 2.Kd2 Rxh1 Black is up quite a bit of material and should go on to win. Skewer 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 17 2021.

■

216 1...Rb6+ Skewering the king and rook. 2.Kc7 Rxd6 Black has won a rook and along with it should win the game. Skewer 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 18 2021.

■

217 1...Qe1+ Skewering the king and queen. 2.Kd6 Qxe8 Black is up a queen for a bishop and should win the endgame without too much trouble. Skewer 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 19 2021.

■

218 1.Qb2+ Skewering the king and queen. 1...Kxd3 2.Qxf6 White is up a queen for a bishop and pawn and should win the game without many issues. Skewer 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Skewer: Skewer 20 2021.

## Discovered Attack

■  
219 1.f5+ Putting the king in check and unleashing the bishop on c7. 1...Kxf5 2.Bxg3 White wins a bishop and should win this endgame, although he has to be careful not to trade off the last pawn. Discovery 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■  
220 1...Nf2+ Checking the king and uncovering an attack on the queen. 2.Ke1 Qxd5 Black is up a significant amount of material and should go on to win. Discovery 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■  
221 1...Nxd5 Trading knights but also attacking the knight by a discovery on h4. 2.Bxd5 2.Nf3 Nf6 and Black has still won a minor piece. 2...Bxh4 Black has won a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Discovery 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■  
222 1...Ng4+ Checking the king and unleashing the rook battery. 2.Kg2 Rxe1 White wins a rook and should win the game. Discovery 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■  
223 1.Ng6+ Sacrificing the knight to win the queen. 1...hxg6 2.Qxd6 White is up a queen for a bishop and should go on to

win the game. Discovery 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

224 1...Bxf2+ Sacrificing the bishop to win the queen by discovery. 2.Rxf2 Qxe5 Black has a queen and pawn for a rook and should win the game. Discovery 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

225 1...Bxh2+ Sacrificing the bishop with check to open up a discovered attack on the queen. 2.Kxh2 Qxd5 Discovery 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

226 1.Bxb5+ Sacrificing the bishop to win the queen by discovery. 1...axb5 2.Qxc3 White is up a lot of material and should go on to win. Discovery 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

227 1...Bxg5 Capturing the knight and unleashing a discovered attack on the queen. Black has won a piece and should go on to win the game. Discovery 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

228 1...Rxxg2+ Sacrificing the rook to open a discovered attack on the queen. 2.Kxxg2 Qxxh4 Black is up material and should win the game. Discovery 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

-

229 1.Bc7 Attacking the rook on a5 and unleashing a discovered attack on the c7- knight. 1...Ra7 2.Rxd7+ Winning the knight and conveniently protecting the bishop. Discovery 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

230 1...Qe3+ Checking the king and revealing a discovered attack on the queen. 2.Kh1 Rxg4 Black is up material and should go on to win. Discovery 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

231 1.Qxc4+ Checking the king while unleashing a discovered attack on the queen. 1...Kh8 2.Rxd8 White is up material and should go on to win. Discovery 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

232 1.Qc3+ Checking the king while discovering the queen. 1...Kg8 2.Rxd8 Discovery 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

233 1.Qb3+ Checking the king and discovering the queen. 1...Kg6 2.Rxe5 White is up material with a much safer king and should go on to win. Discovery 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

234 1...Kd7+ Attacking the rook and revealing a discovered attack on the king. 2.Kh3 Kxc6 After winning the rook, Black is

up a bishop and should win the game. Discovery 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

235 1...Nf3+ Checking the king and unleashing a discovered attack on the queen. 2.gxf3 2.Qxf3 Bxf3 doesn't change much. 2...Rxe3 Black is up material and should go on to win the game. Discovery 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

236 1...Bxh2+ Sacrificing the bishop for a pawn to win the rook on d5 by discovery. 2.Kxh2 Qxd5 Black has won the exchange and should win the game. Discovery 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

237 1.Na6+ Checking the king and revealing a discovered attack on the queen. 1...Kc8 2.Qxe7 White will be up a large amount of material and should win. Discovery 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

238 1.Rf5 Attacking the queen and unleashing a discovered attack on the b8- rook. 1...Qg6 2.Qxb8+ White wins a rook and should go on to win the game. Discovery 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

**Discovered Check and Double Check**

■

239 1...Rc5+ The bishop issues a discovered check, while the rook rounds up the queen. 2.Ke1 Rxa5 Black is up a rook and bishop and should win the endgame without trouble. Discovered Check 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

240 1.Bf5+ By moving the bishop to f5, White checks the king and attacks the rook on c2. 1...Kf8 2.Bxc2 White wins a rook and should win the game. Discovered Check 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

241 1...Re4+ Using the bishop for a discovered check, while the rook blocks the attack on the bishop and counterattacks the rook. 2.Kc6 Black wins the rook and is up a large amount of material. Black should win the game without much trouble. 2...Rxe5 Discovered Check 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

242 1...Bd6+ Blocking the check, with a check! 2.Kg1 Bxc5+ Black wins the bishop and soon more. Black should go on to win from here. Discovered Check 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

243 1...Kg4# A rare situation where moving the king causes checkmate! Discovered Check 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■



244 1...Re5+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to the maximum. White is in check and the rook on c5 is hanging. 2.Kf4 Rxc5 Wins the rook. The game remains complicated but Black will soon capture the kingside pawns as well. Discovered Check 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

245 1.Nf6+ The queen gives a discovered check to the king, while the knight attacks the rook. 1...Kc8 2.Nxe8 White is up a knight and should go on to win. Discovered Check 7-?, xxx 2021.

■

246 1...exd5+ The queen now gives a discovered check, while the bishop on c4 is hanging to the pawn. 2.Be3 Other moves are possible, but all of them lose the bishop. 2...dxc4 Black has won a piece and has a winning position. Black should now make developing and castling a priority. Discovered Check 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

247 1.e5+ Issuing a check to the king and an attack on the queen. 1...Kg8 1...Qg6 doesn't help since the pawn on h5 can capture the queen: 2.hxg6+. 2.exf6 White wins the queen for nothing and should go on to win the game without trouble. Discovered Check 9-?, xxx 2021.

■

248 1...Nxe4+ The bishop on b6 gives a discovered check to the king while the knight attacks the queen. 2.Kh1 Nxd2 Black wins the queen for a knight and should go on to win from here. Discovered Check 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

249 1...fxe4+ Discovered check from the rook and attacking the queen on d3. 2.Kg1 exd3 Black is up material and should go on to win from here. Discovered Check 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

250 1...Rf2+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win the rook on f1. 2.Kc1 Rxf1+ Black has two rooks, a bishop, and two pawns for the queen. Black should go on to win the game from here. Discovered Check 12-?, xxx 2021.

■

251 1.Nd5+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win the queen. 1...Kg8 2.Nxe7+ White is up a queen with a big attack on Black's king. White should win from here. Discovered Check 13-?, xxx 2021.

■

252 1...Rh3+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win the rook on h4. 2.Ke2 Rxh4 Black is up a minor piece for a pawn and should win. Black should make capturing White's f- and e-pawns a priority. Discovered Check 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

253 1.Rxh7+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win the rook on h8. 1...Kd8 2.Rxh8+ White wins a rook and soon more. White should win from here. Discovered Check 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

254 1.c5+ Using the discovered check from the queen to win a bishop. 1...Kh8 2.cxd6 White has won a minor piece and should go on to win the game from here. Discovered Check 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

255 1.Rd7+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win a rook. 1...Nxc4 The best move, capturing the checking piece. 2.Rxd8+ White has two rooks and a pawn for three pieces. White is winning although the game is still complicated. Discovered Check 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

256 1...Nb2+ Using the discovered check from the bishop to win the queen. 1...Nxe3+ is not effective since the king can capture the knight while getting out of check with 2.Kxe3. 2.Nxa6 Nxd1 Black is up material and has a much safer king. Black should go on to win from here. Discovered Check 18-?, xxx 2021.

■

257 1.Nxf7+ Using the discovered check from the queen to win the rook in the corner. 1...Kc7 2.Nxh8 White wins a rook and should win the game. Even if Black wins the knight in the corner, White would still be up the exchange. Discovered Check 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■

258 1...Nc3+ Launching a discovered check while attacking the queen. 2.Be2 2.Qe2 doesn't help since the knight covers that square too: 2...Nxe2. 2...Nxd1 Black is up a significant amount of material and should win. Discovered CheDiscovered Check 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Di 2021.

■  
259 1.Nc6# Double Check 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Double Check: Double 2021.

■  
260 1...Bb4# Double Check 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Do 2021.

■  
261 1...Bxc3# Double Check 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Double Check: Double 2021.

■  
262 1.Nf5# Double check and checkmate. Double Check 4-?,

■  
263 1...Bh4# The rooks cover the e- and d-files while the bishop attacks along the diagonal. Double Check 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Discovered Attack: Do 2021.

## Removing the Guard

■  
264 1.Rxe6+ Removing the guard of the rook. 1...fxe6 2.Kxh3 White is up a rook and should win the endgame. RTG 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

265 1.Bxh6 Removing the guard of the checkmate on f7. Black can stop checkmate, but has lost a minor piece. RTG 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

266 1...Bxe3 Removing the guard of the knight on g5. 2.fxe3 Qxg5 Black wins a knight and should go on to win the game. RTG 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

267 1...Bxd4 Removing the guard of the bishop on b5. 2.Qxd4 Qxb5 Black has won a minor piece and should win the game. RTG 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

268 1...Bxf3 Removing the guard of the checkmate on h2. White may stop the checkmate with 2.g3 but Black has won a piece. RTG 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

269 1...Rxf1+ Removing the guard of the checkmate on h2. 2.Rxf1 Qh2# RTG 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

270 1...Nxc3 Removing the guard of the knight on c7. 2.hxc3 Kxc7 Black is up a minor piece and should win the game. RTG 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

271 1...Bxf3 Removing the guard of the bishop on d4. 2.Qxf3 Qxd4 Black has won a minor piece and should win the game

from here. RTG 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

272 1...Rxf2+ Removing the guard of the rook on e4. 2.Kxf2 Kxe4 Black is up a bishop and should win the endgame. RTG 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

273 1.Bxc6+ Removing the guard of the checkmate on d8. 1...bxc6 1...Bd7 does not change much since 2.Qxd7# ends the game too. 2.Qd8# RTG 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

274 1.Nxf6+ Removing the guard of the rook on d7. 1...Bxf6 2.Rxd7 White is now up a rook and should win without much trouble. RTG 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

275 1...Bxf3 Removing the guard of the bishop on g5. 2.Bxf3 2.Bxf6 doesn't help much since Black can play ...Bxe2 and then recapture on f6, maintaining the piece advantage. 2...Qxg5 Black has won a minor piece and should go on to win the game. RTG 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

276 1.Bxf6 Removing the guard of the bishop on g4. 1...Bxf6 2.Qxg4 White has won a bishop and should go on to win the game. RTG 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
277 1.Nxd6 Removing the guard of the knight on b4. 1...cxd6 1.Qxb4 White is up a bishop and should go on to win. RTG 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
278 1.Rxd6 Removing the guard of the pawn promotion. 1...Rxd6 2.c8Q White queens the pawn and should go on to win. RTG 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
279 1.Rxf6+ Removing the guard of the queen with check. 1...gxf6 2.Qxh5 White is up material with a much safer king and should go on to win the game. RTG 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
280 1.Nxf6+ Removing the guard of the bishop on g4 with a check. 1...exf6 2.Qxg4 White wins a minor piece and should go on to win. RTG 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
281 1.Bxc6+ Removing the guard of the queen with check. 1...bxc6 2.Qxd4 White wins the queen for nothing and should go on to win without many problems. RTG 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■  
282 1...Nxe3 Removing the guard of the knight on g5. 2.fxe3 Qxg5 Black wins a minor piece and should win the game. RTG

## 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

■

283 1...Qxe4 Trading queens and removing the guard of the bishop on e5. 2.fxe4 Nxe5 Black wins a minor piece and should go on to win the game. RTG 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Removing the Guard/De 2021.

## **In-Between Move**

■

284 1...Be3+ Saving the bishop with check. 2.Kf1 bxa5 Black used an intermediate move to save the bishop and then recaptured the knight on a5, winning a piece. In-Between 1-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

285 1...Qxe3+ Saving the queen with check and is then ready to capture the rook on a1. 2.Kh1 Bxa1 After saving the queen with the in-between check, Black was able to capture the rook on a1. In-Between 2-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

286 1.Nd5 Saving the knight and attacking the queen. 1...Qd8 1...Bxe2 does not work since White captures Black's queen with check: 2.Nxf6+ gxf6 3.Qxe2. 2.Bxg4 White was able to save the knight using an in-between move, and then won the bishop on g4. In-Between 3-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■



287 1.Ne5 White's bishop on b5 is attacked by the pawn on a6. Instead of moving the bishop, White forks the queen and knight, while attacking the pinned piece. White now wins material and should go on to win the game. In-Between 4-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

288 1.Nxf6+ Saving the knight by trading with check. 1...Rxf6 2.Rxe1 White recaptures the queen and is up a piece. In-Between 5-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

289 1...Rb4+ Saving the rook on a4 with check. 2.Ka3 Rxf1 By saving the rook first, Black goes up two exchanges and should go on to win. In-Between 6-?, xxx 2021.

■

290 1.Qa8+ First saving the queen with a check. 1.Bxb1 Bxa3 is just a queen trade. 1...Kg7 2.Bxb1 By playing the in-between move 1.Qa8+, White was able to win Black's queen. In-Between 7-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

291 1...Rxd1+ First capturing the rook with check and then recapturing the queen. 2.Kf2 axb6 Black is up a rook and should win the endgame. In-Between 8-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

292 1...Qd6+ Saving the queen with a check. 1...Rxe2 2.Nxc5 is just a trade of queens. 2.Kg1 Rxe2 By playing the in-between move 1...Qd6+, Black was able to save the queen while still

winning White's. In-Between 9-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

293 1...Rb5+ Saving the rook on b2 from capture. 1...Rxd6 2.Rxb2 is just a rook trade. 2.Kh4 Rxd6 By playing 1...Rb5+, Black was able to save the rook on b2 and then capture White's on d6, winning a whole rook. Black should go on to win. In-Between 10-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

294 1.Nxf6+ Trading knights first to avoid the loss of the knight, then recapturing the queen. 1.Rxc2 Bxe4 keeps everything even. 1...gxf6 2.Rxc2 White is up a minor piece and should go on to win. In-Between 11-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

295 1...Rh4+ Saving the rook from capture using a check. 1...Bxc2 2.Bxd4 is just a trade. 2.Kg3 Bxc2 Black has won the exchange and should go on to win the game. In-Between 12-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

296 1...Rg8+ First getting out of the pin on the e-file. 1...exd5 2.Rxe8 is just a trade. 2.Kh3 exd5 Black emerges a rook up and should win the game. In-Between 13-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

297 1...gxf2+ Capturing the bishop with a check, and then recapturing the rook on h8. 1.Qxf2 Bxh8 The in-between move 2...gxf2+ won an extra bishop. Black is up a piece and should

win the game from here. In-Between 14-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

298 1...Rxe2+ Capturing the knight with check and then capturing the rook on d7. 1...Nxd7 2.Kxe3 is just a trade. 2.Kxe2 Nxd7 Black is up a knight and should win the game. In-Between 15-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

299 1.Nxe7+ Saving the knight by trading with check first. 1...Rxe7 2.Rxe1 White is up a piece and is now skewering the rooks, White is winning. In-Between 16-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

300 1.Bxe7 Trading bishops first with plans to capture the knight next. 1.dxe4 Bxg5 is simply a trade of pieces.. 1...Qxe7 2.dxe4 White has won a piece and should win the game. In-Between 17-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

301 1.Rg1+ Getting the rook out of the pin so that White can safely capture the bishop on d5. 1...Kf7 2.Nxd5 White wins a minor piece and should go on to win from here. In-Between 18-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

302 1.Bg3 Saving the bishop with an attack on the queen, then planning to capture the bishop on f1. 1...Qh3 2.Rxf1 White has won a bishop and should win the game. In-Between 19-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

■

303 1...Rb4+ Checking the king away first and eliminating the stalemate trap. 1...Bxh5 looks good until you realize it's stalemate! That's the trick. 1.Kg3 Bxh5 Black is up a bishop and a rook and should go on to win the game. In-Between 20-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: In-Between Move 2021.

## Decoy

■

304 1.Rh8+ Distracting the king away from the queen. 1...Kxh8 2.Qxh6+ White is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win the game. Decoy 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 1 2021.

■

305 1...h5+ Distracting the king away from the defense of the king. 2.Kxh5 Qxf3+ Black is up a queen and should go on to win the game. Decoy 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 2 2021.

■

306 1.Bf7+ Distracting the king away from the queen. 1...Kxf7 2.Qxd8 White has won a queen for a bishop and should go on to win. Decoy 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 3 2021.

■

307 1.Bg6+ A skewer-distraction tactic. Black must take the bishop to avoid losing the rook for nothing. 1...Kxg6 2.Qxe8+ White wins the exchange and should go on to win the game. Decoy 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 4 2021.

■  
308 1.Rd8+ Forcing the rook to capture, distracting it from its defense of the queen. 1...Rxd8 2.Qxc5 White has a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Decoy 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 5 2021.

■  
309 1.Bh7+ Distracting the king away from the rook on f8. 1...Kxh7 2.Qxf8 White wins the exchange and should go on to win the game. Decoy 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 6 2021.

■  
310 1.Bxh7+ Distracting the king away from the rook on f8. 1...Kxh7 2.Qxf8 White wins the exchange and should go on to win the game. Decoy 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 7 2021.

■  
311 1...Ra1+ White is forced to capture the rook which allows Black a checkmate on c2. 2.Qxa1 Qc2# Black used the rook as a distraction for checkmate. Decoy 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 8 2021.

■  
312 1...Rg1+ Distracting the king away from the defense of the queen. 2.Kxg1 Qxf3 Black has a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Decoy 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 9 2021.

■

■  
313 1.Bxh7+ Distracting the king away from the defense of the queen. 1...Kxh7 2.Qxf7 White is up a queen for a knight and should go on to win the game. Decoy 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 10 2021.

■  
314 1.Rg8+ Another skewer-distraction tactic. Black is forced to capture the rook or else lose the queen for free, but then leaves the queen unprotected. 1...Kxg8 2.Qxe8+ White has a queen and two pawns for two rooks. It will not be easy, but White should go on to win. Decoy 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 11 2021.

■  
315 1...Bh3+ Distracting the king away from the defense of the queen. 2.Kxh3 Qxf3 Black has a queen and bishop for two rooks and should go on to win. Decoy 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 12 2021.

■  
316 1.Rd8+ Forcing the rook to capture which leaves the queen on f7 unprotected. 1...Rxd8 2.Qxf7 White is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Decoy 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 13 2021. Decoy 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 13 2021.

■  
317 1.Bg7+ Distracting the king away from the protection of the rook. 1...Kxg7 2.Rxe8 White has won the exchange and should go on to win the game. Decoy 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 14 2021.

■

318 1...Ra4 Offering the rook to promote the pawn on c2. It's also a pin, so White does not have many options here. 2.Rxa4 c1Q+ Black promotes and has a queen and pawn for a rook. Black should win this endgame without much difficulty. Decoy 15-?, xxx 2021.

■

319 1...Bg2+ Distracting the king away from the defense of the queen. 2.Kxg2 Qxe1 Black wins a queen for a minor piece and should win the game. Decoy 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 16 2021.

■

320 1.Rf8+ Forcing the rook to capture, removing it from the defense of the queen. 1...Rxf8 2.Qxe5 White has a queen for a rook and should go on to win. Decoy 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 17 2021.

■

321 1...Bxf3+ Another skewer-distraction tactic. White must take to avoid losing the queen for free, but in either case loses material. 2.Kxf3 Qxd1+ Black has a large material advantage and should go on to win. Decoy 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 18 2021.

■

322 1.Bxf7+ Distracting the king away from the queen. 1...Kxf7 2.Qxd8 White has a big material advantage and should go on to win. Decoy 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 19 2021.

■

323 1...Rf1+ Distracting the knight from the defense of the f3-square. 2.Nxf1 2.Kg2 was also possible but ends in checkmate

as well: 2...Rg1#. 2...Bf3# Always nice to end with checkmate! Decoy 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Decoy: Distraction 20 2021.

## Overloaded

■

324 1.Rxd8+ The queen cannot capture the rook and keep the guard of the rook on c6. The queen was overloaded. 1...Qxd8 2.Qxc6 White is up a rook and should win from here. Overloaded 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

325 1...Bxb2 Taking advantage of the overloaded queen. 2.Qxb2 Qxe4 Black wins a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Overloaded 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

326 1.Bxf4 The queen cannot both guard the bishop on c5 and recapture on f4. The queen is overloaded. 1...Qxf4 2.Nxc5 White wins a minor piece and should win the game. Overloaded 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: O

■

327 1.Rxd8+ Taking advantage of the overloaded knight on f7. 1...Nxd8 2.Nxd6 White is up a bishop and should go on to win the endgame. Overloaded 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■



328 1...Rxb2 Picking on the overloaded queen. 2.Qxb2 Qxa5 Black is up a knight and should go on to win the game. Overloaded 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

329 1...Qxf3+ Taking advantage of the overloaded king. 2.Kxf3 Rxf1 Black is up a bishop and should go on to win without much trouble. Overloaded 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

330 1...Qxg3 Taking advantage of the overloaded f2-pawn. 2.fxg3 Bxe3 Black wins a minor piece and should go on to win. Overloaded 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

331 1.Rxb3 Picking on the overloaded b8- rook. 1...Rxb3 2.Qxe8+ White is up three pawns and should go on to win the endgame. Overloaded 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

332 1.Rxf4 Taking advantage of the overloaded queen. Overloaded 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

333 1...Bxe3 Taking advantage of the overloaded f2-pawn. 2.fxe3 Qxg3+ Black is up two pawns and has an attack on White's king and should go on to win. Overloaded 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

334 1.Nxe5 Taking advantage of the overloaded bishop. 1.Bxh6 is not effective since Black could play 1...Nxf3+ 2.Qxf3 Bxh6, saving the piece. 1...Bxe5 2.Bxh6 White has won a minor piece and should go on to win. Overloaded 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

335 1...Rxe3 Taking advantage of the overloaded king. 2.Kxe3 Rxe5+ Black wins a knight and should win the game although Black should avoid trading the last pawn off. Overloaded 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

336 1.Qxa4 Taking advantage of the back rank weakness which wins at least a rook. 1...Rxa4 Black does not have to take but in either case is at a huge disadvantage: after 1...Re8 White is up a queen for a bishop. 2.Rc8# Overloaded 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

337 1.Rxf5 Taking advantage of the overloaded e6-pawn. 1...exf5+ 2.Kxd5 White is up a bishop in the endgame and should go on to win. Overloaded 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

338 1.Rxb8 Picking on the overloaded e8-rook. 1...Rxb8 2.Kxe3 White is only up a pawn but will win the pawn on c7 shortly. White has a winning advantage. Overloaded 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

339 1.Qxa5 Taking advantage of the overloaded knight on c6. 1...Nxa5 2.Nxe7 White is up two pawns and has threats. Though the situation is complicated, White should go on to win the game from here. Overloaded 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

340 1.Rxd8+ Taking advantage of the overloaded bishop. 1...Bxd8 2.Bxe5 White is up a minor piece and should win the game. Overloaded 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

341 1.Rxg4+ Taking advantage of the overloaded knight on f6. 1...Nxg4 2.Kxe4 White is up a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Overloaded 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

342 1.Rxe8+ Taking advantage of the overloaded rook on d8. 1...Rxe8 2.Rxd6 White wins a knight and with it should win the game. Overloaded 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

■

343 1.Qxf6 Taking advantage of the overloaded g7 pawn. 1...gxf6 2.Bxh6 White wins a minor piece and should win the game. Overloaded 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Overloaded Piece: Ove 2021.

**X-Ray**

■  
344 1...Be7# The bishop X-rays through the king to defend the rook! X-Ray 1-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
345 1.Rxe7 The queen defends the rook through an X-ray of the queen on d6. X-Ray 2-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
346 1...Qb8# X-ray protecting the rook through the king. X-Ray 3-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
347 1...Qxe1+ The rook on e7 X-ray protects the queen on e1. 2.Rxe1 Rxe1# Back rank checkmate. X-Ray 4-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
348 1...Rxc4 The queen and rook X-ray protect each other through White's queen. 2.Qxc4 Rxc4 Black is up a knight and should go on to win. X-Ray 5-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
349 1.Rxf8+ The rook on f1 X-ray protects the rook on f8. 1...Rxf8 2.Rxf8# Back rank checkmate. X-Ray 6-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

350 1.Bxe5# X-ray defending the rook on c7 and creating a checkmate! X-Ray 7-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

351 1...Rxc1 The queen and rook defend each other by X-ray through the white queen. 2.Qxc6 Rxc6 Black is up the exchange and should go on to win the game. X-Ray 8-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

352 1.Rxa6 The queen X-ray defends the rook. X-Ray 9-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

353 1.Bxf6 The bishop and queen X-ray protect each other through Black's queen on g7. 1...Qxh8 2.Bxh8 White wins a rook and should go on to win the game. X-Ray 10-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

354 1...Qxc2 Using the rook on c8 for an X-ray defense. 2.Rxc2 Rxc2 Black is now up a significant amount of material and should go on to win. X-Ray 11-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

355 1.Bg5# X-ray defending the rook and causing checkmate! X-Ray 12-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

■  
356 1.Qxb7+ Using the X-ray defense from the rook on b2. 1...Qxb7 2.Rxb7+ White is up a minor piece and should go on to win the game. X-Ray 13-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
357 1.Qxf8+ Using the X-ray protection from the rook on a8. 1...Rxf8 2.Rxf8# Back rank checkmate! X-Ray 14-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attac X-Ray 15-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
358 1.Rxd7 Winning the bishop using the x-ray of the d1-rook. 1...Rxd7 2.Rxd7 White is up material and should go on to win.

■  
359 1...Bc3+ Forking the queen and king, using an X-ray defense. 2.Qxc3 Qxc3+ Black is up material and should win from here. X-Ray 16-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
360 1.Qxb4 Using the X-ray defense from the rook on b1. 1...Qxb4 1.Rxb4 White is up a minor piece and should win the game from here. X-Ray 17-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■  
361 1.Qb5# Defending the rook on e8 using X-ray and creating a checkmate! X-Ray 18-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

-

362 1.Qh5# Using an X-ray to defend the rook and cause checkmate. X-Ray 19-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

■

363 1.Rxb7 Using the X-ray defense from the queen on d5. 1...Qxd5 3.cxd5 White has won a minor piece and should win the game from here. X-Ray 20-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: X-Ray Attacks: 2021.

## Interference

■

364 1...Ra3 Blocking White's defense of the pawn's promotion. Interference 1-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

365 1...b5 Attacking and blocking the queen's protection of the knight on c6. 2.Qb3 Qxc6 Black wins the knight and should go on to win the game. Interference 2-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

366 1...Bb4 Blocking the queen from stopping the promotion of the pawn. 2.axb4 b1Q+ Black promotes and has a material advantage in the endgame. Interference 3-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

367 1.Nc8 Blocking the rook from stopping the pawn from promoting. Interference 4-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

368 1...e4 Attacking the bishop and blocking its protecting of the knight on d5. 2.Be2 Qxd5 Black wins the knight and should go on to win the game. Interference 5-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

369 1.Rg8 Using the pawn on h7 as support and blocking the rook from stopping the pawn from promoting. Interference 6-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

370 1.Bb8 Blocking the rook from stopping the pawn promotion. Interference 7-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

371 1...Nc3+ Blocking the rook from stopping promotion. Interference 8-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

372 1...Bh5 Blocking the rook and allowing the pawn to promote on the next turn. Interference 9-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

373 1...f4 Attacking and blocking the bishop from defending the knight on e5. Interference 10-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.



■

374 1...e4+ Using a discovered check, while blocking the queen's protection of the rook on c4. 2.Kg2 Rxc4 Black wins a rook and should go on to win the game without much difficulty. Interference 11-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

375 1...c5 Attacking and blocking the queen from protecting the knight. Interference 12-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

376 1...Bh4+ Blocking the rook's protection of the bishop. 2.Ke2 Rxh6 Black wins a minor piece and should win the game.

■

377 1...Be3+ Blocking the queen from protecting the bishop on d3. 2.Kh1 Qxd3 Black wins a piece and should win the game. Interference 14-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

378 1...Nh3+ Blocking the rook from protecting the knight on h7. Interference 15-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

379 1.d4 Blocking the bishop's pin against the f2-pawn. White is now threatening the bishop and the queen. 1...Bxd4 Nxd4 Black should save the queen but White has won a minor piece. Interference 16-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

■

-

380 1...Nd2+ Checking the king and blocking the queen's protection of the bishop on d4. 2.Ke2 Qxd4 Black wins a minor piece and should win the game. Interference 17-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

-

381 1...f4 Blocking the queen's protection of the knight on g5. Interference 18-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

-

382 1...Bd5+ Using the discovered check from the rook on c8 while blocking the rook on d2 from protecting the bishop on d6. 2.Kd1 Kxd6 Black wins a bishop and should go on to win the game. Interference 19-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

-

383 1...Rg4 Blocking the queen's protection of the checkmate on g2. 2.hxg4 2.Qxg4 may be White's best, but also loses: 2...fxg4 and White will be down a queen. 2...Qxg2# Interference 20-?, Beginner Chess Tactics: Interference: I 2021.

## Trapping Pieces

-

384 1...Rhb8 and the queen has no escape. Trapping 1-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

-

385 1.Rh1 and the queen is trapped. Trapping 2-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

386 1.e4 Surprisingly the rook is trapped! Trapping 3-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

387 1.c5 The bishop is trapped. Trapping 4-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

388 1...Be5 The bishop X-ray protects the rook in the corner, the queen is trapped. Trapping 5-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

389 1.Bg5 Using the queen and bishop battery to trap the queen. Trapping 6-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

390 1...h5 Trapping the queen. Trapping 7-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

391 1.Nh4 Trapping the queen. Trapping 8-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

392 1.Bb2 Trapping the queen. Trapping 9-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

393 1...g5 Trapping the bishop. Trapping 10-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

394 1...Bg5 Trapping the queen. Trapping 11-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

395 1.Rd3 Trapping the queen. Trapping 12-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

396 1...Na5 Trapping the queen. Trapping 13-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

397 1...Kg6 and the rook on h5 is surprisingly trapped! Trapping 14-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

398 1.Bc7 Trapping the queen. Trapping 15-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

399 1.Rh4 Trapping the queen. Trapping 16-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

400 1...Bd4 Trapping the rook in the corner. Trapping 17-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

401 1.Bb6 Trapping the queen. Trapping 18-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

402 1...c4 And the bishop is trapped on the open board! Trapping 19-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

■

403 1.Qg7 And the rook on h8 falls. Trapping 20-?, Beginner Tactics: Trapping Pieces: Trap 2021.

## Defense/Recognizing Threats

■

404 1.Nc4 Guarding against the checkmate on b2. White is up a piece and should go on to win. It was important to stop checkmate! Defense 1-?, Defence: Defense 1 (Guided) 2021.

■

405 1...Rf7 Defending against the fork and the attack on the king. Black remains a piece up and should go on to win. Defense 2-?, Defence: Defense 2 (Guided) 2021.

■

406 1.Nc3 Blocking the attack on the rook. White is up material and should go on to win. Defense 3-?, Defence: Defense 3 (Guided) 2021.

■

407 1...b5 Blocking the pin. Black is up a minor piece, but needed to prevent the loss of material with this move! Defense 4-?, Defence: Defense 4 (Guided) 2021.

■

408 1.b4 Defending against the fork. White blocks the check and guards the bishop on c5.

■

409 1.Qg3 Saving the queen on a3 and escaping check. White is up a queen and should go on to win. Defense 6-?, Defence: Defense 6 (Guided) 2021.

■

410 1...Nf6 Blocking the check and saving the knight. Defense 7-?, Defence: Defense 7 (Guided) 2021.

■

411 1...Bc6 Blocking the check, and allowing the queen to protect the hanging bishop on d4. Defense 8-?, Defence: Defense 8 (Guided) 2021.

■

412 1...Qxd6 Guarding the knight on e5 and X-ray protecting the rook on f8. Defense 9-?, Defence: Defense 9 (Guided) 2021.

■

413 1.Rg2 Blocking the check and saving the rook on f2. Defense 10-?, Defence: Defense 10 (Guided) 2021.

■

414 1...Qf6 Blocking the check and saving the queen from the rook on e3. Defense 11-?, Defence: Defense 11 (Guided) 2021.

■

415 1.Nc3 Blocking the check and saving the knight. Defense 12-?, Defence: Defense 12 2021.

■

416 1.Qc3 X-ray protecting the rook on a1 and preventing it's capture. White remains a minor piece up and should go on to win. Defense 13-?, Defence: Defense 13 2021.

■

417 1...Rd4 Using the pin on e3 to block the check. Black is up a rook and a bishop and should win the game from here. 1...Kg8 is not good since White would then have checkmate with 2.Qg7#. Defense 14-?, Defence: Defense 14 2021.

■

418 1.Bf4 Blocking the pin and saving the queen. White remains a minor piece up and should go on to win the game. Defense 15-?, Defence: Defense 15 2021.

■

419 1...Rb8 Guarding the knight on b3. It's not good to move the knight since the knight and bishop are being skewered. 1...Nc5 2.Rxa3 loses a bishop. Defense 16-?, Defence: Defense 16 2021.

■  
420 1...Re5 Protecting the knight and preventing the rook from delivering back rank checkmate. 1...Nf4 would be a bad move since it would allow a back rank checkmate. 2.Re8#.

■  
421 1...Rg8 Stopping the checkmate on g7. This is the only move that keeps Black in the game. Defense 18-?, Defence: Defense 18 2021.

■  
422 1...Bxe6 X-ray protecting the knight on c4 and allowing the queen to protect the rook on a8 by discovered defense. Defense 19-?, Defence: Defense 19 2021.

■  
423 1...Qf4+ Forcing the queens off the board which stops White's checkmate. After the queen trade, Black will be up a minor piece and will promote the passed a-pawn. Defense 20-?, Defence: Defense 20 2021.

■  
424 1...Qxd6 Saving the queen and preventing the fork on c7. Defense 21-?, Defence: Defense 21 2021.

■  
425 1.Nc3 Blocking the check, saving the knight, and protecting the bishop. Now that's a multi-purpose move! Defense 22-?, Defence: Defense 22 2021.

■



426 1.Ng2 Preventing checkmate on h2 – the only move that avoids losing the game. Defense 23-?, Defence: Defense 23 2021.

■

427 1.Qg2 Escaping check and preventing the battery checkmate on h2. Defense 24-?, Defence: Defense 24 2021.

■

428 1.Rd1 Guarding the knight once more. Moving that knight was not an option since that hangs the queen: 1.Ne4 Qxd3. The knight was pinned and moving it meant losing the queen. Defense 25-?, Defence:25 2021. Defense 25-?, Defence: Defense 25 2021.

■

429 1...Qg6 Stopping the helper checkmate on g7. Black remains a lot of material up and should go on to win. Defense 26-?, Defence: Defense 26 2021.

■

430 1.Nf3 Blocking the attack on the f2- pawn, and defending against the attack on the h2 pawn. Defense 27-?, Defence: Defense 27 2021.

■

431 1...Rd8 Stopping both pawns from promoting. Defense 28-?, Defence: Defense 28 2021.

■

432 1.Re1 Using an X-ray defense to prevent the back rank checkmate. 1.Rxd1 Rxd1+ 2.Re1 Rxe1#. Defense 29-?, Defence:

## Defense 29 2021.

■  
433 1...f5 Defending against the helper checkmate on g7, and forking the knight and queen! A multi-purpose move and a good one! Defense 30-?, Defence: Defense 30 2021.

■  
434 1.Bb1 Blocking the skewer and avoiding the loss of the queen. Defense 31-?, Defence: Defense 31 2021.

■  
435 1...Bh6 Preventing checkmate on h8. Notice that the knight on g6 cannot be captures because of the pin. Defense 32-?, Defence: Defense 32 2021.

## **Assorted Checkmates in Two**

■  
436 1...Rh6+ Attacking the h-file. Notice that queen is preventing the king from moving aside so White must block with the queen. 2.Qh4 Rxh4# Checkmate in 2 - #1-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
437 1.Rh8+ Forcing the king to e7 where then the queen will use the c6 pawn as a helper to deliver checkmate. 1...Ke7 2.Qd7# Checkmate in 2 - #2-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

438 1...Qxh2+ Using the queen and bishop battery. 2.Kf1 Qh1# and the pawn on d3 stops the king from escaping. This could be considered a form of back rank checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #3-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

439 1.Rd8+ Forcing the bishop to block, leading to checkmate. 1...Bf8 2.Rxf8# Checkmate in 2 - #4-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

440 1...Qc1+ Notice that the bishop on b8 prevents the king from escaping the back rank. 2.Qxc1 Rxc1# Another form of back rank checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #5-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

441 1.Qxh6+ It's always nice to sacrifice the queen for checkmate! The idea is to open up the rook battery on the 7th rank. 1...gxf6 2.Rh7# Checkmate in 2 - #6-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

442 1...Qxh3+ Picking on the pinned g2 pawn. 2.Kg1 Qxg2# Bishop helper checkmate to finish the game. Checkmate in 2 - #7-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

443 1.Qxf7+ Using the knight on e5 as a helper to capture the pawn safely. 1...Kh8 2.Ng6# Checkmate in 2 - #8-?, xxx 2021.

■

444 1.Bxh7+ Pushing the king to the corner and preparing to bring the rook to the back rank. 1...Kh8 2.Rf8# Checkmate in 2 - #9-?, xxx 2021.

■

445 1.Rxh7+ Using the battery on the 7th rank. 1...Kg8 2.Qf7# Not 2.Qg7+ since the bishop guards that square! 2...Bxg7. Checkmate in 2 - #10-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021

■

446 1.Rxf8+ Clearing the back rank and preparing to bring the other rook down. 1...Kxf8 2.Rd8# and the knight on e7 blocks the king from escaping. Checkmate in 2 - #11-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

447 1.Nxf6+ Removing the guard from h7, and discover attacking with the queen. 1...Bxf6 2.Qxh7# Checkmate in 2 - #12-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

448 1.Qa6+ Kb8 2.Qb7# Queen and pawn helper checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #13-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

449 1.Qh8+ Using the battery to attack the king but also leaving room for the rook to come down next. 1.Qh7+ is not effective since the rook doesn't have a way in. The king escapes: 1...Kf8 2.Qh8+ Ke7. 1...Kf7 2.Rh7# Checkmate in 2 - #14-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

450 1.Qh5+ Using the exposed diagonal toward the king. 1...Ke7 1...Kf8 doesn't change much: 2.Qf7#. 2.Qf7# Knight and queen helper checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #15-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

451 1...Qd1+ A brutal back rank checkmate. Notice that the knight prevents the king from escaping to h2. 2.Rxd1 Rxd1#

■

452 1.Rd8+ Using the battery to attack the king. 1...Kc7 2.Qd6# Rook and queen helper checkmate to finish. Checkmate in 2 - #17-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

453 1...Qxf2+ Using the rook on b2 to take over the 2nd rank. 2.Kh1 Qxg2# Rook and queen battery checkmate to finish. Checkmate in 2 - #18-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

454 1.Rh2+ Forcing the king forward into White's mating net. 1...Kg5 2.Rh5# Black is trapped by White's rook and pawns. Checkmate in 2 - #19-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

455 1...Qxc3+ Using the pin on the b2 pawn. 2.Kb1 Qxb2# Helper checkmate finishes once again! Checkmate in 2 - #20-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

456 1...Rb2+ Using the pawn on c3 as a helper. 2.Ka4 Ra6#  
Finishing with a 'ladder checkmate' with the two rooks.  
Checkmate in 2 - #21-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2:  
Check 2021.

■

457 1.Rxf8+ Making way for the other rook to come to the 8th  
rank. 1...Bxf8 2.Rg8# Knight and rook helper checkmate.  
Checkmate in 2 - #22-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2:  
Check 2021.

■

458 1.Qxg8+ Setting up a knight and rook helper checkmate on  
the back rank. 1...Kxg8 2.Rf8# Checkmate in 2 - #23-?, Beginner  
Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

459 1...Rd2+ Bringing the rook into the attack using the queen's  
help. 2.Kc1 Qxb2# A queen and rook helper checkmate finishes  
the game. Checkmate in 2 - #24-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate  
in 2: Check 2021.

■

460 1.d6+ Attacks the king but also frees the bishop on c4 by  
discovered attack. 1...Ke8 2.Qxf7# A queen and bishop helper  
checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #25-?, Beginner Tactics:  
Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

461 1.Qxh7+ Kf8 2.Qh8# Another form of back rank checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #26-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
462 1.Ne7+ A very clever move unleashing a discovered attack on the h7 pawn. 1...Qxe7 2.Qxh7# Checkmate in 2 - #27-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
463 1...Bxf3+ Taking advantage of the overloaded rook on f1 which is trying to defend the bishop and also the back rank! 2.Rxf3 Rg1# A bishop and rook helper checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #28-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
464 1.Qxf6+ Kd7 2.Nc5# Bringing a new piece into the attack and finishing the game! Checkmate in 2 - #29-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
465 1...Ne2+ Unleashing a queen discovered attack on h2. 2.Bxe2 Qxh2# Checkmate in 2 - #30-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
466 1...Bh3+ Pushing the king to g1 and allowing the rook to come to the 1st rank. 2.Kg1 Re1# Checkmate in 2 - #31-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

467 1.Qxf7+ Kd8 2.Nxe6# The knight attacks the king and also stops it from running to c7. Checkmate in 2 - #32-?, xxx 2021.

■

468 1.Qxh6+ Setting up a 'ladder checkmate' with the two rooks. 1...gxh6 2.Rxh6# Checkmate in 2 - #33-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

469 1.Qg8+ Kh5 2.Qg4# Helper checkmate with the queen and pawn. Checkmate in 2 - #34-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

470 1.Rb8+ Kc7 2.Bf4# Using an X-ray for checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #35-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

471 1...Qxg1+ Removing the guard of the d1-square. 2.Nxg1 Rd1# Checkmate in 2 - #36-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

472 1.Nd6+ Double Check, forcing the king to move! 1...Kd8 2.Qe8# Knight and queen helper checkmate finishes the game. Checkmate in 2 - #37-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

473 1...Nf3+ Double Check! 2.Kd1 Re1# Knight and rook helper checkmate to end the game. Checkmate in 2 - #38-?, Beginner



## Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

474 1...Qf2+ 2.Kd3 Nxe5# A nice checkmate in the middle of the board. Checkmate in 2 - #39-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

475 1.Qxf7+ Rxf7 1...Kh8 doesn't help much: 2.Qxf8#. 2.Re8# Picking on the rook being in a pin. Checkmate in 2 - #40-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

476 1.Rxd8+ Removing the guard of the f7-square. 1...Rxd8 2.Qf7# Pawn and queen helper checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #41-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

477 1.Qf7+ Qxf7 2.exf7# Always nice to checkmate with a pawn! Checkmate in 2 - #42-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

478 1...Nxd3+ 2.Kd1 Bg4# Look at all those pieces at work! Checkmate in 2 - #43-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

479 1.Qf8+ Kh5 2.g4# The king is caught by the pawn! Checkmate in 2 - #44-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
480 1.Qxh7+ To open the h-file. 1...Kxh7 2.Rh5# Checkmate in 2 - #45-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
481 1.Bxf7+ Ke7 2.Nd5# This type of checkmate pattern is called 'Legal's checkmate'. We do not talk about this one in the book, but it would be fun to lookup! Checkmate in 2 - #46-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
482 1...Rxh2+ Opening the h-file 2.Kxh2 Qh4# Checkmate in 2 - #47-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
483 1.Nf6+ Kf8 2.Qh6# and the king is caught by the knight and queen combination. Checkmate in 2 - #48-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
484 1...Qe3+ Using the pin against the knight on d1. 2.Kb1 Rxd1# Back rank checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #49-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■  
485 1.g3+ Ke3 2.Rd3# Black's king is totally trapped by White's pieces. Checkmate in 2 - #50-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

486 1...Rxf1+ Setting up a battery along the 1st rank. 2.Kh2 Rh1# and a battery checkmate finishes the game! Checkmate in 2 - #51-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

487 1.Qh6+ A nice queen sacrifice which leads to a bishop and knight checkmate. 1...Rxh6 2.Bxh6# Checkmate in 2 - #52-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

488 1...Bb5+ Forcing the king forward. 2.Kc5 Qc6# Checkmate in 2 - #53-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

489 1...Qxh2+ Opening the h-file and setting up a 'ladder checkmate' on the g- and h-files. 2.Kxh2 Rh4# Checkmate in 2 - #54-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

490 1.Qf6+ Kg8 2.Ne7# A nice queen and knight checkmate. Checkmate in 2 - #55-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

491 1.Qf8+ Using the pin on the g7 bishop. 1...Rxf8 2.Rxf8# Remember, pinned pieces do not protect! Checkmate in 2 - #56-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

492 1.Bh7+ Kh8 2.Ng6# Checkmate in 2 - #57-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

493 1.g5+ Forcing the king forward. 1...Kh5 2.Rxh7# Checkmate in 2 - #58-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

■

494 1.Qxf8+ Removing the guard of the back rank. 1...Kxf8 2.Rd8# Checkmate in 2 - #59-?, Beginner Tactics: Checkmate in 2: Check 2021.

## Themed Checkmate Patterns

■

495 1...Qxh2+ Sacrificing the queen to allow the rook to come to g1 for an Arabian checkmate. 2.Rxh2 Rg1# Arabian Checkmate 1-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

496 1.Qxh7+ Rxh7 2.Rxh7# Arabian Checkmate 2-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

497 1...Qxh3+ 2.gxh3 Rh2#Arabian Checkmate 3-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

498 1...Rxg3+ 2.Kh2 Nf3+ 3.Kh1 Rg1#

■

499 1.Rxh7+ Rxh7 2.Qg8+ Rxg8 3.Rxg8#

■  
500 1...Qxh2+ 2.Kxh2 Rh4# Anastasia's Checkmate 1-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
501 1.Qxh7+ Kxh7 2.Rh5#.

■  
502 1...Qh5+ 2.gxh5 Rh4# Anastasia's Checkmate 3-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
503 1.Ne7+ Kh8 2.Rxh7+ Kxh7 3.Rh1#

■  
504 1.Ne7+ Kh8 2.Qxh7+ Kxh7 3.Rh4# Anastasia's Checkmate 5-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
505 1.Rh7+ Kg8 2.Rcg7#Blind Swine Checkmate 1-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
506 1.Rexe7+ Kd8 2.Rbd7#

■  
507 1.Rxg7+ Kh8 2.Rxh7+ Kg8 3.Rag7#21.

■

508 1.Rg7+ Kh8 2.Rxh7+ Kg8 3.Rbg7# Blind Swine Checkmate 4-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

509 1.Qxg7+ Rxg7 2.Rgxg7+ Kh8 3.Rxh7+ Kg8 4.Rbg7# 2021.

■

510 1.Qxc6+ bxc6 2.Ba6# Boden's Checkmate 1-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

511 1.Qxe6+ fxe6 1.Bg6#2021.

■

512 1.Qf6+ gxf6 2.Bh6#.

■

513 1.Qc6+ bxc6 2.Ba6#

■

514 1.Qe6+ Nd7 2.Qc6+ bxc6 3.Ba6#

■

515 1.Qh1+ Kg8 2.Qh7#.

■

516 1.Bg1+ Kg8 2.Qh7# 1.

■

517 1.Rh8+ Kxh8 2.Qh1+ Kg8 3.Qh7#

■

518 1.Rh8+ Kxh8 2.Qh4+ Kg8 3.Qh7#

■

519 1.Rh1+ Kg8 2.Rh8+ Kxh8 3.Qh1+ Kg8 4.Qh7# : 2021.

■

520 1.Qf6#

■

521 1...Qb4# Dovetail Checkmate 2-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

522 1.Qh6+ Ke7 2.Qd6# Dovetail Checkmate 3-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

523 1.Qxd8+ Kg7 2.Qh8# Dovetail Checkmate 4-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

524 1...Qf5+ 2.Kxd4 Qe5# Dovetail Checkmate 5-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

525 1.Qd7#

■  
526 1.Qf8+ Kh7 2.Qf7#

■  
527 1.Qxg6+ fxg6 2.Rg7#

■  
528 1.Rh6+ gxf6 2.Qf7#

■  
529 1.Rf8+ Qxf8 2.Rxf8+ 2.Qxg6+ does not work since the queen can block: 2...Qg7. 2...Rxf8 3.Qxg6#

■  
530 1...Qxh4#

■  
531 1.Ng6+ hxg6 2.Rh4#

■  
532 1...Ng3+ 2.hxg3 Qh3#

■  
533 1...Rxf2+ 2.Kxf2 Qh4#

■  
534 1...Qxf2+ 2.Kh1 Qh4#

■



535 1...Re1+ 2.Rf1 Rxf1# Kill Box Checkmate 1-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Kill Box 1 ( 2021.

■

536 1...Rxb3+ 2.cxb3 Rc1#

■

537 1.Qf6+ Kh7 2.Rh8#

■

538 1.Qc6+ Kxa7 2.Ra1+ Kb8 3.Ra8# Or 3.Qa8#. Kill Box Checkmate 4-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Kill Box 4 2021.

■

539 1...Qh3+ 2.Kg1 Ne2+ 3.Rxe2 Rxf1# Example of a Fianchetto-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Fianchetto 2021.

■

540 1...Qa3+ 2.Kb1 Qb2# 1.

■

541 1...Rxb2+ 2.Bxb2 Qg2# Lolli's Checkmate 2-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Lolli's Chec 2021.

■

542 1...Ra1+ 2.Kxa1 Qa3+ 3.Kb1 Qb2#

■

543 1.Nf6+ Rxf6 1...Kh8 leads to checkmate even faster! 2.Qxh7#. 2.exf6 Qe8 3.Qg7# Lolli's Checkmate 4-?, Checkmates:

By Theme Pt 2: Lolli's Chec 2021.

■

544 1.Qh6 Qf8 2.Re8 Qxe8 3.Qg7#

■

545 1.Rd8#

■

546 1.Qb8+ Nxb8 2.Rd8# Opera House Checkmate 2-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

547 1.Rb8+ Nxb8 2.Rxb8#Checkmate 3-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

548 1...Qd1+ 2.Bxd1 Rxd1#

■

549 1...Bd3+ 2.Ke1 Rf1# Opera House Checkmate 5-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■

550 1...Rg1+ 2.Kxg1 Rg8#

■

551 1...Rg1+ 2.Kxg1 Rg8# Pillsbury's Checkmate 2-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
552 1...Bg2+ 2.Kg1 Bxf3#

■  
553 1.Rxg7+ Kh8 2.Rg8+ Kxg8 3.Rg1#

■  
554 1...Qxg2+ 2.Nxg2 Rxg2+ 3.Kh1 Rg1+ 4.Kxg1 Rg8#  
Pillsbury's Checkmate 5-?, Intermediate Checkmates Patterns  
Pt 1: 2021.

■  
555 1...Qg1+ 2.Rxg1 Nf2#

■  
556 1.Qxh7+ Qxh7 2.Nf7# 1.

■  
557 1...Qe1+ 2.Nxe1 Nf2# Smothered Checkmate 3-?,  
Intermediate Checkmates Patterns Pt 1: 2021.

■  
558 1...Nh3+ 2.Kh1 Qg1+ 3.Rxg1 Nf2#

■  
559 1...Nb3+ 27.Kb1 Qc1+ 2.Rxc1 Ncd2#

■

560 1.Rd7# Vukovic's Checkmate 1-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Vukovic Chec 2021.

■

561 1...Ng3+ 2.Kg1 Rg2# Vukovic's Checkmate 2-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Vukovic Chec 2021.

■

562 1.Ne6+ Ke8 2.Re7#

■

563 1.Rxh7+ Kg8 2.Nxf6+ Kf8 3.Rf7# Vukovic's Checkmate 4-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Vukovic Chec 2021.

■

564 1.Rc7+ Ka8 2.Nb6+ Kb8 3.Rb7# Vukovic's Checkmate 5-?, Checkmates: B Theme Pt 2: Vukovic Chec 2021.Vukovic's Checkmate 5-?, Checkmates: By Theme Pt 2: Vukovic Chec 2021.

## Combinations Setting Up Tactics

■

565 1...exf3+ Opens up the queens path along the 4th rank. 2.Nxf3 2.gxf3 leads to the same type of thing. 2...Qc4+ 3.Kf2 Qxd5. 2...Qc4+ Forking the unprotected knight on d5 and the king. 3.d3 Qxd5 Black wins a knight and should go on to win the game. Combination 1-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

566 1.b4 Qa3 2.Rb3 and the queen is trapped. Combination 2-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

567 1.e5 with a discovered attack on the c6 knight as well as an attack on the pinned f6 knight. 1...dxe5 1...Nxe5 also fails since the rook on a8 is unprotected. 2.Qxa8. 2.Qxc6+ White wins a piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 3-?, Combo's Pt 1: Discovered Attack 2021.

■

568 1...Rd1+ Forcing the bishop into a pin. 2.Bf1 Bh3 Attacking the pinned piece. White is in big trouble as Black is threatening ...Rxf1#.

■

569 1...Rh8 2.Qg7 Rag8 and the queen is trapped. Combination 5-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

570 1...Rd4+ an important in-between move, preparing Rxe6. 1...Rxe6 does not work since 2.fxe6 attacks the rook on d7 so Black does not have time to take the rook on g8. 2...Kxg8 3.exd7. 2.Kg3 Rxe6 3.fxe6 Kxg8 Black is a rook up in the endgame and should go on to win. Combination 6-?, Combo's Pt 1: RTG + In-Between 2021.

■

571 1...Qxf2+ Setting up a double check on the f-file. 1...Ng4 doesn't work since the knight was stopping checkmate. 2.Qh7#. 2.Kxf2 Ng4+ Double check and forking the king and queen. 3.Kg2 Nxh6 Black won a rook and should go on to win the

game. Combination 7-?, Combo's Pt 1: Decoy + Fork + Double Che 2021.

■  
572 1.Ng5+ Forcing the king to the f-file. 1...Kf6 2.Qf7+ Skewering the king and queen. 2...Kxg5 3.Qxf1 White is up material and should go on to win from here. Combination 8-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer 2021.

■  
573 1.e4 With a discovered attack on the queen. 1...Qd8 2.e5 Forking the bishop and knight. White wins a minor piece and should go on to win. Combination 9-?, xxx 2021.

■  
574 1.Qe8+ Forcing the king to the f-file. 1...Kf5 2.Qxf7+ Skewering the king and queen. 2...Kxg5 3.Qxf1 White is up a queen for a pawn and should go on to win the game.

■  
575 1.Qxf6+ Attracting the king to the f6-square to set up a fork. 1...Kxf6 2.Ne4+ forking the king and queen. 2...Kg7 3.Nxc5 White wins a piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 11-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■  
576 1...Re2+ Forcing the king to move into a discovered attack. 2.Kf1 Rxa2+ Discovered check on the king and attacking the rook on a1. 3.bxc4 Rxa1 Black has won the exchange and should go on to win the game. Combination 12-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

-

577 1...Bxe2 Exchanging bishops to bring the rook to the e-file. 2.Rxe2 Bc1+ Sacrificing the bishop to win the rook on e2. 3.Kxc1 Rxe2 Black is up the exchange and should go on to win the endgame. Combination 13-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

578 1.Rxa8 Trading to lure the queen away from the c7-square. 1...Qxa8 2.Nc7+ Forking the king and queen. 2...Kd7 3.Nxa8 White is up material and should go on to win the game. Combination 14-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

579 1.Qxd8+ Forcing the rook to move away from g8. 1...Rxd8 Now White's g-pawn is no longer pinned. 2.gxf3 White is up a piece and should go on to win the game from here. Combination 15-?, Combo's Pt 1: Decoy 2021.

■

580 1.Nxd6 Forcing the king to d6. 1...Kxd6 2.Bf4+ Skewering the king and rook. Notice that the knight on d5 cannot capture since it's in a pin. 2...Kd7 3.Bxb8 White wins the exchange and should go on to win the game. Combination 16-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

581 1...Nf3+ Forking the king and queen while using the pin on the d-file. 2.Bxf3 Qxd2 Black wins the queen for a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 17-?, Combo's Pt 1: Pin + Fork 2021.

■

582 1...Qxc3 Removing the guard of c2. 2.bxc3 Nc2+ Forking the king and rook. 3.Kd1 Nxa1 Black is up a rook and should go on to win the game. Combination 18-?, Combo's Pt 1: RTG + Fork 2021.

■

583 1.Qh5+ Setting up a discovered attack on the queen. 1...g6 1...Ke6 2.Nd4+ with the same idea.. 2.Nd6+ Sacrificing the knight to win the queen on a5. 2...cxd6 3.Qxa5 White has a big material advantage and should go on to win. Combination 19-?, Combo's Pt 1: Discovered Attack 2021.

■

584 1...b4+ 2.Kb2 Na4+ 2...Nxd1+ allows the king to escape. 3.Kc1 Qb2+ 4.Kxd1. 3.Kb1 3.Kc1 Qb2#. 3...Qb2# Combination 20-?, Combo's Pt 1: Double Check 2021.

■

585 1...Bxa3 1...Qa5+ does not work since White would play. 2.Qd2 counterattacking the queen.. 2.Nxa3 Qa5+ Forking the knight and king. 3.Qd2 Qxa3 Black is a piece up and should go on to win the game. Combination 21-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

586 1...Bb6 Pinning the knight to the king. 2.Rc1 Defending the knight. 2...Rc8 Attacking the pinned piece. White cannot defend the knight again and will lose it on the next turn. Combination 22-?, Combo's Pt 1: Pin + Attacking Pinned Pi 2021.

■

587 1...Bxe3 Trading bishops but clearing the way for the b-pawn. 2.Qxe3 b5 Forking the knight and bishop. Black will win a



minor piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 23-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

588 1...Nxc6 Sacrificing the knight but clearing the way for the rook. 2.bxc6 Rf8+ Skewering the king and rook. 3.Ke5 Rxf1 Black is up a rook and should go on to win without much trouble. Combination 24-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer 2021.

■

589 1...Bxc3+ Removing the guard of the d5-pawn. 2.bxc3 Bxd5 Skewering the queen and rook. 3.Qf2 Bxh1 Black wins a rook and should go on to win the game. Combination 25-?, Combo's Pt 1: RTG+Skewer 2021.

■

590 1.Bg5 Forcing the queen to g4. 1...Qg4 2.Be2 The queen is trapped. Combination 26-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

591 1.Nb6+ Forcing the king into a discovered check. 1...Kxa7 2.Nc8+ Double check and fork to the king and queen. 2...Kb8 3.Nxe7 White is up material and should go on to win from here. Combination 27-?, Combo's Pt 1: Double Check 2021.

■

592 1...Rxf4 An attraction tactic luring the king to a square and setting up a fork. 2.Kxf4 Nh3+ Forking the king and rook. 3.Ke4 Nxg1 Black finishes ahead a knight and should win the game. Combination 28-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

593 1...Rf6 Forcing the bishop to h5. 2.Bh5 Rh6 Trapping the bishop. Combination 29-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

594 1.Nxd4 Qxd4 2.Bb5+ Winning the queen by discovery. Combination 30-?, Combo's Pt 1: Discovery 2021.

■

595 1.Qxe6+ Forcing the king to capture. 1...Kxe6 2.Re1+ Skewering the king and rook. 2...Kf6 3.Rexe7 White is up a rook and should go on to win the game without much trouble. 3.Rhxe7 is also good. Combination 31-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer 2021.

■

596 1...Nxb5 1...Qa5+ does not work since White can save the knight and block the check with 2.Nc3. 2.Bxb5 Qa5+ Forking the king and bishop. 3.c3 Qxb5 Black has won a piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 32-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

597 1.Re8 A great move! White allows Black to promote but then will skewer the king and the queen. 1.Re7 does not work since 1...Kf6 prevents the skewer. 1...f1Q 2.Rf8+ Skewering the king and queen. 2...Ke4 3.Rxf1 White stopped the pawn from promoting and should go on to win without much trouble. Combination 33-?, Combo's Pt 1: Defence + Skewer 2021.

■

598 1...e2+ Forcing the king to e1. 2.Ke1 Rg1+ Skewering the king and rook. 3.Kxe2 Rxa1 Combination 34-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer 2021.

■

599 1.e6+ Trying to lure the king away from the rook. 1...Kf8 Keeping guard of the rook. 2.e7+ Please take! 2...Kf7 Keeping guard. 3.Rxg8 The king is overloaded. Black cannot stop promotion and recapture the rook. Combination 35-?, Combo's Pt 1: Decoy 2021.

■

600 1.Nc6 Forcing the queen to e8. 1...Qe8 2.Nc7 Trapping the queen. Combination 36-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

601 1.Qxd5 Temporarily sacrificing the queen to set up a fork. 1...Qxd5 2.Nxc7+ Forking the king and queen. 2...Kf8 3.Nxd5 White wins the queen back and is up a piece. White should go on to win the game. Combination 37-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

602 1.Ne4 Forcing the queen to b4. 1...Qb4 2.Ra4 Trapping the queen. Combination 38-?, Combo's Pt 1: Trapping 2021.

■

603 1...Qa5+ Forking the king and bishop. 2.Nc3 Defending against the fork. 2...Bxc3+ Removing the guard of the bishop. 3.bxc3 Qxb5 Black wins a minor piece and should go on to win the game. Combination 39-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork then RTG 2021.

■

604 1.Qxg7+ Forcing the king to the same diagonal as the bishop on b2. 1...Kxg7 2.Rxe3 Taking advantage of the pinned

pawn on d4. Combination 40-?, Combo's Pt 1: Pin 2021.

■

605 1.Qxh6+ Taking advantage of the pinned g7-pawn and the unprotected knight on f4. 1...Kg8 2.Qxf4 White wins a minor piece and should go on to win. Combination 41-?, Combo's Pt 1: Pin + Fork 2021.

■

606 1.Qd8+ This in-between move allows White to capture the bishop on d3 with check. That avoids Black's threat on g2. 1.Qxd3 fails to 1...Rxc2+. 1...Kh7 2.Qxd3+ White captures the bishop with check and goes up two minor pieces! Combination 42-?, Combo's Pt 1: In-Between Move 2021.

■

607 1.Qxf8+ Forcing the king to the a3-f8 diagonal. 1...Kxf8 2.Ba3+ Checking the king while discovered attacking the queen. 2...Kg8 3.Rxd1 White won a minor piece with that tactic and should go on to win from here.

■

608 1.Nxc6+ A very strong in-between move which allows White to capture Black's queen with check. 1.Qxf4 is not a free queen since Black can play 1...Bh6. 1...fxg6 2.Qxf4+ Now White captures the queen with check avoiding the pin on h6. Combination 44-?, Combo's Pt 1: In-Between+Fork 2021.

■

609 1...Bxc2+ Attracting the king to the g2-square. 2.Kxc2 Forking the king and queen. 2...Nf4+ 3.Kf1 Nxd3 Black is up a significant amount of material and should go on to win without

much trouble. Combination 45-?, Combo's Pt 1: Decoy + Fork 2021.

■

610 1.Rh7+ A nice attraction sacrifice, forcing the king to capture or retreat to a square where the king and queen will be forked. 1...Kxh7 1...Kg8 2.Nxf6# is much worse! 2.Nxf6+ Kg7 3.Nxd5 White is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win the game from here. Combination 46-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork + Decoy 2021.

■

611 1...Rb3+ Forcing the king into the diagonal of the bishop. 2.Ka2 Rc3+ The discovered check wins the rook on c1 and along with it the game. 3.b3 Rxc1 Black is up the exchange and two pawns and should go on to win the game. Combination 47-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

612 1.Qb8+ Setting up a discovery on the queen. 1...Bf8 2.Bxf7+ Winning the unprotected queen on b2. 2...Kxf7 3.Qxb2 White is up a large amount of material and should go on to win from here. Combination 48-?, Combo's Pt 1: Discovered Attack 2021.

■

613 1...h4+ Attempting to decoy the king away from the rook. 2.Kf3 Keeping guard of the rook. 2...e4+ Another decoy, but this time White must take. 3.Kxe4 Rxf2 Black wins the rook and has two rooks and a bishop for the queen. Black should go on to win from here. Combination 49-?, Combo's Pt 1: Double Decoy 2021.

■

614 1.Be3+ Skewering the king and rook. 1...Bf4 Blocking the skewer. 2.Bxf4+ Taking advantage of the overloaded king. Black cannot defend the rook on h6 any longer. 2...Kxf4 3.Rxh6 White is up a rook and should go on to win the game. Combination 50-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer + Overload 2021.

■

615 1...Rxg2+ A nice attraction tactic which sets up a fork on the next turn. 2.Kxg2 Ne3+ The whole point! Black gets the rook back but wins a knight in the process. 3.Kg1 Nxc2 Black is up a knight and should go on to win the endgame. Combination 51-?, Combo's Pt 1: Fork 2021.

■

616 1...Qe1+ The rook on g8 is staring at the queen. Set up a discovered attack which wins the queen. Forcing the king to the open diagonal. 2.Kh2 Be5+ With a check to the king and a discovered attack on the queen. 3.f4 Rxg4 Black is up a queen for a rook but more importantly has a big attack on White's king. Black should win from here. Combination 52-?, Combo's Pt 1: Discovery 2021.

■

617 1.Rxa6 Taking advantage of the pinned b7-pawn. Notice the weak back rank. 1...bxa6 2.Rb8+ The whole point of the exchange sacrifice. White skewers Black's king and rook. 2...Ke7 3.Rxh8 White is up a bishop for only two pawns and should win this endgame. Combination 53-?, Combo's Pt 1: Skewer 2021.

■

618 1.Rxe6 Removing the guard of the knight on d5. 1...Qxe6 2.Bxd5 The correct capture which wins the queen for a bishop!

White should go on to win from here. 2.Qxd5 is not the same as this only leads to a queen trade where Black would be up a pawn! Combination 54-?, Combo's Pt 1: Removing the Guard + Pin 2021.

■

619 1.Rg8+ An attraction (decoy) tactic which sets up a fork on the next move. 1...Kxg8 1...Kh7 2.Nf6# is even worse! 2.Nf6+ The point of the tactic. White wins the queen. 2...Kg7 3.Nxd7 White should go on to win the endgame from here. Combination 55-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

620 1.Bb5 Qxb5 2.Nc7+ Kd7 3.Nxb5 Combination 56-?, Combo's Pt 1: Decoy + Pin + Fork 2021.

■

621 1.a7 Re8 2.Bb8.

■

622 1...Rxe1 Removing the guard of the knight on c3. 2.Rxe1 Bxc3+ The point - forking the rook and king in the end. 3.Kb1 Bxe1 Black is up a bishop in the endgame and should go on to win from here. Combination 58-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

623 1.Rxd4 Winning a bishop by setting up a pin. 1...Rxd4 Forcing the rook to a bad square. 2.Bc3 The whole point, pinning the rook to the king. 2...Kg8 3.Bxd4 White is up a bishop and should win the endgame without much trouble. Combination 59-?, Combo's Pt 2: In-Between+Pin 2021.

■

624 1...Rxd4 Luring the queen to the d4-square. 2.Qxd4 Bc5 Pinning the queen and king along the diagonal. Black will win the queen and should win the game. Combination 60-?, Combo's Pt 2: Pin 2021.

■

625 1.Qf6 Threatening helper checkmate on g7 and the unprotected bishop on d6. 1...g6 Preventing checkmate. 2.Qxd6 White wins the bishop and is up a knight and should go on to win from here. Combination 61-?, Combo's Pt 2: Fork+Pin 2021.

■

626 1...Rb1+ Forcing the king to h2. 2.Kh2 Be5+ 3.g3 Bxc7 Black wins a rook and should go on to win the game. Combination 62-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

627 1.Be5+ Sacrificing the bishop to open up the rook on d1. 1.Bb6+ doesn't work since 1...Qxb6 keeps the king from being overloaded.. 1...fxe5 Now the king is overloaded, trying to guard the queen and the rook. 2.Qxc6+ Drawing the king away from the rook. 2...Kxc6 3.Rxd8 White wins the exchange and should go on to win the game from here. Combination 63-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Discovered A 2021.

■

628 1...Qd7 Pinning the knight on c6. Black will recapture on the next turn and keep everything protected. Defense! 1...bxc6 would not be good for Black as they would lose a pawn and the king would be under heavy attack: 2.Qxc6+. Combination 64-?, Combo's Pt 2: Defence+Pin 2021.



■

629 1.Qxf7 Trading queens and clearing the way for the g1-rook. 1...Rxf7 2.Rg8+ Kd7 3.Rxb8 White wins a rook and should go on to win the game from here. Combination 65-?, Combo's Pt 1: Example 1: 2021.

■

630 1.Qxg7+ Attracting the king to the open diagonal. 1...Kxg7 2.Bc3+ Checking the king and attacking the queen by discovery. 2...Kg8 3.Rxa2 White is up a bishop and should go on to win from here. Combination 66-?, Combo's Pt 2: Discovered Attack 2021.

■

631 1...Nxd4 Luring the rook away from the back rank. 2.Rxd4 Rc1+ Forking the queen and king. Combination 79-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

■

632 1...Rxd1+ 2.Qxd1 2.Rxd1 Bxb5 once again takes advantage of the overloaded queen. 2...Qxd1+ Trading queens so that it's safe to win the bishop on b5. 3.Rxd1 Bxb5 Black has won a minor piece and should go on to win. Combination 68-?, Combo's Pt 2: In-Between 2021.

■

633 1.Rxc7 Rxc7 2.Rxc7 and the queen is overloaded. White is up a minor piece and should win the game from here. Combination 69-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded 2021.

■

634 1.Rxf6 Winning the bishop due to a nasty pin being set up. 1...Qxf6 2.Bg5 The point of White's first move. Pinning the queen to the king. Combination 70-?, Combo's Pt 2: Pin 2021.

■

635 1...Rxc2+ Forcing the king to a light square. 2.Kxc2 Bf1+ Using a discovery to win the queen on a5. 3.Rhxf1 Qxa5 Black is up a queen for a rook and should go on to win the game. Combination 71-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

■

636 1...Rxb7 2.Nxb7 Re7 Skewering the knight and bishop. 3.Nc5 3.Be3 Rxb7 and Black wins the knight. 3...Rxa7 Black wins the bishop and should go on to win the game from here. Combination 72-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

■

637 1...Qxc2+ Creating a path back to help the trapped rook! 2.Nd2 Qh7 The queen comes back to help! Combination 73-?, Combo's Pt 2: Defence 2021.

■

638 1...Rxe3 Attracting the queen to the e3-square. 2.Qxe3 Bc5 The point of the tactic. Black wins the queen and should go on to win the game. Combination 74-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

■

639 1...Rxd2 Drawing the queen away from the protection of the knight. 2.Qxd2 Qb5+ Forking the king and knight. 3.Ke1 Qxa4 Black is up a bishop and should go on to win from here. Combination 75-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

■

640 1...Qxg2+ Attracting the king to the g-file where Black has a discovered check awaiting! 1...Bxe5+ doesn't work since White recaptures with check: 2.Qxe5+. 2.Kxg2 Bxe5+ The whole point. Now Black captures the bishop with discovered check and will win the queen back. 3.Kf1 Bxd6 Black won a bishop and should go on to win the game. Combination 76-?, Combo's Pt 2: Discovery 2021.

■

641 1...e5 2.Nc2 e4 Combination 77-?, Combo's Pt 2: Trapping 2021.

■

642 1.Rxe6 Removing the guard of the fork on d7. 1...fxe6 2.Nd7+ Forking the king and rook. 2...Ke7 3.Nxb8 White is up a knight and should go on to win from here. Combination 78-?, Combo's Pt 2: RTG 2021.

■

643 1...Rxd1+ Forcing the queen away from the pawn on h4. 2.Qxd1 Qxh4+ Winning a pawn and more importantly the undefended rook on e7. 3.Kg1 Qxe7 Black is up the exchange and should go on to win from here.

■

644 1.Qxc7+ Forcing the king to a bad square. 1...Kxc7 2.Ba5+ Skewering the king and rook. 2...Kc8 3.Bxd8 Kxd8 White is up the exchange in the endgame and should go on to win. Combination 80-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021. Combination 80-?, Combo's Pt 2: Overloaded + Fork 2021.

## Finish like the World Champions

■  
645 21.Rh8+ Luring the king away from the protection of the queen. 21...Kxh8 22.Qxf7 Steinitz won the queen and later the game. Steinitz-Mongredien, London Match 1863.

■  
646 32...Rxh2+ 33.Kg1 Rdg2# Finishing with the blind swine checkmate, seen earlier in the book. 0-1 Chigorin-Steinitz, World Championship Match 1892 (23).

■  
647 25.Qg5+ Kf7 26.Qxg7# 1-0 Steinitz-Meitner, Vienna 1860.

■  
648 16.Nxd6+ A nice discovery which opens up the queen for a helper checkmate. 16...Qxd6 16...cxd6 17.Qb7# doesn't change much. 17.Qb7# 1-0 Lasker-Gibbons, London simul 1900.

■  
649 31...Qh3+ 32.Kg1 Ne2# 0-1 Raubitschek-Lasker, Trenton Falls 1906.

■  
650 24.Qxe4+ Using the X-ray of the bishop on g6 to create a checkmate. 24...fxe4 25.Bxe4# 1-0 Lasker-Beramje, New York simul 1892.

■

651 21.Qf5+ Qxf5 22.exf5# Checkmate with a pawn! Always cool. 1-0 Capablanca-Rosenthal, New York Rapid-transit match 1909.

■

652 13.Qg5+ Kh8 14.Qf6# 1-0 Capablanca-NN, New York 1918.

■

653 14.Bg6+ A very important move. Other discovered checks allow the king to escape to f7. Here, the bishop controls the very important f7-square and does not allow the king to escape. 14...Kg8 15.Qh7# 1-0 Capablanca-Hoffman, Providence simul 1922.

■

654 27.Qxh7+ Kxh7 28.Rh4# A classic Anastasia's checkmate. 1-0 Alekhine-Leonhardt, Hamburg 1910.

■

655 22.Rf8+ Deflecting the rook away from the defense of the queen. 22...Rxf8 23.Qxe4 Alekhine was up material and went on to win from here. Alekhine-Tselikov, Moscow 1915.

■

656 24.Re8 Pinning and Deflecting the queen away from the defense of the g7- square. 24...Qxe8 25.Qg7# 1-0 Alekhine-Frieman, New York blindfold simul.

■

657 26.Qxh8+ Grabbing a rook before capturing the queen. Sometimes this is known as a 'desperado'. 26.Bxg5 Rxh3 is just

a trade. 26...Kxh8 27.Bxg5 Euwe was up an exchange and a pawn and went on to win. Euwe-Palmer, Hastings 1919.

■

658 19.Ng6+ Forcing the h-file open. 19...hxg6 20.Rh4# White wins by checkmate. Max Euwe-Wiersma, Amsterdam 1920/21.

■

659 23.Qxf7+ Kd7 24.Bg4# 1-0 Euwe-Graves, Amsterdam 1919/20.

■

660 23.Qh6+ Using the pin against the rook on f6. 23...Bh7 24.Qxh7# 1-0 Botvinnik-Timofeev, Leningrad 1924.

■

661 28.Rg8+ Deflecting the queen away from the defense of the e7-square. 28...Qxg8 28...Kd7 29.Qd8#. 29.Qe7# 1-0 Botvinnik-Muchin, Leningrad 1926.

■

662 28...Nf3+ 29.Kf1 29.Kh1 Nxf2# is another checkmate. 29...Ned2# 0-1 Dubinin-Botvinnik, Leningrad ch-URS 1939.

■

663 21.Qxd7+ Winning a rook and setting up the discovered check from the rook on d1. 21.Bxb8 Rxc6 is just a trade.. 21...Kxd7 22.Bxb8+ Smyslov won a bishop and went on to win the game, Smyslov-Kottbauer, Groningen 1946.

■

664 28.Qxg7+ Setting up the fork on the next turn. 28...Kxg7 29.Nh5+ Winning the queen back and defending against the threat on h2. After capturing the queen, Smyslov was up the exchange and two pawns and went on to win, Smyslov-Lutikov, Leningrad ch-URS 1960.

■

665 27...Bg3+ 28.Ke3 Bxe1 White loses a minor piece since the queen is overloaded. Byrne could not capture the bishop and keep the guard of g2, 0-1 D.Byrne-Smyslov, Lugano Olympiad Final-A 1968.

■

666 29...Bf1+ Winning the unprotected queen on h5. 30.Rxf1 Qxh5 0-1 Neibults-Tal, Riga ch-LAT 1954.

■

667 17.Qxd7+ Winning a knight by setting up a fork. 17...Kxd7 18.Nc5+ Tal won the queen back and went on to win the game, Tal-Tringov, Munich Olympiad Final-A 1958.

■

668 28.Qb8+ Kh7 28...Ne8 29.Qxe8+ also wins. 29.Qb1+ Forking the king and rook. White is winning, 1-0 Tal-Bannik, Yerevan ch-URS 1962.

■

669 20...Rxc4 Temporarily sacrificing the exchange to set up a Skewer. 21.Qxc4 Bd5 Petrosian would win the rook back and be up a piece! 0-1 Tal-Petrosian, Willemstad Candidates 1962.

■

670 30.Qh8+ A gorgeous attraction tactic which wins material. 30...Kxh8 31.Nxf7+ Winning the rook and the queen on the next turn, 1-0 Petrosian-Spassky, Moscow World Championship Match 1966 (10).

■

671 24.Bxc5 A simple trade which leaves the bishop on c3 unprotected. 24...Nxc5 25.Qxc3 1-0 Petrosian-Anastasopoulos, Varna Olympiad qual-A 1962.

■

672 23...Bc4+ Clearing the way for the rook on e8. 24.Qxc4 24.Be2 Bxe2#. 24...Re1# 0-1 Kuznetsov-Spassky, Kislovodsk 1960.

■

673 21...Rxd2+ Forcing the king to a bad square. 22.Kxd2 Qa5+ Spassky would win the bishop on the next turn, 0-1 Korelov-Spassky, Leningrad 1961.

■

674 29...Qxe1+ 30.Qxe1 Rxe1# 0-1 Lein-Spassky, Sochi 1964.

■

675 33.Qxh7+ To open the h-file. 33...Kxh7 34.Rh3# A nice checkmate by Fischer! 1-0 Fischer-Pilnik, Santiago 1959.

■

676 23.Nxe7+ Qxe7 24.Qd5+ Forking the king and rook. 1-0 Fischer-Gadia, Mar del Plata 1960.

■



677 40...Nc3+ 41.Kc1 Rc2# 0-1 D.Byrne-Fischer, New York 1956.

■

678 28.Nxe6+ Forking the king and queen, while opening up the 7th rank. 28...fxe6 28...Ke8 29.Nxg5. 29.Qxd7# 1-0 Karpov-Uddenfeldt, Skopje Olympiad 1972.

■

679 34.Qh8+ Ke7 35.Qd8# 1-0 Karpov-Sosonko, Brussels blitz 1987.

■

680 19.Qc3 and Kortchnoi resigned. Karpov is threatening a battery checkmate on g7 and once it's stopped, Nxc5 will trap Kortchnoi's queen, 1-0 Karpov-Kortchnoi, Odessa rapid 2008.

■

681 30...Rxb2 Removing the guard of the d4-pawn and putting the queen in a bad position. 31.Qxb2 Bxd4+ Winning the queen, 0-1 Fedoruk-Kasparov, Baku Team Tournament 1978.

■

682 25.Rxg6 Deflecting the queen away from the defense of h8. 25...Qxg6 26.Qh8# 1-0 Kasparov-Dür, Graz World Championship Teams U26 1981.

■

683 25...Ne2+ Saves the knight from capture. 25...exf3 26.Qxf4 is just a trade. 26.Kh1 exf3 0-1 Ehlvest-Kasparov, Reykjavik World Cup 1988.

■

684 31.Qxh7+ Deflecting the knight away from the defense of g8. 31...Nxb7 32.Rg8# 1-0 Kramnik-Rashkovsky, ch-URS 1991.

■

685 36.Qh3+ Kg6 36...Qh5 37.Qxh5# doesn't change much. 37.Qf5# 1-0 Kramnik- Lautier, Cannes Match 1993.

■

686 28...Qa2+ Forcing the rook on b2 out of the way of the rook on b8. 29.Rxa2 Rb1# 0-1 Gelfand-Kramnik, Berlin European Club Cup 1996.

■

687 31...Nf3+ 0-1 Gil Capape-Anand, Gausdal World Championship U20.

■

688 31.Rxe6 Rxe6 32.Qd7+ Winning the rook on c8. 1-0 Anand-Speelman, Geneve rapid 1996.

■

689 33.gxf7+ Double Check. 33...Kxf7 34.Qg6# 1-0 Anand-Chernin, Eupen European Club Cup 1999.

■

690 22...Rfd8 Skewering the queen and rook. 23.Qxc5 Rxd1+ A fine in-between move which wins the rook for nothing. Carlsen would capture the queen back on the next turn and win the game. 0-1 Haugsrud-Carlsen, Norway Championship Group Junior 2001.

■

691 22.Rxe6 Picking on the overloaded rook on e8. 22...Rxe6 23.Qf8# 1-0 Carlsen-Nikolic, Wijk aan Zee 2005.

■

692 23.Rxf7+ Setting up a fork! 23...Kxf7 24.Nxe5+ Very nice by World Champion Carlsen! 1-0 Carlsen-Greiff, Dos Hermanas Qualifier.

# 1

## Chess Coach Peter Giannatos created *Everyone's First Chess Workbook* for his students

Working on chess tactics and checkmates will help you win more games. It develops your pattern recognition and your 'board vision' – your ability to capitalize on opportunities.

This Workbook features a complete set of fundamental tactics, checkmate patterns, exercises, hints, and solutions. Peter Giannatos selected 738 exercises based on ten years of experience with thousands of pupils at the prize-winning Charlotte Chess Center. All problems are clean, without unnecessary fluff that detracts from their instructive value.

The Workbook has ample room for writing down the solutions to the exercises. This is helpful for both students and coaches, who can assign homework from the book without having to worry about being unable to review the solutions. And writing down the correct chess moves will greatly accelerate your learning process.

*Everyone's First Chess Workbook* offers you a treasure trove of chess knowledge and more than enough lessons to keep you busy for a year!

**PETER GIANNATOS** is the founder and executive director of the Charlotte Chess Center & Scholastic Academy, in Charlotte, North Carolina, USA. Peter has been teaching and organizing chess for more than 10 years. As a teenager, he boosted his chess rating from 589 to over 2000 USCF in less than four years. Since then, Peter has achieved both the FIDE Master title and the US Chess National Master title. He now spends most of his time teaching his students the same techniques he used to rapidly improve.

**NEW IN CHESS**  
www.newinchess.com

Games/Chess  
\$24.95

